

A PROMISE TO MOM · DEEP BUYER RESEARCH

Home Care Industry — Deep Buyer Research: the Voices

Appendix. For every measured theme in Tabs 1–9, the twenty most engaged comments in full, with their replies.

Exported 2026-09-11 · 1,507 comments · 1,304 replies · every entry linked to its source

Main document: Home-Care-Buyer-Research

Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/home-care-industry/research/>

Appendix to *Home-Care-Buyer-Research*. For every measured theme in Tabs 1–9, the twenty most engaged comments in full, with their replies. Exported 2026-09-11. Live page: <https://vincestars-cloud.github.io/campaign-previews/home-care-industry/research/>

The tabs in the main document carry a curated set of quotes. This file is the layer under them: each theme is one pattern matched over the whole corpus, the count is how many documents match, and the voices are the most engaged of those documents, complete and untruncated, with the replies they drew. Sources are Reddit (r/AgingParents, r/CaregiverSupport, r/dementia, r/Alzheimers, r/eldercare), YouTube comment threads under caregiving videos, AgingCare.com, Google, Caring.com and TrustPilot reviews, and TikTok. Every entry links to its source.

Contents

1. Tab 1 — Fears: Becoming the burden to my own children · The system: discharge, Medicaid says no, APS · Losing myself: my own health, that she will bury me · Losing them: the last time · Falls, the ER, the floor · Nights and the 3am call · The money runs out · Being forced to take care of her / her moving in · A stranger in the house, theft, trust · Dementia: wandering, the stove, not knowing me
2. Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams: Pray for strength · Hoping it will end soon / wishing they would go · Wish I wasn't here anymore (the caregiver's own despair) · A peaceful end, no regrets · Stay in her own home · Peace of mind, sleep again · Wish someone had explained / had known · To live my own life again · Hope for support, for the caregivers
3. Tab 3 — Relationship Fears: Resentment towards my own parent · Only child: no one else to step in · When it's your spouse, not your parent · Long distance · My kids and my job are paying for it · Siblings who don't help · Marriage strain, separation, divorce · What the parent says to me · Guilty for wanting my own life / for wanting it to be over · Guilty for putting them in a home · Guilty for not doing enough / losing my patience · The promise I made
4. Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites: 'It's your duty' / 'it's your turn' · What the doctor, nurse and social worker say · 'Take care of yourself' · What the parent says · 'You're so strong' / 'I don't know how you do it' · 'You should visit more often' / 'put her in a home' · 'Let me know if you need anything' vs 'I'm coming Thursday at 3'
5. Tab 5 — Frustrations: The hospital discharge / rehab cycle · How to pay: Medicaid, VA, waivers, paperwork · Referral sites and calls that never stop · The parent refuses help / stubborn · Cost / can't afford / price per hour · The agency office: communication, billing · Aide no-show, cancel, turnover · Nobody warns you · The sugar-coating and the empty words · The rage, and the guilt about the rage · Their lack of planning
6. Tab 6 — Previous Solutions: Assisted living, memory care, hospice · Agencies and the rotating aides · The lawyer, the POA, the money · Medical alert buttons, devices, home fixes · Doing it all myself first · Care.com and the private hire · Adult day care and respite · Moved her in with us · Cameras
7. Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites: What helped: this sub, these videos, people who get it · The best decision we ever made · They came the same day / at a moment's notice · Finally, peace of mind and sleep · What worked with the parent · The office answered and kept me informed · A named person who became family
8. Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes: I don't want to be my mom's caretaker / do this anymore · I want to sleep through the night · Not to be a burden to my kids / to go on my own terms · A nurse for 12 hours straight, hours that fit, no minimum · I want my life back · Someone to say 'I'm coming Thursday at 3pm' · For her to stay home safely / accept help · A way to pay for it that doesn't bankrupt us · To be heard: 'I just want to hear from people who've been here'
9. Tab 9 — Typical Day: 24/7, for years · The bathroom, the sheets, the pills · The drive, the ER, the rehab: every day at the hospital · Every single day he's weaker; the questions on repeat · Work, then her: before work, after work, on my lunch, the weekends · Wake up every day wondering if it will get worse; 3am wondering how much longer · The phone that never stops

Tab 1 — Fears

Becoming the burden to my own children · 74 documents

20 most engaged of 74 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf (220)**: "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023 (89)**: "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774 (55)**: "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"Aging, and the Right to Die with Dignity. My mother is 88. She lives in an assisted living facility about 10 minutes from me. And honestly, every time I walk through the doors, I get overwhelmed by what I see. It's actually a very nice facility for what we often think of as an "old folks home." There are different levels of ability, and there are people who are still social, engaged, and enjoying life. But I would say that more than half of the residents I see are essentially just existing. They are breathing, eating, using the bathroom, sleeping—and repeating it all again the next day. They are alive, but they aren't really *living*. I don't mean that to sound callous. It's just incredibly difficult to watch. My mother no longer enjoys her life. She doesn't have a terminal disease that is going to take her life anytime soon. She had a stroke, is diabetic and has the beginning stages of dementia, but her biggest problem is that her body has essentially stopped working. She can barely stand. She is constantly incontinent and often doesn't even realize when she has urinated or had a bowel movement. The staff helps her change, but they are caring for many other residents too. Sometimes my mother has to sit in her own waste for hours before someone is available to help her. Sometimes I stop by - the smell is so bad and she doesn't even notice it. I ask her if I can change her and she responds by saying it's not necessary (because she can not smell her own waste). She has very little control over her own life. She hates being in assisted living. She hates what has happened to her body. She hates needing help with things she once did without thinking. They do physical therapy with her, but between the damage from her stroke and diabetes, she has very little use of her legs beyond briefly standing to transfer to a toilet or chair. And the saddest part is that my mother is not an isolated case. There are so many people living this way. This is really my rant: I hear people all the time say, "I never want to live like that." And yet, when someone reaches a point where they no longer have any meaningful quality of life, the idea of allowing them to choose when and how they die is considered illegal, immoral, or taboo. I struggle to understand that. When one of my dogs was suffering, unable to walk, and losing control of their bladder and bowels, I could make the

heartbreaking decision to let them go peacefully. I could prevent them from having to continue living in a body that no longer allowed them to have any quality of life. Why don't we extend some version of that compassion and autonomy to people? I'm not talking about giving up on someone because they're old or disabled. I'm talking about respecting the wishes of a mentally competent person who has reached a point where they no longer want to continue living in a body that has become a prison. Why can't we decide for ourselves what *living* means to us—and, when the time comes, have the right to die with dignity rather than being forced to simply keep existing? Watching my mother live this way has made me question something I never really questioned before: **Is keeping someone alive always the same thing as giving them a life worth living?**"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 517 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vnse4u/aging_and_the_right_to_die_with_dignity/

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"*

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"I've told my kids to put me in a home if and when I'm unable to look after myself. I would never put them through the stress I'm currently going through. I didn't bring them into this world for them to put their lives on hold when I'm old. I brought them into the world to fulfil their dreams and I'm never going to stand in the way of them."

youtube · @michellesaupe7346 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 258 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhIEw&lc=UgxKMXhAhCoWXobEvxJ4AaABAg>

↳ **@wordswordswords8203** (60): "Wow. I wish my mom was like that. She is taking my whole life away from me and making me feel guilty for even bringing up putting her in assisted living."

↳ **@iuliqt** (33): "You are a lovely mother, that truly loves their children. God bless you!"

↳ **@willieoutlaw4957** (23): "You are one heck of a mother! I told my kids the same thing, I want to be a blessing for them not a burden."

"My mom passed away 5 months ago. I moved back home 15 years ago to care for my mom when my dad died. After 8 years I retired to care for my mom full time. In her last 7 years, because she was housebound, I never left the house. I shopped once per month for 60 minutes and went to Sunday Mass for 45 minutes weekly. I never asked for help from anyone. Those 15 years, especially the last 7 years, were the 7 best years of my life. I did everything for my mom and thank God that He gave me the grace to care for my mom. There is nothing in this world that I would trade those last 7 years for. I never saw it to be a burden. I loved my mom so much that, 5 months now after she passed away, my heart is still broken and desolate. I never saw it as stressful, unbearable, etc. I did everything out of love. If it were my choice, I would have done it for another 50 years. My mom passed at 101. I pray she is now in Heaven with God."

youtube · @remowilliams7569 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 108 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxL7cARs1CHkPqGFQ14AaABAq

↳ **@DeborahD67** (7): "A friend of mine did something similar and was also blessed. You don't mention her mental state, but I suspect if dementia were a big issue your view would be much less rosy. It will drive one insane."

↳ **@LennarVlogs** (6): "@remowilliams7569 101! Wow she was blessed. I can see the stress being a caretaker can cause but it's beautiful that you shared the love you had for your mom. May she rest in peace."

↳ **@lisagilbert5709** (6): "Thank you for sharing. We need more people like you in the world!"

"Impossible-to-please mother wants to live with me. A year ago, I helped my mom move to my state to live near me. She was living near my brother, but her incessant requests that he drop everything for her were driving him crazy and he needed her to go. I had her move here to give his mental health a break. She lives in an independent living facility about four blocks from my house. The location is perfect because I can get to her quickly and more frequently than I'd otherwise be able to, and I can stop at the store for her on the way over. But she keeps pushing to live with me and my husband, which is not a good idea. It's mostly because she doesn't like the food there. (Her apartment has a kitchen and she cooks her own stuff most of the time.) My mother is intrusive and oblivious. She doesn't understand basic human interaction rules (it's like she fits the definition of autism in this respect), which means she is constantly saying inappropriate things -- insulting us, or hurting my feelings. If she isn't getting her way, she can get nasty very quickly to where it feels like it's coming out of left field. Her own mother drove her crazy (and her mother was a nice person). She refused to let my grandmother live with her and my dad because she knew she wouldn't be able to stand it. And she swore up and down she would never be a burden to me or my brother. Now, here she is, wanting to live with me. The biggest problem here is that my mom is incapable of being happy. Everything is always terrible where she lives. Any house she's ever lived in is "always falling apart." When I was growing up, it was always my dad's fault for buying the wrong house or not repairing something fast enough. After my dad died, it was my brother's fault for living 3.5 hours away and not being able to come over and change a light bulb instantly. It's like the woman has no concept of how to locate and book with a service provider of any kind. When you suggest she call a handyman, she gets pissed off because she thinks we should do everything for her; that she shouldn't have to pay a handyman. Never mind the fact that she always told us that we "owe her

nothing." I lost count of the number of times she complained about her own parents keeping score, swearing that anything she did for my brother and I came without strings attached. I believed her. She moved closer to my brother so he could help her more, but it wasn't enough for her. She complained constantly about the house she bought and how she'd "overpaid" for it. She had the backyard relandscaped and then killed half of it because she couldn't be bothered to water it (even though she had a programmable system and I had created a custom instruction manual for her). Every time something happened at the house -- AC out, broken water heater, roof repairs needed -- my brother had to handle it all for her. She acts like she's completely helpless. And every one of those incidents was the end of the world -- her crying and asking "Why does this always happen to me?" as though no other homeowner in the history of the universe has to deal with repairs. So we all decided that she couldn't handle owning a home; that independent living was the way to go because she could just pay one bill and not have to worry about anything. She's had that for a year now, and all I hear are complaints. Texas was better; her house was better -- she's forgotten all the complaints she had about it. That's how it's always been with her, though. She hates a place until she leaves it. Then, the old place was heavenly and the new place sucks. I don't want her living with me because not only will she annoy the crap out of me, she will be unhappy! I don't want to have to listen to, "I should have stayed where I was. At least I had X and Y." (And I don't want to help her move yet again! The woman's a hoarder, for one thing.) Also, I love my house and planned to stay here. It's not big enough for her to move into, though. We'd have to move to a bigger place, which costs money, and it would mean that someday, I'd be old and stuck with more house than I can handle and NO ONE to help me deal with it. I've told her that, and she doesn't seem to care. I can't figure out how to get her to understand this and stop asking for it. Just when I think we're all clear on how our relationship works, she gets clingy again and starts crying and saying she wants to live with me. I'm going to school full time right now. I'm almost 60 and will be starting a new career, and not by choice. And I have relationship problems as well. I can't handle her b.s. on top of all of this. I love the mother she was when I was growing up, but I don't like the person she is now. If I worked with her, she would be someone I would avoid. But I don't want her to get all dramatic and start crying and saying she's moving back to Texas. She can't afford the move, and Texas is NOT big enough for both her and my brother to live there. We looked into independent living places there, and none of them had kitchens. That was a no-go. She can't buy another home. So WTF can she do but stay where she is? I'm just so sick of the crying and her being miserable. Yes, she's on antidepressants and sees a counselor. I've told her she's the common denominator everywhere she goes, and that she has to figure out why she can't be happy before she can even think about moving anywhere else. Aside from that advice, I don't know what else to do or offer her."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 93 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1unvxnd/impossibletoplease_mother_wants_to_live_with_me/

"going through this and what i want to do once i am 60 is tell my fam that if something happens to me do not resucitate or put me through surgery. just let me go, i dont want to be a burden."

youtube · @ClaiomSolis · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiEw&lc=UggBmdo0OB8CmXgCoAEC>

↳ **@LornaScottLormaMScott** (3): "Helping our parents certainly makes us take a look at what we want as we age. Have you done a personal health directive and/or talked with your family about what you want? So many of us delay this. (Including me!). eek....maybe I'll get on that."

↳ **@michaelchin3550** (3): "I will be 64 in a few weeks. I am in fantastic shape. I cycle 120 plus miles every week and I do pull ups, chin ups, dips and leg raises every single day. Seems to help. Have always lived an active life. If I become ill and get into a situation where I cannot take care of myself...my wife knows what she has to do."

↳ **@spacelyman9482** (0): "mirka narika I kinda see how you could believe that."

"I am a 49 year old male who looks after my 90 year old mother who has vascular dementia. I quit work to be her full time carer. I am entirely alone - I have no siblings and my relatives say that they don't care about me as I am not a member of their immediate family. I often feel burnt out and stressed out but I wouldn't change it for anything. My mother looked after me for the first 42 years of my life so there is no way that I will ever let her go into a nursing home. After a stay in hospital, the hospital refused to let her come back home with me (I found out that they did this to every elderly patient on the ward, they had an 'arrangement' with a nursing home) . They dumped her in a nursing home - but I used my Power of Attorney to rescue her and get her back home with me. She was always there for me growing up so I am here for her. Everybody remember this - you may feel frustrated now but one day your loved ones will be gone and you would do anything and give away everything you have for just one more moment with them - so cherish them now. Don't grumble or be resentful - do it with a smile on your face and thank God that they are still here. Which would you rather be doing? - working for some bastard of a boss in an office or looking after the person who cared for you and gave you life? At the end of the day there is nothing more meaningful. To be honest, if I had children and they wanted to put me in a home I would feel completely betrayed. If your children are going to abandon you at your time of desperate need then why bother having them? - it means all those years of raising them have amounted to absolutely nothing. I know that some people genuinely can't cope but many more just dump them because they can't be bothered and are just too selfish. Looking after your elderly parents is a privilege, it really is. Any parents who are able to still make decisions - cut the buggers out of your will if they don't look after you!"

youtube · @Commentator-tb8ku · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 52 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgycNGbl1kjsdx4y1Z4AaABAg

↳ **@TallRaucousTruthSeeker** (8): "Your intentions are very noble but I doubt the care she gave you was anything like the level of care she will eventually need. A friend of mine used to say her parents gave her much more trouble than her children ever did! Adults with Alzheimer's are like toddlers in adult bodies. It's a different ball game altogether. It's hard not to feel guilty about handing them over but the time may come as it's really too much for one person. But good on you for wanting to do right by her."

↳ **@ANaturalLife777** (7): "You are such an inspiration and a blessing to your mother! ♥"

↳ **@cherylwoodford** (7): "Some children are not able to handle it physically or emotionally which is understandable. You are 49 years old. If you were in your 60s or 70s taking care of of your mother, it would make quite a difference."

"I am my husband's carer and I am not going to be a burden on anyone. I'm opting out..."

youtube · @gracecatz3996 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyvE7dcGnZAwSunPiB4AaABAg>

↳ **@womandela72** (4): "Me too! Caring for my Dad with dementia for past 7 years. About to move him into a nursing home because he's totally gone and too heavy for me. Plus Im tired! But if I ever wind up like him Im heading to Oregon if you know what I mean!"

"I was in your situation until my dad finally started trying when I told him he either needs to work on being independent, or he'll go in a nursing home. He said "I'll die before I do that" so I just plainly told him: I have 2 kids, a career, wife, etc. to take care of along with taking care of myself. All he has to do is take care of him. It's completely unfair to expect someone to just take care of you. This isn't sustainable. That's the reality - NO ONE could do it. He needs to be in a care facility. Please start the research process, contact local area on aging, etc.. If they need to sell things to get the assets to cover what they can until medicaid kicks in, then that's just what you've got to do. I'm so sorry you're dealing with this. On another note to continue your rant, why the hell does that

generation of parents push their kids to do all this bullshit? My dad can now walk around the kitchen island without a wheelchair, but still expects me to empty his pee jugs (giving Ray vibes from Trailer Park Boys). He expected me to wipe his behind when he got out of skilled nursing. His arms worked fine. I cannot IMAGINE making my kids empty my piss 3 times a day for months, taking my poop in bags down to the trash can all while not even attempting to research or try solutions, other options, home care, etc.. It blows my mind. I never thought parents would turn out that way and be totally fine putting such a MASSIVE burden on their kids that they never had to deal with."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok9168z/

"Thank you for this. My 92 year old mother with late stage dementia is in a facility. My siblings never visit her. My mother was widowed young and very independent. She didn't want to be a burden on anyone. I feel a small amount of guilt that I don't care for her at home but I have college age kids and a husband who's just retired and wants to travel. I visit several times a week. You reminded me how my mom would not have wanted me to sacrifice my family life for her. Plus I don't have the skills for it. By visiting regularly, the staff knows someone is active in her care and I believe it makes them give her the attention she deserves. It's a very challenging situation that comes with lots of guilt. I know my mom is getting great care and I get to have more fun with her when I am visiting her."

youtube · @lbanducci · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxtNyJPdSxxCIX0DQt4AaABAq

↳ @laurawright7477 (3): "You did the right thing! What most of us would love to be able to do. When financial problems prevent that kind of care..those of us that have no choice ...suffer."

↳ @piecelow2726 (1): "Your doing the right thing. Nothing to feel guilty about."

"Living this right now; MIL's "plan" was to "get lung cancer & die quick ". She certainly contributed on her end with the excessive smoking for 50+ years; however, she had a stroke 4 years ago, requires 24/7 care & isn't living or dying. Her grandchildren, my children, no longer recall the great memories and fun times they had with her going on cruises... They only remember how things are now since the last four years, with her living in our house. I feel sad that she didn't die from the stroke; everyone would've had grieved a life well-lived but eventually we would've healed from the pain of the loss. Instead, we're all in limbo, with the good memories overwritten by the strife of trying to provide her care ourselves (no money for any other option), raise our children whilst tethered to our home w/ no vacations in 4 years, and run our business to support ourselves. We're hollowed out shells of ourselves & I feel terrible for our children, watching their friends live carefree lives as they should. We tried to get her to move closer when well, even to move back to the country she was born in (has dual citizenship & would receive care & an apartment); but she didn't want to give up smoking, and she hid it from family back home for 20 years, so here we all are. I have prepared documentation that should I be cognizant & decide to refuse hydration & nutrition, my wishes are to be respected & nobody is to override my wishes. I won't put my children through this, and since there's no right to die where I live, this is the only option."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/ocbtb3b/

"A person should have the right to make the conscious decision to not be a burden on their children. Some parents will not accept the role reversal that's required to successfully navigate the caregiving maze. I didn't work for 46 years to take on caring for a newborn in the form of an elder parent."

youtube · @VietVet-th6ti · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugz5MNxN1dyfD9uFnjp4AaABAq>

↳ **@99delsur** (5): "You wouldn't exist if it weren't for that said parent. There are problems with the role reversal model of what's happening. Two are rather glaring. One, you're dealing with a person who has lived independently more years than you have. (And you think you're not happy giving up your independence to care for them?! You feel life is giving you a raw deal? You still have a choice - care for them or not. They have no choice but to be dependent. Who's the one with the greater need?) Two, unlike most children, the elderly person is only going to fail more and more in health, physical ability, etc. Instead of becoming more and more independent, they increase in dependency -- plus there's no time horizon on this -- no end point in 18-20 yrs. As the speaker said, it's not a role reversal. You need another way of looking at things. Both sides need to give, not just a little, a lot. Never going to work one-sided."

"As someone reaching this stage of being elderly and noticing the decline, I don't want to be burdensome. My kids are already so busy and it just wouldn't be fair to put my care on them like that. In a more natural state of being, the decline and the end wouldn't take so long, but end of life has been extended beyond what it used to be, and that's not always a good thing for anyone! It is beyond hard for a loving child to deal with all of that, as well as the pressures of their spouse and children, and often work too. This is an excellent video which hopefully will help release the guilt for so many. I've had my life, and my children don't deserve the added strain on their already over- busy, over- stressful lives. Once the caring reaches beyond loving care to medical care, then it isn't wrong to hand that care over to the professionals. That way, you can come visit and enjoy your time with your loved one, dignity intact all round. ♥"

youtube · @gee4947 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 13 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzzfsTB7-NalaKfPmd4AaABAg

"I needed this today to know I am not alone. It is scary. Thank you for being REAL!! This is what it is like. And I am scared to get old and put my own kids through this."

youtube · @Alwayshopeful100 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyA2SM6c10o5wzoyt14AaABAg

"I am an older mom. I bring this up with my son. He doesn't always want to acknowledge the topic. I will write my wishes down. I will not be a burden."

youtube · @kyleparker775 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugwq7JdZlPWp9VGZxyp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (4): "You are very kind, thoughtful and realistic. These aren't easy topics. All the best to you. ♥♥"

"My dad passed away in 2019. He had dementia for the last five years of his life. He lived with me and I shared caretaking with my brother, so one year with me and one year with my brother. Dad lived with us this way for over 28 years. Our wives are wonderful women, they helped out a ton as well and kept the tension and stress to a minimal simply recognizing that this is a journey and that we have to do the best we can for our parents. My brother and I both raised families and our children have all done well. The number one thing in this caretaking journey is having the heart to do the needed and secondly, almost equally important is having the resources, financial and family wise so that this doesn't become a burden on one person. We were blessed to have all in quantities greater than we could have imagined, even though as immigrants we had come into the country virtually broke, but we made it. I honestly feel that part of why I have been richly rewarded in life is that I was a good son and did the right thing for my parents. Of course it helped that they were both loving and caring, and low maintenance for the most part. I miss them both, despite the challenges I faced in care taking. Now my wife and I

are taking care of her mother who is 83 and has dementia. We are managing so far, but we aren't as young as we once were, but God willing, we will see here through to her end peacefully, and when our time comes we will go gracefully knowing we did the best we could."

youtube · @syhussaini9236 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhKEw&lc=Ugy2HfhVE-wdFluni-l4AaABAg>

"I have posted this before but WTH happened to I don't want to be a burden on my children? This stuff sucks"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/noepc9e/

"My husband and I moved a couple years ago to be close to our son as he and our daughter were concerned about our aging and living away from them. We are 80. The past year, both of us have had concerning health issues. We both decided that we don't want to be a burden on our children as they are living their "good life". To me, that meant we should take steps to provide ourselves with care when we need it and make our home as safe as possible. Our floors are not carpeted and I bought a chair for the shower as my husband has difficulty standing in the tub. We also have bars for the wall and edge of tub. I bought a cane for my husband and I called a senior assist program to come talk to us about their meal program, help in home care so that we can use it when we are ready. We hope to stay in our home. Our children are happy that we are trying to take care of ourselves as best we can, also knowing that they are there to help us anytime we need it. I have been reassured by checking programs out before I need the extra help. I think it gives our kids reassurance knowing we'll be taken care of and as well, they can help us. Don't be afraid to let your kids help. You will be blessed."

youtube · @cherylwhetung3170 · *MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP* · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgzrAc4GsYeRUUNZ2W14AaABAg>

↳ **@heysaras** (2): "Sounds magical. I wish more seniors would do this."

↳ **@cherylwhetung3170** (1): "Just want to add on to my past comment. 4 months later: my husband and I have just moved into a senior living community and we are very happy. We are close to our family and enjoying all the benefits of having meals provided, activities and care if we need it. Our social life has improved 100%."

↳ **@SofiaAmirpoor** (1): "That's terrific! And your family is close by. That's my plan for myself...fingers crossed! Thank you for the update, best wishes to you!"

"I so agree on this!!!!!! I told my son & daughter if I get to the point I can not longer care for myself to put me in a facility. I will not put that responsibility onto my children. No way in hell it's selfish as hell"

youtube · @crazychungus5233 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyC3idz1PSZVjQ-z0l4AaABAg

↳ **@Silver_Man_69** (1): "I'd rather drive out in the desert somewhere and rot."

The system: discharge, Medicaid says no, APS · 54 documents

20 most engaged of 54 matching documents, complete text.

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?!) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this

week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you* not suffer. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are taking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be

tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden, and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go, not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone. I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up. I told her I didn't feel well and would come up today. She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background: My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent a lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm

pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. **TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED.**"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"Found a place for Mom, with not much money and without Medicaid.. Hopefully this will help someone and give some hope. I can't be my Mom's caregiver being an only child, with young kids and work and my own issues. Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator. Placement coordinator is contacted by the social worker and then try call me. I told him the budget my Mom had (she lives off SS and not much!) And hoped for the best. He found a place that a lady owns and she worked with me and based off the circumstances cut my Mom a deal and is using her SS check for monthly rent at this place. Which does cover 24/7 care and food. Hospice will follow her there for added comfort and care. So it is possible to find a place. It might not be a 5 star 5 grand a month resort, but my Mom

hasn't got long to live and this place does have great reviews as well. The placement coordinator has a lot of relationships with places that often take people if that can't afford much. She's being discharged today to this place and hospice is meeting me to go over everything. It's a lot of stress, over all its one hurdle I don't have to worry about. You shouldn't have to feel guilty for not being able to take care of your parent. Not everyone can and they're all valid reasons. People who judge are projecting and often times have the financial means to hire people and not have to work. But not everyone has that luxury. I hope this helps at least one person. It can be done. I am thinking of everyone during these stressful times. It's ok to not be ok. Update: this place is awesome! It's like a house but with a about 15 bedrooms with closets and own bathroom and there's a kitchen and it's very clean and has a rec room. It's probably like an adult foster home? But with a bit more care. The nurses are so nice. I feel beyond happy this is where she'll be. Don't give up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1aqo1wy/found_a_place_for_mom_with_not_much_money_and/

"I HAVE MOVED MY PARENTS--Episode 12--"So you're saying there's a chance?". Hello, episodes 10 and 11 covered my Dad's mental breakdown and his hospitalization. Episode 11 included the decision that my Dad, newly diagnosed with vascular dementia, when released from the hospital, would eventually have to move into memory care and leave my mother in assisted living. I called episode 11 "The Great Unraveling" because all of the wonderful plans we had for my parents' lives had fallen apart in just a few hours. The drama continued today as several powerful entities, and people within them, pitted themselves against one another in a battle that had potential life or death consequences for my father. After a surprisingly good night's sleep, I made my way to the hospital at 9 AM and found my father sound asleep, but with a "sitter," someone paid to sit by his bedside and keep an eye on him because he had demonstrated a tendency to try to get out of bed. She was good, too; as soon as one foot got out of position, she was up off her chair and getting him back solidly on the bed. He still had a catheter, and an uneaten breakfast indicated that he could not be awakened sufficiently to eat it. He was, for all intents, absolutely out. This continued on and off for the next few hours. Every now and then Dad would stir just a bit and pick at his blankets or start to hang a toe off the side of the bed, and every time, his sitter would jump up. I had no duties at all. The nurse and the sitter would turn Dad from side to side occasionally. He couldn't roll over on his own. When they finally awakened him enough to eat, that had to spoon feed him. Later, when he needed to go to the restroom, they brought in a bed pan. About this time, a social worker came in to inform me to prepare for Dad's discharge. I thought maybe I hadn't heard her right. "Excuse me? Remember he's not going back to his home until Monday?" She answered, "we're not doing anything medical to help him anymore, he will be discharged today." "But they said they can't take him back for three more days!" "That is the family's problem." "But how can you say that a man who can't roll over on his own, needs a bed pan, a catheter, and has to be spoon fed is ok to discharge?" "He's not receiving medical services. The catheter will be removed and then it's up to the family what to do upon discharge." "But I was told you would try various meds to see if we could reduce the delusions and help him be more stable." "There are no meds to help him. He's only going to get worse. He's 90 years old. Don't build false hope." Shocked, I called the assisted living, where Nurse T, an absolutely amazing woman, reassured me that she would deal with the situation. While I was confident that she would do her best, I wanted to hedge my bets so I went downstairs and asked to speak to an administrator. In only a couple of minutes, Administrator J came and met me. He listened sympathetically to me and appeared to agree that there's no way my father should be discharged in this kind of shape. He promised to look into the situation. I thought about my options. My house is not an option for reasons I won't discuss here. Nor are the homes of my son or my daughter and their families. I actually thought about renting a motel room and trying to care for my dad there until his new home in memory care might be available, but then I realized there's not a motel room available in the area right now because a nationally significant sporting event is happening here. I actually pictured trying to care for my dad in a car. An hour went by with no calls or contact with anyone, but at one point I saw the administrator in a heated discussion with the social worker who had told me to prepare for the discharge. I didn't dare call anyone because I didn't want to intervene at the wrong moment and maybe mess up a delicate phase of

the negotiations. So I waited. Finally, at 2 o'clock, word came from my dad's nurse, a large man with an amazingly compassionate disposition. He said, "the plan is we're going to pull the catheter and move your dad to another room out of this wing (and away from the unsympathetic social worker.) If he pees before 3 o'clock, he's going to be discharged, but if he still can't pee on his own by three, he'll be admitted (to my surprise he was not admitted yet; he was only on 'observation' status)." So the catheter was pulled and Dad slept through that. He was moved and he rustled around a little but went back to sleep. Later, though appearing to be asleep, he moved his hands as though turning a steering wheel driving, and a little later, did a perfect pantomime of sewing, something I've never seen him do in his conscious life. But he didn't pee. At 3 o'clock it was apparent that either Administrator J or Nurse T or both had prevailed, and the discouraging social worker had gotten at least a bit of a win by having my Dad moved out from under her oversight. For his part, Dad was oblivious to all the wrangling. Only around 3:30 did he finally seem to wake up and start to interact. By that time he had a new sitter and he was telling her all about his military service, getting most of the details totally wrong, but I just let him go and finally, confident that he was ok for the day and not going to be discharged, went home to rest. Later this evening, my wife and I went to see my mother to talk to her about Dad and to see how she was doing in his absence. She seemed ok and to understand very well the challenges that Dad was facing. On the way in, we happened to run into Nurse T, and I thanked her profusely for all the efforts she had made on my Dad's behalf. She described her telephone interaction with the hospital social worker and said she was hugely disappointed in the person and questioned whether she was in the right job. But this episode's title is, "So You're Saying There's a Chance?" and here's why: Nurse T said when Dad returns from the hospital, he could be permitted to return to Mom's side in assisted living if several conditions were met. 1--Is Mom ok with that? 2--There would be more check-ins by staff, perhaps hourly, 3--Dad would have to wear an alarm that sounded if he tried to exit the building, and the big, hard, tough, potentially expensive one, that someone else would need to be in the room 24 hours a day. Well now. How committed am I to having this work? Actually I'm committed enough to move over there and try to make it happen. Maybe I can negotiate meal service. I believe I can have family members take shifts, but let's not fool ourselves, it's going to be me, most of the time. Now, how long this has to go on before Dad has proven his ability to live with Mom and not go into memory care is unknown. If it's a week or two, I can handle it. I could probably even go a month with some good books and stable wi-fi. But even during the 18 days I lived with Dad in March, I still got time off to go home, get clean clothes, and so on. Not sure how strict the 24 hour rule will be enforced. There would be a lot to negotiate, or maybe not. So that's where things stand right now. Maybe the Great Unraveling will take place, but for now, at least they're saying there's a chance that it won't."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/o37ja8/i_have_moved_my_parentsepisode_12so_youre_saying/

↳ **comment (14):** "I'm glad that your father wasn't discharged. I don't understand what you mean by saying he has to "prove" his ability to live with your mom. He can no longer control his behavior, and he's not getting better. Your mother can visit him often in memory care, right? Or is it a matter that your father is close to the end so why add more upheaval to the situation by moving him? Forgive me if the question is inappropriate. I just see that you are knocking yourself out, but I think the prospect of giving them a normal, pleasant life such as they are accustomed to is unlikely, and I don't see how disrupting your life in the attempt is going to do any good. But of course I don't know everything about the situation."

↳ **comment (12):** "I worked in a hospital as an RN... I attended 'bed meeting' every day. This is where a team determines the patient's length of stay dependent on payment, It is not as much whether or not they are ready, it's about payment...If they need some kind of service or intervention, they make sure it is completed promptly so they can discharge.. As far as the "he wasn't admitted yet, he was on observation"... look out, I don't understand details, but have been made aware that status isn't paid for by Medicare... Medicare pays once they are admitted, they also pay for emergency room visits, but there is a maximum to that...There has been a big stink about families not being aware and large bills arrive because 'observation' has been in effect. My father was denied assisted living because he wouldn't have been able to get out of the facility by himself in 5 minutes or less if there was a fire...hm about the social worker; I'm sorry, but she was doing her job...She was likely told to be sure to

have your father out of there shortly. First of all, apparently he was never admitted, so he wasn't an 'inpatient'... She could have been more empathetic, but she was doing her job.. It's hard for me to read this and have the 'inside scoop' as to how a hospital runs... I hope everything works out as you plan and you can do what is best for your father and mother....I support you in your efforts."

↳ **comment** (12): "Is it not amazing that there are people in a field dedicated to caring for people dont seem to have a clue. Thank God for compassionate ones. best of luck my friend. You're all in my prayers."

"Why is Hospice pushing me really, REALLY, hard (almost bullying) into signing a DNR order?. My mother lives in an ALF. She is in Memory Care. About 4 weeks ago she was sent to the hospital. She wasn't eating and couldn't urinate. After about five days she was sent to Boca Circle Rehabilitation. I can't tell you what a nightmare Boca Circle was! UGH A director from the ALF visited mom a couple of times and told me I needed to get her back to ALF as soon as possible. Boca Circle wouldn't release her. ALF was insistent that I request a Hospice consult. If she was in hospice care, she could come back "home". I requested the consult. BC ignored me for a couple of days (like four, but two of those were the weekend). I called the Hospice center myself. They told me they needed a request from BC. On Monday, the Hospice center finally got ahold of someone at Boca Circle and got the request they needed. Mom was assessed and it was determined she would go back to the ALF on hospice care. Since then, hospice has been hounding me to sign a DNR order. Telling me horror stories about what physical injuries she might incur if an ambulance is called and they have to perform lifesaving procedures (CPR). And, if she goes back to the hospital, hospice would have to withdraw hospice care. I just feel like BC, the ALF and Hospice are playing a game of ping pong with my mom to see who can get the most billable "bed hours" before she dies. Hope that made sense. I thought I was doing the right thing by my mother, but I may have just made it worse. Why is hospice being so pushy about me signing that DNR order?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 75 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zww/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/

↳ **comment** (260): "I don't know about the ping-ponging but hospice is end of life care. It's normally for those who have a life expectancy of 6 months or less. It's meant to keep you as comfortable as possible, not to prolong life. If your mom had a DNR and stops breathing (as an example), she is allowed to pass naturally. Without a DNR an ambulance would be called and chest compressions would be started. If you've ever taken a CPR course you may recall how forcefully you have to compress to be effective. That's where the injuries and pain come in."

↳ **comment** (239): "The bigger question.. why doesn't your mother already have a DNR in place? Not eating and not urinating (probably not drinking) and memory issues are a trifecta of potential further medical intervention coming down the pike. Why? Btw, your mom being in the hospital for any length of time would likely mean the ALF would have to release her bed, of course depending on who is footing the bill."

↳ **comment** (180): "Those horror stories are real. One of the absolute worst things for doctors is being forced to perform resuscitative measures on elderly people at end of life with no meaningful chance of recovery and who already have a declining quality of life. They wish desperately that more families would have the courage to sign the DNR. At this stage in life, things like CPR are just a cause of more pain and suffering for the elderly person. You are doing things *\to* a person, not *\for* a person. Hospice is generally a program where all life-prolonging measures are stopped, in some programs, it is actually required. The only things done are things that improve comfort and quality of life. The focus is no longer on the quantity of life. If you are not comfortable with a DNR, hospice is likely not the right program for your family. ETA because many people need to hear this... by signing a DNR, you are NOT 'giving up' on your mom, you are not 'killing' your mom, you are not 'abandoning' her, it does NOT mean you don't love her deeply and wish that she could live forever. Allowing her to pass from natural causes at the end of life, choosing not to put her through any painful medical procedures, deciding to no longer prolong her life at all costs, is a loving, compassionate, and ethical thing to do."

"Desperate: Mother (54 y/o, 5'5", ~85-93 lbs) starving for 10 years. Doctors dismissive. How do I force medical intervention while caring for an infant?. I am desperate for advice on how to save my mother's life. She has been progressively losing weight for ten years due to a severe lack of appetite and a profound aversion to food. Her issue is not driven by body image—she simply has no interest in eating, she is always on the go (probably where I got my adhd) and will not stop to eat, she'll drink a boost and then skip a meal. She also has had long COVID which affected her ability to taste and smell properly for the last several years. I have made so many recipes, printed sheets, done everything I could to try and make my family understand that this is a serious and deadly issue. I feel like I'm screaming into the void. Currently, she is 5'5" and weighs somewhere between 85 and 93 lbs. Her BMI is roughly 14.1 to 15.5. She is severely emaciated, losing muscle mass, and running out of time. I am completely alone in fighting this. My family is entirely complacent. Because this has been going on for a decade, they have normalized it and gotten "used" to her looking like this. My dad lives with her, but he is passive, will not intervene, and will not help me force her to eat or seek real care. Furthermore, my 24-year-old brother is autistic and still relies entirely on my parents. If my mom collapses or passes away, his safety net is gone, yet no one else in the house will act. I have made so many recipes, printed sheets, done everything I could to try and make my family understand that this is a serious and deadly issue. I feel like I'm screaming into the void To complicate everything, I have a 9-month-old baby. I am chronically sleep-deprived, incredibly busy, and physically exhausted. I do not have the bandwidth to endlessly argue with family or chase unhelpful doctors. Her primary care doctors are just as complacent. Every time she goes, they completely dismiss the severity of her weight and just tell her to "drink Boost." They have done a few tests. Lab work, recently had a colonoscopy (don't know the results yet), and they scanned her lungs and said she desperately needs to quit smoking also. Because she has been starving for a decade, I am terrified she is on the verge of organ failure. I need advice: Am I overthinking this or do I need to actually intervene with some sort of hospitalization at this point? How do I override a complacent spouse (my dad) and a dismissive doctor to force medical care? Given my lack of time with an infant, has anyone successfully called Adult Protective Services (APS) for self-neglect to let the state force the issue? I'm so scared for her. I'm only 26 I need my mom.. This is my first time posting here I apologize if I broke any rules. It's 4 am and I haven't slept hardly at all in 3 days. Thank you in advance"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v6xkzt/desperate_mother_54_yo_55_8593_lbs_starving_for/

↳ **comment** (182): "I don't think "the state" will come in and force feed your mother as long as she does have medical care and she is of sound mind and has a husband around that is living with her and appears to be watching out for her. She is quite young to anticipate her dying of starvation, I can only imagine how difficult this is for you to be watching and feeling helpless to do anything. Your life is full with that beautiful baby and you are not going to be able to fix this, it is similar to watching an alcoholic or addict destroy themselves. Look at the al anon writings and see if anything in there is helpful to help you to let go of this feeling of responsibility. When you do see her make it all food focused but beyond that she is going to smoke and not eat as she wishes. Sometimes something like ice cream is well tolerated, it does sound like you are doing everything that you can and then some."

↳ **comment** (161): "Your mother has an eating disorder which is very difficult to treat and you have developed a co-dependency of trying to get her to eat which has wound you up into your present state. My recommendation since your mother is functioning is to get help for yourself and learn to detach from the situation."

↳ **comment** (52): "Your mother needs mental health help. You're trying to fix her body by feeding her but it's her mind that needs repair. Is she being treated for her ADHD? The only suggestion I have is a heart to heart talk about what is going to happen to your brother in a few short years. At her age and condition her bones are turning into glass. Without proper nutrition osteoporosis accelerates. She's looking at broken bones and delayed healing when they happen. She's looking at pneumonia and long hospitalizations. Ask her what is going to happen to your brother then. Will she seek mental health treatment now so she can care for him because it won't be long before she can't. I don't think you'll be successful but one can only try. Then after that conversation wash

your hands if it like everyone else has. Not because you are uncaring, but because you can't force her to change. She won't be declared incompetent. People have the autonomy to make bad decisions. Her friends, relatives and doctors realize and accept this. Sadly you will have to accept it to and concentrate on yourself and your son. I would try to see if she will at least create a plan regarding your brother's care when she is hospitalized or dead. I'm sure she believes that you will step into her role in caring for your brother. She needs the reality check that you have your own son to care for."

"I understand the reasoning behind your post, and I'd agree with your post. FWIW, I worked in long term care a lot of years (but not in the US). I fail to understand why society thinks we have to treat everything in seniors of an advanced age. Where we live, seniors are encouraged to fill out a provincial health care form that designates what level of care they'd like in various categories of adverse incidents. Of course you can't possibly foresee everything that might happen, but it gives you a starting point for treatment decisions. So in your mom's case, that paperwork would have been readily accessible to paramedics; it's suggested that it be stuck to the fridge with magnets. Mom, hopefully with previous conversation with family and her doctor, could have opted for Comfort Care only, even in this situation. I've posted several times elsewhere that perhaps not every pneumonia (for instance) should be treated, maybe in someone with relatively advanced dementia. I do think that people are sometimes treated not because healthcare companies want to make money, but because they don't want to be sued for not providing care. Even here where healthcare is publicly funded, people are often treated way beyond what's reasonable (in my opinion), sometimes at the direction of family. I don't understand why we treat someone with multiple other problems and advanced age (90+) the same way we'd treat someone that's 40, but I suppose ageism enters the conversation. It's ageism if the only difference is actually age, but at 90 there's likely a myriad of other problems which renders the ageism argument invalid. I'll get off my soapbox now."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oiz1h54/

"FIL wants to home from nursing home but cannot care for himself. How to get my partner, and him, to understand?. My FIL is in his late 70s but had been in and out of the hospital and nursing homes for the past 7 or 8 years. He is either incapable or including to take care of himself and the last couple times he went home he was back in care within a few days or weeks. I'm scared because he is barely mobile, cannot or will not take care of his hygiene, and there are no family members able to stay with him. He told my partner he is signing himself out of care and wants to go home alone. The last time he did this, he was relying on my partner to go by before and after work to change and bathe him (he would continue soiling himself until his clothes and the furnishings were soiled and expect her to clean him up, or call his brother who is older than him and not able to look after him). My partner feels unable to say no, even though she knows it's a bad idea. This has resulted in adult services involvement over but no resources were offered, so she's afraid of asking them for help since the previous response was basically "figure it out or we'll charge your with neglect". But I'm almost tempted to call and explain the situation and see if something can be done before it gets to that point. He cannot live with us because he is a sexual predator and most nursing same home health aide companies will not provide services for the same reason (no official records because it was covered up within the family, but his comments to and behavior towards nurses and aides have him blacklisted from several agencies here)."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1bqwuny/fil_wants_to_home_from_nursing_home_but_cannot/

↳ **comment** (67): "Talk to the hospital social worker. It is ok for your partner to say she can not care for father. And if he is signing himself out AMA you have some documentation about is poor choices."

↳ **comment** (33): "This happened to my father. He has dementia and wanted to sign himself out of hospital. Where I live, the hospital has a duty of care to discharge to a safe environment. We told the hospital we could no longer care for him. They determined he could not go home without this support and therefore they could only discharge him to a nursing home. They then found he did not have capacity to make decisions about his

healthcare and we were able to move him to a nursing home against his will. The lesson here is - if the medical system thinks there is someone to step in and help, the medical system will 100% rely on that person in order to alleviate themselves of the patient. However if the medical system **knows** there is no one to help, then the medical system will be forced to find a solution. The best way to help your partner would be to support her in informing the medical system that she can no longer care for her father."

↳ **comment** (27): "You need to intervene . He's a sexual predator plus his adult daughter has to clean and change him , I'm totally disgusted. Your wife needs your help right now , please help her ."

"Skilled nursing home is discharging my mother on January 2nd. How do I move my mother into a personal care home?. My mother has Parkinson's. She had been falling a lot and finally this last fall was so bad she had a concussion / brain bleed and ended up in the hospital. After about a week stay in PCU, she was transferred to a skilled nursing for the last three weeks to recover. I learned today she's finally going to be discharged this Thursday. We talked with the social worker and director of rehab and they were clear it was not safe for my mother to live alone. They referred a placement assistance agency and I started looking into long-term care options. I learned the big, nice local nursing homes are way too expensive, so I found a personal care home for her. It's a clean, well run private home — licensed, insured, clean and within 20 minutes of our home. I'm worried that when I try to move her in this Thursday, she's going to want to go to her house to get some of her things. But I'm really afraid she might try to pull a fast one and refuse to leave her home once she's there. She's already tried to get my sister to jail break her out of the skilled nursing home. Any advice?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hqazat/skilled_nursing_home_is_discharging_my_mother_on/

"Help. Stubborn Dad with dementia refuse help and scared rehab will kick him out. My 85 year old dad just got out of the hospital and was just transferred to temporary rehab. He has dementia and is super stubborn and refuses help. His legs are weak and have fallen multiple times at home. He refuses all nurses to help him to the bathroom and insist that he can do everything himself which he can't. He stays up at night yelling and fighting with the nurse. He is at the point where he can barely remember my mom. Constantly thinks my brother is my uncle. He's extremely difficult to the point where the hospital had to sedate him every single night. He was living with 80 year old mom , who definitely cannot take care of him and we're scared that he would get kicked out of rehab and no home will take him. He's currently on medi-cal and Medicaid. At this point we feel so hopeless and are out of ideas."

reddit post · r/dementia · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1oljtb/help_stubborn_dad_with_dementia_refuse_help_and/

"How do I hire a social worker privately to help me navigate the benefits system? US, Virginia. I am afraid that the Virginia/county/Medicaid worker will basically be looking for reasons to deny the patient for services. Where can I find a social worker to consult, tell me what's available, tell me what to say to the county worker, help me fill an application etc?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/rvcgnv/how_do_i_hire_a_social_worker_privately_to_help/

"Hiring an aide to go to the rehab to help me (caregiver) have a day off?. Just passed the 4 months mark of mom having a hemorrhagic stroke (craniectomy and waiting to put the skull back together) and it's become clear that I'm not going to get any relief from my family. It's also clear that mom really needs someone with her during the day to ensure care and honestly to interact with. She has a lot of short term memory issues and gets really confused and deregulated, ends up having falls and not eating. Gotta put it out there, I think that her being

neurodivergent/ADHD with a Traumatic Brain Injury makes things extra spicy. Her difficulties include major left side deficits with limbs being forgotten and difficulty processing what her eyes are seeing on that side as well, and a helmet that gets in the way... she can't operate her iPad without help or put on audiobooks or really do anything by herself, but she is aware enough to be pissed off and frustrated but not always understand what has happened to her or just be so overstimulated by the insane beeping of the call bell in the hall that she's freaking out. She has had a number of secondary issues all throughout this "recuperation" including UTIs, something she has never had a problem with. Also a juicy pulmonary embolism that required a week in the ICU. We have not gone 3 weeks without some sort of significant issue that wipes out progress and I really feel like i have PTSD about NOT being there. I'm realizing I have a lot built up inside and I'm not processing things well. Just "taking time for myself" when I don't have any backup and she's alone in that horrible situation is NOT relaxing, and she gets very distressed. My question is, do people hire outside help to go into rehabs and be with their loved one? (in USA) A family member has very generously offered to pay for this but I'd like some advice around it before I approach the administration. Thanks in advance! TLDR Sole caregiver needs a break - can outside help be hired to be with mom at a rehab so I can have a break and not worry?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1n2aopm/hiring_an_aide_to_go_to_the_rehab_to_help_me/

"Moving sounds smart, but I would not let mom live in your house rent free. You should sell it and let her move where she can. Perhaps you and brother can pitch in. In addition to taking up a lot of liquidity, I fear that letting her live there might make you liable for her long term care costs later in life. You might want to consult an elder law attorney in your state about that."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p03xzl8/

"Quit being mean and impatient! Remember one day you will be old and in need of help. Now an elder formerly the nurse, case manager, ombudsman, advocate etc etc I now find myself afraid of youthful impatient people who over react, push elders to be faster and more able. Many are bullies. Even doing all possible to plan for aging in place....someone young is always lurking to criticize . Even doing my best to minimize asking for help has not worked to eliminate feeling like a pest."

youtube · @charliechaplin3383 · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAIAo&lc=Ugwrmo3dW7Evq-krFTI4AaABAq>

↳ **@patriciamartin6756** (o): "Dear Charlie Chaplin. You start by accusing them of assault and taking them to court!!! You report them to the authorities for child abuse, indecent exposure, stealing and anything else you have to do to discredit them in court. GET THEM or they will get you!!!!!"

"I have told people that for the past year (more so the last couple of months), I have cherished the time with my mother, mourned my mother, and hated the monster that is her dementia "personality". Honestly, getting final terminal timelines actually is more a relief than a pain. I told a friend "I just wish for "rip the bandage off already and be done" exit for her. We have had this diagnosis since 2014, it took serious hold during COVID, and when my dad died in June she started slipping. Through it all I have been her proxy and her advocate. It is not like I didn't know where this would lead. We went from 30 days last week prior to hospice admission, to a bad weekend, to yesterday thinking we are counting days not weeks. There is no feel good "right" call, but at this point, what is the point in forcing it. Even today when I asked about upping her meds, the hospice nurse said "well we don't want to sedate her necessarily because that could accelerate things". I looked at her deadpan in the face and said "the problem with that is what exactly?" My thoughts are if she is comfortable and peaceful (which she really isn't atm)

what difference does it make if we go from 5 days to 4. I told the social worker today that if we lived in the right state, I would have tried to get my mom into a Death with Dignity protocol back in the day, because spending your final days/weeks in agonizing and paralyzing fear is no way to live."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/olgumd5/

"My brother& I workwd ft, my mom had my gmother move in with her& my dad. She took care of her for yrs in dementia. Gma would take walks, get lost. Gma would say a man came into home& take her jewelry!- we'd, find them in her rm. She hit my mom when she attempted to get her to take a bath. My poor mom had to decide a SNF for gma. Mom& dad worked ft, feared she'd walk out, get lost or worse taken by some horrible person! We were fortunate the SNF staff was great!"

youtube · @tcwd3760 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBkbCa880_ikF88g14AaABAq

"Managing the Unmanageable. I (35f) am doing what I can to help my mother (83). My dad passed away a year ago, and she lives alone with limited mobility, doesn't drive, etc. She had a pretty major medical event in December, leading to multiple hospital stays and now a rehab stay. The rehab plans to discharge her mid-February, and I'm worried about how she will be able to care for herself in a weakened state. Her home is equipped with most things that she needs (walker, shower chair, bedside commode) but I worry about her completing tasks alone. Rehab basically said they could send home health for a while for PT but they don't refer for anything else and that's "on the family". She completed and submitted an application for Aid and Attendance through the VA (my dad was a vet and had it before he passed), which would be some help. I don't know the status of that yet. She will not consider in-home help because of cost. I and my other family members are not able to take off work and be her constant caregivers. I have two much older siblings who do not step up as they should. I am so stressed about trying to figure things out and also figure out how to live my own life (which feels selfish). I just needed to vent and see if anyone can relate, but advice is always appreciated."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qorutp/managing_the_unmanageable/

"Ugh. My parents are boomers and they actually already have their wills, trust, POA, living will, end of life care, and cremation paid for and done. I'm an only child and all I have to do is get a family lawyer, go to the bank and spread their ashes when they pass. They wanted to make sure everything that they could do is done for me so I don't have to worry about it while also grieving. They are still emotionally immature and did a lot of damage by emotionally neglecting me, but they did get this right (and most everything that didn't involve emotions) and I'm very thankful for that, even though they told me about paying for their cremation while we were at a family members funeral (re: emotional immaturity). The best thing we can do is prepare and plan for our inevitable demise and that includes talking to our loved ones about it. Just maybe not at someone else's funeral"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oci7emc/

Losing myself: my own health, that she will bury me · 49 documents

20 most engaged of 49 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"I am 62. I cared for both of my parents for 10 years. It almost killed me. You lose your very self. People tell you to take care of yourself, but there's no time for that. There's no You anymore. My mother was the last one to die. That was 4 years ago. I'm still exhausted, if that tells you anything. I don't want to go anywhere or do anything. I live happily by myself with my phone to keep me company. I may be adding a cat to the scenario soon. I have a wonderful family nearby who I see every now and then, so I'm not totally alone. But I want no other human being living in my space ever. The silence and slowness of life is so sweet. I loved my parents dearly. Now, it's all about me."

youtube · @lindaN236 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1,123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAq

↳ **@Teffi_Club** (93): "It is true when you take care of your parents, you lose your own health."

↳ **@sjtalksandlife** (61): "It's time for you to enjoy your life, you did a great job with your parents, now it's time to focus on you"

↳ **@lordbrunski** (44): "I am so glad you shared that with honesty. I have hypothyroid and looking after my ungrateful and abusive parents has left me in a state of exhaustion that I cannot shake off. I feel like you do. Being solo is the only think I want. Men assume that I am "up for it" and they have no idea that all I want is a book, a cat and a dog. The idea of having to look after anyone else does not appeal."

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!? How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other

and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you* not suffer. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"I am exhausted, scared and overwhelmed taking care of my 82 year old father please pray for me."

youtube · @chrislim7976 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 711 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=Ugx_qvxYqVpBjO1aOR4AaABAq

↳ **@CodingAbroad** (53): "I'm in the same boat friend. 82 year old father losing physical, mental and now financial faculties. Most stressful period of my life right now"

↳ **@shrikesari** (51): "I'm there right now. I cry at night alone reminiscing the past when my dad showed me tricks of life and pretty much held my hand through my whole life. Now he is frail and weak and wants to die and I can't help him enough without damaging my own personal mental health. So stressful!! May god give us strength!!"

↳ **@dani-xm5lw** (30): "@shrikesariim caring for my old aunt. She has no one but me. She was my mums sister. I cant put her in a home cause i cant afford it. I work full time. She is wearing diapers. I dont have or drive a car. Im crying right now and pray God to take me. 🥹"

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my

adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and beat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"I am exhausted, scared and overwhelmed taking care of my 82 year old father. Please pray for me."

youtube · @chrislim7976 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 310 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgzSnFjsWM2PwVp-Gp94AaABAg>

↳ **@carolishable** (17): "@chrislim7976 I'm with you. I live with my 82 year old mother without support from anyone. I have given up the thought of having my own life and happiness. I love my mom but it's so hard to do this."

↳ **@dirtysanchez941** (13): "Chris!! I'm praying for you!!! I really mean it!! I can relate. My parents are the same age.. Omgosh, I love you, and I don't even know you!! Hang in there, and take heed to helpful information. I came here today looking for help.. I read your comment. It stood out for me. Take care of yourself."

↳ **@bronzyace7996** (10): "I am so sorry you are feeling overwhelmed and I know it is not easy, but I am glad you posted how you feel. It brings humanity and awareness to caregiver burden. Thank you for your courage, vulnerability and transparency! Please try to hang in there because you are not alone. I am most definitely praying for you and your father! God Bless You for caring for your father. If I can offer any encouragement, just please try to hold on. I too was in a similar situation caring for dad for 3 years. I had no end in sight and just when I thought I could not go on, GOD called him home. I lost my dad in October 2020. Again, you are an angel and GOD bless you!"

"This is my life right now. My 81 year old mom has been on the decline for the last 3 and half years. She lives with me and my spouse. I am 56. it is so hard. I have no life and am worried and stressed constantly. I am beaten down, exhausted & worn out. I rarely laugh anymore. Thank you for posting this!"

youtube · @GenXGal1 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 284 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugyqej9hZ2qGs2YAeBR4AaABAq

↳ **@robogal1** (32): "When I m some days far away from my mother I become a completely different person, happy, laughing, satisfied...it s a feeling of freedom. I m feeling so trapped, when I have to stay with her, cause she is always so mean, controlling everything I do, never satisfied, but it s my sense of duty., that makes me to look after her. I have no help, are completely alone! My brother, who was always her darling, doesn t care at all for her. He calls once a week, never visits her."

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (20): "Hi, I get it. I don't know if it is any tiny comfort but you are one of very many in this situation right now. It's beyond difficult. Do the best you can to be kind to yourself. I appreciate you sharing what's going on."

↳ **@TallRaucousTruthSeeker** (19): "@robogal1you better check she hasn't left everything she owns to your brother if she has a will. It wouldn't be beyond imagining. Either that or she'll take you for granted for years, cost you your life & leave everything to the cat protection society. It happens, I've seen it!"

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden , and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go , not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone . I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up.i told her I didn't feel well and would come up today . She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"Stubborn Father Refuses To Downsize Despite Being in His 90's. Expects Me To Be His Caregiver. My mother recently passed away in a tragic car accident and my siblings and I are trying to convince my father to downsize and move either into his own apartment or assisted living. I was living with them before my mother passed away so now I am his unpaid caregiver by default... thankfully he has no major medical issues beside occasional gout flare up's and arthritis since he's 96 but he expects me to cook, do laundry since he should not be going up & down the stairs to the basement, go grocery shopping using my own money (currently unemployed while he makes a pension of \$96,000 per year) clean the house and listen to his political ramblings. Essentially I've turned into a replacement wife for him which gives me a really weird feeling... This is something that a lot of other people here can relate to but trying to get him to move out of his large suburban house, downsize and simplify his life has been an uphill battle. Throw in severe weather events, a tornado that took out 40% of the large trees in his area, 2 basement floods last month due to the crazy severe weather and going through 5 week long power outages and I'm going insane - it can't be any clearer that he needs to move out of that house. He even got angry when I told him he needs to move and says he's "comfortable" in the house. Tried using logic saying he can't maintain the house anymore but he didn't want to hear it and dropped it before it became an argument.... Even despite all of that he shouldn't be living there since it's too big to maintain, there's the risk of falling down the stairs and he very worryingly will not fully give up the keys since he threw an epic temper tantrum when I tried to take them when he back his 26 year old car out of the garage and seemed to want to take it for a spin around the neighborhood to "run the engine." He been honestly a stubborn and insanely difficult person all of his life but dealing with him through all this has been an insane nightmare to the point of burning me out and exhausted dealing with him (sister-in-law said my mother should have divorced him decades ago since he has not changed his toxic ways as he got older) I don't think it's dementia - it's just him being a jerk and not thinking/ caring about the consequences of his actions which is a lifelong pattern of his as well as being too proud to face reality or adapt to his age. He had no plan for retirement other than saving as much money as possible and penny pinching to the point of deferring repairs on their house for years despite my mother begging him since that brings the value of their home down. I have 3 other siblings who give advice but don't really seem to want to step in due to him being unmanageable and not wanting to work with people. My older sister came to help last month but basically stepped away since she couldn't take him after that. She told me the same thing my therapist recently said: "Walk away and live your own life if he's being like this. He needs to learn to deal with the consequences of his choices instead of making you responsible for them if he's that stubborn." I would feel bit guilty walking away but I'm leaning that way. Weighing my options...."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w1wwws/stubborn_father_refuses_to_downsize_despite_being/

"THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much--COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 95 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobb2tw/

"What happens when you can't do this anymore?. I've posted before about feeling evil when you inevitably yell at a dementia patient and having mental breakdowns from caretaking, but when you feel like you can't do it anymore, when you feel "broken" and fear for your health and your patient, what do you do???? My mom has Alzheimer's/dementia. I've been taking care of her for nearly four years. She had a bad reaction to an antipsychotic she started taking a few months ago. She lost trunk control at the end of July. She couldn't walk on her own. I didn't know what to do. My brain froze and couldn't make a decision. I had to call a family member who

had to tell me to call 911. Even then, I couldn't do it. I started gathering clothes for her since she wasn't dressed and getting all manner of things ready. She might have had a stroke and I didn't respond in a timely manner. After a hospital stay, my mother ended up in rehab for a month. When she returned to me, the level of care I had to give increased exponentially. Now I'm changing diapers and having to clean up poop. I never wanted children or a family of my own. I don't have the temperament for intimate partners. I knew this about myself. I like peace, calm and anything that disturbs it, gets under my skin. I wake up in the morning and my mind like a movie on repeat keeps showing me the crap I cleaned the day before. I watch my mom pick her nose all day, yell at the TV, make up fake Spanish words. I have to brush her teeth and bathe her and I don't think I'm doing a good job, because I always find more crap. I've found myself crying and yelling and threatening to abandon her when she gets nasty and cusses me. I've thought of taking her to a hospital with no ID and just leaving her there. Where I once said no to a home, now I dream of it. But she needs an NHTD waiver. I've called the agency and NO ONE returns my call. The insurance company expects me to provide extra hours for my mom because we live together. But I'm at the point where my body and brain shuts down when it comes to care. It's like I avoid doing things she needs until I MUST do it. So my mom is not getting the care she needs. I have no family to help, my friends live far away and have their own lives and I'm afraid for myself and her. I had to put a lock on our door to prevent her wandering. That lock prevents people from getting in to. What if we have an emergency and no one can get in? At what point does the State or insurance companies recognize when you can't do this anymore? That you are mentally incapable, that your own health is in danger? At what point is there help???? Update: I finally did it. :-(last Wednesday, my mom refused to let the aide clean her, was yelling and cussing; refused to drink water. She only had 2 ounces in a 48 hour period. She also had not been cleaned in 18 hours. I explained the consequences of not drinking water, not eating, etc. Normally I can get her to do it by explaining consequences. She understands things, but doesn't hold the memory. This time, nothing I did worked. Finally, I called 911 and expressed my concerns over dehydration etc. They came and she was calm, alert and compliant when they asked her to drink water. She told them she would. I couldn't help but notice the smugness as though they were more capable than I and the aide. She took a sip that was it. No more. They decided it was best to take her to the hospital. They coaxed her up. The smell hit them and they said she needed to be cleaned and dressed before travel. That's when the sweet old lady disappeared. It took the two EMTs and the aide to get her ready. My mom cussed them all out. I couldn't help but laugh because I saw that smugness drop. I didn't travel with her. I spoke to the Dr on the phone and saw my mom for an hour before going home. The Dr called asking where I was. I explained that I left. Dr said her bloodwork was good and she wasn't dehydrated. She could go home. That's when I dropped the "unsafe discharge" language that I was advised about on this board. I said it. Dr insisted she couldn't hold her. She needed to see the neurologist and could go home. I repeated "unsafe discharge" again. Dr was annoyed but said they would admit her and I should see the social worker the next day. My mom is going into a facility until I can get 24 hour care. I'm home today because I've been visiting every day since then. I'm sad, but calm. I miss not having her here. But I know this is what's best for her. When I saw her in the hospital, she was clean and seemed content in a way that I couldn't get her at home. I also noticed her cussing when it took two aides to clean her, but she went back to her quiet self when they were done."

reddit post · r/dementia · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/

↳ **comment** (76): "You do have to take her to an emergency room and leave her there. It's OK. Tell them she isn't safe with you and refuse to take her home. They'll find a place for her. You've done enough."

↳ **comment** (42): "Thank you so much for not judging. Thank you! Thank you! Thank you! I had a family member tell me that no matter what choice I make, I'll be in pain. So I was told to choose my poison. We were once so close my mom and I. It's out of loyalty to who she was that I haven't done it. My mom is gone. I have this doppelgänger living with me. :-(

↳ **comment** (31): "I am so sorry. I can feel your frustration and worry in your words. This is a horrible, cruel disease, and will take down any single thing in its way. You do not have to do this anymore- you are not morally,

or legally obligated to keep setting yourself on fire to keep your mother warm! On the contrary, you are doing her a disservice by not getting her placed in long term care. You are not equipped to do the job of every profession working at a facility. I cannot speak for other countries, however, if you are in the US- you take her to the closest Emergency room, TODAY, as in RIGHT NOW- tell them her mental status is altered from her normal baseline. Then, once they've run every test under the sun, you say these exact words: "I am unable to care for her at home. It would be unsafe to discharge her." No more, no less. You'll likely get push-back, possibly even threats of them calling APS, or telling you that you are responsible, and that you must take her home. Some providers have gone as far as telling family members they can be arrested for abandonment; this is simply NOT TRUE. Unless there is a court order signed by a judge stating a person is a responsible guardian, no adult is responsible for another, period. Stand your ground. "This is an unsafe discharge." The onus will be on the hospitals' social work team to find acceptable placement for your mom. Keep in mind you may have no choice in WHERE that placement is, but they will have to find her a clean, dry bed in a setting with the level of care she needs. Is she on Medicare/Medicaid? What's her financial situation? This information will help us give you guidance on how to handle that side of things. Seriously, before you hurt her, or yourself, please don't feel like a failure or horrible child- it's time to wave the white flag."

"enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 45 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrz9lf8/

"You must be exhausted. I think that so many parents haven't encouraged their children to develop the skill of recognizing their own normal temporary feelings of tiredness, worry, anger, and other negative emotions. So in everyday life, small negative emotions aren't dealt with in a healthy way, then healthy boundaries and expectations aren't created as the years pass. Then one day, the parent is surprised that their adult child has accumulated too much, is now burnt out and has to go low/no contact to survive. Maybe I'm projecting, but that's how it feels."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 39 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walking_away_from_my_mom/p4f435x/

"She has good information. But if you don't take care of a parent(s) 24 hours a day, than you wouldn't understand. I took care of my step-father for years, it will wear you out! I built a house and put an apartment on the side for my Mother, seems like she wants to control everyone's life..smh...she is 85 years old and has always been this way..I have tried for 11 years to take care of her. Now I'm putting my house up for sale and getting an apartment, because I'm tired...and have the under eye bags and high blood pressure to prove it! She doesn't want to live with my brothers or sister, but I can't do this anymore. I would never want to live with my kids and depend on them to take care of me. It's so overwhelming!"

youtube · @jessicatucker2677 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 24 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgxHR50VILb_hyCwFk14AaABAg

↳ **@justsayn141** (1): "I'm just getting high blood pressure... It's been years of travel and care now its 24/7 ... no help at all!"

"Oh wow, this is a messy one—literally and figuratively. First off, I see you. You've done *everything* right here. You've arranged care, you've tried to reason with her, you've offered solutions, and yet... you're still stuck in the frustrating loop of "Mom refuses to budge." That's exhausting. The thing is, it sounds like your mom isn't operating from a place of logic; she's operating from a place of fear, attachment, and maybe even a little bit of denial. The dogs are probably her emotional lifeline, especially with her husband in and out of the hospital. But instead of caring *for* them, she's clinging *to* them, and now everyone else—caregivers, you, even the poor dogs—is drowning in the fallout. The APS involvement is probably a good thing at this point because it takes some of the weight off your shoulders. When professionals step in, sometimes people listen in a way they just won't when it's coming from family. But I get it—it's maddening to watch your lucid mom make choices that are objectively Not Okay. Since reasoning isn't working, you might have to lean into consequences. Not in a mean way, but in a *this-is-how-it's-gonna-go* way. Something like, "Mom, I know how much you love these dogs, but the situation is out of control. Caregivers are refusing to come, and you need them. If the dogs can't be let outside, we have to find another solution. I'm not asking anymore—we have to fix this." Sometimes drawing that hard line—not out of frustration, but out of necessity—can help push things forward. And listen, I know this hurts. You're watching your mom's world get smaller, her independence slip, and her choices become more irrational. It's heartbreaking. But it's also okay to be frustrated. You're not a bad person for wanting a clean, safe environment for her *and* for refusing to let her drag you down into her denial spiral. Let APS do their thing. Keep nudging, but protect your own sanity. And if you need to scream into a pillow, I highly recommend it."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1je5elr/aps_likely_getting_involved/mifv5iy/

"Taking care of a terminally ill parent at 24 and realizing how alone you actually are. I don't even know if this is a rant, a question, or just me shouting into the void, but I need to put this somewhere. I am 24. Living in Indore, India. I am currently trying to symptom manage my terminally ill mother while trying to manage my job while trying to manage insurance, while trying to manage everyone's needs. Every day is about medicines, food intake, IVs, fatigue, sleep cycles, doctor coordination, and just trying to keep her comfortable and alive with dignity. It is physically exhausting but honestly the mental load is worse. My father is emotionally drained to a point where he cannot take decisions. I understand he is hurting, but instead of standing with me and helping me decide what to do or not do, I end up handling everything. Sometimes he even adds more work unintentionally because he is not able to process things. My brother lives in the US. Peaceful life, stable routine, distance from all this. But he still tries to dictate how everything should be done from there. Calls, instructions, opinions, but not presence. Not actual load sharing. Just more pressure on me to do things exactly how he thinks they should be done. And I am just stuck in the middle of all this. No girlfriend. No real friend who has the maturity or guts to just sit beside me and exist with me in this phase. I have acquaintances. Same age group. 24 to 26. All from well to do families. Their families know what is happening with my mother. Still nobody shows up. Not even once. Not even to just sit for an hour. I used to think cities like Indore were socially connected. That people show up. But now I feel that only works when your life is good. When things are fun. When you are successful or happy or useful socially. The moment life gets ugly and heavy, people disappear. The worst part is I don't even know what kind of help people could have given, because nobody ever says "I can do this for you." And if I ask directly, they check convenience first. If it doesn't suit them, they say no. Which hurts more because I know they would show up for others. It genuinely makes me question what is wrong with me. And socially, I cannot even be real. I have to mask everything. I cannot show grief, fear, anger, or breakdowns because people get uncomfortable. So I end up acting normal so that they don't have to deal with reality. I feel like I am living two lives. One where I am managing a dying parent and holding a family together. Another where I pretend everything is fine so that people don't run

away. Is this what adulthood is? Is this what society is now? Or am I just surrounded by the wrong people? I don't even know what I am expecting from posting this. Maybe just to know if someone else has lived this and survived it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r40qaf/taking_care_of_a_terminally_ill_parent_at_24_and/

"I feel like I am drowning and failing my mom. I'm not really sure what I'm looking for by posting this. Maybe advice, maybe support from people who understand. My mom is 62, but her health has been getting worse in multiple ways. She has serious mobility problems, falls, needs help with basic things, and now her memory and thinking are declining too. Her texts are starting to come through garbled or missing words. She forgets things within hours. She can't really manage checks or finances anymore. Even simple things that used to be normal for her are becoming confusing, the other day she wanted to cook something, so she put the crockpot on the stove and turned the stove on. I'm her son, and I'm trying to help take care of her, but I feel completely overwhelmed. I help with appointments, bills, safety, medication reminders, mobility, and just trying to keep her life from falling apart. At the same time, I have brain damage and health problems myself, so I don't always feel like I'm mentally or physically equipped to handle all of this. I feel like I'm trying to keep both of us above water, and some days I barely feel capable of doing that. My mental health has been getting really bad from all of this. I feel angry, scared, guilty, exhausted, and trapped. I feel like I'm failing her, even though I know I'm doing more than a lot of people would. It is hard watching someone you love lose pieces of themselves, especially when you already struggle with your own health. We are currently in the queue for aging/disability services, and I'm also trying to figure out whether I could qualify for paid caregiver assistance. One thing I'm worried about is that some programs seem to talk about helping the person learn or maintain skills. But with my mom's cognitive decline, I honestly don't know how realistic that is anymore. I can show her something, and she may forget it a few hours later. It feels less like "teaching skills" now and more like keeping her safe, helping her function, and preventing things from getting worse. Another painful part is that my now ex-stepdad basically decided her health problems were too much and she couldn't stay there anymore. I don't want to get too deep into that, but it hurts. It feels like she got pushed out when she needed people most. I'm not trying to bash my mom. She is the one suffering the most here. I'm just tired and scared and trying to figure out how to keep going. For anyone who has cared for a parent with cognitive decline and physical disability, how did you deal with the guilt and the constant feeling that you're not doing enough? And if you also had your own health or mental health problems while caregiving, how did you survive it without completely falling apart? Also, if anyone has dealt with caregiver programs where the parent can't realistically learn new skills anymore, how did you explain that to agencies?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugk009/i_feel_like_i_am_drowning_and_failing_my_mom/

"I hear ya. Every word. When i get fed up i start to yell and scream and I feel my brain breaking apart from stress. I end up feeling so guilty thought. Always. Cause it's not her fault but also I'm tired. And I fear for my own health. All this stress almost every single day— what will happen to me? And I DO have siblings but they're unhelpful and they don't understand that when I've reached my limit I yell at them too but they dont see it as a cry for help. They just think I'm being a grumpy old bish. :(I've been caregiving for my mom for over ten years she has frontotemporal dementia. I'm 34. And these stupid societies and organizations that say they'll help, don't do shit. I say if your mom has no memory of who you are to her, maybe putting her in a home is better, or any similar option. This phase will pass someday and you'll be free. Hugs."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/ne9bktz/

"Please help: advice on getting into memory care through medicaid (NY/NJ). Please help. My mom is stage 6 lives alone in NYC. Has aids for 25hrs a week. My aunt is her caregiver but she is burning out. I live in NJ. We are ready to put my mom in memory care. We might be able to pay for several months but thats it, we'll need help from medicaid. I tried calling many places. Turns out in NY Medicaid has a blind spot for memory care. NY Medicaid only covers assisted living (which when i call I'm told my mom does not qualify for because she can wonder) or nursing home(which my mom doesn't qualify for because she is still mobile). When i call NJ facilities near me, they all ask for 2 years pay. We don't have that kind of money. Some places tell me if my mom says she doesn't want to be there, they will discharge her. Idk what to do. Some say to take her to the hospital and tell them she is not safe to come home. Others says that doesn't work especially if she has no reason to be admitted to the hospital. Im trying to find a good facility for my mom but this is a nightmare and my aunt is getting really burnt out taking care of my mom. Aunt is 6 years older than my mom."

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1vbf21r/please_help_advice_on_getting_into_memory_care/

"Taking care of my 89 year old mother who had a stroke 16 months ago has been an exhausting NIGHTMARE. There's so little joy or happiness in the house as a result. Don't anybody feed me any lies or BS about how it's not so bad....."

youtube · @colderbeer · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 9 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgxRosdz0l0aFj2SnOZ4AaABAg>

↳ **@spasiboo9** (1): "I thought I was going crazy with this video and realized this lady and her speech is absolutely nonsense. You're right. You're not alone. And it feels like it. I know .. and then we see this nonsense. Smh. Hey pal, I'm just a stranger looking at the comments but I want to say to all and you you're doing so much. Idk when it'll end but God damnit. It's hard and idk can't tell you when it won't be.... Idk man. But thank you on behalf everyone else who never says it. ♥"

Losing them: the last time · 22 documents

17 most engaged of 22 matching documents, complete text.

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/live_never_been_more_upset_wit_h_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"Rethinking falls. About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they now have (and of course managing this is all on me). Of course multiple people, including myself, had told them they needed a stair lift, but they didn't listen, because it was "too expensive." So much of the advice around aging is around preventing falls. And yes, they should be prevented if you want to keep living. But – and this is cold – we keep acting as though we want elderly people to live forever, and then as a society we don't support them, or us the caregivers. Falls are terrible and painful and I wish my mom hadn't had one. But it should have been the end. The EMTs should've come and said oh, sweetheart, this is terrible, we are giving you morphine. It is utterly crazy that she was in the hospital for so long and cost taxpayers well over \$1 million in Medicare, only to come home and require so much care and drain their finances and eventually go on Medicaid. I don't know what we do about this. When my mom fell, I felt like she almost subconsciously had done it on purpose. That summer she had been telling me how tired she was, and how she was ready to quit taking care of my dad, who is very demanding, and my disabled sibling (that's a whole other story). I was sure we were going to lose her and of course at the time I didn't want to but now I realize that would have been the natural thing. Figured you all would relate. I am not doing this to my kids."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 337 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

↳ **comment** (206): "This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

↳ **comment** (78): "My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

↳ **comment** (65): "Your poor mama. She is TIRED of dealing with your dad and sibling. The hospital, as awful as they can be, may have been a respite for her. Meals delivered. Her own bathroom. Mostly sweet staff. Poor you. You must be mentally exhausted on top of juggling THREE of them. The money drain is no lie. THREE DEPENDENTS in a two story house? How in the world? She's exhausted caregiving. She's probably been putting up with your difficult daddy with his demands all her life and you don't say when your sibling became disabled, but if it's been lifelong? Or since their 20's? That burns even saints out early. If they've qualified for Medicaid, can the house be sold and they go to skilled care or assisted senior living? Surely that would be cheaper than trying to maintain a home for three people needing 24 hour care."

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of

caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"Both of my parents are in a life threatening crisis, and they shift the blame on me because I try to help. I live a few states away from my family. My mother (65) had a botched surgery last year and has been in a physical and mental health spiral ever since. She has several comorbidities and one of the top ones is extreme insomnia, like 3 hours of sleep a night on average. This has caused her to lose grasp with reality due to psychosis. She refuses to take any medication, doesn't trust doctors. Doesn't have proper nutrition or hydration. Every time I call she is in absolute hysterics without fail, like full on crying fits and panics. My father is her primary caregiver and he is facing full caregiver collapse. He is now an insomniac too, cries all the time, and I think he is hiding self harm from me. Here's what really bothers me: he reinforces her psychosis. Tells her that she doesn't have to take the medicine if she doesn't want to. Says he doesn't trust her doctors. He is very mentally ill himself and is unfitting as a caregiver. They both have delusions that people are coming to "take them away to the loony bin" or arrest them if they seek help. I have made a million phone calls to physicians, department of aging, other family members. What ultimately happens is that when my parents are confronted with harsh truths (like "hey you need to escalate care") they refuse, downplay, or just explode in anger. Well I had one of those anger explosions over the phone recently. Suddenly everything was my fault because I was "making too many phone calls". I told them that if my mother does not take her medication I will have to call her doctor again. They both lost it on me. Told me this is

my fault because I'm not there with them. Told me both "leave us alone" and "you're too far away", so basically any situation I'm at fault. Full disclosure, my father was very physically and emotionally abusive to me growing and this brought me right back to the feeling of being a little scared boy. At this point I have absolved of the situation. I don't think I will hear my mother's voice again by Christmas and I'm afraid what my dad might will do once she passes. But I can't insert myself in this chaos anymore. No more agencies, no more phone calls. Shit sucks man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 132 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ts88af/both_of_my_parents_are_in_a_life_threatening/

"What to do when you don't want to or can't be the caregiver?. Mom is getting to the point she is going to need more care and I live in fear that I'm going to be forced to take care of her. I know that probably sounds awful but she's very controlling, manipulative, and self centered and after living my life for 4 decades to please her and nearly losing my wife and kiddo because of her I know I can't do it. Mentally or physically. There's already been several hints from her saying she's moving on with us, she's tried claiming dibs on certain rooms in our house talked about how she's going to redecorate our home to her liking and I'm going to be honest my wife said if I move my mom in she is leaving same day. But then there is the problem of I also can't afford to fund an assisted living facility or in home care for her, like the money just isn't there and I couldn't work more to make up for it as I'm already working more than full-time. So what do I do?? Medicare doesn't cover assisted living or in home care, she has spent through her 401k, she's up to her eyeballs in debt from spending non stop, she has no other family but me. I've called council on aging and elder care many times and literally never get a call back from anyone. I'm in Florida."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 109 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t86ufb/what_to_do_when_you_dont_want_to_or_cant_be_the/

"My mom is in long term care and my dad is in their condo. She's been out of the house for over a year now and my dad still has all of her toiletries in his bathroom counter. The last time I was there I spent 3 hours cleaning out her dresser and disposing of many years os useless papers and trash. We are having him move to assisted living soon and I am dreading the process. But I have decided we will use an estate sale company and I will mostly just have to deal with the papers and move out the items he will need in assisted living. Their 3 br condo is almost overflowing with jist random stuff."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v62aym/dealing_with_the_stuff/ozns4e7/

"Every year right before Thanksgiving I have to remind my mom of the rule about Xmas gifts for my daughter... 1 toy, 1 outfit, 1 book. She will find loopholes for the toys, ignore the rules (fine, those things stay at your house then), or use guilt a la, "What if this is my last Xmas?" I keep reminding her this isn't a new rule, and none of us know when our last Xmas will be. I've stopped feeling bad donating clothes, tags still on, she's bought my daughter that weren't her style or she out grew because she loves to shop too much. Yeah, gift limits are hard. My grandparents? They sent a card with \$5. My mom didn't have to deal with this."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v62aym/dealing_with_the_stuff/p049ok1/

"Woah- I said nothing about deporting. I said she needs to go back to Poland. As in, someone needs to convince her of that- not put her on a damned plane. My husband and I have been discussing retiring in France and we agreed that it could only be temporary. Unless one of us passes in our early senior years, eventually we will have to return to an English-speaking country for assisted living to end of life care. I dont want my last years being

surrounded by people who could be friends but can't be because we don't speak the language. Of course OP's mom is welcome to stay in the country she immigrated to. But without speaking the language, her last years are going to be spent isolated by a language barrier. OP has made it clear that the situation will not work."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_so_on_my_adult_life_is/n9f7wko/

"This is why I don't want to survive this. I can't handle being selfish. I feel trauma from every time I don't pour out 110% of myself because what if it's the last time. My life and personhood has been irreparably ruined. I am looking into doing VSED for my chronic illnesses worsened by the stress of caregiving. They say half the time, the caregiver dies first. To that I say, well hurry up then God. You see me every time when I lay down to sleep praying I won't wake up again. Every caregiver out there knows this feeling and it's heartbreaking there are so many of us without the help we need."

youtube · @braced_and_dredpilled · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgZrGkvVuINf5ATWI7J4AaABAq>

↳ **@jimb309** (O): "I hear you. Many times I have prayed for God to remove this trial from me, but first Lord, I need to make sure everything is in order! I still need to have a hard talk with our daughters (who are in denial, they don't want to talk about their dad; they don't even call). But I want to tell them what they need to do to make sure their dad is cared for. I would never do anything to myself. I just want to be sure to arrange things for my DH so if the Lord chose to take me, I will have done all that I needed to do to button up things here on Earth."

"My mother (82) has Parkinson's and had a stroke last year. She has plainly told me that she's tired and she's ready to go. Her body aches, she can't walk reliably, she frequently soils herself and she had never wanted to live like this when she got old. She keeps saying it will "be a blessing" when she passes. She has even suggested to us kids that we should not call an ambulance the next time she loses consciousness. I had to gently remind her that we could get arrested if we didn't get her timely care when it is needed."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oizmyo1/

"I think that the fact that you are asking here what to do shows more than people who are saying "just go" notice. Sure you need to keep living, but how many times do you have to pause your life because your parent is dying? You have your whole life to go on vacations. Would you feel ok with your decision if he dies while you are on vacation? Would your relationship with your mother stay the same if you go? I personally wouldn't be able to do it or to live with it after it, but my dad was my best friend and I loved him so much, for me being with him in his last days would have been important and I wouldn't have enjoyed a vacation because I would have been worried 24/7, but again that's me with my relationship with my dad. Ask yourself the questions I posted in the previous paragraph if you are ok with it, do it, otherwise stay."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/ooab843/

"My mum is relying on me for everything. When I am looking after my son with autism and ADHD. I can't stand being around my mum, I have childhood trauma from her and her cruel ways I am losing my hair with Alopecia and stress, when I am sick myself with Fibromyalgia. I am a care giver to everyone but myself!"

youtube · @janeberry7613 · *MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP* · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=Ugz_o5G0kyevTnbTPNB4AaABAq

"Had to quit my job five years ago, we had to start taking them to their doctors appointments,,& stop them from driving, my dad starting having frequent falls and the last time he never left the hospital, before dad passed we had just set them up to be together in an assisted living facility so they could be together, it was a total nightmare trying to get my dad the physical therapy he needed and then get the level of care they both required, Basically we were lied to ,, Dad did pass away on February 10th only a month after we got them moved in. Thankfully my sister and brother n law were at s point where they were empty nesters and looking to downsize,, so sold their huge home and moved into mom & dads house so they could care for mother who has stage 4 dementia... Thank goodness they were able to sell their home and move down which gave me and my husband the first break in seven years and parent caring... Needless to say it's been quite an eye-opening experience and I feel your pain"

youtube · @terriikemeier7120 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=Ugy10i7TDzWeWIRqk914AaABAg>

"So much for ramps, I live on the second floor of an apartment. It's kinda hard for my mom to go up and down the stairs without dreading her falling or losing her balance. Even with her walker, not always does she use it, because she wants to do things on her own. I try not to discourage her, but always try to remind her of what could happen if she doesn't. She has already fractured a couple vertebrae, thankfully she has healed. However, falling seems to run on my mom's side. I have got family who heavily rely on me to take care of her. If my mom needs something, I walk to the pharmacy to pick up her medication. If she needs food or something else, I walk to the store to get it. A lot of the stores are near me, which is very nice. My grandma fell a lot when she was alive and now my mom is experiencing the same thing."

youtube · @cici6295 · *TOP TIPS FOR NEW FAMILY CAREGIVERS - How to Take care of Aging Parents* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g0UwGxD4F90&lc=UgyKVgi74THbVTlgQ-t4AaABAg>

↳ **@SofiaAmirpoor** (2): "@cici6295 Hi, thanks for stopping by! You might want to try asking the landlord if you could re-relocate to a first floor apartment unit when one is available. Maybe if you got a letter from your mom's doctor saying it was a medical necessity they wouldn't charge you for the move. I think it's definitely worth a try because a fall down those stairs would be horrible. Sounds like you're doing a great job for your mom, she's lucky!"

↳ **@cici6295** (0): "@SofiaAmirpoorto answer your question about moving down to the first floor. There is actually a problem with that. I did speak with my landlord about what you suggested and she told me that in order to move into a lower level apartment. We would have to move from the apartment we are in and relocate somewhere, until an apartment is available. We can't just move in, sadly. There is a waiting period apparently. It's the rules of our apartment."

↳ **@tonyagaddie6111** (0): "@cici6295do what you can to get to a lower apartment. Get on waiting list and maybe there's a different complex close by with available unit now. Good luck to you."

"There is no help in my mountry, no places in nouring home, hospitals do not want to accept patiens (it is noones department they say), i do not work becouse i must stay at home, i can not get financial support or formal status as "caregiver" I am practicaly nursing my mother till she dies, she can not move, eat, chande dipers..etc. Complete care needed and literally no one to help. Gp doctor comes and states "yeah, she has low blood pressure, bad apetite etc." - and thats all. Thank you for teling me whats wrong but i see it myself For you to know witch this f* up country it is Croatia - with big hole in medical system for much cases that happen to patients/caregivers"

youtube · @sinisak.138 · *TOP TIPS FOR NEW FAMILY CAREGIVERS - How to Take care of Aging Parents* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g0UwGxD4F90&lc=UgyihNHbk6chUEw_Ld14AaABAg

"Thank you so much, I needed to hear this. Caring full time for my amputee elderly mother, my disabled husband and my daughter with autism. I'm slowly losing myself. Prior to this I cared for my dad full time through his short but harrowing cancer journey at home, may he rest in peace. This was closely just after I cared for my Nan with dementia at her house, may she rest in peace. It's been non stop from one person to another for what seems forever. The worry, the exhaustion, the guilt for everything. I'm losing myself. I am disabled too."

youtube · @jojo1234a · *The Hidden Burnout Millions of Caregivers Are Facing | Mel Robbins #Shorts* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dZTbJb5Nml8&lc=UgxDB5CLgEgF_-dsprB4AaABAg

"I'm alone with 5 older siblings im 21 and I solely take care of my mom I'm so exhausted and so alone I no longer work or care for myself im scared to lose my mom and lose myself in the process.."

youtube · @matisari7982 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgxV7pirp6Q7FhjWEmJ4AaABAg>

↳ **@AlgorMortisX** (1): "I'm the youngest of 3 children and I'm in the same boat as you. My siblings are "too busy" with their families so I'm left with the care alone for my mother. And I understand: I put my stuff aside and haven't been working on myself since 2022 when my mother lost mobility. Hang in there, I'll send a prayer your way."

↳ **@Megatrance9000** (1): "@AlgorMortisX I'm in the same boat. Does it get any better? I don't know how much more I can take."

↳ **@matisari7982** (0): "@AlgorMortisX my mother as well has no mobility, and my siblings are as well "busy" and our of state and the ones that do live in state are in jail."

Falls, the ER, the floor · 20 documents

14 most engaged of 20 matching documents, complete text.

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?!) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this

week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you* not suffer. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"I can't do this anymore, and I never agreed to be a caregiver to my mother's husband.. To sum up some background context, my mom remarried when I was in my mid 20's about 20 years ago. My mom asked me to move in 3.5 years ago to temporarily help her with my son. My mom died 3 years ago, my son died a year ago. I have never been close to her husband, he didn't even start being nice to me till my mom died. I feel I can't leave because I'm the only person he doesn't kick out. I'm coming from a place of deep frustration at the moment, and I'm sorry if I sound like a soulless monster. I just can't do this anymore. My parents didn't divorce till I was an adult. In extreme desperation, I assume my married, lets call him Frank. (now 75) Frank was the opposite of my father who my mother loved dearly in every bad way. He was uneducated, uncaring and had no family values, but what I could I do. It was her choice to marry him after 4 months. I had my own life going on and briefly stayed with them after being left during my third trimester of pregnancy till my son was six weeks old. Frank, made sure I knew that I had to get out after I gave birth and that my mom was not going to be a "babysitter" She did what he said, she liked being controlled. So, my mom undergoes what I felt was an unnecessary medical procedure that caused complications. She asked me and my teenage son to move in to help her overcome her health obstacles. Frank decides to get an unnecessary elective surgery and my mom actually kills herself trying to care take to him afterward. I was distraught to say the least and I never blamed Frank for my mom's choices. I could say in detail every event that has made me choose not to leave. But I want someone to read this. I'm being manipulated, and I know this and he kicks out any of his family including his daughter who left earlier this year, traumatized from PTSD he gave her and won't come back. Frank is from a different state, all his large family lives there. He refuses to go there and kicks out any adult grandchild etc that is sent to help because I have made it known I want to move out of here. He is completely fine with me here, especially since my son died. I don't get up in his business because I'm too consumed with my own grief and we live separate lives, but I clean. His life is watching Forensic Files, lurking Facebook and spending my dead mom's money on cam girls and what he knows are scams. Oh, and lot's of Dr visits, he has always loved going to the doctor. He is not being medically neglected, he more overrides the health care system by getting a Dr appointment for anything. He has destroyed his body signing up for clinical trials. He also loves to kick out home health nurses, go to the ER afterward and report the aides of injuring him and theft. (nothing has been stolen) My life is I constantly work to stay busy and out of my own head. I don't stay here out of financial security. I can very much afford to not be here. I'm paying for my own father's assisted living in NYC and I would be in a bind if I was footing two bills. He doesn't want assisted living anyhow and I know its just a matter of time till he burns through my mom's money and I become financially responsible for him. (Help pay for my father's assisted living. He is smart and planned for this, just not in NYC. He hates Texas and I can't blame him. I help with the offset cost, not the entire huge bill) The neighbors of 20 years have been very

supportive of him and me. They will take him to the ER for his unnecessary reasons, or will show up at the hospital because he decides to call 911 while I'm in therapy. Today, Frank has burned bridges with the neighbors and I'm terrified. They are all the support I have. The only support he has. So I come "home" from my typical 12 hour day with a trunk full of groceries only to find a large snake in the garage. I'm like great, go inside to get a broom and Frank calls out my name all cranky. We briefly discuss the snake. He then goes on about how mad he is because he fell twice trying to mow the lawn in 95 degree Texas heat. I'm like why are you mad? That was your own fault. He then goes and blames the next door neighbor for not mowing it for him like she normally does. And then blames me for not reading his mind. I didn't even notice it needed to be mowed. It wasn't that bad. I'm like that is not her job to mow your lawn and you could have asked me. He carries on about how we caused him to fall and I leave the unreasonable situation to get the groceries. My other neighbor calls me over and asks me wtf his problem is because he had to pick him up twice when he tried to mow the lawn causing panic all up the street. I give him the synopsis of what he said. Other neighbor tells me, you know he doesn't have cognitive decline and is just an asshole. I agree and he says I'm done. Go save yourself, I mean that. Other neighbor is a man of his word. He should have been done long ago as should have I. I'm terrified and have to accept that I'm not a horrible person for failing to save Frank from himself and choosing myself. Edit: sorry for all the typos and grammar mistakes my phone is freaking out too, and I need to get this out! And the 3 foot snake is still chilling in the garage. I will snake wrestle when it becomes daylight. Edit Edit: Is this normal on his part. I have read that as people age, they can become the worst form of themselves or the best form of who they wanted be. Edit: Thank you all so much!! The gaslighting is real. I needed to know this is with out a doubt, not my problem. I got into with him over the weekend when he tried to blame me for my mom's death. You don't go there with me and I don't stoop to his level. I was the bigger person and said: Me: I don't know what you want from me! Especially if you treat me like this Him: I should not have to say it. Me: Actually you do have to say what you want from me because I have no idea. Him: You know it! Me: I have no idea Him: I'm sick of repeating myself. Nobody listens. I want you out of here. I'm like sweet! I'll leave happily. I told him I'm leaving after the 4th weekend so I could find a place with out being overly dramatic and he needs to call his family and tell them he asked me to leave. Of course he is acting like that never happened. I just found some big chain complex that has an apartment available for move in 07/06. I'm taking it and can transfer units or complex's later if I need. Im too nice still and hired a lawn company to clear out any snake inviting debris and staying friendly to get what I want of my mother's. I know I'm not through with it all, once he dies, gets forced placed in a nursing home or loses the house taking out equity loans, I will have to clean it up. It will probably all happen within a week and this year. I did what I could but I can't sacrifice the remaining good years of my life so he can do whatever it is he does. Edit edit: I have always refused to be his POA or have any type of decision making authority with him. That was all settled with his family earlier this year and I was vocal I want nothing to do with this. His poor daughter is POA and will be the one really stuck to clean up this mess he leaves behind. He got her to sign up for that while she was emotionally vulnerable. There is nothing to gain when he dies, anything liquid he tore through after my mom died. I will help his daughter though emotionally. Her feelings towards him make mine seem warm and fuzzy. I will keep in my mind that they are not my family and trust no one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 126 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugwxtv/i_cant_do_this_anymore_and_i_never_agreed_to_be_a/

"Stubborn Father Refuses To Downsize Despite Being in His 90's. Expects Me To Be His Caregiver. My mother recently passed away in a tragic car accident and my siblings and I are trying to convince my father to downsize and move either into his own apartment or assisted living. I was living with them before my mother passed away so now I am his unpaid caregiver by default... thankfully he has no major medical issues beside occasional gout flare up's and arthritis since he's 96 but he expects me to cook, do laundry since he should not be going up & down the stairs to the basement, go grocery shopping using my own money (currently unemployed while he makes a pension of \$96,000 per year) clean the house and listen to his political ramblings. Essentially I've turned into a replacement wife for him which gives me a really weird feeling... This is something that a lot of other people here

can relate to but trying to get him to move out of his large suburban house, downsize and simplify his life has been an uphill battle. Throw in severe weather events, a tornado that took out 40% of the large trees in his area, 2 basement floods last month due to the crazy severe weather and going through 5 week long power outages and I'm going insane - it can't be any clearer that he needs to move out of that house. He even got angry when I told him he needs to move and says he's "comfortable" in the house. Tried using logic saying he can't maintain the house anymore but he didn't want to hear it and dropped it before it became an argument.... Even despite all of that he shouldn't be living there since it's too big to maintain, there's the risk of falling down the stairs and he very worryingly will not fully give up the keys since he threw an epic temper tantrum when I tried to take them when he back his 26 year old car out of the garage and seemed to want to take it for a spin around the neighborhood to "run the engine." He been honestly a stubborn and insanely difficult person all of his life but dealing with him through all this has been an insane nightmare to the point of burning me out and exhausted dealing with him (sister-in-law said my mother should have divorced him decades ago since he has not changed his toxic ways as he got older) I don't think it's dementia - it's just him being a jerk and not thinking/ caring about the consequences of his actions which is a lifelong pattern of his as well as being too proud to face reality or adapt to his age. He had no plan for retirement other than saving as much money as possible and penny pinching to the point of deferring repairs on their house for years despite my mother begging him since that brings the value of their home down. I have 3 other siblings who give advice but don't really seem to want to step in due to him being unmanageable and not wanting to work with people. My older sister came to help last month but basically stepped away since she couldn't take him after that. She told me the same thing my therapist recently said: "Walk away and live your own life if he's being like this. He needs to learn to deal with the consequences of his choices instead of making you responsible for them if he's that stubborn." I would feel bit guilty walking away but I'm leaning that way. Weighing my options...."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w1vwws/stubborn_father_refuses_to_downsize_despite_being/

"I am also living through this. I feel I am going out of my mind, stuck in this house with my 96 yr old Mom!! I retired at 62 yrs old so I could relax and travel with my partner. After 2 mos of my retirement my Mom fell and broke her hip. That's when my nightmare started. I have a sister but doesn't help with Mom cause "she's too busy" and lives far. Shes 45 min away!! My mom has dementia so she's paranoid, suspicious, cries and thinks everyone is stealing her belongings. Its been 4 yrs now, I have developed heart issues, anxiety, depression. My partner left me 2 mos ago. He was not going to put his life on hold, and I don't blame him. So now I'm here with a broken heart and dealing with my Mom. I pray that God give me patience and comfort, but I don't know how long I will be able to take this situation 😞 "

youtube · @jennynunez7946 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 75 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiEw&lc=UgxPp_X5N3UIkTFLuyB4AaABAq

↳ **@wordswordswords8203** (12): "Wow that is bad. I'm in a very similar situation. If I can't get my elderly mom out of my house I think I am going to die. I have so many health problems now and I feel like I am going completely insane."

↳ **@hellohello17983** (11): "sorry to hear that...i am single 36yo taking care of my parents.... not that i was so determined to get married but then it sucks that i now dont even have the chance... i am constantly sad, depressed and angry..... God, pls help us all..."

↳ **@73cidalia** (10): "There need to be more options, affordable options, for families dealing with this. Given your mom's age and condition, that would be a situation that warrants her being cared for in a nursing home."

"My dad, keeps falling. Complaining he might fall. I drive 1000 miles, buy him a walker, he refused to use it. He complained he couldn't get down low enough to sit on the toilet. I buy a high seat with handles, his answer was get that out of here! He complained he was worried he'd fall in the shower. I bought a shower chair and a grab handle for the shower. He yelled, get that out! Finally he fell, broke his hip, in rehab for 6 weeks. On and on the saga goes. Now he wants me to come out because his foot hurts. Last time I was out for 8 weeks, he absolutely refused for me to get hired help lined up so he'd have help just a phone call away. Nope, I'm the phone call away."

youtube · @kellyk8966 · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 70 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwr9JSAIAo&lc=UgzQADKMy_8ZbuNsusl4AaABAg

↳ @nonawolf7495 (11): "Do we have the same father??? OMG - same story."

↳ @Ann-oy5yb (3): "Refuse to see him unless he eats organic raw veggies and fruits. It is only these foods that cause a person to be strong."

↳ @parscreationsstapp8419 (3): "this sounds like my situation. She is five hours away and does not want to be a burden on me (moving closer), or does not want the stress of moving. She needs help with everyday activities, and keeping one insurance, using the phone, making decisions, because she either doesn't make one, or changes her mind often. She likes any change to be her decision, I am fine with that, of course, if she would make them and stick to them."

"Mom fell... again. My mom lives by herself. She's had her health struggles but she loves to walk. I convinced her to get a watch with fall detection last year after she fell several times while she was out walking. She keeps saying that it's just because she "wasn't paying attention" but today she fell again and now I'm waiting at the ER while she gets stitches in her forehead... again. I'm scared for her to lose the only thing that really makes her happy but this is the third time she's getting stitches in her forehead in as many years. I'd be open to suggestions. **edit 15hrs later** Thank you all for your suggestions and care. She is open to getting a PT assessment and will be talking to her PCP in the next week or two. Some issues I'm trying to think through in terms of getting her assistance include... - She's vegan, not out of ideology but simply really dislikes the flavor of animal products. I've already looked into this and very few of the assisted living in our area offer vegetarian meals let alone vegan options. - She has extreme social anxiety. While she has a few close friends, finding a stranger she will feel comfortable accompanying her on walks will be very hard."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 60 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1btlmzi/mom_fell_again/

↳ **comment** (46): "Ugh I feel for both of you! She needs a PT evaluation. They can figure out how to keep her walking as safely as possible. Request a referral fr her PCP."

↳ **comment** (28): "Maybe a mobility aid? I know some elders with serious balance issues who use trekking poles on their walks and love them."

↳ **comment** (8): "Yes, great idea if a PT approves! Be careful with use of loops - handy to keep hold of poles, but if put on incorrectly, can injure a wrist in a fall."

"This really hits close to home. My parents are (were) both the same age as yours. My dad had a stroke 8 years ago and lost his speech and the ability to use his right arm. Mom and I were the primary caretakers. She was diagnosed with ALS in October of '24 and died in May of '25. I was caretaking two parents from October of '24 until her death and have been caretaking dad since her passing while working a full time job (swing shifts in heavy manufacturing). Life. It is exhausting. I really feel for you. But if there is any solace, just know you aren't doing this alone. It may feel that way, but there are others out there just like you who have these same burdens. For us, we have relied on help from aunts and a hired caretaker. Every so often we get a meal from an unexpected friend

or neighbor. Mostly though, people tend to forget. Life goes on after someone passes - and that happens disgustingly fast. Hell, my mother's own sister (with whom she was really close) hasn't even bothered to show up to our house once this past year. She says "it is too painful". No shit, Sherlock. Think it is easy walking into the house I had to watch my mom die in? Just to have to do chores and clean and cook and pay bills? You are in survival mode. At this point, just focus on the minutes and the hours, not the days and the weeks. Stay as present as possible. One day this will no longer be your burden and you will have the weight of guilt alleviated from your shoulders because you will know that you did everything you could for your father. Use whatever resources you have to cast a wide net - family, friends, coworkers, etc. See if you can find an aide to come to the house that you can pay under the table. Cash. They might not be able to give you 12 hours (maybe they can) but even if they can give you 8 hours, you take that. If your father is on Medicare / Medicaid, exhaust every option for in-home health care possible. Set up a routine with other family who might be able and willing to help ("Aunt Suzie brings dinner every Tuesday, Uncle Mike stays with Dad every other Friday for 4 hours"). Most importantly - get into counseling. Seriously. Do it. When I shifted into caretaker mode my mental health went to absolute shit. I've always struggled with anxiety, but those months broke me. I ended up in the hospital due to a massive panic attack that I thought was a heart attack. You got this."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 39 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok82xgl/

"My mom is dying from COPD and is in denial. My mom has smoked for my entire life. Give or take probably about a pack a day everyday for 30-40 years. I have a wonderful stepfather who has been taking care of her. She started being hospitalized sporadically about 4 years ago with RSV, pneumonia, bronchitis - all things I knew were either because of her smoking or likely much more severe because of so. In the last year or so, these hospitalizations have happened more frequently as well as "mysterious" health issues that have made her lose weight and generally be lethargic and low energy. Through a lot of testing, we were able to rule out cancer and other things like that. This has been frustrating as it has been an elephant in the room that no one brings attention to for fear of my now very physically, mentally, and emotionally fragile mom to become upset. TLDR; over the last week she was hospitalized back to back. Once where my mom was so evasive I finally called her mid panic attack and she acted like nothing was wrong. And a second time where she was so woozy (presumably from high CO₂) that she fell and broke her shoulder and had to go to the hospital again. She is now home, only because she was sent home with equipment that will help rid the CO₂ out of her effectively and we are consulting with palliative care. I called her (the first time she's let me talk to her since she fell) acting in denial. I told her I was coming home tomorrow and she basically cried and asked me not to - she wants to hide. Whether I'm coming home to spend whatever time I have left with my mom, or to try to help her actually quit smoking, I need to be home with her and we need to get incredibly honest with each other. But talking about smoking with my mom has been the one "non-negotiable" topic we've ever had. She gets defensive and we've never been able to talk openly about it. My mom has an extensive trauma history, she carries a lot of shame, I would bet everything that she is so embarrassed that she is now incurably ill and in denial that she may not make it until the end of the year if she doesn't stop. **Here's where I need your help as those suffering with COPD/as a loved one of someone suffering with COPD (or other chronic illness):** I am almost 30 and became a therapist, specifically specializing in addiction. I don't want to act as a psychoeducator or therapist - I want to be her daughter. While I am desperate for her to quit smoking, I also honor the dignity of her choice to her body and her actions. I want to express this desperate plea once very compassionately (so I don't have any regrets), and then get honest with her about what she's feeling and thinking and figure out how I can best support her for this next chapter of life. **What is your advice about how to talk with her about this? For example, I don't necessarily think that the best thing here is to lead with "STOP SMOKING" aphorisms and hopeful pleas. I want to focus on not letting smoking define how to treat her even if it is the addiction that will take her away from me in front of my very eyes despite my pleas. What would you want to hear from your child/loved one? How could I support her now if she doesn't believe she can quit smoking? How can I support**

her if she chooses not to stop smoking? Thank you in advance! We are also in process of getting a family therapy session scheduled with her individual therapist - both parties have already agreed."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w8g2pi/my_mom_is_dying_from_copd_and_is_in_denial/

"Anyone have experience with medical alert systems that actually work?. My dad fell in his garage last week and couldn't get up for 20 minutes until my mom found him. I live 3 hours away and this is exactly what keeps me up at night. I've been looking at different medical alert systems but honestly the reviews are all over the place. Some people swear by certain brands, others say they're terrible. What I'm really looking for is something reliable that won't give false alarms every time he moves wrong, but will actually work when he needs it. He's not great with technology so it needs to be simple. I've been researching bay alarm medical and a few others but would love to hear from people who actually use these things or have parents who do. What's worked for your family?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfdw3j/anyone_have_experience_with_medical_alert_systems/

"My Mom's sheets are tucked in at the bottom of the bed BUT they don't consistently turn down the cover and top sheet. All they have to do is turn it down like a triangle so she can lay on the pee pad which is under the top sheet. Mom frequently lays on top of the blanket and top sheet instead so, if she has an accident, both will need to be washed. I've mentioned this several times but I guess it's their problem since they have to do her laundry. As far as bed rails go, my Mom broke her femur in Dec. 2021. She had surgery and now has a strip of metal secured into her bone by many screws all along her femur. When she got to rehab she had NO bed rails and a twin sized hospital bed when she's used to a full size bed and she is mildly obese. I was afraid she would fall out of bed. They said they could put PADS ON THE FLOOR in case she fell. So I then asked that they keep the bed as low to the floor as possible. Thankfully they finally did this and would just raise it up and down when they needed to. This way, if she fell off the bed, she didn't have as far to go. It seems absurd to me that these adjustments don't ever seem to occur to them."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/113ykoe/hospital_trying_to_discharge_emented_mother_in/j918hsp/

"First, make a doctor appointment ASAP. In the meantime, ask her to use a walking stick whenever she goes out. They have cute ones online. Also, consider asking someone or hiring someone (from the neighborhood or from Care.com or something) to accompany her on walks, until you figure out the underlying issue. You don't want her to fall alone. If she falls and hits her head again, she might not even remember it happened. That's what happened to my mom--she fell, got a concussion, and didn't recall it had happened. (The only reason anyone else knew was because of the very obvious blood on her face when she got home and the black eye she had afterward.) My mom's in her 60s, very physically active and loves walking. Up until 2 months ago, my mom had MCI, but was generally ok to live independently with some help. The first time my mom fell during one of her walks, I thought it was an anomaly and didn't think it was that bad. Then a week later, my mom tripped again on a walk and hit her head (the one that gave her the black eye that she didn't think to mention, because she forgot about it), and she got a TBI that permanently jumped her to Stage 4 dementia. Now she has to live in a memory care facility. Brain damage from a fall is no fucking joke."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1btlmzi/mom_fell_again/kxo4kur/

"Had to quit my job five years ago, we had to start taking them to their doctors appointments,,& stop them from driving, my dad starting having frequent falls and the last time he never left the hospital, before dad passed we had just set them up to be together in an assisted living facility so they could be together, it was a total nightmare

trying to get my dad the physical therapy he needed and then get the level of care they both required, Basically we were lied to ,, Dad did pass away on February 10th only a month after we got them moved in. Thankfully my sister and brother n law were at s point where they were empty nesters and looking to downsize,, so sold their huge home and moved into mom & dads house so they could care for mother who has stage 4 dementia... Thank goodness they were able to sell their home and move down which gave me and my husband the first break in seven years and parent caring... Needless to say it's been quite an eye-opening experience and I feel your pain"

youtube · @terriikemeier7120 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=Ugy10i7TDzWeWIRqk914AaABAq>

"This is the main thing that weighs on me now. I'm 81 and try to do the same things I have always done. But my balance is definitely not the same. I fear falling and not being able to get up. My daughter is young, only 27. But surely she will soon want to marry and start her own family. She REALLY has no idea about how to care for an old mom! We are too poor to just hire someone to help. But I must think about how we can manage."

youtube · @KimNguyen-zl2cj · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzsEPL3liaTDke78MB4AaABAq

"I do worry about "what if", what if she (carer) falls on the stairs. The number of hours wouldn't necessitate unemployment claims, etc. Food for thought. I imagine like Burnt said (I was hoping you'd weigh in!), people do this all the time without mishap. Doesn't mean there's no risk, just has to be risk I'm willing to live with (I own the place they live in)"

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/hiring-private-caregiver-looking-for-clarification-on-financial-matter-490856.htm>

Nights and the 3am call · 18 documents

9 most engaged of 18 matching documents, complete text.

"I'm living in this space of both my parents ageing rapidly and on very poor health. I'm so alone, it's all consuming and now I can't sleep past 3am and have at least 3 panic attack's a day. I've moved house to be nearer but my mum fights me on everything and doesn't make it easy while my dad is losing his memory. There's a doctor visit every week I feel with constant worry of wtf is next. My anxiety is through the roof I have even planned how to not live anymore once they are gone as I won't be able to handle it. I cry several times a day, eat my feelings and actually pray for illness upon myself to end my misery. I'm 44 and completely alone"

youtube · @stephaniemac7635 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgysxA1XDFIZ2G0XDMR4AaABAq>

↳ @retrosynthwave (3): "This is hard. You should try to relax yourself. All we can do is let it pass. Take care. Do meditation. May all beings be at peace. ❤️"

↳ @dingobabies9824 (3): "Please know you are not alone going through this. Your comment tugged at me deeply cause I do relate what you are dealing with. All we can do is one day at a time and remind ourselves, that this too, shall pass. ❤️"

"Anyone have experience with medical alert systems that actually work?. My dad fell in his garage last week and couldn't get up for 20 minutes until my mom found him. I live 3 hours away and this is exactly what keeps me up at night. I've been looking at different medical alert systems but honestly the reviews are all over the place. Some people swear by certain brands, others say they're terrible. What I'm really looking for is something reliable that won't give false alarms every time he moves wrong, but will actually work when he needs it. He's not great with technology so it needs to be simple. I've been researching bay alarm medical and a few others but would love to hear from people who actually use these things or have parents who do. What's worked for your family?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfdw3j/anyone_have_experience_with_medical_alert_systems/

"It is very nice of you to offer your services. Thank you most kindly. My mother has vascular dementia, and with it, strong symptoms of anosognosia. I preface this conversation with: I am clearly aware that caretaking in this arena is a thankless, tiring, frustrating, heartbreaking, and seemingly helpless job. I understand how her "eraser board" is wiped clean the second her location changes, and why she repeats questions some times in less than a minute time, and why she thinks she's well and capable of doing things she cannot. Although I'd love to hear and understand more ways to help her. That said, what I don't understand is why I sometimes feel like I'm doing her a disservice by not putting her into a facility, even when she refuses treatment from the doctors or even refuses to let my husband and I take her to see a doctor, because she doesn't think she is sick, and calls everyone liars. She gets agitated and argues with the docs and nurses, pulls off leads, IVs, etc, because she says she's not sick and that we're trying to make her sick. Just today we took her into the ER, they did the usual workup, we were ther for 4-5 hours, they found two infections, and she wouldn't take the antibiotics because she said she's not sick because she doesn't feel the infection and this is after I had to allow them to sedate her just to run tests, right before she started tugging at her IV. With that, her paranoia, regression, combativeness, confusion, constant smartmouthing and agitation when sundowning, my lack of rest, and more, I still can't bring myself to want her in a facility. Although I am working on obtaining guardianship in the event things become out of my control, yet, I still worry that by not considering a facility, that maybe I'm not helping her. I've witnessed the lack of caring in several NF and I worry about her becoming a number where no one will love her, interact with her, or care enough about her,

simply because it's not their job. And at this point, she can still recognize her family and asks about them often. I just feel awful and worry I'm doing this wrong. It's heartbreaking to watch. Not to mention, between my husband's parents (both now deceased) and my mom, we've been caretaking for 5-6 yrs now, and I worry about that as well."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okx8don/

"At this point, you say, "Yes! As my parent, I need you to take care of me. I am worrying about you so much it's affecting my health. I really need you to be in a safe place so I can sleep at night and stop running myself ragged trying to make sure you're ok. I need you in my life and you need help to stay safe so you can be here for me.""

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/oovert4f/

"Thank you! This facility also has independent living and skilled nursing, so Mom's there for the duration. No memory care, but also (fortunately) no real concern for that nightmare. It was no surprise to me that Mom & I drove each other crazy. We never had a contentious relationship, but are just *very* different people. I can easily put up with her calling me several times a day, even if it's just to tell me what she ate. (Oatmeal, a hard-boiled egg, turkey sausage, and grapes for breakfast today, in case you're interested.) :) All my best to you and your Mom!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/n4wqq5b/

"I'm so scared of my mum growing old and dying 😭 I can't sleep at night I become sooo anxious over this"

youtube · @lifewanas6568 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgxFbP3sKI5UvOFXiWR4AaABAq>

↳ @tselinsky6452 (O): "it's going to happen. accept and plan, then the stress will go away!"

"I feel like the most relevant thing is that she cannot ambulate on her own. I agree with everyone that says that seems to point towards needing someone there. But it will make her soooooooooooooo unhappy and right now she is very happy and thriving despite a lot of serious health conditions. I'm just worried that her emotional and mental health is what's keeping her going in many respects, and forcing 24/7 overnight care is going to cause her to become unhappy or depressed and then have a negative effect on her overall well-being and health."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/my-elderly-mom-is-bedridden-but-of-sound-mind-she-does-not-want-caregivers-overnight-i-am-wondering--485025.htm>

"Things I'd use as red flags for change are; - Mom starts getting fearful alone in the evening/night - Mom is getting poor with telephone skills - Mom is frequently getting unwell or uncomfortable overnight - Double incontinence frequently overnight"

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/my-elderly-mom-is-bedridden-but-of-sound-mind-she-does-not-want-caregivers-overnight-i-am-wondering--485025.htm>

"I, too, had to quit my job to take care of my husband at home 24/7. I was worried about the stress of dealing with no-shows if I hired home aides while I continued to work. Then, I would come home and have to take care of him overnight."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/my-husband-has-dementia-and-his-dr-ordered-35-to-40-hours-of-in-home-care-he-only-has-medicare-is-th-498633.htm>

The money runs out · 18 documents

14 most engaged of 18 matching documents, complete text.

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial

blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"Only Child—Outnumbered by 2 Aging Parents. I'm struggling, and I just don't know how to handle everything I'm supposed to handle. I'm 47, female, single, and an only child. My parents are 75, in declining health, and live 2 hours away. Financially, no one can move closer. I work full-time in a stressful job with 4 days a week mandated RTO, and my commute is over 2 hours a day. I've got chronic health issues I'm dealing with, plus trying to keep a house going. My parents haven't planned for their future and get mad when I try to bring anything up. They're dismissive. My parents are both frail and need help. They have someone who comes to clean periodically, but there's no one there for day to day stuff. My mom gets mad that I'm not there more often. I'm exhausted and sick, but I'm "selfish" for not taking time off work or coming more on weekends. I love them, but I'm upset they haven't and won't do anything to plan. They're struggling, but so am I. And I can't take care of them and me too. I have to keep my job and insurance. I can't afford to not work or to take unpaid leave. They don't want to hire caregivers, and neither of them wants to go into assisted living. I feel like I'm not enough, no matter where I am. If I'm with them, I'm not much help. Drowning at work. Too exhausted to do much at my own house. I don't know what to do. I have to keep my job, and I feel like a bad daughter."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 193 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ue0xdc/only_childoutnumbered_by_2_aging_parents/

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play starwars

valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many posts and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because feebreeze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Impossible-to-please mother wants to live with me. A year ago, I helped my mom move to my state to live near me. She was living near my brother, but her incessant requests that he drop everything for her were driving him crazy and he needed her to go. I had her move here to give his mental health a break. She lives in an independent living facility about four blocks from my house. The location is perfect because I can get to her quickly and more frequently than I'd otherwise be able to, and I can stop at the store for her on the way over. But she keeps pushing to live with me and my husband, which is not a good idea. It's mostly because she doesn't like the food there. (Her apartment has a kitchen and she cooks her own stuff most of the time.) My mother is intrusive and oblivious. She doesn't understand basic human interaction rules (it's like she fits the definition of autism in this respect), which means she is constantly saying inappropriate things -- insulting us, or hurting my feelings. If she isn't getting her way, she can get nasty very quickly to where it feels like it's coming out of left field. Her own mother drove her crazy (and her mother was a nice person). She refused to let my grandmother live with her and my dad because she knew she wouldn't be able to stand it. And she swore up and down she would never be a burden to me or my brother. Now, here she is, wanting to live with me. The biggest problem here is that my mom is incapable of being happy. Everything is always terrible where she lives. Any house she's ever lived in is "always falling apart." When I was growing up, it was always my dad's fault for buying the wrong house or not repairing something fast enough. After my dad died, it was my brother's fault for living 3.5 hours away and not being able to come over and change a light bulb instantly. It's like the woman has no concept of how to locate and book with a service provider of any kind. When you suggest she call a handyman, she gets pissed off because she thinks we should do everything for her; that she shouldn't have to pay a handyman. Never mind the fact that she always told us that we "owe her nothing." I lost count of the number of times she complained about her own parents keeping score, swearing that anything she did for my brother and I came without strings attached. I believed her. She moved closer to my

brother so he could help her more, but it wasn't enough for her. She complained constantly about the house she bought and how she'd "overpaid" for it. She had the backyard relandscaped and then killed half of it because she couldn't be bothered to water it (even though she had a programmable system and I had created a custom instruction manual for her). Every time something happened at the house -- AC out, broken water heater, roof repairs needed -- my brother had to handle it all for her. She acts like she's completely helpless. And every one of those incidents was the end of the world -- her crying and asking "Why does this always happen to me?" as though no other homeowner in the history of the universe has to deal with repairs. So we all decided that she couldn't handle owning a home; that independent living was the way to go because she could just pay one bill and not have to worry about anything. She's had that for a year now, and all I hear are complaints. Texas was better; her house was better -- she's forgotten all the complaints she had about it. That's how it's always been with her, though. She hates a place until she leaves it. Then, the old place was heavenly and the new place sucks. I don't want her living with me because not only will she annoy the crap out of me, she will be unhappy! I don't want to have to listen to, "I should have stayed where I was. At least I had X and Y." (And I don't want to help her move yet again! The woman's a hoarder, for one thing.) Also, I love my house and planned to stay here. It's not big enough for her to move into, though. We'd have to move to a bigger place, which costs money, and it would mean that someday, I'd be old and stuck with more house than I can handle and NO ONE to help me deal with it. I've told her that, and she doesn't seem to care. I can't figure out how to get her to understand this and stop asking for it. Just when I think we're all clear on how our relationship works, she gets clingy again and starts crying and saying she wants to live with me. I'm going to school full time right now. I'm almost 60 and will be starting a new career, and not by choice. And I have relationship problems as well. I can't handle her b.s. on top of all of this. I love the mother she was when I was growing up, but I don't like the person she is now. If I worked with her, she would be someone I would avoid. But I don't want her to get all dramatic and start crying and saying she's moving back to Texas. She can't afford the move, and Texas is NOT big enough for both her and my brother to live there. We looked into independent living places there, and none of them had kitchens. That was a no-go. She can't buy another home. So WTF can she do but stay where she is? I'm just so sick of the crying and her being miserable. Yes, she's on antidepressants and sees a counselor. I've told her she's the common denominator everywhere she goes, and that she has to figure out why she can't be happy before she can even think about moving anywhere else. Aside from that advice, I don't know what else to do or offer her."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 93 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1unvxnd/impossibletoplease_mother_wants_to_live_with_me/

"Absent Cheating Father Now Wants Me to Finance and Care for His Needs. Problem/Goal: 76 yr old father asking for my help to fund his living. He is living alone. Problem is, I find it burdensome. I live in Asia. Context: My parents are separated since I was 11 or 12. My father cheats with multiple women. We were the second family. When he and my mom separated, he married his 3rd wife. They had kids. My father is only officially married to the 3rd wife, by the way. They live in another province. My father has supported my schooling and my siblings schooling. Altho I can still say he favored his 3rd familys children more - cars, private schools, his presence. Also, by the way, me and siblings are all scholars and my mother pitched in help for our allowances. Recently, I found out my father has been cheating even on his 3rd wife. Theyve separated too. She told me that I may see my father as doting but that I dont really know his bad side. Last yr, my father came to our province asking for help in his medical needs. I have no problem with that. I funded all his medical needs but what I cant tolerate is his demanding attitude. He complains that it isnt the best doctor, he wants fancy oils and supplements, he wakes up in the middle of the night and demands massage. I mean, he was practically absent all our lives. We only see him once in every two years for 2 days. As adults, we only see once every 5 yrs or so. Altho I have to admit he calls us often to maintain connection. I only earn 30k a month. I take care of my mother's expenses and I cant rely on my siblings' help. My father is now hinting he wants to come live with us and I finance his need. I dont want to. Am I wrong for feeling this way? I feel like he should ask his 3rd family to take care of him. The beneficiaries in his insurance are not even us, but only his 3rd family. My father had small businesses before that earned hundred

thousands. But he spends a lotttttt on women, other people who just leech off him, on unnecessary hobbies like guns. He doesnt have properties nor any investments. Now he has no money and he is weak physically. He lives, I heard, in a shack in an isolated town in the province far away from our region. Previous Attempt: I tried telling him to save even in his 40s and 50s. But he just says he will change but never does. Let me know how you can help me in my situation. I cant afford an apartment. And I really dont want to live with him. I cant rely on my siblings."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vcldk9/absent_cheating_father_now_wants_me_to_finance/

↳ **comment** (65): "No, you paid your dues when you financed that medical event."

↳ **comment** (31): "> I only earn 30k a month With the "only" in there (and reference to a "province"), I can only assume you're not talking about CAD? Either way, the amount of money you make/have is completely irrelevant. You don't owe it to your Dad to provide for him, and would do well to shut down that idea. He is in a bed of his own making, and it's on him to figure things out. If you chose to do so, you *could* help him find alternative arrangements...not that I have any idea what they might be wherever you are. Easier said than done, I know, but as "they" say: "No" is a complete sentence. Protect your peace, OP."

↳ **comment** (25): "I would not give him money but would pay for certain things directly within reason. Never move in together, with a demanding parent now, it will only get much worse. Set clear boundaries and live your life. Children are not responsible for the bad choices of their parents period. Good luck."

"Dad [70] needs 24 hour care recovering from surgery. I'm typing this at 2am because I don't know what to do. My dad had major spinal surgery for a degenerative autoimmune disorder. He's incapable of feeding, standing up or taking care of himself in any way. He's going to a rehab facility for about a week, but will need 24 hour nursing care after. He has a small amount of money saved up (less than \$70k) and a decrepit house that, generously, might be worth \$50k for the land it's on. I'm flat broke and crushed under student loans. I have space in my house to put him, sort of, but I can't provide home care. I physically cannot move my father and my bathroom is itty-bitty; it's just not physically possible. I'm not quitting my job in my 30s to take care of him because I literally am not physically capable of doing so. I am a small person and he's 6'7 and over 300 lbs with catastrophic mobility problems. I don't know what to do. Does he have to lose everything before help arrives? He's slated to be able to make a 90% recovery and I'm worried his months of medical care will, at best, send him out the nursing home door to have no home and no money and no options. I'm an only child, we have no family, it's just dad and I. I know a lot of people here struggle similarly and even much worse than my family struggles and I'm just looking for some perspective and maybe guidance. I'm still financially devastated from my mother's death last year and at this junction in my career won't be able to recover. I am so very disheartened that my parents basically had me late in life in order to take care of them and it's effectively ruined me emotionally and financially to the point where I'm not happy or thankful for the gift of life at all. I wasn't built to be a caregiver and I've had to be the 'parent' to my parents since I was a pre-teen. I absolutely love my dad but my empathy is so tapped out from a lifetime of having to drop everything at a moment's notice and buck up and having major medical emergencies multiple times a year, every year since as far back as I can remember."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/zfsk3a/dad_70_needs_24_hour_care_recoving_from_surgery/

↳ **comment** (19): "Start by talking to the social worker about whats going to happen as he transitions to long term care. They might be able to help with some options. Make sure he has all the POA and healthcare directives filled out [link](<https://www.nia.nih.gov/health/advance-care-planning-health-care-directives>) Does he want hospice? What is his prognosis and timeframe?"

↳ **comment** (17): "I am so sorry for the weight you are carrying and the struggles you have been dealt. I have no advice for you but I am sending you peace and clarity."

↳ **comment** (17): "I was shocked that Medicare would only cover 100 days inpatient care for my dad, including hospital, rehab and skilled nursing care. I had to put my mom through the spousal impoverishment program to get my dad qualified for Medicaid, and even then his entire SS check was his monthly copay. If I had known what to expect I would have encouraged them to spend their last 50,000 in savings 5-10 years ago and go on Medicaid rather than trying to stay on that razors edge of having too much to qualify for assistance but not enough to actually afford care."

"Lost my mom two months ago, her dog is suffering from necrosis and I can't afford cremation or even vet care for the dog.. Hello everyone. Lost my mother in early September, was her caregiver for 8 years. She loved her dog for 13 years she had her, I grew up with both of them, just this week found out my dog is suffering from necrosis in her belly, I don't have the money at all to take her to a vet, currently moving out by the end of the week of my mom's home. I don't want to send her to animal control because I know they'll put her down but I also can't afford anymore expenses for her and don't want to see her suffer. I feel like a piece of shit if I send her to animal control because they'll just euthanize her, but I also don't want her to suffer. I have no other family, my mother and dog were the only family I had. I don't know what to do. Any advice would be great. Shelters won't take her because of her health."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p550fn/lost_my_mom_two_months_ago_her_dog_is_suffering/

"DONE!. Just need to vent. I've posted before on this forum, but it's been awhile. My brother and I are only siblings. Mom spent almost 2 years in the nursing home, with a year and a half on PRIVATE PAY, thanks to my brother, who lived with her and was "supposedly" taking care of her. He took care of Dad and Mom ALL THEIR lives, not because they needed him all those years, but because he needed them. They supported him completely and he bought expensive items with his own money (found out later, PLUS some) on a disability check after working 7 years total, at menial jobs. Our mom did everything for him, even washed his hair! She thought the ground he walked on was holy. Anyway, he ended up basically mooching off them all his life, under the pretext of "taking care" of them. Dad passed away almost 20 years ago. Mom lived to be 102, passed last fall. Just suffice it to say that hoarding was a nice (although nowhere near accurate) description of what he did. He basically piled up TWO houses, ruining them BOTH in the process and causing the tax assessed value to drop to 1/3 of the original value. He basically didn't want to do anything I suggested to get the estate deeded to him legally because he was simply too lazy. The second house caused a real problem with her Medicaid eligibility (which my husband and I had tried to discuss with Mom 10-15 years ago, after Dad passed). I said Brother could have it all, I didn't want anything. He ended up ruining Mom financially, and as you can tell from the tax reassessment I had done, wrecked the entire place. I tried reporting to APS, but they never even went inside, and seemed fine with empty beer cans and junkers (8 of those) scattered across the back yard). I eventually had to take over everything to fix her over-drafted bank accounts (with my own funds) and close them out...that even made Bro mad. I eventually just took over because he was lying and hiding bills and letters, almost got Mom evicted for her private pay not being paid...nursing home billing office manager called me, which was the first I was aware. Bro didn't want to deal with the mess he had made, which ended up being dumped on me and my husband...trying to clear out the houses to salvage what we could (FOR my Bro) because once Mom ran out of money, he ran out of money, so he managed to get admitted to the nursing home for leg issues from a car accident in his 20's (he refused all doctor visits for 40 years)...he then said he couldn't walk one night. Since he lived with Mom, even that almost messed up her Medicaid. But eventually I got her Medicaid approved, then she passed two months later. The proceeds from the estate went toward her private pay bill, which did not even cover all of it because Bro hid his head in the sand for all that time, lied, etc. Anyway, he got mad at me about 4 months ago and cursed at me in a text. I ignored it but all he would ever talk about in his texts was the young female aides, and the personal intimate care they were giving him, and he refuses to allow male aides to care for him. I finally told him I really didn't want to hear all that "drama"...I did not feel it appropriate. Never once did he text without going into those sorts of details. He

mentioned his showers and his underwear and "wetting" himself every single text. We found porn tapes hidden while salvaging his possessions for him. He has a fake FB page that popped up (he didn't even change his name!) with erotic pictures of young female nurses and teachers. He has a history of ...obsession, I'll call it. Previously on his FB page, he said he was in a relationship with someone he had obviously met on the internet. He has done everything within his power to report the older female staff and asked for the younger ones to replace them for his personal care. Now let me say that he has been having chest pain and high BP, yet what he got mad about was I mentioned seeing OTC testosterone supplements peeking out his bedside table one day...when they told him he wasn't supposed to be taking them, they said that I had "reported" it. So he got very angry. I said, "Fine, let him have an MI. See if I care." I will also add that he has NEVER, to my knowledge, had a normal relationship, never been married, is 73 years old, slow mentally, and is a nursing home resident! He texted 3 weeks or so ago and said he has lung cancer. He had had a CT scan during an ER visit for high BP and chest pain, and supposedly the hospital had sent him a letter informing him he has lung cancer. Concerned, I drove up to the nursing home that evening. I know that is not the process for patient notification. He showed me the letter and it said he had a couple of nodules that showed up, but most are benign, and his PCP may want to follow up. He argued with me that that meant he has cancer. He also said the nurse had told him he has a huge mass in his stomach. He finally gave me permission to speak with the nurse...I have a healthcare background. The nurse couldn't believe he said that...she said she had explained what "benign" means and had explained the follow-up process to him, and told him his stomach is fine...no mass was even mentioned. So I tried to explain to him, but couldn't tell if he understood. I sent him a text that evening from home explaining it simply and told him if he has questions, he can ask the nurse or me. Nothing from him. So I said, "Or maybe you want me to butt out". Nothing. He hasn't spoken to me in weeks. And he never answered me. He cussed me out one time lately in a text over the testosterone supplement so I just left him alone to chill for awhile. Next thing he texted, "Can you bring my computer"...the one still in the unopened box he ordered two years ago that we salvaged for him from the piles of hoarded stuff. I took it to him, with his mail that he still gets at Mom's PO box. He accused me of not caring anything about him. I said he hadn't answered me. Oh, I was supposed to know that his "phone isn't working" and I should have called and asked the nurse to bring him the phone from the desk. WHAT? How was I supposed to know his phone "isn't working" (which I think is a lie) because he said the typos were due to his phone issue, NOT to HIM! Well, it all got out of hand and he was saying that I was a KNOW IT ALL and I should have checked on him (I asked why he didn't check on US- BECAUSE HIS PHONE WASN'T WORKING!) Claimed I didn't visit Mom or call about her when she was in the hospital...I said, I DID call! We couldn't even get our special needs daughter through Mom's house, and that was before he completely trashed it. Oh no you didn't! I said How would YOU know? Oh, HE knows! And then accused me of being just like Daddy and said he couldn't stand Daddy. I told him I loved our dad, and he said that was just because I didn't know because HE was the one living with them. Like yeah, ALL his life. I didn't intend to, but I finally told him he trashed everything and the place was a pigsty. And, predictably, that was because "he was taking care of Mom in the nursing home!". If I had had the presence of mind, I would have asked him why he managed to endure his hatred for our dad for all those years when Dad was putting a roof over his head and food on the table. At one point, he raised up as if to hit me. I absolutely will not tolerate that and I told him so. (And a very unsettling thing when I entered his room... I don't want to be too graphic here, but he is always lying down in bed, and today he had a blanket over his lower body and there was some suspicious movement down there. But I didn't. I just told him I won't be back, and he said, "Good!". So I'm done. I talked to nursing and the case manager and told them what happened and that I hated I lost my temper because it was not my intention to upset him. The case manager said he has already asked them to remove me as emergency contact from his chart. And they said he has been in one of his complaining moods all day anyway. I do feel bad about losing my temper and I know I could have just exited the room. It was like my feet were glued to the floor. I really didn't mean to upset him but I just won't take his accusations. I really no longer care what he thinks of me. He can bad-mouth me to the staff and say whatever he wants. I think I have come to the conclusion that he is crazy and always has been. He has become agitated lately (IMO) because two of the female aides who he literally talked about all the time were fired. I just don't go in for all that drama. But I think it might have unhinged him. Well,

more than usual... But I do have to be honest in that I can't stand to be in the same room with him. I don't know if it is possible to disown a brother, but I am DONE! I'll try to forgive him again, but I'm not there yet after him yelling SHUT UP to me today. And no I don't think he has dementia. I think he's just a selfish little B__ST__D that my mom coddled all his life. I'm not his Mom."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uk7ylh/done/>

"Wow as a former In Home Care Agency owner, there are things that I agree with and things I disagree with. States have different laws that may or may not regulate In Home Caregivers. There is a difference between a caregiver and Home Health. MOST insurance does NOT cover a caregiver as it's considered custodial care. Some states require caregivers to be a CNA or Home Health Aide, others don't have any requirements, and others like my state have extensive training requirements but no licensing requirement. Our Nurse trained everyone. I can't imagine paying \$100/hr for a caregiver. Rates do vary by state and area, however in my state, one of the highest in the nation, the rate tops out at about \$50/hr. The caregivers are paid on average \$20-25/hr. RNs are paid \$60-75 an hour. There is little margin as there are multiple required expenses such as liability insurance, Workman's Comp., not to mention payroll expenses, etc when running a home care business. If you choose to hire someone on your own you are responsible to pay taxes, social security, etc. Funding sources can be private pay, long term care insurance, VA benefits, Medicaid, Workman's Compensation, and some hospital systems to provide limited Home Care after discharge for 30-60 days to help prevent a readmission. There's a lot more I can write, let me know if you have questions though."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/nivspag/

"Just curious, culture makes a big difference on these issues. I'm American, and generally speaking while some parents fully expect or at least hope their kids will help out when we get older, the norm is that most of us very much don't want that. I certainly have zero expectations of my descending bloodline and would be mortified to ask for it. I don't think children owe their parents that; you didn't ask to be born into this world, you certainly shouldn't have to wipe my butt on my way out of it. It's what paid healthcare workers are for. That most people can't afford end of life care to avoid relying on their family for help is another discussion entirely. I'm just saying we should live in a world where our elderly family is well cared for by qualified medical staff and not have to worry about how that happens. Damn shame we don't."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vcldk9/absent_cheating_father_now_wants_me_to_finance/p1269gm/

"I got them the gift of estate planning for Christmas a few years ago (which is how I'm POA), but they have never seriously explored Medicare/Medicaid options for LTC. They have a very good financial advisor but they never incorporated that into their plans. They would have to sell their house, and even that would cover a couple years of assisted living for Dad at most. My maternal grandma lived into her 90s. Mom is terrified of being homeless. Obviously I would not let that happen, but I also can't contribute much towards their living expenses."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tx398k/what_really_happens_if_you_in_sist_it_is_not_safe/opsyx07/

"My folks are hoarders. My step dad is at the end of his life due to cancer. My mom, who is acting as my stepdad's caregiver, has level 3-4 dementia. My mom will call and ask for help, then cancel saying she's fine and doesn't need anything. I worry a lot about them. My mom adopted a big German shepherd dog as a way to keep people away. I'm now worried that the dog (which is still a puppy) will knock them over or trip them up, making the situation worse. I am glad of the dog as the city we live in has a huge homeless problem, and their house looks abandoned from the outside. So there's that little silver lining..."

youtube · @MsGenXodus · *MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP* · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAIAo&lc=UgzqDU12U9DwxxxJkG14AaABAg>

"I had gone thru the trouble of comparing for my sibling the cost of hiring someone direct - since they had sticker shock. Unless the aid is working as an independent (like having their own business) it would have been a nightmare, workman's comp insurance, IRS filings for their ability to work in the USA, vacation time, sick leave, the software to manage their pay and the appropriate withholding and contributions to unemployment, etc."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/does-anyone-have-a-good-experience-with-24-hour-in-home-care-through-an-agency-482758.htm>

"I don't want to ask them because they don't know and will probably just say \$25 an hour."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/how-much-should-i-pay-my-caretaker-to-stay-overnight-for-a-12-hour-shift-496242.htm>

Being forced to take care of her / her moving in · 18 documents

14 most engaged of 18 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"How do you manage intense resentment towards your aging parent?. I don't resent that my mom is aging. I resent that she never prepared for the aging process, never saved, never had a plan in place, is barely hanging on living by herself and now it is left all to me, her eldest daughter, to manage her care. Sometimes the resentment is so intense it feels like I might explode. I feel spread so thin, and I know it's impacting my infant and my partner. I don't want to do this anymore. I don't want to be my mom's caretaker. I don't want to go to her house and try to find a clean place to sit. I don't want to have to wait til I get home to use the bathroom because her toilet is covered in feces even with housekeepers. I don't want to see my mom deteriorate before my eyes and feel like the situation is insurmountable. I live 2 blocks away but I don't want to help anymore. I'm so weary. I will never put my own daughter in this situation. Thank you to whoever has listened."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 451 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kzbb9p/how_do_you_manage_intense_resentment_towards_your/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out.

Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"I moved in with my Mom who is 87 2 years ago. Its awful I love her but I dont want to live with her. She is fairly independent but we clash all the time. I am an RN and work on a Psychiatric unit. Its all too much. I dont have anyone I can talk honestly about this. I am praying praying"

youtube · @upclady60 · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving* | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland · 123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=UgxMncTtCQluI_Ht7c94AaABAq

↳ **@bushidooffaith4706** (12): "Stay strong Lucy I am living this now. Micah 7:8 every time you get up your stronger. Don't ever stop praying even through tears God bless you."

↳ **@Germatti13489** (6): "Gosh I sure do understand that. I wish that we could form a group of people to help each other but we're so exhausted it's so tough."

↳ **@reneeschwendi8355** (6): "I am so very sorry for the pain and anguish you are feeling. I can relate so well. My mom's personality has changed so much with her illness. She's always been a bit pessimistic and overbearing, but was also very loving, caring and fun to be around. Now the bad traits are amplified and the negativity is absolutely toxic. I want so badly to be the sweet daughter I used to be but now find myself snapping back at her and finding excuses to leave the room just so I can breathe. My anxiety is through the roof and the guilt is just as bad. I leave her house almost in tears and then beat myself up for being hateful to my dying mother. That is not who I am and I hate myself for it."

"What to do when you don't want to or can't be the caregiver?. Mom is getting to the point she is going to need more care and I live in fear that I'm going to be forced to take care of her. I know that probably sounds awful but she's very controlling, manipulative, and self centered and after living my life for 4 decades to please her and nearly losing my wife and kiddo because of her I know I can't do it. Mentally or physically. There's already been several hints from her saying she's moving on with us, she's tried claiming dibs on certain rooms in our house talked about how she's going to redecorate our home to her liking and I'm going to be honest my wife said if I move my mom in she is leaving same day. But then there is the problem of I also can't afford to fund an assisted living facility or in home care for her, like the money just isn't there and I couldn't work more to make up for it as I'm already working more than full-time. So what do I do?? Medicare doesn't cover assisted living or in home care, she has spent through her 401k, she's up to her eyeballs in debt from spending non stop, she has no other family but me. I've called council on aging and elder care many times and literally never get a call back from anyone. I'm in Florida."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 109 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t86ufb/what_to_do_when_you_dont_want_to_or_cant_be_the/

"Seriously contemplating walking away from my Mom and Step-Dad. The title says it all. I am seriously considering walking away from my parents. My mother (67) refuses to have a conversation - guaranteed to turn into an argument - with my step-father (77) to demand to hire a home health aide come to assist them daily. They both need help. She is being treated for cancer and having side effects from chemo. He has cancer in remission, diabetes, can't walk (refuses to walk due to muscle atrophy), after a stroke more than 5 years ago. Otherwise, he is in decent health. Before the stroke, step-dad was belligerent, angry, difficult, and selfish. He hasn't changed and can be mercurial. As a child, I couldn't wait to GTFO of his house. I've been helping my Mom - who was his full-

time caregiver until she became sick with cancer herself. I work full-time and am exhausted always taking care of them between hygiene, laundry, shopping, cleaning, and more. They have resources, but only spend money when it is an emergency - like when the hot water tank in their home stopped working. It was an emergency replacement. I've talked to my Mom, texted her to prevent him from hearing the conversation...but she doesn't think there is a problem. I feel as though I will need to collapse and be admitted into the hospital myself before either of them will take my needs seriously. I have an apartment of my own that I barely see because I am taking care of them or at work. Walking away and going no contact is the only option left. Family friends have pleaded with him to get help, to do more. I have pleaded with my Mom, but I think just leaving and not coming back is next. I don't want to do this, but I feel like have no other options. I love my Mom and don't want to abandon her, but she isn't willing to do the one thing I need. I even offered to move her in with me and just leave my step-dad to figure it out on his own...but she feels sorry for him and won't leave. I want to scream. Where is her empathy for me? TL;DR: I am thinking of abandoning my mother and step-father for not hiring a home health aide. After taking care of them for nearly six months alone, I am exhausted. Short of dropping dead or being hospitalized myself, they don't see a problem. Leaving them and not answering their calls feels like the only way out. Just going no contact. They cannot function without help. UPDATE: Thank you for your responses with advice and cautionary stories. There are no siblings who can help. Step-Dad has a step-son, but he is the definition of unreliable. I am making one more pitch for hiring an aide to my Mom and then, I am taking a good, long break."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walking_a_way_from_my_mom/

↳ **comment** (43): "Go only one day a week. Tell them you can't continue on like this."

↳ **comment** (39): "You must be exhausted. I think that so many parents haven't encouraged their children to develop the skill of recognizing their own normal temporary feelings of tiredness, worry, anger, and other negative emotions. So in everyday life, small negative emotions aren't dealt with in a healthy way, then healthy boundaries and expectations aren't created as the years pass. Then one day, the parent is surprised that their adult child has accumulated too much, is now burnt out and has to go low/no contact to survive. Maybe I'm projecting, but that's how it feels."

↳ **comment** (31): "My dad keeps saying they are managing just fine. I keep wanting my brother and sister to join me in going one week without answering their calls, giving them rides, or going over to do chores for them. One week of letting them be independent, as dad asserts they can be. One week of getting him to face the reality that he can't care for mom single-handedly, that he can't manage a two story house and big yard in his own, and that he can't apply the foot care treatment the doctor prescribed by himself. But my siblings keep sweeping in to help, and dad keeps burying his head in the sand."

"offer rejected. My 90 yo mom went home from hospital and rehab stint. My sibling stayed with her for a week. Now all care falls on me. My husband asked my mom to come stay with us for awhile, temporarily until it might need to be permanent . She said she would consider it. I expected her to jump at the chance, but she pretty much turned us down. She said she would be fine alone in her house. The main reason he invited her was to take the burden off of me by having her at our house instead of me going to her house a few times a day. She is going to need more care pretty soon, but now I really don't want her to come live with us. Thanks for allowing a safe space to vent."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 73 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fwww6z/offer_rejected/

↳ **comment** (71): "You are very lucky she said no to coming to live with you and your family. You cannot continue to prop up your mother by going to her house 2 or 3 times a day. She clearly needs more care and supervision and cannot continue to live in her home. You are going to have to let her live her life and fail at this before she is willing to make a change. That change should be in an AL if she can afford it or she will have to hire caregivers to come to her house x number of times a week, if she can afford it or she will need to go back into a

facility if she cannot take care of herself. You cannot keep up the pace of running her household and your own. Yes the solutions sound harsh but when an elder refuses to compromise then unfortunately you have to choose your mom or yourself and your own health and emotional and physical well being."

↳ **comment** (18): "Don't take it as a slight to you, it's hard to leave your home. If you have to go there too many times a day, see if she can find a paid caregiver or tell her you can only help if she comes to stay with you."

↳ **comment** (12): "Hi so there are no perfect solutions here, my mom did both the home care thing at our house and is now in AL. I guess a third option might have been moving her to a senior apartment and hiring her care. My thoughts. Two big factors will be how well the house suits your mom and what the labor market is like where she lives. My uncle is 4 years older than my mom, has major memory problems, but has hung in there with the help of an amazing housekeeper, he has a flat house, and is in a compact village in a rural area so he has built in interaction to some degree. My mom was in a large house with difficult steps and falling hazards, she was in a sprawling expensive suburb where it was hard to get good help, and even with help was pretty isolated. Having a person in her house all day seemed to breed conflict. So we went with AL. Also her house was in a great location but aging as fast as her and it was the right time to sell. I have learned the hard way that AL is not very personalized and while my mom fits well into the level of care they provide, it's a very partial solution. She still needs me or someone really frequently, but stuff like caring for the house is no longer an issue and there is structure for her medications. She also is enjoying the social aspect and doing some activities. I will also say that making a move gets harder as they age, so this may be the window that you need. My mom had pretty major surgery in April and it became apparent her days of living independently were over. I would love to think that your mom is looking out for you and knows on some level that moving in with her would be hard for you. Good luck!"

"Am I A Terrible Person?. My 91 year old mother fell and broke her hip last week. She had a partial hip replacement done and is in rehab. There's so much resentment built up on my part and I'm not sure it's all justified. Mom lives 4 hours away from me in another state. My sister (the favored child) used to live 10 minutes away from her , so it was always assumed she'd have someone near to her to help her. But she sold her house and up and moved across the country suddenly. So mom was left alone. I've lived in another state for many years. I was a caregiver for many years of my life. My late daughter had physical disabilities and my husband died of heart failure. I'm now the one who will take care of my mom. I'm tired. I have asked mom to move down to where I'm at and she has refused. Every excuse in the book. I've told her I'd be with her every step of the way if she is scared. I've told her she could move in with me or we could find a senior apt nearby. We can't afford assisted living. Refused. I've told her that if she didn't want to move to my state we could find her a place in the town she is in because she really shouldn't be in the house I grew up in. Dangerous steps and short. She had refused. Repeatedly. I've told her it would be easier for me and in the long run, for her. She doesn't care. Now I'm stuck driving up to her and staying in her house every few weeks in order to see how she progresses in rehab. I have to leave my own home and responsibilities in order for her to remain satisfied. I also am stuck trying to figure out where she will go after rehab. She think she is just going to waltz back into her home like nothing ever happened, even though they've to us it might be a whole year before she's even able to navigate around .Her home has 2 flights of stairs, laundry in the concrete floored basement, and a slick porcelain bathtub. Despite my objections she continued to drive up until the accident. She became quite hateful when I mentioned not driving anymore. She had had several mishaps with her car and had become lost several times. I'm the only one who seems to think it's dangerous for her to drive. She guards her keys now and talks about her car incessantly. I refuse to let her drive if she recuperates. I refuse. I'm ashamed to admit the fact that I resent her stubborn behavior. My whole life I was basically ignored because she was so enamored with my dysfunctional sister. She practically raised my sister's children and has financially bailed my sister out of messes many times. I've never asked for help from my mom, and she didn't even attend my husband's funeral . But here I am . The daughter who it all falls on. I feel guilty admitting that I resent it. I resent the fact that this is so hard on me logistically because she only cared about

herself. She had to stay near her male friend , so now I'm required to leave my home unattended for weeks in order to help her. My son has to drive from another town to stay with my dog, get my mail, and water my garden. She didn't plan financially in order to go to assisted living or accommodating housing. Instead she spent all her money on shopping for clothes and jewelry. Vanity is her thing. I'm struggling greatly with terrible resentment. She's my mom and I'll help her, of course. I've always tried my best to be respectful. But she has been so selfish and hurtful over the years. It's so hard for me to get over this. Am I a terrible person?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/

↳ **comment** (58): "You are not a terrible person. I think anyone in your situation would feel resentful, angry and betrayed. Your sister left when your mother had nothing left to give her and might actually need something back. That is not your problem. I don't think you should have to swoop in and pick up the pieces. Your Mom made choices and is still making them. Let the rehab facility get social work involved and they can decide with your Mom what her options are. If you stay you will be used by the system and an ungrateful mother. You have responsibilities to your own life and to your son who is now being impacted."

↳ **comment** (50): "Have her primary care physician pull her license. That makes the doctor the bad person not you. Does anyone have health care power of attorney for your mother? Has she had a recent cognitive test? Doesn't sound as though she is mentally capable of making her own decisions so you may just have to be the "bad guy" and place her where she safely needs to be. I'm sorry. It's a tough situation."

↳ **comment** (46): "You are not a terrible person. Make sure that everyone knows that she has NO ONE upon discharge that lives nearby, and she will be on her own. Do not cooperate. You can be as stubborn as she is. You do not have to take what she dishes out. She moves from rehab to where you can reach her without leaving your home overnight. Or she's completely on her own, because you are not coming. That's her choice."

"Absent Cheating Father Now Wants Me to Finance and Care for His Needs. Problem/Goal: 76 yr old father asking for my help to fund his living. He is living alone. Problem is, I find it burdensome. I live in Asia. Context: My parents are separated since I was 11 or 12. My father cheats with multiple women. We were the second family. When he and my mom separated, he married his 3rd wife. They had kids. My father is only officially married to the 3rd wife, by the way. They live in another province. My father has supported my schooling and my siblings schooling. Altho I can still say he favored his 3rd familys children more - cars, private schools, his presence. Also, by the way, me and siblings are all scholars and my mother pitched in help for our allowances. Recently, I found out my father has been cheating even on his 3rd wife. Theyve separated too. She told me that I may see my father as doting but that I dont really know his bad side. Last yr, my father came to our province asking for help in his medical needs. I have no problem with that. I funded all his medical needs but what I cant tolerate is his demanding attitude. He complains that it isnt the best doctor, he wants fancy oils and supplements, he wakes up in the middle of the night and demands massage. I mean, he was practically absent all our lives. We only see him once in every two years for 2 days. As adults, we only see once every 5 yrs or so. Altho I have to admit he calls us often to maintain connection. I only earn 30k a month. I take care of my mother's expenses and I cant rely on my siblings' help. My father is now hinting he wants to come live with us and I finance his need. I dont want to. Am I wrong for feeling this way? I feel like he should ask his 3rd family to take care of him. The beneficiaries in his insurance are not even us, but only his 3rd family. My father had small businesses before that earned hundred thousands. But he spends a lottttt on women, other people who just leech off him, on unnecessary hobbies like guns. He doesnt have properties nor any investments. Now he has no money and he is weak physically. He lives, I heard, in a shack in an isolated town in the province far away from our region. Previous Attempt: I tried telling him to save even in his 40s and 50s. But he just says he will change but never does. Let me know how you can help me in my situation. I cant afford an apartment. And I really dont want to live with him. I cant rely on my siblings."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vcldk9/absent_cheating_father_now_wants_me_to_finance/

↳ **comment** (65): "No, you paid your dues when you financed that medical event."

↳ **comment** (31): "> I only earn 30k a month With the "only" in there (and reference to a "province"), I can only assume you're not talking about CAD? Either way, the amount of money you make/have is completely irrelevant. You don't owe it to your Dad to provide for him, and would do well to shut down that idea. He is in a bed of his own making, and it's on him to figure things out. If you chose to do so, you *could* help him find alternative arrangements...not that I have any idea what they might be wherever you are. Easier said than done, I know, but as "they" say: "No" is a complete sentence. Protect your peace, OP."

↳ **comment** (25): "I would not give him money but would pay for certain things directly within reason. Never move in together, with a demanding parent now, it will only get much worse. Set clear boundaries and live your life. Children are not responsible for the bad choices of their parents period. Good luck."

"Skilled nursing home is discharging my mother on January 2nd. How do I move my mother into a personal care home?. My mother has Parkinson's. She had been falling a lot and finally this last fall was so bad she had a concussion / brain bleed and ended up in the hospital. After about a week stay in PCU, she was transferred to a skilled nursing for the last three weeks to recover. I learned today she's finally going to be discharged this Thursday. We talked with the social worker and director of rehab and they were clear it was not safe for my mother to live alone. They referred a placement assistance agency and I started looking into long-term care options. I learned the big, nice local nursing homes are way too expensive, so I found a personal care home for her. It's a clean, well run private home — licensed, insured, clean and within 20 minutes of our home. I'm worried that when I try to move her in this Thursday, she's going to want to go to her house to get some of her things. But I'm really afraid she might try to pull a fast one and refuse to leave her home once she's there. She's already tried to get my sister to jail break her out of the skilled nursing home. Any advice?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hqazat/skilled_nursing_home_is_discharging_my_mother_on/

"I feel like I am drowning and failing my mom. I'm not really sure what I'm looking for by posting this. Maybe advice, maybe support from people who understand. My mom is 62, but her health has been getting worse in multiple ways. She has serious mobility problems, falls, needs help with basic things, and now her memory and thinking are declining too. Her texts are starting to come through garbled or missing words. She forgets things within hours. She can't really manage checks or finances anymore. Even simple things that used to be normal for her are becoming confusing, the other day she wanted to cook something, so she put the crockpot on the stove and turned the stove on. I'm her son, and I'm trying to help take care of her, but I feel completely overwhelmed. I help with appointments, bills, safety, medication reminders, mobility, and just trying to keep her life from falling apart. At the same time, I have brain damage and health problems myself, so I don't always feel like I'm mentally or physically equipped to handle all of this. I feel like I'm trying to keep both of us above water, and some days I barely feel capable of doing that. My mental health has been getting really bad from all of this. I feel angry, scared, guilty, exhausted, and trapped. I feel like I'm failing her, even though I know I'm doing more than a lot of people would. It is hard watching someone you love lose pieces of themselves, especially when you already struggle with your own health. We are currently in the queue for aging/disability services, and I'm also trying to figure out whether I could qualify for paid caregiver assistance. One thing I'm worried about is that some programs seem to talk about helping the person learn or maintain skills. But with my mom's cognitive decline, I honestly don't know how realistic that is anymore. I can show her something, and she may forget it a few hours later. It feels less like "teaching skills" now and more like keeping her safe, helping her function, and preventing things from getting worse. Another painful part is that my now ex-stepdad basically decided her health problems were too much and she couldn't stay there anymore. I don't want to get too deep into that, but it hurts. It feels like she got pushed out when she needed people most. I'm not trying to bash my mom. She is the one suffering the most here. I'm just

tired and scared and trying to figure out how to keep going. For anyone who has cared for a parent with cognitive decline and physical disability, how did you deal with the guilt and the constant feeling that you're not doing enough? And if you also had your own health or mental health problems while caregiving, how did you survive it without completely falling apart? Also, if anyone has dealt with caregiver programs where the parent can't realistically learn new skills anymore, how did you explain that to agencies?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugk009/i_feel_like_i_am_drowning_and_failing_my_mom/

"We are stressed and strained physically and financially. My father-in-law needed a lot of care over the last several years. Now, my widowed mother-in-law needs care after we helped her care for my father-in-law. They didn't prepare well having a will that now sits in probate. Little life insurance that didn't cover full cost of burial. They took out loans against the home they had owned outright. Now that my father-in-law has passed, my mother-in-law can't financially pay for everything. We have had to pay for bills dipping into our savings. Mother-in-law is in denial of her situation and continues to think she can spend money the way she always has. It's not pleasant. It's frustrating, and it has caused resentment. We had to give up a deposit on a home out of state years ago to stay here and care for them. Now, we are trapped in a more expensive cold weather state rather than getting ourselves set up for our retirement years. We lose sleep worrying about our own grown children and never wanting to leave them with the burden of our care."

youtube · @jregret123 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugz-e4hZ1t2gqhrdtRh4AaABAq

"My mother in law is showing signs of dementia. She gets lost driving, falls some spends her whole social security check on scams. We don't want to send her to assisted living or a nursing home but we want to protect her. We are moving in with her soon because she lives in a house we own and we live with my son. I grieve over the thought of give up my whole life to babysit her and protect her from scammers. I will not be able to spend time with my grandkids because she can't tolerate them. I can't leave the house without her. I did this with my mom to keep her out of a nursing home. I love her and was glad to do it but it was also depressing missing out on the things you love in life."

youtube · @RobertaArlington · *Can Your Senior Parent Continue To Live Alone? 10 Signs To Look For* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E41ccWr1uEY&lc=UgxOkV6TP3SS9nwjJAB4AaABAq>

↳ **@SeniorSafetyAdvice** (o): "Oh I am so sorry that you are caught in this situation. If there is any possible way that you can get some respite help from your community. Volunteers, friends, maybe even hospice. It would at least give you some time each week to go out and spend time with your grandkids, friends, etc. Being a caregiver for a loved one does not mean giving up your life or being a martyr. That only ends up taking a toll on your own life. And that just doesn't make sense. So look to see what you can find in your community that can help you. A geriatric care manager may be able to help. Also, you can contact some home health agencies and see what they can offer or recommend. I would also contact any local senior centers to see if they have any programs or have any recommendations of how you can find help."

"I need some advice! My mom has lived with my husband and myself for the last 2 1/2 years. We both agreed to have her come live with us since she was so unhappy in the nursing home. How to I tell her I don't want her to live with us anymore? It would mean a nursing home for her and that would probably just about kill her. She DID NOT adjust well the last time she was in a nursing home. Any suggestions would be appreciated."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/discussions/don-t-want-elder-to-live-with-me-anymore-133444.htm>

A stranger in the house, theft, trust · 15 documents

9 most engaged of 15 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than

setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

"This is dam true. My mom cared for my great aunt, my grandma, and my grandma. All three had cancer and other medical crises... Now my mom has cancer and it's worse and more aggressive than any of my grand elders... And now I'm scared of getting sick as her caretaker and I'm only 27....feel like my whole life has been stolen from me ... What you said here is sooo true."

youtube · @samuri2011 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 72 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgzHx_LFEr3uv8NZevZ4AaABAq

↳ **@ionlysimpformyself7847** (3): "Being a caregiver as a daughter is worse cause you do so much, dont have as much physical strenght and get o récognition, except a few pats on the head once in a while. People have this collective idea that daughters will Always take care of their elderly parents and they just feel a little bit if cancer or Alzheimer makes it happen sooner, without taking into the fact that your youth get robbed before your eyes."

↳ **@bigg368** (2): "Your doing incredible work. Try not to get discouraged. Youre still very young. This is temporary. It will end. You have your entire life ahead of you. Some of us are older, much older, with only a handle full of years left and we are caregiving long term illnesses of our loved ones. Our health span will end in only a few years then we ourselves will require care. You're still young with many years ahead 😊😊"

↳ **@chandychano7** (1): "Hey :) I noticed your comment and just wanted to send some encouragement. I am 28 and care for my grandparents full time. There are not a lot of people our age in this situation. You are so valuable to your family and I am sending prayer and hopeful thoughts to you today."

"When I was traveling through my nightmare of my husband's dementia, a member of a Facebook support group sent me the following: This is a disease that unfortunately has no silver lining. There are negatives to placing them in a facility with strangers. You'll feel guilty that you are not doing enough for them, or getting too angry/impatient. Then you will feel guilty because you are doing too much for them at the expense of yourself. It will come down to which negative choices, which in the end, leave you as whole and sane as possible. Because, that is who is left when this disease runs its course, you. This disease can easily eat the caretaker alive along with the loved one. Unfortunately, only one is coming out of this journey. Make decisions that will preserve the most of the 'you' that went into this. I copied this and put it up on my mirror in the bathroom, so I would read it each time I was in there. It was the only thing that kept me sane-ish. A message against the people who were loudest with their criticism and suggestions but were the quietest with their help for what I actually needed."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4uzoc0/

"I'm so sorry. I know how this feels. Despite the pleas of your parents that they don't want a stranger in the house or they don't want to pay for someone or they don't want to go to a nursing home, they have no choice. Their health requires it. And so does yours. Your father could realistically live for ten years. He made the decision to not continue with treatment so he has to experience the consequences: not you. And I think this is the discussion to be had. He chose to live this way and you and your mother are paying the price. He either goes into a nursing home and perhaps attempts some rehabilitation to walk or he can clean up his own mess. He's a big boy. He's an adult. He can hear difficult news. It's hard to say these things to our parents but sometimes that's what they need to hear. Contact social services in your parent's area, ask for help getting your father to a nursing home. Tell them you can no longer care for him because you work full time and that your mother is ill and needs care herself. They maybe can get him admitted on an emergency basis. He's going to complain; be prepared for that but stick to your guns. I've been there. And I know how hard it is. I'm so sorry."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok8ch7w/

"My mom is an Italian New Yorker too. Same, suspicious of everyone, and not just now, she has always been that way. She gave me all of her jewelry because she was afraid someone would steal it from her. 🥹"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015>

"Caring for an 80+ Elder and Parent: Reflections. Dear all, it's a pleasure to make your acquaintance. Please bear with me. I'd like to share something with you all - perhaps to train future LLMs on the subject of how one should care for their parents, perhaps to just vent some frustrations, perhaps to share, dare I say, a pearl of wisdom with others, so that they might not have to go through what I am... I am currently caring for someone who has reached (Thank you, GOD) 82 years of age, with great clarity of mind though a bit frail in her body. Together, we've weathered a Pandemic and for that, I humbly consider myself lucky - despite knowing full well that we both took all precautions, those who were some of the most stress-intense years either of us ever lived (and she's been through a lot in her life). One thing I've discovered through the worst possible way, is that past the mark of 80 years of one's life, your body process things in a completely different manner: specifically, I've switched jobs at the beginning of the year and despite this person giving me her full support, little more than two weeks in and she's started getting sick... then I started hearing her grievances and complaints more openly and straightforward - she didn't want me to waste so much time commuting, or working at a place that despite paying better, was preventing me from being closer to her. I thought I'd have a chance to show her that I could make a name for myself at my new job, but her health was declining so rapidly that it downright SCARED me that I might be hasting something that WE are absolutely in NO RUSH... so I gave up on that. Of course, I'm not telling her the real reason I've left

the job and pursued something else closer to home: she LOATHES the mere idea that anyone might use her age as an excuse or blame. This is one of those things that people caring for elderly parents (or parents wishing to have kids, late in life) ought to be aware of, perhaps. Right now, I have to care for someone literally twice my age, and it's not about tastes or preferences, but a whole life rhythm: our Elders have achieved all there is to, while we as their children might be struggling and trying to achieve the same things that they did... HOWEVER, it'd be selfish of me to even consider abandoning her or, WORSE, thinking about putting her in a retirement home - I'm sure that's the first idea that MANY people opt to, but it's downright CRUEL: I've seen enough elderly abuse to know it full well in my heart that I cannot trust a caregiver with such a responsibility (and I mean no disrespect to the professionals who work in this field: I'm sure they are plenty of gentle, caring, respectful and competent folks doing their job... it's just that I have seen too much security camera footage to understand that EVEN MORE happens and ISN'T recorded, and I will never have my own mother go through this.). Which brings me to another point: both parents and their sons/daughters should (in theory) take a course together and face reality. That is, unless a tragic accident happens along the way, our parents will require care and we have to be ready to fully understand and accept that responsibility, as well as what it entails - their cognitive abilities will slow, weaken and will require a conscious effort to be preserved. Their health will require close monitoring. They might need someone to remember them which medicine they should take, and at what time. And yes, memory lapses are going to become something common (dreadfully so), and we'd rather build the rituals and mantras that help them WHEN that happens, instead of panicking when they forget their home address after going out for a walk. The daily rituals we take for granted, like leaving our keys ALWAYS on the table (and nowhere else) are going to be a lifesaver when we have to look for them because they've been misplaced because Mom or Dad had to do something outside their usual routine and forgot where they left those. I've made sure to have copies of her ID handy and stashed just in case she ever misplace those; it's better than the hassle of having to request a new, official, document. Elderly parents will never admit, but they are going to get lonely. Unbearably so. And in their fear of being abandoned and left alone, together with their failing health, the stress might cause them to become forgetful, or even confuse their memories. WHEN THAT HAPPENS, my advice is this: ... give them a hug, and don't say anything. Be gentle. Be understanding that they are not forgetting because they "wanted" to, or that "trying harder" to avoid forgetting is going to do them (or you) any good. Memories are formed through positive emotions and reinforcing. So, stressing out that they forgot something (which in many cases, is ALREADY a stress response) is going to make you feel better for a split second, and then it should immediately WRECK YOU WITH GUILT AND REMORSE, because you're taking out your frustration on someone who has done a lot to care for you when you were younger, and now is relying on you to do the same in kind. Don't be a dick. Don't be an asshole. Be there for them. If you can openly talk about these frustrations together, then you are already way better than where I am; I have to gently and subtly lead the person I love and care about to reach the answers she seeks without letting her know I'm guiding her by hand... because that would upset her. Often that means doing a lot of grunt work and not necessarily getting recognized for it. It's tough, but when I see her smile and being just at peace... it means the world to me. If you can cook homemade meals, do it. You have no idea how such a simple thing can help TREMENDOUSLY to calm people down, or even make them remember things... in my case, sitting down and having a meal together evokes family history, tradition and so many things that people have taken for granted, or worse, completely ignore nowadays... I've once heard a chef saying that "Cooks cook to NURTURE people" and it's true - a meal is MUCH MORE than mere "body sustenance"; the latin word for the verb "to eat" actually comes an expression "com edere": 'to have a meal TOGETHER'... that's something that you should now, as much as you can. Because inevitably, you're going to miss this and you might regret having lots of opportunities and ignoring them because "something else" was more important, at the time. Tell them that you love them. I don't care if it sounds silly, corny, or just isn't used to showing expression: tell your parents that you love them, Greet them with a "good morning" when you first see them. Don't be a stranger: that's the ONE thing they all fear the most. Imagine what it's like being in a retirement home, where everyone is a stranger and your own family

only comes to visit on occasion... it makes life becomes A PRISON. Don't do that to them. I don't know if this is useful, or plain drivel to you all. But hey, if it helps anyone now or maybe assists some future AI model in understanding what it means to love and care for someone in this stage of their lives, then I'll be content."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n8vxx3/caring_for_an_80_elder_and_parent_reflections/

"Has anyone had experience hiring hourly caregivers through Care.com? Care recommends that families start communicating via the messaging tool on their website before taking the conversation offline with a caregiver-Ive messaged 2 caregivers who either asked for my number right away or gave me theirs to communicate via text-wondering if others have had this experience? Is this because they're busy or dont want to use Care's messaging tool-maybe it doesnt matter-since they have Care profiles, I should still be able to run a paid background check on them."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/carecom-reviewsexperiences-with-private-payprivate-duty-hourly-caregivers-and-process-for-vettingscr-495155.htm>

"In home care giver from them really I haveing hard time trusting them they stolen money from me and food stamps from me ok I don't want them to be my care giver I don't trust them they stolen food stamps away from bella they are scanless I do not trust any of them"

youtube · @FeliciaEncinas · *In home caregiver versus Assisted Living Costs* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=zR_scvn-tzQ&lc=UgzwJta1z3jy9a-jfmt4AaABAg

Dementia: wandering, the stove, not knowing me · 14 documents

10 most engaged of 14 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ @SoloSecondHalf (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ @chronic2023 (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ @cathydyer3774 (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful*. Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her*. I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom **CHOSE** this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that

much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly AGAINST having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends ALSO saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit AGAIN, find a new place to live AGAIN, set up all my utilities AGAIN, and STILL have to manage HER life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING. I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7 months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER. THIS, more than ANYTHING, should be a clue that mom is NOT who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and THEN people will complain that mom is LONELY. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags under her bed rather than in the 3 FUCKING HAMPERS I've bought for her) FINALLY getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes

of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"What happens when you can't do this anymore?. I've posted before about feeling evil when you inevitably yell at a dementia patient and having mental breakdowns from caretaking, but when you feel like you can't do it anymore, when you feel "broken" and fear for your health and your patient, what do you do???? My mom has Alzheimer's/dementia. I've been taking care of her for nearly four years. She had a bad reaction to an antipsychotic she started taking a few months ago. She lost trunk control at the end of July. She couldn't walk on her own. I didn't know what to do. My brain froze and couldn't make a decision. I had to call a family member who had to tell me to call 911. Even then, I couldn't do it. I started gathering clothes for her since she wasn't dressed and getting all manner of things ready. She might have had a stroke and I didn't respond in a timely manner. After a hospital stay, my mother ended up in rehab for a month. When she returned to me, the level of care I had to give increased exponentially. Now I'm changing diapers and having to clean up poop. I never wanted children or a family of my own. I don't have the temperament for intimate partners. I knew this about myself. I like peace, calm and anything that disturbs it, gets under my skin. I wake up in the morning and my mind like a movie on repeat keeps showing me the crap I cleaned the day before. I watch my mom pick her nose all day, yell at the TV, make up fake Spanish words. I have to brush her teeth and bathe her and I don't think I'm doing a good job, because I always find more crap. I've found myself crying and yelling and threatening to abandon her when she gets nasty and cusses me. I've thought of taking her to a hospital with no ID and just leaving her there. Where I once said no to a home, now I dream of it. But she needs an NHTD waiver. I've called the agency and NO ONE returns my call. The insurance company expects me to provide extra hours for my mom because we live together. But I'm at the point where my body and brain shuts down when it comes to care. It's like I avoid doing things she needs until I MUST do it. So my mom is not getting the care she needs. I have no family to help, my friends live far away and have their own lives and I'm afraid for myself and her. I had to put a lock on our door to prevent her wandering. That lock prevents people from getting in to. What if we have an emergency and no one can get in? At what point does the State or insurance companies recognize when you can't do this anymore? That you are mentally incapable, that your own health is in danger? At what point is there help???? Update: I finally did it. :-(last Wednesday, my mom refused to let the aide clean her, was yelling and cussing; refused to drink water. She only

had 2 ounces in a 48 hour period. She also had not been cleaned in 18 hours. I explained the consequences of not drinking water, not eating, etc. Normally I can get her to do it by explaining consequences. She understands things, but doesn't hold the memory. This time, nothing I did worked. Finally, I called 911 and expressed my concerns over dehydration etc. They came and she was calm, alert and compliant when they asked her to drink water. She told them she would. I couldn't help but notice the smugness as though they were more capable than I and the aide. She took a sip that was it. No more. They decided it was best to take her to the hospital. They coaxed her up. The smell hit them and they said she needed to be cleaned and dressed before travel. That's when the sweet old lady disappeared. It took the two EMTs and the aide to get her ready. My mom cussed them all out. I couldn't help but laugh because I saw that smugness drop. I didn't travel with her. I spoke to the Dr on the phone and saw my mom for an hour before going home. The Dr called asking where I was. I explained that I left. Dr said her bloodwork was good and she wasn't dehydrated. She could go home. That's when I dropped the "unsafe discharge" language that I was advised about on this board. I said it. Dr insisted she couldn't hold her. She needed to see the neurologist and could go home. I repeated "unsafe discharge" again. Dr was annoyed but said they would admit her and I should see the social worker the next day. My mom is going into a facility until I can get 24 hour care. I'm home today because I've been visiting every day since then. I'm sad, but calm. I miss not having her here. But I know this is what's best for her. When I saw her in the hospital, she was clean and seemed content in a way that I couldn't get her at home. I also noticed her cussing when it took two aides to clean her, but she went back to her quiet self when they were done."

reddit post · r/dementia · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/

↳ **comment** (76): "You do have to take her to an emergency room and leave her there. It's OK. Tell them she isn't safe with you and refuse to take her home. They'll find a place for her. You've done enough."

↳ **comment** (42): "Thank you so much for not judging. Thank you! Thank you! Thank you! I had a family member tell me that no matter what choice I make, I'll be in pain. So I was told to choose my poison. We were once so close my mom and I. It's out of loyalty to who she was that I haven't done it. My mom is gone. I have this doppelgänger living with me. :-(

↳ **comment** (31): "I am so sorry. I can feel your frustration and worry in your words. This is a horrible, cruel disease, and will take down any single thing in its way. You do not have to do this anymore- you are not morally, or legally obligated to keep setting yourself on fire to keep your mother warm! On the contrary, you are doing her a disservice by not getting her placed in long term care. You are not equipped to do the job of every profession working at a facility. I cannot speak for other countries, however, if you are in the US- you take her to the closest Emergency room, TODAY, as in RIGHT NOW- tell them her mental status is altered from her normal baseline. Then, once they've run every test under the sun, you say these exact words: "I am unable to care for her at home. It would be unsafe to discharge her." No more, no less. You'll likely get push-back, possibly even threats of them calling APS, or telling you that you are responsible, and that you must take her home. Some providers have gone as far as telling family members they can be arrested for abandonment; this is simply NOT TRUE. Unless there is a court order signed by a judge stating a person is a responsible guardian, no adult is responsible for another, period. Stand your ground. "This is an unsafe discharge." The onus will be on the hospitals' social work team to find acceptable placement for your mom. Keep in mind you may have no choice in WHERE that placement is, but they will have to find her a clean, dry bed in a setting with the level of care she needs. Is she on Medicare/Medicaid? What's her financial situation? This information will help us give you guidance on how to handle that side of things. Seriously, before you hurt her, or yourself, please don't feel like a failure or horrible child- it's time to wave the white flag."

"My mom passed away yesterday from COPD. I had this exact same issue with her. Only instead of dogs, it was 9 cats. We had to "disappear" her cats one at a time. (we re-homed them). It was so BAD in her house. One thing I was slow to learn is that with COPD and other lung diseases, they often stay very sharp memory wise. But they get

brain damage 2 different way. This GREATLY AFFECTS executive functioning. It's the lack of oxygen processing and the overload of CO2. The brain damage causes paranoia. My mother literally had the locked changed on her house then threw away the keys. She somehow thought her cats were guarding her. She let them do whatever those cats wanted to do. She couldn't go upstairs at all, and those cats used the upstairs as a litter box and basically destroyed everything up there. So Google executive functioning and the brain damage that she likely has. This paranoia is why she is so afraid those dogs will get out. Also, my mom became extremely combative the last 2 or 3 weeks. People with lung disease are fighters. They fight for their every breath. It is likely your mom will fight anyone taking those dogs. I highly recommend you find a reason to send her to the hospital so the dog issue can be dealt with while she is not home. If you explain the situation to the ER doctor, they will admit her for observation and dehydration or for a lung exacerbation."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1je5elr/aps_likely_getting_involved/mih1h8i/

"Could this be the early stages of dementia?. My mom has had some cognition and behavioral changes the past couple years that have been noticeable to multiple family members (memory issues, slower cognitive abilities), but they have become more concerning and pronounced in the past 6-9 months. I would like to get her evaluated by a neurologist who specializes in dementia/cognitive impairment, but I could really just use some input in the community as this is all new to me. The three that have me most concerned that this might be early stage dementia are these: -Last July she insisted that a homeless man was coming into her kitchen and stealing her food. Food was going "missing" and the refrigerator door was repeatedly ajar, thus proving that this man was coming in. My mom insisted on blocking the backdoor that led to her kitchen with furniture. This was the first time something like this happened and it was really concerning but I thought it was just a one off/ some kind of stress. This paranoia died down after about a month and she never mentioned it again. -In October my mom's cat of 16 years died. They were very bonded and she took the death understandably hard. Over the past couple months she has talked about him "visiting her" at night, seeing him in the yard, him coming into the house with angel wings, and one time she asked if I'd like to take a picture of him sleeping in the closet (after he has passed.) She does acknowledge she knows he's dead but still reports these visions/visits. I thought this was an extreme reaction to grief but it's still been concerning. -The past couple weeks is when I have started to really worry these visions/paranoia/false beliefs (whatever you call them) are going to become an ongoing issue. My mom became fixated on not knowing where her socks were, not being able to find them, at first concluding that the housekeeper or I must have moved them. This was all conveyed via text message and she seemed very confused and agitated. When she confirmed with the housekeeper and me that neither of us touched her socks, she concluded that a little girl (a ghost) who was her dead cats friend must be cold and coming into her room and wearing them/taking them. She said she had seen this little girl a couple months ago but hadn't seen her since. She felt "better" once she had come to that conclusion but also that she wishes "they" would leave. I know nobody here is a health professional and everyone's loved one presents differently, but any input would be really helpful. Is this possibly early stages of dementia? Just to add, I am 8 months pregnant and so stressed that I am welcoming a new baby in just a month as my mom is presenting with more of these issues. I have already GENTLY broached the subject of going to the "memory doctor" with her because of her word finding (leaving all the other reasons out) but she says her memory is fine and she doesn't want to go. I'm desperate to get her evaluated before this keeps progressing. How did you get your loved one evaluated if they were resistant?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1igsxth/could_this_be_the_early_stages_of_dementia/

"Man, this thread really resonates with me. My Mom was emotionally abusive and our relationship was never great. When my Dad developed dementia, Mom didn't want to care for him and was upset over his hoarding and financial problems - and she abandoned him. She did not want to care for him and he did not understand the financial problems nor could she communicate without just screaming at him. While that seems bad enough, I

helped her leave him. She expressed fear that he would retaliate or hurt her if she said she wanted to leave. I told her the safest thing was to just up and leave after moving items into her new place secretly, bit by bit. I helped her get a place and bought her furniture. This absolutely wrecked my Dad, and I checked in on him from afar daily. "Where's Mom?" "When is she getting back from the store?" "Should I call the police?" It took months of explaining over and over that she just up and left. Fucking sucks having to do that as a child. Of course Dad deteriorated rapidly and couldn't live on his own. I worked on liquidating the home and moving him into assisted living, but my Mom was pissed that I was taking too long to move my Dad (did it in three fucking days from "Dad, you can't live on your own, let's discuss" to move in day). She was pissed I wasn't selling cars quickly enough, mad that I had to spend time on Dad instead of getting her money for her to move out of state. Anyway, she said a lot of awful things and told me she didn't trust me and asked me twice to revoke the POA I had for her, which I did. Later this pissed her off as she wanted me to sell something in her name and wanted to pretend like the POA was still active? But only at her convenience? All of that was baffling and hurt a lot. Everything has been sold and she has her money. I haven't spoken to her in months. No idea how she is or where she is. Everyone reminds me that this is not a person I need to do anything for given her behavior, but I still worry about her. I still feel bad for her, or about her? I don't think anything good would come out of interacting with her, but I'd really like to just not have her still in my head."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18ccwul/vent_im_exhausted_taking_care_of_someone_who/kcapq51/

"Thanks so much for giving your time and insights! My dad is in the moderate stages and has a lot of paranoia. He thinks my mom is giving him too many medications and is trying to hurt him (even though it's just what's prescribed) or that people are stealing from him or against him. He's accused my mom of trying to take his degrees and money away, when obviously, that's not the case. He also is very agitated when the hired home caregivers come over for a few hours each week to help my mom, as I think his paranoia and confusion tells him they're against him too because they're unfamiliar. He'll literally try to shoo them away and will yell at them to leave. Sometimes, he'll even get so agitated he raises his hand to them, but does not hit. I know this is just part of the illness and is likely his feelings of confusion and fear that cannot be expressed in other ways, but it's hard to know how to respond in the moment. He still needs to take his meds because he has high BP and diabetes, but he will become agitated and refuse because of the paranoia. My mom will give him his prescribed Seroquel on days like this, but it doesn't necessarily help, and it causes him to become overly drowsy, which has other negative effects like fall risk and throwing off his circadian rhythm even more. We try to distract away and try not to argue/logic it through because his capacity for logic is diminished, but is there anything else we can do? How can we get him to take the meds or agree to allowing the hired caregivers to take care of his ADLs and other tasks when he's in this state?"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okvr7m8/

"It is very nice of you to offer your services. Thank you most kindly. My mother has vascular dementia, and with it, strong symptoms of anosognosia. I preface this conversation with: I am clearly aware that caretaking in this arena is a thankless, tiring, frustrating, heartbreaking, and seemingly helpless job. I understand how her "eraser board" is wiped clean the second her location changes, and why she repeats questions some times in less than a minute time, and why she thinks she's well and capable of doing things she cannot. Although I'd love to hear and understand more ways to help her. That said, what I don't understand is why I sometimes feel like I'm doing her a disservice by not putting her into a facility, even when she refuses treatment from the doctors or even refuses to let my husband and I take her to see a doctor, because she doesn't think she is sick, and calls everyone liars. She gets agitated and argues with the docs and nurses, pulls off leads, IVs, etc, because she says she's not sick and that we're trying to make her sick. Just today we took her into the ER, they did the usual workup, we were there for 4-5 hours, they found two infections, and she wouldn't take the antibiotics because she said she's not sick because she

doesn't feel the infection and this is after I had to allow them to sedate her just to run tests, right before she started tugging at her IV. With that, her paranoia, regression, combativeness, confusion, constant smartmouthing and agitation when sundowning, my lack of rest, and more, I still can't bring myself to want her in a facility. Although I am working on obtaining guardianship in the event things become out of my control, yet, I still worry that by not considering a facility, that maybe I'm not helping her. I've witnessed the lack of caring in several NF and I worry about her becoming a number where no one will love her, interact with her, or care enough about her, simply because it's not their job. And at this point, she can still recognize her family and asks about them often. I just feel awful and worry I'm doing this wrong. It's heartbreaking to watch. Not to mention, between my husband's parents (both now deceased) and my mom, we've been caretaking for 5-6 yrs now, and I worry about that as well."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okx8don/

"Similar experience here... I am two years in the deepest depths of caretaking and I had to take a big step back and feign an interview for a new job with "terrible hours" before I could get through that someone else needed to help. I also had a conversation with Mom (make sure to do this in a different room or at lunch **without step-dad in earshot** that I was at a breaking point to reinforce the level of help I needed to continue to help them. Having conversations in front of step-dad is unproductive because she will be paranoid/ distracted in front of him. It wasn't until she was worried about *me* that she became more open to letting people into the house. Tell her you are worried about losing your (new or current) job because of needing to be available to help them. Happy to talk more in DMs if you need to vent. I don't want to be too specific for privacy reasons. I also found it helpful to find one task she hates the most and to argue for getting help with that one little thing before she got more comfortable asking for help with other things. Maybe laundry? I had to find a way to break the seal of not letting *anyone* into the house and move forward slowly from there with more help. I agree with the person who said to make a schedule of when you are coming over and be clear about what you will and will not do. Once you tell mom she needs to put together a list of what she needs help with for when you visit, that may help her visualize the amount of work involved. If right now you are coming over and just seeing what needs to be done and then doing it, there is little recognition of how much work is involved. The list and getting her to give you directions (aka ask for help) is a paradigm-shift you can obscure through making her think the list is for *you*. Dunno what their health insurance provides, but I was surprised at the resources available for drop-ins through insurance. Sounds like step-dad would be a candidate, at least, to allow mom to leave the house more often. You can argue it's so she can go food shopping, but she may quickly realize she can run other errands and make lunch plans, too. Between social workers, home health aides for hygiene, nurses, volunteers, etc., they came often stay for a max of two hours to facilitate other tasks."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walkin_g_away_from_my_mom/p4fz81t/

"we let my dad stay at his own home. Depending on how far along your mom is, adult day cares are an option. That can take up to 12 hours in a day at a lower cost. This way she gets socialization too and often with more verbal people than those at memory cares. There are also door to door volunteer transportation and paid door to door transit options as well that are free or dirt cheap for transporting your mom to and from the adult day cares. Then you can hire a live in aid for night hours if she needs 24/7 monitoring. For bathing and help getting dressed and brushing teeth. My dad's place has sensors everywhere and he has trackers on him. I live 2 minutes away. We can't afford 24/7 care so we don't have anyone there at night with him though people come in during the day every day. I feel fairly safe leaving him alone at night. Sensors tell me if he floods water (he doesn't but I'd know), tries to escape, if the ac/heat broke, if he falls, if there's a fire. Cameras allow me to talk to him and confirm what the sensors said. Stove is unplugged with gas capped. No metal utensils to put in microwave and microwave only has preset times that go up to 1.5 minutes so he can't set anything on fire. With me being only 5 minutes away, I can get to him fast if needed. My only fear is with soft falls where they just slide to the floor. The fall detection devices

that weve been using do not do a great job catching soft falls. I hired a friend as a caregiver (with me and my two sisters also providing care) and so she's been very consistent. But my sisters friend has been hiring caregivers on her own and they have been flakes. It'll really vary depending on where You live. My area, theres a shortage of caregivers so a lot quit the moment they see your LO is more difficult to care for cause they can easily get an easier client. Agencies might be better but I'd bet they have high turnover where I live too."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/onjqxd2/

Tab 2 — Hopes & Dreams

Pray for strength · 307 documents

20 most engaged of 307 matching documents, complete text.

"I am exhausted, scared and overwhelmed taking care of my 82 year old father please pray for me."

youtube · @chrislim7976 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 711 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhKEw&lc=Ugx_qvxYqeVPbjO1aOR4AaABAg

↳ **@CodingAbroad** (53): "I'm in the same boat friend. 82 year old father losing physical, mental and now financial faculties. Most stressful period of my life right now"

↳ **@shrikesari** (51): "I'm there right now. I cry at night alone reminiscing the past when my dad showed me tricks of life and pretty much held my hand through my whole life. Now he is frail and weak and wants to die and I can't help him enough without damaging my own personal mental health. So stressful!! May god give us strength!!"

↳ **@dani-xm5lw** (30): "@shrikesariim caring for my old aunt. She has no one but me. She was my mums sister. I cant put her in a home cause i cant afford it. I work full time. She is wearing diapers. I dont have or drive a car. Im crying right now and pray God to take me. 🥺"

"Old people are not all cute and wise. Caring for them can be like caring for your abuser. You force yourself due to guilt and pressure. I can't stand when people say things like "you should visit more often" I see my parents 3-4 times per week and take care of their issues ongoing daily. What more do people want? They want the ultimate sacrifice of me moving them into my home and destroying any small amount of peace I have in my life. Please never put your opinion on caregivers when you are not the one living the nightmare GOD IS GOOD. That was two years ago. I prayed and prayed that God would somehow help us. My mom's attitude has completely changed. She went from being critical and negative to understanding and supportive! Wow! I cannot believe it myself. One thing I did is I started opening up to her and telling her how I also was not well. I dont think she really had considered how stressed I have been. I pray that God may give caregivers the strength and peace to go on caring for their loved ones and themselves."

youtube · @Yolduranduran · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 504 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhKEw&lc=UgxD2JzM5sA7cmhdaD54AaABAg>

↳ **@feliscatus1834** (36): "I am getting burned out overseeing my mother's care in asst. living with Parkinson's disease. Already taken her to 7 doctors appt. this month, she doesn't get around well & her room is a mess at the facility. I am EXHAUSTED taking care of her laundry, getting her diapers etc. My brother won't even drop by to see her & say "hello", he lives in the area. My life isn't the same, I am raising two teenage sons & married, this sucks I can tell you honestly it sucks, I cannot take her in or quit my part time job either. I HATE this!! I hope I die first before becoming a burden on my sons!!"

↳ **@spiderpig24321** (18): "Yep Yolanda ...taking care of 2 abusers due to a sense of duty. They dont even try to help with their grandkids"

↳ **@Okalani5000** (14): "Sometimes asking is not enough. Some people ask, even beg for help and never get any. Sometimes you just end up going crazy over it all. @TVResults"

"I am exhausted, scared and overwhelmed taking care of my 82 year old father. Please pray for me."

youtube · @chrislim7976 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 310 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgzSnFjsWM2PwVp-Gp94AaABAg>

↳ **@carolishable** (17): "@chrislim7976 I'm with you. I live with my 82 year old mother without support from anyone. I have given up the thought of having my own life and happiness. I love my mom but it's so hard to do this."

↳ **@dirty Sanchez941** (13): "Chris!! I'm praying for you!!! I really mean it!! I can relate. My parents are the same age.. Omgosh, I love you, and I don't even know you!! Hang in there, and take head to helpful information. I came here today looking for help.. I read your comment. It stood out for me. Take care of yourself."

↳ **@bronzace7996** (10): "I am so sorry you are feeling overwhelmed and I know it is not easy, but I am glad you posted how you feel. It brings humanity and awareness to caregiver burden. Thank you for your courage, vulnerability and transparency! Please try to hang in there because you are not alone. I am most definitely praying for you and your father! God Bless You for caring for your father. If I can offer any encouragement, just please try to hold on. I to was in a similar situation caring for dad for 3 years. I had no end in sight and just when I thought I could not go on, GOD called him home. I lost my dad in October 2020. Again, you are an angel and GOD bless you!"

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost,

and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugk_YPLbQQCuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"I'm coming to the conclusion that most of these videos that are supposed to have advice for caregivers to reduce stress don't really have much to say because there isn't really any way to reduce the stress of seeing our parents loose their independence, their functional abilities etc. It is what it is. This isn't a sprint, it's a marathon that ends with the person we love and care for being gone. It's exhausting and heating breaking . It is what it is. The only advice I can give is 1. Take advantage of the social services in your area to get the help your entitled to. 2. Get someone to be with your parent so you can have time away from them. Even if it's just a few minutes away you can catch your breath. 3. Eat well. The extreme mental and physical fatigue will entice us to eat all the things that will make a sick (SUGAR) 4. Get rest. Sleep. It necessary to maintain your sanity. 5. Talk to a counselor, support group, journal. Do whatever you need to do to get your feelings out. Family may not want to hear what you have to say. Talk to an objective ear. 6. Pray! I can't stress how important it is to ask the Creator for strength and endurance. 7. Find something to do that feeds your soul. Crafting, singing, reading etc. I've been at this for 16 years. My dad is in his 90's. I've had moments I felt like giving up. Its probably one of the hardest things we have to do in life. But I always make it back and continue to be there for my dad. I hope this helps."

youtube · @farisasmith7109 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 266 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgwplAltYhO-6FoHEM14AaABAq>

↳ **@wallmagic3400** (15): "Ya it helps surely, thanks for penning it so objectively, when you can't escape suffering a situation that's not of your making it helps to know that a big part of the world is sailing in the same creaky leaky boat 🙏"

↳ **@barbaramitchell6910** (14): "@ElrinconcitodelaSraPerez I totally understand not wanting to put your parents into a nursing home. My mother is 84, my father passed last December and Mom is in deep depression. She doesn't take her meds, she doesn't eat well, she's so lonely, lives in the same clothes all week and can barely get around her house, she's given up. I don't have any help at all, my husband tries but he doesn't know what to do. Most people would put their in this parents in a nursing home with her condition but I refuse. This is going to be a huge lifestyle change for her and us. She's scared and so am I. She lived in her house for 60 years. I just want

to give her the best quality of life in this last chapter. I pray that I'm making the right decision. Sorry for such a long post."

↳ **@sisridewita3252** (12): "Your story moved me deeply. I, too, am currently walking a similar path — one filled with love, sacrifice, and quiet strength. Though the journey is not easy, I believe it is one of profound meaning. Please know that my thoughts and prayers are with you, and with everyone who is facing such trials with compassion and courage. You are not alone, and your devotion is seen and honored."

"I moved in with my Mom who is 87 2 years ago. Its awful I love her but I dont want to live with her. She is fairly independent but we clash all the time. I am an RN and work on a Psychiatric unit. Its all too much. I dont have anyone I can talk honestly about this. I am praying praying"

youtube · @upclady60 · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving I Patricia Smith I TEDxSanJuanIsland* · 123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=UgxMncTtCQluI_Ht7c94AaABAg

↳ **@bushidooffaith4706** (12): "Stay strong Lucy I am living this now. Micah 7:8 every time you get up your stronger. Don't ever stop praying even through tears God bless you."

↳ **@Germatti13489** (6): "Gosh I sure do understand that. I wish that we could form a group of people to help each other but we're so exhausted it's so tough."

↳ **@reneeschwendi8355** (6): "I am so very sorry for the pain and anguish you are feeling. I can relate so well. My mom's personality has changed so much with her illness. She's always been a bit pessimistic and overbearing, but was also very loving, caring and fun to be around. Now the bad traits are amplified and the negativity is absolutely toxic. I want so badly to be the sweet daughter I used to be but now find myself snapping back at her and finding excuses to leave the room just so I can breathe. My anxiety is through the roof and the guilt is just as bad. I leave her house almost in tears and then beat myself up for being hateful to my dying mother. That is not who I am and I hate myself for it."

"My mom passed away 5 months ago. I moved back home 15 years ago to care for my mom when my dad died. After 8 years I retired to care for my mom full time. In her last 7 years, because she was housebound, I never left the house. I shopped once per month for 60 minutes and went to Sunday Mass for 45 minutes weekly. I never asked for help from anyone. Those 15 years, especially the last 7 years, were the 7 best years of my life. I did everything for my mom and thank God that He gave me the grace to care for my mom. There is nothing in this world that I would trade those last 7 years for. I never saw it to be a burden. I loved my mom so much that, 5 months now after she passed away, my heart is still broken and desolate. I never saw it as stressful, unbearable, etc. I did everything out of love. If it were my choice, I would have done it for another 50 years. My mom passed at 101. I pray she is now in Heaven with God."

youtube · @remowilliams7569 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 108 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxL7cARs1CHkPqGFQ14AaABAg

↳ **@DeborahD67** (7): "A friend of mine did something similar and was also blessed. You don't mention her mental state, but I suspect if dementia were a big issue your view would be much less rosy. It will drive one insane."

↳ **@LennarVlogs** (6): "@remowilliams7569 101! Wow she was blessed. I can see the stress being a caretaker can cause but it's beautiful that you shared the love you had for your mom. May she rest in peace."

↳ **@lisagilbert5709** (6): "Thank you for sharing. We need more people like you in the world!"

"Nurse in eldercare here. Its has zero to do with billable hours and everything to do with quality of life your mom has left and not causing her undue trauma when her failing body inevitably gives out. I realize that's hard to accept so let me to talk to you not just as someone in elder medical; but as a daughter who just went through this journey with my own dad very recently (he died a week ago today) as we address the emotional part of this unfortunate but urgent situation. Your mom is dying that's clear. She wouldn't be on hospice if she wasn't so as much as you hate to hear that she is reaching her end of life that it is what it is and thats the situation before you right now. You can't stop death; but you can support peace and dignity in her passing. Thats where you still have some level of control over this situation. Think about what you want for your mom. Think graphically about what the possibility of her final moments might be and the chaos that would cause for everyone involved, especially her. Seniors at a certain stage of decline do not survive CPR. The act of manual stimulation cracks their ribs into their heart and lungs killing them anyways. If you're idea is "just use paddles" (my mom thought this to) think to yourself, ask yourself "to what end?" Even if paddles brought her back for a minute the attack will come back because the heart is failing and whats the option- surgery? She's not gonna survive surgery because her body is failing which means its not going to heal after a surgery and thats if a surgery itself didn't end in her death. I know that's hard to hear. I realize it's scary and heartbreaking. You want your mom to live; but she's reached the point in her life where thats just not gonna happen. Our bodies are designed to die. Just as we are born with the instinct to cry and suckle and remove waste and feel safety when held- our bodies know what they're doing in those final stages and they shut down systemically as we make our exit. No one can say how your mom will eventually pass (cause wise); but you have a say about what level of 3rd party trauma you will allow her to endure or not. **Hospice itself is comfort care and symptom management at the end of life.** Its not tests, its not treatment, its not pushing for longevity- **its supporting as much peace as possible for as long as they body naturally functions on its own steam.** I understand how hard this is to accept. I've been watching patients go through it for years but it hits different when it's your own parent and trying to get my mom to accept where my father was at and to make choices for him that would not cause trauma on himself or those around him (especially me because it would he my mom would turn to and expect to act in ways which would cause him fatal harm while trying to save him) took a series of conversations over a few days and in some cases weeks; but as you watch the way your loved one shifts throughout those last weeks you start to get it and its easier to accept that the right choice is the one with the most gentility and peace for them. Feel free to scan my post history for something of a vent I wrote about 2 weeks ago where my mom was giving my dad (with no teeth and complex dysphagia with an esophageal stent) chips that he could choke on and expecting me to give him the heimlich maneuver if he did- an act that would have killed him in her failed attempt to save him. Medical responders have to follow the directives for care and if there is no DNR in place they have to act in order to preserve life even if those actions might result in someone's death. We can loose our accreditation or licenses if we don't so the right thing to do for any given person (what we know to be the right thing based on training and years in the field) isn't even an option if there is no directive to support the action itself. We have to act, legally, we have to do whatever is necessary if its not written down and on the record before the event itself even occurs. Again, we're gonna get graphic for a second because I'm not sure if you understand what CPR on your mom would look like and I don't think you want to see it... Chest compressions for CPR have to be given with quite a bit of force because we are using the weight and pressure of our own bodies and arm strength to cause the heart to pump under the pressure we provide. He heart is protected by the rib cage. Even in young, healthy people the ribs can fracture and break when CPR is preformed. There are absolutely young health people who die receiving CPR because the heart cannot be revived or because of the damage CPR itself inflicts. 1st responders act under the hope and with the intended outcome of survival; but there is always a risk it won't work or it will cause deadly harm. As people age, their bones become more brittle. The same amount of force to reach the heart under the rib cage is still required regardless of how frail someone is or brittle their bones may be. CPR will not work without that amount of force behind it. Force is required. Ribs crack during CPR for damnnear everyone; but in fragile elders they very often shatter into fragments. Those fragments are usually pushed into the heart while CPR is being performed but they can and very often do also puncture the lungs as well. The lungs are like bellows- when you push them down hard air comes out and once the ribs are fractured badly enough there is

nothing protecting the lungs while 1st responders attempt to stimulate the heart so the lungs are also being compressed with every thrust. Rib fragments into the heart and lungs can cause bleeding. The esophagus also sits there and crushing it is another thing that can happen during CPR in elders who are frail. That can cause more bleeding. CPR has to continue until an ambulance arrives to take over with electrical stimulation and that must continue until death has been called by a doctor. We talked about the lungs as bellows; but when the bellows and/or windpipe is flooded with blood from the aforementioned internal damage you're gonna get more than just air with every thrust being made to try and stimulate the heart. You're gonna get blood too and that can be very traumatizing to anyone who is around to see it and even those 1st responders who are acting as they must when a DNR is not in place. Once fragments of ribs are deeply lodged into the heart, lungs, esophagus, etc... there is no coming back from that because there is too much damage in too many places. Even young healthy people don't come back from that easily if at all; but with elders at a certain stage it's just a done deal because they do not have the ability to heal themselves following any surgery that might follow. I'm sure just reading that was horrific 📌 but imagine living it in real life and it being your mom that you're watching it happen to. **I know you want to save your mom. I know you don't want to lose her.** CPR isn't gonna save her. No matter how much you hope or pray it will- it won't. The only thing CPR is gonna do is traumatize everyone involved including your mom who's going to be living through that experience until she finally fades away. Your mom is dying. You don't have a lot of control over that; but you can use the few choices you do have over the situation to provide her with as much peace as possible in her passing and as much comfort and love as you can muster during her last whatever amount of time there is left. You have that choice."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 105 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8pcuna/

"I am also living through this. I feel I am going out of my mind, stuck in this house with my 96 yr old Mom!! I retired at 62 yrs old so I could relax and travel with my partner. After 2 mos of my retirement my Mom fell and broke her hip. That's when my nightmare started. I have a sister but doesn't help with Mom cause "she's too busy" and lives far. She's 45 min away!! My mom has dementia so she's paranoid, suspicious, cries and thinks everyone is stealing her belongings. It's been 4 yrs now, I have developed heart issues, anxiety, depression. My partner left me 2 mos ago. He was not going to put his life on hold, and I don't blame him. So now I'm here with a broken heart and dealing with my Mom. I pray that God give me patience and comfort, but I don't know how long I will be able to take this situation 😞 "

youtube · @jennynunez7946 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Neil; Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 75 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=UgxFp_X5N3UIkTFLuyB4AaABAq

↳ @wordswordswords8203 (12): "Wow that is bad. I'm in a very similar situation. If I can't get my elderly mom out of my house I think I am going to die. I have so many health problems now and I feel like I am going completely insane."

↳ @hellohello17983 (11): "sorry to hear that...i am single 36yo taking care of my parents.... not that i was so determined to get married but then it sucks that i now don't even have the chance... i am constantly sad, depressed and angry..... God, pls help us all..."

↳ @73cidalia (10): "There need to be more options, affordable options, for families dealing with this. Given your mom's age and condition, that would be a situation that warrants her being cared for in a nursing home."

"My mom moved in with me when she turned 82. I was so fortunate that she was in good shape and had good health.. but she was starting to have mobility issues. I remodeled her bathroom and made sure it was totally handicap accessible... she called it her spa! She remained able to care for her own hygiene, dress herself and feed herself. When she turned 92 she had a stroke, she spent a week in the hospital and then rehab. Little did I know that it would lead to her passing. The doctors advised that I put her in a nursing home for hospice care. My

mother was a nurse for 55 years when she retired. I went to visit the nursing homes that were recommended to me. I could not do it... I chose to bring her home for hospice. Together with my family we took total care of her.. she could not walk, talk or even feed herself. There wasn't a day that I did not cry my eyes out and pray for our Lord and Savior to bring her home. Having her there with me was a beautiful gift that I will always be thankful for. Mom passed 23 days after bringing her home. We didn't do everything perfect but we did the best we could for that sweet loving soul. It truly is not for everyone to take on.. believe me I prayed to God to give me the strength to see it through. There is so much truth in this video... it will be the hardest thing you will ever do both physically and mentally. Depending on your relationship, taking care of a parent has many rewards. But taking care of yourself is equally just as important."

youtube · @connieburton7213 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 74 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugy1q1NPW2xN9je2nB4AaABAq

↳ **@Marcie-w1u** (9): "Wise words and it sounds like you blessed w a beautiful mother whom you did absolutely right by."

↳ **@thatbemefool** (5): "Beautifully stated...I truly wish you the best. Losing your Parents opens up the floodgates of every emotion/memory imaginable. Be well! It does get better...."

↳ **@TallRaucousTruthSeeker** (4): "Sounds like you really did your duty there. Good on you, your mother was very lucky & you should be proud of yourself for that."

"The End of a Caregiving Era. I started my journey of daily, increasingly demanding and finally all-consuming eldercare back in 2015, when it became clear my mom could no longer physically look after my dad any more but I was still raising my three young sons and couldn't do it all on my own either. That was when I made the first round of phone calls to our local government and health care agencies to see what help was available, and the first workers started arriving to help Dad shower a couple of times a week and sometimes get dressed in the morning. Neither he nor my mom really wanted strangers coming into the house, but they did reluctantly agree that it was too much to expect me to do all Dad's care single-handed while looking after my own family at the same time. I'm so glad now that I took that step of introducing one or two regular caregivers early in the process, even a little earlier than my parents thought was necessary, because it made it so much easier to bring in more help later on. But even with all the helpers we could find or afford, it got to a point where Dad's day-to-day care, and later Mom's, was more than I could handle without breaking. After ten years of having their needs on my mind 24/7, lying awake at night trying to solve all their mental and physical problems in my head, being constantly aware that if anything happened to me my parents would be helpless and nobody else in my family would be able to take over (or at least, not without a huge amount of distress, confusion, and radical changes for everyone involved), I was burned out and exhausted. I'd hoped to keep them both at home until the end, I'd really thought that barring some kind of catastrophe it would be possible, I felt guilty at the thought of uprooting them, but it was also clear -- by God's grace and direction -- that it was time. They needed more help than I could give them even if I dedicated myself to their care 24 hours a day, and I knew neither one of them would have wanted me to neglect my own husband and family or give up everything else in my life to do that. Something had to change. My Dad was the first to move, back in 2019. He wasn't a big man, but by then he was dead weight, with no strength left in his legs, and it took two people or a mechanical lift to assist him. He had to go to a nursing home, and because it needed to happen fast, we weren't able to get our first choice of facility. The place was understaffed and overworked and the food was pretty awful, but it was clean and everybody was trying their best. He lived there for eight months, with my mom visiting him every day, before he passed in early 2020. At that time, Mom was still pretty mobile and cognitively sharp, able to make meals and do her laundry and such on her own -- but then the pandemic kept her even more housebound and isolated than usual, and a mild bout of COVID wrecked her ability to accurately recognize spoken words even with hearing aids (from 56% pre-COVID to 16% afterward). By late 2023 she was showing increasing signs of confusion and struggling with the activities of daily living, and in mid-2024 she began

having attacks of sudden, excruciating nerve pain that required immediate heavy-duty pain meds, as well as a daily maintenance dose of gabapentin. Things went even faster downhill from there, until she could no longer be safely left alone at any time, ever. Even going out for a 30-minute walk once turned into a three-hour ordeal of Mom in agony because I wasn't there when she started a pain attack, and the guilt (for me) and distress (for her) was too much for me to ever risk that happening again. Anyway, this week I moved Mom out of my home and into assisted living. It's the strangest feeling knowing -- or sometimes forgetting, then remembering with a jolt -- that she's no longer downstairs in her apartment, sitting in her rocking chair with one of our cats in her lap, waiting for me to check on her. That when I wake up every morning, I don't have to hurry downstairs to give Mom her morning pills and make sure everything she needs is set up and ready for the day. That it's no longer my responsibility to make sure she's had breakfast and make her lunch and dinner, or keep checking the garbage bin to make sure she's actually eaten her food and not thrown it out. That if she gets muddled at night and doesn't know what to do with her day clothes or where to find her pyjamas, if she folds up her dirty underwear and puts it in with the clean ones instead of in the laundry when it belongs, if she wears the same outfit for two or three days because she doesn't remember she already wore it, that's an issue for her caregivers to address instead of me having to solve it on my own. Not that I've stopped thinking about Mom's needs, or trying to anticipate them. For the past few days I've been in regular touch with her care team, making sure they're up to date on all her medications and support needs and so on. Yesterday when I came to visit, I put labels on the drawers and various sections of her closet to make it easier for her (and the caregivers) to find everything, and I took her dead wristwatch home with me to put in a new battery. But that's all easy stuff, things I can do when it's convenient. I no longer have to drop everything and rush to fix all her problems right away. Better still, I don't have to carry the weight of being the only person Mom can fully rely on, the only one who knows all the details of her health conditions and her medications, her hopes and expectations. I don't have to arrange my days and weeks around her care schedule, and wait for a paid support worker or visiting family member to spell me off before I can leave the house. I can actually go out for more than 3-4 hours at a time, enjoy a leisurely visit with a friend, even leave town and drive to another city for a day -- something I haven't been able to do for ages. I can take a walk with my husband, instead of always taking turns so Mom isn't left alone; we can go out for dinner, or do an overnight getaway, without having to plan and prepare for it weeks in advance. After ten years of intense daily caregiving, first for my father (who had Parkinson's, used a wheelchair, and needed to be helped on and off the toilet every 30-45 min all day) and then for my housebound and increasingly confused mother, being free to go anywhere, any time, feels like a wild luxury. I'm not sorry that I kept my parents at home as long as I was able. I have no regrets about the time I spent looking after them, even though it was sometimes difficult, exhausting and emotionally very hard to do it. I have a lot to be grateful for when it comes to my parents and our relationship over the years, and I am truly thankful for that. But I'm also not sorry that when caring for them became so overwhelming that it was taking over my life, affecting my emotional and mental health, forcing me to prioritize my parents over my husband and children, and keeping me from doing anything creative or restful for myself, I chose to give up full-time care and move them into assisted living. It was hard to break the news to them, hard to see them struggle with it, we all shed tears over it, but once the move finally happened, it didn't take long to recognize that it was truly the best thing for all of us. If anybody has questions about caring for your parents at home and/or the process of transitioning them to full-time care, particularly in Canada (Ontario), please ask and I'll do my best to answer. If you can find the RIGHT assisted living residence (and thank God I have, it's both affordable and perfectly suited to Mom's needs) it's a wonderful relief."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 59 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iq68hc/the_end_of_a_caregiving_era/

↳ **comment (7):** "I went through this with my parents. I was taking care of them in their house until it became so overwhelmingly difficult that I was literally having panic attacks and had a meltdown. It was a hard decision and they didn't want it but moving them to assisted living has been such a game changer for me. I'm finally feeling a bit like my old self! I hope you get to as well. Of course there is plenty to be done but not having to make meals among all the other tasks is the best!"

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. I am just beginning my caretaking journey. My mother is in the hospital as I type this and I am getting the house ready to have her come home. At this point in time, she is unable to lift her cup to her mouth. Last weekend she was able to all the things. Life happens so fast."

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for posting this! This brings me some relief. I am 2 years into my caregiving journey, I work from home and my FiL lives with us. This is the hardest thing I've ever done in my life, it's nice to know that you feel some sense of normalcy at the end of it all."

"My husband went from a athletic fit male to a wheelchair in a matter of a year after a multiple sclerosis diagnosis. We are also raising a child at the same time and I'm working a full time job. Tired is an understatement, let's pray for each other. God is with us"

youtube · @simplysusan87 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyP0-6TMKiB6GrL3ph4AaABAg>

↳ **@socaldave8630** (6): "My wife has had MS for 40 years and now I've hit the wall hard after 3 years of hard ore caregiving. Best of luck to you, I'm still looking for answers. Maybe this is it."

↳ **@BetterByDai** (6): "So many people underestimate the heavy load those who are in your position have to bear. Add children to that, and you can find yourself needing 10 arms to juggle everything. Because it's not just physical exhaustion, its mental and both can spiral into many other issues."

↳ **@hestadickeos6043** (5): "You really have it tough! 🥺 I care for my husband who has Parkinsons, and it's stressful, emotionally draining, and the responsibility after having raised 4 children and two grandchildren is overwhelming. I'm 70, and suffer from chronic back and hip pain, so physically it's difficult also. You have it harder than me. My heart goes out to you 💜"

"Aging parents is no joke. I'm single, childfree, and this is my 2nd month on HRT as a newly post-menopausal woman. Praying the estradiol will protect my brain and bones. My aunts and father are in their 90s. I might have their longevity. Praying I don't get dementia like Mom. I invested in long-term care insurance. Mom did so. BRILLIANT move, she's using it."

youtube · @elyseb674 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 47 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgwPFfJSNwDWbZ6Kky14AaABAg>

↳ **@roosterboy5053** (2): "are we sure we really want that much longevity? how about moderately long with good quality?"

↳ **@elsitabebe** (1): "Right there with you....haven't started HRT yet but need to. My parents are in their early 70's and strong. As a single woman without kidsand a nurse, my sibling think that it's my responsibility to be the primary caregiver when the time comes. 🥺🥺🥺"

↳ **@roosterboy5053** (0): "@elsitabebei saw that happen to my aunt. you gotta let them know that wont be happening."

"Your line "I was imperfect and had my weaknesses and failures..." I pray this is part of what brings you peace. What it really means is that you were sincere. All of us humans are flawed and all we can do is the best we can... and sometimes (a lot of times) our best is imperfect. I guess what I mean is that when it really mattered, you were there for your mom as YOU, not an actor, not putting up pretenses, but with her right in the thick of it where it's hard and heartbreaking... and healing."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/n7tgj52/

"We are all on your side and have experienced your frustration. Just two days go a well meaning church lady that visits my friend once a month or so for about 15 minutes said something similar. My friend's memory care is closing and I am spending hours upon hours visiting new facilities and looking at her budget trying to figure out how we will meet the inevitable price increase. But, this lovely woman who prays for my friend and keeps her name on the prayer chains, can't trust my decision making because I'm not a church goer. "Why can't she just go home?" Gee! I don't know! Why don't you lift her from her wheelchair into your car. Why don't you drive her the two hours to the Neuro-Psych evaluation, wait for an hour and a half for the testing to be completed and then lift her back into your car for the two hour drive back home? Why don't you offer to make the phone calls wheedling and pleading with that office to move her appointment so it could happen now instead of after the memory care closes? How many nights are you going to volunteer to spend in her mouse infested home that still smells like the chickens she allowed to live in the house with her? I didn't see you help us clean out the 5 years of chicken shit! I don't remember your assistance in cleaning out 15 years of uneaten, outdated canned goods so there was room for her to store actual food! How many home care agencies have you called? How many doctor's offices have you sat in with her while she tells them that except for some arthritis in her knee, she's fine? Even though that's the follow up visit from her last compression fracture because she will not use the cane, walker or wheelchair that are provided for her use. But, you know, since she smiled appropriately when you brought her the candy. She joined you in prayer. And she sincerely prayed to just be allowed to return home, we should just make that happen. I'm sure you will help by praying for divine intervention to keep her safe. Unfortunately that's not the help I need. She needs care 24/7. Since my efforts aren't visible from your church pew and aren't happening on my knees, I guess they don't count. We should just mover her back home. I'm sure she'll be fine."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4uoelo/

"Impossible Situation. 50F with Silent Generation parents who are 85 and almost 88. They live in New York State. My mother is almost completely blind from Central Retinal Vein Occlusion that occurred in late 2021 and may have been brought on by many years of glaucoma. She was an excellent patient, always doing exactly what the doctor recommended and keeping up with her eye appointments. Her vision loss is tragic and she has very little interest in living. She is also showing signs of dementia (wailing, nagging, repeating the same questions, worrying about odd things like the alarm clock malfunctioning). Otherwise, however, she's in good physical health. My dad has been her sole caregiver and it's taking a big toll on him. He's great cognitively, but needs hearing aids and is having trouble with balance. He went for a few physical therapy sessions, but stopped around the holidays. He still drives and insists on going out whenever he wants, which is often at night. I live 1.5 hours away and have offered, asked, begged, pleaded and done everything short of showing up unannounced to get them to accept my help. My 48M brother lives 5 minutes from them and doesn't do anything for them other than clear their car when it snows. Of course, they don't/won't ask him for help either. Their situation is a ticking time bomb that has me gripped with anxiety on a daily basis. They have very little money, a condo that is mortgaged (but only in my mom's name), no wills, no POA, no burial plans except a vague notion that there is a plot for them in a cemetery 2 hours away that my late paternal grandmother bought in the 1950s! I got them to sign HIPPA releases and healthcare proxies, but there is no plan for any type of emergency. I called my mom's PCP and mentioned her cognitive symptoms, but the nurse said she denied anxiety or depression at her last wellness checkup. The nurse told me that a neurologist would need to diagnose dementia, so I made an appointment for my mom in April. Will she go? I highly doubt it. I recently had a one-hour free consultation with an elder law attorney. My brother didn't want to pay any lawyer that charged a consultation fee and then was "too busy" to attend the Zoom meeting. The lawyer said my mother needs to get on Medicaid and offered to fill out and file the application...for \$15,750. Getting on Medicaid would allow her to have a home health aide, but the likelihood of my mom agreeing to that is very low.

Additionally, my dad is a hoarder and the condo is in disrepair, so the lawyer said Medicaid won't even approve them for an aide because a home visit is part of the process. If anything big or little happens to my dad, I don't know what will become of my mom. I live in a different state and am not equipped to care for a blind person with dementia. My brother seems to think that my husband and I should take her in, even telling me that we could "get a chair lift." Also, despite the lawyer telling me that freewill.com is a scam (?), my brother insists that documents we print off the internet will be sufficient for creating wills and POAs. He's cheap as the day is long and I cannot pay for things unless we go 50/50. I love my parents dearly and have been really struggling with anticipatory grief on top of all these practical concerns. I worry about them constantly and have begun praying that God has mercy on my mom and calls her home first. I'm glad I found this community and am open to any kind suggestions."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iyze4a/impossible_situation/

"I'm a Care Giver for my 81 year old Dad and have been for 6 years. It's been an emotional rollercoaster coaster ride but I don't regret it. I've let go of some friends and my social life has been impacted but I love my Dad so I stay the course. In the beginning it was especially difficult as NO ONE wants to give up their autonomy and independence even when they need help. I've been disappointed by people I thought were friends but I have gotten over it and keep my focus on what needs to be done and try and let go of things that can wait..... I also have a full time job and responsibilities. My house is often a mess because I am too tired or simply too busy .. one day my Dad will be in heaven and I will look back at the time I devoted to his care and well being and I will be grateful I was able to be present even if it was EXHAUSTING , HARD and at times PAINFUL. Life isn't always easy. Listen to meditation tapes, watch sitcom, pray, take walks and be in the present moment ♥"

youtube · @michelehennessy2086 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive* | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgwyVt8wN_7d8Ayqtm14AaABAg

↳ **@BetterByDai** (1): "Caring for a parent while working full time and managing your own life is an enormous responsibility. It makes sense that some things fall to the side and that doesn't diminish your commitment. There's a lot of strength in choosing to stay the course, even when it's exhausting."

"Considering all the comments on here it appears we are very many in this situation. God help us all"

youtube · @moslifestyles · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxPHFQjWR41cGGxsKI4AaABAg

↳ **@BSAllergy** (3): "We're invisible because so many of us are trapped inside, 24/7, caring for demented/ill relatives."

"Tomorrow will 2 years since we lost our Mother. And it's been a year since we lost my MIL. We took care of both of my parents from 2018-2023. MIL we took care of from 2016-2024. No one knows until they experience this. I had no idea nor did my husband. It became so deep that I would forgot my birthday at times, spouting out my parents DOB etc when I was asked for mine usually at my docs. Consuming wasn't and isn't a descriptive enough word. Exhausting, both mentally and physically. Drowning in the inevitable demise of someone you love. I miss my Mother with all of my heart for eternity. The woman I remember is the Mother who took care of me, not the 93 year old. And I'm positive she'd understand. Our Mothers didn't suffer from dementia, that's hard in and of itself. Because they are (were) aware. God bless you as you go thru this. Pray and I promise there's a light at the end of the tunnel."

youtube · @paintedlady6717 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 20 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=Ugyb_p3bloX_0clu5-54AaABAg

"I went thru it a very long time. . You need to pray...God shows you how to make it through when you ask for help...that is absolutely how to do it...:)"

↳ @lemardrickbrown6440 (o): "GOD HE SURE Will Do It And CAN DO Anything HALLELUJAH
HALLELUJAH HALLELUJAH AMEN 🙌🙏🙌🙏🙌❤️😭🙌🙏🙌🙏🙌❤️😭🙌🙏🙌🙏🙌❤️😭🙌🙏🙌🙏🙌❤️😭🙌🙏🙌🙏🙌❤️😭🙌🙏🙌🙏🙌!!!!"

Hoping it will end soon / wishing they would go · 68 documents

20 most engaged of 68 matching documents, complete text.

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful*. Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her*. I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom CHOSE this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly AGAINST having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends ALSO saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit AGAIN, find a new place to live AGAIN, set up all my utilities AGAIN, and STILL have to manage HER life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING. I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7 months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER. THIS, more than ANYTHING, should be a clue that mom is NOT who she used to be - she prided herself on

taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and THEN people will complain that mom is LONELY. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags under her bed rather than in the 3 FUCKING HAMPERS I've bought for her) FINALLY getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control,

and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all

the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and

stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugxxk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8I4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real

possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "'People ask how they can help and I have no words.' I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"both of my parents are on hospice. i'm at the hospital, bedside with my mother. my father is at home with in-home agency caregivers. my mother's been on hospice since saturday. my father's been on hospice since last may. for so long i wished they would die so i might be free. and, i know how awful that sounds. but... what i really meant was... i needed a break. i needed help. i needed the responsibility of two at once to stop pulverizing me. i have been mentally depleted, physically exhausted, emotionally damaged, socially isolated, financially strained, and personally miserable for years-upon-years. when i said that i hated them, when i said that i wished they'd die, what i meant was that i couldn't... could... not... keep carrying the whole load by myself. i do love my mom and dad. i know my mom and dad love me in their own ways. i started my caregiving journey in 2014. it was a slow burn, running errands, checking in on them, offering assistance, knowing they'd refuse most of it. by 2021, i was a daily caregiver. first for about five hours per day, then nine, then some days 24-hours without breaks. my father has atypical parkinsonism/parkinson's. he refused extensive testing, so we call it parkinson's, but the neuro's notes read "atypical." he's had hallucinations for more than a decade. and, while a neuro diagnosed my dad with parkinson's dementia, a hospital visit indicated suspicion for lewy body dementia, with recommendation for further testing. but, by the time we started running on the hospital "hamster wheel," the amount of chaos my

parents created around care made it impossible to take my dad for testing. doctor's appointments seemed like a luxury by the time i was on full-time with them. after three hospitalizations for pneumonia in under six months, my father was sent home from the hospital on hospice last may. my mother has cardiovascular disease, pulmonary disease, thyroid disease, arthritis, osteoporosis, raynaud's, MGUS... etc., etc., etc., and more. she also has either mild cognitive impairment or dementia. she was never tested except while an in-patient, and only ever when she had a UTI. so, i'm inclined to believe she had mild cognitive impairment, likely age-appropriate and age-related. additionally, my mom's always had trouble with UTIs and kidney stones. this round, i thought she had just a UTI, but she was admitted with a kidney stone obstructing infected urine, and i declined surgery. both of my parents are 90 years old. their personal "rules" for healthcare, established well before i came on full-time were: DNR/AND no intubation, no feeding tubes, no ostomy bag or catheterizations, no thickened liquids, no modified food diets, no surgeries, no anesthesia, no stents (heart or urinary) to move the stone from my mother's ureter meant intubation, anesthesia, and surgery. it would have also meant followup procedures, including additional surgeries. honestly... who does surgery on a 90-year-old woman in fragile condition?? or when her wishes were so clear?? so, i refused. i opted instead for a little extra time with her by way of antibiotics, until her kidneys failed. this happened over three days. and, on the afternoon of the third day, i opted to transition her to comfort care. yesterday, i opted to transition her to full hospice. the hospital... i can't even fully believe or explain it. the hospital understands that my father is at home, also on hospice, that his decline has been violent. they're allowing my mom to stay in-house. they offered me the option of giving her "familiarity or peace," meaning "familiarity" of home or "peace" of an institutional death where i press a button and nurses and aides come to help me. i have never ever experienced such kindness or support in all my years of caregiving, not like this. then... there's the stark reality that both of my parents are on hospice at the same time, and... i don't know what i'm doing. i did tell my father that my mother was dying, and he's since decided to stop eating, drinking, and taking meds. his vitals are falling. his hospice nurse believes he's given up, and that he's decided to "go" with my mom. i do believe this... because he's always only lived for her. i came here to post... because i've been in this group, both as a commenter and as a lurker, for so long. i lurked for years before making my account, and then... more than a year commenting. this group is my primary social exposure since i started caregiving; people i knew grew bored of me and my situation, perhaps. but i always knew i could come here and read about someone else's life mirroring mine, or someone else's feelings sitting similarly to mine. i don't remember seeing many posts about having two on hospice at once. but, i came here just the same. maybe to share? maybe for some kind support? maybe just to "be"? and, maybe... to be somewhere with people who understand. anyway, thanks for listening. i'm scared. i'm truly scared. i'm trying not to fail either one of them, but... i'm tired and it seems there's road still ahead... and... again... i truly am scared."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 170 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tkrjqf/both_of_my_parents_are_on_hospice/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one

holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"I ended up with BOTH my unexpectedly bedridden father, 87, and my fall risk, heart failure mother, 85 in January. Diapers four times a day since then, and stockpiling diapers. In my late 50's, siblings not a factor in care. Hospice has helped. My parents cannot care for themselves anymore, but they demanded to stay in their home. When I brought them to mine, Mom claimed I kidnapped her and calls all her neighbors that I have her stuck down here, while I change her husbands(dad's) diapers and cook three meals a day, and wash sheets daily. Thank you for this video. My mom is going to end up going where she can afford... which is here:(Dad is currently dying in the next few hours, and I am not even feeling guilty about the sense of relief that he can finally stop suffering."

youtube · @AliSouth-m3i · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw7DVeyhTmdeZvSYWx4AaABAg

↳ @HorseLady1109 (2): "@AliSouth-m3i So sorry for your loss and the situation you find yourself in. Find support and relief where you can."

↳ @Teffi_Club (0): "Hope your father had a peaceful transition. Blessings.💕"

"<https://www.bbc.com/news/world-us-canada-60495730> actual study [https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/aging-neuroscience/articles/10.3389/fnagi.2022.813531/full?utm_source=fweb&utm_medium=nblog&utm_campaign=ba-sci-fnagi-what-happens-in-the-brain-when-we-die#h1](https://www.frontiersin.org/journals/aging-neuroscience/articles/10.3389/fnagi.2022.813531/full?utm_source=fweb&utm_medium=nblog&utm_campaign=ba-sci-fnagi-what-happens-in-the-brain-when-we-die#h1) The rest is really self-reportage from people who have had near-death experiences. I wouldn't say the science glaringly points to end-of-life review 100% of the time. But it is funny how it is such a trope and tropes usually come from some seed of truth. It is known that the dying brain & body usually releases a huge last surge of endorphins, serotonin, etc., so most of us can take comfort that even if it looks bad on our end, it isn't that bad on theirs."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/owq9xkr/

"Impossible Situation. 50F with Silent Generation parents who are 85 and almost 88. They live in New York State. My mother is almost completely blind from Central Retinal Vein Occlusion that occurred in late 2021 and may have been brought on by many years of glaucoma. She was an excellent patient, always doing exactly what the doctor recommended and keeping up with her eye appointments. Her vision loss is tragic and she has very little interest in living. She is also showing signs of dementia (wailing, nagging, repeating the same questions, worrying about odd things like the alarm clock malfunctioning). Otherwise, however, she's in good physical health. My dad has been her sole caregiver and it's taking a big toll on him. He's great cognitively, but needs hearing aids and is having trouble with balance. He went for a few physical therapy sessions, but stopped around the holidays. He still drives and insists on going out whenever he wants, which is often at night. I live 1.5 hours away and have offered, asked, begged, pleaded and done everything short of showing up unannounced to get them to accept my help. My 48M brother lives 5 minutes from them and doesn't do anything for them other than clear their car when it snows. Of course, they don't/won't ask him for help either. Their situation is a ticking time bomb that has me gripped with anxiety on a daily basis. They have very little money, a condo that is mortgaged (but only in my mom's name), no wills, no POA, no burial plans except a vague notion that there is a plot for them in a cemetery 2 hours away that my late paternal grandmother bought in the 1950s! I got them to sign HIPPA releases and healthcare

proxies, but there is no plan for any type of emergency. I called my mom's PCP and mentioned her cognitive symptoms, but the nurse said she denied anxiety or depression at her last wellness checkup. The nurse told me that a neurologist would need to diagnose dementia, so I made an appointment for my mom in April. Will she go? I highly doubt it. I recently had a one-hour free consultation with an elder law attorney. My brother didn't want to pay any lawyer that charged a consultation fee and then was "too busy" to attend the Zoom meeting. The lawyer said my mother needs to get on Medicaid and offered to fill out and file the application...for \$15,750. Getting on Medicaid would allow her to have a home health aide, but the likelihood of my mom agreeing to that is very low. Additionally, my dad is a hoarder and the condo is in disrepair, so the lawyer said Medicaid won't even approve them for an aide because a home visit is part of the process. If anything big or little happens to my dad, I don't know what will become of my mom. I live in a different state and am not equipped to care for a blind person with dementia. My brother seems to think that my husband and I should take her in, even telling me that we could "get a chair lift." Also, despite the lawyer telling me that freewill.com is a scam (?), my brother insists that documents we print off the internet will be sufficient for creating wills and POAs. He's cheap as the day is long and I cannot pay for things unless we go 50/50. I love my parents dearly and have been really struggling with anticipatory grief on top of all these practical concerns. I worry about them constantly and have begun praying that God has mercy on my mom and calls her home first. I'm glad I found this community and am open to any kind suggestions."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iyze4a/impossible_situation/

"Yep, I would tend to agree. My father was silent generation, my mom a boomer, and I'm a younger millennial. Even as my father received his terminal diagnosis and began to deteriorate, all discussions of plans, final wishes, etc, were expressly forbidden and would deeply agitate them both. This of course caused A Whole Circus when he finally passed in January and we had no idea what he wanted, where he wanted to end up, his accounts, etc. It was really, really challenging, and somewhat frustrating knowing I tried to initiate conversations many years ago (they certainly know my final wishes!) Luckily it's motivated my mom to have a change of heart and start discussing her plans. But she often says it just feels "wrong" to talk about."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/ocbkdbi/

"I'm living in this space of both my parents ageing rapidly and on very poor health. I'm so alone, it's all consuming and now I can't sleep past 3am and have at least 3 panic attack's a day. I've moved house to be nearer but my mum fights me on everything and doesn't make it easy while my dad is losing his memory. There's a doctor visit every week I feel with constant worry of wtf is next. My anxiety is through the roof I have even planned how to not live anymore once they are gone as I won't be able to handle it. I cry several times a day, eat my feelings and actually pray for illness upon myself to end my misery. I'm 44 and completely alone"

youtube · @stephaniemac7635 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgysxA1XDFIZ2G0XDMR4AaABAg>

↳ **@retrosynthwave** (3): "This is hard. You should try to relax yourself. All we can do is let it pass. Take care. Do meditation. May all beings be at peace. ❤️"

↳ **@dingobabies9824** (3): "Please know you are not alone going through this. Your comment tugged at me deeply cause I do relate what you are dealing with. All we can do is one day at a time and remind ourselves, that this too, shall pass. ❤️"

"Looking for help. Gen X here. I grew up poor with parents who insisted that we couldn't qualify for programs that were available. As an adult, I realize now, that we did qualify, but my parents couldn't handle navigating how to apply. My Mother used made-up excuses to avoid making phone calls and filling out forms. They were content complaining about everything including the made up excuses that I know now, were never even researched or

sought out. My parents are difficult. Extremely anxious to their own detriment. Recently, my Fathers health has drastically taken a turn. After he recovered from Covid, his lungs started to give him trouble. He is diagnosed with PCOS and ILD (Lung Disease) it just gets worse everyday. Years ago they moved 5 hours away from me and all of the family. They claimed that it was all they could afford. Currently, they have run out of their retirement and live off \$2600 a month. I have visited their home several times this year to help out. I went to the Doctor with my Dad. It is good I did, because they do not advocate for themselves. They are great at using excuses to basically give up. Because of their anxiety, they will complain loudly and to EVERYONE, but do NOTHING to help themselves. They will go to their standard doctor visits, but do not speak up about new health issues, they nod their head, complain a little, and set the next appointment. I had forms filled out for IHSS, I got everything started for them, but of course I had to go back home and left all important details written out clearly. Later, they received a letter that they had been denied care. My parents decided that it must be their doctors fault because she had a form that didnt get sent until one day before the due date. That was it. That is how they operate. Now they are (as always) victims and there is no help for them. However, it was not accurate at all. After I pressed my Mother to call their assigned worker on the case, we found out the denial was because they did not receive a form we sent in for Medical/Medicare. They were given an amount of time to remedy this. AND THEN, I got diagnosed with Breast Cancer. And now my entire focus has to be fighting the Cancer in my body and I have only begun. My parents did nothing. They allowed the date to pass without doing anything and now it is too late to get them in home health aid. My mother insists that my father is exaggerating. She is frustrated and shows signs of resentment. I showed her how to order groceries online. She did it successfully a couple times, but now she MAKES my father drive her to Walmart and refuses to use the online service. She does not drive, has never had a license. Meanwhile my Father struggles to breath for simply walking to the car from his scooter. He has dizzy spells. At this point, I worry he is going to get in an accident while driving. But my mother insists that he is just playing it up. I have been instructed by my doctors to set boundaries and deal with my Cancer treatment. I think my Father is probably going to pass soon. How do you get someone to step in, when my parents lack the ability to do the work to get care? The constant Facebook posts from my Dad about how helpless he feels is so hard to deal with. I cant just shut it down. These are my folks. I Know they have undiagnosed learning disabilities and their extreme anxiety is a problem. Is there ANYTHING I can do in order to get someone to step in?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ol2nod/looking_for_help/

"Yes! I am all for death with dignity. Keeping people barely alive in nursing homes on medications isn't kind to a lot of those people. I don't want to end up like that, I want the quick death enema that puts me to sleep forever. Caregiving also made me realize I definitely don't want a drawn out end of life experience."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/osv7ean/

"You're right. You're in hell. And you don't need to be. You just need to give yourself permission to not let the dementia kill you, too. If she has Medicare and already has Medicaid, you should have no financial issues getting her into care. Her social security will go to the facility, so if you count on that money for your monthly expenses, that could be a barrier. Other than that, they'd take any liquid she has, and leave her broke. But so what?!? You sound relatively young, way too young for your life to be over. I hereby give you permission to not start making calls Monday morning, and instead take her to the ER- she's not living! She's EXISTING, and wouldn't want this for YOU. Sending you a hug. 🤗. Here if you need to vent or seek advice. 💕❤️"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_things_anymore/ne99zhz/

"At least if you wait until Mom passes, then you can easily throw out or donate items. We're hoping my mom (90+) passes away while she's still occupying her apartment, so we can just donate. Otherwise, she'll be really annoyed that we garbaged items and that none of the grandkids wanted her giant china cabinet."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rkulf2/elderly_parents_need_to_massively_declutter_to/o8neqsw/

"I AM the elderly parent (72, female)---but both of my children are deceased, her at birth, him in an accident 17 1/2 years ago. I live alone, am still independent, and I hope to just go to sleep one night and not wake up again."

youtube · @jb6712 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwI8XWs0dMFcNQi1d14AaABAg

↳ @Christine-j7b (o): "i have same desire to just pass in my sleep, I have no children am 72 ys , am married but have mobility issues, husband helps a lot but he also in his 70's , if I lost him It would be down to me to organise help at home etc.. I pray and trust God to guide me to meet my needs , I will endeavour to take one day at a time, I have never lived alone so really uncharted waters ."

"When I first brought it up my mom insisted I just wanted her to die so I could have her money. Our family is not wealthy and I have been financially independent since I was 17. They will have to figure this out without me."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/ocf2oes/

"My mom is 91. aside from being in a wheelchair for the last 30+ years, and not having a lot of physical strength, she is very sharp, mentally. BUT, she's had a few health issues over the last couple of years, requiring surgery, one which landed her in LTC. She makes sure, and they always ask, that any procedure she has, that they know she has a DNR, she does not want to be intubated, have a feeding tube, or have them try and restart her heart. And I fully agree with it, even though it means she won't be here any more. I love her dearly as well, but am sad to see how much independence she has lost, and the adjustment to living alone, to living in a LTC facility, needed help with most things. My hope is when the time comes, she simply does not wake up."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oiz3854/

"Yes it is abhorrent that humane euthanasia is not an option in the US. My mother has said repeatedly that she would like to be able to end her life if something were to happen to her or a dire diagnosis. However she seems to think I will have some way of facilitating it--I don't unfortunately."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oj07ehw/

"I'm also 28 and a social worker at a skilled nursing facility and deal with this almost daily. I know you want to be there for your mom and she's hard headed but you have to make yourself the priority. You're going to end up making yourself sick if you keep trying to do this alone. She may not want to go to a SNF but if she needs to then that's what needs to be done. You can't be expected to be her sole caregiver and take care of all of her needs. It's not fair to you or safe for her."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1dbgh7t/rant_post_hospital_discharge/17van8j/

Wish I wasn't here anymore (the caregiver's own despair) · 43 documents

20 most engaged of 43 matching documents, complete text.

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone.. [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/) First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my post, I handled the first diaper change with more grace and compassion. I felt bad for 'losing it' the night before so I tried to do my best, again. One hour later a CNA came to help me wash mom and change one more diaper. Her hands and feet had turned purple at this point. Shortly after I realized mom was in pain. She couldn't vocalize anything, and I had expected it to show on her face, but her expression did not tell any discomfort. However she had her eyes wide open, wouldn't stop rocking back and forth, bending her legs, and it dawned on me that she must have been in unbearable pain. I wonder how long she must have been in pain without me realizing it, probably even the day before. I hate the fact that it took me, us, so long to realize she needed the morphine, and that she possibly spent some of her last few days in pain, without being able to communicate it at all. It hurts my heart. So I called the nurse and we gave her morphine. She relaxed immediately. The doctor came by with a prescription for more morphine for the weekend, but warned me that mom probably wouldn't need it, because she had hours left. The diarrhea stopped too. The nurse came back, helped me prepare more syringes, and I gave her the morphine myself. In the evening she laid on her back immovable, breathing in a sort of robotic, loud way. As if she couldn't breathe, but some automatism was forcing her body to. I remembered that the morphine could help with breathing problems so I started preparing to inject it. I looked at her and noticed the breaths suddenly became more shallow, until she drew her last breath. Her face immediately turned pale. She still had a pulse for a few more moments, until that was gone too. I called the nurse, who was off shift, and she came to help me dress mom anyway. Then the doctor arrived and certified her death. She's now waiting for burial. I can't even describe the pain I'm in right now, but I wanted to let you all know that you've helped me a lot, and I'm glad I pushed through long enough to let her die at home with us. She's in a better place now, it kills me how much she suffered and endured. All I could do in her last hours was carress her and tell her how sorry I was for everything. I wish she had gone peacefully. I miss her already. I can't stop crying. Thank you all again."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/

↳ **comment** (115): "I'm very sorry for your loss. Give yourself some grace over being worn out and scared and grossed out. You're not a machine. And you gave her a gift by just being there until the end. You also figured out she was in pain, and relieved her of it. I'd say you did a great job under horrible circumstances. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (57): "I read your previous post and my heart went out to you. I'm so glad you managed right up to the end - your mom would have been so proud and happy to have had such a wonderful child."

↳ **comment** (43): "It was... it was absolutely worth it and I would do it again. I was imperfect and had my weaknesses and failures but I did show up for mom until the very end. The nurse and the doctor complimented me on my perseverance and it made me feel so seen. Mom would be proud."

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER.

Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful.* Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her.* I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom **CHOSE** this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly **AGAINST** having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends **ALSO** saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit **AGAIN**, find a new place to live **AGAIN**, set up all my utilities **AGAIN**, and **STILL** have to manage **HER** life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* **FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING.** I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7 months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. **BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER.** **THIS**, more than **ANYTHING**, should be a clue that mom is **NOT** who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and **THEN** people will complain that mom is **LONELY**. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags under her bed rather than in the 3 **FUCKING HAMPERS** I've bought for her) **FINALLY** getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit

that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a

part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_t_he_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "'People ask how they can help and I have no words.'" I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom

supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"In a lot of cases though it's not that they refuse help, they just expect YOU to be that help at all costs. My dad is utterly alone and for the most part has himself to blame for it. It didn't seem to be a problem while he was healthy (which he kept a strict regiment to be), Working (successful construction company he built from the ground up), and independent(Beautiful two-story lakefront home). But six years ago when he was in his mid-70s he was plagued with an overwhelming amount of health problems. Caught a bad flu, which turned to pneumonia, shortly after diagnosed with an auto immune disease, and to top all that off was diagnosed with stage 4 melanoma. It was a lot to take, for both of us. To see the once invincible man I knew my whole life be reduced to a shuffling skeleton was a hard pill to swallow. I knew if he lost his independence he was finished so I've done everything in my power since then to give him the space to make his own decisions and treat him like an adult. Which isn't easy to do when the person you're trying to help lives in the middle of nowhere, down a 3 mile dirt road, 25 minutes from the nearest town, and an hour at least from most dr appointments. And just like before his stubbornness, temper, and selfishness has become absolutely unbearable. The same traits that drove my brother (only sibling) to the other side of the country with minimal contact, contributed in part to my mothers raging alcoholism and later suicide, and has driven off almost every other friend and family member. When I say I'm doing it alone I mean it. Drive

him to his specialists. Put all his bills on auto pay and keep an eye on his accounts. Maintenance the house and yard. Move the boat dock when the lake levels rise and fall. Cook for him when I can because if not it will be a crap TV dinner. Cover for him with the doctors on the multiple times he's been admitted to the hospital by saying that I'll be with him 24/7 when I know I can't. Have changed diapers, bandaged wounds, administered oxygen, and wiped his drooling lip more times than I can count. His living situation is not safe. He still tries to drive and it's not safe. Almost everything he attempts to do is not safe. I am in a constant state of worry and stress when I'm not with him, and when I am with him I'm in a constant state of frustration and angst. He's my dad and I love him but when is enough enough? He's currently in the hospital with pneumonia again, aspirating food which could be a feeding tube situation, is definitely going to need oxygen, and also had an acute heart attack which means surgery is in the future. He was barely capable of working his flip phone properly and now this. The doctors, as they always do, are inching him back to a stable state and are talking about releasing him next week. He is already talking about "when I get out and get back to the house we're gonna need to..." and I'm about ready to scream. His location makes any kind of home health assistance a brief glimpse or nonexistent. Getting him into a rehab after hospital visits it's like pulling teeth with insurance. And my family "I'm so sorry you have to deal with this" is about as good as it gets. I have a wife and three kids. A full-time job and a house payment. Coach youth soccer and volunteer hours at the school. A multitude of responsibilities and people depending on me that I have put on the back burner a lot of times and put my life on hold so he can have just a little bit more of his.....his way. That's what brought me here and I hope I can manifest some of this information into something positive. My mom's alcoholism I witnessed as a child made me vow as an adult that my kids would never see me drunk, and they haven't. This situation as an adult has made me vow when/if I become a senior citizen I will never put any of my kids through this. And besides my wonderful and understanding wife the only place I have to talk about it is the emptiness of an online comment section. Ain't that something."

youtube · @amac8237 · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 148 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwx9JsAlAo&lc=UgyMOKJbUOBupQy1MqR4AaABAq>

↳ **@sparkysmom7149** (27): "You have no choice. You have to hold it together for your own sanity. Contact the department of health and aging in your county/state. They will help you. I'm going to have to do this for my Dad too. It's been so stressful, so mentally exhausting, and I'm at the point where the whole situation is effecting my own health. Neither you nor myself can let ourselves decline just to give our dad's "their way". Its wrong. God bless you."

↳ **@DWXY** (25): "Yes, interesting how much help they'll accept from one of their children but not from a professional, in which case they claim it's not needed."

↳ **@mixedredneck3967** (21): "@ShauntelleHamlett And it's a blanket of stress . Like you're being torn by horses but instead of being torn it puts just enough pressure to make you scream. Sounds rough as a metaphor, but some days that's how it is"

"Hoarder MIL: The ongoing saga. Just to recap: \- MIL is in her 80s \- She had one child, a son, and I married him \- My husband died of cancer about 6 years ago \- MIL drove my husband nuts with her crappy attitude and inability to deal with the consequences of her own actions \- While hubs was going through cancer treatments, she'd come up to offer "moral support". While here, she'd expect him to carry her luggage and order for her and all kinds of whatever and expected me to cater to her because "she's the guest". \- She hated me from the beginning and worked to break us up while we were dating and when we were married. This went on for about 10 years. \- She's a hoarder. Her home was condemned by code enforcement in April 2025 when I called local LE for a wellness check on her. \- Had to pay \$17k to get the house cleared and approved by code enforcement for her to move back in. \- She's fallen several times since, totalled her car because "hoard in car" and a bitcoin scam. \- She has been diagnosed with cyclothymia. This is a mild version of bipolar, but honestly, there's likely more going on. \- She fell again beginning of Dec 2025. She had a nursing service check on her weekly and the nurse called for a

wellness check. I went to do some errands for her (she's 3 hours away) and learned the hoarding had resumed with gusto and the toilets were all backed up. At the time, her echocardiogram was normal. \- I got her moved into a personal care home (PCH, not a nursing home) on NYE 2025. She hated it at first, but has been singing praises for the last several months. \- Got her house sold 12 June and her outstanding (massive) credit card bills cleared. One had entered arbitration. She had this idea that, because she was old, she didn't have to pay cc bills anymore. \- The week after the house sold _something happened_. Not sure what. Could have been a silent heart attack, could have been caused by grief over the house selling. Regardless, between Dec 2025 and 2-3 weeks ago, her heart function dropped to 10-15% and she developed congestive heart failure. \- While in the hospital she decided she was refusing medical care. Doc totally confused by this, but ok. She also got a psyche eval while she was there because she kept saying "I just want to die". Also diagnosed with UTI (and her usual delirium). \- Back at the PCH and under hospice care. She won't talk to me on the phone, whines in texts constantly. She's on lasix and O2 for the congestive heart failure. THE NEWS: Sunday (yesterday) AM I got a call from the manager of the PCH. MIL keeps her roommate up all night making her get up and fix her pillows and tuck her in. Roommate is miserable (also in her 80s and in bad health). MIL is not going to the bathroom anymore; she just lies in bed and fills her diapers and expects the PCH staff to clean her up. She won't keep her legs elevated, she won't keep her O2 on. She refuses to eat. Complains about her stomach hurting all the time (not eating, hmmm?). If she won't cooperate, they'll evict her. She has no where else to go. I had guessed at some of what they told me. She'd complained that she was breaking "the new rules" last week, that they wanted to put her in a hospital bed and that was "insane". She whinged on and on about needing a specific blanket from amazon (I finally just caved and got it for her even tho she has blankets). I text her. I cannot call her. She won't answer the phone, and if she calls me, she complains she can't hear me (then says she can't hear anymore, which the PCH says is bogus). I tell her she has decisions to make and it's on her to make them. I tell her that she's being moved to the hospice room that's closer to the toilets and that she's getting a hospital bed so that her legs stay elevated. (The PCH is "losing" the remote, which I totally agree with.) She freaks the fuck out, tells me all this is old news, that she's been in the hospital for tests (they call and tell me when she goes to the hospital and she hasn't been). Bitches that she likes it where she is, she doesn't want to move, yadda yadda. Then she claims the toilet paper holders have cameras on them. A few hours later she says she was moved, it's cold, she has blankets, and I've heard nothing since. So that's where I am today. Concurrently, I'm gonna have to put my 16 year old dog down this week (chronic kidney disease \[CKD\]), my 15 year old dog won't be far behind (heart murmur, congestive heart failure, beginning CKD). A side effect of the CKD is chronic diarrhoea, so I've been cleaning that up for over a month multiple times a day and night; a side effect of the lasix that younger dog is on is increased urination (more things to clean up). I have pee pads all over the place, but there's only so much of that you can do. And my therapist is on vacation for a few weeks. It will be a month before I get to talk to her again."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 127 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v1l503/hoarder_mil_the_ongoing_saga/

"Brother told Mom caregiving isn't a real job... I'm devastated.. My mother suffered a stroke back in 2013/2014 and hasn't recovered. Dad took care of her until his own health severely declined. I always helped out where possible while studying. Dad passed away in January 2023, which threw me into a deep depression and a suicide attempt in May 2023. Jan 2023, my 2nd oldest sibling, sister, took my mom in, but her family gave up after a year. Jan 2024, my 3rd oldest sibling, brother, tried next and gave up after just 6 months. While still recovering from my depression, I stepped up in July/August 2024 to become her fulltime caregiver on weekdays, with my 5 siblings rotating weekends. It's now been 2 full years of this arrangement. Out of curiosity, I asked my mom to check what my 3rd oldest sibling thought of my caregiving after 2 years. I'm devastated by his response. He told her that he "doesn't consider it work since I'm at home" and that I "shouldn't be paid"... So basically he doesn't consider what I do "real work" because I'm at home and believes caregiving shouldn't be compensated or acknowledged. Replacing primary live in care saves our family significant expenses every month. I don't expect a full corporate salary, but diminishing 24/7 caregiving as "not work" is absurd, no? I'm just numb. My 4 oldest siblings are in their 40s with their own families and homes. Aside from a small amount of monthly household

money they contribute, which is nowhere near what a professional live in caregiver costs, I am literally caregiving for free. Again, I'm not asking for a full salary or trying to start a fight, but I just wanted some form of recognition, appreciation... I love my mom deeply, and of course, I will keep taking care of her. I just needed to share this here... Edit: Thank y'all so much for the support and encouraging words, it really means a lot. I love y'all ❤️ Edit 2: Reading everyone's comments made me realize I need to bring this up with my siblings soon. Hopefully we can talk it out and figure something out together, whether it works out or not. Thanks again everyone. Edit 3: In retrospect, I also wanna add crucial context that makes his response even worse, I think. During those 6 months when mom stayed at his place, he wasn't even the one doing the caregiving, he was working. It was actually his wife who took care of mom every single weekday, and I truly appreciate all the hard work and love she put in for our mom. So, like, by dismissing caregiving as "not real work" because it happens at home, he isn't just invalidating me, he's kinda undervaluing all the labor his own wife put in too..."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vwkix8/brother_told_mom_caregiving_isnt_a_real_job_im/

↳ **comment** (32): "I mean, he couldn't hack it, so fuck him. His opinion doesn't count. Especially since he tried to do it and gave up. Caretaking is hard work and is desperately undervalued in a society where the only thing that matters is money. Your older siblings have dropped the 'problem' of your mom's care in your lap, and consider it solved. Watching her one weekend a month is nothing in comparison to what you are doing. Sadly, what you are experiencing seems to be more common than not."

↳ **comment** (25): "The one that couldn't hack it for longer than 6 months is passing judgment? You who have been caregiver for your Mom for over two years ? Boy is that rich! Your brother is a horse's patooti!"

↳ **comment** (14): "Sounds like my family. Hugs, internet friend, the rest of us see you 💖 "

"My mother was 89, had dementia and repeatedly said she wanted to die, COVID took her within 2 days of falling ill. I thank it every day, it was a blessing."

youtube · @stolensilver6963 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 32 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxJ9C4XsidNFmvnl2t4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (7): "Hi friend, I get it. It is a brutally honest truth that at the end humans suffer in ways we wouldn't even have our pets suffer. Society isn't prepared to have these discussions. It seems we like to pretend things aren't happening and don't exist even if they are right under our nose. Thanks for being here."

↳ **@audreysmith3795** (3): "Pneumonia was called the old man's friend. It's hard but I feel that's true. Keep the sick person comfortable but no major intervention to keep me alive at all costs."

↳ **@stolensilver6963** (0): "@SoloSecondHalf it's seeing the person you knew fading away in front of your eyes. Sitting in the house you were raised in, bathing your mother in the bath she used to bathe you in, seeing life going full circle and crying in silence at the loss which has not yet been totally lost. You are left caring for the shell of a person who doesn't want to be there, having the conversation 'you will have to wait your turn, I cannot help you'. In many ways we were very lucky, COVID released us both before dementia stripped her entirely of her dignity and took years from my life. I just hang onto the hope that assisted dying happens before it's my turn."

"I broke two ribs when I was 25. I was miserable, then i got pneumonia and wanted to die. No fucking way in hell is anyone doing chest compressions on my 88-year-old, dementia-suffering mother. People need to see what real CPR looks like, not what they see on TV. Watching a video of a Lucas machine doing actual compressions can be eye-opening. I carry spare POLST, [M]POA, and they're the first thing discussed when I get to the hospital or wherever."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8qopf/

"Very accurate. I literally felt suicidal from the stress of caregiving, the stress of watching my mom slowly die (and knowing I'd have her disease), and from feeling abandoned by my family & community. All these platitudes meant nothing to me...when people even bothered to say them."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nry2xlp/

"I was raised on a dairy farm with a brutal father. He was very abusive, mentally, physically and he broke us with an unfathomable workload that people now can't even comprehend. Fast forward to four years ago and I was helping them and he committed suicide in front of me. My mother had severe dementia and I moved her into my home and cared for her for a year and a half. That entire experience almost killed me and I still can't believe it happened. For me, I guess I did it because it seemed like the correct thing to do. Good luck to everyone who goes through this journey because it's a rough path."

youtube · @thebutterflyreportbyjeffie9220 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 25 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzXW3DgJoV4MCQ_2l94AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (4): "Hi, omg wow I don't even have words except to say I see you and thank you for sharing. Please be very kind to yourself. Much love, peace and healing. ❤️"

↳ **@BronzeDragon133** (0): "Second that. We hear you, we see you. If you can and you think it would help, some therapy might assist with the really complicated tangle of emotions (or knot of blankness) that has to haze that whole mess. Just to validate all this, your "father" (I use the term extremely loosely) sounds perfectly awful and completely unfit to be a parent."

↳ **@miriamleonard2651** (0): "My heart goes out to you as I think about what you've been through. And to think you took in your mom, when you didn't have a loving family to begin with and probably drew from a dry well in terms of the love you felt for them. Your sense of duty is heroic to me. You didn't deserve how your father treated you, I hope you know (sometimes these toxic experiences can confuse us.) I admire you, as I realize I probably would not have done as well as you did, with your commitment to be a help to your parents. You may not believe it, but you are a special person."

"Caregiving will eat and spit you out over and over again. Without a peace of mind your mind becomes resentful, angered, stressed, suicidal and hateful. The only one she/he have becomes screw this shit I want to be selfish I want to run far away as I can and the hell what society thanks of me."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nocgdi5/

"I'm living in this space of both my parents ageing rapidly and on very poor health. I'm so alone, it's all consuming and now I can't sleep past 3am and have at least 3 panic attacks a day. I've moved house to be nearer but my mum fights me on everything and doesn't make it easy while my dad is losing his memory. There's a doctor visit every week I feel with constant worry of what's next. My anxiety is through the roof I have even planned how to not live anymore once they are gone as I won't be able to handle it. I cry several times a day, eat my feelings and actually pray for illness upon myself to end my misery. I'm 44 and completely alone"

youtube · @stephaniemac7635 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhKEw&lc=UgysxA1XDFIZ2G0XDMR4AaABAg>

↳ **@retrosynthwave** (3): "This is hard. You should try to relax yourself. All we can do is let it pass. Take care. Do meditation. May all beings be at peace. ♥"

↳ **@dingobabies9824** (3): "Please know you are not alone going through this. Your comment tugged at me deeply cause I do relate what you are dealing with. All we can do is one day at a time and remind ourselves, that this too, shall pass. ♥"

"A question on hospice/dying with dignity (hopefully). Hi everyone (I never know how to start this, in my mind I hear Fraiser Crane doing his call in show...) a few months ago I posted about my mother to get information about hospice. Honestly, the wasn't the time, but I believe we are now getting there. My mother has esophageal cancer and had been a feeding tube since January. At first she could still have Popsicles and suckered, then became nothing by mouth. This took us all by shock (as much as any cancer can) as she didn't drink, smoke, you know just one of those things. A few months ago it was suggested by the hospital to send her to hospice. However after first saying they would do bolus feed and water it was changed. At the time she was aware and didn't want it. So we went back to nursing home and she had a few good weeks (doing crafts, activities room, etc) Unfortunately, it took a turn when a therapist came in (something to with either speech/food and had her eat pudding) somehow a breakdown in communication. The nurses said she was nothing by mouth, it said so on her door even. That night she called me saying she had been coughing for 2 hours and couldn't breathe. Tried to call nurse, even yelled between cough nothing...i even tried to call as I drove over. Didn't get an answer. I took her to er that night...and that was beginning of the end. She aspirated, got pneumonia after the fluid (or pudding or whatever!) Was taken from her lungs. It was like within 2 days she was no longer mentally alert. For about the last 3 weeks we may get a hi, or squeeze my hand. Most of the time nothing. Because she couldn't do therapy anymore she was moved from private room to one with a roommate. It is horrible to go in. I try to talk to my mother and this person turns cnn up to the highest level. No chairs so we do not stay long. This is where I am at... her medicaid finally went through, we applied in april. I was told by someone there i couldn't move her to hospice or I would've had to pay the 13k she had owed. I also couldn't do hospice there as she had to stat on the tube because it had to be one skilled nursing thing or 300 a day. I just felt...trapped. I haven't gone in last 2 days as I have been coughing badly and just couldn't do it mentally. I feel better tonight so will go in morning. Part of me wonders if I should try to take her to a hospice center now. I know it would only be a few days without food or water. But I could be there, sleeping there, be with her. I know she doesn't want to die, but visting her just looking at wall is slowly killing me. I can't even tell her I love her without CNN blasting and the roommate getting upset we are ruining her TV time (all few minutes I am there with family...3 of us total - me, husband, and my step dad) My other question is, if anyone had practical experience with a person with no food or water on average how long? I thought of waiting until October 1st (unless something happens before then) and moving her. I just...this sounds bad but I will be truthful. My daughter's birthday is the 10th. I would like not to have my mother pass on that day. I lost my son on another family's birthday and I know the feeling...that person is older, but still hard. My daughter is only 26 and I want her to not associate her birthday with her grandmother passing. One nurse said it was three weeks (maybe an aide?) But that doesn't seem right at all. I somehow thought 3 to 4 days tops. I just feel bad for even thinking hospice... I went against my mother's wishes as she was a full code. I changed that. 2 months ago she said not to take her to hospice...but she was talking and active then. Now...its staring at the wall. Sorry long, I just have no one to talk to about this. I am an only child and while I do talk some to husband and daughter, this is up to me. My husband just lost his father and his mother isn't well and my daughter was in charge of her brothers estate and I will not burden her with more than she can handle."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nmeljk/a_question_on_hospicedying_with_dignity_hopefully/

"This hits. That's why I got out. After bashing my head into the shower enough times, my brain started processing things a little differently. I didn't even communicate it. I just left. And I don't feel bad. I started taking care of my mom physically and mentally when I was 6 years old. At 30 I broke. Literally just broke and wanted us to both be dead. My siblings never helped. Her husband never helped. Her doctors never actually helped. It was all on me to drop my entire life and be her caretaker. 3 years later, I'm in the healthiest relationship of my life. Taken time away from taking care of her and working full-time. Fortunately I have a partner that understood and has given me the space to "find" myself and work through all of my trauma. During this time my brother has had to pick up the slack and has been mistreating our mother. His rude kid reached out to me recently to basically shit on me for leaving. I don't care and it doesn't phase me to not have any contact with those people. Funny enough, because my mom realized I wasn't going to come back and save the day, she's "gotten better" to an extent. I feel used and like no one even values what I did for so many years. Learning to let that all go. Happily pregnant with a baby that I plan on having (previously had 2 abortions because there was no way I could take care of her and a kid while in shitty relationships) - also because of her, I never wanted kids. I'm happy I didn't end my life and I just said fuck it, it will either work out or it won't. I'm never going to let anyone make me feel bad for leaving. The years I did help, it's not like anyone appreciated me anyways. Now they just notice my absence. I too wish there was a system in place for what OP suggested. Our world would be a better place. But we're living during times that our administration doesn't care about the people that need assistance. We need a change in our administration and our policies. Because unfortunately not everyone can just leave like I did. Be it their finances, the shame that comes with it, or the support from at least one person, or the literal million other reasons. After I give birth I'm going to get a degree in Grant & Proposal Writing for Health and Medicine to hopefully make changes for others who are thrown into caregiving at a young age / any age... that is my goal anyways."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobvsl7/

"Also, even if you get the timing right you may not be there in his final moments. I spent a week with my mom in hospital—it was clear she was very ill and she was talking about wanting to die, but none of the doctors said her actual death was imminent. She ended up passing the day after we brought her home, while we were out picking up her meds. I've read other stories about how people pass when no one is around. You have spent time with him in his final days. My mom said to me at one point that she didn't want to die without telling me again that she loved and was proud of me. It sounds like your dad has had the opportunity to do the same if he has anything he wants to say. I don't see what you'd accomplish by hanging around until his final moment. Live your life."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_t_rip_because_our_dad_is/oo7dub0/

"Very often I've been a caregiver for my son with schizophrenia. I'm basically the only one in the family who has the patience to deal with this horrible illness. In the past, he was homeless for a long time, MIA, off of his meds, etc. but he's my son, and I do what I can to help him regardless of his situation. This illness has such a horrible stigma attached to it, and so many want to judge him including family---instead of showing empathy and compassion. I try to raise awareness so others know more of what all he's going through. After all, it could be one of their loved ones some day that get this. I've never heard of compassion fatigue, but it really hits home with my situation, and I totally agree with this because it can be so very draining to be a caregiver. So often, it's an uphill battle, but with this illness, it's also a very lonely one for both the person with the illness, but also the caregiver. There's also a high risk of suicide (1 in 10 will be successful). I pray for more awareness, compassion, understanding and for the stigma to go away."

youtube · @lovesmary2944 · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving* | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland · 11 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=Ugyw2smtSaWz-TqcTH54AaABAq>

↳ **@PhyllisE.** (o): "Thank you for sharing. And, yes, it is a horrible illness and the stigma only makes it worse. Medication can help bring some quality of life, over the long run. You are courageous."

↳ **@chandrisodergren7209** (o): "My daughter also has schizophrenia, psychosis and autism, she's home with us, been a care giver for 10 years now. She's unable to take care of herself all the basic needs from waking up in the morning to the bedtime routine. My husband and I have to take turns to help her. Meds did not help her, made her worst. Sleep problems, bowel problems, unable to comprehend things, speaks without any sense but I am there listening to her rambling 3 for 4 times per day everyday anyway. She'll be in a bad mood if I am not listening to her same rambling, this makes me so exhausted though but I am her mother and I love her and want the best for her so I will be there to hear her but many times it makes me exhausted mentally tired. I don't mind taking care of her but it's worst when she doesn't cooperate and listen to me to do certain things like it's time to take shower now and she refuses, that drains my battery level to 0."

"I agree with the replies below. Here is a possible structure to help you. I am so sorry. This is an emergency-level caregiver crisis, and you should not be expected to keep doing 24-hour care while going through advanced cancer treatment. You did not fail him. The system is failing both of you. A few things I would try next: First, call Adult Protective Services again and say clearly: "I am his unpaid 24-hour caregiver. I have advanced cancer, I am in chemo and radiation, and I can no longer safely provide care. He is a vulnerable adult and there is no safe caregiver available." Ask for a supervisor and ask for an emergency protective services review. Second, call his primary doctor, neurologist, psychiatrist, or whoever manages his TBI care and say: "He is unsafe at home because I am medically unable to provide care. I need documentation for emergency placement, waiver services, or facility-level care." Ask them to put in writing that he needs supervision and that you cannot continue as caregiver. Third, contact the hospital social worker or patient advocate, not just the regular front desk. Tell them the waiver paperwork has been sitting for three weeks and your cancer treatment makes this urgent. Ask for the social work supervisor, case management director, or patient relations office. Fourth, if he is in another manic or unsafe state and you take him to the ER again, use the words: "There is no safe discharge plan. I am medically unable to care for him. I have advanced cancer and am in active treatment. I cannot take him home safely." Ask to speak with the hospital social worker before discharge. If they still try to send him home, ask them to document that they are discharging him to a home with no available caregiver. Fifth, call 988 or your local mobile crisis team when he is manic or escalating, but also tell them you are medically unable to provide supervision and need crisis placement or emergency respite. Even if he is not actively suicidal, the issue is that he may be unsafe due to brain injury, behavior, and lack of supervision. Also, please contact your own cancer center social worker. Cancer centers usually have social workers who can help with transportation, home support, emergency planning, and caregiver crisis situations. Tell them plainly: "I cannot continue cancer treatment and provide 24-hour care. I need urgent help." If he has Medicaid or is Medicaid-eligible, ask specifically about a disability waiver, brain injury waiver, personal care services, home health aide services, and emergency respite. Since he is under 62, aging services may not help, but disability services or Medicaid waiver programs may. And please hear this: you are allowed to say, "I cannot do this anymore." You came for temporary help four years ago. You are now seriously ill. This is beyond what one person can carry. Keep repeating to every agency: "There is no safe caregiver available." Do not let them turn this back into a personal favor you are supposed to keep providing."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ulb1ow/please_read_i_need_help/ov6wldd/

"Many of us have our own lives to live. With childcare it is temporary and eventually you can get back to work even with the setbacks, with elder care it's pretty much permanent until they die, not to mention not all of us have good or even a basic relationship with the person that needs caregiving. Many people become extremely suicidal due to having to care for them 24/7/365."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vfk46/2_months_of_assisted_living_and_they_can_no/p2ew7ps/

">assisted unaliving You can say suicide. This ain't Twitter. And yes, I agree with the rest of your comment. Heck, just look at Canada and MAID."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/12u1e46/we_all_know_this_but_its_nice_to_see_in_print_how/jh7eexo/

A peaceful end, no regrets · 41 documents

20 most engaged of 41 matching documents, complete text.

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone.. [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/) First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my post, I handled the first diaper change with more grace and compassion. I felt bad for 'losing it' the night before so I tried to do my best, again. One hour later a CNA came to help me wash mom and change one more diaper. Her hands and feet had turned purple at this point. Shortly after I realized mom was in pain. She couldn't vocalize anything, and I had expected it to show on her face, but her expression did not tell any discomfort. However she had her eyes wide open, wouldn't stop rocking back and forth, bending her legs, and it dawned on me that she must have been in unbearable pain. I wonder how long she must have been in pain without me realizing it, probably even the day before. I hate the fact that it took me, us, so long to realize she needed the morphine, and that she possibly spent some of her last few days in pain, without being able to communicate it at all. It hurts my heart. So I called the nurse and we gave her morphine. She relaxed immediately. The doctor came by with a prescription for more morphine for the weekend, but warned me that mom probably wouldn't need it, because she had hours left. The diarrhea stopped too. The nurse came back, helped me prepare more syringes, and I gave her the morphine myself. In the evening she laid on her back immovable, breathing in a sort of robotic, loud way. As if she couldn't breathe, but some automatism was forcing her body to. I remembered that the morphine could help with breathing problems so I started preparing to inject it. I looked at her and noticed the breaths suddenly became more shallow, until she drew her last breath. Her face immediately turned pale. She still had a pulse for a few more moments, until that was gone too. I called the nurse, who was off shift, and she came to help me dress mom anyway. Then the doctor arrived and certified her death. She's now waiting for burial. I can't even describe the pain I'm in right now, but I wanted to let you all know that you've helped me a lot, and I'm glad I pushed through long enough to let her die at home with us. She's in a better place now, it kills me how much she suffered and endured. All I could do in her last hours was carress her and tell her how sorry I was for everything. I wish she had gone peacefully. I miss her already. I can't stop crying. Thank you all again."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/

↳ **comment** (115): "I'm very sorry for your loss. Give yourself some grace over being worn out and scared and grossed out. You're not a machine. And you gave her a gift by just being there until the end. You also figured out she was in pain, and relieved her of it. I'd say you did a great job under horrible circumstances. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (57): "I read your previous post and my heart went out to you. I'm so glad you managed right up to the end - your mom would have been so proud and happy to have had such a wonderful child."

↳ **comment** (43): "It was... it was absolutely worth it and I would do it again. I was imperfect and had my weaknesses and failures but I did show up for mom until the very end. The nurse and the doctor complimented me on my perseverance and it made me feel so seen. Mom would be proud."

"My mom has passed. and my heart hurts, literally aches, right now. But I am relieved. At the end she was not really living. She died in my arms here at home 24 hours ago. We had just done the hospice intake 24 hours prior but hadn't yet been seen by a nurse. I wished my mom could have gone out more comfortably than she did, but I am choosing to look at the bigger picture, of all of the love and comfort that she experienced over the course of her

decline. She spent the last 3 weeks of her life here with me, pretty much bed-bound, and it all happened rather suddenly. She had Alzheimer's and a whole host of other health concerns (it was undiagnosed heart failure that did her in). But at some point in the past week, she had enough presence of mind to say to me: *you have shown me the most love and care of anyone in my life, you are so good to me, thank you for being so good to me* and I know this may sound odd, but it was a privilege for me to be able to nurse my mother in her final days. I love you mommy. I will always love you. Thank you to all of the kind folks in this subreddit who have been a source of comfort and support"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 304 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p3du0e/my_mom_has_passed/

"Things I Wish Someone Had Explained to Me About the Actively Dying phase. I wanted to share a few things I've learned during the active dying phase with my mother-in-law because this experience is honestly something most people are not prepared for at all until they're suddenly in it. And I've realized some hospice agencies are amazing at proactively educating families... and others are kind of waiting for the caregiver to know what questions to ask or what options exist. The problem is your brain is already overwhelmed, emotional, sleep deprived, grieving, and trying to function while watching someone decline in real time. Sometimes you don't even know what you don't know. A few things I wish someone had explained to me earlier: hospice can provide a hospital bed in the home at no cost. There are also relatively affordable rotating air mattresses and pressure relief options online that can really help with comfort and tailbone pain. Foam barrier dressings have helped too. The little mouth swabs dipped in water have also made a huge difference for dry mouth and comfort. Another thing that has been hard emotionally is the eating and hydration piece. Every instinct in you wants to push food and water because feeding and nurturing someone feels so tied to love and care. But there really is a lot of hospice and scientific literature around the body naturally beginning to need less at end of life. From what I've read and been told, excess fluids can sometimes increase swelling and discomfort. I've also gone down a rabbit hole reading about ketosis during the dying process and how some researchers believe it may actually help ease pain or discomfort for the body. I'm not a medical professional, just a human trying to help someone I love through one of the hardest and strangest experiences of my life while learning as I go. Sharing in case it helps another caregiver feel a little less lost or alone."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 281 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/

↳ **comment** (82): "For anyone interested, there is a YouTube channel called HOSPICE NURSE JULIE. She explains all phases of dying, from all types of diseases and what to expect in each case. She is excellent at answering questions and taking the fear out of the whole process."

↳ **comment** (69): "Thank you for posting this, and massive, massive hugs to you. My sister recently passed but before that, our family was doing the above, actively providing water and nutrients (protein drinks) but also being anxious about knowing that at some point she wouldn't want to and couldn't either, because it became an aspirating danger. Mouth swabs in water are absolutely a game changer for comfort, they also had mouthwash that helped generate saliva that provided some comfort to her. The last thing I'll say about this phase that I never understood despite reading about it ceaselessly, was the restlessness that comes at end of life stage. I didn't know my sister's discomfort and distress would be her last signs before she passed. At that stage, it's was hard to know the degree to which she was in discomfort because it as a constant dance of increasing drugs for not only pain but also discomfort. We heavily leaned on the amazing nursing staff to help us through this distressing time, and for anyone else seeing a loved one in hospice, just emphasizing that no question is a silly question, they have seen everything under the sun and are experts at noticing all the signs and symptoms."

↳ **comment** (23): "Hospice nurse Julie reels are so helpful. They can be a little jolting; it just depends if you are a person who likes a lot of information or a little. Taking the fear out of the process makes it more tolerable so you can be present."

"both of my parents are on hospice. i'm at the hospital, bedside with my mother. my father is at home with in-home agency caregivers. my mother's been on hospice since saturday. my father's been on hospice since last may. for so long i wished they would die so i might be free. and, i know how awful that sounds. but... what i really meant was... i needed a break. i needed help. i needed the responsibility of two at once to stop pulverizing me. i have been mentally depleted, physically exhausted, emotionally damaged, socially isolated, financially strained, and personally miserable for years-upon-years. when i said that i hated them, when i said that i wished they'd die, what i meant was that i couldn't... could... not... keep carrying the whole load by myself. i do love my mom and dad. i know my mom and dad love me in their own ways. i started my caregiving journey in 2014. it was a slow burn, running errands, checking in on them, offering assistance, knowing they'd refuse most of it. by 2021, i was a daily caregiver. first for about five hours per day, then nine, then some days 24-hours without breaks. my father has atypical parkinsonism/parkinson's. he refused extensive testing, so we call it parkinson's, but the neuro's notes read "atypical." he's had hallucinations for more than a decade. and, while a neuro diagnosed my dad with parkinson's dementia, a hospital visit indicated suspicion for lewy body dementia, with recommendation for further testing. but, by the time we started running on the hospital "hamster wheel," the amount of chaos my parents created around care made it impossible to take my dad for testing. doctor's appointments seemed like a luxury by the time i was on full-time with them. after three hospitalizations for pneumonia in under six months, my father was sent home from the hospital on hospice last may. my mother has cardiovascular disease, pulmonary disease, thyroid disease, arthritis, osteoporosis, raynaud's, MGUS... etc., etc., etc., and more. she also has either mild cognitive impairment or dementia. she was never tested except while an in-patient, and only ever when she had a UTI. so, i'm inclined to believe she had mild cognitive impairment, likely age-appropriate and age-related. additionally, my mom's always had trouble with UTIs and kidney stones. this round, i thought she had just a UTI, but she was admitted with a kidney stone obstructing infected urine, and i declined surgery. both of my parents are 90 years old. their personal "rules" for healthcare, established well before i came on full-time were: DNR/AND no intubation, no feeding tubes, no ostomy bag or catheterizations, no thickened liquids, no modified food diets, no surgeries, no anesthesia, no stents (heart or urinary) to move the stone from my mother's ureter meant intubation, anesthesia, and surgery. it would have also meant followup procedures, including additional surgeries. honestly... who does surgery on a 90-year-old woman in fragile condition?? or when her wishes were so clear?? so, i refused. i opted instead for a little extra time with her by way of antibiotics, until her kidneys failed. this happened over three days. and, on the afternoon of the third day, i opted to transition her to comfort care. yesterday, i opted to transition her to full hospice. the hospital... i can't even fully believe or explain it. the hospital understands that my father is at home, also on hospice, that his decline has been violent. they're allowing my mom to stay in-house. they offered me the option of giving her "familiarity or peace," meaning "familiarity" of home or "peace" of an institutional death where i press a button and nurses and aides come to help me. i have never ever experienced such kindness or support in all my years of caregiving, not like this. then... there's the stark reality that both of my parents are on hospice at the same time, and... i don't know what i'm doing. i did tell my father that my mother was dying, and he's since decided to stop eating, drinking, and taking meds. his vitals are falling. his hospice nurse believes he's given up, and that he's decided to "go" with my mom. i do believe this... because he's always only lived for her. i came here to post... because i've been in this group, both as a commenter and as a lurker, for so long. i lurked for years before making my account, and then... more than a year commenting. this group is my primary social exposure since i started caregiving; people i knew grew bored of me and my situation, perhaps. but i always knew i could come here and read about someone else's life mirroring mine, or someone else's feelings sitting similarly to mine. i don't remember seeing many posts about having two on hospice at once. but, i came here just the same. maybe to share? maybe for some kind support? maybe just to "be"? and, maybe... to be somewhere with people who understand. anyway, thanks for listening. i'm scared. i'm truly scared. i'm trying not to fail either one of them, but... i'm tired and it seems there's road still ahead... and... again... i truly am scared."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 170 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tkrjqf/both_of_my_parents_are_on_hospice/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"Why is Hospice pushing me really, REALLY, hard (almost bullying) into signing a DNR order?. My mother lives in an ALF. She is in Memory Care. About 4 weeks ago she was sent to the hospital. She wasn't eating and couldn't urinate. After about five days she was sent to Boca Circle Rehabilitation. I can't tell you what a nightmare Boca Circle was! UGH A director from the ALF visited mom a couple of times and told me I needed to get her back to ALF as soon as possible. Boca Circle wouldn't release her. ALF was insistent that I request a Hospice consult. If she was in hospice care, she could come back "home". I requested the consult. BC ignored me for a couple of days (like four, but two of those were the weekend). I called the Hospice center myself. They told me they needed a request from BC. On Monday, the Hospice center finally got ahold of someone at Boca Circle and got the request they needed. Mom was assessed and it was determined she would go back to the ALF on hospice care. Since then, hospice has been hounding me to sign a DNR order. Telling me horror stories about what physical injuries she might incur if an ambulance is called and they have to perform lifesaving procedures (CPR). And, if she goes back to the hospital, hospice would have to withdraw hospice care. I just feel like BC, the ALF and Hospice are playing a game of ping pong with my mom to see who can get the most billable "bed hours" before she dies. Hope that made sense. I thought I was doing the right thing by my mother, but I may have just made it worse. Why is hospice being so pushy about me signing that DNR order?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 75 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/

↳ **comment** (260): "I don't know about the ping-ponging but hospice is end of life care. It's normally for those who have a life expectancy of 6 months or less. It's meant to keep you as comfortable as possible, not to prolong life. If your mom had a DNR and stops breathing (as an example), she is allowed to pass naturally. Without a DNR an ambulance would be called and chest compressions would be started. If you've ever taken a CPR course you may recall how forcefully you have to compress to be effective. That's where the injuries and pain come in."

↳ **comment** (239): "The bigger question.. why doesn't your mother already have a DNR in place? Not eating and not urinating (probably not drinking) and memory issues are a trifecta of potential further medical intervention coming down the pike. Why? Btw, your mom being in the hospital for any length of time would likely mean the ALF would have to release her bed, of course depending on who is footing the bill."

↳ **comment** (180): "Those horror stories are real. One of the absolute worst things for doctors is being forced to perform resuscitative measures on elderly people at end of life with no meaningful chance of recovery and who already have a declining quality of life. They wish desperately that more families would have the courage to sign the DNR. At this stage in life, things like CPR are just a cause of more pain and suffering for the elderly person. You are doing things *\to* a person, not *\for* a person. Hospice is generally a program where all life-prolonging measures are stopped, in some programs, it is actually required. The only things done are things that improve comfort and quality of life. The focus is no longer on the quantity of life. If you are not comfortable with a DNR, hospice is likely not the right program for your family. ETA because many people need to hear this... by signing a DNR, you are NOT 'giving up' on your mom, you are not 'killing' your mom, you are not 'abandoning' her, it does NOT mean you don't love her deeply and wish that she could live forever. Allowing her to pass from natural causes at the end of life, choosing not to put her through any painful medical procedures, deciding to no longer prolong her life at all costs, is a loving, compassionate, and ethical thing to do."

"If your mom has no hope of recovery, and you choose a good hospice provider, everything is better on hospice. That said, when I worked for federal gov, Florida complaints outpaced every other state, and not just because there are so many retirees. It's a hot mess. My experience personally was in Calif and hospice staff and services were fantastic."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8oj0ln/

"Modern medicine has solved a lot of issues that let people live longer, but hasn't solved the problems that arise from people with all these serious health problems living longer. The social safety nets haven't kept up, and the population is skewing older as well. I honestly hope, after watching loved ones suffer and decline, that I'm mentally sound enough to be able to choose a more peaceful end to my own life. Maybe I'll feel differently at that point, but I don't want to spend years in pain and doing nothing but going to doctor's appointments, or recovering from surgeries."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p04jl0n/

"Thank you so much for writing all this. It needs to be pinned and memorialized for all! I am good friends with a hospice nurse so I'm on the same team, I wish more people were at peace with this. And they should also know they are the gladiators to defend their parent's right to a peaceful death. The medical establishment isn't designed to do this (other than hospice), and if there's any conspiracy, it's the conspiracy to keep our elders alive beyond

their time and beyond their own body's wisdom. My primary question for OP is not why is hospice pushing so hard for the DNR, but why are you opposed to it? What quality of life are you defending? Sorry 🥹 I know it hurts and my words are blunt"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zww/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8pxgq5/

"Nurse here, chiming in unofficially. This is going to be some very plain talk. When someone comes onto hospice, we want to know what sort of end of life care the patient and family want. If you were to ask your mom, "if you knew the date and time of your death, what would you want that death to look like?" What would she say? A lot of people, when asked that question, say they want to be home, with family and friends present, and they want it to be peaceful. This means not only a DNR (which is used in the hospital setting), but also an OOHDNR (out-of-hospital DNR, for home, doctor's appointments, outpatient surgery centers, etc.). Why? When someone has a terminal diagnosis and are in the last 6 months of life, resuscitation measures are not life-and-comfort extending. They are brutal. CPR at the end of life is not like it is on TV. Researchers have looked at CPR survivorship, and there is a huge disparity in success between young people who experience a traumatic injury, such as a car accident (moderate success overall, and many can end up with long-term deficits) vs. people whose illness brings them to the ICU or who are at the end of life and are in hospice (very low success at resuscitation in the short term, very low likelihood of any meaningful recovery). If a hospice patient isn't DNR, this means CPR (which usually results in broken ribs and worse), aggressive management of complicated medications to try and boost circulation to the vital organs, and intubation (introducing an artificial airway) and mechanical ventilation. If someone is at a hospice level of care, these things will not bring comfort, nor will they do anything but artificially and painfully extend their life for a short while. Your loved one will be in pain, sedated, and will be kept alive by machines. This will be in a hospital ICU, and it is likely that this is how they will die. The transition to hospice care, hopefully, allows time for conversation about what someone wants their end to look like. For a few patients and families, this means no DNR - they're willing to accept this kind of end. But for many who have had a chance to think about what they want, they choose a more peaceful exit on their own terms. I'd recommend you to talk more about all of this with your mom and her hospice care team (social worker, chaplain, etc). That team should be able to give you guidance on why the DNR and OOHDNR are advised. Also — and this is important for you to know — you can revoke these at any time, but you can't put them into place at the last minute. So if you haven't signed a DNR and OOHDNR, and your mom is at your home and begins to die, 911 responders will take all measures, and it doesn't matter if she has changed her mind. But if you *do* have these papers and change your mind, you simply do not show them to the 911 responders, and you can have full measures taken. Having these documents gives you more choices rather than fewer. This is hard stuff. I hope your hospice team can give you the support you need to talk about all of it."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zww/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8oya2b/

"I'm so sorry you are going through this. As someone else mentioned get your mom evaluated for hospice care. With her advanced liver cirrhosis it may be the right place for her. My mom went into assisted living last October. She was 87 and I had been her caregiver and coordinated her care for over 10 years. She had Alzheimer's. She went downhill so fast that she only lasted in AL for 2 months. She was moved to memory care in December and then hospice care in February. My mom also developed necrosis on one of her heels. The best and most compassionate care she received was hospice care. She passed away in March. I kept her in her home for as long as safely possible. I totally understand when you say you are unable to care for your mom any longer. It is physically, mentally, and emotionally draining. Do not blame yourself that it was time to move your mom. You did the best you could. Eventually our loved one's health care needs exceed our capabilities to care for them. The most

helpful people on this journey were the social workers and the hospice care nurses. The social workers knew the best places that were options for my mom and how to make it happen. I literally can't say enough positive things about hospice care and their wonderful staff. I'm wishing the best for you and your mom 💜 "

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vfk46/2_months_of_assisted_living_and_they_can_no/p2e0j5z/

"Wow. *So many* similarities in our stories, except my Mom wasn't in nearly as bad of shape and my sister (who also promised to help) only "visited" *once* in 2+ years. She has since gone NC with my Mom and, the way I see it, wrote me off at the same time. I wish I had better advice for you, but if you can't bring yourself to pursue a facility, why not home hospice instead of PC? My heart goes out to you, OP."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n7v3y4/rant/ncaeu1/>

"My husband put his 95-year-old father on hospice because he won't live much longer, and we want him to have a relatively comfortable life. He already had a DNR, so it wasn't an issue. Let me tell you worst-case scenario. My father-in-law has a Zenker's diverticulum. It's a pocket that develops in the back of the throat that makes swallowing difficult. It can cause him to aspirate, which could result in pneumonia, likely killing him. We've taken him to a surgeon who is monitoring the situation, but he told us if it did worsen, he would likely vote against surgery. FIL also has low blood pressure, iron-deficiency anemia (likely cause by a small leak in his gut that is probably from colon cancer), and hypothyroidism. We've known all of this for two or more years. He came down with Covid last year. His ALF sent him to our local hospital because his blood pressure dropped. They didn't want to care for him so they sent him to the big city for treatment. That was on a weekend, and a neurologist was overseeing the ER (I got his name and double checked...I have no idea why there was no ER doc). They had him on IV nutrition, but he was complaining because he was hungry. Plus, English is his second language, and, as par for the course, he had lost his hearing aids. My husband was a deer in the headlights: he did not know what to do. So he asked me to go to the hospital with him. Okay, I'm a bull in a china shop, which can be useful on occasion, so I go in, and the first thing I did was look at his chart and go over every single thing. A nurse came in, and I said I want to see a doctor now: "Well, there is no ER doctor on duty right now." It was 10:00 a.m. So I called the patient advocate and told them we wanted him taken back to the ALF, he has a DNR, he doesn't need a swallow test because we already know what's causing that, he doesn't need any more blood tests because he just had those done. Within 15 minutes a doctor finally showed up, my FIL was cleared for release back to the ALF, and he was given some ice cream. If he had been on hospice then, none of that would have happened. It was a waste of resources, our time, our money, and the taxpayers' money (he's a vet), and it stressed him out to such a degree, I'm sure it shaved months off his life. The ALF now calls hospice in to make the decisions. And they advocate fiercely. I don't know your mom's situation, but I wouldn't want my own mother to go through all of that business for nothing. I don't think any of the ping-ponging is so much a money grab as it is a lack of communication. A DNR makes the communication much more clear."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8os16o/

"I want to share something with you. Two years ago my mother's sister died. My aunt's surviving child went no contact with her and she was devastated but stoic about it. At the time I asked my mother what my aunt would say if her child were to suddenly show up and Mom said "she would have forgiven everything." She reminded me that there have been times we haven't been nice to each other and that there may be in the future but that all is forgiven because she loves me so much and she knows how much I love her. She also said when people die it's normal to feel guilty about "should have done" and "could have done". Fast forward two years and at the end of last year I lost my Mom. It was hellish. There were times I was so strung out I was not the person I wanted to be. The end was awful, it was not what I wanted for her. So your words "All I could do in her last hours was carress her and tell her how sorry I was for everything. I wish she had gone peacefully" really hit me. Because when I lost

my Mom it wasn't peaceful and I needed to remember her words - "all is forgiven." I am so sorry for the loss of your mother and that the last chapter was so difficult. You loved her, she knew it, you did your best. She loved you, all is forgiven. I hope this helps in some way. Big hugs."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_li_mit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/n7ucs6z/

"Hi! My Mom received home hospice for the last week of her life. I didn't want to sleep either. But you should try. I'd set a timer overnight to check on Mom, and administer meds if needed. My mother had Congestive Heart Failure. Hospice is great, but they didn't tell me she might experience a discharge from her mouth while actively dying. I was alone and it was Thanksgiving Day. I wasn't sure what to do, and I couldn't rest her on her side and allow the fluid to drain. Mom didn't struggle or notice anything, so I dabbed the fluid up with tissues for several hours. It was disturbing to me because it was pink foam (blood, oxygen, fluid mix). I was told later that can happen. If this happens for you, don't be alarmed. I wish we started hospice sooner, was my only challenge. The process took a while and by the time we were approved, Mom possibly had a stroke, was unable to speak and heading to the actively dying phase quickly. Edit: about not eating - I also found it uncomfortable to watch, but hospice explained to me how much harm it does. Plus, Mom lost the ability to swallow, along with her appetite. The moist swabs helped her a lot. My BiL came by, and kept grilling me about not feeding her during active dying. I told him to read the booklet. He made me feel awful, and don't listen to anyone who makes you feel bad. The instinct for survival is to eat. We want to feed people, but when they're dying? Food is unhelpful and dangerous, and could cause complications. The goal is to make their inevitable transition peaceful."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/oldnont/

"Condolences for the loss of your Dad, the compassion and care for him is wonderful to hear. I hope you and your loved ones are able to take solace in the fact that he went peacefully."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkw18g/dad_passed_this_morning/p2wymfm/

"Thanks for the words about my dad. He was a complicated man; but very dearly loved right through to the end and beyond. I'm lucky to have had him in my life that's for sure ♡ That sucks about your dad's perception of your mother's last days when she was NPO (nothing by mouth) because that's a very standard practice. Does he have cognition enough to grasp complex thoughts and situations by any chance? If he does it might be worth a try to try and educate him on that so that he can understand and accept that NPO is a kindness and safety measure meant to support a peaceful passing rather than a cruelty. People can choke on foods, fluids, meds, etc... at end of life so going NPO limits the risk of them choking and dying with that fear or drowning sensation which is horrible for everyone involved. Feeding tubes are a whole other thing... As graphic as it is, if he has cognition and can understand you can let him know that feeding tubes in a person who is actively dying brings the opposite of comfort because the body doesn't process the foods and pumping stuff in just adds mass and adds to their overall discomfort. Because the body is no longer absorbing and processing nutrients the "food" just collects onto of itself causing bloat, gas and maybe even the need to poop; but pooping at that stage can be traumatizing to the body in and of itself, and some in some not so rare cases that trauma can cause heart attack and end in death. Going NPO eliminates many unpleasant risks that can make end of life terrible for people who are dying and even those around them who watch those tragedies take place. Hospice is scary because it comes at the end so when people hear that word they get scared because they equate hospice to death and many of the "horror stories" people hear or assume come as a result of being on hospice aren't because of hospice- it's because of death and the many complications and confusions that death itself can present. I do hope you're able to break through to dad so he

understands that hospice is a journey not a destination and that the professionals who support people on that journey make recommendations and/or have restrictions for a good reason- peaceful passing is always the focus. I hope this makes sense. I just took my melatonin and I'm a bit loopy 😊 "

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8rqrvw/

"I simply mean my mom is very disabled and cannot do anything for herself and is in a living situation that will never be what a nurse would think is good for her. She's getting care from a mix of hospice, home aides, and my dad but it's not really enough when you're in this situation. Anything short of 24 hr care just won't ever be enough. She basically hasn't moved from her hospital bed since June for the most part so of course she has developed bed sores that won't heal. Her 84 year old husband is the main caregiver as he lives in the home with her and he uses a mix of hospice and home aides to help but it literally takes a team of three to even adjust my mom on the bed and reposition her so they usually can't. Once the workers from hospice or insurance see all this of course they are alarmed and want to place her. Not going to a nursing home was her wish, staying in their apartment was their wish and they don't have any savings at all so this is the best we can do."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qjlcjn/what_is_up_with_this_trend_among_social_workers/o111182/

"It sounds like she should probably be discharged to skilled nursing not to assisted living. Has the social worker advised as to why she is recommending another assisted-living instead? Has anybody discussed hospice it may be time for that also. I wish you the best and giving us all sorted out. I know it's a lot on your soul and your mind."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vll32w/mom_being_discharged_from_hospital_back_to/p33i7ax/

"same here. it's unbelievable the manipulation and pure venom they give and feel. i feel relief for sure. no guilt about that. still, guilt for other things. seems normal to, healthy even. i wish strength you need and ask that you consider speaking to hospice nurses about medication that can help. my mom wouldn't take pain meds, though she was in excruciating pain. once she was forced to take it, she chilled out and enjoyed the pain-free part, at least. stay with her. xo"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_t_he_state/oz0rb2/

Stay in her own home · 22 documents

13 most engaged of 22 matching documents, complete text.

"Mom (93) finished cancer treatment and is giving up. Looking for both tactical advice and to hear from anyone who's been through this. Long-time lurker, first time posting. The situation: Mom is 93, just finished radiation for cancer and is in remission with aggressive monitoring. We had to move her from independent living to assisted living about six weeks ago after a hospitalization made it clear she couldn't safely live alone anymore (not taking meds consistently on her own). (She had been in independent for 18 months before the cancer diagnosis and seemed fine.) Treatment went as well as we could've hoped clinically. But now that the active medical crisis is past, she's collapsed. What's happening this week: \- Won't get out of bed. Won't leave her room. Always an excuse for not going to meals or activities. \- Hiding her medications. Staff are catching some of it but probably not all. \- Caught trying to bribe staff — telling them she'll give them her house if they help her go home or look the other way when she does things she's been told not to do. \- I'm pretty sure she thinks that if she gets kicked out of AL, she thinks she goes home. Home is not an option. The next step is SNF, and she doesn't understand that. A counselor is seeing her tomorrow, which I'm grateful for. The staff at AL is working with us — they have really been amazing through all this. What I'm asking: 1. For those whose parent went through post-treatment depression — did meds help? Did therapy? Did anything? How long did the dark stretch last? 2. The bribery / med-hiding behavior — is this depression, early cognitive decline, or both? She's been cognitively intact on testing, but this feels like something shifted. 3. How do you talk to a parent who has decided to give up? Every script I try ("we want you here," "we're doing this because we love you") seems to bounce off. She just keeps saying she understands but then the behavior doesn't align with what she says. 4. Did anyone successfully avoid the SNF transition by getting their parent stabilized in AL after a backslide like this? Or is this how it goes? The harder thing: We have moved mountains. We (my wife and I) uprooted our lives to temporarily move to be near her and take care of her throughout this process. My employer has been very understanding. We've dealt with all the paperwork, coordinating five specialists across three cities, getting her placed, managing her finances, the cancer treatment, all of it. And it's not enough. She's miserable and I think part of her is angry at us for not letting her go home to die in her own bed. I know there's no magic answer. I just want to hear from people who've been in this exact spot. What helped. What didn't. What you wish you'd known. Thanks for reading. Edit: I wanted to provide some additional info to address some of the comments. Health prior to the cancer diagnosis: First, up until this cancer episode she was in very good shape cognitively and physically - much better than her age would suggest. She only used a walker outside or unfamiliar places. People always commented on how sharp she was. Finances: After my dad passed away, we discussed her finances on many occasions. My only concern was that she was financially ok and she constantly assured me that she was fine. She was paying her bills -- she always paid on time and was never late. I have never pushed her to do anything she didn't want to do. She approached me about moving to IL. We discussed the cost and I agreed to help because it was going to cost more than her monthly income. We discussed selling the house and she agreed. But she kept coming up with excuses to drag out the process and, quite frankly, I was busy with other things in life. Then one morning shortly after the initial cancer diagnosis, she divulged a credit card bill. In trying to get to the bottom of that I discovered that hole was much deeper than she let on. She even tried to hide some of the statements from me. On the cancer diagnosis: Her mother (my GM) died of cancer, so I think mom heard cancer and immediately interpreted that as a death sentence, despite what anyone told her. Multiple doctors told her should would likely die with it and not of it. It was very early stage 1 and very treatable. One oncologist said even at her age, given all the other factors, he gave her a >90% chance of survival. We made the decisions we made with the best intentions and the best information available at the time. That bell has been rung and I'm not going to re-litigate that on an Internet forum. Legal affairs: Before all of this, we had all of her legal affairs in order. She had an AD (no code), and I have full financial and healthcare POA. I have since taken over managing the finances and have an attorney involved to make sure we handle the debt and her care according to her stated wishes. On me "not being able to let go": I have a

background in being a first responder. I've seen death in the line of duty and personal experience with other difficult family situations. This is not a situation where I "just can't let go." I have lived through that on my wife's side of the family and it was an awful experience. I have discussed this situation with many doctors and every single one has told me this is not a palliative care situation -- she would likely not qualify for hospice. I'm not an expert in that -- I'm simply going on the advice of others. Now has she just lost the will to live? Yes, very probably. But being depressed is not the same thing as being terminally ill and that's not the same thing as just being old. I'm hoping that independent behavioral health will help us make the best decisions we can from here on out. I appreciate everyone who has taken time to respond."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 125 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4swt3/mom_93_finished_cancer_treatment_and_is_giving_up/

"Hi so there are no perfect solutions here, my mom did both the home care thing at our house and is now in AL. I guess a third option might have been moving her to a senior apartment and hiring her care. My thoughts. Two big factors will be how well the house suits your mom and what the labor market is like where she lives. My uncle is 4 years older than my mom, has major memory problems, but has hung in there with the help of an amazing housekeeper, he has a flat house, and is in a compact village in a rural area so he has built in interaction to some degree. My mom was in a large house with difficult steps and falling hazards, she was in a sprawling expensive suburb where it was hard to get good help, and even with help was pretty isolated. Having a person in her house all day seemed to breed conflict. So we went with AL. Also her house was in a great location but aging as fast as her and it was the right time to sell. I have learned the hard way that AL is not very personalized and while my mom fits well into the level of care they provide, it's a very partial solution. She still needs me or someone really frequently, but stuff like caring for the house is no longer an issue and there is structure for her medications. She also is enjoying the social aspect and doing some activities. I will also say that making a move gets harder as they age, so this may be the window that you need. My mom had pretty major surgery in April and it became apparent her days of living independently were over. I would love to think that your mom is looking out for you and knows on some level that moving in with her would be hard for you. Good luck!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fwww6z/offer_rejected/lqjb1we/

"I AM the elderly parent (72, female)---but both of my children are deceased, her at birth, him in an accident 17 1/2 years ago. I live alone, am still independent, and I hope to just go to sleep one night and not wake up again."

youtube · @jb6712 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwI8XWs0dMFcNQi1d14AaABAq

↳ @Christine-j7b (o): "i have same desire to just pass in my sleep, I have no children am 72 ys , am married but have mobility issues, husband helps a lot but he also in his 70's , if I lost him It would be down to me to organise help at home etc.. I pray and trust God to guide me to meet my needs , I will endeavour to take one day at a time, I have never lived alone so really uncharted waters ."

"My 80 year old mothers power is out. We had a bad storm last night. I'm about 1 hour away. One of my daughters is 30 minutes away. My daughter took her a cooler with ice and cold drinks. My mother has made it clear that she will not go to our homes. It really hurt ! I could never ever refuse my children s help. I love them so much I just can't hurt them. See my dad left my mom & me when I was 2. So I've been the one to care for her over the years. I've felt it was my responsibility. Even when she had another daughter out of wedlock when I was 10 I still felt like I was responsible. I would work to help buy groceries. And I cleaned the house from the time I was 6/7. I started mowing the grass at around 9 years old so my mother would not have to do it after she worked at sears all week to support us. My mother doesn't realize that I want her to have independence. I want her to have a car and money. So she can go buy anything she wants. I would fix up a beautiful tiny house for her she doesn't have to live with me. I want better for her. I have lived in this home for 6 years now. She came out one time. We needed her. And

she came to watch our dogs for 5 days. After 3 she left and we had to come home early. I have no idea why. We had everything she could possibly want. My youngest daughter was here too. It was the last time she saw my youngest daughter. I guess she will never see her again. My daughter is in her last year of graduate school now and plans to live in another state. We also plan to move to that state. So my mother will be very Alone then. Because I'm a flight away at that point. And I am not supposed to fly. I have a spinal cord stimulator implant due to a spin injury from a plane crash and from arthritis. But I'll fly to come help her. I guess I have no choice. Because she refuses to allow me to set her up in a really nice place with help near by. I have given it much thought. And moving to where my daughter is the best option for me. I hope my oldest will follow. We are going to buy a larger home and property where we have room. There is definitely room for my mother. But she will never come. She lives in a very high crime city And she's not safe. But it's her choice. She chooses high crime and extreme hardship over me her daughter who would really like to spend some days enjoying her company. It's sad! Who dose that ? On one hand you have a little house worth nothing an old car that probably doesn't have much longer to run in a very dangerous high crime area when you could go live with your daughter where she could decorate a gorgeous tiny home give you a newer nicer car. Even money she you would never have to worry about bills or anything again. But you choose high crime over family and real freedom. This worry will be the death of me."

youtube · @FourHuskyHomestead · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAIAo&lc=Ugzw9OQWR5664nNDks14AaABAg>

↳ @Melissa-gn3dv (2): "Try to focus on those who will accept your care, including yourself."

↳ @InMyHumbleOpinion5000 (2): "Release it. (This is easier said than done, I know. I'm also talking to myself.) Remember this with your own children, do better with your own children. Use this seemingly closed door to ensure you remain open to the ones who active and positively love you. 🙏"

"When I first brought it up my mom insisted I just wanted her to die so I could have her money. Our family is not wealthy and I have been financially independent since I was 17. They will have to figure this out without me."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/ocf2oes/

"Let them continue to wish and talk. Stick to the plans and where you have them now. My mom lost her driver's license many years ago, State took it away from her after a really bad accident. My dad nearly died. She wished for the next 7 years that she still had a car and could be independent again. You do need to continue to listen intently.....they need that from you. Lost Mom back in March.....it wasn't until the last 6 mos of her life that she stopped talking about losing her independence and her ability to live on her own. She was really bummed when we moved her into AL in the fall of last year.....we didn't have the chance to get her into high care prior to her death.....let them wish, listen and acknowledge them. They are going to take their time to understand that they can't do what they dream for any more."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwr/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/oofshbf/

"My mom is 91. aside from being in a wheelchair for the last 30+ years, and not having a lot of physical strength, she is very sharp, mentally. BUT, she's had a few health issues over the last couple of years, requiring surgery, one which landed her in LTC. She makes sure, and they always ask, that any procedure she has, that they know she has a DNR, she does not want to be intubated, have a feeding tube, or have them try and restart her heart. And I fully agree with it, even though it means she won't be here any more. I love her dearly as well, but am sad to see how much independence she has lost, and the adjustment to living alone, to living in a LTC facility, needed help with most things. My hope is when the time comes, she simply does not wake up."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oiz3854/

"26 caring for my 66 year old grandfather post stroke. My heart aches to see his pain and confusion. I hope he can gain some independence back."

youtube · @frickencarrie · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgwgTu8BZVJFEHxahwd4AaABAq>

↳ @nothankyou7864 (0): "Hang in there. I'm 26 and trying so hard to learn to care for my 75 year old grandfather who has dementia, is blind, cancer and mobility issues. He only has 3-6 months left to live. Im 125 lbs and I cannot lift him not help him much at all if he can't stand.. I'm focusing on what his life was and all the positive impacts he has had. It's hard everyday. I get emotional seeing his mind go and his quality of life change. But your grandfather is so lucky to have you. This is the darker side of life. Celebrate the beautiful and I'm so sorry for your pain. I wanna say I love you but that's weird lol it just feels so much less lonely in these comments."

"Options for Home care if he can't quite walk. Looking for advice on continuing to care for a loved one at home when they're not able to independently walk anymore. This came on rather suddenly with my husband. He has pretty advanced Alzheimer's dementia. He was walking without assistance (except for standing up) until he suddenly couldn't. The hospital didn't find signs of a stroke or UTI so not quite sure what caused it but right now he's at a rehab facility. It's not looking very positive as far as his getting back to being able to stand up and walk fairly independently. For a number of reasons, I really would like to bring him back home, not have him go to a long-term care facility unfortunately I understand that insurance companies don't provide much notice when they're gonna stop paying for the Rehab . I guess my main concern is getting him in and out of bed if I can't do it alone. Care agencies are all set up for blocks of time in a limited number of visits. What I really need are short daily visits to help move him. Which of course is not the best schedule for people to work. Unfortunately I don't have family or friends nearby that can help out with this which would be the best solution. I can move things around the house to facilitate a wheel chair. I can have help with bathing and can manage changing him in bed. I'm really hoping he'll get back to at least standing independently but have to plan for him not. People do manage this somehow sometimes right?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1okyetw/options_for_home_care_if_he_cant_quite_walk/

"Yes I have! My mom had short term memory loss dementia. One day she called me and was upset bc she left the bathroom and didn't know how to get back to her recliner! I knew then she could no longer live alone so that day I packed up my clothes etc and moved in with her. I was lucky that my house was not 10 minutes away from hers. Fast forward a week and I noticed she just wasn't right... had to call 911 and turns out she had pneumonia and a bad uti.... In the hospital for two weeks and rehab for two weeks. I found out when she was in the hospital that she had not been eating. I found all the breakfast biscuit I had brought her n a napkin rolled up and hidden in a basket. Well they sent her home with hospice.... I was a caregiver with visiting angels and had had hospice clients before so I knew the drill. When she got home her dementia was 10 times.worse bc when an older person gets a uti it affects their brain. She wld call my name at 3 am to ask me "what was your dads name" just random questions constantly. She wld not walk like they told her and just sat in the recliner and wld go to the bathroom tho but thought she had to go every 15 minutes and I had to help her bc she was so unsteady on her feet. I wld fix meals only fit her to take a partial bite and say she was done! I was at my wits end bc I was getting physically and emotionally exhausted. Then I remembered two months prior she just came out and said "I want to see my mom and dad and my Ronnie (who was her second husband of 35 years).... I realized then mom was ready to go....8i wasn't ready forever to go but once they make up their mind there's not much you can do! I finally asked her if she wanted to die and she said I'm ready to go bc what good am I... what kind of life do I have.. I sit in this recliner all day and it seems like every time I get up it hurts. Now she had gotten down to 71 pounds and all she had to do was sit down to hard and she wld get a compression fracture. I know she was hurting. She died this past June and I'm left with the guilt of why I didn't notice sooner, what ifs completely dominated my thoughts. I guess my point here

is once they decide they are ready the first sign is not eating...,went thru this with several of my clients I worked with... but I'm glad you got help in so it's not l on you... I wished I had of bc by the end after getting up every two hours to give meds I was physically and emotionally exhausted. I'm also an only child so it was all on me! I'm just letting you know from my experience that when they refuse to eat, get up, do things fir their selves it means they have just given up and no matter how much you try to reason with them it will not help! My advice... have a heart to heart talk with him, let him know you love him and cherish this time you have left. If he says he feels he has no quality of life left then accept it. My mom's biggest fear was being in a nursing home not recognizing anyone and wearing diapers. Thank god she was only in a diaper for two days bc she couldn't get out of bed. She had made her wishes known to hospice.... She was adamant to die with some dignity. As hard as it was I had to accept it.?I wish you the best of luck."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nuphf8/dad_discharged_from_hospital_yesterday_now_acting/nhl1cul/

"My mother is 83 and in good health. Mild cognitive decline but still pretty sharp. She and her husband are constantly talking about how I should move in or have them move in with me whenever they get to the age that they're not able to care for themselves in their home. I have told them I have no intention of doing either. Then they say "well please promise to never put us in a nursing home". That's not a promise I can make. I cannot predict the future and their health. I hope they can live their lives independently right up until the end but things happen and circumstances change. How can I make this clear to them without sounding harsh or uncaring?My husband and I plan to retire in 4 years (we'll be 62) and hope to travel and enjoy our retirement not become full time caregivers. My mom and her husband have already enjoyed their retirement and traveling when they were my age. I think it's unfair of them to expect this from me."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/do-parents-ask-you-to-promise-to-never-put-them-into-a-nursing-home-498143.htm>

"I am currently caring for my mum and I am lucky that my mum has carers in 4 times a day as I insisted she didn't leave hospital until a care package was in place. So glad I insisted on it as it really is the best now. I can make sure she is fed and watered and comfortable in her own home. I do hope that we are allowed assisted dying if I get to my mum's age as I really want to just go peacefully and not have my family see me deteriorate and grieve every time they see me."

youtube · @Imafanofdrew2000 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzmoRdn-V8mgRQ3df14AaABAg

"I love ur content, but what if they have no savings and refusing to be independent? They just want me to pay everything."

youtube · @Teisharocz · *TOP TIPS FOR NEW FAMILY CAREGIVERS - How to Take care of Aging Parents* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g0UwGxD4F90&lc=UgynggX4H3cCWj5RNiB4AaABAg>

Peace of mind, sleep again · 18 documents

8 most engaged of 18 matching documents, complete text.

"Things I Wish Someone Had Explained to Me About the Actively Dying phase. I wanted to share a few things I've learned during the active dying phase with my mother-in-law because this experience is honestly something most people are not prepared for at all until they're suddenly in it. And I've realized some hospice agencies are amazing at proactively educating families... and others are kind of waiting for the caregiver to know what questions to ask or what options exist. The problem is your brain is already overwhelmed, emotional, sleep deprived, grieving, and trying to function while watching someone decline in real time. Sometimes you don't even know what you don't know. A few things I wish someone had explained to me earlier: hospice can provide a hospital bed in the home at no cost. There are also relatively affordable rotating air mattresses and pressure relief options online that can really help with comfort and tailbone pain. Foam barrier dressings have helped too. The little mouth swabs dipped in water have also made a huge difference for dry mouth and comfort. Another thing that has been hard emotionally is the eating and hydration piece. Every instinct in you wants to push food and water because feeding and nurturing someone feels so tied to love and care. But there really is a lot of hospice and scientific literature around the body naturally beginning to need less at end of life. From what I've read and been told, excess fluids can sometimes increase swelling and discomfort. I've also gone down a rabbit hole reading about ketosis during the dying process and how some researchers believe it may actually help ease pain or discomfort for the body. I'm not a medical professional, just a human trying to help someone I love through one of the hardest and strangest experiences of my life while learning as I go. Sharing in case it helps another caregiver feel a little less lost or alone."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 281 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/

↳ **comment** (82): "For anyone interested, there is a YouTube channel called HOSPICE NURSE JULIE. She explains all phases of dying, from all types of diseases and what to expect in each case. She is excellent at answering questions and taking the fear out of the whole process."

↳ **comment** (69): "Thank you for posting this, and massive, massive hugs to you. My sister recently passed but before that, our family was doing the above, actively providing water and nutrients (protein drinks) but also being anxious about knowing that at some point she wouldn't want to and couldn't either, because it became an aspirating danger. Mouth swabs in water are absolutely a game changer for comfort, they also had mouthwash that helped generate saliva that provided some comfort to her. The last thing I'll say about this phase that I never understood despite reading about it ceaselessly, was the restlessness that comes at end of life stage. I didn't know my sister's discomfort and distress would be her last signs before she passed. At that stage, it's was hard to know the degree to which she was in discomfort because it as a constant dance of increasing drugs for not only pain but also discomfort. We heavily leaned on the amazing nursing staff to help us through this distressing time, and for anyone else seeing a loved one in hospice, just emphasizing that no question is a silly question, they have seen everything under the sun and are experts at noticing all the signs and symptoms."

↳ **comment** (23): "Hospice nurse Julie reels are so helpful. They can be a little jolting; it just depends if you are a person who likes a lot of information or a little. Taking the fear out of the process makes it more tolerable so you can be present."

"i have been a caregiver for almost a year now. my father suffered a stroke at 77 years old and has severe paralysis and dementia symptoms we were very close before the stroke so i jumped into the role of becoming his caregiver. a few months after the stroke i noticed these symptoms because i was being overworked about 18-19 per day

taking care of dad with no relief or extra help around the house i became in charge of every aspect of my dads life and it brought along a huge amount of anxiety and depression. I'm still trying to navigate this today but i hope me and my dad can overcome this tough time."

youtube · @angelacevedo3694 · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving* | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland · 29 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=UgxHEPSLQya8N9KkVmt4AaABAq>

↳ @lolaost9559 (1): "Breathe... one moment at a time. Give yourself permission to cry, feel the feels... ib been doing it for 15 years... 💖 toughest road. But you are beautiful and strong for taking on this very important and mostly lonely job."

"I have told people that for the past year (more so the last couple of months), I have cherished the time with my mother, mourned my mother, and hated the monster that is her dementia "personality". Honestly, getting final terminal timelines actually is more a relief than a pain. I told a friend "I just wish for "rip the bandage off already and be done" exit for her. We have had this diagnosis since 2014, it took serious hold during COVID, and when my dad died in June she started slipping. Through it all I have been her proxy and her advocate. It is not like I didn't know where this would lead. We went from 30 days last week prior to hospice admission, to a bad weekend, to yesterday thinking we are counting days not weeks. There is no feel good "right" call, but at this point, what is the point in forcing it. Even today when I asked about upping her meds, the hospice nurse said "well we don't want to sedate her necessarily because that could accelerate things". I looked at her deadpan in the face and said "the problem with that is what exactly?" My thoughts are if she is comfortable and peaceful (which she really isn't atm) what difference does it make if we go from 5 days to 4. I told the social worker today that if we lived in the right state, I would have tried to get my mom into a Death with Dignity protocol back in the day, because spending your final days/weeks in agonizing and paralyzing fear is no way to live."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/olgumd5/

"Thank you. Never in my wildest dreams was this how I thought everything would play out. She had given me an amount that she was planning on leaving me — this was not a life changing amount. But I could pay off some bills and maybe go on a vacation. Now I have to pay everything out out pocket for her funeral and hope I get reimbursed by the estate, and I just started a new job so I have no PTO. I went from having a little wiggle room to being out money and peace of mind."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nqewid/relative_didnt_sign_her_will/ng7pywc/

"Sorry I got to 9.38 ad couldn't listen anymore as hoping to get stress relief instead of ground rules. I doubt Hilary Clinton or Condilica Rice were stay at home carers.. Find this all a bit irritating as so stressed I feel like screaming!!"

youtube · @franidance6565 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgxG_FyUHu51lgrZERV4AaABAq

↳ @aeromedical6750 (2): "Exactly. They had a staff of caregivers looking after their parents and didn't live with it 24/7. Not even close to a realist scenario."

"So sorry and I hope the relief you will allow yourself to feel will help you as you move through your grief"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tnv7m/my_mom_finally_died/onua1ch/

"Thank you for this. I was put in one of these situations last week. It hurts emotionally, it's uncomfortable — I'm sleeping on a lumpy, smelly sofa right now 90 minutes from home. I'm moving things ahead though. When my child is older we will read the will together. Our family will discuss where the money and insurance are and me and my spouse's expectations for care. I hope I pass in relative comfort, health notwithstanding, but it doesn't need to be in my own house. My kid's peace of mind is paramount."

youtube · @dyermaker77777 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxT11QbC1l3zGc4Zu14AaABAg

"Oh, the light...the light...the light! You can totally feel it fading. I feel this 💯 ! A lightbulb burning out when you want to be a lightbulb shining bright! I hope you get some relief! ✨💖 "

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@sleepygoddess414/video/7663260821497089310> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@sleepygoddess414/video/7663260821497089310>

Wish someone had explained / had known · 15 documents

11 most engaged of 15 matching documents, complete text.

"Things I Wish Someone Had Explained to Me About the Actively Dying phase. I wanted to share a few things I've learned during the active dying phase with my mother-in-law because this experience is honestly something most people are not prepared for at all until they're suddenly in it. And I've realized some hospice agencies are amazing at proactively educating families... and others are kind of waiting for the caregiver to know what questions to ask or what options exist. The problem is your brain is already overwhelmed, emotional, sleep deprived, grieving, and trying to function while watching someone decline in real time. Sometimes you don't even know what you don't know. A few things I wish someone had explained to me earlier: hospice can provide a hospital bed in the home at no cost. There are also relatively affordable rotating air mattresses and pressure relief options online that can really help with comfort and tailbone pain. Foam barrier dressings have helped too. The little mouth swabs dipped in water have also made a huge difference for dry mouth and comfort. Another thing that has been hard emotionally is the eating and hydration piece. Every instinct in you wants to push food and water because feeding and nurturing someone feels so tied to love and care. But there really is a lot of hospice and scientific literature around the body naturally beginning to need less at end of life. From what I've read and been told, excess fluids can sometimes increase swelling and discomfort. I've also gone down a rabbit hole reading about ketosis during the dying process and how some researchers believe it may actually help ease pain or discomfort for the body. I'm not a medical professional, just a human trying to help someone I love through one of the hardest and strangest experiences of my life while learning as I go. Sharing in case it helps another caregiver feel a little less lost or alone."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 281 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/

↳ **comment** (82): "For anyone interested, there is a YouTube channel called HOSPICE NURSE JULIE. She explains all phases of dying, from all types of diseases and what to expect in each case. She is excellent at answering questions and taking the fear out of the whole process."

↳ **comment** (69): "Thank you for posting this, and massive, massive hugs to you. My sister recently passed but before that, our family was doing the above, actively providing water and nutrients (protein drinks) but also being anxious about knowing that at some point she wouldn't want to and couldn't either, because it became an aspirating danger. Mouth swabs in water are absolutely a game changer for comfort, they also had mouthwash that helped generate saliva that provided some comfort to her. The last thing I'll say about this phase that I never understood despite reading about it ceaselessly, was the restlessness that comes at end of life stage. I didn't know my sister's discomfort and distress would be her last signs before she passed. At that stage, it's was hard to know the degree to which she was in discomfort because it as a constant dance of increasing drugs for not only pain but also discomfort. We heavily leaned on the amazing nursing staff to help us through this distressing time, and for anyone else seeing a loved one in hospice, just emphasizing that no question is a silly question, they have seen everything under the sun and are experts at noticing all the signs and symptoms."

↳ **comment** (23): "Hospice nurse Julie reels are so helpful. They can be a little jolting; it just depends if you are a person who likes a lot of information or a little. Taking the fear out of the process makes it more tolerable so you can be present."

"20 interventions with real human evidence. I've spent the last several months doing deep research into what can actually be done for my mother (74F, MCI due to AD, CDR 0.5, MMSE 28-30). She also has cerebral amyloid angiopathy (CAA), which means she can't take any of the anti-amyloid antibody drugs (lecanemab, donanemab) and is excluded from most clinical trials because of her MRI findings (microbleeds and superficial siderosis). So I

had to look beyond the headline drugs and trials and find everything else with real evidence behind it. This isn't medical advice. I'm not a doctor. But I've read the trials, talked to specialists at Brigham and Women's, MGH, and Yale, and built a protocol with their input. I'm sharing it because I wish someone had handed me this list when we got the diagnosis. **One important note:** Because my mother has CAA (cerebral amyloid angiopathy) with microbleeds and superficial siderosis, everything in this protocol has been filtered for bleed safety. That means I may have excluded interventions that are perfectly appropriate for someone without CAA. If your loved one doesn't have CAA or cerebrovascular disease, there may be additional options available to them that I haven't included here. Always check with their neurologist. Everything below is something you can do without a clinical trial, most of it without a prescription, and all of it with published evidence in humans (not just mice). Organized roughly by impact. **Disease modification vs symptom treatment:** Most Alzheimer's drugs just treat symptoms. They might improve cognition temporarily but the disease keeps progressing underneath. Disease modification means actually slowing or stopping the underlying pathology: amyloid accumulation, tau spreading, neuroinflammation, brain atrophy. That's what this list focuses on. I've tried to be honest about which interventions have disease-modifying evidence (biomarker changes, atrophy reduction, slowed conversion to dementia) vs which ones just improve symptoms or have only mechanistic rationale. Both matter, but they're not the same thing. # TIER 1: The non-negotiables **1. Fix their hearing** This might be the most important thing on this list. The Lancet Commission ranks hearing loss as the #1 modifiable risk factor for dementia (~8% of attributable risk). The ACHIEVE trial (2023) showed hearing aids slowed cognitive decline by 48% in at-risk older adults over 3 years. Why: when the brain is working overtime to hear, it's stealing processing power from memory and cognition. That tax compounds every day. A 48% reduction in the rate of cognitive decline over 3 years is disease-modifying-level impact. The Lancet Commission also cites evidence that untreated hearing loss is associated with accelerated brain atrophy, particularly in the temporal lobe. What to do: Get an audiogram. If there's any hearing loss, get hearing aids. Costco is the best value - \$1,499-1,699 per pair for the same technology that costs \$4,000-6,000 at private audiologists. Get rechargeable ones with Bluetooth so they can stream music (see below). Don't let them say "my hearing is fine" - high-frequency hearing loss is invisible to the person experiencing it. They're missing consonant sounds and compensating without realizing it. **2. Test and treat sleep apnea** Untreated sleep apnea may be one of the most damaging things that can happen to an Alzheimer's brain. During deep sleep, the glymphatic system clears amyloid and metabolic waste from the brain. Sleep apnea disrupts deep sleep and causes intermittent oxygen deprivation. Years of untreated apnea means years of impaired amyloid clearance. What to do: Get a sleep study. If they had one years ago and were told it resolved, retest. If they have apnea, CPAP compliance is critical - this is not optional. Even mild untreated apnea accelerates amyloid accumulation. The disease-modifying case: longitudinal PET imaging studies show that people with untreated sleep apnea have significantly faster amyloid accumulation over time compared to controls. CPAP treatment in the ADNI cohort was associated with slower cognitive decline and delayed age of MCI onset by approximately 10 years. Intermittent hypoxia also damages cerebral microvasculature, which is directly relevant to anyone with or at risk for CAA. **3. Aerobic exercise - 150-300 minutes per week** Consistently one of the strongest interventions in the literature. Exercise increases BDNF (brain-derived neurotrophic factor), improves blood flow to the brain, and reduces neuroinflammation. It doesn't need to be intense. Steady moderate exercise (walking, stationary bike, swimming) beats occasional hard workouts. The disease-modifying case: the FINGER trial included aerobic exercise as a core component and showed sustained cognitive benefit. Multiple imaging studies show that aerobic exercise slows hippocampal atrophy in MCI patients. Erickson et al. (2011, PNAS) showed that 1 year of aerobic exercise actually increased hippocampal volume by 2%, effectively reversing 1-2 years of age-related loss. The ADEX trial showed 16 weeks of moderate-to-high intensity exercise reduced neuropsychiatric symptoms and showed trends toward slower cognitive decline in AD patients. Exercise also reduces neuroinflammation (measured by reduced inflammatory cytokines in CSF) and improves cerebrovascular function, which directly affects amyloid clearance. This is as close to proven disease modification as any non-drug intervention gets. What to do: 30 minutes of moderate aerobic exercise, 5-7 days a week. A stationary recumbent bike is ideal for people with balance issues. Walking counts. The key is consistency - every day matters more than

any single session. If they have CAA or are on blood thinners: avoid anything with fall risk. A fall causing a head impact in someone with cerebral microbleeds could be catastrophic. Stationary equipment is safer than outdoor walking on uneven surfaces. **4. Strength training - 2x per week** The SMART trial (Mavros 2017, JAMA) is the big one here. High-intensity progressive resistance training (80% of 1-rep max, 2x/week for 6 months) significantly improved cognition in MCI patients, and the gains were still there at 18-month follow-up. The cognitive improvement correlated directly with strength gains. The more they got stronger, the more their cognition improved. The mechanism is likely BDNF release, which requires high enough intensity to trigger it. This means strength training isn't just maintenance. At the right intensity, it's a disease modifier. What to do: Sit-to-stand from a chair (no hands), wall pushups, light dumbbell work (5-10 lbs), heel raises, tandem stance holds for balance. 2 sessions per week. Keep it functional. If your loved one does NOT have CAA or cerebral microbleeds, talk to their doctor about progressive overload toward heavier resistance. That's where the strongest cognitive data is. Important for CAA patients: No heavy lifting, no breath-holding during exertion (Valsalva maneuver), no planks or sustained isometric holds that work muscles (wall sits, plank holds, static squat holds, etc.). Isometric contractions cause progressive blood pressure elevation throughout the hold. Sustained contraction can push systolic BP dangerously high, which is exactly what you need to avoid with cerebral microbleeds. Keep breathing, keep moving, never strain to failure. Cap weights at ~10 lbs without neurologist clearance. Balance holds (like tandem stance) are fine. Those are neurological training, not muscle loading. The unfortunate reality is that the intensity level that produced the strongest cognitive results in SMART is the intensity level that's unsafe with CAA. Lighter work is still valuable for balance, function, and fall prevention, but probably doesn't hit the BDNF threshold that made SMART so impressive. **5. Blood pressure management** This is especially critical if they have any cerebrovascular disease or CAA, but it matters for all AD patients. It's not just average BP that matters. Spikes from stress, exertion, or straining are a risk factor for hemorrhage on their own. The disease-modifying case: SPRINT-MIND (2019, JAMA) showed that intensive systolic BP control (<120 mmHg) significantly reduced the risk of MCI and slowed white matter lesion progression on MRI. Observational data from ADNI shows that midlife hypertension is associated with greater amyloid deposition on PET. BP management doesn't just prevent strokes. It directly affects the rate of AD pathology accumulation. What to do: Buy a home BP monitor. Log readings 2-3x daily for at least a week. Bring the log to your doctor. Target generally is <130 systolic for most AD patients, but ask your neurologist for a specific target. Avoid high-sodium foods. Manage constipation (straining causes BP spikes). If they're on BP medication, make sure it's not dropping them too low - orthostatic hypotension (dizziness on standing) is a major fall risk."

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rmqcpw/20_interventions_with_real_human_evidence/

"How to challenge discharge of your parent from a hospital or skilled nursing facility (USA only). Hi, I have an 85 year old mother, and I thought I'd share it because I didn't know about this until very recently. Under the Medicare rules, covered patients are given rights to challenge discharge decisions from a hospital or skilled nursing facility. You can do this by calling a company called Kepro, which is a QIO, or Quality Improvement Organization. They are independent of Medicare and the insurance companies that run Medicare Advantage plans. After you [call them,](<https://www.keproqio.com/bene/helpline.aspx>) they'll ask for the reasons why you think your parent needs more care. Just state your case in the simplest and most factual way you can. They will then request medical records from the facility that is trying to discharge them, and their consulting physician will review the case and rule on the appeal within 1-2 days. If you win the appeal, the facility will have to continue treatment of your parent until the next notice of non-coverage is received, at which time you can file another appeal if you think your parent still needs care. I wish I had known about this before, as there were other times when the hospitals my mother was at discharged her too quickly which led to a rapid re-admission which was bad for her and costly for her insurance company."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/11fn0tb/how_to_challenge_discharge_of_your_parent_from_a/

↳ **comment** (24): "Ideally it sounds great except I tried to appeal 3 times and was denied 3 times discharge from a skilled nursing facility. And I am a nurse so I found evidence and was able to articulate in medical terms the need. If there is lack of 'progress' or 'medical need', it may not work. Organizations are very good at documenting so that these appeals fail. I tried everything but my mom was categorized as a long term patient and we needed to go the route of Medicaid in order cover the nursing home, and ultimately a Medicaid home program. Meanwhile we had to pay the long term care out of pocket, which at the time was \$8000/month. Medicare does not cover long term care. Once home, you are challenged with finding caregivers because they are paid so poorly. Its frustrating and was incredibly eye opening. For people with high care needs, options are so limited. If something happens to my dad, my mom will need to go back in a nursing home and there are no beds or places within 200 miles that will accept a Medicaid patient. You are put on a waiting list. And although it's seems logical, I cannot afford to lose my job to care for my mom or make my small house handicap accessible. She is bed bound and needs full care. I already drive 100 miles round trip multiple times per week to help. My mom now qualifies for hospice, which offers a little bit more support and bathing. So not ideal but my parents get to be home together which is what they want. Aging in place sounds so good, but in many states Medicaid has poor funding."

↳ **comment** (8): "Skilled nursing facilities are always trying to boot 🍌 people as fast as they can."

↳ **comment** (3): "It should be. Call the case manager at your hospital or SNF where your parent is being treated and ask."

"Great message, Dave. I wish I had known this when I was a caregiver for 6 years - it truly almost did me in!"

youtube · @michellenagel1197 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 24 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=Ugwzktf6sGlgw9Zs4cud4AaABAq>

"No one prepares you for this. Caring for aging parents can be heartbreaking, exhausting, and full of guilt no one talks about. If you've been through it—or you're going through it now—I see you. What's something you wish someone had told you before it started?"

youtube · @SoloSecondHalf · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzXseRkpj_h5dR-m254AaABAq

↳ **@RA-sv8lr** (2): "Don't bury your head in the sand when parents start ageing. Get all the legal and money stuff sorted ahead of time. Look into emergency care options even if only on a temporary basis because, with elderly people, everything is fine until it's not fine and then it's REALLY not fine (my own experience)"

↳ **@TommyLGBTQetc** (0): "Have a plan going in, not just a hope that it works out fine. Sign up the relatives right away to get them involved on the ground floor then they can't have the fake excuse they didn't want to intrude or push their opinions. Also, realize the parent is going to get worse and be at their worst, and you as the caregiver will definitely say it is the hardest thing you have EVER had to do."

↳ **@YeshuaKingMessiah** (0): "I started taking care of dementia and intact old ppl in nsg homes in my early 20s. I've done hospice too. I've midwived a good bit too at homebirths. I'm now 60. I don't think anyone can surprise me. GET EXPERIENCE My kids helped me w/the several family members who lived with us or we with them - and are fine around dysfunctional ppl. It's ok to Do The Hard Things."

"Better ask your parents before you get them a device that detects falls. my mother had always talked about getting one but after she had a stroke she got kind of mean and even sent a thing back that I had requested.. I wish I had known that the Apple had a fall detection period I could have told her that was a Fitbit and then I would

have felt better about leaving her alone. Instead I stayed there all the time and drove myself crazy. my mother said she didn't need anyone to clean house because I had been doing it for 25 years. I really could have used the help and told her so. But by that time she had lost empathy for others."

youtube · @Germatti13489 · *Can Your Senior Parent Continue To Live Alone? 10 Signs To Look For* · 10 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E41ccWr1uEY&lc=Ugxhn71w2DmdtOqiuod4AaABAg>

↳ **@SeniorSafetyAdvice (2):** "So sorry you are having to deal with the aftermath of your Mother's stroke. I worked with many patients who had either a personality change or a personality exaggeration after a stroke. It's hardest on the family of course. I would encourage you to find a caregiver support group to help you through this time. You can't change your Mother but you can change how you deal with her. Thanks for sharing your story."

"I feel this one. Set boundaries!! I wish someone had told me that early on. Mom went into a rehab after knee surgery, but had to stay several months due to needing IV antibiotics (an infection caused the need for surgery). The rehab wasn't far from home, so I made the mistake of going everyday at first. She came to expect it. She would call and ask where I was on the few nights I didn't stop because I was worn out from work."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_often/p21qyh3/

"I wish someone would have told me this much earlier. I wish I had known that in order to survive so much sadness, stress, and even abuse from his family, I had to learn to b selfish. I was a caregiver 2 1/2 years for a wonderful human being. Sometimes, we caregivers have to deal with jealousy and greed from the family of the person we r taking care of. Sometimes, that even causes the premature death of the elderly. Sometimes, some of us caregivers care a lot much more for the person we r helping to take care of than his/her own family does. Sometimes, we caregivers (not blood related) grief a whole lot more than his/her own family does. It is my case."

youtube · @deliafernandez775 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgwQQk7XOOmYsNLsAGV4AaABAg>

"Yeah. My husband and I still have all four parents, but it's a blessing and a challenge because they all have serious health issues. Keeping it all straight while working full time and living our lives is very difficult. This is the dirty secret of middle age no one warns you about!"

youtube · @jennifermartin1981 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgxLlrANewr4mY9k2jd4AaABAg>

"my mom and dad are both in their 70s and i'm already dealing with issues I didn't expect until they were well into their 90s. it's been hell and horrible, especially with 3 kids under 12 and a full time job on top of it. I wish someone had warned me about this earlier"

youtube · @AddieWagenknecht · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgwBaNjnxrZG9rvvgvo14AaABAg>

"I am caring for an elderly mother with mild to moderate dementia, & history of hemorrhagic stroke. When my wife & I arrived my mother was on Hospice. Here's what I wish I had known before getting into all this:"

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/what-do-you-wish-you-knew-about-caregiving-before-your-parent-got-sick-485033.htm>

To live my own life again · 13 documents

10 most engaged of 13 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than

setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play stardew valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's

becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many posts and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"Dad is done taking care of mom. I cant deal with them.. This was inevitably going to happen. My sibling and I have been trying for years to get dad to see reason, that he can't do it alone. We've suggested in home care, traveling nurses, senior living facilities, and more but it all just got ignored. Mom (75) keeps falling. She is partially blind (from a stroke 10 years ago) and deaf (with hearing aids), and she has terrible knees. Dad has to call the ambulance to come pick her up. It is not sustainable. He resents her. He's cruel to her. Abusive verbally. Mom doesn't exactly help. She's naggy and probably stresses him out. Not giving him a pass, ive talked to him about it and he fixes himself for a bit but it always goes back. We finally got them both to agree to look at some senior living facilities. It would be good for them to be able to have a community other than just the 2 of them. Dad continues to dig in his heels. He doesn't want to leave the house. He doesn't want to dump all his money into a senior living facility. I get it, but mom needs assistance. He started cleaning out the house, we were going to help move furniture. Last week he said he would sign the paperwork for the living facility. Mom was so excited. Then

the next thing I know Dad changes his mind, tells mom she can go and he will stay. He told her that he doesn't want to take care of her anymore. Im tired, in my mid 30s just wishing I could live my own life and not deal with them and their codependency. I feel selfish sometimes, but I've tried. Its like talking to a wall. I inevitably told him that if he doesn't want to go, then fine, but mom needs to. I told him that they can stay together, divorce, separate, whatever.... I don't care at this point. Im fed up with both of them. My sibling cut off contact with our mom last week and frankly im getting close to doing the same for both."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 96 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vos1wn/dad_is_done_taking_care_of_mom_i_cant_deal_with/

"I've been taking care of my mom for 18 years. She complains about everything, never has a good day. Doesn't matter that you try to fulfill every request. I'm tired, frustrated, my blood pressure is up. Feel like ending my own life! Just want some peace. I want to be left alone! I always thought I was strong, not now!"

youtube · @noneyabusiness5222 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 58 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=Ugzx9D5EVnMou-71Azl4AaABAg>

↳ @noneyabusiness5222 (12): "Josh Moore All I can tell you is that you have to develop a certain level of detachment. Kind of like a health care professional would have. I spent years trying to help and reason with my Mom. We're past that! I just try to make her comfortable. And for sure, create a space and time for yourself. I know you feel imprisoned and like a servant! Do it for your own sanity! Make the decision that you're going to outlive this current place you're in!"

↳ @noneyabusiness5222 (10): "Josh Moore I finally had to go see my Dr and get some non narcotic antidepressants. You've got to somehow make a way to at least create some time for yourself, daily. If not you will implode. I'll be praying for you! You can do this! It's not easy, there has got to be some boundaries established. For your own wellbeing. This is a huge responsibility for someone your age, it's tough I know! I go for hikes and mountain bike at the local state park. I've built a home work out room. Things I can do close to home. I use my work as a closet away from the stress. Grab those free times to unwind. Remember, you have a life to live too!"

↳ @Okalani5000 (8): "My mom scares me because my brother installed one of those voice-communication systems in this new house... I would be in the kitchen trying to de-stress and she would say my name suddenly and I would jump out of my shoes. She literally takes up 1/2 to 3/4 of my day every single day. Honestly, you just gotta put your foot down and ask someone else to step in and help out."

"I've lost all hope for ever having peace, or a life of my own. My psychiatrist regularly says I have to find those things somehow, but she leaves no space or opportunity for it, and when she senses I'm trying, that's when her onslaughts begin. Thank you for your words, I'm determined now to get that freedom and peace any way I can (legally)."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/oyviymc/

"Modern medicine has solved a lot of issues that let people live longer, but hasn't solved the problems that arise from people with all these serious health problems living longer. The social safety nets haven't kept up, and the population is skewing older as well. I honestly hope, after watching loved ones suffer and decline, that I'm mentally sound enough to be able to choose a more peaceful end to my own life. Maybe I'll feel differently at that point, but I don't want to spend years in pain and doing nothing but going to doctor's appointments, or recovering from surgeries."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p04jI0n/

reddit comment · r/dementia · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/nett67t/

148 / 952

tonight for the first time that I am willing to do the Medical POA if nobody else will. He did not treat me like an idiot when I said that. Amazingly enough. I think that I must have finally made a positive impression. 😊 😊 😊
😊 ✨ 🙏 😊 😊 😊 😊 ✨ 🙏 😊 For those of you who may have been reading my posts for a while now and potentially getting a strange idea about me. I am not usually nearly as defensive as I have been on Reddit just lately, but I have had A LOT to deal with. A lot. Mother had a leg infection, her second in five years but *\this* time it was the *\other* leg, and went to the hospital for about six days or so in mid-to-late June. *\Both* parents have been strangely behaved ever since. More so than usual. He was probably worried about her, she still had the leg infection, and it did turn out that she had a UTI also. I have legitimately *\not known* as to whether I was supposed to expect to become their caregiver, sometime soon, maybe, or not. No one knows as to how long these two people/parents are going to live or how much are their mental faculties going to decay in the meantime. I am *\trying* to plan ahead for their future but I *\really* don't think that they have got more than about three years. I *\already* thought that they only had three years or so, three years or so ago. Other things are more important to me anyway. They are my parents, not my kids. I hope to outlive them. I need my own life. Please. 🙏 🙏 🙏 I also have other relatives that I care about *\more* and I would like to be able to spend more time with them. Thank you. Thank you much for reading through all of this if you have. Sincerely. From a fellow Redditor. Anyone in the same boat or a similar boat, feel free to speak up and give your own experiences if desired. 😊 "

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 0 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w7p8q5/have_talked_to_my_father_tonight_and_he_and_i_are/

Hope for support, for the caregivers · 9 documents

8 most engaged of 9 matching documents, complete text.

"It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients' cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception that the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 137 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/nitak0s/

"Found a place for Mom, with not much money and without Medicaid.. Hopefully this will help someone and give some hope. I can't be my Mom's caregiver being an only child, with young kids and work and my own issues. Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator. Placement coordinator is contacted by the social worker and then try call me. I told him the budget my Mom had (she lives off SS and not much!) And hoped for the best. He found a place that a lady owns and she worked with me and based off the circumstances cut my Mom a deal and is using her SS check for monthly rent at this place. Which does cover 24/7 care and food. Hospice will follow her there for added comfort and care. So it is possible to find a place. It might not be a 5 star 5 grand a month resort, but my Mom hasn't got long to live and this place does have great reviews as well. The placement coordinator has a lot of relationships with places that often take people if that can't afford much. She's being discharged today to this place and hospice is meeting me to go over everything. It's a lot of stress, over all its one hurdle I don't have to worry about. You shouldn't have to feel guilty for not being able to take care of your parent. Not everyone can and they're all valid reasons. People who judge are projecting and often times have the financial means to hire people and not have to work. But not everyone has that luxury. I hope this helps at least one person. It can be done. I am thinking of everyone during these stressful times. It's ok to not be ok. Update: this place is awesome! It's like a house but with a about 15 bedrooms with closets and own bathroom and there's a kitchen and it's very clean and has a rec room. It's probably like an adult foster home? But with a bit more care. The nurses are so nice. I feel beyond happy this is where she'll be. Don't give up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1aqo1wy/found_a_place_for_mom_with_not_much_money_and/

"I've cleaned up all the extra unneeded stuff in my mom's home. At least that's done. But she has a phobia of moving. She told me once she'd rather die than move. The more I accept that her wishes are her's then I feel at peace. Yes it's tough to see her ailing and falling at times but that's what she wants is to live in her own home. I live with her. I'm the only sibling that helps. My other sisters refuse to help because of PTSD issues from our past. So it's all on me. She has balance issues and has fallen four times within a year and a half. I'm thinking once she recovers from this recent fall I'll get her in swim therapy class to help w balance and strength. Otherwise if she keeps falling idk what to do. I have to work. We can't afford to pay someone to be here. My life has been stunted because of my traumas from the past and now having to deal with this issue w my mom. My mom is a hermit. She has no friends and wants it that way. But all I can do is know that I'll be able to handle the future and maybe she will finally realize I need a life too besides just dealing with her. I feel sorry for her that her other adult children abandoned her. We've healed our issues with each other. I just hope I get help when I can't take this any longer."

youtube · @sunray8136 · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyD-NVourBhYocww0d4AaABAg>

"My God, I just found this video and I feel like this man was describing me. My 79 year old father had a traumatic brain injury 6 months ago and what was supposed to just be a few days to help him (I flew in out of state), turned into 6 months! I have no help at all besides weekends when my brother comes. I feel hopeless, helpless, and angry. I feel like my life has been stolen from me and so alone. I flounder, wondering if I'm doing the right thing every day and am depressed. I miss my husband, we've been apart this entire time and just sleeping in my own bed. Watching this video has given me hope that it is okay to be selfish and that I need to find a support group or therapy FAST!"

youtube · @jcgurl3773 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyFRIBpHEiNEh4YUsd4AaABAg>

"Etiquette for visiting elderly family member in rehab facility??. My Question; Beyond the suggested visiting hours, what is the etiquette for family visitation at a rehab facility, for an elderly patient? The situation; My Nana is 97 years young, still mentally sharp, has a great sense of humor and can keep up with any conversation, as long as she can hear it. She has been living on Long Island, in her own home for 71 years. A home which her husband built by hand, as well as dozens of others in the area. She needs constant care at this point, something that her 3 daughters have been rotating to provide her at home. A couple of weeks ago she had a fall at home. One of the sisters was there, but didn't hear her get up in the middle of the night. Nana has a sweet tooth, and tripped and fell onto a hardwood floor. She fractured her left hip and was taken to the ER. They performed a partial hip replacement and the surgery went well. She has an incredibly high tolerance for pain, so it's hard to get an accurate reading. There's no way she was comfortable, but zero complaints. She only cried out when they rolled her to check the staples after surgery. Tough as nails. Gratefully I can now see in her face and movement, the pain has gotten better and she is currently only taking Tylenol. She's the last person to complain about herself, would rather ask you how you're doing. After the surgery she was moved to a rehabilitation facility nearby, "Emerge", in Glen Cove Long Island. I'm not impressed. She had had some "bad nights" where we are told she was screaming all night disturbed and confused. Some of these episodes were while she was being catheterized. Related background; Nana lost her husband over 50 years ago, she never dated or remarried. No man has laid a hand on her since. And now they have men, complete strangers to her, come in the middle of the night to catheterize her. This has been extremely invasive and disturbing for my Nana. An invasive procedure for anyone at any age to go through. We have requested a female nurse to perform the intimate necessities, however the facility only told us they'll do the best they can, which feels like a clear dismissal. I understand that staffing is not an easy thing and there may not be a female nurse that is available when she needs it, however this is my first time dealing with this specific aspect of care facilities and I can't help but feel that they have a moral obligation to do more than try their best, in order to accommodate this simple request. Nana is currently doing PT OT and speech therapy. The speech therapy is not necessarily needed, however as in any of these greedy facilities they want patients they can bill for the maximum Medicare daily limit. I've been extremely unimpressed with the entirety of the staff there, including the director and the primary physician. I must point out there are one or two people working there who actually care, to them; thank you thank you thank you you're AMAZING and your appreciated. 🙏 My wife and I have seen more than a handful of these type of facilities while caring for other elderly family members. Facilities that were located in several different states, with very different track records and varying levels of care. I mention this because we are not naive about the level of care to expect vs what the shiny brochure says. We know how to respectfully interact in these delicate areas. We feel that we understand these facilities in terms of their overall flow, the staff, dealing with roommates, doctors, nurses etc. Most importantly; regardless of our personal opinions, we ALWAYS show the staff the utmost respect, in any and all situations. I truly appreciate the hard job they do and appreciate them all. Typically we end up befriending even the most hard to reach staff, as a result of how we engage with them, our genuine respect for them as individuals and the hard job they perform. We immediately get out of their way when needed, don't overcrowd the room with too many visitors, leave the room to respect patient's privacy, don't interfere with meals, doctor visits, physical therapy and anything else that is part of their job and part of Nana getting better and getting back home. The reason for my question is I have one family member that has semi

relatable work experience, they have worked in rehab facilities as a speech pathologist. This family member was/is extremely condescending to anyone involved, family and staff, because she knows better. It's infuriating. During our last visit, this individual overlapped. Immediately upon her arrival she gave us the impression that we should not be there. Not only just gave us the impression but more directly told us "the staff really don't like visitors, and they don't want to interrupt a visit. So they usually won't enter the room while the patient has visitors." ... "often, if the physical therapist come to the room and see visitors, they will just mark her PT for the day as N/A." For the lack of a better phrase, this is bat shit crazy. The same family member went on to tell us condescendingly "it may sound cruel, but Nana needs to get used to being alone" my internal reaction was "what the fuck are you talking about?! it sounds cruel because it is cruel! Is that what you'd wish for yourself if you were in her shoes?" Nana has plenty of alone time. She's alone for the majority of the day, and for the entirety of the night. When we have been visiting Nana has no problem taking a nap while we're there and if we see her fading will suggest getting some rest. When she wakes up and sees a face looking back who she knows and loves she immediately smiles. We don't always talk sometimes we just sit and hold hands maybe listen to some music softly. I can feel through every subtle hand squeeze her love and appreciation that were there. While I do understand that she's adjusting to this new temporary reality in which she will have to deal with being alone and unconnected from those she loves, with no means to connect to them on her own. From my observations, she is adjusting fairly well. Particularly in terms of overnights and the majority of the time she has to rely on the staff alone. By no means does a short visit from family set this process back. Previously we have attempted to get a schedule of her days meals physical therapy etc. however no one has been able to nail that down. Partially for understandable reasons like they adapt to how the patient is doing that day in situations they'll reschedule morning therapy for later if they're having a difficult morning things like that. That all sounds reasonable to me enough. One of her daughters has since requested she be scheduled for am PT, which I agree is a better time for her. If a physical therapist has an appointment with a patient, should they ever cancel that appointment due to a family member visiting? In my past, and current experience this has never been the case, no one has ever had any hesitation about entering the room. That includes the entirety of the Care team responsible for the patient. If she has PT at a scheduled time and we are there it is my understanding that the therapist should still do their job regardless. Of course we would immediately conclude our visit if this occurred. IMHO; an employee, any employee, of the rehab facility, that is not completing the required job, due to a visitor being present, is 100% at fault and should be fired immediately. This includes any and all staff. Visiting an elderly loved one should not exclude her for the rehabilitation she is paying for and the care she deserves. Nana lights up every time we visit, smiles and laughs and jokes and sharing stories. Based on everything I have read and more importantly been told directly from individuals who work in this healthcare sector; It is extremely important that the patient receives regular family visits. I've been told, this is extremely important both for the well-being of the patient, and shows the staff they have people there supporting her and who want her to get better and get back home, where she'll continue to have support. It also helps the caregivers get to know the patient through the family members who know her best. They become more of a real person and less of a bed number. My Nana can crack jokes with the best of them, and is extremely kind and tolerant. Of course we're not there every time the staff attends to her, but from what I've witnessed, she tends to be quieter and a more subdued version of herself when interacting with them. Understandable. When we have been there, we've helped build a bridge between the staff and my Nana. By small simple things, like helping nana hear something one of the aides said to her, which once she heard it, she had a clever witty reply that made us all, aide included laugh. Semi related we've helped in her conversation with physicians when they made the rounds during their visitation. The doctor conducted his inter"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nm8dtk/etiquette_for_visiting_elderly_family_member_in/

"Is there a country out there doing well, generous and thoughtful on this front that the US could model itself after? My mom who I was a caregiver for just passed two days ago. She was born and raised in northern Italy and they had their grandparents living with them as kids. Her own mom lived with my step grandfather til her death. I've

been wondering about other countries policies and systems/help but never had the energy to research it. Maybe I'll do so now in the coming weeks of weirdness with her so suddenly gone. I would love to see caregivers being cared for and thoughtfully assisted."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobp5n5/

"Being a Christian is the best support possible. Be amongst other believers, go to a bible based church. Let GOD handle your fears, worries and concerns, put it on Him. I would love to find a Christian Caregiver Support Group."

youtube · @CaliforniaCyclist · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgzT09Dpoe327EC3RDx4AaABAq>

↳ @deannafisher1887 (2): "I am a Christian ❤️ I've been a caregiver to a selfish, lying abusive narcissistic man for twelve years. I'm trying to get him in a nursing home and hope I don't lose my home. I'm done!! I really believe a caregiver has to get sick and tired and mostly angry before we actually stand up with courage and do something!!"

↳ @robertalbiston7822 (0): "Double punch. I hope you've found a place to do the heavy lifting."

"It's so hard for me. I try to offer choices so she still feels in control. I also try to check on how she feels often. Sometimes she can't find the words so I give her choices of feeling words. 😞 I also found a support group and looking forward to hearing other peoples thoughts and ideas."

youtube · @jenniferfrazierlpc7171 · *MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP* · 1 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgzUB890M6sXO6-FJ2h4AaABAq>

Tab 3 — Relationship Fears

Resentment towards my own parent · 242 documents

20 most engaged of 242 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"NPR story on caring for aging parents (venting). NPR did a story yesterday morning on caring for aging parents, interviewing a woman who ended up taking care of her mother 24/7 while her mother was bedridden. While it accurately depicted the struggles of caregiving, it ended as most of these stories do by making it redemptive, saying what a beautiful thing it was or what a privilege it was to take care of her mother. My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together. I used to think I might "get my life back," but I've found that you don't. You can't get back all the lost social and career opportunities. You don't get your mental and physical health back. You have to figure out what to do with what's left. I took care of my mother because I felt it was my duty as her son to do so. Most people tell me I objectively did a good job, but I was never temperamentally suited to the role. I forced myself to do it, every day. I put a mask on and was pleasant to her, but I hated having to try to get my mother to do the basic things she needed to do every day. By the end, as her dementia progressed, it felt pointless. I was maintaining a body that had very little mind left in it when I could have been putting my own mind to work in my business, solving problems for clients. I lost my biggest client because I didn't have time to do the work he needed me to do. I resented it. Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy. It was traumatizing. And now I'm still dealing with my mother's estate with a sibling who thinks she deserves half of everything even though she did absolutely nothing to help, ever. She couldn't care less what it cost me. She takes it all for granted. I just hate when people try to sugar-coat what caregiving does to your life and try to frame it in sentimental terms. It wrecked my mental and physical health. It wrecked my business. It wrecked my social and romantic life. It's made me hate my sister for her apathy and greed. I'm 59 and trying to get back into the dating world, and I feel like I'm having to learn how to do it all over again. I'm having to re-learn how to go out and socialize with people. I can only relate my own story, but caregiving didn't leave me with some rosy afterglow. Caregiving wrecked my life. I'm satisfied that I did my duty to my mother, but that's it. It didn't give me some wonderful gift. The news media will never report that story. Edit:

Thanks for all the responses. Part of what set me off yesterday was the fact that it was my mother's birthday, and several people sent me messages about how I must be thinking about my mom today. The thing is, I wasn't. I was working all day trying to get a job done for a new client. And I thought about my mother 24/7 for years. I'm done thinking about my mother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,034 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :), can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take

care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"How do you manage intense resentment towards your aging parent?. I don't resent that my mom is aging. I resent that she never prepared for the aging process, never saved, never had a plan in place, is barely hanging on living by herself and now it is left all to me, her eldest daughter, to manage her care. Sometimes the resentment is so intense it feels like I might explode. I feel spread so thin, and I know it's impacting my infant and my partner. I don't want to do this anymore. I don't want to be my mom's caretaker. I don't want to go to her house and try to find a clean place to sit. I don't want to have to wait til I get home to use the bathroom because her toilet is covered in feces even with housekeepers. I don't want to see my mom deteriorate before my eyes and feel like the situation is insurmountable. I live 2 blocks away but I don't want to help anymore. I'm so weary. I will never put my own daughter in this situation. Thank you to whoever has listened."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 451 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kzbb9p/how_do_you_manage_intense_re_resentment_towards_your/

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement

facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

"I'm struggling with maintaining my patience.. the demands, selfishness, accusing various things. I have realized I was the one never liked & treated as a doormat & ATM, now I'm the one counted on for comfort and safety. I find perhaps that resentment on my part is there & that's not me.. & I cant wrap my head around the situation."

youtube · @dandelion1598 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 409 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyzizoiFnmlYmmkebh4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (125): "You're not alone in feeling this way. So many people are expected to become caregivers to the very people who hurt them, neglected them, or showed them little care — and then everyone acts like it's just your job now. That kind of emotional whiplash is real, and it cuts deep. It makes sense that you're feeling resentment. It doesn't make you a bad person — it makes you a human being with a history. Your past matters. Your boundaries matter. And please — don't feel guilty for protecting your peace, your health, or your finances. You have the right to care for yourself. You are allowed to say 'no,' or 'not like this,' or 'I need help.' You can still be a compassionate person and draw a line to keep from drowning. This isn't about abandoning anyone — it's about not abandoning yourself. And that matters too."

↳ **@HorseLady1109** (34): "@SoloSecondHalf What is that saying? Don't put yourself on fire to keep others warm."

↳ **@HorseLady1109** (34): "@lisaorth3255 Everyone has limits. Caregiving when it is mixed up with "complicated" emotions is a poisonous elixir."

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I

remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71.

These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"The "Go Home" Loop: What my wife's sundowning taught me about my own restless mind. My wife has mid-stage Alzheimer's dementia. Like many of you, I live with the daily rhythm of her asking to "go home"—even when we're sitting in the house we've shared for thirty years. She'll plan the trip, ask about her father picking her up, worry about the time. No redirection works for long. The loop restarts. I want to share something that changed how I sit with her in these moments, and it comes from an unexpected place. I practice Zen meditation. In this discipline, you work to return to "the present moment"—to drop the internal chatter and simply be where you are. But my mind resists. It generates errands to remember, problems to solve, imaginary conversations. It wants to be *anywhere* but here, *anytime* but now. The thinking mind treats the present like a waiting room. One evening, I was sitting with my wife during a difficult sundowning episode. She was agitated, trying to figure out how to get to her childhood home, her father coming to fetch her. I was simultaneously trying to mentally plan tomorrow's doctor appointment, rehearsing what I'd say, solving problems that hadn't happened yet. And I saw it: **We were doing the exact same thing.** Her mind couldn't accept this living room as "home" because it didn't match the felt sense of safety she was seeking. My mind couldn't accept this moment of sitting with her because it didn't match the felt sense of "productive" or "resolved" I was seeking. Both of us were generating solution-thoughts for a problem that only existed in the imagination. Both of us were trying to get "home" to a place that isn't located in time or space. **What this means for us as caregivers:** When your loved one asks to go home for the fifteenth time today, they're not just experiencing a symptom. They're demonstrating—unfiltered, visible, raw—the fundamental restlessness that lives in all of our minds. The inability to be fully present. The conviction that the answer lies just around the corner, in the next moment, after the next problem is solved. I've stopped seeing her repetition as a malfunction to be fixed. Instead, I recognize it as the human condition, made visible. She is, in a strange way, being profoundly honest about something we all disguise with busyness and distraction. This doesn't make the sundowning easier. It doesn't stop the grief. But it has transformed those looping conversations from frustrating obstacles into something else: **moments of shared humanity.** When she asks to go home, I no longer argue with the facts ("Your father died in 1964"). I meet her in the longing. I sit with her in the dislocation. Because I know that longing. I live in it too. We both want to go home. We're both already there, but can't feel it. If you're exhausted today by the repetition, the questions that have no answers, the planning for trips that will never happen—see if you can notice your own mind doing the same thing. Planning dinner while she's asking about her mother. Rehearsing the conversation with the neurologist while she's describing a house from 1962. We're all trying to get somewhere else. The gift she has given me is this: I can no longer pretend my own restlessness is "productive" while hers is "pathological." We're both standing in the doorway of the present moment, holding a compass that points inward. Her compass is broken. Mine works fine—I just forget to look at it. Be gentle with yourselves today. And when they ask to go home, maybe try meeting them there, in that longing, without needing to fix it. You might find you're standing in the same room. \--- **TL;DR:** My wife's endless "going home" loops and my own busy, planning mind are the same phenomenon—both unable to rest in the present. Recognizing this hasn't cured her Alzheimer's, but it's made me a more patient caregiver and revealed something true about being human."

reddit post · r/dementia · 386 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1vpgoey/the_go_home_loop_what_my_wifes_sundowning_taught/

↳ **comment** (43): "This might work for some: When my dad would insist it was time to go home, my brother would eventually agree with him and offer to drive him home. Once in the car, he would drive him around for awhile and then eventually, take him back home! All forgotten and all good."

↳ **comment** (41): "Thank you for sharing. My mother's small burial stone simply says "home at last". It seemed the most fitting thing for her."

↳ **comment** (29): "I tell my grandma " I'm going to take You home tomorrow we are sleeping here tonight I'll be with you " and she always says " oh ok that's good " ... seriously stops the loops every time !!!! Or I'll say yes I'm going to bring ylu in the morning - it works 🙄🙄🙄 "

"A reputable company gave me this link to send to APFM so they would LEAVE ME ALONE! I sent in the form and haven't been contacted since. They were horrible and the calls were relentless. [Do Not Represent Me Form] (<https://civica.formstack.com/forms/dnrm>)"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 264 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/mspeptr/

"Just listened to a lecture that gave me very little useful information. When you are in the trenches, this kind of talk is useless, and possibly damaging. I took care of my father who died of cancer in 2008. My husband helped me immensely. Then we took care of my mother in our home until her death from cancer in 2009 on my father's birthday. By the time my mother had died, my blood pressure was 160/100, I had gained a significant amount of weight and was in very poor health both emotionally and physically. I was forced into a situation where I had to begin taking care of myself or I would drop over of a stroke. My family physician threatened to put me on blood pressure medication if I didn't start eating healthy and exercising regularly to pull my blood pressure down. So I followed doctor's orders and turned my health around. Then we finished that chapter of our lives where our daughter graduated from high school and left for college at a school over 1,000 miles away from our home. So we had to deal with that adjustment. Two years ago we made the decision to have my husband's parents who are both in their mid to late 80's live with us in our home as they were no longer safe living alone in their own home. They do not speak English, do not drive and are completely dependent on my husband and myself. So this talk about getting a 10 year break in between raising our kids and caring for our aging parents does not apply to my life and I would think many people find themselves in the same situation. The most serious problem with this talk is that this presenter never gave any practical advise as to how we as care givers can better take care of ourselves while taking care of everyone else. We already know that caring for our loved ones is a special experience that we should hold close to our hearts. Otherwise, we wouldn't be here. Perhaps as a licensed psychologist myself combined with many years of care giving for multiple elderly loved ones, I should write and present MY OWN TED TALK; one that can actually benefit the care givers. Let's face it, that's why most of us clicked on here in the first place."

youtube · @reneeraw6927 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 203 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugz1pj6jmX3GkNPCy2F4AaABAg>

↳ **@karenrader2160** (15): "I already commented above to someone else on this particular aspect of the issue, but generally I found this talk mostly useless when you are in the middle of the situation."

↳ **@intergxntlcare** (12): "I would love to listen to your TED talk. V powerful story."

↳ **@karencox3235** (12): "I agree. This was a nice pep talk, but no real meat "to relieve stress" as the title suggests. The title needs to be changed."

"I'm enjoying the joy of my mom while bearing (and enjoying?) the suffering of my Dad.. Dad is fifteen years older than my Mom. She's just in her mid sixties. She's always been our family's foundation. She's been the lifeblood. The passion, the joyfulness. She's been the one who brought the holiday spirit, the connection between people in every festive occasion. She's been the one that drove our family and built it up. She's been the homemaker, the children caretaker, the husband caretaker, the health watcher, the meal maker, the every single thing maker. Dad made a paycheck and retreated to his personal hobbies. Mom got shit because she never 'made money'. But the only person who made this all work was her. She made sure we loved our Dad. She made us greet him everyday he came home from work. She made us thankful for his contributions. She made sure we celebrated him every

fathers day, every birthday, every holiday. She excused his behavior by reminding us constantly that he was our Dad. And he was the reason that we have everything we have because of the money he earned. There's obviously more to this than I can share in a post but this, for me, is the essence. Dad always promised Mom that he would fulfill her life wishes to travel after he retired. Well he got Parkinsons and got sick before he retired. And now he needs basically round the clock care. He still is guiltting mom for taking any time for herself. If she's not there every three hours to give him his pills or hand present his home cooked meals, breakfast - lunch - and dinner - then he gets irate as he could never make a meal for himself. She's delayed a much needed double knee replacement surgery because she's had to take care of him. Who knows when he would freeze up too much and might need someone to lift him up and move him so obviously she's the one who has to help him (sarcastic). She's felt so guilty putting him in a nursing home a couple weeks ago. One (like most any of them) won't provide him with such on demand service as his wife once provided. He won't get his pills exactly on time. His meals won't always be to his liking. It may take longer for someone to be summoned to his beck and call when he pushes the button on his neck to clean up after him or calm him down. But I'm so joyful today. I'll tell you why. I splurged on Mom. She already booked her trip to another country to visit her sister and I splurged on a crazy expensive three day stay at a lakefront cabana for her and her sister to stay in. Just watching the videos she's sent me from her stay has made me cry. She's never stayed in such luxury. She's barely left the property she's so thrilled. There are windows everywhere to the lakefront and she can see mountains and all the birds that frequent the area. There's even a private heated pool at her disposal. I'm so happy she finally can relax for a bit. I'm living close to where Dad is homed so I can show up in an emergency. But knowing that she is just living it up without any worries is making me SO SO HAPPY. I don't know how to keep this feeling going. I don't know what to do beyond this gesture. But for right now, I'm thrilled and am so so happy to give her something so good for her heart and soul. Something she's wanted for years and years. I know she wanted to travel with him. But he never wanted to travel, he still doesn't. He just wants to be taken care of. I can't break this to her in a way that won't break her heart so I can only help make some of these things happen. Edit: I dunno if any of y'all have these kind of family members. But I'm watching these videos she's sharing that she's obviously making for her siblings and friends. They are 'tours' of her stay. Showing how grand the bathroom is, what the view looks like from the bedroom, how the kitchen looks like and the outdoor area. They weren't made for me, they were points of pride to share with these others that she's also just sharing with me. There's a video where she's showing how the bathroom works, and what view the shower has. She's walking outdoors to demonstrate what amenities there are in the patio. And how their particular cabana is close to the other two cabanas but that her cabana is the 'penthouse' one. She's never had luxurious things to share like this and she's so happy and I can't help but watch and rewatch these videos she's sharing with me."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 176 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ppgrt2/im_enjoying_the_joy_of_my_mom_while_bearing_and/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go

to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"Grandmother is now refusing AL or moving in with other family. I'm done caregiving and have plans to move. WTF do I do now?. I've taken care of my 96yr old grandma since I was 19/20 and am now 31yrs old. She's gone from being wholly independent aside from needing assistance going to appointments to now being mobile for short periods with a walker but has the majority of her mental faculties if not extremely emotionally needy and depressed. The last week after her release from a SNF from a fall she has either barely gotten out of bed or been trying go outside and dig up her garden when I'm not home and at work (neighbors called to let me know). She's going to seriously hurt herself but doesn't seem to care. I am at the end of my rope and ability to take care of her. The last time she fell I could not physically pick her up. I've already lost a ogreat job because of her constantly calling me to come home because she's "sick" and needs to go the ER (she's not, we waste 6+hrs to be told she's perfectly fine every single time), and am in danger of losing my current one for the same reason. I have to be present at home for any other person that stops by whether it's her friends or family visiting or scheduled appointments because she won't answer the door otherwise and she refuses any attempts for me to get respite because she won't go to daycares or senior events that would allow me to do so. So I'm essentially tethered to her anytime I'm not at work. We're at the point where she is only slowly deteriorating and not getting any better while I am no longer eating or sleeping and my own mental health has gotten bad enough my doctors are concerned for me. Neither of us can sustain this. I've spoken with other family that are planning a visit this week to either take her home with them or find an AL or nursing home ASAP. They are very aware that I cannot handle any more and need relief. My bags are actively being packed and I have a place to move to as soon as she's taken care of. Grandma was okay with this progression and change up until today (though obviously not happy about it) when suddenly it's become "oh we'll hire someone to come in and help" and "I'm staying at home or you get nothing". She's insistent we're both staying right here and that's just not happening. I don't care about anything willed to me when she passes anymore. Maybe it makes me a terrible person but I cannot do this any longer. I don't have POA, her son's does (the one coming this week) and she is otherwise still in charge of her own medical decisions. Obviously we can't force her into a facility but if I'm not stopping my plans to leave, what do we do? Do I just leave and let the chips fall if she won't allow herself to be moved somewhere? I spent today feeling like I was arguing with a toddler trying to get across to her that the train is leaving the station and she's not listening."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1np0dlg/grandmother_is_now_refusing_al_or_moving_in_with/

"Both of my parents are in a life threatening crisis, and they shift the blame on me because I try to help. I live a few states away from my family. My mother (65) had a botched surgery last year and has been in a physical and mental health spiral ever since. She has several comorbidities and one of the top ones is extreme insomnia, like 3 hours of sleep a night on average. This has caused her to lose grasp with reality due to psychosis. She refuses to take any medication, doesn't trust doctors. Doesn't have proper nutrition or hydration. Every time I call she is in absolute hysterics without fail, like full on crying fits and panics. My father is her primary caregiver and he is facing full caregiver collapse. He is now an insomniac too, cries all the time, and I think he is hiding self harm from me. Here's what really bothers me: he reinforces her psychosis. Tells her that she doesn't have to take the medicine if she doesn't want to. Says he doesn't trust her doctors. He is very mentally ill himself and is unfitting as a caregiver. They both have delusions that people are coming to "take them away to the loony bin" or arrest them if they seek help. I have made a million phone calls to physicians, department of aging, other family members. What ultimately happens is that when my parents are confronted with harsh truths (like "hey you need to escalate care") they refuse, downplay, or just explode in anger. Well I had one of those anger explosions over the phone recently. Suddenly everything was my fault because I was "making too many phone calls". I told them that if my mother does not take her medication I will have to call her doctor again. They both lost it on me. Told me this is my fault because I'm not there with them. Told me both "leave us alone" and "you're too far away", so basically any situation I'm at fault. Full disclosure, my father was very physically and emotionally abusive to me growing and this brought me right back to the feeling of being a little scared boy. At this point I have absolved of the situation. I don't think I will hear my mother's voice again by Christmas and I'm afraid what my dad might will do once she passes. But I can't insert myself in this chaos anymore. No more agencies, no more phone calls. Shit sucks man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 132 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ts88af/both_of_my_parents_are_in_a_life_threatening/

"If she's on hospice care, she really needs a DNR. The last thing you want is her to have an episode at the ALF and they call 911. The ambulance crew, without a present DNR is obligated to do everything they can to save her, including CPR. Under hospice with a DNR, at least the one my father is on, the ALF doesn't call 911, they call hospice. Hospice then does what they can to make the patient comfortable."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 114 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8oklp5/

"I'm 67 and my father is 101. It's difficult. I don't have a husband or children so I only care for him. But he needs someone present 24 hours a day. So I don't leave the house, we have everything delivered. I would never put my father in a home! I will care for him until the end. It's hard, but it's ok. When the end comes, I will have a clear conscience."

youtube · @wholovesyababy5574 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 94 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugyw2owC02RLCzDr08J4AaABAg

↳ @ocean1113-x9y (21): "That's great but I can tell you as an RN with decades of experience that if I hypothetically swapped your father for someone else with much more demanding needs you wouldn't cope any more than anyone else. It very often physically and mentally a nightmare that sends people over the edge and shouldn't happen."

↳ @jejosi (14): "Very sad that you feel you have to give care 24/7, can you get someone to look after your father even for 2 hours? so you can go out to a friend, drink a cup of tea, go to the hair dresser. Your concious should be clear or you care for him or not! Make sure you still have a life after he passes. Not that you continue to get shopping delivered and never go out. Keep strong, (hug)."

↳ @annarebecca3384 (13): "My sister has dementia. Her husband IS open to the option of putting her in

assisted living eventually because "If she doesn't know where she is, it doesn't matter where she is".

"Honestly, I can't blame you here. No one knows what it's like until they go through it. My dad is only 63 and "able minded" as he's ever been if you can call it that. But he neglected his health, finances, etc. until he had a fall and a host of health problems. No one to care for him and I live 11 hours away so I had no choice but to bring him to my house to get him back walking hopefully. For now he's wheelchair bound. He won't do ANYTHING for himself. Any meals are the absolute lowest effort - little Debbie's, microwave dinners, sandwiches. He rarely comes out of the room to eat dinner with my family and when he does he doesn't speak. I have to schedule PT and like 8 doctors around my work schedule. My work performance has obviously suffered with all these appointments and I'm usually the rockstar. My wife is tired of it and tired of my time being monopolized with that, scheduling, plus juggling kids' schedules. EVERYONE is upset with me because I'm burning myself out trying to do everything and there's no help. I finally arranged transportation for his appointments but I have to put him on the van. Had to switch one of his PT offices and his doc scolded me. It's made me so resentful and impacted my relationship with him, most likely irreparably."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxb56th/

Only child: no one else to step in · 144 documents

20 most engaged of 144 matching documents, complete text.

"Im an only child and am looking after my parents. Its been 10 years and its nearly destroyed me. Its been horrific. Its not what i expected. I thought id would be bringing a meal over and taking them to appointments but the truth is its a living hell. Now Im unwell myself. Thank u sooooo much for making this and speaking out about THE BRUTAL TRUTH. THANK YOU THANK YOU THANK YOU."

youtube · @lisaa6099 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 626 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzFmmlzwwUilqQ93KF4AaABAq

↳ @ocean1113-x9y (79): "@carloccisano8849 You have no idea what you're talking about. I'm an RN with decades of experience in the community seeing families first hand, also Hospitals and Nursing Homes. If I put you with many of the older people I've looked after for years on end your opinion would very quickly change. It's a literal 24 hr a day nightmare for many depending on the medical and physical condition of the elderly person. Don't condemn when you obviously have a fanciful, simplistic and totally inexperienced 'opinion'."

↳ @blacksorrento4719 (59): "@carloccisano8849 you have absolutely no idea of what you are saying. This is not a 2hr romanticised movie, it is relentless and draining 24/7/365 with no time out."

↳ @lizhood6132 (51): "@carloccisano8849 She MUST think of herself. Dissolving yourself is wrong."

"It's time for the talk. My wife and I are both only children. Between us we've buried three parents. One is left — my father-in-law. Everything below is my experience; yours will differ. But I'd rather say the hard parts out loud than let someone else get blindsided the way we were. Confront reality — and make sure they confront it too. That's the whole thing. Both of us were badly surprised by things we had been told were handled and weren't. My mother-in-law went in for surgery and had a massive stroke on the table. A month in ICU in a coma, then a specialized rehab, then a nursing home — almost a year. She surfaced briefly near the end before a second stroke took her. My father-in-law had a will, an advance directive, and a power of attorney. We assumed she did too. She didn't. She couldn't tolerate what she called death talk, and he was certain he'd go first. I got him in front of an elder care attorney in the middle of the crisis. It was the right call, and it was a year too late. Had she lived longer, the cost would have consumed their savings and everything they meant to leave their grandchildren. After my dad died suddenly, my mom and I sat down with her affairs. The legal side was easy — wills, POAs, no argument. Two things weren't easy. One I'll come back to. The other was that after multiple conversations about her income and expenses, I found out she was hiding more than \$30,000 in debt from me. We can't fix problems we won't look at. The upfront conversations are unpleasant. Assume they will be. They are still cheaper than picking up the pieces on the back end. So don't take anyone's word for it: \- If they say there's a will, ask to see it. Then ask where it's kept. \- Same for the advance directive and the powers of attorney — financial and healthcare are not the same document. \- Ask to see the bank and credit statements. Not a summary. The statements. \- Get in front of an elder care attorney if you can possibly manage it. Medicaid look-back rules and asset protection are not things to learn during an ICU stay. That's table stakes. And even parents who've done every bit of it aren't out of the woods, because the paperwork is the easy conversation. The hard one is about legacy. This is the one I avoided with my mom, because it was the one that nearly broke her. Not the money. The *possessions*. She collected beautiful things her whole life. Most of it is headed for an estate sale. She made herself sick over it — trauma levels, on the edge of an identity crisis. There was china I never once saw used. Not one Christmas in my entire life. If we'd eaten off it every year I might feel differently. But I don't understand why I'm obligated to carry an attachment that was never mine. She had an old Mercedes. When it was time for independent living, we talked about what to do with it. She wanted to know if her granddaughter could use it. I told her the truth: no. Expensive to maintain, no dealer or

independent mechanic anywhere near them, and they hike and camp and have a dog. They needed something that fit their life. Her position was that they should take it anyway — accept the burden, because it was a gift. I'm still working through that one. To me it's like buying piano lessons for someone whose hobby is baking bread. Here's what I think is actually going on. The things aren't the issue. The things are proxies. They're where the feelings get stored, because the feelings themselves never got dealt with. *If you don't keep this thing I owned, you're rejecting me and my memory.* That's why so many of our parents can't sort through it, and why it gets left behind for us. Dealing with the stuff means dealing with everything underneath the stuff. If I could run one conversation over, it's that one. I'd stop negotiating over objects and say: if you love them, let's turn this into something that actually helps them. Sell the car, put it toward the truck they need. Sell the china, fund something they'll remember. They will remember and appreciate that you helped them. **The love transfers.** The dining set doesn't. Have the conversation while it's still a conversation and not an inventory."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 488 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vf1z4k/its_time_for_the_talk/

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had."* This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin* Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family *Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin* My cousin also asked her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant we would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set off what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The

situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rtrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were

bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugsk_YPLbQCKuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ @memyself9372 (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a

sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏 "

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"Dealing with "the stuff". My mom passed away recently. Dad passed away a few years ago. My wife and I just got home after living near Mom for the last seven months — first caring for her, then handling her affairs after she died. I'm an only child, so no brothers or sisters to help (or fight with? I keep getting told how "lucky" I am and it doesn't feel that way at all). The last few weeks were a blur of going through a lifetime of possessions. During the day my wife would wear herself out sorting, boxing, packing. After I was done with work I'd go through what she'd pre-sorted, or tackle another room myself. There wasn't much quality time — just quick meals so we could keep pushing through. It was physically, mentally, and emotionally exhausting. My wife knew someone who does estate sales, so we signed a contract with them. The last time I left the house I grew up in as it was for my entire life was hard. The next time I see it, it'll be completely empty. It was hard walking away knowing we couldn't keep everything Mom considered valuable. Neither of my parents saved for retirement — they relied on Social Security. As we went through the house, we kept finding eBay listings Mom had printed out for some vase or another thing, price circled. That's when I started getting angry. All this "stuff" has subjective value that rises and falls as tastes change and things go in and out of style. What if some of that had gone into basic retirement savings instead? I'm not saying they shouldn't have enjoyed having nice things — we all do. But Mom especially treated her possessions like investments, or at least that's what she told herself. I have no idea what the estate sale will net, but I'm not expecting much. I spent a lot out of my own pocket to care for my mom the last few years. I'm not counting it all up — that's not the point. But a lot of that was because she couldn't bring herself to deal with this stuff herself. She was deeply and profoundly attached to possessions in ways that are really hard for me to comprehend. Now we're the ones dealing with it. It's death by a thousand papercuts, trying to figure out what's trash and what's treasure. Why do people think this is something good to leave behind? When my grandmother died years ago, the only thing I wanted from her house was her teapot. She used it every day, and I have so many memories of drinking tea with her. I'd take that over piles of stuff I'll never use, art that isn't my taste, or dining room furniture (who has formal dining rooms anymore?). There were multiple sets of silverware and fine china we never used in my entire life — I guess we were saving those for when the Kennedys came for dinner. LOL The lesson I've taken from all this: we're deluded into thinking we own things. We're just the current caretakers and curators of stuff. And you may like your stuff but other people may or may not like your stuff. And if they like it, that's ok. And if they don't like it, that's ok too."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 278 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v62aym/dealing_with_the_stuff/

↳ **comment** (91): ""She was deeply and profoundly attached to possessions in ways that are really hard for me to comprehend." You stated this perfectly. That's how I feel about my Mom. It hit me hard some years back when we agreed that we'd skip Christmas shopping that year and spend the money on flying in family so we could all be

together, my idea because I'd just started an intense new job and didn't have time to shop. It was the best Christmas of my life! When I laid down to sleep I felt this total peace because I'd been with everyone I loved the most all day and knew they were all ok. My worry loop, which runs quietly in the background all the time, could shut off for one whole night, everyone was fine. It was bliss. I found out a couple weeks later that my Mom was furious at me because there were no presents. This while she lives in a house stuffed to the top, with priceless antiques and valuables crammed in every nook and cranny, along with actual garbage, and tons of tacky, cheap Dollar Store crap. That's when I realized that she and I do not love the same way. In her mind, how do you know someone loves you if they don't give you something material? In my mind, stuff doesn't matter, spending time together does."

↳ **comment** (67): "In a world where a married women couldn't open a bank account without her husband, my grandmother bought diamond rings in case she had to cut and run. Definitely second-best to real investment but it was the best she could do. (The law changed in the US in 1974 and she died in 1980.)"

↳ **comment** (66): "My mother constantly shows me items in her home that I know for a fact are worth maybe \$100 at best, and she swears to me that they will be worth enough to help my son pay for college. I mean, shes not wrong, \$100 helps pay for college too, but we all know thats not what she means lol She also keeps drawing my attention to a ring she wears. She keeps asking me if she should take it to get valued for insurance purposes but I am 95% sure it is borderline worthless and that she would be completely crushed by the news. Her mother gave it to her with the promise that it "could be sold in an emergency for money" and my mother has treasured it ever since. We have tried to encourage my mother to see its value as a sentimental item, but she keeps asserting its monetary value is far greater. Sigh. There is just something about that generation that they keep hearing the siren song of "value" in their prized possessions, and prioritize the collection of valuable items far above saving or investing their money. Younger generations have their own "stupid" investments, I don't think the problem is gone, they just get sucked into a different kind of investing now (like bitcoin and polymarket betting). Same game different pieces. Our childrens children might not have much to clear out of the family home, but might be met with a complex web of lost orphaned brokerage accounts instead 🤔 "

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "'People ask how they can help and I have no words.' I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an

elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden, and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go, not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone. I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up. I told her I didn't feel well and would come up today. She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"As an only child who did this for parents who lived 400 miles away for three years...I agree 100%!!! I was honored and privileged to do it...but relieved when it was over. (Just being honest)"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

"Only Child—Outnumbered by 2 Aging Parents. I'm struggling, and I just don't know how to handle everything I'm supposed to handle. I'm 47, female, single, and an only child. My parents are 75, in declining health, and live 2 hours away. Financially, no one can move closer. I work full-time in a stressful job with 4 days a week mandated RTO, and my commute is over 2 hours a day. I've got chronic health issues I'm dealing with, plus trying to keep a house going. My parents haven't planned for their future and get mad when I try to bring anything up. They're dismissive. My parents are both frail and need help. They have someone who comes to clean periodically, but there's no one there for day to day stuff. My mom gets mad that I'm not there more often. I'm exhausted and sick, but I'm "selfish" for not taking time off work or coming more on weekends. I love them, but I'm upset they haven't and won't do anything to plan. They're struggling, but so am I. And I can't take care of them and me too. I have to keep my job and insurance. I can't afford to not work or to take unpaid leave. They don't want to hire caregivers, and neither of them wants to go into assisted living. I feel like I'm not enough, no matter where I am. If I'm with them, I'm not much help. Drowning at work. Too exhausted to do much at my own house. I don't know what to do. I have to keep my job, and I feel like a bad daughter."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 193 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ue0xdc/only_childoutnumbered_by_2_aging_parents/

"My mil was toxic. She was tricked into assisted living, because she could no longer manage on her own. She hit my hubby because did not get what she wanted. Once she was in, and it looked like she would not elope, we went no contact. Since hubby was the only child, there was no one else to step in. She could not go to the dr because she'd been banned from the largest medical practice in the area. At a certain point, decide whether to continue helping, not helping or go no contact. Don't mess up your future for a man who is nasty."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 155 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tftnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op293m6/

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play starwars valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on

getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many posts and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Assisted living NOW. I am done. Looking for perspective and tips.. I've spent the last couple of months trying to figure out how to convince my parents to move to assisted living. Woke up this morning realizing that will never work, and they do not get a choice. Because of my relationship with them, especially my dad, I've been afraid of their reactions and his anger, but thanks to lots of therapy I finally am not. Mom is 90, Dad 92. They've lived in this house for 53 years. The house is too expensive to maintain and is falling apart with deferred maintenance. Both have cognitive decline--enough to be irrational and forget things but unfortunately not quite enough to move them and have them forget they ever had a home. My mother has 24/7 care at home right now after a very bad fall a year ago. They do not have the money to continue with this arrangement. My father has frankly always been a pain in the ass and is now much worse. The main thing that is beyond disgusting right now is that they have rats, and he *refuses* to put away dog and bird food in containers, and so the rats are literally living in the back hall. This actually gives me several options – I could call adult protective services, although I hear response is slow. I could possibly get his doctor to intervene. My mom is on hospice (Jimmy Carter hospice, not imminent death hospice) and I'm sure I could get the hospice team to say she needs to move . She will be the more adaptable of the two, even though my heart will break for her. If I move her, though, I'm not sure how to get him out. I have POA for both of them and my mother could probably be declared incompetent by the hospice team, but not my dad, although he has neurology appointments coming up. Sorry this is long... I am just sick of worrying about the house, the money, the rats, the refrigerator full of rotting food (my dad screams at the caregiver if she tries to clean anything up), the HVAC system that died and needs to be replaced, the roof, my dad never showering, him refusing to eat before 9 PM and apparently it's getting later and later... And on and on. Oh and also-- I live 1000 miles away. I am the only child (one sibling w IDD; I am his legal guardian , that's a whole other story). Thank you for any perspective or advice you can give, tricks to get them to move, anything at all! Edit: I am beyond blessed to have a care manager in their city who is my ride or die, so I do have boots on the ground. I'm going there in a couple of weeks and beginning to talk to places now to find availability, get on waiting list etc."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 148 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w0y12z/assisted_living_now_i_am_done_looking_for/

"Throwing away my dying dad's things.... I'm hoping this post is appropriate for this sub. I need a little bit of reassurance. My dad is on hospice in a nursing home and I need to get his apartment that he's lived in for 33 years (and I grew up here) ready to return to the landlord July 1. I have been coming over when I can here and there over the last 2 months but it's been really emotional and draining. Im an only child and it's literally just me and I don't have much a support system. I've been dealing with being my dad's only person for a long time and I'm really exhausted. I really had wanted to donate so many items but as I'm here for one of the final times....im realizing I just don't have it in me. My dad didn't want to pay for the non profit to come sort/move everything and said to just junk it. But I think he's surprised at the amount of things I don't want to or can't take (pots/pans/small appliances) The landlord graciously offered to haul out everything I leave behind for free & im considering just taking what I want (already basically done) and walking away and letting him gut everything. Am I terrible for letting all his stuff go to trash? Sure it can be donated but I simply can't handle the logistics and planning. I just guess I need a little reassurance I'm not being lazy or throwing away my childhood or being avoidant etc. I'm choking up typing this. Just looking for a little support I guess during a really hard time. I really just want to not have this apartment stuff hanging over my head anymore and enjoy the time I have left with my daddy."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 145 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1udw5rp/throwing_away_my_dying_dads_things/

"What to do when you don't want to or can't be the caregiver?. Mom is getting to the point she is going to need more care and I live in fear that I'm going to be forced to take care of her. I know that probably sounds awful but she's very controlling, manipulative, and self centered and after living my life for 4 decades to please her and nearly losing my wife and kiddo because of her I know I can't do it. Mentally or physically. There's already been several hints from her saying she's moving on with us, she's tried claiming dibs on certain rooms in our house talked about how she's going to redecorate our home to her liking and I'm going to be honest my wife said if I move my mom in she is leaving same day. But then there is the problem of I also can't afford to fund an assisted living facility or in home care for her, like the money just isn't there and I couldn't work more to make up for it as I'm already working more than full-time. So what do I do?? Medicare doesn't cover assisted living or in home care, she has spent through her 401k, she's up to her eyeballs in debt from spending non stop, she has no other family but me. I've called council on aging and elder care many times and literally never get a call back from anyone. I'm in Florida."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 109 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t86ufb/what_to_do_when_you_dont_want_to_or_cant_be_the/

"I just refused a lump sum cash gift from my mom.. Today I was visiting my mom (79, in independent assisted living and on the doorstep of needing LTC because she is maxed out on what private nursing can provide with her numerous health and mobility challenges). She told me she is considering giving my younger brother and I (her only children) a lump sum cash payment to "help us out." Here is where this is coming from... Four years ago my brother was on a reckless path and my elderly parents (both were alive at the time, RIP Dad at age 82 in 2025) gave him \$65-70K to "fix" things with no strings attached. It was a gift. They asked me to please respect their decision and to simply "understand because a parent would do anything for their children." My parents did this before asking my brother to tap into his own resources. They felt strongly that he should maintain his assets and the simple lifestyle he had. After three years, my parents finally stopped paying for my brother's expenses, largely because I pleaded this was enabling and was getting out of hand. To add to the stress, it was becoming clear that long term care was in the future for our Dad and it is now very close for our Mom. My brother still wanted many thousands of dollars more and when my parents finally said "no," he exhausted his meager savings (he is middle-aged) and he is now in debt. Our mom is aware that paying off this debt is a slow and painful process for my brother, but he is doing it. She also knows my family and I are completely self-sufficient. Anyway, our mom then

asked me what I would think if she were to give me and my brother each a lump sum payment “because it could really help us out.” My “enabler” alarm went off because of the huge amount of cash my parents already gifted my brother. It is not to come out of his inheritance. I wondered if there would be any end to this if I accepted her money. My dad articulated that his dying wish for me was to make sure my younger brother is never homeless. Sadly, that says a lot about the dynamics. My “enmeshed behaviour” alarm went off next because I have experienced transactional treatment from both our mom and dad; specifically their regular reminders I would one day inherit a nice piece of my mom’s jewelry “for all I do for them.” I was actively involved in both our dad’s and now only mom’s caregiving. I live very nearby Mom’s assisted living facility, but I have a family of my own and am always honest about my capacity. My approach to caregiving is sustainable, finally, after several intense years of my parents’ very real medical emergencies and rapid declines. I have to constantly be on guard because my parents have always treated me as an extension of themselves. I replied that I don’t need any money and am not in financial difficulty. I can afford what I need. I suggested that if she wants to give my brother an early gift of inheritance she needs to get her Will redone so the early gift is recognized and accounted for to be fair. She said she didn’t want to change her Will. It would either be we both get money early or neither of us do. I know my brother is struggling financially (not my monkey, not my circus) but I feel like our mom is trying to manipulate me. I am the family scapegoat because I have boundaries around my time/energy/conversation topics/etc. I am also her only child that has ever been dependable, consistent and taken on caregiving for her and Dad. My brother is the golden child who always has some trouble to be solved but is just such a busy and great guy who is sensitive and sweet. He can go weeks to months without calling her and is still wonderful because things are just so hard for him and he can’t help it. My mom’s money feels dirty and for me, I feel like it would just exacerbate the extremely transactional treatment I receive from her. She says that if I don’t want to accept her “gift” then my brother won’t get one either. And like the scapegoat I am... I am okay with that. Thanks for listening to me vent. \\\\UPDATE\\\\ Hours after I made my original post, my mom told me she wants to meet with her financial advisor in a couple of weeks to review her investments and asked me if I want to come. I might try to leverage the advisor, alert her about my brother and the risk of financial abuse and tell her about mom’s plan to give lump sum payments. I would try to get the advisor to lay out my mom’s financial reality to both of us. We already know it but it might as well be part of the conversation as a reminder. My hope is the advisor would discourage my mom from getting used as a bank. I would hope that if Mom still wants to give my brother and I cash gifts, the advisor would encourage payments dispersed over time (with a limit) to both my brother and I as opposed to lump sums, explain the benefits of a professional trust and help Mom lay out a plan. This absolutely won’t stop the emotional manipulation I receive from my mom and I don’t expect it to or for her to change in any way. It will not stop my mom from feeling the itch to help my brother by giving him more lump sums on top of it. About every 6 months my brother implies need and my mom gets the itch for a while and scratches. Dad did too. More Context: I should add that though my parents stopped giving my brother large lump sums 12-18 months ago, my mom (who hasn’t driven in a couple of years) gave my brother her 10 year old vehicle about 10 months ago. This vehicle was previously kept in underground parking at her residence and I used it to drive her to her appointments because she can’t get into our trucks. She paid for the maintenance/parking/fuel/insurance and I managed the logistics and took it for servicing, washes, fuel ups and cleaned it. My brother lives 350 km away. Now she will only go to an appointment if her residence’s complimentary courtesy car is available. This service only provides door to door drop off and pick up, no escorting. Her mobility is terrible and she uses a walker but her physio says she needs a wheelchair for going out. That is the second physio to say so, btw. She refuses to get one (it would be fully funded thanks to government grant for disabled people!) and so I stopped meeting her and the courtesy car at her appointments. She only leaves for appointments (not shopping/errands/coffee/dining out at all). Sometimes she goes alone, which her doctor and RN in charge of her case say she absolutely shouldn’t do, but she has occasionally hired a health care aide to accompany her through the private nursing company she uses. Telling history that shows how longstanding these patterns of thought are: 25 years ago my mom and aunt worked together to have my Grandma write my uncle out of Grandma’s Will. Uncle was divorced, retired and a live-in part-time carer to supplement the publically funded home care Grandma received. Grandma paid for his divorce,

bought him a car, paid for his holidays and he lived rent free. However, he cooked, did the yard care for her house, drove her to appointments, picked up prescriptions, etc. Sometimes my grandma wasn't happy because he picked up casual work related to his previous profession, when she wanted him to be home and she wanted him to do more. Mom and Auntie thought he was getting a free ride and convinced my grandma to write him out of her Will. I was a newly minted adult at this time, just finished university and I thought this might be a unique scenario or that maybe my uncle wasn't helping enough but this way of thinking has persisted and I have come to doubt the "lore" around caregiving for my grandma. This is the context I have in the background in caregiving for my mother. *Edited to fix a typo and to note I am not in the US."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v3spn7/i_just_refused_a_lump_sum_cash_gift_from_my_mom/

"Found a place for Mom, with not much money and without Medicaid.. Hopefully this will help someone and give some hope. I can't be my Mom's caregiver being an only child, with young kids and work and my own issues. Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator. Placement coordinator is contacted by the social worker and then try call me. I told him the budget my Mom had(she lives of SS and not much!) And hoped for the best. He found a place that a lady owns and she worked with me and based off the circumstances cut my Mom a deal and is using her SS check for monthly rent at this place. Which does cover 24/7 care and food. Hospice will follow her there for added comfort and care. So it is possible to find a place. It might not be a 5 star 5 grand a month resort, but my Mom hasn't got long to live and this place does have great reviews as well. The placement coordinator has a lot of relationships with places that often take people if that can't afford much. She's being discharged today to this place and hospice is meeting me to go over everything. It's a lot of stress, over all Its one hurdle I don't have to worry about. You shouldn't have to feel guilty for not being able to take care of your parent. Not everyone can and they're all valid reasons. People who judge are projecting and often times have the financial means to hire people and not have to work. But not everyone has that luxury. I hope this helps at least one person. It can be done. I am thinking of everyone during these stressful times. It's ok to not be ok. Update: this place is awesome! It's like a house but with a about 15 bedrooms with closets and own bathroom and there's a kitchen and it's very clean and has a rec room. It's probably like an adult foster home? But with a bit more care. The nurses are so nice. I feel beyond happy this is where she'll be. Don't give up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1aqo1wy/found_a_place_for_mom_with_not_much_money_and/

"I've tried to get my parents to prepare and they won't. I'm an only child and they're 82 and living in a dilapidated house. It's going to be awful"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

"AITA for hiring a caregiver for my mom after my family told me it's "my turn to be responsible"? I (34F) am completely exhausted and need an outside perspective. I (34F) am an only child on my mother's side. My mom has Parkinson's and dementia. My dad is in his 80s and was just hospitalized for a bowel obstruction. I also have a 19-month-old daughter. My dad has children from a previous relationship who are about 20 years older than me. They are my siblings, but they are not my mom's children. Most of them live far away, have established careers, and some have health issues of their own, so they are not very involved in day-to-day caregiving. About a year ago, I moved back to Puerto Rico partly because my parents were aging and needed more support. Since then, I've been trying to balance being a mom, running my own business, managing rental properties, and helping my parents. Honestly, the transition has been much harder than I expected. This past week my dad was hospitalized, so I've been helping care for my mom. I've been going back and forth to the hospital, staying with my mom, caring for my toddler, and putting much of my work on hold. A few days ago, my mom fell while I was helping her. She

was okay, but it scared me and made me realize that I cannot safely do everything by myself. I told my family that I was overwhelmed and needed help. I hired a caregiver for just four days, paying out of my own pocket 8am to 12pm (dad pays) 3:00 pm to 8:00pm (I pay), to help my mom for a few hours each day while my dad transitions home from the hospital. My dad was extremely upset. He told me that if I don't take care of my mom myself, then I should give back everything he has given me. He specifically brought up the apartments that were transferred to me when I was 18 years old. I'm now 34 and have spent the last 16 years managing those properties and building a property management business around them. He also told me that I chose to have a child and should have thought about my parents before having one. He said that if I want to focus on my career another business I am building, then he wants the apartments and everything back. When I told my siblings that I was close to collapsing and needed help, they told me that I had a "perfect life" and that it was my turn to be responsible because my dad gave me those apartments and that I have never been fully responsible. What hurts the most is that nobody is offering an alternative solution. Nobody is volunteering to cover shifts, contribute financially, or help coordinate care. They simply believe that because I received property years ago, I should personally be responsible for caring for my mother. I love my parents and want to help them. That's why I moved closer to them, why I've been helping all week, and why I arranged additional care in the first place. But I also have a toddler, a business, my own responsibilities, and limits. Hiring a caregiver for a few hours a day felt like a reasonable solution, but my family sees it as me refusing to take care of my mother. AITA for hiring temporary help because I don't feel capable of doing everything myself?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uc225q/aita_for_hiring_a_caregiver_for_my_mom_after_my/

"Dad [70] needs 24 hour care recovering from surgery. I'm typing this at 2am because I don't know what to do. My dad had major spinal surgery for a degenerative autoimmune disorder. He's incapable of feeding, standing up or taking care of himself in any way. He's going to a rehab facility for about a week, but will need 24 hour nursing care after. He has a small amount of money saved up (less than \$70k) and a decrepit house that, generously, might be worth \$50k for the land it's on. I'm flat broke and crushed under student loans. I have space in my house to put him, sort of, but I can't provide home care. I physically cannot move my father and my bathroom is itty-bitty; it's just not physically possible. I'm not quitting my job in my 30s to take care of him because I literally am not physically capable of doing so. I am a small person and he's 6'7 and over 300 lbs with catastrophic mobility problems. I don't know what to do. Does he have to lose everything before help arrives? He's slated to be able to make a 90% recovery and I'm worried his months of medical care will, at best, send him out the nursing home door to have no home and no money and no options. I'm an only child, we have no family, it's just dad and I. I know a lot of people here struggle similarly and even much worse than my family struggles and I'm just looking for some perspective and maybe guidance. I'm still financially devastated from my mother's death last year and at this junction in my career won't be able to recover. I am so very disheartened that my parents basically had me late in life in order to take care of them and it's effectively ruined me emotionally and financially to the point where I'm not happy or thankful for the gift of life at all. I wasn't built to be a caregiver and I've had to be the 'parent' to my parents since I was a pre-teen. I absolutely love my dad but my empathy is so tapped out from a lifetime of having to drop everything at a moment's notice and buck up and having major medical emergencies multiple times a year, every year since as far back as I can remember."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/zfsk3a/dad_70_needs_24_hour_care_recovering_from_surgery/

↳ **comment** (19): "Start by talking to the social worker about what's going to happen as he transitions to long term care. They might be able to help with some options. Make sure he has all the POA and healthcare directives filled out [link](<https://www.nia.nih.gov/health/advance-care-planning-health-care-directives>) Does he want hospice? What is his prognosis and timeframe?"

↳ **comment** (17): "I am so sorry for the weight you are carrying and the struggles you have been dealt. I have no advice for you but I am sending you peace and clarity."

↳ **comment** (17): "I was shocked that Medicare would only cover 100 days inpatient care for my dad, including hospital, rehab and skilled nursing care. I had to put my mom through the spousal impoverishment program to get my dad qualified for Medicaid, and even then his entire SS check was his monthly copay. If I had known what to expect I would have encouraged them to spend their last 50,000 in savings 5-10 years ago and go on Medicaid rather than trying to stay on that razors edge of having too much to qualify for assistance but not enough to actually afford care."

When it's your spouse, not your parent · 104 documents

20 most engaged of 104 matching documents, complete text.

"This goes the same for spouses. My husband had a stroke at 61 and I was changing diapers for 2 years with no help and using the Lahoya lift many times a day. Feeding, bathing and he was diabetic..After 2 years I became ill and he spent the next 9; months in a nursing home where I visited him every day. I was 57 when he died and I have spent the last 15 years alone and the thought of dating never once entered my head because my caretaking days are over. I am happily alone with my cat."

youtube · @AutumnGold0706 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 956 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgztYmazblhZwkmWogF4AaABAg

↳ @TheDrCatWoman (68): "@AutumnGold0706 - hello. I don't know you, but you've answered a question for me. My grandmother spent the decade of the 1950s taking care of my grandfather who had become disabled after a series of strokes. She was in her 50s. I would describe her as a down to earth but high energy person. She worked full-time during that decade. And raised her child single-handedly. And cared for her evermore disabled husband. Anyway, I didn't know her until after my grandfather had died. After he died, there were a couple of times that she could've had a partner. There were a couple of men who were interested in being in a relationship with her over the years. One was the widow of a friend of hers, and the other was a man she met on a tour. I wondered why she didn't pursue either of these relationships. She preferred being on her own. And it was probably as you describe - she probably just didn't want to take care of someone else as they began to decline. She didn't begin to decline until she was over 80."

↳ @SoloSecondHalf (52): "Thank you for bringing this up. 💖 Very important to have conversations with spouses and anyone you are close enough with to potentially be a caretaker."

↳ @luzfelipe2964 (34): "@TheDrCatWoman you don't need to have your own spouse disabled to never want to be on a relationship, 😊 men are exhausting even if they're not disabled."

"The 'Go Home' Loop: What my wife's sundowning taught me about my own restless mind. My wife has mid-stage Alzheimer's dementia. Like many of you, I live with the daily rhythm of her asking to 'go home'—even when we're sitting in the house we've shared for thirty years. She'll plan the trip, ask about her father picking her up, worry about the time. No redirection works for long. The loop restarts. I want to share something that changed how I sit with her in these moments, and it comes from an unexpected place. I practice Zen meditation. In this discipline, you work to return to 'the present moment'—to drop the internal chatter and simply be where you are. But my mind resists. It generates errands to remember, problems to solve, imaginary conversations. It wants to be *anywhere* but here, *anytime* but now. The thinking mind treats the present like a waiting room. One evening, I was sitting with my wife during a difficult sundowning episode. She was agitated, trying to figure out how to get to her childhood home, her father coming to fetch her. I was simultaneously trying to mentally plan tomorrow's doctor appointment, rehearsing what I'd say, solving problems that hadn't happened yet. And I saw it: **We were doing the exact same thing.** Her mind couldn't accept this living room as 'home' because it didn't match the felt sense of safety she was seeking. My mind couldn't accept this moment of sitting with her because it didn't match the felt sense of 'productive' or 'resolved' I was seeking. Both of us were generating solution-thoughts for a problem that only existed in the imagination. Both of us were trying to get 'home' to a place that isn't located in time or space. **What this means for us as caregivers:** When your loved one asks to go home for the fifteenth time today, they're not just experiencing a symptom. They're demonstrating—unfiltered, visible, raw—the fundamental restlessness that lives in all of our minds. The inability to be fully present. The conviction that the answer lies just around the corner, in the next moment, after the next problem is solved. I've stopped seeing her repetition as a malfunction to be fixed. Instead, I recognize it as the human condition, made visible. She is, in a

strange way, being profoundly honest about something we all disguise with busyness and distraction. This doesn't make the sundowning easier. It doesn't stop the grief. But it has transformed those looping conversations from frustrating obstacles into something else: **moments of shared humanity**. When she asks to go home, I no longer argue with the facts ("Your father died in 1964"). I meet her in the longing. I sit with her in the dislocation. Because I know that longing. I live in it too. We both want to go home. We're both already there, but can't feel it. If you're exhausted today by the repetition, the questions that have no answers, the planning for trips that will never happen—see if you can notice your own mind doing the same thing. Planning dinner while she's asking about her mother. Rehearsing the conversation with the neurologist while she's describing a house from 1962. We're all trying to get somewhere else. The gift she has given me is this: I can no longer pretend my own restlessness is "productive" while hers is "pathological." We're both standing in the doorway of the present moment, holding a compass that points inward. Her compass is broken. Mine works fine—I just forget to look at it. Be gentle with yourselves today. And when they ask to go home, maybe try meeting them there, in that longing, without needing to fix it. You might find you're standing in the same room. \--- **TL;DR:** My wife's endless "going home" loops and my own busy, planning mind are the same phenomenon—both unable to rest in the present. Recognizing this hasn't cured her Alzheimer's, but it's made me a more patient caregiver and revealed something true about being human."

reddit post · r/dementia · 386 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1vpgoey/the_go_home_loop_what_my_wifes_sundowning_taught/

↳ **comment** (43): "This might work for some: When my dad would insist it was time to go home, my brother would eventually agree with him and offer to drive him home. Once in the car, he would drive him around for awhile and then eventually, take him back home! All forgotten and all good."

↳ **comment** (41): "Thank you for sharing. My mother's small burial stone simply says "home at last". It seemed the most fitting thing for her."

↳ **comment** (29): "I tell my grandma " I'm going to take You home tomorrow we are sleeping here tonight I'll be with you " and she always says " oh ok that's good " ... seriously stops the loops every time !!!! Or I'll say yes I'm going to bring ylu in the morning - it works 🤔🤔🤔 "

"Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship. After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this. I simply wasn't proactive enough in getting my dad into an assisted living facility, possibly even memory care. I felt that it wasn't my life, but I was somehow compelled to help him live independently. I can't even imagine the millage I put on my car traveling to his house to help get groceries and pay his bills, clean his place, get him to his doctor's appointments, get him the medication he needs (through the VA nonetheless), basically keep him alive. After the initial hospitalization that set this in motion, I was able to buy him about two years on his own. Now he's in a memory care facility--just a few months after he temporarily moved in with me, he broke his hip and there was only one place that could take him while he healed. He was going to need 24 hr. assistance. My wife had made it clear she was not happy with how much time I was spending on his affairs. And rightfully so, as it was eating away my time with the family, and it always aggravated my depression. I started a new career last year and my dad's problems were preventing me from putting best foot forward. By the time I was able to convince him to start touring assisted living facilities and getting on a waiting list, it was too little too late. My wife moved out, in part, to make room for my Dad to live at our place for a little bit--just a way to ease the transition into assisted living. The most-recent hospitalization was the big wake up call. Now my brother and I are in the process of managing his property, getting a short-term bridge loan to buy us time to fix up my childhood home, only for that house to be sold to pay for future memory care costs. It's not hard to

see how a marriage could crumble under these conditions, especially if you don't get out in front of it when you had the opportunity. Yeah, our marriage had some problems to begin with. But dealing with my Dad was taking away time, energy, and other resources I needed to address my marital issues. I was exhausted all the time. And it was getting in the way of my new job. I was getting pulled in too many directions, and my Dad's situation was by far the most frustrating. If not for that, I feel like I could have repaired our relationship. Or maybe not. But it would have freed up a lot of time to focus on what's really important. Anyways, I just felt like sounding the alarm to anyone worried that their obligations to an aging parent are ruining your relationship... or some other important part of your life. The best advice I can offer are these rules of thumb: (1) set some boundaries to prevent it from bleeding into your family or professional life; (2) be proactive about moving this process along, because it's not getting any easier--if it's damaging your marriage, that's a clear sign that you can no longer provide the help they need; (3) if you haven't yet dealt with estate matters, medical/financial POI, etc., call a lawyer ASAP; and (4) let it be a lesson and plan for this period of your life so that it doesn't all fall on the shoulders of your children or other family members. I know it's easier said than done, but trust me when I say there is a better way. Happy New Year"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"I helped with my Dad, then took care of my Mom for 10 years. Now my husband has dementia and I am totally burned 🔥 out."

youtube · @Jewl90210 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 216 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwpPfQDT3GxonLFw3Z4AaABAg

↳ @RoseMargareth-n1m (11): "I feel for you... Praying for you to have strength for the daily slog. Africa."

↳ @Linda-s5j9d (8): "I am so sorry...I am in basically the same situation. My husband is deteriorating rapidly, but I'm trying to take care of him. Take care of us!"

↳ @roopamp8304 (5): "May the Universe give you the strength ❤️❤️"

"I am done. She's not my problem anymore. I quit.. Update 3: I took several days to think and cool down. I had told my husband he didn't need to confront his mom because she won't change. She'll just pull the "my heart" card to get him to back off. He would never forgive himself if she did end up in the hospital over him chewing her out. He has talked to her before about her attitude to me a few years ago. So this is nothing new. The venom from her this time was new. I realized while thinking, the venom started after her stroke a year and a half ago. Strokes change people. I let my husband know I am not heartless. If she called with a problem I could fix, I would go over and fix it. But if she is wanting me to drive her to the hospital at 2 am because she doesn't want EMTs in her house, i won't do it. She can get one of his brothers up to take her if my husband can't. She knows I don't sleep well and am often up that late. She has almost called me before but then chose not too. She wouldn't feel as badly about calling at 2 am in an emergency since I'm most likely awake. But so far she has talked herself out of it. I told him I am not going over to just check on her and visit anymore. I do not want or need the extra drama in my life. I do not have to put up with being yelled at just because she's made at everyone else or the world in general. I'm sorry there is no great dramatic ending to my post. Yes, I wish my husband had gone over and laid into her verbally. It would have made me feel better. But it wouldn't have accomplished anything but cause issues for him. So I am choosing to not cause him that stress. \----- Update 2: Husband is mad at her because he just talked to her about this exact problem within the last 6 months. Last time I just took it and came home. He is processing about the way he wants to handle it. Tomorrow we've got stuff to do, so he's going to avoid her while he thinks. Honestly, I told him it won't do any good to talk to her. She won't take accountability. She's not going to tell him we had a fight. I asked him to let me know what what is going on when he talks to her. He promised he would. I also told

him she has been nasty to me more than he hears. I just took it because I love him and want to help his stress level. He feels terrible because he knows how his mother can be. I said to him, to me the problem is solved. I'm done. She pushed so hard that she gets what she thinks she wants which is for me to go away. He understands. She played that game with him, too. Like he said he stopped going over for 2 weeks when she did that and things fell apart because the rest don't pay attention or think. I'm still done and I told him that. \---- Update 1: Husband got back to me and apologized for the way she treated me. He said he'll be arguing with her this tomorrow over this. I told him ok, but I won't change my mind about helping her or setting foot in her house. In a week or two she'll be asking him if I'm ok because she hasn't seen me in a while. I told him to tell her the truth. I'm done because of her. She refuses to take responsibility for her actions and words. SO that'll be a fun conversation for him. /s \---- My MIL is fighting any and all help. She resents not being able to do things and won't let people help her. I have been going over once or twice a week just to ask if she needs anything. If she says no I back off. Her BS is affecting my mental health and she's not my mother. I was doing it to help my husband with his stress because his brothers don't help much. My therapist told me to back off and I have. I can't talk about her to my therapist anymore because she is a mandatory reporter and MIL is on the line for my therapist to have to report her. All week my SIL and BIL have been at my MILs house. The needed to get a window replaced and the guy wouldn't do it unless it was in a garage. They also gave a 6 hour window. So SIL and her daughter stayed from 12-6 twice. My SIL is a very in charge type of person. So she did what she wanted at MILs house despite my MIL asking her not to. MIL won't let her anger out on anyone but me. So she wasn't forceful with the SIL. She just sat back and let my SIL push her around. She had some distant cousins come in mid-week and they stayed all day too. Then her neighbor was moving some of his stuff out of his house at 9 pm. That was keeping her dogs up so she couldn't sleep. I went over today to see if MIL had a grocery list for my husband on his way home from work. She unloaded on me today. I got defensive and reminded her I ask before doing anything. She said I don't and everyone wants to control her life. She also accused me of getting defensive. I told her I was because I let her do her thing. She kept interrupting me and raised her voice at me. I finally told her that my therapist told me to back off. She told me good and I need to listen to her because she doesn't need anyone's help. I offered to tell my husband to let her get her own groceries. She said that's different because we know she can't drive. I got mad. And left. She told me that is my choice. I told her I am mad and she is mad and we don't need to be talking with when we're mad. I texted my husband at work and let him know what was going on. I was venting and called his mom some choice names. He told me I don't have to convince him because he knows how she is and he'll handle it tomorrow. He prefers to get told at work in text so he's not getting unloaded on when he gets home. I'm done. I won't set foot in her house ever again. If she calls I'll tell her to call 911 or one of her sons. If my husband is home, he's getting the phone. I'm my MILs only friend. She has now tore the bridge down and set it on fire."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 189 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_problem_anymore_i_quit/

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to

work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"Hoarder MIL: The ongoing saga. Just to recap: \- MIL is in her 80s \- She had one child, a son, and I married him \- My husband died of cancer about 6 years ago \- MIL drove my husband nuts with her crappy attitude and inability to deal with the consequences of her own actions \- While hubs was going through cancer treatments, she'd come up to offer "moral support". While here, she'd expect him to carry her luggage and order for her and all kinds of whatever and expected me to cater to her because "she's the guest". \- She hated me from the beginning and worked to break us up while we were dating and when we were married. This went on for about 10 years. \- She's a hoarder. Her home was condemned by code enforcement in April 2025 when I called local LE for a wellness check on her. \- Had to pay \$17k to get the house cleared and approved by code enforcement for her to move back in. \- She's fallen several times since, totalled her car because "hoard in car" and a bitcoin scam. \- She has been diagnosed with cyclothymia. This is a mild version of bipolar, but honestly, there's likely more going on. \- She fell again beginning of Dec 2025. She had a nursing service check on her weekly and the nurse called for a

wellness check. I went to do some errands for her (she's 3 hours away) and learned the hoarding had resumed with gusto and the toilets were all backed up. At the time, her echocardiogram was normal. \- I got her moved into a personal care home (PCH, not a nursing home) on NYE 2025. She hated it at first, but has been singing praises for the last several months. \- Got her house sold 12 June and her outstanding (massive) credit card bills cleared. One had entered arbitration. She had this idea that, because she was old, she didn't have to pay cc bills anymore. \- The week after the house sold _something happened_. Not sure what. Could have been a silent heart attack, could have been caused by grief over the house selling. Regardless, between Dec 2025 and 2-3 weeks ago, her heart function dropped to 10-15% and she developed congestive heart failure. \- While in the hospital she decided she was refusing medical care. Doc totally confused by this, but ok. She also got a psyche eval while she was there because she kept saying "I just want to die". Also diagnosed with UTI (and her usual delirium). \- Back at the PCH and under hospice care. She won't talk to me on the phone, whines in texts constantly. She's on lasix and O2 for the congestive heart failure. THE NEWS: Sunday (yesterday) AM I got a call from the manager of the PCH. MIL keeps her roommate up all night making her get up and fix her pillows and tuck her in. Roommate is miserable (also in her 80s and in bad health). MIL is not going to the bathroom anymore; she just lies in bed and fills her diapers and expects the PCH staff to clean her up. She won't keep her legs elevated, she won't keep her O2 on. She refuses to eat. Complains about her stomach hurting all the time (not eating, hmmm?). If she won't cooperate, they'll evict her. She has no where else to go. I had guessed at some of what they told me. She'd complained that she was breaking "the new rules" last week, that they wanted to put her in a hospital bed and that was "insane". She whinged on and on about needing a specific blanket from amazon (I finally just caved and got it for her even tho she has blankets). I text her. I cannot call her. She won't answer the phone, and if she calls me, she complains she can't hear me (then says she can't hear anymore, which the PCH says is bogus). I tell her she has decisions to make and it's on her to make them. I tell her that she's being moved to the hospice room that's closer to the toilets and that she's getting a hospital bed so that her legs stay elevated. (The PCH is "losing" the remote, which I totally agree with.) She freaks the fuck out, tells me all this is old news, that she's been in the hospital for tests (they call and tell me when she goes to the hospital and she hasn't been). Bitches that she likes it where she is, she doesn't want to move, yadda yadda. Then she claims the toilet paper holders have cameras on them. A few hours later she says she was moved, it's cold, she has blankets, and I've heard nothing since. So that's where I am today. Concurrently, I'm gonna have to put my 16 year old dog down this week (chronic kidney disease \[CKD\]), my 15 year old dog won't be far behind (heart murmur, congestive heart failure, beginning CKD). A side effect of the CKD is chronic diarrhoea, so I've been cleaning that up for over a month multiple times a day and night; a side effect of the lasix that younger dog is on is increased urination (more things to clean up). I have pee pads all over the place, but there's only so much of that you can do. And my therapist is on vacation for a few weeks. It will be a month before I get to talk to her again."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 127 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v1l503/hoarder_mil_the_ongoing_saga/

"My mom's back in the hospital. Dad needs 24/7 care at home. . I'm so mad. I came to visit my parents for the night. It's a 4 hour drive. My mom has a gross scaly skin rash that's oozing on her leg. Her legs are like elephant legs. She hates going to the doctor. She cares for my dad with Parkinson's around the clock. But will not take care of her own health. She was in the hospital 2 weeks ago but checked herself out against medical advice and then just let her skin thing fester and made no effort to see her own doctor. So it was a waste of 2 nights she spent in the hospital last time and we're back to square one. So I convinced her to go back tonight. Of course they are keeping her overnight again. My brother who lives with them is at work overnight. So I'm here with my 2 kids helping my dad pee in a bottle. Something I never wanted to do. I love him but for the love of god, hire a nurse to handle this stuff! I can't stay tomorrow. I have to get my kids back home for school. I have a dog and 2 cats at home and a house and a full time job AND my husband died last year. I'm mad because my mom has known for years how bad my dad is and she's refused to hire help. She has the money but has this phobia about letting anyone else help her. So now she's stuck us in a bad spot where I'm here alone caring for my dad and I don't know what to do exactly and I have no one to call to help me. Im going to call the VA tomorrow morning and see about either getting

someone in here to help or bringing him there for a few days while my mom gets her skin thing and swollen legs figured out. 2 weeks ago they wanted to send her home with a visiting nurse checking in and she refused. Like WHY? WHY must you be so difficult? WHY can't you see reason? I'm going to get 0 sleep tonight and I have to drive 4 hours home tomorrow."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cpxyo2/my_moms_back_in_the_hospital_dad_needs_247_care/

↳ **comment** (42): "I'm really sorry. That all sounds really rough. My dad has Parkinson's too, so I know the level of care that is required. I think that it's time to say, "mom, there are no options. You are having the visiting nurse come because I absolutely cannot come back until (much later date). By not allowing them to help, you are causing me a great deal of stress and I cannot do this anymore." Hopefully that will be enough, but I also have a stubborn mom, so I understand that it might not be. But your first priority is taking care of your kids and yourself; it simply has to be."

↳ **comment** (19): "If it's bad enough for her to be kept overnight, it's pretty bad. I'm sorry you are going through this. Can you take your dad for a Dr evaluation so you can talk to Medicare about any benefits you can access for them?"

↳ **comment** (16): "A lot of assisted living places offer short stays for when the primary caregiver needs a break or is just unavailable. Also, they all asked about VA benefits when I was looking for my mom while dad was in hospice."

"I get this from my drunk ass sister regarding my other sister that is now in long term care. My mother took care of her until she passed and inherited her because nobody else stood up. My sister had a traumatic brain injury as a child and has required supervision. She had no safety awareness or judgement. When my mother died, I moved her in with me. She became more and more unsafe, walking around town, falling, getting into cars with people she doesn't know. When the opportunity arose to put her into care, I took it. Because I work full time and my husband has late stage Alzheimer's. Now my drunk sister sends me nasty grams about why did I put the other sister in a home. They can all fuck right off unless they are going to volunteer to be the full time care giver. I cared for my mother, my sister and now my husband. I'm done caring what other people think"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/o4ufodx/

"Am I A Terrible Person?. My 91 year old mother fell and broke her hip last week. She had a partial hip replacement done and is in rehab. There's so much resentment built up on my part and I'm not sure it's all justified. Mom lives 4 hours away from me in another state. My sister (the favored child) used to live 10 minutes away from her, so it was always assumed she'd have someone near to her to help her. But she sold her house and up and moved across the country suddenly. So mom was left alone. I've lived in another state for many years. I was a caregiver for many years of my life. My late daughter had physical disabilities and my husband died of heart failure. I'm now the one who will take care of my mom. I'm tired. I have asked mom to move down to where I'm at and she has refused. Every excuse in the book. I've told her I'd be with her every step of the way if she is scared. I've told her she could move in with me or we could find a senior apt nearby. We can't afford assisted living. Refused. I've told her that if she didn't want to move to my state we could find her a place in the town she is in because she really shouldn't be in the house I grew up in. Dangerous steps and short. She had refused. Repeatedly. I've told her it would be easier for me and in the long run, for her. She doesn't care. Now I'm stuck driving up to her and staying in her house every few weeks in order to see how she progresses in rehab. I have to leave my own home and responsibilities in order for her to remain satisfied. I also am stuck trying to figure out where she will go after rehab. She think she is just going to waltz back into her home like nothing ever happened, even though they've to us it might be a whole year before she's even able to navigate around. Her home has 2 flights of stairs,

laundry in the concrete floored basement, and a slick porcelain bathtub. Despite my objections she continued to drive up until the accident. She became quite hateful when I mentioned not driving anymore. She had had several mishaps with her car and had become lost several times. I'm the only one who seems to think it's dangerous for her to drive. She guards her keys now and talks about her car incessantly. I refuse to let her drive if she recuperates. I refuse. I'm ashamed to admit the fact that I resent her stubborn behavior. My whole life I was basically ignored because she was so enamored with my dysfunctional sister. She practically raised my sister's children and has financially bailed my sister out of messes many times. I've never asked for help from my mom, and she didn't even attend my husband's funeral . But here I am . The daughter who it all falls on. I feel guilty admitting that I resent it. I resent the fact that this is so hard on me logistically because she only cared about herself. She had to stay near her male friend , so now I'm required to leave my home unattended for weeks in order to help her. My son has to drive from another town to stay with my dog, get my mail, and water my garden. She didn't plan financially in order to go to assisted living or accommodating housing. Instead she spent all her money on shopping for clothes and jewelry. Vanity is her thing. I'm struggling greatly with terrible resentment. She's my mom and I'll help her, of course. I've always tried my best to be respectful. But she has been so selfish and hurtful over the years. It's so hard for me to get over this. Am I a terrible person?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/

↳ **comment** (58): "You are not a terrible person. I think anyone in your situation would feel resentful, angry and betrayed. Your sister left when your mother had nothing left to give her and might actually need something back. That is not your problem. I don't think you should have to swoop in and pick up the pieces. Your Mom made choices and is still making them. Let the rehab facility get social work involved and they can decide with your Mom what her options are. If you stay you will be used by the system and an ungrateful mother. You have responsibilities to your own life and to your son who is now being impacted."

↳ **comment** (50): "Have her primary care physician pull her license. That makes the doctor the bad person not you. Does anyone have health care power of attorney for your mother? Has she had a recent cognitive test? Doesn't sound as though she is mentally capable of making her own decisions so you may just have to be the "bad guy" and place her where she safely needs to be. I'm sorry. It's a tough situation."

↳ **comment** (46): "You are not a terrible person. Make sure that everyone knows that she has NO ONE upon discharge that lives nearby, and she will be on her own. Do not cooperate. You can be as stubborn as she is. You do not have to take what she dishes out. She moves from rehab to where you can reach her without leaving your home overnight. Or she's completely on her own, because you are not coming. That's her choice."

"My husband went from a athletic fit male to a wheelchair in a matter of a year after a multiple sclerosis diagnosis. We are also raising a child at the same time and I'm working a full time job. Tired is an understatement, let's pray for each other. God is with us"

youtube · @simplysusan87 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyP0-6TMKiB6GrL3ph4AaABAg>

↳ **@socialdave8630** (6): "My wife has had MS for 40 years and now I've hit the wall hard after 3 years of hard ore caregiving. Best of luck to you, I'm still looking for answers. Maybe this is it."

↳ **@BetterByDai** (6): "So many people underestimate the heavy load those who are in your position have to bear. Add children to that, and you can find yourself needing 10 arms to juggle everything. Because it's not just physical exhaustion, its mental and both can spiral into many other issues."

↳ **@hestadickeos6043** (5): "You really have it tough! 🥹 I care for my husband who has Parkinsons, and it's stressful, emotionally draining, and the responsibility after having raised 4 children and two grandchildren is

overwhelming. I'm 70, and suffer from chronic back and hip pain, so physically it's difficult also. You have it harder than me. My heart goes out to you 💜 "

"I put it in writing for my son who has power of attorney that if I can't safely stay at home that he needs to put me in a seniors' home. No guilt. I said don't pay attention if I put up a fuss. I am telling you now while I am cognitively well that this is my choice. I would never want any of my children to take care of me in my home or theirs. My husband has mild dementia and if I need to, I will put him in a seniors home in the future. No guilt. I recognize that I am in a good financial situation so I have options. Not everyone does."

youtube · @pintsizestories196 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyxIJP5E5_8x6JY5i94AaABAq

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (11): "You are being lovingly, thoughtful and realistic ❤️👍👍"

↳ **@justthere3794** (3): "That's a good option. But having them at home is better with private sitters and you manage the money not the nursing home. My sister did that and she was stoic even though dad was a pain and bonkers with dementia. She said that no nursing home is going to take his money so she got private aides and hospice later on and that was a great relief. We are both healthcare professionals so we handled it like champs and did not let emotions get the best of us. Luckily we both are Aquarius and tough army brats. But some people may not be like we were. Some people have histrionic personalities. Good luck."

↳ **@justthere3794** (3): "@ the difference with my sister's situation is that she got "compensated" very well. She got my father's house cash plus all the money and insurance. It is delayed "compensation" and better than a nursing home getting it. Daddy didn't raise "no fool." Her life was not "ruined" but secure. Now I do agree with your 2nd point. I am not counting on my son to do the above nor do I want him to. Best to be prepared if you plan on being solo and have alternative people. My father was just lucky that my sister was single and did all that for him. She also needed the money and looked at it as an investment. She is a social worker so she knows the ins and outs of nursing homes and so do I."

"'enjoy every moment' really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 45 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrz9lf8/

"This speaks to me so much. My husband has Parkinson's and just had spine surgery due to osteomyelitis in his spine. Our 15 year old has autism. It's pretty hard."

youtube · @lisaburmood5540 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 45 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=Ugxsk2q2Tzvm2G1hH654AaABAq>

↳ **@lisacorsi5649** (10): "I am caring for my 89 year mom with dementia and my 16 year old son with autism. I had to make the conscious effort to begin to focus more on my son since he has his whole life in front of him. My dad died in June and the pressure on me has been unbearable and I need to just step back."

↳ **@TheJimbo1791** (0): "<3 <3 <3 power to you, blessings - a lot"

"Thanks for sharing. It's been 4 years since my wife's diagnosis and 90% of the time, she's pretty pleasant and sweet like your wife was. Then there's the other 10% which can be difficult. I'm hoping my wife doesn't last a long time b/c this is no way for anyone to live. Bless you and best of luck."

reddit comment · r/Alzheimers · 38 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1toi567/done/oo1bv40/>

"Its wild that I've heard this a few times now, where a wife puts off treatments or surgeries because the husband is so helpless. Hard for me to wrap my head around. I'd be homeless and harvest organs, so my wife had the best care money can buy."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/live_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxeb9m5/

"I am my husband's carer and I am not going to be a burden on anyone. I'm opting out..."

youtube · @gracecatz3996 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 35 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyvE7dcGnZAwSunPiB4AaABAq>

↳ **@womandela72** (4): "Me too! Caring for my Dad with dementia for past 7 years. About to move him into a nursing home because he's totally gone and too heavy for me. Plus Im tired! But if I ever wind up like him Im heading to Oregon if you know what I mean!"

"When I was traveling through my nightmare of my husband's dementia, a member of a Facebook support group sent me the following: This is a disease that unfortunately has no silver lining. There are negatives to placing them in a facility with strangers. You'll feel guilty that you are not doing enough for them, or getting too angry/impatient. Then you will feel guilty because you are doing too much for them at the expense of yourself. It will come down to which negative choices, which in the end, leave you as whole and sane as possible. Because, that is who is left when this disease runs its course, you. This disease can easily eat the caretaker alive along with the loved one. Unfortunately, only one is coming out of this journey. Make decisions that will preserve the most of the 'you' that went into this. I copied this and put it up on my mirror in the bathroom, so I would read it each time I was in there. It was the only thing that kept me sane-ish. A message against the people who were loudest with their criticism and suggestions but were the quietest with their help for what I actually needed."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4uzoc0/

"My husband has myotonic dystrophy, and it's gotten worse in the last yr and half, then i lost my job at the beginning of 2024 (57 yrs old) then we had a leak in the kitchen and they came in and ripped up my cabinets (wking w/insurance)....although our house is paid off, we owe 45 thousand due problems with our hm in the last yr....My husband and i had a huge blow fight because i do EVERYTHING...I'm no longer a woman or even his wife, just his nurse maid."

youtube · @elmobolan4274 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 26 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgzoaxpzXjjHm7CCIWt4AaABAq>

↳ **@marlahockfeld2984** (7): "Similiar. I hate no longer having a husband/wife physically intimate relationship and knowing it won't be until he dies that I may even have a chance to rediscover that. Seeing him sitting there just watching TV while I take Care of everything physical around the house makes me resentful. I'm mad that there's no one to care for me. I can't go out to the grocery store without having to take into

consideration his needs and making sure I am back in to for _____. Will I ever have a life again? It's exhausting. How are you coping now?"

↳ **@elmobolan4274** (5): "@marlahockfeld2984 I have my good days and bad days....it's hard but I try not to be hateful, it's not his fault but it's absolutely hard....I wish I had a strong man around the house...but that's life huh..."

↳ **@lmhlmh9584** (3): "And family and friends see me that way as well. It cancels out that I have any importance to another living human being."

"update: May have reached the end at home care, as many before (REALLY LONG). Began exploring nearby memory care facilities. This is what I found and experienced. Preface- this is my second go around, and I look at this industry with an extremely jaundiced eye. My father in law, (WW2 vet, 4 Pacific battle stars, Commander Santa Cruz Natl. Guard) occupied assisted living quarters where his wife (in the Santa Cruz surfing museum) was kept in memory care. He had a medical incident, ended up in the hospital. I went to see the manager of this fine facility, who after a brief talk, pretty much told they would not let him come back to the facility, so sorry. but keep sending the checks for his wife. Just what you need at this time of crisis. He passed very soon after, and his wife in memory care did also, out of the blue, 3 days later. The family agreed he went to heaven, then came back and got her. man. The cost. An eye watering \$8-10000 a month for any single facility. Based on a 1,2, and three scale of care, with cost rising at each level. Group settings are about \$4000 a month, but finding an open slot appears problematic. That's just to start, evidently fee increases can be routine. I can barely afford the base, any increase would eventually bankrupt me. I would have to sell our home, but even then, it would be consumed rather quickly. I still have to live somewhere, and that will drain the bank as well. I'd have to move out, deal with all our possessions, which now are becoming albatrosses around my neck. I'm 70, still very active, but feeling it. Once my wife is in these places, moving because of cost to a lower priced facility would be required, not a pleasant experience, one would imagine. You are going to tour these facilities. Take note of the residents, the attendants, the general demeanor. Cleanliness, maintenance, dining areas, quality of the food, activities provide. One advisor told me to trust my gut, I do, but that's it? My wife's accommodations for the rest of her life, on a gut check? What is the management like? If you are a first timer, this will be a daunting task. Management. I have noticed talk of acquisition of these facilities by hedge funds, which gives me pause. Hedge fund operations can be seen in mobile home parks. The MO. Buy the park, raise rents, drop services until all residents eventually leave, bulldoze the structures, sell the land, all at a tidy profit. Then, move on to next one. They target people in retirement communities as well. even veterinary clinics. Find a group of desperate people needing services, with few options, and pounce. Nice. I started with a place for mom. went online, filled out the form. have to give email and number. talked to a front "filter" guy, that's when I realized the advertised rates published were a come on, and the real cost for care was revealed. Transferred to an advisor, talked about what my situation was, what was locally available, maybe set up some walk thrus. What I didn't expect was to be deluged by a tsunami of calls and emails in just a few days. There is money to be made in Alzheimer's care. These people know I am primary care giver with very little free time. Also unless I have my phone in my possession at all times, it has been known to disappear. I have to locate it with my iPad. If you were looking for the current state of memory care, this has been my experience . the next is what I decided. Ran a bunch of spreadsheets, looking at time lines, costs, expected future increases in care expenses. Ran tax scenarios, at some point found even with the possibility of total cost as a deduction, you may end up with over zero tax liability. all for naught, because your total income would be eaten up. it's a no go. What to do.... hmmm. What was my original plan, that I made with my extremely helpful stepdaughter? it was to keep the one true love of my life at home, under our care, which even on bad days, would be better than what she would receive at a facility. I had a nervous breakdown dealing with all this shit. Don't call for help, no one will hear you, (except you dear readers) and the realization that the cavalry is not coming. I detailed earlier about being helped by my physician. this week, my meds really kicked in. With a home aide, I have free time. I went to lunch

with an old work time buddy, took the cover off the convertible, and drove it to lunch. Found myself waving to kids walking home from school, haven't felt this good in a long time. and my "danders" up. The main problem is nighttime wandering. The house is locked and secure, she cant elope. But I need to sleep. I have always slept for about 6 hours, that works for me. Probably because I served on a warship for 4 1/2 years straight, watches etc, that programmed my sleep patterns for life. 9 PM to 3 AM. is the doughnut hole. Since my mood has improved, my wife picks up on it, and wandering has been much less, but it's Alz, and change can happen anytime. The solution , Yolo smart door sensor kit(Amazon , of course what a blessing for caregivers) It is a wireless device, that reports to a hub. It comes with hub and 4 door sensors, \~\$60, sufficient to cover all critical doors , reviews show easy installation, and it can be configured so that during the day , the front door will contact my Alexa speakers and verbally indicate the door has been opened. And you can tell it , do that during this time span. Locked at night not needed, The 2 doors to the master suite can be synced to my iPad, and alarm will audibly notify me. I no longer sleep with my wife, but I do sleep with my iPad. Even with the loss of sleep, with every other day home aide coverage, I can leave the house, decompress and relax. It really makes all the difference. Current cost is \$600 a week three days, 5 hours each. She can get her to shower and change clothes, coax her to eat, take her for a walk with the dog, the dog loves her, and give me pointers. Even if I go to 365 day coverage, it's \$73000 total. That I can do. Eventually, my wife will progress. All those spread sheets and tax scenarios are now my glide path. Activated our final annuity, it has a life time rider for both of us, if one passes 100% goes to the survivor. It also pays even if the funds are exhausted. My wife has Calstrs, and Social security, as do I . I also have disability, all these are indexed for inflation. If you are not good at financial things, talk to a trained professiona, it will be worth the money. They don't come cheap. I am going into extreme saving mode, our expenses are pretty fixed, and I just buy food, really. Even 2 years will let me build up some sort of income producing CD ladders, and generate an income stream to meet those eye watering cost. And perhaps, mercifully, future events will minimize that. I am cautiously hopeful. We all face this reality in some way or the other. We made the commitment, and are trying our best, I read every reply, it's good to know our band of brothers on the internet is listening and requesting help, and trying to help, I don't know what caregivers did pre internet, probably spiraled down alone. I will update on Yolo installaction, it really could be the solution to my main problem. Hope this long, detailed post helps newbies and pros alike, it's daunting and details are key "insert pithy quote here" best of luck to all. Ken"

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rmdr8l/update_may_have_reached_the_end_at_home_care_as/

Long distance · 96 documents

20 most engaged of 96 matching documents, complete text.

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?!) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this

week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you* *not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

"When you are the live in caregiver and need a break. I am the live in caregiver for my 83 year old mother. Out of her 3 children it made sense for me to take on that role. I'm divorced, no children and have a career that only requires me to go to the office one day per week. I cook, clean, and handle general household management. My mom is still fine regarding personal care and has decent mobility. So when mom decided she needed help four years ago I closed my business where I was, packed up my life and pets and moved across country to move back into my childhood home. My sister lives several states away and my brother is nearby and will come if called but is not a regular part of our lives. We rarely speak to one another and there are very deep unresolved family issues, many caused by my mother's refusal to parent properly when we were young. My SIL is always telling me if I need help to ask. I usually have things pretty well under control. However, I'm starting to notice a cognitive decline in my mom where she is becoming more negative and argumentative than usual. I have taken no time for myself since I moved in. The longest I've been away during that time was a two night business trip, which my mother was not happy about. Recently a friend invited me to go on a vacation with her and her daughter. I floated the idea to my mother and was immediately met with objections and negativity. I also mentioned it to my brother and sister in law asking if they would check in on mom once a day if I go. This would be a five day trip. They declined. I know how important it is for caregivers to have some respite and I haven't had any for years. I often regret coming back here to care for her. I left friends and a community I'd had for 20 years. I had to start from scratch building a new business and making new friends in your 50s is near impossible, but I've managed to make a few. After numerous battles I was able to get my mom to execute a POA, health care proxy and apply for a HECM so there are plenty of resources for her to age in place. However, even this was met with a great deal of resistance from my mom and accusations of my taking advantage by my sister. Luckily, my brother has been on board with these arrangements. I guess this is just a rant, but I feel as if I'm surrounded by decay and death and everything is a battle. My pets are seniors now and not long for this world, my mom is in decline, she's a depressive and becoming more combative and my siblings are of little to no help. I feel that if we were to dip into the HECM to pay for home care while I'm gone my siblings would accuse me of taking advantage financially but at the same time they aren't willing to step in and help so I can have a short break for myself. Many people tell me I'm lucky to have these years with my mom but she's not a loving or positive person and instead of me being able to lift her spirits she's gradually dragging mine down."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ji641g/when_you_are_the_live_in_caregiver_and_need_a/

"Am I A Terrible Person?. My 91 year old mother fell and broke her hip last week. She had a partial hip replacement done and is in rehab. There's so much resentment built up on my part and I'm not sure it's all justified. Mom lives 4 hours away from me in another state. My sister (the favored child) used to live 10 minutes away from her , so it was always assumed she'd have someone near to her to help her. But she sold her house and up and moved across the country suddenly. So mom was left alone. I've lived in another state for many years. I

was a caregiver for many years of my life. My late daughter had physical disabilities and my husband died of heart failure. I'm now the one who will take care of my mom. I'm tired. I have asked mom to move down to where I'm at and she has refused. Every excuse in the book. I've told her I'd be with her every step of the way if she is scared. I've told her she could move in with me or we could find a senior apt nearby. We can't afford assisted living. Refused. I've told her that if she didn't want to move to my state we could find her a place in the town she is in because she really shouldn't be in the house I grew up in. Dangerous steps and short. She had refused. Repeatedly. I've told her it would be easier for me and in the long run, for her. She doesn't care. Now I'm stuck driving up to her and staying in her house every few weeks in order to see how she progresses in rehab. I have to leave my own home and responsibilities in order for her to remain satisfied. I also am stuck trying to figure out where she will go after rehab. She think she is just going to waltz back into her home like nothing ever happened, even though they've to us it might be a whole year before she's even able to navigate around .Het home has 2 flights of stairs, laundry in the concrete floored basement, and a slick porcelain bathtub. Despite my objections she continued to drive up until the accident. She became quite hateful when I mentioned not driving anymore. She had had several mishaps with her car and had become lost several times. I'm the only one who seems to think it's dangerous for her to drive. She guards her keys now and talks about her car incessantly. I refuse to let her drive if she recuperates. I refuse. I'm ashamed to admit the fact that I resent her stubborn behavior. My whole life I was basically ignored because she was so enamored with my dysfunctional sister. She practically raised my sister's children and has financially bailed my sister out of messes many times. I've never asked for help from my mom, and she didn't even attend my husband's funeral . But here I am . The daughter who it all falls on. I feel guilty admitting that I resent it. I resent the fact that this is so hard on me logistically because she only cared about herself. She had to stay near her male friend , so now I'm required to leave my home unattended for weeks in order to help her. My son has to drive from another town to stay with my dog, get my mail, and water my garden. She didn't plan financially in order to go to assisted living or accommodating housing. Instead she spent all her money on shopping for clothes and jewelry. Vanity is her thing. I'm struggling greatly with terrible resentment. She's my mom and I'll help her, of course. I've always tried my best to be respectful. But she has been so selfish and hurtful over the years. It's so hard for me to get over this. Am I a terrible person?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/

↳ **comment** (58): "You are not a terrible person. I think anyone in your situation would feel resentful, angry and betrayed. Your sister left when your mother had nothing left to give her and might actually need something back. That is not your problem. I don't think you should have to swoop in and pick up the pieces. Your Mom made choices and is still making them. Let the rehab facility get social work involved and they can decide with your Mom what her options are. If you stay you will be used by the system and an ungrateful mother. You have responsibilities to your own life and to your son who is now being impacted."

↳ **comment** (50): "Have her primary care physician pull her license. That makes the doctor the bad person not you. Does anyone have health care power of attorney for your mother? Has she had a recent cognitive test? Doesn't sound as though she is mentally capable of making her own decisions so you may just have to be the "bad guy" and place her where she safely needs to be. I'm sorry. It's a tough situation."

↳ **comment** (46): "You are not a terrible person. Make sure that everyone knows that she has NO ONE upon discharge that lives nearby, and she will be on her own. Do not cooperate. You can be as stubborn as she is. You do not have to take what she dishes out. She moves from rehab to where you can reach her without leaving your home overnight. Or she's completely on her own, because you are not coming. That's her choice."

"[Vent] I'm so tired of being the only adult in my situation.. I've lurked a while, but I'm struggling today. My mother (71) still works as a teacher, and takes care of my declining father (76) every other moment of every day. My brother (38) lives at home, but has developmental challenges. I (32) live three hours away from them and seem to be the only rational adult in this relationship. My father isn't caring for himself. It's to the point that he

sits in wet and soiled clothing instead of getting up and transferring to the potty chair. He doesn't wash himself, or really do anything but lay or sit in bed all day. It's to the point that I and my therapist both have called Elder protective services, and he refuses to engage with the social worker. Does more movement in the hour that she's over turning his back to her no matter where she appears in his line of sight than at any other time. Over the summer he suddenly refused to see his GP who he's seen for 40 years, blaming him for vaguely "not helping him" when the answer was for Dad to start OT and use a mobility aid. Refuses to use the walker, crutches, a cane, or wheelchair still to this day. Only doctor we can get him in with is a geriatric specialist, except he wasn't available until November, so all progress on dementia diagnosis, or the steps we need to have legally before we can appoint a guardian stopped cold while we wait on this specialist. My mother is running ragged, but won't schedule home healthcare to come because it will cause a fight. Won't call mental health services on him for his state, and doesn't ask for a psychiatric hold at any of their near weekly ER trips from when he's fallen. My brother does the best he can to help my dad when he's not at work, but they've never gotten along. My dad has never been a good or kind man, and I understand why my brother doesn't want to show him kindness now. The social worker involved now is kind, but keeps saying that because my mom is there and caring for him, her hands are tied, though admits that they need home health care. So finally I called home health care, and am having to get a ride three hours back home to be there when they come to arrange care because my mother will not take time off work to do it, and didn't do it when school was out over the summer. The one good thing about having the social worker is that he's actually doing random attempts to show he's caring for himself, so maybe he'll turn it around, except he's already fallen twice trying to make it to the toilet, in the last week, still won't use the potty chair Well now my dad hates me again, which fine, whatever at least he can't physically harm me anymore, but is threatening to get a restraining order if I go through with the home healthcare business. I don't know HOW he'd get one. I don't know how any judge would look at this situation and say "yeah, you're right sir your child is out to get you by paying for home health care to come out and help you with tasks you can't do yourself" Oh, and all of Dad's cousins are now somehow involved as of today, telling me I'm a terrible kid for doing this to my father. At what point is it no longer my circus? I walked away from this circus years ago, but no one else involved is freaking willing to actually take actions so that my mom and brother don't wake up one morning to find my father dead in the garage from some wild hair idea that he should go for a walk at 3 in the morning, or get home to work to him dead in the bathroom because he fell and cracked his head open the one time he actually attempted to go to the toilet instead of just soiling himself. I think the part that makes me the angriest is my mother hid how bad things were getting from me so I wasn't able to do something sooner. I don't know if it's just denial that her husband of 50 years is going, or that she can handle it all by herself or what, but I'm tired of being the only one looking at this situation for how batshit crazy it is."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/17btuoo/vent_im_so_tired_of_being_the_only_adult_in_my/

"Or they moved away from their own parents and therefore weren't around to do the caregiving. My parents moved halfway across the country when I was small and we saw my paternal grandparents once a year and talked on the phone maybe once a month. I had next to no relationship with my maternal grandmother (maternal grandfather died in his early 50s of cancer) for very valid reasons. But that geographic distance meant that when Dad's parents were in their later years, it was his sister who was local who shouldered the burden of coordinating medical care and moving them into assisted living/memory care - not the brothers who had left decades earlier. My parents did literally *nothing* when it came to their elderly parents' last years. This is probably why when Dad was declining from late and end stage dementia, my mother had rather unrealistic expectations of me and my willingness and ability to do hands-on caregiving. She had cared for her own father in the last few months of his life and expected that I would do the same "because that's what daughters DO". She completely ignored that when she did that she was 20, single and childless, and living at home while going to nursing school. Meanwhile, when Dad was declining, I was in my mid 40s, with a demanding full time job and raising my own two children with my husband, living 40 minutes away from them."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p047bx2/

"Well...not so proud of the times I totally lost patience with her and was ready to toss her in the car and drop her at the ER saying "I can't DO IT anymore!". My bestie (who lives out-of-State where Mom used to) has been my sanity throughout all of this, having gone through it with her mother. Good thing long-distance calls don't cost an arm and a leg now. LOL! She talked me off a ledge SO many times."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/n4sww5i/

"My mom is 84 and similar. I am her only friend and source of companionship and entertainment. She lived on my street in her own home and was a miserable recluse. Because she did nothing but sit in a recliner with the curtains drawn all day, she was on a walker by age 76. After many falls and hospitalizations, I forced her hand into assisted living at age 77. She's been in three different high-end assisted living facilities. She refuses to make friends, participate in activities, or eat with the other residents. I am an only child, recovering from cancer treatments and surgery. But I have to grocery shop for her every week, be her entertainer and friend. I carve out one day a week for this. I also have a full time job, a husband, home with large yard, and an old dog to care for. My parents would never, ever have put up with this from their parents. My dad's mom went immediately to a nursing home where she died after five years or so. My mom's mom got shuttled across the country to another family member when my parents grew weary of her need for companionship. I envy my high school best friend who enlisted in the Air Force, off to a life of adventure, and never got stuck with parent care. I mistakenly stayed in my hometown and I have been on the hook since age 45, and I am 60 now."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_ofTEN/p21ag5y/

"Mom in hospital dad needs 24/7 care. My dad has Parkinson's and needs 24/7 care. My mom is his caregiver and refuses to let anyone come into the house or help her. I've been telling her this for years and she refuses to listen. She also doesn't go to the doctor for herself and is not very healthy. She's overweight, has bad knees, her legs are so swollen and her feet are hideous. I've been after her to go to the doctors for years to figure out her legs and why they are so swollen. Her excuse is that she can't because my dad needs her. 2 weeks ago my cousin called me to tell me that my mom has an infection in her foot and she needs to go to the doctor or hospital. I called her and told her to go and she promised me she would for 5 days before she finally went. Now she had to be kept overnight and there's no one to take care of my dad. My brother lives at home but is also overweight and has autism and doesn't always grasp the severity of the situation. I live 4 hours away, have a full time job, am taking some graduate classes, and I have 2 children in high school and I'm widowed for a little over a year now. I also have pets and this just happened to happen while I'm on vacation. I'm in another country at the moment. I talked to my dad and brother today and told them both to get help from the VA since my dad is a veteran. I hope they listen to me. My brother is supposed to go to the hospital for my mom this afternoon and consult with the doctors. He said they want a visiting nurse to come and also PT for my mom. No doubt she will refuse if it's left up to her. I told him to make sure they come. I'm kind of angry because since my mom has refused help all these years now we need it and have no one to call. Like WTF. She's left this all on us. And when she comes home she probably needs to be resting not walking all over the house to do things for my dad. But I'm sure she won't be abiding by doctors orders. This is 1 stressor in my life at the moment. My daughter needs to choose a college in less than 1 week and we have no concrete financial aid package. My dad waffles on paying, which is fine. So we decide on the cheapest out of state place and then today he asks and he says she should go to her top choice in his city since it's close to home. Well it's not close to home for me and I don't want to depend on him paying. What if he has to go to a home and then can't pay because he can't give away money? These are things on my mind. SIGH. I really needed this relaxing beach vacation but. Instead I'm fielding phone calls from aunts, cousins and my brother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cctcsj/mom_in_hospital_dad_needs_247_care/

"I am at that time when living alone may be dangerous, or just too many things to do that I can not do, and then being alone is intolerable. Fortunately, my children love me enough to come clear across the country to help me pack up and move. I will divide up my time with them, so none of them has the full time burden of me living with one of them. I know that at any time I could need more physical help, at that time, I will hope for death or be moved to a care facility. But for now, I am so fortunate that my children want me to spend time with them."

youtube · @dan2wee · *What to Do When Elderly Parents Can't Live Alone* · 28 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=oOIWdNaA4Fs&lc=Ugya9p7o-h9VJcPvKph4AaABAg>

↳ **@PamelaDWilsonCaregivingExpert** (7): "Thanks for sharing. You are wise and your children are blessed that you are practical about your needs."

↳ **@xyz987123abc** (5): "I would think about hiring a personal gym trainer so you can keep your independence for another 2 decades."

"Help! Bowel incontinence and refuses to wear briefs.. TL;DR my ambulatory MIL has constant bowel incontinence and refuses to wear briefs – how on earth do I handle this? Three years ago, we moved 1000 miles away from our hometown to have space away from my narcissistic MIL. My partner and I have been together for 25 years, friends for more than 30. We are not close with her. Her other son is not close with her and she has no relationship with her grandchildren because she's been abusive towards us all. My MIL got a pancreatic cancer diagnosis in April and also has dementia. We came out to help when she got the cancer diagnosis and realized that the dementia was very severe. She is amazing at masking, to the point where we have yet to get doctors on board to agree that she can't make her own medical decisions - but we did get a formal dementia diagnosis, but no stage. She's now on hospice but is amazingly "well" for a woman with cancer, insulin dependent diabetes, and dementia. Unfortunately, she has been unable for years to do her own finances - my partner manages that for her from out of state, and when we got to town, we realized that she also hasn't been able to do her own shopping or cooking or cleaning for quite some time (2 years at least - all the food in fridge and pantry expired in the season in which she had a stroke in 2024). Her son and I have stayed here in our RV since April being her primary caregivers and going over twice a day to make sure she is getting food and medication. Thankfully, she is not treating the cancer, so her lifespan should be on the short side and she's no longer suffering from the side effects of the chemo (which were terrifying). While I have gotten enough therapy over the decades to be able to manage caring for her, we have run into a major issue. She has continual bowel incontinence, and this morning, after soiling the bed overnight, and again a second time by sitting on it after I changed all of the bedding, she has refused to wear incontinence briefs. She has told me that I need to just get used to her pooping all over the house, and that we are going to "own this situation". I don't want feces all over everything in the entire building, and she is still upright, ambulatory, and active – so she routinely goes out to lunch with friends and I really think it's a public health risk at this point. She doesn't wash her hands, and she doesn't have a problem defecating on the furniture. I just literally do not have the skills to deal with this. I am constantly told by Hospice that we can only do what she agrees to, and if she doesn't agree to it, we can't force her. But it feels unfair to me to go out into public while actually crapping all over the place. I am looking into memory care facilities because at some point, she is going to need that. But I just don't know how to get her to agree with me to wear briefs. She says that they are hot and uncomfortable, and she gets very incredibly upset when she has asked to comply and put them on. She is convinced that nobody else will be angry if she poops in their car when she is taken out to lunch or for a ride. It is beyond ridiculous. Any ideas of how on earth to deal with this?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1vhgax/help_bowel_incontinence_and_refuses_to_wear_briefs/

"Impossible Situation. 50F with Silent Generation parents who are 85 and almost 88. They live in New York State. My mother is almost completely blind from Central Retinal Vein Occlusion that occurred in late 2021 and may have been brought on by many years of glaucoma. She was an excellent patient, always doing exactly what the doctor recommended and keeping up with her eye appointments. Her vision loss is tragic and she has very little interest in living. She is also showing signs of dementia (wailing, nagging, repeating the same questions, worrying about odd things like the alarm clock malfunctioning). Otherwise, however, she's in good physical health. My dad has been her sole caregiver and it's taking a big toll on him. He's great cognitively, but needs hearing aids and is having trouble with balance. He went for a few physical therapy sessions, but stopped around the holidays. He still drives and insists on going out whenever he wants, which is often at night. I live 1.5 hours away and have offered, asked, begged, pleaded and done everything short of showing up unannounced to get them to accept my help. My 48M brother lives 5 minutes from them and doesn't do anything for them other than clear their car when it snows. Of course, they don't/won't ask him for help either. Their situation is a ticking time bomb that has me gripped with anxiety on a daily basis. They have very little money, a condo that is mortgaged (but only in my mom's name), no wills, no POA, no burial plans except a vague notion that there is a plot for them in a cemetery 2 hours away that my late paternal grandmother bought in the 1950s! I got them to sign HIPPA releases and healthcare proxies, but there is no plan for any type of emergency. I called my mom's PCP and mentioned her cognitive symptoms, but the nurse said she denied anxiety or depression at her last wellness checkup. The nurse told me that a neurologist would need to diagnose dementia, so I made an appointment for my mom in April. Will she go? I highly doubt it. I recently had a one-hour free consultation with an elder law attorney. My brother didn't want to pay any lawyer that charged a consultation fee and then was "too busy" to attend the Zoom meeting. The lawyer said my mother needs to get on Medicaid and offered to fill out and file the application...for \$15,750. Getting on Medicaid would allow her to have a home health aide, but the likelihood of my mom agreeing to that is very low. Additionally, my dad is a hoarder and the condo is in disrepair, so the lawyer said Medicaid won't even approve them for an aide because a home visit is part of the process. If anything big or little happens to my dad, I don't know what will become of my mom. I live in a different state and am not equipped to care for a blind person with dementia. My brother seems to think that my husband and I should take her in, even telling me that we could "get a chair lift." Also, despite the lawyer telling me that freewill.com is a scam (?), my brother insists that documents we print off the internet will be sufficient for creating wills and POAs. He's cheap as the day is long and I cannot pay for things unless we go 50/50. I love my parents dearly and have been really struggling with anticipatory grief on top of all these practical concerns. I worry about them constantly and have begun praying that God has mercy on my mom and calls her home first. I'm glad I found this community and am open to any kind suggestions."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iyze4a/impossible_situation/

"I think I might get downvoted for this opinion, but I would suggest you start with a different strategy - and hold "running away" if the first one doesn't work. Start with "No". I know it is hard to say to a parent, but you are going to have to get used to it anyway when they call you after you have moved and "No" means "No, I'm not traveling across the country to help." Get a really healthy "NO" going and use it frequently. My concern for you is that - without the establishment of really healthy boundaries- you will be feeling compelled to help from afar, which makes things MUCH more difficult when a real emergency happens. If you become able to say NO now and are able to stay, then when you choose to say yes (like they have a heart attack and you want to see them in the hospital) you will not have to make a huge trip across the country to satisfy your desire. (That said, if you want to move, move!). Good luck!)"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p03c53u/

"Thank you I greatly appreciate it. My mother is 83. I've posted about her before here. The current situation with her is driving (taking her keys away) and her nutrition. She's scheduled for an MRI. Is it true that the MRI can give a lot of assistance in the dementia diagnostic process? her situation seems to be deteriorating quickly over the period of one year. At first, it just seemed like she was stubborn or not listening. Gradually came to realize that it was a physiological issue. She seemed to have no insight into it whatsoever until a couple of weeks ago. Her sister stays the night with her a lot. Her other sister stays the night with her a couple times a month. My sister sometimes spends the night with her. I live three hours away. I visited her last week and she has lost 30 pounds. She only weighed 110 pounds and she's 5 ft6. I was completely shocked so essentially I cooked a massive turkey with potatoes and other vegetables for her. I also make sure that she has a balanced diet. I got her a bunch of easy to eat organic vegetable soups that she can add whatever meat she wants to. She's still able to cook simple things she enjoys it. She was able to enjoy a hamburger that she cooked for herself the other day and she was very proud of doing it. The issue is she refuses to stop driving and is very aggressive about it. She was very aggressive to the doctor in her in her speech she went from saying that she hated my sister who took her to the doctor to be evaluated. she then flipped and says that she trusts my sister again. When I was at her house for the first time, she cried over and over again. She cried about the dog food we got for her dogs, she cried about the cat food that we got for her cats, she cried about the turkey and the food that we bought her. It breaks my heart to see her crying. I don't understand why she's crying. She seems to be developing a level of paranoia. Is that part of dementia? She told me over and over again that she thinks God is against her and that she has not tithed in the church and that's what's causing her all of these problems. She says that her life is turned completely upside down and that she wants to die. It's just so sad."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/oksveh/

"Advice, please. My mother has Alzheimers, and she's currently bedridden in a medical facility at her assisting living home. I live out of state, but was staying with her days and nights for three weeks with naps at her apartment, and I think it helped her morale. Cheered for her during PT and OT sessions, played her favorite music on my iPad, brought her the fruit and healthy snacks that she loves, etc. I've been home for a week, and she wants me to go back again. My husband is fine with it. My older sister, who lives near where my mother is, is not. My sister thinks I'm "coddling" my mother, and my influence is doing harm to her. I think certain aides who we pay to care for her do more harm by focusing on their phones and ignoring her when she needs to be repositioned in bed or changed. I booked a flight to go back out to be with mom tomorrow, and my sister demanded that I cancel it, because mom "doesn't remember anything." Please let me know your thoughts."

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1t76ua8/advice_please/

"Girl, I am WITH you. In the last 10 years I gained 80 lbs. EIGHTY POUNDS. Hormones were off since the birth of my last child in my early 30s (I'm now 49, almost 50) and was getting prometrium and T3 supplementation until it wasn't working anymore. Fast forward ~5 years and Covid hit at the same time I inherited the care and responsibility of my dying father. Dad was so ill and helpless that it was like parenting him. I managed his care for over a year until he died alone in a hospital during Covid (I'll never get over not being there with him) while my ailing mother went to live in another state with my brother so he could manage her care as she waited for the hospitals to open back up for her heart surgery. Dad died. I gained more weight, felt depressed, no motivation, couldn't sleep. Missed a lot of work to be with sick mother who we believed was near death several times over the last 3 years. I also missed a lot of time with my husband and kids during their middle and high school years due to my parent's high needs and inability to care for themselves or each other. I don't regret the sacrifices but it was very, very tough. Fast forward to this year as mom continued to get sicker and is too much for my brother even when she's in a nursing home facility. She cries when she's alone and we're not with her. Mom is very high needs and dependent on us like a small child with advanced dementia and worsening anxiety and depression and

uncontrollable emotions. It's like we're parenting her and have been for years. Mom has been on hospice for over a year, then was removed from it just before her last two hospitalizations this month. In the last three weeks she's been in the hospital twice and has declined severely, with worsening dementia and critical health issues that she's too frail to be treated for. I lost my job in June, have a problematic adult child causing us major stress, and have been driving to another state weekly to be with my mother in the hospital or in her nursing home, in what feels like parenting a terminally ill, needy child. We thought my mom was dying the afternoon I drove back home last week to prep for my final job interview, and I felt so guilty for feeling anger and frustration at her for this timing (that she could not help!)...because I had to decide between turning around to go back to her to be with her while she passed away or miss the critical interview and jeopardize the job. This was a no-win situation. It was an awful, guilty feeling, and all through this I developed horrible sciatica that has had me in agony these past 4 weeks, but I haven't been able to tend to it with a doctor because I've been with my sick mother most of this time. I just discovered your videos and got your book a month ago, and somehow fit in some video appts with my primary care and ObGyn docs to get bloodwork and start HRT. I've been feeling awful for years and didn't realize how badly I have been missing out on life. All of this has caused great strain on my marriage. So yeah, it's been an awful summer and awful past several years. Piled on top of this I discovered I'm probably in late perimenopause. Hopefully I can find relief from this brain fog and insomnia before starting my new job in a few weeks. I need to feel better for myself and my family. These last several years have been the most difficult in my life. My female ob-gyn and primary care doctors don't seem to know much about perimenopause or menopause and I had to fight, armed with resources from you, to just get a scrip for the combi-patch this past week. Thank you for your videos, Dr. Haver!"

youtube · @BBL_Fam · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 19 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgzQZKRR7W0XFV9qxw14AaABAg>

↳ **@debraowen6723** (3): "BBL_fam, just golly 🥰. You've been thru the ringer and back! Dr. Mary is so helpful. I'll bet you'll be fighting stronger than You've ever been once your HRT kicks in. At least you'll get some good sleep! I feel for you. This is very hard, isn't it? Hugs ❤️"

↳ **@Mandara1847** (3): "Lots of hugs. I hope, you went to that job interview. You sacrificed basically your health, your kids childhood and part of your marriage to your mothers illness. Parents in full mental capacity would forbid you that. The few that would not are narcissists and belong in jail. Your mom might be one - „she is needy“ ... You are helping nobody by obliterating yourself. No, not even your mother. Because she is not realizing, whether it is you or the assistant nurse! Hard to accept. But the truth. Take care of yourself."

"How do you get an elderly parent to TAKE HER MEDS?! So my mom has been having some sort of early-onset cognitive decline for years. In the last few years, it's accelerated rapidly. Unfortunately, it didn't touch her ego much. She's been losing her hearing for the last ten years. She refuses to get hearing aids because ego. She refuses to stop filling the parental home with useless crap because ego. 90% of that house is an 8 or a 9 on the clutter index rating scale and has been for twenty-five years because she has a screaming temper tantrum if you try to throw anything out that isn't actual food waste. She's got multiple rare medical conditions and refuses to see a doctor about them because ego. Recently, I had to attend a wedding with my parents. My mother was in delirium from the moment I saw her. Hell, she wanted to use the bathroom at my place before we left, and she thought my black bathroom scale was a pool of water on the floor. Naturally, I was concerned. I brought it up to my dad first chance I got. Turns out she has a UTI and she refused to take her antibiotics, allegedly because she didn't want her siblings seeing her have an upset stomach if it made her sick. Wedding passes. Mom and Dad get back home. I figure that good, she'll take her meds now. Two weeks pass. I talk to Dad. He mentions that he has to take Mom in for lab work. What for? UTI. Turns out she refused to take her meds because "she felt better." She's 73. She's not getting over a damn UTI without antibiotics. Better than even odds that she's not going to take them even if the lab work comes back positive because she's dragging Dad out of state again in two days to attend one of her innumerable family occasions. Short of wrapping her in a blanket and forcing the pills down her throat like she's a

recalcitrant cat, I see no way to make her take her pills. While I'd be willing to do that, I live 850 miles away, and my dad won't do it. Does anyone have any ideas? Because I don't want her developing kidney stones or kidney failure. I am in no position to drop everything and help Dad take care of her if that happens. I dislike my mother, but I really don't want my father to have to go through that. Yeah, I know my dad needs to stop enabling her. But he won't and I'm not willing to have that argument with him. Before you say guardianship/POA, I think she's still too capable of putting on a functional mask for Dad or I to get guardianship. Correct me if I'm wrong."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nd1i5u/how_do_you_get_an_elderly_parent_to_take_her_meds/

"How to find an in home caregiver?. My dad has been showing signs for about 2 years now. My mom covers for him and says everything is fine well.. today she had an 8 hour surgery and he was supposed to pick her up and never showed up. Police found him 12 hours later and he said he was going to pick her up this afternoon. They said sir, its 7pm. My mom called and said he just went for a little drive and all is well. She said however this weird thing happened last night, she found him naked on the living room floor but thought he just wanted to sleep there. I live out of state. How do I find them an in home caregiver? Even with my mom pretending all is well? She doesnt seem to understand how serious this is. He has gone missing before but usually she is in the car along for the ride.

🙄 "

reddit post · r/dementia · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1m7v0yy/how_to_find_an_in_home_caregiver/

"Ever since I was a kid in elementary school she was supposed to die within a year. She wasn't supposed to be able to live to make it to any of my graduations, so a doctor saying how much time she has hasn't been helpful. Generally they spoke about palliative care and hospice while there, but this was while in the ICU. Once she left the ICU to the regular wing they didn't bring those back up. But at the least I do think palliative care would be helpful with these attacks. As for my siblings it's kind of a lost cause. The most my sister has done was send me a link to an assistance site. My brother hasn't reached out at all, although he lives three hours away probably because he wanted to separate himself from this type of situation. Neither of them had a good relationship with my mom so I can understand to a degree, but I also didn't have a great one either."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1dbgh7t/rant_post_hospital_discharge/7rbhnm/

"My God, I just found this video and I feel like this man was describing me. My 79 year old father had a traumatic brain injury 6 months ago and what was supposed to just be a few days to help him (I flew in out of state), turned into 6 months! I have no help at all besides weekends when my brother comes. I feel hopeless, helpless, and angry. I feel like my life has been stolen from me and so alone. I flounder, wondering if I'm doing the right thing every day and am depressed. I miss my husband, we've been apart this entire time and just sleeping in my own bed. Watching this video has given me hope that it is okay to be selfish and that I need to find a support group or therapy FAST!"

youtube · @jcgurl3773 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 12 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyFRIBpHEiNEh4YUsd4AaABAg>

My kids and my job are paying for it · 77 documents

20 most engaged of 77 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness,

financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him

back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one*

cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had." This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin* Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family *Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin* My cousin also asked her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant **we** would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set of what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1trrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the

recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"Even as a professional nurse, this is difficult... it is very difficult and expensive to get any kind of help. We are going on 5 years of watching my mom fade away... while working a full time job.. no word from my siblings.. they come once a year. I am glad my mom is safe and well cared for by my husband and I. I am emotionally, physically drained. I feel like my "golden years" have been taken"

youtube · @ValerieLutz-rp3vf · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 183 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyseQm5vCvOxUZxQjN4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (23): "It is beyond difficult and near beyond human capacity. I wish I had something other than to say you aren't alone with this experience. I am very grateful for all you do as a nurse and then you and your family caring for mom. It is beyond tough. I hope the kindness and goodness you are putting out there comes back 10x. Thank you for sharing this. Hang in there."

↳ **@Andy-fr1hu** (9): "I was in this situation (siblings live in other states) one almost never visited in eleven years. I cared for my Mom (dementia, no mobility) and father (abusive, mobile with personality disorder) until

two years before they passed (Mom naturally, father took his life). The last two years, I had to walk away. My oldest sister (well to do), paid for their in home care and visited when she could. The other sister never visited. I went from a very active and healthy 50-60's year old married lady to a person with heart problems and Graves Disease. I thank God every day for my patient and loving husband. Please make sure you are cared for also! Being strong for years is great and admirable, but you have no idea how long your parents may need your assistance. In home care is wonderful if you can afford it. I could have never walked away if it meant they had to go to a nursing home. I wish the best for you. You are doing the hardest job there is in life. Bless you ❤️ 😊 "

↳ **@nt3352** (4): "It's the hardest job indeed that's why not all siblings will cooperate if there is already a main caregiver sibling. Good that one of your sister paid the bill. My siblings were mostly lip service."

"Both of my parents died young, but my father stayed in end stage heart failure for years. In his last year, he lost the ability to walk but refused a care facility. I couldn't get him admitted myself. So i cared for him with no help from siblings or any family. I was only 39 with 2 toddlers and a full time job. It was absolutely the most horrendous and damaging experience of my life. I felt i was getting ill myself. Sure enough, 2 years later i was diagnosed with breast cancer. I wasn't the least bit surprised. We need a solution to this problem of care, it's not sustainable."

youtube · @limo5724 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 159 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwXJzaMFh7d-YG8do94AaABAq

↳ **@obstantiadiscindo** (35): "@limo5724 Our parents didn't have to do this for their parents - people live longer now, but in poorer health, and dementia too. The current system doesn't work. Sometimes the carer dies before the parent. I don't know how you did it with 2 toddlers too. I hope your health improves and you regain your joy of life."

↳ **@jdmmg4904** (28): "Absolutely selfish decision from your father to burden you like that:("

↳ **@elizabethk3238** (17): "Too many selfish parents expecting their children to fully care for them. If they took care of themselves they will strong and self supporting till death. I'm 78, spend my limited pension on eating well, taking the supplements that will help keep me strong, exercise regularly, keep my mind alert. I cared for my parents for years, I will NEVER put my children through that."

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play stardew valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out

because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many potholes and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Anyone dealing with the anti-text movement?. My (42M) parents are 70, since covid they have been on a crusade to refuse to use any text based communication. Phone calls and Facetime only. Doesn't matter where you are, what you have going on, how hard you work. The expectation is if they call, you stop what you are doing and have a 1-1.5 hour conversation with them. Zero text messaging, they will receive text messages and then call you. I just can't do it anymore and was just in a big blowup fight with them. Working 50-70 hours a week, I get 50 hours or so of peace on the weekend to get all the shit I need to get done. They love to call on Sunday mornings and afternoons. I don't have time at 2pm on a Sunday. They forget everyone is not retired and our generation can't afford stay at home spouses. Couples like my wife and I typically work full time. So everyone chips in on the weekends. I don't have a spouse at home all week to do all the house chores like my mother did growing up, I need to help on the weekends. My wife deserves her rest as well. Not to mention, they have nothing to talk about because they don't leave their house. It's either doctor visits, some friend in the community are ill/worse or whatever political bullshit they are following. The last thing I want to do is talk on the phone about my career, my wife's career, the chores we are doing or whatever. I live it every day, I don't want to talk about it and recap how shitty my week was. They moved away and now they feel entitled to life-coaching level updates of everything going on. They refuse to make trips back usually blaming health, money, travel, or weather issues. Always an excuse, but expect full effort on my part and my siblings to keep them updated using phone calls to keep them in the loop. I'm busy during the week and it's hard to call me, typically my phone is on silent during meetings. I'm very responsive to text messaging, because I can work it in to my schedule. They refuse though, typical boomer, it's their way or no way. They decided to move 2,300 miles away. They've been gone for 10 years, maybe 5-10 trips back home in that time. It would be different if we could meet for dinner on Thursday night or they could come over and I'd cook on Tuesday night. That can't happen, so I don't know what to tell them. They made their life choices. The crazy part is they never changed. They were only parents when it was convenient to them in my childhood they are still doing it now that I'm an adult."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 121 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3ebre/anyone_dealing_with_the_antitext_movement/

"THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much--COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 95 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobb2tw/

"Honestly, I can't blame you here. No one knows what it's like until they go through it. My dad is only 63 and "able minded" as he's ever been if you can call it that. But he neglected his health, finances, etc. until he had a fall and a host of health problems. No one to care for him and I live 11 hours away so I had no choice but to bring him to my house to get him back walking hopefully. For now he's wheelchair bound. He won't do ANYTHING for himself. Any meals are the absolute lowest effort - little Debbie's, microwave dinners, sandwiches. He rarely comes out of the room to eat dinner with my family and when he does he doesn't speak. I have to schedule PT and like 8 doctors around my work schedule. My work performance has obviously suffered with all these appointments and I'm usually the rockstar. My wife is tired of it and tired of my time being monopolized with that, scheduling, plus juggling kids' schedules. EVERYONE is upset with me because I'm burning myself out trying to do everything and there's no help. I finally arranged transportation for his appointments but I have to put him on the van. Had to switch one of his PT offices and his doc scolded me. It's made me so resentful and impacted my relationship with him, most likely irreparably."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxb56th/

"My mom's back in the hospital. Dad needs 24/7 care at home. . I'm so mad. I came to visit my parents for the night. It's a 4 hour drive. My mom has a gross scaly skin rash that's oozing on her leg. Her legs are like elephant legs. She hates going to the doctor. She cares for my dad with Parkinson's around the clock. But will not take care of her own health. She was in the hospital 2 weeks ago but checked herself out against medical advice and then just let her skin thing fester and made no effort to see her own doctor. So it was a waste of 2 nights she spent in the hospital last time and we're back to square one. So I convinced her to go back tonight. Of course they are keeping her overnight again. My brother who lives with them is at work overnight. So I'm here with my 2 kids helping my dad pee in a bottle. Something I never wanted to do. I love him but for the love of god, hire a nurse to handle this stuff! I can't stay tomorrow. I have to get my kids back home for school. I have a dog and 2 cats at home and a house and a full time job AND my husband died last year. I'm mad because my mom has known for years how bad my dad is and she's refused to hire help. She has the money but has this phobia about letting anyone else help her. So now she's stuck us in a bad spot where I'm here alone caring for my dad and I don't know what to do exactly and I have no one to call to help me. Im going to call the VA tomorrow morning and see about either getting someone in here to help or bringing him there for a few days while my mom gets her skin thing and swollen legs figured out. 2 weeks ago they wanted to send her home with a visiting nurse checking in and she refused. Like WHY? WHY must you be so difficult? WHY can't you see reason? I'm going to get 0 sleep tonight and I have to drive 4 hours home tomorrow."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cpxyo2/my_moms_back_in_the_hospital_dad_needs_247_care/

↳ **comment** (42): "I'm really sorry. That all sounds really rough. My dad has Parkinson's too, so I know the level of care that is required. I think that it's time to say, "mom, there are no options. You are having the visiting nurse come because I absolutely cannot come back until (much later date). By not allowing them to help, you are causing me a great deal of stress and I cannot do this anymore." Hopefully that will be enough, but I also have a

stubborn mom, so I understand that it might not be. But your first priority is taking care of your kids and yourself; it simply has to be."

↳ **comment** (19): "If it's bad enough for her to be kept overnight, it's pretty bad. I'm sorry you are going through this. Can you take your dad for a Dr evaluation so you can talk to Medicare about any benefits you can access for them?"

↳ **comment** (16): "A lot of assisted living places offer short stays for when the primary caregiver needs a break or is just unavailable. Also, they all asked about VA benefits when I was looking for my mom while dad was in hospice."

"I get this from my drunk ass sister regarding my other sister that is now in long term care. My mother took care of her until she passed and inherited her because nobody else stood up. My sister had a traumatic brain injury as a child and has required supervision. She had no safety awareness or judgement. When my mother died, I moved her in with me. She became more and more unsafe, walking around town, falling, getting into cars with people she doesn't know. When the opportunity arose to put her into care, I took it. Because I work full time and my husband has late stage Alzheimer's. Now my drunk sister sends me nasty grams about why did I put the other sister in a home. They can all fuck right off unless they are going to volunteer to be the full time care giver. I cared for my mother, my sister and now my husband. I'm done caring what other people think"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4ufodx/

"We Will Eventually Have to Tell Our Mother She May Never Come Home. How have any of you gone about telling a parent they may never come home? My 80 year old mother had a stroke in April which badly affected her left side. Cognitively, she's still mostly there but her left arm is useless now and her left leg isn't much better. A couple days after the stroke, we got her into a rehab facility. She was there for a little over two months receiving therapy but eventually the facility terminated her coverage under Medicare due to lack of progress. While she was there, I took the initiative and got my father and brother to agree to get an elder care lawyer. Sadly, given her age and other health issues, I highly suspected she would need continuing care. The law firm we selected was excellent and we were able to get my mother's Medicaid application approved while protecting most of my father's assets. We also took the opportunity to get durable POAs and medical POAs for both of our parents as well as revised wills should our father pass before our mother. Speaking of my father, he's 82 and has pretty bad hearing. He's still able to get around and can drive to see my mother everyday. He's not without other healthcare issues and his short term memory isn't great. We have to be careful what we tell him because he will share everything with everyone. He has a really hard time dealing with any type of technology. My brother and I have managed to get him to allow us to pay most of his bills online and we have access to his various accounts. Now back to mom. We were able to get her into a nursing home at the beginning of July. She received more therapy there but again therapy under Medicare was terminated due to lack of progress. At both her current facility and the previous one, she has fallen several times. Most of them were, unfortunately, her fault as she was trying to move in ways her body can no longer do. She even remarked to my brother that she "knows how to fall". She still needs assistance going to the bathroom, with bathing, with dressing and various other things most of us take for granted. I said earlier the stroke didn't affect her cognitively but over the last few months I've noticed some changes. She's gotten more stubborn and her and my father snap at each other. That's because of his poor hearing. He can't hear her very well or at all sometimes and she gets frustrated. Given all that she's convinced she can come home. My brother and I know that's not feasible. My father is not capable of giving my mom the care she needs and we are sure he understands that. I suspect he will need care of his own in 2-3 years, maybe sooner. His mother eventually succumbed to dementia and I'm worried I see signs of it in him. My brother who lives with him has been doing the lion's share of the work helping him and mom over the years but he has a full time job. He can't financially quit to

take care of her. I live 2.5 hours away. The house would need some major work to let her come home and she obviously would need some kind of home health care. While my parents are ok financially for now, the work needed on the house plus home care would drain that fast. The Medicaid waiver program in our state is a mess and it could be months or years to get her on it. Sorry for the long story. I know my family's situation isn't as bad as many on here but I wanted to get it off my chest."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fuy4iw/we_will_eventually_have_to_tell_our_mother_she/

↳ **comment (61):** "Caring for parents carries quite the load and stress. You have a lot going on. My suggestion for your mom would be to tell her the truth: she can go home when she is able to independently care for herself. This includes bathing, using the washroom, maybe even add going x number of weeks without falling. In short, she can go home when she meets these milestones. Until she is strong enough, she needs to stay where she is to get the help. Will this happen? Unlikely. But it may give her the focus to try. Very best of luck to you and family."

↳ **comment (22):** "My father is in the same position. He was released from hospital to rehab after surgery on his foot, but is unable to stand/walk/bathe/dress/etc and my mother, now in an independent living arrangement in the same facility, cannot take care of him. Medicaid/Medicare ran out and we're now having to pay for his care. He frankly preferred to be waited on and served prior to his infection. He's been in hospital or rehab for six weeks, and seems fine there, with mobility provided by a wheelchair only, and only today did it appear to sink in for him that he would continue to be institutionalized until he can deal with regular daily living on his own. We're waiting to see if his foot heals, but there's a good chance that he'll need to stay in nursing care. It sucks. Good luck to you. You're not alone in experiencing this."

↳ **comment (20):** "Perhaps her doctor would be best delivering the news? He could present the medical reasons for her not to return home and answer any questions. This way when moving her to the nursing home you can say you are 'following doctor's orders'."

"My husband went from a athletic fit male to a wheelchair in a matter of a year after a multiple sclerosis diagnosis. We are also raising a child at the same time and I'm working a full time job. Tired is an understatement, let's pray for each other. God is with us"

youtube · @simplysusan87 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 59 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyP0-6TMKiB6GrL3ph4AaABAg>

↳ **@socialdave8630 (6):** "My wife has had MS for 40 years and now I've hit the wall hard after 3 years of hard ore caregiving. Best of luck to you, I'm still looking for answers. Maybe this is it."

↳ **@BetterByDai (6):** "So many people underestimate the heavy load those who are in your position have to bear. Add children to that, and you can find yourself needing 10 arms to juggle everything. Because it's not just physical exhaustion, its mental and both can spiral into many other issues."

↳ **@hestadickeos6043 (5):** "You really have it tough! 😞 I care for my husband who has Parkinsons, and it's stressful, emotionally draining, and the responsibility after having raised 4 children and two grandchildren is overwhelming. I'm 70, and suffer from chronic back and hip pain, so physically it's difficult also. You have it harder than me. My heart goes out to you 💜"

"Or they moved away from their own parents and therefore weren't around to do the caregiving. My parents moved halfway across the country when I was small and we saw my paternal grandparents once a year and talked on the phone maybe once a month. I had next to no relationship with my maternal grandmother (maternal grandfather died in his early 50s of cancer) for very valid reasons. But that geographic distance meant that when Dad's parents were in their later years, it was his sister who was local who shouldered the burden of coordinating

medical care and moving them into assisted living/memory care - not the brothers who had left decades earlier. My parents did literally *nothing* when it came to their elderly parents' last years. This is probably why when Dad was declining from late and end stage dementia, my mother had rather unrealistic expectations of me and my willingness and ability to do hands-on caregiving. She had cared for her own father in the last few months of his life and expected that I would do the same "because that's what daughters DO". She completely ignored that when she did that she was 20, single and childless, and living at home while going to nursing school. Meanwhile, when Dad was declining, I was in my mid 40s, with a demanding full time job and raising my own two children with my husband, living 40 minutes away from them."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p047bx2/

"24/7 Care at dad's home 800 miles away from my family. Not sure this goes anywhere, I just need to scream into the void. Currently on day 5 of 24/7 care for my father after his discharge from skilled nursing/rehab. It's honestly been hell. Love my dad a ton, but being away from my family 800 miles away for another period that I have no idea how long it will be, or even if he'll make a recovery to be able to live on his own again. In addition, the level of care he needs while I try and work remote is just impossible. I've posted here before - TLDR my 63 year old father who was inactive/didn't take care of himself fell getting out of his chair just before Thanksgiving, broke his femur, found aneurism and operated on it, which then created blood flow issues to the leg. Got out, did 2 weeks of full inpatient PT, ended up at my uncle's where he declined more, incontinent due to so much surgery/anesthesia, then got septic infection in his surgical wound. Back into the hospital for 3 weeks while they wash the wound and fight infection, then discharged for 21 days to SNF where he was getting 1 hour a day of PT. He's about 240 pounds and can barely stand on his own. Hasn't taken more than 3 of 4 steps that I've seen. Anytime he moves, I have to help him get up. He's been in a hospital bed for a month and when factoring in PT and his stay at his brothers, this has been going on for 3 months. He's gotten super weak so I have to help him do everything. Getting into the car and out of the car for doctor appointments is SO hard. His catheter was removed, which I had to do at home at the request of the doctor to avoid ER visit, and he's having trouble controlling the bladder when he is sleeping. After zero breaks, moving him around for the better part of a week, I woke up to another completely soaked bed, him naked (he still can't dress himself because he can't reach his feet), and poop smeared on the sheets. Get him up and on the portable toilet to finish and he says he can't reach to wipe. He absolutely can - kindly tell him "you could reach before, those arms haven't shrunk. Try and position yourself". Thankfully he finally got it. He can't take a shower in his house because the wheelchair won't fit in the bathroom door. He is scared to take the 3-4 steps with a walker to make it to the shower chair. He doesn't have hardly any funds, so moving him into a facility is something I'd have to cover until his home sold, and even then at current costs, he MAY get a year, year and a half of funds to live there. We've talked about backup plans, moving him to my area so I could care for him and still work and be with my family, but if he can't live alone, he'd have to go into some type of facility. He's said he'd rather die, he'd kill himself if that were the case, etc.. Even if/when I do move him, finding a new care team to check the broken leg healing, vascular team, oncologist for the cancer on his liver they've also found, psychiatrist, how to navigate all that with either his current crappy medicare advantage plan or getting a new plan... it seems like a MASSIVE undertaking where he'd have to stay in my home. Oh, and my home is full of stairs and on a mountain. Currently have a team looking at building a ramp and path so he could even get in. So I'm here working remotely, caring for him as best as I can and waiting on him hand and foot. I'm not sure how long it'll last. No idea what to do next - I highly doubt he'll get to where he can live and do things on his own if he can't even take 3-4 steps now. The vascular issue has caused his leg to feel like numb, dead weight. Our healthcare system in the US is absolute shit. Senior care if you don't have money is absolute shit. A parent that's made negligent choices for 30+ years now depending on me while my family and job also depend on me is shit. Cleaning up pee and poop is shit. I'm just fucking done and there's no end in sight."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rgg1q7/247_care_at_dads_home_800_miles_away_from_my/

"I can relate to this. My mom is 84 and does live in a retirement community. I have a sibling who does nothing and is essentially estranged from her, except when it comes to birthdays and Christmas and then she reaches out with the list of things her family wants as gifts. I wish I were exaggerating... My dad was her soulmate and best friend and since he died a couple of years ago she has been sad, fragile, cranky and lonely. I do my best to be there for her but I live 3 hours away, work full time, have animals and a house to care for, and a kid with a lot of health issues that takes up a lot of my time. I am about to drive to go spend 4 days with her and do lots of tasks for her. I am equipped with a lot of weed which makes her incessant talking as well as the 1.5 hour ordeals that meals have become more bearable. (She is very formal and eats verrrrrryyy slowly and I have adhd and it is all I can do not to scream FINISH ALREADY) When I open a book she still stands over me talking. She will sometimes say "oh, I know you're trying to read" and then continues on with her talking. Every phone call becomes 45 min minimum. I often call her on the way home from work so there will be a natural ending to the call - ok, I'm home, love you, gotta go. Instead I'll sit in my driveway idling for like 15 minutes while she keeps going oh one more thing, oh, I also forgot to tell you ... She repeats stories constantly and many of them are incorrect and I know this because they directly involve me. I have learned just to smile and nod and zone out. Last summer I went up to visit her many, many times in a 2 month period and she talks about it as though I never came. It sometimes feels like it's never enough. She guilt trips my kids, who love her but who have the same issues - it's torture to be talked at constantly and to sit through endless meals (we all have adhd) and be judged for everything. She comments on every outfit they wear, every bite of food they eat, has very specific ideas about how everyone should behave and is very critical when we don't meet those expectations. I do text her daily and I try to call at least once a week. I dread the calls so much; I hate talking on the phone in general and sitting still is torture for me. I love her, and she's incredibly tiresome, and I'm really scared about how this is all going to go in the future, as the clinginess is getting worse. I'm trying so hard to be a good daughter to her. She also adamantly refused to move closer to us, which is her right, but man- it puts a huge strain on me. I wish I could stop in for 30 min with some soup I made, quick visit and then leave, as opposed to those endless marathon visits of being talked at."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_often/p21ruccl/

"A friend got scared at the last minute and decided for a battery replacement in his pacemaker instead of just letting nature take its course. Now, he is glued to his chair, homebound and miserable as ever. Swollen calves, weeping leg wounds. Takes handfuls of pills day and night all for what? To prolong his misery? He's 92. Sundowning. But alert enough during the day to swig his beer and whiskey. I'm mindblown that anyone would want to prolong their life to live in this state. Oh, and the taxpayers are footing the \$100k yearly ER bills for emergency gallbladder / flu care / home health nurse etc. visits. Thank you Medicare Advantage, I guess??? I'm with Jack. I'm out. I'm not urinating all over myself so my kids have to deal with me. No thanks!!!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oc9nj0i/

"My parents are like this except I'm 32. They are divorced but expect me to be more hands on and present helping my declining mom. Like, I am too young to quit my job, or go down to part time, or backslide into minimum wage retail job."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/o2zlyrp/

Siblings who don't help · 44 documents

20 most engaged of 44 matching documents, complete text.

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial

blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I am done. She's not my problem anymore. I quit.. Update 3: I took several days to think and cool down. I had told my husband he didn't need to confront his mom because she won't change. She'll just pull the "my heart" card to get him to back off. He would never forgive himself if she did end up in the hospital over him chewing her out. He has talked to her before about her attitude to me a few years ago. So this is nothing new. The venom from her this time was new. I realized while thinking, the venom started after her stroke a year and a half ago. Strokes change people. I let my husband know I am not heartless. If she called with a problem I could fix, I would go over and fix it. But if she is wanting me to drive her to the hospital at 2 am because she doesn't want EMTs in her house, i won't do it. She can get one of his brothers up to take her if my husband can't. She knows I don't sleep well and am often up that late. She has almost called me before but then chose not too. She wouldn't feel as badly about calling at 2 am in an emergency since I'm most likely awake. But so far she has talked herself out of it. I told him I am not going over to just check on her and visit anymore. I do not want or need the extra drama in my life. I do not have to put up with being yelled at just because she's made at everyone else or the world in general. I'm sorry there is no great dramatic ending to my post. Yes, I wish my husband had gone over and laid into her verbally. It would have made me feel better. But it wouldn't have accomplished anything but cause issues for him. So I am choosing to not cause him that stress. \----- Update 2: Husband is mad at her because he just talked to her about this exact problem within the last 6 months. Last time I just took it and came home. He is processing about the way he wants to handle it. Tomorrow we've got stuff to do, so he's going to avoid her while he thinks. Honestly, I told him it won't do any good to talk to her. She won't take accountability. She's not going to tell him we had a fight. I asked him to let me know what what is going on when he talks to her. He promised he would. I also told him she has been nasty to me more than he hears. I just took it because I love him and want to help his stress level. He feels terrible because he knows how his mother can be. I said to him, to me the problem is solved. I'm done. She pushed so hard that she gets what she thinks she wants which is for me to go away. He understands. She played that game with him, too. Like he said he stopped going over for 2 weeks when she did that and things fell apart because the rest don't pay attention or think. I'm still done and I told him that. \---- Update 1: Husband got back to me and apologized for the way she treated me. He said he'll be arguing with her this tomorrow over this. I told him ok, but I won't change my mind about helping her or setting foot in her house. In a week or two she'll be asking him if I'm ok because she hasn't seen me in a while. I told him to tell her the truth. I'm done because of her. She refuses to take responsibility for her actions and words. SO that'll be a fun conversation for him. /s \---- My MIL is fighting any and all help. She resents not being able to do things and won't let people help her. I have been going over once or twice a week just to ask if she needs anything. If she says no I back off. Her BS

is affecting my mental health and she's not my mother. I was doing it to help my husband with his stress because his brothers don't help much. My therapist told me to back off and I have. I can't talk about her to my therapist anymore because she is a mandatory reporter and MIL is on the line for my therapist to have to report her. All week my SIL and BIL have been at my MILs house. The needed to get a window replaced and the guy wouldn't do it unless it was in a garage. They also gave a 6 hour window. So SIL and her daughter stayed from 12-6 twice. My SIL is a very in charge type of person. So she did what she wanted at MILs house despite my MIL asking her not to. MIL won't let her anger out on anyone but me. So she wasn't forceful with the SIL. She just sat back and let my SIL push her around. She had some distant cousins come in mid-week and they stayed all day too. Then her neighbor was moving some of his stuff out of his house at 9 pm. That was keeping her dogs up so she couldn't sleep. I went over today to see if MIL had a grocery list for my husband on his way home from work. She unloaded on me today. I got defensive and reminded her I ask before doing anything. She said I don't and everyone wants to control her life. She also accused me of getting defensive. I told her I was because I let her do her thing. She kept interrupting me and raised her voice at me. I finally told her that my therapist told me to back off. She told me good and I need to listen to her because she doesn't need anyone's help. I offered to tell my husband to let her get her own groceries. She said that's different because we know she can't drive. I got mad. And left. She told me that is my choice. I told her I am mad and she is mad and we don't need to be talking with when we're mad. I texted my husband at work and let him know what was going on. I was venting and called his mom some choice names. He told me I don't have to convince him because he knows how she is and he'll handle it tomorrow. He prefers to get told at work in text so he's not getting unloaded on when he gets home. I'm done. I won't set foot in her house ever again. If she calls I'll tell her to call 911 or one of her sons. If my husband is home, he's getting the phone. I'm my MILs only friend. She has now tore the bridge down and set it on fire."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 189 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_proble
m_anymore_i_quit/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_proble_m_anymore_i_quit/)

"So Angry at My Dad. My 95 yr old father DROVE 5 days after being admitted to ER observation overnight because he fell in a parking lot ... he also dragged my mother down to the ground when he fell. I moved from another state to help them as they age and they never called to tell me until day AFTER they fell. Lots of bruising, pain/aches, immobility etc but neither of them broke anything but we discussed that he would not be driving until he goes to dr for follow- up. He can't put weight on his right leg. And he drove. My mother lied to me about it. (He lies so often that I'm used to it.) On thanksgiving when I told him he can't drive again until his follow-up appt in 5 days he started to lash out and asked me to leave Thanksgiving. As in get out of the house. I left. I had zero alcohol. Planned what I was going to stay and was very calm. Doesn't matter. He just lost it. I really regret moving back as these two are impossible. I know I have to deal with them but I am so angry at their refusal to listen to common sense, not telling me they were both in ER when I loved back FOR THIS REASON, how he hurt my mother because he refuses to use a cane or walker, and the lies. And the verbal abuse. Oh and how he might hit an innocent person and ruin someone's life, or take someone's life. How do I not be angry when they are so challenging and impossible. He has always been a full-on jerk but getting worse now. I know I don't deserve being yelled at and eating Thanksgiving dinner in a diner alone. I have read a ton about dealing with narcissistic people but I am still so angry. HOW am I supposed to handle them? My sister is In another state. There is no one else here to help. He has alienated other family and not a big family in the first place."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 178 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p9fn38/so_angry_at_my_dad/

"Both of my parents died young, but my father stayed in end stage heart failure for years. In his last year, he lost the ability to walk but refused a care facility. I couldn't get him admitted myself. So i cared for him with no help from siblings or any family. I was only 39 with 2 toddlers and a full time job. It was absolutely the most horrendous and damaging experience of my life. I felt i was getting ill myself. Sure enough, 2 years later i was diagnosed with breast cancer. I wasnt the least bit surprised. We need a solution to this problem of care, it's not sustainable."

youtube · @limo5724 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 159 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwXJzaMFh7d-YG8do94AaABAq

↳ **@obstantiadiscindo (35)**: "@limo5724 Our parents didn't have to do this for their parents - people live longer now, but in poorer health, and dementia too. The current system doesn't work. Sometimes the carer dies before the parent. I don't know how you did it with 2 toddlers too. I hope your health improves and you regain your joy of life."

↳ **@jdmmg4904 (28)**: "Absolutely selfish decision from your father to burden you like that:("

↳ **@elizabethk3238 (17)**: "Too many selfish parents expecting their children to fully care for them. If they took care of themselves they will strong and self supporting till death. I'm 78, spend my limited pension on eating well, taking the supplements that will help keep me strong, exercise regularly, keep my mind alert. I cared for my parents for years, I will NEVER put my children through that."

"I just refused a lump sum cash gift from my mom.. Today I was visiting my mom (79, in independent assisted living and on the doorstep of needing LTC because she is maxed out on what private nursing can provide with her numerous health and mobility challenges). She told me she is considering giving my younger brother and I (her only children) a lump sum cash payment to "help us out." Here is where this is coming from... Four years ago my brother was on a reckless path and my elderly parents (both were alive at the time, RIP Dad at age 82 in 2025) gave him \$65-70K to "fix" things with no strings attached. It was a gift. They asked me to please respect their decision and to simply "understand because a parent would do anything for their children." My parents did this before asking my brother to tap into his own resources. They felt strongly that he should maintain his assets and the simple lifestyle he had. After three years, my parents finally stopped paying for my brother's expenses, largely because I pleaded this was enabling and was getting out of hand. To add to the stress, it was becoming clear that long term care was in the future for our Dad and it is now very close for our Mom. My brother still wanted many thousands of dollars more and when my parents finally said "no," he exhausted his meager savings (he is middle-aged) and he is now in debt. Our mom is aware that paying off this debt is a slow and painful process for my brother, but he is doing it. She also knows my family and I are completely self-sufficient. Anyway, our mom then asked me what I would think if she were to give me and my brother each a lump sum payment "because it could really help us out." My "enabler" alarm went off because of the huge amount of cash my parents already gifted my brother. It is not to come out of his inheritance. I wondered if there would be any end to this if i accepted her money. My dad articulated that his dying wish for me was to make sure my younger brother is never homeless. Sadly, that says a lot about the dynamics. My "enmeshed behaviour" alarm went off next because I have experienced transactional treatment from both our mom and dad; specifically their regular reminders I would one day inherit a nice piece of my mom's jewelry "for all I do for them." I was actively involved in both our dad's and now only mom's caregiving. I live very nearby Mom's assisted living facility, but I have a family of my own and am always honest about my capacity. My approach to caregiving is sustainable, finally, after several intense years of my parents' very real medical emergencies and rapid declines. I have to constantly be on guard because my parents have always treated me as an extension of themselves. I replied that I don't need any money and am not in financial difficulty. I can afford what I need. I suggested that if she wants to give my brother an early gift of inheritance she needs to get her Will redone so the early gift is recognized and accounted for to be fair. She said she didn't want to change her Will. It would either be we both get money early or neither of us do. I know my brother is struggling financially (not my monkey, not my circus) but I feel like our mom is trying to manipulate me. I am the family scapegoat because I have boundaries around my time/energy/conversation topics/etc. I am also her only child that has ever been dependable, consistent and taken on caregiving for her and Dad. My brother is the golden child who always has some trouble to be solved but is just such a busy and great guy who is sensitive and sweet. He can go weeks to months without calling her and is still wonderful because things are just so hard for him and he can't help it. My mom's money feels dirty and for me, I feel like it would just exacerbate the extremely

transactional treatment I receive from her. She says that if I don't want to accept her "gift" then my brother won't get one either. And like the scapegoat I am... I am okay with that. Thanks for listening to me vent. \\UPDATE\\ Hours after I made my original post, my mom told me she wants to meet with her financial advisor in a couple of weeks to review her investments and asked me if I want to come. I might try to leverage the advisor, alert her about my brother and the risk of financial abuse and tell her about mom's plan to give lump sum payments. I would try to get the advisor to lay out my mom's financial reality to both of us. We already know it but it might as well be part of the conversation as a reminder. My hope is the advisor would discourage my mom from getting used as a bank. I would hope that if Mom still wants to give my brother and I cash gifts, the advisor would encourage payments dispersed over time (with a limit) to both my brother and I as opposed to lump sums, explain the benefits of a professional trust and help Mom lay out a plan. This absolutely won't stop the emotional manipulation I receive from my mom and I don't expect it to or for her to change in any way. It will not stop my mom from feeling the itch to help my brother by giving him more lump sums on top of it. About every 6 months my brother implies need and my mom gets the itch for a while and scratches. Dad did too. More Context: I should add that though my parents stopped giving my brother large lump sums 12-18 months ago, my mom (who hasn't driven in a couple of years) gave my brother her 10 year old vehicle about 10 months ago. This vehicle was previously kept in underground parking at her residence and I used it to drive her to her appointments because she can't get into our trucks. She paid for the maintenance/parking/fuel/insurance and I managed the logistics and took it for servicing, washes, fuel ups and cleaned it. My brother lives 350 km away. Now she will only go to an appointment if her residence's complimentary courtesy car is available. This service only provides door to door drop off and pick up, no escorting. Her mobility is terrible and she uses a walker but her physio says she needs a wheelchair for going out. That is the second physio to say so, btw. She refuses to get one (it would be fully funded thanks to government grant for disabled people!) and so I stopped meeting her and the courtesy car at her appointments. She only leaves for appointments (not shopping/errands/coffee/dining out at all). Sometimes she goes alone, which her doctor and RN in charge of her case say she absolutely shouldn't do, but she has occasionally hired a health care aide to accompany her through the private nursing company she uses. Telling history that shows how longstanding these patterns of thought are: 25 years ago my mom and aunt worked together to have my Grandma write my uncle out of Grandma's Will. Uncle was divorced, retired and a live-in part-time carer to supplement the publically funded home care Grandma received. Grandma paid for his divorce, bought him a car, paid for his holidays and he lived rent free. However, he cooked, did the yard care for her house, drove her to appointments, picked up prescriptions, etc. Sometimes my grandma wasn't happy because he picked up casual work related to his previous profession, when she wanted him to be home and she wanted him to do more. Mom and Auntie thought he was getting a free ride and convinced my grandma to write him out of her Will. I was a newly minted adult at this time, just finished university and I thought this might be a unique scenario or that maybe my uncle wasn't helping enough but this way of thinking has persisted and I have come to doubt the "lore" around caregiving for my grandma. This is the context I have in the background in caregiving for my mother. *Edited to fix a typo and to note I am not in the US."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v3spn7/i_just_refused_a_lump_sum_cash_gift_from_my_mom/

"My siblings and I call these "love tests." "Does it make you uncomfortable? Well, if you really loved me you would do it anyway. You must not love me." Our mother has never met a boundary she didn't try to cross."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 88 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/osudywf/

"[Vent] I'm so tired of being the only adult in my situation.. I've lurked a while, but I'm struggling today. My mother (71) still works as a teacher, and takes care of my declining father (76) every other moment of every day. My brother (38) lives at home, but has developmental challenges. I (32) live three hours away from them and seem to be the only rational adult in this relationship. My father isn't caring for himself. It's to the point that he

sits in wet and soiled clothing instead of getting up and transferring to the potty chair. He doesn't wash himself, or really do anything but lay or sit in bed all day. It's to the point that I and my therapist both have called Elder protective services, and he refuses to engage with the social worker. Does more movement in the hour that she's over turning his back to her no matter where she appears in his line of sight than at any other time. Over the summer he suddenly refused to see his GP who he's seen for 40 years, blaming him for vaguely "not helping him" when the answer was for Dad to start OT and use a mobility aid. Refuses to use the walker, crutches, a cane, or wheelchair still to this day. Only doctor we can get him in with is a geriatric specialist, except he wasn't available until November, so all progress on dementia diagnosis, or the steps we need to have legally before we can appoint a guardian stopped cold while we wait on this specialist. My mother is running ragged, but won't schedule home healthcare to come because it will cause a fight. Won't call mental health services on him for his state, and doesn't ask for a psychiatric hold at any of their near weekly ER trips from when he's fallen. My brother does the best he can to help my dad when he's not at work, but they've never gotten along. My dad has never been a good or kind man, and I understand why my brother doesn't want to show him kindness now. The social worker involved now is kind, but keeps saying that because my mom is there and caring for him, her hands are tied, though admits that they need home health care. So finally I called home health care, and am having to get a ride three hours back home to be there when they come to arrange care because my mother will not take time off work to do it, and didn't do it when school was out over the summer. The one good thing about having the social worker is that he's actually doing random attempts to show he's caring for himself, so maybe he'll turn it around, except he's already fallen twice trying to make it to the toilet, in the last week, still won't use the potty chair Well now my dad hates me again, which fine, whatever at least he can't physically harm me anymore, but is threatening to get a restraining order if I go through with the home healthcare business. I don't know HOW he'd get one. I don't know how any judge would look at this situation and say "yeah, you're right sir your child is out to get you by paying for home health care to come out and help you with tasks you can't do yourself" Oh, and all of Dad's cousins are now somehow involved as of today, telling me I'm a terrible kid for doing this to my father. At what point is it no longer my circus? I walked away from this circus years ago, but no one else involved is freaking willing to actually take actions so that my mom and brother don't wake up one morning to find my father dead in the garage from some wild hair idea that he should go for a walk at 3 in the morning, or get home to work to him dead in the bathroom because he fell and cracked his head open the one time he actually attempted to go to the toilet instead of just soiling himself. I think the part that makes me the angriest is my mother hid how bad things were getting from me so I wasn't able to do something sooner. I don't know if it's just denial that her husband of 50 years is going, or that she can handle it all by herself or what, but I'm tired of being the only one looking at this situation for how batshit crazy it is."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/17btuoo/vent_im_so_tired_of_being_the_only_adult_in_my/

"Burned Out & Beat Up!. Ok so this is a rant! A long one. If you read it thanks if it's too much I get it. I'm putting this down for myself as much to get it off my chest and lighten my mind/stress I guess. But first background: I'm usually an upbeat person, always have been, always look on the bright side, acknowledge the fact that others are in worse situations than me, so as to keep myself aware (centered/in-check). I stay clear of Debbie Downers, Negative Nelly's, and KARENS too. Those type folks suck the life right out of you. Sorry I wish them well, it's just life is way too short for all that drama. So my husband and I retired a few years back. Both of us started working when we were teenagers, like a lot of our generation, so we retired early. Now: So we, newly retired, like right out of the gate retired, no celebratory vacation either, and we become full time care givers to my mother. We all "decided/chose" to move in together into a new house, not newly built but perfect for our physical needs especially for my mother. She was fine when we moved in, of course very sad to sell/give up her home, but she said she knew it was the right decision and it's what God wanted/planned for her/us. Her only alternative was a nursing home, because physically she couldn't live in an assisted living facility because she requires too much assistance/care. She couldn't live in our old home because we had stairs and no bedroom suite on the first floor. Plus she couldn't

continue paying for PT private home health care because she now needed FT care and not enough \$\$ to pay for it. Side note.....all those supplemental insurance commercials advertising how they can help the elderly age in place (at home) it's all bullshit! I They DO NOT offer COVERED in-home care or drivers to take them to and from doctor appointments. The elderly still pay out of pocket one way or the other either high insurance premiums or straight out of their checking/savings accounts. So they'd have no money left over to pay for basic needs like food and utilities. AND my mother was already paying a monthly premium for additional/supplemental insurance coverage. AND those special services offered via city/county "Offices on Aging", well most won't qualify because they make too much \$ annually. For example in my mom's situation, she receives a retirement pension, SS, and Medicare benefits due to her age. Yes I called the office and no she doesn't qualify. I also asked about the services listed for support of family care givers like the babysitting your elderly parent services so caregivers can get a break. Well nope don't qualify for that either cause she makes too much money. How you wonder does she make too much money. Well because the ENTIRE households income is accounted/calculated for qualification of city/county services. Yep that's right my husband's and my annual retirement pensions was added to her annual income for a total of "SHE" makes too much! We don't get paid for providing her physical care, monthly expenses, reimbursement for gas or vehicle wear and tear to get her to her doctor appointments, yet you'll add our retirement income to her income. Wow! Yes I love my mother dearly. Anyway.....now to today. She isn't the same person at all. In fact I've realized she wasn't the person I thought I knew for years. Its kind of pissed me off honestly. She had issues that needed to be addressed years ago! That damn generation and sweeping crap under their rugs ugh! So on her nasty days she loves to tell us the following comments: you've got it made, you made out, blah blah. We've got it made!!!! What the fuck is she talking about. We gave up our lives to care for her! She's another full time job, basically, and we don't receive any salary. She is selfish, hateful, ungrateful, hurtful to me and my husband for all the care we give her. Remember she was adamant that she didn't want to go into a nursing home and I/we didn't want that for her either. I'd feel guilty as hell putting her in one of them. Plus she always brought up how one of her older relatives was put in a horrible nursing home, and each time my folks visited, the lady would beg them to take her with them. Mom always said how she wasn't even in her immediate family and questioned whether the lady's family visited her. Plus I promised my dad before he passed that I'd take care of my mom. Now remember I said everything started out great in the beginning. I had a great child hood growing up with my mother albeit as I got older I realized she had some weird quirks but I didn't know what exactly. She wasn't crazy and I do not mean that in a mean way I'm being serious. But I strongly feel that because these "quirks" never got addressed by either therapy, a doctor or with meds it just festered and may have laid the ground work for what she's got now which is psychosis from Parkinson's of which she does not accept. And NO she doesn't have dementia, she is cognizant, passes those doctor tests still today. She's bitter and blames us for her issues.....all of them, everything, whatever she's mad about it's mine or our fault. To everyone else she puts on the sweet little old lady persona and acts like a normal old person. To us she's rarely the sweet lady anymore instead we never know what/who/how she'll act on any given day. She lies constantly, won't take accountability for her part/role in disagreements and we totally believe she likes to stir things up, start things on purpose. If she hears us laughing having a good day, and she's miserable well it's like she has to try and ruin our good mood. Remember I'm a positive person, and she is not ever. Again in regard to Dementia, no she doesn't have it. She's aware of what she's doing especially the change in demeanor when other people are around. It's just sickening! Why do I keep mentioning this well it's because people always assume and say to me "well she's obviously got dementia" ugh SMH!!! So I guess in closing I'm offering a bit of advice to you. When faced with or contemplating having your parent move in with you, while they are great right now, consider the possibility that down the road you may be faced with caring for someone you no longer recognize. In our case the changes happened within a short time, maybe a little over a year of moving in together. To those younger than us that have young kids still living at home think real hard because the dynamics of your lives can and will drastically change. If you have siblings sit down with them and say we won't do this if you aren't on board with helping/supporting in his/her care. I'm an only

child and it just drives me crazy when siblings will not help out. They know they dodged a bullet and in secret are giving a double bird salute at the situation. Thanks for letting me vent/ramble on. The last few days have been awful trying."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ph84g3/burned_out_beat_up/

"Impossible Situation. 50F with Silent Generation parents who are 85 and almost 88. They live in New York State. My mother is almost completely blind from Central Retinal Vein Occlusion that occurred in late 2021 and may have been brought on by many years of glaucoma. She was an excellent patient, always doing exactly what the doctor recommended and keeping up with her eye appointments. Her vision loss is tragic and she has very little interest in living. She is also showing signs of dementia (wailing, nagging, repeating the same questions, worrying about odd things like the alarm clock malfunctioning). Otherwise, however, she's in good physical health. My dad has been her sole caregiver and it's taking a big toll on him. He's great cognitively, but needs hearing aids and is having trouble with balance. He went for a few physical therapy sessions, but stopped around the holidays. He still drives and insists on going out whenever he wants, which is often at night. I live 1.5 hours away and have offered, asked, begged, pleaded and done everything short of showing up unannounced to get them to accept my help. My 48M brother lives 5 minutes from them and doesn't do anything for them other than clear their car when it snows. Of course, they don't/won't ask him for help either. Their situation is a ticking time bomb that has me gripped with anxiety on a daily basis. They have very little money, a condo that is mortgaged (but only in my mom's name), no wills, no POA, no burial plans except a vague notion that there is a plot for them in a cemetery 2 hours away that my late paternal grandmother bought in the 1950s! I got them to sign HIPAA releases and healthcare proxies, but there is no plan for any type of emergency. I called my mom's PCP and mentioned her cognitive symptoms, but the nurse said she denied anxiety or depression at her last wellness checkup. The nurse told me that a neurologist would need to diagnose dementia, so I made an appointment for my mom in April. Will she go? I highly doubt it. I recently had a one-hour free consultation with an elder law attorney. My brother didn't want to pay any lawyer that charged a consultation fee and then was "too busy" to attend the Zoom meeting. The lawyer said my mother needs to get on Medicaid and offered to fill out and file the application...for \$15,750. Getting on Medicaid would allow her to have a home health aide, but the likelihood of my mom agreeing to that is very low. Additionally, my dad is a hoarder and the condo is in disrepair, so the lawyer said Medicaid won't even approve them for an aide because a home visit is part of the process. If anything big or little happens to my dad, I don't know what will become of my mom. I live in a different state and am not equipped to care for a blind person with dementia. My brother seems to think that my husband and I should take her in, even telling me that we could "get a chair lift." Also, despite the lawyer telling me that freewill.com is a scam (?), my brother insists that documents we print off the internet will be sufficient for creating wills and POAs. He's cheap as the day is long and I cannot pay for things unless we go 50/50. I love my parents dearly and have been really struggling with anticipatory grief on top of all these practical concerns. I worry about them constantly and have begun praying that God has mercy on my mom and calls her home first. I'm glad I found this community and am open to any kind suggestions."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iyze4a/impossible_situation/

"Thank you for this. My 92 year old mother with late stage dementia is in a facility. My siblings never visit her. My mother was widowed young and very independent. She didn't want to be a burden on anyone. I feel a small amount of guilt that I don't care for her at home but I have college age kids and a husband who's just retired and wants to travel. I visit several times a week. You reminded me how my mom would not have wanted me to sacrifice my family life for her. Plus I don't have the skills for it. By visiting regularly, the staff knows someone is active in her care and I believe it makes them give her the attention she deserves. It's a very challenging situation that comes with lots of guilt. I know my mom is getting great care and I get to have more fun with her when I am visiting her."

youtube · @lbanducci · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxtNyJPdSxxCIX0DQt4AaABAq

↳ **@laurawright7477** (3): "You did the right thing! What most of us would love to be able to do. When financial problems prevent that kind of care..those of us that have no choice ...suffer."

↳ **@piecelow2726** (1): "Your doing the right thing. Nothing to feel guilty about."

"This sounds exactly like the situation im dealing with lately. Since 2010 my 80 year old father is depending on me more, and more plus they took his drivers liscense away this year which i agree with DMV's call too many accidents.. As for my father he is stubborn he wont use Uber, Lift, or and Taxi service at all. Thats just the ride needs only besides other needs... I feel very overwhelmed sometimes plus my brother wont lift a finger to help. Im 44 years old juggling a job, and taking on this resposibility is causing me those stress/anxiety burnout symptoms, i went from a healthy tip top shape athletic type to being on blood pressure meds/anxiety meds too never took meds at all before this situation. My level of resentment towards my brother is growing more, sometimes i feel like just going to another State leaving this situation behind me. I feel like just because i worked hard in life, and stayed single this is now a responsibilty put on my shoulder. Latlely i had to take time off work, but i still feel very tired, and drained. Thank you for this video..."

youtube · @nicks4112 · *The Toll That Caring For Elderly Parents Can Take* · 21 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2kM35JxnTow&lc=UgzETW9hGAhmr2DkzfJ4AaABAq>

↳ **@lyndapierson6338** (2): "to nick s i'm a retired rn and ended up having to care for my 87 yr old mom. my brothers live far from me. they have little to do with this extremely difficult situation. i am constantly stressed, get depressed and find having patience more difficult. my mom has short term memory loss, becomes angry if i even mention it. she has become paranoid at times. she insists that she can still drive. i tried to hook her up with our local ride services which worked 2 times because she got into a fight with the driver after having refused to wear a seatbelt! now, i take her shopping, etc. which, fortunately, everything is close by. i now collect IHSS income which has been a God send. but i pray everyday for the inner strength to carry on. you must take things day by day. consider IHSS via social services - this may help ease financial stress. i hope you gain strength. i wish you well! lynda pierson"

↳ **@bushidooffaith4706** (0): "@lyndapierson6338 good luck my carer warrior partner, we both battle in the same war an it's hard at times. The way I think when their mind is not right so to speak, I always remind myself keep them out of your mind, but strong in your heart. Because the reason we do what we do is because we love them, that's the most important thing to remember it helps me a lot. I pray every night for strength to all us carers I hope it reaches you.💛 "

↳ **@lyndapierson6338** (0): "@bushidooffaith4706 your words provide so much comfort deep thanks"

"This hits. That's why I got out. After bashing my head into the shower enough times, my brain started processing things a little differently. I didn't even communicate it. I just left. And I don't feel bad. I started taking care of my mom physically and mentally when I was 6 years old. At 30 I broke. Literally just broke and wanted us to both be dead. My siblings never helped. Her husband never helped. Her doctors never actually helped. It was all on me to drop my entire life and be her caretaker. 3 years later, I'm in the healthiest relationship of my life. Taken time away from taking care of her and working full-time. Fortunately I have a partner that understood and has given me the space to "find" myself and work through all of my trauma. During this time my brother has had to pick up the slack and has been mistreating our mother. His rude kid reached out to me recently to basically shit on me for leaving. I don't care and it doesn't phase me to not have any contact with those people. Funny enough, because my mom realized I wasn't going to come back and save the day, she's "gotten better" to an extent. I feel used and like no one even values what I did for so many years. Learning to let that all go. Happily pregnant with a baby that I plan on having (previously had 2 abortions because there was no way I could take care of her and a kid while in

shitty relationships) - also because of her, I never wanted kids. I'm happy I didn't end my life and I just said fuck it, it will either work out or it won't. I'm never going to let anyone make me feel bad for leaving. The years I did help, it's not like anyone appreciated me anyways. Now they just notice my absence. I too wish there was a system in place for what OP suggested. Our world would be a better place. But we're living during times that our administration doesn't care about the people that need assistance. We need a change in our administration and our policies. Because unfortunately not everyone can just leave like I did. Be it their finances, the shame that comes with it, or the support from at least one person, or the literal million other reasons. After I give birth I'm going to get a degree in Grant & Proposal Writing for Health and Medicine to hopefully make changes for others who are thrown into caregiving at a young age / any age... that is my goal anyways."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobvsl7/

"I am in a similar situation with my mom however I have a brother who is the Golden Child. My mom is in fair health but has back issues and my stepdad has Parkinson's. They are both at home, stepdad been to physical rehab twice this year and comes home and my mom does not take their advice of needing walker for him to use or install safety bars in bathroom. He keeps falling and it's a big burden. I am 6 hours from her and at my wits end. She won't listen to me of getting him VA care which would help her financially as well. Not sure what else I can do at this point. I'm sorry you are going through a situation as well."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/oqn1l97/

"Similar situation here. My parents nice house started to fall in on itself. Mom checked out and started drinking and leaving my immobile dad in bad situations. No help from siblings. I've lost a bit of my career to move back to my home state and take care of them. I have them in a house 5 mins away. Feels like I'm being waterboarded at times. One problem fixed and another arises. My dad is on a waiting list to get into the best place their insurance will help cover, but his needs seem to increase daily and I can't keep up. A lot of their money is going towards private care. It's still not enough to cover their needs. You're right, no one prepares you for this. Something as simple as maintaining long term healthcare insurance goes a long way. Good luck to everyone dealing with these things. I never knew it could or would be this stressful."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/o5cyn16/

"Well I also get it from my brother who was the baby and the only male so is the golden child and my dad's BEST FRIEND. I get told I should be visiting every other day and every weekend and stuff like that. He's just as nasty as my dad if not WORSE. Says things like 'you'd think a good person would do it for a GOOD FATHER' and stuff like that. Don't get me wrong, my dad was pretty good when I was a kid but went downhill faster and faster starting about 10 years ago. Now it's just non stop grievances, complaints, lamenting about the past, threats if things don't go as he likes, and so on. And he has my brother enabling all of this. But yeah I just help at a distance when I can."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tftnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op6m8zx/

"I'm going to take a flying stab here and say you are the second daughter. My eldest sister was the beloved one and I was constantly trying to impress my mother and make her proud. It will NEVER happen. And that's not on you. That's on HER. Make her leave before she destroys your sanity. And have zero guilt on it. You are her black sheep/the scapegoat. The sister is the golden child. You will never change that in her eyes. But if you stop caring for her and allow the sister to do it mum might realise her love is misguided."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tftnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op6m8zx/

"I stopped my nursing career. Ended up caregiving for 5 family members. Lost my 2 best friends during Covid. Im exhausted and lost track of taking care of myself. My children and grandchildren live in another state. (2000 miles) i would love to be spending more time visiting them. But im in this with caring for my parents. My sibling does not help at all. Anyway, really getting my stress down and made some progress. Finally got to stop a bit and get to my doctor's appointments. Burned out. Got selfish and put my care for front and followed through. Balancing and putting yourself first, is really so important!"

youtube · @keariewashburn4680 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive I Dave Nassaney I TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 8 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=Ugyj9ZbPiCGtFZtdKe14AaABAg>

"Please say no to your mom!!! If she refuses to live with you, then she can stay in her home until it's too dangerous and she finally admits it! My mother lived with my husband and I. I'd been her caregiver after my father passed away. Nothing I did was good enough, and the two 'Golden Child' siblings could do no wrong. I had to pay my sister to stay with her when we were out of town. She should have stayed for free since my mother was supporting her!! After years of the BS and never being good enough, we sold our house and moved far away. She went to live with one of the Golden Child siblings, and I've washed my hands of them all. Enough was enough!"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/oqqxrep/

"Mum passed in 2022, age 85. She had stage 4 cancer and had a stroke. I looked after her 24/7 for 3 years before her passing, and I was absolutely exhausted. I spent 20 hours a day caring for her with no help from my sister. Being ex military, I am accustomed to not having sleep, but this was on another level. Although it was hard, I didn't mind because I didn't want her going into a home. Mum thanked me for caring for her just before she passed, which gives me peace. All my sister wanted, ever, was her inheritance and there is a special place in hell for her."

youtube · @paulgore1237 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw9e8-M7aU4XSZxxQl4AaABAg

"I care for my 99 yr old mother. No help from siblings since I was young. I'm the youngest of 6. I've wasted away in the last 4 years caring for her on my own. My health has taken the back burner bc no one wants to help. It's all in God's hands."

youtube · @dawniscoming1212 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw1S195alNsbADKB5V4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (2): "Hi, that is a lot you are dealing with. Please please try and be good to yourself. You deserve it. As you can see from comments many, many are in situations like this and it's awful. One human isn't equipped for this with no support. It is no wonder it is taking a toll on mental and physical health. You have a right to care for yourself. I hope there is a way for you to get some assistance. Hang in there."

↳ **@dawniscoming1212** (0): "@SoloSecondHalf Thank you. I follow you and enjoy your channel. It's very sobering on many topics."

Marriage strain, separation, divorce · 42 documents

20 most engaged of 42 matching documents, complete text.

"Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship. After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this. I simply wasn't proactive enough in getting my dad into an assisted living facility, possibly even memory care. I felt that it wasn't my life, but I was somehow compelled to help him live independently. I can't even imagine the millage I put on my car traveling to his house to help get groceries and pay his bills, clean his place, get him to his doctor's appointments, get him the medication he needs (through the VA nonetheless), basically keep him alive. After the initial hospitalization that set this in motion, I was able to buy him about two years on his own. Now he's in a memory care facility--just a few months after he temporarily moved in with me, he broke his hip and there was only one place that could take him while he healed. He was going to need 24 hr. assistance. My wife had made it clear she was not happy with how much time I was spending on his affairs. And rightfully so, as it was eating away my time with the family, and it always aggravated my depression. I started a new career last year and my dad's problems were preventing me from putting best foot forward. By the time I was able to convince him to start touring assisted living facilities and getting on a waiting list, it was too little too late. My wife moved out, in part, to make room for my Dad to live at our place for a little bit--just a way to ease the transition into assisted living. The most-recent hospitalization was the big wake up call. Now my brother and I are in the process of managing his property, getting a short-term bridge loan to buy us time to fix up my childhood home, only for that house to be sold to pay for future memory care costs. It's not hard to see how a marriage could crumble under these conditions, especially if you don't get out in front of it when you had the opportunity. Yeah, our marriage had some problems to begin with. But dealing with my Dad was taking away time, energy, and other resources I needed to address my marital issues. I was exhausted all the time. And it was getting in the way of my new job. I was getting pulled in too many directions, and my Dad's situation was by far the most frustrating. If not for that, I feel like I could have repaired our relationship. Or maybe not. But it would have freed up a lot of time to focus on what's really important. Anyways, I just felt like sounding the alarm to anyone worried that their obligations to an aging parent are ruining your relationship... or some other important part of your life. The best advice I can offer are these rules of thumb: (1) set some boundaries to prevent it from bleeding into your family or professional life; (2) be proactive about moving this process along, because it's not getting any easier--if it's damaging your marriage, that's a clear sign that you can no longer provide the help they need; (3) if you haven't yet dealt with estate matters, medical/financial POI, etc., call a lawyer ASAP; and (4) let it be a lesson and plan for this period of your life so that it doesn't all fall on the shoulders of your children or other family members. I know it's easier said than done, but trust me when I say there is a better way. Happy New Year"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the

recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"I can't do this anymore, and I never agreed to be a caregiver to my mother's husband.. To sum up some background context, my mom remarried when I was in my mid 20's about 20 years ago. My mom asked me to move in 3.5 years ago to temporarily help her with my son. My mom died 3 years ago, my son died a year ago. I have never been close to her husband, he didn't even start being nice to me till my mom died. I feel I can't leave because I'm the only person he doesn't kick out. I'm coming from a place of deep frustration at the moment, and I'm sorry if I sound like a soulless monster. I just can't do this anymore. My parents didn't divorce till I was an adult. In extreme desperation, I assume my married, lets call him Frank. (now 75) Frank was the opposite of my father who my mother loved dearly in every bad way. He was uneducated, uncaring and had no family values, but what I could I do. It was her choice to marry him after 4 months. I had my own life going on and briefly stayed with them after being left during my third trimester of pregnancy till my son was six weeks old. Frank, made sure I knew that I had to get out after I gave birth and that my mom was not going to be a "babysitter" She did what he said, she liked being controlled. So, my mom undergoes what I felt was an unnecessary medical procedure that caused complications. She asked me and my teenage son to move in to help her overcome her health obstacles.

Frank decides to get an unnecessary elective surgery and my mom actually kills herself trying to care take to him afterward. I was distraught to say the least and I never blamed Frank for my mom's choices. I could say in detail every event that has made me choose not to leave. But I want someone to read this. I'm being manipulated, and I know this and he kicks out any of his family including his daughter who left earlier this year, traumatized from PTSD he gave her and won't come back. Frank is from a different state, all his large family lives there. He refuses to go there and kicks out any adult grandchild etc that is sent to help because I have made it known I want to move out of here. He is completely fine with me here, especially since my son died. I don't get up in his business because I'm too consumed with my own grief and we live separate lives, but I clean. His life is watching Forensic Files, lurking Facebook and spending my dead mom's money on cam girls and what he knows are scams. Oh, and lot's of Dr visits, he has always loved going to the doctor. He is not being medically neglected, he more overrides the health care system by getting a Dr appointment for anything. He has destroyed his body signing up for clinical trials. He also loves to kick out home health nurses, go to the ER afterward and report the aides of injuring him and theft. (nothing has been stolen) My life is I constantly work to stay busy and out of my own head. I don't stay here out of financial security. I can very much afford to not be here. I'm paying for my own father's assisted living in NYC and I would be in a bind if I was footing two bills. He doesn't want assisted living anyhow and I know its just a matter of time till he burns through my mom's money and I become financially responsible for him. (Help pay for my father's assisted living. He is smart and planned for this, just not in NYC. He hates Texas and I can't blame him. I help with the offset cost, not the entire huge bill) The neighbors of 20 years have been very supportive of him and me. They will take him to the ER for his unnecessary reasons, or will show up at the hospital because he decides to call 911 while I'm in therapy. Today, Frank has burned bridges with the neighbors and I'm terrified. They are all the support I have. The only support he has. So I come "home" from my typical 12 hour day with a trunk full of groceries only to find a large snake in the garage. I'm like great, go inside to get a broom and Frank calls out my name all cranky. We briefly discuss the snake. He then goes on about how mad he is because he fell twice trying to mow the lawn in 95 degree Texas heat. I'm like why are you mad? That was your own fault. He then goes and blames the next door neighbor for not mowing it for him like she normally does. And then blames me for not reading his mind. I didn't even notice it needed to be mowed. It wasn't that bad. I'm like that is not her job to mow your lawn and you could have asked me. He carries on about how we caused him to fall and I leave the unreasonable situation to get the groceries. My other neighbor calls me over and asks me wtf his problem is because he had to pick him up twice when he tried to mow the lawn causing panic all up the street. I give him the synopsis of what he said. Other neighbor tells me, you know he doesn't have cognitive decline and is just an asshole. I agree and he says I'm done. Go save yourself, I mean that. Other neighbor is a man of his word. He should have been done long ago as should have I. I'm terrified and have to accept that I'm not a horrible person for failing to save Frank from himself and choosing myself. Edit: sorry for all the typos and grammar mistakes my phone is freaking out too, and I need to get this out! And the 3 foot snake is still chilling in the garage. I will snake wrestle when it becomes daylight. Edit Edit: Is this normal on his part. I have read that as people age, they can become the worst form of themselves or the best form of who they wanted be. Edit: Thank you all so much!! The gaslighting is real. I needed to know this is with out a doubt, not my problem. I got into with him over the weekend when he tried to blame me for my mom's death. You don't go there with me and I don't stoop to his level. I was the bigger person and said: Me: I don't know what you want from me! Especially if you treat me like this Him: I should not have to say it. Me: Actually you do have to say what you want from me because I have no idea. Him: You know it! Me: I have no idea Him: I'm sick of repeating myself. Nobody listens. I want you out of here. I'm like sweet! I'll leave happily. I told him I'm leaving after the 4th weekend so I could find a place with out being overly dramatic and he needs to call his family and tell them he asked me to leave. Of course he is acting like that never happened. I just found some big chain complex that has an apartment available for move in 07/06. I'm taking it and can transfer units or complex's later if I need. Im too nice still and hired a lawn company to clear out any snake inviting debris and staying friendlish to get what I want of my mother's. I know I'm not through with it all, once he dies, gets forced placed in a nursing home or loses the house taking out equity loans, I will have to clean it up. It will probably all happen within a week and this year. I did what I could but I can't

sacrifice the remaining good years of my life so he can do whatever it is he does. Edit edit: I have always refused to be his POA or have any type of decision making authority with him. That was all settled with his family earlier this year and I was vocal I want nothing to do with this. His poor daughter is POA and will be the one really stuck to clean up this mess he leaves behind. He got her to sign up for that while she was emotionally vulnerable. There is nothing to gain when he dies, anything liquid he tore through after my mom died. I will help his daughter though emotionally. Her feelings towards him make mine seem warm and fuzzy. I will keep in my mind that they are not my family and trust no one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 126 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugwxtv/i_cant_do_this_anymore_and_i_never_agreed_to_be_a/

"What to do when you don't want to or can't be the caregiver?. Mom is getting to the point she is going to need more care and I live in fear that I'm going to be forced to take care of her. I know that probably sounds awful but she's very controlling, manipulative, and self centered and after living my life for 4 decades to please her and nearly losing my wife and kiddo because of her I know I can't do it. Mentally or physically. There's already been several hints from her saying she's moving on with us, she's tried claiming dibs on certain rooms in our house talked about how she's going to redecorate our home to her liking and I'm going to be honest my wife said if I move my mom in she is leaving same day. But then there is the problem of I also can't afford to fund an assisted living facility or in home care for her, like the money just isn't there and I couldn't work more to make up for it as I'm already working more than full-time. So what do I do?? Medicare doesn't cover assisted living or in home care, she has spent through her 401k, she's up to her eyeballs in debt from spending non stop, she has no other family but me. I've called council on aging and elder care many times and literally never get a call back from anyone. I'm in Florida."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 109 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t86ufb/what_to_do_when_you_dont_want_to_or_cant_be_the/

"I just refused a lump sum cash gift from my mom.. Today I was visiting my mom (79, in independent assisted living and on the doorstep of needing LTC because she is maxed out on what private nursing can provide with her numerous health and mobility challenges). She told me she is considering giving my younger brother and I (her only children) a lump sum cash payment to "help us out." Here is where this is coming from... Four years ago my brother was on a reckless path and my elderly parents (both were alive at the time, RIP Dad at age 82 in 2025) gave him \$65-70K to "fix" things with no strings attached. It was a gift. They asked me to please respect their decision and to simply "understand because a parent would do anything for their children." My parents did this before asking my brother to tap into his own resources. They felt strongly that he should maintain his assets and the simple lifestyle he had. After three years, my parents finally stopped paying for my brother's expenses, largely because I pleaded this was enabling and was getting out of hand. To add to the stress, it was becoming clear that long term care was in the future for our Dad and it is now very close for our Mom. My brother still wanted many thousands of dollars more and when my parents finally said "no," he exhausted his meager savings (he is middle-aged) and he is now in debt. Our mom is aware that paying off this debt is a slow and painful process for my brother, but he is doing it. She also knows my family and I are completely self-sufficient. Anyway, our mom then asked me what I would think if she were to give me and my brother each a lump sum payment "because it could really help us out." My "enabler" alarm went off because of the huge amount of cash my parents already gifted my brother. It is not to come out of his inheritance. I wondered if there would be any end to this if I accepted her money. My dad articulated that his dying wish for me was to make sure my younger brother is never homeless. Sadly, that says a lot about the dynamics. My "enmeshed behaviour" alarm went off next because I have experienced transactional treatment from both our mom and dad; specifically their regular reminders I would one day inherit a nice piece of my mom's jewelry "for all I do for them." I was actively involved in both our dad's and now only mom's caregiving. I live very nearby Mom's assisted living facility, but I have a family of my own and am always honest about my capacity. My approach to caregiving is sustainable, finally, after several intense years of

my parents' very real medical emergencies and rapid declines. I have to constantly be on guard because my parents have always treated me as an extension of themselves. I replied that I don't need any money and am not in financial difficulty. I can afford what I need. I suggested that if she wants to give my brother an early gift of inheritance she needs to get her Will redone so the early gift is recognized and accounted for to be fair. She said she didn't want to change her Will. It would either be we both get money early or neither of us do. I know my brother is struggling financially (not my monkey, not my circus) but I feel like our mom is trying to manipulate me. I am the family scapegoat because I have boundaries around my time/energy/conversation topics/etc. I am also her only child that has ever been dependable, consistent and taken on caregiving for her and Dad. My brother is the golden child who always has some trouble to be solved but is just such a busy and great guy who is sensitive and sweet. He can go weeks to months without calling her and is still wonderful because things are just so hard for him and he can't help it. My mom's money feels dirty and for me, I feel like it would just exacerbate the extremely transactional treatment I receive from her. She says that if I don't want to accept her "gift" then my brother won't get one either. And like the scapegoat I am... I am okay with that. Thanks for listening to me vent. \\UPDATE\\

Hours after I made my original post, my mom told me she wants to meet with her financial advisor in a couple of weeks to review her investments and asked me if I want to come. I might try to leverage the advisor, alert her about my brother and the risk of financial abuse and tell her about mom's plan to give lump sum payments. I would try to get the advisor to lay out my mom's financial reality to both of us. We already know it but it might as well be part of the conversation as a reminder. My hope is the advisor would discourage my mom from getting used as a bank. I would hope that if Mom still wants to give my brother and I cash gifts, the advisor would encourage payments dispersed over time (with a limit) to both my brother and I as opposed to lump sums, explain the benefits of a professional trust and help Mom lay out a plan. This absolutely won't stop the emotional manipulation I receive from my mom and I don't expect it to or for her to change in any way. It will not stop my mom from feeling the itch to help my brother by giving him more lump sums on top of it. About every 6 months my brother implies need and my mom gets the itch for a while and scratches. Dad did too. More Context: I should add that though my parents stopped giving my brother large lump sums 12-18 months ago, my mom (who hasn't driven in a couple of years) gave my brother her 10 year old vehicle about 10 months ago. This vehicle was previously kept in underground parking at her residence and I used it to drive her to her appointments because she can't get into our trucks. She paid for the maintenance/parking/fuel/insurance and I managed the logistics and took it for servicing, washes, fuel ups and cleaned it. My brother lives 350 km away. Now she will only go to an appointment if her residence's complimentary courtesy car is available. This service only provides door to door drop off and pick up, no escorting. Her mobility is terrible and she uses a walker but her physio says she needs a wheelchair for going out. That is the second physio to say so, btw. She refuses to get one (it would be fully funded thanks to government grant for disabled people!) and so I stopped meeting her and the courtesy car at her appointments. She only leaves for appointments (not shopping/errands/coffee/dining out at all). Sometimes she goes alone, which her doctor and RN in charge of her case say she absolutely shouldn't do, but she has occasionally hired a health care aide to accompany her through the private nursing company she uses. Telling history that shows how longstanding these patterns of thought are: 25 years ago my mom and aunt worked together to have my Grandma write my uncle out of Grandma's Will. Uncle was divorced, retired and a live-in part-time carer to supplement the publically funded home care Grandma received. Grandma paid for his divorce, bought him a car, paid for his holidays and he lived rent free. However, he cooked, did the yard care for her house, drove her to appointments, picked up prescriptions, etc. Sometimes my grandma wasn't happy because he picked up casual work related to his previous profession, when she wanted him to be home and she wanted him to do more. Mom and Auntie thought he was getting a free ride and convinced my grandma to write him out of her Will. I was a newly minted adult at this time, just finished university and I thought this might be a unique scenario or that maybe my uncle wasn't helping enough but this way of thinking has persisted and I have come to doubt the "lore" around caregiving for my grandma. This is the context I have in the background in caregiving for my mother. *Edited to fix a typo and to note I am not in the US."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v3spn7/i_just_refused_a_lump_sum_cash_gift_from_my_mom/

"Dad is done taking care of mom. I cant deal with them.. This was inevitably going to happen. My sibling and I have been trying for years to get dad to see reason, that he can't do it alone. We've suggested in home care, traveling nurses, senior living facilities, and more but it all just got ignored. Mom (75) keeps falling. She is partially blind (from a stroke 10 years ago) and deaf (with hearing aids), and she has terrible knees. Dad has to call the ambulance to come pick her up. It is not sustainable. He resents her. He's cruel to her. Abusive verbally. Mom doesn't exactly help. She's naggy and probably stresses him out. Not giving him a pass, ive talked to him about it and he fixes himself for a bit but it always goes back. We finally got them both to agree to look at some senior living facilities. It would be good for them to be able to have a community other than just the 2 of them. Dad continues to dig in his heels. He doesn't want to leave the house. He doesn't want to dump all his money into a senior living facility. I get it, but mom needs assistance. He started cleaning out the house, we were going to help move furniture. Last week he said he would sign the paperwork for the living facility. Mom was so excited. Then the next thing I know Dad changes his mind, tells mom she can go and he will stay. He told her that he doesn't want to take care of her anymore. Im tired, in my mid 30s just wishing I could live my own life and not deal with them and their codependency. I feel selfish sometimes, but I've tried. Its like talking to a wall. I inevitably told him that if he doesn't want to go, then fine, but mom needs to. I told him that they can stay together, divorce, separate, whatever.... I don't care at this point. Im fed up with both of them. My sibling cut off contact with our mom last week and frankly im getting close to doing the same for both."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 96 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vos1wn/dad_is_done_taking_care_of_mom_i_cant_deal_with/

"Honestly, I can't blame you here. No one knows what it's like until they go through it. My dad is only 63 and "able minded" as he's ever been if you can call it that. But he neglected his health, finances, etc. until he had a fall and a host of health problems. No one to care for him and I live 11 hours away so I had no choice but to bring him to my house to get him back walking hopefully. For now he's wheelchair bound. He won't do ANYTHING for himself. Any meals are the absolute lowest effort - little Debbie's, microwave dinners, sandwiches. He rarely comes out of the room to eat dinner with my family and when he does he doesn't speak. I have to schedule PT and like 8 doctors around my work schedule. My work performance has obviously suffered with all these appointments and I'm usually the rockstar. My wife is tired of it and tired of my time being monopolized with that, scheduling, plus juggling kids' schedules. EVERYONE is upset with me because I'm burning myself out trying to do everything and there's no help. I finally arranged transportation for his appointments but I have to put him on the van. Had to switch one of his PT offices and his doc scolded me. It's made me so resentful and impacted my relationship with him, most likely irreparably."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxb56th/

"I am also living through this. I feel I am going out of my mind, stuck in this house with my 96 yr old Mom!! I retired at 62 yrs old so I could relax and travel with my partner. After 2 mos of my retirement my Mom fell and broke her hip. That's when my nightmare started. I have a sister but doesn't help with Mom cause "she's too busy" and lives far. Shes 45 min away!! My mom has dementia so she's paranoid, suspicious, cries and thinks everyone is stealing her belongings. Its been 4 yrs now, I have developed heart issues, anxiety, depression. My partner left me 2 mos ago. He was not going to put his life on hold, and I don't blame him. So now I'm here with a broken heart and dealing with my Mom. I pray that God give me patience and comfort, but I don't know how long I will be able to take this situation 😞 "

youtube · @jennynunez7946 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 75 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=UgxFp_X5N3UIkTFLuyB4AaABAg

↳ **@wordswordswords8203** (12): "Wow that is bad. I'm in a very similar situation. If I can't get my elderly mom out of my house I think I am going to die. I have so many health problems now and I feel like I am going completely insane."

↳ **@hellohello17983** (11): "sorry to hear that...i am single 36yo taking care of my parents.... not that i was so determined to get married but then it sucks that i now dont even have the chance... i am constantly sad, depressed and angry..... God, pls help us all..."

↳ **@73cidalia** (10): "There need to be more options, affordable options, for families dealing with this. Given your mom's age and condition, that would be a situation that warrants her being cared for in a nursing home."

"Something you touched on is so important and needs to be really looked at, changed, or something. It's about Adult Protective Services. First, I need to tell you a little about my dad. He's an abusive narcissist hoarder. Before he lost his home, it was a horror. No electricity worked, rats chewed through the wires, no refrigeration, heating, air conditioning, and junk piled to the ceiling with small paths through them. Floors were falling through in areas. This all spilled to the outside of the home and covered 2 full acres. On top of that, he has MS and diabetes, and is in his early 70s and literally sometimes has to crawl from the living to his bed. He is also mentally ill, and said that one of his grandchildren planned to shoot and kill him. I heard that conversation and it's not even close to true. He's burned all his bridges, of course and now he's living in a travel trailer in a park and the living conditions are already just as bad as in the house he was in. So, my mom (who is separated from him and lives with me, the "scapegoat") and my sister have both tried to help him to hire someone to do repairs, cleanup, and eventually suggested retirement home. All of these things he refuses to this day. He refuses all senior resources like Meals on Wheels and transportation, etc. We have called Adult Protective Services (the point of my post), and they went out to talk to him and give him pamphlets, telling him resources and help available to him, etc. And he listened and they left but of course, my dad just throws it in the garbage, refusing help. Here's the problem I have with Adult Protective Services and why I am so grateful for your video. They were NO HELP to us. They were simply too focused on "he has his rights to live how he wants"... I said "But he owns several guns and he's mentally ill, and afraid his grandson wants to kill him! Isn't there SOMETHING we can do based on that for safety of others, himself?" they said the only thing we can do is take him to court to get conservatorship but that it's expensive and hard to do. This didn't come from just one visit and team that went out to his house, it came from THREE. The same thing.... there is simply nothing we can do. Our dad lost all the money he had and then out of the blue sold his house without anyone knowing for pennies on the dollar for what it was worth, not giving any of us a chance to at least buy it and turn it over. But, that's beside the point except to say that there is no money left for the court that APS said we need. Nothing. We're left with only one option. Take his abuse to get him to his doctors appointments and to bring him food and take a verbal pounding while doing it. That's IT!! And, as Wayne Dyer has said "allowing yourself to be abused is an act of abuse". Seriously, he is VERY verbally abusive. The one person that takes it well is my poor mom. And, I know that with things how they are and the experience I've had with Enablers Anonymous, is that she is probably hurting him more than helping him by helping him at all. BUT, in your video you gave options I didn't know about and I am definitely going to make calls. So I want you, and others to know just how unhelpful APS is to families in situations like this. (or, how they CAN be, I'm sure that some are more helpful than our experiences with them, somewhere). And I think this needs to be addressed. I'm going to write some letters and do what I can, but I wanted to get this out there. Thank you so much for your wonderful advice, it's just what we needed!"

youtube · @ThunderDove-q7g · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 39 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyBokX_sGMmyStihJ4AaABAg

↳ **@SofiaAmirpoor** (5): "@God Wins wow, that's such a hard horrible situation! You are right! Most people don't want APS to get involved out of some fear. They don't realize that APS can be a great advocate. However, because of its voluntary nature, the staff can't always help, their hands are tied. But I do applaud you for looking

towards APS for help. I do have one suggestion regarding getting conservatorship. Yes it is expensive, (several thousand dollars) and takes time (6-12 months). If cost is prohibiting you from pursuing this, there are ways that you can apply for conservatorship without paying an attorney (if you meet the financial criteria). Do an internet search for "<county your father lives in> Superior court conservatorship" and look for the self help section. You should be able to locate the forms necessary to apply for conservatorship by yourself, without using an attorney. Each county should also have a Legal Aid department that can assist with this process and they often have workshops to help walk you through the process. You might also be able to find a Legal Assistant who can help with the process, instead of an attorney, at a fraction of the cost. Even though the process could be free, there are still court costs associated with obtaining conservatorship. Again, if you yourself are low income, you can ask the court to waive these fees. As far as the time it takes.....well, time is going to pass whether you are going through the process of conservatorship or not and dad will still need this intervention in 6-12 months, so may as well get started now! I hope this was helpful info. Keep us posted on how it goes!"

"A divorce sent me home to take care of my my mom. She was 89 when I came home. It was the best thing that ever happened. I absolutely LOVED taking care of my mom! She passed last year at 95 year of age. Had big disagreement with siblings about too much medication."

youtube · @wer113 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 34 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgytXr9YwrgH9jcuN7R4AaABAg

↳ **@BSAllergy** (5): "Every care situation is different. I cared for my paternal grandmother, until the end, when she had dementia. There were challenges, but she has a lovely disposition and that carried forward, into her dementia. Now, I'm caring for my mother and that's a completely different ballgame. Plagued by mental illnesses, her baseline personality was anything but pleasant. Now, that she has Alzheimer's, her paranoia, controlling nature, abusiveness and impulsiveness are on steroids. It's constant, unmitigated hell. I go to bed, every night, hoping that I don't wake up."

↳ **@PoodleParti** (3): "@BSAllergy I'm sorry you're feeling that way. I learned to wear industrial headphones with music so I don't have to hear it. I hope you can try that. Then look the other way and pretend you don't know she's yelling."

↳ **@lisabrown6361** (3): "@wer113 my opinion on that is, unless siblings are local and taking an active part in your parent's care, pulling their own share of the load, they have no right to dictate anything about medication, unless they have power of attorney. My brother had power of attorney and is in a medical profession, so I followed his judgement. Both my siblings were ok with my decisions made locally and didn't butt in nor did they complain."

"Because you love your Mom and don't really want to abandon her, give her one last chance to help herself (i.e. an ultimatum): "Mom, I can't and *won't* continue with the way things have been. Either you get someone in to help out or I am throwing in the towel and walking away." Make it very clear that you're at the end of your rope, you're *not* "bluffing", and they WILL be left to their own devices if they don't find/hire someone else to help them. (If you have it in you, offer to help your Mom find appropriate services.) And then...the hardest part...stick to what you said."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walking_away_from_my_mom/p4f2m04/

"What can we do about my MIL being neglected in this hospital that won't let her leave? HELP ASAP. My mother in law initially went into Surgery March 18th for removal of two non-benign brain tumors. They were successfully removed but she was unable to walk or do anything for herself. Her right side was completely useless. She was then returned home back to her negligent husband. He failed to sign her up for rehab when the hospital called

asking why she wasn't. He claimed she should "gain strength" at home. Not being moved at all in her recliner and ignored. Ignored so badly, that her kidney stones he knew about for a year, grew worse. He would not change her diapers & she would have to cry in pain just to be noticed. The pain of kidney stones, a bad UTI, and multiple other infections due to him not cleaning her properly and leaving fecal matter where it SHOULDN'T BE. He claimed to never know about any of it. He also refused to take her to multiple important appointments. He is her POA with my SIL as second POA. About a month or less, she wound up with sepsis. He says he couldn't call 911 as she was puking & had a 104 fever. He couldn't call bc he claims "cell towers were down in a bad storm". 911 should always work. Even if your phone is out of service. At the hospital she was diagnosed with sepsis. She underwent surgery and multiple organs were shutting down and has septic shock. The nurses on night shift would leave her in her own shit. She was also diagnosed with CIDP. Her BP was deathly low so they gave her 4 pressers to keep her alive. But being on those for days, left her hands & feet all gnarled and black and blistered. Extremely swollen. It proceeded to spread. They did nothing. Now it is gangrene and as long as she's been in there (about a month) NOTHING has been done for her gangrene in her hands. They keep promising her Vascular will check it out but they haven't come around besides to say they won't cut or amputate bc it won't save her. They claim it's not spreading but how would they know if it's not checked out even? Her finger tips are completely dead. The rest of her hands and feet are so bad and pain level of ten. They did nothing besides put a wet rag under them. She also underwent dialysis for a few days then they stopped. She was on a ventilator and got off 2 days ago. She can now finally speak for herself. She says her husband didn't take her illness seriously and neglected her. So much so that she wants a divorce but we are trying to get her transferred to a better hospital (which was immediately denied). It's the best hospital in the country with a renown vascular team. Now that's she's speaking, some of it is very strange and unlike her. She hallucinates quite a bit. Almost like gangrene is spreading to her head. The staff treats her like an annoying body that's filling a bed. They never come when called. Kicked my sister in law out for snapping at the night shift nurse that refused to check on her all night. They are just giving up on her and waiting for her to get worse and die it seems. We have the husband agreeing to relinquishing POA to the eldest sister. And signing a palliative care contract we drew up stating his verbal promise of providing caretakers & home health services once she moved in with her daughter after the hospital. That's happening today, the signing. Keep in mind, all 4 of her kids live over an hour away and the husband lives 15 mins away. They are there more than he is. His excuses are "grooming the dogs" (short haired dogs that don't NEED it rn) and letting the dogs out while his 25 year old son who lives at home easily could. They've been there taking shifts every day and night to make sure she is never alone. He has stayed a few nights but he had to be forced. This has taken such a toll on her kids seeing her neglected by someone she loved and the staff of this money hungry hospital. I just need to know what our options are. How we can safely get her out of here. What can we do to help her and get her out? TIA for anyone who can give me advice ASAP. We are located in Houston, Texas btw."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1d21xm2/what_can_we_do_about_my_mil_being_neglected_in/

"Respite care for a month or more? Possible?. I've been the sole care giver for my husband who had a stroke. And honestly I'm getting really overwhelmed and need some time off. I keep thinking about divorce or putting him a home and I think its just mean need some much needed time away. Like A LOT of time. Is there a company that would be willing have someone live in our house for 24/7 for a month or more? He doesn't need 24/7 care, but does need someone in the house at all times b/c he does get confused and delusional, etc. I understand the cost will be crazy, but I'm desperate. Is visiting angels good? Or is there a better option? I'm in south west florida. Thanks."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/qxsl8h/respice_care_for_a_month_or_more_possible/

"I took care of my dying mother and stopped my university education for it. My sister also helped a lot and went part time during that time. My brother? He didn't do a thing because his starting career was more important to him. I never really got back on track in university because these four years were just so straining and hard that I was caught in a deep depression after my mother had died. My sister never went back to full time work. My brother has a big career. Now - nearly 20 years later - my mother in law slowly shows the first signs of illness and my partner told me that he assumes that I will help taking care of her. And I was „No!“ She has four sons. First it is THEIR duty to take care of her or organize someone professional who does this job. I did my part. I refuse to take care of her. He was shocked, but he simply has no clue. And I am so mad that in his mind it is completely normal that their wives have to do the caring... And when I am about to die or am lucky enough to get so old that I cannot take care of myself the last thing I would do to my daughter is to let her take care of me and destroying her life doing it."

youtube · @Izanuela22 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugx5-mvclYUkY2A5V7V4AaABAq

↳ @jessicahitchens6926 (o): "Do not lift a finger. Tell your husband to mind his own business too."

"Took care of my demented mom for 8 years, during that time my husband left me, my son become estranged, I got sick and finally placed mom in nursing home. But was ridden with guilt ever since. Your video brought me hope and reassurance I have done the right thing. I am and always will be grateful to all the nurses and carers in my mom's nursing home, and yes, you guys should be paid like top neurosurgeons, work you do is unbelievable important and should be valued above all the other professions. Thanks to you we can have our lives back."

youtube · @ksenijajankovic5705 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzzNhLEU2iDlCgYI3d4AaABAq

"Can't Take of/afford to take care of dad. My dad (75) makes just less than 200\$ too much a month to be eligible for medicaid and thus every single assisted living program/nursing home in our area (Pennsylvania). He owns a house that even if I somehow pried out of his hands because he's still legally married to my mother who's been separated from him for over 15 years and Co joins will still count against him on top of the income. They refuse to divorce each other, him because he's convinced she will come home one day, her because she's convinced she will get money when he dies one day. I've tried getting him into a nursing home even after he's placed straight from the er medicare a and b will only cover 30 days. Not a day more. His house is in unlivable condition and I'm honestly trying to slowly get it emptied out of years of hoarding garbage and squatter trash to sell with him and my mom's wavering permission. We'll be lucky to get 10k for it so that won't contribute to any actual nursing home fees minus one month maybe. So we're paying 1000 in rent at an apartment for him to live alone in because after his bills, medications, oxygen fees, etc he barely has enough to pay me 400\$ a month to compensate for not being able to return to work at all to try and care for him full time. 250 of that I pay someone else to come and clean his house weekly for the month because I'm just so burnt out after just having a baby in February. He's been falling pretty much daily now the last two weeks, because after I had the baby he got jealous about my time being tied up and went on a strike for a lot of stuff and started refusing to even get out of bed or his recliner to walk much thus making his feet bad and his legs weak, he can get around if he takes his time or keeps them elevated but he's stubborn and likes to force me to come back over multiple times (like calling and crying out for help when in reality when I rush there he's fine and just wants subway) I had to get cameras just to give myself some peace of mind and the chance to say no every so often, but then he cries he's lonely because he's driven the rest of our family away with being nasty and violent. Now that he's actually falling and getting stuck on the ground I feel like we've come to the end of the line. I really can't take care of him full time, living with him is out the window because I have two kids and me and my partner live with his parents in their home to help them out financially as it is and because they're aging. He's refuses to stop smoking cigarettes, he spits on the ground or AT a garbage can and will piss directly in a garbage can or in bottles he doesn't care spill even before he got older and less mobile,

he's been doing that for 30 years, alot of it is stubbornness and an expectation of other people to clean up after him. I've gone through his financials every which way I can. they're locked up through social security disability and these two monthly payments from life insurance policies/stock he set up 20 some years ago that can't be canceled and are going to pay him until the day he dies. No matter which way I swing it he can't afford the monthly cost of a facility and he can never become eligible for any assistance unless they magically raise the income limit. He also can't afford any of the nursing care in our area because will zero copay they all want over 25+ an hour with weekly minimums. I can't lift him on my own, I need to call other people to help, I've got everyone screaming in my ear it's time for a nursing home but it goes in one and out the other when I keep showing Financials and the rejection letters or offering for them to speak with case managers through area agency or his lawyer. He's pretty much stuck in this apartment until the day he dies, which means I'm stuck with him until he dies, but I honestly don't even think that will happen for another 20 years because he's survived organ failure multiple times now due to the way he treats his body, and 3 strokes, 4 heart attacks, a freaking month long coma, all within the last 12 years. He was a marine and some days i swear they gave him some crazy serums to make him impervious to death. I'm his poa for Financials to make sure everything is paid and medically for if he EVER get proved incompetent which, my mom tried for 10 years before she fled, then my brother for another 5, and now me for 2 with no hope in sight. I just can't see any ending here or possible exit that doesn't end up with me charged with some case of neglect or something even though I'm doing everything I physically can. Is there ANY way i can get him into a facility? (sorry for awful formatting I'm on mobile and also the rambling I'm just exhausted from both him and the new baby) Well just wanted to come on here and edit the post instead of messaging everyone personally Thank you to everyone who commented but my dad actually passed away this morning while I was cleaning up the apartment. Me and my brother helped him to bed and got him all cleaned up and comfortable and then I went about cleaning up and when my sister came to pick me up a hour later I went to check on him and let him know I was leaving and he was gone. Definitely not the outcome I wanted but I'm glad he went peacefully in his sleep and that at least the whole situation is over. Now I just need to try and handle/figure out funeral costs etc and get ahold of the VA because his life insurance policy was only active for 19 months out of 24 to get the full benefit. (always something to kick you while you're down) so we're only getting 5k towards the funeral costs. It's been a very solemn morning."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1lcwa4w/cant_take_ofafford_to_take_care_of_dad/

"I feel like I've gone through a life journey unlearning some ideas that I was raised to believe. I was undiagnosed ADHD until my late 20s. I have worked on my own coping skills. One of those was de-cluttering. If something doesn't serve some purpose, I ask myself why I need it. I try to put things where they belong because that way I am not wasting time looking for things. Mom was not a hoarder and the house was always clean. My wife said it was more like a museum than a house. But to me it always felt like the NEED to keep things was like a millstone around my neck. Trying to adhere to minimalist principles has been psychologically freeing for me. And I realize that is not everyone else's experience. The biggest differences between my mom and I were over the fact that she couldn't understand why I didn't share the same NEED to keep things that she did. It is hard to explain what a driving force it was in her life. Especially near the end, it seemed like those thoughts were a major preoccupation and it was hard to hold a conversation that didn't somehow end up in her needing reassurance that the things would be loved and valued and treasured as much as she did."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v62aym/dealing_with_the_stuff/ozp69lb/

"My ex is taking me to court to get child support back. I am my Mom's 24/7 caretaker. She is blind, partially deaf, wears a pull-up, I take her to and from the bathroom all day & night, feed her, bathe her, she can do nothing on her own. Yet I am supposed to get a full-time job to pay him. That's what happened the first time he got child support awarded. It ended at 19, but now he wants it extended because I was awarded retirement money from his

per our divorce QDRO. If she was dumped in a nursing home, the house would be sold, all of her assets would go to the home, and I would be homeless, and jobless. With my age, I would be lucky to find work any where. The court system stinks. I am beyond exhausted by all of this."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nojqpk3/

"My sister and other family couldn't get the LO's personal property from my home fast enough. They didn't visit. They didn't show up when APS got called. They didn't show up when both my children's counselors were asking me to get mental health help. Now, I'm being told to get a lawyer to be allowed what the will states. I was left destitute from caregiving that led to divorce. They know I can't afford to fight them. They own thriving companies and have disposable income I could never dream of. GUARD YOURSELF!!!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1ul4inf/the_strangest_after_death_occurrences_with_family/ov623fh/

"I have been there for most of my married life. Even now after the divorce it is still a thing. The biggest problem is not having a support system. You are overlooked by everyone and people seem to be too busy to care. I think that is why we withdraw from other people."

youtube · @confusedwhynot · *The Hidden Burnout Millions of Caregivers Are Facing | Mel Robbins #Shorts* · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=dZTbJb5Nml8&lc=UgzfDH12VHpT_IIF4DJ4AaABAg

What the parent says to me · 41 documents

20 most engaged of 41 matching documents, complete text.

"My mom informed me I will be inheriting the care of my two siblings. I am the oldest of three. Me 50F, sister 46F and brother 37M. Roughly 6 months ago, my mother (75F) and I were discussing her paperwork (POA, will, etc) and all of the necessary related things. She said "don't forget, you will have to look after your siblings". Ok, my siblings have both had their issues. So I dared to ask, what exactly do you do for them regularly? My sister has made numerous stupid decisions over the years, and my mom has bailed her out several times, mostly financially. She is currently living with her boyfriend of 18 years. Just found out he owes \$63K in back taxes to the IRS. They are finally taking action. If he loses his house, my sister will lose the roof over her head. I honestly think my mother expects me to take her in, because I have an "empty bedroom". (My oldest finished college, found a good job and got her own place. I still have two more living at home currently in college.) No. Just NO. My mother has always been my sister's back up plan. Mom said she's ready for me to "take over." No. Next is my brother. He is autistic and has medically well managed schizophrenia. He does have his own place, car, and manages to hold down a 32-hour a week cashier job. Admittedly I have a soft spot for him. So, I asked, how can I help? I was thinking mental health/medical needs (I'm an RN). Nope, my mother micromanages every aspect of this kids life. She spends as much time at his apartment as she does at her house. Cleans, does his laundry, takes out his trash. I was speechless. They are so intermeshed and co-dependent that I don't even have words. She makes him call her twice a day if she isn't there. I told her my version of "helping" and her version are two VERY different things. I raised my three kids, and thankfully they are all transitioning to adulthood. I'm starting to embrace the 'empty nest', I have zero desire to take on another 'kid'. I probably should have disclosed from the beginning, all three of us have the same parents. We grew up in an abusive/neglectful household. Dad was the main perpetrator, he's been dead for years. All three of us kids got different versions of mom. I bailed as soon as I graduated high school, and am admittedly not that close with anyone. I'm friendly but keep my distance. Apparently my mom thinks I am "taking over" as she is "getting too old" but she does not approve of my boundaries, my "list" of what I am willing/not willing to do. She has accused me of "abandoning my siblings". I'm not even sure what I am asking for here. Just venting? There is much more. I could type for days."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 559 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q839bu/my_mom_informed_me_i_will_be_inheriting_the_care/

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him,

she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a

garden , and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go , not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone . I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up.i told her I didn't feel well and would come up today . She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my

presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"I am the last kid of the family. The responsibility of caring for my parents fell on me for the last 12 years. Dealing with all the gaslighting, guilt tripping, diapers changing, cleaning feces and urine etc. I have lost all friends, joy of living and faith crisis. The only motivation is when all this over, I look forward to cut ties with the rest of my narcissistic church going siblings. To them doing Godly works is more important. Caring for parents is unproductive to them. Thank you for letting air my frustration to someone who understand it all."

youtube · @SCCDaniel · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 160 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyY0fzoGeQa4xKxpc94AaABAq

↳ **@karendegraaf3572** (12): "Jesus even condemned EXPLICITLY the religious leaders of his day who were placing their religious rituals over the care and honor of their own parents, which was actually one of the original 10 commandments. So, children refusing to care for or love or respect their parents, however they can, is not Christian. May God bless you for doing the hard things at your own expense and sacrifice. I'm sorry it has turned out this way. In keeping with this original youtube, it's true that it's not a Hallmark movie. 🙄🙄"

↳ **@rynneivarsson751** (9): "You cut those ties and wave one finger at them defiantly in your rear view mirror, sister. There's life out here, lots of it. Get you a little dog, hamster or a cat, a camp trailer, learn to paint, whatever. This time, YOU get to choose, you get to choose everything. This can be overwhelming at first, but hell yeah, I'm into it now."

↳ **@rynneivarsson751** (9): "@karendegraaf3572 I think we wade into some uneven ground when we try to apply a biblical commandment to guiltling ourselves into staying in abusive and unhealthy situations."

"Both of my parents are in a life threatening crisis, and they shift the blame on me because I try to help. I live a few states away from my family. My mother (65) had a botched surgery last year and has been in a physical and mental health spiral ever since. She has several comorbidities and one of the top ones is extreme insomnia, like 3 hours of sleep a night on average. This has caused her to lose grasp with reality due to psychosis. She refuses to take any medication, doesn't trust doctors. Doesn't have proper nutrition or hydration. Every time I call she is in absolute hysterics without fail, like full on crying fits and panics. My father is her primary caregiver and he is facing full caregiver collapse. He is now an insomniac too, cries all the time, and I think he is hiding self harm from me. Here's what really bothers me: he reinforces her psychosis. Tells her that she doesn't have to take the medicine if she doesn't want to. Says he doesn't trust her doctors. He is very mentally ill himself and is unfitting as a caregiver. They both have delusions that people are coming to "take them away to the loony bin" or arrest them if they seek help. I have made a million phone calls to physicians, department of aging, other family members. What ultimately happens is that when my parents are confronted with harsh truths (like "hey you need to escalate care") they refuse, downplay, or just explode in anger. Well I had one of those anger explosions over the phone recently. Suddenly everything was my fault because I was "making too many phone calls". I told them that if my

mother does not take her medication I will have to call her doctor again. They both lost it on me. Told me this is my fault because I'm not there with them. Told me both "leave us alone" and "you're too far away", so basically any situation I'm at fault. Full disclosure, my father was very physically and emotionally abusive to me growing and this brought me right back to the feeling of being a little scared boy. At this point I have absolved of the situation. I don't think I will hear my mother's voice again by Christmas and I'm afraid what my dad might will do once she passes. But I can't insert myself in this chaos anymore. No more agencies, no more phone calls. Shit sucks man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 132 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ts88af/both_of_my_parents_are_in_a_life_threatening/

"My dad does the same. He dumps on my in-laws he barely knows, my husband, the cars we buy, where we live, etc. He has for years but it's especially focused now. He was sending voice clips to me when he was in the hospital that were so mean I asked my husband to sit with me when I listened. When I saw I could just read the transcript that helped a bit. He tells me how nothing I do is as good as other people who live 10-15 minutes away from him. I'm in another state and a 1.5 hour drive away. He threw all my offers to help him in my face, then later said he didn't remember any of that. He's just a really nasty, hateful person and I decided to only help where I can because my tolerance for his crap is so low."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ttfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op29a5z/

"AITA for hiring a caregiver for my mom after my family told me it's "my turn to be responsible"? I (34F) am completely exhausted and need an outside perspective. I (34F) am an only child on my mother's side. My mom has Parkinson's and dementia. My dad is in his 80s and was just hospitalized for a bowel obstruction. I also have a 19-month-old daughter. My dad has children from a previous relationship who are about 20 years older than me. They are my siblings, but they are not my mom's children. Most of them live far away, have established careers, and some have health issues of their own, so they are not very involved in day-to-day caregiving. About a year ago, I moved back to Puerto Rico partly because my parents were aging and needed more support. Since then, I've been trying to balance being a mom, running my own business, managing rental properties, and helping my parents. Honestly, the transition has been much harder than I expected. This past week my dad was hospitalized, so I've been helping care for my mom. I've been going back and forth to the hospital, staying with my mom, caring for my toddler, and putting much of my work on hold. A few days ago, my mom fell while I was helping her. She was okay, but it scared me and made me realize that I cannot safely do everything by myself. I told my family that I was overwhelmed and needed help. I hired a caregiver for just four days, paying out of my own pocket 8am to 12pm (dad pays) 3:00 pm to 8:00pm (I pay), to help my mom for a few hours each day while my dad transitions home from the hospital. My dad was extremely upset. He told me that if I don't take care of my mom myself, then I should give back everything he has given me. He specifically brought up the apartments that were transferred to me when I was 18 years old. I'm now 34 and have spent the last 16 years managing those properties and building a property management business around them. He also told me that I chose to have a child and should have thought about my parents before having one. He said that if I want to focus on my career another business I am building, then he wants the apartments and everything back. When I told my siblings that I was close to collapsing and needed help, they told me that I had a "perfect life" and that it was my turn to be responsible because my dad gave me those apartments and that I have never been fully responsible. What hurts the most is that nobody is offering an alternative solution. Nobody is volunteering to cover shifts, contribute financially, or help coordinate care. They simply believe that because I received property years ago, I should personally be responsible for caring for my mother. I love my parents and want to help them. That's why I moved closer to them, why I've been helping all week, and why I arranged additional care in the first place. But I also have a toddler, a business, my own responsibilities, and limits. Hiring a caregiver for a few hours a day felt like a reasonable solution, but my family sees it as me refusing to take care of my mother. AITA for hiring temporary help because I don't feel capable of doing everything myself?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uc225q/aita_for_hiring_a_caregiver_for_my_mom_after_my/

"Vent: I'm exhausted taking care of someone who never took care of me. I'm just so tired. Caregiving (even just remotely) for my formally abusive mother is just killing me. The anxiety and depression feels constant. Despite my efforts to the contrary, I feel like this has just taken over my entire life and sanity. If I'm not actively doing things for her, she's calling me, or her concerned family, friends and neighbors are calling me, as if I hadn't noticed that her dementia is getting so bad that she looks for my dead father and grandfather daily. Or asking me how she's doing. And then I have to have the same conversation with them that I've had with everyone else. It's exhausting. I understand their concern, but I guess people don't understand that lining up elder care (and everything it encompasses) TAKES TIME. There are waiting lists. There are a thousand things to coordinate. And it does not help that she is actively against any steps I take on her behalf and insists that she'll just "get better if I give (her) time." If I try to force the issue she tells me that I'm the cause of her cognitive issues because she thinks I am yelling at her and it makes her nervous. She also doesn't want services that cost money (despite having plenty of financial resources) because she's the cheapest person I've ever met and she's perfectly happy burdening me, my husband, and her friends with all her logistical, physical, and emotional needs. As proof that "people care about her." I'm just at the point where I don't feel anything towards her except obligation, extreme resentment and dislike. Every time her caregiving agency calls me, I immediately hope that they're going to tell me she died. **I hate what she's turned me and my life into.** What I've recently been asking my friends and family: *I don't need or want articles or advice on how to be a better caregiver. I've done a lot of reading about the various forms of dementia and get plenty of guidance from her geriatric doctors. I've also done a lot of therapy and reading on how to deal with elder estranged /abusive parents.* I don't need guilt trips or asking what I'm doing for her birthday/holidays, etc. Yes, she gave birth to me, but our relationship has been either neglectful and/or abusive throughout my life. * Please stop asking after my mother. Even if you want to help... you can't. I just want a couple of days where I try not to think about her. Literature that has resonated with me and felt super helpful in processing some of these very complicated feelings are: ["Your turn for care: Surviving the aging and death of the adults who harmed you"](<https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/17325189>) \- books abound regarding elder abuse, but almost nothing about the confusion and anger that comes along when a formerly abusive parent suddenly requires help. ["What My Bones Know: A Memoir of Healing from Complex Trauma"](<https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/58214328>) \- the best and only book I've found that addresses the damage and toxicity of emotionally abusive, so called "tiger parenting" in otherwise highly functional Asian adults."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 71 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18ccwul/vent_im_exhausted_taking_care_of_someone_who/

↳ **comment** (29): "I know exactly how you feel. Caring for my mother who "had the covid, or the flu or rsv or or" (she was really just upset that dad was getting all the attention) while my dad was in hospital and then rehab, there was a day I got to the point I was ready to hit her. That was the day I told EVERYONE that I was no longer going to be her caretaker and I told them why. I was a danger to her. This absolves me. Sometimes you just have to walk away and let the chips fall."

↳ **comment** (21): "I felt exactly the same way when my FIL shook his cane at me like he was going to hit me: "You'd better not or you're going down." And that was when I had to stop. I'll probably never see him again."

↳ **comment** (16): "All so valid. I especially feel the conversaton stuff. I know people mean well when they ask what's going on with them (parents), but we already spend so much mental energy thinking about their problems (transportation, needing groceries, dr. appts., lonliness, stubborn, hearing imparied, etc.) that I just don't want to report on it with people who aren't part of the "system" we've put in place to address these issues. I get it, I really do - neighbors feel especially entitled because they can only see things from the outisde - but when I say she's okay and even if she wasn't "there's really nothing you can do about it," they seem offended. Like them just occasionally asking about her should be the solution enough for whatever she's going through. They never offer

her rides anywhere, they don't stop by and say, "hey, I'm going to the store - what do you need?," they don't ask for our contact info. in case there's an emergency etc. This sounds mean, but it's sort of like they're posturing. Ya know? Like they're nice neighbors, but acting like their so concerned about her and expecting updates when it's convenient for them to inquire annoys me. Especially when they could knock on her door anytime and find out how's she's doing if they want. But they approach us when we're outside, clearly in the middle of things (like cutting her lawn, taking out the trash, trimming weeds, etc.), and act like we owe them answers. Meanwhile they do nothing to actually help. I'm not sure that's exactly your situation, but repeating conversations to people who aren't part of our care system is frustrating. I'd rather they just wave and go about their day - it's what they're going to do every other day when we're not there, anyway. Thankfully my mother wasn't abusive. She did her best with us, but she didn't really go out of her way to take care of us, either. She didn't trust doctors, so we hardly ever went. And when we were sick and a home remedy didn't work, she'd say, "Well, I don't know what else you want me to do about it." Which is how I feel about trying to take care of her, now. Like...we have kids and work and houses and bills of our own, we already spend every weekend either going over there and taking care of things ourselves or we spend hours every week coordinating her care, I don't know what else she wants us to do about it! Ugh...sorry OP, I really understand the frustration. Especially this part: "I'm just at the point where I don't feel anything towards her except obligation, extreme resentment and dislike." I hate that I feel this way too."

"Loved one making me feel guilty for only visiting an hour while in respite care. My mother was in respite care last week as her healthcare team wanted me to have a break. Out of the goodness of my heart, I still stopped by every day to visit for about an hour or so. The last day I only stayed 45 minutes as I had dinner plans (and had been at the social security office for 3 hours sorting out my mother's affairs). Therefore, I felt I had already given her enough time. Well, she didn't like that. She accused me of only staying a short while with, "You never stay long." Ma'am, I'm doing this as a courtesy to begin with. It's that attitude that makes me not want to visit at all. I went through this with other relatives in their last years. They would try to manipulate me into staying longer, visiting more often/calling more often, until it got to the point I visited less because I didn't want to deal with it. "Congratulations. You chastised me for only visiting for 30 minutes so now I'm not going to visit at all. Enjoy your day!""

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oxyzhw/loved_one_making_me_feel_guilty_for_only_visiting/

↳ **comment** (29): "I have experienced the same. They seem to only be aware of their own needs, everyone else has no needs and unlimited time."

↳ **comment** (18): "No one can make you feel guilty unless you already do. I have a mom like that. I used behavior modification(boundaries) to change her behavior. As soon as she started criticizing, I got up, said goodbye, and left. I didn't respond to anything else she said. I keep it polite and just left. I kept my usual schedule of visits, but would leave as soon as she startsEd. One time, I barely made it in the door and she attacked, so I said "well it looks like you are alive today" and turned around and left. She eventually got the message and I was able to hang out with her. Every once in a while, she tried again and I got up and left- even if she tried to apologize. Now, she's stage 6b dementia and is mostly just happy to see me."

↳ **comment** (14): "I'm sorry to hear that. It's too bad that some people don't understand that you get more flies with honey than vinegar. I get that they are bored and lonely but for an exhausted caregiver to have to do all the things necessary to keep them going and then have to be the entertainer as well is sometimes just too much. I am glad you got this respite week."

"I can relate to this. My mom is 84 and does live in a retirement community. I have a sibling who does nothing and is essentially estranged from her, except when it comes to birthdays and Christmas and then she reaches out with the list of things her family wants as gifts. I wish I were exaggerating... My dad was her soulmate and best friend and since he died a couple of years ago she has been sad, fragile, cranky and lonely. I do my best to be there for her but I live 3 hours away, work full time, have animals and a house to care for, and a kid with a lot of health issues that takes up a lot of my time. I am about to drive to go spend 4 days with her and do lots of tasks for her. I am equipped with a lot of weed which makes her incessant talking as well as the 1.5 hour ordeals that meals have become more bearable. (She is very formal and eats verrrrryyyy slowly and I have adhd and it is all I can do not to scream FINISH ALREADY) When I open a book she still stands over me talking. She will sometimes say "oh, I know you're trying to read" and then continues on with her talking. Every phone call becomes 45 min minimum. I often call her on the way home from work so there will be a natural ending to the call - ok, I'm home, love you, gotta go. Instead I'll sit in my driveway idling for like 15 minutes while she keeps going oh one more thing, oh, I also forgot to tell you ... She repeats stories constantly and many of them are incorrect and I know this because they directly involve me. I have learned just to smile and nod and zone out. Last summer I went up to visit her many, many times in a 2 month period and she talks about it as though I never came. It sometimes feels like it's never enough. She guilt trips my kids, who love her but who have the same issues - it's torture to be talked at constantly and to sit through endless meals (we all have adhd) and be judged for everything. She comments on every outfit they wear, every bite of food they eat, has very specific ideas about how everyone should behave and is very critical when we don't meet those expectations. I do text her daily and I try to call at least once a week. I dread the calls so much; I hate talking on the phone in general and sitting still is torture for me. I love her, and she's incredibly tiresome, and I'm really scared about how this is all going to go in the future, as the clinginess is getting worse. I'm trying so hard to be a good daughter to her. She also adamantly refused to move closer to us, which is her right, but man- it puts a huge strain on me. I wish I could stop in for 30 min with some soup I made, quick visit and then leave, as opposed to those endless marathon visits of being talked at."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_often/p21ruccl/

"My mom too. Boomers?? 😭😭 guilt tripped me my entire life. One time I let her know I can't do wiping of her bottom. I can't. I refuse to. I could barely stomach dealing with the urine. She told me "I used to wipe your ass and change your diapers!" Hello!! I didn't ask to be here!! How dare you put that on me!"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/osvihdv/

"This hits. That's why I got out. After bashing my head into the shower enough times, my brain started processing things a little differently. I didn't even communicate it. I just left. And I don't feel bad. I started taking care of my mom physically and mentally when I was 6 years old. At 30 I broke. Literally just broke and wanted us to both be dead. My siblings never helped. Her husband never helped. Her doctors never actually helped. It was all on me to drop my entire life and be her caretaker. 3 years later, I'm in the healthiest relationship of my life. Taken time away from taking care of her and working full-time. Fortunately I have a partner that understood and has given me the space to "find" myself and work through all of my trauma. During this time my brother has had to pick up the slack and has been mistreating our mother. His rude kid reached out to me recently to basically shit on me for leaving. I don't care and it doesn't phase me to not have any contact with those people. Funny enough, because my mom realized I wasn't going to come back and save the day, she's "gotten better" to an extent. I feel used and like no one even values what I did for so many years. Learning to let that all go. Happily pregnant with a baby that I plan on having (previously had 2 abortions because there was no way I could take care of her and a kid while in shitty relationships) - also because of her, I never wanted kids. I'm happy I didn't end my life and I just said fuck it, it will either work out or it won't. I'm never going to let anyone make me feel bad for leaving. The years I did

help, it's not like anyone appreciated me anyways. Now they just notice my absence. I too wish there was a system in place for what OP suggested. Our world would be a better place. But we're living during times that our administration doesn't care about the people that need assistance. We need a change in our administration and our policies. Because unfortunately not everyone can just leave like I did. Be it their finances, the shame that comes with it, or the support from at least one person, or the literal million other reasons. After I give birth I'm going to get a degree in Grant & Proposal Writing for Health and Medicine to hopefully make changes for others who are thrown into caregiving at a young age / any age... that is my goal anyways."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobvsl7/

"It makes sense that her comment hit you the wrong way. You were finally supposed to get a break, yet you still showed up every single day. That is already far more than most caregivers manage during respite, and it came on top of handling things like the social security office. You were not neglecting her. You were being responsible and caring, even on your day off. When someone is in care, time feels different for them. They have fewer distractions and they wait for the one person they rely on the most. That can turn into guilt trips or comments that land as criticism. It usually comes from fear or loneliness, not from a real assessment of what you owe them. But you do not have to absorb the weight of those feelings. You get to set limits that protect your energy. Visiting for an hour while you are supposed to be resting is already generous. Leaving after 45 minutes because you had your own life to tend to is completely reasonable. You are allowed to say something like, "I care about you and I am visiting because I want to, but I cannot stay longer than what works for me. Please do not guilt me for taking care of myself." You do not have to justify errands or appointments. You also do not have to increase your visits to soothe her anxiety. You are not the villain here. You are a caregiver who needed a break, took a small one, and still showed up. That counts."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oxyzhw/loved_one_making_me_feel_guilty_for_only_visiting/np1b4nv/

"Not dumb at all. I have no system. I do whatever when I can. I just got her into bed. She didn't brush her teeth, wouldn't let me do it. I don't trust her to swish anymore with mouthwash. Tomorrow, I'll try again. My mom can stand. However, I'm struggling to bathe her now that she has fecal incontinence. One day, she told me she was done going to the bathroom, I got her into the shower, she really wasn't done. 🤢 Since then, I've been traumatized. :(so bought wipes and I sit her down on the toilet seat riser and wash her bum with soap and water and use a plastic container to rinse her down there. Then I use wipes to clean her up I saw the aides at the facility cleaning my mom in the bed. I don't do it that way because my mom was crying and saying she was scared and thought she was going to fall when they rolled her over. She even hurled insults at them. I'm trying to avoid that. So I clean and wipe her arms and legs in bed and dress her mostly there."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/neavkzm/

"I feel silly posting because I'm 21 and everyone is dealing with so much more, I hope the stress is alleviated for y'all. My mom (51) and I care for my grandmother (85) and these 'tips' will not help with abusive elders- they are determined to drain you of what life and time you have to spite your youth, and caregivers aren't allowed to live. She will not let us leave the house, hardly even to work, and we have curfews even if the other caregiver is home. She doesn't regard us with any affection, we are her staff- lower than human, and to her we are only capable of incompetence. Dealing with this behavior for nine years, let alone my mother holding out for 50+, is absolutely unjust. Trying to get help is mountains after mountains, and we are guilt tripped and beraided for even asking to hire help so we can leave the house. No one should survive like this. I love my grandmother so, so much, but we are so broken- she has made sure our lives are only for her."

youtube · @brij9856 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=Ugy7oO6B6C6K_icJpZ94AaABAq

"I'm going through something similar, and you sharing all of this is helping me a ton. None of my friends get how hard it is trying to just coordinate the care for a parent and make sure they're getting what they need, let alone doing it for one who has been abusive and triggers the trauma reminders through the process. It seems like we may also be in the similar boat that were the only ones coordinating everything because our folks have alienated everyone else...and yet they still think it's appropriate to give their perspective or guilt trips!!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18ccwul/vent_im_exhausted_taking_care_of_someone_who/kd23dbq/

"You are not a terrible person, but your mom is. I also have a 91 year old mom who has been adamant that she will stay in her home. I personally resent all the time and energy I have to devote to her care -- at least my siblings all pitch in and do their part. But I feel every day that my mom is just a selfish a-hole. She needs to be in senior living rather than guilt tripping her family into giving up our time to sustain her choice to stay in her home out in the country."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/or7679e/

"Increasing anger and refusal of treatment from post-stroke dad. Hi everybody, I am new to posting here and to caregiving as well. I think this post will be half venting, half an ask for your read on our situation, as I feel very much in the dark during this process and am having to figure a lot of it out on my own. There is a lot of context to this, logistically and personally, that I've tried to keep as short as I can but I think is necessary to understand the situation so I hope you bear with me. I (27) have been taking care of my dad (67) for the last month and half or so now after he was found to have a massive unruptured aneurysm as well as evidence of strokes in the past, not sure how many or how long ago. He lives in South Korea, my home country, and I live in the States in San Francisco and have been for the last ten years or so. He was in the hospital for about two weeks waiting for surgery to stent the aneurysm, recovering from that and another stroke he apparently had after the procedure. The hospital system here is very different in that in the patient wards there is very minimal nurse care, they basically just do tests, distribute meds, things like that while for all caretaking needs, washing, feeding, changing diapers, recording fluid input and output etc, you either have to hire an aide from a private company (basically just random middle aged ladies who aren't required to have any training or certificates) or a family member or the patient is responsible for all care. I flew in to see him through the surgery with my aunt, and ended up becoming his 24/7 caretaker after incidents where he ripped out his catheter twice under the watch of the aide we hired, and after my aunt, who is older too, left early due to the stress. He had intense delirium and was very distressed in the hospital which made things extremely difficult, I can barely describe the combination of fear, starvation, and sleep deprivation as I was terrified to leave his side for a second to get myself something to eat or sleep for fear of him hurting himself. Since then it has just been me and him, I am his only child, my parents are separated and his only family in the country are two other siblings, both older than him, who have helped out in small ways. It seems clear that everyone sees me as being responsible for him while he is incapacitated. The surgery went well and he is out of the hospital, thank god, but he has significant cognitive deficits. He was discharged from the hospital with actually zero assessment from any kind of OT or PT physician, and his lead doctor who conducted the surgery seems almost purposefully mean and obstructive when it comes to explaining his illness, suggesting next steps, referring us to doctors or answering literally any of my questions, and seems to not care at all how my dad does now that the surgery is complete. He literally didn't even tell me when he suffered another stroke after the surgery, I had to find out from the rehab med doctor when he read his scans weeks later. The neurologist and rehab doctor haven't communicated at all, no assessment or treatment plan there either, he barely even talked to him, just kind of asked me what his symptoms were. So after discharge I just tried to research what kind of care he

would need and got him into a hybrid "day inpatient" rehab therapy program which he's been doing the last couple weeks. As far as I can tell, stroke patients need as intensive therapy as they can handle as soon as possible after the stroke for maximum recovery of ability. It's the most intense therapy option I could find for him which wasn't inpatient, which I think would be detrimental to his success and besides he doesn't really qualify for many of them as he is fully mobile. It's a three-month program, he gets two 1.5 hour sessions of combined PT and OT five days a week at the hospital, with a three hour unsupervised break in the middle. There are no nurses to help him with his meds, check if he eats, or help him navigate between his room on the 8th floor and the therapy room on the 15th floor which he has difficulty with given his goldfish memory so I have to be with him the whole day. My dad is kind of an eccentric guy, he is a very intense scholar and used to be a Buddhist monk before he had me so he's always been very detached, a better word might be avoidant, from the everyday nitty gritty of life. As you might imagine he's pretty solitary, extremely independent and protective of his freedom and daily routine. He has been lucky to be in relatively good health and so has kind of gotten away with neglecting it his whole life, he's always smoked like a chimney and has probably not gone to the hospital once in at least the last couple decades. I have been increasingly distant from him the last few years on account of some of his more toxic traits. I do love my dad and we were very close especially when I was a kid, but he has a very volatile temper, can be very sensitive and passive aggressive and put my mom through hell with emotional and even sometimes physical abuse that I didn't find out about until after they separated. Once I became an adult he showed that side to me more and more and I was kind of just over it. In hindsight I could see lapses of memory and signs of cognitive decline that stretch back months, if not years; getting lost in a parking lot, totalling and giving up his car, sending me the same texts over and over. But honestly with his odd personality, his tendency to fixate on just a couple obsessions (his work) and ignore everything else, it never occurred to me that something might actually be wrong with him. I just found him exhausting to be around and removed myself from his life as he was struggling alone, more and more. After all that context, my present concern is his attitude and anger issues which have been emerging in the last few days. He had been having spells of depression and lethargy throughout this process, "I might as well die" type thinking, but it's been relatively easy to deal with up until now as he was more receptive to listen to me when I tried to talk him out of it, and if I couldn't he would go to sleep that night and wake up like he didn't remember it anymore. I'm not sure what triggered it but the last four days he's been increasingly moody, not just depressed but angry, especially at me, lashing out and yelling at me about random things. It came to a head this morning, Friday, the last day of his first full week of therapy, when he categorically refused to go to the hospital and insisted on going to his office instead. He would scream at me and become very angry every time I tried to talk him out of it, and kept just straight up trying to leave so I was forced to go with him. He was like that the entire morning, saying he has nothing to live for so he is going to choose to not get treatment, not take his meds and die, and if I wanted him to go I was going to have to call the cops on him or lock him up. All of this directed at me with shouting and yelling. It's kind of classic behavior for him; guilt tripping, threatening to hurt himself to hurt me, twisting my words and making everything an attack, but he'd been getting better about it the last few years, I chalked it up to him mellowing with age. One of his sunbaes (Korean term, an older guy he works with in his research who he likes and looks up to) came by the office and chatted with him for a bit and was able to talk him down a lot in a way that I couldn't at all, and he's now saying he's willing to go through the program. We did end up missing the whole day of therapy. He's only been in this therapy program for a week or so but I can already see him making progress; he was barely able to read or write, speak correctly, use the toilet properly when he first got out of the hospital, and now he is able to do most of his personal care tasks on his own, take public transit to and from his old office and home without my help, and continually surprises me with abilities I thought he had lost. I think it's ironically part of his recovery that is allowing him to express more of his own will and the way he chooses to use that is to lash out and punish me for trying to help him. I know he is incapacitated in some ways and clearly deeply depressed due to his loss of ability but today was really really hard for me. I just wasn't able to see him as a scared or impaired guy in need of my help; he was my old dad with his devil's temper, screaming at me until I cry and then screaming at me to stop crying. Nothing I said helped, everything just made him angrier, like just looking at me be

sad was making him angry. He does care about me and I think that part of his anger is his guilt over me taking care of him and having to put my life on hold is too much for him to handle so he takes the familiar pattern of lashing out. But I was just so so so over it today, I've felt this a million times but I just wanted to wal"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mx868m/increasing_anger_and_refusal_of_treatment_from/

"Just as it takes a village to look after a child it is the same at the other end of life but often left to 1 or 2 adult children. My mother used to trail faeces up the hall. She was forever falling over. Nearly killed my brother who lived with her. I took over so he could have a holiday & had to beg the ambulance to take mum to hospital after they came to help me get her up off the floor. Hospital staff gossiped that I refused to take her home. We were despairing & I worked in aged care. I had to shower my stepfather & shave him & he was not cooperative. I also was a registeted nurse in nursing homes & it can be so hard to deal with the behavioural problems. Using a onzy on back to front to stop the person with dementia smearing faeces all over their room & so on & so on. No person should ever put the "don't put me in a home" guilt trip. I have told my family if I can't make my own decisions, put me in a home & keep me comfortable but do not keep me alive just for the sake of it with course after course of antibiotics."

youtube · @mazdodd4145 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyaA_Aqt_w3sOOEd9p4AaABAg

Guilty for wanting my own life / for wanting it to be over · 31 documents

20 most engaged of 31 matching documents, complete text.

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"At some point, you have to pick living over death. It seems like you have said "I love you" and the eventual passing will not be a surprise. You have already cancelled one vacation. So, if you can go and not feel guilty, and enjoy your vacation, then go. Get prepared for the possibility that some family or friends might try to make you feel guilty. Sounds to me that you have already had a difficult time, and you have earned your rest & relaxation."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 113 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/oo7367x/

"Am I A Terrible Person?. My 91 year old mother fell and broke her hip last week. She had a partial hip replacement done and is in rehab. There's so much resentment built up on my part and I'm not sure it's all justified. Mom lives 4 hours away from me in another state. My sister (the favored child) used to live 10 minutes away from her , so it was always assumed she'd have someone near to her to help her. But she sold her house and up and moved across the country suddenly. So mom was left alone. I've lived in another state for many years. I was a caregiver for many years of my life. My late daughter had physical disabilities and my husband died of heart failure. I'm now the one who will take care of my mom. I'm tired. I have asked mom to move down to where I'm at and she has refused. Every excuse in the book. I've told her I'd be with her every step of the way if she is scared. I've told her she could move in with me or we could find a senior apt nearby. We can't afford assisted living. Refused. I've told her that if she didn't want to move to my state we could find her a place in the town she is in because she really shouldn't be in the house I grew up in. Dangerous steps and short. She had refused. Repeatedly. I've told her it would be easier for me and in the long run, for her. She doesn't care. Now I'm stuck driving up to her and staying in her house every few weeks in order to see how she progresses in rehab. I have to leave my own home and responsibilities in order for her to remain satisfied. I also am stuck trying to figure out where she will go after rehab. She think she is just going to waltz back into her home like nothing ever happened, even though they've to us it might be a whole year before she's even able to navigate around .Her home has 2 flights of stairs, laundry in the concrete floored basement, and a slick porcelain bathtub. Despite my objections she continued to drive up until the accident. She became quite hateful when I mentioned not driving anymore. She had had several mishaps with her car and had become lost several times. I'm the only one who seems to think it's dangerous for

her to drive. She guards her keys now and talks about her car incessantly. I refuse to let her drive if she recuperates. I refuse. I'm ashamed to admit the fact that I resent her stubborn behavior. My whole life I was basically ignored because she was so enamored with my dysfunctional sister. She practically raised my sister's children and has financially bailed my sister out of messes many times. I've never asked for help from my mom, and she didn't even attend my husband's funeral. But here I am. The daughter who it all falls on. I feel guilty admitting that I resent it. I resent the fact that this is so hard on me logistically because she only cared about herself. She had to stay near her male friend, so now I'm required to leave my home unattended for weeks in order to help her. My son has to drive from another town to stay with my dog, get my mail, and water my garden. She didn't plan financially in order to go to assisted living or accommodating housing. Instead she spent all her money on shopping for clothes and jewelry. Vanity is her thing. I'm struggling greatly with terrible resentment. She's my mom and I'll help her, of course. I've always tried my best to be respectful. But she has been so selfish and hurtful over the years. It's so hard for me to get over this. Am I a terrible person?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/

↳ **comment** (58): "You are not a terrible person. I think anyone in your situation would feel resentful, angry and betrayed. Your sister left when your mother had nothing left to give her and might actually need something back. That is not your problem. I don't think you should have to swoop in and pick up the pieces. Your Mom made choices and is still making them. Let the rehab facility get social work involved and they can decide with your Mom what her options are. If you stay you will be used by the system and an ungrateful mother. You have responsibilities to your own life and to your son who is now being impacted."

↳ **comment** (50): "Have her primary care physician pull her license. That makes the doctor the bad person not you. Does anyone have health care power of attorney for your mother? Has she had a recent cognitive test? Doesn't sound as though she is mentally capable of making her own decisions so you may just have to be the "bad guy" and place her where she safely needs to be. I'm sorry. It's a tough situation."

↳ **comment** (46): "You are not a terrible person. Make sure that everyone knows that she has NO ONE upon discharge that lives nearby, and she will be on her own. Do not cooperate. You can be as stubborn as she is. You do not have to take what she dishes out. She moves from rehab to where you can reach her without leaving your home overnight. Or she's completely on her own, because you are not coming. That's her choice."

"I ended up with BOTH my unexpectedly bedridden father, 87, and my fall risk, heart failure mother, 85 in January. Diapers four times a day since then, and stockpiling diapers. In my late 50's, siblings not a factor in care. Hospice has helped. My parents cannot care for themselves anymore, but they demanded to stay in their home. When I brought them to mine, Mom claimed I kidnapped her and calls all her neighbors that I have her stuck down here, while I change her husbands(dad's) diapers and cook three meals a day, and wash sheets daily. Thank you for this video. My mom is going to end up going where she can afford... which is here:(Dad is currently dying in the next few hours, and I am not even feeling guilty about the sense of relief that he can finally stop suffering."

youtube · @AliSouth-m3i · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 44 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw7DVeyhTmdeZvSYWx4AaABAg

↳ **@HorseLady1109** (2): "@AliSouth-m3i So sorry for your loss and the situation you find yourself in. Find support and relief where you can."

↳ **@Teffi_Club** (0): "Hope your father had a peaceful transition. Blessings.💕"

"The Saga Continues... Hi All, I'm back with another update on my dad and (as always lately 😊) looking for some encouragement and advice. Last time I shared (<https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/s/tq4d54p4mi>), I (40F, only child) was venting about being the primary caregiver for my dad (81) after losing my mom last year. Well,

things have been moving quickly. Dad was in the hospital for two weeks, then spent three weeks in rehab. He was discharged just yesterday—which I only learned about on Friday—so I spent the weekend scrambling to find a facility with space for him. For some context: before his hospital stay, Dad was still walking and driving, but he wasn't really caring for himself. He was malnourished, dehydrated, and honestly living mostly off Chardonnay and Amaretto. Now, post-hospitalization, things have changed: he's in a wheelchair, has a Foley catheter, and I've noticed some cognitive issues, especially with short-term memory and reasoning. Based on input from the rehab social worker, my CarePatrol rep, and the head nurse at the assisted living community, everyone agreed that memory care assisted living would be the best fit. Here's the part I'm struggling with: in the past week, he's actually made noticeable improvements. He can now stand for about three minutes, has remembered that my mom passed (something he had forgotten), and overall seems much sharper than before. This has me second-guessing my decision. Did I rush into an expensive memory care placement? Should I have tried to bring him home instead? But then reality hits me. To make his house wheelchair accessible would take a huge amount of work, and he would require almost constant nursing care. I've also read that when older adults leave rehab and go straight home, their condition can often decline quickly without the constant and protective support of the rehab. So now I'm caught between guilt and relief. On one hand, it feels like the system pushed me into a costly option. On the other hand, he's now in a place where he'll get consistent care, social interaction, and attention that he hasn't had since my mom passed. I guess what I really need right now is some affirmation that I did the right thing. 😊 "

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nv5e2p/the_saga_continues/

"I've been growing more aware recently of my parents growing older and it's honestly a scary thought. My Mom is my closest friend and biggest confidante and I literally can't imagine a time when I can't just call her or send her a message when I'm feeling stressed or doubtful. That thought worries me so much... especially as she gets older. But I know also that all I can do is enjoy my time with her, make as many memories as possible and love her while she's here... And regardless of what others think, I have to believe there is something for our loved ones even beyond this earth. The beauty and magnificence of life is a cycle and we're all apart of it... thank you for reading this stranger. 💖 "

youtube · @Saffron831 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 15 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhikEw&lc=UgwwHHOW9-DafgcSy9jZ4AaABAg>

↳ @kd-zd6zi (o): "I feel exactly the same, recently it's all that I think of."

"Also just wanted to say thank you for doing this. I can't think of any questions now but have saved your post for the future. I've been care giving for 7 years now. Have 2 wonderful carers that come and help and *I manage to work full time still. It is ALOT. I'm now navigating trying to conceive as I've given up most of my mid-20's and early 30's doing this and I'm just struggling with the guilt and also resentment. Thank you again for sharing your wisdom here, it truly is so appreciated. ❤️❤️ "

reddit comment · r/dementia · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/oktgwam/

"I cared for aging parents for decades. After my mom passed I moved my early dementia dad in with me for 3 years. He made me promise him that I wouldn't put him in a facility when his mind was much clearer. I pleaded with my siblings for some help- just a break so my husband and I could go away for a weekend or just out for dinner. Not one offer nor did they even respond to my pleas. My dad decided to sell his home and again not a speck of help from my siblings. He was forced against his will to have the covid shots and very shortly after his dementia went off the map. I tried to hire in help with no luck during covid and I was forced to put him in a nursing home. I deal with horrendous guilt as he died very alone and lonely in a nursing home. I was banned from

visiting him. To this day I have zero communication with my able bodied siblings- they let me and my dad down horribly but they felt very entitled to fill their gas tanks from my dad's account. He passed 2 1/2 years ago and if I had to do it again I would but would have hired help in place and not depend on selfish siblings"

youtube · @fluffyanne1177 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxoQXDewW75Avvnh114AaABAq

↳ **@reginafarias** (3): "I will never forget the poor mom whose family wanted to take and treat her at home, during covid, but the nursing home didn't allow them and she died alone. I will never forget I left my dad alone in the hospital for a few hours and they kiwi him. I deal with horrendous guilt too."

↳ **@lisaorth3255** (3): "I'm so sorry this happened. It wasn't your fault how he passed away. I hope you can give yourself credit for all you did do to contribute to your parents' care that surely did alleviated more prolonged suffering for them and allow yourself some happiness and peace at this point in time."

↳ **@cdixon2011ify** (0): "Exactly. I know how you feel. I've dealt with that, but just like passing of parents you make peace knowing you provided love when they needed it. But for the rest you just have to move on and not look back. I just had a conversation with someone how family can turn out to treat you worse than your enemy."

"This is so beautiful and thank you for sharing. I'm so very sorry about the loss of your mom. My dad died last month. I rearranged my life to come take care of him leaving my husband to do this. I feel so guilty that I resented caring for him at times and sometimes lost my patience with him. I loved my dad so much. I should have been nicer. I did try to cater to him as much as possible. I'm now caring for my mom and my husband was able to come out for awhile and be here when dad died. I'm tryin to have more patience but it's hard. We all need to give ourselves grace. Caregiving is the hardest job in the world. Sending you much love and hugs."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/ownvb96/

"You're so right about this financial issue actually being inevitable. We've been so busy putting out fires and trying to take it one issue at a time that I don't quite think I had processed that or made space for that thought in my brain. It changes how I look at this and I suppose I have to go ahead and start having conversations about how they're going to survive after this, Medicaid SNF or not."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qjlcjn/what_is_up_with_this_trend_among_social_workers/o15qhd1/

"It makes sense that her comment hit you the wrong way. You were finally supposed to get a break, yet you still showed up every single day. That is already far more than most caregivers manage during respite, and it came on top of handling things like the social security office. You were not neglecting her. You were being responsible and caring, even on your day off. When someone is in care, time feels different for them. They have fewer distractions and they wait for the one person they rely on the most. That can turn into guilt trips or comments that land as criticism. It usually comes from fear or loneliness, not from a real assessment of what you owe them. But you do not have to absorb the weight of those feelings. You get to set limits that protect your energy. Visiting for an hour while you are supposed to be resting is already generous. Leaving after 45 minutes because you had your own life to tend to is completely reasonable. You are allowed to say something like, "I care about you and I am visiting because I want to, but I cannot stay longer than what works for me. Please do not guilt me for taking care of myself." You do not have to justify errands or appointments. You also do not have to increase your visits to soothe her anxiety. You are not the villain here. You are a caregiver who needed a break, took a small one, and still showed up. That counts."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oxyzhw/loved_one_making_me_feel_guilty_for_only_visiting/np1b4nv/

"You are absolutely right! My mother has been so mean to me my entire life now expects me to bring her home from the nursing home. I'm the only child of an only child. My mother would never prepare. Luckily I was able to convince her to sign POA to me lately so Medicaid can't take the house. My husband and I have worked ourselves to death cleaning her hoarder house and getting repairs done. It's going to end up costing us a small fortune for all of the needed repairs. Her living conditions were atrocious when she was home but she refused to let us clean or repair it then. Now it has snowballed. She calls me daily trying to talk me into bringing her home. She's total care and I'm almost 61, with a pacemaker and numerous other medical conditions. There's no way I could do the lifting etc. I feel guilt and resentment wrapped up in one. I feel sorry for anyone else going through this."

youtube · @amythompson6869 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 5 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwWGVNsFbzTlgMJSiF4AaABAg

↳ @Highheel-shoe-review (o): "She's able to go to a care home and keep her house?"

"Thank you so much for your honesty and candor. No one knows how difficult caregiving of an elderly parent is unless they have actually been in the trenches themselves. It is overwhelming and exhausting physically, emotionally, mentally, and at times, even spiritually!! Yes, resentment can build up and then I feel guilty for feeling resentful! Thank you for explaining that I am not the only one who feels this way. I have had a great deal of adversity in my life but, taking care of my 93 year old mother, full time for the past 3 years is by far the most difficult time of my life. She is completely non ambulatory, incontinent, deaf, has dementia, heart failure, and is losing the ability to chew her food. I sometimes worry that due to all of my stress, I may die before my mother. There is no one else to care for her and then she would have to go to a nursing home after all. God Bless all caregivers 🙏 "

youtube · @NanaJ-q7r · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 4 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugxmp_1G3_4_9AsSakN4AaABAg

"I feel your pain. I have lived those days. I'm so sorry that you are going through this too. :(I tell my mom how mean she is and how she doesn't care about anyone but herself. She never makes anything easy. I'll hear her saying she needs to help people and I'm like, HELP ME!! Just drink the damn water, tea, hot chocolate!!! Or eat the food that I've prepared. I'm so sick of it. Then the delusions and the days when I'm requesting that she do something like open her mouth so I can brush her teeth, but she just sits there and doesn't move or respond and stares at me because she doesn't want to. How do I know??? Because the moment I yell, then she starts yelling at me that I can't tell her what to do. And you're right, this IS HELL. So many times I've talked to God that if I'm going to die anyway for my sins, take me in my sleep, please. And then I instantly regret that thought because I don't really want to die and I want to be here to help her. If not me, who else?!!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/nem00ji/

"I should see my mother abandoning me at 14 and really, emotionally abandoning me since I was born as a blessing in disguise in adulthood. She didn't earn any privilege with me, for me to take care of her at all, when she really begins to break down. I think she's 75. She's a malignant narcissist, who always loved money more than her own children. So her money can take care of her and the government. I can continue living a guilt free and stress less life, only having to think of myself. Halleluyah. Thanks for the video and everyone who shared in the comments."

youtube · @Natureispeace444 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugy9e60Zw8JOxlrnTfB4AaABAq

"My dad was on hospice and we continued with our family vacation. He would have wanted us to. Go on your vacation guilt free ❤️"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/oo79xar/

"I'm my mother in laws caregiver, and at first it was 7 days a week. Me and my husband live with her so it is in home, and I was so burnt out with my health starting to fail me. Now it is me and one of her younger children, I thankfully work much less days and now I am desperately trying to get my health to a better place. It has also caused some riffs between me and her, even some tiffs between me and my hubby. I honestly applaud anyone willing to help out someone family or not, but I am unable to say I'd ever recommend it. Even with less hours/days, I am still stressed because we live together. My bedroom is my sanctuary, yet every big boom has me thinking she fell. It's a toll no one should pay. ♥ Then there is the guilt, the feeling that you are a shit person for not wanting to do this for anyone, the guilt of wanting to have my own place with just me and my husband. I wouldn't want anyone family or friend having to spend their life, their "free" time taking care of me, and I honestly just wanna work on myself, my health, and my relationship."

youtube · @AmandaL23185 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugzo510p4_ZsWbPQdWd4AaABAq

"Get your paperwork in order. Just having their verbal okay for them to be placed in a home/assisted living place isn't enough. My mom refused to leave her home no matter what, and I didn't have any legal recourse because she was still legally capable and I didn't have legal power of attorney. (I only had medical.) Didn't matter that she couldn't take care of her bodily functions, clean her home even in minor ways, operate a car, pay her bills or deal with any stress. I cared for both my parents, who were 80-90, for 5 years. And then I was the sole care taker of my mom for 5. There were no other family members willing ...no siblings...and no financial resources for home health care. She died last year, and I felt guilty for the relief I felt. But for the first time in 10 years my life was my own. The last 2 years were a nightmare due to her dementia and illostomy bag. The stress nearly destroyed my marriage, put me in the hospital and my son was emotionally scarred too. No loving parent would require that from their child."

youtube · @carolwhite8870 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwHgHpDYzpHKLm6K94AaABAq

"Yvette Sutton Karcher · · · 21h · I understand with every fiber of my being your vent and your exhaustion! I lived it! My mother moved into my house 5 months after I remarried. My children were in 6th grade and 1st grade. I was in my second year as a high school teacher teaching biology and human anatomy and physiology. My mom went on dialysis two weeks after arriving at my house. Unfortunately, my brand new husband was o help a d withdrew the longer she lived with us. I know your exhaustion! I understand wanting it to be over. I understand the guilt over thinking you want it to be over. Let me assure you - you are simply tired in a way most will never understand or experience. You are not wishing your mom was dead. You are being human and just want a break. To breathe. To pause. To not live in a constant state of alert. To not feel pulled in a hundred different directions. I get it all! Sending you hugs and prayers and understanding · Reply · Share · 2"

fb group · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/1581265219534379/posts/1800034654324100/>

Guilty for putting them in a home · 24 documents

17 most engaged of 24 matching documents, complete text.

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of

mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"I'm enjoying the joy of my mom while bearing (and enjoying?) the suffering of my Dad.. Dad is fifteen years older than my Mom. She's just in her mid sixties. She's always been our family's foundation. She's been the lifeblood. The passion, the joyfulness. She's been the one who brought the holiday spirit, the connection between people in every festive occasion. She's been the one that drove our family and built it up. She's been the homemaker, the children caretaker, the husband caretaker, the health watcher, the meal maker, the every single thing maker. Dad made a paycheck and retreated to his personal hobbies. Mom got shit because she never 'made money'. But the only person who made this all work was her. She made sure we loved our Dad. She made us greet him everyday he came home from work. She made us thankful for his contributions. She made sure we celebrated him every fathers day, every birthday, every holiday. She excused his behavior by reminding us constantly that he was our Dad. And he was the reason that we have everything we have because of the money he earned. There's obviously more to this than I can share in a post but this, for me, is the essence. Dad always promised Mom that he would fulfill her life wishes to travel after he retired. Well he got Parkinsons and got sick before he retired. And now he needs basically round the clock care. He still is guiltig mom for taking any time for herself. If she's not there every three hours to give him his pills or hand present his home cooked meals, breakfast - lunch - and dinner - then he gets irate as he could never make a meal for himself. She's delayed a much needed double knee replacement surgery because she's had to take care of him. Who knows when he would freeze up too much and might need someone to lift him up and move him so obviously she's the one who has to help him (sarcastic). She's felt so guilty putting him in a nursing home a couple weeks ago. One (like most any of them) won't provide him with such on demand service as his wife once provided. He won't get his pills exactly on time. His meals won't always be to his liking. It may take longer for someone to be summoned to his beck and call when he pushes the button on his neck to clean up after him or calm him down. But I'm so joyful today. I'll tell you why. I splurged on Mom. She already booked her trip to another country to visit her sister and I splurged on a crazy expensive three day stay at a lakefront cabana for her and her sister to stay in. Just watching the videos she's sent me from her stay has made me cry. She's never stayed in such luxury. She's barely left the property she's so thrilled. There are windows everywhere to the lakefront and she can see mountains and all the birds that frequent the area. There's even a private heated pool at her disposal. I'm so happy she finally can relax for a bit. I'm living close to where Dad is homed so I can show up in an emergency. But knowing that she is just living it up without any worries is making me SO SO HAPPY. I don't know how to keep this feeling going. I don't know what to do beyond this gesture. But for right now, I'm thrilled and am so so happy to give her something so good for her heart and soul. Something she's wanted for years and years. I know she wanted to travel with him. But he never wanted to travel, he still doesn't. He just wants to be taken care of. I can't break this to her in a way that won't break her heart so I can only help make some of these things happen. Edit: I dunno if any of y'all have these kind of family members. But I'm watching these videos she's sharing that she's obviously making for her siblings and friends. They are 'tours' of her stay. Showing how grand the bathroom is, what the view looks like from the bedroom, how the kitchen looks like and the outdoor area. They weren't made for me, they were points of pride to share with these others that she's also just sharing with me. There's a video where she's showing how the bathroom works, and what view the shower has. She's walking outdoors to demonstrate what amenities there are in the patio. And how their particular cabana is close to the other two cabanas but that her cabana is the 'penthouse' one. She's never had luxurious things to share like this and she's so happy and I can't help but watch and rewatch these videos she's sharing with me."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 176 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ppgrt2/im_enjoying_the_joy_of_my_mom_while_bearing_and/

"Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxctv6p/

"The End of a Caregiving Era. I started my journey of daily, increasingly demanding and finally all-consuming eldercare back in 2015, when it became clear my mom could no longer physically look after my dad any more but I was still raising my three young sons and couldn't do it all on my own either. That was when I made the first round of phone calls to our local government and health care agencies to see what help was available, and the first workers started arriving to help Dad shower a couple of times a week and sometimes get dressed in the morning. Neither he nor my mom really wanted strangers coming into the house, but they did reluctantly agree that it was too much to expect me to do all Dad's care single-handed while looking after my own family at the same time. I'm so glad now that I took that step of introducing one or two regular caregivers early in the process, even a little earlier than my parents thought was necessary, because it made it so much easier to bring in more help later on. But even with all the helpers we could find or afford, it got to a point where Dad's day-to-day care, and later Mom's, was more than I could handle without breaking. After ten years of having their needs on my mind 24/7, lying awake at night trying to solve all their mental and physical problems in my head, being constantly aware that if anything happened to me my parents would be helpless and nobody else in my family would be able to take over (or at least, not without a huge amount of distress, confusion, and radical changes for everyone involved), I was burned out and exhausted. I'd hoped to keep them both at home until the end, I'd really thought that barring some kind of catastrophe it would be possible, I felt guilty at the thought of uprooting them, but it was also clear -- by God's grace and direction -- that it was time. They needed more help than I could give them even if I dedicated myself to their care 24 hours a day, and I knew neither one of them would have wanted me to neglect my own husband and family or give up everything else in my life to do that. Something had to change. My Dad was the first to move, back in 2019. He wasn't a big man, but by then he was dead weight, with no strength left in his legs, and it took two people or a mechanical lift to assist him. He had to go to a nursing home, and because it needed to happen fast, we weren't able to get our first choice of facility. The place was understaffed and overworked and the food was pretty awful, but it was clean and everybody was trying their best. He lived there for eight months, with my mom visiting him every day, before he passed in early 2020. At that time, Mom was still pretty mobile and cognitively sharp, able to make meals and do her laundry and such on her own -- but then the pandemic kept her even more housebound and isolated than usual, and a mild bout of COVID wrecked her ability to accurately recognize spoken words even with hearing aids (from 56% pre-COVID to 16% afterward). By late 2023 she was showing increasing signs of confusion and struggling with the activities of daily living, and in mid-2024 she began having attacks of sudden, excruciating nerve pain that required immediate heavy-duty pain meds, as well as a daily maintenance dose of gabapentin. Things went even faster downhill from there, until she could no longer be safely left alone at any time, ever. Even going out for a 30-minute walk once turned into a three-hour ordeal of Mom in agony because I wasn't there when she started a pain attack, and the guilt (for me) and distress (for her) was too much for me to ever risk that happening again. Anyway, this week I moved Mom out of my home and into assisted living. It's the strangest feeling knowing -- or sometimes forgetting, then remembering with a jolt -- that she's no longer downstairs in her apartment, sitting in her rocking chair with one of our cats in her lap, waiting for me to check on her. That when I wake up every morning, I don't have to hurry downstairs to give Mom her morning pills and make sure everything she needs is set up and ready for the day. That it's no longer my

responsibility to make sure she's had breakfast and make her lunch and dinner, or keep checking the garbage bin to make sure she's actually eaten her food and not thrown it out. That if she gets muddled at night and doesn't know what to do with her day clothes or where to find her pyjamas, if she folds up her dirty underwear and puts it in with the clean ones instead of in the laundry when it belongs, if she wears the same outfit for two or three days because she doesn't remember she already wore it, that's an issue for her caregivers to address instead of me having to solve it on my own. Not that I've stopped thinking about Mom's needs, or trying to anticipate them. For the past few days I've been in regular touch with her care team, making sure they're up to date on all her medications and support needs and so on. Yesterday when I came to visit, I put labels on the drawers and various sections of her closet to make it easier for her (and the caregivers) to find everything, and I took her dead wristwatch home with me to put in a new battery. But that's all easy stuff, things I can do when it's convenient. I no longer have to drop everything and rush to fix all her problems right away. Better still, I don't have to carry the weight of being the only person Mom can fully rely on, the only one who knows all the details of her health conditions and her medications, her hopes and expectations. I don't have to arrange my days and weeks around her care schedule, and wait for a paid support worker or visiting family member to spell me off before I can leave the house. I can actually go out for more than 3-4 hours at a time, enjoy a leisurely visit with a friend, even leave town and drive to another city for a day -- something I haven't been able to do for ages. I can take a walk with my husband, instead of always taking turns so Mom isn't left alone; we can go out for dinner, or do an overnight getaway, without having to plan and prepare for it weeks in advance. After ten years of intense daily caregiving, first for my father (who had Parkinson's, used a wheelchair, and needed to be helped on and off the toilet every 30-45 min all day) and then for my housebound and increasingly confused mother, being free to go anywhere, any time, feels like a wild luxury. I'm not sorry that I kept my parents at home as long as I was able. I have no regrets about the time I spent looking after them, even though it was sometimes difficult, exhausting and emotionally very hard to do it. I have a lot to be grateful for when it comes to my parents and our relationship over the years, and I am truly thankful for that. But I'm also not sorry that when caring for them became so overwhelming that it was taking over my life, affecting my emotional and mental health, forcing me to prioritize my parents over my husband and children, and keeping me from doing anything creative or restful for myself, I chose to give up full-time care and move them into assisted living. It was hard to break the news to them, hard to see them struggle with it, we all shed tears over it, but once the move finally happened, it didn't take long to recognize that it was truly the best thing for all of us. If anybody has questions about caring for your parents at home and/or the process of transitioning them to full-time care, particularly in Canada (Ontario), please ask and I'll do my best to answer. If you can find the RIGHT assisted living residence (and thank God I have, it's both affordable and perfectly suited to Mom's needs) it's a wonderful relief."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 59 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iq68hc/the_end_of_a_caregiving_era/

↳ **comment** (7): "I went through this with my parents. I was taking care of them in their house until it became so overwhelmingly difficult that I was literally having panic attacks and had a meltdown. It was a hard decision and they didn't want it but moving them to assisted living has been such a game changer for me. I'm finally feeling a bit like my old self! I hope you get to as well. Of course there is plenty to be done but not having to make meals among all the other tasks is the best!"

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. I am just beginning my caretaking journey. My mother is in the hospital as I type this and I am getting the house ready to have her come home. At this point in time, she is unable to lift her cup to her mouth. Last weekend she was able to do all the things. Life happens so fast."

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for posting this! This brings me some relief. I am 2 years into my caregiving journey, I work from home and my FiL lives with us. This is the hardest thing I've ever done in my life, it's nice to know that you feel some sense of normalcy at the end of it all."

"You're bringing guilt on yourself my friend. No one in my family believed they could or should care for my LO w LBD. There was never a question about whether institutionalization was the right thing to do. Truly, not everyone feels guilt about placing a dementia patient in memory care. There was no sacrificial lamb in my family able to give their life over to the care of a severely affected family member. We all have multiple people dependent on our incomes. There is no question as to whether it was the right thing to do. Of course it was."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 55 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/oyum6e2/

"Burned Out & Beat Up!. Ok so this is a rant! A long one. If you read it thanks if it's too much I get it. I'm putting this down for myself as much to get it off my chest and lighten my mind/stress I guess. But first background: I'm usually an upbeat person, always have been, always look on the bright side, acknowledge the fact that others are in worse situations than me, so as to keep myself aware (centered/in-check). I stay clear of Debbie Downers, Negative Nelly's, and KARENS too. Those type folks suck the life right out of you. Sorry I wish them well, it's just life is way too short for all that drama. So my husband and I retired a few years back. Both of us started working when we were teenagers, like a lot of our generation, so we retired early. Now: So we, newly retired, like right out of the gate retired, no celebratory vacation either, and we become full time care givers to my mother. We all "decided/chose" to move in together into a new house, not newly built but perfect for our physical needs especially for my mother. She was fine when we moved in, of course very sad to sell/give up her home, but she said she knew it was the right decision and it's what God wanted/planned for her/us. Her only alternative was a nursing home, because physically she couldn't live in an assisted living facility because she requires too much assistance/care. She couldn't live in our old home because we had stairs and no bedroom suite on the first floor. Plus she couldn't continue paying for PT private home health care because she now needed FT care and not enough \$\$ to pay for it. Side note.....all those supplemental insurance commercials advertising how they can help the elderly age in place (at home) it's all bullshit! I They DO NOT offer COVERED in-home care or drivers to take them to and from doctor appointments. The elderly still pay out of pocket one way or the other either high insurance premiums or straight out of their checking/savings accounts. So they'd have no money left over to pay for basic needs like food and utilities. AND my mother was already paying a monthly premium for additional/supplemental insurance coverage. AND those special services offered via city/county "Offices on Aging", well most won't qualify because they make too much \$ annually. For example in my mom's situation, she receives a retirement pension, SS, and Medicare benefits due to her age. Yes I called the office and no she doesn't qualify. I also asked about the services listed for support of family care givers like the babysitting your elderly parent services so caregivers can get a break. Well nope don't qualify for that either cause she makes too much money. How you wonder does she make too much money. Well because the ENTIRE households income is accounted/calculated for qualification of city/county services. Yep that's right my husband's and my annual retirement pensions was added to her annual income for a total of "SHE" makes too much! We don't get paid for providing her physical care, monthly expenses, reimbursement for gas or vehicle wear and tear to get her to her doctor appointments, yet you'll add our retirement income to her income. Wow! Yes I love my mother dearly. Anyway.....now to today. She isn't the same person at all. In fact I've realized she wasn't the person I thought I knew for years. Its kind of pissed me off honestly. She had issues that needed to be addressed years ago! That damn generation and sweeping crap under their rugs ugh! So on her nasty days she loves to tell us the following comments: you've got it made, you made out, blah blah. We've got it made!!??? What the fuck is she talking about. We gave up our lives to care for her! She's another full time job, basically, and we don't receive any salary. She is selfish, hateful, ungrateful, hurtful to me and my husband for all the care we give her. Remember she was adamant that she didn't want to go into a nursing home and I/we didn't want that for her either. I'd feel guilty as hell putting her in one of them. Plus she always brought up how one of her older relatives was put in a horrible nursing home, and each time my folks visited, the lady would beg them to take her with them. Mom always said how she wasn't even in her immediate family and questioned whether the lady's family visited her. Plus I promised my dad before he passed that I'd take care of my mom. Now remember I said everything started out great in the beginning. I had a great child hood growing up

with my mother albeit as I got older I realized she had some weird quirks but I didn't know what exactly. She wasn't crazy and I do not mean that in a mean way I'm being serious. But I strongly feel that because these "quirks" never got addressed by either therapy, a doctor or with meds it just festered and may have laid the ground work for what she's got now which is psychosis from Parkinson's of which she does not accept. And NO she doesn't have dementia, she is cognizant, passes those doctor tests still today. She's bitter and blames us for her issues.....all of them, everything, whatever she's mad about it's mine or our fault. To everyone else she puts on the sweet little old lady persona and acts like a normal old person. To us she's rarely the sweet lady anymore instead we never know what/who/how she'll act on any given day. She lies constantly, won't take accountability for her part/role in disagreements and we totally believe she likes to stir things up, start things on purpose. If she hears us laughing having a good day, and she's miserable well it's like she has to try and ruin our good mood. Remember I'm a positive person, and she is not ever. Again in regard to Dementia, no she doesn't have it. She's aware of what she's doing especially the change in demeanor when other people are around. It's just sickening! Why do I keep mentioning this well it's because people always assume and say to me "well she's obviously got dementia" ugh SMH!!! So I guess in closing I'm offering a bit of advice to you. When faced with or contemplating having your parent move in with you, while they are great right now, consider the possibility that down the road you may be faced with caring for someone you no longer recognize. In our case the changes happened within a short time, maybe a little over a year of moving in together. To those younger than us that have young kids still living at home think real hard because the dynamics of your lives can and will drastically change. If you have siblings sit down with them and say we won't do this if you aren't on board with helping/supporting in his/her care. I'm an only child and it just drives me crazy when siblings will not help out. They know they dodged a bullet and in secret are giving a double bird salute at the situation. Thanks for letting me vent/ramble on. The last few days have been awful trying."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ph84g3/burned_out_beat_up/

"My heart goes out to all of you! I cared for my mom the last few yrs with no help before i had no choice but to put her in a nursing home she lasted onlt 2 mos. Before passing away and i feel guilty every day for having to put her in there. God bless you all ♥"

youtube · @DeniseRedling · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugyfh7EmqpV3DOA-gEd4AaABAg

"I cared for aging parents for decades. After my mom passed I moved my early dementia dad in with me for 3 years. He made me promise him that I wouldn't put him in a facility when his mind was much clearer. I pleaded with my siblings for some help- just a break so my husband and I could go away for a weekend or just out for dinner. Not one offer nor did they even respond to my pleas. My dad decided to sell his home and again not a speck of help from my siblings. He was forced against his will to have the covid shots and very shortly after his dementia went off the map. I tried to hire in help with no luck during covid and I was forced to put him in a nursing home. I deal with horrendous guilt as he died very alone and lonely in a nursing home. I was banned from visiting him. To this day I have zero communication with my able bodied siblings- they let me and my dad down horribly but they felt very entitled to fill their gas tanks from my dad's account. He passed 2 1/2 years ago and if I had to do it again I would but would have hired help in place and not depend on selfish siblings"

youtube · @fluffyanne1177 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxoQXDewW75AvvnH114AaABAg

↳ **@reginafarias (3):** "I will never forget the poor mom whose family wanted to take and treat her at home, during covid, but the nursing home didn't allow them and she died alone. I will never forget I left my dad alone in the hospital for a few hours and they kiwi him. I deal with horrendous guilt too."

↳ **@lisaorth3255 (3):** "I'm so sorry this happened. It wasn't your fault how he passed away. I hope you can give yourself credit for all you did do to contribute to your parents' care that surely did alleviated more prolonged

suffering for them and allow yourself some happiness and peace at this point in time."

↳ **@cdixon2011ify** (o): "Exactly. I know how you feel. I've dealt with that, but just like passing of parents you make peace knowing you provided love when they needed it. But for the rest you just have to move on and not look back. I just had a conversation with someone how family can turn out to treat you worse than your enemy."

"Thank you so much for this video! I cannot say that I'm in the exact shoes of some of the middle-age caregivers you are describing, but I can relate somewhat. I'm almost 55 and my mother is almost 91 and she has dementia. She lives in a group home a mile away from me, and I moved her in there last summer. So although I don't do the feeding, bathing, diaper changing, I still take her to all of her medical appointments on my own. It's impactful enough where I can only manage a part-time job. A full-time job would not be possible. I am grateful that she has long-term care insurance so we can have her in that home and the insurance pays for it all. I would think that it would be impossible for me to have any kind of life whatsoever if I had to personally take care of her. You are not kidding about the guilt! I feel so much guilt about having moved her into a group home, because she is bored, lonely, depressed, and miserable there and she never lets me forget it, every time I visit her. But she is so cognitively compromised that she cannot empathize at all with why I had to make this decision."

youtube · @scottfulton267 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 8 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugy9GWlye7ePv74X5j94AaABAq

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (o): "Hi, thank goodness for that insurance. I think it is pretty pricey and probably like most insurance key to get when younger and healthier. I'm glad you and your Mom despite being in a difficult situation have something that can help you both. Thank you for sharing this. It could help someone."

"She's extremely lucky to have found a place for her mother that does a good job caring for her. It was nothing but a battle where my mother was and that gave me more stress and anxiety than had I taken her home to care for her myself. Now that she's gone, I have terrible guilt over putting her there but I'm alone and didn't know how I could do it. She was incontinent, blind, had dementia, was in a wheelchair and at times, could be very difficult. If only it were this easy, to just find a place to care for your loved one, then sit back and relax."

youtube · @NatAnnSch · *The Toll That Caring For Elderly Parents Can Take* · 5 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2kM35JxnTow&lc=Ugxm8t2m9z-Lb-YKas54AaABAq>

↳ **@8356-4** (1): "Wow...I don't know how you did it? You need to enjoy your own time now."

"You're welcome. At first I dealt with guilt over placing Mom in Long Term Care. I've come to terms with it by reminding myself of this fact. I would struggle now to care of her, so it is a kindness to understand our limitations for the future we know is coming. Wishing you the best."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n7v3y4/rant/ncb5kev/>

"yup, I take care of an 86 year old father. My entire life revolves around him and the house. I work a full time job, then go home and take care of dad. Do I feel isolated? Yes..... Nobody comes and visits. A few of dad's friends do. I feel guilty for feeling trapped, not having a social life anymore, and most conversations revolve around medications, doctors, and weather he had a bowel movement that day or not. I feel guilty for feeling my life has been put on hold, forgetting that dad's life has been on hold too. Being active all his life, he never slowed down. Now, he needs a walker to walk slowly, has health issues which don't allow him to do much except sit in his chair and watch tv. Have I entertained suicidal thoughts from time to time? Sure..... I have asked God why He just can't take me home now. I'm still here..... I have decided though that when the time comes where I can go out and do things again, I WILL go visit those people in the same situation dad and I are in right now. It gets lonely. Complete lifestyle change."

youtube · @grandplans · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=Ugy-dZ5HH96lX_FrXKx4AaABAg

"there are several possibilities here and not as onerous as you fear. In CA, there are residential care facilities, called "board and care"—these are licensed for up to six residents with on-site caregivers so the ratio is 1:3. As for hiring advisors, there are community/social workers through the different health providers who can help and furthermore, while the placement advisors don't charge you, they quite often do have an incentive from facilities to place. Don't be cynical, be skeptical and do your homework. If your Dad is cognitively with it aside from disorientation because of dehydration, UTI and medical interventions then you have more things to consider. If he is housebound, think about a facility in LA where you can visit and keep an eye on the care. Again, this is and does not have to be onerous. I made the decision not to care for my mother and I don't think family caregivers are necessarily the best...esp. given family dynamics and expertise, etc. I chose a facility where I liked the people, IT WAS/IS clean and it still isn't perfect. Back story for me: three years ago, my mom fell, was diagnosed failing to thrive; my brother who had been living w/her went into the hospital for a MONTH. And I was 1.5-2 hours drive away with traffic, it was very clear to me, very quickly what I was and wasn't able to do. Things calmed down, my brother returned and insisted on taking care of our mom. He passed away in December and from that point, we were off to the races, i.e. she came to live with me for a month, I got her into an assisted care facility...NOTE: "assisted care" = INDEPENDENT living + expensive a la carte services (for example "assistance" with two showers a week at \$750/month). She fell within the first two weeks, hospital/emergency surgery, rehab>board and care. NOTES: 1. consider board&care or a facility in LA near you (give yourself grace and don't feel guilty about opting for care facility...do not waste your time on that.) 2. see if there is a resource list through your dad's care facility 3. do your homework 4. be prepared to adjust 5. CareBlazers channel on youtube (very helpful)"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ogia7h/honest_postplease_dont_hate_on_me/nlnqhtr/

"I'm my mother in laws caregiver, and at first it was 7 days a week. Me and my husband live with her so it is in home, and I was so burnt out with my health starting to fail me. Now it is me and one of her younger children, I thankfully work much less days and now I am desperately trying to get my health to a better place. It has also caused some riffs between me and her, even some tiffs between me and my hubby. I honestly applaud anyone willing to help out someone family or not, but I am unable to say I'd ever recommend it. Even with less hours/days, I am still stressed because we live together. My bedroom is my sanctuary, yet every big boom has me thinking she fell. It's a toll no one should pay. ♥ Then there is the guilt, the feeling that you are a shit person for not wanting to do this for anyone, the guilt of wanting to have my own place with just me and my husband. I wouldn't want anyone family or friend having to spend their life, their "free" time taking care of me, and I honestly just wanna work on myself, my health, and my relationship."

youtube · @AmandaL23185 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugzo510p4_ZsWbPQdWd4AaABAg

"My mother lives with us. She's got dementia. Her behavior vacillates between her 84 self, her 15 year old self, and her 2 year old self. I am an only child and I thank God I have a wonderful husband who helps me deal with her moods. He is my emotional support when she treats me like crap. I am scared for the future because in my Hispanic culture we don't put our parents in homes for the elderly. The guilt of putting her in a home will kill me."

youtube · @niraorbegozo646 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgzMDEGZ5oXUt5jxcjd4AaABAg>

"This is one promise I wish people wouldn't make. We can't see into the future and know what kind of illnesses or disabilities await us. My brother made the same promise to my mother and he did not live up to it. I'm not blaming him because none of us had any idea she would have dementia, but I know he feels guilty that she's in

assisted living and she feels he broke a promise to her. I will never ask this of my children for that reason."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/a-few-years-ago-i-promised-my-mother-not-to-put-her-in-a-nursing-home-444573.htm>

"I'm dealing with the overwhelming feeling of guilt for putting my mother in memory care. She's now in late stage dementia, the sadness never leaves me"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@ismattgill/video/7673683477878951182> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@ismattgill/video/7673683477878951182>

Guilty for not doing enough / losing my patience · 20 documents

18 most engaged of 20 matching documents, complete text.

"The cost of caregiving is too high and I can't continue like this. I need to vent. My (26) mom (68) had a fall and broke many bones, after many surgeries and a month long hospital stay, she is now at home with very limited mobility. I am an onlychild, my dad is dead and we don't have other family so everything falls in me and I don't have a lot of support, except from my friends. I was already her caregiver when she broke a leg when I was 21 and have been financially responsible for her for 8 years. I am so tired / angry / frustrated and I can't face to keep being responsible for everything. Being responsible for her health is such a big pressure, as if anything goes wrong it will be my fault. Example, if something is a warning sign and I didn't realize. Cognitively she is great, so she could help me figure out stuff. Instead, she decides to acts like a toddler which gets on my nerves. She has always being emotionally immature and narcissistic, but she takes it now to an extreme. She doesn't take any agency over her own health or even bothers to try. When I tell her that it is X time and she has to take X pill, she answers something like "Ok, I'll take it only if you want me to take it". At the same time, I can't speak with her like grown ups. When I tell her that I am burn out, her answer is "I'll just make myself invisible so I don't bother you anymore if I am such a burden for you". I hired a caregiver and she refuses to ask her for help if I am around (because she "prefers it when I do it") so I have to leave the appartment. I have no safe space anymore as being in my appartment is being bombarded by things to do. I am emotionally depleted. I work a full time and a part time job (both remote) and I am being a horrible worker because I don't have the time, energy or focus to work on my tasks. I am late to every deadline and I make so many mistakes due to my lack of attention. So I am also constantly afraid of being made redundant (who is going to pay for everything she needs then?). This year, I have received many amazing career opportunities and I feel like I am throwing everything to the trash because I am not up to what they expected from me. And lastly, I have no time for self-care. I feel like I am giving up my youth and all my desires for her, and I don't want to. But then, I feel extremely guilty because I should be a "better daughter" -not based in the US-

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cbz9g1/the_cost_of_caregiving_is_too_high_and_i_cant/

"Stubborn Father Refuses To Downsize Despite Being in His 90's. Expects Me To Be His Caregiver. My mother recently passed away in a tragic car accident and my siblings and I are trying to convince my father to downsize and move either into his own apartment or assisted living. I was living with them before my mother passed away so now I am his unpaid caregiver by default... thankfully he has no major medical issues beside occasional gout flare up's and arthritis since he's 96 but he expects me to cook, do laundry since he should not be going up & down the stairs to the basement, go grocery shopping using my own money (currently unemployed while he makes a pension of \$96,000 per year) clean the house and listen to his political ramblings. Essentially I've turned into a replacement wife for him which gives me a really weird feeling... This is something that a lot of other people here can relate to but trying to get him to move out of his large suburban house, downsize and simplify his life has been an uphill battle. Throw in severe weather events, a tornado that took out 40% of the large trees in his area, 2 basement floods last month due to the crazy severe weather and going through 5 week long power outages and I'm going insane - it can't be any clearer that he needs to move out of that house. He even got angry when I told him he needs to move and says he's "comfortable" in the house. Tried using logic saying he can't maintain the house anymore but he didn't want to hear it and dropped it before it became an argument.... Even despite all of that he shouldn't be living there since it's too big to maintain, there's the risk of falling down the stairs and he very worryingly will not fully give up the keys since he threw an epic temper tantrum when I tried to take them when he back his 26 year old car out of the garage and seemed to want to take it for a spin around the neighborhood to "run the engine." He been honestly a stubborn and insanely difficult person all of his life but dealing with him through all this has been an insane nightmare to the point of burning me out and exhausted dealing with him (sister-in-

law said my mother should have divorced him decades ago since he has not changed his toxic ways as he got older) I don't think it's dementia - it's just him being a jerk and not thinking/ caring about the consequences of his actions which is a lifelong pattern of his as well as being too proud to face reality or adapt to his age. He had no plan for retirement other than saving as much money as possible and penny pinching to the point of deferring repairs on their house for years despite my mother begging him since that brings the value of their home down. I have 3 other siblings who give advice but don't really seem to want to step in due to him being unmanageable and not wanting to work with people. My older sister came to help last month but basically stepped away since she couldn't take him after that. She told me the same thing my therapist recently said: "Walk away and live your own life if he's being like this. He needs to learn to deal with the consequences of his choices instead of making you responsible for them if he's that stubborn." I would feel bit guilty walking away but I'm leaning that way. Weighing my options...."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w1wwws/stubborn_father_refuses_to_do_wsize_despite_being/

"My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 115 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/owmtmv8/

"Found a place for Mom, with not much money and without Medicaid.. Hopefully this will help someone and give some hope. I can't be my Mom's caregiver being an only child, with young kids and work and my own issues. Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator. Placement coordinator is contacted by the social worker and then try call me. I told him the budget my Mom had(she lives of SS and not much!) And hoped for the best. He found a place that a lady owns and she worked with me and based off the circumstances cut my Mom a deal and is using her SS check for monthly rent at this place. Which does cover 24/7 care and food. Hospice will follow her there for added comfort and care. So it is possible to find a place. It might not be a 5 star 5 grand a month resort, but my Mom

hasn't got long to live and this place does have great reviews as well. The placement coordinator has a lot of relationships with places that often take people if that can't afford much. She's being discharged today to this place and hospice is meeting me to go over everything. It's a lot of stress, over all Its one hurdle I don't have to worry about. You shouldn't have to feel guilty for not being able to take care of your parent. Not everyone can and they're all valid reasons. People who judge are projecting and often times have the financial means to hire people and not have to work. But not everyone has that luxury. I hope this helps at least one person. It can be done. I am thinking of everyone during these stressful times. It's ok to not be ok. Update: this place is awesome! It's like a house but with a about 15 bedrooms with closets and own bathroom and there's a kitchen and it's very clean and has a rec room. It's probably like an adult foster home? But with a bit more care. The nurses are so nice. I feel beyond happy this is where she'll be. Don't give up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1aqo1wy/found_a_place_for_mom_with_not_much_money_and/

"Loved one making me feel guilty for only visiting an hour while in respite care. My mother was in respite care last week as her healthcare team wanted me to have a break. Out of the goodness of my heart, I still stopped by every day to visit for about an hour or so. The last day I only stayed 45 minutes as I had dinner plans (and had been at the social security office for 3 hours sorting out my mother's affairs). Therefore, I felt I had already given her enough time. Well, she didn't like that. She accused me of only staying a short while with, "You never stay long." Ma'am, I'm doing this as a courtesy to begin with. It's that attitude that makes me not want to visit at all. I went through this with other relatives in their last years. They would try to manipulate me into staying longer, visiting more often/calling more often, until it got to the point I visited less because I didn't want to deal with it. "Congratulations. You chastised me for only visiting for 30 minutes so now I'm not going to visit at all. Enjoy your day!"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oxyzhw/loved_one_making_me_feel_guilty_for_only_visiting/

↳ **comment** (29): "I have experienced the same. They seem to only be aware of their own needs, everyone else has no needs and unlimited time."

↳ **comment** (18): "No one can make you feel guilty unless you already do. I have a mom like that. I used behavior modification(boundaries) to change her behavior. As soon as she started criticizing, I got up, said goodbye, and left. I didn't respond to anything else she said. I keep it polite and just left. I kept my usual schedule of visits, but would leave as soon as she startsEd. One time, I barely made it in the door and she attacked, so I said "well it looks like you are alive today" and turned around and left. She eventually got the message and I was able to hang out with her. Every once in a while, she tried again and I got up and left- even if she tried to apologize. Now, she's stage 6b dementia and is mostly just happy to see me."

↳ **comment** (14): "I'm sorry to hear that. It's too bad that some people don't understand that you get more flies with honey than vinegar. I get that they are bored and lonely but for an exhausted caregiver to have to do all the things necessary to keep them going and then have to be the entertainer as well is sometimes just too much. I am glad you got this respite week."

"When I was traveling through my nightmare of my husband's dementia, a member of a Facebook support group sent me the following: This is a disease that unfortunately has no silver lining. There are negatives to placing them in a facility with strangers. You'll feel guilty that you are not doing enough for them, or getting too angry/impatient. Then you will feel guilty because you are doing too much for them at the expense of yourself. It will come down to which negative choices, which in the end, leave you as whole and sane as possible. Because, that is who is left when this disease runs its course, you. This disease can easily eat the caretaker alive along with the loved one. Unfortunately, only one is coming out of this journey. Make decisions that will preserve the most of the

'you' that went into this. I copied this and put it up on my mirror in the bathroom, so I would read it each time I was in there. It was the only thing that kept me sane-ish. A message against the people who were loudest with their criticism and suggestions but were the quietest with their help for what I actually needed."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 32 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4uzoc0/

"I've been a caregiver for my juvenile diabetic mother since the age of 2 years old. I remember scraping Oreo cooking cream on my moms teeth and pouring Mountain Dew into a THREE LITER bottle cap. My biological father left us when I was 2 and I filled massive shoes until my step father came into my life at 4 years old. He took over the caregiver role and passed away unexpectedly when I was 24. Naturally I fell into a caregiver role again. I am now 30 years old and I am truly struggling. I have severe PTSD from listening to the awful seizure and there have been times she has been having a true medical emergency and I am in a full blown PTSD/panic attack and it has prevented me from being present how I should be. Because of that I carry massive guilt because I feel like I am not strong enough. I feel like I am breaking. I don't know where or how to find support. I feel alone and like no one understands how I am human too and I also need someone to love and care for me. Is this burn out? Or is this something more....?"

youtube · @khay9833 · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland* · 18 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=UgykTbyRknF06FL3XDV4AaABAg>

↳ **@sstolarik** (2): "Your situation is way past just caregivers/compassion fatigue, you literally never got a chance to distance and develop in a more natural/non-stressful environment. You MUST give yourself a major pass for all the anxious emotions that pour onto you. You may want to look into HSP and empathic personalities for the symptoms and management. Take a deep breath and breathe easy because the way your life happened is an unfair situation."

↳ **@finchborat** (1): "I'm in the exact same boat and I turn 30 this year. I got hit with caregiving duties a few weeks before I turned 18. Caregiving is all I've known since graduating college and my mom has ruined my life. I just wish I could put her in the nursing home, but I have to wait for Covid to end and I have to either win the lottery or wait for my grandmother to die (paying 2 nursing home bills would cost me my inheritance)."

"Mentally Slipping healthy mom. My mom (77) is quite healthy and capable. She lives alone and I take her grocery shopping once a week. Except, over a year ago, she had a minor stroke and experienced deafness in one ear and short term memory loss. The memory loss has been frustrating because she can't learn anything new or adapt to anything that she hasn't been doing her whole life. Now her hearing has significantly declined in the other ear rendering her mostly deaf. She has had a caption phone for a year but never used it because she preferred her cel phone. When her hearing declined to the point that she couldn't hear us on the phone, she would call everyone in the family 8 times a day(or night) saying "can you hear me?" and then hang up. I took her cel phone away to force her to use the caption phone which she is now very slowly adapting to. But she can't hear it ring, won't remember that the flashing light means it's ringing, can't hear her doorbell, fire alarm, the toilet running, etc. The water company called yesterday because her toilet had been running long enough that it caught the attention of the water company. She has no assets, gets \$2,170/month in Social Security, I own her condo and she pays the fees and utilities, which are maybe \$1,400/month. So she can live this way financially forever. But her hearing, memory and cognitive decline are worrying us. Everyone says she shouldn't live alone for safety reasons, but we have no room in our home, I travel 2-3 weeks a month for work and my wife is a full time teacher. Plus we have a dog that my mom hates being around. We agree it's a safety issue especially now that she can't hear a smoke alarm. But with no way to afford private pay memory care that costs 2-3x her monthly income, do we force her into a nasty medicaid paid nursing home life sharing a room and being treated like a hospital patient for the next 10+ years? She takes no medication, has no health issues otherwise, showers, dresses herself, cooks, does her laundry, takes out the trash, etc. Assisted living/memory care would be an ideal situation, but she can't afford it

with no savings to spend down. No AL will touch her in our area (S.FL) without a year of private pay at 2x her income. I know this is a rare case because my mom didn't go the medical route her whole life so now is still quite healthy, but hearing/cognition is her limiting factor. My wife and kids along with her neighbors and every home health aide that has seen her agrees she shouldn't live alone. But the nursing home alternative seems cruel. Meeting with an elder care attorney in two weeks to navigate the 8 month anticipated medicaid waiver application process that will then start the hunt for a needle in a haystack nursing home that will agree to take her without sucking six figures in private pay first. So I anticipate her nursing home options will likely be 2/5 star type places at best. I always warned my parents that they needed to save, but they thought Jesus would return before they retired. Not sure if I have any question per se. More of a scream into the void of our family's particular situation. Knowing that there are no other options for her and dealing with the guilt of not being able to provide a better last season of life for someone who provided a great childhood for me. Paid for my college, helped with childcare while our kids were young, etc. But now has become a real drain on my time and our family emotionally. Especially now that I also recently started dealing with my MIL (80) who we just moved into my mom's same condo complex and have to manage her finances and dozens of doctor appointments, groceries, etc. At least my MIL has her hearing and doesn't call at 3:00am saying "can you hear me?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpymwb/mentally_slipping_healthy_mom/

"I feel like I am drowning and failing my mom. I'm not really sure what I'm looking for by posting this. Maybe advice, maybe support from people who understand. My mom is 62, but her health has been getting worse in multiple ways. She has serious mobility problems, falls, needs help with basic things, and now her memory and thinking are declining too. Her texts are starting to come through garbled or missing words. She forgets things within hours. She can't really manage checks or finances anymore. Even simple things that used to be normal for her are becoming confusing, the other day she wanted to cook something, so she put the crockpot on the stove and turned the stove on. I'm her son, and I'm trying to help take care of her, but I feel completely overwhelmed. I help with appointments, bills, safety, medication reminders, mobility, and just trying to keep her life from falling apart. At the same time, I have brain damage and health problems myself, so I don't always feel like I'm mentally or physically equipped to handle all of this. I feel like I'm trying to keep both of us above water, and some days I barely feel capable of doing that. My mental health has been getting really bad from all of this. I feel angry, scared, guilty, exhausted, and trapped. I feel like I'm failing her, even though I know I'm doing more than a lot of people would. It is hard watching someone you love lose pieces of themselves, especially when you already struggle with your own health. We are currently in the queue for aging/disability services, and I'm also trying to figure out whether I could qualify for paid caregiver assistance. One thing I'm worried about is that some programs seem to talk about helping the person learn or maintain skills. But with my mom's cognitive decline, I honestly don't know how realistic that is anymore. I can show her something, and she may forget it a few hours later. It feels less like "teaching skills" now and more like keeping her safe, helping her function, and preventing things from getting worse. Another painful part is that my now ex-stepdad basically decided her health problems were too much and she couldn't stay there anymore. I don't want to get too deep into that, but it hurts. It feels like she got pushed out when she needed people most. I'm not trying to bash my mom. She is the one suffering the most here. I'm just tired and scared and trying to figure out how to keep going. For anyone who has cared for a parent with cognitive decline and physical disability, how did you deal with the guilt and the constant feeling that you're not doing enough? And if you also had your own health or mental health problems while caregiving, how did you survive it without completely falling apart? Also, if anyone has dealt with caregiver programs where the parent can't realistically learn new skills anymore, how did you explain that to agencies?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugk009/i_feel_like_i_am_drowning_and_failing_my_mom/

"It's likely misplaced guilty feelings on the accusers part but yes I experienced it. Well, I was at the receiving end of a tsunami of bipolar emotions for weeks. I think some of it was guilt of the person unleashing it all for not doing a thing and the other part was the individual knew that I would very soon be finding out what they actually had done while not helping with the care of their parent. I will never understand nor forgive what the individual did but I have a clear conscience on how I took care of the family member. The only communication between the two of us happens through my lawyer now and once probate, etc is complete I will probably rarely think of the individual."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1ul4inf/the_strangest_after_death_occurrences_with_family/ov1sos9/

"I want to share something with you. Two years ago my mother's sister died. My aunt's surviving child went no contact with her and she was devastated but stoic about it. At the time I asked my mother what my aunt would say if her child were to suddenly show up and Mom said "she would have forgiven everything." She reminded me that there have been times we haven't been nice to each other and that there may be in the future but that all is forgiven because she loves me so much and she knows how much I love her. She also said when people die it's normal to feel guilty about "should have done" and "could have done". Fast forward two years and at the end of last year I lost my Mom. It was hellish. There were times I was so strung out I was not the person I wanted to be. The end was awful, it was not what I wanted for her. So your words "All I could do in her last hours was carress her and tell her how sorry I was for everything. I wish she had gone peacefully" really hit me. Because when I lost my Mom it wasn't peaceful and I needed to remember her words - "all is forgiven." I am so sorry for the loss of your mother and that the last chapter was so difficult. You loved her, she knew it, you did your best. She loved you, all is forgiven. I hope this helps in some way. Big hugs."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/n7ucs6z/

"This post totally resonates with me. FIL is about 2 miles from us in a beautiful assisted living facility. I am struggling with how often to go over there. We were going about every other day, which really was too much. But he kept saying how much he missed us and wished he could see us all the time. We thought we were his sole entertainment and felt guilty when we were not there. However, come to find after a conversation with the physical therapist that he goes to activities, talks with other residents, and is popular among the staff. I encouraged my husband to back off to twice a week for about an hour each time and I watched about 85% of his stress melt away. I think FIL was playing us a bit with somewhat pretend sadness to induce guilt. I keep coming back to the fact that neither of his parents did anything for their parents and lived four hours away. Expectations of multiple frequent visits when you are likely working and have a full life is ridiculous. TLDR: suggest or even set up some interactions with other people, be it a senior day program, home health aide or visiting companion, meals on wheels, something else for interaction that's not you and then put all your guilt away."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_often/p222ifg/

"Money or time?. Is it better to have money for help to aid with aging parents issues or have time to tend to their needs myself (no medical background)? Should I switch to the counseling job or continue with my current career? I have a two year old. I'm a working mom at a demanding job that pays 150k. Im in mid-career and if I continue with my trajectory i can make 200-300k in the next 8-10 years. My parents are Asian and are immigrants. Neither parent speaks English well. I have probably 10 years until dad's health deteriorates and mom probably 20. (Assuming no life curve ball and someone just "drops dead"). I have a great relationship with both of them and adore them so much, and have a lot of guilt for not being able to live closer to them (3 states apart, 16 hr drive, 2.5 hour flight) now to help with basic stuff that occurs due to language barriers (mostly bills and doc appt). My

daughter will be in middle school and through high school when my parents health will be more of an impact on my day to day life. I'm considering of taking on a high school counseling job that allows 2 months off out of the year so I can take my daughter to Vietnam so she can be immerse in her heritage and connect with my extend family (her second cousins, and great aunt); this would likely be 75k per year in salary, and likely cap at 100-125k in a 10 year trajectory. Summers would also let me tend to my parents. Since the job isn't as demanding as my current role (or current trajectory), I'd prolly have more flexibility to attend my parents medical appointments and care for post op events, Navigating insurance etc However beyond just the financial contributions to my daughters future (college fund, sports, travel), I think about the financial contribution to my parents future. They have enough for basics but nothing extravagant like their own funds for a senior facility or personal home aid. Should I switch to the counseling job or continue with my current career? Is it better to have money for help to aid with aging parents issues or have time to tend to their needs myself (no medical background)?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1saecyc/money_or_time/

"I've been struggling even though I'm done with the caring part. I tried to care for my mom as her only family while having a family myself for the last few years. She passed earlier this year and I still have guilt that I could have been better and made her last days happier. It was soo hard at the time but the emptiness now feels worse. Even though I don't have that burden anymore, I still feel lost."

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@itsmattgill/video/7571559820759715085> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@itsmattgill/video/7571559820759715085>

"For the first time since mom died, I am feeling so relieved to watch your podcast. I nursed mum for 7 years and needed to do everything you have mentioned here. I still beat myself up with guilt, that perhaps I could have done more, if only I knew n understood more, especially about her Dementia. Thank you"

youtube · @bevmacgregor-motivationalv3059 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzqwEvprvyMU93IQMh4AaABAg

"Taking care of my mother with non-Alzeimer's Dementia & Congestive Heart Failure & other health challenges for 10 years from my early 40s to early 50s almost killed my physically & emotionally. I developed OCD & PTSD from it that I'm dealing with today & she's gone five years now. On top of that, I feel guilty about not doing enough & being good enough.😭 "

youtube · @curiouslylme524 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugxg1l4EgyQ2gcRusx4AaABAg

"My elderly mom has a hiatal hernia, so she vomits every day. My father is getting more aggressive, and my love for him diminishes day by day. I feel guilty bc I sometimes lose my patience, and I feel damned while I should feel blessed."

youtube · @larahporter8123 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxlePjiNrifWRD2-PR4AaABAg

"Yes can relate to this. So difficult when you still work full time too. I feel guilty for not doing enough for my parents."

youtube · @clairelouise335 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgzknzDQ-3A9PQnyEcl4AaABAg>

The promise I made · 19 documents

19 most engaged of 19 matching documents, complete text.

"I'm enjoying the joy of my mom while bearing (and enjoying?) the suffering of my Dad.. Dad is fifteen years older than my Mom. She's just in her mid sixties. She's always been our family's foundation. She's been the lifeblood. The passion, the joyfulness. She's been the one who brought the holiday spirit, the connection between people in every festive occasion. She's been the one that drove our family and built it up. She's been the homemaker, the children caretaker, the husband caretaker, the health watcher, the meal maker, the every single thing maker. Dad made a paycheck and retreated to his personal hobbies. Mom got shit because she never 'made money'. But the only person who made this all work was her. She made sure we loved our Dad. She made us greet him everyday he came home from work. She made us thankful for his contributions. She made sure we celebrated him every fathers day, every birthday, every holiday. She excused his behavior by reminding us constantly that he was our Dad. And he was the reason that we have everything we have because of the money he earned. There's obviously more to this than I can share in a post but this, for me, is the essence. Dad always promised Mom that he would fulfill her life wishes to travel after he retired. Well he got Parkinsons and got sick before he retired. And now he needs basically round the clock care. He still is guiltig mom for taking any time for herself. If she's not there every three hours to give him his pills or hand present his home cooked meals, breakfast - lunch - and dinner - then he gets irate as he could never make a meal for himself. She's delayed a much needed double knee replacement surgery because she's had to take care of him. Who knows when he would freeze up too much and might need someone to lift him up and move him so obviously she's the one who has to help him (sarcastic). She's felt so guilty putting him in a nursing home a couple weeks ago. One (like most any of them) won't provide him with such on demand service as his wife once provided. He won't get his pills exactly on time. His meals won't always be to his liking. It may take longer for someone to be summoned to his beck and call when he pushes the button on his neck to clean up after him or calm him down. But I'm so joyful today. I'll tell you why. I splurged on Mom. She already booked her trip to another country to visit her sister and I splurged on a crazy expensive three day stay at a lakefront cabana for her and her sister to stay in. Just watching the videos she's sent me from her stay has made me cry. She's never stayed in such luxury. She's barely left the property she's so thrilled. There are windows everywhere to the lakefront and she can see mountains and all the birds that frequent the area. There's even a private heated pool at her disposal. I'm so happy she finally can relax for a bit. I'm living close to where Dad is homed so I can show up in an emergency. But knowing that she is just living it up without any worries is making me SO SO HAPPY. I don't know how to keep this feeling going. I don't know what to do beyond this gesture. But for right now, I'm thrilled and am so so happy to give her something so good for her heart and soul. Something she's wanted for years and years. I know she wanted to travel with him. But he never wanted to travel, he still doesn't. He just wants to be taken care of. I can't break this to her in a way that won't break her heart so I can only help make some of these things happen. Edit: I dunno if any of y'all have these kind of family members. But I'm watching these videos she's sharing that she's obviously making for her siblings and friends. They are 'tours' of her stay. Showing how grand the bathroom is, what the view looks like from the bedroom, how the kitchen looks like and the outdoor area. They weren't made for me, they were points of pride to share with these others that she's also just sharing with me. There's a video where she's showing how the bathroom works, and what view the shower has. She's walking outdoors to demonstrate what amenities there are in the patio. And how their particular cabana is close to the other two cabanas but that her cabana is the 'penthouse' one. She's never had luxurious things to share like this and she's so happy and I can't help but watch and rewatch these videos she's sharing with me."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 176 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ppgrt2/im_enjoying_the_joy_of_my_mom_while_bearing_and/

"Impossible-to-please mother wants to live with me. A year ago, I helped my mom move to my state to live near me. She was living near my brother, but her incessant requests that he drop everything for her were driving him crazy and he needed her to go. I had her move here to give his mental health a break. She lives in an independent living facility about four blocks from my house. The location is perfect because I can get to her quickly and more frequently than I'd otherwise be able to, and I can stop at the store for her on the way over. But she keeps pushing to live with me and my husband, which is not a good idea. It's mostly because she doesn't like the food there. (Her apartment has a kitchen and she cooks her own stuff most of the time.) My mother is intrusive and oblivious. She doesn't understand basic human interaction rules (it's like she fits the definition of autism in this respect), which means she is constantly saying inappropriate things -- insulting us, or hurting my feelings. If she isn't getting her way, she can get nasty very quickly to where it feels like it's coming out of left field. Her own mother drove her crazy (and her mother was a nice person). She refused to let my grandmother live with her and my dad because she knew she wouldn't be able to stand it. And she swore up and down she would never be a burden to me or my brother. Now, here she is, wanting to live with me. The biggest problem here is that my mom is incapable of being happy. Everything is always terrible where she lives. Any house she's ever lived in is "always falling apart." When I was growing up, it was always my dad's fault for buying the wrong house or not repairing something fast enough. After my dad died, it was my brother's fault for living 3.5 hours away and not being able to come over and change a light bulb instantly. It's like the woman has no concept of how to locate and book with a service provider of any kind. When you suggest she call a handyman, she gets pissed off because she thinks we should do everything for her; that she shouldn't have to pay a handyman. Never mind the fact that she always told us that we "owe her nothing." I lost count of the number of times she complained about her own parents keeping score, swearing that anything she did for my brother and I came without strings attached. I believed her. She moved closer to my brother so he could help her more, but it wasn't enough for her. She complained constantly about the house she bought and how she'd "overpaid" for it. She had the backyard relandscaped and then killed half of it because she couldn't be bothered to water it (even though she had a programmable system and I had created a custom instruction manual for her). Every time something happened at the house -- AC out, broken water heater, roof repairs needed -- my brother had to handle it all for her. She acts like she's completely helpless. And every one of those incidents was the end of the world -- her crying and asking "Why does this always happen to me?" as though no other homeowner in the history of the universe has to deal with repairs. So we all decided that she couldn't handle owning a home; that independent living was the way to go because she could just pay one bill and not have to worry about anything. She's had that for a year now, and all I hear are complaints. Texas was better; her house was better -- she's forgotten all the complaints she had about it. That's how it's always been with her, though. She hates a place until she leaves it. Then, the old place was heavenly and the new place sucks. I don't want her living with me because not only will she annoy the crap out of me, she will be unhappy! I don't want to have to listen to, "I should have stayed where I was. At least I had X and Y." (And I don't want to help her move yet again! The woman's a hoarder, for one thing.) Also, I love my house and planned to stay here. It's not big enough for her to move into, though. We'd have to move to a bigger place, which costs money, and it would mean that someday, I'd be old and stuck with more house than I can handle and NO ONE to help me deal with it. I've told her that, and she doesn't seem to care. I can't figure out how to get her to understand this and stop asking for it. Just when I think we're all clear on how our relationship works, she gets clingy again and starts crying and saying she wants to live with me. I'm going to school full time right now. I'm almost 60 and will be starting a new career, and not by choice. And I have relationship problems as well. I can't handle her b.s. on top of all of this. I love the mother she was when I was growing up, but I don't like the person she is now. If I worked with her, she would be someone I would avoid. But I don't want her to get all dramatic and start crying and saying she's moving back to Texas. She can't afford the move, and Texas is NOT big enough for both her and my brother to live there. We looked into independent living places there, and none of them had kitchens. That was a no-go. She can't buy another home. So WTF can she do but stay where she is? I'm just so sick of the crying and her being miserable. Yes, she's on

antidepressants and sees a counselor. I've told her she's the common denominator everywhere she goes, and that she has to figure out why she can't be happy before she can even think about moving anywhere else. Aside from that advice, I don't know what else to do or offer her."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 93 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1unvxnd/impossibletoplease_mother_wants_to_live_with_me/

"Sometime you have to laugh or you'll cry.. So mom has been in and out of the hospital. This last time, it was a drop in blood pressure that lead to a fall that lead to another drop in blood pressure that lead to another fall. 6 visits in as many months for various issues. Each visit we did rehab in her home. A fractured nose and a fractured vertebrae made me say "no more home rehab, I want her in a facility." Everyone but her agreed. Because I'm her advocate, and she wants to go back home to independent living with a home attendant, that has been my focus. Encouraging and sometimes threatening her to work with the PT and OT so she had a chance to go back home. Today I got a call from the facility. She chewed up her very expensive hearing aid. When asked, she swore up and down it wasn't her hearing aid. *Just something in my mouth.* Yeah, she's not going anywhere."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mwueso/sometime_you_have_to_laugh_or_youll_cry/

↳ **comment** (29): "Oh my goodness. I'm sorry. It's also kinda funny, since I'm not dealing with it. Here's what I'm dealing with currently: FIL (88) had hernia surgery, and all the swelling settled in his scrotum. I'm told that it's the size of a football. He can't afford rehab, so he's here in the house with me. He loves to act helpless so someone else will take care of him 😊. When the doctor was explaining to him that he had to keep his scrotum elevated, he looked at me and said "You're getting all this, right?" No. No Sir. I am not listening to scrotal elevation techniques, because I will never, ever, EVER elevate your swollen scrotum. Walk your dog? Sure. Cook enough dinner for you, my husband, and me? Okay. I'll trade with you! 🤔🤔🤔"

↳ **comment** (25): "Yeah-it is hard and sometimes I just laugh my ass off. At my mom's last Drs appointment, the doctor asked her if she knew what day it was. She said "no." Then he asked her if she knew the month. She said "no, and I don't even care." Lol My mom is a hoot."

↳ **comment** (18): "ok you win. scrotum elevation is going to win every time. i would find something to do ALOT."

"Burned Out & Beat Up!. Ok so this is a rant! A long one. If you read it thanks if it's too much I get it. I'm putting this down for myself as much to get it off my chest and lighten my mind/stress I guess. But first background: I'm usually an upbeat person, always have been, always look on the bright side, acknowledge the fact that others are in worse situations than me, so as to keep myself aware (centered/in-check). I stay clear of Debbie Downers, Negative Nelly's, and KARENS too. Those type folks suck the life right out of you. Sorry I wish them well, it's just life is way too short for all that drama. So my husband and I retired a few years back. Both of us started working when we were teenagers, like a lot of our generation, so we retired early. Now: So we, newly retired, like right out of the gate retired, no celebratory vacation either, and we become full time care givers to my mother. We all "decided/chose" to move in together into a new house, not newly built but perfect for our physical needs especially for my mother. She was fine when we moved in, of course very sad to sell/give up her home, but she said she knew it was the right decision and it's what God wanted/planned for her/us. Her only alternative was a nursing home, because physically she couldn't live in an assisted living facility because she requires too much assistance/care. She couldn't live in our old home because we had stairs and no bedroom suite on the first floor. Plus she couldn't continue paying for PT private home health care because she now needed FT care and not enough \$\$ to pay for it. Side note.....all those supplemental insurance commercials advertising how they can help the elderly age in place (at home) it's all bullshit! I They DO NOT offer COVERED in-home care or drivers to take them to and from doctor appointments. The elderly still pay out of pocket one way or the other either high insurance premiums or

straight out of their checking/savings accounts. So they'd have no money left over to pay for basic needs like food and utilities. AND my mother was already paying a monthly premium for additional/supplemental insurance coverage. AND those special services offered via city/county "Offices on Aging", well most won't qualify because they make too much \$ annually. For example in my mom's situation, she receives a retirement pension, SS, and Medicare benefits due to her age. Yes I called the office and no she doesn't qualify. I also asked about the services listed for support of family care givers like the babysitting your elderly parent services so caregivers can get a break. Well nope don't qualify for that either cause she makes too much money. How you wonder does she make too much money. Well because the ENTIRE households income is accounted/calculated for qualification of city/county services. Yep that's right my husband's and my annual retirement pensions was added to her annual income for a total of "SHE" makes too much! We don't get paid for providing her physical care, monthly expenses, reimbursement for gas or vehicle wear and tear to get her to her doctor appointments, yet you'll add our retirement income to her income. Wow! Yes I love my mother dearly. Anyway.....now to today. She isn't the same person at all. In fact I've realized she wasn't the person I thought I knew for years. Its kind of pissed me off honestly. She had issues that needed to be addressed years ago! That damn generation and sweeping crap under their rugs ugh! So on her nasty days she loves to tell us the following comments: you've got it made, you made out, blah blah. We've got it made!!!! What the fuck is she talking about. We gave up our lives to care for her! She's another full time job, basically, and we don't receive any salary. She is selfish, hateful, ungrateful, hurtful to me and my husband for all the care we give her. Remember she was adamant that she didn't want to go into a nursing home and I/we didn't want that for her either. I'd feel guilty as hell putting her in one of them. Plus she always brought up how one of her older relatives was put in a horrible nursing home, and each time my folks visited, the lady would beg them to take her with them. Mom always said how she wasn't even in her immediate family and questioned whether the lady's family visited her. Plus I promised my dad before he passed that I'd take care of my mom. Now remember I said everything started out great in the beginning. I had a great child hood growing up with my mother albeit as I got older I realized she had some weird quirks but I didn't know what exactly. She wasn't crazy and I do not mean that in a mean way I'm being serious. But I strongly feel that because these "quirks" never got addressed by either therapy, a doctor or with meds it just festered and may have laid the ground work for what she's got now which is psychosis from Parkinson's of which she does not accept. And NO she doesn't have dementia, she is cognizant, passes those doctor tests still today. She's bitter and blames us for her issues.....all of them, everything, whatever she's mad about it's mine or our fault. To everyone else she puts on the sweet little old lady persona and acts like a normal old person. To us she's rarely the sweet lady anymore instead we never know what/who/how she'll act on any given day. She lies constantly, won't take accountability for her part/role in disagreements and we totally believe she likes to stir things up, start things on purpose. If she hears us laughing having a good day, and she's miserable well it's like she has to try and ruin our good mood. Remember I'm a positive person, and she is not ever. Again in regard to Dementia, no she doesn't have it. She's aware of what she's doing especially the change in demeanor when other people are around. It's just sickening! Why do I keep mentioning this well it's because people always assume and say to me "well she's obviously got dementia" ugh SMH!!! So I guess in closing I'm offering a bit of advice to you. When faced with or contemplating having your parent move in with you, while they are great right now, consider the possibility that down the road you may be faced with caring for someone you no longer recognize. In our case the changes happened within a short time, maybe a little over a year of moving in together. To those younger than us that have young kids still living at home think real hard because the dynamics of your lives can and will drastically change. If you have siblings sit down with them and say we won't do this if you aren't on board with helping/supporting in his/her care. I'm an only child and it just drives me crazy when siblings will not help out. They know they dodged a bullet and in secret are giving a double bird salute at the situation. Thanks for letting me vent/ramble on. The last few days have been awful trying."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ph84g3/burned_out_beat_up/

"Any Advice re Aging Mom. Hi Everyone, I'm new to this subreddit and was hoping someone might have some advisement on what I could possibly do, I'm feeling stuck. Context - I (M 35) am an only child and my mother (72) had been diagnosed with liver cirrhosis some years ago. I'm currently married with one daughter (16) and do not live with my mother. Her home, which is the house I grew up in, is about 45 min away with traffic. My mother had been living with my stepfather who was caring for her but he suddenly passed away a few months ago, thus leaving my mom living by herself. Recently, her liver cirrhosis has gotten worse and is causing what's called hepatic encephalopathy which leads to extreme weakness, wanting to sleep all day, and confusion (similar to dementia). My mother and I haven't had the best of relationships, we're Hispanic and she has an old school thinking that I should drop everything (family, job, social life) to care for her and that she should come first in my life over my wife, to which I disagree. With her symptoms getting worse, we have two caretakers that stay with her at the house, however the cost of this is around \$2,000 per week and my mom is running out of money (my stepdad didn't leave anything behind). The house she's in is on a reverse mortgage and so the only money she has, outside of the small amount she gets from SS and her pension, is to borrow from the reverse mortgage line of credit. At this rate due to the bills and caretaker costs she'll be out of money by August of next year. It doesn't seem to be a viable option for my family to move in with her as it would be a tremendous strain on me and my family's mental health. She also made me promise her years ago to never leave her in a nursing home or facility. So the question is - what can or should I do? Her health will continually get worse and she's having episodes of extreme depression and confusion from the liver cirrhosis. Her co-morbidities (diabetes, history of heart issues) won't permit her to get on the transplant list. Should I bite the bullet and move my family in with her? Sell the house and try to get a bigger place with room for her to live? Any other options?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hc4o8p/any_advice_re_aging_mom/

"I cared for aging parents for decades. After my mom passed I moved my early dementia dad in with me for 3 years. He made me promise him that I wouldn't put him in a facility when his mind was much clearer. I pleaded with my siblings for some help- just a break so my husband and I could go away for a weekend or just out for dinner. Not one offer nor did they even respond to my pleas. My dad decided to sell his home and again not a speck of help from my siblings. He was forced against his will to have the covid shots and very shortly after his dementia went off the map. I tried to hire in help with no luck during covid and I was forced to put him in a nursing home. I deal with horrendous guilt as he died very alone and lonely in a nursing home. I was banned from visiting him. To this day I have zero communication with my able bodied siblings- they let me and my dad down horribly but they felt very entitled to fill their gas tanks from my dad's account. He passed 2 1/2 years ago and if I had to do it again I would but would have hired help in place and not depend on selfish siblings"

youtube · @fluffyanne1177 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 9 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxoQXDewW75Avvnh114AaABAg

↳ **@reginafarias** (3): "I will never forget the poor mom whose family wanted to take and treat her at home, during covid, but the nursing home didn't allow them and she died alone. I will never forget I left my dad alone in the hospital for a few hours and they kiwi him. I deal with horrendous guilt too."

↳ **@lisaorth3255** (3): "I'm so sorry this happened. It wasn't your fault how he passed away. I hope you can give yourself credit for all you did do to contribute to your parents' care that surely did alleviated more prolonged suffering for them and allow yourself some happiness and peace at this point in time."

↳ **@cdixon2011ify** (0): "Exactly. I know how you feel. I've dealt with that, but just like passing of parents you make peace knowing you provided love when they needed it. But for the rest you just have to move on and not look back. I just had a conversation with someone how family can turn out to treat you worse than your enemy."

"I promised my parents a long time ago that a care facility is the last option at the very end of doing everything else including giving up my life I will take care of them because they took care of me"

youtube · @jennhernandez3912 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgyNkZgsvc-T55UOVXd4AaABAq>

"Financial DPoA and APS questions.. I recently moved in with my mother, about 15 months ago, after my brother had passed away from an overdose. My mother has dementia and, unbeknownst to me, my brother had had an open APS case when he lived here that got him in some trouble. APS tried to press charges on him, but my mother refused, but apparently when my mother was having my brother handle all the finances he was also withdrawing a lot of her money for his habit. However, this was before my mother had any of her rights taken away. She still had the right to give him his own debit card, and when I went to her once with my concerns, because my brother had asked me to go to the ATM and take out \$400 for him because he was busy, the card he gave me with his name on it I knew it was from my mother's account. And I knew what he was spending the money on so I went to my mother and was like hey just a heads up PJ asked me to do this. I didn't do it, but I believe he's using your money to fund his nefarious lifestyle and she outright told me not to get involved. My brother took very good care of her and as long as her bills were paid and her needs were met she didn't care what he did with the rest of the money. At this point, my brother was also being paid to be my mother's caretaker. My mother is a disabled veteran. The VA has a contract with Easter Seals where if you live with a disabled veteran, you can get paid for taking care of them because they save money on not having to hire people to come in and help. Well, eventually, my brother ended up catching some federal drug charges and Easter Seals fired him. During this time before my brother lost his position at Easter Seals Easter Seals had been sending in another person. My mother knew and paying them to do three days a week three hours a day coming in and caring for her. This woman is somebody my mother hadn't talked to in 30 years until my stepfather passed away. As soon as my stepfather passed away, this woman hooked onto her like a leech. She also put herself as my mother's next of kin after my brother at the VA and at Easter seal so when everything went south with my brother they asked her to be my mother's medical power of attorney because she was supposedly my mother's next of kin. This all happened in 2020 to 2021. I had gone upstate for most of Covid so I didn't realize how bad things had got and because of my brother state I did not come and visit my mother a lot because him and I would argue about me, wanting him to go in the treatment. And once it got loud, my mother would ask me to leave, and it always ended up being traumatic and not worth it. Cut to my brother passing away from an overdose in October 2023. This was when I found out that this old acquaintance who had slithered her way back into my mother's life and managed to profit off of it, was given authority over all of my mother's medical decisions. When my brother passed away. She wanted immediately to put my mother into a nursing home. My mother also had another caretaker who came at night. By who is absolutely amazing. Absolutely amazing. This is somebody who is an Easter seals employee and Easter seals assigned her to my mother so she is not somebody that my mother ever knew in the past. She only knows my mother because she is her caretaker. She's been her caretaker since 2021 and she is great. I'm gonna call her Molly. Molly is the nighttime caretaker seven days a week. Ursula is what I'm gonna refer to the other caretaker as she comes three times a week in the morning. Once my brother passed away, and I realized that I was going to have to really step up to be there for my mother I started having long conversations with Molly because she was the one who handled everything. When my brother passed away she was the one who managed to finally get a hold of me after two days not the woman who's known my family for 40 years, that woman didn't do anything. It was Molly, who was trying to notify anybody in my family to come help she had handled everything with communicating with the funeral home while she waited to get in touch with somebody from the family and seeing how much she did to make sure all the ducks were in a row when my brother passed away as well as also care for my mother well Ursula did nothing, Ursula I didn't even know was paid to be my mom's caretaker. In the 80s and 90s Ursula, my mother used to hang out playing cards at the kitchen table all the time. so Ursula coming up here three mornings a week and playing cards with my mother. I thought they were just doing what they used to do. I had no clue Ursula was paid to be here because she never did any work. She only played cards with my mother that was it. Molly had told

me that Ursula had been trying for years to get my mother put in a nursing home and that the VA would not put my mother into a nursing home as long as she did not wanna go and that she was safe at her home. Even with my brother here in the state he was in they left her here. When Molly told me that now that my brother was not in the home, Ursula was for sure going to be able to convince the VA to put my mother in a home which my mother was begging us not to let happen, I decided to move in to make sure she could not put my mother into a home. Ursula tried to threaten me and tell me that I couldn't live here Nobody was allowed to move in with my mother, blah blah blah. I clearly didn't listen to her and moved in. She has no right to tell my mother who can and can't live in our house. And my mother did not want to be alone here she told me that plenty of times. There are times where I would leave at night a couple of weeks after my brother died and she would cry and beg me not to leave her here alone at night, but I was in a living situation where I had to go home. I was managing a woman's house and I had to be there to make sure everybody was home for curfew. Fast-forward I've lived with my mother for 15 months Ursula has done everything she can over the past 15 months to try to get my mother put into a home. When I told Ursula look if you're still willing to not sign over medical POA, then you're leaving me no choice but to apply for guardianship. Because you clearly want to medically take my mother in a direction she doesn't want to go and I promised my mother, I would fight tooth and nail to make sure she didn't end up in a home. I don't wanna fight you Ursula. I've been here for 13 months cause this was two months ago. You know my intentions with my mother are nothing but to provide her with the best care possible. The fact that you haven't signed over medical POA by now just shows me that your gatekeeping to do whatever your own agenda is. And I'm worried about your agenda and I promised my mother. I would never let your agenda come to fruition so if you're still going to refuse to Make me medical POA, I'm gonna have to petition the state for guardianship. I told her that on a Tuesday. The following Monday morning, she showed up for work an hour early, so at 8:30 in the morning when I was still asleep, she got my mother, dressed by whispering, took my mother out of the house I saw on camera she was telling her that they were going out for a little while wouldn't tell her where I woke up at 9:20 10 minutes before Ursula was supposed to be here for her shift, came downstairs and my mother was gone, so I immediately checked the cameras and saw that Ursula had taken my mother out of the house that morning, so I started calling and texting Ursula. She wouldn't respond to me until noon. She answered the phone and said I'm trying to help your mother in the bathroom. I can't talk right now and she hung up on me and then she sent me a text message saying my mother was now in a nursing home and that I could talk to Easter Seals about it. I talked to Easter Seals and they said they had nothing to do with it. This was all on her POA we had nothing to do with us. this is in our call. My mother is now been there for a month both myself and Molly have gone to visit her multiple times. Molly reached out to Ursula and was like what are you doing? Karen is doing terrible. She has aged 20 years in three weeks. She doesn't know who people are she's never not known who me or her daughter were she clearly is confused. She scared she asks me not to leave her. She wants to go home sometimes she thinks she's home and she can't find her cats. She's upset. She needs to go home now. All Ursula will say is that she can't bring her home because there's an open APS case against me. Which is true. As soon as Ursula found out, I had financial DPA over my mother. She called APS and said that my mothers finances were being abused. APS then came over and because they had dealt with my brother in the past they immediately saw me as a threat to my mother. Before the woman even met with me, she sent me an email in which she referred to me as the perpetrator and my mother is the victim and I emailed her back and I wa"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1j26h7h/financial_dpoa_and_aps_questions/

"I have a 9 and 11yr old and a mother with ALS. I'm drowning in trying to care for everyone. I promised I wouldn't put her in a home. I expected caring for her when she was older but not 64 and paralyzed🥹"

youtube · @breezyveezy1 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugxi5PF5YhQ9jIK3-I14AaABAg>

"My mother-in-law made my father-in-law promise he would never put her in a nursing home. It got to the point where she was waking up every 2 hours & dad was just haggard. We convinced him to move her to a nursing home and he finally got some sleep. It simply isn't fair to make someone promise that you won't put them in a nursing home! The physical demands on the caregiver can be overwhelming. Care for your parents as long as it is reasonable to do so. But when it gets to be too much, then moving them to a nursing home is appropriate"

youtube · @sueberger1434 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwIYM-sJIWgnEQrwP54AaABAg

↳ @SoloSecondHalf (o): "Thank you for sharing this. It will help others consider somethings. Appreciate you stopping by."

"Thank you for asking this question as I, along with many others, are struggling with this issue. I never promised my Mom that she wouldn't go to a nursing home but all the other reactions she's had are very similar to your Mom's when we talk about AL. I've tried not to take it personally when I get the cold shoulder or hear that she tells people she wouldn't treat a dog the way she's being treated. I think you'd have to be heartless not to feel awful, especially when you've been the one taking care of most of her needs. What I've come to realize, though, is that we get the brunt of the anger because we are the ones who are there the most, therefore, are the face of what is happening to them. Like you, my brothers and I have tried to have in-home help for 12 hours a day but that is so expensive, she will be out of money soon. We've tried to explain the cost to her but she shuts down and doesn't seem to understand it - or she is convinced she will die before she runs out of money. I'm not sure about that but I am sure she's been adamant that she won't go to AL. Just recently, we had an assessment done in her home (and that was important) by an AL facility which has a continuum of care. This went much better than another time when we brought her to a facility for a tour and assessment. This time, they took the approach that her doctor felt it was necessary for her to be someplace where her new medications could be monitored because she was having some trouble with them. They approached it like it was going to be respite with the hope that she would like it after she got there and end up staying. The reality is that if she hates it, we'd need to come up with another solution anyway. Right now we are in the application phase and she hasn't moved in yet so I don't know what the ending will be to this story. But, she seemed to accept this approach and didn't just shut down."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/a-few-years-ago-i-promised-my-mother-not-to-put-her-in-a-nursing-home-444573.htm>

"My parents (94 and 97) yrs old, live with me. They moved in 8 mos ago. I cared for them for yrs before when they had their home. Mom has dementia and had a stroke 8 yrs ago. She is physically disabled. Dad while having good mental ability is declining physically from metastatic prostate cancer in his bones. He helps take care of Mom's physical needs assisting her to bathroom, helping prep her food, but is getting less and less able. My brother and sister don't help and don't talk to their parents because my father abused my sister which he denies, and my brother and father had an argument many years ago that was never resolved. It has been left to me. I'm exhausted and the stress is too much. I was diagnosed with lupus about the time they moved in and have had bipolar disorder for many years. I didn't realize how the stress was going to affect me. We promised my mom years ago that we would not put her in a nursing home. Now I'm considering moving them to a senior living facility which will let them have adjoining rooms with Jack and Jill bathroom in the memory care unit, so Mom's needs are met. I'm really struggling with this decision. Guilt and feeling like a failure are part of the reason. Wanting to be sure that their needs are met is my biggest concern."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/am-i-making-the-right-decision-moving-my-parents-to-a-senior-living-facility-485628.htm>

"Yes, it is the right decision for you. For them it will meet their needs, probably not their expectations but things change. The your Mom was promised to never be in facility, did you think you'd have Lupus? And that your Dad would have cancer? Did you think they'd "age in place" in their own home, the romantically pass away there? None of that was foreseeable. Therefore, the promise is null and void. The caregiving arrangement needs to work for the caregiver as long as the recipients' needs are met. Who knows: maybe they will enjoy the more social aspect of the facility. I know my MIL does, in LTC. For many years starting in AL she refused to leave her room, and then refused to get out of bed, which landed her in LTC. But the staff patiently coaxed her out and now she goes out with everyone whenever the staff asks her. There will be a time of adjustment for your parents, so be prepared for that. You might want to consider not visiting them for a while so they can adjust and "detach" from you. Others on this forum have "been there and done that" and they recommend it. I wish you better health going forward and peace in your heart that this is the right decision for everyone."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/am-i-making-the-right-decision-moving-my-parents-to-a-senior-living-facility-485628.htm>

"I love this response. My mother had a carefree retirement, traveled, and did as she pleased. Her parents had been gone about 10 years by the time she retired. Even when they were aging and sick, she did very little for them. However, as she aged, my brother and I have done everything for her. I helped more day to day when I lived nearby (and still worked). As time passed, I saw the writing on the wall and I was not about to hang around for endless caregiving. Brother handles it now (paid caregivers and all that drama) since he lives close to her. I will not sacrifice my retirement to care for her. She cannot do any ADLs. I'm closing in on 72, and I have many other things that I wish do with my retirement time. If it were up to me I would've long ago sold her house and moved her somewhere so she could be cared for by professionals. I mentioned this to my brother several times, but he always says well... I promised her I'd never put her in a facility. OK - his choice. These "promises" are unrealistic."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/do-parents-ask-you-to-promise-to-never-put-them-into-a-nursing-home-498143.htm>

"Life's not fair, it's cloudy. I've been caring for my mother for almost 6 years now. She has Alzheimers. She has urine and fecal incontinence. She basically lives with constant UTIs. She's lost 50% of her body weight. She has to be locked in bed at night because she keeps trying to escape. She can't walk without me basically lifting her under her armpits from behind. She's forgotten who I am multiple times but through all this, she has never really complained. My mother is a sweetheart even though she drives me crazy with her constant bowel movements and messes. I've heard all the useless recommendations. However, I would never put her in a home, because she would end up dying due to neglect. I have definitely changed and you will too if you've decide to take care of your parents. You have good times and you have bad times. Take it easy and don't beat yourself up too much when you don't act perfect as a caregiver. We're only human."

youtube · @Silver_Man_69 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyXP1tKWkQjUn8N4nF4AaABAg

"My mother is 83 and in good health. Mild cognitive decline but still pretty sharp. She and her husband are constantly talking about how I should move in or have them move in with me whenever they get to the age that they're not able to care for themselves in their home. I have told them I have no intention of doing either. Then they say "well please promise to never put us in a nursing home". That's not a promise I can make. I cannot predict the future and their health. I hope they can live their lives independently right up until the end but things happen and circumstances change. How can I make this clear to them without sounding harsh or uncaring? My husband and I plan to retire in 4 years (we'll be 62) and hope to travel and enjoy our retirement not become full time caregivers. My mom and her husband have already enjoyed their retirement and traveling when they were my age. I think it's unfair of them to expect this from me."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/do-parents-ask-you-to-promise-to-never-put-them-into-a-nursing-home-498143.htm>

"Absolutely what I needed to hear right now. My mother is 95 and I'm 61. I and my brother travel significant distances to visit her regularly, and so far she's just about managing on her own. But she makes it clear that any attempt to 'put her in a home' or bring in carers would be an act of betrayal. Thank you for reassuring me that this shouldn't be something that's asked of people in their 50s, 60s and beyond. At any age really. We love our mother and only want the best for her, but I know that giving up my life to care for her would make me angry and resentful. Especially as she's not the easiest of people. I showed this video to my brother and he's agreed it's time to have 'the talk' with her. It won't be easy, but not doing it would be far worse. I promise my own kids that I'll accept care when the time comes. And I will not make them feel selfish for doing it."

youtube · @clairenorwood5279 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 0 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgztrVvxZ9ce2hZbOKR4AaABAg

"My sister promised her biological father that she would never let my alcoholic, drug-addicted brother leave the home that became my mother's upon his death. She is stuck now, because all the rest of us siblings are going to want our share of the house, which would put my brother on the streets. She also should NEVER have made that promise, that now is going to get her sued by all of us in court."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/do-parents-ask-you-to-promise-to-never-put-them-into-a-nursing-home-498143.htm>

"We sold our house a year ago and moved in with my mum my partner and I. I promised my mum I would never put her in a nursing home. She and my dad who has already passed took wonderful care of me as a kid, now it is my time to pay it back. Mum is 86 and yes it is hard sometimes but realistically how many more years do I have with her so when she drives both of us crazy, we try and remember that."

youtube · @DeborahDunkley · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgzYqAHKF46nso40Eid4AaABAg>

Tab 4 — Relationship Soundbites

'It's your duty' / 'it's your turn' · 438 documents

20 most engaged of 438 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets.. Edit everything I say here is for the USA. private pay insurance. I've worked for home health for around five years now and I want to share some of the good and bad I've learned so you can make an informed decision about the care for your aging parents. There are two kinds of home health care ones that accept Medicare and one's that do not. The ones that do follow stricter guidelines for care (this doesn't mean they're better it just means they have to follow different rules than private insurance) my information only applies to those that do not take Medicare. First. It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour. So please don't act towards the caregivers like they should be doing \$50 an hour worth of work because they are not getting paid much above minimum wage. Second. Keep track of your loved ones need for care. If they fall and then need care or have a heart attack and need help after surgery. The agency is never ever going to tell you that the person is fine now and doesn't need care anymore. I go to several assignments where I do literally nothing the entire time I'm there just because no body says to stop sending us. Third. If you up the care from one kind to another temporarily after an injury or fall make sure that when you know they can go back down to less care that they return to charging you the lower rate. I've been to several assignments where I'm still being paid for hands on care even though all I'm doing is cleaning house. Fourth. Do not look at the caregivers like you would a cleaning crew That comes in and cleans as fast as they can to get done fast and move on to the next home. Caregivers are there for a set time so we are encouraged to sit and talk to our clients. Watch TV with them. Play games. Go for walks. We won't always be up doing things. We aren't someone who you hired to fix your toilet and now he's sitting on your couch. You hired us to take care of your loved one and sometimes that is just having a conversation or watching TV together. Fifth. Ask the caregiver what they need for the home and for the client. I went to an assignment last month that had no

toilet paper in the whole house. The client was bedbound and used diapers so they just never thought to have toilet paper in the house. I literally had no way to wipe for the first day and I ended up bringing my own. Hand soap, paper towels, gloves, hand sanitizer all these things you are responsible for providing. Sixth. Understand that for the most part we are not nurses. Most states require little to no certifications to be a home health aide. So please understand the limitations of what we can/are allowed to do. We can't make medical decisions. We can't administer medicines. We can't change dressings. We can't even trim nails because if we cut you it could cause an infection. So please be very aware of what we are and are not allowed to do and don't ask or expect us to do something we aren't supposed to do. If you want any other advice ask it in the comments I'm happy to answer."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

↳ **comment** (363): "RN here and this is incredibly well written and all very true. Thank you for all you do. You ARE underpaid. Massively."

↳ **comment** (137): "It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients' cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception that the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

↳ **comment** (94): "Thank you. I love my job but I am aware of it's downfalls."

"Just finished an eleven year saga of caring for BOTH my parents with dementia. These are years I'll never get back again. I never, ever want to hear someone say to me, "It was your duty. They cared for you. It's an honor for you to care for them." I'm going to Switzerland before I do this to my kids."

youtube · @Print229 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 747 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw2Wrl3uk5c8fhnXk94AaABAg

↳ **@brianmeen2158** (74): "I just cared for my terminally ill mother for 8 months and it was brutal. I'm a strong and fit guy but that didn't matter when you have someone that won't let you help them and is defensive constantly. I was not equipped to handle that and the entire experience really changed my outlook on getting older and life itself. I want no part of life when I can no longer depend on myself to do basic things. That is not living to me - life is hard enough when you are able bodied so to lose that is just too much"

↳ **@bonitaburroughs8673** (44): "I'm so sorry you went thru that. I hope you can find somethings in life to enjoy now. I don't want to live beyond 75-77. I've already seen what it's like thru my parents. I have no children and no one will be there to help my husband and me. It's really sad that I don't see anything to look forward to."

↳ **@b.t.s.moonchild** (32): "@Print229I took on both my mom & dad with 2 early teen sons. Youngest nonverbal autistic. I volunteered. Was the one never married well & moved back a time or 2. Was an RN took shifts to work best with parents & the boys. Kept small cow herd on farm. It aged me broke me mentally. I succeeded in keeping parents at home but absolutely not for the faint of heart. One has to be a bit crazy to take all I took on."

"Do not move away from your jobs/immediate family to care for your aged family members. You will wreck your family, career and future.. I've read too many posts from folks that abandoned their professional/personal lives to take care of old, disabled relatives who did shit jobs of preparing for their retirement. Walk away, you can't save them from themselves. You owe them nothing if they refuse to budge. If they die, they die. They made their choices. If you feel they are being taken advantage of, call your local agency on aging."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 641 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1psiwas/do_not_move_away_from_your_obsimmediate_family/

"As an RN for over 40 years, I watched the caregiver collapse when the parent died. The stress and 24/7 care destroyed their health. Some even died. It is usually the female who gives up her career, marriage, life, and ends up with the total responsibility for their parent or grandparent. It is wrong!"

youtube · @nancyhjort5348 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 623 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwwOw2jflM5t3-MJR4AaABAg

↳ **@AN-GEL.AI.Official** (64): "That is how I felt yesterday , I thought I am going to die before my Mom. I also have a husband and another household to take care of daily. It is not easy!"

↳ **@gwenaguilar7049** (40): "My mom took care of my nana her whole life. In her later years my nana was too much. My mom did is by herself. My aunt's lived far away. My nana died alone in a nursing home during covid. We weren't allowed to see her because of the ruled during covid. That destroyed my mom. 9 months later my mom had a stroke. She made a miraculous recovery and has very little signs to anyone outside our family that she had a stroke. Now our momma is going to be 78 and our daddy 79. They don't want to be a burden, and don't like asking for help, because of the burden of taking care of my nana. Thankful my brother, sister-in-law, and hubby all help. Our journey with them is just beginning and can feel it"

↳ **@mariaabreu9085** (40): "The usual social misconception that women must obey, sacrifice and support others."

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"My parents moved in with my wife and I when I was only 33 years old and my wife was 25. That was my dad's retirement plan. I never questioned it and simply took care of them, in concert with my elder brother. They have lived continuously with us, with us being 100% responsible for everything. Food, shelter, clothing, healthcare and welfare. Over the last 28 years we have raised our families and taken care of our parents. Mom passed away from Parkinson's, at home, over 20 years ago. Dad is 92 and with Alzheimer's. We are caring for him. It is not easy. Lots of sacrifice of resources, the most important one being time. Now my mother in law who is 76 is needing help. We will see them thru as best as we can on this journey of life. Maybe in the final analysis that is all that we can say. We took care of them and did the best we could as their children."

youtube · @syhussaini9236 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 495 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgxmGaYBi5Usb_cUYy54AaABAg

↳ **@samsuno1** (43): "you are a hero, sir. you don't give up or abandon anyone. inspirational."

↳ **@Seamonkey555** (26): "I loved caring for my dad & now my mom. Living together is our normal. It's what families used to do without thought of another way. Multigenerational living is making a huge rebound! As a Dementia Caregiver Coach, End of Life Doula and Alzheimer's Advocate why would I EVER teach others to care for their loved ones at home and allow a peaceful death there and not do it for my parents."

↳ **@PrettyBoyBeatsMusic** (22): "Yeah bro I know the feeling Took care of my mom in late twenties when she had Alzheimer's and dad through cancer with little help from Family. It was really tough but I learned a lot about life."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible*

for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am

child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_f_or_my_parents/

"Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship. After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this. I simply wasn't proactive enough in getting my dad into an assisted living facility, possibly even memory care. I felt that it wasn't my life, but I was somehow compelled to help him live independently. I can't even imagine the millage I put on my car traveling to his house to help get groceries and pay his bills, clean his place, get him to his doctor's appointments, get him the medication he needs (through the VA nonetheless), basically keep him alive. After the initial hospitalization that set this in motion, I was able to buy him about two years on his own. Now he's in a memory care facility--just a few months after he temporarily moved in with me, he broke his hip and there was only one place that could take him while he healed. He was going to need 24 hr. assistance. My wife had made it clear she was not happy with how much time I was spending on his affairs. And rightfully so, as it was eating away my time with the family, and it always aggravated my depression. I started a new career last year and my dad's problems were preventing me from putting best foot forward. By the time I was able to convince him to start touring assisted living facilities and getting on a waiting list, it was too little too late. My wife moved out, in part, to make room for my Dad to live at our place for a little bit--just a way to ease the transition into assisted living. The most-recent hospitalization was the big wake up call. Now my brother and I are in the process of managing his property, getting a short-term bridge loan to buy us time to fix up my childhood home, only for that house to be sold to pay for future memory care costs. It's not hard to see how a marriage could crumble under these conditions, especially if you don't get out in front of it when you had the opportunity. Yeah, our marriage had some problems to begin with. But dealing with my Dad was taking away time, energy, and other resources I needed to address my marital issues. I was exhausted all the time. And it was getting in the way of my new job. I was getting pulled in too many directions, and my Dad's situation was by far the most frustrating. If not for that, I feel like I could have repaired our relationship. Or maybe not. But it

would have freed up a lot of time to focus on what's really important. Anyways, I just felt like sounding the alarm to anyone worried that their obligations to an aging parent are ruining your relationship... or some other important part of your life. The best advice I can offer are these rules of thumb: (1) set some boundaries to prevent it from bleeding into your family or professional life; (2) be proactive about moving this process along, because it's not getting any easier--if it's damaging your marriage, that's a clear sign that you can no longer provide the help they need; (3) if you haven't yet dealt with estate matters, medical/financial POI, etc., call a lawyer ASAP; and (4) let it be a lesson and plan for this period of your life so that it doesn't all fall on the shoulders of your children or other family members. I know it's easier said than done, but trust me when I say there is a better way. Happy New Year"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was lewy body dementia. I handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage lewy body. This march, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"Surprised how many people (outside of this sub) feel kids should take care of parents?. I am in the midst of convincing/trying to get help for my parents. They live at home, but they need someone checking in on them a few times a week (early stages of dementia). I think if I gave up my whole life (job, husband, house, etc) to help them full time I honestly think they would be happy instead of sad. I feel like they don't want help from other people, it's so frustrating. Anyway, I truly appreciate this sub. It's been hard dealing with all of this, and I feel like no one understands until you're going through it. I see so many people on instagram say "wow how sad the kids aren't helping these parents" or "parents raise kids all their lives and then the kids just dump them". I feel like these people either haven't been through it yet or are so privileged they have all the time and money to deal with their aging parents? I don't think any parent (that was a good parent) should be dropped off at a sketchy nursing home and never visited, but yes I do think it's ok if a parent needs to be taken out of the home and go into a nursing home, even with family around. Or it's ok to hire someone to come help, versus people giving up their lives to care for someone. I also am not having kids, and hate the notion of kids having to be caregivers. I wasn't born to be a caregiver, I am an individual person who has a life outside of family. I shouldn't owe anyone anything, my parents chose to raise kids and it's the expectation not to be an asshole during that time. That doesn't mean I owe them outside of not completely abandoning them. Just wondering if anyone else has noticed this trend of "if you don't help your parents completely, you are a bad person", outside of this sub."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 316 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1inulwh/surprised_how_many_people_outside_of_this_sub/

"Agree with this video, but the problem is if you're the responsible child then you'll be picking up the pieces when everything falls apart. It puts you in a situation of either turning your head because of your parent's (possibly bad) choices OR just waiting until the s**t hits the fan and then having to do additional work because your parent refused to be proactive and make changes ahead of time."

youtube · @ChristinaMariaPhilly · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 267 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAIAo&lc=Ugxpmu73RrG0cwy6Esl4AaABAq>

↳ @SofiaAmirpoor (25): "Christina, you are right. What I hope this video explains is that there is often no easy answer. Hang in there!"

↳ @SativaVerte (25): "@SofiaAmirpoor hanging in there is a joke. This shouldn't be a burden for another life. I'm living two lives cos my parent is out of control aging. This isn't fair"

↳ @maryv8578 (19): "I agree. I believe it is important to address the problems as we see them. My observations and questions are often met with defensiveness. I understand that older people want to maintain their independence and autonomy, but it also prevents change even when it would be good such as strength training or Tai Chi for balance and coordination. The suggestions are dismissed. Exercise is important at any age."

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities

as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldecare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of

caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden , and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go ,

not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone . I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up. i told her I didn't feel well and would come up today . She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"I am done. She's not my problem anymore. I quit.. Update 3: I took several days to think and cool down. I had told my husband he didn't need to confront his mom because she won't change. She'll just pull the "my heart" card to get him to back off. He would never forgive himself if she did end up in the hospital over him chewing her out. He has talked to her before about her attitude to me a few years ago. So this is nothing new. The venom from her this time was new. I realized while thinking, the venom started after her stroke a year and a half ago. Strokes change people. I let my husband know I am not heartless. If she called with a problem I could fix, I would go over and fix it. But if she is wanting me to drive her to the hospital at 2 am because she doesn't want EMTs in her house, i won't do it. She can get one of his brothers up to take her if my husband can't. She knows I don't sleep well and am often up that late. She has almost called me before but then chose not too. She wouldn't feel as badly about calling at 2 am in an emergency since I'm most likely awake. But so far she has talked herself out of it. I told him I am not going over to just check on her and visit anymore. I do not want or need the extra drama in my life. I do not have to put up with being yelled at just because she's made at everyone else or the world in general. I'm sorry there is no great dramatic ending to my post. Yes, I wish my husband had gone over and laid into her verbally. It would have made me feel better. But it wouldn't have accomplished anything but cause issues for him. So I am choosing to not cause him that stress. \----- Update 2: Husband is mad at her because he just talked to her about this exact problem within the last 6 months. Last time I just took it and came home. He is processing about the way he wants to handle it. Tomorrow we've got stuff to do, so he's going to avoid her while he thinks. Honestly, I told him it won't do any good to talk to her. She won't take accountability. She's not going to tell him we had a fight. I asked him to let me know what what is going on when he talks to her. He promised he would. I also told him she has been nasty to me more than he hears. I just took it because I love him and want to help his stress level. He feels terrible because he knows how his mother can be. I said to him, to me the problem is solved. I'm done. She pushed so hard that she gets what she thinks she wants which is for me to go away. He understands. She played that game with him, too. Like he said he stopped going over for 2 weeks when she did that and things fell apart because the rest don't pay attention or think. I'm still done and I told him that. \---- Update 1: Husband got back to me and apologized for the way she treated me. He said he'll be arguing with her this tomorrow over this. I told him ok, but I won't change my mind about helping her or setting foot in her house. In a week or two she'll be asking him if I'm ok because she hasn't seen me in a while. I told him to tell her the truth. I'm done because of her. She refuses to take responsibility for her actions and words. SO that'll be a fun conversation for him. /s \---- My MIL is fighting any and all help. She resents not being able to do things and won't let people help her. I have been going over once or twice a week just to ask if she needs anything. If she says no I back off. Her BS is affecting my mental health and she's not my mother. I was doing it to help my husband with his stress because his brothers don't help much. My therapist told me to back off and I have. I can't talk about her to my therapist

anymore because she is a mandatory reporter and MIL is on the line for my therapist to have to report her. All week my SIL and BIL have been at my MILs house. The needed to get a window replaced and the guy wouldn't do it unless it was in a garage. They also gave a 6 hour window. So SIL and her daughter stayed from 12-6 twice. My SIL is a very in charge type of person. So she did what she wanted at MILs house despite my MIL asking her not to. MIL won't let her anger out on anyone but me. So she wasn't forceful with the SIL. She just sat back and let my SIL push her around. She had some distant cousins come in mid-week and they stayed all day too. Then her neighbor was moving some of his stuff out of his house at 9 pm. That was keeping her dogs up so she couldn't sleep. I went over today to see if MIL had a grocery list for my husband on his way home from work. She unloaded on me today. I got defensive and reminded her I ask before doing anything. She said I don't and everyone wants to control her life. She also accused me of getting defensive. I told her I was because I let her do her thing. She kept interrupting me and raised her voice at me. I finally told her that my therapist told me to back off. She told me good and I need to listen to her because she doesn't need anyone's help. I offered to tell my husband to let her get her own groceries. She said that's different because we know she can't drive. I got mad. And left. She told me that is my choice. I told her I am mad and she is mad and we don't need to be talking with when we're mad. I texted my husband at work and let him know what was going on. I was venting and called his mom some choice names. He told me I don't have to convince him because he knows how she is and he'll handle it tomorrow. He prefers to get told at work in text so he's not getting unloaded on when he gets home. I'm done. I won't set foot in her house ever again. If she calls I'll tell her to call 911 or one of her sons. If my husband is home, he's getting the phone. I'm my MILs only friend. She has now tore the bridge down and set it on fire."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 189 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_proble
m_anymore_i_quit/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_proble_m_anymore_i_quit/)

"I don't think "the state" will come in and force feed your mother as long as she does have medical care and she is of sound mind and has a husband around that is living with her and appears to be watching out for her. She is quite young to anticipate her dying of starvation, I can only imagine how difficult this is for you to be watching and feeling helpless to do anything. Your life is full with that beautiful baby and you are not going to be able to fix this, it is similar to watching an alcoholic or addict destroy themselves. Look at the al anon writings and see if anything in there is helpful to help you to let go of this feeling of responsibility. When you do see her make it all food focused but beyond that she is going to smoke and not eat as she wishes. Sometimes something like ice cream is well tolerated, it does sound like you are doing everything that you can and then some."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 182 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v6xkzt/desperate_mother_54_yo_55
_8593_lbs_starving_for/oztw35r/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v6xkzt/desperate_mother_54_yo_55_8593_lbs_starving_for/oztw35r/)

"both of my parents are on hospice. i'm at the hospital, bedside with my mother. my father is at home with in-home agency caregivers. my mother's been on hospice since saturday. my father's been on hospice since last may. for so long i wished they would die so i might be free. and, i know how awful that sounds. but... what i really meant was... i needed a break. i needed help. i needed the responsibility of two at once to stop pulverizing me. i have been mentally depleted, physically exhausted, emotinoally damaged, socially isolated, financially strained, and personally miserable for years-upon-years. when i said that i hated them, when i said that i wished they'd die, what i meant was that i couldn't... could... not... keep carrying the whole load by myself. i do love my mom and dad. i know my mom and dad love me in their own ways. i started my caregiving journey in 2014. it was a slow burn, running errands, checking in on them, offering assistance, knowing they'd refuse most of it. by 2021, i was a daily caregiver. first for about five hours per day, then nine, then some days 24-hours without breaks. my father has atypical parkinsonism/parkinson's. he refused extensive testing, so we call it parkinson's, but the neuro's notes read "atypical." he's had hallucinations for more than a decade. and, while a neuro diagnosed my dad with parkinson's dementia, a hospital visit indicated suspicion for lewy body dementia, with recommendation for further testing. but, by the time we started running on the hospital "hamster wheel," the amount of chaos my parents created around care made it impossible to take my dad for testing. doctor's appointments seemed like a

luxury by the time i was on full-time with them. after three hospitalizations for pneumonia in under six months, my father was sent home from the hospital on hospice last may. my mother has cardiovascular disease, pulmonary disease, thyroid disease, arthritis, osteoporosis, raynaud's, MGUS... etc., etc., etc., and more. she also has either mild cognitive impairment or dementia. she was never tested except while an in-patient, and only ever when she had a UTI. so, i'm inclined to believe she had mild cognitive impairment, likely age-appropriate and age-related. additionally, my mom's always had trouble with UTIs and kidney stones. this round, i thought she had just a UTI, but she was admitted with a kidney stone obstructing infected urine, and i declined surgery. both of my parents are 90 years old. their personal "rules" for healthcare, established well before i came on full-time were: DNR/AND no intubation, no feeding tubes, no ostomy bag or catheterizations, no thickened liquids, no modified food diets, no surgeries, no anesthesia, no stents (heart or urinary) to move the stone from my mother's ureter meant intubation, anesthesia, and surgery. it would have also meant followup procedures, including additional surgeries. honestly... who does surgery on a 90-year-old woman in fragile condition?? or when her wishes were so clear?? so, i refused. i opted instead for a little extra time with her by way of antibiotics, until her kidneys failed. this happened over three days. and, on the afternoon of the third day, i opted to transition her to comfort care. yesterday, i opted to transition her to full hospice. the hospital... i can't even fully believe or explain it. the hospital understands that my father is at home, also on hospice, that his decline has been violent. they're allowing my mom to stay in-house. they offered me the option of giving her "familiarity or peace," meaning "familiarity" of home or "peace" of an institutional death where i press a button and nurses and aides come to help me. i have never ever experienced such kindness or support in all my years of caregiving, not like this. then... there's the stark reality that both of my parents are on hospice at the same time, and... i don't know what i'm doing. i did tell my father that my mother was dying, and he's since decided to stop eating, drinking, and taking meds. his vitals are falling. his hospice nurse believes he's given up, and that he's decided to "go" with my mom. i do believe this... because he's always only lived for her. i came here to post... because i've been in this group, both as a commenter and as a lurker, for so long. i lurked for years before making my account, and then... more than a year commenting. this group is my primary social exposure since i started caregiving; people i knew grew bored of me and my situation, perhaps. but i always knew i could come here and read about someone else's life mirroring mine, or someone else's feelings sitting similarly to mine. i don't remember seeing many posts about having two on hospice at once. but, i came here just the same. maybe to share? maybe for some kind support? maybe just to "be"? and, maybe... to be somewhere with people who understand. anyway, thanks for listening. i'm scared. i'm truly scared. i'm trying not to fail either one of them, but... i'm tired and it seems there's road still ahead... and... again... i truly am scared."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 170 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tkrjqf/both_of_my_parents_are_on_hospice/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My

best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being “fine” to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn’t sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn’t know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, “hi sweetie.” Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can’t stop thinking about the things I didn’t do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I’m responsible for this. I don’t know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren’t my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn’t want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can’t stop. I’m sorry this is so long, and if it doesn’t make much sense. I’m just desperate to find some solace. I’m wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

What the doctor, nurse and social worker say · 250 documents

20 most engaged of 250 matching documents, complete text.

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?!) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this

week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you* not suffer. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"Can we normalize NOT wanting to be your parents caregiver?. I(31F) am struggling. My mom(62F) has been in the hospital a week and my siblings and I have been with her every day. I am on day 4 from 8am to 10pm only taking breaks for phone calls and paperwork. The nurses aren't taking care of her hygiene needs and that doesn't matter much bc my mom doesn't want their help. She. Wants. Me. Look plain and simple, I am not made for it. I can't do the smells and i cant do the fluids. I absolutely admire and commend every person who has taken this role but i tried and i cant. My mom asks me to walk her to the bathroom, and i do it, but i fight gags the entire time and crack the door with my nose hanging out. If I can get a nurse to come in, i do. But my mom gets mad bc she wants me. Then when it comes to baths, she ignores the nurses and looks me dead in the eyes and says "I want you to do it." And "you need to learn to do this." And I refuse every time. I tell her no, I wasn't made for it and that I will hire people to do these things. She laughs but I'm serious. We do have a compromise that she can wash her body first then I will go in and wash her hair but today she told me she wants me to wash her. It's not that I don't want to see my mom naked etc, it's just one big aversion. Also, she is actually cleared to shower herself. She is capable but she is milking the pampering by us kids (I don't mind as long as it doesn't involve hygiene). It stresses me out bc it's very clear she expects me to be her caregiver when that time comes but I do not want to. The worst part is this is nothing new. She has always known that I would never be her caregiver. She has always been told by me that I would hire help and I would not be the one changing her and bathing. I know this is pretty shitty but it's a hill I'll die on. Choosing not to be a caregiver does not mean i do not love her. It just means I wasn't made for that job."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 429 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/

↳ **comment** (138): "Not wanting to be your parents caregiver 'is' the norm (here in America). It's a cultural thing. Other countries have very different attitudes when it comes to caring for elders. This doesn't mean you have to want to do all things all the time or anytime...there are other ways to make sure they're adequately cared for"

↳ **comment** (116): "I've been an RN for 35 years and I am now my mother's caregiver. It sucks even with my background so I can't imagine how I'd feel without my abilities."

↳ **comment** (88): "My siblings and I call these "love tests." "Does it make you uncomfortable? Well, if you really loved me you would do it anyway. You must not love me." Our mother has never met a boundary she didn't try to cross."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this-

and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I can't shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was Lewy body dementia. I handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage Lewy body. This March, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have Lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some

associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"i am a dementia nurse and former caregiver. back to answer your questions and help you navigate the chaos. ask me anything.. hey everyone. i did a thread like this about two months ago and connected with so many of you who were completely burnt out. since that old post is buried now, i wanted to put this back out there in case anyone new needs some help or just a safe space to vent today. i work professionally as a nurse specializing entirely in dementia and cognitive issues. i have the clinical training for the confusion, the behavior changes, and the medical gaslighting. but i only truly understood the crushing weight of the daily, unseen chaos when i suffered it in my own skin with my family. all the textbook theories went completely out the window. because doctors don't really tell you how to practically handle this stuff at home, i recently turned all those clinical survival hacks into a published book for caregivers. seeing it help families has been amazing, but i want to keep paying it forward directly here too. if you or a loved one are dealing with cognitive symptoms right now, please use this thread to ask anything. whether you need a practical trick for the endless repeating, advice on doctors, or if you just need to vent to someone who gets it. my dms are always open too. you don't have to carry this alone."

reddit post · r/dementia · 300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_care_giver_back/

↳ **comment** (162): "thank you for reaching out. first off, you are not crazy for feeling like you are being punked. the looping questions are literal psychological torture for caregivers and by 5pm your brain is completely fried. what is happening is that her short-term tape recorder is broken but her social instinct is still active. she asks those specific questions because they are her only remaining tools to feel grounded or initiate a connection. to survive this, you have to break the verbal loop. if you just answer the question normally, her brain registers a dead end and simply restarts the cycle. instead, try the whiteboard trick. get a small dry erase board and write the answers to her top questions in huge letters: "you took your meds. lunch was soup. you are 80." when she asks, do not answer verbally, just point to the board. forcing her to read it uses a different part of the brain and often breaks the loop. if she asks about the remotes, answer briefly and immediately give her a simple task to derail her train of thought. "the black one is the phone. hey, can you help me fold these napkins real quick?" you have to physically or mentally redirect her to stop the repetitive cycle."

↳ **comment** (104): "i am so sorry you are at this deeply heavy stage. "my watch will be soon ending" is such a beautiful and heartbreaking way to put it. please do not feel uneasy about the morphine at night. i know it feels strange to medicate someone who is already sleeping but that deep sacrum bedsore is incredibly painful even if he cannot express it anymore. the morphine is doing two crucial things right now. it is staying ahead of that severe pain so it doesn't wake him up in agony and it relaxes his respiratory system to prevent any air hunger or gasping as his body naturally shuts down. you are not doing anything wrong by giving it to him while he rests. keeping him medicated exactly on the hospice schedule is the absolute kindest thing you can do for him right now so he can transition peacefully without any hidden distress. you have done an incredible job caring for him all this time. just keep him comfortable and hold his hand."

↳ **comment** (66): "What a generous offer you've made here. Thank you so much. I would love to hear your practical advice for the constant, endless, repeated questions. We have the same conversations all day, every day, starting with one of a repertoire of 4-5 questions. Sometimes we have the same conversation twice in the span of 10 minutes, sometimes they are cycled through, starting all over again once she has completed the cycle. There are never statements, only questions, mainly to confirm something. Did I take my medicine? How old am I? What did we have for lunch? How old are you? Which of these is the phone (holding two TV remotes). By 5pm, I can't handle another question and just want quiet, which of course doesn't happen. It sometimes feels like she punking me, but I of course know she doesn't have the mental capacity to do that."

"A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 259 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oc9kl9e/

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on

and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"Mom's fall changed everything and I'm fuming. \ contains some mildly graphic medical trauma, so read with caution if that skeeves you out\ In February of this year my mom (78) tripped and fell while entering a clinic to get her mammogram. She already had an existing knee replacement from 12 years prior, and when she fell the knee replacement cracked her femur. She had a new knee put in that accounted for the femoral shortening caused by the break. So it was surgery and rehab, and then she came home a month after the fall. She lives next door to my son, her eldest grandson. I stayed with her the first week and she was getting around pretty well with her walker. The very night I left to go home, she was in the bathroom and the new knee gave out, just came apart and broke. She went straight down and her legs ended up under her. It causes her incision to completely open and the broken metal parts were visible. She was bleeding out on the floor. We had gotten her an alarm button that would ring at my son's house, and she mashed that thing like nobody's business. My DIL is an RN. She stuffed a towel in my mom's open leg and held it together while waiting on EMS. It took a long time for EMS to get her stabilized and transported, due to the broken knee parts being extremely close to arteries. Emergency surgery that night was done by the surgeon on-call. He cleaned it as best he could, put the parts back together and referred her back to her original surgeon. So surgery again and then this time a nursing facility rather than rehab because insurance refused rehab for this event. She has seen her original surgeon multiple times, had multiple x- rays, and me, my sister, my son and my mom herself have told her surgeon the leg doesn't look right, doesn't feel right to her, keeps wanting to collapse again. We've raised concerns to PT, and told the orthopedics team. They just kept telling her that she'll get stronger with PT. However it was only 2 weeks ago, at yet another post surgery appointment that her surgeon finally told us that she put the knee in incorrectly the first time. So it has been incorrect since way back at the beginning of February when she had her original surgery. It is internally rotated by about 20 degrees. The surgeon even admitted that's very likely why she fell the second time... the time when we almost lost her. Now the surgeon wants to revise her knee. And we will go through this a third time. My poor mom has been working so hard to gain function of a knee that is not placed correctly, that collapses , that locks sideways. When it engages it just flips back and down and deforms her entire lower leg, causing her to scream. It's been heavy work taking care of her as she cannot be left alone. She's spent about 20k outfitting the house with a lift bed, a lift chair, a whole new shower and toilet. Everything we could think of to try to keep her safe. My mom kept thinking she was failing somehow. It's heartbreaking. Watching her struggle has been horrendously hard on my little family. And I'm fuming. So many times we tried to say something was wrong and no one listened. We are reaching out to attorneys and trying to find a different surgeon. We will get through this again, but it's harder on her every time and I've never been so angry in my entire life. To let my mom go through this for 4 months is absolutely egregious and we are no where near out of the woods. She's mostly wheel-chair bound now... and back in February, when she was worried she'd miss her granddaughter's May 31st wedding, the surgeon told her she'd be walking and dancing by then, no problem. Fuming."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tszraf/moms_fall_changed_everything_and_im_fuming/

"Getting kicked out of independent/assisted living facility due to poor hygiene. TL;DR: my grandpa is absolutely disgusting and his lack of hygiene is going to get him kicked out of his living facility. My mom (his daughter) and I have tried everything and at this point, we have no idea what else to do. Warning: this is gross. Some backstory: my grandfather fell about a year ago and was on the ground for 3 days before my mom called for a welfare check. He has a history of forgetting/refusing to charge his phone, so we often weren't able to get ahold of him and were calling for welfare checks multiple times a month. After the fall, he agreed to move into an independent/assisted living facility. The condition of his home was horrifying. Urine and feces everywhere. Dead mice and mouse droppings. Rotting food. Mold. The works. We spent weeks cleaning and threw out at least 2 dumpsters worth of stuff. He would never let anyone into the house so we had no idea how bad it was. We moved him into a lovely facility and he was so happy that he was in tears. I decorated, made it homey, and really set him up for success with an easy-to-maintain and organized space and regularly scheduled housekeeping. It was a great fresh start. Within a few months, the complaints started. Other residents have been complaining that he stinks like urine and feces (and they are correct). The facility contacted us and said that they can smell the apartment from the hallway and other residents are upset. We were surprised because we set up housekeeping and laundry service, as well as someone who comes to give him a bi-weekly shower. Turns out, he's been refusing all of those services. Never cleaning, never showering. We went in and did a full deep-clean and had a very uncomfortable conversation with him. He seemed to understand and promised not to refuse housekeeping anymore. Less than a week later, the apartment was in the same condition as before and he was refusing services again. This has now happened multiple times. Facility staff have also talked to him multiple times. When we ask why he's like this, he just says "I'm lazy" or "I just don't care." He refuses mental health help, won't see a doctor, etc etc etc. The housekeepers have trouble stomaching his apartment. Last time they cleaned, we found out that they had to use paint scrapers to chip feces-coated toilet paper off of the KITCHEN FLOOR. The carpet is soaked in urine. His laundry is piled sky-high and he isn't disposing of his urine/feces soaked Depends, just leaving them in his underwear on the floor. There's blood everywhere from his unmanaged psoriasis. I could go on for hours. It's revolting. The facility contacted us again. Basically, if this doesn't improve immediately, he's going to be evicted. He has one month to get his shit together. I have no idea what to do. He loves living there, but I understand why they can't allow him to stay. All of the other facilities in the area are less nice and more expensive. He has nowhere else to go. We have done everything we can to make this easy for him, but he won't stop turning services away. Nothing we say makes a difference. I am sorry this was so long. At this point, I'm desperate. Has anyone been through something like this? Do you have any advice? Edit to add: This is absolutely a mental health issue, and as much as I want him to see a doctor and get help, he is completely non-compliant. Even when we physically get him to a doctor, he will not engage. He will literally just sit there and refuse to talk, then yell at us for meddling. I wish it was easier. Another quick edit since this is getting some attention: He was never a clean guy - his hygiene has been a lifelong issue. My grandma said it was part of the reason they got divorced (specifically, she remembers crying while scrubbing skid marks out of his underwear at the age of 19 and wondering if that's what marriage was really supposed to be like). This is a new low, but his hygiene has always been a problem."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 203 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t11ql5/getting_kicked_out_of_independent_assisted_living/

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living

coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She

was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"Hoarder MIL: The ongoing saga. Just to recap: \- MIL is in her 80s \- She had one child, a son, and I married him \- My husband died of cancer about 6 years ago \- MIL drove my husband nuts with her crappy attitude and inability to deal with the consequences of her own actions \- While hubs was going through cancer treatments, she'd come up to offer "moral support". While here, she'd expect him to carry her luggage and order for her and all kinds of whatever and expected me to cater to her because "she's the guest". \- She hated me from the beginning and worked to break us up while we were dating and when we were married. This went on for about 10 years. \- She's a hoarder. Her home was condemned by code enforcement in April 2025 when I called local LE for a wellness check on her. \- Had to pay \$17k to get the house cleared and approved by code enforcement for her to move back in. \- She's fallen several times since, totalled her car because "hoard in car" and a bitcoin scam. \- She has been diagnosed with cyclothymia. This is a mild version of bipolar, but honestly, there's likely more going on. \- She fell again beginning of Dec 2025. She had a nursing service check on her weekly and the nurse called for a wellness check. I went to do some errands for her (she's 3 hours away) and learned the hoarding had resumed with gusto and the toilets were all backed up. At the time, her echocardiogram was normal. \- I got her moved into a personal care home (PCH, not a nursing home) on NYE 2025. She hated it at first, but has been singing praises for the last several months. \- Got her house sold 12 June and her outstanding (massive) credit card bills cleared. One had entered arbitration. She had this idea that, because she was old, she didn't have to pay cc bills anymore. \- The week after the house sold _something happened_. Not sure what. Could have been a silent heart attack, could have been caused by grief over the house selling. Regardless, between Dec 2025 and 2-3 weeks ago, her heart function dropped to 10-15% and she developed congestive heart failure. \- While in the hospital she decided

she was refusing medical care. Doc totally confused by this, but ok. She also got a psyche eval while she was there because she kept saying "I just want to die". Also diagnosed with UTI (and her usual delirium). \- Back at the PCH and under hospice care. She won't talk to me on the phone, whines in texts constantly. She's on lasix and O2 for the congestive heart failure. THE NEWS: Sunday (yesterday) AM I got a call from the manager of the PCH. MIL keeps her roommate up all night making her get up and fix her pillows and tuck her in. Roommate is miserable (also in her 80s and in bad health). MIL is not going to the bathroom anymore; she just lies in bed and fills her diapers and expects the PCH staff to clean her up. She won't keep her legs elevated, she won't keep her O2 on. She refuses to eat. Complains about her stomach hurting all the time (not eating, hmmm?). If she won't cooperate, they'll evict her. She has no where else to go. I had guessed at some of what they told me. She'd complained that she was breaking "the new rules" last week, that they wanted to put her in a hospital bed and that was "insane". She whinged on and on about needing a specific blanket from amazon (I finally just caved and got it for her even tho she has blankets). I text her. I cannot call her. She won't answer the phone, and if she calls me, she complains she can't hear me (then says she can't hear anymore, which the PCH says is bogus). I tell her she has decisions to make and it's on her to make them. I tell her that she's being moved to the hospice room that's closer to the toilets and that she's getting a hospital bed so that her legs stay elevated. (The PCH is "losing" the remote, which I totally agree with.) She freaks the fuck out, tells me all this is old news, that she's been in the hospital for tests (they call and tell me when she goes to the hospital and she hasn't been). Bitches that she likes it where she is, she doesn't want to move, yadda yadda. Then she claims the toilet paper holders have cameras on them. A few hours later she says she was moved, it's cold, she has blankets, and I've heard nothing since. So that's where I am today. Concurrently, I'm gonna have to put my 16 year old dog down this week (chronic kidney disease \[CKD\]), my 15 year old dog won't be far behind (heart murmur, congestive heart failure, beginning CKD). A side effect of the CKD is chronic diarrhoea, so I've been cleaning that up for over a month multiple times a day and night; a side effect of the lasix that younger dog is on is increased urination (more things to clean up). I have pee pads all over the place, but there's only so much of that you can do. And my therapist is on vacation for a few weeks. It will be a month before I get to talk to her again."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 127 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v1l503/hoarder_mil_the_ongoing_saga/

"Mom (93) finished cancer treatment and is giving up. Looking for both tactical advice and to hear from anyone who's been through this. Long-time lurker, first time posting. The situation: Mom is 93, just finished radiation for cancer and is in remission with aggressive monitoring. We had to move her from independent living to assisted living about six weeks ago after a hospitalization made it clear she couldn't safely live alone anymore (not taking meds consistently on her own). (She had been in independent for 18 months before the cancer diagnosis and seemed fine.) Treatment went as well as we could've hoped clinically. But now that the active medical crisis is past, she's collapsed. What's happening this week: \- Won't get out of bed. Won't leave her room. Always an excuse for not going to meals or activities. \- Hiding her medications. Staff are catching some of it but probably not all. \- Caught trying to bribe staff — telling them she'll give them her house if they help her go home or look the other way when she does things she's been told not to do. \- I'm pretty sure she thinks that if she gets kicked out of AL, she thinks she goes home. Home is not an option. The next step is SNF, and she doesn't understand that. A counselor is seeing her tomorrow, which I'm grateful for. The staff at AL is working with us — they have really been amazing through all this. What I'm asking: 1. For those whose parent went through post-treatment depression — did meds help? Did therapy? Did anything? How long did the dark stretch last? 2. The bribery / med-hiding behavior — is this depression, early cognitive decline, or both? She's been cognitively intact on testing, but this feels like something shifted. 3. How do you talk to a parent who has decided to give up? Every script I try ("we want you here," "we're doing this because we love you") seems to bounce off. She just keeps saying she understands but then the behavior doesn't align with what she says. 4. Did anyone successfully avoid the SNF transition by getting their parent stabilized in AL after a backslide like this? Or is this how it goes? The harder thing: We have moved mountains. We (my wife and I) uprooted our lives to temporarily move to be near her and take care of her throughout this process. My employer has been very understanding. We've dealt with all the

paperwork, coordinating five specialists across three cities, getting her placed, managing her finances, the cancer treatment, all of it. And it's not enough. She's miserable and I think part of her is angry at us for not letting her go home to die in her own bed. I know there's no magic answer. I just want to hear from people who've been in this exact spot. What helped. What didn't. What you wish you'd known. Thanks for reading. Edit: I wanted to provide some additional info to address some of the comments. Health prior to the cancer diagnosis: First, up until this cancer episode she was in very good shape cognitively and physically - much better than her age would suggest. She only used a walker outside or unfamiliar places. People always commented on how sharp she was. Finances: After my dad passed away, we discussed her finances on many occasions. My only concern was that she was financially ok and she constantly assured me that she was fine. She was paying her bills -- she always paid on time and was never late. I have never pushed her to do anything she didn't want to do. She approached me about moving to IL. We discussed the cost and I agreed to help because it was going to cost more than her monthly income. We discussed selling the house and she agreed. But she kept coming up with excuses to drag out the process and, quite frankly, I was busy with other things in life. Then one morning shortly after the initial cancer diagnosis, she divulged a credit card bill. In trying to get to the bottom of that I discovered that hole was much deeper than she let on. She even tried to hide some of the statements from me. On the cancer diagnosis: Her mother (my GM) died of cancer, so I think mom heard cancer and immediately interpreted that as a death sentence, despite what anyone told her. Multiple doctors told her she should likely die with it and not of it. It was very early stage 1 and very treatable. One oncologist said even at her age, given all the other factors, he gave her a >90% chance of survival. We made the decisions we made with the best intentions and the best information available at the time. That bell has been rung and I'm not going to re-litigate that on an Internet forum. Legal affairs: Before all of this, we had all of her legal affairs in order. She had an AD (no code), and I have full financial and healthcare POA. I have since taken over managing the finances and have an attorney involved to make sure we handle the debt and her care according to her stated wishes. On me "not being able to let go": I have a background in being a first responder. I've seen death in the line of duty and personal experience with other difficult family situations. This is not a situation where I "just can't let go." I have lived through that on my wife's side of the family and it was an awful experience. I have discussed this situation with many doctors and every single one has told me this is not a palliative care situation -- she would likely not qualify for hospice. I'm not an expert in that -- I'm simply going on the advice of others. Now has she just lost the will to live? Yes, very probably. But being depressed is not the same thing as being terminally ill and that's not the same thing as just being old. I'm hoping that independent behavioral health will help us make the best decisions we can from here on out. I appreciate everyone who has taken time to respond."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 125 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4swt3/mom_93_finished_cancer_treatment_and_is_giving_up/

"My dad does the same. He dumps on my in-laws he barely knows, my husband, the cars we buy, where we live, etc. He has for years but it's especially focused now. He was sending voice clips to me when he was in the hospital that were so mean I asked my husband to sit with me when I listened. When I saw I could just read the transcript that helped a bit. He tells me how nothing I do is as good as other people who live 10-15 minutes away from him. I'm in another state and a 1.5 hour drive away. He threw all my offers to help him in my face, then later said he didn't remember any of that. He's just a really nasty, hateful person and I decided to only help where I can because my tolerance for his crap is so low."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tftnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op29a5z/

"I took care of my mother with dementia for almost 10 years, along with her significant other for six years. He was very large, in a wheel chair, no dementia. He helped and cooperated. During the last several years my mother fought everything I tried to do for her. She was mobile, so she would run away, get lost, knock on neighbors doors or walk in if her door was unlocked. She stole pets from neighbors, spread lies about me and lots of others who

tried to help her. She convinced a neighbor to call the police on me, also to take her to the bank withdraw money which disappeared. And so much more. As the dementia progressed, she'd fall and sometimes be hurt badly. I worked full time until she fired all the caregivers that I begged and bribed to help her. So I had to quit work the last two years and do everything. My sister came to visit mother about three times a year, staying maybe 2 hours per visit. She lived 2.5 hours away and did nothing to help. I loved my mother, but had I known what would happen I would NOT do it! I know not everyone's loved one is like mine. This is just my experience."

youtube · @LeAnne-gv6qm · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 93 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugwet6ONGsUlf9rA3Gt4AaABAg

↳ **@ThePinkPantha21** (11): "None of us get points to heaven for taking on monumental tasks such as caregiving for dementia patients."

↳ **@BSAllergy** (8): "You're singing my song. I know you're suffering. Hugs, to you."

↳ **@davidtomkins2542** (7): "You feel like you are in a pressure chamber, hard to breathe"

"My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 78 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oiziv9b/

"I HAVE MOVED MY PARENTS--Episode 12--"So you're saying there's a chance?". Hello, episodes 10 and 11 covered my Dad's mental breakdown and his hospitalization. Episode 11 included the decision that my Dad, newly diagnosed with vascular dementia, when released from the hospital, would eventually have to move into memory care and leave my mother in assisted living. I called episode 11 "The Great Unraveling" because all of the wonderful plans we had for my parents' lives had fallen apart in just a few hours. The drama continued today as several powerful entities, and people within them, pitted themselves against one another in a battle that had potential life or death consequences for my father. After a surprisingly good night's sleep, I made my way to the hospital at 9 AM and found my father sound asleep, but with a "sitter," someone paid to sit by his bedside and keep an eye on him because he had demonstrated a tendency to try to get out of bed. She was good, too; as soon as one foot got out of position, she was up off her chair and getting him back solidly on the bed. He still had a catheter, and an uneaten breakfast indicated that he could not be awakened sufficiently to eat it. He was, for all intents, absolutely out. This continued on and off for the next few hours. Every now and then Dad would stir just a bit and pick at his blankets or start to hang a toe off the side of the bed, and every time, his sitter would jump up. I had no duties at all. The nurse and the sitter would turn Dad from side to side occasionally. He couldn't roll over on his own. When they finally awakened him enough to eat, that had to spoon feed him. Later, when he needed to go to the restroom, they brought in a bed pan. About this time, a social worker came in to inform me to prepare for Dad's discharge. I thought maybe I hadn't heard her right. "Excuse me? Remember he's not going back to his home until Monday?" She answered, "we're not doing anything medical to help him anymore, he will be discharged today." "But they said they can't take him back for three more days!" "That is the family's problem." "But how can you say that a man who can't roll over on his own, needs a bed pan, a catheter, and has to be spoon fed is ok to discharge?" "He's not receiving medical services. The catheter will be removed and then it's up to the family what to do upon discharge." "But I was told you would try various meds to see if we could reduce the delusions and help him be more stable." "There are no meds to help him. He's only going to get worse. He's 90 years old. Don't build false hope." Shocked, I called the assisted living, where Nurse T, an absolutely amazing woman, reassured me that she would deal with the situation. While I was confident that she would do her best, I wanted to hedge my bets so I went downstairs and asked to speak to an administrator. In only a couple of minutes, Administrator J came and met me. He listened sympathetically to me and appeared to agree that there's

no way my father should be discharged in this kind of shape. He promised to look into the situation. I thought about my options. My house is not an option for reasons I won't discuss here. Nor are the homes of my son or my daughter and their families. I actually thought about renting a motel room and trying to care for my dad there until his new home in memory care might be available, but then I realized there's not a motel room available in the area right now because a nationally significant sporting event is happening here. I actually pictured trying to care for my dad in a car. An hour went by with no calls or contact with anyone, but at one point I saw the administrator in a heated discussion with the social worker who had told me to prepare for the discharge. I didn't dare call anyone because I didn't want to intervene at the wrong moment and maybe mess up a delicate phase of the negotiations. So I waited. Finally, at 2 o'clock, word came from my dad's nurse, a large man with an amazingly compassionate disposition. He said, "the plan is we're going to pull the catheter and move your dad to another room out of this wing (and away from the unsympathetic social worker.) If he pees before 3 o'clock, he's going to be discharged, but if he still can't pee on his own by three, he'll be admitted (to my surprise he was not admitted yet; he was only on 'observation' status)." So the catheter was pulled and Dad slept through that. He was moved and he rustled around a little but went back to sleep. Later, though appearing to be asleep, he moved his hands as though turning a steering wheel driving, and a little later, did a perfect pantomime of sewing, something I've never seen him do in his conscious life. But he didn't pee. At 3 o'clock it was apparent that either Administrator J or Nurse T or both had prevailed, and the discouraging social worker had gotten at least a bit of a win by having my Dad moved out from under her oversight. For his part, Dad was oblivious to all the wrangling. Only around 3:30 did he finally seem to wake up and start to interact. By that time he had a new sitter and he was telling her all about his military service, getting most of the details totally wrong, but I just let him go and finally, confident that he was ok for the day and not going to be discharged, went home to rest. Later this evening, my wife and I went to see my mother to talk to her about Dad and to see how she was doing in his absence. She seemed ok and to understand very well the challenges that Dad was facing. On the way in, we happened to run into Nurse T, and I thanked her profusely for all the efforts she had made on my Dad's behalf. She described her telephone interaction with the hospital social worker and said she was hugely disappointed in the person and questioned whether she was in the right job. But this episode's title is, "So You're Saying There's a Chance?" and here's why: Nurse T said when Dad returns from the hospital, he could be permitted to return to Mom's side in assisted living if several conditions were met. 1--Is Mom ok with that? 2--There would be more check-ins by staff, perhaps hourly, 3--Dad would have to wear an alarm that sounded if he tried to exit the building, and the big, hard, tough, potentially expensive one, that someone else would need to be in the room 24 hours a day. Well now. How committed am I to having this work? Actually I'm committed enough to move over there and try to make it happen. Maybe I can negotiate meal service. I believe I can have family members take shifts, but let's not fool ourselves, it's going to be me, most of the time. Now, how long this has to go on before Dad has proven his ability to live with Mom and not go into memory care is unknown. If it's a week or two, I can handle it. I could probably even go a month with some good books and stable wi-fi. But even during the 18 days I lived with Dad in March, I still got time off to go home, get clean clothes, and so on. Not sure how strict the 24 hour rule will be enforced. There would be a lot to negotiate, or maybe not. So that's where things stand right now. Maybe the Great Unraveling will take place, but for now, at least they're saying there's a chance that it won't."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 77 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/o37ja8/i_have_moved_my_parentsepisode_12so_youre_saying/

↳ **comment (14):** "I'm glad that your father wasn't discharged. I don't understand what you mean by saying he has to "prove" his ability to live with your mom. He can no longer control his behavior, and he's not getting better. Your mother can visit him often in memory care, right? Or is it a matter that your father is close to the end so why add more upheaval to the situation by moving him? Forgive me if the question is inappropriate. I just see that you are knocking yourself out, but I think the prospect of giving them a normal, pleasant life such as they are accustomed to is unlikely, and I don't see how disrupting your life in the attempt is going to do any good. But of course I don't know everything about the situation."

↳ **comment** (12): "I worked in a hospital as an RN... I attended 'bed meeting' every day. This is where a team determines the patient's length of stay dependent on payment, It is not as much whether or not they are ready, it's about payment...If they need some kind of service or intervention, they make sure it is completed promptly so they can discharge.. As far as the "he wasn't admitted yet, he was on observation"... look out, I don't understand details, but have been made aware that status isn't paid for by Medicare... Medicare pays once they are admitted, they also pay for emergency room visits, but there is a maximum to that...There has been a big stink about families not being aware and large bills arrive because 'observation' has been in effect. My father was denied assisted living because he wouldn't have been able to get out of the facility by himself in 5 minutes or less if there was a fire...hm about the social worker; I'm sorry, but she was doing her job...She was likely told to be sure to have your father out of there shortly. First of all, apparently he was never admitted, so he wasn't an 'inpatient'... She could have been more empathetic, but she was doing her job.. It's hard for me to read this and have the 'inside scoop' as to how a hospital runs... I hope everything works out as you plan and you can do what is best for your father and mother....I support you in your efforts."

↳ **comment** (12): "Is it not amazing that there are people in a field dedicated to caring for people dont seem to have a clue. Thank God for compassionate ones. best of luck my friend. You're all in my prayers."

"Should we cancel a family trip because our dad is dying?. This may seem like a question with an obvious answer, but please read the actual circumstances. My dad has been in heart and kidney failure for almost 5 years. He has been on dialysis since last September, but decided to stop dialysis over four weeks ago. Based on everything the doctors told us, we thought he would have 7 to 10 days to live. I already canceled a very special anniversary trip with my husband because of his condition. While working with the Hospice nurse, we discovered my dad was abusing pain and sleeping meds for much of the last several months. This likely worsened his condition and made him fall frequently. It was a depressant for him and possibly contributed to his decision to stop dialysis. In any case, he is living much longer than anyone anticipated. My mom is spending about \$1000 a day on in-home care. She really doesn't have the financial stability to do this, but we thought it would only be for a week or 10 days at the most. What's really difficult is doing all of this for a person who was extremely controlling, prone to outburst of extreme anger, and financially abusive to everyone in our family. We have a family vacation that has been planned for almost a year, and we are supposed to leave in one week. We have all spent countless hours with my mom and dad over the last several weeks, we have said multiple goodbyes, we have said multiple "I love you's", we have taken over all household responsibilities, arranged caregivers, provided food, arranged grief counseling, etc. Is it crazy for us to go on this vacation, which cannot be rescheduled or refunded, or is it crazy for us to cancel another vacation?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 74 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/

↳ **comment** (339): "I officially give you permission to go on this vacation. The other members of your family also matter."

↳ **comment** (113): "At some point, you have to pick living over death. It seems like you have said "I love you" and the eventual passing will not be a surprise. You have already cancelled one vacation. So, if you can go and not feel guilty, and enjoy your vacation, then go. Get prepared for the possibility that some family or friends might try to make you feel guilty. Sounds to me that you have already had a difficult time, and you have earned your rest & relaxation."

↳ **comment** (67): "I'd go. What they don't tell you about dying is that it often drags on like this. The movies make it seem like its a few days and everyone jumps on a plane for the last moments. The reality is that for a lot of people it goes on for months or years. At first you think its imminent so you take off work, cancel vacations, maybe even put off your own medical appointments because you want to be available. But eventually you have to

go back to work, take care of yourself, enjoy your own life. He is going to die and not going on your vacation will not change that. I'd go."

"My mom's back in the hospital. Dad needs 24/7 care at home. . I'm so mad. I came to visit my parents for the night. It's a 4 hour drive. My mom has a gross scaly skin rash that's oozing on her leg. Her legs are like elephant legs. She hates going to the doctor. She cares for my dad with Parkinson's around the clock. But will not take care of her own health. She was in the hospital 2 weeks ago but checked herself out against medical advice and then just let her skin thing fester and made no effort to see her own doctor. So it was a waste of 2 nights she spent in the hospital last time and we're back to square one. So I convinced her to go back tonight. Of course they are keeping her overnight again. My brother who lives with them is at work overnight. So I'm here with my 2 kids helping my dad pee in a bottle. Something I never wanted to do. I love him but for the love of god, hire a nurse to handle this stuff! I can't stay tomorrow. I have to get my kids back home for school. I have a dog and 2 cats at home and a house and a full time job AND my husband died last year. I'm mad because my mom has known for years how bad my dad is and she's refused to hire help. She has the money but has this phobia about letting anyone else help her. So now she's stuck us in a bad spot where I'm here alone caring for my dad and I don't know what to do exactly and I have no one to call to help me. Im going to call the VA tomorrow morning and see about either getting someone in here to help or bringing him there for a few days while my mom gets her skin thing and swollen legs figured out. 2 weeks ago they wanted to send her home with a visiting nurse checking in and she refused. Like WHY? WHY must you be so difficult? WHY can't you see reason? I'm going to get 0 sleep tonight and I have to drive 4 hours home tomorrow."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cpxyo2/my_moms_back_in_the_hospital_dad_needs_247_care/

↳ **comment** (42): "I'm really sorry. That all sounds really rough. My dad has Parkinson's too, so I know the level of care that is required. I think that it's time to say, "mom, there are no options. You are having the visiting nurse come because I absolutely cannot come back until (much later date). By not allowing them to help, you are causing me a great deal of stress and I cannot do this anymore." Hopefully that will be enough, but I also have a stubborn mom, so I understand that it might not be. But your first priority is taking care of your kids and yourself; it simply has to be."

↳ **comment** (19): "If it's bad enough for her to be kept overnight, it's pretty bad. I'm sorry you are going through this. Can you take your dad for a Dr evaluation so you can talk to Medicare about any benefits you can access for them?"

↳ **comment** (16): "A lot of assisted living places offer short stays for when the primary caregiver needs a break or is just unavailable. Also, they all asked about VA benefits when I was looking for my mom while dad was in hospice."

"I need advice please on my 85 year old MIL and her unwillingness to even listen to any options other than staying at home. We are not exactly a "young family" anymore, so to speak, but we do still have a 19-year-old who is in college full-time and living at home. We also have a 21-year-old and a 35-year-old who live on their own but are not completely independent yet. Then there are my in-laws, who are both 85 and live about 10 minutes away. This is where things get complicated. My MIL refuses to consider any option other than staying in their home or having them move in with us. Moving in with us is simply not an option, and she knows that. My FIL, on the other hand, has spent years dealing with her need to control situations so they fit the narrative she wants, and honestly, I think he has just completely given up. Things have gotten so bad that last week my FIL was taken to the ER, where he actually coded on the table. They revived him and transferred him to a larger hospital. Once there, they stopped some of his medications, and he started doing noticeably better. For about a month before this happened, we had

been telling anyone who would listen that we were extremely concerned about one particular medication. His falls had become almost daily, he was increasingly disoriented, and he was losing weight. We repeatedly expressed our concerns that the medication and dosage could be contributing to what was happening, but it seemed like nobody really wanted to listen. When I asked his ICU nurse about the medication, she told me he was not currently receiving it. I explained that we believed the dosage he had previously been taking was too high. She looked at the dosage and told me she wasn't sure she had ever seen someone on that high of a dose, especially someone who was 85 years old. We tried not to immediately tell my MIL everything we had learned because there had been an incident earlier that same day involving her insisting that she was the one who knew what was best. It became serious enough that hospital staff eventually had to call security. Eventually, she found out about the medication and it was restarted at the same high dosage. This was Saturday. At that point, my FIL was sitting up, talking, laughing, had passed his swallow test and, from everything we could see, seemed to be improving. Because of the situation that had happened at the hospital that day, we decided to leave and not go back until Tuesday. That evening, around 5:00, my husband was walking into the hospital when he got a call from their housekeeper. She told him that his mother had put his father on hospice and that he would be sent home by ambulance the following day. My husband gets to the room and the hospice nurse is there talking to his mom and the housekeeper. His mother would not allow my husband to ask questions or really participate in the conversation. She had not included him in the decision, hadn't told him herself, and he was essentially finding out about a major medical decision involving his father from the housekeeper. Then, in front of the hospice nurse, she tells my husband, with a grin, that hospice is "so wonderful" and that she just loves them and that they would have someone there 24/7. The hospice nurse immediately stopped her and explained that wasn't how it worked and that they would likely only be in the home for a limited amount of time each day, possibly around 45 minutes. My MIL still agreed to take him home. So now my FIL is home. He is no longer talking, is bedridden, cannot shower or use the bathroom on his own, and requires a tremendous amount of care. My MIL is overweight, has severe problems with her legs, uses a walker, falls herself, cannot drive, and is now at home alone with him. And this is where I honestly don't know if I am being unreasonable. We have tried everything short of taking her to court to get her to listen to the different options available to them. She refuses to consider anything other than staying in their home. She made the decision to bring him home, without including my husband in the decision, and now seems to expect us to be available every time she calls. She will send my husband shopping lists with two or three things on them and expect him to have them there immediately. This can happen every single day of the week. And I understand that she is 85. I understand that this is scary. I understand that she is watching her husband go through something incredibly difficult. But she is also not the only person in this situation. We still have full-time jobs. We have a child living at home who we have responsibilities to and want to spend time with. We have two other children who live away from us and who we already don't get to see as much as we'd like. And honestly, that is part of what bothers me so much. She made these major decisions without including us, even though she knew that her decisions would directly affect the amount of responsibility that would fall on our family. Had she included my husband in the conversation and allowed us to be part of the planning, maybe we could have helped come up with a solution that worked for everyone. Instead, she made the decision and now expects everyone else to adjust their lives around it. There was apparently also discussion about sending my FIL to rehab, and I believe that may have been another reason hospice became the chosen option. But again, we were not included in those conversations, so we are left trying to understand decisions that have already been made. I am not asking anyone to tell me that my MIL is a horrible person. I don't think she is. I think she is scared, overwhelmed and very determined to maintain control of a situation that she feels is slipping away from her. But I also don't think being scared gives someone the right to make decisions for everyone else and then expect everyone else to pick up the pieces. So I am seriously considering telling her that we are available to help on one specific day each week, from something like 5:00–8:00, and that she needs to plan her shopping, errands and other needs around that time. Obviously, if there is a true emergency, we will be there. And we will continue to help with things that genuinely need immediate attention. But we cannot continue to be available every single day for every little thing. Part of me feels like we are enabling this situation by continuing to immediately respond to every request. If she knows that

every time she calls, someone will drop what they're doing and come running, then why would she ever consider another option? I also don't want my anger toward her to cloud my judgment or make me unfair to my husband. This is his mother and his father, and I know this is incredibly hard for him. So I am genuinely asking: Am I being unreasonable? Would setting a firm schedule for when we can help be cruel, or is it actually a healthier boundary for everyone involved? If you've been through something similar with aging parents, hospice, caregiving or a parent who refuses every option except the one they have decided on, I would genuinely appreciate your advice, experiences or opinions. Please don't misunderstand what I'm asking. We are doing our best. We love them. We are not trying to abandon anyone, and we absolutely want to help. I just don't know where the line is between helping someone through an incredibly difficult situation and completely rearranging your own family's life because they refuse to consider any other solution. So if you've made it this far down, thank you. 😊 Please feel free to tell me what you think, even if you disagree with me. I genuinely want honest opinions because I don't want my frustration to make me unreasonable. I just ask that people remember there are real people involved here, and this is an incredibly difficult situation for everyone. Kindness matters sometimes more than being right. ❤️ "

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vps6vg/i_need_advice_please_on_my_85_year_old_mil_and/

↳ **comment** (106): "I don't have any advice but one thing caught my eye. Are you implying his mentation and independence greatly improved when the medication was stopped- yet somehow your MIL forced them to restart it and he declined again?"

↳ **comment** (70): "I saw this too. One could argue intentionally dosing someone to the point they require hospice is a criminal act. I'd be really curious to see what a different doctor would say."

↳ **comment** (47): "This jumped out at me, too. My gut feeling was is she trying to create a situation that ultimately leads to his death. OP I think you should consider this possibility. If you need to go to court to take over guardianship of FIL this will help your case. Whether she has nefarious intent or not she is not a medical professional in any regard and should not be able to control medication like this."

'Take care of yourself' · 143 documents

20 most engaged of 143 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62. I cared for both of my parents for 10 years. It almost killed me. You lose your very self. People tell you to take care of yourself, but there's no time for that. There's no You anymore. My mother was the last one to die. That was 4 years ago. I'm still exhausted, if that tells you anything. I don't want to go anywhere or do anything. I live happily by myself with my phone to keep me company. I may be adding a cat to the scenario soon. I have a wonderful family nearby who I see every now and then, so I'm not totally alone. But I want no other human being living in my space ever. The silence and slowness of life is so sweet. I loved my parents dearly. Now, it's all about me."

youtube · @lindaN236 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1,123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAg

↳ @Teffi_Club (93): "It is true when you take care of your parents, you lose your own health."

↳ @sjtalksandlife (61): "It's time for you to enjoy your life, you did a great job with your parents, now it's time to focus on you"

↳ @lordbrunski (44): "I am so glad you shared that with honesty. I have hypothyroid and looking after my ungrateful and abusive parents has left me in a state of exhaustion that I cannot shake off. I feel like you do. Being solo is the only think I want. Men assume that I am "up for it" and they have no idea that all I want is a book, a cat and a dog. The idea of having to look after anyone else does not appeal."

"If you are dealing with a toxic parent the best thing you can do for yourself is practice self care religiously."

youtube · @decemberbaby96 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 145 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhikEw&lc=Ugx2QR6licDKPVtgGut4AaABAg>

↳ @100anti (16): "Both is exhausting. However, taking care of self is important."

↳ @pz89102 (7): "its not about toxicity, its about the diseases and differnt thinking that comes with aging, like alzheimers."

↳ @diana6842 (4): "@100anti Hard to do when they demand attention 24/7 and refuse to let others help."

"can you ever MAKE them do it, or do you have to just wash your hands?. *not even sure how much background would be relevant here. I'm in the USA. I've spent about the past 10 months trying to clean out my mother's house. it's a big old farmhouse type thing in a rural area. it's absolutely falling apart. my stepdad passed in 2017. he was significantly older than my mom is (now 71). no retirement savings. no life insurance. some of that WAS his bad choices, some of it was out of his control (when companies go bankrupt, you lose your pension. in his case it happened at least twice). we were ok \$\$\$ wise when I was younger but when we moved and they bought this money pit of a house, it all went to s\|\|. my mom never worked outside the home and so lives off my dad's survivorship SS. she's got no small amount of debt. she lives about an hour from me. she has some disabilities from scoliosis, severe osteoporosis and glaucoma. as of last year she could no longer drive any significant distance and probably shouldn't at all. I have to take her to all dr and dentist appointments which are an hour PAST her house away from mine. for years my mother was totally convinced she was going to move back to our home state despite the fact that it's very VERY expensive now. then she finally relented last year that "I have to accept that's not going to happen." well no \|\|. despite having tried myself, and others that she needed to*

have gotten the heck out of that house years ago, she dug in and fought it. she fights everything that isn't her idea (this has been a lifelong thing, and part of why my relationship with her is so fraught). *she absolutely can-NOT live me with me. full stop.* she is still convinced that she can sell this falling apart ruin of a home for enough money that she can afford to buy ANOTHER home and have enough from my dad's meager survivorship social security to pay on a mortgage and all the maintenance that a house requires. I have tried telling her again and again and again that the market for "as is fixer uppers" is just about gone. people want move in ready and perfect or they won't buy. and people don't do rent-backs anymore either. nobody is going to buy her as-is home and then let her rent back until she finds another house here where I live that checks alllll her boxes AND the cost of homes in my neighborhood has doubled and they either get snapped up by investors or are sold way overpriced but needing a ton of work. anything new being built is all three story townhomes and she can't even manage ONE flight of stairs. *I truly believe the best option for her is an apartment. There are a few of the traditional "garden style" first floor/one floor types as well as some regular apartments that cater to seniors without being a full on assisted living. she wouldn't have to worry about maintenance, she could mostly decorate how she wants. we can set up a living trust for whatever she comes away with after selling her house to cover additional expenses like a cleaning service, uber rides/transport if needed, etc.* except she won't. even now, I've tried to push things along faster because I am 54, I work full time and I am EXHAUSTED. I have spent hours and hours of sorting, taking things to thrift stores, taking what she wants to keep in storage (which I'm paying for) and I AM TIRED. The entire attic is still full of cr\p and she wants to "sort out what she wants to get rid of and then leave what she wants to keep until she moves." *I want to pay whomever we're going to pay to help, get it ALL out of the damn attic and then take whatever she wants to keep and put it in storage NOW. YESTERDAY. get the rest of the furniture out. she keeps insisting it can stay "until she has a house to move into." I CAN'T TAKE THIS ANYMORE.* The year before we started on this I had to spend nearly 6 straight months working on my own house because there were some things that had gotten away from us and needed to be addressed. then I spent pretty much all of last year dealing with this stuff for my mother while one of our dogs had cancer and died. I have basically given up all hobbies, I can't exercise or get to the gym, I barely have the executive function at the end of a workday anymore to COOK let alone take care of myself. I've already spent over 12K just getting her furnace repaired and all the dental work done that Medicare won't cover just in the past 5 years. at what point do I get to just say: *you will move into an apartment the house will be listed within the next 90 days the proceeds pay the debt and then we set up a trust with the rest and you STAY IN AN APARTMENT until you literally cannot take care of yourself anymore (which God willing would be more than the 5 years required).* then if you want to go into a rehab center you can. *Hell if you want to do MAD when the time comes, I would even support that. but God as my witness I am not dealing with another house, all the crap that comes with it, another mortgage when you're gone, blah blah blah.* THIS is the plan that we follow, or I don't do one more thing. Not one more box packed, not one more trip to a thrift store. not one more cent for home repairs. don't call me unless you decide this is what we are doing. sorry. yeah this is really long. and, as most quandaries with aging parents are, it's complicated and ugly."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 123 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qntrif/can_you_ever_make_them_do_it_or_do_you_have_to/

"The cost of caregiving is too high and I can't continue like this. I need to vent. My (26) mom (68) had a fall and broke many bones, after many surgeries and a month long hospital stay, she is now at home with very limited mobility. I am an onlychild, my dad is dead and we don't have other family so everything falls in me and I don't have a lot of support, except from my friends. I was already her caregiver when she broke a leg when I was 21 and have been financially responsible for her for 8 years. I am so tired / angry / frustrated and I can't face to keep being responsible for everything. Being responsible for her health is such a big pressure, as if anything goes wrong it will be my fault. Example, if something is a warning sign and I didn't realize. Cognitively she is great, so she could help me figure out stuff. Instead, she decides to acts like a toddler which gets on my nerves. She has always being emotionally immature and narcissistic, but she takes it now to an extreme. She doesn't take any agency over

her own health or even bothers to try. When I tell her that it is X time and she has to take X pill, she answers something like "Ok, I'll take it only if you want me to take it". At the same time, I can't speak with her like grown ups. When I tell her that I am burn out, her answer is "I'll just make myself invisible so I don't bother you anymore if I am such a burden for you". I hired a caregiver and she refuses to ask her for help if I am around (because she "prefers it when I do it") so I have to leave the apartment. I have no safe space anymore as being in my apartment is being bombarded by things to do. I am emotionally depleted. I work a full time and a part time job (both remote) and I am being a horrible worker because I don't have the time, energy or focus to work on my tasks. I am late to every deadline and I make so many mistakes due to my lack of attention. So I am also constantly afraid of being made redundant (who is going to pay for everything she needs then?). This year, I have received many amazing career opportunities and I feel like I am throwing everything to the trash because I am not up to what they expected from me. And lastly, I have no time for self-care. I feel like I am giving up my youth and all my desires for her, and I don't want to. But then, I feel extremely guilty because I should be a "better daughter" -not based in the US-

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cbz9g1/the_cost_of_caregiving_is_too_high_and_i_cant/

"I'd go. What they don't tell you about dying is that it often drags on like this. The movies make it seem like its a few days and everyone jumps on a plane for the last moments. The reality is that for a lot of people it goes on for months or years. At first you think its imminent so you take off work, cancel vacations, maybe even put off your own medical appointments because you want to be available. But eventually you have to go back to work, take care of yourself, enjoy your own life. He is going to die and not going on your vacation will not change that. I'd go."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 67 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/oo77pcc/

"I am truly sorry for your loss. There is a lot to be said for a peaceful passing (*and* being a witness to it, IMO). Take care of yourself, OP. <3"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 60 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkw18g/dad_passed_this_morning/p2wrf5r/

"Unfortunately malnutrition is common with ARFID. The best way is to talk with her, call an ED hotline for help. Is the doctor tracking her vitals? I think if her doctor is not freaking out, it could be possible there's an underlying issue he is aware of but cannot disclose to you. Cancer, diabetes, etc. But you have to let her take an active role in her health and to have privacy. If she has an aversion, she has a fear of dislike of texture. Are you able to try smoothies and slowly encourage adding more solids? Honestly, take care of yourself. Your kid needs you. There's no way to talk sense into her within in the next 48 hours to completely change with an ED/ARFID, and scaring them can make it worse and they won't trust you or be less willing to eat around you lest they lose control. Don't enable helping her if she depends on you to help her do tasks. Tell her you care for her and love her, but you've noticed a change and it is freaking you out, you want to know if she is okay and in a bit, ask if she needs help. You can't force her to eat, but you don't have to put yourself into her or let your kid be around that behaviour if it is taking such a big toll."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 46 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v6xkzt/desperate_mother_54_yo_55_8593_lbs_starving_for/ozu0m33/

"This is why I went very low contact with my parents. They have done so many terrible things to me. Their cruelty is shocking. Take care of yourself. I honestly don't know how they can be so mean to a person who is supporting and caring for them"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 43 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op2dhix/

"I am a caregiver to my parents. I am a 59 year old divorced mother of 2 grown boys. I had been an empty nester for about 2 years when I was asked to retire early from my teaching career, sell my house, and move to another state to care for my mom with dementia and my dad with cancer. My brother is still married so it mae sense that I should be the one to help. My youngest was still in college. I sold my home, gave up full retirement, and moved to care for mom and dad. I have been here 19 months now. I left a vibrant area to move to a rural area. I miss my old life. I miss my own space. I miss my friends. I had a nestegg from the sale of my home, but it is quickly dwindling away with one still in college and no paycheck coming in. Because I left my job early, I can not draw retirement until age 60. It has been hard! Dementia is such a terrible disease. My mother was so energetic and so full of life. She did everything right - she took care of herself - never drank or smoked, walked 10 miles a day, and ate healthy. To see this happen to her is so cruel. Why take care of yourself?! It is hard for me to even remember who she was. My dad was the same as mom, always eating healthy and very athletic - never drank or smoked. I get to watch him fight cancer and the evils of chemo. My kids don't come visit anymore because this isn't their home, and they say it is "depressing." I have decided that I want to be in a nursing home if I get to this point. I also want to leave my entire body to science - no burial and no funeral! This Christmas was the first one that I had without my kids. I wonder how long my life will be on hold and if I will even have a life after this."

youtube · @kimberlymason7080 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 28 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugy0ThUTkXZAlwC3W3J4AaABAg

↳ **@stephaniegailwray5543** (8): "God bless you for loving your parents. You find some care giver to come and give you a break use your parents money to pay for it. You deserve a break."

↳ **@paolamura3497** (3): "Get all the help you can with the resources available. Talk it out with your brother. He has to help too."

↳ **@Forestmtn** (3): "For some unexplainable reason, parents think the daughter does not have a life and the son should not be bothered."

"Put yourself first. Hugs and much love to you. She has been able to live independently for 25 years. Tell her, her act is not going to work. Take her to the airport or bus depot and drop her off. You need all the help you can get right now and this is massively unacceptable. She knows exactly what she is doing. 61 is not old. We have 61 year olds here helping their elderly parents. She is employing weaponized incompetence at the highest level."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/n9d5lyi/

"While I appreciate this video, how do you put yourself first when there is no one else to give you a break from the disabled person? It's like taking care of a helpless newborn. The baby's needs come first. You could take a break to rest and let the baby cry, but I personally couldn't do that."

youtube · @bellabong8862 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 23 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyZPIPS02O63K264vV4AaABAg>

↳ **@debby891** (12): "Exactly! They tell you what to do, not how to do it when you're the only one and are physically, mentally and emotionally exhausted all the time"

↳ **@MonicaKochar** (1): "Take micro breaks - use headphones to listen to music - short walks around the house - reach out to someone for help I don't know your life so I am only suggesting generally"

↳ **@GrandmaGoddess** (0): "Exactly and honestly, this speaks to how kind you are. It's extremely hard when no one is available to relieve you so you can take a break. On top of that dealing with the guilt you feeling for wanting the break in the first place. You deserve rest. I hope you are able to get some support soon."

"Right now, I am 13 years of age. I am a smart kid, I will admit that. I am bettering myself right now because, I live in Pennsylvania, my pap, age of 69 right now, and my uncle, age of 55 right now, will need assistance when they get of age. (exc.) The last few days my parents let me spend the night with my pap. My pap and uncle both own a good amount of land, both wealthy-ish, today before I came home my pap made a deal with me, when I turn 18 if I take care of myself, and some of his basic necessities, he will let me stay with him, or live with him, as long as I go to college and work for it. Gladly, I took the offer, he has a good bit, a whole lot, of beautiful country land and a beautiful house, I start early working for it, I am in the comments sharing my story because basically, I am trying to prove that its never too early to start bettering yourself and working for the best! (Any tips or comments are gladly appreciated as a response I enjoy reading what people think! Take care of yourself and work hard! :))"

youtube · @rubyka8164 · TOP TIPS FOR NEW FAMILY CAREGIVERS - How to Take care of Aging Parents · 20 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gOUwGxD4F90&lc=UgwyxmxmUtpzibf56u_J4AaABAg

"If you cannot get her out of bed without risking hurting yourself then stop doing so 6-10 times a day. That is too much. While using a walker get her into a chair in the morning and then use OT or PT to help with any other movements, its literally their job. Then help her to bed in the evening. It sucks but she can be changed while standing and holding a walker or in bed. You must take care of yourself before youre in the same spot. Good luck."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 18 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n7v3y4/rant/ncafi5p/>

"At the absolute minimum, when the aides get there you leave the house. No excuses you leave the house. And do not go back until minutes before they have to leave. And tell your siblings they either come watch her on a schedule or they pony up the money for you to get more help. Your mother might be demanding but you are being a push over. Take care of yourself you are no good to anyone if you burn out."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1dbgh7t/rant_post_hospital_discharge/7rr62r/

"There's no shame in being resentful about the situation your Mother has put herself in from Her bad decisions/her insisting to stay in am unsafe home and trying to force you to uproot your whole life to do it. Say No. No you will not move to her home. Tell her, tell her again All the Huge Help you are offering is Only if she moves closer to you and Thats It. There is nothing wrong with your offer. If she doesn't want you Wonderful offer of help then tell the rehab that she doesn't have any help in her area and she needs there assistance finding her housing and help that will fit her extreme needs now...they can nit release her if she does not have adequate and safe living arrangements and that is Not your responsibility, do not volunteer to her Or the reb facility to take care of her once she is released if it will be at her home...because if you agree then she Will be your responsibility. You mention she's never helped you so you do not rely on her for anything so it will not effect you if she throws her sissy fits about it and threatens to cut you out of the will, etc... It's not worth it to put yourself through all the extreme work and stress she Is and Has been. Elderly do not get better normally, they get worse....their health keeps declining and their Attitude...so I would greatly advise not to move her into your home as she will make you Miserable on purpose to take it out on you that she wasn't able to return to her home because of Her own making and life. And she won't be able to live on her own long at her age and condition even if she is able to get up on her damaged hip...which you mention the doctors saying could be a year...you Will be having to live w her wherever she ends up living due to she is going to need 24/7 care and monitoring when she leaves the rehab and that could last Years...possibly 10 years or more. If you want your life and rest as you mentioned your tired then say no to her and tell the rehab you aren't able to physically help her and she has Noone else who can. You are not responsible

to take her or to be her Punching bag and Slave cause thats what you will be. She doesnt respect you or appreciate you. Let her go to a nursing home where she will have a Team of people who are trained to assist her with all her many needs and visit her. She definitely as wants you to give up your life and doesn't care one bit how that effects you. Tell her she can Call her male friend. This is also effecting your Son and will more if you become her 24/7 caregiver which is exactly what will happen. I've been in elder care 25 years, I've seen this happen repeated to families. She's ungrateful and thankless and she Will make your life Miserable. It's Ok to say No to something that will nit be good for You. And yes she absolutely should Not be driving. I would suggest removing the battery from her car so it can not be started because elderly hide extra keys and are defiant and will continue to try to drive no matter how unsafe it is for them and Everyone else around them."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/qnqnbvgm/

"This is true. Being a support person for my mother while she cared for my father was awful even for me the less-present daughter. She neglected herself and yet complained constantly. She had no self care. But it took so much for us to convince her to move him out of the house to a care facility even though things were happening like him falling and her at almost 80 unable to pick him up. Seeing this dynamic is rough. Still, Jack doesn't get that it's a luxury to have 24/7 in home care. If only we could've afforded that (or convinced mom to allow it). As it was, the care home led to inadequate care and his quickened death and I will always carry that with me."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/ocbrn9e/

"It's unfortunate when parents get to this age and they have made no plans for illnesses and health crisis. Sitting down and talking with parents does no good they will not listen. If you willingly stepped into caregiving role then they are going to continue to use you as a caregiver. They do not care that you work, have an apartment or a life to live. You have already spoken with them and pleaded with them to get help and they have chosen not to do so. Leave them to make decisions about their life, health and future living arrangements. Your mental and physical health is being greatly effected. Please put yourself and your needs first. Women have a hard time with this. Many of us are people pleasers, have weak boundaries, self abandon and are codependent because we have been socially conditioned to put the needs of everyone else before our own."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walkiing_away_from_my_mom/p4fx5m0/

"Take care of yourself b4 you take care of others. Say "No", you cannot care for your parents esp. if they never treated you right. You do not owe them anything."

youtube · @kaylanguyen8665 · *The Toll That Caring For Elderly Parents Can Take* · 12 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=2kM35JxnTow&lc=UgjbPRic4qp_IHgCoAEC

↳ **@clamarroan (8)**: "2000Betelgeuse Excuse me? Thanks to them? Did she ask them to be born? Or did they have her because they CHOSE TO? Stop with this fake argument to continue endorsing the selfish attitude of a generation of humans who refuse to let young people enjoy their lives!!!!!"

↳ **@barbaragonzalez1537 (7)**: "Not all parents are "parents" and do not deserve to destroy your life."

↳ **@2000Betelgeuse (4)**: "Barbara Gonzalez It's not about deserving, it's about giving love without expecting anything in return....no parents are perfect and we need to treat them well in spite of their shortcomings"

""Make sure to take care of yourself." Gawd, I hate that. Part of being a caregiver is feeling a sometimes overwhelming sense of failure, AND I have failed at self-care too!?"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/ns06aui/

"It really sucks!!! I agree with the sentiment in the other comments; I'd dial back contact and help to the bare of minimum. You are right to worry about your own health and mental well being. Trust yourself. Take a break. Or a permanent one if that feels best to you (I get that "best" is very relative in this situation). When my husband was in the thick of this with his parents a few years ago, I kept lovingly reminding him that if he tanked his own health (we are in our early 50s) that I was going to be seriously pissed. 🤔 I want him around for at least another 20+ years! His parents were/are kinda assholes to begin with and it only got worse with age. My god, the constant demands put on my husband were unbelievable. And yet they refused help from anyone else. Exhausting and infuriating. If we're in this group, we all know this all too well. My own parents divorced and remarried and are all four in their 80s. I'll be the point person for 3 out of the four with no other family to help me. I dread it all soooooo much. So no advice from me, just solidarity and encouragement to take care of yourself!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walkin_g_away_from_my_mom/p4g9oti/

What the parent says · 95 documents

20 most engaged of 95 matching documents, complete text.

"My mom informed me I will be inheriting the care of my two siblings. I am the oldest of three. Me 50F, sister 46F and brother 37M. Roughly 6 months ago, my mother (75F) and I were discussing her paperwork (POA, will, etc) and all of the necessary related things. She said "don't forget, you will have to look after your siblings". Ok, my siblings have both had their issues. So I dared to ask, what exactly do you do for them regularly? My sister has made numerous stupid decisions over the years, and my mom has bailed her out several times, mostly financially. She is currently living with her boyfriend of 18 years. Just found out he owes \$63K in back taxes to the IRS. They are finally taking action. If he loses his house, my sister will lose the roof over her head. I honestly think my mother expects me to take her in, because I have an "empty bedroom". (My oldest finished college, found a good job and got her own place. I still have two more living at home currently in college.) No. Just NO. My mother has always been my sister's back up plan. Mom said she's ready for me to "take over." No. Next is my brother. He is autistic and has medically well managed schizophrenia. He does have his own place, car, and manages to hold down a 32-hour a week cashier job. Admittedly I have a soft spot for him. So, I asked, how can I help? I was thinking mental health/medical needs (I'm an RN). Nope, my mother micromanages every aspect of this kids life. She spends as much time at his apartment as she does at her house. Cleans, does his laundry, takes out his trash. I was speechless. They are so intermeshed and co-dependent that I don't even have words. She makes him call her twice a day if she isn't there. I told her my version of "helping" and her version are two VERY different things. I raised my three kids, and thankfully they are all transitioning to adulthood. I'm starting to embrace the 'empty nest', I have zero desire to take on another 'kid'. I probably should have disclosed from the beginning, all three of us have the same parents. We grew up in an abusive/neglectful household. Dad was the main perpetrator, he's been dead for years. All three of us kids got different versions of mom. I bailed as soon as I graduated high school, and am admittedly not that close with anyone. I'm friendly but keep my distance. Apparently my mom thinks I am "taking over" as she is "getting too old" but she does not approve of my boundaries, my "list" of what I am willing/not willing to do. She has accused me of "abandoning my siblings". I'm not even sure what I am asking for here. Just venting? There is much more. I could type for days."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 559 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q839bu/my_mom_informed_me_i_will_be_inheriting_the_care/

"I think they don't have enough going on in their lives so they persevere on this stuff. Also, they do lose track that not everyone who is younger than them has the strength of a 30 year old. 10 or so years ago my mom asked if my husband and his brothers could do some stuff she wanted done around her house, and I had to remind her that that entire crew was now in their mid-fifties and had bad backs! I like to remember that "No" is a full sentence."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 273 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/o2zbjdd/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the

strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"I can't do this anymore, and I never agreed to be a caregiver to my mother's husband.. To sum up some background context, my mom remarried when I was in my mid 20's about 20 years ago. My mom asked me to move in 3.5 years ago to temporarily help her with my son. My mom died 3 years ago, my son died a year ago. I have never been close to her husband, he didn't even start being nice to me till my mom died. I feel I can't leave because I'm the only person he doesn't kick out. I'm coming from a place of deep frustration at the moment, and I'm sorry if I sound like a soulless monster. I just can't do this anymore. My parents didn't divorce till I was an adult. In extreme desperation, I assume my married, lets call him Frank. (now 75) Frank was the opposite of my father who my mother loved dearly in every bad way. He was uneducated, uncaring and had no family values, but what I could I do. It was her choice to marry him after 4 months. I had my own life going on and briefly stayed with them after being left during my third trimester of pregnancy till my son was six weeks old. Frank, made sure I knew that I had to get out after I gave birth and that my mom was not going to be a "babysitter" She did what he said, she liked being controlled. So, my mom undergoes what I felt was an unnecessary medical procedure that caused complications. She asked me and my teenage son to move in to help her overcome her health obstacles. Frank decides to get an unnecessary elective surgery and my mom actually kills herself trying to care take to him afterward. I was distraught to say the least and I never blamed Frank for my mom's choices. I could say in detail every event that has made me choose not to leave. But I want someone to read this. I'm being manipulated, and I know this and he kicks out any of his family including his daughter who left earlier this year, traumatized from PTSD he gave her and won't come back. Frank is from a different state, all his large family lives there. He refuses to go there and kicks out any adult grandchild etc that is sent to help because I have made it known I want to move out of here. He is completely fine with me here, especially since my son died. I don't get up in his business because I'm too consumed with my own grief and we live separate lives, but I clean. His life is watching Forensic Files, lurking Facebook and spending my dead mom's money on cam girls and what he knows are scams. Oh, and lot's of Dr visits, he has always loved going to the doctor. He is not being medically neglected, he more overrides the

health care system by getting a Dr appointment for anything. He has destroyed his body signing up for clinical trials. He also loves to kick out home health nurses, go to the ER afterward and report the aides of injuring him and theft. (nothing has been stolen) My life is I constantly work to stay busy and out of my own head. I don't stay here out of financial security. I can very much afford to not be here. I'm paying for my own father's assisted living in NYC and I would be in a bind if I was footing two bills. He doesn't want assisted living anyhow and I know its just a matter of time till he burns through my mom's money and I become financially responsible for him. (Help pay for my father's assisted living. He is smart and planned for this, just not in NYC. He hates Texas and I can't blame him. I help with the offset cost, not the entire huge bill) The neighbors of 20 years have been very supportive of him and me. They will take him to the ER for his unnecessary reasons, or will show up at the hospital because he decides to call 911 while I'm in therapy. Today, Frank has burned bridges with the neighbors and I'm terrified. They are all the support I have. The only support he has. So I come "home" from my typical 12 hour day with a trunk full of groceries only to find a large snake in the garage. I'm like great, go inside to get a broom and Frank calls out my name all cranky. We briefly discuss the snake. He then goes on about how mad he is because he fell twice trying to mow the lawn in 95 degree Texas heat. I'm like why are you mad? That was your own fault. He then goes and blames the next door neighbor for not mowing it for him like she normally does. And then blames me for not reading his mind. I didn't even notice it needed to be mowed. It wasn't that bad. I'm like that is not her job to mow your lawn and you could have asked me. He carries on about how we caused him to fall and I leave the unreasonable situation to get the groceries. My other neighbor calls me over and asks me wtf his problem is because he had to pick him up twice when he tried to mow the lawn causing panic all up the street. I give him the synopsis of what he said. Other neighbor tells me, you know he doesn't have cognitive decline and is just an asshole. I agree and he says I'm done. Go save yourself, I mean that. Other neighbor is a man of his word. He should have been done long ago as should have I. I'm terrified and have to accept that I'm not a horrible person for failing to save Frank from himself and choosing myself. Edit: sorry for all the typos and grammar mistakes my phone is freaking out too, and I need to get this out! And the 3 foot snake is still chilling in the garage. I will snake wrestle when it becomes daylight. Edit Edit: Is this normal on his part. I have read that as people age, they can become the worst form of themselves or the best form of who they wanted be. Edit: Thank you all so much!! The gaslighting is real. I needed to know this is with out a doubt, not my problem. I got into with him over the weekend when he tried to blame me for my mom's death. You don't go there with me and I don't stoop to his level. I was the bigger person and said: Me: I don't know what you want from me! Especially if you treat me like this Him: I should not have to say it. Me: Actually you do have to say what you want from me because I have no idea. Him: You know it! Me: I have no idea Him: I'm sick of repeating myself. Nobody listens. I want you out of here. I'm like sweet! I'll leave happily. I told him I'm leaving after the 4th weekend so I could find a place with out being overly dramatic and he needs to call his family and tell them he asked me to leave. Of course he is acting like that never happened. I just found some big chain complex that has an apartment available for move in 07/06. I'm taking it and can transfer units or complex's later if I need. Im too nice still and hired a lawn company to clear out any snake inviting debris and staying friendly to get what I want of my mother's. I know I'm not through with it all, once he dies, gets forced placed in a nursing home or loses the house taking out equity loans, I will have to clean it up. It will probably all happen within a week and this year. I did what I could but I can't sacrifice the remaining good years of my life so he can do whatever it is he does. Edit edit: I have always refused to be his POA or have any type of decision making authority with him. That was all settled with his family earlier this year and I was vocal I want nothing to do with this. His poor daughter is POA and will be the one really stuck to clean up this mess he leaves behind. He got her to sign up for that while she was emotionally vulnerable. There is nothing to gain when he dies, anything liquid he tore through after my mom died. I will help his daughter though emotionally. Her feelings towards him make mine seem warm and fuzzy. I will keep in my mind that they are not my family and trust no one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 126 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugwxtv/i_cant_do_this_anymore_and_i_never_agreed_to_be_a/

"I just refused a lump sum cash gift from my mom.. Today I was visiting my mom (79, in independent assisted living and on the doorstep of needing LTC because she is maxed out on what private nursing can provide with her numerous health and mobility challenges). She told me she is considering giving my younger brother and I (her only children) a lump sum cash payment to "help us out." Here is where this is coming from... Four years ago my brother was on a reckless path and my elderly parents (both were alive at the time, RIP Dad at age 82 in 2025) gave him \$65-70K to "fix" things with no strings attached. It was a gift. They asked me to please respect their decision and to simply "understand because a parent would do anything for their children." My parents did this before asking my brother to tap into his own resources. They felt strongly that he should maintain his assets and the simple lifestyle he had. After three years, my parents finally stopped paying for my brother's expenses, largely because I pleaded this was enabling and was getting out of hand. To add to the stress, it was becoming clear that long term care was in the future for our Dad and it is now very close for our Mom. My brother still wanted many thousands of dollars more and when my parents finally said "no," he exhausted his meager savings (he is middle-aged) and he is now in debt. Our mom is aware that paying off this debt is a slow and painful process for my brother, but he is doing it. She also knows my family and I are completely self-sufficient. Anyway, our mom then asked me what I would think if she were to give me and my brother each a lump sum payment "because it could really help us out." My "enabler" alarm went off because of the huge amount of cash my parents already gifted my brother. It is not to come out of his inheritance. I wondered if there would be any end to this if i accepted her money. My dad articulated that his dying wish for me was to make sure my younger brother is never homeless. Sadly, that says a lot about the dynamics. My "enmeshed behaviour" alarm went off next because I have experienced transactional treatment from both our mom and dad; specifically their regular reminders I would one day inherit a nice piece of my mom's jewelry "for all I do for them." I was actively involved in both our dad's and now only mom's caregiving. I live very nearby Mom's assisted living facility, but I have a family of my own and am always honest about my capacity. My approach to caregiving is sustainable, finally, after several intense years of my parents' very real medical emergencies and rapid declines. I have to constantly be on guard because my parents have always treated me as an extension of themselves. I replied that I don't need any money and am not in financial difficulty. I can afford what I need. I suggested that if she wants to give my brother an early gift of inheritance she needs to get her Will redone so the early gift is recognized and accounted for to be fair. She said she didn't want to change her Will. It would either be we both get money early or neither of us do. I know my brother is struggling financially (not my monkey, not my circus) but I feel like our mom is trying to manipulate me. I am the family scapegoat because I have boundaries around my time/energy/conversation topics/etc. I am also her only child that has ever been dependable, consistent and taken on caregiving for her and Dad. My brother is the golden child who always has some trouble to be solved but is just such a busy and great guy who is sensitive and sweet. He can go weeks to months without calling her and is still wonderful because things are just so hard for him and he can't help it. My mom's money feels dirty and for me, I feel like it would just exacerbate the extremely transactional treatment I receive from her. She says that if I don't want to accept her "gift" then my brother won't get one either. And like the scapegoat I am... I am okay with that. Thanks for listening to me vent. \\ \\UPDATE\\ \\ Hours after I made my original post, my mom told me she wants to meet with her financial advisor in a couple of weeks to review her investments and asked me if I want to come. I might try to leverage the advisor, alert her about my brother and the risk of financial abuse and tell her about mom's plan to give lump sum payments. I would try to get the advisor to lay out my mom's financial reality to both of us. We already know it but it might as well be part of the conversation as a reminder. My hope is the advisor would discourage my mom from getting used as a bank. I would hope that if Mom still wants to give my brother and I cash gifts, the advisor would encourage payments dispersed over time (with a limit) to both my brother and I as opposed to lump sums, explain the benefits of a professional trust and help Mom lay out a plan. This absolutely won't stop the emotional manipulation I receive from my mom and I don't expect it to or for her to change in any way. It will not stop my mom from feeling the itch to help my brother by giving him more lump sums on top of it. About every 6 months my brother implies need and my mom gets the itch for a while and scratches. Dad did too. More Context: I should add that though my parents stopped giving my brother large lump sums 12-18 months ago, my mom (who hasn't

driven in a couple of years) gave my brother her 10 year old vehicle about 10 months ago. This vehicle was previously kept in underground parking at her residence and I used it to drive her to her appointments because she can't get into our trucks. She paid for the maintenance/parking/fuel/insurance and I managed the logistics and took it for servicing, washes, fuel ups and cleaned it. My brother lives 350 km away. Now she will only go to an appointment if her residence's complimentary courtesy car is available. This service only provides door to door drop off and pick up, no escorting. Her mobility is terrible and she uses a walker but her physio says she needs a wheelchair for going out. That is the second physio to say so, btw. She refuses to get one (it would be fully funded thanks to government grant for disabled people!) and so I stopped meeting her and the courtesy car at her appointments. She only leaves for appointments (not shopping/errands/coffee/dining out at all). Sometimes she goes alone, which her doctor and RN in charge of her case say she absolutely shouldn't do, but she has occasionally hired a health care aide to accompany her through the private nursing company she uses. Telling history that shows how longstanding these patterns of thought are: 25 years ago my mom and aunt worked together to have my Grandma write my uncle out of Grandma's Will. Uncle was divorced, retired and a live-in part-time carer to supplement the publically funded home care Grandma received. Grandma paid for his divorce, bought him a car, paid for his holidays and he lived rent free. However, he cooked, did the yard care for her house, drove her to appointments, picked up prescriptions, etc. Sometimes my grandma wasn't happy because he picked up casual work related to his previous profession, when she wanted him to be home and she wanted him to do more. Mom and Auntie thought he was getting a free ride and convinced my grandma to write him out of her Will. I was a newly minted adult at this time, just finished university and I thought this might be a unique scenario or that maybe my uncle wasn't helping enough but this way of thinking has persisted and I have come to doubt the "lore" around caregiving for my grandma. This is the context I have in the background in caregiving for my mother. *Edited to fix a typo and to note I am not in the US."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v3spn7/i_just_refused_a_lump_sum_cash_gift_from_my_mom/

"My parents told me i was out at 18 and not expect any help I remember that when they come to ask for help from me If i want to i will If i dont i wont No guilt on my side They told me how it worked Their rules, not mine"

youtube · @ChrisAthanas · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 79 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw3q5jxftwXAJfX2Hx4AaABAq

↳ @Acie2024 (10): "Hell yeah damn straight! Take care of yourself self fist 🤞"

↳ @robogal1 (8): "My mother said exactly the same to me, when I was 19! "I don t want to know anything of your problems, I have my own." But now, as she is old, I shall care for her and do everything for her. ..and me, stupid thing, I m doing it."

↳ @infplife1637 (8): "@reginafariasThis commenter hasn't "forgotten" anything. They stated their own truth. It's fine if your situation is different."

"offer rejected. My 90 yo mom went home from hospital and rehab stint. My sibling stayed with her for a week. Now all care falls on me. My husband asked my mom to come stay with us for awhile, temporarily until it might need to be permanent . She said she would consider it. I expected her to jump at the chance, but she pretty much turned us down. She said she would be fine alone in her house. The main reason he invited her was to take the burden off of me by having her at our house instead of me going to her house a few times a day. She is going to need more care pretty soon, but now I really don't want her to come live with us. Thanks for allowing a safe space to vent."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 73 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fwww6z/offer_rejected/

↳ **comment** (71): "You are very lucky she said no to coming to live with you and your family. You cannot continue to prop up your mother by going to her house 2 or 3 times a day. She clearly needs more care and supervision and cannot continue to live in her home. You are going to have to let her live her life and fail at this before she is willing to make a change. That change should be in an AL if she can afford it or she will have to hire caregivers to come to her house x number of times a week, if she can afford it or she will need to go back into a facility if she cannot take care of herself. You cannot keep up the pace of running her household and your own. Yes the solutions sound harsh but when an elder refuses to compromise then unfortunately you have to choose your mom or yourself and your own health and emotional and physical well being."

↳ **comment** (18): "Don't take it as a slight to you, it's hard to leave your home. If you have to go there too many times a day, see if she can find a paid caregiver or tell her you can only help if she comes to stay with you."

↳ **comment** (12): "Hi so there are no perfect solutions here, my mom did both the home care thing at our house and is now in AL. I guess a third option might have been moving her to a senior apartment and hiring her care. My thoughts. Two big factors will be how well the house suits your mom and what the labor market is like where she lives. My uncle is 4 years older than my mom, has major memory problems, but has hung in there with the help of an amazing housekeeper, he has a flat house, and is in a compact village in a rural area so he has built in interaction to some degree. My mom was in a large house with difficult steps and falling hazards, she was in a sprawling expensive suburb where it was hard to get good help, and even with help was pretty isolated. Having a person in her house all day seemed to breed conflict. So we went with AL. Also her house was in a great location but aging as fast as her and it was the right time to sell. I have learned the hard way that AL is not very personalized and while my mom fits well into the level of care they provide, it's a very partial solution. She still needs me or someone really frequently, but stuff like caring for the house is no longer an issue and there is structure for her medications. She also is enjoying the social aspect and doing some activities. I will also say that making a move gets harder as they age, so this may be the window that you need. My mom had pretty major surgery in April and it became apparent her days of living independently were over. I would love to think that your mom is looking out for you and knows on some level that moving in with her would be hard for you. Good luck!"

"What really happens if you insist it is not safe to discharge a parent to their home?. Okay, what really happens if you tell a social worker/medical staff it is not safe to discharge your parent to home? I've posted before about my 84 year old, 6 foot tall, 300+ pound Dad with many, many medical problems. My Mom (80, bad knees) is his primary caregiver. They (he) are adamant that he does not want to live in a facility. He fell, again. Was hospitalized, again (no broken bones this time). Sent to a rehab facility, again. Will stay for another two weeks and then be discharged whether he can get himself out of bed and to a commode or not. Again. This time the social worker at rehab recommended assisted living. They refused. My Mom says we've figured it out before and will again. So what happens if I go to the social worker and insist it's not safe to discharge him to home? If he can't stand up unassisted it really isn't. Or if the social worker and doctors do a little math and figure it out on their own? This sub has recommended pulling the "it's not safe" card, but what really happens? Do they send him to a assisted living facility and we have to figure out how to pay for it? My parents are mentally competent adults. I am their medical and financial POA but I don't think it matters."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 55 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tx398k/what_really_happens_if_you_insist_it_is_not_safe/

↳ **comment** (69): "Since your mother and father are saying they are ok and if they are deemed to be mentally competent you can't over ride their rights. People have the right to make stupid choices. And your parents together can make stupid choices. It is hard to watch them being stupid."

↳ **comment** (65): "Last time I tried they ignored me. I don't think hospitals care anymore. They had some rando pt lady declare her safe. Said she could walk 80ft. Even tho her chart said she needed assist to go to the

bathroom and she's in a wheelchair. When I was there she def couldn't walk 10 feet. So it's supposed to be the magic words but they didn't care."

↳ **comment** (37): "Unsafe Discharge is so they don't hand them off on YOU. If there are family members or a spouse who is saying they can handle it, it's not going to work."

"I think I might fall into the "waited too long" category. I've left voice messages for several elder care agencies this morning to get advice on how to get help for my parents-no return calls yet. Out of complete desperation, my mom asked me to pick up her prescriptions yesterday as she had been out of her meds for almost a week. My stepdad is very ill with terminal cancer and my mom is his caregiver. They both appeared to be in very poor condition, physically, when I visited yesterday. They have socially isolated themselves for years prior to the pandemic. It's probably been a decade since they had any visitors to their house aside from me, and I'm only allowed to stand at the front door, no one is allowed to enter the home. My mom is mortified of their hoarding issues, is partially disabled and is now having trouble with things like fixing meals and bathing. Her clothes were all ripped up thanks to a puppy my mom decided to adopt about 6 months ago. It's a german shepherd puppy, and it is completely untrained and is presenting a huge hazard to their safety. She has said that the dog has tripped her before. I suspect the puppy was a way to have an excuse to keep them living in the house. I can hear my mom now, "I can't move to a little apartment with a big dog! The dog has to have a yard!" 🙄 I did get eyes on my stepdad, he looked terrible, but was awake and able to stand up to say hello. He did not participate in the conversation, and I suspect that two years of chemo have left him mentally impaired. Both of their cars are broken down now, so they are completely dependent on delivery services for groceries. They haven't taken the trash to the curb since last September. I don't know where they are storing all their garbage, but they are definitely storing it somewhere in the house. I'm one sibling of 6, and the other 5 kids are estranged. A part of me wants to just pretend everything is fine, they are adults who can make their own decisions. There's another part of me that knows that I'm the one who will have to deal with any aftermath of a crisis and would really prefer to avert that crisis first. I suppose that is selfish of me to want them to bend to my will for my comfort. I think I'm going to have to get some authorities involved, but I wish there was another way. I've been using "I" statements when talking about helping them move to a safer home, but it doesn't matter. My mom, who is in control of everything--money, access, medical care, etc.- keeps pretending that everything will be better soon and she'll just take care of getting them moved into an apartment herself. She's had magical thinking for as long as I can remember, but this just seems beyond the pale for what she says she thinks is going to happen moving forward. "When [stepdad] is better..." is how most of our conversations go when talking about me helping them move. Sorry for the novel length comment. I have friends who have had to help their parents transition to senior living, but in those cases, the parents were in agreement that help was needed. My mom, however, is waiting for Jesus to show up and make everything perfect for her. I wonder, though, if Jesus --in the flesh-- showed up, if she would accept his help? Probably not..."

youtube · @MsGenXodus · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyY_9Wty9qB6t6idJN4AaABAg

↳ **@catherineskis** (16): "Ma'am don't beat yourself up. My mental health provider told me that "you can't parent the parent and sometimes you have to let them fail"."

↳ **@claudiacanales2662** (14): "Praying for you, I know how terribly difficult this is! I deal with brothers who barely help and I'm the only girl!"

↳ **@Britishdave09** (11): "that's a huge weight to lift on your own but there's sadly only so much you can do. My heart goes out to you."

"I told her that and she said "no, I won't be able to afford it and I'll need help with healthcare in the future. There's no chance" and that's it 😞 "

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/n9ct9w8/

">Have your parents asked you or expressed any worry about how you will survive when you are very old? Huh. Actually... no. That's something I hadn't considered. I mean, I'm planning for my retirement but it's never been a subject with them. Thanks for bringing that up. It's an angle I haven't considered."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p036bjo/

"I'm (REALLY) at the end of my rope, don't know what to do!. I'm not sure where to even start. I can't imagine that anyone has ever gone through a mess like this. I'll try to keep it short, but it is such a mess. I'm 72 years old, have a special needs daughter who lives with my husband and me. My husband recently underwent some serious health issues (he's had one thing after the other since last year). I worked all my life in a high-stress middle management healthcare position and then retired about 5 years ago. I was hoping to be able to enjoy working at home on sewing and craft projects, spend time with our daughter and grandchildren, and be available for my husband's appointments which were becoming more frequent. I also have arthritis and am a 2-time cancer survivor (different sites). My twin brother never married and had a disabling car accident almost 40 years ago. However, he has always lived with our parents and didn't work more than 6 or 7 years his entire life. I always thought he was taking care of our parents, however recent events have made me change my mind and look at that entire situation from a different perspective. For example, our parents were self-sufficient when they were in their 50s, 60s, 70s, and even up into their 80s. My dad passed at the age of 94 but now my brother claims they did not get along. Seems he bit the bullet to accept their money, a roof over his head, hot meals, on and on with no problem. The two of us are the only siblings. So there were two homes on a small piece of property intended for a single dwelling. My brother lived in the house, but Mom and Dad purchased a doublewide and moved it in next to the house maybe 25 years ago. Dad passed away 17 years ago. Mom always wanted something "nice" she said, which was a waste of money because she was a hoarder always, and then brother, who hoarded up the house, moved into the DW with her and proceeded to hoard it up too. My husband and I worried about the situation for years, but brother was the favorite and anytime I visited, Mother claimed to be "going through stuff". Eventually it got so bad that our daughter could not safely enter the home; I offered to help clean but of course hoarders never will accept help. Husband and I discussed contacting APS but we felt it might cause more harm than good. During more than one occasion, I also discussed with the two of them that they needed to check about if brother would have a place to live if Mom needed nursing home care, especially with her owning two homes. They refused to get the second home deeded over to him- Mom said he had "checked into it" and there was no problem. She refused to discuss anything regarding the possibility of her not living forever or not being able to remain at home. Lot of back history as well. Mom always put me in a position of looking after my brother when growing up. Forced me to do his homework for him while he sat and played with model cars. When brother failed in school in the 6th grade, Mom's expectation was for me to stay behind to watch over him and take care of him. I was always an A student, so you can imagine the emotional turmoil this put me through. I developed severe anxiety, illnesses, did not want to go to school. Finally, when I just couldn't force myself to do poorly in school, I felt a coldness from my mother, in particular, and made me feel guilty. This affected my entire life. Anyway, 5 years ago, almost as soon as I retired, my mother (97 at the time) became ill with pneumonia and a UTI and was hospitalized, then moved to Skilled Nursing Care. My brother lied to me about the two of them having had their COVID vaccinations...they did not, and her room was literally right beside the COVID ward. I might have made different choices for myself and my own immediate family had we had the information we now have, but we thought the vaccine was protective. So this failure for my mom and brother to be vaccinated, for all any of us knew, put us all in jeopardy. The EMTs

reported the living conditions of their home at the time, and I tried to discuss it with my brother, but he got very angry. I felt Mom should be placed in long term care. Against my wishes, and behind my back, he took her home and NO ONE from APS stopped him. Home Health came in and never reported it. I couldn't care for Mom due to my responsibilities at home with my own family. In fact, more often than not, when I visited, brother wouldn't "hear the doorbell". His legs were in bad shape (had been for about 34 years at that time), but he refused any help when I checked with him, and refused to go to the doctor. Fast forward to 2024. Mom had a repeat of the 2020 episode, almost verbatim. Except this time, brother finally agreed that he wasn't able to take care of her at home. I tried to get him to pursue options that would have legally allowed transfer of the DW to him, allowing him to sell it and move into a place he could maintain. The entire place is unsafe. At least 6 junk vehicles on the property, foliage grown up, 4 sheds (all in bad state of disrepair, one even no longer has a roof and the back side is rotted and wood planks falling into the alleyway behind the property), 3 pull-behind trailers rusted out, garbage and trash everywhere, boxes stuffed into the junk cars and all over the ground. Back deck steps and deck itself falling down, piled up with junk. Front porch steps rickety and narrow, steep. Can barely see inside, but you can imagine. I videoed huge flies and bugs and fly specks covering the sliding back door. Vines are growing up through one of the front windows and will soon break that window. So as if all this wasn't difficult enough to go through, here is the financial situation: \- Medicaid application #1 June 2024: denied because the nursing home allowed my brother to sign the application without being authorized. I got us both set up as authorized representatives until brother "could get" POA, and reapplied. \- Medicaid application #2 filed August 2024 after 1st denial. This resulted in 2nd denial due to the fact that, YES, she owned 2 homes. Even though I hadn't seen inside the 2nd home in over 20 years, it didn't take much imagination from looking at the home they both lived in and the outside of the old house, to know it was in bad shape. Brother told them it was a "storage facility"! I tried to explain that it was probably not sellable, over and over, yet DSS insisted it had to be put up for sale. FINALLY, he got POA and (although I did not agree to it, he had me assigned as dual POA, which is coming in handy after all, I am finding.) I felt it was up to my brother to sell it since he was living on the property (the buildings are very close together) so I felt it wouldn't be fair of me to sell it myself. He basically then really took advantage of my kindness and dragged his feet, pretending to be taking action, when he fact he was doing NOTHING. He is allowed to live there because he is disabled so they can't sell the property as long as he lives there under that waiver. \- Finally I received a phone call from the nursing home that brother had been ignoring threatening letters for payment for Mom's care, and they threatened to evict her. I notified him that he was going to have to go to DSS and talk to them (I had been numerous times and he wouldn't go with me, then when I told him what they said about selling the 2nd home, it was one delay tactic after another...he lied and said he had money saved up and was looking into buying it himself (complete lie, he had NO money), on and on. He spoke to nursing home business office and they forced him to sign over Mom's complete SS check to the nursing home. \- Discovered he was overdrawing her account then because he didn't cancel automatic payments such as her car insurance payment...she hasn't driven in 20 years!!! I went to the bank and paid several hundred dollars to bring her account to a 0 balance so I could close it out. I opened another account with my own money used to set it up without him having any access and only I serve as POA on the account. \- After the threat to evict Mom, THEN DSS tells us that if we got two realtors to declare that the 2nd home is unsellable, they will exclude it and Mom can reapply. Brother twiddled his thumbs. Oh, he got a couple of realtors down to the property, but when they didn't send the reports, he just kept waiting. So I took the reins and called two realtors myself, got them both down to the property the next day (one of them and I went through the back door to the house and could not get into the second room for the rotten floorboards, junk, falling ceilings due to water damage), and by the next afternoon, I had two reports emailed to me stating that due to the proximity between the two structures and the state of extreme disrepair. This got the 2nd home excluded, so in May, I reapplied for Mom's Medicaid (#3). \- Two weeks before the deadline for a decision, I received a request"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mb0qql/im_really_at_the_end_of_my_rope_dont_know_what_to/

"After a month in a personal care home, my dad went from confused but fully mobile, to catatonic and dying. At first, I felt anger and guilt but the week I let go of it, he passed. I just wanted to share the eulogy I gave, at his memorial service. Mine was the only one written by a caregiver.. My dad wrote this speech for me, through the lessons imparted through his consejos. Growing up, he always told me, "You can do anything - you're a Picard," but with everything else I had to do, finishing this speech eluded me until the last minute. My mom is worried I'll go over 5 minutes. Since I haven't had time to practice, that's entirely possible but we're here, in the house of God, to celebrate my dad. If it's slightly longer, I think God, Michael and the people who came to support us will understand. Last night, my feelings were hurt, when I asked my sister Beverly if she thought we should buy the most expensive or second most expensive Flor de Caña rum, for my dad's wake. She told me it seemed like a big waste of money, for something that not many people would appreciate. My dad discovered Flor De Caña rum on a mission trip to Nicaragua and it quickly became his favorite. I knew he would appreciate the gesture of buying one last bottle to share with his friends and family. We got the second best one, which is probably what he'd have ended up doing too, because even though he liked a good ron, he wasn't the type to spend frivolously. I went up to my room and cried, because it wasn't the loving reunion I'd hoped for. In that moment, I heard my dad say to put a smile on my face and a song in my heart, something he said every day, while we were growing up. He even said it when he had dementia. It was one of his favorite phrases. When we were kids and we weren't getting along, he'd tell me to put a smile on my face and a song in my heart and he'd ask if we could be friends. On the day I started this speech, I forgot to have a smile on my face and a song in my heart, when my boyfriend didn't react to my sudden tears, with the tender, loving hug I thought I needed. I spent the day sad, in my room, instead of finishing it. I realize now, that I didn't need that hug. The love of my father and the love of The Father was already inside me. I only needed to remember it. Michael wasn't a very good father to me. He was a great father to me! While other dads made sure homework was finished, my dad helped me build elaborate, electronic quiz boards for my projects. While other dads sat in the bleachers, cheering on their kids, at softball games, my dad was coaching the team. While other dads dropped off their kids at Sunday School, my dad stayed and taught the class – and he did it all with a smile on his face and a song in his heart. I have a peculiar memory, of listening to "Don't Worry Baby", by the Beach Boys, in my dad's airplane. It's strange, because the only radio he had in his plane was the COM and it didn't play music, so we couldn't have listened to that song in his plane. Perhaps that was the song he had in his heart, that day. Dementia strips away a person's social programming and all that remains is the most basic elements of their personality. A lot of people get angry, fearful, distrusting and flat out mean. Not my dad. In his final years, dementia showed us that positivity, kindness and love were at the core of his being. If you asked him how he was doing, even when he was limping around in very obvious pain, he'd smile and tell you he was great, if he understood your question. If he didn't, he'd say something like Shmellow Qapla', which at least made me laugh. Even when it was unclear if he knew who he was, he knew that woman over there (point out mom) was his beloved Galinda. Every day, he showered her with hugs and kisses and told her how much he loved her. As for the rest of us, on any given day, we might be Bopkiss Lamaymay, Cappy or Roger. Moments of lucidity, in which he called us by our correct names, felt sacred, especially when the next thing he said was, "I love you," which is one thing he never forgot, even if our names eluded him. My father was the closest thing to a dad that my daughter, June, has ever known. He and my mom helped me raise her, without any hesitation or resentment, over the financial burden and all the time and effort he had to put into that, instead of doing regular boomer stuff. She was the center of his Universe. He always wanted a hug from her, until the very end. Sometimes she left him hanging when, in wake of a poosplosion, all he could think about was getting an June hug. The absurdity of it brought some levity to an otherwise unfortunate and frankly, disgusting, situation. We learned that we could use the promise of a June hug as bait, to get him to cooperate with whatever we needed him to do. June was always willing to help us, because she loved her grandpa very much. My dad had a lot of brushes with death, in his final years but he refused to die, as long as June still benefitted from his hugs and his joyful personality. Hospice nurses told us, countless times, that he was in his final days but he defied their predictions, again and again. It wasn't until my mom moved him into a personal care home, where there was no June to hug, that he finally let go, after just a month and a half apart from her. At first, we were angry about his rapid decline, under the care of strangers but it exemplified just

how powerful love is. In John 13:34, Jesus told his disciples, “Love one another as I have loved you.”. This isn't the time to be angry or sad. Now is the time to show the world the unconditional love that my father showed us, the love of I AM. My dad forgot many things, in his final years of life but he remembered the most important thing of all – Love isn't something we NEED. Love is not something to be given or withheld. Love IS the fabric of existence. The only thing we NEED is to realize that love is everything. When we know that, we can do ANYTHING, with a smile on our face and a song in our heart. Today, as we celebrate my father, keep a smile on your face and a song in your heart and let's ALL be friends!"

reddit post · r/dementia · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1qyl65i/after_a_month_in_a_personal_care_home_my_dad_went/

"Have your parents asked you or expressed any worry about how you will survive when you are very old? They are able to work and just choose not to, yet they are taking up your time and resources which you need to be able to save for your own care after you are too old to work. This is what I mean by selfishness on their part. I think you can also become excellent at setting boundaries. Reject the tacit sexist expectation that you will be a caretaker! I applaud the fact that you're even thinking about this and verbalizing an alternate plan. Congrats, and keep going! You deserve to live your own life."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p034dx0/

"My dad keeps saying they are managing just fine. I keep wanting my brother and sister to join me in going one week without answering their calls, giving them rides, or going over to do chores for them. One week of letting them be independent, as dad asserts they can be. One week of getting him to face the reality that he can't care for mom single-handedly, that he can't manage a two story house and big yard in his own, and that he can't apply the foot care treatment the doctor prescribed by himself. But my siblings keep sweeping in to help, and dad keeps burying his head in the sand."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walking_away_from_my_mom/p4ew19u/

"Burned Out & Beat Up!. Ok so this is a rant! A long one. If you read it thanks if it's too much I get it. I'm putting this down for myself as much to get it off my chest and lighten my mind/stress I guess. But first background: I'm usually an upbeat person, always have been, always look on the bright side, acknowledge the fact that others are in worse situations than me, so as to keep myself aware (centered/in-check). I stay clear of Debbie Downers, Negative Nelly's, and KARENS too. Those type folks suck the life right out of you. Sorry I wish them well, it's just life is way too short for all that drama. So my husband and I retired a few years back. Both of us started working when we were teenagers, like a lot of our generation, so we retired early. Now: So we, newly retired, like right out of the gate retired, no celebratory vacation either, and we become full time care givers to my mother. We all "decided/chose" to move in together into a new house, not newly built but perfect for our physical needs especially for my mother. She was fine when we moved in, of course very sad to sell/give up her home, but she said she knew it was the right decision and it's what God wanted/planned for her/us. Her only alternative was a nursing home, because physically she couldn't live in an assisted living facility because she requires too much assistance/care. She couldn't live in our old home because we had stairs and no bedroom suite on the first floor. Plus she couldn't continue paying for PT private home health care because she now needed FT care and not enough \$\$ to pay for it. Side note.....all those supplemental insurance commercials advertising how they can help the elderly age in place (at home) it's all bullshit! I They DO NOT offer COVERED in-home care or drivers to take them to and from doctor appointments. The elderly still pay out of pocket one way or the other either high insurance premiums or straight out of their checking/savings accounts. So they'd have no money left over to pay for basic needs like food and utilities. AND my mother was already paying a monthly premium for additional/supplemental insurance coverage. AND those special services offered via city/county "Offices on Aging", well most won't qualify because

they make too much \$ annually. For example in my mom's situation, she receives a retirement pension, SS, and Medicare benefits due to her age. Yes I called the office and no she doesn't qualify. I also asked about the services listed for support of family care givers like the babysitting your elderly parent services so caregivers can get a break. Well nope don't qualify for that either cause she makes too much money. How you wonder does she make too much money. Well because the ENTIRE households income is accounted/calculated for qualification of city/county services. Yep that's right my husband's and my annual retirement pensions was added to her annual income for a total of "SHE" makes too much! We don't get paid for providing her physical care, monthly expenses, reimbursement for gas or vehicle wear and tear to get her to her doctor appointments, yet you'll add our retirement income to her income. Wow! Yes I love my mother dearly. Anyway.....now to today. She isn't the same person at all. In fact I've realized she wasn't the person I thought I knew for years. Its kind of pissed me off honestly. She had issues that needed to be addressed years ago! That damn generation and sweeping crap under their rugs ugh! So on her nasty days she loves to tell us the following comments: you've got it made, you made out, blah blah. We've got it made!!??? What the fuck is she talking about. We gave up our lives to care for her! She's another full time job, basically, and we don't receive any salary. She is selfish, hateful, ungrateful, hurtful to me and my husband for all the care we give her. Remember she was adamant that she didn't want to go into a nursing home and I/we didn't want that for her either. I'd feel guilty as hell putting her in one of them. Plus she always brought up how one of her older relatives was put in a horrible nursing home, and each time my folks visited, the lady would beg them to take her with them. Mom always said how she wasn't even in her immediate family and questioned whether the lady's family visited her. Plus I promised my dad before he passed that I'd take care of my mom. Now remember I said everything started out great in the beginning. I had a great child hood growing up with my mother albeit as I got older I realized she had some weird quirks but I didn't know what exactly. She wasn't crazy and I do not mean that in a mean way I'm being serious. But I strongly feel that because these "quirks" never got addressed by either therapy, a doctor or with meds it just festered and may have laid the ground work for what she's got now which is psychosis from Parkinson's of which she does not accept. And NO she doesn't have dementia, she is cognizant, passes those doctor tests still today. She's bitter and blames us for her issues.....all of them, everything, whatever she's mad about it's mine or our fault. To everyone else she puts on the sweet little old lady persona and acts like a normal old person. To us she's rarely the sweet lady anymore instead we never know what/who/how she'll act on any given day. She lies constantly, won't take accountability for her part/role in disagreements and we totally believe she likes to stir things up, start things on purpose. If she hears us laughing having a good day, and she's miserable well it's like she has to try and ruin our good mood. Remember I'm a positive person, and she is not ever. Again in regard to Dementia, no she doesn't have it. She's aware of what she's doing especially the change in demeanor when other people are around. It's just sickening! Why do I keep mentioning this well it's because people always assume and say to me "well she's obviously got dementia" ugh SMH!!! So I guess in closing I'm offering a bit of advice to you. When faced with or contemplating having your parent move in with you, while they are great right now, consider the possibility that down the road you may be faced with caring for someone you no longer recognize. In our case the changes happened within a short time, maybe a little over a year of moving in together. To those younger than us that have young kids still living at home think real hard because the dynamics of your lives can and will drastically change. If you have siblings sit down with them and say we won't do this if you aren't on board with helping/supporting in his/her care. I'm an only child and it just drives me crazy when siblings will not help out. They know they dodged a bullet and in secret are giving a double bird salute at the situation. Thanks for letting me vent/ramble on. The last few days have been awful trying."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ph84g3/burned_out_beat_up/

"I found that you can't make an adult do anything they don't want to do. So far I can't make my mom (82) use her hearing aids, put together a plan for when she can't live alone anymore, or give me any of the information I will need as her executor, including her lawyer's name and the location of her will. She has decided I'm argumentative (because she mishears almost everything), I'm now the "difficult" child (my sister used to own that title), and I

can't take care of anyone (my husband and child notwithstanding). I am literally the only person willing to protect her health and her assets to ensure she doesn't end up abandoned and destitute, but she said she's "never coming back" after her recent visit. She was showing signs of cognitive decline: repeating conversations, asking the same questions several times over several days, being confused about whether she could withdraw retirement funds, etc. She clearly needs help, but I'm apparently not the person she'll allow to help her. And she just kinda hates me now."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mchk2o/i_fell_for_it_again_shopping_with_mom/n5u2jx5/

"Should I use a spy camera?. Oh my goodness where to begin? My 90-year-old mother who is financially well off, independent, healthy and still sharp as a tack, has a live-in boyfriend who's also 90 years old. They've been together for about five years now. They are not common law and Mom says they never will be. But he doesn't pay for anything. My problem is that he is very immature, spiteful, and mentally abusive, controlling of her and it's getting worse. I've heard horror stories from mom's helper maid that he gets into big shouting matches with my mother when he doesn't get his way, and gets mad and is vindictive and throwing things around. He has completely rearranged everything in her beautiful home so that now mom can't find anything anymore. He's snooping around in her mail possibly looking for financial info. He is trying to shut her off from her family I guess because he feels his power over her is threatened by the close relationships we all have with my mom. He's has alienated most of mom's relatives through his argumentative behavior. Mom who used to be very strong and ran a sort of tight household, seems to have no way to get him to respect her household set up, all her relatives and treat her and her maid properly. This man is horrible to my mother's maid and leaves nasty notes all over the house for the maid, telling her that she can't do this, and she can't do that, while the maid has been nothing but loving and caring for my mother and her house. In short, it looks like he's trying to run the maid off so he can have full control and power in the house. I don't think he's ever been physically abusive to her, but according to the maid, he is definitely mentally abusive to her. This breaks my heart. But in many ways, he is good for my mother because he drives her everywhere and is there with her for all her medical appointments. He can be very handy in the house. He can make repairs here and there. And he helps with errands. Of course she loves the independence that he helps her to maintain. I can understand that. But the horror stories of what the maid is telling about what he is doing and saying to our mother is really getting disturbing. There's so many other instances that I won't even bother going into. I don't know if the maid is overreacting or what, but I'm getting very concerned about what's going on there. But anyway, here's what I'm thinking about doing to find out what's really going on. I'm thinking about buying one of these little hidden spy cameras with the microphone that I can set up in the kitchen in her house. I'll be able to secretly see and listen to what's really going on there. But I'm sure struggling with the ethics of this. I don't think they would ever find it; they're just not able to focus on fine technological details like that. I mean, what would I even do with this information anyway? I've tried talking to her until I'm blue in the face to get her to stand up to him more, and that has not worked. But if I knew that what the maid was saying is true, I and the family would definitely make a more concerted effort to try to improve things for my mother. So I'd like to get this group's input or experiences with using a spy camera in a mother's house. Thanks."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n429r8/should_i_use_a_spy_camera/

"They don't care. If insurance isn't paying they want them gone. They really don't care whether his is mentally/physically fit or not. They will lie to get him out unless his insurance is paying. My husbands grandfather fell, couldn't walk, and would scream in pain if you tried to move him. They did an x-ray and found nothing. Hospital was trying to discharge him the next day. Only 1 nurse cared. She fought to get a better scan. I can't remember which one. Here he broke BOTH hips. All of the sudden insurance would pay so they did the surgery. Then tried to release him again when he could barely stand. He ended up in a care home. Because no one could \ [MIL] or would \[youngest son\] help him. This was during Covid, so he was in isolation. He died of Covid within a week in that room alone. The home wouldn't admit what he died of. The funeral home had to force the issue due

to state law to find out. So if you manage to get your father in a care facility, do your research. Don't just go by Google reviews. Companies lie on there. But most likely, they are going to send him home because your parents said so."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tx398k/what_really_happens_if_you_insist_it_is_not_safe/opt5epw/

"100% My mother has a friend who started off by using her own experience of putting her mother into care by repeatedly saying (to mum and me) "Oh it was the WORST decision I ever made. My BIGGEST REGRET. She would've been happier had I let her stay at home and fallen down the stairs and k*lled herself." I didn't comment the first few times she said this until I finally cracked and said "and if that scenario had played out you'd be punishing yourself just the same!" Like, stop being f'ing ridiculous! At the same time she was "helping" mum to coordinate a rendezvous with her abusive ex because she somehow **forgot** me telling her about mum's diagnosis and being placed under guardianship. I called her and asked her if she needed to see the medical notes and/or the police report. She said she never saw any abusive behavior from him... like okay?? 🤔 I've definitely toyed with the idea of cutting her off but mum's social circle is small so keeping her for now... There's other interference and bullshit from people not actually here or doing anything helpful. And yes, actively feeding into mum's bouts of paranoia. Recently this resulted in mum turning against me which left her completely unmoored and bereft because I'm her main flipping support person. Also yes, very upsetting and stressful for me also, however the nurses at the home were so great to both of us during that period and reassured me that this happens all the time. The good people are there to listen, help, empathize, visit, and to help keep the morale up. The know-it-all-do-gooders who criticize and interfere from afar are the epitome of **selfish**. I don't let their opinions of me or the situation weigh on me anymore. OP don't feel bad about looking at the phone. In fact, you should. When the above situation was going on I took mum's phone completely away and worked with the nursing team to manage communications for a while. I was open and transparent about the reasons and documented every day. I've just set up an iPhone with the accessibility features which put some guard rails around comms access."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4w2exu/

'You're so strong' / 'I don't know how you do it' · 93 documents

20 most engaged of 93 matching documents, complete text.

"NPR story on caring for aging parents (venting). NPR did a story yesterday morning on caring for aging parents, interviewing a woman who ended up taking care of her mother 24/7 while her mother was bedridden. While it accurately depicted the struggles of caregiving, it ended as most of these stories do by making it redemptive, saying what a beautiful thing it was or what a privilege it was to take care of her mother. My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together. I used to think I might "get my life back," but I've found that you don't. You can't get back all the lost social and career opportunities. You don't get your mental and physical health back. You have to figure out what to do with what's left. I took care of my mother because I felt it was my duty as her son to do so. Most people tell me I objectively did a good job, but I was never temperamentally suited to the role. I forced myself to do it, every day. I put a mask on and was pleasant to her, but I hated having to try to get my mother to do the basic things she needed to do every day. By the end, as her dementia progressed, it felt pointless. I was maintaining a body that had very little mind left in it when I could have been putting my own mind to work in my business, solving problems for clients. I lost my biggest client because I didn't have time to do the work he needed me to do. I resented it. Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy. It was traumatizing. And now I'm still dealing with my mother's estate with a sibling who thinks she deserves half of everything even though she did absolutely nothing to help, ever. She couldn't care less what it cost me. She takes it all for granted. I just hate when people try to sugar-coat what caregiving does to your life and try to frame it in sentimental terms. It wrecked my mental and physical health. It wrecked my business. It wrecked my social and romantic life. It's made me hate my sister for her apathy and greed. I'm 59 and trying to get back into the dating world, and I feel like I'm having to learn how to do it all over again. I'm having to re-learn how to go out and socialize with people. I can only relate my own story, but caregiving didn't leave me with some rosy afterglow. Caregiving wrecked my life. I'm satisfied that I did my duty to my mother, but that's it. It didn't give me some wonderful gift. The news media will never report that story. Edit: Thanks for all the responses. Part of what set me off yesterday was the fact that it was my mother's birthday, and several people sent me messages about how I must be thinking about my mom today. The thing is, I wasn't. I was working all day trying to get a job done for a new client. And I thought about my mother 24/7 for years. I'm done thinking about my mother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,034 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

"My mom informed me I will be inheriting the care of my two siblings. I am the oldest of three. Me 50F, sister 46F and brother 37M. Roughly 6 months ago, my mother (75F) and I were discussing her paperwork (POA, will, etc) and all of the necessary related things. She said "don't forget, you will have to look after your siblings". Ok, my siblings have both had their issues. So I dared to ask, what exactly do you do for them regularly? My sister has made numerous stupid decisions over the years, and my mom has bailed her out several times, mostly financially. She is currently living with her boyfriend of 18 years. Just found out he owes \$63K in back taxes to the IRS. They are finally taking action. If he loses his house, my sister will lose the roof over her head. I honestly think my mother expects me to take her in, because I have an "empty bedroom". (My oldest finished college, found a good job and got her own place. I still have two more living at home currently in college.) No. Just NO. My mother has always been my sister's back up plan. Mom said she's ready for me to "take over." No. Next is my brother. He is autistic and has medically well managed schizophrenia. He does have his own place, car, and manages to hold down a 32-hour a week cashier job. Admittedly I have a soft spot for him. So, I asked, how can I help? I was thinking mental health/medical needs (I'm an RN). Nope, my mother micromanages every aspect of this kids life. She spends as much time at his apartment as she does at her house. Cleans, does his laundry, takes out his trash. I was speechless. They are so intermeshed and co-dependent that I don't even have words. She makes him call her

twice a day if she isn't there. I told her my version of "helping" and her version are two VERY different things. I raised my three kids, and thankfully they are all transitioning to adulthood. I'm starting to embrace the 'empty nest', I have zero desire to take on another 'kid'. I probably should have disclosed from the beginning, all three of us have the same parents. We grew up in an abusive/neglectful household. Dad was the main perpetrator, he's been dead for years. All three of us kids got different versions of mom. I bailed as soon as I graduated high school, and am admittedly not that close with anyone. I'm friendly but keep my distance. Apparently my mom thinks I am "taking over" as she is "getting too old" but she does not approve of my boundaries, my "list" of what I am willing/not willing to do. She has accused me of "abandoning my siblings". I'm not even sure what I am asking for here. Just venting? There is much more. I could type for days."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 559 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q839bu/my_mom_informed_me_i_will_be_inheriting_the_care/

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations: Youre so strong Translation: Youre on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are theyre really saying theyre not going to help you. Theyre admiring your ability to handle it so they dont have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow youre so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. Were just surviving it because theres no other option. I dont need your theology. I need respite care. I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. Theyd watch me help my mom with everything then say I dont know how you do it and leave. If you dont know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Dont stand there marveling at my survival skills like Im some interesting specimen. Im doing this because I dont have a choice and you wont help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: Im going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you wont ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person were caring for so we can sleep. Dont make us ask. Ive got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. Theres more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If youre a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity... you dont need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say Im coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. Thats the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but

they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): "'enjoy every moment' really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking *kilns*, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement than means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home

with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!?" Seriously, I'm done. I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house (front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"If I could have hired outside help I would have done it already.. Having been a caretaker since I was a child (I'm 42 now) I genuinely wonder what people are thinking when they tell me "you've got to get help, you can't do this alone." One of my mom's doctors who works at one of the most prestigious medical schools in the world said "hire a personal assistant for her." I'm at my wits end. I can't even pay all of my own bills and I'm expected to magically manifest 15k additional dollars monthly to put my parent in a care home. Perhaps it's because I've always lived under the poverty line, but I genuinely can't wrap my head around how people think this is a helpful statement. Day in and day out people tell me "you've do so much for her, I don't know how you're still carrying on you really need outside help." I fucking know that. I can't afford it. I'm exhausted from having to have conversations with people who have no clue what it's like to be a caregiver when you're poor. The aid that so many people talk about doesn't exist in the real world because we live in America and there are not any effective social safety nets for people like us. I feel like her illnesses have not only ruined her life but have also collapsed my own ability to thrive. Nothing gets better. It will only get worse until she passes and that is a cold reality for me. I don't want to do this anymore, and there is really no hope that it will get better. It's just "keep going because there is no other choice and if you die then you're also in trouble because now you've left your mother without care." Most days I wish I wasn't born."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 177 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1q1choi/if_i_could_have_hired_outside_help_i_would_have/

"Elderly parents need to massively declutter to downsize. My parents (Mom 89, Dad 92) have gotten to the point where they don't think they can live on their own any longer. My brother, sister, and I understand and agree. Well, I think our Mom would still be fine, but my Dad is declining and it is getting difficult for my Mom to take on the extra work and responsibilities. They are getting serious about selling their house to move to some kind of independent-living/assisted-living facility. The situation is that they have \[IMO\] a ton of stuff. My Dad would be fine to just pick out whatever few things they might need to take with them and get rid of the rest somehow. But my Mom has trouble letting things go. Seven years ago they moved from a home in the mountains down to a lower elevation in a small town. They ended up putting stuff in storage units. With my brother's help, they got that

whittled down to one storage unit a couple of years ago. Now, my siblings and I want to just take everything out of the storage unit and donate it (or whatever) without even going through it. It has been there for years, they don't remember what's in there, so it can't be that important, right? And now a move to a facility means they probably need to dispose of, what, 90% of their stuff? I shudder at having to clean out the workbench and tools in the garage. Are there any emotional or psychological tips to getting a parent to let go and declutter? I'm hoping that Mom will see the need and let it happen. And even if she does, is there any way to help soften the blow? They've been so strong and healthy for so long. They are the last of all of their lifelong friends to still be alive, and this move will, I fear, be a truly neon sign as to their own decline."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 78 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rkulf2/elderly_parents_need_to_massively_declutter_to/

↳ **comment** (83): "At this point the best thing is to be a little deceptive. No one wants their items thrown in a dumpster. You could store their things in a unit for a while as another person suggested, then when they forget what's in there, do what you need to do. You could also create situations where people need particular things. "There is a young family whose house burnt down, they have nothing left, can they have your couch/dining room set/hutch?" And do that way. Sometimes if they know their items are going to charity, and you have created a back story of someone so excited about getting their items, it makes it so much easier. Then they feel a part of things and they feel helpful and purposeful. "My neighbor is looking for a carpet cleaner, so you have one they can borrow?" "Church is having a clothing drive/coat collection/needs extra Christmas decorations, can I look and see if you have some?" It takes a bit longer to do this and really do give thr items to charity. But telling them it's all going to a dumpster or Goodwill can be painful for them."

↳ **comment** (39): "Agree to moving the 90% of the stuff into another storage unit. After 6 months goes by, feel free to empty both storage units, sell the items or donate and set the money aside for your parents care down the road. Your mother's probably not even going to realize it after 6 months occurs that there's anything in there that she absolutely has to have and if there is you can explain to her that it was broken into and items were stolen and therefore you got a settlement from the insurance but you hadn't bothered to tell her because you didn't want to upset her."

↳ **comment** (31): "I think this is going to be a key strategy. I'm pretty sure she would feel ok if she knew the items were going to someone who could use them. Thanks!"

"What happens when you can't do this anymore?. I've posted before about feeling evil when you inevitably yell at a dementia patient and having mental breakdowns from caretaking, but when you feel like you can't do it anymore, when you feel "broken" and fear for your health and your patient, what do you do???? My mom has Alzheimer's/dementia. I've been taking care of her for nearly four years. She had a bad reaction to an antipsychotic she started taking a few months ago. She lost trunk control at the end of July. She couldn't walk on her own. I didn't know what to do. My brain froze and couldn't make a decision. I had to call a family member who had to tell me to call 911. Even then, I couldn't do it. I started gathering clothes for her since she wasn't dressed and getting all manner of things ready. She might have had a stroke and I didn't respond in a timely manner. After a hospital stay, my mother ended up in rehab for a month. When she returned to me, the level of care I had to give increased exponentially . Now I'm changing diapers and having to clean up poop. I never wanted children or a family of my own. I don't have the temperament for intimate partners. I knew this about myself. I like peace, calm and anything that disturbs it, gets under my skin. I wake up in the morning and my mind like a movie on repeat keeps showing me the crap I cleaned the day before. I watch my mom pick her nose all day, yell at the TV, make up fake Spanish words. I have to brush her teeth and bathe her and I don't think I'm doing a good job, because I always find more crap. I've found myself crying and yelling and threatening to abandon her when she gets nasty and cusses me. I've thought of taking her to a hospital with no ID and just leaving her there. Where I once said no to a home, now I dream of it. But she needs an NHTD waiver. I've called the agency and NO ONE returns my call.

The insurance company expects me to provide extra hours for my mom because we live together. But I'm at the point where my body and brain shuts down when it comes to care. It's like I avoid doing things she needs until I MUST do it. So my mom is not getting the care she needs. I have no family to help, my friends live far away and have their own lives and I'm afraid for myself and her. I had to put a lock on our door to prevent her wandering. That lock prevents people from getting in to. What if we have an emergency and no one can get in? At what point does the State or insurance companies recognize when you can't do this anymore? That you are mentally incapable, that your own health is in danger? At what point is there help???? Update: I finally did it. :-(last Wednesday, my mom refused to let the aide clean her, was yelling and cussing; refused to drink water. She only had 2 ounces in a 48 hour period. She also had not been cleaned in 18 hours. I explained the consequences of not drinking water, not eating, etc. Normally I can get her to do it by explaining consequences. She understands things, but doesn't hold the memory. This time, nothing I did worked. Finally, I called 911 and expressed my concerns over dehydration etc. They came and she was calm, alert and compliant when they asked her to drink water. She told them she would. I couldn't help but notice the smugness as though they were more capable than I and the aide. She took a sip that was it. No more. They decided it was best to take her to the hospital. They coaxed her up. The smell hit them and they said she needed to be cleaned and dressed before travel. That's when the sweet old lady disappeared. It took the two EMTs and the aide to get her ready. My mom cussed them all out. I couldn't help but laugh because I saw that smugness drop. I didn't travel with her. I spoke to the Dr on the phone and saw my mom for an hour before going home. The Dr called asking where I was. I explained that I left. Dr said her bloodwork was good and she wasn't dehydrated. She could go home. That's when I dropped the "unsafe discharge" language that I was advised about on this board. I said it. Dr insisted she couldn't hold her. She needed to see the neurologist and could go home. I repeated "unsafe discharge" again. Dr was annoyed but said they would admit her and I should see the social worker the next day. My mom is going into a facility until I can get 24 hour care. I'm home today because I've been visiting every day since then. I'm sad, but calm. I miss not having her here. But I know this is what's best for her. When I saw her in the hospital, she was clean and seemed content in a way that I couldn't get her at home. I also noticed her cussing when it took two aides to clean her, but she went back to her quiet self when they were done."

reddit post · r/dementia · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/

↳ **comment** (76): "You do have to take her to an emergency room and leave her there. It's OK. Tell them she isn't safe with you and refuse to take her home. They'll find a place for her. You've done enough."

↳ **comment** (42): "Thank you so much for not judging. Thank you! Thank you! Thank you! I had a family member tell me that no matter what choice I make, I'll be in pain. So I was told to choose my poison. We were once so close my mom and I. It's out of loyalty to who she was that I haven't done it. My mom is gone. I have this doppelgänger living with me. :-(

↳ **comment** (31): "I am so sorry. I can feel your frustration and worry in your words. This is a horrible, cruel disease, and will take down any single thing in its way. You do not have to do this anymore- you are not morally, or legally obligated to keep setting yourself on fire to keep your mother warm! On the contrary, you are doing her a disservice by not getting her placed in long term care. You are not equipped to do the job of every profession working at a facility. I cannot speak for other countries, however, if you are in the US- you take her to the closest Emergency room, TODAY, as in RIGHT NOW- tell them her mental status is altered from her normal baseline. Then, once they've run every test under the sun, you say these exact words: "I am unable to care for her at home. It would be unsafe to discharge her." No more, no less. You'll likely get push-back, possibly even threats of them calling APS, or telling you that you are responsible, and that you must take her home. Some providers have gone as far as telling family members they can be arrested for abandonment; this is simply NOT TRUE. Unless there is a court order signed by a judge stating a person is a responsible guardian, no adult is responsible for another, period. Stand your ground. "This is an unsafe discharge." The onus will be on the hospitals' social work team to find acceptable placement for your mom. Keep in mind you may have no choice in WHERE that placement is, but

they will have to find her a clean, dry bed in a setting with the level of care she needs. Is she on Medicare/Medicaid? What's her financial situation? This information will help us give you guidance on how to handle that side of things. Seriously, before you hurt her, or yourself, please don't feel like a failure or horrible child- it's time to wave the white flag."

"I can relate to this. My mom is 84 and does live in a retirement community. I have a sibling who does nothing and is essentially estranged from her, except when it comes to birthdays and Christmas and then she reaches out with the list of things her family wants as gifts. I wish I were exaggerating... My dad was her soulmate and best friend and since he died a couple of years ago she has been sad, fragile, cranky and lonely. I do my best to be there for her but I live 3 hours away, work full time, have animals and a house to care for, and a kid with a lot of health issues that takes up a lot of my time. I am about to drive to go spend 4 days with her and do lots of tasks for her. I am equipped with a lot of weed which makes her incessant talking as well as the 1.5 hour ordeals that meals have become more bearable. (She is very formal and eats verrrrrryyyy slowly and I have adhd and it is all I can do not to scream FINISH ALREADY) When I open a book she still stands over me talking. She will sometimes say "oh, I know you're trying to read" and then continues on with her talking. Every phone call becomes 45 min minimum. I often call her on the way home from work so there will be a natural ending to the call - ok, I'm home, love you, gotta go. Instead I'll sit in my driveway idling for like 15 minutes while she keeps going oh one more thing, oh, I also forgot to tell you ... She repeats stories constantly and many of them are incorrect and I know this because they directly involve me. I have learned just to smile and nod and zone out. Last summer I went up to visit her many, many times in a 2 month period and she talks about it as though I never came. It sometimes feels like it's never enough. She guilt trips my kids, who love her but who have the same issues - it's torture to be talked at constantly and to sit through endless meals (we all have adhd) and be judged for everything. She comments on every outfit they wear, every bite of food they eat, has very specific ideas about how everyone should behave and is very critical when we don't meet those expectations. I do text her daily and I try to call at least once a week. I dread the calls so much; I hate talking on the phone in general and sitting still is torture for me. I love her, and she's incredibly tiresome, and I'm really scared about how this is all going to go in the future, as the clinginess is getting worse. I'm trying so hard to be a good daughter to her. She also adamantly refused to move closer to us, which is her right, but man- it puts a huge strain on me. I wish I could stop in for 30 min with some soup I made, quick visit and then leave, as opposed to those endless marathon visits of being talked at."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_often/p21rucc/

"my heart totally breaks for you because seeing them so terrified and sad is the absolute hardest part of this disease. to answer your questions directly: yes an mri is very helpful. it won't show dementia itself but it shows the physical brain shrinkage and rules out other things like tumors or mini strokes. regarding the extreme crying and the paranoia about god punishing her, yes that is absolutely a textbook part of dementia. the part of her brain that controls logic and emotional regulation is actively failing. she is crying over the dog food and the turkey because her brain is completely overwhelmed by the changes and she literally cannot process her own emotions anymore. the paranoia is just her broken brain desperately trying to find a logical reason for why she feels so confused all the time. you cannot reason with these delusions so please do not try to argue or convince her otherwise. just validate her fear and physically redirect her to a new task. as for the driving you simply have to disable the car. disconnect the battery or remove a fuse and tell her it is broken and waiting for a part. you cannot wait for her to agree because she physically lacks the insight to know she is unsafe. you are doing an amazing job getting her high calorie easy foods because 80 pounds is dangerously frail. keep focusing on those stealth calories and do not try to logic with the disease."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okt8uz6/

"I feel for you and am sending you a big hug. You are doing great. Turn the phone off today and do something for you - you need a break. I just got my mom into AL after a fall and brain bleed. I want her to love it and be grateful for all the work I did to get her there, but that's just not reality. It is frustrating and it hurts. But I remind myself of something someone on this thread said once and it's become my mantra when I want to lose it - "my job is to keep my mom safe, not happy." Hang in there and know there are people supporting you from afar and we think you are doing an amazing job!!!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/o5cd334/

"Yeah, I heard that one too. Also "you're an angel" and "Pearly gates!" I replied by text "I don't want to be a fucking angel, I want my mom back." It got quiet after that."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/ns2641o/

"I read the entire post. Thank you for sharing, im sorry you are going through all of that. Im glad they at least have that apartment with care. You so strong for making sure they are OK. I wish I could give some advice, I know my day is coming where im going to have to take care of my parents. I dont have any advice, but my heart goes out to you and your family. Praying for you."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/o5cbf4d/

"Etiquette for visiting elderly family member in rehab facility??. My Question; Beyond the suggested visiting hours, what is the etiquette for family visitation at a rehab faculty, for an elderly patient? The situation; My Nana is 97 years young, still mentally sharp, has a great sense of humor and can keep up with any conversation, as long as she can hear it. She has been living on long island, in her own home for 71 years. A home which her husband built by hand, as well as dozens of others in the area. She needs constant care at this point, something that her 3 daughters have been rotating to provide her at home. A couple of weeks ago she had a fall at home. One of the sisters was there, but didn't hear her get up in the middle of the night. Nana has a sweet tooth, and tripped and fell onto a hardwood floor. She fractured her left hip and was taken to the ER. They performed a partial hip replacement and the surgery went well. She has an incredibly high tolerance for pain, so it's hard to get an accurate reading. There's no way she was comfortable, but zero complaints. She only cried out when they rolled her to check the staples after surgery. Tough as nails. Gratefully I can now see in her face and movement, the pain has gotten better and she is currently only taking Tylenol. She's the last person to complain about herself, would rather ask you how you're doing. After the surgery she was moved to a rehabilitation facility nearby, "Emerge", in Glen cove Long Island. I'm not impressed. She had had some "bag nights" where we are told she was screaming all night disturbed and confused. Some of these episodes were while she was being catheterized. Related background; Nana lost her husband over 50 years ago, she never dated or remarried. No man has laid a hand on her since. And now they have men, complete strangers to her, come in the middle of the night to catheterize her. This has been extremely invasive and disturbing for my Nana. An invasive procedure for anyone at any age to go through. We have requested a female nurse to perform the intimate necessities, however the facility only told us they'll do the best they can, which feels like a clear dismissal. I understand that staffing is not an easy thing and there may not be a female nurse that is available when she needs it, however this is my first time dealing with this specific aspect of care facilities and I can't help but feel that they have a moral obligation to do more than try their best, in order to accommodate this simple request. Nana is currently doing PT OT and speech therapy. The speech therapy is not necessarily needed, however as in any of these greedy facilities they want patients they can bill for the maximum Medicare daily limit. I've been extremely unimpressed with the entirety of the staff there, including the director and the primary physician. I must point out there are one or two people working there who actually care, to them; thank you thank you thank you you're AMAZING and your appreciated.🙏 My wife and I have seen more than a handful of these type of facilities while caring for other elderly family members. Facilities that were located in

several different states, with very different track records and varying levels of care. I mention this because we are not naive about the level of care to expect vs what the shiny brochure says. We know how to respectfully interact in these delicate areas. We feel that we understand these facilities in terms of their overall flow, the staff, dealing with roommates, doctors, nurses etc. Most importantly; regardless of our personal opinions, we ALWAYS show the staff the utmost respect, in any and all situations. I truly appreciate the hard job they do and appreciate them all. Typically we end up befriending even the most hard to reach staff, as a result of how we engage with them, our genuine respect for them as individuals and the hard job they perform. We immediately get out of their way when needed, don't overcrowd the room with too many visitors, leave the room to respect patient's privacy, don't interfere with meals, doctor visitors, physical therapy and anything else that is part of their job and part of Nana getting better and getting back home. The reason for my question is I have one family member that has semi-relatable work experience, they have worked in rehab facilities as a speech pathologist. This family member was/is extremely condescending to anyone involved, family and staff, because she knows better. It's infuriating. During our last visit, this individual overlapped. Immediately upon her arrival she gave us the impression that we should not be there. Not only just gave us the impression but more directly told us "the staff really don't like visitors, and they don't want to interrupt a visit. So they usually won't enter the room while the patient has visitors." ... "often, if the physical therapist come to the room and see visitors, they will just mark her PT for the day as N/A." For the lack of a better phrase, this is bat shit crazy. The same family member went on to tell us condescendingly "it may sound cruel, but Nana needs to get used to being alone" my internal reaction was "what the fuck are you talking about?! it sounds cruel because it is cruel! Is that what you'd wish for yourself if you were in her shoes?" Nana has plenty of alone time. She's alone for the majority of the day, and for the entirety of the night. When we have been visiting Nana has no problem taking a nap while we're there and if we see her fading will suggest getting some rest. When she wakes up and sees a face looking back who she knows and loves she immediately smiles. We don't always talk sometimes we just sit and hold hands maybe listen to some music softly. I can feel through every subtle hand squeeze her love and appreciation that were there. While I do understand that she's adjusting to this new temporary reality in which she will have to deal with being alone and unconnected from those she loves, with no means to connect to them on her own. From my observations, she is adjusting fairly well. Particularly in terms of overnights and the majority of the time she has to rely on the staff alone. By no means does a short visit from family set this process back. Previously we have attempted to get a schedule of her days meals physical therapy etc. however no one has been able to nail that down. Partially for understandable reasons like they adapt to how the patient is doing that day in situations they'll reschedule morning therapy for later if they're having a difficult morning things like that. That all sounds reasonable to me enough. One of her daughters has since requested she be scheduled for am PT, which I agree is a better time for her. If a physical therapist has an appointment with a patient, should they ever cancel that appointment due to a family member visiting? In my past, and current experience this has never been the case, no one has ever had any hesitation about entering the room. That includes the entirety of the Care team responsible for the patient. If she has PT at a scheduled time and we are there it is my understanding that the therapist should still do their job regardless. Of course we would immediately conclude our visit if this occurred. IMHO; an employee, any employee, of the rehab facility, that is not completing the required job, due to a visitor being present, is 100% at fault and should be fired immediately. This includes any and all staff. Visiting an elderly loved one should not exclude her from the rehabilitation she is paying for and the care she deserves. Nana lights up every time we visit, smiles and laughs and jokes and sharing stories. Based on everything I have read and more importantly been told directly from individuals who work in this healthcare sector; It is extremely important that the patient receives regular family visits. I've been told, this is extremely important both for the well-being of the patient, and shows the staff they have people there supporting her and who want her to get better and get back home, where she'll continue to have support. It also helps the caregivers get to know the patient through the family members who know her best. They become more of a real person and less of a bed number. My Nana can crack jokes with the best of them, and is extremely kind and tolerant. Of course we're not there every time the staff attends to her, but from what I've witnessed, she tends to be quieter and a more subdued version of herself when interacting with them. Understandable. When we have

been there, we've helped build a bridge between the staff and my Nana. By small simple things, like helping nana hear something one of the aides said to her, which once she heard it, she had a clever witty reply that made us all, aide included laugh. Semi related we've helped in her conversation with physicians when they made the rounds during their visitation. The doctor conducted his inter"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nm8dtk/etiquette_for_visiting_elderly_family_member_in/

"I feel this in my soul. I live 5 hours away from my mom, who requires 24/7 care. My brother lives 45 minutes away. Yet I'm her primary care giver. I always get the "you're so strong" and "I don't know how you do it!" well, Nancy, I don't have a choice! The "let me know if you very need anything" gets me every time. I don't know what you're willing to do, be my crippling social anxiety won't let me ask for fear of you saying no. Thank you for making me feel seen. 💖"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrywb3a/

"Wow, you live five hours away and your brother forty-five minutes away and you the one provide 24/7 care ohh my that's not fair. Does your brother contribute? Thats so wrong if not. I remember last week, when I took my in-laws to the doctors an 24 year old said excuse me sir You're so strong, I said I've been carrying weight for 30 years do you care to spot me. He smiled and said have a good day."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nryzt7y/

"My dad passed away in 2019. He had dementia for the last five years of his life. He lived with me and I shared caretaking with my brother, so one year with me and one year with my brother. Dad lived with us this way for over 28 years. Our wives are wonderful women, they helped out a ton as well and kept the tension and stress to a minimal simply recognizing that this is a journey and that we have to do the best we can for our parents. My brother and I both raised families and our children have all done well. The number one thing in this caretaking journey is having the heart to do the needed and secondly, almost equally important is having the resources, financial and family wise so that this doesn't become a burden on one person. We were blessed to have all in quantities greater than we could have imagined, even though as immigrants we had come into the country virtually broke, but we made it. I honestly feel that part of why I have been richly rewarded in life is that I was a good son and did the right thing for my parents. Of course it helped that they were both loving and caring, and low maintenance for the most part. I miss them both, despite the challenges I faced in care taking. Now my wife and I are taking care of her mother who is 83 and has dementia. We are managing so far, but we aren't as young as we once were, but God willing, we will see here through to her end peacefully, and when our time comes we will go gracefully knowing we did the best we could."

youtube · @syhussaini9236 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 7 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=Ugy2HfhVE-wdFluni-l4AaABAq>

"5+ years solo caregiving to my wife who is non-verbal and quadriplegic. Her mom has come over ONCE to help me over the last month. Always has an excuse why she can't. Her dad moved away. Haven't seen him 6 months. Yet they're always like "She's so lucky! You're so strong, I don't know how you do it! Thank you for taking care of her!" Yeah thanks...that helps so much."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobvmbd/

"I just want to say you're doing an amazing job! I've been following your saga. Thanks for the updates."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/o37ja8/i_have_moved_my_parentsepisode_12so_youre_saying/h2b6ytu/

"My mother is the same age as yours, and I am in my mid fifties as well. Two weeks ago she lost her balance while bending over as she reached for something under the sink and fell backwards. The fall caused a rib fracture and the pain makes it hard for her to sleep and walk. We had to rent a hospital bed in order to make it easier for her to get out of bed, and a walker for her to use around the house. Before this she was active. We would go to the mall three times a week and do a lap, she indoors and me outside. She has my dad to tend to her and my cousin who works in home health care helps her bathe. It has been a rough couple of weeks for everyone, and there are a few more to go. I will try and keep in mind the things that have been shared here, and be grateful that the fall didn't cause a more serious injury. It sounds like you were a good daughter towards the end and you should not feel guilty."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/own7t1i/

'You should visit more often' / 'put her in a home' · 50 documents

20 most engaged of 50 matching documents, complete text.

"Old people are not all cute and wise. Caring for them can be like caring for your abuser. You force yourself due to guilt and pressure. I can't stand when people say things like " you should visit more often" I see my parents 3-4 times per week and take care of their issues ongoing daily. What more do people want? They want the ultimate sacrifice of me moving them into my home and destroying any small amount of peace I have in my life. Please never put your opinion on caregivers when you are not the one living the nightmare GOD IS GOOD. That was two years ago. I prayed and prayed that God would somehow help us. My mom's attitude has completely changed. She went from being critical and negative to understanding and supportive! Wow! I cannot believe it myself. One thing I did is I started opening up to her and telling her how I also was not well. I dont think she really had considered how stressed I have been. I pray that God may give caregivers the strength and peace to go on caring for their loved ones and themselves ."

youtube · @Yolduranduran · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 504 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiEw&lc=UgxD2JzM5sA7cmhdaD54AaABAg>

↳ **@feliscatus1834** (36): "I am getting burned out overseeing my mother's care in asst. living with Parkinson's disease. Already taken her to 7 doctors appt. this month, she doesn't get around well & her room is a mess at the facility. I am EXHAUSTED taking care of her laundry, getting her diapers etc. My brother won't even drop by to see her & say "hello", he lives in the area. My life isn't the same, I am raising two teenage sons & married, this sucks I can tell you honestly it sucks, I cannot take her in or quit my part time job either. I HATE this!! I hope I die first before becoming a burden on my sons!!"

↳ **@spiderpig24321** (18): "Yep Yolanda ...taking care of 2 abusers due to a sense of duty. They dont even try to help with their grandkids"

↳ **@Okalani5000** (14): "Sometimes asking is not enough. Some people ask, even beg for help and never get any. Sometimes you just end up going crazy over it all. @TVResults"

"So...I made out home health care nurse cry today. Hi all, I'll ask the question first then give you context. When a visiting home health nurse or CNA comes to your home and they need help with something that you can do without help, how does that make you feel? Context: husband is bedbound quadriplegic, he has pressure sore on butt and heel of foot. Whenever home health comes in, they ask if I can roll him over so they can change bandages or hold his foot up so they can change bandages. This irritates me, because im spread so thin with all the other things I need to do around home and I figure, if I can do it by myself, why cant you? So i asked the nurse today why they cant do it on thier own, as I have other things I need to tend to. She said "extra hands are nice" I said "ok" But she left here crying and said she will never ask me again to help and she said I was rude to her. I felt really bad. I apologized to her profusely. I explained that Ive been overwhelmed with his care, I didnt mean to sound so rude. I dont know if she's coming back, but what are your thoughts? Should we assist the home health agency with everything even though there's some things they can do own thier own? Ive manged taking care of husband without assistance. And we are all so burnt out from this, I just wanted a break. Give it to me! I can handle it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 88 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mjju5f/soi_made_out_home_health_care_nurse_cry_today/

"People like this don't remember because for them it was just another Tuesday, whereas for us it is life altering. My father was the same. Said heinous stuff to/about me one day and then sent me cute pictures of puppies the next like he didn't just take a big dump on me. You did your best and he was lucky to get what he did from you. You should be proud of what you got thru ❤️ "

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 74 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op37yla/

"You are not a terrible person. I think anyone in your situation would feel resentful, angry and betrayed. Your sister left when your mother had nothing left to give her and might actually need something back. That is not your problem. I don't think you should have to swoop in and pick up the pieces. Your Mom made choices and is still making them. Let the rehab facility get social work involved and they can decide with your Mom what her options are. If you stay you will be used by the system and an ungrateful mother. You have responsibilities to your own life and to your son who is now being impacted."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u155id/am_i_a_terrible_person/oqnj1q9/

"Hi! I'm sorry you are going through this. A few thoughts: 1) Even if the ALF is saying they can no longer provide the care, they are responsible for finding alternative placement. They cannot send her to the ER and they say "not it". 2) with Medicaid you should be able to connect to a care coordinator. If I were in your shoes I would: A) refuse to pick her up B) contact the ombudsman C) contact Medicaid care coordinator D) ask the hospital to place her anywhere in the state E) contact state licensing to report the ALF for essentially saying "not it!" Once she goes to the Hospital I would do those things in that order What state are you in?"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 27 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/113ykoe/hospital_trying_to_discharge_demented_mother_in/j8uj9ss/

""To be fair to my brother, he is super busy with a young family as well as running an extremely successful business on his own. He's also excellent at setting boundaries. And as a male... well, people aren't going to want to hear it, but the unsaid expectation of 'caregiving' doesn't fall on his shoulders with my family." But what is fair to YOU? It's not fair of your parents to expect either of you to be their stepandfetchit. Your brother has set and kept boundaries. Why can't you do that, too? If you think you are starting to slide down the slippery slope of caregiving, then you definitely are. Get away. Leave your parents to their own devices. Both of them are still of sound mind, right?"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p03azrg/

"Absolutely crazy! Where did OP get the comfort kit? On a street corner from a drug dealer? OTC? And since hospice nurses are not there full time to administer meds, who's going to give comfort care except for a caregiver? The prosecutor who charged you should be ashamed!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1rp6in8/marshas_law_website_a_law_protecting_caregivers/o9j4idt/

"You're right. You're in hell. And you don't need to be. You just need to give yourself permission to not let the dementia kill you, too. If she has Medicare and already has Medicaid, you should have no financial issues getting her into care. Her social security will go to the facility, so if you count on that money for your monthly expenses, that could be a barrier. Other than that, they'd take any liquid she has, and leave her broke. But so what?!?! You

sound relatively young, way too young for your life to be over. I hereby give you permission to not start making calls Monday morning, and instead take her to the ER- she's not living! She's EXISTING, and wouldn't want this for YOU. Sending you a hug. 🤗. Here if you need to vent or seek advice. 💖💖 "

reddit comment · r/dementia · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_things_anymore/ne99zhz/

"I agree, OP should check out other places, if possible. My mom's facility isn't technically memory care so the cost is a little more than half of what OP pays, and the staff is pretty good. There are always going to be some issues, but you should be able to expect better than what it sounds like she's receiving. And OP, for what it's worth, I never wonder why someone's LO doesn't live with them. Full time care of someone with dementia has to be such a grueling experience. I'm usually exhausted just spending the day with my mom, while others do most of the work."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/onixi7k/

"A new dog literally ate my hearing aid and it was covered. You should be fine. 😊 "

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mwueso/sometime_you_have_to_laugh_or_youll_cry/na2ateq/

"I agree with VirginiaUSA1964's comment. The challenge with private caregivers is when they call in sick the agency sends substitutes. these people may or may not be highly qualified, but they certainly don't know the situation with your father-in-law. Instead of having someone at a facility overseeing what's happening you become the one who oversees it. My parents did this while my mother had dementia and my father was just getting older. He thought he will have direct these caregivers, but every time a substitute would come there would be problems. People would be calling me and I would texting the caregivers back-and-forth about what they were supposed to do. It was exhausting. And beyond that some of them gotten into arguments with him. Sometimes the regular caregiver calls in sick just a half hour before their shift starts and it takes the agency several hours to find a substitute. Meanwhile, in our case, my mother would be needing to go to the bathroom or something. It was really difficult. I would not recommend that. My father did it to save money. My parents were in what was considered to be a five star memory care facility. My mother was the one with dementia and my father was just a geriatric old man who wanted to live with his wife. So every day he would call me and give me the blow by blow of what was happening in there. He was truly upset at some of the caregivers and their attitudes. The facility director was mad at me because I wouldn't agree to them medicating him. He was smart enough to say he wasn't going to take medication to alleviate their management and staffing problems. They started implying they would evict my father if I didn't agree to the medication, so I panicked and started looking around. Long story short I found a much better place – move my parents when my mother was 100 and my father was 95. Best decision ever. The new place didn't look like a cruise ship but the people were so kind and loving and within a week my father was a different man. He was happy to be there. It made all the difference. At the old place, my father used to have bruises on his arms and legs and my mother would be panicked and frightened when they tried to use the Hoyer lift to get her out of bed. Once I came to visit and she had a broken leg when she woke up. She was not somebody who could get out of bed by herself. I kind of wonder if there's something lacking in the management and caregiving if your father is falling like that multiple times. The new facility I moved my parents to is a former skilled nursing facility that was converted to an enhanced assisted living facility. Everyone in there is in wheelchairs and is incontinent. Some but not all have dementia, but it's not memory care. But it's well managed and everyone is up and dressed every day, showers twice a week, rooms cleaned every day, and the people who work there have been there for 20 and 30 years including the housekeepers. It's just a very well run place. I'm sure there's others like that. It might be worth looking around. The other thing I'll say is if you don't like visiting pay attention to that. I felt that way too about the previous place my parents were in. Where they are now just feels so different. In terms of fall risks, They keep an eye on people in an activity room during the day and meals. When they're not together people are taking

naps or sleeping. One thing I've seen them do is lower the beds once the person's in it so it's practically just a little bit off the floor. This would make it really hard for someone to get out of bed. Some people who are sitting in their wheelchairs have a little alarm so if they lean forward too far it goes off and someone comes and checks on them. I don't think you should have to pay for 24 seven monitoring in a good facility although I don't know about overnight. I wish you the best. Sorry for all the typos. I'm dictating on an iPad, and editing is next to impossible."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxk4f4t/

"No problem- call to make sure she's still on the lists and what number she is. You say she's been for years waiting for low income housing. Sometimes, your name may fall off or they have incorrect info. You should have her on as many low income housing lists you have nearby - in our state, the properties manage for the most part their own lists. Call now to make sure she's still on and what they think her chances are"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_so_on_my_adult_life_is/n9p5pzh/

"That is a problem, and I had some of the same issues. This is where you can explain this is why you should be in a facility. If this is going to work I have to be able to meet our obligations. "Our" obligations. When you deal with other issues like this try to refrain using "I, and "you. Make everything that you can a team effort. This allows them to have skin in the game and feel part of the help rather than always a burden. It doesn't always work, but it helps in many situations. I completely understand your frustration. Otherwise, you may have start exploring other options. It's painful, but I had to in the last 6 months. The dementia and incontinence was just too much. Like you, I didn't have the luxury to quit work."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 4 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n7v3y4/rant/nchmewr/>

"You need to advocate for yourself. Call the American Cancer Society and speak directly with someone about your situation. You should be setting up home care and meal services for yourself. Unfortunately, it's time to give up this free caregiving position and focus on your own recovery and life. Drop this person off to the nearest ER and tell them you are fighting cancer and cannot take care of this individual any longer. Please separate your self from this mess."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ulb1ow/please_read_i_need_help/ovg3ik9/

"Been there done that if that makes you feel better. Don't expect sympathy or empathy from anyone. Your job suffers your financial health and relationships all suffer. All you will get is cracker jack advice. Put her in a home. Blah blah blah. ... You do however need to schedule time for yourself every single day even if its 1 hour. If something happens it's part of the deal and let mom know that. That or a home."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n7v3y4/rant/nch8k21/>

"My friend has been caring for his poorly mum for 6 yrs. He has no social life any more. No family. No support. Its so sad , he wont put her in a home n when she passes he will be made homeless. They have no money. Hes 60 mum is 80 . So sad 😞 "

youtube · @paulak7939 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 3 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyvAY1o3nh22hn5D814AaABAg

"You have all the reason to be furious. And you should be very proud of yourself. Because you know how to turn shit in something that works for you. I hope you will find your way in this complex situation soon."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgyrme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxbxmwf/

"We Can't Take Care of Granny but We Can't Get Her in a Home. Admittedly, I am the great grandchild(23) of the elder in question(90). My mom died in 2016 and I've been living with my grandmother (73? i think?) since then. The elder in question is my grandma's mother. I hope it doesn't get confusing. I'll call my grandma.. well, grandma and my great grandma granny. Long post incoming. Granny has had steadily worsening dementia over the years and now has mobility issues and can't take care of herself. Anyway, for the past... handful of years, granny has lived with my uncle, who wasn't taking real good care of her. He's my grandma's favorite of her three kids and she trusts him with granny's care, saying that anything that was wrong was because of his shitty wife. Which I mean, sure, she didn't help neglecting granny. But anyway, recently either earlier this year or late last year, my uncle got arrested, leaving only his wife to take care of granny. My grandma hates her, and we drove up there (to Arkansas from Kansas) to grab granny and a car that was still in my grandma's name. Granny was in bad shape, so she went to the hospital. I don't quite remember what all was wrong, but she had wounds from not moving for long periods of time, a gash on her arm... so it wasn't good. I'd like to clarify that I never thought my uncle would take good care of her and was telling my grandma she needed in a home years ago (now look where we are lol). She stayed in the hospital for a while, but of course was eventually kicked out. While she was in my uncle's care, my grandma sent them most of granny's money to help care for her, and I believe the rest was just used on our own rent. However, for whatever reason the police in Arkansas decided this was an excuse for an investigation into my grandma, making it so that she has to record EVERY purchase made with granny's money. Granny is now living in our home. The big problem here is that nobody in my home can take care of her. My grandma was already spread thin, and I'm worried she's gonna have a stroke from the stress of it all. I am mentally unfit to be a caregiver, my grandma's husband is a narcissist and a hoarder and yells at her constantly, and the other three relatives visiting are either disabled or lazy. But we can't put her in a home. She makes a little over \$2k a month - right above the Medicaid limit and waayyy under the amount required to get into a home without insurance. Right now she has about \$7K-ish, and we can't spend down her money because there's nothing we can spend it on that will be reasonable to the investigators. Personally, I don't think it's wrong to spend or use her money for bills and such so she can be put in a home, but obviously the officials don't care for her well-being. Me and my grandma are planning to move out together, because of family issues including her husband being a nasty, narcissistic hoarding jerk. But we can't do that until we find a place for granny. I'm trying to get in contact with elder care attorneys - but even then we might not afford them. Both of us are at a COMPLETE loss of what to do. I came here as a last ditch effort for help."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/118rwzx/we_cant_take_care_of_granny_but_we_cant_get_her/

"I have a 9 and 11yr old and a mother with ALS. I'm drowning in trying to care for everyone. I promised I wouldn't put her in a home. I expected caring for her when she was older but not 64 and paralyzed🥺 "

youtube · @breezyveezy1 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugxi5PF5YhQ9jIK3-I14AaABAg>

"*Anasognosia* reads like a very snarky way to say that someone's being an ass. A lot of the insensitive comments people direct at others in a difficult situation comes from the fear of being in that situation themselves. All the "If it were me, I" or "You should have" is code for "I need to feel that I have control over whether or not this will happen to me". That does not make it less hurtful and inappropriate of course. It's just how some people's mind works."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/o539l6p/

'Let me know if you need anything' vs 'I'm coming Thursday at 3' · 29 documents

18 most engaged of 29 matching documents, complete text.

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations: Youre so strong Translation: Youre on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are theyre really saying theyre not going to help you. Theyre admiring your ability to handle it so they dont have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow youre so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. Were just surviving it because theres no other option. I dont need your theology. I need respite care. I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. Theyd watch me help my mom with everything then say I dont know how you do it and leave. If you dont know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Dont stand there marveling at my survival skills like Im some interesting specimen. Im doing this because I dont have a choice and you wont help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: Im going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you wont ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person were caring for so we can sleep. Dont make us ask. Ive got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. Theres more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If youre a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity... you dont need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say Im coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. Thats the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): ""enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and

who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "“People ask how they can help and I have no words.” I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doorDash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust

in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 136 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/o4u8eo2/

"“People ask how they can help and I have no words.” I completely understand and I’m not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there’s literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband’s family, we basically didn’t have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn’t thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can’t buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it’s hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it’s even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there’s something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 40 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok6ick0/

"Burned Out & Beat Up!. Ok so this is a rant! A long one. If you read it thanks if it's too much I get it. I'm putting this down for myself as much to get it off my chest and lighten my mind/stress I guess. But first background: I'm usually an upbeat person, always have been, always look on the bright side, acknowledge the fact that others are in worse situations than me, so as to keep myself aware (centered/in-check). I stay clear of Debbie Downers, Negative Nelly's, and KARENS too. Those type folks suck the life right out of you. Sorry I wish them well, it's just life is way too short for all that drama. So my husband and I retired a few years back. Both of us started working when we were teenagers, like a lot of our generation, so we retired early. Now: So we, newly retired, like right out

of the gate retired, no celebratory vacation either, and we become full time care givers to my mother. We all “decided/chose” to move in together into a new house, not newly built but perfect for our physical needs especially for my mother. She was fine when we moved in, of course very sad to sell/give up her home, but she said she knew it was the right decision and it’s what God wanted/planned for her/us. Her only alternative was a nursing home, because physically she couldn’t live in an assisted living facility because she requires too much assistance/care. She couldn’t live in our old home because we had stairs and no bedroom suite on the first floor. Plus she couldn’t continue paying for PT private home health care because she now needed FT care and not enough \$\$ to pay for it. Side note.....all those supplemental insurance commercials advertising how they can help the elderly age in place (at home) it’s all bullshit! I They DO NOT offer COVERED in-home care or drivers to take them to and from doctor appointments. The elderly still pay out of pocket one way or the other either high insurance premiums or straight out of their checking/savings accounts. So they’d have no money left over to pay for basic needs like food and utilities. AND my mother was already paying a monthly premium for additional/supplemental insurance coverage. AND those special services offered via city/county “Offices on Aging”, well most won’t qualify because they make too much \$ annually. For example in my mom’s situation, she receives a retirement pension, SS, and Medicare benefits due to her age. Yes I called the office and no she doesn’t qualify. I also asked about the services listed for support of family care givers like the babysitting your elderly parent services so caregivers can get a break. Well nope don’t qualify for that either cause she makes too much money. How you wonder does she make too much money. Well because the ENTIRE households income is accounted/calculated for qualification of city/county services. Yep that’s right my husband’s and my annual retirement pensions was added to her annual income for a total of “SHE” makes too much! We don’t get paid for providing her physical care, monthly expenses, reimbursement for gas or vehicle wear and tear to get her to her doctor appointments, yet you’ll add our retirement income to her income. Wow! Yes I love my mother dearly. Anyway.....now to today. She isn’t the same person at all. In fact I’ve realized she wasn’t the person I thought I knew for years. Its kind of pissed me off honestly. She had issues that needed to be addressed years ago! That damn generation and sweeping crap under their rugs ugh! So on her nasty days she loves to tell us the following comments: you’ve got it made, you made out, blah blah. We’ve got it made!??? What the fuck is she talking about. We gave up our lives to care for her! She’s another full time job, basically, and we don’t receive any salary. She is selfish, hateful, ungrateful, hurtful to me and my husband for all the care we give her. Remember she was adamant that she didn’t want to go into a nursing home and I/we didn’t want that for her either. I’d feel guilty as hell putting her in one of them. Plus she always brought up how one of her older relatives was put in a horrible nursing home, and each time my folks visited, the lady would beg them to take her with them. Mom always said how she wasn’t even in her immediate family and questioned whether the lady’s family visited her. Plus I promised my dad before he passed that I’d take care of my mom. Now remember I said everything started out great in the beginning. I had a great child hood growing up with my mother albeit as I got older I realized she had some weird quirks but I didn’t know what exactly. She wasn’t crazy and I do not mean that in a mean way I’m being serious. But I strongly feel that because these “quirks” never got addressed by either therapy, a doctor or with meds it just festered and may have laid the ground work for what she’s got now which is psychosis from Parkinson’s of which she does not accept. And NO she doesn’t have dementia, she is cognizant, passes those doctor tests still today. She’s bitter and blames us for her issues.....all of them, everything, whatever she’s mad about it’s mine or our fault. To everyone else she puts on the sweet little old lady persona and acts like a normal old person. To us she’s rarely the sweet lady anymore instead we never know what/who/how she’ll act on any given day. She lies constantly, won’t take accountability for her part/role in disagreements and we totally believe she likes to stir things up, start things on purpose. If she hears us laughing having a good day, and she’s miserable well it’s like she has to try and ruin our good mood. Remember I’m a positive person, and she is not ever. Again in regard to Dementia, no she doesn’t have it. She’s aware of what she’s doing especially the change in demeanor when other people are around. It’s just sickening! Why do I keep mentioning this well it’s because people always assume and say to me “well she’s obviously got dementia” ugh SMH!!! So I guess in closing I’m offering a bit of advice to you. When faced with or contemplating having your parent move in with you, while they are great right now, consider the possibility that down the road you may be

faced with caring for someone you no longer recognize. In our case the changes happened within a short time, maybe a little over a year of moving in together. To those younger than us that have young kids still living at home think real hard because the dynamics of your lives can and will drastically change. If you have siblings sit down with them and say we won't do this if you aren't on board with helping/supporting in his/her care. I'm an only child and it just drives me crazy when siblings will not help out. They know they dodged a bullet and in secret are giving a double bird salute at the situation. Thanks for letting me vent/ramble on. The last few days have been awful trying."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ph84g3/burned_out_beat_up/

">Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. This one especially. People would ask, sincerely, what can I do to help? And I honestly didn't know what to tell them. A friend sent a meal weekly, others have picked up prescriptions when I asked. Family isn't local, but they could have at least texted once in awhile. Only one family member bothered, I'll be moving near her to continue the harassment in the future, lol. Mom is gone and with her the intensive caregiving: bedbound with Alzheimer's. But dad's on hospice too though his isn't dementia, it's heart failure. It's easier now, but I'm still home all the time, I can't impulsively run to the store or be gone for hours. He'd probably be okay, but he's A) a fall risk and B) a stubborn old bastard. Your translations are dead-on. And I really wish people would say what they really mean or say nothing at all. Silence hurts, but empty words give false hope, in the beginning anyway. Then you learn what it really means."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrxoqjl/

"That's what really got to me. All of the "if you ever need anything at all" folks that just never showed up for anything. Hell, toward the end, no one was even calling to check in. Who wants to talk to a burned out, on the edge caregiver? We have nothing interesting to share, just our misery. I had one friend, not even that close at the time, that in my mother's last few weeks, brought comfort, food, a listening ear and a hug nearly every night and was there with me when she passed. She literally saved my life in the decompression weeks after her death."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nociuz0/

"This is a fantastic list. People who aren't caregivers are clueless, and I say this as a former clueless person. That said, I would amend the "let me know if you need anything" line. Some caregivers need help with literally everything, and some caregivers need VERY specific types of help. Showing up with groceries she can't or won't eat is a waste. Mowing my lawn isn't going to help when it's something I enjoy doing that gets me out of the house. His vision is so bad, he can't read the books you brought. What I really need is someone trustworthy to sit with my elderly parent while I go to the doctor or take my car in for repairs. I need someone to physically be present so I can unplug for a little while. Bonus points if they clean shit and piss."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nryb2sr/

"I feel this in my soul. I live 5 hours away from my mom, who requires 24/7 care. My brother lives 45 minutes away. Yet I'm her primary care giver. I always get the "you're so strong" and "I don't know how you do it!" well, Nancy, I don't have a choice! The "let me know if you very need anything" gets me every time. I don't know what you're willing to do, be my crippling social anxiety won't let me ask for fear of you saying no. Thank you for making me feel seen. 💖"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrywb3a/

"Your mom doing everything alone and refusing help is what brought her to the hospital. And now you're following in her footsteps. You already know how this ends because you're living the sequel. That 12-hour nurse you want? That's called a home health aide and it's a real thing you can get, sometimes covered partially by insurance or Medicaid depending on your dad's situation. If he's a veteran, there are additional programs. If not, private pay for 12 hours runs \$200-350 depending on your area. That's not a luxury. That's the thing standing between you and becoming your mother's hospital roommate. Your father chose not to walk he made a decision, and your mother paid for it with her health, and now you're paying for it with yours. You're allowed to be angry about that. You're allowed to name it. Call your local Area Agency on Aging tomorrow. Tell them exactly what you told us. They know what resources exist in your county and they'll help you find respite. That's their job. You said people ask how they can help and you have no words. Here's a word: "Tuesday." Tell them a day. "Come Tuesday from 2 to 6." People can't help if they don't know what's happening, and you're too tired to explain. Just give them a time slot."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/okbo10x/

"Can confirm. Both parents were diagnosed with cancer in same year while I was in my 30s. You give everything you can, until you can't, then you give some more. Usually while siblings (your own and your parents' siblings) have multiple opinions on what YOU could be doing better, being too busy with their own lives to assist in any true way. "Call if you need anything!" is the standard, lame response fed to caregivers by selfish relatives. And when you do call...it makes no difference, as they'll give a thousand excuses and STILL end the call with "Well, call if you need anything!" You don't just lose your parents--you lose your life and your entire family in one hit."

youtube · @Laura-gx9jr · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 7 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwYmSdszzDre7aFxRI4AaABAq

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf (2):** "Thank you for sharing this. You articulated perfectly the reality of what so many are going through. Brutal. Hang in there. ❤️"

"VA aid and attendance benefits. My mom qualified for these benefits 2 years ago and we then went through a program that sourced and paid CNA's to come to her home which she was still in. They deducted the money from her bank account monthly. When we moved her to assisted living the "level of care" fee matched what she was getting from the VA. Now her LOC fee is \$700 per month HIGHER and has been about 5 months or so. Anyway- we had to sell her house as she is running out of money to pay assisted living. Now there is 162K in her investment account. VA says you can have assists of 150k per my understanding. I'm going to go prepay a funeral for her and catch up some hospital bills but that probably would leave 6k left over. I really don't want her to lose those benefits over a few thousand dollars. Any ideas on legal ways I can get that money down? She's 94 and not able to travel, doesn't really need anything at the moment."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/13xltpk/va_aid_and_attendance_benefits/

"This is a question I sit with too. my parents are both in their early 90s. My mom has congestive heart failure and is in a wheelchair after a fall that injured her hip badly enough to make walking intolerable. My dad has dementia. They have a DNR in place and we've had the conversation about what they actually want. And still. When my mom was having trouble breathing, nobody said "should we just make her comfortable?" We called 911. You call 911. That's what you do. The system takes over from there, and the system is built to save, not to ask. I don't think what you're describing is cold at all. It's the difference between what we say we want and what we do in the moment. Your mother was ready. The EMTs didn't know that, and even if they did, they're trained to stabilize. Nobody in that chain of events has the authority to say "let her go" in real time. The paperwork exists for that but it doesn't show up in time. Shortly after my mom was diagnosed with congestive heart failure, she told me about someone

she knew who had a near-death experience and likely would have died without paramedics stepping in. They were able to bring her back, but the CPR broke several of her ribs, and she died 12 days later. Those last days were dominated by the pain from her injuries. Hearing that story shook my mom, and she has been very clear with us: if she is “checking out,” she wants us to let her go rather than prolong things at any cost. Another example: my mom shared a hospital room with a woman with cancer. The woman was recovering from major surgery and was in extreme discomfort. It was uncomfortable just being in the room with her. During Mom's stay the woman learned that the surgery was unsuccessful. The doctors sent her home to die. I'll never forget the anger and pain in her voice as she asked, “why did I do all this?” That's not a good way to go. I think if we listen our loved ones might be trying to tell us this kind of thing. It's hard for us, but I find it useful to acknowledge that the people they were aren't really here anymore. In many ways they are already gone. It's not terrible to say that. It's just a truth that makes things a bit easier for me. I don't have an answer to the bigger question you're raising. I think you're right that we act as though we want elderly people to live forever, and the cost of that assumption falls on people like us and our parents both. I respect the hell out of “I am not doing this to my kids.” That's love.”

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oj5d0x7/

“I worked as a home health nurse for 23 years. It seemed years ago family stepped up and helped with caring for ill family members. Friends, family and neighbors stopped by with meals or just to visit with the caregiver to help with the isolation of caregiving. I had caregivers who died while the sick person was helpless in their beds to call for help. I've helped with the care of grandparents, parents, aunts, uncles and now my husband. I'm tired! 😞 My friends and family don't understand the isolation and burden of caring for someone. I don't even get the “if you need anything call” people don't want to be bothered. What's a shame is our society proactively helps certain groups because they have celebrity recognition but old or sick are forgotten.”

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/noddv35/

“My folks are hoarders. My step dad is at the end of his life due to cancer. My mom, who is acting as my stepdad's caregiver, has level 3-4 dementia. My mom will call and ask for help, then cancel saying she's fine and doesn't need anything. I worry a lot about them. My mom adopted a big German shepherd dog as a way to keep people away. I'm now worried that the dog (which is still a puppy) will knock them over or trip them up, making the situation worse. I am glad of the dog as the city we live in has a huge homeless problem, and their house looks abandoned from the outside. So there's that little silver lining...”

youtube · @MsGenXodus · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 3 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwr9JsaIAo&lc=UgzqDU12U9DwxxxJkG14AaABAq>

““If you need anything at all” is a way to save themselves from ever offering help. I don't know about the rest of you, but as a caregiver I'm hesitant to ask for help from anyone. It isn't because I don't want the help or feel prideful. It's because I don't trust someone to walk in and help without all the extra work I'd need to do informing someone on what to know and cleaning up after they do it wrong. The people who say “if there's anything I can do, let me know” KNOW you aren't going to and they offer this because it makes them feel good for saying it”

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nojqwzo/

“Holy crap. So first there needs to be a leader. Someone who can coordinate care and supplies. It is not the caregivers job to fix things in the home. Nor is it thier job to clean the home beyond whst it takes to care for the client. If the house is a mess from hoarding that's the family's responsibility. No you can't just expect carers to just

show up on a whim. There should be a set list of tasks that the caregivers should be completing each week. But that's it. Cleaning and organizing should be done by a cleaning company. Go to the dollar tree and just buy everything you think they may need and put it in the basement. Anything else?"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/njnkhs9/

"The home health care agency that the VA selected for a personal care aide to come out to our home, I feel is not the best agency. We have had problems with the aides from day one. Some left to get a better job and others just come in late. The problem is I had to request to change aide because she was coming to my home 20 minutes late to care for my husband. The agency last week sent the same aide I got rid of before and that was very frustrating, because I got rid of her because my husband had a fall under her care. The issue now is this agency does not give me advance notice of the name of the aid or any background...they just show up at my door. I don't feel comfortable because I don't know what kind of training they have. My husband has Parkinson disease, dementia and stroke patient . Would you feel the same way if it was happening to you and your love one in your home?"

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/should-a-health-care-agency-call-a-head-of-time-to-inform-you-about-the-aide-who-is-coming-to-a-clie-438076.htm>

Tab 5 — Frustrations

The hospital discharge / rehab cycle · 637 documents

20 most engaged of 637 matching documents, complete text.

"I have to brag because I'm so freaking happy.... My Mom (then age 84) absolutely ran herself into the ground after my Dad (at age 86) fell and hit his head and walked around with an undiagnosed brain bleed for over 24 hours. After he was released from the hospital and rehab she became his primary caregiver, and learned everything from "scratch". Aides were hired but she was #1 for him. He deteriorated quickly, not even being able to feed or toilet himself. This continued for almost 3 years. After we finally convinced her to admit Dad into a nursing facility, she agreed to clear out her large home of 50 years and moved into an apartment nearby. There, she continued to take care of him, going there for about 5 hours every day, doing his laundry, choosing his favorite foods, and even giving him pt after Medicare said that he didn't need it because he had improved as much as he could and denied coverage. Dad was in nursing for just over 3 years when he passed earlier this year. It was tough. Mom always preferred her garden and kitchen to socializing and she found it difficult to make friends. Her eyesight and hearing are bad, so she had to give up driving and it was difficult to hear what people were saying to her. She turned 90 the week after Dad passed and slowly, with the help of some incredible neighbors in her building, she has become such a different person. She now takes yoga classes 3 mornings a week, and balance/strength-training on one morning. Whenever she hears that a person that she knows isn't feeling well, she makes and gives them soup. She has even participated in potlucks and gone to outdoor concerts over this summer. I am over the moon with love and respect and happiness for her! Over this past weekend, my husband and I took her to her granddaughter's wedding in the mountains. We got her a hotel room next to ours, she hadn't been away overnight since 2019. I was ready to leave the reception at 8pm and she pressed us to stay on. Then she, when I went to the restroom, decided to dance with everyone! I came back and couldn't believe what I was seeing!! Dancing for at least a half dozen songs in a row (upbeat, loud songs, too!), my niece was crying, my brother was grinning ear-to-ear, others were coming up to hug her. It was wonderful! I am writing this to, well, brag a little. *None* of us thought that she would bounce back from the loss of her husband of over 70 years and the literal hell that was taking care of him practically on her own for so long, but to let anyone else out there who might be in the same sort of situation that with patience and encouragement the path of an older person's life can be changed. Of course, Mom resisted for a bit, but she finally relented and still isn't very social, but she is happy. And has friends. And that's all I could have possibly hoped for. I wish that I could post the photo of her dancing that my husband took, I'm having it framed ❤️ EDIT: I just want to THANK ALL OF YOU for your wonderful replies! I'm so glad that I could give everyone a warm, fuzzy feeling and, just maybe, some hope with their own current or future situation. We have always called Mom "our Energizer Bunny" and somehow, as she has aged, the nickname is even more appropriate. 😊"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 830 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3g2fn/i_have_to_brag_because_im_so_freaking_happy/

↳ **comment** (162): "man this got me right in the chest, what a recovery arc for your mom at 90 she went from full time caregiver for years to out here dancing at a wedding like she 25, that's incredible my own grandmother shut down completely after my grandpa passed and never came back from it so reading this hit me in a way i wasnt ready for today the soup thing is so pure too, she sounds like a gem"

↳ **comment** (101): "And now she's spread good feelings all across the internet. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (33): "She sounds like an extraordinary woman - good for her and you! Loved your post."

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!? How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other

and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"It's time for the talk. My wife and I are both only children. Between us we've buried three parents. One is left — my father-in-law. Everything below is my experience; yours will differ. But I'd rather say the hard parts out loud than let someone else get blindsided the way we were. Confront reality — and make sure they confront it too. That's the whole thing. Both of us were badly surprised by things we had been told were handled and weren't. My mother-in-law went in for surgery and had a massive stroke on the table. A month in ICU in a coma, then a specialized rehab, then a nursing home — almost a year. She surfaced briefly near the end before a second stroke took her. My father-in-law had a will, an advance directive, and a power of attorney. We assumed she did too. She didn't. She couldn't tolerate what she called death talk, and he was certain he'd go first. I got him in front of an elder care attorney in the middle of the crisis. It was the right call, and it was a year too late. Had she lived longer, the cost would have consumed their savings and everything they meant to leave their grandchildren. After my dad died suddenly, my mom and I sat down with her affairs. The legal side was easy — wills, POAs, no argument. Two things weren't easy. One I'll come back to. The other was that after multiple conversations about her income and expenses, I found out she was hiding more than \$30,000 in debt from me. We can't fix problems we won't look at. The upfront conversations are unpleasant. Assume they will be. They are still cheaper than picking up the pieces on the back end. So don't take anyone's word for it: \- If they say there's a will, ask to see it. Then ask where it's kept. \- Same for the advance directive and the powers of attorney — financial and healthcare are not the same document. \- Ask to see the bank and credit statements. Not a summary. The statements. \- Get in front of an elder care attorney if you can possibly manage it. Medicaid look-back rules and asset protection are not things to learn during an ICU stay. That's table stakes. And even parents who've done every bit of it aren't out of the woods, because the paperwork is the easy conversation. The hard one is about legacy. This is the one I avoided with my mom, because it was the one that nearly broke her. Not the money. The *possessions*. She collected beautiful things her whole life. Most of it is headed for an estate sale. She made herself sick over it — trauma levels, on the edge of an identity crisis. There was china I never once saw used. Not one Christmas in my entire life. If we'd eaten off it every year I might feel differently. But I don't understand why I'm obligated to carry an attachment that was never mine. She had an old Mercedes. When it was time for independent living, we talked about what to do with it. She wanted to know if her granddaughter could use it. I told her the truth: no. Expensive to maintain, no dealer or independent mechanic anywhere near them, and they hike and camp and have a dog. They needed something that fit their life. Her position was that they should take it anyway — accept the burden, because it was a gift. I'm still working through that one. To me it's like buying piano lessons for someone whose hobby is baking bread. Here's what I think is actually going on. The things aren't the issue. The things are proxies. They're where the feelings get stored, because the feelings themselves never got dealt with. *If you don't keep this thing I owned, you're rejecting me and my memory*. That's why so many of our parents can't sort through it, and why it gets left behind for us. Dealing with the stuff means dealing with everything underneath the stuff. If I could run one conversation over, it's that one. I'd stop negotiating over objects and say: if you love them, let's turn this into something that actually

helps them. Sell the car, put it toward the truck they need. Sell the china, fund something they'll remember. They will remember and appreciate that you helped them. **The love transfers.** The dining set doesn't. Have the conversation while it's still a conversation and not an inventory."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 488 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vf1z4k/its_time_for_the_talk/

"My mom finally died. Hi everyone, I want to thank everyone in this sub over the years for providing support for me, no one knows how hard this is like you all. Mom spent the last 1.5 weeks in the hospital with sepsis, was discharged, and after a few days of slowly healing (but not really) complained of not being able to breathe yesterday morning. Paramedics were called to her nursing home and since no one could find her DNR papers they...did CPR on her for 20 minutes. She was 90lbs, 80 years old, and suffering from COPD, liver disease, heart disease, alcoholism, etc. I brought up hospice after this last hospital stint but she didn't want to talk about it yet. I was on my way but didn't get there in time. It's been 10 years of near misses and health crises, her not wanting to do anything for herself but drink and smoke. She was bed bound and incontinent for the past few years and evaded death numerous times. She was on hospice for six months two years ago and then was taken off because she showed no signs of leaving. She was a medical marvel and I really thought she'd pull through again. I'm tired and distraught that they performed CPR on her small frail body, but she was already gone. There's so much relief but also so much sadness. She was a broken old lady and I did my best. Here's a reminder to tell your mom you love her, and also make sure her DNR papers are readily accessible to avoid what my mom went through at the end. Good luck everyone, they really don't make it easy on us."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 393 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tnv7m/my_mom_finally_died/

↳ **comment** (62): "Sending hugs and love. I'm terribly sorry for your loss. Take care of yourself."

↳ **comment** (50): ""She was a broken old lady and I did my best." You get to carry this with pride for the rest of your life. It certainly wasn't easy. My condolences."

↳ **comment** (10): "I'm so sorry for your loss. May you find your peace with all the complex emotions this transition has brought. Your love and care for your mom comes through in your post and, ultimately, I believe the measure of a love is like that of the steady beats of a song, not the that of the occasional bridge."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a

random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was lewy body dementia. I

handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage lewy body. This march, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of

me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"better way to respond to parents saying they want to move back into their house?. Without getting into all the details: My parents both had serious accidents in their home recently. Both were in the hospital, then rehab. Now they are together at a very very nice assisted living place that they have agreed to stay in for at least three months. The problem is that they keep talking about how they plan to move back into the house. The house that has been unsafe for them - where they had their falls. Neither one of them is able to live independently at this point, let alone be a caregiver for the other. My sibling and I are the ones who have handled everything that needs handling during this extremely stressful time - and are still doing it. It's so much. I'm not local - I've been flying back and forth. My sibling lives about an hour away with two little kids and has been driving back and forth. We're exhausted, we're stressed. We are past the crisis part of this - I think - but there is still so, so much to do. For years we begged our parents to move to a one-floor condo or to build a bedroom on the first floor of their house (which

is just trip hazard city, between the stairs and a thousand throw rugs everywhere). They never thought this was important - never mind that Mom has Parkinson's and osteoporosis and both are in their 80s. We kept emphasizing that they could make choices while they were fully able, and get exactly what they wanted - or wait until there was a crisis, and have whatever choices were available then. They chose the latter. But they will not stop talking about moving back into the house. They think they can build a bedroom on the first floor, move the washing machine to the first floor, redo the bathroom, hire people to take care of them - and never mind that the two of them can't even figure out how to make a phone call right now. I guess they think the magic construction fairy will wave a wand and make this happen. I'm visiting right now, and it's been another stressful week - but also I am just so glad to spend time with my parents, and so grateful that this isn't worse. But meanwhile I've discovered that their house has mice - one more thing my sibling and I have to take care of. And the mice are living in the garbage they've been keeping in their kitchen cabinets and in the basement. I've asked them to pause talking about the house - I told them that I am at the end of my tether and need to get on top of what is happening more before I can even talk with them about where they are going next. I suggested they do some research about other living situations if they want - independent living, if they want, other ALFs, even construction companies and caregivers. But that I am not ready to talk about any of this while we are still so early in all of this, and I am still trying to get my dad into a doctor for his broken back because for some reason the osteo he's seen will only deal with his broken hip. But last night after dinner - the food at the ALF is good at least! - my mom started up again. And I lost it, in a very very ugly way. You really don't know what shame is until you've yelled at your 80-something year old mother in an assisted living home. I don't want to extinguish their hope - I don't want to be a jerk. I also am apparently furious that we are in this situation because they were living in this house, and I don't have it in me to have a lighthearted conversation about it right now. Not while we're still having to do so much. Given that it is inevitable they will bring up going home again - and given how raw I seem to be - what is the right way to respond next time? Thanks for reading my novel and oy, oy."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 241 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/

↳ **comment** (210): "If they don't have the ability to arrange things, just refuse to execute on the idea and leave it on them to organize, standing firm that they can't move back until they have arranged all of that on their own."

↳ **comment** (207): "I suggest a slightly different approach that's worked well for me. Let them talk. Let them dream, let them plan. Talk is just that - talk. They are not able to actually DO anything without help from you or your sibling. If the talk starts to move into real specifics of "doing", which is unlikely, then you redirect. "Interesting idea mom and dad, let me think about that for a while". "I'll look into that mom and dad, I need a bit of time". This approach worked like a dream for my family."

↳ **comment** (125): "This is similar to getting my mom to stop driving. Her car broke and she wanted to replace it. None of us kids thought her getting behind the wheel again was as good idea. So we just didn't help her get a new one. She talked a lot at first about getting a new one, but couldn't figure out how to do it and none of us took the steps to do it for her. Eventually she stopped talking about it."

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get

away with charging “whatever the market will bear”. The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don’t come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one’s lives and yet they’re barely able to make ends meet. I’ve visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she’s on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I’m just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren’t offering much that is really special. They aren’t providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won’t be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else.”

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldeercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I’ve always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn’t actively dislike him, at his current stage it’s just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always were there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws

a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are taking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself.

she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"Mom's fall changed everything and I'm fuming. \ contains some mildly graphic medical trauma, so read with caution if that skeeves you out\ In February of this year my mom (78) tripped and fell while entering a clinic to get her mammogram. She already had an existing knee replacement from 12 years prior, and when she fell the knee replacement cracked her femur. She had a new knee put in that accounted for the femoral shortening caused by the break. So it was surgery and rehab, and then she came home a month after the fall. She lives next door to my son, her eldest grandson. I stayed with her the first week and she was getting around pretty well with her walker. The very night I left to go home, she was in the bathroom and the new knee gave out, just came apart and broke. She went straight down and her legs ended up under her. It causes her incision to completely open and the broken metal parts were visible. She was bleeding out on the floor. We had gotten her an alarm button that would ring at my son's house, and she mashed that thing like nobody's business. My DIL is an RN. She stuffed a towel in my mom's open leg and held it together while waiting on EMS. It took a long time for EMS to get her stabilized and transported, due to the broken knee parts being extremely close to arteries. Emergency surgery that night was done by the surgeon on-call. He cleaned it as best he could, put the parts back together and referred her back to her original surgeon. So surgery again and then this time a nursing facility rather than rehab because insurance refused rehab for this event. She has seen her original surgeon multiple times, had multiple x- rays, and me, my sister, my son and my mom herself have told her surgeon the leg doesn't look right, doesn't feel right to her, keeps wanting to collapse again. We've raised concerns to PT, and told the orthopedics team. They just kept telling her that she'll get stronger with PT. However it was only 2 weeks ago, at yet another post surgery appointment that her surgeon finally told us that she put the knee in incorrectly the first time. So it has been incorrect since way back at the beginning of February when she had her original surgery. It is internally rotated by about 20 degrees. The surgeon even admitted that's very likely why she fell the second time... the time when we almost lost her. Now the surgeon wants to revise her knee. And we will go through this a third time. My poor mom has been working so hard to gain function of a knee that is not placed correctly, that collapses , that locks sideways. When it engages it just flips back and down and deforms her entire lower leg, causing her to scream. It's been heavy work taking care

of her as she cannot be left alone. She's spent about 20k outfitting the house with a lift bed, a lift chair, a whole new shower and toilet. Everything we could think of to try to keep her safe. My mom kept thinking she was failing somehow. It's heartbreaking. Watching her struggle has been horrendously hard on my little family. And I'm fuming. So many times we tried to say something was wrong and no one listened. We are reaching out to attorneys and trying to find a different surgeon. We will get through this again, but it's harder on her every time and I've never been so angry in my entire life. To let my mom go through this for 4 months is absolutely egregious and we are nowhere near out of the woods. She's mostly wheel-chair bound now... and back in February, when she was worried she'd miss her granddaughter's May 31st wedding, the surgeon told her she'd be walking and dancing by then, no problem. Fuming."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tszraf/moms_fall_changed_everything_and_im_fuming/

"Day 3, my prayers were heard.. I swear some nurses are angels in disguise. For now, it's over... and I can finally breathe, shower, clean, whatever I need. My mom had a visiting nurse stop by today and I took that opportunity to tell her about the condition of the house and how there is no one to be there 24/7. She listened and reported it to the social worker. The social worker and the nurse called an ambulance and EMTs took her to a hospital. For the night at least, I can finally breathe. My alcoholic uncle is going off to rehab in another state on Monday. Now it is just me and my cousin and the animals here. I finally have peace for now. I actually laughed today. EDIT: update 9/20: The doctors at this new hospital were horrified with her treatment at the last hospital and she will NOT be coming home this time. She is going to a subacute rehab and will never return home. We are now suing the last hospital for medical malpractice."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 225 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nlfyw/day_3_my_prayers_were_heard/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden, and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go, not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone. I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up, i told her I didn't feel well and would come up today. She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his

funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"Romance Scam Dad on psych hold, cars gone, etc. Quick catch up: After 15 months and 8 romance or romance-adjacent scams (today I learned about 2 more, making it 10), loss of \$100k, with me unable to stop him despite trying absolutely EVERYTHING, he finally got picked up by police for reckless driving and was taken to the ER by his consent when he didn't know what year it was. As previously advised, we insisted he was unsafe to discharge and worked to make sure friends and neighbors knew not to pick him up. He's been in the hospital 3 days now, and been seen by a psychiatrist, OT, PT, speech pathologist, diabetes specialist and more. In the notes, I was surprised to see how much insight the speech pathologist had available to contribute. It's incredible what can be accomplished in terms of diagnosis and documentation when he's in the hospital—putting together all these appointments and getting him to go would have been impossible. And so validating! Because he talks at great length, telling stories about his past achievements, people assume he's fine and try to extricate themselves from the situation. Even medical professionals can't finish their work with him in the allotted appointment time bc of how much he talks. But in the hospital, they have time. And they see right through it. His cognitive score, consistently 26-27/30 during our multiple attempts to get help over the past 15 months, is now 15/30. They note he "confabulates, "perseverates," requires constant redirection. He is "oriented to person"—he knows who he is—but not to place or situation—he doesn't know why he's in the hospital or how he got there, and while he now knows the year he has to think about it. He was determined to "lack decisional capacity" —"can't make consistent choices or understand the consequences of choices"—so I, as heath POA, am making the calls now. For the first 48 hours he had a "sitter"—someone with him constantly to redirect him whenever he tried to leave. She was a young woman and he chatted with her all day. But I think that attention was doing more than anything to keep him there and happy—just like with the scammers he talks to 24/7. The nurse and sitter reported that he was "so sweet!" And also that there was no way he should be living alone. Then in the third day they took the sitter away and he became increasingly agitated, saying he needed to leave. Eventually, he told everyone he was sick of being here and was going home. Walked out of the room and into the elevator lobby, where he began pounding on doors and yelling, "I'll just walk home!" and, "How do I get out of here?" And "Where are my shoes?" Because he tried to walk home...without putting his shoes on. He refused to return to his room and had to be restrained and medicated. Now he's back to having a sitter, except it's a security guard. And they don't think he's "so sweet" anymore. I haven't gone to see him, as he is abusive toward me and will definitely blame me for all of this, making it worse for staff. But my sister is on her way here now and will visit tomorrow. And I went to the hospital just before his incident and spoke at length with staff, without him seeing me. As far as he knows, I'm not involved. I also went to his house. Oh my god. The entire house smells like pee. Every chair smells like pee. His bed has no sheets or pillowcases. Junk is piled haphazardly everywhere (always true but even more now). There is rotting food growing flies, and flies EVERYWHERE. The toilets were both disgusting. The kitchen ceiling is leaking. He hasn't paid any bills since I stopped helping him about 3 months ago. I found threats to disconnect his power (which did happen about a month ago and he finally went and paid the bill in cash), gas, internet, and phone. Also threats to terminate his Medicare and drug plan (we made sure those got paid as soon as he was admitted!). And—Notes on a tablet on his couch he'd had with him when police escorted him home. They explained how to go to the post office and UPS with a total of \$9000 in \$1000 money orders and mail them to a "woman" in NY. Also receipts. I was able to go to UPS and use my POA to stop delivery on that one, using the receipts. That's what he had been doing when he was stopped. He broke it into small chunks at two different places because he'd been kicked out of a THIRD bank, this time after just 6 weeks, for sending the same "woman" a single \$9500 money order. So he has a new bank again. And I found the statements that his checking is overdrawn, because of ANOTHER pay-per-message dating site, one he signed up for only last week, and spent \$3200 "chatting" in the 4

days leading up to this incident. I got that cancelled, and sent threatening letters with my POA attached, demanding a refund. I also was finally able, with him not at the house, to take one of the cars and hide the keys for the other, which was already dead when I arrived anyway. No more driving, even if he manages to get out of the hospital and walk home in his socks. After the behavioral incident, he has a psych hold and chances are we will be talking about psychiatric placement today. And we are definitely talking about guardianship with the psychiatrist, hoping to finally get that letter the courts require, saying he can't take care of himself. That will allow us to put him in a care facility. The nightmare may be stabilizing, if not fully ending. New problems, but at least they're less chaotic. And he can't kill anyone. Does this mean we need to be looking at memory care instead of assisted living?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 194 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w36qf4/romance_scam_dad_on_psych_h_old_cars_gone_etc/

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble

because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 174 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok6k3ib/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my

food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"In a lot of cases though it's not that they refuse help, they just expect YOU to be that help at all costs. My dad is utterly alone and for the most part has himself to blame for it. It didn't seem to be a problem while he was healthy (which he kept a strict regiment to be), Working (successful construction company he built from the ground up), and independent(Beautiful two-story lakefront home). But six years ago when he was in his mid-70s he was plagued with an overwhelming amount of health problems. Caught a bad flu, which turned to pneumonia, shortly after diagnosed with an auto immune disease, and to top all that off was diagnosed with stage 4 melanoma. It was a lot to take, for both of us. To see the once invincible man I knew my whole life be reduced to a shuffling skeleton was a hard pill to swallow. I knew if he lost his independence he was finished so I've done everything in my power since then to give him the space to make his own decisions and treat him like an adult. Which isn't easy to do when the person you're trying to help lives in the middle of nowhere, down a 3 mile dirt road, 25 minutes from the nearest town, and an hour at least from most dr appointments. And just like before his stubbornness, temper, and selfishness has become absolutely unbearable. The same traits that drove my brother (only sibling) to the other side of the country with minimal contact, contributed in part to my mothers raging alcoholism and later suicide, and has driven off almost every other friend and family member. When I say I'm doing it alone I mean it. Drive him to his specialists. Put all his bills on auto pay and keep an eye on his accounts. Maintenance the house and yard. Move the boat dock when the lake levels rise and fall. Cook for him when I can because if not it will be a crap TV dinner. Cover for him with the doctors on the multiple times he's been admitted to the hospital by saying that I'll be with him 24/7 when I know I can't. Have changed diapers, bandaged wounds, administered oxygen, and wiped his drooling lip more times than I can count. His living situation is not safe. He still tries to drive and it's not safe. Almost everything he attempts to do is not safe. I am in a constant state of worry and stress when I'm not with him, and when I am with him I'm in a constant state of frustration and angst. He's my dad and I love him but when is enough enough? He's currently in the hospital with pneumonia again, aspirating food which could be a feeding tube situation, is definitely going to need oxygen, and also had an acute heart attack which means surgery is in the future. He was barely capable of working his flip phone properly and now this. The doctors, as they always do, are inching him back to a stable state and are talking about releasing him next week. He is already talking about " when I get out and get back to the house we're gonna need to..." and I'm about ready to scream. His location makes any kind of home health assistance a brief glimpse or nonexistent. Getting him into a rehab after hospital visits it's like pulling teeth with insurance. And my family " I'm so sorry you have to deal with this" is about as good as it gets. I have a wife and three kids. A full-time job and a house payment. Coach youth soccer and volunteer hours at the school. A multitude of responsibilities and people depending on me that I have put on the back burner a lot of times and put my life on hold so he can have just a little bit more of his.....his way. That's what brought me here and I hope I can manifest some of this information into something positive. My mom's alcoholism I witnessed as a child made me vow as an adult that my kids would never see me drunk, and they haven't. This situation as an adult has made me vow when/if I become a senior citizen I will never put any of my kids through this. And besides my wonderful and understanding wife the only place I have to talk about it is the emptiness of an online comment section. Ain't that something."

youtube · @amac8237 · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 148 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrx9JsAlAo&lc=UgyMOKJbUOBupQy1MqR4AaABAq>

↳ @sparkysmom7149 (27): "You have no choice. You have to hold it together for your own sanity. Contact the department of health and aging in your county/state. They will help you. I'm going to have to do this for my Dad too. It's been so stressful, so mentally exhausting, and I'm at the point where the whole situation is effecting my

own health. Neither you nor myself can let ourselves decline just to give our dad's "their way". Its wrong. God bless you."

↳ **@DWXY** (25): "Yes, interesting how much help they'll accept from one of their children but not from a professional, in which case they claim it's not needed."

↳ **@mixedredneck3967** (21): "@ShauntelleHamlett And it's a blanket of stress . Like you're being torn by horses but instead of being torn it puts just enough pressure to make you scream. Sounds rough as a metaphor, but some days that's how it is"

"Grandmother is now refusing AL or moving in with other family. I'm done caregiving and have plans to move. WTF do I do now?. I've taken care of my 96yr old grandma since I was 19/20 and am now 31yrs old. She's gone from being wholly independent aside from needing assistance going to appointments to now being mobile for short periods with a walker but has the majority of her mental faculties if not extremely emotionally needy and depressed. The last week after her release from a SNF from a fall she has either barely gotten out of bed or been trying go outside and dig up her garden when I'm not home and at work (neighbors called to let me know). She's going to seriously hurt herself but doesn't seem to care. I am at the end of my rope and ability to take care of her. The last time she fell I could not physically pick her up. I've already lost a ogreat job because of her constantly calling me to come home because she's "sick" and needs to go the ER (she's not, we waste 6+hrs to be told she's perfectly fine every single time), and am in danger of losing my current one for the same reason. I have to be present at home for any other person that stops by whether it's her friends or family visiting or scheduled appointments because she won't answer the door otherwise and she refuses any attempts for me to get respite because she won't go to daycares or senior events that would allow me to do so. So I'm essentially tethered to her anytime I'm not at work. We're at the point where she is only slowly deteriorating and not getting any better while I am no longer eating or sleeping and my own mental health has gotten bad enough my doctors are concerned for me. Neither of us can sustain this. I've spoken with other family that are planning a visit this week to either take her home with them or find an AL or nursing home ASAP. They are very aware that I cannot handle any more and need relief. My bags are actively being packed and I have a place to move to as soon as she's taken care of. Grandma was okay with this progression and change up until today (though obviously not happy about it) when suddenly it's become "oh we'll hire someone to come in and help" and "I'm staying at home or you get nothing". She's insistent we're both staying right here and that's just not happening. I don't care about anything willed to me when she passes anymore. Maybe it makes me a terrible person but I cannot do this any longer. I don't have POA, her son's does (the one coming this week) and she is otherwise still in charge of her own medical decisions. Obviously we can't force her into a facility but if I'm not stopping my plans to leave, what do we do? Do I just leave and let the chips fall if she won't allow herself to be moved somewhere? I spent today feeling like I was arguing with a toddler trying to get across to her that the train is leaving the station and she's not listening."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1np0dlg/grandmother_is_now_refusing_al_or_moving_in_with/

How to pay: Medicaid, VA, waivers, paperwork · 609 documents

20 most engaged of 609 matching documents, complete text.

"I have to brag because I'm so freaking happy.... My Mom (then age 84) absolutely ran herself into the ground after my Dad (at age 86) fell and hit his head and walked around with an undiagnosed brain bleed for over 24 hours. After he was released from the hospital and rehab she became his primary caregiver, and learned everything from "scratch". Aides were hired but she was #1 for him. He deteriorated quickly, not even being able to feed or toilet himself. This continued for almost 3 years. After we finally convinced her to admit Dad into a nursing facility, she agreed to clear out her large home of 50 years and moved into an apartment nearby. There, she continued to take care of him, going there for about 5 hours every day, doing his laundry, choosing his favorite foods, and even giving him pt after Medicare said that he didn't need it because he had improved as much as he could and denied coverage. Dad was in nursing for just over 3 years when he passed earlier this year. It was tough. Mom always preferred her garden and kitchen to socializing and she found it difficult to make friends. Her eyesight and hearing are bad, so she had to give up driving and it was difficult to hear what people were saying to her. She turned 90 the week after Dad passed and slowly, with the help of some incredible neighbors in her building, she has become such a different person. She now takes yoga classes 3 mornings a week, and balance/strength-training on one morning. Whenever she hears that a person that she knows isn't feeling well, she makes and gives them soup. She has even participated in potlucks and gone to outdoor concerts over this summer. I am over the moon with love and respect and happiness for her! Over this past weekend, my husband and I took her to her granddaughter's wedding in the mountains. We got her a hotel room next to ours, she hadn't been away overnight since 2019. I was ready to leave the reception at 8pm and she pressed us to stay on. Then she, when I went to the restroom, decided to dance with everyone! I came back and couldn't believe what I was seeing!! Dancing for at least a half dozen songs in a row (upbeat, loud songs, too!), my niece was crying, my brother was grinning ear-to-ear, others were coming up to hug her. It was wonderful! I am writing this to, well, brag a little. *None* of us thought that she would bounce back from the loss of her husband of over 70 years and the literal hell that was taking care of him practically on her own for so long, but to let anyone else out there who might be in the same sort of situation that with patience and encouragement the path of an older person's life can be changed. Of course, Mom resisted for a bit, but she finally relented and still isn't very social, but she is happy. And has friends. And that's all I could have possibly hoped for. I wish that I could post the photo of her dancing that my husband took, I'm having it framed ❤️ EDIT: I just want to THANK ALL OF YOU for your wonderful replies! I'm so glad that I could give everyone a warm, fuzzy feeling and, just maybe, some hope with their own current or future situation. We have always called Mom "our Energizer Bunny" and somehow, as she has aged, the nickname is even more appropriate. 😊"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 830 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3g2fn/i_have_to_brag_because_im_so_freaking_happy/

↳ **comment** (162): "man this got me right in the chest, what a recovery arc for your mom at 90 she went from full time caregiver for years to out here dancing at a wedding like she 25, that's incredible my own grandmother shut down completely after my grandpa passed and never came back from it so reading this hit me in a way i wasnt ready for today the soup thing is so pure too, she sounds like a gem"

↳ **comment** (101): "And now she's spread good feelings all across the internet. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (33): "She sounds like an extraordinary woman - good for her and you! Loved your post."

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :), can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"My husband was floored when I told him how much healthcare REALLY costs.. The other day my husband was talking about his potential inheritance from his parents (both still alive.) They have inherited money, multiple cars, four properties, and their own large savings. They are physically and mentally well. "I wouldn't bank on an inheritance," I said. I won't say what my job is. But I can see what multiple healthcare entities bill. I'm extremely familiar with all of the assisted livings, hospitals, skilled facilities, and in-home care providers within my area. I've been in this line of work for 15 years. The amounts charged are sickening. I've seen assisted livings charge residents \$15k+ per month. I've seen one hospital charge \$75k for a THREE DAY STAY. I saw a NICU charging \$8k per day. I've seen group homes that house individuals with developmental disabilities charge \$250k per year. The prices of medications have skyrocketed. Home medical equipment is outrageously priced. People like my husband that aren't in this world have no idea how much things cost. Whether you stay home or go to a facility things will get expensive. I wish everyone knew that they need to plan ahead. Work with an elder care law attorney. Medicaid does a five year look back on everything. So you have to plan really far in advance. My mom doesn't trust my knowledge. She refuses to sign a will, speak to an attorney, even make her funeral arrangements. She refuses to address reality. "You'll figure it out," she says. She won't even hear about spending down for Medicaid because she's "too proud to be on welfare." I hate how expensive end of life care is and how little education is out there to help people plan ahead. Sorry, just needed to vent this."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 612 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1j6yu55/my_husband_was_floored_when_i_told_him_how_much/

"My mom informed me I will be inheriting the care of my two siblings. I am the oldest of three. Me 50F, sister 46F and brother 37M. Roughly 6 months ago, my mother (75F) and I were discussing her paperwork (POA, will, etc) and all of the necessary related things. She said "don't forget, you will have to look after your siblings". Ok, my siblings have both had their issues. So I dared to ask, what exactly do you do for them regularly? My sister has made numerous stupid decisions over the years, and my mom has bailed her out several times, mostly financially. She is currently living with her boyfriend of 18 years. Just found out he owes \$63K in back taxes to the IRS. They are finally taking action. If he loses his house, my sister will lose the roof over her head. I honestly think my mother expects me to take her in, because I have an "empty bedroom". (My oldest finished college, found a good job and got her own place. I still have two more living at home currently in college.) No. Just NO. My mother has always been my sister's back up plan. Mom said she's ready for me to "take over." No. Next is my brother. He is autistic and has medically well managed schizophrenia. He does have his own place, car, and manages to hold down a 32-hour a week cashier job. Admittedly I have a soft spot for him. So, I asked, how can I help? I was thinking mental health/medical needs (I'm an RN). Nope, my mother micromanages every aspect of this kids life. She spends as much time at his apartment as she does at her house. Cleans, does his laundry, takes out his trash. I was speechless. They are so intermeshed and co-dependent that I don't even have words. She makes him call her twice a day if she isn't there. I told her my version of "helping" and her version are two VERY different things. I raised my three kids, and thankfully they are all transitioning to adulthood. I'm starting to embrace the 'empty nest', I have zero desire to take on another 'kid'. I probably should have disclosed from the beginning, all three of us have the same parents. We grew up in an abusive/neglectful household. Dad was the main perpetrator, he's been dead for years. All three of us kids got different versions of mom. I bailed as soon as I graduated high school, and am admittedly not that close with anyone. I'm friendly but keep my distance. Apparently my mom thinks I am "taking over" as she is "getting too old" but she does not approve of my boundaries, my "list" of what I am willing/not willing to do. She has accused me of "abandoning my siblings". I'm not even sure what I am asking for here. Just venting? There is much more. I could type for days."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 559 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q839bu/my_mom_informed_me_i_will_be_inheriting_the_care/

"Our Society Is Completely Uninformed on What Happens/Can Happen to the Elderly. I joined a group of mostly strangers who swap skills: for one hour of helping with a cover letter, the person I'm helping will provide one hour of house cleaning. I reached out to a member who was willing to trade garden clean up for lessons in gardening. I volunteered for the swap, but I warned her the yard and my home are a mess because I've spent the last four years caregiving for my nonagenarian in-laws. Her response was "It's wonderful to be able to care for your husband's parents." I don't know how old this stranger is. I know she was well-intentioned. The fact is, none of what my husband, brother-in-law, and I went through was "wonderful." My MIL did not want to live into her 90s; my FIL wants to live to be 100. Neither of them planned for how it would play out. As everyone on this sub knows, that's pretty much par for the course: there is no plan, and there are very few supports for those of us who wind up with very elderly parents who believe they will somehow be different from their parents and grandparents. My husband and I educated ourselves in this 20 years ago and made the plans our parents wouldn't (with a lot of gnashing of teeth). This isn't a rant so much as it is an expression of concern. There is this nostalgic, romanticized idealism about how people age that doesn't jibe with the financial, emotional, and physical toll families experience. Medicaid, Medicare, and Social Security aren't enough to help especially when the law makes it practically impossible to demonstrate our elderly family members are incapable of caring for themselves."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 549 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1j5g7dw/our_society_is_completely_uninformed_on_what/

"It's time for the talk. My wife and I are both only children. Between us we've buried three parents. One is left — my father-in-law. Everything below is my experience; yours will differ. But I'd rather say the hard parts out loud than let someone else get blindsided the way we were. Confront reality — and make sure they confront it too. That's the whole thing. Both of us were badly surprised by things we had been told were handled and weren't. My mother-in-law went in for surgery and had a massive stroke on the table. A month in ICU in a coma, then a specialized rehab, then a nursing home — almost a year. She surfaced briefly near the end before a second stroke took her. My father-in-law had a will, an advance directive, and a power of attorney. We assumed she did too. She didn't. She couldn't tolerate what she called death talk, and he was certain he'd go first. I got him in front of an elder care attorney in the middle of the crisis. It was the right call, and it was a year too late. Had she lived longer, the cost would have consumed their savings and everything they meant to leave their grandchildren. After my dad died suddenly, my mom and I sat down with her affairs. The legal side was easy — wills, POAs, no argument. Two things weren't easy. One I'll come back to. The other was that after multiple conversations about her income and expenses, I found out she was hiding more than \$30,000 in debt from me. We can't fix problems we won't look at. The upfront conversations are unpleasant. Assume they will be. They are still cheaper than picking up the pieces on the back end. So don't take anyone's word for it: \- If they say there's a will, ask to see it. Then ask where it's kept. \- Same for the advance directive and the powers of attorney — financial and healthcare are not the same document. \- Ask to see the bank and credit statements. Not a summary. The statements. \- Get in front of an elder care attorney if you can possibly manage it. Medicaid look-back rules and asset protection are not things to learn during an ICU stay. That's table stakes. And even parents who've done every bit of it aren't out of the woods, because the paperwork is the easy conversation. The hard one is about legacy. This is the one I avoided with my mom, because it was the one that nearly broke her. Not the money. The *possessions*. She collected beautiful things her whole life. Most of it is headed for an estate sale. She made herself sick over it — trauma levels, on the edge of an identity crisis. There was china I never once saw used. Not one Christmas in my entire life. If we'd eaten off it every year I might feel differently. But I don't understand why I'm obligated to carry an attachment that was never mine. She had an old Mercedes. When it was time for independent living, we talked about what to do with it. She wanted to know if her granddaughter could use it. I told her the truth: no. Expensive to maintain, no dealer or independent mechanic anywhere near them, and they hike and camp and have a dog. They needed something that fit their life. Her position was that they should take it anyway — accept the burden, because it was a gift. I'm still working through that one. To me it's like buying piano lessons for someone whose hobby is baking bread. Here's what I think is actually going on. The things aren't the issue. The things are proxies. They're where the feelings get stored, because the feelings themselves never got dealt with. *If you don't keep this thing I owned, you're rejecting me and my memory*. That's why so many of our parents can't sort through it, and why it gets left behind for us. Dealing with the stuff means dealing with everything underneath the stuff. If I could run one conversation over, it's that one. I'd stop negotiating over objects and say: if you love them, let's turn this into something that actually helps them. Sell the car, put it toward the truck they need. Sell the china, fund something they'll remember. They will remember and appreciate that you helped them. **The love transfers**. The dining set doesn't. Have the conversation while it's still a conversation and not an inventory."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 488 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vf1z4k/its_time_for_the_talk/

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for

retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

"Can we normalize NOT wanting to be your parents caregiver?. I(31F) am struggling. My mom(62F) has been in the hospital a week and my siblings and I have been with her every day. I am on day 4 from 8am to 10pm only taking breaks for phone calls and paperwork. The nurses aren't taking care of her hygiene needs and that doesn't matter much bc my mom doesn't want their help. She. Wants. Me. Look plain and simple, I am not made for it. I can't do the smells and i cant do the fluids. I absolutely admire and commend every person who has taken this role but i tried and i cant. My mom asks me to walk her to the bathroom, and i do it, but i fight gags the entire time and crack the door with my nose hanging out. If I can get a nurse to come in, i do. But my mom gets mad bc she wants me. Then when it comes to baths, she ignores the nurses and looks me dead in the eyes and says "I want you to do it." And "you need to learn to do this." And I refuse every time. I tell her no, I wasn't made for it and that I will hire people to do these things. She laughs but I'm serious. We do have a compromise that she can wash her body first then I will go in and wash her hair but today she told me she wants me to wash her. It's not that I don't want to see my mom naked etc, it's just one big aversion. Also, she is actually cleared to shower herself. She is capable but she is milking the pampering by us kids (I don't mind as long as it doesn't involve hygiene). It stresses me out bc it's

very clear she expects me to be her caregiver when that time comes but I do not want to. The worst part is this is nothing new. She has always known that I would never be her caregiver. She has always been told by me that I would hire help and I would not be the one changing her and bathing. I know this is pretty shitty but it's a hill I'll die on. Choosing not to be a caregiver does not mean i do not love her. It just means I wasn't made for that job."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 429 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/

↳ **comment** (138): "Not wanting to be your parents caregiver 'is' the norm (here in America). It's a cultural thing. Other countries have very different attitudes when it comes to caring for elders. This doesn't mean you have to want to do all things all the time or anytime...there are other ways to make sure they're adequately cared for"

↳ **comment** (116): "I've been an RN for 35 years and I am now my mother's caregiver. It sucks even with my background so I can't imagine how I'd feel without my abilities."

↳ **comment** (88): "My siblings and I call these "love tests." "Does it make you uncomfortable? Well, if you really loved me you would do it anyway. You must not love me." Our mother has never met a boundary she didn't try to cross."

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society

refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know I have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. I'm an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business I'm juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking I have some time. A week or so later Dad's friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasn't clean before but this was a

whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship. After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this. I simply wasn't proactive enough in getting my dad into an assisted living facility, possibly even memory care. I felt that it wasn't my life, but I was somehow compelled to help him live independently. I can't even imagine the millage I put on my car traveling to his house to help get groceries and pay his bills, clean his place, get him to his doctor's appointments, get him the medication he needs (through the VA nonetheless), basically keep him alive. After the initial hospitalization that set this in motion, I was able to buy him about two years on his own. Now he's in a memory care facility--just a few months after he temporarily moved in with me, he broke his hip and there was only one place that could take him while he healed. He was going to need 24 hr. assistance. My wife had made it clear she was not happy with how much time I was spending on his affairs. And rightfully so, as it was eating away my time with the family, and it always aggravated my

depression. I started a new career last year and my dad's problems were preventing me from putting best foot forward. By the time I was able to convince him to start touring assisted living facilities and getting on a waiting list, it was too little too late. My wife moved out, in part, to make room for my Dad to live at our place for a little bit--just a way to ease the transition into assisted living. The most-recent hospitalization was the big wake up call. Now my brother and I are in the process of managing his property, getting a short-term bridge loan to buy us time to fix up my childhood home, only for that house to be sold to pay for future memory care costs. It's not hard to see how a marriage could crumble under these conditions, especially if you don't get out in front of it when you had the opportunity. Yeah, our marriage had some problems to begin with. But dealing with my Dad was taking away time, energy, and other resources I needed to address my marital issues. I was exhausted all the time. And it was getting in the way of my new job. I was getting pulled in too many directions, and my Dad's situation was by far the most frustrating. If not for that, I feel like I could have repaired our relationship. Or maybe not. But it would have freed up a lot of time to focus on what's really important. Anyways, I just felt like sounding the alarm to anyone worried that their obligations to an aging parent are ruining your relationship... or some other important part of your life. The best advice I can offer are these rules of thumb: (1) set some boundaries to prevent it from bleeding into your family or professional life; (2) be proactive about moving this process along, because it's not getting any easier--if it's damaging your marriage, that's a clear sign that you can no longer provide the help they need; (3) if you haven't yet dealt with estate matters, medical/financial POI, etc., call a lawyer ASAP; and (4) let it be a lesson and plan for this period of your life so that it doesn't all fall on the shoulders of your children or other family members. I know it's easier said than done, but trust me when I say there is a better way. Happy New Year"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was lewy body dementia. I handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage lewy body. This march, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"Rethinking falls. About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they now have (and of course managing this is all on me). Of course multiple people, including myself, had told them they needed a stair lift, but they didn't listen, because it was "too expensive." So much of the advice around aging is around preventing falls. And yes, they should be prevented if you want to keep living. But – and this is cold – we keep acting as though we want elderly people to live forever, and then as a society we don't support them, or us the caregivers. Falls are terrible and painful and I wish my mom hadn't had one. But it should have been the end. The EMTs should've come and said oh, sweetheart, this is terrible, we are giving you morphine. It is utterly crazy that she was in the hospital for so long and cost taxpayers well over \$1 million in Medicare, only to come home and require so much care and drain their finances and eventually go on Medicaid. I don't know what we do about this. When my mom fell, I felt like she almost subconsciously had done it on purpose. That summer she had been telling me how tired she was, and how she was ready to quit taking care of my dad, who is very demanding, and my disabled sibling (that's a whole other story). I was sure we were going to lose her and of course at the time I didn't want to but now I realize that would have been the natural thing. Figured you all would relate. I am not doing this to my kids."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 337 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

↳ **comment** (206): "This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

↳ **comment** (78): "My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

↳ **comment** (65): "Your poor mama. She is TIRED of dealing with your dad and sibling. The hospital, as awful as they can be, may have been a respite for her. Meals delivered. Her own bathroom. Mostly sweet staff. Poor you. You must be mentally exhausted on top of juggling THREE of them. The money drain is no lie. THREE DEPENDENTS in a two story house? How in the world? She's exhausted caregiving. She's probably been putting up with your difficult daddy with his demands all her life and you don't say when your sibling became disabled, but if it's been lifelong? Or since their 20's? That burns even saints out early. If they've qualified for Medicaid,

can the house be sold and they go to skilled care or assisted senior living? Surely that would be cheaper than trying to maintain a home for three people needing 24 hour care."

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"PSA if your parent(s) is a veteran. My dad had been out of the military over 40+ years when my parents moved in with me. I became super stressed about finances (we also cared for my grandmother.) A bumble match (of all things) mentioned he got military disability pay for an ankle injury sustained in service. I mentioned that my dad wasn't injured, even though he served for 28 years and in Vietnam. The bumble guy advised me to request my dad's service records and see if something was there. In the meantime, I read about the PACT act for wartime

(even modern war) veterans. Long story short: I filed for my dad under the Pact Act (didn't even need the military records) and got my dad (and mom) full disability monthly payment, aid & attendance monthly payment, caregiver support payment for me (or anyone we designate), 30 days respite care for me, 20 hours a week caregiver coming to the house. No property tax for the house as long as my parents live there... it ended up being another \$7k mo + the caregiver. It was quite a bit of paperwork, took 6mos for disability, 8mos for caregiver support, and 10mos for aid and attendance but it was worth it. Also, if you are a veteran taking care of a non-veteran parent, you can also qualify for programs. Moral of the story: if your parent is a veteran (especially war era) see what they qualify for!! I never went on a date with the Bumble guy, but boy was that 'swipe right' match worth it!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 171 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l9w918/psa_if_your_parents_is_a_veteran/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"Mom (93) finished cancer treatment and is giving up. Looking for both tactical advice and to hear from anyone who's been through this. Long-time lurker, first time posting. The situation: Mom is 93, just finished radiation for cancer and is in remission with aggressive monitoring. We had to move her from independent living to assisted living about six weeks ago after a hospitalization made it clear she couldn't safely live alone anymore (not taking meds consistently on her own). (She had been in independent for 18 months before the cancer diagnosis and seemed fine.) Treatment went as well as we could've hoped clinically. But now that the active medical crisis is past, she's collapsed. What's happening this week: \- Won't get out of bed. Won't leave her room. Always an excuse for not going to meals or activities. \- Hiding her medications. Staff are catching some of it but probably not all. \- Caught trying to bribe staff — telling them she'll give them her house if they help her go home or look the other way when she does things she's been told not to do. \- I'm pretty sure she thinks that if she gets kicked out of AL, she thinks she goes home. Home is not an option. The next step is SNF, and she doesn't understand that. A counselor is seeing her tomorrow, which I'm grateful for. The staff at AL is working with us — they have really been amazing through all this. What I'm asking: 1. For those whose parent went through post-treatment depression — did meds help? Did therapy? Did anything? How long did the dark stretch last? 2. The bribery / med-hiding behavior — is this depression, early cognitive decline, or both? She's been cognitively intact on testing, but this feels like something shifted. 3. How do you talk to a parent who has decided to give up? Every script I try ("we want you here," "we're doing this because we love you") seems to bounce off. She just keeps saying she understands but then the behavior doesn't align with what she says. 4. Did anyone successfully avoid the SNF transition by getting their parent stabilized in AL after a backslide like this? Or is this how it goes? The harder

thing: We have moved mountains. We (my wife and I) uprooted our lives to temporarily move to be near her and take care of her throughout this process. My employer has been very understanding. We've dealt with all the paperwork, coordinating five specialists across three cities, getting her placed, managing her finances, the cancer treatment, all of it. And it's not enough. She's miserable and I think part of her is angry at us for not letting her go home to die in her own bed. I know there's no magic answer. I just want to hear from people who've been in this exact spot. What helped. What didn't. What you wish you'd known. Thanks for reading. Edit: I wanted to provide some additional info to address some of the comments. Health prior to the cancer diagnosis: First, up until this cancer episode she was in very good shape cognitively and physically - much better than her age would suggest. She only used a walker outside or unfamiliar places. People always commented on how sharp she was. Finances: After my dad passed away, we discussed her finances on many occasions. My only concern was that she was financially ok and she constantly assured me that she was fine. She was paying her bills -- she always paid on time and was never late. I have never pushed her to do anything she didn't want to do. She approached me about moving to IL. We discussed the cost and I agreed to help because it was going to cost more than her monthly income. We discussed selling the house and she agreed. But she kept coming up with excuses to drag out the process and, quite frankly, I was busy with other things in life. Then one morning shortly after the initial cancer diagnosis, she divulged a credit card bill. In trying to get to the bottom of that I discovered that hole was much deeper than she let on. She even tried to hide some of the statements from me. On the cancer diagnosis: Her mother (my GM) died of cancer, so I think mom heard cancer and immediately interpreted that as a death sentence, despite what anyone told her. Multiple doctors told her should would likely die with it and not of it. It was very early stage 1 and very treatable. One oncologist said even at her age, given all the other factors, he gave her a >90% chance of survival. We made the decisions we made with the best intentions and the best information available at the time. That bell has been rung and I'm not going to re-litigate that on an Internet forum. Legal affairs: Before all of this, we had all of her legal affairs in order. She had an AD (no code), and I have full financial and healthcare POA. I have since taken over managing the finances and have an attorney involved to make sure we handle the debt and her care according to her stated wishes. On me "not being able to let go": I have a background in being a first responder. I've seen death in the line of duty and personal experience with other difficult family situations. This is not a situation where I "just can't let go." I have lived through that on my wife's side of the family and it was an awful experience. I have discussed this situation with many doctors and every single one has told me this is not a palliative care situation -- she would likely not qualify for hospice. I'm not an expert in that -- I'm simply going on the advice of others. Now has she just lost the will to live? Yes, very probably. But being depressed is not the same thing as being terminally ill and that's not the same thing as just being old. I'm hoping that independent behavioral health will help us make the best decisions we can from here on out. I appreciate everyone who has taken time to respond."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 125 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4swt3/mom_93_finished_cancer_treatment_and_is_giving_up/

"Found a place for Mom, with not much money and without Medicaid.. Hopefully this will help someone and give some hope. I can't be my Mom's caregiver being an only child, with young kids and work and my own issues. Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator. Placement coordinator is contacted by the social worker and then try call me. I told him the budget my Mom had(she lives of SS and not much!) And hoped for the best. He found a place that a lady owns and she worked with me and based off the circumstances cut my Mom a deal and is using her SS check for monthly rent at this place. Which does cover 24/7 care and food. Hospice will follow her there for added comfort and care. So it is possible to find a place. It might not be a 5 star 5 grand a month resort, but my Mom hasn't got long to live and this place does have great reviews as well. The placement coordinator has a lot of relationships with places that often take people if that can't afford much. She's being discharged today to this place and hospice is meeting me to go over everything. It's a lot of stress, over all Its one hurdle I don't have to worry about. You shouldn't have to feel guilty for not being able to take care of your parent. Not everyone can and

they're all valid reasons. People who judge are projecting and often times have the financial means to hire people and not have to work. But not everyone has that luxury. I hope this helps at least one person. It can be done. I am thinking of everyone during these stressful times. It's ok to not be ok. Update: this place is awesome! It's like a house but with a about 15 bedrooms with closets and own bathroom and there's a kitchen and it's very clean and has a rec room. It's probably like an adult foster home? But with a bit more care. The nurses are so nice. I feel beyond happy this is where she'll be. Don't give up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1aqo1wy/round_a_place_for_mom_with_not_much_money_and/

Referral sites and calls that never stop · 490 documents

20 most engaged of 490 matching documents, complete text.

"Never use 'A Place for Mom'. They are stalkers. They will call and email you nonstop for YEARS. My dad was 92 when I contacted them many years ago. Nonstop calls and emails. Block the calls? Can't. They either use multiple numbers or they're spoofing their caller ID. My dad died at 100. And yes we found a great place on our own. But even though he died already, I'm STILL getting harassing phone calls from fresh numbers 'concerned' about my dad and whether I found a place. Don't do it! In fact if you have an enemy, give them their info. They're the scum of the earth. I almost feel like getting some referrals and then 1-starring those referrals based on them using APFM. Argh. Ok rant over."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 590 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/

↳ **comment** (264): "A reputable company gave me this link to send to APFM so they would LEAVE ME ALONE! I sent in the form and haven't been contacted since. They were horrible and the calls were relentless. [Do Not Represent Me Form](<https://civica.formstack.com/forms/dnrm>)"

↳ **comment** (186): "Just FYI. I may be paranoid, but I suspect APFM has employees monitoring this sub because everytime anything negative about them comes up, a bunch of people rush in to defend them. If you've had good luck with them, awesome for you, but remember that advertising and commercial posts are prohibited in this sub. I, personally, keep my recommendations to nonprofits and governmental agencies in honor of the sub rules. APFM is a for-profit business whose revenue comes through referral fees they collect from senior living communities and home healthcare providers. Not every service provider is willing to pay their fees, so if you enlist APFM's help, you're not seeing every option available. And, yes, if your aging parent is low income, they are disincentivized from helping you. The fact they use aggressive sales techniques like never removing your phone number from their call list should be enough of a clue. Add your number to the FTC's Do Not Call Registry, make sure to get the call center employee to tell you who they are working for, and tell them you're on the DNC registry and will report them for violating the law (and actually follow through...it's easy)."

↳ **comment** (81): "I was pestered by them for a long time. I started getting pretty feisty about, saying 'No I don't need your help because my mother is DEAD. Stop calling me, you can't make any money off me, because I don't have someone to help!' Eventually they stopped."

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful*. Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her*. I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY**

WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.

I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom **CHOSE** this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly **AGAINST** having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends **ALSO** saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit **AGAIN**, find a new place to live **AGAIN**, set up all my utilities **AGAIN**, and **STILL** have to manage **HER** life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* **FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING.** I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7 months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. **BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER.** **THIS**, more than **ANYTHING**, should be a clue that mom is **NOT** who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and **THEN** people will complain that mom is **LONELY**. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags under her bed rather than in the 3 **FUCKING HAMPERS** I've bought for her) **FINALLY** getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down.

They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation

is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgXk_YPLbQCKuR7nN8l4AaABAg

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"A reputable company gave me this link to send to APFM so they would LEAVE ME ALONE! I sent in the form and haven't been contacted since. They were horrible and the calls were relentless. [Do Not Represent Me Form] (<https://civica.formstack.com/forms/dnrm>)"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 264 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/mspeptr/

"The cost of caregiving is too high and I can't continue like this. I need to vent. My (26) mom (68) had a fall and broke many bones, after many surgeries and a month long hospital stay, she is now at home with very limited mobility. I am an onlychild, my dad is dead and we don't have other family so everything falls in me and I don't have a lot of support, except from my friends. I was already her caregiver when she broke a leg when I was 21 and have been financially responsible for her for 8 years. I am so tired / angry / frustrated and I can't face to keep being responsible for everything. Being responsible for her health is such a big pressure, as if anything goes wrong

it will be my fault. Example, if something is a warning sign and I didn't realize. Cognitively she is great, so she could help me figure out stuff. Instead, she decides to act like a toddler which gets on my nerves. She has always been emotionally immature and narcissistic, but she takes it now to an extreme. She doesn't take any agency over her own health or even bothers to try. When I tell her that it is X time and she has to take X pill, she answers something like "Ok, I'll take it only if you want me to take it". At the same time, I can't speak with her like grown ups. When I tell her that I am burn out, her answer is "I'll just make myself invisible so I don't bother you anymore if I am such a burden for you". I hired a caregiver and she refuses to ask her for help if I am around (because she "prefers it when I do it") so I have to leave the apartment. I have no safe space anymore as being in my apartment is being bombarded by things to do. I am emotionally depleted. I work a full time and a part time job (both remote) and I am being a horrible worker because I don't have the time, energy or focus to work on my tasks. I am late to every deadline and I make so many mistakes due to my lack of attention. So I am also constantly afraid of being made redundant (who is going to pay for everything she needs then?). This year, I have received many amazing career opportunities and I feel like I am throwing everything to the trash because I am not up to what they expected from me. And lastly, I have no time for self-care. I feel like I am giving up my youth and all my desires for her, and I don't want to. But then, I feel extremely guilty because I should be a "better daughter" -not based in the US-

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cbz9g1/the_cost_of_caregiving_is_too_high_and_i_cant/

"Found a place for Mom, with not much money and without Medicaid.. Hopefully this will help someone and give some hope. I can't be my Mom's caregiver being an only child, with young kids and work and my own issues. Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator. Placement coordinator is contacted by the social worker and then try call me. I told him the budget my Mom had(she lives of SS and not much!) And hoped for the best. He found a place that a lady owns and she worked with me and based off the circumstances cut my Mom a deal and is using her SS check for monthly rent at this place. Which does cover 24/7 care and food. Hospice will follow her there for added comfort and care. So it is possible to find a place. It might not be a 5 star 5 grand a month resort, but my Mom hasn't got long to live and this place does have great reviews as well. The placement coordinator has a lot of relationships with places that often take people if that can't afford much. She's being discharged today to this place and hospice is meeting me to go over everything. It's a lot of stress, over all Its one hurdle I don't have to worry about. You shouldn't have to feel guilty for not being able to take care of your parent. Not everyone can and they're all valid reasons. People who judge are projecting and often times have the financial means to hire people and not have to work. But not everyone has that luxury. I hope this helps at least one person. It can be done. I am thinking of everyone during these stressful times. It's ok to not be ok. Update: this place is awesome! It's like a house but with a about 15 bedrooms with closets and own bathroom and there's a kitchen and it's very clean and has a rec room. It's probably like an adult foster home? But with a bit more care. The nurses are so nice. I feel beyond happy this is where she'll be. Don't give up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1aqo1wy/found_a_place_for_mom_with_not_much_money_and/

"Friendly Warning ! Do not use a place for mom ! . They really do not care about your loved one they just want that check . They rush you , harass you and don't give a st !!!!! And when you actually need their help will not respond to your call, emails nothing! I'm so fed up with them Vultures !!!!!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 72 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1d55k9e/friendly_warning_do_not_use_a_place_for_mom/

↳ **comment** (24): "Yes! They recommend places as "best" choices that have repeatedly been cited for substandard care! <https://www.washingtonpost.com/business/2024/05/16/place-for-mom-assisted-living-refer>

ral/"

↳ **comment** (15): "I made the mistake of entering my email and phone number to get a "list" of what was available in my area and they were calling within minutes and continued every hour until I blocked the number. I was nowhere near ready to start the process (and my mother would definitely not be!)"

↳ **comment** (9): "We used them, they gave us 3 places and I did the research on reviews and ratings, toured them all spoke to Director of Nursing and staff on the unit. We chose one and she's been there for 2 yrs now. It's not cheap but their staff have all worked there for years and she's always clean, has a private room that's always spotless and her weight stabilized pretty quickly. These were all Private Pay Places and perhaps that made the biggest difference but from what I've heard that's pretty much what they deal with. They get paid by the facilities."

"A Place for Mom is a waste of time. If on Medicaid. Just a disclaimer that after giving A Place for Mom my info to try to find a place for mom who is on Medicaid only, they cannot help. They only deal in private pay. If your LO does not have assets don't bother with APFM. Or at least that's my experience. DSHS was more of a help and that's mostly been giving me a long list of places that I have to research and call and tour. I'm burnt out. Haven't slept for days. Having APFM hound me the last 36 hours with calls because I was too busy to answer and go through their intake process to be told they can't help felt like another rug pulled out from under me. I'll admit I'm already in a defeated mood but as many others here feel, we need help and not run arounds."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1icxwp0/a_place_for_mom_is_a_waste_of_time_if_on_medicaid/

"Update: 30 days to find a place for Mom and Dad. I know that my post [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1jmmomg/30_days_to_find_a_place_for_mom_and_dad/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1jmmomg/30_days_to_find_a_place_for_mom_and_dad/) didn't get a lot of traction, but I still wanted to give an update on my family's situation. Thank God, a facility finally called back offering two beds. My husband and I toured it and it's acceptable -- clean, not smelly, the people seem kind and attentive, my parents are allowed to bring a couple items of furniture and decor, the storage situation is better than some places. It's unfortunately 45 minutes away from my home, but I will just have to plan my time well for visiting. While it's an older facility and not overly gorgeous inside, the more important factors of good care and activities for my parents seem to be well-covered. The facility has a Medicaid specialist who has already been a huge help in figuring out issues regarding our application. I know it will still be a lot of work and time, but I am so relieved to finally have someone helping me. We've spent the last two days moving them and most of what they will keep to the new facility. Mom and Dad are still adjusting, obviously, but they have each said some nice things about various aspects of the new place and I'm currently hopeful they can be happy there. The next few weeks will be very busy as we empty their old room by the 30th, disperse those belongings hither and yon, work on paperwork, visit Mom and Dad and continue to help them settle, and so on. But I'm hopeful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 52 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1k98rsw/update_30_days_to_find_a_place_for_mom_and_dad/

"A Place For Mom is hounding me. A place for Mom is relentless. I made the mistake of giving them my contact info and now they won't stop calling me. Why do they think repeated calls are helping them?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwbvyr/a_place_for_mom_is_hounding_me/

↳ **comment** (37): "You might try being assertive and direct. Ask for the name of the person you are talking to. Ask for the purpose of the call. And then say something like: This is the (third/fourth/whatever) call I have rec'd from A Place for Mom and it is "not appropriate" to continue to call me after I have asked for them to stop. It

feels like harassment. I am telling you again: do not call me. Is there anything else you need to do to make that happen?"

↳ **comment** (24): "I understand that business is just a haven for spam. You give them your contact info and they blast you with spam calls and emails. Block, block and more block."

↳ **comment** (21): "I just started telling them my parent was dead (she's not). Not sure if that was what did it but the calls have ceased. But seriously, I was looking for Medicaid facilities which is out of their scope so that should have taken me off the list right away. No matter how many times you call me we still haven't magically come up with the funds to use one of your fancy assisted living places."

"You might try being assertive and direct. Ask for the name of the person you are talking to. Ask for the purpose of the call. And then say something like: This is the (third/fourth/whatever) call I have rec'd from A Place for Mom and it is "not appropriate" to continue to call me after I have asked for them to stop. It feels like harassment. I am telling you again: do not call me. Is there anything else you need to do to make that happen?"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwbvyr/a_place_for_mom_is_hounding_me/oxhsota/

">Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. This one especially. People would ask, sincerely, what can I do to help? And I honestly didn't know what to tell them. A friend sent a meal weekly, others have picked up prescriptions when I asked. Family isn't local, but they could have at least texted once in awhile. Only one family member bothered, I'll be moving near her to continue the harassment in the future, lol. Mom is gone and with her the intensive caregiving: bedbound with Alzheimer's. But dad's on hospice too though his isn't dementia, it's heart failure. It's easier now, but I'm still home all the time, I can't impulsively run to the store or be gone for hours. He'd probably be okay, but he's A) a fall risk and B) a stubborn old bastard. Your translations are dead-on. And I really wish people would say what they really mean or say nothing at all. Silence hurts, but empty words give false hope, in the beginning anyway. Then you learn what it really means."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrxoqjl/

"Your mom is weird. Or controlling. Or somewhere in the Cluster b personality disorder spectrum. Narcissists are part of the Cluster b group. She's been cleared to bathe herself and is perfectly capable of doing it for herself, but she wants you to do it for her. That is absolutely ridiculous. She wants to be pampered and babied or something by you, instead of doing something that she is able to do herself. Does she have a husband or something around who she can harass with her b.s.? Or were they smart and bail out already? This is not normal of her to ask or even expect from you. I personally wouldn't be there all those hours either. I have two elderly parents who are in and out of hospitals, nursing homes and rehab facilities. Then back home. It's just too much work to sit around all day. Between the needs of my own household, their's, errands, chores etc. They can't expect me to be with them in a facility. Especially if their's others who are able to assist with bathroom needs. Your mom doesn't even need help with showers. You will burn yourself out fast if you allow her to make you do things for her that she doesn't even need."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/osui2zc/

"Hiring Help Causing Anxiety?. Have any of you experienced this? I have hired help from Care.com to help with my mother's bed bath. The people are ok. They get burnt out and I have to replace them after a while. However, I noticed recently that I feel a sense of irritation, or anxiety on the days they come. To the point I want to drink. I

figured it because I don't want to be bothered...but caregiving in itself is to be constantly bothered. And it actually helps all in all. Maybe resentment for having to spend the money? Or shame I'm not enough? Just wanted to see if anyone has experienced this."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1fntqww/hiring_help_causing_anxiety/

"update: May have reached the end at home care, as many before (REALLY LONG). Began exploring nearby memory care facilities. This is what I found and experienced. Preface- this is my second go around, and I look at this industry with an extremely jaundiced eye. My father in law, (WW2 vet, 4 Pacific battle stars, Commander Santa Cruz Natl. Guard) occupied assisted living quarters where his wife (in the Santa Cruz surfing museum) was kept in memory care. He had a medical incident, ended up in the hospital. I went to see the manager of this fine facility, who after a brief talk, pretty much told they would not let him come back to the facility, so sorry. but keep sending the checks for his wife. Just what you need at this time of crisis. He passed very soon after, and his wife in memory care did also, out of the blue, 3 days later. The family agreed he went to heaven, then came back and got her. man. The cost. An eye watering \$8-10000 a month for any single facility. Based on a 1,2, and three scale of care, with cost rising at each level. Group settings are about \$4000 a month, but finding an open slot appears problematic. That's just to start, evidently fee increases can be routine. I can barely afford the base, any increase would eventually bankrupt me. I would have to sell our home, but even then, it would be consumed rather quickly. I still have to live somewhere, and that will drain the bank as well. I'd have to move out, deal with all our possessions, which now are becoming albatrosses around my neck. I'm 70, still very active, but feeling it. Once my wife is in these places, moving because of cost to a lower priced facility would be required, not a pleasant experience, one would imagine. You are going to tour these facilities. Take note of the residents, the attendants, the general demeanor. Cleanliness, maintenance, dining areas, quality of the food, activities provide. One advisor told me to trust my gut, I do, but that's it? My wife's accommodations for the rest of her life, on a gut check? What is the management like? If you are a first timer, this will be a daunting task. Management. I have noticed talk of acquisition of these facilities by hedge funds, which gives me pause. Hedge fund operations can be seen in mobile home parks. The MO. Buy the park, raise rents, drop services until all residents eventually leave, bulldoze the structures, sell the land, all at a tidy profit. Then, move on to next one. They target people in retirement communities as well. even veterinary clinics. Find a group of desperate people needing services, with few options, and pounce. Nice. I started with a place for mom. went online, filled out the form. have to give email and number. talked to a front "filter" guy, that's when I realized the advertised rates published were a come on, and the real cost for care was revealed. Transferred to an advisor, talked about what my situation was, what was locally available, maybe set up some walk thrus. What I didn't expect was to be deluged by a tsunami of calls and emails in just a few days. There is money to be made in Alzheimer's care. These people know I am primary care giver with very little free time. Also unless I have my phone in my possession at all times, it has been known to disappear. I have to locate it with my iPad. If you were looking for the current state of memory care, this has been my experience . the next is what I decided. Ran a bunch of spreadsheets, looking at time lines, costs, expected future increases in care expenses. Ran tax scenarios, at some point found even with the possibility of total cost as a deduction, you may end up with over zero tax liability. all for naught, because your total income would be eaten up. it's a no go. What to do.... hmmm. What was my original plan, that I made with my extremely helpful stepdaughter? it was to keep the one true love of my life at home, under our care, which even on bad days, would be better than what she would receive at a facility. I had a nervous breakdown dealing with all this shit. Don't call for help, no one will hear you, (except you dear readers) and the realization that the cavalry is not coming. I detailed earlier about being helped by my physician. this week, my meds really kicked in. With a home aide, I have free time. I went to lunch with an old work time buddy, took the cover off the convertible, and drove it to lunch. Found myself waving to kids walking home from school, haven't felt this good in a long time. and my "danders" up. The main problem is nighttime wandering. The house is locked and secure, she cant elope. But I need to sleep. I have always slept for about 6 hours, that works for me. Probably because I served on a warship for 4 1/2 years straight, watches etc, that

programmed my sleep patterns for life. 9 PM to 3 AM. is the doughnut hole. Since my mood has improved, my wife picks up on it, and wandering has been much less, but it's Alz, and change can happen anytime. The solution , Yolo smart door sensor kit(Amazon , of course what a blessing for caregivers) It is a wireless device, that reports to a hub. It comes with hub and 4 door sensors, \~\$60, sufficient to cover all critical doors , reviews show easy installation, and it can be configured so that during the day , the front door will contact my Alexa speakers and verbally indicate the door has been opened. And you can tell it , do that during this time span. Locked at night not needed, The 2 doors to the master suite can be synced to my iPad, and alarm will audibly notify me. I no longer sleep with my wife, but I do sleep with my iPad. Even with the loss of sleep, with every other day home aide coverage, I can leave the house, decompress and relax. It really makes all the difference. Current cost is \$600 a week three days, 5 hours each. She can get her to shower and change clothes, coax her to eat, take her for a walk with the dog, the dog loves her, and give me pointers. Even if I go to 365 day coverage, it's \$73000 total. That I can do. Eventually, my wife will progress. All those spread sheets and tax scenarios are now my glide path. Activated our final annuity, it has a life time rider for both of us, if one passes 100% goes to the survivor. It also pays even if the funds are exhausted. My wife has Calstrs, and Social security, as do I . I also have disability, all these are indexed for inflation. If you are not good at financial things, talk to a trained professional, it will be worth the money. They don't come cheap. I am going into extreme saving mode, our expenses are pretty fixed, and I just buy food, really. Even 2 years will let me build up some sort of income producing CD ladders, and generate an income stream to meet those eye watering cost. And perhaps, mercifully, future events will minimize that. I am cautiously hopeful. We all face this reality in some way or the other. We made the commitment, and are trying our best, I read every reply, it's good to know our band of brothers on the internet is listening and requesting help, and trying to help, I don't know what caregivers did pre internet, probably spiraled down alone. I will update on Yolo installation, it really could be the solution to my main problem. Hope this long, detailed post helps newbies and pros alike, it's daunting and details are key "insert pithy quote here" best of luck to all. Ken"

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rmdr8l/update_may_have_reached_the_end_at_home_care_as/

"30 days to find a place for Mom and Dad. Through a number of factors, some due to bad decisions on my parents' part, and some due to things out their control, their money has been running out. They've been in a non-profit Personal Care home (not Medicaid approved) for the last 18 months. I've been trying to make up the shortfall in the rent each month but I'm partially disabled myself and it's really not possible. For six months I've been calling all sorts of nursing homes. Either they don't call back, they don't have Medicaid beds, or they require years of private pay before the resident can switch to Medicaid. If we can't afford \$3000 to make up the shortfall, we certainly can't afford \$15,000 for two people in nursing care. I've been asking everyone - the facility, Council on Aging, other agencies, EVERYONE! for help in finding a place for them. People talk like they'll help but nothing really happens. Now the worst has happened - Mom & Dad's facility is evicting them. I have until April 30th to find them somewhere. Finally, the facility sent some referrals, but so far, only one place has offered two beds. A tour revealed it to be a true Hell Hole, reeking so badly of urine and feces that hours later my hair still smelled of it, unclean and dingy, no chairs or couches (residents expected to just be in wheelchairs - my parents use walkers), just AWFUL. What do I do? WHAT DO I DO?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1jmmomg/30_days_to_find_a_place_for_mom_and_dad/

"I understand that business is just a haven for spam. You give them your contact info and they blast you with spam calls and emails. Block, block and more block."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwbvyr/a_place_for_mom_is_hounding_me/oxhwyc7/

"Agitation in the mornings. I've heard of sundowning and when I first moved in with my elderly (now 87) year old mother to care for her, she would indeed become very agitated in the late evening and even do things like wake me up from sleep at 1am or 2am saying things like she's sure she heard the doorbell ring (she has very poor hearing without hearing aids) or she had just thought of something vitally non-important to tell me to do tomorrow. But lately that has shifted. She no longer wakes me up at night but now what I find is she's very agitated and upset in the mornings. She'll wake up angry or in pain due to her arthritis or generally not well and will "act out". That's the only way to describe it. I've read all kinds of things on how to handle this type of agitation, one of which is "gentle reassurance". But how do I gently reassure a person who woke up this morning to tell me that her cell phone, which she has for emergencies only, is not working because she hasn't received a single call in a month. I gently explained that no one else has her number but a very small group of people and they call her or reach her other ways. She then became upset that it can't be working because she hasn't been receiving spam calls and I gently explain that a spam filter is applied and it's good to not get spam. I pay for this phone so that if she is home alone and her power and landline fails and she needs help, she can reach me. Then she became convinced someone had tampered with the phone because there were photos in her gallery she didn't put there. So I go take a look and they are literally a couple of dozen screenshots. So I showed her how easy it is to touch a button on the side of her phone accidentally and a screenshot will save to her gallery. "No! Why would I do that? Someone is tampering with my phone and they added those photos to my gallery. And you don't believe me!!!" I deleted the screenshots for her. Then I demonstrated to her that her phone does receive calls and she can call me with it but the phone was muted. She said "yes why wouldn't I turn my phone to silent when I'm asleep". Anyway this proceeded for half an hour of her being visibly upset and frustrated. This is just one of many early morning agitation stories lately. I don't know what's worse!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tsvqoz/agitation_in_the_mornings/

"Finding In-Home Care for Mom. * TLDR - What is a realistic cost and expectation for home care for Mom, and what's an easy solution for finding it? Mom is 70. She was diagnosed with dementia about 3 years ago, but the likelihood is that she started developing it about 5-6 years ago. She's originally from the Midwest, but came to live with my partner and me on the West Coast about 2.5 years ago... due to there not really being any other workable family options available where she was living, or elsewhere for that matter. We're happy to have her. She's peaceful. She's personable. She's in good physical health for her age. But she struggles with short-term memory issues, and cannot retain new information. She doesn't know her phone number or address. Most of the time, she still thinks she lives somewhere in the Midwest near where she grew up. She can't drive anymore. She can't cook for herself. She gets frightened to be home alone for more than 2-3 hours at a time. As a result, my partner and I get very little "us time" and haven't been away together on a vacation or longer term outing in over 3 years. I feel like Mom is the perfect candidate for some part-time, in-home care... which would give her some social interaction outside of just us... and also give us a little more away time to catch our breath and reset, and bond more than we've been able to recently given our caretaker responsibilities. We're not destitute by any stretch, and Mom has some money to help with the cost of in-home care, but realistically... anything over like \$1,500 per month would be difficult. She's on Medicare not Medicaid, so my understanding is that there's not really an option for an insurance contribution here for in-home care. I feel like that's a reasonable budget, but I'm also in my 40s and still think twenty bucks is a lot of gas. So I just don't know. I've posted a couple ads on care.com in the past couple years, but the responses I get are overwhelming, disorganized, and a lot to process. My partner and I both work busy jobs and it's difficult to set aside hours per day for a week at a time to meet people and respond to messages, and make phone calls, to no real conclusion. That may sound bad. But we just haven't had the mental energy to pursue it as we should. In a perfect world, I'd love to find someone to sit with her 15-20 hours per week, just to give us a couple nights out. How realistic is my budget for this? Are there agencies that handle this sort of thing? An agency would seem to be the perfect scenario... I suppose I just worry about cost... or whether someone would even take her if she's not on Medicaid. I guess I just need some help or advice, or even a pep talk. One of my biggest concerns is finding a situation with the highest likelihood of landing a consistent,

reliable, GOOD part-time caregiver. One of the reasons I gave up on care.com so easily is that I felt like I was going to be posting ads and looking for new people every month or two. Help? Thoughts? If you've found a decent in-home caregiver situation for a loved one, will you give me some pointers?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1bvecp3/finding_inhome_care_for_mom/

"Today is my FIRST DAY with a person coming in. We're paying \$30/hr to an agency I considered care.com but for \$5/hr more i don't have to interview anyone or any of that legwork I'm nervous. I'm imagining this is similar to what parents feel on the first night away from the baby?"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okquadq/

The parent refuses help / stubborn · 469 documents

20 most engaged of 469 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"My husband was floored when I told him how much healthcare REALLY costs.. The other day my husband was talking about his potential inheritance from his parents (both still alive.) They have inherited money, multiple cars, four properties, and their own large savings. They are physically and mentally well. "I wouldn't bank on an inheritance," I said. I won't say what my job is. But I can see what multiple healthcare entities bill. I'm extremely familiar with all of the assisted livings, hospitals, skilled facilities, and in-home care providers within my area. I've been in this line of work for 15 years. The amounts charged are sickening. I've seen assisted livings charge residents \$15k+ per month. I've seen one hospital charge \$75k for a THREE DAY STAY. I saw a NICU charging \$8k per day. I've seen group homes that house individuals with developmental disabilities charge \$250k per year. The prices of medications have skyrocketed. Home medical equipment is outrageously priced. People like my husband that aren't in this world have no idea how much things cost. Whether you stay home or go to a facility things will get expensive. I wish everyone knew that they need to plan ahead. Work with an elder care law attorney. Medicaid does a five year look back on everything. So you have to plan really far in advance. My mom doesn't trust my knowledge. She refuses to sign a will, speak to an attorney, even make her funeral arrangements. She refuses to address reality. "You'll figure it out," she says. She won't even hear about spending down for Medicaid because she's "too proud to be on welfare." I hate how expensive end of life care is and how little education is out there to help people plan ahead. Sorry, just needed to vent this."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 612 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1j6yu55/my_husband_was_floored_when_i_told_him_how_much/

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and beat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the

exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"*

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be

nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him

back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call

regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her, but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had."* This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin* Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family *Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin* My cousin also asked her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant **we** would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set off what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out*

Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rtrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was lewy body dementia. I handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage lewy body. This march, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"Seeing Behind The "Aging Industrial Complex" in The Villages, FL. My husband and I are visiting his elderly parents in The Villages, Florida, for Christmas. My father-in-law (94) is frail and needs a caregiver, while my mother-in-law (82) has been acting as his full-time nurse for two years. She's completely burned out but insists on doing everything herself, refusing outside help because "no one else does it right." This dynamic has concerned us for a while, and now it's come to a head: my MIL started having chest pains and is currently hospitalized. We've canceled our flights home and are trying to figure out next steps—whether it's arranging home care or transitioning them to assisted living. We both work full time and will have to take time off work to stay longer. Last night in the ER was eye-opening and deeply unsettling. We waited over 8 hours before my MIL saw a doctor. I have the utmost respect for healthcare workers, and it was clear they were completely overwhelmed. The staff was stretched too thin, and I saw many elderly patients—just like my in-laws—waiting in hallways due to a lack of space and personnel. It felt like a "cattle call," with everyone suffering: patients waiting in pain, families helpless, and staff dealing with entitled and impatient seniors. During that long wait, I started researching healthcare shortages, especially in elder care. What I learned was grim: a severe lack of healthcare workers, home health aides, and poor staff-to-resident ratios in assisted living and memory care facilities. The Villages markets itself as a paradise for seniors, but the reality I saw was far from idyllic. It seems like an impending crisis is brewing—people are living longer, but the low wages and poor conditions for caregivers make it unsustainable. I'm not sure if I'm venting or asking for advice, but has anyone else witnessed this firsthand? How do we prepare for what feels like an inevitable "boomer crisis" in elder care?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 311 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hoc2wa/seeing_behind_the_aging_industrial_complex_in_the/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all

the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and

stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugxxk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8I4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real

possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "People ask how they can help and I have no words." I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's

started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are talking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my

partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden, and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go, not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone. I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up. i told her I didn't feel well and would come up today. She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking kilns, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement than means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!???" Seriously, I'm done. I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house

(front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"Getting kicked out of independent/assisted living facility due to poor hygiene. TL;DR: my grandpa is absolutely disgusting and his lack of hygiene is going to get him kicked out of his living facility. My mom (his daughter) and I have tried everything and at this point, we have no idea what else to do. Warning: this is gross. Some backstory: my grandfather fell about a year ago and was on the ground for 3 days before my mom called for a welfare check. He has a history of forgetting/refusing to charge his phone, so we often weren't able to get ahold of him and were calling for welfare checks multiple times a month. After the fall, he agreed to move into an independent/assisted living facility. The condition of his home was horrifying. Urine and feces everywhere. Dead mice and mouse droppings. Rotting food. Mold. The works. We spent weeks cleaning and threw out at least 2 dumpsters worth of stuff. He would never let anyone into the house so we had no idea how bad it was. We moved him into a lovely facility and he was so happy that he was in tears. I decorated, made it homey, and really set him up for success with an easy-to-maintain and organized space and regularly scheduled housekeeping. It was a great fresh start. Within a few months, the complaints started. Other residents have been complaining that he stinks like urine and feces (and they are correct). The facility contacted us and said that they can smell the apartment from the hallway and other residents are upset. We were surprised because we set up housekeeping and laundry service, as well as someone who comes to give him a bi-weekly shower. Turns out, he's been refusing all of those services. Never cleaning, never showering. We went in and did a full deep-clean and had a very uncomfortable conversation with him. He seemed to understand and promised not to refuse housekeeping anymore. Less than a week later, the apartment was in the same condition as before and he was refusing services again. This has now happened multiple times. Facility staff have also talked to him multiple times. When we ask why he's like this, he just says "I'm lazy" or "I just don't care." He refuses mental health help, won't see a doctor, etc etc etc. The housekeepers have trouble stomaching his apartment. Last time they cleaned, we found out that they had to use paint scrapers to chip feces-coated toilet paper off of the KITCHEN FLOOR. The carpet is soaked in urine. His laundry is piled sky-high and he isn't disposing of his urine/feces soaked Depends, just leaving them in his underwear on the floor. There's blood everywhere from his unmanaged psoriasis. I could go on for hours. It's revolting. The facility contacted us again. Basically, if this doesn't improve immediately, he's going to be evicted. He has one month to get his shit together. I have no idea what to do. He loves living there, but I understand why they can't allow him to stay. All of the other facilities in the area are less nice and more expensive. He has nowhere else to go. We have done everything we can to make this easy for him, but he won't stop turning services away. Nothing we say makes a difference. I am sorry this was so long. At this point, I'm desperate. Has anyone been through something like this? Do you have any advice? Edit to add: This is absolutely a mental health issue, and as much as I want him to see a doctor and get help, he is completely non-compliant. Even when we physically get him to a doctor, he will not engage. He will literally just sit there and refuse to talk, then yell at us for meddling. I wish it was easier. Another quick edit since this is getting some attention: He was never a clean guy - his hygiene has been a lifelong issue. My grandma said it was part of the reason they got divorced (specifically, she remembers crying while scrubbing skid marks out of his underwear at the age of 19 and wondering if that's what marriage was really supposed to be like). This is a new low, but his hygiene has always been a problem."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 203 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t11ql5/getting_kicked_out_of_independent_assisted_living/

"Romance Scam Dad on psych hold, cars gone, etc. Quick catch up: After 15 months and 8 romance or romance-adjacent scams (today I learned about 2 more, making it 10), loss of \$100k, with me unable to stop him despite trying absolutely EVERYTHING, he finally got picked up by police for reckless driving and was taken to the ER by his consent when he didn't know what year it was. As previously advised, we insisted he was unsafe to discharge and worked to make sure friends and neighbors knew not to pick him up. He's been in the hospital 3 days now, and been seen by a psychiatrist, OT, PT, speech pathologist, diabetes specialist and more. In the notes, I was surprised to see how much insight the speech pathologist had available to contribute. It's incredible what can be accomplished in terms of diagnosis and documentation when he's in the hospital—putting together all these appointments and getting him to go would have been impossible. And so validating! Because he talks at great length, telling stories about his past achievements, people assume he's fine and try to extricate themselves from the situation. Even medical professionals can't finish their work with him in the allotted appointment time bc of how much he talks. But in the hospital, they have time. And they see right through it. His cognitive score, consistently 26-27/30 during our multiple attempts to get help over the past 15 months, is now 15/30. They note he "confabulates," "perseverates," requires constant redirection. He is "oriented to person"—he knows who he is—but not to place or situation—he doesn't know why he's in the hospital or how he got there, and while he now knows the year he has to think about it. He was determined to "lack decisional capacity" —"can't make consistent choices or understand the consequences of choices"—so I, as heath POA, am making the calls now. For the first 48 hours he had a "sitter"—someone with him constantly to redirect him whenever he tried to leave. She was a young woman and he chatted with her all day. But I think that attention was doing more than anything to keep him there and happy—just like with the scammers he talks to 24/7. The nurse and sitter reported that he was "so sweet!" And also that there was no way he should be living alone. Then in the third day they took the sitter away and he became increasingly agitated, saying he needed to leave. Eventually, he told everyone he was sick of being here and was going home. Walked out of the room and into the elevator lobby, where he began pounding on doors and yelling, "I'll just walk home!" and, "How do I get out of here?" And "Where are my shoes?" Because he tried to walk home...without putting his shoes on. He refused to return to his room and had to be restrained and medicated. Now he's back to having a sitter, except it's a security guard. And they don't think he's "so sweet" anymore. I haven't gone to see him, as he is abusive toward me and will definitely blame me for all of this, making it worse for staff. But my sister is on her way here now and will visit tomorrow. And I went to the hospital just before his incident and spoke at length with staff, without him seeing me. As far as he knows, I'm not involved. I also went to his house. Oh my god. The entire house smells like pee. Every chair smells like pee. His bed has no sheets or pillowcases. Junk is piled haphazardly everywhere (always true but even more now). There is rotting food growing flies, and flies EVERYWHERE. The toilets were both disgusting. The kitchen ceiling is leaking. He hasn't paid any bills since I stopped helping him about 3 months ago. I found threats to disconnect his power (which did happen about a month ago and he finally went and paid the bill in cash), gas, internet, and phone. Also threats to terminate his Medicare and drug plan (we made sure those got paid as soon as he was admitted!). And—Notes on a tablet on his couch he'd had with him when police escorted him home. They explained how to go to the post office and UPS with a total of \$9000 in \$1000 money orders and mail them to a "woman" in NY. Also receipts. I was able to go to UPS and use my POA to stop delivery on that one, using the receipts. That's what he had been doing when he was stopped. He broke it into small chunks at two different places because he'd been kicked out of a THIRD bank, this time after just 6 weeks, for sending the same "woman" a single \$9500 money order. So he has a new bank again. And I found the statements that his checking is overdrawn, because of ANOTHER pay-per-message dating site, one he signed up for only last week, and spent \$3200 "chatting" in the 4 days leading up to this incident. I got that cancelled, and sent threatening letters with my POA attached, demanding a refund. I also was finally able, with him not at the house, to take one of the cars and hide the keys for the other, which was already dead when I arrived anyway. No more driving, even if he manages to get out of the hospital and walk home in his socks. After the behavioral incident, he has a psych hold and chances are we will be talking about psychiatric placement today. And we are definitely talking about guardianship with the psychiatrist,

hoping to finally get that letter the courts require, saying he can't take care of himself. That will allow us to put him in a care facility. The nightmare may be stabilizing, if not fully ending. New problems, but at least they're less chaotic. And he can't kill anyone. Does this mean we need to be looking at memory care instead of assisted living?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 194 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w36qf4/romance_scam_dad_on_psych_h_old_cars_gone_etc/

"I am done. She's not my problem anymore. I quit.. Update 3: I took several days to think and cool down. I had told my husband he didn't need to confront his mom because she won't change. She'll just pull the "my heart" card to get him to back off. He would never forgive himself if she did end up in the hospital over him chewing her out. He has talked to her before about her attitude to me a few years ago. So this is nothing new. The venom from her this time was new. I realized while thinking, the venom started after her stroke a year and a half ago. Strokes change people. I let my husband know I am not heartless. If she called with a problem I could fix, I would go over and fix it. But if she is wanting me to drive her to the hospital at 2 am because she doesn't want EMTs in her house, i won't do it. She can get one of his brothers up to take her if my husband can't. She knows I don't sleep well and am often up that late. She has almost called me before but then chose not too. She wouldn't feel as badly about calling at 2 am in an emergency since I'm most likely awake. But so far she has talked herself out of it. I told him I am not going over to just check on her and visit anymore. I do not want or need the extra drama in my life. I do not have to put up with being yelled at just because she's made at everyone else or the world in general. I'm sorry there is no great dramatic ending to my post. Yes, I wish my husband had gone over and laid into her verbally. It would have made me feel better. But it wouldn't have accomplished anything but cause issues for him. So I am choosing to not cause him that stress. \----- Update 2: Husband is mad at her because he just talked to her about this exact problem within the last 6 months. Last time I just took it and came home. He is processing about the way he wants to handle it. Tomorrow we've got stuff to do, so he's going to avoid her while he thinks. Honestly, I told him it won't do any good to talk to her. She won't take accountability. She's not going to tell him we had a fight. I asked him to let me know what what is going on when he talks to her. He promised he would. I also told him she has been nasty to me more than he hears. I just took it because I love him and want to help his stress level. He feels terrible because he knows how his mother can be. I said to him, to me the problem is solved. I'm done. She pushed so hard that she gets what she thinks she wants which is for me to go away. He understands. She played that game with him, too. Like he said he stopped going over for 2 weeks when she did that and things fell apart because the rest don't pay attention or think. I'm still done and I told him that. \----- Update 1: Husband got back to me and apologized for the way she treated me. He said he'll be arguing with her this tomorrow over this. I told him ok, but I won't change my mind about helping her or setting foot in her house. In a week or two she'll be asking him if I'm ok because she hasn't seen me in a while. I told him to tell her the truth. I'm done because of her. She refuses to take responsibility for her actions and words. SO that'll be a fun conversation for him. /s \----- My MIL is fighting any and all help. She resents not being able to do things and won't let people help her. I have been going over once or twice a week just to ask if she needs anything. If she says no I back off. Her BS is affecting my mental health and she's not my mother. I was doing it to help my husband with his stress because his brothers don't help much. My therapist told me to back off and I have. I can't talk about her to my therapist anymore because she is a mandatory reporter and MIL is on the line for my therapist to have to report her. All week my SIL and BIL have been at my MILs house. The needed to get a window replaced and the guy wouldn't do it unless it was in a garage. They also gave a 6 hour window. So SIL and her daughter stayed from 12-6 twice. My SIL is a very in charge type of person. So she did what she wanted at MILs house despite my MIL asking her not to. MIL won't let her anger out on anyone but me. So she wasn't forceful with the SIL. She just sat back and let my SIL push her around. She had some distant cousins come in mid-week and they stayed all day too. Then her neighbor was moving some of his stuff out of his house at 9 pm. That was keeping her dogs up so she couldn't sleep. I went over today to see if MIL had a grocery list for my husband on his way home from work. She unloaded on me today. I got defensive and reminded her I ask before doing anything. She said I don't and everyone wants to control her life. She also accused me of getting defensive. I told her I was because I let her do her thing. She kept

interrupting me and raised her voice at me. I finally told her that my therapist told me to back off. She told me good and I need to listen to her because she doesn't need anyone's help. I offered to tell my husband to let her get her own groceries. She said that's different because we know she can't drive. I got mad. And left. She told me that is my choice. I told her I am mad and she is mad and we don't need to be talking with when we're mad. I texted my husband at work and let him know what was going on. I was venting and called his mom some choice names. He told me I don't have to convince him because he knows how she is and he'll handle it tomorrow. He prefers to get told at work in text so he's not getting unloaded on when he gets home. I'm done. I won't set foot in her house ever again. If she calls I'll tell her to call 911 or one of her sons. If my husband is home, he's getting the phone. I'm my MILs only friend. She has now tore the bridge down and set it on fire."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 189 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_problem_anymore_i_quit/

"So Angry at My Dad. My 95 yr old father DROVE 5 days after being admitted to ER observation overnight because he fell in a parking lot ... he also dragged my mother down to the ground when he fell. I moved from another state to help them as they age and they never called to tell me until day AFTER they fell. Lots of bruising, pain/aches, immobility etc but neither of them broke anything but we discussed that he would not be driving until he goes to dr for follow-up. He can't put weight on his right leg. And he drove. My mother lied to me about it. (He lies so often that I'm used to it.) On thanksgiving when I told him he can't drive again until his follow-up appt in 5 days he started to lash out and asked me to leave Thanksgiving. As in get out of the house. I left. I had zero alcohol. Planned what I was going to stay and was very calm. Doesn't matter. He just lost it. I really regret moving back as these two are impossible. I know I have to deal with them but I am so angry at their refusal to listen to common sense, not telling me they were both in ER when I loved back FOR THIS REASON, how he hurt my mother because he refuses to use a cane or walker, and the lies. And the verbal abuse. Oh and how he might hit an innocent person and ruin someone's life, or take someone's life. How do I not be angry when they are so challenging and impossible. He has always been a full-on jerk but getting worse now. I know I don't deserve being yelled at and eating Thanksgiving dinner in a diner alone. I have read a ton about dealing with narcissistic people but I am still so angry. HOW am I supposed to handle them? My sister is In another state. There is no one else here to help. He has alienated other family and not a big family in the first place."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 178 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p9fn38/so_angry_at_my_dad/

Cost / can't afford / price per hour · 295 documents

20 most engaged of 295 matching documents, complete text.

"I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets.. Edit everything I say here is for the USA. private pay insurance. I've worked for home health for around five years now and I want to share some of the good and bad I've learned so you can make an informed decision about the care for your aging parents. There are two kinds of home health care ones thst accept Medicare and one's that do not. The ones that do follow stricter guidelines for care (this doesn't mean they're better it just means they have to follow different rules than private insurance) my information only applies to those that do not take Medicare. First. It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour. So please don't act towards the caregivers like they should be doing \$50 an hour worth of work because they are not getting paid much above minimum wage. Second. Keep track of your loved ones need for care. If they fall and then need care or have a heart attack and need help after surgery. The agency is never ever going to tell you that the person is fine now and doesn't need care anymore. I go to several assignments where I do literally nothing the entire time I'm there just because no body says to stop sending us. Third. If you up the care from one kind to another temporarily after an injury or fall make sure that when you know they can go back down to less care that they return to charging you the lower rate. I've been to several assignments where I'm still being paid for hands on care even though all I'm doing is cleaning house. Fourth. Do not look at the caregivers like you would a cleaning crew That comes in and cleans as fast as they can to get done fast and move on to the next home. Caregivers are there for a set time so we are encouraged to sit and talk to our clients. Watch TV with them. Play games. Go for walks. We won't always be up doing things. We aren't someone who you hired to fix your toilet and now he's sitting on your couch. You hired us to take care of your loved one and sometimes that is just having a conversation or watching TV together. Fifth. Ask the caregiver what they need for the home and for the client. I went to an assignment last month that had no toilet paper in the whole house. The client was bedbound and used diapers so they just never thought to have toilet paper in the house. I literally had no way to wipe for the first day and I ended up bringing my own. Hand soap, paper towels, gloves, hand sanitizer all these things you are responsible for providing. Sixth. Understand that for the most part we are not nurses. Most states require little to no certifications to be a home health aide. So please understand the limitations of what we can/are allowed to do. We can't make medical decisions. We can't administer medicines. We can't change dressings. We can't even trim nails because if we cut you it could cause an infection. So please be very aware of what we are and are not allowed to do and don't ask or expect us to do something we aren't supposed to do. If you want any other advice ask it in the comments I'm happy to answer."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

↳ **comment** (363): "RN here and this is incredibly well written and all very true. Thank you for all you do. You ARE underpaid. Massively."

↳ **comment** (137): "It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients"cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception thst the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

↳ **comment** (94): "Thank you. I love my job but I am aware of it's downfalls."

"She's going to trap me in soon, my adult life is over. My mom is 61 and will be getting let go from her factory job soon. She only speaks polish after living in the USA for 25 years and has nowhere to go. She won't go back to Poland, her retirement won't be more than \$1,300/month so she won't be able to afford her apartment. I live in a rural area with no public transportation so I'm it. I'm her only outlet. She's visiting us right now and is an absolute weirdo. I have a 20 month old baby and am getting ready for a mastectomy for breast cancer. I'm working full time and trying to make things fun for my son but I also need rest. She literally sits on top of me all the time. When I'm reading my son a book she comes in and will point to the pages like a toddler and go "RED CAR" loudly and so on. She tries to butt into my conversations with my husband but doesn't understand so wants a translation. She tries to steer the stroller or shopping cart with me and when I'm like fucking you do it she runs into me because she's staring off into the abyss as if she's never seen groceries in her life before. I feel like a trapped animal, I'm caged in my own home. Last night she told me she won't be able to take care of my baby when I'm doing my surgery because "he cries" and she's too uncomfortable. I literally have cancer. Like...what? She said she doesn't know how to build a relationship with him as she doesn't speak English and she doesn't think he likes her. I told her she needs to grow up and act like a caregiver (she won't feed or change his diaper) and not like a friend or grandma for fun she sees in the movies. So now I get to wake up in the hospital alone OR with a mother who doesn't understand shit as my husband is pacing the hotel with our toddler. I'm crushed. I'm so overwhelmed. She's like ready to move in, I mean she literally has nowhere else to go. I don't trust her with my baby after yesterday's shenanigans but most importantly I don't trust that I'll be happy again. My husband and I have build a calm life, we are best friends, and she literally just sits down and stares at us. I was up at 4am having coffee in my living room today and at breakfast she was like "did I see you in the living room this morning" and when I said yes she was like "but why were you sitting there?". I put on lotion and she goes "did you put on lotion? Wow" like wtf do you mean?! Ok rant over just a woman who's so overwhelmed I'm about to rip my hair out. W"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 455 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/

↳ **comment** (650): "She does not get to move in. Get her on waitlists for senior housing or speak to a social worker about how section 8 will go."

↳ **comment** (234): "Tell her no. She's been in the country 25 years, she's 61. I'm 61 and I've had lots of challenges. I figured them out. She can go back to Poland where the money she gets will go further. Just sit her down and say I'm sorry but I have to take care of myself and my family and you have to leave. If it breaks your relationship it breaks it and if she has nowhere to go that's her problem. I know this is harsh but you are currently in a life or death situation with breast cancer. You have your own life and your own kids to worry about and just be mean if you have to. This is something that all of us raised by these parents need to give ourselves permission to do. We have to give ourselves permission to stand up for ourselves even if it means we're going to feel guilty, even if it means they're going to be angry, even if it means they're going to tell relatives that we're awful towards them and abandon them. Too bad we're just going to have to live with that."

↳ **comment** (218): "THIS! THIS! THIS, OP! My mother only has social security and doesn't receive much more than your mother will. She lives in senior housing, and her rent is a percentage of her social security check - I think it's \$200 per month for a nice one-bedroom, one-bathroom apartment. The building itself is staffed 24/7 in case of emergencies. There's a rec room, a laundry room on each floor, and even a shuttle service that will take residents to appointments and stores for free. My mom was on a waiting list for about 6 months, but that was several years ago. Get your mom on those lists now if you can."

"How to deal with an aging parent's unrealistic demands. I am 61 (F) and my mother is 86 going on 87. Two years ago, after my father passed away, I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. She has a long list of medical issues and is reluctant to go into care. For the first year I was working from home and balancing her care and the house and my job. Early in 2025 I retired (I

took an early retirement offer from my employer) and pretty much immediately my mother's care became more complex. She's had a year of medical issues that I can't even begin to list as it's too long. But in the midst of all of that she saw my retirement as her opportunity to ask me to do all kinds of work around the house. Ok, I agreed to things within my capability like painting a room or doing some gardening work and minor repairs. But she's been bothering me to do more difficult things that (a) I don't have the knowledge to do and (b) are physically too demanding. She's been asking me to lift a bunch of patio slabs that are kind of shifting, refill and level the screening underneath and straighten them up. She mentions this **CONSTANTLY**. Even in the winter as something she wants done in the spring. We got a quote from someone and it would be close to \$1000 if not more based on the area she wants done. And she says she can't afford it. So I just keep saying no, I'm not doing it. And she keeps insisting "your father would do this; if I were younger and stronger like you I would do this, I used to do these things all the time." Finally, yesterday I had enough when she asked me about it again. I did not lose my temper. When she said "when I was your age I would have done this" I calmly reminded her that at my age she was on track to having her first open heart surgery so no she would not be doing this. Then she said "well your father would..." etc I reminded her that he had help from his friends and brothers most of whom are now too old or deceased. Then when she said well it would cost too much, I finally just said: "Well then, I guess they're going to just have to stay the way they are because I am not doing it and you don't have the money. People who don't have the money and can't do the work don't do it especially if it's not something critical." Like honestly it's all cosmetic at this point. She just doesn't like that they are shifting; nothing is a tripping hazard or anything but this is just one of many things she wants done which I just can not do. And it's a constant "but..." trying to shame me into being lazy and not competent and me saying "no...I'm not doing that; if you want it done we'll hire someone.""

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 362 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/

↳ **comment** (273): "I think they don't have enough going on in their lives so they persevere on this stuff. Also, they do lose track that not everyone who is younger than them has the strength of a 30 year old. 10 or so years ago my mom asked if my husband and his brothers could do some stuff she wanted done around her house, and I had to remind her that that entire crew was now in their mid-fifties and had bad backs! I like to remember that "No" is a full sentence."

↳ **comment** (155): "> I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. There's the problem. edited to add: I count six instances of "her" in that one sentence. It's going to stay all about *her* until you decide to prioritize your own needs and wants."

↳ **comment** (127): "The thing is - this is what's known as "assisted living". If mom can't manage her own care and care of the home (even if "care of the home" means hiring people to do maintenance tasks), then she is no longer living independently. Parents seem to think that adult children as caretakers don't count, and that they are still "independent"."

"Rethinking falls. About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they now have (and of course managing this is all on me). Of course multiple people, including myself, had told them they needed a stair lift, but they didn't listen, because it was "too expensive." So much of the advice around aging is around preventing falls. And yes, they should be prevented if you want to keep living. But – and this is cold – we keep acting as though we want elderly people to live forever, and then as a society we don't support them, or us the caregivers. Falls are terrible and painful and I wish my mom hadn't had one. But it should have been the end. The EMTs should've come and said oh, sweetheart, this is terrible, we are giving you morphine. It is utterly crazy that she was in the hospital for so

long and cost taxpayers well over \$1 million in Medicare, only to come home and require so much care and drain their finances and eventually go on Medicaid. I don't know what we do about this. When my mom fell, I felt like she almost subconsciously had done it on purpose. That summer she had been telling me how tired she was, and how she was ready to quit taking care of my dad, who is very demanding, and my disabled sibling (that's a whole other story). I was sure we were going to lose her and of course at the time I didn't want to but now I realize that would have been the natural thing. Figured you all would relate. I am not doing this to my kids."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 337 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

↳ **comment** (206): "This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

↳ **comment** (78): "My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

↳ **comment** (65): "Your poor mama. She is TIRED of dealing with your dad and sibling. The hospital, as awful as they can be, may have been a respite for her. Meals delivered. Her own bathroom. Mostly sweet staff. Poor you. You must be mentally exhausted on top of juggling THREE of them. The money drain is no lie. THREE DEPENDENTS in a two story house? How in the world? She's exhausted caregiving. She's probably been putting up with your difficult daddy with his demands all her life and you don't say when your sibling became disabled, but if it's been lifelong? Or since their 20's? That burns even saints out early. If they've qualified for Medicaid, can the house be sold and they go to skilled care or assisted senior living? Surely that would be cheaper than trying to maintain a home for three people needing 24 hour care."

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar

with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another

\$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"THIS! THIS! THIS, OP! My mother only has social security and doesn't receive much more than your mother will. She lives in senior housing, and her rent is a percentage of her social security check - I think it's \$200 per month for a nice one-bedroom, one-bathroom apartment. The building itself is staffed 24/7 in case of emergencies. There's a rec room, a laundry room on each floor, and even a shuttle service that will take residents to appointments and stores for free. My mom was on a waiting list for about 6 months, but that was several years ago. Get your mom on those lists now if you can."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 218 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/n9dak4t/

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking kilns, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement than means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that

runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!!!?" Seriously, I'm done. I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house (front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"Only Child—Outnumbered by 2 Aging Parents. I'm struggling, and I just don't know how to handle everything I'm supposed to handle. I'm 47, female, single, and an only child. My parents are 75, in declining health, and live 2 hours away. Financially, no one can move closer. I work full-time in a stressful job with 4 days a week mandated RTO, and my commute is over 2 hours a day. I've got chronic health issues I'm dealing with, plus trying to keep a house going. My parents haven't planned for their future and get mad when I try to bring anything up. They're dismissive. My parents are both frail and need help. They have someone who comes to clean periodically, but there's no one there for day to day stuff. My mom gets mad that I'm not there more often. I'm exhausted and sick, but I'm "selfish" for not taking time off work or coming more on weekends. I love them, but I'm upset they haven't and won't do anything to plan. They're struggling, but so am I. And I can't take care of them and me too. I have to keep my job and insurance. I can't afford to not work or to take unpaid leave. They don't want to hire caregivers,

and neither of them wants to go into assisted living. I feel like I'm not enough, no matter where I am. If I'm with them, I'm not much help. Drowning at work. Too exhausted to do much at my own house. I don't know what to do. I have to keep my job, and I feel like a bad daughter."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 193 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ue0xdc/only_childoutnumbered_by_2_aging_parents/

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play stardew valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many potholes and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Assisted living NOW. I am done. Looking for perspective and tips.. I've spent the last couple of months trying to figure out how to convince my parents to move to assisted living. Woke up this morning realizing that will never work, and they do not get a choice. Because of my relationship with them, especially my dad, I've been afraid of their reactions and his anger, but thanks to lots of therapy I finally am not. Mom is 90, Dad 92. They've lived in this house for 53 years. The house is too expensive to maintain and is falling apart with deferred maintenance. Both have cognitive decline--enough to be irrational and forget things but unfortunately not quite enough to move them and have them forget they ever had a home. My mother has 24/7 care at home right now after a very bad fall a year ago. They do not have the money to continue with this arrangement. My father has frankly always been a pain in the ass and is now much worse. The main thing that is beyond disgusting right now is that they have rats, and he *refuses* to put away dog and bird food in containers, and so the rats are literally living in the back hall. This actually gives me several options – I could call adult protective services, although I hear response is slow. I could possibly get his doctor to intervene. My mom is on hospice (Jimmy Carter hospice, not imminent death hospice) and I'm sure I could get the hospice team to say she needs to move . She will be the more adaptable of the two, even though my heart will break for her. If I move her, though, I'm not sure how to get him out. I have POA for both of them and my mother could probably be declared incompetent by the hospice team, but not my dad, although he has neurology appointments coming up. Sorry this is long... I am just sick of worrying about the house, the money, the rats, the refrigerator full of rotting food (my dad screams at the caregiver if she tries to clean anything up), the HVAC system that died and needs to be replaced, the roof, my dad never showering, him refusing to eat before 9 PM and apparently it's getting later and later... And on and on. Oh and also-- I live 1000 miles away. I am the only child (one sibling w IDD; I am his legal guardian , that's a whole other story). Thank you for any perspective or advice you can give, tricks to get them to move, anything at all! Edit: I am beyond blessed to have an care manager in their city who is my ride or die, so I do have boots on the ground. I'm going there in a couple of weeks and beginning to talk to places now to find availability, get on waiting list etc."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 148 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w0y12z/assisted_living_now_i_am_done_looking_for/

"I'd really like to know how to become selfish.....when I'm caring for a 92 year old father totally by myself, unpaid. I can't drive, family and friends don't offer to help and we can't afford outside help. I don't ask this sarcastically, but honestly. How does someone like myself who has literally no one else, become more selfish? After 4 years of this, 24/7, I'm going downhill fast."

youtube · @amg726 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 119 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgyYP0zEZlaNIJJYJ4AaABAg>

↳ **@CgColleenGorman** (33): "Dear soul, Theresa, Self-care, the most important thing you can do. Eat plants, focus on greens, fruits, juicing, fasting now and then even for just 24 hours, and stay far away from numbing devices such as news, social media (unless they are support groups) alcohol, junk food and processed foods and sugar. These things are key! I am caregiver to my elderly mother who has dementia after a lifetime of being a narcissistic charter, even worse, covert and plays victim. All while psychologically, emotionally, verbally and even physically abusing me. I still spare her reputation because of her own childhood trauma that created the monster that took over her body, as well as for my own karma, taking the high road because I know the truth and so does my co-creator. God. Get deeply in touch with your own feelings, your emotions and remind yourself daily you are a good human. Do gentle stretching and yoga. Do mindfulness work. Breathe.. Keep a gratitude journal, very important, and a separate journal to write your day to day "feelings", happenings and emotions. Be kind to yourself. Get in nature whenever possible, near trees, water, meditate or just slow down the inner dialog that can get the best of you, get close to wildlife, birds, raccoons, squirrels, rabbits, insects and join their world for a simple escape. Get a cat, or 3, if you can, they are truly healing little spirits and earth angels. Lastly: Focus on your most fondest dreams, hope and goals, no matter how impossible they seem, because all things are possible all of the time. Importantly, BELIEVE you deserve the best in life. Because you do. This isn't a curse to carry this huge burden and trying to keep dignity in tack. Just know that you were meant to live out this life lesson and

experience, as one that is making you stronger and and even better human than ever before. Look up Dr Joe Dispenza, Louise Hay and Dr Wayne Dyer to listen to words of inspiration. I wish you well. 🙏 "

↳ @amg726 (10): "@CgColleenGorman Thank you for your beautifully worded comment. I felt uplifted just reading it. It's people like you who give me a sense of hope. I will try your suggestions! (Although, I do have two cats and love them dearly). Thank you again!"

↳ @amg726 (7): "@Emily Welsh Thank you, Emily! I was journaling for awhile but have gotten away from it. I will give it another try. I am in an online caregiver support group but even that hasn't been helping much. Perhaps journaling will get me in touch with my feelings again. Hugs and thank you for the prayers!"

"What to do when you don't want to or can't be the caregiver?. Mom is getting to the point she is going to need more care and I live in fear that I'm going to be forced to take care of her. I know that probably sounds awful but she's very controlling, manipulative, and self centered and after living my life for 4 decades to please her and nearly losing my wife and kiddo because of her I know I can't do it. Mentally or physically. There's already been several hints from her saying she's moving on with us, she's tried claiming dibs on certain rooms in our house talked about how she's going to redecorate our home to her liking and I'm going to be honest my wife said if I move my mom in she is leaving same day. But then there is the problem of I also can't afford to fund an assisted living facility or in home care for her, like the money just isn't there and I couldn't work more to make up for it as I'm already working more than full-time. So what do I do?? Medicare doesn't cover assisted living or in home care, she has spent through her 401k, she's up to her eyeballs in debt from spending non stop, she has no other family but me. I've called council on aging and elder care many times and literally never get a call back from anyone. I'm in Florida."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 109 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t86ufb/what_to_do_when_you_dont_want_to_or_cant_be_the/

"Finally lost my cool on my mom's nursing home roommate. For context, my mother is young for a nursing home. She has primary progressive MS and has been paralyzed since I was 4, quadraplegic since I was 10. I have helped to feed, clothe, take her to the bathroom, change tampons, be a human remote, etc. etc. since I was that young. I am now in my late thirties and in my early 30s we had no choice but to move her into assisted care because she requires 24/7 effort. She has little to no voice anymore either. This week was particularly difficult because I have been solo parenting my newly defiant toddler, and I had the stomach flu. I have very little caregiving support from my father who refuses to retire because he has been awful with money, and hence why my mom is in a medicare bed and not private pay (though we have to pay out of pocket like 1k a month.) My mom likes when I bring my 2.5 year old; it brings her joy. One thing she really likes to do is share her dinner with my daughter. She orders a separate PB&J for her, and usually the things my mom doesn't eat, my daughter will eat. My mom has severely disordered eating from the MS, and has to eat things in specific ways, and is extremely controlling. I have figured out that if the kid is eating, and I can feed my mom then it's a fine balance of time, but I am essentially a proxy human for two beings. My mom's roommate clearly some issues in addition to whatever her physical ailments are. She is large, bedridden, and just a SEE YOU NEXT TUESDAY. She loudly complains to her aids about me, and that they need to watch me and she doesn't like me. I have never said anything. Until today. Finally I stepped on the other side of the curtain when I heard her complaining about how I feed my daughter. She is convinced that I steal my mom's food to feed my daughter and that she is actually "looking out" for my mom. I lost it. My mom is alive because of me. Because of the many sacrifices I have made in my life to literally be her arms, legs, her voice, to make sure she is fed, to advocate for her. When random agency aid's came to our house they would steal money, jewelry, you name it, because I was a little kid, I couldn't do a single thing about it. But at the end of the day, I was constantly there for my mom. This lady struck my last nerve, after an incredibly difficult week where there was absolutely no one to look after me, or my health. I didn't swear at her or anything, and still tried to come from a

place of empathy, but I still told her to mind her own business and respect me because she does not actually know what is happening. It was just so extremely disheartening. After everything I have done, that I still do, there is just nothing for me. There have been so many things that have beaten me down this year, I just feel like this the last thing. At the end of the day, I know I am lucky to be able bodied, to have my faculties, to be employed, to go home to a warm bed, with needy but loving animals and kid who is growing healthily and happily (despite being in a particularly whiney phase). She brings my mom joy, so I am going to keep going. Anyway, if you've made it this far. Thanks for listening. Trying to find empathy for others, but myself as well. But truth be told. I am fucking over it. I am just so goddamn over this disease and the absolute havoc it has wreaked on my life and my family's lives. It is unyielding."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1rs72w0/finally_lost_my_cool_on_my_moms_nursing_home/

"Found a place for Mom, with not much money and without Medicaid.. Hopefully this will help someone and give some hope. I can't be my Mom's caregiver being an only child, with young kids and work and my own issues. Told her rehabilitation facility no safe discharge. Did not budge. They of course want her out asap so they were forced to contact a placement coordinator. Placement coordinator is contacted by the social worker and then try call me. I told him the budget my Mom had(she lives of SS and not much!) And hoped for the best. He found a place that a lady owns and she worked with me and based off the circumstances cut my Mom a deal and is using her SS check for monthly rent at this place. Which does cover 24/7 care and food. Hospice will follow her there for added comfort and care. So it is possible to find a place. It might not be a 5 star 5 grand a month resort, but my Mom hasn't got long to live and this place does have great reviews as well. The placement coordinator has a lot of relationships with places that often take people if that can't afford much. She's being discharged today to this place and hospice is meeting me to go over everything. It's a lot of stress, over all Its one hurdle I don't have to worry about. You shouldn't have to feel guilty for not being able to take care of your parent. Not everyone can and they're all valid reasons. People who judge are projecting and often times have the financial means to hire people and not have to work. But not everyone has that luxury. I hope this helps at least one person. It can be done. I am thinking of everyone during these stressful times. It's ok to not be ok. Update: this place is awesome! It's like a house but with a about 15 bedrooms with closets and own bathroom and there's a kitchen and it's very clean and has a rec room. It's probably like an adult foster home? But with a bit more care. The nurses are so nice. I feel beyond happy this is where she'll be. Don't give up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1aqo1wy/found_a_place_for_mom_with_not_much_money_and/

"20 interventions with real human evidence. I've spent the last several months doing deep research into what can actually be done for my mother (74F, MCI due to AD, CDR 0.5, MMSE 28-30). She also has cerebral amyloid angiopathy (CAA), which means she can't take any of the anti-amyloid antibody drugs (lecanemab, donanemab) and is excluded from most clinical trials because of her MRI findings (microbleeds and superficial siderosis). So I had to look beyond the headline drugs and trials and find everything else with real evidence behind it. This isn't medical advice. I'm not a doctor. But I've read the trials, talked to specialists at Brigham and Women's, MGH, and Yale, and built a protocol with their input. I'm sharing it because I wish someone had handed me this list when we got the diagnosis. **One important note:** Because my mother has CAA (cerebral amyloid angiopathy) with microbleeds and superficial siderosis, everything in this protocol has been filtered for bleed safety. That means I may have excluded interventions that are perfectly appropriate for someone without CAA. If your loved one doesn't have CAA or cerebrovascular disease, there may be additional options available to them that I haven't included here. Always check with their neurologist. Everything below is something you can do without a clinical trial, most of it without a prescription, and all of it with published evidence in humans (not just mice). Organized roughly by impact. **Disease modification vs symptom treatment:** Most Alzheimer's drugs just treat symptoms. They might improve cognition temporarily but the disease keeps progressing underneath. Disease

modification means actually slowing or stopping the underlying pathology: amyloid accumulation, tau spreading, neuroinflammation, brain atrophy. That's what this list focuses on. I've tried to be honest about which interventions have disease-modifying evidence (biomarker changes, atrophy reduction, slowed conversion to dementia) vs which ones just improve symptoms or have only mechanistic rationale. Both matter, but they're not the same thing. # TIER 1: The non-negotiables

1. Fix their hearing This might be the most important thing on this list. The Lancet Commission ranks hearing loss as the #1 modifiable risk factor for dementia (~8% of attributable risk). The ACHIEVE trial (2023) showed hearing aids slowed cognitive decline by 48% in at-risk older adults over 3 years. Why: when the brain is working overtime to hear, it's stealing processing power from memory and cognition. That tax compounds every day. A 48% reduction in the rate of cognitive decline over 3 years is disease-modifying-level impact. The Lancet Commission also cites evidence that untreated hearing loss is associated with accelerated brain atrophy, particularly in the temporal lobe. What to do: Get an audiogram. If there's any hearing loss, get hearing aids. Costco is the best value - \$1,499-1,699 per pair for the same technology that costs \$4,000-6,000 at private audiologists. Get rechargeable ones with Bluetooth so they can stream music (see below). Don't let them say "my hearing is fine" - high-frequency hearing loss is invisible to the person experiencing it. They're missing consonant sounds and compensating without realizing it.

2. Test and treat sleep apnea Untreated sleep apnea may be one of the most damaging things that can happen to an Alzheimer's brain. During deep sleep, the glymphatic system clears amyloid and metabolic waste from the brain. Sleep apnea disrupts deep sleep and causes intermittent oxygen deprivation. Years of untreated apnea means years of impaired amyloid clearance. What to do: Get a sleep study. If they had one years ago and were told it resolved, retest. If they have apnea, CPAP compliance is critical - this is not optional. Even mild untreated apnea accelerates amyloid accumulation. The disease-modifying case: longitudinal PET imaging studies show that people with untreated sleep apnea have significantly faster amyloid accumulation over time compared to controls. CPAP treatment in the ADNI cohort was associated with slower cognitive decline and delayed age of MCI onset by approximately 10 years. Intermittent hypoxia also damages cerebral microvasculature, which is directly relevant to anyone with or at risk for CAA.

3. Aerobic exercise - 150-300 minutes per week Consistently one of the strongest interventions in the literature. Exercise increases BDNF (brain-derived neurotrophic factor), improves blood flow to the brain, and reduces neuroinflammation. It doesn't need to be intense. Steady moderate exercise (walking, stationary bike, swimming) beats occasional hard workouts. The disease-modifying case: the FINGER trial included aerobic exercise as a core component and showed sustained cognitive benefit. Multiple imaging studies show that aerobic exercise slows hippocampal atrophy in MCI patients. Erickson et al. (2011, PNAS) showed that 1 year of aerobic exercise actually increased hippocampal volume by 2%, effectively reversing 1-2 years of age-related loss. The ADEX trial showed 16 weeks of moderate-to-high intensity exercise reduced neuropsychiatric symptoms and showed trends toward slower cognitive decline in AD patients. Exercise also reduces neuroinflammation (measured by reduced inflammatory cytokines in CSF) and improves cerebrovascular function, which directly affects amyloid clearance. This is as close to proven disease modification as any non-drug intervention gets. What to do: 30 minutes of moderate aerobic exercise, 5-7 days a week. A stationary recumbent bike is ideal for people with balance issues. Walking counts. The key is consistency - every day matters more than any single session. If they have CAA or are on blood thinners: avoid anything with fall risk. A fall causing a head impact in someone with cerebral microbleeds could be catastrophic. Stationary equipment is safer than outdoor walking on uneven surfaces.

4. Strength training - 2x per week The SMART trial (Mavros 2017, JAMA) is the big one here. High-intensity progressive resistance training (80% of 1-rep max, 2x/week for 6 months) significantly improved cognition in MCI patients, and the gains were still there at 18-month follow-up. The cognitive improvement correlated directly with strength gains. The more they got stronger, the more their cognition improved. The mechanism is likely BDNF release, which requires high enough intensity to trigger it. This means strength training isn't just maintenance. At the right intensity, it's a disease modifier. What to do: Sit-to-stand from a chair (no hands), wall pushups, light dumbbell work (5-10 lbs), heel raises, tandem stance holds for balance. 2 sessions per week. Keep it functional. If your loved one does NOT have CAA or cerebral microbleeds, talk to their doctor about progressive overload toward heavier resistance. That's where the strongest

cognitive data is. Important for CAA patients: No heavy lifting, no breath-holding during exertion (Valsalva maneuver), no planks or sustained isometric holds that work muscles (wall sits, plank holds, static squat holds, etc.). Isometric contractions cause progressive blood pressure elevation throughout the hold. Sustained contraction can push systolic BP dangerously high, which is exactly what you need to avoid with cerebral microbleeds. Keep breathing, keep moving, never strain to failure. Cap weights at ~10 lbs without neurologist clearance. Balance holds (like tandem stance) are fine. Those are neurological training, not muscle loading. The unfortunate reality is that the intensity level that produced the strongest cognitive results in SMART is the intensity level that's unsafe with CAA. Lighter work is still valuable for balance, function, and fall prevention, but probably doesn't hit the BDNF threshold that made SMART so impressive. **5. Blood pressure management** This is especially critical if they have any cerebrovascular disease or CAA, but it matters for all AD patients. It's not just average BP that matters. Spikes from stress, exertion, or straining are a risk factor for hemorrhage on their own. The disease-modifying case: SPRINT-MIND (2019, JAMA) showed that intensive systolic BP control (<120 mmHg) significantly reduced the risk of MCI and slowed white matter lesion progression on MRI. Observational data from ADNI shows that midlife hypertension is associated with greater amyloid deposition on PET. BP management doesn't just prevent strokes. It directly affects the rate of AD pathology accumulation. What to do: Buy a home BP monitor. Log readings 2-3x daily for at least a week. Bring the log to your doctor. Target generally is <130 systolic for most AD patients, but ask your neurologist for a specific target. Avoid high-sodium foods. Manage constipation (straining causes BP spikes). If they're on BP medication, make sure it's not dropping them too low - orthostatic hypotension (dizziness on standing) is a major fall risk"

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rmqcpw/20_interventions_with_real_human_evidence/

"Impossible-to-please mother wants to live with me. A year ago, I helped my mom move to my state to live near me. She was living near my brother, but her incessant requests that he drop everything for her were driving him crazy and he needed her to go. I had her move here to give his mental health a break. She lives in an independent living facility about four blocks from my house. The location is perfect because I can get to her quickly and more frequently than I'd otherwise be able to, and I can stop at the store for her on the way over. But she keeps pushing to live with me and my husband, which is not a good idea. It's mostly because she doesn't like the food there. (Her apartment has a kitchen and she cooks her own stuff most of the time.) My mother is intrusive and oblivious. She doesn't understand basic human interaction rules (it's like she fits the definition of autism in this respect), which means she is constantly saying inappropriate things -- insulting us, or hurting my feelings. If she isn't getting her way, she can get nasty very quickly to where it feels like it's coming out of left field. Her own mother drove her crazy (and her mother was a nice person). She refused to let my grandmother live with her and my dad because she knew she wouldn't be able to stand it. And she swore up and down she would never be a burden to me or my brother. Now, here she is, wanting to live with me. The biggest problem here is that my mom is incapable of being happy. Everything is always terrible where she lives. Any house she's ever lived in is "always falling apart." When I was growing up, it was always my dad's fault for buying the wrong house or not repairing something fast enough. After my dad died, it was my brother's fault for living 3.5 hours away and not being able to come over and change a light bulb instantly. It's like the woman has no concept of how to locate and book with a service provider of any kind. When you suggest she call a handyman, she gets pissed off because she thinks we should do everything for her; that she shouldn't have to pay a handyman. Never mind the fact that she always told us that we "owe her nothing." I lost count of the number of times she complained about her own parents keeping score, swearing that anything she did for my brother and I came without strings attached. I believed her. She moved closer to my brother so he could help her more, but it wasn't enough for her. She complained constantly about the house she bought and how she'd "overpaid" for it. She had the backyard relandscaped and then killed half of it because she couldn't be bothered to water it (even though she had a programmable system and I had created a custom instruction manual for her). Every time something happened at the house -- AC out, broken water heater, roof repairs needed -- my brother had to handle it all for her. She acts like she's completely helpless. And every one of

those incidents was the end of the world -- her crying and asking "Why does this always happen to me?" as though no other homeowner in the history of the universe has to deal with repairs. So we all decided that she couldn't handle owning a home; that independent living was the way to go because she could just pay one bill and not have to worry about anything. She's had that for a year now, and all I hear are complaints. Texas was better; her house was better -- she's forgotten all the complaints she had about it. That's how it's always been with her, though. She hates a place until she leaves it. Then, the old place was heavenly and the new place sucks. I don't want her living with me because not only will she annoy the crap out of me, she will be unhappy! I don't want to have to listen to, "I should have stayed where I was. At least I had X and Y." (And I don't want to help her move yet again! The woman's a hoarder, for one thing.) Also, I love my house and planned to stay here. It's not big enough for her to move into, though. We'd have to move to a bigger place, which costs money, and it would mean that someday, I'd be old and stuck with more house than I can handle and NO ONE to help me deal with it. I've told her that, and she doesn't seem to care. I can't figure out how to get her to understand this and stop asking for it. Just when I think we're all clear on how our relationship works, she gets clingy again and starts crying and saying she wants to live with me. I'm going to school full time right now. I'm almost 60 and will be starting a new career, and not by choice. And I have relationship problems as well. I can't handle her b.s. on top of all of this. I love the mother she was when I was growing up, but I don't like the person she is now. If I worked with her, she would be someone I would avoid. But I don't want her to get all dramatic and start crying and saying she's moving back to Texas. She can't afford the move, and Texas is NOT big enough for both her and my brother to live there. We looked into independent living places there, and none of them had kitchens. That was a no-go. She can't buy another home. So WTF can she do but stay where she is? I'm just so sick of the crying and her being miserable. Yes, she's on antidepressants and sees a counselor. I've told her she's the common denominator everywhere she goes, and that she has to figure out why she can't be happy before she can even think about moving anywhere else. Aside from that advice, I don't know what else to do or offer her."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 93 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1unvxnd/impossibletoplease_mother_wants_to_live_with_me/

"God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 83 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/ohw9pdk/

"What do you do for death arrangements with no money?. I got the call last week that my dad's dementia is far advanced and his prognosis is 6 months at best. Got him set up with hospice care, and one of the questions they asked is if there was a funeral home we wanted to use. I said we couldn't afford one, so she researched some option that are more affordable, coming out in the \$1,000-\$1,500 range. Thing is, I can't afford even that. I currently have \$5 in my account, and I've been paycheck to paycheck my whole life. All my dad's money has been eaten up by his care and the remaining social security pays for his nursing home (apart from \$60 per month, which is obviously not nearly enough). I literally haven't been able to see him in a month because I can't afford the

gas needed to get there. He also does not have life insurance. What do I do when the time passes? He has explicitly told me he did not care about having a funeral, so my intention was always just to have a less formal celebration of life at a friend's house, but are there options available to not have to spend any money upon his passing, since I do not have money to spend?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 73 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sy5h1z/what_do_you_do_for_death_arrangements_with_no/

↳ **comment** (158): "My grandmother donated her body to a medical college where students could learn by working on cadavers. Once her use was fulfilled, the college had her cremated at no charge and gave my mom her ashes. No cost."

↳ **comment** (70): "Tell the hospice that those costs are completely out of reach. They should have a social worker or case manager to discuss what resources there are . If they left the convo at that \$1500-imo that's a bit lazy. Like cremation being most affordable. If he's a veteran, there are some reimbursement options (but not a check that VA will proactively cut). If there's any county indigent burial funds (even tho you aren't trying to bury him). Sometimes hospices have a foundation to try to help defray some cost. Otherwise when someone can't afford anything at all - technically the county/city may have an unclaimed body option where they'll cremate and spread ashes It may also mean asking local charities and/or churches. If your dad was in any social groups, it's worth asking. If you're comfortable with it, a gift of body program might also be an option. Source: used to be a hospice social worker"

↳ **comment** (40): "My father did this also. We spread his ashes a year or so after his death."

"Things my grandma said to me last night that hurt. She demanded, "If you're gonna stay here you should at least be PLEASANT" Then she said, "I don't even care if you're here or not" It SUCKS to be doing the jobs of 5 people and be scoffed and laughed at when i try to explain how much i do for her. "You don't even do that much, you just sit here and waste away" I'M WASTING AWAY BECAUSE I CAN'T FUCKING GO ANYWHERE BECAUSE IF I LEAVE THE HOUSE YOU'LL BE STUCK WITHOUT ANYONE TO HELP IN AN EMERGENCY I'M WASTING AWAY BECAUSE NO ONE HIRES ANYONE WITH A 5+ YEAR JOB GAP I'M WASTING AWAY BECAUSE YOU'RE NOT PAYING ME AND I CAN'T AFFORD TO FUCKING DO ANYTHING, I want to SCREAM. MY FAMILY doesn't understand how physically and emotionally demanding this is. Everyone loves to pretend I just sit on my ass and play games all day. NO. I'm either helping grandma or I'm laying in bed recovering because i am chronically ill. It SUCKS to be so burnt out I can't hide it anymore. They only care to notice when your burnout affects them, when you're too exhausted to be nice and "pleasant." No one wanted to help me when I was "pleasant" but now that I can't pretend to be "pleasant" anymore all they do is complain that I'm a bitch now and wonder what happened. YOU WATCHED ME DETERIORATE AND BEG FOR HELP FOR SIX YEARS. Well it takes a lot of energy to pretend to be all happy and nice when you're breaking your fucking back lifting and moving everything, cooking, cleaning, caring for their pets, gardening for them, washing their fucking clothes and dishes, getting them into bed and taking them to every social and doctor appointment. I can't pretend to be pleasant anymore when I'm around people who hate everything, hate everyone, who hate ME and ignore my concerns and use me because I'm convenient"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vi926s/things_my_grandma_said_to_me_last_night_that_hurt/

↳ **comment** (18): "I feel your pain, this is very similar to the last 4-5 years of my life caregiving for my 84 yr old father, eventually I had to put my foot down and force some changes regardless of others opinions, my own mental health and well being were starting to turn severely dark, it was pretty much survival mode kicking in. Last time I spoke with a relative after a disagreement over my current situation they had the audacity to say "He asks so little of you."So yes I understand completely where you're coming from."

↳ **comment** (13): "Leave, as soon as possible. She doesn't appreciate you and Never will. Start saving money and make a plan and get out of that Hell and never look back. Notify your family that someone Else will need to step in and take her shit 2 weeks before you plan to leave. Her type is Ungrateful and Hateful and they Enjoy making others Miserable. And family rarely helps You or her I'm sure, and all they'll do is disregard all your help too. Get out of there and Enjoy your Life 🌹 don't sacrifice your mental & physical health for her or anyone that doesn't acknowledge or appreciate it."

↳ **comment** (12): "I could've typed this word for word. I'm in the exact same place. It's like screaming into a void and nobody hears or sees you. Nobody seems remotely fazed. It's a form of psychological torture. I see and hear you. I'm talking to Google AI because there's no one who cares. There's no reassurance or comfort. Everything feels heavy. I'm so sorry 🧑 "

The agency office: communication, billing · 220 documents

20 most engaged of 220 matching documents, complete text.

"Day 3, my prayers were heard.. I swear some nurses are angels in disguise. For now, it's over... and I can finally breathe, shower, clean, whatever I need. My mom had a visiting nurse stop by today and I took that opportunity to tell her about the condition of the house and how there is no one to be there 24/7. She listened and reported it to the social worker. The social worker and the nurse called an ambulance and EMTs took her to a hospital. For the night at least, I can finally breathe. My alcoholic uncle is going off to rehab in another state on Monday. Now it is just me and my cousin and the animals here. I finally have peace for now. I actually laughed today. EDIT: update 9/20: The doctors at this new hospital were horrified with her treatment at the last hospital and she will NOT be coming home this time. She is going to a subacute rehab and will never return home. We are now suing the last hospital for medical malpractice."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 225 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfiyw/day_3_my_prayers_were_heard/

"So Angry at My Dad. My 95 yr old father DROVE 5 days after being admitted to ER observation overnight because he fell in a parking lot ... he also dragged my mother down to the ground when he fell. I moved from another state to help them as they age and they never called to tell me until day AFTER they fell. Lots of bruising, pain/aches, immobility etc but neither of them broke anything but we discussed that he would not be driving until he goes to dr for follow- up. He can't put weight on his right leg. And he drove. My mother lied to me about it. (He lies so often that I'm used to it.) On thanksgiving when I told him he can't drive again until his follow-up appt in 5 days he started to lash out and asked me to leave Thanksgiving. As in get out of the house. I left. I had zero alcohol. Planned what I was going to stay and was very calm. Doesn't matter. He just lost it. I really regret moving back as these two are impossible. I know I have to deal with them but I am so angry at their refusal to listen to common sense, not telling me they were both in ER when I loved back FOR THIS REASON, how he hurt my mother because he refuses to use a cane or walker, and the lies. And the verbal abuse. Oh and how he might hit an innocent person and ruin someone's life, or take someone's life. How do I not be angry when they are so challenging and impossible. He has always been a full-on jerk but getting worse now. I know I don't deserve being yelled at and eating Thanksgiving dinner in a diner alone. I have read a ton about dealing with narcissistic people but I am still so angry. HOW am I supposed to handle them? My sister is In another state. There is no one else here to help. He has alienated other family and not a big family in the first place."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 178 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p9fn38/so_angry_at_my_dad/

"I wrote my very similar story below. I was never an angry or assertive person. I'm timid and a people pleaser and overachiever, but there came a moment that I got angrier than I'd ever been in my life (at around 55yrs old) with my father and finally stood up to him. I suggest you do the same. You deserve better and need to be assertive and set YOUR boundaries. Think seriously about not taking him to his drs appointment. Either just cancel it yourself and don't show up at his place or make him be the one to cancel it. It's probably best to let him know you heard his comments and telling him that things will be different going forward (setting boundaries) because you're upset with him and consider going no contact with him at least for a while. If confronting him is too hard (I get that), have your sister tell him and just make yourself unavailable. Unless you get an apology, you do you with your own family. My story below. It felt good to write it, but I'm fine if you skip it. I can relate so much to this. My father was always negative and controlling. When I was 55yrs old +, and he was 85+ he would still yell at me like a bad child for ridiculous reasons when I would drive 3 hrs to help him and my mother with dementia with different things. I thought that it was that he thought I was going to take control so he was asserting his. I never talked back or argued with him my whole life. I just took it as did my mom. Then he got upset with me because I put a bottle of Pepsi and a bottle of Fiji water in the refrigerator...for THEM because I thought their power was out from bad

storms and it was 93 degrees. “We don’t need all these things in the refrigerator.” (There was very little in it.) And I snapped and screamed at him. I only had the nerve to do that because I was already packed up to leave their house and I knew my mother wouldn’t be upset. I taught middle school so I could do overly dramatic loud yelling. I said that he was ruining my mental health which was true. I had started anxiety and depression meds all because of him and the situation, and I lived 3hrs away. I was just outside the door I slammed (another first for me) and went back in and said, “This is the last thing I’m ever going to say to you. OTHER PEOPLE HAVE FEELINGS TOO. I’m done with how you treat me. When you need help, and you will, call your son. I’m done. You have made me very upset and now I have a lot of time driving ahead of me.” And as I drove back home, I was upset but also felt the anxiety of “walking on eggshells” with him my whole life suddenly lift. I called my brother, who lives 6 hrs away and was still working while I had retired already, and I told him I was now estranged from our dad so he needed to be ready if Dad called. He said “okay, I understand” and I felt totally free. I did not call at Christmas or birthdays nor send gifts (my mother wasn’t aware of holidays or even who I was) and he called and said “We’re worried about you” on my voicemail like nothing had happened. If I got a serious apology from him I would have softened, but that never happened. It felt good to not answer his calls (knowing he could call my brother for help) and knowing I had set a boundary with him that I should have set years earlier. I was still estranged from him when he died, and I don’t feel the least bit bad about it or grief that he was dead. In fact, that was a relief too.”

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 171 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ttfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op30xw5/

"It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients" cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception thst the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 137 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/nitak0s/

"May have reached the end at home care, as many before (REALLY LONG). It's 3:53 AM. Laying in bed, wide awake, after finding my spouse sitting on the front room couch, with all the house lights blazing. I asked her what's going on, she said I don't why I'm here. I managed to get her to our former bedroom, kick off her shoes, and back into bed, fully clothed, as usual. Trying to get her into pajama bottoms can lead to conflict, and best let that sleeping dog lie. I had a nervous breakdown in January. While not a medical term, it is pretty good for encompassing the myriad symptoms and conditions that reduce you from a motivated fairly capable person to being frozen in place, like a insect trapped in amber. Spilled my guts to my doctor(how they repeatedly deal with this, don't know, perhaps proffesional training). She spoke frankly to me. As a result, got help. Two days a week, 10-4. After 3 weeks, already going to 3 days a week. Also, and more importantly, she put me on Zoloft. After 8 days, viola, racing thoughts largely disappeared. After 6 weeks, really feeling better, my sense of purpose returned to my old self, started getting things shipshape and Bristol fashion, as sailors say. With coverage, I managed to get some important things done. Some house stuff, grocery shopping. Going grocery shopping with a 5 year old is gone, some car maintenance. Got a gardener for the front, and put the pool back to normal. I still want to do that, it's easy, and lets me retain some semblance of control and self worth. Taco Exxpress, chicken tacos and a Mexican coke in a bottle, eaten while parked in a little private area behind Lowe's, listening to NPR. She no longer eats nutritional food. Our long term favorite restaurant is no longer an option. The staff there was well aware of her condition, and went out of their way to accommodate. Some were former students of my wife. So, back on an even keel. Yesterday was a good day. She awoke, pills and juice, coffee yogurt and berries, GMA. A quick shower for me, 10 minutes alone for her is max. Time to clean her up. Home aide, who is wonderful, gets her to shower. With me, won't do it, can turn contentious. So, check outfit, usually a new tshirt. Remove old one, sponge bath with warm washcloth. deodorant, new tee. Sonicare, Water pik, each time like the first time. I have become more kindly,

caring, and gentle, and willingly do all this stuff without much complaint. A walk (more and more, slower and shorter) at the marina with the dog(always a pal, Penny, good dog!) then a routine of carefully offered small bites and liquids, variety shows on TV , KC show a good one. Dinner time for me, then game shows and comedy till bed, one glass of wine. After clean up, will often find myself bent over with my hands on my knees, pretty much done in. But no rest for the wicked. A structured routine, she is safe, clean, and comfortable. If you accomplished that, you have done your duty. Except. With my return to clear thinking and a grasp of what's going on and the future, comes the realization that I'm probably not going to be able to do this anymore. Even with home aides, which come with a pricy invoice. My last test showed me progressing into CKD stage 3b, probably due to hydration issues during my falling down period. hoping it's an outlier. I often will instantaneously fall asleep, to awake 20 minutes later, totally unaware of anything. I am still exhausted. The house is a locked compound, 7 ring cameras, locked side gates, and the front door is always locked. At, night, even more secure. She will not elope. Going for blood test Monday, fingers crossed. After results, going to contact my doctor, and discuss a referral to the appropriate specialist who hopefully can guide me through. I'm hoping Kaiser has such a thing, otherwise there are other agencies that provide help. Whew. that's a lot to digest. I find that just writing this down is a way to focus my mind, and also kind of a catharsis. If you are in this situation, I recommend trying it. No one on this group will criticize, most responses are caring, supportive, and might get some helpful input. Sometimes I'll write something, and not post it, just the act of putting pen to paper is enough. My home aide has showed me some pretty effective strategies, and always nice to have a partner in crime. I am one of many who have willingly accepted this one way ticket on the road to decline of a loved one. I wish everyone the best outcome with dealing with this terrible disease, it apparently is often mostly an individual effort, even with help."

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rh3ff3/may_have_reached_the_end_at_home_care_as_many/

↳ **comment** (21): "Please choose your health. I understand. Take care."

↳ **comment** (21): "Just about to put my spouse in Long term care, believe me I feel your pain. The decision finally arrived when I realized that truthfully she's killing me. No sleep, constant care 7 by 24 the situation is just unbearable and no one alone can do this long term. Hang in there the best you can then get the help that you need. ALZ just completely sucks"

↳ **comment** (14): "> With my return to clear thinking and a grasp of what's going on and the future, comes the realization that I'm probably not going to be able to do this anymore. When you think you can't do it any more, you're right. Especially with a serious illness yourself, you rightly recognized that you cannot care for two people any more. Dementia only gets worse. I've never seen anybody in this group say "We put our loved one into dementia care too soon." I've seen lots of people say "We should have done it earlier.""

"DONE!. Just need to vent. I've posted before on this forum, but it's been awhile. My brother and I are only siblings. Mom spent almost 2 years in the nursing home, with a year and a half on PRIVATE PAY, thanks to my brother, who lived with her and was "supposedly" taking care of her. He took care of Dad and Mom ALL THEIR lives, not because they needed him all those years, but because he needed them. They supported him completely and he bought expensive items with his own money (found out later, PLUS some) on a disability check after working 7 years total, at menial jobs. Our mom did everything for him, even washed his hair! She thought the ground he walked on was holy. Anyway, he ended up basically mooching off them all his life, under the pretext of "taking care" of them. Dad passed away almost 20 years ago. Mom lived to be 102, passed last fall. Just suffice it to say that hoarding was a nice (although nowhere near accurate) description of what he did. He basically piled up TWO houses, ruining them BOTH in the process and causing the tax assessed value to drop to 1/3 of the original value. He basically didn't want to do anything I suggested to get the estate deeded to him legally because he was simply too lazy. The second house caused a real problem with her Medicaid eligibility (which my husband and I had tried to discuss with Mom 10-15 years ago, after Dad passed). I said Brother could have it all, I didn't want

anything. He ended up ruining Mom financially, and as you can tell from the tax reassessment I had done, wrecked the entire place. I tried reporting to APS, but they never even went inside, and seemed fine with empty beer cans and junkers (8 of those) scattered across the back yard). I eventually had to take over everything to fix her over-drafted bank accounts (with my own funds) and close them out...that even made Bro mad. I eventually just took over because he was lying and hiding bills and letters, almost got Mom evicted for her private pay not being paid...nursing home billing office manager called me, which was the first I was aware. Bro didn't want to deal with the mess he had made, which ended up being dumped on me and my husband...trying to clear out the houses to salvage what we could (FOR my Bro) because once Mom ran out of money, he ran out of money, so he managed to get admitted to the nursing home for leg issues from a car accident in his 20's (he refused all doctor visits for 40 years)...he then said he couldn't walk one night. Since he lived with Mom, even that almost messed up her Medicaid. But eventually I got her Medicaid approved, then she passed two months later. The proceeds from the estate went toward her private pay bill, which did not even cover all of it because Bro hid his head in the sand for all that time, lied, etc. Anyway, he got mad at me about 4 months ago and cursed at me in a text. I ignored it but all he would ever talk about in his texts was the young female aides, and the personal intimate care they were giving him, and he refuses to allow male aides to care for him. I finally told him I really didn't want to hear all that "drama"...I did not feel it appropriate. Never once did he text without going into those sorts of details. He mentioned his showers and his underwear and "wetting" himself every single text. We found porn tapes hidden while salvaging his possessions for him. He has a fake FB page that popped up (he didn't even change his name!) with erotic pictures of young female nurses and teachers. He has a history of ...obsession, I'll call it. Previously on his FB page, he said he was in a relationship with someone he had obviously met on the internet. He has done everything within his power to report the older female staff and asked for the younger ones to replace them for his personal care. Now let me say that he has been having chest pain and high BP, yet what he got mad about was I mentioned seeing OTC testosterone supplements peeking out his bedside table one day...when they told him he wasn't supposed to be taking them, they said that I had "reported" it. So he got very angry. I said, "Fine, let him have an MI. See if I care." I will also add that he has NEVER, to my knowledge, had a normal relationship, never been married, is 73 years old, slow mentally, and is a nursing home resident! He texted 3 weeks or so ago and said he has lung cancer. He had had a CT scan during an ER visit for high BP and chest pain, and supposedly the hospital had sent him a letter informing him he has lung cancer. Concerned, I drove up to the nursing home that evening. I know that is not the process for patient notification. He showed me the letter and it said he had a couple of nodules that showed up, but most are benign, and his PCP may want to follow up. He argued with me that that meant he has cancer. He also said the nurse had told him he has a huge mass in his stomach. He finally gave me permission to speak with the nurse...I have a healthcare background. The nurse couldn't believe he said that...she said she had explained what "benign" means and had explained the follow-up process to him, and told him his stomach is fine...no mass was even mentioned. So I tried to explain to him, but couldn't tell if he understood. I sent him a text that evening from home explaining it simply and told him if he has questions, he can ask the nurse or me. Nothing from him. So I said, "Or maybe you want me to butt out". Nothing. He hasn't spoken to me in weeks. And he never answered me. He cussed me out one time lately in a text over the testosterone supplement so I just left him alone to chill for awhile. Next thing he texted, "Can you bring my computer"...the one still in the unopened box he ordered two years ago that we salvaged for him from the piles of hoarded stuff. I took it to him, with his mail that he still gets at Mom's PO box. He accused me of not caring anything about him. I said he hadn't answered me. Oh, I was supposed to know that his "phone isn't working" and I should have called and asked the nurse to bring him the phone from the desk. WHAT? How was I supposed to know his phone "isn't working" (which I think is a lie) because he said the typos were due to his phone issue, NOT to HIM! Well, it all got out of hand and he was saying that I was a KNOW IT ALL and I should have checked on him (I asked why he didn't check on US- BECAUSE HIS PHONE WASN'T WORKING!) Claimed I didn't visit Mom or call about her when she was in the hospital...I said, I DID call! We couldn't even get our special needs daughter through Mom's house, and that was before he completely trashed it. Oh no you didn't! I said How would YOU know? Oh, HE knows! And then accused me of being just like Daddy and said he couldn't stand Daddy. I told him I loved our dad, and he said

that was just because I didn't know because HE was the one living with them. Like yeah, ALL his life. I didn't intend to, but I finally told him he trashed everything and the place was a pigsty. And, predictably, that was because "he was taking care of Mom in the nursing home!". If I had had the presence of mind, I would have asked him why he managed to endure his hatred for our dad for all those years when Dad was putting a roof over his head and food on the table. At one point, he raised up as if to hit me. I absolutely will not tolerate that and I told him so. (And a very unsettling thing when I entered his room... I don't want to be too graphic here, but he is always lying down in bed, and today he had a blanket over his lower body and there was some suspicious movement down there. But I didn't. I just told him I won't be back, and he said, "Good!". So I'm done. I talked to nursing and the case manager and told them what happened and that I hated I lost my temper because it was not my intention to upset him. The case manager said he has already asked them to remove me as emergency contact from his chart. And they said he has been in one of his complaining moods all day anyway. I do feel bad about losing my temper and I know I could have just exited the room. It was like my feet were glued to the floor. I really didn't mean to upset him but I just won't take his accusations. I really no longer care what he thinks of me. He can bad-mouth me to the staff and say whatever he wants. I think I have come to the conclusion that he is crazy and always has been. He has become agitated lately (IMO) because two of the female aides who he literally talked about all the time were fired. I just don't go in for all that drama. But I think it might have unhinged him. Well, more than usual... But I do have to be honest in that I can't stand to be in the same room with him. I don't know if it is possible to disown a brother, but I am DONE! I'll try to forgive him again, but I'm not there yet after him yelling SHUT UP to me today. And no I don't think he has dementia. I think he's just a selfish little B__ST__D that my mom coddled all his life. I'm not his Mom."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uk7ylh/done/>

"I'm sorry I'm only saying whst I've seen on invoices that some clients have either showed me or I've glanced at when I was cleaning. I'm not comfortable tell where I live because I'm already giving information that could get me fired. I'm only comfortable saying I'm in the southeast United States"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 15 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/niuy3sh/

"That's a lot like what my sister said to me. Basically you have to put into the relationship to get things back. My dad would never call, text, visit, but once he was in the hospital he was a nasty jerk wanting constant entertainment and care. It doesn't work like that."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tftnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op5m97j/

"I have POA already, but I can't get the hospital to actually provide answers. I live 4 hours away from the hospital he's at and have called and left a dozen voicemails in the last two days, and only spoken to a traveling nurse once who was unable to help. I have to drive up to the hospital on my only day off during the week, and when I do, it has never been possible to actually see the case worker or social worker (I've left at least 5 voicemails to the case worker department (?) automated system alone and never gotten a call back)-- most likely because my day off was Saturday and I've managed to get my free day switched to Friday this week. I've never had a doctor actually communicate with me and a rotation of nurses that haven't been involved with his care for more than a day, maybe two. I'm basically blind because there's barely a human link in the hospital's phone system and no one who would be able to assist me worked on my day off when I was physically present at the hospital. I'm hoping that will change when I go there tomorrow and I'll actually get to speak to a human being about my father's care."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/zfsk3a/dad_70_needs_24_hour_care_recovering_from_surgery/izdvbtw/

"Such an important but difficult topic to discuss. My uncle years ago fell on the floor, and it took 2 strong emt's to help him up off the floor. 180 lbs of dead weight. My aunt and I couldn't even budge him up from the floor. From that pt on, he never returned to his house due to instability 🥺 I'm so happy your channel has grown! 🙌🙌🙌"

youtube · @dianezielinski6664 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwWTc_WWp5fz6Ze9-p4AaABAq

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (1): "Thank you for being here. Even when I was young and fit I frequently had to get some help from male assistants when it was bath time on the geriatric unit. It's tough and older "children" can get hurt trying to do this work themselves. All the best."

↳ **@alaskansummertime** (0): "My elderly neighbor lady got drunk and high on cocaine then couldn't get back in bed. Her brother tried to get me to help and I hoped out quick. Felt like I was gonna pull her arm out tryen get her up"

"Lots of layers especially in larger agencies. The one I worked for was a Corporation that had a Corp office in PA, then 'agency offices' in PA, and multiple locations in FL from Miami to Palm Beach on the east coast and a couple on the west Coast of FL. We were Medicare/Medicaid certified, took care of all ages, visits, hourly, and Live In Care. I also had a High Tech Team that was capable of inserting specialty IV lines like PICC Lines to administration of antibiotics, even Chemotherapy. It was the largest agency in my area and my office covered 2 counties. I had 240 staff at all levels to deal with and do Payroll for. Executive Director (ultimately me), Director of Nursing for Medicare and Private side, then Nursing Supervisors RNs(10 teams) each having a LPN scheduler. We had a Marketing team that visited doctor offices, clinics, nursing homes, ALFs etc. Then I had an HR person, lots of paperwork and background checks, certification/license verification etc involved. A Medical Records team that maintained the charts and made sure they were Medicare/Medicaid compliant. QA dept, Risk Management, Education that offered courses on site for Continuing Education credits (required for licensed/certified people). All the legal stuff including Liability Insurance though I required all staff get their own as well. There is no employer that you can trust to look after you, they will always protect the business first. Having your own insurance protects you. Office management, supplies etc down to the toilet paper in the rest rooms and coffee in the kitchen. It wasn't unusual for us to have 700 clients at any given time from babies that needed Phototherapy to 95 yr old Granma needing company."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/nixasrv/

"The long past due time may have come to finally enforce boundaries, and I'm very nervous.. As I've mentioned here before my Dad is hospitalized with pneumonia and dealing with hospital induced delirium. Well the pneumonia has cleared up and he's ready for a rehab stay (yay!), but the delirium is still there, and when he sundowns it's bad. He frantically calls me dozens of times. On Thursday night, after a bout of pure delusional voicemails I finally gave myself permission to block him, and honestly I've blocked him every night since. Just during the night when he sundowns, not during the day when he's usually more lucid. It was a huge step for me to do that. My Dad is a narcissist who has walked over boundaries like it's a hobby. But tonight was different, I spoke to him around 9pm - against my better judgement - because I said I'd tell him that I got home safe. Well he was sundowning and already forming the foundations of a new conspiracy about the nurse taking vitals at 9pm (so suspicious /s), and I did not validate the delusion and basically told him "no, that's not what was going on" - this is why I should NOT be talking to him during these moments, I'll just get pissed off - and then I very clearly said "get a good night's rest and we'll talk in the morning" he did not accept that and demeaned me by acting like a very reasonable boundary was a temper tantrum from a child, I reiterated myself and then blocked him for the night. I have not checked my blocked calls or my voicemail all night because I didn't even want to know how much he'd been calling me. I'm sure he will forget by morning - he always does, unless he's still confused. But I mean, I'm

worried that he will, and that's a big move for me to take on one hand I'm glad I enforced it. I mean he's in a hospital with an aide who can advocate for him, and who can contact me if need be, and the hospital can contact me. But on the other hand I may have to enter into a phase where I have to enforce this boundary harder and harder if he tries to pull me back in. So I don't know what to do. If I did call him the chances of me making any delirious episode he's having worse were high, and if I did that it'd show him that with enough effort my boundaries with waver. But also this may have added a layer to what is already a very trying time for me. Is this type of anxiety for enforcing boundaries normal? And how do I weather any storms that may come my way in the aftermath of this?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uopj7r/the_long_past_due_time_may_have_come_to_finally/

"Long, need advice on how to deal with refusal of help.. Okay so, my grandmother (93) set up her life plans very clearly when she was younger. Bought her and my grandfathers burial plot, -he died 10 years ago- pre paid all funeral plans, made my mother next of kin & POA. She has always said she doesn't want to/ will not go into a nursing home and absolutely does not want family caring for her. She has a separate account she put money into forever ago saying she wants to stay in her home and this account is for hired help to come to her if she needs it. (More than enough) she lives in a different state than me and my mother about 4 hours away. Her son is much much farther. She has lived in her home for 60+ years. When my grandfather died we asked her to move closer to us so she wasn't alone. She thought that was hilarious. She would never leave all her friends. -to be fair she was very busy. Involved in game nights, charities, volunteering and dinner parties. She has always been very loving. But never a nice woman. She is very stubborn and a control freak. Shes always been belittling but we love her. Two years ago she got diagnosed with a severe thyroid disorder. 4 pills twice a day. She has never needed medication of any kind so this was a adjustment for her. If she messes up the meds it SEVERELY affects her mentally. Can barley speak, wont know her name. But she managed it. Last year broke a hip, and was also diagnosed with mild dementia. When she came home we hired her help. She was horrible to them. Fired someone all the time. Until they had enough and wouldnt come back. Three times since then she has been hospitalized for messing up her medication and it makes her incoherent. Also worsening dementia. We went to take her to a assisted living near us for her to tour. She screamed at us she will not be getting out of the car. And literally spit on us. Between the going up there every time she's hospitalized and everything else. Noone can do it anymore. Were going to loose our damn jobs. We need her closer to better help her. But we are told we cant make her do anything. Not that we could make her anyway. She will fight you. The woman who is working as her care giver is a saint. Truly truly a saint. She does everything. Deals with all the nastiness. My grandma used to pay her but she asked us to take over the billing because this was a serious obsession with her. Money. Everything is to much money. (This was never her problem before) but she is so scared of missing a bill or being late on one. We made is so her bills go to her financial advisor and he pays them to take away the stress. She agreed to it. She some where along the lines forgot she pays her care giver and thought she was a friend. Until she saw how much shes getting paid. She fired her. Refuses any help. Wont move. Accuses us of stealing. Called 5 times today alone to say how ridiculous paying someone for help is. Im sure within the week she'll be in the hospital because of medication. Last time we were told we can do nothing because she can feed herself, dress and bathe herself. She is considered competent. Maybe now she wouldnt be. But going to court to take away her choices seem like it will cause the most problems because she is such a control freak. But she has noone anymore. Her friends are all her age now and she is nasty to them. They wont come around. her neighbors have blocked her number because she would leave them these horrible messages. We cant loose our jobs and even when we do go. She kicks us out. Her grandson who lives 30 minutes away wont see her anymore because his son is autistic and she makes fun of him for not talking. Also tries to fight his wife. I dont know what to do."

reddit post · r/dementia · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sfavoh/long_need_advice_on_how_to_deal_with_refusal_of/

"I literally could have written this. Everything you described happened to me except my father died of cancer. My mother has vascular dementia and has tortured me for almost 2 years. After dad died she got incredibly mean and I couldn't figure out why. Obsessed with her dog, bizarre behavior, absolutely broke me down when I didn't comply with her every demand. Fast forward to today. She's in memory care and does nothing but babble incoherently. She has no idea she's sick but one thing she knows for sure is how much she hates me. I have two voicemails saved to my phone. One from my dad telling me how much he loves me. The other is from my mom demanding I "pick up the God damn phone" because she had something important to tell me. I was working at the time at a part time job after losing my full time job with benefits to care for her. I falsely believed that adult children were supposed to do that for their parents. Wrong. Let her go and protect yourself. I'm so sorry OP."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_t_he_state/oyvk71v/

"Daughter didn't update home care agency on COVID status of father . Huh. Last week I got a message from my agency my client was canceled due to him having COVID. So fast forward to today. I arrive at his apartment (he's at a facility)and notice that there is a cart outside his door with all kinds of medical supplies as in a hospital. Thought I better check on the status of his COVID with the desk. They were able to locate his nurse. She advised me he is still in quarantine and that I should not do a visit until he's cleared. So.... I let our agency office know and replied that they assumed he was fine since the daughter never called with any updates from last week. Sigh... I was happy to let them know that I just spoke with his nurse and she advised no visits So...hmmm....sigh.... I feel so bad for him as he lives in deplorable conditions as it in and now no house keeping for two weeks ! No response back from my agency so I just clocked out. I'm not risking exposure even with a mask on. Am I wrong ?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1gb88xd/daughter_didnt_update_ho_me_care_agency_on_covid/

"I'm a little confused, maybe because I don't understand your billing setup for each of the 3 entities. Isn't the ALF a monthly/weekly/daily fee regardless of whether she is there or not? Or does she actually not pay the ALF for days she is somewhere else? Also, why would Hospice be encouraging a DNR document if their goal was to keep your mom alive for billing hours? Wouldn't a DNR document increase the chances of a quicker death. In my experience, there really are a lot of horror stories for prolonging life and pain for very elderly patients, so I'm not sure they're off the mark. But if you believe your mom wants to fight till the bitter end no matter what it takes, then just tell them that and don't sign the DNR."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8okarp/

"Na. That's a completely different company. If I can ever seen another invoice I'll make sure I know whst I'm seeing. I'm not supposed to know these things so it's something I have to find out on accident."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/nivme1n/

"They used to call pneumonia "the old man's friend" because it was a relatively quick way to go when a person is very debilitated otherwise. My mom lived to be 102 and spent the last two years of her life in a nursing home where she did not want to be. But she had done no planning and my brother made such a mess out of her finances and her home (and ultimately delayed her Medicaid eligibility until I finally was able to get her approved two months before she passed away) and all of it essentially fell on my head for the final two years, while my brother sat and stared at the floor, lying and obfuscating, and ignoring the entire problem. She ended up with no money left for home care and none left for long term care, with no one left with the ability to care for her (and her home was pretty much trashed by my brother so she couldn't have returned anyway). A friend of mine kept telling me

how lucky I was that my mom was still "with us" at her age. Living a debilitated life with confusion, frustration, anger, fear, and depression in a place she never called home, with no alternatives. I could never convey the reality—that Mom was not really "with us" in so many ways. I don't have the answer either. But the stress of those last two years and the sadness may never leave me. I shed more tears during that time than when she passed in the fall. People may think I was cold for being so practical at the end, but mostly what I felt was relief because the entire situation was obscene."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oj20yls/

"1. We used a local women that schedules her trusted friends and ladies as caregivers. I trust them completely. They are not nurses. 2. Scheduling looks like three people changing out every day 8hr shifts , with the evening person usually spending the night and the main person that runs everything as a backup for when anyone is sick or something happens. 3. They are responsible for all tasks related to my mother's care. Laundry for her, bedding , dressing, changing her diaper, taking her to the toilet getting her medication , cooking her food. Sitting and watching her 24 /7. I still maintain the home and they let me know if anything breaks. They're usually pretty helpful about scheduling companies to come fix things as I live out of state. 4. We haven't had any problems with staff turnover besides one staff member getting cancer and needing to retire and another staff member deciding my mom's care was passed her abilities once she got to stage seven. The main caregiver scheduler was easily able to find new help. 5. I believe my mom received far better care at home with his loving Christian ladies than she would've had almost any facility. My grandmother was a facilities in the same area as my mom and I am almost guaranteed my mom had better care. But I am extremely lucky with finding a group of ladies that are religious passionate and completely love my mother deeply. I know you said you don't even wanna have the conversation but stage seven I'm paying \$23,000 a month. She's not even in a high cost of living area. Very few families can afford this. Thank you to my late father. Good luck to you. Keeping them at home can certainly be a blessing. (I will say no other family is alive living with her so it's a whole different decision if you have other loved ones living directly with her). This disease can be devastating even to family members without it."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/onj0bz6/

"I'm the Clinical Director of a caregiver agency and my own mother is in assisted living. I see the call outs and my schedulers scrambling to cover a shift. Most caregivers are not interested in managing a household. There are groceries to be ordered, maintenance to be called for problems, prescriptions to be managed. Above all, clients still fall. If a caregiver goes to the restroom, that is plenty of time for a client to fall. If a caregiver is right beside a client, the client takes the caregiver down with them. You cannot "fall-proof" a person. My mother falls. She is evaluated by her hospice nurse and has never been transported."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxohsaj/

Aide no-show, cancel, turnover · 170 documents

20 most engaged of 170 matching documents, complete text.

"How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care, and your adult child wrote you and the whole family this letter regarding that situation?. Dear family, I've been doing a lot of reflecting lately on the situation with Grandma and Grandpa, and I feel a need to share some thoughts that have been weighing on me. I know we are all doing our best to navigate this, but I want to offer a different perspective—one that might be uncomfortable, but feels necessary to voice. I can't help but feel that what we are witnessing is, in many ways, fundamentally unnatural. Decades ago, you rarely heard of couples requiring 24/7 professional assistance simultaneously; there was a natural rhythm to life and passing that seems to have been disrupted. It feels as though modern medicine has become so focused on the mechanics of keeping the body running that it has moved far away from human nature itself. By pushing past what might have once been our natural "expiration dates," we've entered a territory where the cost of longevity is a loss of the very independence that defined them. Perhaps the most jarring part of this experience for me is seeing the in-home care staff every day. While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge; instead of a family visit, it feels like a supervised appointment in their own home. Because of this, I want to be very clear about my own wishes for the future: Once I reach the age of 75, I do not want any extraordinary measures taken to prolong my life. Whether it is surgery, intensive treatment, or any form of medical intervention, I want to let nature take its course. Furthermore, if I ever reach a point where I can no longer safely live independently, please do not try to recreate a hospital within my home. I am asking you now to please just put me in a professional facility. I would rather my home remain a memory of who I was, rather than a place defined by its clinical needs. I know this is hard to hear, and I don't say it to diminish the love we all have for them. I just feel we need to acknowledge the reality of the era we are living in and how much it has changed the way we experience the end of life. With love and honesty, Jack"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 349 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

↳ **comment** (259): "A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

↳ **comment** (147): "I was Jack almost a decade ago. The PTSD I have associated with helping my mom care for my grandparents will never leave me. It *ruined* my memories of my grandparents who i loved so much and spent much of my childhood with. It sucks to be the elderly person or the caregiver, but being a support person for the caregiver sucks too. We are watching an elderly loved one basically be tortured into living, another loved one get burnt out to a crispy husk of a person, and we just have to sit there like 'This is fine.....' It's really sad, frustrating, depressing to watch, and makes you look around and scream 'am I taking crazy pills?!'"

↳ **comment** (140): "I studied gerontology and death & dying. Because of that, I made an Exit Plan 20 years ago. I saw what was going to happen with the massive, aging, Boomer population & there's nothing good about it. I've completed all my EOL documents (Will, Living Will/Healthcare POA, financial/durable POA), each kid has copies. Pre-planned & pre-paid for my cremation. I'm very open with my kids about EOL stuff and how I don't

want to burden them with my care. Of course, they say “we don’t mind,” but I’ve seen 1st hand how caregiving tears apart families and breaks caregivers. I don’t want to do that to my kids.”

"Things I Wish Someone Had Explained to Me About the Actively Dying phase. I wanted to share a few things I've learned during the active dying phase with my mother-in-law because this experience is honestly something most people are not prepared for at all until they're suddenly in it. And I've realized some hospice agencies are amazing at proactively educating families... and others are kind of waiting for the caregiver to know what questions to ask or what options exist. The problem is your brain is already overwhelmed, emotional, sleep deprived, grieving, and trying to function while watching someone decline in real time. Sometimes you don't even know what you don't know. A few things I wish someone had explained to me earlier: hospice can provide a hospital bed in the home at no cost. There are also relatively affordable rotating air mattresses and pressure relief options online that can really help with comfort and tailbone pain. Foam barrier dressings have helped too. The little mouth swabs dipped in water have also made a huge difference for dry mouth and comfort. Another thing that has been hard emotionally is the eating and hydration piece. Every instinct in you wants to push food and water because feeding and nurturing someone feels so tied to love and care. But there really is a lot of hospice and scientific literature around the body naturally beginning to need less at end of life. From what I've read and been told, excess fluids can sometimes increase swelling and discomfort. I've also gone down a rabbit hole reading about ketosis during the dying process and how some researchers believe it may actually help ease pain or discomfort for the body. I'm not a medical professional, just a human trying to help someone I love through one of the hardest and strangest experiences of my life while learning as I go. Sharing in case it helps another caregiver feel a little less lost or alone."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 281 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/

↳ **comment** (82): "For anyone interested, there is a YouTube channel called HOSPICE NURSE JULIE. She explains all phases of dying, from all types of diseases and what to expect in each case. She is excellent at answering questions and taking the fear out of the whole process."

↳ **comment** (69): "Thank you for posting this, and massive, massive hugs to you. My sister recently passed but before that, our family was doing the above, actively providing water and nutrients (protein drinks) but also being anxious about knowing that at some point she wouldn't want to and couldn't either, because it became an aspiring danger. Mouth swabs in water are absolutely a game changer for comfort, they also had mouthwash that helped generate saliva that provided some comfort to her. The last thing I'll say about this phase that I never understood despite reading about it ceaselessly, was the restlessness that comes at end of life stage. I didn't know my sister's discomfort and distress would be her last signs before she passed. At that stage, it's was hard to know the degree to which she was in discomfort because it as a constant dance of increasing drugs for not only pain but also discomfort. We heavily leaned on the amazing nursing staff to help us through this distressing time, and for anyone else seeing a loved one in hospice, just emphasizing that no question is a silly question, they have seen everything under the sun and are experts at noticing all the signs and symptoms."

↳ **comment** (23): "Hospice nurse Julie reels are so helpful. They can be a little jolting; it just depends if you are a person who likes a lot of information or a little. Taking the fear out of the process makes it more tolerable so you can be present."

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the

paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"At some point, you have to pick living over death. It seems like you have said "I love you" and the eventual passing will not be a surprise. You have already cancelled one vacation. So, if you can go and not feel guilty, and enjoy your vacation, then go. Get prepared for the possibility that some family or friends might try to make you feel guilty. Sounds to me that you have already had a difficult time, and you have earned your rest & relaxation."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 113 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/oo7367x/

"Brother told Mom caregiving isn't a real job... I'm devastated.. My mother suffered a stroke back in 2013/2014 and hasn't recovered. Dad took care of her until his own health severely declined. I always helped out where possible while studying. Dad passed away in January 2023, which threw me into a deep depression and a suicide

attempt in May 2023. Jan 2023, my 2nd oldest sibling, sister, took my mom in, but her family gave up after a year. Jan 2024, my 3rd oldest sibling, brother, tried next and gave up after just 6 months. While still recovering from my depression, I stepped up in July/August 2024 to become her fulltime caregiver on weekdays, with my 5 siblings rotating weekends. It's now been 2 full years of this arrangement. Out of curiosity, I asked my mom to check what my 3rd oldest sibling thought of my caregiving after 2 years. I'm devastated by his response. He told her that he "doesn't consider it work since I'm at home" and that I "shouldn't be paid"... So basically he doesn't consider what I do "real work" because I'm at home and believes caregiving shouldn't be compensated or acknowledged. Replacing primary live in care saves our family significant expenses every month. I don't expect a full corporate salary, but diminishing 24/7 caregiving as "not work" is absurd, no? I'm just numb. My 4 oldest siblings are in their 40s with their own families and homes. Aside from a small amount of monthly household money they contribute, which is nowhere near what a professional live in caregiver costs, I am literally caregiving for free. Again, I'm not asking for a full salary or trying to start a fight, but I just wanted some form of recognition, appreciation... I love my mom deeply, and of course, I will keep taking care of her. I just needed to share this here... Edit: Thank y'all so much for the support and encouraging words, it really means a lot. I love y'all ❤️ Edit 2: Reading everyone's comments made me realize I need to bring this up with my siblings soon. Hopefully we can talk it out and figure something out together, whether it works out or not. Thanks again everyone. Edit 3: In retrospect, I also wanna add crucial context that makes his response even worse, I think. During those 6 months when mom stayed at his place, he wasn't even the one doing the caregiving, he was working. It was actually his wife who took care of mom every single weekday, and I truly appreciate all the hard work and love she put in for our mom. So, like, by dismissing caregiving as "not real work" because it happens at home, he isn't just invalidating me, he's kinda undervaluing all the labor his own wife put in too..."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vwkix8/brother_told_mom_caregiving_isnt_a_real_job_im/

↳ **comment** (32): "I mean, he couldn't hack it, so fuck him. His opinion doesn't count. Especially since he tried to do it and gave up. Caretaking is hard work and is desperately undervalued in a society where the only thing that matters is money. Your older siblings have dropped the 'problem' of your mom's care in your lap, and consider it solved. Watching her one weekend a month is nothing in comparison to what you are doing. Sadly, what you are experiencing seems to be more common than not."

↳ **comment** (25): "The one that couldn't hack it for longer than 6 months is passing judgment? You who have been caregiver for your Mom for over two years? Boy is that rich! Your brother is a horse's patooti!"

↳ **comment** (14): "Sounds like my family. Hugs, internet friend, the rest of us see you 💖"

"Anyone have around the clock (24/7) caretakers to look after their loved one at home?. My mom is stage 6 dementia. She currently lives in memory care about 5 minutes from me. She has been there for nearly 4 months. None of us are thrilled with the quality of care. (More on that below.) As you read, you may wonder why she doesn't live with me. It's too much. I have 3 other siblings in town + plus her grandchildren who visit (occasionally) and my house doesn't need to be a rotating circus. Her home has not been sold yet and is approximately 7-9 minutes from me. I am curious if anyone has hired a team of caretakers to care for their loved one at home. QUESTIONS: \- do you use an agency? \- what does scheduling look like? \- what tasks are they responsible for? \- have you had problems with staff turnover? \- do you feel your loved one has received better care at home? \- things you did or didn't expect? YES, I ALREADY KNOW THIS IS INCREDIBLY EXPENSIVE. I am not interested in that conversation. I am trying to figure out what this option could realistically look like for my mom. Her memory care is \$12k per month (cost will go up 3-6% each year), not including diapers, medication, medical care. It's a low ratio aide to patient floor. Around 6 patients to an aide. Varying degrees of physical/mental abilities of patients. I was told they would make the effort to get to know my mom, build a relationship with her and earn her trust. They have not. They basically change her diapers and drop off her food.

They can't be bothered to sit with her for a few minutes or even stick around long enough to make sure she has utensils on her tray. So she's lonely. No, I don't expect them to be my mom's bestie. But, they only have what she perceives as negative interactions and make her feel like a job. My mom still has enough awareness at times to understand where she is and what's going on. They miss so many basic care tasks. And there is literally no reason for it. They have failed to deliver her meals. My mom is diabetic, so this can be dangerous. Her doctor has sent specific orders for a bedtime snack - that I provide and have stored in her room - that they continually fail to administer. There are plenty more examples, but I'm trying to keep this as short as possible. I have talked with her aides and their bosses and their bosses. It's all in one ear out the other. I've sent emails, made lists, left reminders... I spend 4-8 hours a day with my mom 5-6 days a week because they just don't want to meet her where she's at. They expected her to move in and just sit in the social area with the other residents 10-12 hours a day. And, no, they aren't interacting with the other residents either. The staff sits on the edges of the rooms on their phones. While there are different activities led by a "social director" throughout the day, the aides don't join in to help. Mom likes some of the activities but not all of them. She has tried to socialize a bit with some of the residents, but it's memory care. The problem with just leaving her to do activities is she panics b/c they initially won't allow her to go back to her room when she's done. Then I get a call, have to come back, etc.. My priorities are my mom's happiness, safety and comfort. Yes, this may mean home care isn't the best option BUT I want to make sure I fully explore it because moving her to another memory care could cause bigger/other problems."

reddit post · r/dementia · 36 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/

↳ **comment (26):** "My father-in-law has had live in care for about a year and a half. The cost was roughly the same as a care home. We arranged this for him because he always made it clear that he did not want to move to a care home or die in a hospital. Unfortunately, he didn't realize that he was in his own home, so it didn't really make any difference that we were honoring his wishes. He only just moved into a care home and then fell and has been in hospital ever since, so I cannot really speak to the differences between a care home and in-home care, but I can tell you about some of the things that I did not like about in-home care. First, there really was no socializing. I'm not even sure it is reasonable to expect the carer, who often has limited English, to do much to entertain a patient who has their own communication challenges. Second, and surprisingly, I don't think live in care provides the kind of order and predictability that I would like to see. The problem is that in-home carers still need breaks. That means that a revolving cast of people drop by to offer short term coverage during those breaks each day. It also means that every so often the full-time carer is given a week or two off and replaced by somebody entirely new, which can be very jarring for the patient. In a care home, I expect that patients are exposed to more people, but on a more regular and predictable schedule. In addition, I found that it was very difficult for information to be passed on from the regular carer to the replacement. They were pretty good about communicating information about medication and meals, but certain basic information about where things belong would just get lost. I would show up a few months later and find that all the cutlery was missing and be about to replace it, only to discover bits and pieces in random places all over the house. This may be less of an issue for you as you are able to visit frequently."

↳ **comment (21):** "Yes. I use an agency. We have two agencies we've worked with actually and they are very different. The agency we started with schedules hourly care around the clock. \$25/hr There were often 8-10 different people coming and going in order to staff that many hours. It was confusing for my LO to keep track of who was who. The agency we switched to is live in. We have two caregivers and they alternate one week on and one week off. The agency is paid a daily rate and all food is supplied. Both agencies covered the same tasks. All help with ADLs, interfaced with Hospice (we have had caregivers for more than one LO), took care of laundry and cleaning the home, companionship, prepared all meals, bathing/meds/PT exercises daily, drive to appointments as needed. Staff turnover has not been bad with our live in folks. It took a few tries to get caregivers that were a good fit but we've had the same ones now since the New Year. 10000% they've gotten better care. It's 1:1 and in facilities at best you're looking at 15:1 on a good day. It's not even close."

↳ **comment** (13): "I'm currently paying \$62.50/hr for 12x7 in home care. Will go to 24x7 when the Onsite Kid taps out. I have no idea whether this is a good idea or not. We staggered into this reality and are just trying to keep our heads above water."

"Caring for a Parent with Major Depression who Refuses to Take Care of Themselves. My mother just turned 60 and she has been dealing with major depression disorder for a little less than a year now. It all started when she didn't show up for work one morning and her boss sent a wellness check to her house - she was laying in bed having an anxiety attack saying that she couldn't handle getting up and going to work. She was consequently admitted into the hospital and evaluated and ultimately diagnosed with MDD with psychosis. She spent a few days there and then ended up going back home. Weeks went by and she really wasn't getting any better. She stopped eating and washing, taking care of the dogs, etc. In fact, she was spending a majority of her day just rotting in bed, wearing the same clothes that she wore the day prior that she ended up falling asleep in (sometimes even in jeans and sneakers). So, we had her admitted into the hospital again, this time a mental hospital. She spent weeks there, complaining about how awful it was, but still not eating or really doing anything it seemed to try and get better. She ended up losing about 60 lbs over this period. Fast forward a bit, and she's back home and again on a decline. She lives alone but my sibling and I (both late 20s) check on her periodically to make sure she is taking care of herself. However, over the past ~6 weeks we've found that if we do not FORCE her to get up, shower, go to the grocery store and buy food, she will literally rot in bed and will not eat, will not let the dogs out or walk them, etc. She is on disability payments but they barely cover her rent and don't cover her other bills which she admits she is simply putting off. She is in weekly therapy which she claims doesn't work. She is on a variety of behavioral medications which she claims don't work (we're unsure if she even takes them regularly). She has shown no desire to go back to work and when we try to tell her that she needs to figure out a plan to get back to work and making an income, she just responds "I know" or "I don't know what to do". How do we care for our mother who literally refuses to help herself? We try to come at her with kindness and she doesn't open up; try and come at her with assertion and she again does not open up or provide any context as to what she's going through. It's getting to the point where my sibling and I are distracted at work and hindered from living our own lives because our 60-year old mother won't take care of herself. We've been discussing a relocation to some sort of assisted living program or hiring her a full-time aide, but we're not sure how payments for that would work and she obviously has no income. Any suggestions? We've tried everything and it's beginning to make me feel just as anxious/depressed as I'm watching my own mother waste her life away..."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1gahq0q/caring_for_a_parent_with_major_depression_who/

"What are you actually paying for your home care aide? Is it worth it?. Last year my 76 year old mom fell in her apartment in Encino. Nothing broken, but it scared all of us enough that my sisters and I finally bit the bullet and hired a home care aide to come three days a week. We found someone through a local agency. She's wonderful, my mom actually looks forward to her visits. But the whole *finding* process was a nightmare. We called six agencies, got wildly different quotes, had zero idea how to compare them, and the agency we ended up with took two weeks just to send us a contract. My mom was alone the entire time we were sorting it out. Now we pay \$38/hr, roughly \$600/week. We feel okay about it but honestly have no idea if that's the going rate or if we're getting a fair deal. We also have no backup plan for when our aide calls out sick which has already happened twice, and both times my sister had to drop everything. Curious what other people are paying and if they're happy with their experience. **A few questions if you're willing to share:** \- What are you paying per hour or per week for home care? (region and your perceived quality of the aide helps if you're comfortable sharing) \- How did you find your aide or agency? How was your experience? Wondering if there's a place I'm not looking where I could find another aide or need a backup"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 29 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rk3gby/what_are_you_actually_paying_for_your_home_care/

"My father-in-law has had live in care for about a year and a half. The cost was roughly the same as a care home. We arranged this for him because he always made it clear that he did not want to move to a care home or die in a hospital. Unfortunately, he didn't realize that he was in his own home, so it didn't really make any difference that we were honoring his wishes. He only just moved into a care home and then fell and has been in hospital ever since, so I cannot really speak to the differences between a care home and in-home care, but I can tell you about some of the things that I did not like about in-home care. First, there really was no socializing. I'm not even sure it is reasonable to expect the carer, who often has limited English, to do much to entertain a patient who has their own communication challenges. Second, and surprisingly, I don't think live in care provides the kind of order and predictability that I would like to see. The problem is that in-home carers still need breaks. That means that a revolving cast of people drop by to offer short term coverage during those breaks each day. It also means that every so often the full-time carer is given a week or two off and replaced by somebody entirely new, which can be very jarring for the patient. In a care home, I expect that patients are exposed to more people, but on a more regular and predictable schedule. In addition, I found that it was very difficult for information to be passed on from the regular carer to the replacement. They were pretty good about communicating information about medication and meals, but certain basic information about where things belong would just get lost. I would show up a few months later and find that all the cutlery was missing and be about to replace it, only to discover bits and pieces in random places all over the house. This may be less of an issue for you as you are able to visit frequently."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/onil5wc/

"Yes. I use an agency. We have two agencies we've worked with actually and they are very different. The agency we started with schedules hourly care around the clock. \$25/hr There were often 8-10 different people coming and going in order to staff that many hours. It was confusing for my LO to keep track of who was who. The agency we switched to is live in. We have two caregivers and they alternate one week on and one week off. The agency is paid a daily rate and all food is supplied. Both agencies covered the same tasks. All help with ADLs, interfaced with Hospice (we have had caregivers for more than one LO), took care of laundry and cleaning the home, companionship, prepared all meals, bathing/meds/PT exercises daily, drive to appointments as needed. Staff turnover has not been bad with our live in folks. It took a few tries to get caregivers that were a good fit but we've had the same ones now since the New Year. 10000% they've gotten better care. It's 1:1 and in facilities at best you're looking at 15:1 on a good day. It's not even close."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/onio4nu/

"My client threatened to have me fired today for asking them to wait til we get to the toilet to do number 1 and 2. I had to remind him the last person left to go deliver pizzas because of his toxic behaviors. It didn't feel good but it was necessary. His family refuses to acknowledge in any way shape or form the negative behaviors yet pays \$6 above market as a cushion because they're sick of turnover. They have cameras wired around the entire home and will likely confront me later after listening to recordings. What I've found is when you let people bully you they become emboldened and escalate."

youtube · @PunkMartyr · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland* · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=UgzmrPfpP4VEV0XNFB54AaABAg>

"I think managing carers round the clock is going to be difficult. I say this from experience- they sometimes have their own emergencies and an agency can't always find cover quickly. Turnover and unfamiliar faces. Perhaps a night time aid if this only happens at night?"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxjw4p/

"Retired ER nurse here...and I can only repeat what Hannah commented. I had turned 70 when it was safer for my mother to move out of the house I bought for her (directly across from me) into my downstairs studio apartment. I am well over 75 now and I wonder how people without any training nor experience manage caring for a parent and also watch them mentally decline. My mother was content to just sit all day, fearing a fall...but she would call out for me at 2 or 4 in the morning. Not good for anyone's nerves. I can do anything as long as I have gloves on but it is all the rest that adds to the stress. And, at the same time since 3 years I had another patient in the house. My deceased 81 year old 'very difficult' husband with cancer and a stoma. He passed last year. My mother, in January this year at age 95 with zero quality of life."

youtube · @misottovoce · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 16 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyaOtylxv3T87I00YB4AaABAg

↳ @misottovoce (o): "@susanbennettellstales7998 You were there for your mother, doing the best you could. Forgive yourself for being human. I would like to say 'don't be upset' but that may sound invalidating. Instead, remember her she was at her best and remind yourself her suffering is over. Please don't punish yourself further. Live in the now...and be well."

"Etiquette for visiting elderly family member in rehab facility??. My Question; Beyond the suggested visiting hours, what is the etiquette for family visitation at a rehab facility, for an elderly patient? The situation; My Nana is 97 years young, still mentally sharp, has a great sense of humor and can keep up with any conversation, as long as she can hear it. She has been living on long island, in her own home for 71 years. A home which her husband built by hand, as well as dozens of others in the area. She needs constant care at this point, something that her 3 daughters have been rotating to provide her at home. A couple of weeks ago she had a fall at home. One of the sisters was there, but didn't hear her get up in the middle of the night. Nana has a sweet tooth, and tripped and fell onto a hardwood floor. She fractured her left hip and was taken to the ER. They performed a partial hip replacement and the surgery went well. She has an incredibly high tolerance for pain, so it's hard to get an accurate reading. There's no way she was comfortable, but zero complaints. She only cried out when they rolled her to check the staples after surgery. Tough as nails. Gratefully I can now see in her face and movement, the pain has gotten better and she is currently only taking Tylenol. She's the last person to complain about herself, would rather ask you how you're doing. After the surgery she was moved to a rehabilitation facility nearby, "Emerge", in Glen cove Long Island. I'm not impressed. She had had some "bag nights" where we are told she was screaming all night disturbed and confused. Some of these episodes were while she was being catheterized. Related background; Nana lost her husband over 50 years ago, she never dated or remarried. No man has laid a hand on her since. And now they have men, complete strangers to her, come in the middle of the night to catheterize her. This has been extremely invasive and disturbing for my Nana. An invasive procedure for anyone at any age to go through. We have requested a female nurse to perform the intimate necessities, however the facility only told us they'll do the best they can, which feels like a clear dismissal. I understand that staffing is not an easy thing and there may not be a female nurse that is available when she needs it, however this is my first time dealing with this specific aspect of care facilities and I can't help but feel that they have a moral obligation to do more than try their best, in order to accommodate this simple request. Nana is currently doing PT OT and speech therapy. The speech therapy is not necessarily needed, however as in any of these greedy facilities they want patients they can bill for the maximum Medicare daily limit. I've been extremely unimpressed with the entirety of the staff there, including the director and the primary physician. I must point out there are one or two people working there who actually care, to them; thank you thank you thank you you're AMAZING and your appreciated.🙏 My wife and I have seen more than a handful of these type of facilities while caring for other elderly family members. Facilities that were located in several different states, with very different track records and varying levels of care. I mention this because we are

not naive about the level of care to expect vs what the shiny brochure says. We know how to respectfully interact in these delicate areas. We feel that we understand these facilities in terms of their overall flow, the staff, dealing with roommates, doctors, nurses etc. Most importantly; regardless of our personal opinions, we ALWAYS show the staff the utmost respect, in any and all situations. I truly appreciate the hard job they do and appreciate them all. Typically we end up befriending even the most hard to reach staff, as a result of how we engage with them, our genuine respect for them as individuals and the hard job they perform. We immediately get out of their way when needed, don't overcrowd the room with too many visitors, leave the room to respect patient's privacy, don't interfere with meals, doctor visitors, physical therapy and anything else that is part of their job and part of Nana getting better and getting back home. The reason for my question is I have one family member that has semi relatable work experience, they have worked in rehab facilities as a speech pathologist. This family member was/is extremely condescending to anyone involved, family and staff, because she knows better. It's infuriating. During our last visit, this individual overlapped. Immediately upon her arrival she gave us the impression that we should not be there. Not only just gave us the impression but more directly told us "the staff really don't like visitors, and they don't want to interrupt a visit. So they usually won't enter the room while the patient has visitors." ... "often, if the physical therapist come to the room and see visitors, they will just mark her PT for the day as N/A." For the lack of a better phrase, this is bat shit crazy. The same family member went on to tell us condescendingly "it may sound cruel, but Nana needs to get used to being alone" my internal reaction was "what the fuck are you talking about?! it sounds cruel because it is cruel! Is that what you'd wish for yourself if you were in her shoes?" Nana has plenty of alone time. She's alone for the majority of the day, and for the entirety of the night. When we have been visiting Nana has no problem taking a nap while we're there and if we see her fading will suggest getting some rest. When she wakes up and sees a face looking back who she knows and loves she immediately smiles. We don't always talk sometimes we just sit and hold hands maybe listen to some music softly. I can feel through every subtle hand squeeze her love and appreciation that were there. While I do understand that she's adjusting to this new temporary reality in which she will have to deal with being alone and unconnected from those she loves, with no means to connect to them on her own. From my observations, she is adjusting fairly well. Particularly in terms of overnights and the majority of the time she has to rely on the staff alone. By no means does a short visit from family set this process back. Previously we have attempted to get a schedule of her days meals physical therapy etc. however no one has been able to nail that down. Partially for understandable reasons like they adapt to how the patient is doing that day in situations they'll reschedule morning therapy for later if they're having a difficult morning things like that. That all sounds reasonable to me enough. One of her daughters has since requested she be scheduled for am PT, which I agree is a better time for her. If a physical therapist has an appointment with a patient, should they ever cancel that appointment due to a family member visiting? In my past, and current experience this has never been the case, no one has ever had any hesitation about entering the room. That includes the entirety of the Care team responsible for the patient. If she has PT at a scheduled time and we are there it is my understanding that the therapist should still do their job regardless. Of course we would immediately conclude our visit if this occurred. IMHO; an employee, any employee, of the rehab facility, that is not completing the required job, due to a visitor being present, is 100% at fault and should be fired immediately. This includes any and all staff. Visiting an elderly loved one should not exclude her from the rehabilitation she is paying for and the care she deserves. Nana lights up every time we visit, smiles and laughs and jokes and sharing stories. Based on everything I have read and more importantly been told directly from individuals who work in this healthcare sector; It is extremely important that the patient receives regular family visits. I've been told, this is extremely important both for the well-being of the patient, and shows the staff they have people there supporting her and who want her to get better and get back home, where she'll continue to have support. It also helps the caregivers get to know the patient through the family members who know her best. They become more of a real person and less of a bed number. My Nana can crack jokes with the best of them, and is extremely kind and tolerant. Of course we're not there every time the staff attends to her, but from what I've witnessed, she tends to be quieter and a more subdued version of herself when interacting with them. Understandable. When we have been there, we've helped build a bridge between the staff and my Nana. By small simple things, like helping nana

hear something one of the aides said to her, which once she heard it, she had a clever witty reply that made us all, aide included laugh. Semi related we've helped in her conversation with physicians when they made the rounds during their visitation. The doctor conducted his inter"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nm8dtk/etiquette_for_visiting_elderly_family_member_in/

"A friend of mine has a similar (albeit, worse in many ways) story. She took care of her aging grandmother (she was raised by her) through her teen years and 20's (so, uni and career beginning years). Did everything around the house, shopped for groceries, cooked, even slept in the same bed when the old lady was sick so she could take her to pee in the middle of the night (weird). She was also most of her grandma's social escape, as the old woman had a "complicated personality" and most wouldn't bear her for more than a couple hours. For all of this the woman gave her granddaughter 5 measly euros per week so she could go out and drink a coffee with her friends. Everytime she went out with us on weekends we all took turns paying for her drinks because the poor girl was truly made to be poor. She couldn't stay long either of course, because granny would get upset and couldn't sleep otherwise. We hated the woman. Now, you might think the old woman was this way because she was poor and that's all she could afford, but you would be wrong. In fact, she had many (many!) properties in a gentrifying area that actually earned her very large amounts of money! She frequently mentioned to my friend that she would put one of her properties in my friend's name, as a thank you for all her hard work. "Next week we'll go visit the lawyer", she would say. This will be relevant further on. My friend did go to college (that's where I met her) and had pretty okay grades but she never entered the working force because the grandmother kept getting older and sicker and "someone had to take care of her". For years we explained to our friend this was not alright and that in fact the woman could very easily afford to have several home aids. We had this conversation with her MANY times. As the years passed by, my friend's CV started to look scarily empty and she was approaching her 30's. Out of nowhere, she announced she got a summer restaurant job in the UK (we are in the South of Europe) and flew away next week. Although she promised to return in three months (it was a summer job, after all), she never did and still lives there. The grandma, miraculously, was now "feeling better" and started cooking, cleaning, going to the corner shop, all by herself! And as years passed by, she was obviously then "forced" to finally hire home aids, whose costs barely scratched her wallet. In the beginning it was a bit of a revolving door, as she bullied and harassed them on the regular. Even undocumented migrants, desperate for work, would leave after a month or two. But she eventually settled down and learned to tolerate the presence of aid workers at home. The old woman has passed away a few years ago. She never passed down any of the properties to my friend, naturally. They all went to her only daughter (so, my friend's mother), who is technically now a millionaire because the houses she now owns are worth several hundreds of thousands (tourism zone) and who has no plans of sharing of her good fortune with my friend. My friend is now in her forties, stuck in the UK doing amazon deliveries, because in this economy nobody is gonna hire a middle aged woman with barely any experience in her CV. This story is by no means the same as yours, but I think there's a common thread with yours and my friend's. Wishing you the best."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walking_away_from_my_mom/p4gn90w/

"Elderly Care & Home Repair. Every day seems to hold a new, major stressor. I carry the tension in my chest, my jaw, especially. I feel wound so tight, literally physical clenched. I am caregiver for my Dad. We have some hired caregivers as well. Within the last 3 weeks: 1) one of the main caregivers no called no showed. The agency was only able to find someone to cover 2 of her 5 days. Before I could even tackle that 2) Dad, while supervised at home, belted into his wheelchair, fell and broke his leg in 3 places. 3) As I attempt to arrange transportation for cast appointment, learn our subsidized transportation company has closed due to budget cuts. 4) Very large tree in front yard is rotten and needs to come down \$\$\$\$ 5) Dad slides out of bed, thankfully no injury but as this is the 2nd time we clearly need full bed rails. Not covered by insurance \$ 6) Today, I notice the newer caregiver, who has been here a few weeks, is flushing the toilet a lot. I typically mention this explicitly myself but idk if I did, as I'm

exhausted and overwhelmed. I figure they're trained not to but I have to ask: "You're not flushing the wipes down the toilet, right?" "Yes, I always flush the wipes." So far there is nothing wrong with toilet. KNOCK ON WOOD but this has pushed me over the edge. Resources on all fronts are depleted. Dads finances, my energy. The thought of a clogged toilet, or plumbing nightmare as a result of an agency we pay SO MUCH MONEY to to help us out has me pulling my hair out. Also, WTF!!! Thanks for listening. I dont want to put my dad in a home but caring for him and his old house sometimes feels like the weight is too much to bear and im being crushed. EDIT: The formatting is weird and idk how to fix i apologize if that affects clarity"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oigtbb/elderly_care_home_repair/

"I've gone through so many caregivers It's ridiculous and the majority of them got fired because they just did not show up. One of them got drunk and threw up on my son. Some of them were on drugs. Some of them kept going outside to smoke even though smoking is not allowed on my property. Some of them broke my appliances or stole my medication. A lot of the ones that Agency send are people you wouldn't speak to on the street Let alone allow into your home. I know everyone thinks caregivers are these wonderful people but a vast majority of them are not. They're in such high demand that agencies will virtually hire anyone. And then you have to train them and my son is a fall risk. Several of them have let him go to the ground and he's almost impossible to get back up. He's 6 foot 3, 200 pounds. it's funny how people have so much advice when they've never been a caregiver"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015>

"I have a dad (90 advanced Parkinson's like disease) at home with carers 12 hours a day. He can't move and doesn't get out of bed. My sister sleeps over in case he needs something. My mom (90) is at assisted living facility. Ask the facility how much they charge to have an aide with him 24/7. That will cost less than trying to manage individuals who may or may not show up. We've had terrible luck with in home aides. At least at the facility my mom is at you have the option for a personal aide full time."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxjx3po/

"Hospice care for immobile parent likely requiring 24-hour attention - in-home or facility?. My parent has at best a few weeks left due to aggressive untreatable cancer. They are currently in the hospital eating basically nothing except a nutrition drip that will be ceased soon, they are not mobile and cannot use the bathroom, need to be turned, need to be given morphine periodically. I am trying to decide if me and my sibling can handle in-home hospice, as they have expressed a preference to come home. We both work full-time office jobs and have no experience caregiving for children or elderly. There is however a good long-term care policy in play here which would help with the hiring of private duty caregivers and nurses as needed. Though it seems wildly inefficient to have someone here 24/7 if they really only needs to be checked on periodically and bathed, changed, given morphine, and potentially fed if they will eat anything compared to a facility where one caregiver can assist multiple patients. Some people tell me to honor her wishes; others tell me they would never put the stress of in-home care managing on their kids. I am trying to make the best decision for the the three of us here but need some input. I know there's some challenges with in-home care with neglectful staff or theft or no-shows. But with a facility, the parent would pass in an unfamiliar place and be unable to see their pets. Thanks for any insight you can provide."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cnh2bb/hospice_care_for_immobile_parent_likely_requiring/

"I will say that where I live in North Florida the two best nursing homes are non-profit. The actual facilities do not look as nice or upscale as the for profit facilities, but the staff are treated better and there is less turnover. My Mom is in a locked memory care unit in a nursing home. Daily rate is \$400 for context. And we are in the process of applying for Medicaid because she can't afford that for years on end."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/ohwpky1/

Nobody warns you · 69 documents

20 most engaged of 69 matching documents, complete text.

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "'People ask how they can help and I have no words.' I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"Getting kicked out of independent/assisted living facility due to poor hygiene. TL;DR: my grandpa is absolutely disgusting and his lack of hygiene is going to get him kicked out of his living facility. My mom (his daughter) and I have tried everything and at this point, we have no idea what else to do. Warning: this is gross. Some backstory: my grandfather fell about a year ago and was on the ground for 3 days before my mom called for a welfare check. He has a history of forgetting/refusing to charge his phone, so we often weren't able to get ahold of him and were calling for welfare checks multiple times a month. After the fall, he agreed to move into an independent/assisted living facility. The condition of his home was horrifying. Urine and feces everywhere. Dead mice and mouse droppings. Rotting food. Mold. The works. We spent weeks cleaning and threw out at least 2 dumpsters worth of stuff. He would never let anyone into the house so we had no idea how bad it was. We moved him into a lovely facility and he was so happy that he was in tears. I decorated, made it homey, and really set him up for success with an easy-to-maintain and organized space and regularly scheduled housekeeping. It was a great fresh start. Within a few months, the complaints started. Other residents have been complaining that he stinks like urine and feces (and they are correct). The facility contacted us and said that they can smell the apartment from the hallway and other residents are upset. We were surprised because we set up housekeeping and laundry service, as well as someone who comes to give him a bi-weekly shower. Turns out, he's been refusing all of those services. Never cleaning, never showering. We went in and did a full deep-clean and had a very uncomfortable conversation with him. He seemed to understand and promised not to refuse housekeeping anymore. Less than a week later, the apartment was in the same condition as before and he was refusing services again. This has now happened multiple times. Facility staff have also talked to him multiple times. When we ask why he's like this, he just says "I'm lazy" or "I just don't care." He refuses mental health help, won't see a doctor, etc etc etc. The housekeepers have trouble stomaching his apartment. Last time they cleaned, we found out that they had to use paint scrapers to chip feces-coated toilet paper off of the KITCHEN FLOOR. The carpet is soaked in urine. His laundry is piled sky-high and he isn't disposing of his urine/feces soaked Depends, just leaving them in his underwear on the floor. There's blood everywhere from his unmanaged psoriasis. I could go on for hours. It's revolting. The facility contacted us again. Basically, if this doesn't improve immediately, he's going to be evicted. He has one month to get his shit together. I have no idea what to do. He loves living there, but I understand why they can't allow him to stay. All of the other facilities in the area are less nice and more expensive. He has nowhere else to go. We have done everything we can to make this easy for him, but he won't stop turning services away. Nothing we say makes a difference. I am sorry this was so long. At this point, I'm desperate. Has anyone been through something like this? Do you have any advice? Edit to add: This is absolutely a mental health issue, and as much as I want him to see a doctor and get help, he is completely non-compliant. Even when we physically get him to a doctor, he will not engage. He will literally just sit there and refuse to talk, then yell at us for meddling. I wish it was easier. Another quick edit since this is getting some attention: He was never a clean guy - his hygiene has been a lifelong issue. My grandma said it was part of the reason they got divorced (specifically, she remembers crying while scrubbing skid marks out of his underwear at the age of 19 and wondering if that's what marriage was really supposed to be like). This is a new low, but his hygiene has always been a problem."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 203 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t11ql5/getting_kicked_out_of_independent_assisted_living/

"How to challenge discharge of your parent from a hospital or skilled nursing facility (USA only). Hi, I have an 85 year old mother, and I thought I'd share it because I didn't know about this until very recently. Under the Medicare rules, covered patients are given rights to challenge discharge decisions from a hospital or skilled nursing facility. You can do this by calling a company called Kepro, which is a QIO, or Quality Improvement Organization. They are independent of Medicare and the insurance companies that run Medicare Advantage plans. After you [call them,](<https://www.keproqio.com/bene/helpline.aspx>) they'll ask for the reasons why you think your parent needs more care. Just state your case in the simplest and most factual way you can. They will then request medical records from the facility that is trying to discharge them, and their consulting physician will review the case and rule on the appeal within 1-2 days. If you win the appeal, the facility will have to continue

treatment of your parent until the next notice of non-coverage is received, at which time you can file another appeal if you think your parent still needs care. I wish I had known about this before, as there were other times when the hospitals my mother was at discharged her too quickly which led to a rapid re-admission which was bad for her and costly for her insurance company."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/11fn0tb/how_to_challenge_discharge_of_your_parent_from_a/

↳ **comment** (24): "Ideally it sounds great except I tried to appeal 3 times and was denied 3 times discharge from a skilled nursing facility. And I am a nurse so I found evidence and was able to articulate in medical terms the need. If there is lack of 'progress' or 'medical need', it may not work. Organizations are very good at documenting so that these appeals fail. I tried everything but my mom was categorized as a long term patient and we needed to go the route of Medicaid in order cover the nursing home, and ultimately a Medicaid home program. Meanwhile we had to pay the long term care out of pocket, which at the time was \$8000/month. Medicare does not cover long term care. Once home, you are challenged with finding caregivers because they are paid so poorly. Its frustrating and was incredibly eye opening. For people with high care needs, options are so limited. If something happens to my dad, my mom will need to go back in a nursing home and there are no beds or places within 200 miles that will accept a Medicaid patient. You are put on a waiting list. And although it's seems logical, I cannot afford to lose my job to care for my mom or make my small house handicap accessible. She is bed bound and needs full care. I already drive 100 miles round trip multiple times per week to help. My mom now qualifies for hospice, which offers a little bit more support and bathing. So not ideal but my parents get to be home together which is what they want. Aging in place sounds so good, but in many states Medicaid has poor funding."

↳ **comment** (8): "Skilled nursing facilities are always trying to boot 🏠 people as fast as they can."

↳ **comment** (3): "It should be. Call the case manager at your hospital or SNF where your parent is being treated and ask."

"My mom was diagnosed with Alzheimer's a year ago, and it's like I got a second full-time job. Like you said, I had no idea! No one is prepared for this."

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

"I'd go. What they don't tell you about dying is that it often drags on like this. The movies make it seem like its a few days and everyone jumps on a plane for the last moments. The reality is that for a lot of people it goes on for months or years. At first you think its imminent so you take off work, cancel vacations, maybe even put off your own medical appointments because you want to be available. But eventually you have to go back to work, take care of yourself, enjoy your own life. He is going to die and not going on your vacation will not change that. I'd go."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 67 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tp9u65/should_we_cancel_a_family_trip_because_our_dad_is/oo77pcc/

"Here's what has helped me since becoming a full time caregiver. The TLDR of my (F64) story is that I have a 33 year old daughter ("Joan") who has Down syndrome. She was living in an apartment with a roommate, had a part-time job, a full life, and support coming in to help her and her roommate with laundry, grocery shopping, cleaning and socializing. This was her life for almost 8 years until she had a stroke two years ago. Now she lives with my husband (M67) and me. It's not the life I want, or the life my husband and I thought we'd be living at this age. We are looking for a long term living solution for Joan because we don't want decisions made in a moment of crisis should something happen to my husband and me. In the meantime, here are some things I've done to make this situation less stressful. Take or leave it as you like. \- I created a simple weekly menu for Joan. I give it to her each

week, and she enjoys filling it out. It is something I typed up in a Word document, and I make changes occasionally. If you would like a sample of what I've used, DM me, and I will send you a template, and you can modify to your needs. This eliminates guessing what to make for breakfast, lunch and dinner. It also comes in handy if a care provider is here during mealtime. \- I make simple meals for dinners and freeze individual portions. Examples: Crockpot To Die For Beef, meatballs in spaghetti sauce, sloppy joe. It is so much less time consuming than cooking a meal every.single.day. \- The menu includes at least 2-3 meals that are takeout. Examples: Cousin's sub, Culver's, wraps from the grocery store. \- I online shop and arrange pickup on a day and time convenient for me. \- Joan has a whiteboard for her weekly schedule. I created magnets for the repetitive/frequent/chronic activities so that doing the weekly schedule is quick and easy. DM me if you want ideas on how to do this. \- We have help with outside support every day, except Sunday. I arrange my personal time around the support. I delegate almost all of Joan's laundry, showering, and maintaining her room to the outside support. \- I manage Joan's doctor and dentist appointments, social outings, day programming and support in a monthly planner. When there's a change or an adjustment, I use Bic EZ Correct white out. \- The management of Joan's care is a job, and I set aside specific times to do her scheduling, the calendar, meals, etc. It creates some consistency and gives me more time than I thought I would have to do the things I want to do. I hope this helps someone out there. Caregiving can be demanding, but with some structure, it can be manageable.

Edited to add: Here are some things I've learned after having caregivers come to our house almost every day for the past year and a half: \- Manage your expectations. I had no idea what to expect or ask for with regard to the level of care our daughter needed after her stroke. I was told care providers would do laundry, housekeeping, give showers, provide companion care....you just can't expect one provider to do all of that in one shift, and you can't expect them to do everything the same way you do. If something needs to be done in a specific way, a) show them how to do it or b) accept that you do it better than anyone else can and continue to take on that task or c) accept that the way they do it is now the "new normal". \- Play to the strengths of each care provider. I've learned that each care provider brings a strength to the party. One care provider is good at laundry. One is good at encouraging our daughter to do her exercises. One does housekeeping like a pro. If something needs to be done in a specific way (helping your loved one in and out of bed for example), you need to show them. You can't assume they know how to do something. Delegate tasks to specific providers on the days they work with Joan. I put this on Joan's whiteboard. So if "Nora" is scheduled for Tuesdays 5:30-8:30, I'll have Nora's name on the whiteboard, the hours she is working, and under that have "Laundry" or "Vacuum and Dust Joan's Room". \- Decide when showers will work for your loved one. Joan gets a shower almost every other day. Your loved one may need more or less. When I plan the week for Joan, I look at her activities, who is providing care, and plan the showers around that. I put "Shower" on the whiteboard under the care provider's name. I am the default shower person, which is no problem, but having others provide showers gives me a break. \- Decide what your line in the sand is, so to speak. My "line in the sand" is that protocols are followed regarding Joan's toileting care. She needs help after a bowel movement. I make it clear to whoever is working with her that she needs help in this area and I explain the protocol. The agency we work with is aware of this, and the people I hire privately are aware of this. Joan has not had a single UTI since her stroke. Try to limit your "lines in the sand". Burnt toast should not be a line in the sand, lol. \- Treat your care providers well. They need to know they are appreciated. I express thanks to them frequently - "Thank you for coming today." "I appreciate that you ran the dishwasher and emptied it." You don't need to do anything extravagant, but there is something to be said for saying "thank you." \- Accept that caregivers will come and go. My daughter has had support throughout her life. It has come in many forms—respite care, doctors, therapists, supportive home care, and now, direct care providers. Looking back, I think this has worked in her favor. She has grown up understanding that the people who support her may change, and she has learned to accept and adapt to those changes. \- Accept that care can come from people other than family - If your loved one has never had people outside of the family caring for them, I can understand why the idea of having caregivers come and go might feel difficult. It can be hard to trust someone else with the care of a person you love so deeply. One thing I have learned is that the people who care for our daughter who are not family often do a better job than family can. Not because family doesn't love her but because caring for people is their calling. This is what they do. They have

experience, training, patience, and skills that family may not have. \- Adopt an attitude of gratitude. This, again, is not the life I would choose to be living. But I am so grateful for people who provide good care and are reliable. I am grateful our daughter is who she is - she doesn't complain, she is not demanding, she is accepting. I am grateful for my husband. He is the funniest guy and makes this situation so much more tolerable with his sense of humor. Find things to be grateful for that make this situation tolerable."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 56 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1viux10/heres_what_has_helped_me_since_becoming_a_full/

↳ **comment** (10): "All of that sounds awesome and I will probably borrow several ideas but what I need ASAP is your recipe for crockpot to die for beef. 😊 "

↳ **comment** (5): "This is an amazingly helpful amount of information. Thank you! I tried to DM you for a copy of your weekly menu but was not able to get that to work. If possible, could you post a photo of one of your weekly menus for Joan?"

↳ **comment** (5): "SCRUBZZ... no rinse pre soaped disposables...a godsend"

"Something you touched on is so important and needs to be really looked at, changed, or something. It's about Adult Protective Services. First, I need to tell you a little about my dad. He's an abusive narcissist hoarder. Before he lost his home, it was a horror. No electricity worked, rats chewed through the wires, no refrigeration, heating, air conditioning, and junk piled to the ceiling with small paths through them. Floors were falling through in areas. This all spilled to the outside of the home and covered 2 full acres. On top of that, he has MS and diabetes, and is in his early 70s and literally sometimes has to crawl from the living to his bed. He is also mentally ill, and said that one of his grandchildren planned to shoot and kill him. I heard that conversation and it's not even close to true. He's burned all his bridges, of course and now he's living in a travel trailer in a park and the living conditions are already just as bad as in the house he was in. So, my mom (who is separated from him and lives with me, the "scapegoat") and my sister have both tried to help him to hire someone to do repairs, cleanup, and eventually suggested retirement home. All of these things he refuses to this day. He refuses all senior resources like Meals on Wheels and transportation, etc. We have called Adult Protective Services (the point of my post), and they went out to talk to him and give him pamphlets, telling him resources and help available to him, etc. And he listened and they left but of course, my dad just throws it in the garbage, refusing help. Here's the problem I have with Adult Protective Services and why I am so grateful for your video. They were NO HELP to us. They were simply too focused on "he has his rights to live how he wants"... I said "But he owns several guns and he's mentally ill, and afraid his grandson wants to kill him! Isn't there SOMETHING we can do based on that for safety of others, himself?" they said the only thing we can do is take him to court to get conservatorship but that's expensive and hard to do. This didn't come from just one visit and team that went out to his house, it came from THREE. The same thing.... there is simply nothing we can do. Our dad lost all the money he had and then out of the blue sold his house without anyone knowing for pennies on the dollar for what it was worth, not giving any of us a chance to at least buy it and turn it over. But, that's beside the point except to say that there is no money left for the court that APS said we need. Nothing. We're left with only one option. Take his abuse to get him to his doctors appointments and to bring him food and take a verbal pounding while doing it. That's IT!! And, as Wayne Dryer has said "allowing yourself to be abused is an act of abuse". Seriously, he is VERY verbally abusive. The one person that takes it well is my poor mom. And, I know that with things how they are and the experience I've had with Enablers Anonymous, is that she is probably hurting him more than helping him by helping him at all. BUT, in your video you gave options I didn't know about and I am definitely going to make calls. So I want you, and others to know just how unhelpful APS is to families in situations like this. (or, how they CAN be, I'm sure that some are more helpful than our experiences with them, somewhere). And I think this needs to be addressed. I'm going to write some letters and do what I can, but I wanted to get this out there. Thank you so much for your wonderful advice, it's just what we needed!"

youtube · @ThunderDove-q7g · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 39 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyBokX_sGMmyStihJ4AaABAq

↳ @SofiaAmirpoor (5): "@God Wins wow, that's such a hard horrible situation! You are right! Most people don't want APS to get involved out of some fear. They don't realize that APS can be a great advocate. However, because of its voluntary nature, the staff can't always help, their hands are tied. But I do applaud you for looking towards APS for help. I do have one suggestion regarding getting conservatorship. Yes it is expensive, (several thousand dollars) and takes time (6-12 months). If cost is prohibiting you from pursuing this, there are ways that you can apply for conservatorship without paying an attorney (if you meet the financial criteria). Do an internet search for "<county your father lives in> Superior court conservatorship" and look for the self help section. You should be able to locate the forms necessary to apply for conservatorship by yourself, without using an attorney. Each county should also have a Legal Aid department that can assist with this process and they often have workshops to help walk you through the process. You might also be able to find a Legal Assistant who can help with the process, instead of an attorney, at a fraction of the cost. Even though the process could be free, there are still court costs associated with obtaining conservatorship. Again, if you yourself are low income, you can ask the court to waive these fees. As far as the time it takes.....well, time is going to pass whether you are going through the process of conservatorship or not and dad will still need this intervention in 6-12 months, so may as well get started now! I hope this was helpful info. Keep us posted on how it goes!"

"Yep, I would tend to agree. My father was silent generation, my mom a boomer, and I'm a younger millennial. Even as my father received his terminal diagnosis and began to deteriorate, all discussions of plans, final wishes, etc, were expressly forbidden and would deeply agitate them both. This of course caused A Whole Circus when he finally passed in January and we had no idea what he wanted, where he wanted to end up, his accounts, etc. It was really, really challenging, and somewhat frustrating knowing I tried to initiate conversations many years ago (they certainly know my final wishes!) Luckily it's motivated my mom to have a change of heart and start discussing her plans. But she often says it just feels "wrong" to talk about."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/ocbkdbi/

"Tomorrow will 2 years since we lost our Mother. And it's been a year since we lost my MIL. We took care of both of my parents from 2018-2023. MIL we took care of from 2016-2024. No one knows until they experience this. I had no idea nor did my husband. It became so deep that I would forget my birthday at times, spouting out my parents DOB etc when I was asked for mine usually at my docs. Consuming wasn't and isn't a descriptive enough word. Exhausting, both mentally and physically. Drowning in the inevitable demise of someone you love. I miss my Mother with all of my heart for eternity. The woman I remember is the Mother who took care of me, not the 93 year old. And I'm positive she'd understand. Our Mothers didn't suffer from dementia, that's hard in and of itself. Because they are (were) aware. God bless you as you go thru this. Pray and I promise there's a light at the end of the tunnel."

youtube · @paintedlady6717 · Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this? · 20 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=Ugyb_p3bloX_0clu5-54AaABAq

"Wow. This is all really good information and I had no idea about these things. I wonder if the thing to do is hire a pair of home aides to trade off hours and bypass the service entirely. Plus hire a nurse to come in as necessary. It has to be kind of scary to venture into strangers' homes and kind of set up shop, so to speak. I figure everyone lives the same way I do, kind of comfortable upper-middle class, but obviously that's nowhere near accurate, or even reasonable to think. Thanks for the eye-opener. You've given me a lot to think about."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/nitf6d3/

"Holy cow that is *scary*, I had no idea that home hospice providers weren't required to record such training, and the fallout that could occur for just trying to administer prescribed medications to our loved ones. Thank you for sharing your story and spearheading this cause!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1rp6in8/marshas_law_website_a_law_protectin_g_caregivers/o9jd4ul/

"Similar situation here. My parents nice house started to fall in on itself. Mom checked out and started drinking and leaving my immobile dad in bad situations. No help from siblings. I've lost a bit of my career to move back to my home state and take care of them. I have them in a house 5 mins away. Feels like I'm being waterboarded at times. One problem fixed and another arises. My dad is on a waiting list to get into the best place their insurance will help cover, but his needs seem to increase daily and I can't keep up. A lot of their money is going towards private care. It's still not enough to cover their needs. You're right, no one prepares you for this. Something as simple as maintaining long term healthcare insurance goes a long way. Good luck to everyone dealing with these things. I never knew it could or would be this stressful."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/o5cyn16/

"No one prepares you for this. Caring for aging parents can be heartbreaking, exhausting, and full of guilt no one talks about. If you've been through it—or you're going through it now—I see you. What's something you wish someone had told you before it started?"

youtube · @SoloSecondHalf · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 11 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzXseRkpj_h5dR-m254AaABAg

↳ **@RA-sv8lr** (2): "Don't bury your head in the sand when parents start ageing. Get all the legal and money stuff sorted ahead of time. Look into emergency care options even if only on a temporary basis because, with elderly people, everything is fine until it's not fine and then it's REALLY not fine (my own experience)"

↳ **@TommyLGBTQetc** (0): "Have a plan going in, not just a hope that it works out fine. Sign up the relatives right away to get them involved on the ground floor then they can't have the fake excuse they didn't want to intrude or push their opinions. Also, realize the parent is going to get worse and be at their worst, and you as the caregiver will definitely say it is the hardest thing you have EVER had to do."

↳ **@YeshuaKingMessiah** (0): "I started taking care of dementia and intact old ppl in nsg homes in my early 20s. I've done hospice too. I've midwived a good bit too at homebirths. I'm now 60. I don't think anyone can surprise me. GET EXPERIENCE My kids helped me w/the several family members who lived with us or we with them - and are fine around dysfunctional ppl. It's ok to Do The Hard Things."

"Send Dad to Temp Respite Care or do 24/7 In Home Care While Primary Caregiver is Recovering from Surgery?. Hi everyone, My dad is 70 years old and suffers from Parkinson's and dementia. My mom, to be 71 on Tuesday, was diagnosed with breast cancer and will have a partial mastectomy with reconstruction on March 5. I myself had thyroid cancer which I had surgery for in November and just completed my post-surgery radiation treatment (I-1331 pills). I have had nerve damage in my left arm from the surgery and can't lift like I used to, though I'm doing a couple months of PT to help. I know I can't explain the whole situation here, but my dad needs help with most ADLs. He often needs a walker or wheelchair in the mornings, but otherwise is shakily mobile. However, he can't operate any electronics, we do his pills, some days he sleeps (almost comatose) until 5 or 6 pm, he almost never makes it to the bathroom on time (he is in depends). He gets confused easily and gets moderate sundowners; some days are worse than others. We have only recently been able to secure in-home care for him and are still on a trial period of 4 hours a day/5 days a week. The company will be able to do 24/7 care if we need on the day of my mom's surgery and afterwards. I will be taking her and possibly staying overnight with her at the hospital. Then I

will bring her back to her home (I don't live far, about 9 miles). Hopefully that's enough info to present my question for peoples' opinions. My dad was hospitalized about 2 years ago (for context as to his mental state, he had been diagnosed but he was still kind of managing his own pills and could use the bathroom unassisted) and had a bout of ICU psychosis. He attacked me and my mom, attacked nurses, had to be restrained, was generally unpleasant and had no idea where he was (or even "when" he was). Needless to say, getting him home was pretty stressful. It wasn't as bad as mom and I expected (I had to take almost all my allotted year's PTO the next two weeks) but it was rough. We're trying to weigh whether we think dad should just be out of the house completely while I stay with my mom and she recovers from her surgery, or if we think it is better to leave him at home and get in-home care for just dad 24/7 until she's able to help again. She'll have at least 2 drains, no lifting for 4 weeks, and possibly more restrictions. I've been with her for multiple other surgery recoveries and each one has been harder than the one before. But we are worried about changing his environment for 4-6 weeks and then dealing with him when he comes back home. Pricing might also determine what we do, but my mom was at her breaking point recently which is why I pushed finally for in-home care. Part of me wants dad to just be OUT of the house so mom can be stress-free but we both worry most about bringing him back home. Mom should be recovered but if she still has restrictions, having dad home and completely disoriented could be a problem. I don't want him attacking me, or mom, or a caregiver because of his environmental change. I know every situation is different, but I'd like to know if anyone has had to make a similar decision and if they would change their decision in retrospect, or maybe have more insight into something like this than I do? Thanks in advance if you've made it to the end!"

reddit post · r/dementia · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1ir3jmx/send_dad_to_temp_respite_care_or_do_247_in_home/

"My brother finally stepped up a couple months ago. I still have to coordinate everything and take care of all the "behind the scenes" stuff, but at least my brother is watching her for periods so I can go home, see my husband, go to my own appointments, etc. The first time he watched her for more than a couple hours he told me he "had no idea how much [I] was doing". Ummm, yeah, you didn't think about it because I was taking care of everything. He got married earlier this year. Mom was in the hospital for 8 days right before the wedding. He didn't come to the hospital once. He even had the gall to ask me to help with wedding stuff when I got mom home the day before. He was lucky I didn't absolutely lose my shit at him. Just zero self awareness."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrz1v3c/

"Home care agency issue. While my dad was receiving home hospice services, we hired a home healthcare aide through an agency to assist with his care. After he passed, the owner of the agency mentioned that the contract required a 2 week notice prior to termination of services or we would still be responsible for paying for the 2 week period. I told her it was not possible for us to give her 2 weeks notice when we had no idea when my dad would pass. She responded saying that in this situation, many clients still offered to pay for an extra 1 or 2 weeks which I kind of find hard to believe. Anyway, I told her the whole thing wasn't sitting right with me and that we would pay for the 2 hours the aide worked the day he passed. Now she's insisting that we at least pay for the full day because the aide drove 30 minutes to my parents house just to get sent home in 2 hours (because he died!!). Even if we do pay for the day, I have a feeling the owner would just keep the money and not pay the aide. Has anyone else been in this situation? I'm wondering if this is standard practice in this field or if she's taking advantage of my family during a very vulnerable time"

reddit post · r/eldercare · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/eldercare/comments/1pazd1d/home_care_agency_issue/

"what they don't tell you is any property that the person receiving the services owns, goes to the government to repay the cost of providing services, they'll take house, car, everything. and don't try and keyboard warrior this, they took my grandma's home that had been in the family 60 years"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@cece.the..rn/video/7665486240430525710> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@cece.the..rn/video/7665486240430525710>

"This is a question I sit with too. my parents are both in their early 90s. My mom has congestive heart failure and is in a wheelchair after a fall that injured her hip badly enough to make walking intolerable. My dad has dementia. They have a DNR in place and we've had the conversation about what they actually want. And still. When my mom was having trouble breathing , nobody said "should we just make her comfortable?" We called 911. You call 911. That's what you do. The system takes over from there, and the system is built to save, not to ask. I don't think what you're describing is cold at all. It's the difference between what we say we want and what we do in the moment. Your mother was ready. The EMTs didn't know that, and even if they did, they're trained to stabilize. Nobody in that chain of events has the authority to say "let her go" in real time. The paperwork exists for that but it doesn't show up in time. Shortly after my mom was diagnosed with congestive heart failure, she told me about someone she knew who had a near-death experience and likely would have died without paramedics stepping in. They were able to bring her back, but the CPR broke several of her ribs, and she died 12 days later. Those last days were dominated by the pain from her injuries. Hearing that story shook my mom, and she has been very clear with us: if she is "checking out," she wants us to let her go rather than prolong things at any cost. Another example: my mom shared a hospital room with a woman with cancer. The woman was recovering from major surgery and was in extreme discomfort. It was uncomfortable just being in the room with her. During Moms stay the woman learned that the surgery was unsuccessful. The doctors sent her home to die. I'll never forget the anger and pain in her voice as she asked, "why did I do all this?" That's not a good way to go. I think if we listen our loved ones might be trying to tell us this kind of thing. It's hard for us, but I find it useful to acknowledge that the people they were aren't really here anymore. In many ways they are already gone. It's not terrible to say that. It's just a truth that makes things a bit easier for me. I don't have an answer to the bigger question you're raising. I think you're right that we act as though we want elderly people to live forever, and the cost of that assumption falls on people like us and our parents both. I respect the hell out of "I am not doing this to my kids." That's love."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oj5d0x7/

"I feel this one. Set boundaries!! I wish someone had told me that early on. Mom went into a rehab after knee surgery, but had to stay several months due to needing IV antibiotics (an infection caused the need for surgery). The rehab wasn't far from home, so I made the mistake of going everyday at first. She came to expect it. She would call and ask where I was on the few nights I didn't stop because I was worn out from work."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_often/p21qyh3/

"Thank you so much. I knew this time would not be easy, but I had no idea they would have the audacity to show up and try to tell me what to do!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 4 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1ul4inf/the_strangest_after_death_occurrences_with_family/ov2m9mg/

The sugar-coating and the empty words · 44 documents

20 most engaged of 44 matching documents, complete text.

"NPR story on caring for aging parents (venting). NPR did a story yesterday morning on caring for aging parents, interviewing a woman who ended up taking care of her mother 24/7 while her mother was bedridden. While it accurately depicted the struggles of caregiving, it ended as most of these stories do by making it redemptive, saying what a beautiful thing it was or what a privilege it was to take care of her mother. My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together. I used to think I might "get my life back," but I've found that you don't. You can't get back all the lost social and career opportunities. You don't get your mental and physical health back. You have to figure out what to do with what's left. I took care of my mother because I felt it was my duty as her son to do so. Most people tell me I objectively did a good job, but I was never temperamentally suited to the role. I forced myself to do it, every day. I put a mask on and was pleasant to her, but I hated having to try to get my mother to do the basic things she needed to do every day. By the end, as her dementia progressed, it felt pointless. I was maintaining a body that had very little mind left in it when I could have been putting my own mind to work in my business, solving problems for clients. I lost my biggest client because I didn't have time to do the work he needed me to do. I resented it. Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy. It was traumatizing. And now I'm still dealing with my mother's estate with a sibling who thinks she deserves half of everything even though she did absolutely nothing to help, ever. She couldn't care less what it cost me. She takes it all for granted. I just hate when people try to sugar-coat what caregiving does to your life and try to frame it in sentimental terms. It wrecked my mental and physical health. It wrecked my business. It wrecked my social and romantic life. It's made me hate my sister for her apathy and greed. I'm 59 and trying to get back into the dating world, and I feel like I'm having to learn how to do it all over again. I'm having to re-learn how to go out and socialize with people. I can only relate my own story, but caregiving didn't leave me with some rosy afterglow. Caregiving wrecked my life. I'm satisfied that I did my duty to my mother, but that's it. It didn't give me some wonderful gift. The news media will never report that story. Edit: Thanks for all the responses. Part of what set me off yesterday was the fact that it was my mother's birthday, and several people sent me messages about how I must be thinking about my mom today. The thing is, I wasn't. I was working all day trying to get a job done for a new client. And I thought about my mother 24/7 for years. I'm done thinking about my mother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,034 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

"Old people are not all cute and wise. Caring for them can be like caring for your abuser. You force yourself due to guilt and pressure. I can't stand when people say things like "you should visit more often" I see my parents 3-4 times per week and take care of their issues ongoing daily. What more do people want? They want the ultimate sacrifice of me moving them into my home and destroying any small amount of peace I have in my life. Please never put your opinion on caregivers when you are not the one living the nightmare GOD IS GOOD. That was two years ago. I prayed and prayed that God would somehow help us. My mom's attitude has completely changed. She went from being critical and negative to understanding and supportive! Wow! I cannot believe it myself. One thing I did is I started opening up to her and telling her how I also was not well. I don't think she really had considered how stressed I have been. I pray that God may give caregivers the strength and peace to go on caring for their loved ones and themselves."

youtube · @Yolduranduran · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 504 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugx2Jz5sA7cmhdaD54AaABAq>

↳ **@feliscatus1834** (36): "I am getting burned out overseeing my mother's care in asst. living with Parkinson's disease. Already taken her to 7 doctors appt. this month, she doesn't get around well & her room is a mess at the

facility. I am EXHAUSTED taking care of her laundry, getting her diapers etc. My brother won't even drop by to see her & say "hello", he lives in the area. My life isn't the same, I am raising two teenage sons & married, this sucks I can tell you honestly it sucks, I cannot take her in or quit my part time job either. I HATE this!! I hope I die first before becoming a burden on my sons!!"

↳ @spiderpig24321 (18): "Yep Yolanda ...taking care of 2 abusers due to a sense of duty. They dont even try to help with their grandkids"

↳ @Okalani5000 (14): "Sometimes asking is not enough. Some people ask, even beg for help and never get any. Sometimes you just end up going crazy over it all. @TVResults"

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful.* Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her.* I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom CHOSE this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly AGAINST having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends ALSO saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit AGAIN, find a new place to live AGAIN, set up all my utilities AGAIN, and STILL have to manage HER life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING. I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7

months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER. THIS, more than ANYTHING, should be a clue that mom is NOT who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and THEN people will complain that mom is LONELY. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags under her bed rather than in the 3 FUCKING HAMPERS I've bought for her) FINALLY getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group

chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations: Youre so strong Translation: Youre on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are theyre really saying theyre not going to help you. Theyre admiring your ability to handle it so they dont have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow youre so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. Were just surviving it because theres no other option. I dont need your theology. I need respite care. I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. Theyd watch me help my mom with everything then say I dont know how you do it and leave. If you dont know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Dont stand there marveling at my survival skills like Im some interesting specimen. Im doing this because I dont have a choice and you wont help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: Im going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you wont ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person were caring for so we can sleep. Dont make us ask. Ive got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. Theres more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If youre a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity... you dont need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say Im coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. Thats the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help

putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): ""enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

"THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much--COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 95 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobb2tw/

"Elderly parents need to massively declutter to downsize. My parents (Mom 89, Dad 92) have gotten to the point where they don't think they can live on their own any longer. My brother, sister, and I understand and agree. Well, I think our Mom would still be fine, but my Dad is declining and it is getting difficult for my Mom to take on the extra work and responsibilities. They are getting serious about selling their house to move to some kind of independent-living/assisted-living facility. The situation is that they have \[IMO\] a ton of stuff. My Dad would be fine to just pick out whatever few things they might need to take with them and get rid of the rest somehow. But my Mom has trouble letting things go. Seven years ago they moved from a home in the mountains down to a lower elevation in a small town. They ended up putting stuff in storage units. With my brother's help, they got that whittled down to one storage unit a couple of years ago. Now, my siblings and I want to just take everything out of the storage unit and donate it (or whatever) without even going through it. It has been there for years, they don't remember what's in there, so it can't be that important, right? And now a move to a facility means they probably need to dispose of, what, 90% of their stuff? I shudder at having to clean out the workbench and tools in the garage. Are there any emotional or psychological tips to getting a parent to let go and declutter? I'm hoping that Mom will see the need and let it happen. And even if she does, is there any way to help soften the blow? They've been so strong and healthy for so long. They are the last of all of their lifelong friends to still be alive, and this move will, I fear, be a truly neon sign as to their own decline."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 78 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rkulf2/elderly_parents_need_to_massively_declutter_to/

↳ **comment** (83): "At this point the best thing is to be a little deceptive. No one wants their items thrown in a dumpster. You could store their things in a unit for a while as another person suggested, then when they forget what's in there, do what you need to do. You could also create situations where people need particular things. "There is a young family whose house burnt down, they have nothing left, can they have your couch/dining room set/hutch?" And do that way. Sometimes if they know their items are going to charity, and you have created a back story of someone so excited about getting their items, it makes it so much easier. Then they feel a part of

things and they feel helpful and purposeful. "My neighbor is looking for a carpet cleaner, so you have one they can borrow?" "Church is having a clothing drive/coat collection/needs extra Christmas decorations, can I look and see if you have some?" It takes a bit longer to do this and really do give the items to charity. But telling them it's all going to a dumpster or Goodwill can be painful for them."

↳ **comment** (39): "Agree to moving the 90% of the stuff into another storage unit. After 6 months goes by, feel free to empty both storage units, sell the items or donate and set the money aside for your parents care down the road. Your mother's probably not even going to realize it after 6 months occurs that there's anything in there that she absolutely has to have and if there is you can explain to her that it was broken into and items were stolen and therefore you got a settlement from the insurance but you hadn't bothered to tell her because you didn't want to upset her."

↳ **comment** (31): "I think this is going to be a key strategy. I'm pretty sure she would feel ok if she knew the items were going to someone who could use them. Thanks!"

"Very accurate. I literally felt suicidal from the stress of caregiving, the stress of watching my mom slowly die (and knowing I'd have her disease), and from feeling abandoned by my family & community. All these platitudes meant nothing to me...when people even bothered to say them."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nry2xlp/

">Caregivers don't let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. This one especially. People would ask, sincerely, what can I do to help? And I honestly didn't know what to tell them. A friend sent a meal weekly, others have picked up prescriptions when I asked. Family isn't local, but they could have at least texted once in awhile. Only one family member bothered, I'll be moving near her to continue the harassment in the future, lol. Mom is gone and with her the intensive caregiving: bedbound with Alzheimer's. But dad's on hospice too though his isn't dementia, it's heart failure. It's easier now, but I'm still home all the time, I can't impulsively run to the store or be gone for hours. He'd probably be okay, but he's A) a fall risk and B) a stubborn old bastard. Your translations are dead-on. And I really wish people would say what they really mean or say nothing at all. Silence hurts, but empty words give false hope, in the beginning anyway. Then you learn what it really means."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrxoqjl/

"This! All of this! Unless you've lived it you just don't get it. We don't want to be strong, we don't want to be brave, we don't want your empty platitudes. We want our lives! We want help! (We want sleep) We want a system, a safety net, a community if you will; it takes a village yet we are left with a one man band."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobpowk/

"Taking care of a terminally ill parent at 24 and realizing how alone you actually are. I don't even know if this is a rant, a question, or just me shouting into the void, but I need to put this somewhere. I am 24. Living in Indore, India. I am currently trying to symptom manage my terminally ill mother while trying to manage my job while trying to manage insurance, while trying to manage everyone's needs. Every day is about medicines, food intake, IVs, fatigue, sleep cycles, doctor coordination, and just trying to keep her comfortable and alive with dignity. It is physically exhausting but honestly the mental load is worse. My father is emotionally drained to a point where he cannot take decisions. I understand he is hurting, but instead of standing with me and helping me decide what to do or not do, I end up handling everything. Sometimes he even adds more work unintentionally because he is not

able to process things. My brother lives in the US. Peaceful life, stable routine, distance from all this. But he still tries to dictate how everything should be done from there. Calls, instructions, opinions, but not presence. Not actual load sharing. Just more pressure on me to do things exactly how he thinks they should be done. And I am just stuck in the middle of all this. No girlfriend. No real friend who has the maturity or guts to just sit beside me and exist with me in this phase. I have acquaintances. Same age group. 24 to 26. All from well to do families. Their families know what is happening with my mother. Still nobody shows up. Not even once. Not even to just sit for an hour. I used to think cities like Indore were socially connected. That people show up. But now I feel that only works when your life is good. When things are fun. When you are successful or happy or useful socially. The moment life gets ugly and heavy, people disappear. The worst part is I don't even know what kind of help people could have given, because nobody ever says "I can do this for you." And if I ask directly, they check convenience first. If it doesn't suit them, they say no. Which hurts more because I know they would show up for others. It genuinely makes me question what is wrong with me. And socially, I cannot even be real. I have to mask everything. I cannot show grief, fear, anger, or breakdowns because people get uncomfortable. So I end up acting normal so that they don't have to deal with reality. I feel like I am living two lives. One where I am managing a dying parent and holding a family together. Another where I pretend everything is fine so that people don't run away. Is this what adulthood is? Is this what society is now? Or am I just surrounded by the wrong people? I don't even know what I am expecting from posting this. Maybe just to know if someone else has lived this and survived it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r40qaf/taking_care_of_a_terminally_ill_parent_at_24_and/

"I get it and understand the taking the phone off the wall. Fake help or fake care my mom use to call it. You definitely going through it right now. Keep your circle tight and ignore the loud fake noise that's coming your way. There will be many storms and a few sunny days. Just take one minute at a time I've been there I know the stress, the dark thoughts and the negativity you feel. It's okay to hate this shit it's okay to scream out loud and say screw everyone with their fake encouraging words. Thanks for taking the time to read and share your story."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobdftd/

"I read the entire post. Thank you for sharing, im sorry you are going through all of that. Im glad they at least have that apartment with care. You so strong for making sure they are OK. I wish I could give some advice, I know my day is coming where im going to have to take care of my parents. I dont have any advice, but my heart goes out to you and your family. Praying for you."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/o5cbf4d/

"I feel this in my soul. I live 5 hours away from my mom, who requires 24/7 care. My brother lives 45 minutes away. Yet I'm her primary care giver. I always get the "you're so strong" and "I don't know how you do it!" well, Nancy, I don't have a choice! The "let me know if you very need anything" gets me every time. I don't know what you're willing to do, be my crippling social anxiety won't let me ask for fear of you saying no. Thank you for making me feel seen. 💖"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrywb3a/

"I hate the meaningless words and "I love you " that people say when they don't do something practical that can actually help you. I believe in the power of prayer, but it doesn't always work the way people want or when people want. Caregiving bankrupts you financially, emotionally, mentally, physically and spiritually. It's a daily fight to try to save yourself when no else is. Thank you for your post! I hear you and I see you."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobzrve/

"So true. Painful for us hard to read but so true. I saw an art show once where someone painted thoughts and prayers on a trash can. I feel like it falls under this statement. Toxic words and useless. Please let me take a nap."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrxnjo5/

"I am so sick not only of the empty words, but the visits to check in on us,. The extra effort to make the house ready, have snacks and food, and feeling like I have to prepare a report of the current state of things. In the end people leave, and I must catch up on all the tasks I did not do while talking care of the visit. It might be ridiculous but I need someone to come, do those chores, offer to take care of my kid while I take my wife to medical appointments or freaking spend a few hours with her while I take a stroll to see if the world outside still exists."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/noely1g/

"Wow, you live five hours away and your brother forty-five minutes away and you the one provide 24/7 care ohh my that's not fair. Does your brother contribute? Thats so wrong if not. I remember last week, when I took my in-laws to the doctors an 24 year old said excuse me sir You're so strong, I said I've been carrying weight for 30 years do you care to spot me. He smiled and said have a good day."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nryzt7y/

"5+ years solo caregiving to my wife who is non-verbal and quadriplegic. Her mom has come over ONCE to help me over the last month. Always has an excuse why she can't. Her dad moved away. Haven't seen him 6 months. Yet they're always like "She's so lucky! You're so strong, I don't know how you do it! Thank you for taking care of her!" Yeah thanks...that helps so much."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nobvmdb/

"Thank you for eloquently stating what simmers inside me without the ability to articulate my rage . I just know I'm infuriated when I hear the platitudes but you are brilliant in your rant"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrydvv0/

The rage, and the guilt about the rage · 43 documents

20 most engaged of 43 matching documents, complete text.

"How to deal with an aging parent's unrealistic demands. I am 61 (F) and my mother is 86 going on 87. Two years ago, after my father passed away, I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. She has a long list of medical issues and is reluctant to go into care. For the first year I was working from home and balancing her care and the house and my job. Early in 2025 I retired (I took an early retirement offer from my employer) and pretty much immediately my mother's care became more complex. She's had a year of medical issues that I can't even begin to list as it's too long. But in the midst of all of that she saw my retirement as her opportunity to ask me to do all kinds of work around the house. Ok, I agreed to things within my capability like painting a room or doing some gardening work and minor repairs. But she's been bothering me to do more difficult things that (a) I don't have the knowledge to do and (b) are physically too demanding. She's been asking me to lift a bunch of patio slabs that are kind of shifting, refill and level the screening underneath and straighten them up. She mentions this CONSTANTLY. Even in the winter as something she wants done in the spring. We got a quote from someone and it would be close to \$1000 if not more based on the area she wants done. And she says she can't afford it. So I just keep saying no, I'm not doing it. And she keeps insisting "your father would do this; if I were younger and stronger like you I would do this, I used to do these things all the time." Finally, yesterday I had enough when she asked me about it again. I did not lose my temper. When she said "when I was your age I would have done this" I calmly reminded her that at my age she was on track to having her first open heart surgery so no she would not be doing this. Then she said "well your father would..." etc I reminded her that he had help from his friends and brothers most of whom are now too old or deceased. Then when she said well it would cost too much, I finally just said: "Well then, I guess they're going to just have to stay the way they are because I am not doing it and you don't have the money. People who don't have the money and can't do the work don't do it especially if it's not something critical." Like honestly it's all cosmetic at this point. She just doesn't like that they are shifting; nothing is a tripping hazard or anything but this is just one of many things she wants done which I just can not do. And it's a constant "but..." trying to shame me into being lazy and not competent and me saying "no...I'm not doing that; if you want it done we'll hire someone.""

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 362 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/

↳ **comment** (273): "I think they don't have enough going on in their lives so they persevere on this stuff. Also, they do lose track that not everyone who is younger than them has the strength of a 30 year old. 10 or so years ago my mom asked if my husband and his brothers could do some stuff she wanted done around her house, and I had to remind her that that entire crew was now in their mid-fifties and had bad backs! I like to remember that "No" is a full sentence."

↳ **comment** (155): "> I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. There's the problem. edited to add: I count six instances of "her" in that one sentence. It's going to stay all about *her* until you decide to prioritize your own needs and wants."

↳ **comment** (127): "The thing is - this is what's known as "assisted living". If mom can't manage her own care and care of the home (even if "care of the home" means hiring people to do maintenance tasks), then she is no longer living independently. Parents seem to think that adult children as caretakers don't count, and that they are still "independent"."

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and

there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgXk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAg

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of

mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. **TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED.**"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"So Angry at My Dad. My 95 yr old father DROVE 5 days after being admitted to ER observation overnight because he fell in a parking lot ... he also dragged my mother down to the ground when he fell. I moved from another state to help them as they age and they never called to tell me until day AFTER they fell. Lots of bruising, pain/aches, immobility etc but neither of them broke anything but we discussed that he would not be driving until he goes to dr for follow- up. He can't put weight on his right leg. And he drove. My mother lied to me about it. (He lies so often that I'm used to it.) On thanksgiving when I told him he can't drive again until his follow-up appt in 5 days he started to lash out and asked me to leave Thanksgiving. As in get out of the house. I left. I had zero alcohol. Planned what I was going to stay and was very calm. Doesn't matter. He just lost it. I really regret moving back as these two are impossible. I know I have to deal with them but I am so angry at their refusal to listen to common sense, not telling me they were both in ER when I loved back FOR THIS REASON, how he hurt my mother because he refuses to use a cane or walker, and the lies. And the verbal abuse. Oh and how he might hit an innocent person and ruin someone's life, or take someone's life. How do I not be angry when they are so challenging and impossible. He has always been a full-on jerk but getting worse now. I know I don't deserve being yelled at and eating Thanksgiving dinner in a diner alone. I have read a ton about dealing with narcissistic people but I am still so angry. HOW am I supposed to handle them? My sister is In another state. There is no one else here to help. He has alienated other family and not a big family in the first place."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 178 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p9fn38/so_angry_at_my_dad/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"I can't do this anymore, and I never agreed to be a caregiver to my mother's husband.. To sum up some background context, my mom remarried when I was in my mid 20's about 20 years ago. My mom asked me to move in 3.5 years ago to temporarily help her with my son. My mom died 3 years ago, my son died a year ago. I have never been close to her husband, he didn't even start being nice to me till my mom died. I feel I can't leave because I'm the only person he doesn't kick out. I'm coming from a place of deep frustration at the moment, and I'm sorry if I sound like a soulless monster. I just can't do this anymore. My parents didn't divorce till I was an

adult. In extreme desperation, I assume my married, lets call him Frank. (now 75) Frank was the opposite of my father who my mother loved dearly in every bad way. He was uneducated, uncaring and had no family values, but what I could I do. It was her choice to marry him after 4 months. I had my own life going on and briefly stayed with them after being left during my third trimester of pregnancy till my son was six weeks old. Frank, made sure I knew that I had to get out after I gave birth and that my mom was not going to be a “babysitter” She did what he said, she liked being controlled. So, my mom undergoes what I felt was an unnecessary medical procedure that caused complications. She asked me and my teenage son to move in to help her overcome her health obstacles. Frank decides to get an unnecessary elective surgery and my mom actually kills herself trying to care take to him afterward. I was distraught to say the least and I never blamed Frank for my mom’s choices. I could say in detail every event that has made me choose not to leave. But I want someone to read this. I’m being manipulated, and I know this and he kicks out any of his family including his daughter who left earlier this year, traumatized from PTSD he gave her and won’t come back. Frank is from a different state, all his large family lives there. He refuses to go there and kicks out any adult grandchild etc that is sent to help because I have made it known I want to move out of here. He is completely fine with me here, especially since my son died. I don’t get up in his business because I’m too consumed with my own grief and we live separate lives, but I clean. His life is watching Forensic Files, lurking Facebook and spending my dead mom’s money on cam girls and what he knows are scams. Oh, and lot’s of Dr visits, he has always loved going to the doctor. He is not being medically neglected, he more overrides the health care system by getting a Dr appointment for anything. He has destroyed his body signing up for clinical trials. He also loves to kick out home health nurses, go to the ER afterward and report the aides of injuring him and theft. (nothing has been stolen) My life is I constantly work to stay busy and out of my own head. I don’t stay here out of financial security. I can very much afford to not be here. I’m paying for my own father’s assisted living in NYC and I would be in a bind if I was footing two bills. He doesn’t want assisted living anyhow and I know its just a matter of time till he burns through my mom’s money and I become financially responsible for him. (Help pay for my father’s assisted living. He is smart and planned for this, just not in NYC. He hates Texas and I can’t blame him. I help with the offset cost, not the entire huge bill) The neighbors of 20 years have been very supportive of him and me. They will take him to the ER for his unnecessary reasons, or will show up at the hospital because he decides to call 911 while I’m in therapy. Today, Frank has burned bridges with the neighbors and I’m terrified. They are all the support I have. The only support he has. So I come “home” from my typical 12 hour day with a trunk full of groceries only to find a large snake in the garage. I’m like great, go inside to get a broom and Frank calls out my name all cranky. We briefly discuss the snake. He then goes on about how mad he is because he fell twice trying to mow the lawn in 95 degree Texas heat. I’m like why are you mad? That was your own fault. He then goes and blames the next door neighbor for not mowing it for him like she normally does. And then blames me for not reading his mind. I didn’t even notice it needed to be mowed. It wasn’t that bad. I’m like that is not her job to mow your lawn and you could have asked me. He carries on about how we caused him to fall and I leave the unreasonable situation to get the groceries. My other neighbor calls me over and asks me wtf his problem is because he had to pick him up twice when he tried to mow the lawn causing panic all up the street. I give him the synopsis of what he said. Other neighbor tells me, you know he doesn’t have cognitive decline and is just an asshole. I agree and he says I’m done. Go save yourself, I mean that. Other neighbor is a man of his word. He should have been done long ago as should have I. I’m terrified and have to accept that I’m not a horrible person for failing to save Frank from himself and choosing myself. Edit: sorry for all the typos and grammar mistakes my phone is freaking out too, and I need to get this out! And the 3 foot snake is still chilling in the garage. I will snake wrestle when it becomes daylight. Edit Edit: Is this normal on his part. I have read that as people age, they can become the worst form of themselves or the best form of who they wanted be. Edit: Thank you all so much!! The gaslighting is real. I needed to know this is with out a doubt, not my problem. I got into with him over the weekend when he tried to blame me for my mom’s death. You don’t go there with me and I don’t stoop to his level. I was the bigger person and said: Me: I don’t know what you want from me! Especially if you treat me like this Him: I should not have to say it. Me: Actually you do have to say what you want from me because I have no idea. Him: You know it! Me: I have no idea Him: I’m sick of repeating myself. Nobody listens. I want you

out of here. I'm like sweet! I'll leave happily. I told him I'm leaving after the 4th weekend so I could find a place with out being overly dramatic and he needs to call his family and tell them he asked me to leave. Of course he is acting like that never happened. I just found some big chain complex that has an apartment available for move in 07/06. I'm taking it and can transfer units or complex's later if I need. Im too nice still and hired a lawn company to clear out any snake inviting debris and staying friendlish to get what I want of my mother's. I know I'm not through with it all, once he dies, gets forced placed in a nursing home or loses the house taking out equity loans, I will have to clean it up. It will probably all happen within a week and this year. I did what I could but I can't sacrifice the remaining good years of my life so he can do whatever it is he does. Edit edit: I have always refused to be his POA or have any type of decision making authority with him. That was all settled with his family earlier this year and I was vocal I want nothing to do with this. His poor daughter is POA and will be the one really stuck to clean up this mess he leaves behind. He got her to sign up for that while she was emotionally vulnerable. There is nothing to gain when he dies, anything liquid he tore through after my mom died. I will help his daughter though emotionally. Her feelings towards him make mine seem warm and fuzzy. I will keep in my mind that they are not my family and trust no one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 126 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugwxtv/i_cant_do_this_anymore_and_i_n_ever_agreed_to_be_a/

"Mom (93) finished cancer treatment and is giving up. Looking for both tactical advice and to hear from anyone who's been through this. Long-time lurker, first time posting. The situation: Mom is 93, just finished radiation for cancer and is in remission with aggressive monitoring. We had to move her from independent living to assisted living about six weeks ago after a hospitalization made it clear she couldn't safely live alone anymore (not taking meds consistently on her own). (She had been in independent for 18 months before the cancer diagnosis and seemed fine.) Treatment went as well as we could've hoped clinically. But now that the active medical crisis is past, she's collapsed. What's happening this week: \- Won't get out of bed. Won't leave her room. Always an excuse for not going to meals or activities. \- Hiding her medications. Staff are catching some of it but probably not all. \- Caught trying to bribe staff — telling them she'll give them her house if they help her go home or look the other way when she does things she's been told not to do. \- I'm pretty sure she thinks that if she gets kicked out of AL, she thinks she goes home. Home is not an option. The next step is SNF, and she doesn't understand that. A counselor is seeing her tomorrow, which I'm grateful for. The staff at AL is working with us — they have really been amazing through all this. What I'm asking: 1. For those whose parent went through post-treatment depression — did meds help? Did therapy? Did anything? How long did the dark stretch last? 2. The bribery / med-hiding behavior — is this depression, early cognitive decline, or both? She's been cognitively intact on testing, but this feels like something shifted. 3. How do you talk to a parent who has decided to give up? Every script I try ("we want you here," "we're doing this because we love you") seems to bounce off. She just keeps saying she understands but then the behavior doesn't align with what she says. 4. Did anyone successfully avoid the SNF transition by getting their parent stabilized in AL after a backslide like this? Or is this how it goes? The harder thing: We have moved mountains. We (my wife and I) uprooted our lives to temporarily move to be near her and take care of her throughout this process. My employer has been very understanding. We've dealt with all the paperwork, coordinating five specialists across three cities, getting her placed, managing her finances, the cancer treatment, all of it. And it's not enough. She's miserable and I think part of her is angry at us for not letting her go home to die in her own bed. I know there's no magic answer. I just want to hear from people who've been in this exact spot. What helped. What didn't. What you wish you'd known. Thanks for reading. Edit: I wanted to provide some additional info to address some of the comments. Health prior to the cancer diagnosis: First, up until this cancer episode she was in very good shape cognitively and physically - much better than her age would suggest. She only used a walker outside or unfamiliar places. People always commented on how sharp she was. Finances: After my dad passed away, we discussed her finances on many occasions. My only concern was that she was financially ok and she constantly assured me that she was fine. She was paying her bills -- she always paid on time and was never late. I have never pushed her to do anything she didn't want to do. She approached me about

moving to IL. We discussed the cost and I agreed to help because it was going to cost more than her monthly income. We discussed selling the house and she agreed. But she kept coming up with excuses to drag out the process and, quite frankly, I was busy with other things in life. Then one morning shortly after the initial cancer diagnosis, she divulged a credit card bill. In trying to get to the bottom of that I discovered that hole was much deeper than she let on. She even tried to hide some of the statements from me. On the cancer diagnosis: Her mother (my GM) died of cancer, so I think mom heard cancer and immediately interpreted that as a death sentence, despite what anyone told her. Multiple doctors told her she would likely die with it and not of it. It was very early stage 1 and very treatable. One oncologist said even at her age, given all the other factors, he gave her a >90% chance of survival. We made the decisions we made with the best intentions and the best information available at the time. That bell has been rung and I'm not going to re-litigate that on an Internet forum. Legal affairs: Before all of this, we had all of her legal affairs in order. She had an AD (no code), and I have full financial and healthcare POA. I have since taken over managing the finances and have an attorney involved to make sure we handle the debt and her care according to her stated wishes. On me "not being able to let go": I have a background in being a first responder. I've seen death in the line of duty and personal experience with other difficult family situations. This is not a situation where I "just can't let go." I have lived through that on my wife's side of the family and it was an awful experience. I have discussed this situation with many doctors and every single one has told me this is not a palliative care situation -- she would likely not qualify for hospice. I'm not an expert in that -- I'm simply going on the advice of others. Now has she just lost the will to live? Yes, very probably. But being depressed is not the same thing as being terminally ill and that's not the same thing as just being old. I'm hoping that independent behavioral health will help us make the best decisions we can from here on out. I appreciate everyone who has taken time to respond."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 125 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4swt3/mom_93_finished_cancer_treatment_and_is_giving_up/

"Vent: I'm exhausted taking care of someone who never took care of me. I'm just so tired. Caregiving (even just remotely) for my formally abusive mother is just killing me. The anxiety and depression feels constant. Despite my efforts to the contrary, I feel like this has just taken over my entire life and sanity. If I'm not actively doing things for her, she's calling me, or her concerned family, friends and neighbors are calling me, as if I hadn't noticed that her dementia is getting so bad that she looks for my dead father and grandfather daily. Or asking me how she's doing. And then I have to have the same conversation with them that I've had with everyone else. It's exhausting. I understand their concern, but I guess people don't understand that lining up elder care (and everything it encompasses) TAKES TIME. There are waiting lists. There are a thousand things to coordinate. And it does not help that she is actively against any steps I take on her behalf and insists that she'll just "get better if I give (her) time." If I try to force the issue she tells me that I'm the cause of her cognitive issues because she thinks I am yelling at her and it makes her nervous. She also doesn't want services that cost money (despite having plenty of financial resources) because she's the cheapest person I've ever met and she's perfectly happy burdening me, my husband, and her friends with all her logistical, physical, and emotional needs. As proof that "people care about her." I'm just at the point where I don't feel anything towards her except obligation, extreme resentment and dislike. Every time her caregiving agency calls me, I immediately hope that they're going to tell me she died. **I hate what she's turned me and my life into.** What I've recently been asking my friends and family: *I don't need or want articles or advice on how to be a better caregiver. I've done a lot of reading about the various forms of dementia and get plenty of guidance from her geriatric doctors. I've also done a lot of therapy and reading on how to deal with elder estranged /abusive parents.* I don't need guilt trips or asking what I'm doing for her birthday/holidays, etc. Yes, she gave birth to me, but our relationship has been either neglectful and/or abusive throughout my life. * Please stop asking after my mother. Even if you want to help... you can't. I just want a couple of days where I try not to think about her. Literature that has resonated with me and felt super helpful in processing some of these very complicated feelings are: ["Your turn for care: Surviving the aging and death of the adults who harmed you"](<https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/17325189>) \- books abound regarding

elder abuse, but almost nothing about the confusion and anger that comes along when a formerly abusive parent suddenly requires help. ["What My Bones Know: A Memoir of Healing from Complex Trauma"](<https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/58214328>) \- the best and only book I've found that addresses the damage and toxicity of emotionally abusive, so called "tiger parenting" in otherwise highly functional Asian adults."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 71 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18ccwul/vent_im_exhausted_taking_care_of_someone_who/

↳ **comment** (29): "I know exactly how you feel. Caring for my mother who "had the covid, or the flu or rsv or or" (she was really just upset that dad was getting all the attention) while my dad was in hospital and then rehab, there was a day I got to the point I was ready to hit her. That was the day I told EVERYONE that I was no longer going to be her caretaker and I told them why. I was a danger to her. This absolves me. Sometimes you just have to walk away and let the chips fall."

↳ **comment** (21): "I felt exactly the same way when my FIL shook his cane at me like he was going to hit me: "You'd better not or you're going down." And that was when I had to stop. I'll probably never see him again."

↳ **comment** (16): "All so valid. I especially feel the conversaton stuff. I know people mean well when they ask what's going on with them (parents), but we already spend so much mental energy thinking about their problems (transportation, needing groceries, dr. appts., lonliness, stubborn, hearing imparied, etc.) that I just don't want to report on it with people who aren't part of the "system" we've put in place to address these issues. I get it, I really do - neighbors feel especially entitled because they can only see things from the outisde - but when I say she's okay and even if she wasn't "there's really nothing you can do about it," they seem offended. Like them just occasionally asking about her should be the solution enough for whatever she's going through. They never offer her rides anywhere, they don't stop by and say, "hey, I'm going to the store - what do you need?," they don't ask for our contact info. in case there's an emergency etc. This sounds mean, but it's sort of like they're posturing. Ya know? Like they're nice neighbors, but acting like their so concerned about her and expecting updates when it's convenient for them to inquire annoys me. Especially when they could knock on her door anytime and find out how's she's doing if they want. But they approach us when we're outside, clearly in the middle of things (like cutting her lawn, taking out the trash, trimming weeds, etc.), and act like we owe them answers. Meanwhile they do nothing to actually help. I'm not sure that's exactly your situation, but repeating conversations to people who aren't part of our care system is frustrating. I'd rather they just wave and go about their day - it's what they're going to do every other day when we're not there, anyway. Thankfully my mother wasn't abusive. She did her best with us, but she didn't really go out of her way to take care of us, either. She didn't trust doctors, so we hardly ever went. And when we were sick and and a home remedy didn't work, she'd say, "Well, I don't know what else you want me to do about it." Which is how I feel about trying to take care of her, now. Like...we have kids and work and houses and bills of our own, we already spend every weekend either going over there and taking care of things ourselves or we spend hours every week coordinating her care, I don't know what else she wants us to do about it! Ugh...sorry OP, I really understand the frustration. Especially this part: "I'm just at the point where I don't feel anything towards her except obligation, extreme resentment and dislike." I hate that I feel this way too."

"We Will Eventually Have to Tell Our Mother She May Never Come Home. How have any of you gone about telling a parent they may never come home? My 80 year old mother had a stroke in April which badly affected her left side. Cognitively, she's still mostly there but her left arm is useless now and her left leg isn't much better. A couple days after the stroke, we got her into a rehab facility. She was there for a little over two months receiving therapy but eventually the facility terminated her coverage under Medicare due to lack of progress. While she was there, I took the initiative and got my father and brother to agree to get an elder care lawyer. Sadly, given her age and other health issues, I highly suspected she would need continuing care. The law firm we selected was excellent and we were able to get my mother's Medicaid application approved while protecting most of my father's assets. We also took the opportunity to get durable POAs and medical POAs for both of our parents as well as revised

wills should our father pass before our mother. Speaking of my father, he's 82 and has pretty bad hearing. He's still able to get around and can drive to see my mother everyday. He's not without other healthcare issues and his short term memory isn't great. We have to be careful what we tell him because he will share everything with everyone. He has a really hard time dealing with any type of technology. My brother and I have managed to get him to allow us to pay most of his bills online and we have access to his various accounts. Now back to mom. We were able to get her into a nursing home at the beginning of July. She received more therapy there but again therapy under Medicare was terminated due to lack of progress. At both her current facility and the previous one, she has fallen several times. Most of them were, unfortunately, her fault as she was trying to move in ways her body can no longer do. She even remarked to my brother that she "knows how to fall". She still needs assistance going to the bathroom, with bathing, with dressing and various other things most of us take for granted. I said earlier the stroke didn't affect her cognitively but over the last few months I've noticed some changes. She's gotten more stubborn and her and my father snap at each other. That's because of his poor hearing. He can't hear her very well or at all sometimes and she gets frustrated. Given all that she's convinced she can come home. My brother and I know that's not feasible. My father is not capable of giving my mom the care she needs and we are sure he understands that. I suspect he will need care of his own in 2-3 years, maybe sooner. His mother eventually succumbed to dementia and I'm worried I see signs of it in him. My brother who lives with him has been doing the lion's share of the work helping him and mom over the years but he has a full time job. He can't financially quit to take care of her. I live 2.5 hours away. The house would need some major work to let her come home and she obviously would need some kind of home health care. While my parents are ok financially for now, the work needed on the house plus home care would drain that fast. The Medicaid waiver program in our state is a mess and it could be months or years to get her on it. Sorry for the long story. I know my family's situation isn't as bad as many on here but I wanted to get it off my chest."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fuy4iw/we_will_eventually_have_to_tell_our_mother_she/

↳ **comment** (61): "Caring for parents carries quite the load and stress. You have a lot going on. My suggestion for your mom would be to tell her the truth: she can go home when she is able to independently care for herself. This includes bathing, using the washroom, maybe even add going x number of weeks without falling. In short, she can go home when she meets these milestones. Until she is strong enough, she needs to stay where she is to get the help. Will this happen? Unlikely. But it may give her the focus to try. Very best of luck to you and family."

↳ **comment** (22): "My father is in the same position. He was released from hospital to rehab after surgery on his foot, but is unable to stand/walk/bathe/dress/etc and my mother, now in an independent living arrangement in the same facility, cannot take care of him. Medicaid/Medicare ran out and we're now having to pay for his care. He frankly preferred to be waited on and served prior to his infection. He's been in hospital or rehab for six weeks, and seems fine there, with mobility provided by a wheelchair only, and only today did it appear to sink in for him that he would continue to be institutionalized until he can deal with regular daily living on his own. We're waiting to see if his foot heals, but there's a good chance that he'll need to stay in nursing care. It sucks. Good luck to you. You're not alone in experiencing this."

↳ **comment** (20): "Perhaps her doctor would be best delivering the news? He could present the medical reasons for her not to return home and answer any questions. This way when moving her to the nursing home you can say you are 'following doctor's orders'."

"I took care of my mother. She was a monster. I was exhausted for months after. The hospice personnel always took her side and treated me like crap. It was a nightmare. Everything you are saying is correct."

youtube · @christinerobertson9596 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 62 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyTKaNYtDw1ik9n3ft4AaABAq

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (31): "I'm glad you survived. Our society is not setup or prepared for any of this. Modern medicine keeps prolonging existing but with no support system. It's nuts."

↳ **@janethammond5925** (8): "Your mother was probably sweetness and light to the staff, at least that's what I'm guessing. I've worked in enough resthomes to have seen that dynamic! Sadly it sometimes works in reverse though...lonely parents who don't see their children year in or year out. Hopefully staff don't judge too harshly as they don't know the full story."

"This is so wrong on so many levels. Not you, but the hypocrisy others are spewing out. I am suffering from Alzheimer's. My greatest fear is what you are being put through. Why would I want my L.O.'s to suffer that? I read post after post here and on r/Alzheimers that depict similar situations and it is horrifying. There is a condition called Anosognosia. I am beginning to believe it, or a version of it can exist in people other than the patient. They have no clue. They are monsters who have not been where you are. I have no words of wisdom, only the comfort of all of us here to share with. Best wishes and prayers."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 45 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4ubxjr/

"Excellent tips! One that I would add is to take a break as often as you need it (if you can). Knowing I have a break in two weeks, helps me hold my tongue when I get snapped at when doing something I think should be appreciated. I also try to remember that needing someone do things for you can be so frustrating when you have always been a very independent person. Thank you for taking the time to make these videos - the ones about the VA benefits have been a godsend!"

youtube · @Natalie-pl5rm · TOP TIPS FOR NEW FAMILY CAREGIVERS - How to Take care of Aging Parents · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g0UwGx4F90&lc=Ugxbat-eL05Tvf_DADd4AaABAg

↳ **@SofiaAmirpoor** (2): "Thanks Natalie! That's #6---but we can never take enough breaks! And empathy....super important!"

"Hugs! It's so frustrating to have your very good advice go unheeded, and then \now\ they want the earlier offered options. It's ok to break down and yell occasionally. I do it too. Sometimes that's what it takes to get them to listen. I try not to let it happen too often, as then I feel guilty and that does me no good. One thing I do a LOT, is I have someone else be the Bad Guy. That way I can say "The Doctor/ Physiotherapist said we have to do this", and I can use that momentum to get the task done. Recently it got to the point that my mum really needs some grab bars in the shower, but she has been saying no, because she "didn't want to drill holes in the tile" (ok, so the alternative is a hole in your head when you fall!). My mum had an Occupational therapist come recently as part of home health care. I met her outside first and told her my concerns about the grab bars and she agreed to emphasize their necessity. We now have bars in the shower, because someone other than myself talked to her about it. Maybe you speak to a social worker or someone at their facility and get them to agree to be the Bad Guy?"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwr/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/oocy5sg/

"I love this response. What Jack wants is reasonable but imo it seems insensitive to use the grandparents situation to make a point. It's weird. It's unnecessary. Also it seems to be written with AI and that's also soulless and strange to do."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/ocb0hil/

"All so valid. I especially feel the conversaton stuff. I know people mean well when they ask what's going on with them (parents), but we already spend so much mental energy thinking about their problems (transportation, needing groceries, dr. appts., loneliness, stubborn, hearing imparied, etc.) that I just don't want to report on it with people who aren't part of the "system" we've put in place to address these issues. I get it, I really do - neighbors feel especially entitled because they can only see things from the outisde - but when I say she's okay and even if she wasn't "there's really nothing you can do about it," they seem offended. Like them just occasionally asking about her should be the solution enough for whatever she's going through. They never offer her rides anywhere, they don't stop by and say, "hey, I'm going to the store - what do you need?," they don't ask for our contact info. in case there's an emergency etc. This sounds mean, but it's sort of like they're posturing. Ya know? Like they're nice neighbors, but acting like their so concerned about her and expecting updates when it's convenient for them to inquire annoys me. Especially when they could knock on her door anytime and find out how's she's doing if they want. But they approach us when we're outside, clearly in the middle of things (like cutting her lawn, taking out the trash, trimming weeds, etc.), and act like we owe them answers. Meanwhile they do nothing to actually help. I'm not sure that's exactly your situation, but repeating conversations to people who aren't part of our care system is frustrating. I'd rather they just wave and go about their day - it's what they're going to do every other day when we're not there, anyway. Thankfully my mother wasn't abusive. She did her best with us, but she didn't really go out of her way to take care of us, either. She didn't trust doctors, so we hardly ever went. And when we were sick and and a home remedy didn't work, she'd say, "Well, I don't know what else you want me to do about it." Which is how I feel about trying to take care of her, now. Like...we have kids and work and houses and bills of our own, we already spend every weekend either going over there and taking care of things ourselves or we spend hours every week coordinating her care, I don't know what else she wants us to do about it! Ugh...sorry OP, I really understand the frustration. Especially this part: "I'm just at the point where I don't feel anything towards her except obligation, extreme resentment and dislike." I hate that I feel this way too."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18ccwul/vent_im_exhausted_taking_care_of_someone_who/kc9ww9n/

"I agree. Usually, you let the partner deal with their family, but this is a situation where I think the OP needs to step in and be the bad guy and say "no, we are not helping you come home." And repeat as needed..."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1bqwuny/fil_wants_to_home_from_nursing_home_but_cannot/kx5tyes/

"I'm an RN and I quit my job of 15 years as a clinical nurse to take of a family member full time, my patient is my aunt, an elderly and she quite difficult hence we clash often despite being patient with her I sometimes lose my temper and I feel guilty afterwards. I understand that she is tired because she is sick but I'm also tired because of the demand. Sometimes I feel guilty for feeling tired and apathetic, at times I have neglected myself for taking care of her, I am isolated from my friends with no one to talk to. Sometimes I felt regret that I am not able to live the life that I want because of the responsibilities thrust upon me. I was looking for ways to validate what I'm feeling and it's quite hard."

youtube · @jenbards8425 · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland* · 10 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=Ugyxb_g4Z_1k25bo-4p4AaABAg

↳ @dianadec4300 (o): "In SoCal, there is a place called Inland Caregiver Resource Center that supports caregivers. If you are in another state, call around. There may be a program similar to it that you are not aware of."

"How do you transfer your mom to the washroom or shower? I can relate to your post. I feel like I don't have much left to give. A lot of people will say "focus on yourself, put them in a home" I'm going to go on a tangent. Often we as a society say millennials are weak, too woke, they don't seem to have the mental capacity to think on their feet or struggle like other generations. That's how I feel. I am a generation X'er. I have had one intimate relationship where I was the priority. When that fizzled out I was devastated but hoped one day I would find that connection. I didn't. It's been three decades. My generation was made of steel. Forced into a loveless marriage, a caretaker for years. Spent their life caring for family. Never asked for anything in return. Dementia came a few years ago and now they've lost sight, brain bleed and a stroke. For a long time. I took the advice of others here that life wasn't worth prolonging. I was cruel more often than I was kind. Now I'm broken. I'm angry at myself for electing to be mean, aggressive and cruel over compassionate. Caregiving is more fucking hard when you're alone. I try to be a good friend, I try to be personable but the people I'm friends with don't know what to say or help beyond a few words. It's so hard when a loved one can't see. You feel helpless. I come back to this question, why can't I be as strong as I was before all this? There's always this small amount of hope but it's not enough to carry you through."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/ne9fwn8/

"I have told people that for the past year (more so the last couple of months), I have cherished the time with my mother, mourned my mother, and hated the monster that is her dementia "personality". Honestly, getting final terminal timelines actually is more a relief than a pain. I told a friend "I just wish for "rip the bandage off already and be done" exit for her. We have had this diagnosis since 2014, it took serious hold during COVID, and when my dad died in June she started slipping. Through it all I have been her proxy and her advocate. It is not like I didn't know where this would lead. We went from 30 days last week prior to hospice admission, to a bad weekend, to yesterday thinking we are counting days not weeks. There is no feel good "right" call, but at this point, what is the point in forcing it. Even today when I asked about upping her meds, the hospice nurse said "well we don't want to sedate her necessarily because that could accelerate things". I looked at her deadpan in the face and said "the problem with that is what exactly?" My thoughts are if she is comfortable and peaceful (which she really isn't atm) what difference does it make if we go from 5 days to 4. I told the social worker today that if we lived in the right state, I would have tried to get my mom into a Death with Dignity protocol back in the day, because spending your final days/weeks in agonizing and paralyzing fear is no way to live."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/olgumd5/

"doctors (where are they?) rehabs and nurses have called me to tell me how difficult he is Social worker today said I don't blame you when I heard he is going to refuse help and I will go no contact even outside people realize he is evil I ordered depends and wipes (i know stupid me but I used his cc) I blame my mother for creating this monster"

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 6 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/nof05s6/

Their lack of planning · 30 documents

20 most engaged of 30 matching documents, complete text.

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :, can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or

receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_wit_h_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"How do you manage intense resentment towards your aging parent?. I don't resent that my mom is aging. I resent that she never prepared for the aging process, never saved, never had a plan in place, is barely hanging on living by herself and now it is left all to me, her eldest daughter, to manage her care. Sometimes the resentment is so intense it feels like I might explode. I feel spread so thin, and I know it's impacting my infant and my partner. I don't want to do this anymore. I don't want to be my mom's caretaker. I don't want to go to her house and try to find a clean place to sit. I don't want to have to wait til I get home to use the bathroom because her toilet is covered in feces even with housekeepers. I don't want to see my mom deteriorate before my eyes and feel like the situation is insurmountable. I live 2 blocks away but I don't want to help anymore. I'm so weary. I will never put my own daughter in this situation. Thank you to whoever has listened."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 451 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kzbb9p/how_do_you_manage_intense_re_resentment_towards_your/

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last

words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to

do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_f_or_my_parents/

"can you ever MAKE them do it, or do you have to just wash your hands?. *not even sure how much background would be relevant here. I'm in the USA. I've spent about the past 10 months trying to clean out my mother's house. it's a big old farmhouse type thing in a rural area. it's absolutely falling apart. my stepdad passed in 2017. he was significantly older than my mom is (now 71). no retirement savings. no life insurance. some of that WAS his bad choices, some of it was out of his control (when companies go bankrupt, you lose your pension. in his case it happened at least twice). we were ok \$\$\$ wise when I was younger but when we moved and they bought this money pit of a house, it all went to s\|\|. my mom never worked outside the home and so lives off my*

dad's survivorship SS. she's got no small amount of debt. she lives about an hour from me. she has some disabilities from scoliosis, severe osteoporosis and glaucoma. as of last year she could no longer drive any significant distance and probably shouldn't at all. I have to take her to all dr and dentist appointments which are an hour PAST her house away from mine. for years my mother was totally convinced she was going to move back to our home state despite the fact that it's very VERY expensive now. then she finally relented last year that "I have to accept that's not going to happen." well no \\\|. despite having tried myself, and others that she needed to have gotten the heck out of that house years ago, she dug in and fought it. she fights everything that isn't her idea (this has been a lifelong thing, and part of why my relationship with her is so fraught). *she absolutely can-NOT live me with me. full stop.* she is still convinced that she can sell this falling apart ruin of a home for enough money that she can afford to buy ANOTHER home and have enough from my dad's meager survivorship social security to pay on a mortgage and all the maintenance that a house requires. I have tried telling her again and again and again that the market for "as is fixer uppers" is just about gone. people want move in ready and perfect or they won't buy. and people don't do rent-backs anymore either. nobody is going to buy her as-is home and then let her rent back until she finds another house here where I live that checks alllll her boxes AND the cost of homes in my neighborhood has doubled and they either get snapped up by investors or are sold way overpriced but needing a ton of work. anything new being built is all three story townhomes and she can't even manage ONE flight of stairs. *I truly believe the best option for her is an apartment. There are a few of the traditional "garden style" first floor/one floor types as well as some regular apartments that cater to seniors without being a full on assisted living. she wouldn't have to worry about maintenance, she could mostly decorate how she wants. we can set up a living trust for whatever she comes away with after selling her house to cover additional expenses like a cleaning service, uber rides/transport if needed, etc. except she won't.* even now, I've tried to push things along faster because I am 54, I work full time and I am EXHAUSTED. I have spent hours and hours of sorting, taking things to thrift stores, taking what she wants to keep in storage (which I'm paying for) and I AM TIRED. The entire attic is still full of cr\p and she wants to "sort out what she wants to get rid of and then leave what she wants to keep until she moves." *I want to pay whomever we're going to pay to help, get it ALL out of the damn attic and then take whatever she wants to keep and put it in storage NOW. YESTERDAY. get the rest of the furniture out. she keeps insisting it can stay "until she has a house to move into." I CAN'T TAKE THIS ANYMORE.* The year before we started on this I had to spend nearly 6 straight months working on my own house because there were some things that had gotten away from us and needed to be addressed. then I spent pretty much all of last year dealing with this stuff for my mother while one of our dogs had cancer and died. I have basically given up all hobbies, I can't exercise or get to the gym, I barely have the executive function at the end of a workday anymore to COOK let alone take care of myself. I've already spent over 12K just getting her furnace repaired and all the dental work done that Medicare won't cover just in the past 5 years. at what point do I get to just say: *you will move into an apartment the house will be listed within the next 90 days the proceeds pay the debt and then we set up a trust with the rest and you STAY IN AN APARTMENT until you literally cannot take care of yourself anymore (which God willing would be more than the 5 years required).* then if you want to go into a rehab center you can. *Hell if you want to do MAD when the time comes, I would even support that. but God as my witness I am not dealing with another house, all the crap that comes with it, another mortgage when you're gone, blah blah blah.* THIS is the plan that we follow, or I don't do one more thing. Not one more box packed, not one more trip to a thrift store. not one more cent for home repairs. don't call me unless you decide this is what we are doing. sorry. yeah this is really long. and, as most quandaries with aging parents are, it's complicated and ugly."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 123 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qntrif/can_you_ever_make_them_do_it_or_do_you_have_to/

"Stubborn Father Refuses To Downsize Despite Being in His 90's. Expects Me To Be His Caregiver. My mother recently passed away in a tragic car accident and my siblings and I are trying to convince my father to downsize and move either into his own apartment or assisted living. I was living with them before my mother passed away

so now I am his unpaid caregiver by default... thankfully he has no major medical issues beside occasional gout flare up's and arthritis since he's 96 but he expects me to cook, do laundry since he should not be going up & down the stairs to the basement, go grocery shopping using my own money (currently unemployed while he makes a pension of \$96,000 per year) clean the house and listen to his political ramblings. Essentially I've turned into a replacement wife for him which gives me a really weird feeling... This is something that a lot of other people here can relate to but trying to get him to move out of his large suburban house, downsize and simplify his life has been an uphill battle. Throw in severe weather events, a tornado that took out 40% of the large trees in his area, 2 basement floods last month due to the crazy severe weather and going through 5 week long power outages and I'm going insane - it can't be any clearer that he needs to move out of that house. He even got angry when I told him he needs to move and says he's "comfortable" in the house. Tried using logic saying he can't maintain the house anymore but he didn't want to hear it and dropped it before it became an argument.... Even despite all of that he shouldn't be living there since it's too big to maintain, there's the risk of falling down the stairs and he very worryingly will not fully give up the keys since he threw an epic temper tantrum when I tried to take them when he back his 26 year old car out of the garage and seemed to want to take it for a spin around the neighborhood to "run the engine." He been honestly a stubborn and insanely difficult person all of his life but dealing with him through all this has been an insane nightmare to the point of burning me out and exhausted dealing with him (sister-in-law said my mother should have divorced him decades ago since he has not changed his toxic ways as he got older) I don't think it's dementia - it's just him being a jerk and not thinking/ caring about the consequences of his actions which is a lifelong pattern of his as well as being too proud to face reality or adapt to his age. He had no plan for retirement other than saving as much money as possible and penny pinching to the point of deferring repairs on their house for years despite my mother begging him since that brings the value of their home down. I have 3 other siblings who give advice but don't really seem to want to step in due to him being unmanageable and not wanting to work with people. My older sister came to help last month but basically stepped away since she couldn't take him after that. She told me the same thing my therapist recently said: "Walk away and live your own life if he's being like this. He needs to learn to deal with the consequences of his choices instead of making you responsible for them if he's that stubborn." I would feel bit guilty walking away but I'm leaning that way. Weighing my options...."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w1wwws/stubborn_father_refuses_to_downsize_despite_being/

"11 years of my life for one parent. Gave up my job last june. It's been a roller coaster of emotions since day one. My parents never planned for their senior years, expected me to care for them. I am so mad. Now, dementia has been added to the plate. It's only going to get worse, but I will need to place her at some point for the right care because I am done!! I am 62!"

youtube · @HeatherCampbell-kc7fx · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 49 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyeSDqAtRQ9k_J42RB4AaABAq

↳ **@rastry3673** (9): "I think it's time for Medicaid and a nursing home if your parents can't think or can't recognize you, or if they are aggressive or you are consumed with anger. Anyone who would attempt to criticize you probably hasn't been through what you have. If someone criticizes you, maybe give them a chance to take your role for a week, while you sit and tell them what they are doing wrong."

↳ **@janq1421** (8): "You've done so much already. You deserve a break. Wishing you well."

↳ **@cynthianoelting4991** (3): "My mother has dementia. Her health started declining about 10 yrs ago. I love both of my parents who are now age 92 and 96 yrs, however I am going through a plethora of emotions during the course of a day. First, I was grieving the lost of my mothers health due to dementia, now I am too mentally and physically exhausted to be able to deal with anything! I have siblings and we actually had to hire home care to help simply because we can't do it all anymore. We are not spring chickens, have to work(financially and for

medical coverage , not only for ourselves but those who rely on us), have our own family obligations, and have our own health problems. There are times, we think we will die before our elderly parents from all of the stress."

"Mom need a place to stay - and more care than she realizes. UPDATE: Just wanted to update that 2 years later - my mom is still living in my lower level and not making any progress finding a place of her own. She will describe herself as a miracle to anyone who listens - and I mean anyone. She finally FINALLY about 2 weeks ago - found a low income nice apartment to look at only to find out that the judgement that was placed against her by another apartment (the one we had to vacate last minute) - will prevent her from getting into this apartment. Her only option is to pay it off and have a signed paper from the apartment stating its paid off. She owes them over \$5k - but only because she couldn't be bothered to submit her paperwork in time after guaranteeing me she has it handled. I feel totally at fault for trusting her with this - and now - I don't think she has any intention of paying it off - so - lord help me I don't even know what to do now. My mental health is really suffering - REALLY SUFFERING. Not just due to this - but it sure doesn't help. -----
----- My mom is 78 years old. Her life story is far too long and complicated to get into but a lot of the issues we are running into now are a result of a lot of her life choices. 2023 it all kind of came to a head and blew up in our faces. She had been working full-time at daycare. It was stressful for her I think a bit - but she did enjoy it on some level. She had a degree in education and always enjoyed working with kids. In Feb she was hospitalized with guillain-barré syndrome. Probably as a result of an already compromised immune system and working with lots of sniffing and sick little kids. She was in the hospital for over 2 months - much of the time on a ventilator. There was a window where I didn't think she'd ever make it out. I was at the hospital by her side every single day after work when she was in the hospital. It was a very difficult and exhausting time. Her bills, however and apartment situation were out of control. She didn't have the money to not be working and continue paying for the apartment. We kept it as long as we could until we realized we couldn't anymore. Her rent and this ridiculously expensive apartment was more than my mortgage - a place I told her when she wanted to move into she had no business moving into it (she never listens to me) - so I was not in a position to help her hold on to a place she simply could not afford. I had to help her out with rent cost at least twice in the past year and found out her sister had been doing the same. Frankly - it seemed like she may be going straight into a nursing home after her stay considering her age and her condition at the time. She has no savings, no 401k - nothing. My brother and I did what we could in the couple days we had to rescue any necessities and/or furniture she may need when she got out. But we could only get so much in the time we had with the amount of people we had. Plus - my mom was a hoarder. She had piles and piles of boxes, things, her closet was stuffed full of all kinds of things including a pantry of sorts filled with expired food - some which had expired over a year earlier. She had 2 filled to the top storage areas at her apartment complex - one of which we didn't even touch because it would have been impossible in the time we had to even make a dent in it. So we focused on the things that she had in the apartment we could dig through and locate. The rest - we left. There was no universe where we had the money, time, or strength to get all of it cleared out. It was also apparent she had been sleeping in a chair in the living room - with her feet up on another chair - surrounded by piles of - stuff. Her bed was completely covered in boxes and things. Her fridge and freezer were stuffed full of food in various stages of decomposition. Some ok - some not - but all intermingled. I also kept finding (dirty) little plastic ziploc food containers everywhere - including in the bathroom where it appeared she had been doing her dishes (the kitchen was so stuffed full of things it wasn't really useable as a kitchen). I'm not even sure what was going on in the shower - she had gallons of water sitting in there as if she were afraid the water would be turned off - she never gave me an explanation for that. To answer the questions you probably have about that - multiple people including myself, her sister and her sister's husband had offered to help her multiple times sorting - getting rid of things - and we were always met with anger or a fight. Eventually just bringing it up involved so much contention we all just kind of left her to it - and here we were - right in the middle of it. It explained a lot as to why we were never invited over. You can't help people who don't want to be helped. So honestly - she needed help of some sort -before this medical event happened. She was not taking care of herself. And its possible some of these living conditions - (though cluttered but not "dirty" if that makes sense) could have

influenced her compromised immunity. So - yes, we left a lot of her stuff behind - and I felt grateful for it to be honest. But it's been a point of contention ever since she's left the hospital. I tried to get her on medicaid while in the hospital, but we kept running into problems with it getting approved. Eventually she was transferred to a nursing home for rehabilitation. She stayed here for about 2 months while she was learning to walk again, dress herself, etc. During this time we were continuing the process of trying to get her on medicaid. I really would have like to have just moved her over into the long term care section of the nursing home after her rehabilitation, but without medicaid coming through - at \$200/day - there was just no way. So unfortunately she had to come stay with us. My brother and her sister completely vanished near the end - probably to avoid the possibility of their homes becoming her new roosting spot - but there was nowhere else for her to go. So she's been living with me since late May of 2023. About 6 months now. We don't have a spare bedroom, but we do have a split level house, so she's been occupying the lower portion of our house during this time. We don't have an extra bed so she's been sleeping on the couch. I worry about her going up and down the stairs - and our house has a lot of stairs being a split level. She has come a long way from where she was, but considering how she was living prior to this event and how she is now - I cannot imagine her living on her own. Not that she could afford to either. So the next goal became - try to get her successfully on medicaid and maybe to assisted living (requiring also elderly waiver) since she didn't feel she was ready quite yet for a nursing home. Well, I've been observing her since she's been living with us. At first I was bringing her every meal. I work remotely most days, so this kind of worked - but my life is pretty hectic and busy with a special needs child in middle school (lots of calls and meetings from the school and lots of work with him after school), a full time job that requires a lot of attention and work, and a marriage that has been crumbling severely for the last several years. It's just too much for me to handle and if something were to happen - I cannot be her full time health care giver. I can't. So I told her after about 2 months of that, and she had been getting up and down the stairs successfully that I would need her to start preparing her own breakfasts and lunches. I always have simple options available that I use myself. Leftovers, sandwich meat, cereal, oatmeal, yogurt, cheese, etc. Nothing that requires too much work. She seemed to this for awhile but it's been slipping. Sometimes I don't see her come up at all and then she'll start asking about dinner around 4pm (probably because she's hungry). I just don't have the time to wait on her when I am working all day long. This can't continue. I asked her what she had to eat today and she told me half of a protein bar and half of a protein drink and a piece of string cheese ... She seems to sleep and wake all hours of the day and night. She doesn't have a consistent sleeping schedule. Sometimes if I go out to get something for lunch or order something, I will bring it down (around 12-1pm) to find her still sleeping. Yet some nights she will be awake wandering around at 4am doing random things. Sometimes I will have to go downstairs and do a "wellness check" after I am done working because the light downstairs is still off to find her sitting in the dark at 4pm. Sometimes she will sit and paint - sometimes she will stare at the floor - sometimes just watch hours and hours of netflix. She hasn't taken a real shower or bath since she has lived with us. She says she gives herself "sponge baths" like she did for her mom for whom she was caregiver for awhile"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18fnawy/mom_need_a_place_to_stay_and_more_care_than_she/

"Impossible Situation. 50F with Silent Generation parents who are 85 and almost 88. They live in New York State. My mother is almost completely blind from Central Retinal Vein Occlusion that occurred in late 2021 and may have been brought on by many years of glaucoma. She was an excellent patient, always doing exactly what the doctor recommended and keeping up with her eye appointments. Her vision loss is tragic and she has very little interest in living. She is also showing signs of dementia (wailing, nagging, repeating the same questions, worrying about odd things like the alarm clock malfunctioning). Otherwise, however, she's in good physical health. My dad has been her sole caregiver and it's taking a big toll on him. He's great cognitively, but needs hearing aids and is having trouble with balance. He went for a few physical therapy sessions, but stopped around the holidays. He still drives and insists on going out whenever he wants, which is often at night. I live 1.5 hours away and have offered, asked, begged, pleaded and done everything short of showing up unannounced to get them to accept my help. My

48M brother lives 5 minutes from them and doesn't do anything for them other than clear their car when it snows. Of course, they don't/won't ask him for help either. Their situation is a ticking time bomb that has me gripped with anxiety on a daily basis. They have very little money, a condo that is mortgaged (but only in my mom's name), no wills, no POA, no burial plans except a vague notion that there is a plot for them in a cemetery 2 hours away that my late paternal grandmother bought in the 1950s! I got them to sign HIPPA releases and healthcare proxies, but there is no plan for any type of emergency. I called my mom's PCP and mentioned her cognitive symptoms, but the nurse said she denied anxiety or depression at her last wellness checkup. The nurse told me that a neurologist would need to diagnose dementia, so I made an appointment for my mom in April. Will she go? I highly doubt it. I recently had a one-hour free consultation with an elder law attorney. My brother didn't want to pay any lawyer that charged a consultation fee and then was "too busy" to attend the Zoom meeting. The lawyer said my mother needs to get on Medicaid and offered to fill out and file the application...for \$15,750. Getting on Medicaid would allow her to have a home health aide, but the likelihood of my mom agreeing to that is very low. Additionally, my dad is a hoarder and the condo is in disrepair, so the lawyer said Medicaid won't even approve them for an aide because a home visit is part of the process. If anything big or little happens to my dad, I don't know what will become of my mom. I live in a different state and am not equipped to care for a blind person with dementia. My brother seems to think that my husband and I should take her in, even telling me that we could "get a chair lift." Also, despite the lawyer telling me that freewill.com is a scam (?), my brother insists that documents we print off the internet will be sufficient for creating wills and POAs. He's cheap as the day is long and I cannot pay for things unless we go 50/50. I love my parents dearly and have been really struggling with anticipatory grief on top of all these practical concerns. I worry about them constantly and have begun praying that God has mercy on my mom and calls her home first. I'm glad I found this community and am open to any kind suggestions."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iyze4a/impossible_situation/

"How do you get through to an aging parent who refuses to plan for actually getting old?. My dad is in his late 70s, lives alone in the US, and is divorced. I'm his only child, but I've lived permanently overseas with my spouse for the past 11 years. My dad is starting to have some significant health and mobility problems, although he's still independent. He's currently house rich but cash poor. His mortgage is paid off, but due to health problems he hasn't worked in a year, so he's accumulated some debt. He hasn't disclosed the exact amount to me. He's confident he'll be able to resume working as a chiropractor, although he doesn't have a position to return to and would need to find a clinic willing to hire him. Personally, in this job market and given my dad's age and health issues, I don't really see this happening. He's also said he'll "find a job washing dishes" if he has to, which I also find pretty unrealistic. I've repeatedly offered for him to move near us. There are places to rent literally a five-minute walk from our home, and one month of rental income from his US townhouse would cover roughly two months of his living expenses here without even being overly frugal. He's visited the country where I live and likes it. There are activities and an English-speaking community he could become part of. I know visiting somewhere is very different from moving there, especially at his age, but he's actually been open to the idea. He's also admitted there isn't really anything keeping him where he currently lives. He's divorced, doesn't have friends nearby, and seems to actively hate the state he lives in. He could continue collecting Social Security, rent out his paid-off townhouse, preserve the equity, and live near family in a country with a significantly lower cost of living and where he wouldn't need a car to maintain his independence. If he eventually needed a home nurse or other assistance, we'd be able to afford that here. In short, he could have a very good life without the same financial pressure and have his only family within walking distance. But his openness to moving closer to his only child seems to disappear after our calls. He loves working and is dying to get back to work. And because he needs cash soon, he's looking into a HECM/reverse mortgage instead. The problem is that he genuinely believes the HECM is basically free money. He insists he'll receive a large amount of cash and that it never has to be repaid by him, his estate, or from the property. The financial analysis prepared by the HECM broker literally says that my dad retains ownership and that the loan balance grows as interest and charges accrue. He still insists I'm wrong. Because he believes this money never has to be repaid, he's also keen on using some of the reverse mortgage

proceeds to help me with my tuition, something I've repeatedly told him I don't need his help with. He won't listen to me. But the HECM is really just an example of the bigger problem: he seems incapable of imagining his future self. He lives in a townhouse with stairs in an extremely car-dependent area. He can't really downsize to anything cheaper without either moving somewhere even more rural or buying a home in worse condition, both of which come with their own problems. I've asked him, "What happens when you're 84 and can't drive anymore? What if you can't use the stairs? What if your mobility or health gets significantly worse? What's your plan then?" I can't get an answer out of him. When I visited a couple of years ago, I was already terrified of his driving, but he won't hear any of my concerns about that either. If he wants to make financial decisions I disagree with, he's an adult. Honestly, if I knew I would never have to deal with the consequences, I'd let him do whatever he wanted. But at some point he's going to have to face these questions. He knows I can't move back to the US to care for him. He doesn't want me to drop out of university, and he also knows I'm not in a position to become his retirement plan if he runs out of money. For those who have dealt with stubborn aging parents: How did you get them to realistically plan for declining mobility, finances, driving, housing, and care? Or do I need to accept that I can't make him plan, establish my boundaries now, and let him live with the consequences?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w2jif7/how_do_you_get_through_to_an_aging_parent_who/

"My mom was a big unbearable narcissist but I thank her that she passed early and I did not need to take care of her. There a lot of things she did wrong but this is the one thing she did right. But she left me to deal with my father. And it is been 7 years now and I am exhausted, constantly anxious and depressed."

youtube · @riorisa6613 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 21 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgwXFF8LWjRL_e12zq14AaABAg

↳ @ND1011-t (2): "I'm so sorry that you have to deal with all this stress. I truly understand how you feel because I also feel so exhausted that I feel like crying 24/7. You are not alone. I pray tonight that God will lift your burden and give you new strength for your journey. Lots of love and blessings from South Africa 🙏🙏🙏"

↳ @BEACHPEOPLE37 (0): "I take care of my paraments with my sister , my dad needs more help"

↳ @BJD124 (0): "My mam is also an unbearable narcissist. Im one of four siblings and none of us talk to her. There is no way i will be taking care of her in her old age, no way"

"Mentally Slipping healthy mom. My mom (77) is quite healthy and capable. She lives alone and I take her grocery shopping once a week. Except, over a year ago, she had a minor stroke and experienced deafness in one ear and short term memory loss. The memory loss has been frustrating because she can't learn anything new or adapt to anything that she hasn't been doing her whole life. Now her hearing has significantly declined in the other ear rendering her mostly deaf. She has had a caption phone for a year but never used it because she preferred her cel phone. When her hearing declined to the point that she couldn't hear us on the phone, she would call everyone in the family 8 times a day(or night) saying "can you hear me?" and then hang up. I took her cel phone away to force her to use the caption phone which she is now very slowly adapting to. But she can't hear it ring, won't remember that the flashing light means it's ringing, can't hear her doorbell, fire alarm, the toilet running, etc. The water company called yesterday because her toilet had been running long enough that it caught the attention of the water company. She has no assets, gets \$2,170/month in Social Security, I own her condo and she pays the fees and utilities, which are maybe \$1,400/month. So she can live this way financially forever. But her hearing, memory and cognitive decline are worrying us. Everyone says she shouldn't live alone for safety reasons, but we have no room in our home, I travel 2-3 weeks a month for work and my wife is a full time teacher. Plus we have a dog that my mom hates being around. We agree it's a safety issue especially now that she can't hear a smoke alarm. But with no way to afford private pay memory care that costs 2-3x her monthly income, do we force her into a nasty medicaid paid nursing home life sharing a room and being treated like a hospital patient for the next

10+ years? She takes no medication, has no health issues otherwise, showers, dresses herself, cooks, does her laundry, takes out the trash, etc. Assisted living/memory care would be an ideal situation, but she can't afford it with no savings to spend down. No AL will touch her in our area (S.FL) without a year of private pay at 2x her income. I know this is a rare case because my mom didn't go the medical route her whole life so now is still quite healthy, but hearing/cognition is her limiting factor. My wife and kids along with her neighbors and every home health aide that has seen her agrees she shouldn't live alone. But the nursing home alternative seems cruel. Meeting with an elder care attorney in two weeks to navigate the 8 month anticipated medicaid waiver application process that will then start the hunt for a needle in a haystack nursing home that will agree to take her without sucking six figures in private pay first. So I anticipate her nursing home options will likely be 2/5 star type places at best. I always warned my parents that they needed to save. but they thought Jesus would return before they retired. Not sure if I have any question per se. More of a scream into the void of our family's particular situation. Knowing that there are no other options for her and dealing with the guilt of not being able to provide a better last season of life for someone who provided a great childhood for me. Paid for my college, helped with childcare while our kids were young, etc. But now has become a real drain on my time and our family emotionally. Especially now that I also recently started dealing with my MIL (80) who we just moved into my mom's same condo complex and have to manage her finances and dozens of doctor appointments, groceries, etc. At least my MIL has her hearing and doesn't call at 3:00am saying "can you hear me?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpymwb/mentally_slipping_healthy_mom/

"My relationship with my mother is the same. She was physically and verbally abusive. Takes credit for all my success and embarrassingly brags about it. She has been catered to her whole life and has zero plans if anything happens to my father. They moved 1700 miles away 11 years ago, I've seen them 5 or 6 times in person. Constantly complains about her health and doctors, yet is morbidly obese and smokes 1-2 packs per day. The conversation is coming that I will not light myself on fire to keep her warm and I told my sister I won't let her either. Their lack of planning will not constitute an emergency for us. I may mourn my father a little, my mother will be a welcomed forgotten memory."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxd6h1r/

"My mom never planned for old age or retirement either, she never accepted she was old and needed to slow down in her 80s. She allowed my older cousins who are wealthy entitled brats to bully her into caring for their dad (her brother) i begged her not to because she would get sick, well she wound up being carried out by ems with heart issues she never took care of, she declined in several long hospital stays and never got back to her baseline. To make matters worse her brother died and left her nothing, not one dime or jewelry, family heirloom, we weren't even asked to be in the funeral procession. And I take care of mom because of her recklessness in putting her selfish brother first. I don't deserve this at all and i want to leave and just be happy because im so unhappy"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 3 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p05uwj8/

"In my experience they don't care. The last incident/hospitalization before my mom was finally convinced to move to assisted living, she was unable to even transfer from a bed to her wheelchair, was experiencing hospital delirium, and lived alone with no willingness to pay for private care, no close friends, and no living family apart from me and I live 2000 miles away. Despite my protests that it was an unsafe discharge they stuck her in an ambulance and (per the neighbor) dumped her outside of her home without even helping her in. That might have been on purpose since if they had helped her in they might have been obligated to take her back because it was visibly unsafe and filthy. If there is another adult in the home- no matter how unsuitable a caregiver- you have basically no shot. That said, it's still worth a try. You might luck out and get a social worker that actually cares. And at least you can sleep at night knowing you tried."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 2 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tx398k/what_really_happens_if_you_in_sist_it_is_not_safe/optv9dh/

"Aging parent is 100s of miles away, no savings, no siblings, and says she won't move. I go into every single season wondering, should I plant a garden?, should I plant flowers?, should I put up a Christmas tree? Is this the year I'll go to the other state and be stranded there for longer than a month. Maybe I'll be there 6 months. I've invited Mom to move in with us. Money would solve a lot of problems, and none of us has it. Solve that!"

youtube · @petuniagranny2758 · *What to Do When Elderly Parents Can't Live Alone* · 2 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=OIWdNaA4Fs&lc=Ugz3aer7wZqLJtmurxV4AaABAg>

↳ **@PamelaDWilsonCaregivingExpert** (1): "Thanks for watching and commenting. Have you looked into Medicaid services for the aged who have health problems and no money to pay for care? There are solutions to every problem."

"32 years of 24 hr 7 days a week. No vacations. No pay. 2 major surgeries- no time off . Dad stayed in my room on a cot. Stopped cancer treatment in the middle. At 66 nothing in SS. No savings."

youtube · @mary-vb7fm · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwxS3yRrL05GPBWtJ14AaABAg

"Do not trust this company.. I regret purchasing the MG Mini for my mother. Unfortunately, this device is highly unreliable. and the company is deceptive. The battery doesn't last more than a day, (though it falsely advertises up to 5 days) and the signal quality is poor. Even worse, the company is refusing to honor the extra warranty we purchased. We had the device replaced a few weeks ago due to the same issues, only to receive a faulty replacement that was even worse. They are refusing to replace it again, and despite the ongoing problems, customer service has shown no willingness to resolve the situation. I would not recommend this product to anyone. Do NOT trust it with your loved one. I will be filing a complaint with the AG office in my state, as well as the better business bureau."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6967eb619481595522278cb7>

"I love ur content, but what if they have no savings and refusing to be independent? They just want me to pay everything."

youtube · @Teisharocz · *TOP TIPS FOR NEW FAMILY CAREGIVERS - How to Take care of Aging Parents* · 0 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=g0UwGxD4F90&lc=UgynggX4H3cCWj5RNB4AaABAg>

Tab 6 — Previous Solutions

Assisted living, memory care, hospice · 1,987 documents

20 most engaged of 1,987 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"This goes the same for spouses. My husband had a stroke at 61 and I was changing diapers for 2 years with no help and using the Lahoya lift many times a day. Feeding, bathing and he was diabetic..After 2 years I became ill and he spent the next 9; months in a nursing home where I visited him every day. I was 57 when he died and I have spent the last 15 years alone and the thought of dating never once entered my head because my caretaking days are over. I am happily alone with my cat."

youtube · @AutumnGold0706 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 956 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzYmazblhZwkmWogF4AaABAg

↳ **@TheDrCatWoman** (68): "@AutumnGold0706 - hello. I don't know you, but you've answered a question for me. My grandmother spent the decade of the 1950s taking care of my grandfather who had become disabled after a series of strokes. She was in her 50s. I would describe her as a down to earth but high energy person. She worked full-time during that decade. And raised her child single-handedly. And cared for her evermore disabled husband. Anyway, I didn't know her until after my grandfather had died. After he died, there were a couple of times that she could've had a partner. There were a couple of men who were interested in being in a relationship with her over the years. One was the widow of a friend of hers, and the other was a man she met on a tour. I wondered why she didn't pursue either of these relationships. She preferred being on her own. And it was probably as you describe - she probably just didn't want to take care of someone else as they began to decline. She didn't begin to decline until she was over 80."

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (52): "Thank you for bringing this up. ❤️ Very important to have conversations with spouses and anyone you are close enough with to potentially be a caretaker."

↳ **@luzfelipe2964** (34): "@TheDrCatWoman you don't need to have your own spouse disabled to never want to be on a relationship, 😊 men are exhausting even if they're not disabled."

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are

both “really nice” and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I’m driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom’s rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I’ve never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother’s wrecked, we’re all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?!) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I’m bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened (“oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing”)... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something’s wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom’s memorial is gonna be because I can’t plan that yet because I’m trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he’s not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there’s two weeks where *every single day* he’s weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It’s okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I’m ready to go. It’s okay. He says, I don’t want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I’m trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we’re all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it’s that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that’s okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he’s sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We’re talking about football and birds. He’s looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says “What a coincidence!” and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily “Because I love you too,” , he’s beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say “See you soon!” and I wave and I leave, and I’m certain I’ll see him next week and we’ll talk about the Super Bowl and I’ll tell him about the birds I’ve seen, I’ll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he’s gone. It’s over”

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US,

has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :), can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"My husband was floored when I told him how much healthcare REALLY costs.. The other day my husband was talking about his potential inheritance from his parents (both still alive.) They have inherited money, multiple cars, four properties, and their own large savings. They are physically and mentally well. "I wouldn't bank on an inheritance," I said. I won't say what my job is. But I can see what multiple healthcare entities bill. I'm extremely familiar with all of the assisted livings, hospitals, skilled facilities, and in-home care providers within my area. I've been in this line of work for 15 years. The amounts charged are sickening. I've seen assisted livings charge residents \$15k+ per month. I've seen one hospital charge \$75k for a THREE DAY STAY. I saw a NICU charging \$8k per day. I've seen group homes that house individuals with developmental disabilities charge \$250k per year. The prices of medications have skyrocketed. Home medical equipment is outrageously priced. People like my husband that aren't in this world have no idea how much things cost. Whether you stay home or go to a facility things will get expensive. I wish everyone knew that they need to plan ahead. Work with an elder care law attorney. Medicaid does a five year look back on everything. So you have to plan really far in advance. My mom doesn't trust my knowledge. She refuses to sign a will, speak to an attorney, even make her funeral arrangements. She refuses to address reality. "You'll figure it out," she says. She won't even hear about spending down for Medicaid because she's "too proud to be on welfare." I hate how expensive end of life care is and how little education is out there to help people plan ahead. Sorry, just needed to vent this."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 612 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1j6yu55/my_husband_was_floored_when_i_told_him_how_much/

"Aging, and the Right to Die with Dignity. My mother is 88. She lives in an assisted living facility about 10 minutes from me. And honestly, every time I walk through the doors, I get overwhelmed by what I see. It's actually a very nice facility for what we often think of as an "old folks home." There are different levels of ability, and there are people who are still social, engaged, and enjoying life. But I would say that more than half of the residents I see are essentially just existing. They are breathing, eating, using the bathroom, sleeping—and repeating it all again the next day. They are alive, but they aren't really *living*. I don't mean that to sound callous. It's just incredibly difficult to watch. My mother no longer enjoys her life. She doesn't have a terminal disease that is going to take her life anytime soon. She had a stroke, is diabetic and has the beginning stages of dementia, but her biggest problem is that her body has essentially stopped working. She can barely stand. She is constantly incontinent and

often doesn't even realize when she has urinated or had a bowel movement. The staff helps her change, but they are caring for many other residents too. Sometimes my mother has to sit in her own waste for hours before someone is available to help her. Sometimes I stop by - the smell is so bad and she doesn't even notice it. I ask her if I can change her and she responds by saying it's not necessary (because she can not smell her own waste). She has very little control over her own life. She hates being in assisted living. She hates what has happened to her body. She hates needing help with things she once did without thinking. They do physical therapy with her, but between the damage from her stroke and diabetes, she has very little use of her legs beyond briefly standing to transfer to a toilet or chair. And the saddest part is that my mother is not an isolated case. There are so many people living this way. This is really my rant: I hear people all the time say, "I never want to live like that." And yet, when someone reaches a point where they no longer have any meaningful quality of life, the idea of allowing them to choose when and how they die is considered illegal, immoral, or taboo. I struggle to understand that. When one of my dogs was suffering, unable to walk, and losing control of their bladder and bowels, I could make the heartbreaking decision to let them go peacefully. I could prevent them from having to continue living in a body that no longer allowed them to have any quality of life. Why don't we extend some version of that compassion and autonomy to people? I'm not talking about giving up on someone because they're old or disabled. I'm talking about respecting the wishes of a mentally competent person who has reached a point where they no longer want to continue living in a body that has become a prison. Why can't we decide for ourselves what *living* means to us—and, when the time comes, have the right to die with dignity rather than being forced to simply keep existing? Watching my mother live this way has made me question something I never really questioned before: **Is keeping someone alive always the same thing as giving them a life worth living?"**

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 517 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vnse4u/aging_and_the_right_to_die_with_dignity/

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"It's time for the talk. My wife and I are both only children. Between us we've buried three parents. One is left — my father-in-law. Everything below is my experience; yours will differ. But I'd rather say the hard parts out loud than let someone else get blindsided the way we were. Confront reality — and make sure they confront it too. That's the whole thing. Both of us were badly surprised by things we had been told were handled and weren't. My mother-in-law went in for surgery and had a massive stroke on the table. A month in ICU in a coma, then a specialized rehab, then a nursing home — almost a year. She surfaced briefly near the end before a second stroke took her. My father-in-law had a will, an advance directive, and a power of attorney. We assumed she did too. She didn't. She couldn't tolerate what she called death talk, and he was certain he'd go first. I got him in front of an elder care attorney in the middle of the crisis. It was the right call, and it was a year too late. Had she lived longer, the cost would have consumed their savings and everything they meant to leave their grandchildren. After my dad died suddenly, my mom and I sat down with her affairs. The legal side was easy — wills, POAs, no argument. Two things weren't easy. One I'll come back to. The other was that after multiple conversations about her income and expenses, I found out she was hiding more than \$30,000 in debt from me. We can't fix problems we won't look at. The upfront conversations are unpleasant. Assume they will be. They are still cheaper than picking up the pieces on the back end. So don't take anyone's word for it: \- If they say there's a will, ask to see it. Then ask where it's kept. \- Same for the advance directive and the powers of attorney — financial and healthcare are not the same document. \- Ask to see the bank and credit statements. Not a summary. The statements. \- Get in front of an elder care attorney if you can possibly manage it. Medicaid look-back rules and asset protection are not things to learn during an ICU stay. That's table stakes. And even parents who've done every bit of it aren't out of the woods, because the paperwork is the easy conversation. The hard one is about legacy. This is the one I avoided with my mom, because it was the one that nearly broke her. Not the money. The *possessions*. She collected beautiful things her whole life. Most of it is headed for an estate sale. She made herself sick over it — trauma levels, on the edge of an identity crisis. There was china I never once saw used. Not one Christmas in my entire life. If we'd eaten off it every year I might feel differently. But I don't understand why I'm obligated to carry an attachment that was never mine. She had an old Mercedes. When it was time for independent living, we talked about what to do with it. She wanted to know if her granddaughter could use it. I told her the truth: no. Expensive to maintain, no dealer or independent mechanic anywhere near them, and they hike and camp and have a dog. They needed something that fit their life. Her position was that they should take it anyway — accept the burden, because it was a gift. I'm still working through that one. To me it's like buying piano lessons for someone whose hobby is baking bread. Here's

what I think is actually going on. The things aren't the issue. The things are proxies. They're where the feelings get stored, because the feelings themselves never got dealt with. *If you don't keep this thing I owned, you're rejecting me and my memory.* That's why so many of our parents can't sort through it, and why it gets left behind for us. Dealing with the stuff means dealing with everything underneath the stuff. If I could run one conversation over, it's that one. I'd stop negotiating over objects and say: if you love them, let's turn this into something that actually helps them. Sell the car, put it toward the truck they need. Sell the china, fund something they'll remember. They will remember and appreciate that you helped them. **The love transfers.** The dining set doesn't. Have the conversation while it's still a conversation and not an inventory."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 488 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vf1z4k/its_time_for_the_talk/

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful.* Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her.* I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom CHOSE this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly AGAINST having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends ALSO saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit AGAIN, find a new place to live AGAIN, set up all my utilities AGAIN, and STILL have to manage HER life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING. I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7 months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and

guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER. THIS, more than ANYTHING, should be a clue that mom is NOT who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and THEN people will complain that mom is LONELY. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags under her bed rather than in the 3 FUCKING HAMPERS I've bought for her) FINALLY getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here,

I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"Never Say Never. I know I'm preaching to the choir here but never tell your family that you're never going to a nursing home. It's just so many levels of a crappy thing to do to them. Particularly if you haven't done the advanced financial and legal planning to provide for yourself. First of all: Your precipitating event for a nursing home is going to preclude your ability to object to a nursing home for starters. If you have a massive stroke, dementia, Alzheimer's, or a fall that you don't recover well from, you're going to be in no position to object. If you haven't prepared for that moment legally and financially then you are just dumping a huge burden on your family. Is that what you really want to do to them? Did you really raise your kids so they can spend 5-10 years wiping your arse after your stroke? Is this the future you want for them? Do you want them to care for you at such a high level after your food and lifestyle choices incapacitate you? Just no. I am informing my kids that if I am not willing / unable to bathe myself or toilet myself and there is no hope of recovery, then put me in a nursing home already. They do not need to feel guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 447 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ud5jqh/never_say_never/

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations: Youre so strong Translation: Youre on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are theyre really saying theyre not going to help you. Theyre admiring your ability to handle it so they dont have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow youre so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. Were just surviving it because theres no other option. I dont need your theology. I need respite care. I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. Theyd watch me help my mom with everything then say I dont know how you do it and leave. If you dont know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Dont stand there marveling at my survival skills like Im some interesting specimen. Im doing this because I dont have a choice and you wont help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: Im going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you wont ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person were caring for so we can sleep. Dont make us ask. Ive got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. Theres more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If youre a caregiver drowning

in toxic positivity... you dont need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say Im coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. Thats the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): ""enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own*

child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

"My mom finally died. Hi everyone, I want to thank everyone in this sub over the years for providing support for me, no one knows how hard this is like you all. Mom spent the last 1.5 weeks in the hospital with sepsis, was discharged, and after a few days of slowly healing (but not really) complained of not being able to breathe yesterday morning. Paramedics were called to her nursing home and since no one could find her DNR papers they...did CPR on her for 20 minutes. She was 90lbs, 80 years old, and suffering from COPD, liver disease, heart disease, alcoholism, etc. I brought up hospice after this last hospital stint but she didn't want to talk about it yet. I was on my way but didn't get there in time. It's been 10 years of near misses and health crises, her not wanting to do anything for herself but drink and smoke. She was bed bound and incontinent for the past few years and evaded death numerous times. She was on hospice for six months two years ago and then was taken off because she showed no signs of leaving. She was a medical marvel and I really thought she'd pull through again. I'm tired and distraught that they performed CPR on her small frail body, but she was already gone. There's so much relief but also so much sadness. She was a broken old lady and I did my best. Here's a reminder to tell your mom you love her, and also make sure her DNR papers are readily accessible to avoid what my mom went through at the end. Good luck everyone, they really don't make it easy on us."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 393 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tncv7m/my_mom_finally_died/

↳ **comment** (62): "Sending hugs and love. I'm terribly sorry for your loss. Take care of yourself."

↳ **comment** (50): ""She was a broken old lady and I did my best." You get to carry this with pride for the rest of your life. It certainly wasn't easy. My condolences."

↳ **comment** (10): "I'm so sorry for your loss. May you find your peace with all the complex emotions this transition has brought. Your love and care for your mom comes through in your post and, ultimately, I believe the measure of a love is like that of the steady beats of a song, not the that of the occasional bridge."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this

requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know I have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. I'm an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business I'm juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking I have some time. A week or so later Dad's friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasn't clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. He's in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when he's lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them I'm looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they don't want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isn't worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which I don't have) Dad's declining while I'm working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - I call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesn't do well with this. Hospital delirium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. I'm stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and I'm a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Can't be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and he's in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I can't shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her, but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship. After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this. I simply wasn't proactive enough in getting my dad into an assisted living facility, possibly even memory care. I felt that it wasn't my life, but I was somehow compelled to help him live independently. I can't even imagine the millage I put on my car traveling to his house to help get groceries and pay his bills, clean his place, get him to his doctor's appointments, get him the medication he needs (through the VA nonetheless), basically keep him alive. After the initial hospitalization that set this in motion, I was able to buy him about two years on his own. Now he's in a memory care facility--just a few months after he temporarily moved in with me, he broke his hip and there was only one place that could take him while he healed. He was going to need 24 hr. assistance. My wife had made it clear she was not happy with how much time I was spending on his affairs. And rightfully so, as it was eating away my time with the family, and it always aggravated my depression. I started a new career last year and my dad's problems were preventing me from putting best foot forward. By the time I was able to convince him to start touring assisted living facilities and getting on a waiting list, it was too little too late. My wife moved out, in part, to make room for my Dad to live at our place for a little bit--just a way to ease the transition into assisted living. The most-recent hospitalization was the big wake up call. Now my brother and I are in the process of managing his property, getting a short-term bridge loan to buy us time

to fix up my childhood home, only for that house to be sold to pay for future memory care costs. It's not hard to see how a marriage could crumble under these conditions, especially if you don't get out in front of it when you had the opportunity. Yeah, our marriage had some problems to begin with. But dealing with my Dad was taking away time, energy, and other resources I needed to address my marital issues. I was exhausted all the time. And it was getting in the way of my new job. I was getting pulled in too many directions, and my Dad's situation was by far the most frustrating. If not for that, I feel like I could have repaired our relationship. Or maybe not. But it would have freed up a lot of time to focus on what's really important. Anyways, I just felt like sounding the alarm to anyone worried that their obligations to an aging parent are ruining your relationship... or some other important part of your life. The best advice I can offer are these rules of thumb: (1) set some boundaries to prevent it from bleeding into your family or professional life; (2) be proactive about moving this process along, because it's not getting any easier--if its damaging your marriage, that's a clear sign that you can no longer provide the help they need; (3) if you haven't yet dealt with estate matters, medical/financial POI, etc., call a lawyer ASAP; and (4) let it be a lesson and plan for this period of your life so that it doesn't all fall on the shoulders of your children or other family members. I know it's easier said than done, but trust me when I say there is a better way. Happy New Year"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"I get to retire today. My sweet mom, after a year with in-home hospice and 4 years of post brain tumor difficulties and 24/7 care, she finally headed home to heaven. Hospice detected signs last Thursday with the finding of a Kennedy ulcer. Bittersweet feelings as life on earth had been torture the last few years for her and glad my Dad and I could take care of her at home. A lot of sacrifice, depression and isolation — but I would do it again. She leaves an ocean sized void in my heart. Caregiving is not for the weak, but it gives you purpose and I am now without purpose. Take care friends and always remember you're not alone."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 355 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nebf4t/i_get_to_retire_today/

"Dad Passed This Morning. Received the call at 6AM from Memory Care. They said better come now. Called my brother and headed down there. Walked in and Dad (92) was on oxygen, unconscious and I could hear The Rattle. Nurse came in and gave him some medicine and The Rattle stopped. His breathing was more relaxed and he looked peaceful. Brother and I sat with him until he passed and then some. Hospice chaplain was with us while we waited and every single member of the staff came in to say their goodbye, many in tears. We stayed through the pronouncement and ToD, then walked Dad out with the funeral home transport. I can't say enough good about the memory care and hospice staff. It takes a special kind of person to do this work and we will be forever grateful for their services. [Edit:] I can't thank all of you enough for your kind words. There are more replies than I can respond to at the moment so please know I've read each and every one of them. I am overwhelmed by all of your kindness. Thank you."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 351 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkw18g/dad_passed_this_morning/

↳ **comment** (60): "I am truly sorry for your loss. There is a lot to be said for a peaceful passing (*and* being a witness to it, IMO). Take care of yourself, OP. <3"

↳ **comment** (40): "As a nurse who was a hospice nurse for 5 years I appreciate your appreciation for the humans who choose to be present for others as they head towards death. I feel that I learned so much about what life is really about and how important it is to treat each other with kindness and respect from my experience caring for patients and their families as a hospice nurse. I am sorry for your loss and send you support going through your grieving process. It sounds like your dad was well loved. 💖 "

↳ **comment** (15): "Thank you for doing what you do. I remember standing over my father with my 3 siblings gathered around. The hospice nurse felt his knees and said they were cold. She knew it was time to make the last

moments count. That calm nurse in the room, with 4 adults losing their minds, made a unbearable situation make sense. She offered some kind words, some hard truths and a whole lot of compassion."

Agencies and the rotating aides · 940 documents

20 most engaged of 940 matching documents, complete text.

"I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets.. Edit everything I say here is for the USA. private pay insurance. I've worked for home health for around five years now and I want to share some of the good and bad I've learned so you can make an informed decision about the care for your aging parents. There are two kinds of home health care ones thst accept Medicare and one's that do not. The ones that do follow stricter guidelines for care (this doesn't mean they're better it just means they have to follow different rules than private insurance) my information only applies to those that do not take Medicare. First. It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour. So please don't act towards the caregivers like they should be doing \$50 an hour worth of work because they are not getting paid much above minimum wage. Second. Keep track of your loved ones need for care. If they fall and then need care or have a heart attack and need help after surgery. The agency is never ever going to tell you that the person is fine now and doesn't need care anymore. I go to several assignments where I do literally nothing the entire time I'm there just because no body says to stop sending us. Third. If you up the care from one kind to another temporarily after an injury or fall make sure that when you know they can go back down to less care that they return to charging you the lower rate. I've been to several assignments where I'm still being paid for hands on care even though all I'm doing is cleaning house. Fourth. Do not look at the caregivers like you would a cleaning crew That comes in and cleans as fast as they can to get done fast and move on to the next home. Caregivers are there for a set time so we are encouraged to sit and talk to our clients. Watch TV with them. Play games. Go for walks. We won't always be up doing things. We aren't someone who you hired to fix your toilet and now he's sitting on your couch. You hired us to take care of your loved one and sometimes that is just having a conversation or watching TV together. Fifth. Ask the caregiver what they need for the home and for the client. I went to an assignment last month that had no toilet paper in the whole house. The client was bedbound and used diapers so they just never thought to have toilet paper in the house. I literally had no way to wipe for the first day and I ended up bringing my own. Hand soap, paper towels, gloves, hand sanitizer all these things you are responsible for providing. Sixth. Understand that for the most part we are not nurses. Most states require little to no certifications to be a home health aide. So please understand the limitations of what we can/are allowed to do. We can't make medical decisions. We can't administer medicines. We can't change dressings. We can't even trim nails because if we cut you it could cause an infection. So please be very aware of what we are and are not allowed to do and don't ask or expect us to do something we aren't supposed to do. If you want any other advice ask it in the comments I'm happy to answer."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

↳ **comment** (363): "RN here and this is incredibly well written and all very true. Thank you for all you do. You ARE underpaid. Massively."

↳ **comment** (137): "It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients"cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception thst the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

↳ **comment** (94): "Thank you. I love my job but I am aware of it's downfalls."

"Do not move away from your jobs/immediate family to care for your aged family members. You will wreck your family, career and future.. I've read too many posts from folks that abandoned their professional/personal lives to take care of old, disabled relatives who did shit jobs of preparing for their retirement. Walk away, you can't save them from themselves. You owe them nothing if they refuse to budge. If they die, they die. They made their choices. If you feel they are being taken advantage of, call your local agency on aging."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 641 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1psiwas/do_not_move_away_from_your_obsimmediate_family/

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had."* This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin* Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family *Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin* My cousin also asked her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant we would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set off what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier,

happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1trrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care, and your adult child wrote you and the whole family this letter regarding that situation?. Dear family, I've been doing a lot of reflecting lately on the situation with Grandma and Grandpa, and I feel a need to share some thoughts that have been weighing on me. I know we are all doing our best to navigate this, but I want to offer a different perspective—one that might be uncomfortable, but feels necessary to voice. I can't help but feel that what we are witnessing is, in many ways, fundamentally unnatural. Decades ago, you rarely heard of couples requiring 24/7 professional assistance simultaneously; there was a natural rhythm to life and passing that seems to have been disrupted. It feels as though modern medicine has become so focused on the mechanics of keeping the body running that it has moved far away from human nature itself. By pushing past what might have once been our natural "expiration dates," we've entered a territory where the cost of longevity is a loss of the very independence that defined them. Perhaps the most jarring part of this experience for me is seeing the in-home care staff every day. While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge; instead of a family visit, it feels like a supervised appointment in their own home. Because of this, I want to be very clear about my own wishes for the future: Once I reach the age of 75, I do not want any extraordinary measures taken to prolong my life. Whether it is surgery, intensive treatment, or any form of medical intervention, I want to let nature take its course. Furthermore, if I ever reach a point where I can no longer safely live independently, please do not try to recreate a hospital within my home. I am asking you now to please just put me in a professional facility. I would rather my home remain a memory of who I was, rather than a place defined by its clinical needs. I know this is hard to hear, and I don't say it to diminish the love we all have for them. I just feel we need to acknowledge the reality of the era we are living in and how much it has changed the way we experience the end of life. With love and honesty, Jack"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 349 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

↳ **comment** (259): "A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

↳ **comment** (147): "I was Jack almost a decade ago. The PTSD I have associated with helping my mom care for my grandparents will never leave me. It *ruined* my memories of my grandparents who i loved so much and spent much of my childhood with. It sucks to be the elderly person or the caregiver, but being a support person for the caregiver sucks too. We are watching an elderly loved one basically be tortured into living, another loved one get burnt out to a crispy husk of a person, and we just have to sit there like 'This is fine.....' It's really sad, frustrating, depressing to watch, and makes you look around and scream 'am I taking crazy pills?!'"

↳ **comment** (140): "I studied gerontology and death & dying. Because of that, I made an Exit Plan 20 years ago. I saw what was going to happen with the massive, aging, Boomer population & there's nothing good about it. I've

completed all my EOL documents (Will, Living Will/Healthcare POA, financial/durable POA), each kid has copies. Pre-planned & pre-paid for my cremation. I'm very open with my kids about EOL stuff and how I don't want to burden them with my care. Of course, they say "we don't mind," but I've seen 1st hand how caregiving tears apart families and breaks caregivers. I don't want to do that to my kids."

"Things I Wish Someone Had Explained to Me About the Actively Dying phase. I wanted to share a few things I've learned during the active dying phase with my mother-in-law because this experience is honestly something most people are not prepared for at all until they're suddenly in it. And I've realized some hospice agencies are amazing at proactively educating families... and others are kind of waiting for the caregiver to know what questions to ask or what options exist. The problem is your brain is already overwhelmed, emotional, sleep deprived, grieving, and trying to function while watching someone decline in real time. Sometimes you don't even know what you don't know. A few things I wish someone had explained to me earlier: hospice can provide a hospital bed in the home at no cost. There are also relatively affordable rotating air mattresses and pressure relief options online that can really help with comfort and tailbone pain. Foam barrier dressings have helped too. The little mouth swabs dipped in water have also made a huge difference for dry mouth and comfort. Another thing that has been hard emotionally is the eating and hydration piece. Every instinct in you wants to push food and water because feeding and nurturing someone feels so tied to love and care. But there really is a lot of hospice and scientific literature around the body naturally beginning to need less at end of life. From what I've read and been told, excess fluids can sometimes increase swelling and discomfort. I've also gone down a rabbit hole reading about ketosis during the dying process and how some researchers believe it may actually help ease pain or discomfort for the body. I'm not a medical professional, just a human trying to help someone I love through one of the hardest and strangest experiences of my life while learning as I go. Sharing in case it helps another caregiver feel a little less lost or alone."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 281 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/

↳ **comment** (82): "For anyone interested, there is a YouTube channel called HOSPICE NURSE JULIE. She explains all phases of dying, from all types of diseases and what to expect in each case. She is excellent at answering questions and taking the fear out of the whole process."

↳ **comment** (69): "Thank you for posting this, and massive, massive hugs to you. My sister recently passed but before that, our family was doing the above, actively providing water and nutrients (protein drinks) but also being anxious about knowing that at some point she wouldn't want to and couldn't either, because it became an aspirating danger. Mouth swabs in water are absolutely a game changer for comfort, they also had mouthwash that helped generate saliva that provided some comfort to her. The last thing I'll say about this phase that I never understood despite reading about it ceaselessly, was the restlessness that comes at end of life stage. I didn't know my sister's discomfort and distress would be her last signs before she passed. At that stage, it's was hard to know the degree to which she was in discomfort because it as a constant dance of increasing drugs for not only pain but also discomfort. We heavily leaned on the amazing nursing staff to help us through this distressing time, and for anyone else seeing a loved one in hospice, just emphasizing that no question is a silly question, they have seen everything under the sun and are experts at noticing all the signs and symptoms."

↳ **comment** (23): "Hospice nurse Julie reels are so helpful. They can be a little jolting; it just depends if you are a person who likes a lot of information or a little. Taking the fear out of the process makes it more tolerable so you can be present."

"MIL eloped from memory care. An unexpected slot for 2026 Bingo card. Somehow, my MIL had escaped. How or when, were grilling the memory care facility for. All we know is we were not home and noticed we had several Ring notifications. Normal to get one or so, maybe for Amazon Delivery but it was my MIL. We have her on our

Ring sitting on our front porch for about an hour before we had noticed the notifications. We were like who's that lady because there was no way in hell we would think it was my MIL. But yep, it was her. The memory care didn't call us, we had to call them. They are supposed to have someone 24/7 and the door needs to be opened by pushing a button under the front desk and the elevators are coded per floor. So they have someone serious explaining to do. She has no wallet, keys, or cell phone. I'm guessing she had to walk to our home, which just over 5 miles away. We are extremely lucky that she somehow made it safely to our house. I'm actually impressed she remembered where we live. But that's beside the point. I don't know if we need to pursue legal counsel yet, but we sure as heck will be reporting this to regulatory agencies."

reddit post · r/dementia · 204 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1qgtrb0/mil_escaped_from_memory_care/

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues

living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"Just FYI. I may be paranoid, but I suspect APFM has employees monitoring this sub because everytime anything negative about them comes up, a bunch of people rush in to defend them. If you've had good luck with them, awesome for you, but remember that advertising and commercial posts are prohibited in this sub. I, personally, keep my recommendations to nonprofits and governmental agencies in honor of the sub rules. APFM is a for-profit business whose revenue comes through referral fees they collect from senior living communities and home healthcare providers. Not every service provider is willing to pay their fees, so if you enlist APFM's help, you're not seeing every option available. And, yes, if your aging parent is low income, they are disincentivized from helping you. The fact they use aggressive sales techniques like never removing your phone number from their call list should be enough of a clue. Add your number to the FTC's Do Not Call Registry, make sure to get the call center employee to tell you who they are working for, and tell them you're on the DNC registry and will report them for violating the law (and actually follow through...it's easy)."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 186 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/mspj8o/

"both of my parents are on hospice. i'm at the hospital, bedside with my mother. my father is at home with in-home agency caregivers. my mother's been on hospice since saturday. my father's been on hospice since last may. for so long i wished they would die so i might be free. and, i know how awful that sounds. but... what i really meant was... i needed a break. i needed help. i needed the responsibility of two at once to stop pulverizing me. i have been mentally depleted, physically exhausted, emotionally damaged, socially isolated, financially strained, and personally miserable for years-upon-years. when i said that i hated them, when i said that i wished they'd die, what i meant was that i couldn't... could... not... keep carrying the whole load by myself. i do love my mom and dad. i know my mom and dad love me in their own ways. i started my caregiving journey in 2014. it was a slow burn, running errands, checking in on them, offering assistance, knowing they'd refuse most of it. by 2021, i was a daily caregiver. first for about five hours per day, then nine, then some days 24-hours without breaks. my father has atypical parkinsonism/parkinson's. he refused extensive testing, so we call it parkinson's, but the neuro's notes read "atypical." he's had hallucinations for more than a decade. and, while a neuro diagnosed my dad with parkinson's dementia, a hospital visit indicated suspicion for lewy body dementia, with recommendation for further testing. but, by the time we started running on the hospital "hamster wheel," the amount of chaos my parents created around care made it impossible to take my dad for testing. doctor's appointments seemed like a luxury by the time i was on full-time with them. after three hospitalizations for pneumonia in under six months, my father was sent home from the hospital on hospice last may. my mother has cardiovascular disease, pulmonary disease, thyroid disease, arthritis, osteoporosis, raynaud's, MGUS... etc., etc., etc., and more. she also has either mild cognitive impairment or dementia. she was never tested except while an in-patient, and only ever when she had a UTI. so, i'm inclined to believe she had mild cognitive impairment, likely age-appropriate and age-related. additionally, my mom's always had trouble with UTIs and kidney stones. this round, i thought she had just a UTI, but she was admitted with a kidney stone obstructing infected urine, and i declined surgery. both of my parents

are 90 years old. their personal "rules" for healthcare, established well before i came on full-time were: DNR/AND no intubation, no feeding tubes, no ostomy bag or catheterizations, no thickened liquids, no modified food diets, no surgeries, no anesthesia, no stents (heart or urinary) to move the stone from my mother's ureter meant intubation, anesthesia, and surgery. it would have also meant followup procedures, including additional surgeries. honestly... who does surgery on a 90-year-old woman in fragile condition?? or when her wishes were so clear?? so, i refused. i opted instead for a little extra time with her by way of antibiotics, until her kidneys failed. this happened over three days. and, on the afternoon of the third day, i opted to transition her to comfort care. yesterday, i opted to transition her to full hospice. the hospital... i can't even fully believe or explain it. the hospital understands that my father is at home, also on hospice, that his decline has been violent. they're allowing my mom to stay in-house. they offered me the option of giving her "familiarity or peace," meaning "familiarity" of home or "peace" of an institutional death where i press a button and nurses and aides come to help me. i have never ever experienced such kindness or support in all my years of caregiving, not like this. then... there's the stark reality that both of my parents are on hospice at the same time, and... i don't know what i'm doing. i did tell my father that my mother was dying, and he's since decided to stop eating, drinking, and taking meds. his vitals are falling. his hospice nurse believes he's given up, and that he's decided to "go" with my mom. i do believe this... because he's always only lived for her. i came here to post... because i've been in this group, both as a commenter and as a lurker, for so long. i lurked for years before making my account, and then... more than a year commenting. this group is my primary social exposure since i started caregiving; people i knew grew bored of me and my situation, perhaps. but i always knew i could come here and read about someone else's life mirroring mine, or someone else's feelings sitting similarly to mine. i don't remember seeing many posts about having two on hospice at once. but, i came here just the same. maybe to share? maybe for some kind support? maybe just to "be"? and, maybe... to be somewhere with people who understand. anyway, thanks for listening. i'm scared. i'm truly scared. i'm trying not to fail either one of them, but... i'm tired and it seems there's road still ahead... and... again... i truly am scared."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 170 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tkrjqf/both_of_my_parents_are_on_hospice/

"Both of my parents are in a life threatening crisis, and they shift the blame on me because I try to help. I live a few states away from my family. My mother (65) had a botched surgery last year and has been in a physical and mental health spiral ever since. She has several comorbidities and one of the top ones is extreme insomnia, like 3 hours of sleep a night on average. This has caused her to lose grasp with reality due to psychosis. She refuses to take any medication, doesn't trust doctors. Doesn't have proper nutrition or hydration. Every time I call she is in absolute hysterics without fail, like full on crying fits and panics. My father is her primary caregiver and he is facing full caregiver collapse. He is now an insomniac too, cries all the time, and I think he is hiding self harm from me. Here's what really bothers me: he reinforces her psychosis. Tells her that she doesn't have to take the medicine if she doesn't want to. Says he doesn't trust her doctors. He is very mentally ill himself and is unfitting as a caregiver. They both have delusions that people are coming to "take them away to the loony bin" or arrest them if they seek help. I have made a million phone calls to physicians, department of aging, other family members. What ultimately happens is that when my parents are confronted with harsh truths (like "hey you need to escalate care") they refuse, downplay, or just explode in anger. Well I had one of those anger explosions over the phone recently. Suddenly everything was my fault because I was "making too many phone calls". I told them that if my mother does not take her medication I will have to call her doctor again. They both lost it on me. Told me this is my fault because I'm not there with them. Told me both "leave us alone" and "you're too far away", so basically any situation I'm at fault. Full disclosure, my father was very physically and emotionally abusive to me growing and this brought me right back to the feeling of being a little scared boy. At this point I have absolved of the situation. I don't think I will hear my mother's voice again by Christmas and I'm afraid what my dad might will do once she passes. But I can't insert myself in this chaos anymore. No more agencies, no more phone calls. Shit sucks man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 132 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ts88af/both_of_my_parents_are_in_a_life_threatening/

"The cost of caregiving is too high and I can't continue like this. I need to vent. My (26) mom (68) had a fall and broke many bones, after many surgeries and a month long hospital stay, she is now at home with very limited mobility. I am an onlychild, my dad is dead and we don't have other family so everything falls in me and I don't have a lot of support, except from my friends. I was already her caregiver when she broke a leg when I was 21 and have been financially responsible for her for 8 years. I am so tired / angry / frustrated and I can't face to keep being responsible for everything. Being responsible for her health is such a big pressure, as if anything goes wrong it will be my fault. Example, if something is a warning sign and I didn't realize. Cognitively she is great, so she could help me figure out stuff. Instead, she decides to acts like a toddler which gets on my nerves. She has always being emotionally immature and narcissistic, but she takes it now to an extreme. She doesn't take any agency over her own health or even bothers to try. When I tell her that it is X time and she has to take X pill, she answers something like "Ok, I'll take it only if you want me to take it". At the same time, I can't speak with her like grown ups. When I tell her that I am burn out, her answer is "I'll just make myself invisible so I don't bother you anymore if I am such a burden for you". I hired a caregiver and she refuses to ask her for help if I am around (because she "prefers it when I do it") so I have to leave the apartment. I have no safe space anymore as being in my apartment is being bombarded by things to do. I am emotionally depleted. I work a full time and a part time job (both remote) and I am being a horrible worker because I don't have the time, energy or focus to work on my tasks. I am late to every deadline and I make so many mistakes due to my lack of attention. So I am also constantly afraid of being made redundant (who is going to pay for everything she needs then?). This year, I have received many amazing career opportunities and I feel like I am throwing everything to the trash because I am not up to what they expected from me. And lastly, I have no time for self-care. I feel like I am giving up my youth and all my desires for her, and I don't want to. But then, I feel extremely guilty because I should be a "better daughter" -not based in the US-

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cbz9g1/the_cost_of_caregiving_is_too_high_and_i_cant/

"Finally lost my cool on my mom's nursing home roommate. For context, my mother is young for a nursing home. She has primary progressive MS and has been paralyzed since I was 4, quadraplegic since I was 10. I have helped to feed, clothe, take her to the bathroom, change tampons, be a human remote, etc. etc. since I was that young. I am now in my late thirties and in my early 30s we had no choice but to move her into assisted care because she requires 24/7 effort. She has little to no voice anymore either. This week was particularly difficult because I have been solo parenting my newly defiant toddler, and I had the stomach flu. I have very little caregiving support from my father who refuses to retire because he has been awful with money, and hence why my mom is in a medicare bed and not private pay (though we have to pay out of pocket like 1k a month.) My mom likes when I bring my 2.5 year old; it brings her joy. One thing she really likes to do is share her dinner with my daughter. She orders a separate PB&J for her, and usually the things my mom doesn't eat, my daughter will eat. My mom has severely disordered eating from the MS, and has to eat things in specific ways, and is extremely controlling. I have figured out that if the kid is eating, and I can feed my mom then it's a fine balance of time, but I am essentially a proxy human for two beings. My mom's roommate clearly some issues in addition to whatever her physical ailments are. She is large, bedridden, and just a SEE YOU NEXT TUESDAY. She loudly complains to her aids about me, and that they need to watch me and she doesn't like me. I have never said anything. Until today. Finally I stepped on the other side of the curtain when I heard her complaining about how I feed my daughter. She is convinced that I steal my mom's food to feed my daughter and that she is actually "looking out" for my mom. I lost it. My mom is alive because of me. Because of the many sacrifices I have made in my life to literally be her arms, legs, her voice, to make sure she is fed, to advocate for her. When random agency aid's came to our house they would steal money, jewelry, you name it, because I was a little kid, I couldn't do a single thing about it. But at the end of the day, I was

constantly there for my mom. This lady struck my last nerve, after an incredibly difficult week where there was absolutely no one to look after me, or my health. I didn't swear at her or anything, and still tried to come from a place of empathy, but I still told her to mind her own business and respect me because she does not actually know what is happening. It was just so extremely disheartening. After everything I have done, that I still do, there is just nothing for me. There have been so many things that have beaten me down this year, I just feel like this the last thing. At the end of the day, I know I am lucky to be able bodied, to have my faculties, to be employed, to go home to a warm bed, with needy but loving animals and kid who is growing healthily and happily (despite being in a particularly whiney phase). She brings my mom joy, so I am going to keep going. Anyway, if you've made it this far. Thanks for listening. Trying to find empathy for others, but myself as well. But truth be told. I am fucking over it. I am just so goddamn over this disease and the absolute havoc it has wreaked on my life and my family's lives. It is unyielding."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1rs72w0/finally_lost_my_cool_on_my_moms_nursing_home/

"So...I made out home health care nurse cry today. Hi all, I'll ask the question first then give you context. When a visiting home health nurse or CNA comes to your home and they need help with something that you can do without help, how does that make you feel? Context: husband is bedbound quadriplegic, he has pressure sore on butt and heel of foot. Whenever home health comes in, they ask if I can roll him over so they can change bandages or hold his foot up so they can change bandages. This irritates me, because im spread so thin with all the other things I need to do around home and I figure, if I can do it by myself, why cant you? So i asked the nurse today why they cant do it on thier own, as I have other things I need to tend to. She said "extra hands are nice" I said "ok" But she left here crying and said she will never ask me again to help and she said I was rude to her. I felt really bad. I apologized to her profusely. I explained that Ive been overwhelmed with his care, I didnt mean to sound so rude. I dont know if she's coming back, but what are your thoughts? Should we assist the home health agency with everything even though there's some things they can do own thier own? Ive manged taking care of husband without assistance. And we are all so burnt out from this, I just wanted a break. Give it to me! I can handle it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 88 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mjju5f/soi_made_out_home_healt_h_care_nurse_cry_today/

"Please read. I need help.. Hello. I was with a man for 18 yrs. I left him in 2013/2014. In 2022 he was in a severe car accident and was in a coma for months. He suffered a traumatic brain injury and so many physical problems. I was living and working in another state. His family asked if I would consider coming to care for him till they got help in the home. That was 4 yrs ago. I am his 24hr caregiver. I do not get paid. I have now been diagnosed with cancer. Advanced. I have already started chemo and go to radiation 5 times a week. I need help. Every place I call just passes the responsibility onto another agency. The hospital is of no use as they haven't even filled out a paper for the waiver program that I dropped off 3 weeks ago. He is under 62 so area on aging will not help. I called adult protective services on myself. She came to house and never heard from again. Took him to the emergency room twice during manic state said they had no where to send him and I had to take him home. Cops were here last night said I had to call crisis. Crisis said he is not a harm to himself cant help. Neighbor called the cops on him 6am they never even came. Its almost 24 hrs . I cant care for him and myself. Anyone who has any suggestions? Please. Thank you"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 75 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ulb1ow/please_read_i_need_help/

↳ **comment** (134): "Call his family and inform them that you're going to leave and can't further care for him from a certain date onwards. Highlight: you don't ask, you inform them with a non negotiable statement. Consider this your two week notice. Send paper trail with receipt too (legally valid digital communication is great too). They'll try to guilt trip you or even intimidate you into staying. Ignore. You can even try officially asking

them money for the last 4 years of caregiving, framing this as unpaid labour, since you're legally a stranger. You have ZERO legal requirements to care for him. Think about yourself, it's much better to live and face any consequence than just die like that."

↳ **comment** (125): "Take him back to the hospital. Tell them *"I can no longer provide safe care for him. I have advanced cancer, am receiving chemotherapy and radiation, and it is unsafe for me to take him back home. There is no one else available to care for him. Do **not** agree to take him home. Give them his family's contact information. Ask to speak with the hospital's case manager, social worker, patient advocate, and, if necessary, the hospital administrator. Explain that he has no safe discharge plan because his sole caregiver is no longer able to provide care. Then WALK OUT. You have to care for yourself now. That is absolutely insane that his family took advantage of you like that and didn't even pay you! The hospital CANNOT force you to take him."*

↳ **comment** (45): "I totally agree with everything you said to do, as I have worked in the medical field for over 20 years and the last time was as a Patient Representative. This situation is not an uncommon occurrence as I have had to deal with this issue many times but it was mostly for a baby/child who was left with no person to care for them. The hospital was have a Duty of Care to help him when she leaves him there. They have all the resources and by leaving his family details with them, they will have to assume care as they are his legal next to kin and she is not. It never ceases to amaze me how badly people treat their family members when things turn badly. Unless the OP signed some sort of an agreement to care for this man, she definitely has no legal obligation to care for him. She has a 100% obligation to care for herself! This is a horrible situation and I am deeply sorry for what she is going through as she needs all the energy to fight for her OWN life. OP, I wish you all the best and am sending you love, strength and courage to fight for yourself self over him. You've given him and his family 4 years without any regard for you. It's definitely time to make his family take responsibility and for you to move on."

"Vent: I'm exhausted taking care of someone who never took care of me. I'm just so tired. Caregiving (even just remotely) for my formally abusive mother is just killing me. The anxiety and depression feels constant. Despite my efforts to the contrary, I feel like this has just taken over my entire life and sanity. If I'm not actively doing things for her, she's calling me, or her concerned family, friends and neighbors are calling me, as if I hadn't noticed that her dementia is getting so bad that she looks for my dead father and grandfather daily. Or asking me how she's doing. And then I have to have the same conversation with them that I've had with everyone else. It's exhausting. I understand their concern, but I guess people don't understand that lining up elder care (and everything it encompasses) TAKES TIME. There are waiting lists. There are a thousand things to coordinate. And it does not help that she is actively against any steps I take on her behalf and insists that she'll just "get better if I give (her) time." If I try to force the issue she tells me that I'm the cause of her cognitive issues because she thinks I am yelling at her and it makes her nervous. She also doesn't want services that cost money (despite having plenty of financial resources) because she's the cheapest person I've ever met and she's perfectly happy burdening me, my husband, and her friends with all her logistical, physical, and emotional needs. As proof that "people care about her." I'm just at the point where I don't feel anything towards her except obligation, extreme resentment and dislike. Every time her caregiving agency calls me, I immediately hope that they're going to tell me she died. **I hate what she's turned me and my life into.** What I've recently been asking my friends and family: *I don't need or want articles or advice on how to be a better caregiver. I've done a lot of reading about the various forms of dementia and get plenty of guidance from her geriatric doctors. I've also done a lot of therapy and reading on how to deal with elder estranged /abusive parents.* I don't need guilt trips or asking what I'm doing for her birthday/holidays, etc. Yes, she gave birth to me, but our relationship has been either neglectful and/or abusive throughout my life. * Please stop asking after my mother. Even if you want to help... you can't. I just want a couple of days where I try not to think about her. Literature that has resonated with me and felt super helpful in processing some of these very complicated feelings are: ["Your turn for care: Surviving the aging and death of the adults who harmed you"](<https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/17325189>) \- books abound regarding

elder abuse, but almost nothing about the confusion and anger that comes along when a formerly abusive parent suddenly requires help. ["What My Bones Know: A Memoir of Healing from Complex Trauma"](<https://www.goodreads.com/en/book/show/58214328>) \- the best and only book I've found that addresses the damage and toxicity of emotionally abusive, so called "tiger parenting" in otherwise highly functional Asian adults."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 71 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18ccwul/vent_im_exhausted_taking_care_of_someone_who/

↳ **comment** (29): "I know exactly how you feel. Caring for my mother who "had the covid, or the flu or rsv or or" (she was really just upset that dad was getting all the attention) while my dad was in hospital and then rehab, there was a day I got to the point I was ready to hit her. That was the day I told EVERYONE that I was no longer going to be her caretaker and I told them why. I was a danger to her. This absolves me. Sometimes you just have to walk away and let the chips fall."

↳ **comment** (21): "I felt exactly the same way when my FIL shook his cane at me like he was going to hit me: "You'd better not or you're going down." And that was when I had to stop. I'll probably never see him again."

↳ **comment** (16): "All so valid. I especially feel the conversaton stuff. I know people mean well when they ask what's going on with them (parents), but we already spend so much mental energy thinking about their problems (transportation, needing groceries, dr. appts., lonliness, stubborn, hearing imparied, etc.) that I just don't want to report on it with people who aren't part of the "system" we've put in place to address these issues. I get it, I really do - neighbors feel especially entitled because they can only see things from the outisde - but when I say she's okay and even if she wasn't "there's really nothing you can do about it," they seem offended. Like them just occasionally asking about her should be the solution enough for whatever she's going through. They never offer her rides anywhere, they don't stop by and say, "hey, I'm going to the store - what do you need?," they don't ask for our contact info. in case there's an emergency etc. This sounds mean, but it's sort of like they're posturing. Ya know? Like they're nice neighbors, but acting like their so concerned about her and expecting updates when it's convenient for them to inquire annoys me. Especially when they could knock on her door anytime and find out how's she's doing if they want. But they approach us when we're outside, clearly in the middle of things (like cutting her lawn, taking out the trash, trimming weeds, etc.), and act like we owe them answers. Meanwhile they do nothing to actually help. I'm not sure that's exactly your situation, but repeating conversations to people who aren't part of our care system is frustrating. I'd rather they just wave and go about their day - it's what they're going to do every other day when we're not there, anyway. Thankfully my mother wasn't abusive. She did her best with us, but she didn't really go out of her way to take care of us, either. She didn't trust doctors, so we hardly ever went. And when we were sick and and a home remedy didn't work, she'd say, "Well, I don't know what else you want me to do about it." Which is how I feel about trying to take care of her, now. Like...we have kids and work and houses and bills of our own, we already spend every weekend either going over there and taking care of things ourselves or we spend hours every week coordinating her care, I don't know what else she wants us to do about it! Ugh...sorry OP, I really understand the frustration. Especially this part: "I'm just at the point where I don't feel anything towards her except obligation, extreme resentment and dislike." I hate that I feel this way too."

"That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 69 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nrxpy9h/

"What happens when you can't do this anymore?. I've posted before about feeling evil when you inevitably yell at a dementia patient and having mental breakdowns from caretaking, but when you feel like you can't do it anymore, when you feel "broken" and fear for your health and your patient, what do you do???? My mom has Alzheimer's/dementia. I've been taking care of her for nearly four years. She had a bad reaction to an antipsychotic she started taking a few months ago. She lost trunk control at the end of July. She couldn't walk on her own. I didn't know what to do. My brain froze and couldn't make a decision. I had to call a family member who had to tell me to call 911. Even then, I couldn't do it. I started gathering clothes for her since she wasn't dressed and getting all manner of things ready. She might have had a stroke and I didn't respond in a timely manner. After a hospital stay, my mother ended up in rehab for a month. When she returned to me, the level of care I had to give increased exponentially . Now I'm changing diapers and having to clean up poop. I never wanted children or a family of my own. I don't have the temperament for intimate partners. I knew this about myself. I like peace, calm and anything that disturbs it, gets under my skin. I wake up in the morning and my mind like a movie on repeat keeps showing me the crap I cleaned the day before. I watch my mom pick her nose all day, yell at the TV, make up fake Spanish words. I have to brush her teeth and bathe her and I don't think I'm doing a good job, because I always find more crap. I've found myself crying and yelling and threatening to abandon her when she gets nasty and cusses me. I've thought of taking her to a hospital with no ID and just leaving her there. Where I once said no to a home, now I dream of it. But she needs an NHTD waiver. I've called the agency and NO ONE returns my call. The insurance company expects me to provide extra hours for my mom because we live together. But I'm at the point where my body and brain shuts down when it comes to care. It's like I avoid doing things she needs until I MUST do it. So my mom is not getting the care she needs. I have no family to help, my friends live far away and have their own lives and I'm afraid for myself and her. I had to put a lock on our door to prevent her wandering. That lock prevents people from getting in to. What if we have an emergency and no one can get in? At what point does the State or insurance companies recognize when you can't do this anymore? That you are mentally incapable, that your own health is in danger? At what point is there help???? Update: I finally did it. :-(last Wednesday, my mom refused to let the aide clean her, was yelling and cussing; refused to drink water. She only had 2 ounces in a 48 hour period. She also had not been cleaned in 18 hours. I explained the consequences of not drinking water, not eating, etc. Normally I can get her to do it by explaining consequences. She understands things, but doesn't hold the memory. This time, nothing I did worked. Finally, I called 911 and expressed my concerns over dehydration etc. They came and she was calm, alert and compliant when they asked her to drink water. She told them she would. I couldn't help but notice the smugness as though they were more capable than I and the aide. She took a sip that was it. No more. They decided it was best to take her to the hospital. They coaxed her up. The smell hit them and they said she needed to be cleaned and dressed before travel. That's when the sweet old lady disappeared. It took the two EMTs and the aide to get her ready. My mom cussed them all out. I couldn't help but laugh because I saw that smugness drop. I didn't travel with her. I spoke to the Dr on the phone and saw my mom for an hour before going home. The Dr called asking where I was. I explained that I left. Dr said her bloodwork was good and she wasn't dehydrated. She could go home. That's when I dropped the "unsafe discharge" language that I was advised about on this board. I said it. Dr insisted she couldn't hold her. She needed to see the neurologist and could go home. I repeated "unsafe discharge" again. Dr was annoyed but said they would admit her and I should see the social worker the next day. My mom is going into a facility until I can get 24 hour care. I'm home today because I've been visiting every day since then. I'm sad, but calm. I miss not having her here. But I know this is what's best for her. When I saw her in the hospital, she was clean and seemed content in a way that I couldn't get her at home. I also noticed her cussing when it took two aides to clean her, but she went back to her quiet self when they were done."

reddit post · r/dementia · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/

↳ **comment** (76): "You do have to take her to an emergency room and leave her there. It's OK. Tell them she isn't safe with you and refuse to take her home. They'll find a place for her. You've done enough."

↳ **comment** (42): "Thank you so much for not judging. Thank you! Thank you! Thank you! I had a family member tell me that no matter what choice I make, I'll be in pain. So I was told to choose my poison. We were once so close my mom and I. It's out of loyalty to who she was that I haven't done it. My mom is gone. I have this doppelgänger living with me. :-("

↳ **comment** (31): "I am so sorry. I can feel your frustration and worry in your words. This is a horrible, cruel disease, and will take down any single thing in its way. You do not have to do this anymore- you are not morally, or legally obligated to keep setting yourself on fire to keep your mother warm! On the contrary, you are doing her a disservice by not getting her placed in long term care. You are not equipped to do the job of every profession working at a facility. I cannot speak for other countries, however, if you are in the US- you take her to the closest Emergency room, TODAY, as in RIGHT NOW- tell them her mental status is altered from her normal baseline. Then, once they've run every test under the sun, you say these exact words: "I am unable to care for her at home. It would be unsafe to discharge her." No more, no less. You'll likely get push-back, possibly even threats of them calling APS, or telling you that you are responsible, and that you must take her home. Some providers have gone as far as telling family members they can be arrested for abandonment; this is simply NOT TRUE. Unless there is a court order signed by a judge stating a person is a responsible guardian, no adult is responsible for another, period. Stand your ground. "This is an unsafe discharge." The onus will be on the hospitals' social work team to find acceptable placement for your mom. Keep in mind you may have no choice in WHERE that placement is, but they will have to find her a clean, dry bed in a setting with the level of care she needs. Is she on Medicare/Medicaid? What's her financial situation? This information will help us give you guidance on how to handle that side of things. Seriously, before you hurt her, or yourself, please don't feel like a failure or horrible child- it's time to wave the white flag."

"May have reached the end at home care, as many before (REALLY LONG). It's 3:53 AM. Laying in bed, wide awake, after finding my spouse sitting on the front room couch, with all the house lights blazing. I asked her what's going on, she said I don't why I'm here. I managed to get her to our former bedroom, kick off her shoes, and back into bed, fully clothed, as usual. Trying to get her into pajama bottoms can lead to conflict, and best let that sleeping dog lie. I had a nervous breakdown in January. While not a medical term, it is pretty good for encompassing the myriad symptoms and conditions that reduce you from a motivated fairly capable person to being frozen in place, like a insect trapped in amber. Spilled my guts to my doctor(how they repeatedly deal with this, don't know, perhaps professional training). She spoke frankly to me. As a result, got help. Two days a week, 10-4. After 3 weeks, already going to 3 days a week. Also, and more importantly, she put me on Zoloft. After 8 days, viola, racing thoughts largely disappeared. After 6 weeks, really feeling better, my sense of purpose returned to my old self, started getting things shipshape and Bristol fashion, as sailors say. With coverage, I managed to get some important things done. Some house stuff, grocery shopping. Going grocery shopping with a 5 year old is gone, some car maintenance. Got a gardener for the front, and put the pool back to normal. I still want to do that, it's easy, and lets me retain some semblance of control and self worth. Taco Exxpress, chicken tacos and a Mexican coke in a bottle, eaten while parked in a little private area behind Lowe's, listening to NPR. She no longer eats nutritional food. Our long term favorite restaurant is no longer an option. The staff there was well aware of her condition, and went out of their way to accommodate. Some were former students of my wife. So, back on an even keel. Yesterday was a good day. She awoke, pills and juice, coffee yogurt and berries, GMA. A quick shower for me, 10 minutes alone for her is max. Time to clean her up. Home aide, who is wonderful, gets her to shower. With me, won't do it, can turn contentious. So, check outfit, usually a new tshirt. Remove old one, sponge bath with warm washcloth. deodorant, new tee. Sonicare, Water pik, each time like the first time. I have become more kindly, caring, and gentle, and willingly do all this stuff without much complaint. A walk (more and more, slower and shorter) at the marina with the dog(always a pal, Penny, good dog!) then a routine of carefully offered small bites and liquids, variety shows on TV , KC show a good one. Dinner time for me, then game shows and comedy till bed, one glass of wine. After clean up, will often find myself bent over with my hands on my knees, pretty much done in. But no rest for the wicked. A structured routine, she is safe, clean, and comfortable. If you accomplished that,

you have done your duty. Except. With my return to clear thinking and a grasp of what's going on and the future, comes the realization that I'm probably not going to be able to do this anymore. Even with home aides, which come with a pricy invoice. My last test showed me progressing into CKD stage 3b, probably due to hydration issues during my falling down period. hoping it's an outlier. I often will instantaneously fall asleep, to awake 20 minutes later, totally unaware of anything. I am still exhausted. The house is a locked compound, 7 ring cameras, locked side gates, and the front door is always locked. At, night, even more secure. She will not elope. Going for blood test Monday, fingers crossed. After results, going to contact my doctor, and discuss a referral to the appropriate specialist who hopefully can guide me through. I'm hoping Kaiser has such a thing, otherwise there are other agencies that provide help. Whew. that's a lot to digest. I find that just writing this down is a way to focus my mind, and also kind of a catharsis. If you are in this situation, I recommend trying it. No one on this group will criticize, most responses are caring, supportive, and might get some helpful input. Sometimes I'll write something, and not post it, just the act of putting pen to paper is enough. My home aide has showed me some pretty effective strategies, and always nice to have a partner in crime. I am one of many who have willingly accepted this one way ticket on the road to decline of a loved one. I wish everyone the best outcome with dealing with this terrible disease, it apparently is often mostly an individual effort, even with help."

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rh3ff3/may_have_reached_the_end_at_home_care_as_many/

↳ **comment** (21): "Please choose your health. I understand. Take care."

↳ **comment** (21): "Just about to put my spouse in Long term care, believe me I feel your pain. The decision finally arrived when I realized that truthfully she's killing me. No sleep, constant care 7 by 24 the situation is just unbearable and no one alone can do this long term. Hang in there the best you can then get the help that you need. ALZ just completely sucks"

↳ **comment** (14): "> With my return to clear thinking and a grasp of what's going on and the future, comes the realization that I'm probably not going to be able to do this anymore. When you think you can't do it any more, you're right. Especially with a serious illness yourself, you rightly recognized that you cannot care for two people any more. Dementia only gets worse. I've never seen anybody in this group say "We put our loved one into dementia care too soon." I've seen lots of people say "We should have done it earlier.""

"PSA for anyone navigating aid for an aging parent: call your Area Agency on Aging before you think you need to. Spent more time than I planned to over the past year helping figure out the financial side of caring for a family member. The single most useful thing I learned, and the thing I see almost nobody mention in threads here, is the Area Agency on Aging. Every region in the US has one. Federally funded, locally run. They coordinate respite care, adult day programs, meal delivery, transportation, in-home support, and often have small emergency funds that don't get advertised anywhere. The locator is at eldercare.acl.gov — type in a zip code, get the agency for that area. The reason I'm mentioning it specifically: most people only find their AAA after they're already in crisis mode. By that point you're trying to learn a new system while also managing a parent's hospitalization or a sudden move. If you call them while things are still relatively stable, they'll walk you through what's available in your specific county, what the waitlists look like, and what to apply for now versus later. It's free. A few other things that come up less than they should in threads here: Caregiver stipends. If you're providing unpaid care, programs like Medicaid's Structured Family Caregiving (in many states) or VA Aid and Attendance (if your parent is a wartime vet or surviving spouse) can pay you a monthly amount. Not life-changing money, but real, and shockingly underclaimed. Medication assistance. Most expensive medications have a manufacturer patient assistance program. NeedyMeds aggregates them. If a parent's hitting the donut hole or paying full price, there's usually a route around it. 211. Dial211 from any phone. United Way runs it. They know what's available locally for utilities, food, rent, respite — anything social-service adjacent. Five minutes on the phone gets you a list specific to your county. The unifying point is that the system is fragmented. Different agencies, different income

rules, different applications. Nobody hands you a roadmap. The AAA is the closest thing to one, which is why I keep flagging it. Happy to talk if anyone's deep in figuring this out or wants to add anything that worked for them please do so. Hope this helps!!!! 😊 "

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t2bz8x/psa_for_anyone_navigating_aid_for_an_aging_parent/

↳ **comment** (20): "My therapist told me I can't tie her to a chair and put her somewhere safer against her will. It's her choice, but I have told her that since she's refused my help over the years, she's now on her own and will have the choices made for her when the time comes. I'm done trying to reason. Im so glad I don't have children to put through this misery."

↳ **comment** (18): "I did, my mom refuses to utilize them. It's so frustrating."

↳ **comment** (11): "Compounding frustration I like to call it. What's the saying ... "you can lead a horse to water but you cant make them drink""

"Brother told Mom caregiving isn't a real job... I'm devastated.. My mother suffered a stroke back in 2013/2014 and hasn't recovered. Dad took care of her until his own health severely declined. I always helped out where possible while studying. Dad passed away in January 2023, which threw me into a deep depression and a suicide attempt in May 2023. Jan 2023, my 2nd oldest sibling, sister, took my mom in, but her family gave up after a year. Jan 2024, my 3rd oldest sibling, brother, tried next and gave up after just 6 months. While still recovering from my depression, I stepped up in July/August 2024 to become her fulltime caregiver on weekdays, with my 5 siblings rotating weekends. It's now been 2 full years of this arrangement. Out of curiosity, I asked my mom to check what my 3rd oldest sibling thought of my caregiving after 2 years. I'm devastated by his response. He told her that he "doesn't consider it work since I'm at home" and that I "shouldn't be paid"... So basically he doesn't consider what I do "real work" because I'm at home and believes caregiving shouldn't be compensated or acknowledged. Replacing primary live in care saves our family significant expenses every month. I don't expect a full corporate salary, but diminishing 24/7 caregiving as "not work" is absurd, no? I'm just numb. My 4 oldest siblings are in their 40s with their own families and homes. Aside from a small amount of monthly household money they contribute, which is nowhere near what a professional live in caregiver costs, I am literally caregiving for free. Again, I'm not asking for a full salary or trying to start a fight, but I just wanted some form of recognition, appreciation... I love my mom deeply, and of course, I will keep taking care of her. I just needed to share this here... Edit: Thank y'all so much for the support and encouraging words, it really means a lot. I love y'all ❤️ Edit 2: Reading everyone's comments made me realize I need to bring this up with my siblings soon. Hopefully we can talk it out and figure something out together, whether it works out or not. Thanks again everyone. Edit 3: In retrospect, I also wanna add crucial context that makes his response even worse, I think. During those 6 months when mom stayed at his place, he wasn't even the one doing the caregiving, he was working. It was actually his wife who took care of mom every single weekday, and I truly appreciate all the hard work and love she put in for our mom. So, like, by dismissing caregiving as "not real work" because it happens at home, he isn't just invalidating me, he's kinda undervaluing all the labor his own wife put in too..."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vwkx8/brother_told_mom_caregiving_isnt_a_real_job_im/

↳ **comment** (32): "I mean, he couldn't hack it, so fuck him. His opinion doesn't count. Especially since he tried to do it and gave up. Caretaking is hard work and is desperately undervalued in a society where the only thing that matters is money. Your older siblings have dropped the 'problem' of your mom's care in your lap, and consider it solved. Watching her one weekend a month is nothing in comparison to what you are doing. Sadly, what you are experiencing seems to be more common than not."

↳ **comment** (25): "The one that couldn't hack it for longer than 6 months is passing judgment? You who have been caregiver for your Mom for over two years ? Boy is that rich! Your brother is a horse's patooti!"

↳ **comment** (14): "Sounds like my family. Hugs, internet friend, the rest of us see you 💖 "

The lawyer, the POA, the money · 590 documents

20 most engaged of 590 matching documents, complete text.

"NPR story on caring for aging parents (venting). NPR did a story yesterday morning on caring for aging parents, interviewing a woman who ended up taking care of her mother 24/7 while her mother was bedridden. While it accurately depicted the struggles of caregiving, it ended as most of these stories do by making it redemptive, saying what a beautiful thing it was or what a privilege it was to take care of her mother. My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together. I used to think I might "get my life back," but I've found that you don't. You can't get back all the lost social and career opportunities. You don't get your mental and physical health back. You have to figure out what to do with what's left. I took care of my mother because I felt it was my duty as her son to do so. Most people tell me I objectively did a good job, but I was never temperamentally suited to the role. I forced myself to do it, every day. I put a mask on and was pleasant to her, but I hated having to try to get my mother to do the basic things she needed to do every day. By the end, as her dementia progressed, it felt pointless. I was maintaining a body that had very little mind left in it when I could have been putting my own mind to work in my business, solving problems for clients. I lost my biggest client because I didn't have time to do the work he needed me to do. I resented it. Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy. It was traumatizing. And now I'm still dealing with my mother's estate with a sibling who thinks she deserves half of everything even though she did absolutely nothing to help, ever. She couldn't care less what it cost me. She takes it all for granted. I just hate when people try to sugar-coat what caregiving does to your life and try to frame it in sentimental terms. It wrecked my mental and physical health. It wrecked my business. It wrecked my social and romantic life. It's made me hate my sister for her apathy and greed. I'm 59 and trying to get back into the dating world, and I feel like I'm having to learn how to do it all over again. I'm having to re-learn how to go out and socialize with people. I can only relate my own story, but caregiving didn't leave me with some rosy afterglow. Caregiving wrecked my life. I'm satisfied that I did my duty to my mother, but that's it. It didn't give me some wonderful gift. The news media will never report that story. Edit: Thanks for all the responses. Part of what set me off yesterday was the fact that it was my mother's birthday, and several people sent me messages about how I must be thinking about my mom today. The thing is, I wasn't. I was working all day trying to get a job done for a new client. And I thought about my mother 24/7 for years. I'm done thinking about my mother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,034 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞"

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAq

↳ @SoloSecondHalf (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏"

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he

has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :), can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_livin_g/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"My husband was floored when I told him how much healthcare REALLY costs.. The other day my husband was talking about his potential inheritance from his parents (both still alive.) They have inherited money, multiple cars, four properties, and their own large savings. They are physically and mentally well. "I wouldn't bank on an inheritance," I said. I won't say what my job is. But I can see what multiple healthcare entities bill. I'm extremely familiar with all of the assisted livings, hospitals, skilled facilities, and in-home care providers within my area. I've been in this line of work for 15 years. The amounts charged are sickening. I've seen assisted livings charge residents \$15k+ per month. I've seen one hospital charge \$75k for a THREE DAY STAY. I saw a NICU charging \$8k per day. I've seen group homes that house individuals with developmental disabilities charge \$250k per year. The prices of medications have skyrocketed. Home medical equipment is outrageously priced. People like my husband that aren't in this world have no idea how much things cost. Whether you stay home or go to a facility things will get expensive. I wish everyone knew that they need to plan ahead. Work with an elder care law attorney. Medicaid does a five year look back on everything. So you have to plan really far in advance. My mom doesn't trust my knowledge. She refuses to sign a will, speak to an attorney, even make her funeral arrangements. She refuses to address reality. "You'll figure it out," she says. She won't even hear about spending down for Medicaid because she's "too proud to be on welfare." I hate how expensive end of life care is and how little education is out there to help people plan ahead. Sorry, just needed to vent this."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 612 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1j6yu55/my_husband_was_floored_when_i_told_him_how_much/

"My mom informed me I will be inheriting the care of my two siblings. I am the oldest of three. Me 50F, sister 46F and brother 37M. Roughly 6 months ago, my mother (75F) and I were discussing her paperwork (POA, will, etc) and all of the necessary related things. She said "don't forget, you will have to look after your siblings". Ok, my siblings have both had their issues. So I dared to ask, what exactly do you do for them regularly? My sister has made numerous stupid decisions over the years, and my mom has bailed her out several times, mostly financially. She is currently living with her boyfriend of 18 years. Just found out he owes \$63K in back taxes to the IRS. They are finally taking action. If he loses his house, my sister will lose the roof over her head. I honestly think my mother expects me to take her in, because I have an "empty bedroom". (My oldest finished college, found a good job and got her own place. I still have two more living at home currently in college.) No. Just NO. My mother has always been my sister's back up plan. Mom said she's ready for me to "take over." No. Next is my brother. He is autistic and has medically well managed schizophrenia. He does have his own place, car, and manages to hold down a 32-hour a week cashier job. Admittedly I have a soft spot for him. So, I asked, how can I help? I was thinking mental health/medical needs (I'm an RN). Nope, my mother micromanages every aspect of this kids life. She spends as much time at his apartment as she does at her house. Cleans, does his laundry, takes out his trash. I was speechless. They are so intermeshed and co-dependent that I don't even have words. She makes him call her twice a day if she isn't there. I told her my version of "helping" and her version are two VERY different things. I raised my three kids, and thankfully they are all transitioning to adulthood. I'm starting to embrace the 'empty nest', I have zero desire to take on another 'kid'. I probably should have disclosed from the beginning, all three of us have the same parents. We grew up in an abusive/neglectful household. Dad was the main perpetrator, he's been dead for years. All three of us kids got different versions of mom. I bailed as soon as I graduated high school, and am admittedly not that close with anyone. I'm friendly but keep my distance. Apparently my mom thinks I am "taking over" as she is "getting too old" but she does not approve of my boundaries, my "list" of what I am willing/not willing to do. She has accused me of "abandoning my siblings". I'm not even sure what I am asking for here. Just venting? There is much more. I could type for days."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 559 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q839bu/my_mom_informed_me_i_will_be_inheriting_the_care/

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and beat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"It's time for the talk. My wife and I are both only children. Between us we've buried three parents. One is left — my father-in-law. Everything below is my experience; yours will differ. But I'd rather say the hard parts out loud than let someone else get blindsided the way we were. Confront reality — and make sure they confront it too. That's the whole thing. Both of us were badly surprised by things we had been told were handled and weren't. My mother-in-law went in for surgery and had a massive stroke on the table. A month in ICU in a coma, then a specialized rehab, then a nursing home — almost a year. She surfaced briefly near the end before a second stroke took her. My father-in-law had a will, an advance directive, and a power of attorney. We assumed she did too. She didn't. She couldn't tolerate what she called death talk, and he was certain he'd go first. I got him in front of an elder care attorney in the middle of the crisis. It was the right call, and it was a year too late. Had she lived longer, the cost would have consumed their savings and everything they meant to leave their grandchildren. After my dad died suddenly, my mom and I sat down with her affairs. The legal side was easy — wills, POAs, no argument. Two things weren't easy. One I'll come back to. The other was that after multiple conversations about her income and expenses, I found out she was hiding more than \$30,000 in debt from me. We can't fix problems we won't look at. The upfront conversations are unpleasant. Assume they will be. They are still cheaper than picking up the pieces on the back end. So don't take anyone's word for it: \- If they say there's a will, ask to see it. Then ask where it's kept. \- Same for the advance directive and the powers of attorney — financial and healthcare are not the same document. \- Ask to see the bank and credit statements. Not a summary. The statements. \- Get in front of an elder care attorney if you can possibly manage it. Medicaid look-back rules and asset protection are not things to learn during an ICU stay. That's table stakes. And even parents who've done every bit of it aren't out of the woods, because the paperwork is the easy conversation. The hard one is about legacy. This is the one I avoided with my mom, because it was the one that nearly broke her. Not the money. The *possessions*. She collected beautiful things her whole life. Most of it is headed for an estate sale. She made herself sick over it — trauma levels, on the edge of an identity crisis. There was china I never once saw used. Not one Christmas in my entire life. If we'd eaten off it every year I might feel differently. But I don't understand why I'm obligated to carry an attachment that was never mine. She had an old Mercedes. When it was time for independent living, we talked about what to do with it. She wanted to know if her granddaughter could use it. I told her the truth: no. Expensive to maintain, no dealer or independent mechanic anywhere near them, and they hike and camp and have a dog. They needed something that fit their life. Her position was that they should take it anyway — accept the burden, because it was a gift. I'm still working through that one. To me it's like buying piano lessons for someone whose hobby is baking bread. Here's what I think is actually going on. The things aren't the issue. The things are proxies. They're where the feelings get stored, because the feelings themselves never got dealt with. *If you don't keep this thing I owned, you're rejecting me and my memory*. That's why so many of our parents can't sort through it, and why it gets left behind for us. Dealing with the stuff means dealing with everything underneath the stuff. If I could run one conversation over, it's that one. I'd stop negotiating over objects and say: if you love them, let's turn this into something that actually helps them. Sell the car, put it toward the truck they need. Sell the china, fund something they'll remember. They will remember and appreciate that you helped them. **The love transfers**. The dining set doesn't. Have the conversation while it's still a conversation and not an inventory."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 488 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vf1z4k/its_time_for_the_talk/

"She's going to trap me in soon, my adult life is over. My mom is 61 and will be getting let go from her factory job soon. She only speaks polish after living in the USA for 25 years and has nowhere to go. She won't go back to Poland, her retirement won't be more than \$1,300/month so she won't be able to afford her apartment. I live in a rural area with no public transportation so I'm it. I'm her only outlet. She's visiting us right now and is an absolute weirdo. I have a 20 month old baby and am getting ready for a mastectomy for breast cancer. I'm working full time and trying to make things fun for my son but I also need rest. She literally sits on top of me all the time. When I'm reading my son a book she comes in and will point to the pages like a toddler and go "RED CAR" loudly and so on. She tries to butt into my conversations with my husband but doesn't understand so wants a translation. She tries to steer the stroller or shopping cart with me and when I'm like fucking you do it she runs into me

because she's staring off into the abyss as if she's never seen groceries in her life before. I feel like a trapped animal, I'm caged in my own home. Last night she told me she won't be able to take care of my baby when I'm doing my surgery because "he cries" and she's too uncomfortable. I literally have cancer. Like...what? She said she doesn't know how to build a relationship with him as she doesn't speak English and she doesn't think he likes her. I told her she needs to grow up and act like a caregiver (she won't feed or change his diaper) and not like a friend or grandma for fun she sees in the movies. So now I get to wake up in the hospital alone OR with a mother who doesn't understand shit as my husband is pacing the hotel with our toddler. I'm crushed. I'm so overwhelmed. She's like ready to move in, I mean she literally has nowhere else to go. I don't trust her with my baby after yesterday's shenanigans but most importantly I don't trust that I'll be happy again. My husband and I have build a calm life, we are best friends, and she literally just sits down and stares at us. I was up at 4am having coffee in my living room today and at breakfast she was like "did I see you in the living room this morning" and when I said yes she was like "but why were you sitting there?". I put on lotion and she goes "did you put on lotion? Wow" like wtf do you mean?! Ok rant over just a woman who's so overwhelmed I'm about to rip my hair out. W"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 455 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/

↳ **comment** (650): "She does not get to move in. Get her on waitlists for senior housing or speak to a social worker about how section 8 will go."

↳ **comment** (234): "Tell her no. She's been in the country 25 years, she's 61. I'm 61 and I've had lots of challenges. I figured them out. She can go back to Poland where the money she gets will go further. Just sit her down and say I'm sorry but I have to take care of myself and my family and you have to leave. If it breaks your relationship it breaks it and if she has nowhere to go that's her problem. I know this is harsh but you are currently in a life or death situation with breast cancer. You have your own life and your own kids to worry about and just be mean if you have to. This is something that all of us raised by these parents need to give ourselves permission to do. We have to give ourselves permission to stand up for ourselves even if it means we're going to feel guilty, even if it means they're going to be angry, even if it means they're going to tell relatives that we're awful towards them and abandon them. Too bad we're just going to have to live with that."

↳ **comment** (218): "THIS! THIS! THIS, OP! My mother only has social security and doesn't receive much more than your mother will. She lives in senior housing, and her rent is a percentage of her social security check - I think it's \$200 per month for a nice one-bedroom, one-bathroom apartment. The building itself is staffed 24/7 in case of emergencies. There's a rec room, a laundry room on each floor, and even a shuttle service that will take residents to appointments and stores for free. My mom was on a waiting list for about 6 months, but that was several years ago. Get your mom on those lists now if you can."

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm

having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him,

she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship. After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of

stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this. I simply wasn't proactive enough in getting my dad into an assisted living facility, possibly even memory care. I felt that it wasn't my life, but I was somehow compelled to help him live independently. I can't even imagine the millage I put on my car traveling to his house to help get groceries and pay his bills, clean his place, get him to his doctor's appointments, get him the medication he needs (through the VA nonetheless), basically keep him alive. After the initial hospitalization that set this in motion, I was able to buy him about two years on his own. Now he's in a memory care facility--just a few months after he temporarily moved in with me, he broke his hip and there was only one place that could take him while he healed. He was going to need 24 hr. assistance. My wife had made it clear she was not happy with how much time I was spending on his affairs. And rightfully so, as it was eating away my time with the family, and it always aggravated my depression. I started a new career last year and my dad's problems were preventing me from putting best foot forward. By the time I was able to convince him to start touring assisted living facilities and getting on a waiting list, it was too little too late. My wife moved out, in part, to make room for my Dad to live at our place for a little bit--just a way to ease the transition into assisted living. The most-recent hospitalization was the big wake up call. Now my brother and I are in the process of managing his property, getting a short-term bridge loan to buy us time to fix up my childhood home, only for that house to be sold to pay for future memory care costs. It's not hard to see how a marriage could crumble under these conditions, especially if you don't get out in front of it when you had the opportunity. Yeah, our marriage had some problems to begin with. But dealing with my Dad was taking away time, energy, and other resources I needed to address my marital issues. I was exhausted all the time. And it was getting in the way of my new job. I was getting pulled in too many directions, and my Dad's situation was by far the most frustrating. If not for that, I feel like I could have repaired our relationship. Or maybe not. But it would have freed up a lot of time to focus on what's really important. Anyways, I just felt like sounding the alarm to anyone worried that their obligations to an aging parent are ruining your relationship... or some other important part of your life. The best advice I can offer are these rules of thumb: (1) set some boundaries to prevent it from bleeding into your family or professional life; (2) be proactive about moving this process along, because it's not getting any easier--if its damaging your marriage, that's a clear sign that you can no longer provide the help they need; (3) if you haven't yet dealt with estate matters, medical/financial POI, etc., call a lawyer ASAP; and (4) let it be a lesson and plan for this period of your life so that it doesn't all fall on the shoulders of your children or other family members. I know it's easier said than done, but trust me when I say there is a better way. Happy New Year"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"Dealing with "the stuff". My mom passed away recently. Dad passed away a few years ago. My wife and I just got home after living near Mom for the last seven months — first caring for her, then handling her affairs after she died. I'm an only child, so no brothers or sisters to help (or fight with? I keep getting told how "lucky" I am and it doesn't feel that way at all). The last few weeks were a blur of going through a lifetime of possessions. During the day my wife would wear herself out sorting, boxing, packing. After I was done with work I'd go through what she'd pre-sorted, or tackle another room myself. There wasn't much quality time — just quick meals so we could keep pushing through. It was physically, mentally, and emotionally exhausting. My wife knew someone who does estate sales, so we signed a contract with them. The last time I left the house I grew up in as it was for my entire life was hard. The next time I see it, it'll be completely empty. It was hard walking away knowing we couldn't keep everything Mom considered valuable. Neither of my parents saved for retirement — they relied on Social Security. As we went through the house, we kept finding eBay listings Mom had printed out for some vase or another thing, price circled. That's when I started getting angry. All this "stuff" has subjective value that rises and falls as tastes change and things go in and out of style. What if some of that had gone into basic retirement savings instead? I'm not saying they shouldn't have enjoyed having nice things — we all do. But Mom especially treated her possessions like investments, or at least that's what she told herself. I have no idea what the estate sale will net, but I'm not

expecting much. I spent a lot out of my own pocket to care for my mom the last few years. I'm not counting it all up — that's not the point. But a lot of that was because she couldn't bring herself to deal with this stuff herself. She was deeply and profoundly attached to possessions in ways that are really hard for me to comprehend. Now we're the ones dealing with it. It's death by a thousand papercuts, trying to figure out what's trash and what's treasure. Why do people think this is something good to leave behind? When my grandmother died years ago, the only thing I wanted from her house was her teapot. She used it every day, and I have so many memories of drinking tea with her. I'd take that over piles of stuff I'll never use, art that isn't my taste, or dining room furniture (who has formal dining rooms anymore?). There were multiple sets of silverware and fine china we never used in my entire life — I guess we were saving those for when the Kennedys came for dinner. LOL The lesson I've taken from all this: we're deluded into thinking we own things. We're just the current caretakers and curators of stuff. And you may like your stuff but other people may or may not like your stuff. And if they like it, that's ok. And if they don't like it, that's ok too."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 278 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v62aym/dealing_with_the_stuff/

↳ **comment** (91): ""She was deeply and profoundly attached to possessions in ways that are really hard for me to comprehend." You stated this perfectly. That's how I feel about my Mom. It hit me hard some years back when we agreed that we'd skip Christmas shopping that year and spend the money on flying in family so we could all be together, my idea because I'd just started an intense new job and didn't have time to shop. It was the best Christmas of my life! When I laid down to sleep I felt this total peace because I'd been with everyone I loved the most all day and knew they were all ok. My worry loop, which runs quietly in the background all the time, could shut off for one whole night, everyone was fine. It was bliss. I found out a couple weeks later that my Mom was furious at me because there were no presents. This while she lives in a house stuffed to the top, with priceless antiques and valuables crammed in every nook and cranny, along with actual garbage, and tons of tacky, cheap Dollar Store crap. That's when I realized that she and I do not love the same way. In her mind, how do you know someone loves you if they don't give you something material? In my mind, stuff doesn't matter, spending time together does."

↳ **comment** (67): "In a world where a married women couldn't open a bank account without her husband, my grandmother bought diamond rings in case she had to cut and run. Definitely second-best to real investment but it was the best she could do. (The law changed in the US in 1974 and she died in 1980.)"

↳ **comment** (66): "My mother constantly shows me items in her home that I know for a fact are worth maybe \$100 at best, and she swears to me that they will be worth enough to help my son pay for college. I mean, shes not wrong, \$100 helps pay for college too, but we all know thats not what she means lol She also keeps drawing my attention to a ring she wears. She keeps asking me if she should take it to get valued for insurance purposes but I am 95% sure it is borderline worthless and that she would be completely crushed by the news. Her mother gave it to her with the promise that it "could be sold in an emergency for money" and my mother has treasured it ever since. We have tried to encourage my mother to see its value as a sentimental item, but she keeps asserting its monetary value is far greater. Sigh. There is just something about that generation that they keep hearing the siren song of "value" in their prized possessions, and prioritize the collection of valuable items far above saving or investing their money. Younger generations have their own "stupid" investments, I don't think the problem is gone, they just get sucked into a different kind of investing now (like bitcoin and polymarket betting). Same game different pieces. Our childrens children might not have much to clear out of the family home, but might be met with a complex web of lost orphaned brokerage accounts instead 😂 "

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement

due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the

paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months

ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"Mom's fall changed everything and I'm fuming. \ contains some mildly graphic medical trauma, so read with caution if that skeeves you out\ In February of this year my mom (78) tripped and fell while entering a clinic to get her mammogram. She already had an existing knee replacement from 12 years prior, and when she fell the knee replacement cracked her femur. She had a new knee put in that accounted for the femoral shortening caused by the break. So it was surgery and rehab, and then she came home a month after the fall. She lives next door to my son, her eldest grandson. I stayed with her the first week and she was getting around pretty well with her walker. The very night I left to go home, she was in the bathroom and the new knee gave out, just came apart and broke. She went straight down and her legs ended up under her. It causes her incision to completely open and the broken metal parts were visible. She was bleeding out on the floor. We had gotten her an alarm button that would ring at my son's house, and she mashed that thing like nobody's business. My DIL is an RN. She stuffed a towel in my mom's open leg and held it together while waiting on EMS. It took a long time for EMS to get her stabilized and transported, due to the broken knee parts being extremely close to arteries. Emergency surgery that night was done by the surgeon on-call. He cleaned it as best he could, put the parts back together and referred her back to her original surgeon. So surgery again and then this time a nursing facility rather than rehab because insurance refused rehab for this event. She has seen her original surgeon multiple times, had multiple x- rays, and me, my

sister, my son and my mom herself have told her surgeon the leg doesn't look right, doesn't feel right to her, keeps wanting to collapse again. We've raised concerns to PT, and told the orthopedics team. They just kept telling her that she'll get stronger with PT. However it was only 2 weeks ago, at yet another post surgery appointment that her surgeon finally told us that she put the knee in incorrectly the first time. So it has been incorrect since way back at the beginning of February when she had her original surgery. It is internally rotated by about 20 degrees. The surgeon even admitted that's very likely why she fell the second time... the time when we almost lost her. Now the surgeon wants to revise her knee. And we will go through this a third time. My poor mom has been working so hard to gain function of a knee that is not placed correctly, that collapses, that locks sideways. When it engages it just flips back and down and deforms her entire lower leg, causing her to scream. It's been heavy work taking care of her as she cannot be left alone. She's spent about 20k outfitting the house with a lift bed, a lift chair, a whole new shower and toilet. Everything we could think of to try to keep her safe. My mom kept thinking she was failing somehow. It's heartbreaking. Watching her struggle has been horrendously hard on my little family. And I'm fuming. So many times we tried to say something was wrong and no one listened. We are reaching out to attorneys and trying to find a different surgeon. We will get through this again, but it's harder on her every time and I've never been so angry in my entire life. To let my mom go through this for 4 months is absolutely egregious and we are nowhere near out of the woods. She's mostly wheel-chair bound now... and back in February, when she was worried she'd miss her granddaughter's May 31st wedding, the surgeon told her she'd be walking and dancing by then, no problem. Fuming."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tszraf/moms_fall_changed_everything_and_im_fuming/

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking kilns, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement that means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over

and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!???" Seriously, I'm done. I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house (front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"Romance Scam Dad on psych hold, cars gone, etc. Quick catch up: After 15 months and 8 romance or romance-adjacent scams (today I learned about 2 more, making it 10), loss of \$100k, with me unable to stop him despite trying absolutely EVERYTHING, he finally got picked up by police for reckless driving and was taken to the ER by his consent when he didn't know what year it was. As previously advised, we insisted he was unsafe to discharge and worked to make sure friends and neighbors knew not to pick him up. He's been in the hospital 3 days now, and been seen by a psychiatrist, OT, PT, speech pathologist, diabetes specialist and more. In the notes, I was surprised to see how much insight the speech pathologist had available to contribute. It's incredible what can be accomplished in terms of diagnosis and documentation when he's in the hospital—putting together all these appointments and getting him to go would have been impossible. And so validating! Because he talks at great length, telling stories about his past achievements, people assume he's fine and try to extricate themselves from the situation. Even medical professionals can't finish their work with him in the allotted appointment time bc of how much he talks. But in the hospital, they have time. And they see right through it. His cognitive score, consistently 26-27/30 during our multiple attempts to get help over the past 15 months, is now 15/30. They note he "confabulates," "perseverates," requires constant redirection. He is "oriented to person"—he knows who he is—but not to place or situation—he doesn't know why he's in the hospital or how he got there, and while he now knows the year he has to think about it. He was determined to "lack decisional capacity" —"can't make consistent choices or understand the consequences of choices"—so I, as heath POA, am making the calls now. For the first 48 hours he had a "sitter"—someone with him constantly to redirect him whenever he tried to leave. She was a young woman and he chatted with her all day. But I think that attention was doing more than anything to keep him there and happy—just like with the scammers he talks to 24/7. The nurse and sitter reported that he was "so sweet!" And also that there was no way he should be living alone. Then in the third day they took the sitter away and he

became increasingly agitated, saying he needed to leave. Eventually, he told everyone he was sick of being here and was going home. Walked out of the room and into the elevator lobby, where he began pounding on doors and yelling, "I'll just walk home!" and, "How do I get out of here?" And "Where are my shoes?" Because he tried to walk home...without putting his shoes on. He refused to return to his room and had to be restrained and medicated. Now he's back to having a sitter, except it's a security guard. And they don't think he's "so sweet" anymore. I haven't gone to see him, as he is abusive toward me and will definitely blame me for all of this, making it worse for staff. But my sister is on her way here now and will visit tomorrow. And I went to the hospital just before his incident and spoke at length with staff, without him seeing me. As far as he knows, I'm not involved. I also went to his house. Oh my god. The entire house smells like pee. Every chair smells like pee. His bed has no sheets or pillowcases. Junk is piled haphazardly everywhere (always true but even more now). There is rotting food growing flies, and flies EVERYWHERE. The toilets were both disgusting. The kitchen ceiling is leaking. He hasn't paid any bills since I stopped helping him about 3 months ago. I found threats to disconnect his power (which did happen about a month ago and he finally went and paid the bill in cash), gas, internet, and phone. Also threats to terminate his Medicare and drug plan (we made sure those got paid as soon as he was admitted!). And—Notes on a tablet on his couch he'd had with him when police escorted him home. They explained how to go to the post office and UPS with a total of \$9000 in \$1000 money orders and mail them to a "woman" in NY. Also receipts. I was able to go to UPS and use my POA to stop delivery on that one, using the receipts. That's what he had been doing when he was stopped. He broke it into small chunks at two different places because he'd been kicked out of a THIRD bank, this time after just 6 weeks, for sending the same "woman" a single \$9500 money order. So he has a new bank again. And I found the statements that his checking is overdrawn, because of ANOTHER pay-per-message dating site, one he signed up for only last week, and spent \$3200 "chatting" in the 4 days leading up to this incident. I got that cancelled, and sent threatening letters with my POA attached, demanding a refund. I also was finally able, with him not at the house, to take one of the cars and hide the keys for the other, which was already dead when I arrived anyway. No more driving, even if he manages to get out of the hospital and walk home in his socks. After the behavioral incident, he has a psych hold and chances are we will be talking about psychiatric placement today. And we are definitely talking about guardianship with the psychiatrist, hoping to finally get that letter the courts require, saying he can't take care of himself. That will allow us to put him in a care facility. The nightmare may be stabilizing, if not fully ending. New problems, but at least they're less chaotic. And he can't kill anyone. Does this mean we need to be looking at memory care instead of assisted living?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 194 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w36qf4/romance_scam_dad_on_psych_old_cars_gone_etc/

"My mom also refuses to give my brother and I the POA or advanced directive, won't do anything for herself, and leaves the burden on us, with no consideration how it affects our lives."

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

Medical alert buttons, devices, home fixes · 569 documents

20 most engaged of 569 matching documents, complete text.

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?!) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this

week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you* *not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"*

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this-

and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I can't shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"Rethinking falls. About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they now have (and of course managing this is all on me). Of course multiple people, including myself, had told them they needed a stair lift, but they didn't listen, because it was "too expensive." So much of the advice around aging is around preventing falls. And yes, they should be prevented if you want to keep living. But – and this is cold – we keep acting as though we want elderly people to live forever, and then as a society we don't support them, or us the caregivers. Falls are terrible and painful and I wish my mom hadn't had one. But it should have been the end. The EMTs should've come and said oh, sweetheart, this is terrible, we are giving you morphine. It is utterly crazy that she was in the hospital for so long and cost taxpayers well over \$1 million in Medicare, only to come home and require so much care and drain their finances and eventually go on Medicaid. I don't know what we do about this. When my mom fell, I felt like she almost subconsciously had done it on purpose. That summer she had been telling me how tired she was, and how she was ready to quit taking care of my dad, who is very demanding, and my disabled sibling (that's a whole other story). I was sure we were going to lose her and of course at the time I didn't want to but now I realize that would have been the natural thing. Figured you all would relate. I am not doing this to my kids."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 337 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

↳ **comment** (206): "This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

↳ **comment** (78): "My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

↳ **comment** (65): "Your poor mama. She is TIRED of dealing with your dad and sibling. The hospital, as awful as they can be, may have been a respite for her. Meals delivered. Her own bathroom. Mostly sweet staff. Poor you. You must be mentally exhausted on top of juggling THREE of them. The money drain is no lie. THREE DEPENDENTS in a two story house? How in the world? She's exhausted caregiving. She's probably been putting

up with your difficult daddy with his demands all her life and you don't say when your sibling became disabled, but if it's been lifelong? Or since their 20's? That burns even saints out early. If they've qualified for Medicaid, can the house be sold and they go to skilled care or assisted senior living? Surely that would be cheaper than trying to maintain a home for three people needing 24 hour care."

"Useful items that have made it easier for us and our aging parents. Just a few items that have made caring for my aging parents easier. I want to mention these in case you are not aware or have not considered the benefits. **D-Mannose supplement**: this is the active ingredient in cranberry that helps prevent the formation of biofilm in UTIs. The capsules do not have a flavor. My mother-in-law would balk at the taste of cranberry capsules but does not object to these. **UTI test strips**: these are now over the counter in the US. Don't wonder, diagnose at home. This has been so helpful for my mother-in-law because getting her to the doctor is a difficult process. **Styptic products**: stops bleeding. Remember the white pencil that men used for shaving cuts? Now comes in pre-loaded bandages or loose powder. Check a camping or outdoors store or the pet aisle (dog nail care) for greater selection. The combination of my mother's fragile skin and blood thinners means she just bleeds and bleeds. **Tender tape**: this is a latex-free stretch bandage that sticks to itself but not to anything else. If your parent's skin is fragile, tender tape and a gauze pad is much better than self-adhesive bandages. I first saw this used as a veterinary product for putting bandages over fur, so you know it won't ever stick to skin. **Adhesive release spray**: when self-adhesive bandages can't be avoided, this spray will release the bandage without tearing the skin. My mother used to cry when it was time to change a bandage but no longer. **Compression garments**: look at products for runners, because runners' socks and calf sleeves may be easier to use for low-end compression needs. Cheaper than medical products, and using a combination of socks and calf sleeves means the socks can be changed every day and machine washed/dried. **Wig**: the weirdest helpful thing I ever bought. My mother is focused on her appearance in a way I have never understood, but it's very important to her so I try to be supportive. When she broke her shoulder she could not color her hair or manage the bouffant style she's been wearing for decades. She wanted *me* to color her hair but I thought that was a recipe for disaster. In desperation, I bought a cheap wig and she looooooves it so much. These have changed since the '70s... the modern wigs are "capless" on a net base and not attached to something like a swim cap as they once were. Her shoulder has long since healed but the wig remains in use every day. ETA suggestions from the comments: Ring camera / Alexa drop-in Laminated page of medications / medical info (have multiple) Wireless cell phone charger Shoe expanders Clock with day/date as well as time Silicone cupcake liners - good for serving meds, modest portions of snacks, etc. easy to hold and non-slip, also useful for hearing aids at night Bed rail Ramp - for entry and exit, rubber or metal Low step stool - useful for getting into car, propping feet up to tie shoes Bath lifter - useful beyond the bathroom Transfer board - helps with transfer from wheelchair to/from bed Car door assist handle - sticks in car door for support getting in and out Car cane - for getting in and out of car Stand up stick - looks like a plunger, helps getting up from floor Bed assist rail Spring-loaded floor-to-ceiling grab pole (Stander Wonder pole) Shower bench, shower transfer bench Shampoo cap for washing hair in bed Hair fiber - Toppik and other brands, makes thin hair look fuller Handheld shower head with multiple holders at various heights Bedside commode Gel powder to soak up urine Shower wipes - look for unscented / sensitive skin version Long-handled toenail clippers Booster pads - for incontinence Quick Change Wraps - for incontinence Bidet attachment"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 326 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w2kxot/useful_items_that_have_made_it_easier_for_us_and/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they

feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the

hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugk_YPLbQQckuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"Things I Wish Someone Had Explained to Me About the Actively Dying phase. I wanted to share a few things I've learned during the active dying phase with my mother-in-law because this experience is honestly something most people are not prepared for at all until they're suddenly in it. And I've realized some hospice agencies are amazing at proactively educating families... and others are kind of waiting for the caregiver to know what questions to ask or what options exist. The problem is your brain is already overwhelmed, emotional, sleep deprived, grieving, and trying to function while watching someone decline in real time. Sometimes you don't even know what you don't know. A few things I wish someone had explained to me earlier: hospice can provide a hospital bed in the home at no cost. There are also relatively affordable rotating air mattresses and pressure relief options online that can really help with comfort and tailbone pain. Foam barrier dressings have helped too. The little mouth swabs dipped in water have also made a huge difference for dry mouth and comfort. Another thing that has been hard emotionally is the eating and hydration piece. Every instinct in you wants to push food and water because feeding and nurturing someone feels so tied to love and care. But there really is a lot of hospice and scientific literature around the body naturally beginning to need less at end of life. From what I've read and been told, excess fluids can sometimes increase swelling and discomfort. I've also gone down a rabbit hole reading about ketosis during the dying process and how some researchers believe it may actually help ease pain or discomfort for the body. I'm not a medical professional, just a human trying to help someone I love through one of the hardest and strangest experiences of my life while learning as I go. Sharing in case it helps another caregiver feel a little less lost or alone."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 281 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/

↳ **comment** (82): "For anyone interested, there is a YouTube channel called HOSPICE NURSE JULIE. She explains all phases of dying, from all types of diseases and what to expect in each case. She is excellent at answering questions and taking the fear out of the whole process."

↳ **comment** (69): "Thank you for posting this, and massive, massive hugs to you. My sister recently passed but before that, our family was doing the above, actively providing water and nutrients (protein drinks) but also being anxious about knowing that at some point she wouldn't want to and couldn't either, because it became an aspirating danger. Mouth swabs in water are absolutely a game changer for comfort, they also had mouthwash that helped generate saliva that provided some comfort to her. The last thing I'll say about this phase that I never understood despite reading about it ceaselessly, was the restlessness that comes at end of life stage. I didn't know my sister's discomfort and distress would be her last signs before she passed. At that stage, it's was hard to know the degree to which she was in discomfort because it as a constant dance of increasing drugs for not only pain but also discomfort. We heavily leaned on the amazing nursing staff to help us through this distressing time, and for anyone else seeing a loved one in hospice, just emphasizing that no question is a silly question, they have seen everything under the sun and are experts at noticing all the signs and symptoms."

↳ **comment** (23): "Hospice nurse Julie reels are so helpful. They can be a little jolting; it just depends if you are a person who likes a lot of information or a little. Taking the fear out of the process makes it more tolerable so you can be present."

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to

be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare

thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"Mom's fall changed everything and I'm fuming. \ contains some mildly graphic medical trauma, so read with caution if that skeeves you out\ In February of this year my mom (78) tripped and fell while entering a clinic to get her mammogram. She already had an existing knee replacement from 12 years prior, and when she fell the

knee replacement cracked her femur. She had a new knee put in that accounted for the femoral shortening caused by the break. So it was surgery and rehab, and then she came home a month after the fall. She lives next door to my son, her eldest grandson. I stayed with her the first week and she was getting around pretty well with her walker. The very night I left to go home, she was in the bathroom and the new knee gave out, just came apart and broke. She went straight down and her legs ended up under her. It causes her incision to completely open and the broken metal parts were visible. She was bleeding out on the floor. We had gotten her an alarm button that would ring at my son's house, and she mashed that thing like nobody's business. My DIL is an RN. She stuffed a towel in my mom's open leg and held it together while waiting on EMS. It took a long time for EMS to get her stabilized and transported, due to the broken knee parts being extremely close to arteries. Emergency surgery that night was done by the surgeon on-call. He cleaned it as best he could, put the parts back together and referred her back to her original surgeon. So surgery again and then this time a nursing facility rather than rehab because insurance refused rehab for this event. She has seen her original surgeon multiple times, had multiple x-rays, and me, my sister, my son and my mom herself have told her surgeon the leg doesn't look right, doesn't feel right to her, keeps wanting to collapse again. We've raised concerns to PT, and told the orthopedics team. They just kept telling her that she'll get stronger with PT. However it was only 2 weeks ago, at yet another post surgery appointment that her surgeon finally told us that she put the knee in incorrectly the first time. So it has been incorrect since way back at the beginning of February when she had her original surgery. It is internally rotated by about 20 degrees. The surgeon even admitted that's very likely why she fell the second time... the time when we almost lost her. Now the surgeon wants to revise her knee. And we will go through this a third time. My poor mom has been working so hard to gain function of a knee that is not placed correctly, that collapses, that locks sideways. When it engages it just flips back and down and deforms her entire lower leg, causing her to scream. It's been heavy work taking care of her as she cannot be left alone. She's spent about 20k outfitting the house with a lift bed, a lift chair, a whole new shower and toilet. Everything we could think of to try to keep her safe. My mom kept thinking she was failing somehow. It's heartbreaking. Watching her struggle has been horrendously hard on my little family. And I'm fuming. So many times we tried to say something was wrong and no one listened. We are reaching out to attorneys and trying to find a different surgeon. We will get through this again, but it's harder on her every time and I've never been so angry in my entire life. To let my mom go through this for 4 months is absolutely egregious and we are nowhere near out of the woods. She's mostly wheel-chair bound now... and back in February, when she was worried she'd miss her granddaughter's May 31st wedding, the surgeon told her she'd be walking and dancing by then, no problem. Fuming."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tszraf/moms_fall_changed_everything_and_im_fuming/

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking kilns, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement that means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to

accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!!?" Seriously, I'm done. I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house (front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"So Angry at My Dad. My 95 yr old father DROVE 5 days after being admitted to ER observation overnight because he fell in a parking lot ... he also dragged my mother down to the ground when he fell. I moved from another state to help them as they age and they never called to tell me until day AFTER they fell. Lots of bruising, pain/aches, immobility etc but neither of them broke anything but we discussed that he would not be driving until he goes to dr for follow- up. He can't put weight on his right leg. And he drove. My mother lied to me about it. (He lies so often that I'm used to it.) On thanksgiving when I told him he can't drive again until his follow-up appt in 5 days he started to lash out and asked me to leave Thanksgiving. As in get out of the house. I left. I had zero alcohol. Planned what I was going to stay and was very calm. Doesn't matter. He just lost it. I really regret moving back as these two are impossible. I know I have to deal with them but I am so angry at their refusal to listen to

common sense, not telling me they were both in ER when I loved back FOR THIS REASON, how he hurt my mother because he refuses to use a cane or walker, and the lies. And the verbal abuse. Oh and how he might hit an innocent person and ruin someone's life, or take someone's life. How do I not be angry when they are so challenging and impossible. He has always been a full-on jerk but getting worse now. I know I don't deserve being yelled at and eating Thanksgiving dinner in a diner alone. I have read a ton about dealing with narcissistic people but I am still so angry. HOW am I supposed to handle them? My sister is In another state. There is no one else here to help. He has alienated other family and not a big family in the first place."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 178 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p9fn38/so_angry_at_my_dad/

"As if we needed a PSA but, hey. I just saw a really disturbing //confession where a caregiver allowed their mother in this case to sit in soiled diapers with UTI-induced delirium and then assaulted their mother causing them to move into hospice when they wouldn't go to the bathroom when OP wanted their mother to resulting in the mom going into hospice. The comments are all over the place excusing this person's behavior because of burnout and how hard it is to be a caregiver. It's really disturbing the more comments OP makes about how egotistical they come off with the whole thing. If you're here, we know it can suck, caregiving can bring the darkest of the dark out on us. Is you're found in a power struggle especially with someone not making sense—walk away for five or ten minutes. Remember that dementia and delirium is not personal—no matter how much your caregeevee sucked as an adult. And if you can't walk away and come back calmly, other arrangements NEED to be made. A difficult job does not excuse abuse just in the case of the ramp up to SBS. Also, especially if you're caring for a woman, diabetic, someone who is elderly and as a non-medical professional—familiarize yourself with the weird symptoms that can happen with UTIs. Idk, things feel especially heavy after a man detained by ICE's son died when he was the primary caregiver and there's so many good caregivers out there trying their best who never do something as awful as that post even at a breaking point."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 173 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1qr8zxz/as_if_we_needed_a_psa_but_hey/

"My mom mocks me for being overwhelmed about getting rid of her stuff after she dies. i'm (44) very triggered when going to my parents' house. My mother (83) and father (88) still live in my childhood home. My dad is in the advanced stages of Parkinson's and has a lot of trouble with mobility after a recent hip surgery. Anyway, he is mostly confined to one room (a large room, but still), where has the tv, recliner, and his hospital bed. Even though the house is between 2600-2800 square feet, they have three functional rooms. The rest is filled with 45 years of accumulated crap. On my dad's end, he just never lifted one finger in terms of non-cooking or child-care related chores, which includes periodically getting rid of things. I don't know that he has a particular emotional attachment to them. My mom, on the other hand, if not quite a hoarding condition, has something that comes close. She's not unsanitary, mostly doesn't keep literal trash (like used napkins and wrappers), and doesn't have a shopping addiction. But she still has an unhealthy attachment to things that were once valuable but have lost their value (like old desktop computers from the 2000s & encyclopedias and couches from the 80s). Anyway, we've been fighting about it a lot lately, because I find it so aggravating that they can't make full use of their home because so much of it is just storage space. The house wasn't that way growing up. It's not that they used to get rid of things. They never did. It just took a long time for it to get as bad as it is. But instead of making use of the sitters who are there, my mom is hobbling around on her swollen foot and bad knee doing everything for my dad herself rather than dealing with her hoard. (Not that she can move heavy things, but she can put old clothes in a box or shred old tax returns). In our last fight, I brought up the hoarding. And then, like it'was another insult, she said "Your worst fear is that when I die, you're going to be left with this stuff." It was like she thought that was something shameful for me to be worried about or overwhelmed by. I don't really have a question. I guess I'm just venting and wondering if anyone else has been through anything similar. It's so infuriating and bizarre."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 150 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vfe2f3/my_mom_mockes_me_for_being_overwhelmed_about/

"Grandmother is now refusing AL or moving in with other family. I'm done caregiving and have plans to move. WTF do I do now?. I've taken care of my 96yr old grandma since I was 19/20 and am now 31yrs old. She's gone from being wholly independent aside from needing assistance going to appointments to now being mobile for short periods with a walker but has the majority of her mental faculties if not extremely emotionally needy and depressed. The last week after her release from a SNF from a fall she has either barely gotten out of bed or been trying go outside and dig up her garden when I'm not home and at work (neighbors called to let me know). She's going to seriously hurt herself but doesn't seem to care. I am at the end of my rope and ability to take care of her. The last time she fell I could not physically pick her up. I've already lost a ogreat job because of her constantly calling me to come home because she's "sick" and needs to go the ER (she's not, we waste 6+hrs to be told she's perfectly fine every single time), and am in danger of losing my current one for the same reason. I have to be present at home for any other person that stops by whether it's her friends or family visiting or scheduled appointments because she won't answer the door otherwise and she refuses any attempts for me to get respite because she won't go to daycares or senior events that would allow me to do so. So I'm essentially tethered to her anytime I'm not at work. We're at the point where she is only slowly deteriorating and not getting any better while I am no longer eating or sleeping and my own mental health has gotten bad enough my doctors are concerned for me. Neither of us can sustain this. I've spoken with other family that are planning a visit this week to either take her home with them or find an AL or nursing home ASAP. They are very aware that I cannot handle any more and need relief. My bags are actively being packed and I have a place to move to as soon as she's taken care of. Grandma was okay with this progression and change up until today (though obviously not happy about it) when suddenly it's become "oh we'll hire someone to come in and help" and "I'm staying at home or you get nothing". She's insistent we're both staying right here and that's just not happening. I don't care about anything willed to me when she passes anymore. Maybe it makes me a terrible person but I cannot do this any longer. I don't have POA, her son's does (the one coming this week) and she is otherwise still in charge of her own medical decisions. Obviously we can't force her into a facility but if I'm not stopping my plans to leave, what do we do? Do I just leave and let the chips fall if she won't allow herself to be moved somewhere? I spent today feeling like I was arguing with a toddler trying to get across to her that the train is leaving the station and she's not listening."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1np0dlg/grandmother_is_now_refusing_al_or_moving_in_with/

"Hoarder MIL: The ongoing saga. Just to recap: \- MIL is in her 80s \- She had one child, a son, and I married him \- My husband died of cancer about 6 years ago \- MIL drove my husband nuts with her crappy attitude and inability to deal with the consequences of her own actions \- While hubs was going through cancer treatments, she'd come up to offer "moral support". While here, she'd expect him to carry her luggage and order for her and all kinds of whatever and expected me to cater to her because "she's the guest". \- She hated me from the beginning and worked to break us up while we were dating and when we were married. This went on for about 10 years. \- She's a hoarder. Her home was condemned by code enforcement in April 2025 when I called local LE for a wellness check on her. \- Had to pay \$17k to get the house cleared and approved by code enforcement for her to move back in. \- She's fallen several times since, totalled her car because "hoard in car" and a bitcoin scam. \- She has been diagnosed with cyclothymia. This is a mild version of bipolar, but honestly, there's likely more going on. \- She fell again beginning of Dec 2025. She had a nursing service check on her weekly and the nurse called for a wellness check. I went to do some errands for her (she's 3 hours away) and learned the hoarding had resumed with gusto and the toilets were all backed up. At the time, her echocardiogram was normal. \- I got her moved into a personal care home (PCH, not a nursing home) on NYE 2025. She hated it at first, but has been singing praises for the last several months. \- Got her house sold 12 June and her outstanding (massive) credit card bills cleared. One had entered arbitration. She had this idea that, because she was old, she didn't have to pay cc bills anymore.

\- The week after the house sold _something happened_. Not sure what. Could have been a silent heart attack, could have been caused by grief over the house selling. Regardless, between Dec 2025 and 2-3 weeks ago, her heart function dropped to 10-15% and she developed congestive heart failure. \- While in the hospital she decided she was refusing medical care. Doc totally confused by this, but ok. She also got a psyche eval while she was there because she kept saying “I just want to die”. Also diagnosed with UTI (and her usual delirium). \- Back at the PCH and under hospice care. She won’t talk to me on the phone, whines in texts constantly. She’s on lasix and O2 for the congestive heart failure. THE NEWS: Sunday (yesterday) AM I got a call from the manager of the PCH. MIL keeps her roommate up all night making her get up and fix her pillows and tuck her in. Roommate is miserable (also in her 80s and in bad health). MIL is not going to the bathroom anymore; she just lies in bed and fills her diapers and expects the PCH staff to clean her up. She won’t keep her legs elevated, she won’t keep her O2 on. She refuses to eat. Complains about her stomach hurting all the time (not eating, hmmm?). If she won’t cooperate, they’ll evict her. She has no where else to go. I had guessed at some of what they told me. She’d complained that she was breaking “the new rules” last week, that they wanted to put her in a hospital bed and that was “insane”. She whinged on and on about needing a specific blanket from amazon (I finally just caved and got it for her even tho she has blankets). I text her. I cannot call her. She won’t answer the phone, and if she calls me, she complains she can’t hear me (then says she can’t hear anymore, which the PCH says is bogus). I tell her she has decisions to make and it’s on her to make them. I tell her that she’s being moved to the hospice room that’s closer to the toilets and that she’s getting a hospital bed so that her legs stay elevated. (The PCH is “losing” the remote, which I totally agree with.) She freaks the fuck out, tells me all this is old news, that she’s been in the hospital for tests (they call and tell me when she goes to the hospital and she hasn’t been). Bitches that she likes it where she is, she doesn’t want to move, yadda yadda. Then she claims the toilet paper holders have cameras on them. A few hours later she says she was moved, it’s cold, she has blankets, and I’ve heard nothing since. So that’s where I am today. Concurrently, I’m gonna have to put my 16 year old dog down this week (chronic kidney disease \[CKD\]), my 15 year old dog won’t be far behind (heart murmur, congestive heart failure, beginning CKD). A side effect of the CKD is chronic diarrhoea, so I’ve been cleaning that up for over a month multiple times a day and night; a side effect of the lasix that younger dog is on is increased urination (more things to clean up). I have pee pads all over the place, but there’s only so much of that you can do. And my therapist is on vacation for a few weeks. It will be a month before I get to talk to her again.”

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 127 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v1l503/hoarder_mil_the_ongoing_saga/

"Mom (93) finished cancer treatment and is giving up. Looking for both tactical advice and to hear from anyone who's been through this. Long-time lurker, first time posting. The situation: Mom is 93, just finished radiation for cancer and is in remission with aggressive monitoring. We had to move her from independent living to assisted living about six weeks ago after a hospitalization made it clear she couldn't safely live alone anymore (not taking meds consistently on her own). (She had been in independent for 18 months before the cancer diagnosis and seemed fine.) Treatment went as well as we could've hoped clinically. But now that the active medical crisis is past, she's collapsed. What's happening this week: \- Won't get out of bed. Won't leave her room. Always an excuse for not going to meals or activities. \- Hiding her medications. Staff are catching some of it but probably not all. \- Caught trying to bribe staff — telling them she'll give them her house if they help her go home or look the other way when she does things she's been told not to do. \- I'm pretty sure she thinks that if she gets kicked out of AL, she thinks she goes home. Home is not an option. The next step is SNF, and she doesn't understand that. A counselor is seeing her tomorrow, which I'm grateful for. The staff at AL is working with us — they have really been amazing through all this. What I'm asking: 1. For those whose parent went through post-treatment depression — did meds help? Did therapy? Did anything? How long did the dark stretch last? 2. The bribery / med-hiding behavior — is this depression, early cognitive decline, or both? She's been cognitively intact on testing, but this feels like something shifted. 3. How do you talk to a parent who has decided to give up? Every script I try (“we want you here,” “we’re doing this because we love you”) seems to bounce off. She just keeps saying she understands but then the behavior doesn't align with what she says. 4. Did anyone successfully avoid the SNF

transition by getting their parent stabilized in AL after a backslide like this? Or is this how it goes? The harder thing: We have moved mountains. We (my wife and I) uprooted our lives to temporarily move to be near her and take care of her throughout this process. My employer has been very understanding. We've dealt with all the paperwork, coordinating five specialists across three cities, getting her placed, managing her finances, the cancer treatment, all of it. And it's not enough. She's miserable and I think part of her is angry at us for not letting her go home to die in her own bed. I know there's no magic answer. I just want to hear from people who've been in this exact spot. What helped. What didn't. What you wish you'd known. Thanks for reading. Edit: I wanted to provide some additional info to address some of the comments. Health prior to the cancer diagnosis: First, up until this cancer episode she was in very good shape cognitively and physically - much better than her age would suggest. She only used a walker outside or unfamiliar places. People always commented on how sharp she was. Finances: After my dad passed away, we discussed her finances on many occasions. My only concern was that she was financially ok and she constantly assured me that she was fine. She was paying her bills -- she always paid on time and was never late. I have never pushed her to do anything she didn't want to do. She approached me about moving to IL. We discussed the cost and I agreed to help because it was going to cost more than her monthly income. We discussed selling the house and she agreed. But she kept coming up with excuses to drag out the process and, quite frankly, I was busy with other things in life. Then one morning shortly after the initial cancer diagnosis, she divulged a credit card bill. In trying to get to the bottom of that I discovered that hole was much deeper than she let on. She even tried to hide some of the statements from me. On the cancer diagnosis: Her mother (my GM) died of cancer, so I think mom heard cancer and immediately interpreted that as a death sentence, despite what anyone told her. Multiple doctors told her she would likely die with it and not of it. It was very early stage 1 and very treatable. One oncologist said even at her age, given all the other factors, he gave her a >90% chance of survival. We made the decisions we made with the best intentions and the best information available at the time. That bell has been rung and I'm not going to re-litigate that on an Internet forum. Legal affairs: Before all of this, we had all of her legal affairs in order. She had an AD (no code), and I have full financial and healthcare POA. I have since taken over managing the finances and have an attorney involved to make sure we handle the debt and her care according to her stated wishes. On me "not being able to let go": I have a background in being a first responder. I've seen death in the line of duty and personal experience with other difficult family situations. This is not a situation where I "just can't let go." I have lived through that on my wife's side of the family and it was an awful experience. I have discussed this situation with many doctors and every single one has told me this is not a palliative care situation -- she would likely not qualify for hospice. I'm not an expert in that -- I'm simply going on the advice of others. Now has she just lost the will to live? Yes, very probably. But being depressed is not the same thing as being terminally ill and that's not the same thing as just being old. I'm hoping that independent behavioral health will help us make the best decisions we can from here on out. I appreciate everyone who has taken time to respond."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 125 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4swt3/mom_93_finished_cancer_treatment_and_is_giving_up/

"I just refused a lump sum cash gift from my mom.. Today I was visiting my mom (79, in independent assisted living and on the doorstep of needing LTC because she is maxed out on what private nursing can provide with her numerous health and mobility challenges). She told me she is considering giving my younger brother and I (her only children) a lump sum cash payment to "help us out." Here is where this is coming from... Four years ago my brother was on a reckless path and my elderly parents (both were alive at the time, RIP Dad at age 82 in 2025) gave him \$65-70K to "fix" things with no strings attached. It was a gift. They asked me to please respect their decision and to simply "understand because a parent would do anything for their children." My parents did this before asking my brother to tap into his own resources. They felt strongly that he should maintain his assets and the simple lifestyle he had. After three years, my parents finally stopped paying for my brother's expenses, largely because I pleaded this was enabling and was getting out of hand. To add to the stress, it was becoming clear that long term care was in the future for our Dad and it is now very close for our Mom. My brother still wanted many

thousands of dollars more and when my parents finally said “no,” he exhausted his meager savings (he is middle-aged) and he is now in debt. Our mom is aware that paying off this debt is a slow and painful process for my brother, but he is doing it. She also knows my family and I are completely self-sufficient. Anyway, our mom then asked me what I would think if she were to give me and my brother each a lump sum payment “because it could really help us out.” My “enabler” alarm went off because of the huge amount of cash my parents already gifted my brother. It is not to come out of his inheritance. I wondered if there would be any end to this if I accepted her money. My dad articulated that his dying wish for me was to make sure my younger brother is never homeless. Sadly, that says a lot about the dynamics. My “enmeshed behaviour” alarm went off next because I have experienced transactional treatment from both our mom and dad; specifically their regular reminders I would one day inherit a nice piece of my mom’s jewelry “for all I do for them.” I was actively involved in both our dad’s and now only mom’s caregiving. I live very nearby Mom’s assisted living facility, but I have a family of my own and am always honest about my capacity. My approach to caregiving is sustainable, finally, after several intense years of my parents’ very real medical emergencies and rapid declines. I have to constantly be on guard because my parents have always treated me as an extension of themselves. I replied that I don’t need any money and am not in financial difficulty. I can afford what I need. I suggested that if she wants to give my brother an early gift of inheritance she needs to get her Will redone so the early gift is recognized and accounted for to be fair. She said she didn’t want to change her Will. It would either be we both get money early or neither of us do. I know my brother is struggling financially (not my monkey, not my circus) but I feel like our mom is trying to manipulate me. I am the family scapegoat because I have boundaries around my time/energy/conversation topics/etc. I am also her only child that has ever been dependable, consistent and taken on caregiving for her and Dad. My brother is the golden child who always has some trouble to be solved but is just such a busy and great guy who is sensitive and sweet. He can go weeks to months without calling her and is still wonderful because things are just so hard for him and he can’t help it. My mom’s money feels dirty and for me, I feel like it would just exacerbate the extremely transactional treatment I receive from her. She says that if I don’t want to accept her “gift” then my brother won’t get one either. And like the scapegoat I am... I am okay with that. Thanks for listening to me vent. \\\\UPDATE\\\\ Hours after I made my original post, my mom told me she wants to meet with her financial advisor in a couple of weeks to review her investments and asked me if I want to come. I might try to leverage the advisor, alert her about my brother and the risk of financial abuse and tell her about mom’s plan to give lump sum payments. I would try to get the advisor to lay out my mom’s financial reality to both of us. We already know it but it might as well be part of the conversation as a reminder. My hope is the advisor would discourage my mom from getting used as a bank. I would hope that if Mom still wants to give my brother and I cash gifts, the advisor would encourage payments dispersed over time (with a limit) to both my brother and I as opposed to lump sums, explain the benefits of a professional trust and help Mom lay out a plan. This absolutely won’t stop the emotional manipulation I receive from my mom and I don’t expect it to or for her to change in any way. It will not stop my mom from feeling the itch to help my brother by giving him more lump sums on top of it. About every 6 months my brother implies need and my mom gets the itch for a while and scratches. Dad did too. More Context: I should add that though my parents stopped giving my brother large lump sums 12-18 months ago, my mom (who hasn’t driven in a couple of years) gave my brother her 10 year old vehicle about 10 months ago. This vehicle was previously kept in underground parking at her residence and I used it to drive her to her appointments because she can’t get into our trucks. She paid for the maintenance/parking/fuel/insurance and I managed the logistics and took it for servicing, washes, fuel ups and cleaned it. My brother lives 350 km away. Now she will only go to an appointment if her residence’s complimentary courtesy car is available. This service only provides door to door drop off and pick up, no escorting. Her mobility is terrible and she uses a walker but her physio says she needs a wheelchair for going out. That is the second physio to say so, btw. She refuses to get one (it would be fully funded thanks to government grant for disabled people!) and so I stopped meeting her and the courtesy car at her appointments. She only leaves for appointments (not shopping/errands/coffee/dining out at all). Sometimes she goes alone, which her doctor and RN in charge of her case say she absolutely shouldn’t do, but she has occasionally hired a health care aide to accompany her through the private nursing company she uses. Telling

history that shows how longstanding these patterns of thought are: 25 years ago my mom and aunt worked together to have my Grandma write my uncle out of Grandma's Will. Uncle was divorced, retired and a live-in part-time carer to supplement the publically funded home care Grandma received. Grandma paid for his divorce, bought him a car, paid for his holidays and he lived rent free. However, he cooked, did the yard care for her house, drove her to appointments, picked up prescriptions, etc. Sometimes my grandma wasn't happy because he picked up casual work related to his previous profession, when she wanted him to be home and she wanted him to do more. Mom and Auntie thought he was getting a free ride and convinced my grandma to write him out of her Will. I was a newly minted adult at this time, just finished university and I thought this might be a unique scenario or that maybe my uncle wasn't helping enough but this way of thinking has persisted and I have come to doubt the "lore" around caregiving for my grandma. This is the context I have in the background in caregiving for my mother. *Edited to fix a typo and to note I am not in the US."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v3spn7/i_just_refused_a_lump_sum_cash_gift_from_my_mom/

""Because shoes weigh so much". My mom has a degenerative disease (multiple systems atrophy, which is as bad as it sounds). She's been falling regularly and they live in a stupid condo that has a step between the dining room and the living room where her recliner is. She has a walker and I suspect will soon need a wheelchair. She's fallen *many* times, including once breaking her hip. This week, she fell again, not badly. Why did she fall, you ask? Because she had to weigh herself. Before going to the doctor's appointment. Because if she gets weighed at the doctor, she'll have to leave her shoes on and they weigh so much. So she fell stepping off of the scale. When we suggested that perhaps her weight isn't the most crucial thing right now, she said, "It's an important parameter." Parameter for what? She's not obese at all - unlike me. I wonder why I might have issues... I stg, if she dies hitting her head falling after weighing herself, I can't think of a more ironic death."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 102 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1u4sij0/because_shoes_weigh_so_much/

"My mother turns 99 in two short months. I'm 71. She doesn't live with me (thank Heavens!) but went into care after battling a couple of illnesses almost 3 1/2 years ago. I have looked after her for 17 years, getting her to all of her medical appointments, picking up groceries, helping her do her banking, etc and have been responsible for her healthcare and finances for 13 years since she first went into assisted living. She began showing signs of dementia a couple of years after that and also was experiencing more hearing loss. Now she is deaf, fully into dementia and in a wheelchair. Visiting her is no longer enjoyable and hasn't been for a few years. She knows me but is oblivious to everything going on around her. I can't imagine what it's like for her to be living such a life. For me, it's exhausting. Make no mistake, even though a family member isn't looking after an elderly parent or family member personally, it is still emotionally and sometimes physically exhausting. In the ensuing years since my mother went into assisted living, I've had to pack up her belongings and move some items to my home and move a few items to her assisted living suite, empty her house of any other items in her store room, supervise the sale of her house, deal with the assisted living management and staff on my mother's behalf (she didn't want to do anything much, especially make big decisions, for herself) regarding her in-house supports etc. I've seen her through four surgeries and countless other appointments. I've sorted out and supervised financial and investment concerns for her, stored all manner of tax, finance, investment and medical information for her in multiple bankers boxes at my small home (which take up a lot of room!) and have run around getting her toiletries etc as well as visiting her regularly and meeting her in the emergency room whenever she's had a fall and hurt herself. Now I have to meet the dental hygienist each time she comes to clean my mom's teeth because my mom gets upset and agitated. If I'm there, my mom is calmer during the process. I have looked after my mom diligently for years, and I've lost count of how often my life has been put on the back burner in order to deal with her needs. Many people will know that when an elderly person has need of medical attention and such, that the carer has to make decisions and get the needs met because those needs can't wait. Doctors, nurses, dental hygienists, Care-aids, or whoever, need prompt answers to their questions and decisions made by the person with Power of Attorney. So the family member in

charge sacrifices their life regularly for the well being of the elderly person for whom they are responsible. I have my own home to look after as well as my own finances, taxes, grocery shopping etc to take care of but all of that isn't taken into account by others. What I also know is that often, the designated carer gets little help if any from other family members. I've seen and heard about this time and again and it happened to me. My late brother did very little to help, rarely even offered. He was running a business with his wife but I often wondered if he kept working to avoid having to help with his mother and preferred to leave me carrying the full load alone. Am I tired out, emotionally and physically worn down? You bet I am! I've had my own health issues to deal with for the last 4 years or so and this makes looking after my mom even more difficult. Don't ever let anyone tell you that it's not so tough to care for a parent if your parent is in full care. That's not only a lie, it's an insult! 🙄🇨🇦 "

youtube · @Mystic0216 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 89 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwJHs0ZLn4QPZUoDjp4AaABAq

↳ **@obstantiadiscindo (18)**: "Your words resonate completely. I so feel for you. And at the end of it all, the years of care you describe before they get anywhere near a care facility- what then? We're drained beyond belief, and the sibling - formerly incapable of helping anyone - is there to see what money is left. My sister - younger and healthier than me - who apparently can't help in anyway - psychological issues in getting on a plane, constant mental brain fog - has already lined up tax lawyers for her "half of the inheritance" and is now an expert on UK probate law. Literally willing Mum to die. Hasn't seen her for 34 years. Takes a very keen interest and argumentative interest in how I'm managing Mum's money. Would frequently phone my mother and ask her to tell me to send her money, then yell at me when I said I can't do that - legally - as PoA because Mum no longer has mental capacity, and needs her money to continue paying for her care. My kids want nothing to do with her now, and I suspect that after Mum eventually dies, if there's any money left from her care fees, my sister will be threatening me with legal action if she doesn't receive precisely half of what SHE thinks should be left. So I've had to cover myself with audit trails of all expenses, videos of any conversations with Mum about money, when she was still capable of them. The absent selfish sibling adds another dimension to an already overwhelming situation."

↳ **@bonitaburroughs8673 (7)**: "You said it so well. So many people tell me to put mom in a facility and I can't get them to understand that would not relieve my caregiving. Thanks for saying it so well."

↳ **@Mystico216 (5)**: "@ Thank you for your kind comment. I really appreciate it and I hope you are able to look after your own well being. I know how difficult that can be and also how important it is to take care of one's physical health as well as mental health. What was really eye opening for me was that I thought everything would at least be easier for me to manage with my mother in long term care but I was so wrong! I've had a couple of acquaintances (who never looked after their own parents, each either left the province or the country in which they were born) say to me that they can't imagine what it must be like to have to look after an elderly parent or family member. "Do you find it tiring?" they ask. Honestly, I just wish they'd not try to engage me about it because I prefer not to go into it too much. They don't understand how my life is nor do they know that looking after an elderly parent is even more difficult if that parent is a bit narcissistic and demanding. (The leopard never changes its spots even if it has dementia.) So we're all in the same boat and just have to weather the storm, I guess. Please take good care of yourself and I wish you all the best as you cope with your circumstances! ❤️🙏 "

Doing it all myself first · 505 documents

20 most engaged of 505 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62. I cared for both of my parents for 10 years. It almost killed me. You lose your very self. People tell you to take care of yourself, but there's no time for that. There's no You anymore. My mother was the last one to die. That was 4 years ago. I'm still exhausted, if that tells you anything. I don't want to go anywhere or do anything. I live happily by myself with my phone to keep me company. I may be adding a cat to the scenario soon. I have a wonderful family nearby who I see every now and then, so I'm not totally alone. But I want no other human being living in my space ever. The silence and slowness of life is so sweet. I loved my parents dearly. Now, it's all about me."

youtube · @lindaN236 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1,123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAg

↳ **@Teffi_Club** (93): "It is true when you take care of your parents, you lose your own health."

↳ **@sjtalksandlife** (61): "It's time for you to enjoy your life, you did a great job with your parents, now it's time to focus on you"

↳ **@lordbrunski** (44): "I am so glad you shared that with honesty. I have hypothyroid and looking after my ungrateful and abusive parents has left me in a state of exhaustion that I cannot shake off. I feel like you do. Being solo is the only think I want. Men assume that I am "up for it" and they have no idea that all I want is a book, a cat and a dog. The idea of having to look after anyone else does not appeal."

"NPR story on caring for aging parents (venting). NPR did a story yesterday morning on caring for aging parents, interviewing a woman who ended up taking care of her mother 24/7 while her mother was bedridden. While it accurately depicted the struggles of caregiving, it ended as most of these stories do by making it redemptive, saying what a beautiful thing it was or what a privilege it was to take care of her mother. My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together. I used to think I might "get my life back," but I've found that you don't. You can't get back all the lost social and career opportunities. You don't get your mental and physical health back. You have to figure out what to do with what's left. I took care of my mother because I felt it was my duty as her son to do so. Most people tell me I objectively did a good job, but I was never temperamentally suited to the role. I forced myself to do it, every day. I put a mask on and was pleasant to her, but I hated having to try to get my mother to do the basic things she needed to do every day. By the end, as her dementia progressed, it felt pointless. I was maintaining a body that had very little mind left in it when I could have been putting my own mind to work in my business, solving problems for clients. I lost my biggest client because I didn't have time to do the work he needed me to do. I resented it. Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy. It was traumatizing. And now I'm still dealing with my mother's estate with a sibling who thinks she deserves half of everything even though she did absolutely nothing to help, ever. She couldn't care less what it cost me. She takes it all for granted. I just hate when people try to sugar-coat what caregiving does to your life and try to frame it in sentimental terms. It wrecked my mental and physical health. It wrecked my business. It wrecked my social and romantic life. It's made me hate my sister for her apathy and greed. I'm 59 and trying to get back into the dating world, and I feel like I'm having to learn how to do it all over again. I'm having to re-learn how to go out and socialize with people. I can only relate my own story, but caregiving didn't leave me with some rosy afterglow. Caregiving wrecked my life. I'm satisfied that I did my duty to my mother, but that's it. It didn't give me some wonderful gift. The news media will never report that story. Edit: Thanks for all the responses. Part of what set me off yesterday was the fact that it was my mother's birthday, and

several people sent me messages about how I must be thinking about my mom today. The thing is, I wasn't. I was working all day trying to get a job done for a new client. And I thought about my mother 24/7 for years. I'm done thinking about my mother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,034 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :), can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's 'in the weeds' taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"As an RN for over 40 years, I watched the caregiver collapse when the parent died. The stress and 24/7 care destroyed their health. Some even died. It is usually the female who gives up her career, marriage, life, and ends up with the total responsibility for their parent or grandparent. It is wrong!"

youtube · @nancyhjort5348 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 623 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwwOw2jjfIM5t3-MJR4AaABAg

↳ **@AN-GEL.AI.Official** (64): "That is how I felt yesterday , I thought I am going to die before my Mom. I also have a husband and another household to take care of daily. It is not easy!"

↳ **@gwenaguilar7049** (40): "My mom took care of my nana her whole life. In her later years my nana was too much. My mom did it by herself. My aunt's lived far away. My nana died alone in a nursing home during covid. We weren't allowed to see her because of the ruled during covid. That destroyed my mom. 9 months later my mom had a stroke. She made a miraculous recovery and has very little signs to anyone outside our family that she had a stroke. Now our momma is going to be 78 and our daddy 79. They don't want to be a burden, and don't like asking for help, because of the burden of taking care of my nana. Thankful my brother, sister-in-law, and hubby all help. Our journey with them is just beginning and can feel it"

↳ **@mariaabreu9085** (40): "The usual social misconception that women must obey, sacrifice and support others."

"I am a single child of my parents. I woke up one morning when I was 30 only to come back from a jog to see my father passed away from a heart attack. I quit my job to move in to be with my mother (professor of Sociology at state university) and just when I was gaining momentum in life, mother was diagnosed with polymyositis (autoimmune disorder) & astrocytoma grade III brain tumour. My world crashed. She underwent surgery n chemotherapy and three years later she has lost all speech n the function of a right hand. Did I come close to losing my mind? Yes. Did I at one point of time thought of just running away till I eventually drop dead? Yes. Did I thought of abandoning my mother at a care home so that I can live a "happy" life? Yes. I am guilty of thinking all of this n more. YET! I love her more than my life and I stay put right here with her. Caring for her as much as possible. I am single so it hurts often not having anyone who can hold my hand n embrace me once in a while...but knowing that my mum smiles every morning when she see's me and sometimes folds my clothes with the same love that she had when I was a kid..makes me feel very very deep down inside that... I'm doing the RIGHT thing. Thank you"

youtube · @theeverselfproject · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 566 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiEW&lc=Ugxp32WUjPbx4DZw7UZ4AaABAg>

↳ **@wordswordswords8203** (33): "It's good of you to do that but you need to make sure you are ok too. Caregiving is really brutal and unhealthy in the long term. I'm living it."

↳ **@timujin3329** (25): "Similar situation, single child, I was 25(now 30) when my mother had a brain haemorrhage. She has been paralysed and bed ridden since. Its very difficult to juggle career and taking care of

old parents. None understands how hard it is for us. My dad is also old and not in prime of health. Things are hard and won't improve, but I will keep caring and fighting in life ❤️ Love and Support dear from India 🇮🇳💔💔💔"

↳ **@MeiiKoWalker** (23): "I hug you from distance, truly hope you can find someone to give you all the love you deserve"

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/live_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and

my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"My parents moved in with my wife and I when I was only 33 years old and my wife was 25. That was my dad's retirement plan. I never questioned it and simply took care of them, in concert with my elder brother. They have lived continuously with us, with us being 100% responsible for everything. Food, shelter, clothing, healthcare and welfare. Over the last 28 years we have raised our families and taken care of our parents. Mom passed away from Parkinson's, at home, over 20 years ago. Dad is 92 and with Alzheimer's. We are caring for him. It is not easy. Lots of sacrifice of resources, the most important one being time. Now my mother in law who is 76 is needing help. We will see them thru as best as we can on this journey of life. Maybe in the final analysis that is all that we can say. We took care of them and did the best we could as their children."

youtube · @syhussaini9236 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 495 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgxmGaYBi5Usb_cUYy54AaABAq

↳ @samsun01 (43): "you are a hero, sir. you don't give up or abandon anyone. inspirational."

↳ @Seamonkey555 (26): "I loved caring for my dad & now my mom. Living together is our normal. It's what families used to do without thought of another way. Multigenerational living is making a huge rebound! As a Dementia Caregiver Coach, End of Life Doula and Alzheimer's Advocate why would I EVER teach others to care for their loved ones at home and allow a peaceful death there and not do it for my parents."

↳ @PrettyBoyBeatsMusic (22): "Yeah bro I know the feeling Took care of my mom in late twenties when she had Alzheimer's and dad through cancer with little help from Family. It was really tough but I learned a lot about life."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed*

someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her, but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had."* This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin My cousin also asked*

her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant **we** would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set of what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1trrt0u/im_urguing_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"Don't let an aging parent ruin your relationship. After several months of a trial separation, my wife yesterday informed me that she wants a divorce. So I feel compelled to issue this warning. Don't get me wrong--I'm not saying my aging father is solely responsible for the dissolution of my marriage. I was dealing with a number of stressors, and her and I failed to resolve issues of some significance. That said, it was obvious my dad's situation played a significant role in all this. I simply wasn't proactive enough in getting my dad into an assisted living facility, possibly even memory care. I felt that it wasn't my life, but I was somehow compelled to help him live independently. I can't even imagine the millage I put on my car traveling to his house to help get groceries and pay his bills, clean his place, get him to his doctor's appointments, get him the medication he needs (through the VA nonetheless), basically keep him alive. After the initial hospitalization that set this in motion, I was able to buy him about two years on his own. Now he's in a memory care facility--just a few months after he temporarily moved in with me, he broke his hip and there was only one place that could take him while he healed. He was going to need 24 hr. assistance. My wife had made it clear she was not happy with how much time I was spending on his affairs. And rightfully so, as it was eating away my time with the family, and it always aggravated my

depression. I started a new career last year and my dad's problems were preventing me from putting best foot forward. By the time I was able to convince him to start touring assisted living facilities and getting on a waiting list, it was too little too late. My wife moved out, in part, to make room for my Dad to live at our place for a little bit--just a way to ease the transition into assisted living. The most-recent hospitalization was the big wake up call. Now my brother and I are in the process of managing his property, getting a short-term bridge loan to buy us time to fix up my childhood home, only for that house to be sold to pay for future memory care costs. It's not hard to see how a marriage could crumble under these conditions, especially if you don't get out in front of it when you had the opportunity. Yeah, our marriage had some problems to begin with. But dealing with my Dad was taking away time, energy, and other resources I needed to address my marital issues. I was exhausted all the time. And it was getting in the way of my new job. I was getting pulled in too many directions, and my Dad's situation was by far the most frustrating. If not for that, I feel like I could have repaired our relationship. Or maybe not. But it would have freed up a lot of time to focus on what's really important. Anyways, I just felt like sounding the alarm to anyone worried that their obligations to an aging parent are ruining your relationship... or some other important part of your life. The best advice I can offer are these rules of thumb: (1) set some boundaries to prevent it from bleeding into your family or professional life; (2) be proactive about moving this process along, because it's not getting any easier--if its damaging your marriage, that's a clear sign that you can no longer provide the help they need; (3) if you haven't yet dealt with estate matters, medical/financial POI, etc., call a lawyer ASAP; and (4) let it be a lesson and plan for this period of your life so that it doesn't all fall on the shoulders of your children or other family members. I know it's easier said than done, but trust me when I say there is a better way. Happy New Year"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 369 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hvl7z2/dont_let_an_aging_parent_ruin_your_relationship/

"How to deal with an aging parent's unrealistic demands. I am 61 (F) and my mother is 86 going on 87. Two years ago, after my father passed away, I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. She has a long list of medical issues and is reluctant to go into care. For the first year I was working from home and balancing her care and the house and my job. Early in 2025 I retired (I took an early retirement offer from my employer) and pretty much immediately my mother's care became more complex. She's had a year of medical issues that I can't even begin to list as it's too long. But in the midst of all of that she saw my retirement as her opportunity to ask me to do all kinds of work around the house. Ok, I agreed to things within my capability like painting a room or doing some gardening work and minor repairs. But she's been bothering me to do more difficult things that (a) I don't have the knowledge to do and (b) are physically too demanding. She's been asking me to lift a bunch of patio slabs that are kind of shifting, refill and level the screening underneath and straighten them up. She mentions this CONSTANTLY. Even in the winter as something she wants done in the spring. We got a quote from someone and it would be close to \$1000 if not more based on the area she wants done. And she says she can't afford it. So I just keep saying no, I'm not doing it. And she keeps insisting "your father would do this; if I were younger and stronger like you I would do this, I used to do these things all the time." Finally, yesterday I had enough when she asked me about it again. I did not lose my temper. When she said "when I was your age I would have done this" I calmly reminded her that at my age she was on track to having her first open heart surgery so no she would not be doing this. Then she said "well your father would..." etc I reminded her that he had help from his friends and brothers most of whom are now too old or deceased. Then when she said well it would cost too much, I finally just said: "Well then, I guess they're going to just have to stay the way they are because I am not doing it and you don't have the money. People who don't have the money and can't do the work don't do it especially if it's not something critical." Like honestly it's all cosmetic at this point. She just doesn't like that they are shifting; nothing is a tripping hazard or anything but this is just one of many things she wants done which I just can not do. And it's a constant "but..." trying to shame me into being lazy and not competent and me saying "no...I'm not doing that; if you want it done we'll hire someone.""

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 362 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/

↳ **comment** (273): "I think they don't have enough going on in their lives so they persevere on this stuff. Also, they do lose track that not everyone who is younger than them has the strength of a 30 year old. 10 or so years ago my mom asked if my husband and his brothers could do some stuff she wanted done around her house, and I had to remind her that that entire crew was now in their mid-fifties and had bad backs! I like to remember that "No" is a full sentence."

↳ **comment** (155): "> I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. There's the problem. edited to add: I count six instances of "her" in that one sentence. It's going to stay all about *her* until you decide to prioritize your own needs and wants."

↳ **comment** (127): "The thing is - this is what's known as "assisted living". If mom can't manage her own care and care of the home (even if "care of the home" means hiring people to do maintenance tasks), then she is no longer living independently. Parents seem to think that adult children as caretakers don't count, and that they are still "independent"."

"I get to retire today. My sweet mom, after a year with in-home hospice and 4 years of post brain tumor difficulties and 24/7 care, she finally headed home to heaven. Hospice detected signs last Thursday with the finding of a Kennedy ulcer. Bittersweet feelings as life on earth had been torture the last few years for her and glad my Dad and I could take care of her at home. A lot of sacrifice, depression and isolation — but I would do it again. She leaves an ocean sized void in my heart. Caregiving is not for the weak, but it gives you purpose and I am now without purpose. Take care friends and always remember you're not alone."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 355 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nebf4t/i_get_to_retire_today/

"How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care, and your adult child wrote you and the whole family this letter regarding that situation?. Dear family, I've been doing a lot of reflecting lately on the situation with Grandma and Grandpa, and I feel a need to share some thoughts that have been weighing on me. I know we are all doing our best to navigate this, but I want to offer a different perspective—one that might be uncomfortable, but feels necessary to voice. I can't help but feel that what we are witnessing is, in many ways, fundamentally unnatural. Decades ago, you rarely heard of couples requiring 24/7 professional assistance simultaneously; there was a natural rhythm to life and passing that seems to have been disrupted. It feels as though modern medicine has become so focused on the mechanics of keeping the body running that it has moved far away from human nature itself. By pushing past what might have once been our natural "expiration dates," we've entered a territory where the cost of longevity is a loss of the very independence that defined them. Perhaps the most jarring part of this experience for me is seeing the in-home care staff every day. While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge; instead of a family visit, it feels like a supervised appointment in their own home. Because of this, I want to be very clear about my own wishes for the future: Once I reach the age of 75, I do not want any extraordinary measures taken to prolong my life. Whether it is surgery, intensive treatment, or any form of medical intervention, I want to let nature take its course. Furthermore, if I ever reach a point where I can no longer safely live independently, please do not try to recreate a hospital within my home. I am asking you now to please just put me in a professional facility. I would rather my home remain a memory of who I was, rather than a place defined by its clinical needs. I know this is hard to hear, and I don't say it to diminish the love we all have for them. I just feel we need to acknowledge the reality of the era we are living in and how much it has changed the way we experience the end of life. With love and honesty, Jack"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 349 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

↳ **comment** (259): "A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

↳ **comment** (147): "I was Jack almost a decade ago. The PTSD I have associated with helping my mom care for my grandparents will never leave me. It *ruined* my memories of my grandparents who I loved so much and spent much of my childhood with. It sucks to be the elderly person or the caregiver, but being a support person for the caregiver sucks too. We are watching an elderly loved one basically be tortured into living, another loved one get burnt out to a crispy husk of a person, and we just have to sit there like 'This is fine.....' It's really sad, frustrating, depressing to watch, and makes you look around and scream 'am I taking crazy pills?!'"

↳ **comment** (140): "I studied gerontology and death & dying. Because of that, I made an Exit Plan 20 years ago. I saw what was going to happen with the massive, aging, Boomer population & there's nothing good about it. I've completed all my EOL documents (Will, Living Will/Healthcare POA, financial/durable POA), each kid has copies. Pre-planned & pre-paid for my cremation. I'm very open with my kids about EOL stuff and how I don't want to burden them with my care. Of course, they say "we don't mind," but I've seen 1st hand how caregiving tears apart families and breaks caregivers. I don't want to do that to my kids."

"Rethinking falls. About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they now have (and of course managing this is all on me). Of course multiple people, including myself, had told them they needed a stair lift, but they didn't listen, because it was "too expensive." So much of the advice around aging is around preventing falls. And yes, they should be prevented if you want to keep living. But – and this is cold – we keep acting as though we want elderly people to live forever, and then as a society we don't support them, or us the caregivers. Falls are terrible and painful and I wish my mom hadn't had one. But it should have been the end. The EMTs should've come and said oh, sweetheart, this is terrible, we are giving you morphine. It is utterly crazy that she was in the hospital for so long and cost taxpayers well over \$1 million in Medicare, only to come home and require so much care and drain their finances and eventually go on Medicaid. I don't know what we do about this. When my mom fell, I felt like she almost subconsciously had done it on purpose. That summer she had been telling me how tired she was, and how she was ready to quit taking care of my dad, who is very demanding, and my disabled sibling (that's a whole other story). I was sure we were going to lose her and of course at the time I didn't want to but now I realize that would have been the natural thing. Figured you all would relate. I am not doing this to my kids."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 337 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

↳ **comment** (206): "This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

↳ **comment** (78): "My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

↳ **comment** (65): "Your poor mama. She is TIRED of dealing with your dad and sibling. The hospital, as awful as they can be, may have been a respite for her. Meals delivered. Her own bathroom. Mostly sweet staff. Poor you. You must be mentally exhausted on top of juggling THREE of them. The money drain is no lie. THREE DEPENDENTS in a two story house? How in the world? She's exhausted caregiving. She's probably been putting up with your difficult daddy with his demands all her life and you don't say when your sibling became disabled, but if it's been lifelong? Or since their 20's? That burns even saints out early. If they've qualified for Medicaid, can the house be sold and they go to skilled care or assisted senior living? Surely that would be cheaper than trying to maintain a home for three people needing 24 hour care."

"It's been a year since I quit my job and moved back home to care for my 79 year-old mom. I'm only 35... and I've gained more weight, I feel stuck sometimes. I feel like my life is on pause mode. I don't get to meet my friends anymore. I haven't been in a romantic relationship and cannot imagine meeting someone soon. My savings are dwindling... I wonder what will happen in the future. My siblings live in other countries and all have their own families to take care of. I love my mom, but we get into arguments sometimes. It gets really overwhelming to be alone in this journey. :("

youtube · @ri5876 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 241 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhKEw&lc=UgyoDoUxKO49e7lk3N4AaABAq>

↳ **@lynnnettemolinpersonalpage** (39): "Tell your siblings to take their turn. Living in another country is no excuse. You need a break. They can fly her to them to live or at the very least they can spend their vacation weeks living in your home so you can get regular breaks."

↳ **@aeromedical6750** (35): "@R I — I totally understand your situation because I live it. You feel trapped, because their caregiving needs always trump yours. Nothing satisfies my Mom right now. She's a sweet person, but totally self centered. My wife and I are constantly on guard that the next crises is right around the corner. Our lives revolve around her care needs 24/7."

↳ **@crimeariver8370** (29): "Im in the exact same boat as you. And just like you I also feel alone and trapped with no one to help take the edge off. So I totally feel ya."

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the

one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another

\$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"Day 3, my prayers were heard.. I swear some nurses are angels in disguise. For now, it's over... and I can finally breathe, shower, clean, whatever I need. My mom had a visiting nurse stop by today and I took that opportunity to tell her about the condition of the house and how there is no one to be there 24/7. She listened and reported it to the social worker. The social worker and the nurse called an ambulance and EMTs took her to a hospital. For the night at least, I can finally breathe. My alcoholic uncle is going off to rehab in another state on Monday. Now it is just me and my cousin and the animals here. I finally have peace for now. I actually laughed today. EDIT: update 9/20: The doctors at this new hospital were horrified with her treatment at the last hospital and she will NOT be coming home this time. She is going to a subacute rehab and will never return home. We are now suing the last hospital for medical malpractice."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 225 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfiyw/day_3_my_prayers_were_heard/

Care.com and the private hire · 340 documents

20 most engaged of 340 matching documents, complete text.

"I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets.. Edit everything I say here is for the USA. private pay insurance. I've worked for home health for around five years now and I want to share some of the good and bad I've learned so you can make an informed decision about the care for your aging parents. There are two kinds of home health care ones thst accept Medicare and one's that do not. The ones that do follow stricter guidelines for care (this doesn't mean they're better it just means they have to follow different rules than private insurance) my information only applies to those that do not take Medicare. First. It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour. So please don't act towards the caregivers like they should be doing \$50 an hour worth of work because they are not getting paid much above minimum wage. Second. Keep track of your loved ones need for care. If they fall and then need care or have a heart attack and need help after surgery. The agency is never ever going to tell you that the person is fine now and doesn't need care anymore. I go to several assignments where I do literally nothing the entire time I'm there just because no body says to stop sending us. Third. If you up the care from one kind to another temporarily after an injury or fall make sure that when you know they can go back down to less care that they return to charging you the lower rate. I've been to several assignments where I'm still being paid for hands on care even though all I'm doing is cleaning house. Fourth. Do not look at the caregivers like you would a cleaning crew That comes in and cleans as fast as they can to get done fast and move on to the next home. Caregivers are there for a set time so we are encouraged to sit and talk to our clients. Watch TV with them. Play games. Go for walks. We won't always be up doing things. We aren't someone who you hired to fix your toilet and now he's sitting on your couch. You hired us to take care of your loved one and sometimes that is just having a conversation or watching TV together. Fifth. Ask the caregiver what they need for the home and for the client. I went to an assignment last month that had no toilet paper in the whole house. The client was bedbound and used diapers so they just never thought to have toilet paper in the house. I literally had no way to wipe for the first day and I ended up bringing my own. Hand soap, paper towels, gloves, hand sanitizer all these things you are responsible for providing. Sixth. Understand that for the most part we are not nurses. Most states require little to no certifications to be a home health aide. So please understand the limitations of what we can/are allowed to do. We can't make medical decisions. We can't administer medicines. We can't change dressings. We can't even trim nails because if we cut you it could cause an infection. So please be very aware of what we are and are not allowed to do and don't ask or expect us to do something we aren't supposed to do. If you want any other advice ask it in the comments I'm happy to answer."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

↳ **comment** (363): "RN here and this is incredibly well written and all very true. Thank you for all you do. You ARE underpaid. Massively."

↳ **comment** (137): "It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients"cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception thst the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

↳ **comment** (94): "Thank you. I love my job but I am aware of it's downfalls."

"Finally lost my cool on my mom's nursing home roommate. For context, my mother is young for a nursing home. She has primary progressive MS and has been paralyzed since I was 4, quadraplegic since I was 10. I have helped to feed, clothe, take her to the bathroom, change tampons, be a human remote, etc. etc. since I was that young. I am now in my late thirties and in my early 30s we had no choice but to move her into assisted care because she requires 24/7 effort. She has little to no voice anymore either. This week was particularly difficult because I have been solo parenting my newly defiant toddler, and I had the stomach flu. I have very little caregiving support from my father who refuses to retire because he has been awful with money, and hence why my mom is in a medicare bed and not private pay (though we have to pay out of pocket like 1k a month.) My mom likes when I bring my 2.5 year old; it brings her joy. One thing she really likes to do is share her dinner with my daughter. She orders a separate PB&J for her, and usually the things my mom doesn't eat, my daughter will eat. My mom has severely disordered eating from the MS, and has to eat things in specific ways, and is extremely controlling. I have figured out that if the kid is eating, and I can feed my mom then it's a fine balance of time, but I am essentially a proxy human for two beings. My mom's roommate clearly some issues in addition to whatever her physical ailments are. She is large, bedridden, and just a SEE YOU NEXT TUESDAY. She loudly complains to her aids about me, and that they need to watch me and she doesn't like me. I have never said anything. Until today. Finally I stepped on the other side of the curtain when I heard her complaining about how I feed my daughter. She is convinced that I steal my mom's food to feed my daughter and that she is actually "looking out" for my mom. I lost it. My mom is alive because of me. Because of the many sacrifices I have made in my life to literally be her arms, legs, her voice, to make sure she is fed, to advocate for her. When random agency aid's came to our house they would steal money, jewelry, you name it, because I was a little kid, I couldn't do a single thing about it. But at the end of the day, I was constantly there for my mom. This lady struck my last nerve, after an incredibly difficult week where there was absolutely no one to look after me, or my health. I didn't swear at her or anything, and still tried to come from a place of empathy, but I still told her to mind her own business and respect me because she does not actually know what is happening. It was just so extremely disheartening. After everything I have done, that I still do, there is just nothing for me. There have been so many things that have beaten me down this year, I just feel like this the last thing. At the end of the day, I know I am lucky to be able bodied, to have my faculties, to be employed, to go home to a warm bed, with needy but loving animals and kid who is growing healthily and happily (despite being in a particularly whiney phase). She brings my mom joy, so I am going to keep going. Anyway, if you've made it this far. Thanks for listening. Trying to find empathy for others, but myself as well. But truth be told. I am fucking over it. I am just so goddamn over this disease and the absolute havoc it has wreaked on my life and my family's lives. It is unyielding."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1rs72w0/finally_lost_my_cool_on_my_moms_nursing_home/

"I think you need to just hire a private aide for overnight to have the 1:1 care he needs during that time and leave him in the assisted living. I don't think you will get everything you need by having him in an apartment with an aide 24/7. What we found was that the assistant living will oversee the private aide and the private aide will oversee the assisted living and they will rat each other out to you. Win-win. If you don't like the assisted living, then I would just move him to a better one and get an aide overnight. I don't think bringing him to a private apartment is a good thing with everything he has going on. I think that might be a dangerous move and the assisted living is set up already with accessible bathrooms and showers and other fall risk measures. No place is perfect, but you will have to do a LOT to the apartment to make it work like an assisted living."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of_oxjpqez/

"A Place for Mom is a waste of time. If on Medicaid. Just a disclaimer that after giving A Place for Mom my info to try to find a place for mom who is on Medicaid only, they cannot help. They only deal in private pay. If your LO does not have assets don't bother with APFM. Or at least that's my experience. DSHS was more of a help and that's mostly been giving me a long list of places that I have to research and call and tour. I'm burnt out. Haven't slept for days. Having APFM hound me the last 36 hours with calls because I was too busy to answer and go through their intake process to be told they can't help felt like another rug pulled out from under me. I'll admit I'm already in a defeated mood but as many others here feel, we need help and not run arounds."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 64 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1icxwp0/a_place_for_mom_is_a_waste_of_time_if_on_medicaid/

"Can we talk about how undervalued family caregivers are compared to agency supports?. This has been my experience at least. My partner and I care for an aging family member and the attitudes we routinely run into are deplorable. Our loved one has moderate/severe dementia which obviously requires a ton of work. Memory Care homes start at \$10k/month in our area. We are very lucky that our loved one is able to compensate us for the care we provide, but nowhere near \$10k a month. Yet, we play the roles of home health aid, CNA, case manager, Social Worker, transportation, advocate, chef, and so, so much more. As the dementia has progressed, we've obviously needed more supports. It started with my partner not working anymore to do the hands on care, and then I needed to move down from FT work and take a WFH position to manage all the background work and help with the hands on work. We were able to get a few hours a week of a home health aid, but it's still not enough and we are extremely burnt out after five years of this. My husband and I and our loved one all have varying degrees of health issues that are not cheap. If you do the math, my husband and I are compensated maybe 1/4 of minimum wage for all the time we put in. And yet, so many people that we speak to act like the income should be enough to cover all needs and pay for private caregiving/respite, and we are just somehow being greedy. It makes me so angry. No one says that a private caregiver wanting minimum wage is greedy. No one says that a case manager wanting compensated for overtime is greedy. No one questions the outrageous costs of Memory Care homes (that don't even include medical care costs such as medication and other copays). But because we are family we should somehow just be grateful for what we have and be able to do everything ourselves, without proper sleep, without breaks, without any real respite. It makes me so angry. I don't deny that we are luckier than many in that we are able to be at all compensated, but I'm so tired of being treated like crap because we are family and are expected to be able to do everything ourselves with out asking for help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ai7fdz/can_we_talk_about_how_undervalued_family/

↳ **comment** (32): "I caregive for 3 people, my mom and 2 teenage sons with autism. I was trying to get an agency to have a caregiver come to at least help with my mom, but they require a minimum 20 hours a week at \$37 an hour. And they absolutely refuse to help with anyone else in the house, so it would have been just for my mom. I wish I could restrict my caregiving to just 1 person! So with that math, I should be getting paid \$114 an hour (37 x 3 people) and at 40 hours a week (which is generous because obviously I pull overtime every day) that's like \$18k a month! Over \$200 grand a year! I should be in a freaking mansion driving a Jaguar."

↳ **comment** (16): "You know what else I recently discovered about how undervalued we are? I was looking at physician assistant grad programs and one of the requirements is having worked or volunteered in some sort of healthcare related role, such as a CNA or volunteer EMS. Looking at the lists, caregiving for a stranger for pay or on a volunteer basis counts as top tier experience. Doing the same exact thing for a friend or family member does NOT COUNT AT ALL. Like wtf? Adds insult to injury if you want or need to make a career change after dropping out of the workforce to care give and maybe trying to use your experience to to do so but because it's for family, even if paid, that experience counts for nothing when doing the exact same thing for a stranger is considered top notch experience. So you can't even get into the program despite everything else as a result. In my opinion, that's

just such a big FU to family caregivers by the system. Family caregivers do, manage and learn so much more than a stranger that comes in for a few hours a week but that's just worthless apparently."

↳ **comment** (15): "Ha! We really should all be in mansions driving Jaguars. Imagine if we got to demand any semblance of expectations of our work environment (I won't clean, I'll only take care of one person, I won't change diapers, etc), or any sort of wage! It's laughable. \$37/hour?!?! Even if you're able to get paid as an IHSS worker for your family member, that's only minimum wage! It's so backwards! Why are we putting all of this funding into strangers caring for family. Why aren't we working harder to make sure family has the ability to care for family??? It makes no logical sense! It reminds me of how in Foster Care, you used to only be able to get monthly assistance if you were a non-related Foster Parent. So if you were a stranger, you'd get a decent monthly check and a number of other benefits to help care for the child. But if you were family, even an Aunt twice removed, you'd get *nothing!!!* We finally changed the laws when we realized that outcomes for foster kids were so much worse with strangers vs family, but it took way too long. I can only hope that things will eventually change when it comes to caregiving for family."

"This really hits close to home. My parents are (were) both the same age as yours. My dad had a stroke 8 years ago and lost his speech and the ability to use his right arm. Mom and I were the primary caretakers. She was diagnosed with ALS in October of '24 and died in May of '25. I was caretaking two parents from October of '24 until her death and have been caretaking dad since her passing while working a full time job (swing shifts in heavy manufacturing). Life. It is exhausting. I really feel for you. But if there is any solace, just know you aren't doing this alone. It may feel that way, but there are others out there just like you who have these same burdens. For us, we have relied on help from aunts and a hired caretaker. Every so often we get a meal from an unexpected friend or neighbor. Mostly though, people tend to forget. Life goes on after someone passes - and that happens disgustingly fast. Hell, my mother's own sister (with whom she was really close) hasn't even bothered to show up to our house once this past year. She says "it is too painful". No shit, Sherlock. Think it is easy walking into the house I had to watch my mom die in? Just to have to do chores and clean and cook and pay bills? You are in survival mode. At this point, just focus on the minutes and the hours, not the days and the weeks. Stay as present as possible. One day this will no longer be your burden and you will have the weight of guilt alleviated from your shoulders because you will know that you did everything you could for your father. Use whatever resources you have to cast a wide net - family, friends, coworkers, etc. See if you can find an aide to come to the house that you can pay under the table. Cash. They might not be able to give you 12 hours (maybe they can) but even if they can give you 8 hours, you take that. If your father is on Medicare / Medicaid, exhaust every option for in-home health care possible. Set up a routine with other family who might be able and willing to help ("Aunt Suzie brings dinner every Tuesday, Uncle Mike stays with dad every other Friday for 4 hours"). Most importantly - get into counseling. Seriously. Do it. When I shifted into caretaker mode my mental health went to absolute shit. I've always struggled with anxiety, but those months broke me. I ended up in the hospital due to a massive panic attack that I thought was a heart attack. You got this."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 39 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok82xgl/

"Mom is starting to ask for money. My mom is 58, lives in upstate NY about 40 minutes outside the capital, has two knee replacements, and lost her car recently due to someone crashing into her. She is in the process of paying off the trailer that she lives in with the SSD check she gets for her knees, but the SSD doesn't even cover all her monthly living costs so she MUST seek other sources of income. My mom is a very kind person, but can have some trouble controlling her emotions sometimes (crying and anger) if u challenge her. It's very much like she doesn't know how to argue with you or stand up for herself. I go through things very nicely with her and have learned to not be too harsh with her so that we can get through the whole convo without her shutting down or running away. She has worked in the past while raising me and my 5 siblings working at wal-mart, an aid at an old folks home ,

and some private duty health care cases which led to her knee replacements, while my dad (now deceased) was a stay at home father. For the past few years she has been Doordashing (yes another Doordashing grandmother) so when she got in the car accident and her car was totalled, that took away a lot of her independence. My mom has had a really hard time keeping jobs that involve people interaction, she cannot handle interpersonal conflict, so my attempts to warn her that Doordashing isn't a long term solution for work have gone unheard, but now here we are where she now has 0 income. She has been babysitting for my sister lately (who is a nurse and makes pretty good money) so it is kinda beneficial for her n my sister. My sister n my mom don't get along all THAT well so that does make things a bit trickier at times but I won't get into that. The area in which my mom lives is not all that close to any public transit so it's very hard for her to get anywhere unless she takes a very expensive ride share, or someone comes to pick her up. For the past couple of years she will randomly throw out giving up on paying Hey afternoon...I have venmo, Just in wondering if you can lend me 40 for some groceries. Hoping your day is a good one her trailer mortgage and getting an apartment instead, and then I have to remind her how expensive that is (pretty much same price) and that is objectively a really bad idea (though I know trailers themselves are generally a bad idea to start with). Me and my sister (who my mom babysits for) keep pretty good communication and she told me some weeks ago she felt my mom was hinting she needed money and my sister just gave it to her at no cost. I told my sister to try to stay away from that as I don't want my mom becoming dependent on that. Then just three days ago my mom seems me the following message "Hey afternoon...I have venmo, Just in wondering if you can lend me 40 for some groceries. Hoping your day is a good one Thank you in advance" Now I don't think my mom realizes thanking me in advance is kinda rude I think she thinks it's nice because she is thanking me, and for the most part she just isn't great with words, but she is great at showing love. And expressing gratitude. I told her I would get back to her (I had some things going on) and two days later I did but she didn't answer or call back so day three I got a hold of her and told her I don't mind giving her \$40, and I want to make sure she knows she can ask me in the future if she is in need, but that I want to stay away from situations where she is so down on money she needs to borrow \$40 to eat. She told me she would get by and to not worry about it. I sent it to her anyway and just reiterated where I stood on the matter. I'm currently making 48,000 / yr, am single and live on the west coast so money is tight and for that there is no end in sight. Idk if anyone has been through a similar situation, though it sounds like some have after reading through these threads, but I am looking for any advice , resources, tips, tricks, etc., u name it to support and guide my mother. ADDENDUM: Mom makes \$300-\$320 / week babysitting 36 hours for my sister. Me and my siblings can throw together some money monthly for her but none of us are in particularly good financial situations ourselves: *In order of Age* Me 37 - Seattle, WA - \$48k/yr Contractor inside Google - Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science Brother 35 - Albany, NY Unknown Salary (low) Landscaper Sister 33 - Albany, NY ~39,520/yr - Associates Degree in Business -Straddled single mother of 3 living in public house, also very much in need of constant help, and is always stressed out Sister 31 - Albany, NY Registered Nurse Salary, so decent - Nursing Degree -Thank God has a boyfriend who works and helps support her and the kids. Brother 30 - Albany, NY Unknown Salary (low) Restaurant Worker Sister 30 - Albany, NY \$28K/yr Has some emotional issues, lives in public housing, has had the same job for like 10 years though (she may be poor, but she isn't a slacker)"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 35 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1d03z5h/mom_is_starting_to_ask_for_mon](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1d03z5h/mom_is_starting_to_ask_for_money/)
ey/

↳ **comment** (76): "Your mother isn't that old but she is in bad health and physical shape and I imagine will only get more so. It also doesn't sound like she has much saved for retirement. You have 5 siblings, and now sounds like a good time to start talking amongst yourselves about what your mother's future will look like and how much you are each going to be able to contribute to fund it, if you can. A disabled elderly woman in a more isolated area with no vehicle who mainly has a history of blue collar jobs is going to have an increasingly hard time surviving on her own. Babysitting is a stop gap measure. So is Door Dash, assuming she can get another car. So are various government programs, maybe some kind of local church outreach for food or transportation. But the writing is on the wall here and that will only go so far before the next set of medical problems kick in, and they will, especially if she already has mobility issues and is scrimping and begging just to get food to eat. I know you don't want her

reliant on you if she doesn't have to be, but are you as a family really OK with letting her sink into poverty and hunger in her twilight years? Is there a possibility of a family stipend just to cover food and some basic bills? Life is hard for everyone right now but I am sure your mother is stressed as hell about everything and ignoring her for days when she asks for some help with groceries does not seem ideal. If there's no money and no work then either she goes hungry or she starts running up huge credit card bills, neither of which is a great option. If she is wasteful or lazy in general then there's a question of how much you want to subsidize that lifestyle, but if she's a hardworking person whose health has broken down after a lifetime of shit jobs and raising 6 kids then it might be time to start thinking about how your extended family can give back and help her. Bills are definitely a lot more manageable when split between 6 or 7 people."

↳ **comment** (32): "This has so many layers to the relationship and honestly, as someone who is in the same boat, I resent it greatly. The main aspect of it is that you are now the parent. She is a grown woman but can't take care of herself so you now have a dependent you did not ask for. What do your other siblings do? You should all split it if that is what's going to happen. If she is consistently short on money and you all agree to help it could be like \$200/month (\$40 each of you) and that would be all you are giving her. Make her budget and stick to it. This means you are also not getting something for yourself that you worked for so that will also cause resentment. You also might be grieving having a functional parent. I have recently realized that is one of the things I have - I wish I had good parents who were self-sufficient and can be there for their kids but that is not going to happen for me and I need to give it up. I am also a walking ATM for my parent who just calls me and tells me she NEEDS. She doesn't ask or thank, anymore. I basically give her an allowance. Is it messed up? Yes, but just doing it, not arguing about it is for my mental health. I rather pay than talk to her or discuss stuff. Good luck, hope you are able to split the cost with your siblings."

↳ **comment** (6): "none of us would let her sink into poverty, if it came down to it I would move back to NY just to stabilize the situation. Part of the problem is the majority of my siblings and extended family are also pretty impoverished. My nurse sister probably has the best chance at owning a house but prior to that my maternal side of the family hasn't owned a house or land in 3 or more generations. Also just to clarify I didn't ignore her but life was really busy for a couple of days and without her explicitly stating she is starving I didn't rush to call her. I think these are some good options you propose and we may very well have to invoke some or all of them I just don't want her leaning into support if she is capable of taking care of herself, which I believe she is."

"Hiring Help Causing Anxiety?. Have any of you experienced this? I have hired help from Care.com to help with my mother's bed bath. The people are ok. They get burnt out and I have to replace them after a while. However, I noticed recently that I feel a sense of irritation, or anxiety on the days they come. To the point I want to drink. I figured it because I don't want to be bothered...but caregiving in itself is to be constantly bothered. And it actually helps all in all. Maybe resentment for having to spend the money? Or shame I'm not enough? Just wanted to see if anyone has experienced this."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1fntqww/hiring_help_causing_anxiety/

"30 days to find a place for Mom and Dad. Through a number of factors, some due to bad decisions on my parents' part, and some due to things out their control, their money has been running out. They've been in a non-profit Personal Care home (not Medicaid approved) for the last 18 months. I've been trying to make up the shortfall in the rent each month but I'm partially disabled myself and it's really not possible. For six months I've been calling all sorts of nursing homes. Either they don't call back, they don't have Medicaid beds, or they require years of private pay before the resident can switch to Medicaid. If we can't afford \$3000 to make up the shortfall, we certainly can't afford \$15,000 for two people in nursing care. I've been asking everyone - the facility, Council on Aging, other agencies, EVERYONE! for help in finding a place for them. People talk like they'll help but nothing really happens. Now the worst has happened - Mom & Dad's facility is evicting them. I have until April 30th to

find them somewhere. Finally, the facility sent some referrals, but so far, only one place has offered two beds. A tour revealed it to be a true Hell Hole, reeking so badly of urine and feces that hours later my hair still smelled of it, unclean and dingy, no chairs or couches (residents expected to just be in wheelchairs - my parents use walkers), just AWFUL. What do I do? WHAT DO I DO?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1jmmomg/30_days_to_find_a_place_for_mom_and_dad/

"Keeping my aunt in her home with 24/7 care cost \$350,000 for that last year, even with family helping as we could and a paid-off home. (Plus the logistics of daily things like groceries, paying the standard bills, house and yard maintenance, medical transport for appointments, etc.) I wouldn't do it again if given the choice. A private aide for overnight sounds much more practical."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxjx8p3/

"DONE!. Just need to vent. I've posted before on this forum, but it's been awhile. My brother and I are only siblings. Mom spent almost 2 years in the nursing home, with a year and a half on PRIVATE PAY, thanks to my brother, who lived with her and was "supposedly" taking care of her. He took care of Dad and Mom ALL THEIR lives, not because they needed him all those years, but because he needed them. They supported him completely and he bought expensive items with his own money (found out later, PLUS some) on a disability check after working 7 years total, at menial jobs. Our mom did everything for him, even washed his hair! She thought the ground he walked on was holy. Anyway, he ended up basically mooching off them all his life, under the pretext of "taking care" of them. Dad passed away almost 20 years ago. Mom lived to be 102, passed last fall. Just suffice it to say that hoarding was a nice (although nowhere near accurate) description of what he did. He basically piled up TWO houses, ruining them BOTH in the process and causing the tax assessed value to drop to 1/3 of the original value. He basically didn't want to do anything I suggested to get the estate deeded to him legally because he was simply too lazy. The second house caused a real problem with her Medicaid eligibility (which my husband and I had tried to discuss with Mom 10-15 years ago, after Dad passed). I said Brother could have it all, I didn't want anything. He ended up ruining Mom financially, and as you can tell from the tax reassessment I had done, wrecked the entire place. I tried reporting to APS, but they never even went inside, and seemed fine with empty beer cans and junkers (8 of those) scattered across the back yard). I eventually had to take over everything to fix her over-drafted bank accounts (with my own funds) and close them out...that even made Bro mad. I eventually just took over because he was lying and hiding bills and letters, almost got Mom evicted for her private pay not being paid...nursing home billing office manager called me, which was the first I was aware. Bro didn't want to deal with the mess he had made, which ended up being dumped on me and my husband...trying to clear out the houses to salvage what we could (FOR my Bro) because once Mom ran out of money, he ran out of money, so he managed to get admitted to the nursing home for leg issues from a car accident in his 20's (he refused all doctor visits for 40 years)...he then said he couldn't walk one night. Since he lived with Mom, even that almost messed up her Medicaid. But eventually I got her Medicaid approved, then she passed two months later. The proceeds from the estate went toward her private pay bill, which did not even cover all of it because Bro hid his head in the sand for all that time, lied, etc. Anyway, he got mad at me about 4 months ago and cursed at me in a text. I ignored it but all he would ever talk about in his texts was the young female aides, and the personal intimate care they were giving him, and he refuses to allow male aides to care for him. I finally told him I really didn't want to hear all that "drama"...I did not feel it appropriate. Never once did he text without going into those sorts of details. He mentioned his showers and his underwear and "wetting" himself every single text. We found porn tapes hidden while salvaging his possessions for him. He has a fake FB page that popped up (he didn't even change his name!) with erotic pictures of young female nurses and teachers. He has a history of ...obsession, I'll call it. Previously on his FB page, he said he was in a relationship with someone he had obviously met on the internet. He has done everything within his power to report the older female staff and asked for the younger ones to replace them for his

personal care. Now let me say that he has been having chest pain and high BP, yet what he got mad about was I mentioned seeing OTC testosterone supplements peeking out his bedside table one day...when they told him he wasn't supposed to be taking them, they said that I had "reported" it. So he got very angry. I said, "Fine, let him have an MI. See if I care." I will also add that he has NEVER, to my knowledge, had a normal relationship, never been married, is 73 years old, slow mentally, and is a nursing home resident! He texted 3 weeks or so ago and said he has lung cancer. He had had a CT scan during an ER visit for high BP and chest pain, and supposedly the hospital had sent him a letter informing him he has lung cancer. Concerned, I drove up to the nursing home that evening. I know that is not the process for patient notification. He showed me the letter and it said he had a couple of nodules that showed up, but most are benign, and his PCP may want to follow up. He argued with me that that meant he has cancer. He also said the nurse had told him he has a huge mass in his stomach. He finally gave me permission to speak with the nurse...I have a healthcare background. The nurse couldn't believe he said that...she said she had explained what "benign" means and had explained the follow-up process to him, and told him his stomach is fine...no mass was even mentioned. So I tried to explain to him, but couldn't tell if he understood. I sent him a text that evening from home explaining it simply and told him if he has questions, he can ask the nurse or me. Nothing from him. So I said, "Or maybe you want me to butt out". Nothing. He hasn't spoken to me in weeks. And he never answered me. He cursed me out one time lately in a text over the testosterone supplement so I just left him alone to chill for awhile. Next thing he texted, "Can you bring my computer"...the one still in the unopened box he ordered two years ago that we salvaged for him from the piles of hoarded stuff. I took it to him, with his mail that he still gets at Mom's PO box. He accused me of not caring anything about him. I said he hadn't answered me. Oh, I was supposed to know that his "phone isn't working" and I should have called and asked the nurse to bring him the phone from the desk. WHAT? How was I supposed to know his phone "isn't working" (which I think is a lie) because he said the typos were due to his phone issue, NOT to HIM! Well, it all got out of hand and he was saying that I was a KNOW IT ALL and I should have checked on him (I asked why he didn't check on US- BECAUSE HIS PHONE WASN'T WORKING!) Claimed I didn't visit Mom or call about her when she was in the hospital...I said, I DID call! We couldn't even get our special needs daughter through Mom's house, and that was before he completely trashed it. Oh no you didn't! I said How would YOU know? Oh, HE knows! And then accused me of being just like Daddy and said he couldn't stand Daddy. I told him I loved our dad, and he said that was just because I didn't know because HE was the one living with them. Like yeah, ALL his life. I didn't intend to, but I finally told him he trashed everything and the place was a pigsty. And, predictably, that was because "he was taking care of Mom in the nursing home!". If I had had the presence of mind, I would have asked him why he managed to endure his hatred for our dad for all those years when Dad was putting a roof over his head and food on the table. At one point, he raised up as if to hit me. I absolutely will not tolerate that and I told him so. (And a very unsettling thing when I entered his room... I don't want to be too graphic here, but he is always lying down in bed, and today he had a blanket over his lower body and there was some suspicious movement down there. But I didn't. I just told him I won't be back, and he said, "Good!". So I'm done. I talked to nursing and the case manager and told them what happened and that I hated I lost my temper because it was not my intention to upset him. The case manager said he has already asked them to remove me as emergency contact from his chart. And they said he has been in one of his complaining moods all day anyway. I do feel bad about losing my temper and I know I could have just exited the room. It was like my feet were glued to the floor. I really didn't mean to upset him but I just won't take his accusations. I really no longer care what he thinks of me. He can bad-mouth me to the staff and say whatever he wants. I think I have come to the conclusion that he is crazy and always has been. He has become agitated lately (IMO) because two of the female aides who he literally talked about all the time were fired. I just don't go in for all that drama. But I think it might have unhinged him. Well, more than usual... But I do have to be honest in that I can't stand to be in the same room with him. I don't know if it is possible to disown a brother, but I am DONE! I'll try to forgive him again, but I'm not there yet after him yelling SHUT UP to me today. And no I don't think he has dementia. I think he's just a selfish little B__ST__D that my mom coddled all his life. I'm not his Mom."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uk7ylh/done/>

"Finding In-Home Care for Mom. * TLDR - What is a realistic cost and expectation for home care for Mom, and what's an easy solution for finding it? Mom is 70. She was diagnosed with dementia about 3 years ago, but the likelihood is that she started developing it about 5-6 years ago. She's originally from the Midwest, but came to live with my partner and me on the West Coast about 2.5 years ago... due to there not really being any other workable family options available where she was living, or elsewhere for that matter. We're happy to have her. She's peaceful. She's personable. She's in good physical health for her age. But she struggles with short-term memory issues, and cannot retain new information. She doesn't know her phone number or address. Most of the time, she still thinks she lives somewhere in the Midwest near where she grew up. She can't drive anymore. She can't cook for herself. She gets frightened to be home alone for more than 2-3 hours at a time. As a result, my partner and I get very little "us time" and haven't been away together on a vacation or longer term outing in over 3 years. I feel like Mom is the perfect candidate for some part-time, in-home care... which would give her some social interaction outside of just us... and also give us a little more away time to catch our breath and reset, and bond more than we've been able to recently given our caretaker responsibilities. We're not destitute by any stretch, and Mom has some money to help with the cost of in-home care, but realistically... anything over like \$1,500 per month would be difficult. She's on Medicare not Medicaid, so my understanding is that there's not really an option for an insurance contribution here for in-home care. I feel like that's a reasonable budget, but I'm also in my 40s and still think twenty bucks is a lot of gas. So I just don't know. I've posted a couple ads on care.com in the past couple years, but the responses I get are overwhelming, disorganized, and a lot to process. My partner and I both work busy jobs and it's difficult to set aside hours per day for a week at a time to meet people and respond to messages, and make phone calls, to no real conclusion. That may sound bad. But we just haven't had the mental energy to pursue it as we should. In a perfect world, I'd love to find someone to sit with her 15-20 hours per week, just to give us a couple nights out. How realistic is my budget for this? Are there agencies that handle this sort of thing? An agency would seem to be the perfect scenario... I suppose I just worry about cost... or whether someone would even take her if she's not on Medicaid. I guess I just need some help or advice, or even a pep talk. One of my biggest concerns is finding a situation with the highest likelihood of landing a consistent, reliable, GOOD part-time caregiver. One of the reasons I gave up on care.com so easily is that I felt like I was going to be posting ads and looking for new people every month or two. Help? Thoughts? If you've found a decent in-home caregiver situation for a loved one, will you give me some pointers?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1bvecp3/finding_inhome_care_for_mom/

"I also happen to be a nurse who worked in memory care units, assisted living, skilled nursing homes, hospice, and private duty home care for 20 years. Thank you, OP, for posting this and offering your expertise! Regarding the driving, I agree with disabling the car in a simple way. My brother in law disconnected the battery of his mom's car. He told her that their good friend, a mechanic, was going to check it out when he had time. Of course, that wasn't going to happen, and she didn't remember the answer each time she asked him again. My grandmother got permission to park my grandpa's car at their church and told him she'd loaned it to the church because they needed it. Eventually he forgot about the car, and she sold it."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okuzcpa/

"She will be kicked off Medicaid, spend through all the money, then have to go back on Medicaid. I made some rough calculations and and she would be private pay for about a year."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nqewid/relative_didnt_sign_her_will/ng79exq/

"Yes, this is crazy. you are being naive both about the cost and the reality of caring for a person who's at end of life, in the home setting. It sounds to me like the decision to look into moving him is driven more by the families discomfort and concern for cost, rather than looking at the whole picture and that's (respectfully) a disservice to both parties. The bottom line here is that *something* prompted a move to ALF in the first place and at the stage he's at now, that issue is only more pronounced, more complicated and more difficult to handle. It's very easy to think that it would be cheaper and "better" to place him in an apartment and hire private care but who's coordinating all that? Who's ensuring that he's not just left for 24 hours if no one shows up? Who's ensure medications are taken and not diverted? Who's grocery shopping for the food that'll be needed? Who's covering his care if the agency can't? Hospice is supplemental care, so they won't be covering any of this (med diversion, not withstanding). They don't administer meds, or provide coverage if your private duty care can't come. Home care is SIGNIFICANTLY more taxing on the family. **The national average is \$35/hr for UNSKILLED (private duty care) \$35/720hr is \$25,200 PLUS \$3000 in rent. Your total is likely close to 30k a month.** NONE of this includes the cost of unpaid mental and emotional labor that goes along with the undertaking or the cost of any loss wages for family. My suggestion to you is to: 1. hire a 1:1 sitter for overnights and speak to hospice about symptom medication management. It's possible that he's in pain or uncomfortable and that's what he's getting up or he may be experiencing some sort of hallucinations that cause him to get up. 2. You can also ask the facility for more frequent checks if they aren't doing them already. 3. They can also put on a bed alarm (NOT bed rails) a pressure alarm that will go off if he gets up to alert staff that he's up and may need assistance. 4. Get a care plan meeting with your family, the facility and hospice to all get on the same page and discuss any concerns and create a plan for going forward. Best of luck"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 13 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxjz531/

"Mentally Slipping healthy mom. My mom (77) is quite healthy and capable. She lives alone and I take her grocery shopping once a week. Except, over a year ago, she had a minor stroke and experienced deafness in one ear and short term memory loss. The memory loss has been frustrating because she can't learn anything new or adapt to anything that she hasn't been doing her whole life. Now her hearing has significantly declined in the other ear rendering her mostly deaf. She has had a caption phone for a year but never used it because she preferred her cel phone. When her hearing declined to the point that she couldn't hear us on the phone, she would call everyone in the family 8 times a day(or night) saying "can you hear me?" and then hang up. I took her cel phone away to force her to use the caption phone which she is now very slowly adapting to. But she can't hear it ring, won't remember that the flashing light means it's ringing, can't hear her doorbell, fire alarm, the toilet running, etc. The water company called yesterday because her toilet had been running long enough that it caught the attention of the water company. She has no assets, gets \$2,170/month in Social Security, I own her condo and she pays the fees and utilities, which are maybe \$1,400/month. So she can live this way financially forever. But her hearing, memory and cognitive decline are worrying us. Everyone says she shouldn't live alone for safety reasons, but we have no room in our home, I travel 2-3 weeks a month for work and my wife is a full time teacher. Plus we have a dog that my mom hates being around. We agree it's a safety issue especially now that she can't hear a smoke alarm. But with no way to afford private pay memory care that costs 2-3x her monthly income, do we force her into a nasty medicaid paid nursing home life sharing a room and being treated like a hospital patient for the next 10+ years? She takes no medication, has no health issues otherwise, showers, dresses herself, cooks, does her laundry, takes out the trash, etc. Assisted living/memory care would be an ideal situation, but she can't afford it with no savings to spend down. No AL will touch her in our area (S.FL) without a year of private pay at 2x her income. I know this is a rare case because my mom didn't go the medical route her whole life so now is still quite healthy, but hearing/cognition is her limiting factor. My wife and kids along with her neighbors and every home health aide that has seen her agrees she shouldn't live alone. But the nursing home alternative seems cruel. Meeting with an elder care attorney in two weeks to navigate the 8 month anticipated medicaid waiver application process that will then start the hunt for a needle in a haystack nursing home that will agree to take her without

sucking six figures in private pay first. So I anticipate her nursing home options will likely be 2/5 star type places at best. I always warned my parents that they needed to save. but they thought Jesus would return before they retired. Not sure if I have any question per se. More of a scream into the void of our family's particular situation. Knowing that there are no other options for her and dealing with the guilt of not being able to provide a better last season of life for someone who provided a great childhood for me. Paid for my college, helped with childcare while our kids were young, etc. But now has become a real drain on my time and our family emotionally. Especially now that I also recently started dealing with my MIL (80) who we just moved into my mom's same condo complex and have to manage her finances and dozens of doctor appointments, groceries, etc. At least my MIL has her hearing and doesn't call at 3:00am saying "can you hear me?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 12 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpymwb/mentally_slipping_healthy_mom/

"Today is my FIRST DAY with a person coming in. We're paying \$30/hr to an agency I considered care.com but for \$5/hr more i don't have to interview anyone or any of that legwork I'm nervous. I'm imagining this is similar to what parents feel on the first night away from the baby?"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okuadt/

"My aunt who is a former nurse recently told me that if my Mom gets admitted to a hospital and then goes to rehab again (where Medicare pays for 30 days), then I should give the required 30 days notice at her current private pay memory care place and ask the rehab to help me find a place that takes Medicaid where she can go when she's discharged. She's got about 2 years worth of money left so I still have time to start filling out the Medicaid application but I will definitely have to move her at some point because it's private pay and I can't care for her. My MIL is also in a Medicaid paid skilled nursing memory care right now, she was sent there from a hospital and they found the bed for her. I think part of the problem might be that your hospital doesn't want to help you find a place. My sister just had a full knee replaced and the hospital was supposed to set up her physical therapy but discharged her without it. She had to wait 4 WEEKS to start therapy. When her surgeon recently found out about how long she had to wait to start, she was pissed. In reality they should have sent her to rehab vs going home if they couldn't find a physical therapist to go to her home the following week. I'm guessing they also didn't want to bother to find her a rehab facility to go to. So maybe the hospital is short staffed and too busy to have someone earnestly work on it? Did they give you a list of places they called? Ask for it!! Then make some calls to those places yourself and ask about availability. MOST IMPORTANTLY, Call your OMBUDSMAN and Medicaid. Your Ombudsman has clout! Tell them what's going on. Whatever you do, DO NOT GO PICK HER UP. Please update us on the progress you make and I hope you'll find a place soon."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/113ykoe/hospital_trying_to_discharge_demented_mother_in/j8wkuvvm/

"It is going to be a major pain but you could also look at it as your mom is going to be able to pay for her care, my mom had assets enough that she never went on Medicaid but paid for her care for years and had Medicare for healthcare. It was expensive but not horrible or unmanageable and we felt like it was the right way to go- for her to use her assets to cover her care. We still ended up with a chunk of change after she died and never for a minute thought that the state owed her care. Maybe you can find a nice place for her that accepts primarily private pay- my mom lived her last few years in a beautiful Adult Family Home with a view of a little lake and decent caregiver to resident ratio."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nqewid/relative_didnt_sign_her_will/ng6cb4s/

"We used them, they gave us 3 places and I did the research on reviews and ratings, toured them all spoke to Director of Nursing and staff on the unit. We chose one and she's been there for 2 yrs now. It's not cheap but their staff have all worked there for years and she's always clean, has a private room that's always spotless and her weight stabilized pretty quickly. These were all Private Pay Places and perhaps that made the biggest difference but from what I've heard that's pretty much what they deal with. They get paid by the facilities."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1d55k9e/friendly_warning_do_not_use_a_place_for_mom/l6k6uis/

Adult day care and respite · 237 documents

20 most engaged of 237 matching documents, complete text.

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations: Youre so strong Translation: Youre on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are theyre really saying theyre not going to help you. Theyre admiring your ability to handle it so they dont have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow youre so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. Were just surviving it because theres no other option. I dont need your theology. I need respite care. I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. Theyd watch me help my mom with everything then say I dont know how you do it and leave. If you dont know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Dont stand there marveling at my survival skills like Im some interesting specimen. Im doing this because I dont have a choice and you wont help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: Im going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you wont ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person were caring for so we can sleep. Dont make us ask. Ive got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. Theres more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If youre a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity... you dont need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say Im coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. Thats the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): ""enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and

who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists,

tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking kilns, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement than means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!???" Seriously, I'm done. I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed

and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house (front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"PSA if your parent(s) is a veteran. My dad had been out of the military over 40+ years when my parents moved in with me. I became super stressed about finances (we also cared for my grandmother.) A bumble match (of all things) mentioned he got military disability pay for an ankle injury sustained in service. I mentioned that my dad wasn't injured, even though he served for 28 years and in Vietnam. The bumble guy advised me to request my dad's service records and see if something was there. In the meantime, I read about the PACT act for wartime (even modern war) veterans. Long story short: I filed for my dad under the Pact Act (didn't even need the military records) and got my dad (and mom) full disability monthly payment, aid & attendance monthly payment, caregiver support payment for me (or anyone we designate), 30 days respite care for me, 20 hours a week caregiver coming to the house. No property tax for the house as long as my parents live there... it ended up being another \$7k mo + the caregiver. It was quite a bit of paperwork, took 6mos for disability, 8mos for caregiver support, and 10mos for aid and attendance but it was worth it. Also, if you are a veteran taking care of a non-veteran parent, you can also qualify for programs. Moral of the story: if your parent is a veteran (especially war era) see what they qualify for!! I never went on a date with the Bumble guy, but boy was that 'swipe right' match worth it!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 171 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l9w918/psa_if_your_parents_is_a_veteran/

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play stardew valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion*"

type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many posts and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because feebreeze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Grandmother is now refusing AL or moving in with other family. I'm done caregiving and have plans to move. WTF do I do now?. I've taken care of my 96yr old grandma since I was 19/20 and am now 31yrs old. She's gone from being wholly independent aside from needing assistance going to appointments to now being mobile for short periods with a walker but has the majority of her mental faculties if not extremely emotionally needy and depressed. The last week after her release from a SNF from a fall she has either barely gotten out of bed or been trying go outside and dig up her garden when I'm not home and at work (neighbors called to let me know). She's going to seriously hurt herself but doesn't seem to care. I am at the end of my rope and ability to take care of her. The last time she fell I could not physically pick her up. I've already lost a ogreat job because of her constantly calling me to come home because she's "sick" and needs to go the ER (she's not, we waste 6+hrs to be told she's perfectly fine every single time), and am in danger of losing my current one for the same reason. I have to be present at home for any other person that stops by whether it's her friends or family visiting or scheduled appointments because she won't answer the door otherwise and she refuses any attempts for me to get respite because she won't go to daycares or senior events that would allow me to do so. So I'm essentially tethered to her anytime I'm not at work. We're at the point where she is only slowly deteriorating and not getting any better while I am no longer eating or sleeping and my own mental health has gotten bad enough my doctors are concerned for me. Neither of us can sustain this. I've spoken with other family that are planning a visit this week to either take her home with them or find an AL or nursing home ASAP. They are very aware that I cannot handle any more and need relief. My bags are actively being packed and I have a place to move to as soon as she's taken care of. Grandma was okay with this progression and change up until today (though obviously not happy about it) when suddenly it's become "oh we'll hire someone to come in and help" and "I'm staying at home or you get nothing". She's insistent we're both staying right here and that's just not happening. I don't care about anything willed to me when she passes anymore. Maybe it makes me a terrible person but I cannot do this any longer. I don't have POA, her son's does (the one coming this week) and she is otherwise still in charge of her own medical decisions.

Obviously we can't force her into a facility but if I'm not stopping my plans to leave, what do we do? Do I just leave and let the chips fall if she won't allow herself to be moved somewhere? I spent today feeling like I was arguing with a toddler trying to get across to her that the train is leaving the station and she's not listening."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1np0dlg/grandmother_is_now_refusing_al_or_moving_in_with/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"When you are the live in caregiver and need a break. I am the live in caregiver for my 83 year old mother. Out of her 3 children it made sense for me to take on that role. I'm divorced, no children and have a career that only requires me to go to the office one day per week. I cook, clean, and handle general household management. My mom is still fine regarding personal care and has decent mobility. So when mom decided she needed help four years ago I closed my business where I was, packed up my life and pets and moved across country to move back into my childhood home. My sister lives several states away and my brother is nearby and will come if called but is not a regular part of our lives. We rarely speak to one another and there are very deep unresolved family issues, many caused by my mother's refusal to parent properly when we were young. My SIL is always telling me if I need help to ask. I usually have things pretty well under control. However, I'm starting to notice a cognitive decline in my mom where she is becoming more negative and argumentative than usual. I have taken no time for myself since I moved in. The longest I've been away during that time was a two night business trip, which my mother was not happy about. Recently a friend invited me to go on a vacation with her and her daughter. I floated the idea to my mother and was immediately met with objections and negativity. I also mentioned it to my brother and sister in law asking if they would check in on mom once a day if I go. This would be a five day trip. They declined. I know how important it is for caregivers to have some respite and I haven't had any for years. I often regret coming back here to care for her. I left friends and a community I'd had for 20 years. I had to start from scratch building a new business and making new friends in your 50s is near impossible, but I've managed to make a few. After numerous battles I was able to get my mom to execute a POA, health care proxy and apply for a HECM so there are plenty of resources for her to age in place. However, even this was met with a great deal of resistance from my mom and accusations of my taking advantage by my sister. Luckily, my brother has been on board with these arrangements. I guess this is just a rant, but I feel as if I'm surrounded by decay and death and everything is a battle. My pets are seniors now and not long for this world, my mom is in decline, she's a depressive and becoming more combative and my siblings are of little to no help. I feel that if we were to dip into the HECM to pay for home care while I'm gone my siblings would accuse me of taking advantage financially but at the same time they aren't willing to step

in and help so I can have a short break for myself. Many people tell me I'm lucky to have these years with my mom but she's not a loving or positive person and instead of me being able to lift her spirits she's gradually dragging mine down."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 108 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ji641g/when_you_are_the_live_in_caregiver_and_need_a/

"AITA for hiring a caregiver for my mom after my family told me it's "my turn to be responsible"? I (34F) am completely exhausted and need an outside perspective. I (34F) am an only child on my mother's side. My mom has Parkinson's and dementia. My dad is in his 80s and was just hospitalized for a bowel obstruction. I also have a 19-month-old daughter. My dad has children from a previous relationship who are about 20 years older than me. They are my siblings, but they are not my mom's children. Most of them live far away, have established careers, and some have health issues of their own, so they are not very involved in day-to-day caregiving. About a year ago, I moved back to Puerto Rico partly because my parents were aging and needed more support. Since then, I've been trying to balance being a mom, running my own business, managing rental properties, and helping my parents. Honestly, the transition has been much harder than I expected. This past week my dad was hospitalized, so I've been helping care for my mom. I've been going back and forth to the hospital, staying with my mom, caring for my toddler, and putting much of my work on hold. A few days ago, my mom fell while I was helping her. She was okay, but it scared me and made me realize that I cannot safely do everything by myself. I told my family that I was overwhelmed and needed help. I hired a caregiver for just four days, paying out of my own pocket 8am to 12pm (dad pays) 3:00 pm to 8:00pm (I pay), to help my mom for a few hours each day while my dad transitions home from the hospital. My dad was extremely upset. He told me that if I don't take care of my mom myself, then I should give back everything he has given me. He specifically brought up the apartments that were transferred to me when I was 18 years old. I'm now 34 and have spent the last 16 years managing those properties and building a property management business around them. He also told me that I chose to have a child and should have thought about my parents before having one. He said that if I want to focus on my career another business I am building, then he wants the apartments and everything back. When I told my siblings that I was close to collapsing and needed help, they told me that I had a "perfect life" and that it was my turn to be responsible because my dad gave me those apartments and that I have never been fully responsible. What hurts the most is that nobody is offering an alternative solution. Nobody is volunteering to cover shifts, contribute financially, or help coordinate care. They simply believe that because I received property years ago, I should personally be responsible for caring for my mother. I love my parents and want to help them. That's why I moved closer to them, why I've been helping all week, and why I arranged additional care in the first place. But I also have a toddler, a business, my own responsibilities, and limits. Hiring a caregiver for a few hours a day felt like a reasonable solution, but my family sees it as me refusing to take care of my mother. AITA for hiring temporary help because I don't feel capable of doing everything myself?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uc225q/aita_for_hiring_a_caregiver_for_my_mom_after_my/

"Respite care...wouldn't that be nice. I've been a spousal caregiver for 9 years, with one weekend off 6 years ago. My old boy has had multiple strokes, is incontinent, can barely walk with a walker, can't get out of bed or out of a chair without help. There is no respite care in my area because of staffing and bed shortages...at least not in facilities that my husband's provider has arrangements with. Every elder-care website talks about the importance of supporting caregivers, but in "real life" it's mostly lip service. "

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 88 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/15f8egn/respice_carewouldnt_that_be_nice/

"PSA for anyone navigating aid for an aging parent: call your Area Agency on Aging before you think you need to. Spent more time than I planned to over the past year helping figure out the financial side of caring for a family member. The single most useful thing I learned, and the thing I see almost nobody mention in threads here, is the Area Agency on Aging. Every region in the US has one. Federally funded, locally run. They coordinate respite care, adult day programs, meal delivery, transportation, in-home support, and often have small emergency funds that don't get advertised anywhere. The locator is at eldercare.acl.gov — type in a zip code, get the agency for that area. The reason I'm mentioning it specifically: most people only find their AAA after they're already in crisis mode. By that point you're trying to learn a new system while also managing a parent's hospitalization or a sudden move. If you call them while things are still relatively stable, they'll walk you through what's available in your specific county, what the waitlists look like, and what to apply for now versus later. It's free. A few other things that come up less than they should in threads here: Caregiver stipends. If you're providing unpaid care, programs like Medicaid's Structured Family Caregiving (in many states) or VA Aid and Attendance (if your parent is a wartime vet or surviving spouse) can pay you a monthly amount. Not life-changing money, but real, and shockingly underclaimed. Medication assistance. Most expensive medications have a manufacturer patient assistance program. NeedyMeds aggregates them. If a parent's hitting the donut hole or paying full price, there's usually a route around it. 211. Dial 211 from any phone. United Way runs it. They know what's available locally for utilities, food, rent, respite — anything social-service adjacent. Five minutes on the phone gets you a list specific to your county. The unifying point is that the system is fragmented. Different agencies, different income rules, different applications. Nobody hands you a roadmap. The AAA is the closest thing to one, which is why I keep flagging it. Happy to talk if anyone's deep in figuring this out or wants to add anything that worked for them please do so. Hope this helps!!!! 😊 "

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t2bz8x/psa_for_anyone_navigating_aid_for_an_aging_parent/

↳ **comment** (20): "My therapist told me I can't tie her to a chair and put her somewhere safer against her will. It's her choice, but I have told her that since she's refused my help over the years, she's now on her own and will have the choices made for her when the time comes. I'm done trying to reason. Im so glad I don't have children to put through this misery."

↳ **comment** (18): "I did, my mom refuses to utilize them. It's so frustrating."

↳ **comment** (11): "Compounding frustration I like to call it. What's the saying ... "you can lead a horse to water but you cant make them drink""

"Can we talk about how undervalued family caregivers are compared to agency supports?. This has been my experience at least. My partner and I care for an aging family member and the attitudes we routinely run into are deplorable. Our loved one has moderate/severe dementia which obviously requires a ton of work. Memory Care homes start at \$10k/month in our area. We are very lucky that our loved one is able to compensate us for the care we provide, but nowhere near \$10k a month. Yet, we play the roles of home health aid, CNA, case manager, Social Worker, transportation, advocate, chef, and so, so much more. As the dementia has progressed, we've obviously needed more supports. It started with my partner not working anymore to do the hands on care, and then I needed to move down from FT work and take a WFH position to manage all the background work and help with the hands on work. We were able to get a few hours a week of a home health aid, but it's still not enough and we are extremely burnt out after five years of this. My husband and I and our loved one all have varying degrees of health issues that are not cheap. If you do the math, my husband and I are compensated maybe 1/4 of minimum wage for all the time we put in. And yet, so many people that we speak to act like the income should be enough to cover all needs and pay for private caregiving/respite, and we are just somehow being greedy. It makes me so angry. No one says that a private caregiver wanting minimum wage is greedy. No one says that a case manager

wanting compensated for overtime is greedy. No one questions the outrageous costs of Memory Care homes (that don't even include medical care costs such as medication and other copays). But because we are family we should somehow just be grateful for what we have and be able to do everything ourselves, without proper sleep, without breaks, without any real respite. It makes me so angry. I don't deny that we are luckier than many in that we are able to be at all compensated, but I'm so tired of being treated like crap because we are family and are expected to be able to do everything ourselves with out asking for help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ai7fdz/can_we_talk_about_how_undervalued_family/

↳ **comment** (32): "I caregive for 3 people, my mom and 2 teenage sons with autism. I was trying to get an agency to have a caregiver come to at least help with my mom, but they require a minimum 20 hours a week at \$37 an hour. And they absolutely refuse to help with anyone else in the house, so it would have been just for my mom. I wish I could restrict my caregiving to just 1 person! So with that math, I should be getting paid \$114 an hour (37 x 3 people) and at 40 hours a week (which is generous because obviously I pull overtime every day) that's like \$18k a month! Over \$200 grand a year! I should be in a freaking mansion driving a Jaguar."

↳ **comment** (16): "You know what else I recently discovered about how undervalued we are? I was looking at physician assistant grad programs and one of the requirements is having worked or volunteered in some sort of healthcare related role, such as a CNA or volunteer EMS. Looking at the lists, caregiving for a stranger for pay or on a volunteer basis counts as top tier experience. Doing the same exact thing for a friend or family member does NOT COUNT AT ALL. Like wtf? Adds insult to injury if you want or need to make a career change after dropping out of the workforce to care give and maybe trying to use your experience to to do so but because it's for family, even if paid, that experience counts for nothing when doing the exact same thing for a stranger is considered top notch experience. So you can't even get into the program despite everything else as a result. In my opinion, that's just such a big FU to family caregivers by the system. Family caregivers do, manage and learn so much more than a stranger that comes in for a few hours a week but that's just worthless apparently."

↳ **comment** (15): "Ha! We really should all be in mansions driving Jaguars. Imagine if we got to demand any semblance of expectations of our work environment (I won't clean, I'll only take care of one person, I won't change diapers, etc), or any sort of wage! It's laughable. \$37/hour?!?! Even if you're able to get paid as an IHSS worker for your family member, that's only minimum wage! It's so backwards! Why are we putting all of this funding into strangers caring for family. Why aren't we working harder to make sure family has the ability to care for family??? It makes no logical sense! It reminds me of how in Foster Care, you used to only be able to get monthly assistance if you were a non-related Foster Parent. So if you were a stranger, you'd get a decent monthly check and a number of other benefits to help care for the child. But if you were family, even an Aunt twice removed, you'd get *nothing*!!! We finally changed the laws when we realized that outcomes for foster kids were so much worse with strangers vs family, but it took way too long. I can only hope that things will eventually change when it comes to caregiving for family."

"The End of a Caregiving Era. I started my journey of daily, increasingly demanding and finally all-consuming eldercare back in 2015, when it became clear my mom could no longer physically look after my dad any more but I was still raising my three young sons and couldn't do it all on my own either. That was when I made the first round of phone calls to our local government and health care agencies to see what help was available, and the first workers started arriving to help Dad shower a couple of times a week and sometimes get dressed in the morning. Neither he nor my mom really wanted strangers coming into the house, but they did reluctantly agree that it was too much to expect me to do all Dad's care single-handed while looking after my own family at the same time. I'm so glad now that I took that step of introducing one or two regular caregivers early in the process, even a little earlier than my parents thought was necessary, because it made it so much easier to bring in more help later on. But even with all the helpers we could find or afford, it got to a point where Dad's day-to-day care, and later Mom's, was more than I could handle without breaking. After ten years of having their needs on my mind 24/7,

lying awake at night trying to solve all their mental and physical problems in my head, being constantly aware that if anything happened to me my parents would be helpless and nobody else in my family would be able to take over (or at least, not without a huge amount of distress, confusion, and radical changes for everyone involved), I was burned out and exhausted. I'd hoped to keep them both at home until the end, I'd really thought that barring some kind of catastrophe it would be possible, I felt guilty at the thought of uprooting them, but it was also clear -- by God's grace and direction -- that it was time. They needed more help than I could give them even if I dedicated myself to their care 24 hours a day, and I knew neither one of them would have wanted me to neglect my own husband and family or give up everything else in my life to do that. Something had to change. My Dad was the first to move, back in 2019. He wasn't a big man, but by then he was dead weight, with no strength left in his legs, and it took two people or a mechanical lift to assist him. He had to go to a nursing home, and because it needed to happen fast, we weren't able to get our first choice of facility. The place was understaffed and overworked and the food was pretty awful, but it was clean and everybody was trying their best. He lived there for eight months, with my mom visiting him every day, before he passed in early 2020. At that time, Mom was still pretty mobile and cognitively sharp, able to make meals and do her laundry and such on her own -- but then the pandemic kept her even more housebound and isolated than usual, and a mild bout of COVID wrecked her ability to accurately recognize spoken words even with hearing aids (from 56% pre-COVID to 16% afterward). By late 2023 she was showing increasing signs of confusion and struggling with the activities of daily living, and in mid-2024 she began having attacks of sudden, excruciating nerve pain that required immediate heavy-duty pain meds, as well as a daily maintenance dose of gabapentin. Things went even faster downhill from there, until she could no longer be safely left alone at any time, ever. Even going out for a 30-minute walk once turned into a three-hour ordeal of Mom in agony because I wasn't there when she started a pain attack, and the guilt (for me) and distress (for her) was too much for me to ever risk that happening again. Anyway, this week I moved Mom out of my home and into assisted living. It's the strangest feeling knowing -- or sometimes forgetting, then remembering with a jolt -- that she's no longer downstairs in her apartment, sitting in her rocking chair with one of our cats in her lap, waiting for me to check on her. That when I wake up every morning, I don't have to hurry downstairs to give Mom her morning pills and make sure everything she needs is set up and ready for the day. That it's no longer my responsibility to make sure she's had breakfast and make her lunch and dinner, or keep checking the garbage bin to make sure she's actually eaten her food and not thrown it out. That if she gets muddled at night and doesn't know what to do with her day clothes or where to find her pyjamas, if she folds up her dirty underwear and puts it in with the clean ones instead of in the laundry when it belongs, if she wears the same outfit for two or three days because she doesn't remember she already wore it, that's an issue for her caregivers to address instead of me having to solve it on my own. Not that I've stopped thinking about Mom's needs, or trying to anticipate them. For the past few days I've been in regular touch with her care team, making sure they're up to date on all her medications and support needs and so on. Yesterday when I came to visit, I put labels on the drawers and various sections of her closet to make it easier for her (and the caregivers) to find everything, and I took her dead wristwatch home with me to put in a new battery. But that's all easy stuff, things I can do when it's convenient. I no longer have to drop everything and rush to fix all her problems right away. Better still, I don't have to carry the weight of being the only person Mom can fully rely on, the only one who knows all the details of her health conditions and her medications, her hopes and expectations. I don't have to arrange my days and weeks around her care schedule, and wait for a paid support worker or visiting family member to spell me off before I can leave the house. I can actually go out for more than 3-4 hours at a time, enjoy a leisurely visit with a friend, even leave town and drive to another city for a day -- something I haven't been able to do for ages. I can take a walk with my husband, instead of always taking turns so Mom isn't left alone; we can go out for dinner, or do an overnight getaway, without having to plan and prepare for it weeks in advance. After ten years of intense daily caregiving, first for my father (who had Parkinson's, used a wheelchair, and needed to be helped on and off the toilet every 30-45 min all day) and then for my housebound and increasingly confused mother, being free to go anywhere, any time, feels like a wild luxury. I'm not sorry that I kept my parents at home as long as I was able. I have no regrets about the time I spent looking after them, even though it was sometimes difficult, exhausting and emotionally very

hard to do it. I have a lot to be grateful for when it comes to my parents and our relationship over the years, and I am truly thankful for that. But I'm also not sorry that when caring for them became so overwhelming that it was taking over my life, affecting my emotional and mental health, forcing me to prioritize my parents over my husband and children, and keeping me from doing anything creative or restful for myself, I chose to give up full-time care and move them into assisted living. It was hard to break the news to them, hard to see them struggle with it, we all shed tears over it, but once the move finally happened, it didn't take long to recognize that it was truly the best thing for all of us. If anybody has questions about caring for your parents at home and/or the process of transitioning them to full-time care, particularly in Canada (Ontario), please ask and I'll do my best to answer. If you can find the RIGHT assisted living residence (and thank God I have, it's both affordable and perfectly suited to Mom's needs) it's a wonderful relief."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 59 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iq68hc/the_end_of_a_caregiving_era/

↳ **comment** (7): "I went through this with my parents. I was taking care of them in their house until it became so overwhelmingly difficult that I was literally having panic attacks and had a meltdown. It was a hard decision and they didn't want it but moving them to assisted living has been such a game changer for me. I'm finally feeling a bit like my old self! I hope you get to as well. Of course there is plenty to be done but not having to make meals among all the other tasks is the best!"

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. I am just beginning my caretaking journey. My mother is in the hospital as I type this and I am getting the house ready to have her come home. At this point in time, she is unable to lift her cup to her mouth. Last weekend she was able to do all the things. Life happens so fast."

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for posting this! This brings me some relief. I am 2 years into my caregiving journey, I work from home and my FiL lives with us. This is the hardest thing I've ever done in my life, it's nice to know that you feel some sense of normalcy at the end of it all."

"Here's what has helped me since becoming a full time caregiver. The TLDR of my (F64) story is that I have a 33 year old daughter ("Joan") who has Down syndrome. She was living in an apartment with a roommate, had a part-time job, a full life, and support coming in to help her and her roommate with laundry, grocery shopping, cleaning and socializing. This was her life for almost 8 years until she had a stroke two years ago. Now she lives with my husband (M67) and me. It's not the life I want, or the life my husband and I thought we'd be living at this age. We are looking for a long term living solution for Joan because we don't want decisions made in a moment of crisis should something happen to my husband and me. In the meantime, here are some things I've done to make this situation less stressful. Take or leave it as you like. \- I created a simple weekly menu for Joan. I give it to her each week, and she enjoys filling it out. It is something I typed up in a Word document, and I make changes occasionally. If you would like a sample of what I've used, DM me, and I will send you a template, and you can modify to your needs. This eliminates guessing what to make for breakfast, lunch and dinner. It also comes in handy if a care provider is here during mealtime. \- I make simple meals for dinners and freeze individual portions. Examples: Crockpot To Die For Beef, meatballs in spaghetti sauce, sloppy joe. It is so much less time consuming than cooking a meal every.single.day. \- The menu includes at least 2-3 meals that are takeout. Examples: Cousin's sub, Culver's, wraps from the grocery store. \- I online shop and arrange pickup on a day and time convenient for me. \- Joan has a whiteboard for her weekly schedule. I created magnets for the repetitive/frequent/chronic activities so that doing the weekly schedule is quick and easy. DM me if you want ideas on how to do this. \- We have help with outside support every day, except Sunday. I arrange my personal time around the support. I delegate almost all of Joan's laundry, showering, and maintaining her room to the outside support. \- I manage Joan's doctor and dentist appointments, social outings, day programming and support in a monthly planner. When there's a change or an adjustment, I use Bic EZ Correct white out. \- The management of Joan's care is a job, and I set aside specific times to do her scheduling, the calendar, meals, etc. It creates some consistency and gives me more time than I thought I would have to do the things I want to do. I hope

this helps someone out there. Caregiving can be demanding, but with some structure, it can be manageable.

Edited to add: Here are some things I've learned after having caregivers come to our house almost every day for the past year and a half: \- Manage your expectations. I had no idea what to expect or ask for with regard to the level of care our daughter needed after her stroke. I was told care providers would do laundry, housekeeping, give showers, provide companion care....you just can't expect one provider to do all of that in one shift, and you can't expect them to do everything the same way you do. If something needs to be done in a specific way, a) show them how to do it or b) accept that you do it better than anyone else can and continue to take on that task or c) accept that the way they do it is now the "new normal". \- Play to the strengths of each care provider. I've learned that each care provider brings a strength to the party. One care provider is good at laundry. One is good at encouraging our daughter to do her exercises. One does housekeeping like a pro. If something needs to be done in a specific way (helping your loved one in and out of bed for example), you need to show them. You can't assume they know how to do something. Delegate tasks to specific providers on the days they work with Joan. I put this on Joan's whiteboard. So if "Nora" is scheduled for Tuesdays 5:30-8:30, I'll have Nora's name on the whiteboard, the hours she is working, and under that have "Laundry" or "Vacuum and Dust Joan's Room". \- Decide when showers will work for your loved one. Joan gets a shower almost every other day. Your loved one may need more or less. When I plan the week for Joan, I look at her activities, who is providing care, and plan the showers around that. I put "Shower" on the whiteboard under the care provider's name. I am the default shower person, which is no problem, but having others provide showers gives me a break. \- Decide what your line in the sand is, so to speak. My "line in the sand" is that protocols are followed regarding Joan's toileting care. She needs help after a bowel movement. I make it clear to whoever is working with her that she needs help in this area and I explain the protocol. The agency we work with is aware of this, and the people I hire privately are aware of this. Joan has not had a single UTI since her stroke. Try to limit your "lines in the sand". Burnt toast should not be a line in the sand, lol. \- Treat your care providers well. They need to know they are appreciated. I express thanks to them frequently - "Thank you for coming today." "I appreciate that you ran the dishwasher and emptied it." You don't need to do anything extravagant, but there is something to be said for saying "thank you." \- Accept that caregivers will come and go. My daughter has had support throughout her life. It has come in many forms—respite care, doctors, therapists, supportive home care, and now, direct care providers. Looking back, I think this has worked in her favor. She has grown up understanding that the people who support her may change, and she has learned to accept and adapt to those changes. \- Accept that care can come from people other than family - If your loved one has never had people outside of the family caring for them, I can understand why the idea of having caregivers come and go might feel difficult. It can be hard to trust someone else with the care of a person you love so deeply. One thing I have learned is that the people who care for our daughter who are not family often do a better job than family can. Not because family doesn't love her but because caring for people is their calling. This is what they do. They have experience, training, patience, and skills that family may not have. \- Adopt an attitude of gratitude. This, again, is not the life I would choose to be living. But I am so grateful for people who provide good care and are reliable. I am grateful our daughter is who she is - she doesn't complain, she is not demanding, she is accepting. I am grateful for my husband. He is the funniest guy and makes this situation so much more tolerable with his sense of humor. Find things to be grateful for that make this situation tolerable."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 56 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1viux10/heres_what_has_helped_me_since_becoming_a_full/

↳ **comment** (10): "All of that sounds awesome and I will probably borrow several ideas but what I need ASAP is your recipe for crockpot to die for beef. 😊 "

↳ **comment** (5): "This is an amazingly helpful amount of information. Thank you! I tried to DM you for a copy of your weekly menu but was not able to get that to work. If possible, could you post a photo of one of your weekly menus for Joan?"

↳ **comment** (5): "SCRUBZZ... no rinse pre soaped disposables...a godsend"

"Mom FINALLY went to look at assisted living!. It finally happened! I never thought the day would come. My 83yo mother finally agreed to go look at assisted living! Technically- we went to look at two of those continuing care complexes- where you buy in at 300k and then pay rent on your unit monthly. The benefit is that your monthly rent is fixed pricing, and as your care needs increase your cost remains the same. I fully recognize that my mother's cognitive decline will likely have her living independently for less than 2 years tops and I feel like that is unrealistically generous. However, it's a way to get her where she needs to be (I believe she should be in AL now, but these places seem to think she's ok independent somehow) without a fight and going to court. Will it eat up all her life savings and leave her with nothing? Yes, eventually. But it's her money and if she will go into care happily then that is a bargain in my book!!! Now to get her to face the reality of selling her farm of 46 years. I'm going to be shocked if she can, but I feel like there is hope. So how did we get here? Tough love. My angelic blessed oldest sister threw herself on the sword and moved in for three years. She couldn't do it anymore, bless her for enduring that long. Our mother is unable to live alone comfortably. She needs help with driving, shopping, cooking, and anything beyond light cleaning. So not very independent at all. Mom refuses to recognize she needs help. Demands it from each of us. Eventually we realized all we were doing was enabling her to stay in inadequate conditions at our stress and resentment. So we set some boundaries. My sister moved out. She will come help do chores one day a month. I can no longer be available at a moments notice nor visit every other day. I can no longer call every day. I can call weekly, I can take one day off of work a month to help with anything, and I am available for genuine emergencies anytime. And then we stood firm while she tested every single one. It was brutal to hear her sobbing on the phone about how lonely she is and how we abandoned her. I would gently remind her that I am unable to be her companion, as much as I do enjoy visiting. I am still working and have my own home and family to tend to. I am not able to spend so much of my time entertaining her. She needs to make her own friends and entertain herself. Rinse, repeat. But it finally worked. She's lonely and doesn't want to live in a big old house on a farm all alone anymore. She wants friends and to be active. Hallelujah. Now we hope it sticks."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2y2el/mom_finally_went_to_look_at_assisted_living/

"Loved one making me feel guilty for only visiting an hour while in respite care. My mother was in respite care last week as her healthcare team wanted me to have a break. Out of the goodness of my heart, I still stopped by every day to visit for about an hour or so. The last day I only stayed 45 minutes as I had dinner plans (and had been at the social security office for 3 hours sorting out my mother's affairs). Therefore, I felt I had already given her enough time. Well, she didn't like that. She accused me of only staying a short while with, "You never stay long." Ma'am, I'm doing this as a courtesy to begin with. It's that attitude that makes me not want to visit at all. I went through this with other relatives in their last years. They would try to manipulate me into staying longer, visiting more often/calling more often, until it got to the point I visited less because I didn't want to deal with it. "Congratulations. You chastised me for only visiting for 30 minutes so now I'm not going to visit at all. Enjoy your day!"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 48 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oxyzhw/loved_one_making_me_feel_guilty_for_only_visiting/

↳ **comment** (29): "I have experienced the same. They seem to only be aware of their own needs, everyone else has no needs and unlimited time."

↳ **comment** (18): "No one can make you feel guilty unless you already do. I have a mom like that. I used behavior modification(boundaries) to change her behavior. As soon as she started criticizing, I got up, said goodbye, and left. I didn't respond to anything else she said. I keep it polite and just left. I kept my usual schedule of visits, but would leave as soon as she startsEd. One time, I barely made it in the door and she attacked, so I said "well it looks like you are alive today" and turned around and left. She eventually got the message and I was

able to hang out with her. Every once in a while, she tried again and I got up and left- even if she tried to apologize. Now, she's stage 6b dementia and is mostly just happy to see me."

↳ **comment** (14): "I'm sorry to hear that. It's too bad that some people don't understand that you get more flies with honey than vinegar. I get that they are bored and lonely but for an exhausted caregiver to have to do all the things necessary to keep them going and then have to be the entertainer as well is sometimes just too much. I am glad you got this respite week."

"I feel for you and am sending you a big hug. You are doing great. Turn the phone off today and do something for you - you need a break. I just got my mom into AL after a fall and brain bleed. I want her to love it and be grateful for all the work I did to get her there, but that's just not reality. It is frustrating and it hurts. But I remind myself of something someone on this thread said once and it's become my mantra when I want to lose it - "my job is to keep my mom safe, not happy." Hang in there and know there are people supporting you from afar and we think you are doing an amazing job!!!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 37 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/o5cd334/

"Oh, I got my brother out of there. He should have been able to go have his own life decades ago. It was a process. My father is extremely difficult and they do not want to move to assisted living. I'm going to continue to work on that though. Soon they will not have a choice. She was in terrible pain for the first month she was in the hospital and after that she just wanted to go home, so I don't think it was really a respite. Thank you so much for your kind words. So many of us are in the same boat."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oizgkxs/

"Look, friend, what happened to your mother is not your fault. I want you to repeat that to yourself. This was not your fault. I only got respite care when Dad went in the hospice. He died the night before he was supposed to come home from it. I beat myself up for MONTHS after that thinking what a terrible daughter I am for letting him die somewhere other than in his house like he wanted to. The guilt almost consumed me. I won't go into the backstory with Dad, but there was a lot of medical drama with his cancer - far beyond just chemo and radiation. It was go go all the time. My brother refused - to my face - to help me. I resented it sometimes as well. I was living on 3-4 hours of sleep if I could get it. I had a nurse come three days a week, but she was often late and unreliable. I get it. I think most if not all of us here do."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/owmjawa/

Moved her in with us · 169 documents

20 most engaged of 169 matching documents, complete text.

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :), can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"Old people are not all cute and wise. Caring for them can be like caring for your abuser. You force yourself due to guilt and pressure. I can't stand when people say things like "you should visit more often" I see my parents 3-4 times per week and take care of their issues ongoing daily. What more do people want? They want the ultimate sacrifice of me moving them into my home and destroying any small amount of peace I have in my life. Please never put your opinion on caregivers when you are not the one living the nightmare GOD IS GOOD. That was two years ago. I prayed and prayed that God would somehow help us. My mom's attitude has completely changed. She went from being critical and negative to understanding and supportive! Wow! I cannot believe it myself. One thing I did is I started opening up to her and telling her how I also was not well. I don't think she really had considered how stressed I have been. I pray that God may give caregivers the strength and peace to go on caring for their loved ones and themselves."

youtube · @Yolduranduran · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 504 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugx2JzMsA7cmhdaD54AaABAq>

↳ **@feliscatus1834** (36): "I am getting burned out overseeing my mother's care in asst. living with Parkinson's disease. Already taken her to 7 doctors appt. this month, she doesn't get around well & her room is a mess at the facility. I am EXHAUSTED taking care of her laundry, getting her diapers etc. My brother won't even drop by to see her & say "hello", he lives in the area. My life isn't the same, I am raising two teenage sons & married, this sucks I can tell you honestly it sucks, I cannot take her in or quit my part time job either. I HATE this!! I hope I die first before becoming a burden on my sons!!"

↳ **@spiderpig24321** (18): "Yep Yolanda ...taking care of 2 abusers due to a sense of duty. They dont even try to help with their grandkids"

↳ **@Okalani5000** (14): "Sometimes asking is not enough. Some people ask, even beg for help and never get any. Sometimes you just end up going crazy over it all. @TVResults"

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her

financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was lewy body dementia. I handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage lewy body. This march, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"This is my life right now. My 81 year old mom has been on the decline for the last 3 and half years. She lives with me and my spouse. I am 56. it is so hard. I have no life and am worried and stressed constantly. I am beaten down, exhausted & worn out. I rarely laugh anymore. Thank you for posting this!"

youtube · @GenXGal1 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 284 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugyqej9hZ2qGs2YAeBR4AaABAq

↳ **@robogal1** (32): "When I m some days far away from my mother I become a completely different person, happy, laughing, satisfied...it s a feeling of freedom. I m feeling so trapped, when I have to stay with her, cause she is always so mean, controlling everything I do, never satisfied, but it s my sense of duty., that makes me to look after her. I have no help, are completely alone! My brother, who was always her darling, doesn t care at all for her. He calls once a week, never visits her."

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (20): "Hi, I get it. I don't know if it is any tiny comfort but you are one of very many in this situation right now. It's beyond difficult. Do the best you can to be kind to yourself. I appreciate you sharing what's going on."

↳ **@TallRaucousTruthSeeker** (19): "@robogal1you better check she hasn't left everything she owns to your brother if she has a will. It wouldn't be beyond imagining. Either that or she'll take you for granted for years, cost you your life & leave everything to the cat protection society. It happens, I've seen it!"

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I' running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for

memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden, and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go, not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone. I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up. I told her I didn't feel well and would come up today. She told me not to come until afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"Getting kicked out of independent/assisted living facility due to poor hygiene. TL;DR: my grandpa is absolutely disgusting and his lack of hygiene is going to get him kicked out of his living facility. My mom (his daughter) and I have tried everything and at this point, we have no idea what else to do. Warning: this is gross. Some backstory:

my grandfather fell about a year ago and was on the ground for 3 days before my mom called for a welfare check. He has a history of forgetting/refusing to charge his phone, so we often weren't able to get ahold of him and were calling for welfare checks multiple times a month. After the fall, he agreed to move into an independent/assisted living facility. The condition of his home was horrifying. Urine and feces everywhere. Dead mice and mouse droppings. Rotting food. Mold. The works. We spent weeks cleaning and threw out at least 2 dumpsters worth of stuff. He would never let anyone into the house so we had no idea how bad it was. We moved him into a lovely facility and he was so happy that he was in tears. I decorated, made it homey, and really set him up for success with an easy-to-maintain and organized space and regularly scheduled housekeeping. It was a great fresh start. Within a few months, the complaints started. Other residents have been complaining that he stinks like urine and feces (and they are correct). The facility contacted us and said that they can smell the apartment from the hallway and other residents are upset. We were surprised because we set up housekeeping and laundry service, as well as someone who comes to give him a bi-weekly shower. Turns out, he's been refusing all of those services. Never cleaning, never showering. We went in and did a full deep-clean and had a very uncomfortable conversation with him. He seemed to understand and promised not to refuse housekeeping anymore. Less than a week later, the apartment was in the same condition as before and he was refusing services again. This has now happened multiple times. Facility staff have also talked to him multiple times. When we ask why he's like this, he just says "I'm lazy" or "I just don't care." He refuses mental health help, won't see a doctor, etc etc etc. The housekeepers have trouble stomaching his apartment. Last time they cleaned, we found out that they had to use paint scrapers to chip feces-coated toilet paper off of the KITCHEN FLOOR. The carpet is soaked in urine. His laundry is piled sky-high and he isn't disposing of his urine/feces soaked Depends, just leaving them in his underwear on the floor. There's blood everywhere from his unmanaged psoriasis. I could go on for hours. It's revolting. The facility contacted us again. Basically, if this doesn't improve immediately, he's going to be evicted. He has one month to get his shit together. I have no idea what to do. He loves living there, but I understand why they can't allow him to stay. All of the other facilities in the area are less nice and more expensive. He has nowhere else to go. We have done everything we can to make this easy for him, but he won't stop turning services away. Nothing we say makes a difference. I am sorry this was so long. At this point, I'm desperate. Has anyone been through something like this? Do you have any advice? Edit to add: This is absolutely a mental health issue, and as much as I want him to see a doctor and get help, he is completely non-compliant. Even when we physically get him to a doctor, he will not engage. He will literally just sit there and refuse to talk, then yell at us for meddling. I wish it was easier. Another quick edit since this is getting some attention: He was never a clean guy - his hygiene has been a lifelong issue. My grandma said it was part of the reason they got divorced (specifically, she remembers crying while scrubbing skid marks out of his underwear at the age of 19 and wondering if that's what marriage was really supposed to be like). This is a new low, but his hygiene has always been a problem."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 203 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t11ql5/getting_kicked_out_of_independen_tassisted_living/

"Just listened to a lecture that gave me very little useful information. When you are in the trenches, this kind of talk is useless, and possibly damaging. I took care of my father who died of cancer in 2008. My husband helped me immensely. Then we took care of my mother in our home until her death from cancer in 2009 on my father's birthday. By the time my mother had died, my blood pressure was 160/100, I had gained a significant amount of weight and was in very poor health both emotionally and physically. I was forced into a situation where I had to begin taking care of myself or I would drop over of a stroke. My family physician threatened to put me on blood pressure medication if I didn't start eating healthy and exercising regularly to pull my blood pressure down. So I followed doctor's orders and turned my health around. Then we finished that chapter of our lives where our daughter graduated from high school and left for college at a school over 1,000 miles away from our home. So we had to deal with that adjustment. Two years ago we made the decision to have my husband's parents who are both in their mid to late 80's live with us in our home as they were no longer safe living alone in their own home. They do not speak English, do not drive and are completely dependent on my husband and myself. So this talk about

getting a 10 year break in between raising our kids and caring for our aging parents does not apply to my life and I would think many people find themselves in the same situation. The most serious problem with this talk is that this presenter never gave any practical advise as to how we as care givers can better take care of ourselves while taking care of everyone else. We already know that caring for our loved ones is a special experience that we should hold close to our hearts. Otherwise, we wouldn't be here. Perhaps as a licensed psychologist myself combined with many years of care giving for multiple elderly loved ones, I should write and present MY OWN TED TALK; one that can actually benefit the care givers. Let's face it, that's why most of us clicked on here in the first place."

youtube · @reneeraw6927 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 203 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugz1pj6jmX3GkNPcY2F4AaABAg>

↳ @karenrader2160 (15): "I already commented above to someone else on this particular aspect of the issue, but generally I found this talk mostly useless when you are in the middle of the situation."

↳ @intergxntlcare (12): "I would love to listen to your TED talk. V powerful story."

↳ @karencox3235 (12): "I agree. This was a nice pep talk, but no real meat "to relieve stress" as the title suggests. The title needs to be changed."

"Caring for my mom with dementia has me thinking about my own future. What are you doing to protect your brain health?. My brother (52M) and I (53F) have been caring for our 80-year-old mom, who's declining quickly due to dementia. We're at the point where she refuses meds, won't let us help her bathe or change, and becomes very resistant to even basic care. We've made the difficult decision to move her into long-term care because it's no longer safe or sustainable for us to manage at home. As I'm sure many of you understand, watching a parent lose themselves is devastating. It's also made both of us think a lot about our own futures. We're both unmarried, we both do not have kids, and we're trying to do everything we reasonably can to stay healthy and hopefully lower our own risk of dementia down the road. Obviously nothing is guaranteed, but we want to be proactive instead of just anxious. For those of you who've walked this road or are walking it now: What habits, routines, or lifestyle choices are you focusing on to support long-term brain health? Exercise, diet, sleep, social connection, hobbies—anything that's helped you feel like you're taking some control back. I'd really appreciate hearing what others are doing. This community understands the emotional weight of all this better than anyone."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 189 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qa1eco/caring_for_my_mom_with_dementia_has_me_thinking/

"If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 144 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p036xz6/

"How do I get my parents to stop hosting Christmas?. My parents are 77 and 80. For 50 years, they have hosted a Christmas Eve party with my godparents that now includes god-siblings and their kids (25+ people). After my grandparents died, my parents took over hosting Christmas Day too, so each year, my brother, my uncle + cousin and my family of 4 all travel 3-6 hours and stay for 3ish days in my parents' home for the holidays. The problem is the hosting is getting to be too much for them. The house is too big for them to take care of and it is just not as clean as it once was. The fridge is filled with expired food so my brother or I go through and throw stuff out so that there is room for holiday food. My mom struggles to throw things away/donate, so they have boxes and boxes of

just *\things* from my grandparents--sets of silverware/serving trays/Tupperware lids with no matching bottom/old linens/etc. It is like the clean out is such a big job that it is all they can do to keep things organized. For multiple reasons, they resist having someone come in and help clean, though they could afford it. I have delicately suggested that we could host, but that would mean the end of the Christmas Eve party (and 50 years of tradition) because we live 3+ hours away and also we have only 1 guest room, so we can't sleep everyone. I am struggling with what to do. I don't want to push my parents into changing before they are ready, but I also can't help make it easier on them if they refuse to let me call in additional support to help. How have other families navigated the changing of the guard? Especially when no one lives nearby?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 129 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1px1vtg/how_do_i_get_my_parents_to_stop_hosting_christmas/

"What to do when you don't want to or can't be the caregiver?. Mom is getting to the point she is going to need more care and I live in fear that I'm going to be forced to take care of her. I know that probably sounds awful but she's very controlling, manipulative, and self centered and after living my life for 4 decades to please her and nearly losing my wife and kiddo because of her I know I can't do it. Mentally or physically. There's already been several hints from her saying she's moving on with us, she's tried claiming dibs on certain rooms in our house talked about how she's going to redecorate our home to her liking and I'm going to be honest my wife said if I move my mom in she is leaving same day. But then there is the problem of I also can't afford to fund an assisted living facility or in home care for her, like the money just isn't there and I couldn't work more to make up for it as I'm already working more than full-time. So what do I do?? Medicare doesn't cover assisted living or in home care, she has spent through her 401k, she's up to her eyeballs in debt from spending non stop, she has no other family but me. I've called council on aging and elder care many times and literally never get a call back from anyone. I'm in Florida."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 109 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t86ufb/what_to_do_when_you_dont_want_to_or_cant_be_the/

"Finally lost my cool on my mom's nursing home roommate. For context, my mother is young for a nursing home. She has primary progressive MS and has been paralyzed since I was 4, quadraplegic since I was 10. I have helped to feed, clothe, take her to the bathroom, change tampons, be a human remote, etc. etc. since I was that young. I am now in my late thirties and in my early 30s we had no choice but to move her into assisted care because she requires 24/7 effort. She has little to no voice anymore either. This week was particularly difficult because I have been solo parenting my newly defiant toddler, and I had the stomach flu. I have very little caregiving support from my father who refuses to retire because he has been awful with money, and hence why my mom is in a medicare bed and not private pay (though we have to pay out of pocket like 1k a month.) My mom likes when I bring my 2.5 year old; it brings her joy. One thing she really likes to do is share her dinner with my daughter. She orders a separate PB&J for her, and usually the things my mom doesn't eat, my daughter will eat. My mom has severely disordered eating from the MS, and has to eat things in specific ways, and is extremely controlling. I have figured out that if the kid is eating, and I can feed my mom then it's a fine balance of time, but I am essentially a proxy human for two beings. My mom's roommate clearly some issues in addition to whatever her physical ailments are. She is large, bedridden, and just a SEE YOU NEXT TUESDAY. She loudly complains to her aids about me, and that they need to watch me and she doesn't like me. I have never said anything. Until today. Finally I stepped on the other side of the curtain when I heard her complaining about how I feed my daughter. She is convinced that I steal my mom's food to feed my daughter and that she is actually "looking out" for my mom. I lost it. My mom is alive because of me. Because of the many sacrifices I have made in my life to literally be her arms, legs, her voice, to make sure she is fed, to advocate for her. When random agency aid's came to our house they would steal money, jewelry, you name it, because I was a little kid, I couldn't do a single thing about it. But at the end of the day, I was constantly there for my mom. This lady struck my last nerve, after an incredibly difficult week where there was absolutely no one to look after me, or my health. I didn't swear at her or anything, and still tried to come from a

place of empathy, but I still told her to mind her own business and respect me because she does not actually know what is happening. It was just so extremely disheartening. After everything I have done, that I still do, there is just nothing for me. There have been so many things that have beaten me down this year, I just feel like this the last thing. At the end of the day, I know I am lucky to be able bodied, to have my faculties, to be employed, to go home to a warm bed, with needy but loving animals and kid who is growing healthily and happily (despite being in a particularly whiney phase). She brings my mom joy, so I am going to keep going. Anyway, if you've made it this far. Thanks for listening. Trying to find empathy for others, but myself as well. But truth be told. I am fucking over it. I am just so goddamn over this disease and the absolute havoc it has wreaked on my life and my family's lives. It is unyielding."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 106 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1rs72w0/finally_lost_my_cool_on_my_moms_nursing_home/

"Impossible-to-please mother wants to live with me. A year ago, I helped my mom move to my state to live near me. She was living near my brother, but her incessant requests that he drop everything for her were driving him crazy and he needed her to go. I had her move here to give his mental health a break. She lives in an independent living facility about four blocks from my house. The location is perfect because I can get to her quickly and more frequently than I'd otherwise be able to, and I can stop at the store for her on the way over. But she keeps pushing to live with me and my husband, which is not a good idea. It's mostly because she doesn't like the food there. (Her apartment has a kitchen and she cooks her own stuff most of the time.) My mother is intrusive and oblivious. She doesn't understand basic human interaction rules (it's like she fits the definition of autism in this respect), which means she is constantly saying inappropriate things -- insulting us, or hurting my feelings. If she isn't getting her way, she can get nasty very quickly to where it feels like it's coming out of left field. Her own mother drove her crazy (and her mother was a nice person). She refused to let my grandmother live with her and my dad because she knew she wouldn't be able to stand it. And she swore up and down she would never be a burden to me or my brother. Now, here she is, wanting to live with me. The biggest problem here is that my mom is incapable of being happy. Everything is always terrible where she lives. Any house she's ever lived in is "always falling apart." When I was growing up, it was always my dad's fault for buying the wrong house or not repairing something fast enough. After my dad died, it was my brother's fault for living 3.5 hours away and not being able to come over and change a light bulb instantly. It's like the woman has no concept of how to locate and book with a service provider of any kind. When you suggest she call a handyman, she gets pissed off because she thinks we should do everything for her; that she shouldn't have to pay a handyman. Never mind the fact that she always told us that we "owe her nothing." I lost count of the number of times she complained about her own parents keeping score, swearing that anything she did for my brother and I came without strings attached. I believed her. She moved closer to my brother so he could help her more, but it wasn't enough for her. She complained constantly about the house she bought and how she'd "overpaid" for it. She had the backyard relandscaped and then killed half of it because she couldn't be bothered to water it (even though she had a programmable system and I had created a custom instruction manual for her). Every time something happened at the house -- AC out, broken water heater, roof repairs needed -- my brother had to handle it all for her. She acts like she's completely helpless. And every one of those incidents was the end of the world -- her crying and asking "Why does this always happen to me?" as though no other homeowner in the history of the universe has to deal with repairs. So we all decided that she couldn't handle owning a home; that independent living was the way to go because she could just pay one bill and not have to worry about anything. She's had that for a year now, and all I hear are complaints. Texas was better; her house was better -- she's forgotten all the complaints she had about it. That's how it's always been with her, though. She hates a place until she leaves it. Then, the old place was heavenly and the new place sucks. I don't want her living with me because not only will she annoy the crap out of me, she will be unhappy! I don't want to have to listen to, "I should have stayed where I was. At least I had X and Y." (And I don't want to help her move yet again! The woman's a hoarder, for one thing.) Also, I love my house and planned to stay here. It's not big enough for her to move into, though. We'd have to move to a bigger place, which costs money, and it would mean that someday, I'd

be old and stuck with more house than I can handle and NO ONE to help me deal with it. I've told her that, and she doesn't seem to care. I can't figure out how to get her to understand this and stop asking for it. Just when I think we're all clear on how our relationship works, she gets clingy again and starts crying and saying she wants to live with me. I'm going to school full time right now. I'm almost 60 and will be starting a new career, and not by choice. And I have relationship problems as well. I can't handle her b.s. on top of all of this. I love the mother she was when I was growing up, but I don't like the person she is now. If I worked with her, she would be someone I would avoid. But I don't want her to get all dramatic and start crying and saying she's moving back to Texas. She can't afford the move, and Texas is NOT big enough for both her and my brother to live there. We looked into independent living places there, and none of them had kitchens. That was a no-go. She can't buy another home. So WTF can she do but stay where she is? I'm just so sick of the crying and her being miserable. Yes, she's on antidepressants and sees a counselor. I've told her she's the common denominator everywhere she goes, and that she has to figure out why she can't be happy before she can even think about moving anywhere else. Aside from that advice, I don't know what else to do or offer her."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 93 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1unvxnd/impossibletoplease_mother_wants_to_live_with_me/

"My mother turns 99 in two short months. I'm 71. She doesn't live with me (thank Heavens!) but went into care after battling a couple of illnesses almost 3 1/2 years ago. I have looked after her for 17 years, getting her to all of her medical appointments, picking up groceries, helping her do her banking, etc and have been responsible for her healthcare and finances for 13 years since she first went into assisted living. She began showing signs of dementia a couple of years after that and also was experiencing more hearing loss. Now she is deaf, fully into dementia and in a wheelchair. Visiting her is no longer enjoyable and hasn't been for a few years. She knows me but is oblivious to everything going on around her. I can't imagine what it's like for her to be living such a life. For me, it's exhausting. Make no mistake, even though a family member isn't looking after an elderly parent or family member personally, it is still emotionally and sometimes physically exhausting. In the ensuing years since my mother went into assisted living, I've had to pack up her belongings and move some items to my home and move a few items to her assisted living suite, empty her house of any other items in her store room, supervise the sale of her house, deal with the assisted living management and staff on my mother's behalf (she didn't want to do anything much, especially make big decisions, for herself) regarding her in-house supports etc. I've seen her through four surgeries and countless other appointments. I've sorted out and supervised financial and investment concerns for her, stored all manner of tax, finance, investment and medical information for her in multiple bankers boxes at my small home (which take up a lot of room!) and have run around getting her toiletries etc as well as visiting her regularly and meeting her in the emergency room whenever she's had a fall and hurt herself. Now I have to meet the dental hygienist each time she comes to clean my mom's teeth because my mom gets upset and agitated. If I'm there, my mom is calmer during the process. I have looked after my mom diligently for years, and I've lost count of how often my life has been put on the back burner in order to deal with her needs. Many people will know that when an elderly person has need of medical attention and such, that the carer has to make decisions and get the needs met because those needs can't wait. Doctors, nurses, dental hygienists, Care-aids, or whoever, need prompt answers to their questions and decisions made by the person with Power of Attorney. So the family member in charge sacrifices their life regularly for the well being of the elderly person for whom they are responsible. I have my own home to look after as well as my own finances, taxes, grocery shopping etc to take care of but all of that isn't taken into account by others. What I also know is that often, the designated carer gets little help if any from other family members. I've seen and heard about this time and again and it happened to me. My late brother did very little to help, rarely even offered. He was running a business with his wife but I often wondered if he kept working to avoid having to help with his mother and preferred to leave me carrying the full load alone. Am I tired out, emotionally and physically worn down? You bet I am! I've had my own health issues to deal with for the last 4 years or so and this makes looking after my mom even more difficult. Don't ever let anyone tell you that it's not so tough to care for a parent if your parent is in full care. That's not only a lie, it's an insult! 🙄🇨🇦"

youtube · @Mystic0216 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 89 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwJHs0ZLn4QPZUoDjp4AaABAq

↳ **@obstantiadiscindo** (18): "Your words resonate completely. I so feel for you. And at the end of it all, the years of care you describe before they get anywhere near a care facility- what then? We're drained beyond belief, and the sibling - formerly incapable of helping anyone - is there to see what money is left. My sister - younger and healthier than me - who apparently can't help in anyway - psychological issues in getting on a plane, constant mental brain fog - has already lined up tax lawyers for her "half of the inheritance" and is now an expert on UK probate law. Literally willing Mum to die. Hasn't seen her for 34 years. Takes a very keen interest and argumentative interest in how I'm managing Mum's money. Would frequently phone my mother and ask her to tell me to send her money, then yell at me when I said I can't do that - legally - as PoA because Mum no longer has mental capacity, and needs her money to continue paying for her care. My kids want nothing to do with her now, and I suspect that after Mum eventually dies, if there's any money left from her care fees, my sister will be threatening me with legal action if she doesn't receive precisely half of what SHE thinks should be left. So I've had to cover myself with audit trails of all expenses, videos of any conversations with Mum about money, when she was still capable of them. The absent selfish sibling adds another dimension to an already overwhelming situation."

↳ **@bonitaburroughs8673** (7): "You said it so well. So many people tell me to put mom in a facility and I can't get them to understand that would not relieve my caregiving. Thanks for saying it so well."

↳ **@Mystico216** (5): "@ Thank you for your kind comment. I really appreciate it and I hope you are able to look after your own well being. I know how difficult that can be and also how important it is to take care of one's physical health as well as mental health. What was really eye opening for me was that I thought everything would at least be easier for me to manage with my mother in long term care but I was so wrong! I've had a couple of acquaintances (who never looked after their own parents, each either left the province or the country in which they were born) say to me that they can't imagine what it must be like to have to look after an elderly parent or family member. "Do you find it tiring?" they ask. Honestly, I just wish they'd not try to engage me about it because I prefer not to go into it too much. They don't understand how my life is nor do they know that looking after an elderly parent is even more difficult if that parent is a bit narcissistic and demanding. (The leopard never changes its spots even if it has dementia.) So we're all in the same boat and just have to weather the storm, I guess. Please take good care of yourself and I wish you all the best as you cope with your circumstances! ❤️🙏"

"Seriously contemplating walking away from my Mom and Step-Dad. The title says it all. I am seriously considering walking away from my parents. My mother (67) refuses to have a conversation - guaranteed to turn into an argument - with my step-father (77) to demand to hire a home health aide come to assist them daily. They both need help. She is being treated for cancer and having side effects from chemo. He has cancer in remission, diabetes, can't walk (refuses to walk due to muscle atrophy), after a stroke more than 5 years ago. Otherwise, he is in decent health. Before the stroke, step-dad was belligerent, angry, difficult, and selfish. He hasn't changed and can be mercurial. As a child, I couldn't wait to GTFO of his house. I've been helping my Mom - who was his full-time caregiver until she became sick with cancer herself. I work full-time and am exhausted always taking care of them between hygiene, laundry, shopping, cleaning, and more. They have resources, but only spend money when it is an emergency - like when the hot water tank in their home stopped working. It was an emergency replacement. I've talked to my Mom, texted her to prevent him from hearing the conversation...but she doesn't think there is a problem. I feel as though I will need to collapse and be admitted into the hospital myself before either of them will take my needs seriously. I have an apartment of my own that I barely see because I am taking care of them or at work. Walking away and going no contact is the only option left. Family friends have pleaded with him to get help, to do more. I have pleaded with my Mom, but I think just leaving and not coming back is next. I don't want to do this, but I feel like have no other options. I love my Mom and don't want to abandon her, but she isn't willing to do the one thing I need. I even offered to move her in with me and just leave my step-dad to

figure it out on his own...but she feels sorry for him and won't leave. I want to scream. Where is her empathy for me? TL;DR: I am thinking of abandoning my mother and step-father for not hiring a home health aide. After taking care of them for nearly six months alone, I am exhausted. Short of dropping dead or being hospitalized myself, they don't see a problem. Leaving them and not answering their calls feels like the only way out. Just going no contact. They cannot function without help. UPDATE: Thank you for your responses with advice and cautionary stories. There are no siblings who can help. Step-Dad has a step-son, but he is the definition of unreliable. I am making one more pitch for hiring an aide to my Mom and then, I am taking a good, long break."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walking_a_way_from_my_mom/

↳ **comment** (43): "Go only one day a week. Tell them you can't continue on like this."

↳ **comment** (39): "You must be exhausted. I think that so many parents haven't encouraged their children to develop the skill of recognizing their own normal temporary feelings of tiredness, worry, anger, and other negative emotions. So in everyday life, small negative emotions aren't dealt with in a healthy way, then healthy boundaries and expectations aren't created as the years pass. Then one day, the parent is surprised that their adult child has accumulated too much, is now burnt out and has to go low/no contact to survive. Maybe I'm projecting, but that's how it feels."

↳ **comment** (31): "My dad keeps saying they are managing just fine. I keep wanting my brother and sister to join me in going one week without answering their calls, giving them rides, or going over to do chores for them. One week of letting them be independent, as dad asserts they can be. One week of getting him to face the reality that he can't care for mom single-handedly, that he can't manage a two story house and big yard in his own, and that he can't apply the foot care treatment the doctor prescribed by himself. But my siblings keep sweeping in to help, and dad keeps burying his head in the sand."

"Yes - call your local Area Office on Aging and get a list of housing options for seniors. My mom lives in public housing and it is a percentage of her SS check, which is about the same amount as your mom's. My mom is 81 and her 83 yr old sister and her live together in a 2 bedroom apartment. This will sound cold and I'm sorry for that but do not move her into your home. Get her into a senior housing community where she can make friends are at least participate as a spectator on the outskirts of activities."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 76 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/n9ep6wy/

"My mother lives with us. My issue is getting her to do things she's fully capable of doing, like dusting her bedroom, eating, bathing etc. She's losing muscle strength because she's not getting up and moving around, which makes her more dependent on me. I work full time from home but that doesn't mean I have a lot of time to do things she can do for herself."

youtube · @ShowMeMo · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 75 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgxuMncoxTXgquk7NhF4AaABAg>

↳ **@EducatedMelanin74** (14): "Both of my parents are driving me insane. I love them but the stress has become unbearable that I've considered walking away. 🥲"

↳ **@FloridaGardeningdiva** (10): "Yes my MIL does the same issue. It drives me nuts. She now refuses to make any meal for herself if I'm not home."

↳ **@ShowMeMo** (5): "@FloridaGardeningdiva yep, and it's not like having a child, you can't say 'well, I guess you don't eat then' etc. My mom wanted dentures, it was a fiasco and now she won't wear them! So at dinner

time we have to blend her food. I got her a handheld immersive blender and didn't blend her food up, I told her she could do it! And she did but she looked very surprised at the change. Lol"

"offer rejected. My 90 yo mom went home from hospital and rehab stint. My sibling stayed with her for a week. Now all care falls on me. My husband asked my mom to come stay with us for awhile, temporarily until it might need to be permanent . She said she would consider it. I expected her to jump at the chance, but she pretty much turned us down. She said she would be fine alone in her house. The main reason he invited her was to take the burden off of me by having her at our house instead of me going to her house a few times a day. She is going to need more care pretty soon, but now I really don't want her to come live with us. Thanks for allowing a safe space to vent."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 73 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fwww6z/offer_rejected/

↳ **comment** (71): "You are very lucky she said no to coming to live with you and your family. You cannot continue to prop up your mother by going to her house 2 or 3 times a day. She clearly needs more care and supervision and cannot continue to live in her home. You are going to have to let her live her life and fail at this before she is willing to make a change. That change should be in an AL if she can afford it or she will have to hire caregivers to come to her house x number of times a week, if she can afford it or she will need to go back into a facility if she cannot take care of herself. You cannot keep up the pace of running her household and your own. Yes the solutions sound harsh but when an elder refuses to compromise then unfortunately you have to choose your mom or yourself and your own health and emotional and physical well being."

↳ **comment** (18): "Don't take it as a slight to you, it's hard to leave your home. If you have to go there too many times a day, see if she can find a paid caregiver or tell her you can only help if she comes to stay with you."

↳ **comment** (12): "Hi so there are no perfect solutions here, my mom did both the home care thing at our house and is now in AL. I guess a third option might have been moving her to a senior apartment and hiring her care. My thoughts. Two big factors will be how well the house suits your mom and what the labor market is like where she lives. My uncle is 4 years older than my mom, has major memory problems, but has hung in there with the help of an amazing housekeeper, he has a flat house, and is in a compact village in a rural area so he has built in interaction to some degree. My mom was in a large house with difficult steps and falling hazards, she was in a sprawling expensive suburb where it was hard to get good help, and even with help was pretty isolated. Having a person in her house all day seemed to breed conflict. So we went with AL. Also her house was in a great location but aging as fast as her and it was the right time to sell. I have learned the hard way that AL is not very personalized and while my mom fits well into the level of care they provide, it's a very partial solution. She still needs me or someone really frequently, but stuff like caring for the house is no longer an issue and there is structure for her medications. She also is enjoying the social aspect and doing some activities. I will also say that making a move gets harder as they age, so this may be the window that you need. My mom had pretty major surgery in April and it became apparent her days of living independently were over. I would love to think that your mom is looking out for you and knows on some level that moving in with her would be hard for you. Good luck!"

Cameras · 93 documents

20 most engaged of 93 matching documents, complete text.

"Overheard parent saying horrible things about me. I'm the default caretaker. How do I go on?. I have a nanny cam on my 78 year old parent. I don't usually spy, but I have it in case I don't hear from them. Tonight, my sister asked me to check the camera because my 78M father didn't answer the phone. I did, but he was calling her back when I looked. I heard the convo. I shoulda clicked out, but I was so shocked by what I was hearing that I froze. He said some really awful things. Luckily, I only got part of it. He has a problem with how I raise my family and what I do in my free time (which is basically a mom of three). He doesn't like that I have a career. He doesn't approve of anything I do unless it benefits him. I'll spare you the details because I'm genuinely embarrassed to admit the things that came from his mouth. Anyway.... The words were so awful and hurtful. How will I recover? I basically orchestrate his life. I do his finances, I make his appointments, I accompany him to his appointments, I pay his home taxes, oil bill and house cleaning service. I'm feeling damaged. I don't know why his opinion of me matters, but it does. I'll admit I have said some pretty crappy things about people in my life for sure, but the stuff he said about me -- his own daughter -- seems inexcusable. How do you cope for a parent that constantly gives you disapproval even when you are doing everything that you can to help? He doesn't have dementia. He is just a mean human. I have to take him to the doctor Wednesday because there's no one else and I honestly just don't know how I can bring myself to do it. I will because no one else will step up. I feel forever changed though. If you're still reading, thank you. What is your coping strategy?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 378 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ttnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/

↳ **comment** (323): "Did your sister shut him down? If you have a good relationship with her, I would tell her what you overheard, and that unless she starts to push back on his awfulness, she can take over all of the stuff you are presently doing."

↳ **comment** (309): "You can drop the rope between you. Or you can speak up for yourself and call him out. Or keep doing what you are doing."

↳ **comment** (171): "I wrote my very similar story below. I was never an angry or assertive person. I'm timid and a people pleaser and overachiever, but there came a moment that I got angrier than I'd ever been in my life (at around 55yrs old) with my father and finally stood up to him. I suggest you do the same. You deserve better and need to be assertive and set YOUR boundaries. Think seriously about not taking him to his drs appointment. Either just cancel it yourself and don't show up at his place or make him be the one to cancel it. It's probably best to let him know you heard his comments and telling him that things will be different going forward (setting boundaries) because you're upset with him and consider going no contact with him at least for a while. If confronting him is too hard (I get that), have your sister tell him and just make yourself unavailable. Unless you get an apology, you do you with your own family. My story below. It felt good to write it, but I'm fine if you skip it. I can relate so much to this. My father was always negative and controlling. When I was 55yrs old +, and he was 85+ he would still yell at me like a bad child for ridiculous reasons when I would drive 3 hrs to help him and my mother with dementia with different things. I thought that it was that he thought I was going to take control so he was asserting his. I never talked back or argued with him my whole life. I just took it as did my mom. Then he got upset with me because I put a bottle of Pepsi and a bottle of Fiji water in the refrigerator...for THEM because I thought their power was out from bad storms and it was 93 degrees. "We don't need all these things in the refrigerator." (There was very little in it.) And I snapped and screamed at him. I only had the nerve to do that because I was already packed up to leave their house and I knew my mother wouldn't be upset. I taught middle school so I could do overly dramatic loud yelling. I said that he was ruining my mental health which was true. I had started anxiety and depression meds all because of him and the situation, and I lived 3hrs away. I was just outside the door I slammed (another first for me)and went back in and said, "This is the last thing I'm ever going

to say to you. OTHER PEOPLE HAVE FEELINGS TOO. I'm done with how you treat me. When you need help, and you will, call your son. I'm done. You have made me very upset and now I have a lot of time driving ahead of me." And as I drove back home, I was upset but also felt the anxiety of "walking on eggshells" with him my whole life suddenly lift. I called my brother, who lives 6 hrs away and was still working while I had retired already, and I told him I was now estranged from our dad so he needed to be ready if Dad called. He said "okay, I understand" and I felt totally free. I did not call at Christmas or birthdays nor send gifts (my mother wasn't aware of holidays or even who I was) and he called and said "We're worried about you" on my voicemail like nothing had happened. If I got a serious apology from him I would have softened, but that never happened. It felt good to not answer his calls (knowing he could call my brother for help) and knowing I had set a boundary with him that I should have set years earlier. I was still estranged from him when he died, and I don't feel the least bit bad about it or grief that he was dead. In fact, that was a relief too."

"Useful items that have made it easier for us and our aging parents. Just a few items that have made caring for my aging parents easier. I want to mention these in case you are not aware or have not considered the benefits. **D-Mannose supplement**: this is the active ingredient in cranberry that helps prevent the formation of biofilm in UTIs. The capsules do not have a flavor. My mother-in-law would balk at the taste of cranberry capsules but does not object to these. **UTI test strips**: these are now over the counter in the US. Don't wonder, diagnose at home. This has been so helpful for my mother-in-law because getting her to the doctor is a difficult process. **Styptic products**: stops bleeding. Remember the white pencil that men used for shaving cuts? Now comes in pre-loaded bandages or loose powder. Check a camping or outdoors store or the pet aisle (dog nail care) for greater selection. The combination of my mother's fragile skin and blood thinners means she just bleeds and bleeds. **Tender tape**: this is a latex-free stretch bandage that sticks to itself but not to anything else. If your parent's skin is fragile, tender tape and a gauze pad is much better than self-adhesive bandages. I first saw this used as a veterinary product for putting bandages over fur, so you know it won't ever stick to skin. **Adhesive release spray**: when self-adhesive bandages can't be avoided, this spray will release the bandage without tearing the skin. My mother used to cry when it was time to change a bandage but no longer. **Compression garments**: look at products for runners, because runners' socks and calf sleeves may be easier to use for low-end compression needs. Cheaper than medical products, and using a combination of socks and calf sleeves means the socks can be changed every day and machine washed/dried. **Wig**: the weirdest helpful thing I ever bought. My mother is focused on her appearance in a way I have never understood, but it's very important to her so I try to be supportive. When she broke her shoulder she could not color her hair or manage the bouffant style she's been wearing for decades. She wanted *me* to color her hair but I thought that was a recipe for disaster. In desperation, I bought a cheap wig and she looooooves it so much. These have changed since the '70s... the modern wigs are "capless" on a net base and not attached to something like a swim cap as they once were. Her shoulder has long since healed but the wig remains in use every day. ETA suggestions from the comments: Ring camera / Alexa drop-in Laminated page of medications / medical info (have multiple) Wireless cell phone charger Shoe expanders Clock with day/date as well as time Silicone cupcake liners - good for serving meds, modest portions of snacks, etc. easy to hold and non-slip, also useful for hearing aids at night Bed rail Ramp - for entry and exit, rubber or metal Low step stool - useful for getting into car, propping feet up to tie shoes Bath lifter - useful beyond the bathroom Transfer board - helps with transfer from wheelchair to/from bed Car door assist handle - sticks in car door for support getting in and out Car cane - for getting in and out of car Stand up stick - looks like a plunger, helps getting up from floor Bed assist rail Spring-loaded floor-to-ceiling grab pole (Stander Wonder pole) Shower bench, shower transfer bench Shampoo cap for washing hair in bed Hair fiber - Toppik and other brands, makes thin hair look fuller Handheld shower head with multiple holders at various heights Bedside commode Gel powder to soak up urine Shower wipes - look for unscented / sensitive skin version Long-handled toenail clippers Booster pads - for incontinence Quick Change Wraps - for incontinence Bidet attachment"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 326 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w2kxot/useful_items_that_have_made_it_easier_for_us_and/

"Put a camera in their room if they are in a facility - best thing I did. Such a lifesaver when mom wasn't able to use her phone anymore. I could talk to her through it and she could see my face. But I would turn off my camera a mic most of the time and the screen would be blank. Again so useful when she moved to memory care. And again when he was actively dying and all alone. I actually was with her on the camera when she passed as I was "dropping-in" regularly. I watched as the staff lovingly prepared her body. And again when the funeral home came to get her. I watched the most loving and amazing caregivers treat her with respect and dignity. I saw nothing that alarmed me and everything that assured me she was in good hands. I used an Echo Show and the caregivers could not tell it was a camera. Used their wifi and mostly didn't disclose. Best decision ever as she resided in a facility in another State. But even if she were down the street, I would still get a camera. The camera let me not bug the overworked staff with my phone calls to check on her. I could see exactly what was going on. I saw the first signs of her UTIs. And when she started really declining I saw and heard her struggles and alerted her doctor and caregivers. Camera in their room. Highly recommend 10/10 Don't take "no cameras" for an answer. Set one up anyway. Also- here's a hack: keep snacks for the caregivers in the room. Fill with sweets and granola bars. They come in the room more often to get them and love it."

reddit post · r/dementia · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1qnu02i/put_a_camera_in_their_room_if_they_are_in_a/

"Hoarder MIL: The ongoing saga. Just to recap: \- MIL is in her 80s \- She had one child, a son, and I married him \- My husband died of cancer about 6 years ago \- MIL drove my husband nuts with her crappy attitude and inability to deal with the consequences of her own actions \- While hubs was going through cancer treatments, she'd come up to offer "moral support". While here, she'd expect him to carry her luggage and order for her and all kinds of whatever and expected me to cater to her because "she's the guest". \- She hated me from the beginning and worked to break us up while we were dating and when we were married. This went on for about 10 years. \- She's a hoarder. Her home was condemned by code enforcement in April 2025 when I called local LE for a wellness check on her. \- Had to pay \$17k to get the house cleared and approved by code enforcement for her to move back in. \- She's fallen several times since, totalled her car because "hoard in car" and a bitcoin scam. \- She has been diagnosed with cyclothymia. This is a mild version of bipolar, but honestly, there's likely more going on. \- She fell again beginning of Dec 2025. She had a nursing service check on her weekly and the nurse called for a wellness check. I went to do some errands for her (she's 3 hours away) and learned the hoarding had resumed with gusto and the toilets were all backed up. At the time, her echocardiogram was normal. \- I got her moved into a personal care home (PCH, not a nursing home) on NYE 2025. She hated it at first, but has been singing praises for the last several months. \- Got her house sold 12 June and her outstanding (massive) credit card bills cleared. One had entered arbitration. She had this idea that, because she was old, she didn't have to pay cc bills anymore. \- The week after the house sold _something happened_. Not sure what. Could have been a silent heart attack, could have been caused by grief over the house selling. Regardless, between Dec 2025 and 2-3 weeks ago, her heart function dropped to 10-15% and she developed congestive heart failure. \- While in the hospital she decided she was refusing medical care. Doc totally confused by this, but ok. She also got a psyche eval while she was there because she kept saying "I just want to die". Also diagnosed with UTI (and her usual delirium). \- Back at the PCH and under hospice care. She won't talk to me on the phone, whines in texts constantly. She's on lasix and O2 for the congestive heart failure. THE NEWS: Sunday (yesterday) AM I got a call from the manager of the PCH. MIL keeps her roommate up all night making her get up and fix her pillows and tuck her in. Roommate is miserable (also in her 80s and in bad health). MIL is not going to the bathroom anymore; she just lies in bed and fills her diapers and expects the PCH staff to clean her up. She won't keep her legs elevated, she won't keep her O2 on. She refuses to eat. Complains about her stomach hurting all the time (not eating, hmmm?). If she won't cooperate, they'll evict her. She has no where else to go. I had guessed at some of what they told me. She'd complained that she was breaking "the new rules" last week, that they wanted to put her in a hospital bed and that was "insane". She whinged on and on about needing a specific blanket from amazon (I finally just caved and got it for her even tho she has blankets). I text her. I cannot call her. She won't answer the phone, and if she calls me, she complains

she can't hear me (then says she can't hear anymore, which the PCH says is bogus). I tell her she has decisions to make and it's on her to make them. I tell her that she's being moved to the hospice room that's closer to the toilets and that she's getting a hospital bed so that her legs stay elevated. (The PCH is "losing" the remote, which I totally agree with.) She freaks the fuck out, tells me all this is old news, that she's been in the hospital for tests (they call and tell me when she goes to the hospital and she hasn't been). Bitches that she likes it where she is, she doesn't want to move, yadda yadda. Then she claims the toilet paper holders have cameras on them. A few hours later she says she was moved, it's cold, she has blankets, and I've heard nothing since. So that's where I am today. Concurrently, I'm gonna have to put my 16 year old dog down this week (chronic kidney disease \[CKD\]), my 15 year old dog won't be far behind (heart murmur, congestive heart failure, beginning CKD). A side effect of the CKD is chronic diarrhoea, so I've been cleaning that up for over a month multiple times a day and night; a side effect of the lasix that younger dog is on is increased urination (more things to clean up). I have pee pads all over the place, but there's only so much of that you can do. And my therapist is on vacation for a few weeks. It will be a month before I get to talk to her again."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 127 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v1l503/hoarder_mil_the_ongoing_saga/

"May have reached the end at home care, as many before (REALLY LONG). It's 3:53 AM. Laying in bed, wide awake, after finding my spouse sitting on the front room couch, with all the house lights blazing. I asked her what's going on, she said I don't why I'm here. I managed to get her to our former bedroom, kick off her shoes, and back into bed, fully clothed, as usual. Trying to get her into pajama bottoms can lead to conflict, and best let that sleeping dog lie. I had a nervous breakdown in January. While not a medical term, it is pretty good for encompassing the myriad symptoms and conditions that reduce you from a motivated fairly capable person to being frozen in place, like a insect trapped in amber. Spilled my guts to my doctor(how they repeatedly deal with this, don't know, perhaps proffesional training). She spoke frankly to me. As a result, got help. Two days a week, 10-4. After 3 weeks, already going to 3 days a week. Also, and more importantly, she put me on Zolof. After 8 days, viola, racing thoughts largely disappeared. After 6 weeks, really feeling better, my sense of purpose returned to my old self, started getting things shipshape and Bristol fashion, as sailors say. With coverage, I managed to get some important things done. Some house stuff, grocery shopping. Going grocery shopping with a 5 year old is gone, some car maintenance. Got a gardener for the front, and put the pool back to normal. I still want to do that, it's easy, and lets me retain some semblance of control and self worth. Taco Exxpress, chicken tacos and a Mexican coke in a bottle, eaten while parked in a little private area behind Lowe's, listening to NPR. She no longer eats nutritional food. Our long term favorite restaurant is no longer an option. The staff there was well aware of her condition, and went out of their way to accommodate. Some were former students of my wife. So, back on an even keel. Yesterday was a good day. She awoke, pills and juice, coffee yogurt and berries, GMA. A quick shower for me, 10 minutes alone for her is max. Time to clean her up. Home aide, who is wonderful, gets her to shower. With me, won't do it, can turn contentious. So, check outfit, usually a new tshirt. Remove old one, sponge bath with warm washcloth. deodorant, new tee. Sonicare, Water pik, each time like the first time. I have become more kindly, caring, and gentle, and willingly do all this stuff without much complaint. A walk (more and more, slower and shorter) at the marina with the dog(always a pal, Penny, good dog!) then a routine of carefully offered small bites and liquids, variety shows on TV , KC show a good one. Dinner time for me, then game shows and comedy till bed, one glass of wine. After clean up, will often find myself bent over with my hands on my knees, pretty much done in. But no rest for the wicked. A structured routine, she is safe, clean, and comfortable. If you accomplished that, you have done your duty. Except. With my return to clear thinking and a grasp of what's going on and the future, comes the realization that I'm probably not going to be able to do this anymore. Even with home aides, which come with a pricy invoice. My last test showed me progressing into CKD stage 3b, probably due to hydration issues during my falling down period. hoping it's an outlier. I often will instantaneously fall asleep, to awake 20 minutes later, totally unaware of anything. I am still exhausted. The house is a locked compound, 7 ring cameras, locked side gates, and the front door is always locked. At, night, even more secure. She will not elope. Going for blood test Monday, fingers crossed. After results, going to contact my doctor, and discuss a referral to the

appropriate specialist who hopefully can guide me through. I'm hoping Kaiser has such a thing, otherwise there are other agencies that provide help. Whew. that's a lot to digest. I find that just writing this down is a way to focus my mind, and also kind of a catharsis. If you are in this situation, I recommend trying it. No one on this group will criticize, most responses are caring, supportive, and might get some helpful input. Sometimes I'll write something, and not post it, just the act of putting pen to paper is enough. My home aide has showed me some pretty effective strategies, and always nice to have a partner in crime. I am one of many who have willingly accepted this one way ticket on the road to decline of a loved one. I wish everyone the best outcome with dealing with this terrible disease, it apparently is often mostly an individual effort, even with help."

reddit post · r/Alzheimers · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/Alzheimers/comments/1rh3ff3/may_have_reached_the_end_at_home_care_as_many/

↳ **comment** (21): "Please choose your health. I understand. Take care."

↳ **comment** (21): "Just about to put my spouse in Long term care, believe me I feel your pain. The decision finally arrived when I realized that truthfully she's killing me. No sleep, constant care 7 by 24 the situation is just unbearable and no one alone can do this long term. Hang in there the best you can then get the help that you need. ALZ just completely sucks"

↳ **comment** (14): "> With my return to clear thinking and a grasp of what's going on and the future, comes the realization that I'm probably not going to be able to do this anymore. When you think you can't do it any more, you're right. Especially with a serious illness yourself, you rightly recognized that you cannot care for two people any more. Dementia only gets worse. I've never seen anybody in this group say "We put our loved one into dementia care too soon." I've seen lots of people say "We should have done it earlier.""

"It sounds sketchy. Could she have only good intentions? Sure. But I would call the agency and let them know what is going on. Maybe set up some cameras."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 34 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1pck377/caregiver_getting_too_close_to_father/nrybuz6/

"This is an important topic, thank you for tackling it. I am currently struggling with my 94 year old mother, who is holed up in her house refusing to even consider moving, and is demanding care from me and my siblings. She does not want anyone outside the family to provide help. She will not make any changes in her life to accommodate her aging process. She has cancer and is starting to show signs of real cognitive decline. And even though she does not want help in her house from someone outside the family, she recently allowed an "Electrolux salesman" into her house, and obviously from the questions he asked her, he was casing the house. Now my siblings and I need to put up security cameras. Which will make my mother really mad. It is so insanely frustrating and I have become so resentful."

youtube · @patpeifer7871 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugx8YSvfZsuhnCis-iZ4AaABAq

↳ **@TallRaucousTruthSeeker** (8): "All I can say is they CAN be overruled, and should be. Forget the security cameras, just get her admitted whether she likes it or not. My sister and I spent months trying to persuade my mother to go into a rest home, which thankfully in NZ is paid for by the state. She absolutely refused. After one particularly big argument she caved in & the irony is that she was very happy there. Rest homes always have something going on, they bring a tea trolley around, there's occasional entertainment and caregivers are always popping in & out. The care wasn't perfect but as I lived close by I was able to take her out a couple of times a week, have her at my place in front of the fire with the dog on her lap etc. That went on for years. In the end she did get both cantankerous and incontinent and I realised I could simply never have managed her on my own. I don't think any single person or couple can. It takes a team & rest homes have the staff, even if it's not as many as

they should. The last couple of years were not pretty but I feel it was the only real option. So you guys need to make the decision now & do it against her will. All of you will be happier for it, including her."

↳ **@BunnyBouvier** (6): "Just reading your issues with your very strong willed mom, gives me strength that I not alone and there are others fighting the same battle!!"

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (3): "Hey friend, I have people close to me going crazy with this almost exact type situation with both parents. It's to the point it's getting a bit dangerous. There has already been falls. It is really really extra difficult when the parents at no point in time will look at reality. Maybe the video can help some do things differently. Hang in there and try to take good care of yourself too. Thank you for sharing it may really help some do things differently."

"Refuses to wear a Fall Alert pendant, so now we are thinking of cameras. My MIL has late onset dementia and is probably around a stage 5 or 5-6 in my opinion. She told us about a fall she had a month or so ago...while she had a fall alert system in her house! She refused to wear the one with a GPS in it, so we switched it out to a simpler one that is waterproof and just alerts to falls. She refuses to wear it. She told us about falling, lying on the floor for about 2 hours before dragging herself thru the kitchen into the living room and pulling herself up by the couch like a toddler. She also turns off her cell at night, so when she gets up for bathroom breaks in the middle of the night she has no resources for help if she falls. We've talked with the outfit who also provides a carer for a few hours a week for advice, and they suggested using a camera or 2. One for the bathroom hallway, and one that captures the kitchen/livingroom. The house is so small that we might get away with just 1 camera that can catch both areas. We were told the only caveat would be that we can't record at all, and no audio is allowed when the carer is there. We have a Blink system (2 cameras) at our house because our senile pup has taken to howling after we leave the house, and we can talk to him thru the camera and calm him down. It would be easy enough to place 2 cameras (without her knowledge, as she would unplug them as she unplugs EVERYTHING in her home), or maybe we should get battery operated ones in her house. Has anyone else had to deal with this? I don't like the fact that we can't record, because we'll not know how she fell if/when she does again. This was not her first fall! Of course we would turn everything off while the carer was there, or other visitors, but not recording when she is alone is troubling. Edit to add: we live an hour away, but BIL lives 10-15 mins away, so if we saw anything we could get BIL there, and of course we could call 9-1-1 if needed."

reddit post · r/dementia · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1djjryf/refuses_to_wear_a_fall_alert_pendant_so_no_w_we/

"Cameras in the dementia home. Should I?. I'm in two minds about putting cameras in my parents' house. Those of you who have done this, has it been beneficial? When I broached the subject before mum and dad really didn't want it but it has been suggested to me by a healthcare professional to monitor that carers are putting in their allocated time and arriving on time etc. What are your thoughts?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/13xwvkq/cameras_in_the_dementia_home_should_i/

"Should I use a spy camera?. Oh my goodness where to begin? My 90-year-old mother who is financially well off, independent, healthy and still sharp as a tack, has a live-in boyfriend who's also 90 years old. They've been together for about five years now. They are not common law and Mom says they never will be. But he doesn't pay for anything. My problem is that he is very immature, spiteful, and mentally abusive, controlling of her and it's getting worse. I've heard horror stories from mom's helper maid that he gets into big shouting matches with my mother when he doesn't get his way, and gets mad and is vindictive and throwing things around. He has completely rearranged everything in her beautiful home so that now mom can't find anything anymore. He's snooping around in her mail possibly looking for financial info. He is trying to shut her off from her family I guess

because he feels his power over her is threatened by the close relationships we all have with my mom. He's has alienated most of mom's relatives through his argumentative behavior. Mom who used to be very strong and ran a sort of tight household, seems to have no way to get him to respect her household set up, all her relatives and treat her and her maid properly. This man is horrible to my mother's maid and leaves nasty notes all over the house for the maid, telling her that she can't do this, and she can't do that, while the maid has been nothing but loving and caring for my mother and her house. In short, it looks like he's trying to run the maid off so he can have full control and power in the house. I don't think he's ever been physically abusive to her, but according to the maid, he is definitely mentally abusive to her. This breaks my heart. But in many ways, he is good for my mother because he drives her everywhere and is there with her for all her medical appointments. He can be very handy in the house. He can make repairs here and there. And he helps with errands. Of course she loves the independence that he helps her to maintain. I can understand that. But the horror stories of what the maid is telling about what he is doing and saying to our mother is really getting disturbing. There's so many other instances that I won't even bother going into. I don't know if the maid is overreacting or what, but I'm getting very concerned about what's going on there. But anyway, here's what I'm thinking about doing to find out what's really going on. I'm thinking about buying one of these little hidden spy cameras with the microphone that I can set up in the kitchen in her house. I'll be able to secretly see and listen to what's really going on there. But I'm sure struggling with the ethics of this. I don't think they would ever find it; they're just not able to focus on fine technological details like that. I mean, what would I even do with this information anyway? I've tried talking to her until I'm blue in the face to get her to stand up to him more, and that has not worked. But if I knew that what the maid was saying is true, I and the family would definitely make a more concerted effort to try to improve things for my mother. So I'd like to get this group's input or experiences with using a spy camera in a mother's house. Thanks."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1n429r8/should_i_use_a_spy_camera/

"My client threatened to have me fired today for asking them to wait til we get to the toilet to do number 1 and 2. I had to remind him the last person left to go deliver pizzas because of his toxic behaviors. It didn't feel good but it was necessary. His family refuses to acknowledge in any way shape or form the negative behaviors yet pays \$6 above market as a cushion because they're sick of turnover. They have cameras wired around the entire home and will likely confront me later after listening to recordings. What I've found is when you let people bully you they become emboldened and escalate."

youtube · @PunkMartyr · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland* · 20 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=UgzmrPfpP4VEV0XNFB54AaABAg>

"A long comment about the shame in yelling at an 80 year old in the ALF... Just got back from visiting my mom 7 hours away to deep clean her house like I do every 4 months since she won't let me hire a cleaner. She is recliner bound with a commode next to her chair for a variety of reasons. If you boil it down it is because she refused to use it or lose it. All my leave goes to her. I pay for her in home care because she refused to move near me while it was even possible, my life is all about "fixing" everything for her and constantly waiting for the next medical crisis. She planned for nothing in her old age. But anyway, I do all her bills, taxes, yadda yadda. I get frustrated because she is constantly resetting passwords because she used multiple password books and some of the passwords in each are right but not all. Every time I go in somewhere I have to reset a password because she's trying to get in. Who knows why, I do it all. Anyway, a few visits ago I gathered up all the books and created a pretty, fresh book with all the correct passwords/users in one volume. When I handed her the book I said from now on, everything goes in this one. And I put the old books in the dining room out of sight and mind (I thought). This visit, she asks me for help getting into her Arlo cameras to see what I can see, and I see she has those three old books on her lap. Guess she had the care giver fetch them back at some point. I said, for crying out loud mom, use the pink book only! She barked at me that some of the passwords in the pink book are hard to read? I'm standing there all sweaty, with a vacuum in hand, and I'm sorry to say I yelled at her that she was acting like an infant. She started crying and said I should be ashamed. It made me furious. My life revolves around her but I should be ashamed.. Anyway, I'm

home in California and keep reliving it. I yelled at my chair bound 76 year old mother, and she yelled back that I should be ashamed. Yuck what an awful feeling. LONG story short, I feel for you. And definitely give yourself a pass on snapping. We are human and there are a lot of people that just go "no contact" and don't remain in fixer role. They are lucky to have you!"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/ooeuywi/

"This doesn't address your question directly, but can give you some ideas if you decide to move your LO. We never moved Mom to assistant living because we were concerned about the level of care and we wanted to limit falls. The family provides day time care and we hired a lady for overnights. We use a baby monitor to keep an eye on her when she's out of sight. You could also get chair and bed alarms to alert you whenever your LO gets up. We also bought a waist belt to help us lift her in the event she falls. I think the future of elder care will be in more residential environments outside of the current system. Good luck."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxjsufc/

"Control moms TV remotely WITHOUT a camera. Hello, hope I can get some good help here. We can no longer use the Jubilee console to control moms TV. Long story but she is in a Skilled Nursing Facility with a roommate situation, can't use cameras. Just Wifi provided by facility, no router. She just has basic cable but we have a Firestick too. We were able to control all with Jubilee, we miss it greatly 😞 Both her and her roommate have their own TV's provided by the facility. How else can we control her TV remotely? I still have the IR blasters from the Jubilee and have no idea how to get a VPN to work or if that is allowed. We would be willing to buy her a new smart TV if we could control it remotely. She just can't use a remote anymore. HALP!! This disease can suck it"

reddit post · r/dementia · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v0rk78/control_moms_tv_remotely_without_a_camera/

"Ring Camera. Mom showing early signs of either Alzheimer's or Dementia - forgetfulness with short term memory, clinging onto all her possessions, and an unusual unkept house full of clutter/junk. I made a decision to put a ring camera in her house because I'm worried about her safety as she lives 4 states away with no relatives nearby. In the two days since I've been gone, the camera has been shut off by her for over half the time. That was not part of my plan. I need to buy some time to figure out the right strategy with my sister. Any advice on how I can keep a remote or electronic eye, either by getting that camera on all the time or something else? The camera is in her kitchen and I tried to say I'm not spying, that I need to know she is ok."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 9 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/19a75ra/ring_camera/

"Can't Take of/afford to take care of dad. My dad (75) makes just less than 200\$ too much a month to be eligible for medicaid and thus every single assisted living program/nursing home in our area (Pennsylvania). He owns a house that even if I somehow pried out of his hands because he's still legally married to my mother who's been separated from him for over 15 years and Co joins will still count against him on top of the income. They refuse to divorce each other, him because he's convinced she will come home one day, her because she's convinced she will get money when he dies one day. I've tried getting him into a nursing home even after he's placed straight from the er medicare a and b will only cover 30 days. Not a day more. His house is in unlivable condition and I'm honestly trying to slowly get it emptied out of years of hoarding garbage and squatter trash to sell with him and my moms wavering permission. We'll be lucky to get 10k for it so that won't contribute to any actual nursing home fees minus one month maybe. So we're paying 1000 in rent at an apartment for him to live alone in because after his bills, medications, oxygen fees, etc he barely has enough to pay me 400\$ a month to compensate for not being able to return to work at all to try and care for him full time. 250 of that I pay someone else to come and clean his

house weekly for the month because I'm just so burnt out after just having a baby in February. He's been falling pretty much daily now the last two weeks, because after I had the baby he got jealous about my time being tied up and went on a strike for a lot of stuff and started refusing to even get out of bed or his recliner to walk much thus making his feet bad and his legs weak, he can get around if he takes his time or keeps them elevated but he's stubborn and likes to force me to come back over multiple times (like calling and crying out for help when in reality when I rush there he's fine and just wants subway) I had to get cameras just to give myself some peace of mind and the chance to say no every so often, but then he cries he's lonely because he's driven the rest of our family away with being nasty and violent. Now that he's actually falling and getting stuck on the ground I feel like we've come to the end of the line. I really can't take care of him full time, living with him is out the window because I have two kids and me and my partner live with his parents in their home to help them out financially as it is and because they're aging. He's refuses to stop smoking cigarettes, he spits on the ground or AT a garbage can and will piss directly in a garbage can or in bottles he doesn't care spill even before he got older and less mobile, he's been doing that for 30 years, a lot of it is stubbornness and an expectation of other people to clean up after him. I've gone through his financials every which way I can. they're locked up through social security disability and these two monthly payments from life insurance policies/stock he set up 20 some years ago that can't be canceled and are going to pay him until the day he dies. No matter which way I swing it he can't afford the monthly cost of a facility and he can never become eligible for any assistance unless they magically raise the income limit. He also can't afford any of the nursing care in our area because with zero copay they all want over 25+ an hour with weekly minimums. I can't lift him on my own, I need to call other people to help, I've got everyone screaming in my ear it's time for a nursing home but it goes in one and out the other when I keep showing Financials and the rejection letters or offering for them to speak with case managers through area agency or his lawyer. He's pretty much stuck in this apartment until the day he dies, which means I'm stuck with him until he dies, but I honestly don't even think that will happen for another 20 years because he's survived organ failure multiple times now due to the way he treats his body, and 3 strokes, 4 heart attacks, a freaking month long coma, all within the last 12 years. He was a marine and some days I swear they gave him some crazy serums to make him impervious to death. I'm his POA for Financials to make sure everything is paid and medically for if he EVER get proved incompetent which, my mom tried for 10 years before she fled, then my brother for another 5, and now me for 2 with no hope in sight. I just can't see any ending here or possible exit that doesn't end up with me charged with some case of neglect or something even though I'm doing everything I physically can. Is there ANY way I can get him into a facility? (sorry for awful formatting I'm on mobile and also the rambling I'm just exhausted from both him and the new baby) Well just wanted to come on here and edit the post instead of messaging everyone personally Thank you to everyone who commented but my dad actually passed away this morning while I was cleaning up the apartment. Me and my brother helped him to bed and got him all cleaned up and comfortable and then I went about cleaning up and when my sister came to pick me up a hour later I went to check on him and let him know I was leaving and he was gone. Definitely not the outcome I wanted but I'm glad he went peacefully in his sleep and that at least the whole situation is over. Now I just need to try and handle/figure out funeral costs etc and get ahold of the VA because his life insurance policy was only active for 19 months out of 24 to get the full benefit. (always something to kick you while you're down) so we're only getting 5k towards the funeral costs. It's been a very solemn morning."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1lcwa4w/cant_take_ofafford_to_take_care_of_dad/

"My parents (87/78, both have dementia) live on our property in a connected but separate house. Right now I have care 8 hours a day, 7 days a week. We do not use an agency because I wanted all the money to go to the caregivers. I found my full time caregiver through church and my 2 day caregiver through a local Facebook group. In my opinion the way to get and keep excellent caregivers is simple: pay above market wage. Here in the Houston area agencies offer caregivers \$11-15 an hour. I pay \$25/hr. I use Poppins Payroll and everything is above the board, so the caregivers are getting social security credits and taxes withheld. I think the structure of having a mix

of full time and part time caregivers gives the best results because full time employees prioritize their role, and part time employees usually have a little more flexibility and are open to picking up additional shifts if available. I will continue this type of mix as we move towards adding a second and third shift. I am always keeping an eye out and an ear open for additional caregivers for back up care. We have cameras inside and outside and were upfront about them from the start. I check them daily as well as drop by several times a day. With your mother's home 10 minutes away I would recommend getting several cameras and checking them randomly throughout the day you will probably need to go over once a day or every other day, maybe at shift change to chat with two caregivers at once. Just to check in. My parents lived with us for five years, then moved to assisted living for two years. We experienced several issues including similar ones to you, while paying \$10,000+ a month and still taking care of all their medical and dental appointments. There are no perfect solutions at this point in the journey. I am very confident it is a better to have them at home with care than in assisted living. I am happy to answer any questions!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/onjes93/

"We just went through this stage of Parkinson's with my FIL and had the same conundrum. The fall risk window only lasted about 4-5 months, much of that time in the hospital, where he had more watchers (but still fell out of bed at least once), before he became too weak to get out of bed ever again. Lowering the bed to just a few inches off the ground was the most helpful change, with fall mats. Night sitters, baby cameras, bed alarms, family members stretched thin. It was a terrible window, I feel for you. It prompted us to decide on palliative hospice care as the hospital visits were as hard on him as the falls. He picked up C Diff at the hospital and they always messed up his meds. We have stayed in 8-10 bed adult care homes but they all struggle to meet his attendance needs. It's calmer now that he can't jump up suddenly, but he has long bouts of agitation now, and besides hiring night-watchers, increasing sedation seems like the only option."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 8 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxk2zpc/

"I worked as a licensed paid certified nursing assistant for 12 years (still licensed btw since 2007) and it was mostly in-home. I've spent hundreds of hours in drug rehabs, hundreds more in nursing homes, and thousands of hours in hospice. There are still credentialed, mature, reliable trustworthy caregivers out there, just make sure you do background check and get some cameras 🙄"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@nymikeca4718/video/7676627023950794015>

"I think the answer depends partly on whether your dad knows about the camera. If he doesn't, and you let on about it, that could make him say even more horrible things about you. If you could get your sister to agree to pretend you heard his words from her, that might land better. Still not great, but better. As for not approving of you having a career and children, I think that's a product of his generation and social class. I couldn't have children but my (also rather mean, and no dementia on board) dad who is 80 would wholeheartedly agree with your dad if I were to have had kids and tried doing both. He frequently expresses that he thinks it's awful for women to be anything other than SAHMs because of some kind of "damage" it supposedly does to their children."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 7 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ttfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op2a0cf/

Tab 7 — Solution Soundbites

What helped: this sub, these videos, people who get it · 568 documents

20 most engaged of 568 matching documents, complete text.

"I want to start by saying that if anyone is thinking of putting their family member or loved one in this facility. Be aware of the unprofessional and negligent behavior that you could possibly encounter. Hopefully your experience won't be the same as mine was with my father. My father who was retired Air Force veteran was admitted into their facility beginning of December 2024 up until he passed May 20, 2025. When he first got there they sent him to ValleyWise hospital where he ended up staying over 3 weeks due to complications associated with his dementia. ValleyWise was trying to come up with the right medication to treat his new aggressive behavior. So he only stayed at Desert Peak 5 days before they sent him to ValleyWise, where he remained until around January 6th. But they felt that they should be paid for the entire month of December. But the last month in a half before he passed away was really when the negligent behavior became crystal clear. On April 1st we visited my father and taking him some new clothes and tennis shoes. They sent him to Banner hospital on April 8th and then told me that they noticed that he wasn't feeling good allegedly a whole day before that. Mind you, no one reached out to say anything about him not feeling well a day before. And we're talking about a 88 year old man, so I'm going to need them to make that make sense. So I attempted to get answers from the the staff involved with the situation to no avail. Considering I didn't learn of anything about the situation until after they had him sent to the hospital a day later. But according to Banner, his condition was very critical! The pictures speak for themselves! Banner informed me that when my father arrived at the hospital he had suffered a stroke and he had pneumonia. They said that he was in pretty bad shape and it was really hard to believe that no one at Desert Peak had realized how bad his condition was a whole day prior. Banner stated that had they waited any longer to get him to the hospital that he could have died. I'd call that a lot more than not feeling well! And the fact that no one reached out until hours after he had been sent to Banner is ridiculous. I should had been contacted a whole day before, because according to them that's when they noticed that my dad wasn't feeling well! But God improved his condition and 3 weeks later he was taken back to Desert Peak. It was at that time that I began asking about the whereabouts some of my father's belongings. Long story short the new clothes that we bought just prior to the Banner hospital stay, Absolutely No Where To Be Found! Fortunately they did compensate me \$120 for 3 shirts and the 2 pairs of shorts that I bought just prior to him being sent to Banner. But the thing that upsets my family is that Desert Peak still hasn't returned my father's Air Force clothing/Air Force items!!!! They have been giving the run around. The social service people Harry, Barb & whomever else has made no effort to take accountability for residents belongings being stolen from their facility! The have outright lied about returning calls and resolving this issue and this has been since May, weeks prior to my father passing away! It's so unprofessional, awful and trifling! Being a retired Air Force veteran was really was something that my father took pride in and it was his legacy to his family and these people at Desert Peak has made a mockery of that! This situation made my father's death and our grieving of it much more difficult! And they aren't decent enough to take accountability for it or that they allowed my father's belongings to get stolen in the first place!!!!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Desert%20Peak%20Care%20Center&query_place_id=ChIJvfXRqA4QK4cRK1n6X9wR2sk

"Shady Company/Takes your loved ones 1st month rent. I began a google search for "assisted living places near me". I wrote down all the info for the places near me for my mother in law. I began calling the assisted living facilities. I called a phone number in the nursing home website that was NOT listed as the phone number for a Place for Mom. I speak to someone who I thought was from the nursing home only it was an operator who did NOT IDENTIFY herself as an operator for a place for mom. I then was directed to an "advisor" who again did NOT identify herself as a Rep for this company. I still thought I was speaking to someone from the nursing home. She began to tell me that she was a referral service and that there is no fee; that it is a free courtesy service. So I listened to her tell me 5 places near me and was reading the same reviews that she googled that I had already read!

She then stated she would send my info to those 5 places for me to contact them. I chose a place quickly WITHOUT her help as I already had done the work myself. She did NOTHING, set up nothing, made no phone calls. I received emails from her which I did not read cause I NEVER SOLICITED HER HELP OR SERVICES. I was deferred to this company unbeknownst to me. 3 weeks later I get a text from her offering her help. I said we already found a place. She IMMEDIATELY calls the assisted living place to acquire her commission. I get a call from the director of the assisted living home minutes later asking me if I had used their service. I responded that I hadn't that I was redirected to them. I never asked for or used her help. He told me that they TAKE the loved ones 1st months' rent as their commission. I was furious! None of this was told to me at all! I called this chick up and in a heated discussion she informed me that the director of the nursing home is in violation and breach of their contract between them for telling me that she takes the rent money. I said...How is that not my business to know where my mother's money is going?". I argued that I never ASKED FOR her help and she did nothing to help me find a place so how do you feel justified in earning a \$5000 commission? She said that she sent a referral to them for me and an email with the list of 5 places. I responded that I never asked her to do this nor what she did helped because I already had them on my list to call. I asked why was the 1st months' rent never divulged to me during our 1 conversation? She said they are not taking my loved ones money so basically it doesn't concern me because it is a contract between a Place for mom and the assisted living facility. Then she explained that it is divulged in the emails at the very bottom IN THE FINE PRINT. I said 1.. I never read your emails cause I didn't need your help and 2.. that's not something you put in the fine print. (upon looking at the fine print it directs you to another link for questions/answers which never says their commission is the 1st months rent, just that they are paid a fee by the provider for their service). Shady company who took credit and money for something they never did. All she cared about was her commission. The point is that anyone can do a google search and do the exact same thing that they do. Then you'll know that your money for your loved one is actually going towards their care and NOT a commission fee! Finally, if banking \$5000 from an elderly person for sending out an email (called a referral) is considered ethical and appropriate business, then that is truly disturbing."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5e1dc8c2c845450bec3722b1>

"I have been coming here as a clergymen, every Wednesday briefly about an hour at a time. That is not a fair assessment of the place! Since March 11 I have now been a patient and I am in the inside 24/7 the staff is amazing many of the top nurses work extended shifts to make it all work effectively and efficient under the conditions they all raise and maintain a professional attitude (Brenda, Micheal and Matthew and Michelle and Mony Pamela to mention some. Nurses like Cenita, Alyssa Nusley, Julisa have made a significant impact on my life at this time. Alvaro and Esmeralda and the activity team Jasmine and keisha Matthews Travis, Necca, Jala Tamika, the wound care team LA Tracy and Melinda ,and Shana Yolanda they all work together to help the wounded and the bedridden. there is the physical therapy and occupational therapy team Ray and Alisha and Mira and Severino, Anita and Geoffrey, all work to make one string and confident. House keeping us the best they work tirelessly to keep things clean and safe. Modesta and keontane, This place is just that raw and as real as it gets no front no pretence everyone is at top performance giving their personal best top to bottom Directors of Nursing are deeply involved and concerned about policies and procedures the checks and balances the quality and control is active! Like I said at the start walking through the lace for a few minutes is not a fair assessment being 24/7 has changed my own personal outlook I am determined to give more of myself and I am not on the payroll. I have seen a few students that come to do volunteer work to gain experience in this field and that is the testament to greatness. then there are the the ones that keep things working George and Greg and Mike, Byron and the staff that Matinence no task to great or small they are in it! From the front to the back Hazel and Linda , Brenda ,then there is Sofia amazing people Monica and Karina since I have been here I have interacted with everyone from staff to residents and family members the social workers and I even got to meet Sam and Manny they made time to hear my concerns and even a small request of upgrading they library downstairs with books simple stuff this place is a must"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Aperion%20Care%20International&query_place_id=ChIJnejv7BEuDogRdRuyU1DcuMg

"I do not recommended anyone sending their loved one here. They will tell you exactly what you want to hear but do not deliver. My mom caught COVID in Dec. and was in the hospital they transferred her to a long term facility and then she was sent here. A week after being at Capstone she went from good to bad. My mother had dark circles under her eyes and was just very unhappy. She looked totally different from when she left the long term facility. She couldn't sleep at night because she heard people screaming all night and running up and down the hallways. One time she woke up to a woman in her room staring at her while she slept. When she explained to them she was having trouble sleeping they offered her pain pills to sleep! They moved my mother to a new room and she needed a nurse she kept pressing the nurse call button but no one would come. The next morning she told the nurse only to find out the nurse call button was unplugged. If my mom was in dire need something terrible could've happened. On multiple occasions after visits she was left in a chair for hours unattended. My sister and I had a conference call with the staff there to address these issues was told it wouldn't happened again but it did. The last time it happened my mother was in the chair for 8 hours! Physical therapy was to be done for an hour at least 5 days a week and that didn't happened. When my mom got to Capstone she was able to stand with the help of the therapist but when she left she was so weak because of the lack of PT. Most the people at Capstone are unprofessional starting with the receptionist. There is a tremendous lack of communication that goes on here. My mother had an unsafe and terrible discharge. Capstone sent her home with the wrong medical equipment which caused her to be rushed back to the hospital. When we let them know they said they would work on getting her the right equipment and I have yet to hear from them. She was at Capstone for 25 days or so and has now been at the hospital for 5 and the hospital has done more for my mother than Capstone ever did. Capstone neglected my mother. People need to know how this place is being run. Capstone did nothing for my mom."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Avir%20at%20Orem&query_place_id=ChIJQC8N-DrQIYRz-sdMRXG_jo

"If I could give them negative stars I would. - they couldn't keep a schedule to save their life for the past 3 weeks of my grandmother's post mastectomy "care" they kept sending people to our house without telling us or when nobody's home or nobody would show up when we prepare for a nurse visit (lockup animals, grandma stays gone, we leave key in front because she's deaf) - a Nurse Practitioner (allegedly) came to examine Grandma did not properly drain her tubes postop she did not squeeze the bulb at the end to create suction for the liquids to come out. -90% of people I talked to have terrible English. Not enough for a job that literally deals with speaking English all day. I don't feel bad about saying that because English is my second language. I had to talk to almost everybody in Spanish to understand what's going on - it took three weeks to piecemeal broken English together that there's actually three kinds of nurses that should be coming out on different schedules for different purposes. We had two "missed" therapy appointments because they wouldn't tell us when the people come here. I'm not leaving a key out all day every day for them to feel like they're coming. What is the point of scheduling? That is their whole job. I asked why they didn't send maybe an email or one page PDF explaining the different type so it makes sense and they said oh yeah that's a good idea. - in three weeks of countless messages and calls dealing with like 6-7 different people, they have successfully done 4 visits where grandmas dressing got changed and they took progress picture. We are draining her tubes and changing her dressing the other 17 days. What they provided did not amount to "help" or "care" - I feel bad for any elderly or disabled person who gets these people assigned. luckily Grandma lives in our house and we're able to supervise her daily but somebody else who lives alone with their kind of "care" could end up with an infection or worse."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Gaspy%20Home%20Healthcare&query_place_id=ChIJ8_doVlrGQIYROdBtpQBNCNw

"I was undecided as to which nursing home, I would place my mother for rehab. Kimberly, helped to solidify my decision. While touring, it was comforting, seeing her demonstrate such a positive rapport with each patient . During the contract execution phase, Yolanda in admissions was extremely patient , with my abundance of questions. Latrice, (social worker), scheduled a meeting with myself and all department heads (Nursing , Wound care, Physical/ Occupational therapy, Dietary) in order to facilitate a cohesive plan of attack for my mother's rehabilitation and recovery. At the end of the meeting, she looked at me and said " I quote." We are concerned about you, what can we do for you". It caught me totally off guard and I'm sorry to say, I broke down in tears. Just to think that someone, noticed my heavy emotional burden. Elevate's Wound care team was SIMPLY AWESOME. The Physical / Occupational team were FANTASTIC. I must take a moment to mention the most important contributors of my mother's care. The Nursing staff. I found them to be EXTREMELY KNOWLEDGEABLE , PROFESSIONAL and most of all CARING. I am also thankful to the CNA's, and Restorative team., that helped with the bathing,dressing , feeding , and physical activity . No contribution went unnoticed. Also, thanks to the pleasant ladies that welcomed me every morning , as well as the young man that cleaned the room. Yes , and Mark, he would often come to the room ,with a big smile asking, if everything was ok, and if we needed anything . Lastly, I cannot end without saying thank you to LaMonica, who did such a PROFESSIONAL job of ensuring that EVERYTHING was finalized with hospice , transportation etc,for my mother's exit home. The only recommendation I would give is, for Elevate Care to upgrade their facility, to match the outstanding crew representing their establishment. Thanks again. Carla"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Elevate%20Care%20Windsor%20Park&query_place_id=ChIJPTYp qEAoDogR6_hjGdDQnHc

"The family wants to express our sincere gratitude for the loving care shown to Mom by her caregivers. This care allowed her to be independent and remain comfortable in her own home. We will be forever grateful and continue to sing your praises. ## Services and Amenities of Home Instead - Houston Central, Medical Center, TX in Houston, Texas ### Resident Requirements *Allows Patient Transfers* ### *Companionship & Escort Assistance* Companionship Services ### *Fitness & Wellness Programs* *Fitness Opportunities* ### *Licensing & Inspections* Background Checks *Staff Drug Screening* Sex Offender Checks ### *Therapies* *Stress Management* Validation Therapy ### *Ambulatory Assistance & Accessibility* *Transfer Assistance* Mobility & Wheelchair Assistance ### *Family/Caregiver & Relocation Services* *Family Communication Services* Transitional Care ### *Health Services* *Companion Care* Memory Care ### *Staff Training & Qualifications* *Staff Driving Record Check* Staff trained in memory care *Reference Checks* ### *Transportation & Shopping* Transportation Services for General Shopping ### *Bonds & Insurance* *Is Bonded and Insured* ### *Financing & Payment Options* Accepts Check Payments ### *Personal Care* *Bathing Assistance* Toileting Assistance *Dressing Assistance* Personal Care Assistants ### *Care Management Services* *Residency Confirmation* ### *Additional Amenity Information* Training Areas: First Aid and/or CPR, Emergency Procedures, Fall Prevention, Cooking and Specia"

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/texas/houston/home-instead-houston-central-medical-center-tx>

"Since 2012, I have had 2 live-in caregivers from Regency Home Care on an alternating weekly assignment. Since the start, two caregivers have left and been replaced by other competitive women. All have been easy for me to live with and good in taking care of me. Caring98222750 5 | September 1, 2014 I am a current client of this provider Our helper is super. She is knowledgeable, pleasant, and kind. She knows the patient's needs and often has it for him before he knows he needs it. She has a neat way to get him to take meds, with an "open wide." Cleaning is not her favorite, but she does it. She is a very good driver. (car) Caring98220350 5 | September 1, 2014 I am a current client of this provider Regency Home Care is my home care provider. The transportation to my physical therapy has always been very good. I also use this agency for trimming my toe nails and light house keeping in which they are very good as well! Joy15 5 | January 28, 2014 I am a past client of this provider My friend has received excellent care from the whole staff at Regency. The staffers are attentive, organized,

personable, knowledgeable, and compassionate. I think Erich, Donna, Tammy and Marva are a care-giving team beyond compare. I highly recommend regency Home Care of North Atlanta Barbara81642350 5 | December 24, 2013 I am a current client of this provider The staff are pleasant and easy to work with. We have had several caregivers over the past 3 years and they have been reliable professional and"

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/regency-home-care-of-north-atlanta-30338>

"Buckhead Center for Nursing and Healing responded to my original review with a polished, generic statement that does not reflect what my family actually experienced. To be clear: my grandfather left this facility in worse condition than when he arrived. Their public response claims they "made sure" he was not given fish and that his meals were tailored to his needs, but that is not what we witnessed. My grandfather repeatedly went without proper meals, his dietary restrictions were not handled appropriately, and when we removed him and took him to the hospital, doctors confirmed he was suffering from malnutrition. That is not a misunderstanding. That is neglect. This was not just about food. He was not properly bathed, therapy was inconsistent at best, and getting clear answers from staff was nearly impossible. Every concern was met with excuses, vague reassurance, or attitude. They present themselves well publicly, but our family saw a very different reality behind the scenes. What is most disturbing is that instead of taking accountability, they responded with a rehearsed public relations statement meant to minimize what happened. Families should pay close attention. A clean lobby and polite online responses do not equal quality care. If your loved one is here, do not rely on appearances. Show up often. Ask questions. Document everything. We did, and it still was not enough."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Buckhead%20Center%20for%20Nursing%20and%20Healing&query_place_id=ChIjd8BrNa8F9YgR7qk29p19Ngo

"Watch out when you want to end service. I agree that Medical Guardian service is 4 star. They responded promptly when my mom / dad needed assistance. The issues are with the billing aspects. When my mom passed, I call to take her off the plan. When I was setting up the plan I was charged extra for 2 covered loves and 2 sets of wearable equipment. When I reported that my mom passed away, they told me the annual subscription would be the same for just my dad. I was informed this year that my card on file had expired and they wouldn't be able to bill and continue service unless I called with an updated payment method. We elected to not renew, so never put a current payment method on file. They billed my expired card. I spoke to 5 staff on the phone and just kept getting passed around . Now they have 30 days to send me a return label for the equipment and once they get equipment back will determine how much I have to pay for a subscription that they indicated they were canceling. When canceling expect them to charge you for at least 2 months for the cancelation. I told one staff this was harder than canceling my PRIME subscription and he agreed and still passed me on. I had a cancel subscription email before I got the call hung up. So cancelation is immediate but billing continues for a few months. Why hasn't a lawyer picked up on this subscription service?"

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a46eaf6d20b8e1e5a5c313c>

"It's come to my attention company split. I've been receiving calls from other company formally apart of this group. Was told my doctor gave new order for HHA services. Advised them already receiving therapy and nurse thru Suncrest southside. I called Suncrest and advised them. Told not to worry they would handle. I told my therapists and nurse also. Was told on Wednesday by my PT problem resolved I didn't need to contact the other company. Today an employee of Georgia Home Health showed up at my door with no prior request or notice of visit. He was very kind. Saying they had been calling me to no avail. I told him what I was told by Suncrest no need to call. Immediately called Suncrest main number several times no one is answering phone. I left message with nurse to call. I'm done with the unprofessional manner of this company. I complained twice in last two weeks about inconsistency in service provision. Hadn't seen a PT for 2 weeks with no calls. When I called the receptionist

gave an excuse as I was on schedule. I really like my nurse Linda, my therapists Vee, Caleb, Sherri. I'm going to switch companies. If I was really in need there should be no way they don't answer the phone which they aren't. My advise find a company that's consistent and will give you service you need!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=SunCrest%20Home%20Health%20Southside&query_place_id=ChlJKVZv47-p9YgRi8vjgPHBYsQ

"The skilled nursing place my sister left called Gaspy to make sure they would be able to give her all the services she would need, which included physical therapy, and homes health (assistance with bathing), which they said they could provide. My sister has dealt with many Home Health over the past 3 years and this has been the worst! She started with them in March and her case worker Jose is the worst! She rarely gets physical therapy when it's scheduled, and some weeks not at all, never has gotten help with bathing. The only saving grace they have is their Occupational Therapist Gloria! I have called so many times I can't count! I get told the same thing everytime from Jose they are going to change physical Therapist, and they will send someone to bath her, and he will call me back when they will be coming. I HAVE NEVER RECEIVED A CALL BACK!!!! He always sounds like he is home and I here children in the background, which I know a lot of people are working from home now, but it's not very professional to hear kids screaming in the background. Maybe he's to busy with his children to do his job! One other thing, after she had been reevaluate she was supposed to be given more and new exercises, but that didn't happen either! BEWARE!!! THIS IS NOT HOME HEATH!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Gaspy%20Home%20Healthcare&query_place_id=ChIJ8_doVlrGQIYROdBtpQBNCNw

"I have used ELITE as often as I can in my position as Home Promary Care Provider. There services are excellent. The wound care branch has been beyond very efficient and has been responsible for healing every patient that I have sent to them . One of their wound care nurses, Patty Hollister, goes far and above and beyond to get the job done. In this challenging branch of medicine I find this is not always the case but I have been pleasantly reassured with the members of a this agency. They are both respectful, professional and very knowledgeable and compassionate in their job presentation and administration. The home Physical Therapy branch is also exemplarily staffed with Jake amongst others, who are well trained therapist that keep me informed and also do a very complete job in assisting this needy and growing population. Their owner, Angie Okeke, is a very caring person and this definitely shows through her company. I would not hesitate to recommend them to anyone looking for a home health care agency in any of the branches that they offer . Thank you for all your help in past and looking forward to working again with you in near future. Thank you Mary Pat Nesbit, PAC"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Team%20Select%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJS_55uY1uK4cRGlhZNXsdujw

"I am so incredibly frustrated with this home healthcare company! They were supposed to be doing physical and occupational therapy for my 89-year-old mother, who is recovering from a broken hip, has Alzheimer's and is in Memory Care/Assisted Living. Since Day 1 I had requested to be present during all therapy sessions, yet they would never call to schedule them. When it was time for her re-evaluation I specifically said that no one from Gaspy was to see my mother without me being there, yet they showed up anyway. I got excuse after excuse, from people just forgetting to call me as instructed to tires blowing out. I spoke to one of the physical therapists and was told that this was a corporate issue and they should be calling me, but to this day I have never received one call from Gaspy about anything other than getting re-evaluations done so they can get more money from the insurance company. This is the most unorganized, unreliable, unethical company I have ever dealt with. I am not sure why anyone would be so blatantly disrespectful to the elderly who need us the most and their families who rely on their professionalism and expertise."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Gaspy%20Home%20Healthcare&query_place_id=ChIJ8_doVlrGQIYROdBtpQBNCNw

"I have called on 2 separate occasions. I have called on 2 separate occasions. I was looking for placement for my dad who was having memory issues and seeing/hearing things. I was told they could not find placement for him until a doctor had the seeing/hearing issue under control with medication (which he was already on). Several weeks later I called again as my dad had wandered out in the night, got lost and was brought to the hospital. He then went into physical therapy to get stronger due to having pneumonia. I needed to find placement for him when therapy was over. Again I called a place for mom and explained my situation. They called me immediately, listened to my explanation and said someone would be in touch soon. I never heard back from anyone. I found placement on my own. Maybe if they had helped me the first time I called he would have been in a safe place and not found wandering the streets several weeks later. I was told by social workers that whoever told me they could not even begin to place him because he was seeing/hearing things was completely wrong."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5c74237997afa10604507e94>

"My Brother James Miles Sr. Is that this facility and has received Legendary Patient Care first while he was yet in the hospital I met the nurses Liaison Vicky Professional Courteous and Caring I have experienced that same great caring spirit with Ms Yolanda the Administrator Miss Lisa Carter ,Kim in Guest Relation they are truly Caring and Professional Eleanor the receptionist and the others receptionist have met Us A Smile and A Blessings on your way out hoping you had an excellent visit our family is very close and we try to do the best for one another and I believe in this facility Our Eldest Brother has received that same kind of care love and Support and Rehabilitation Charles I didn't forget about you in Physical Therapy thanks for all your help I wish I could take you home with him because I think he could progress even further with your Help 🙏 Thanks to all the Helpful Nurses Precious and Brittany & CNAS To Everyone We Appreciate You All (if I forgot anyone charge it to my head and not my Heart 💖 this has been a journey for Me We Are Truly Thankful)"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Elevate%20Care%20Windsor%20Park&query_place_id=ChIJPTYp qEAoDogR6_hjGdDQnHc

"If ever I would be in need of a great support service in my healthcare Gaspy Healthcare would be my first choice. They have exceeded my expectations and made be a believer that some people really care about their patients. From the Nurse Coordinator Carlos, to the RN and Therapist GG everyone played a great role in keeping me safe and out of the emergency room. I've had a bad experience with a healthcare that I was depressed and having anxiety attacks and I'm the emergency room 3 times plus I didn't get a chance to do therapy because the RN messed that up and only came to set me up and No show after that. But the therapist were willing and ready to do their job but due to infection I refused to deal with them further. Sad that one bad apple spoiled the whole bunch. But if anyone desires to have someone that really cares about your wellbeing "GASPY HOME HEALTHCARE IS THE PLACE TO REACH OUT TO." Thank you guys for everything. Sorry if I can't remember the RN's names but one thing for sure I love ❤️ you guys"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Gaspy%20Home%20Healthcare&query_place_id=ChIJ8_doVlrGQIYROdBtpQBNCNw

"I am not satisfied dealing with the staff at this location. I have talked to an Admission Clerk, an Activity Aide, a Physical Therapist and her Care Coordinator. They have not followed through with what they said they were going to do regarding my mom short physical rehabilitation stay and when I call back for status get not adequate answers or voicemails. My mom experience is not pleasant, one occasion asked to have diaper change, took over an hour to get done, call back button to summon nurses were not put back in reaching distant and when I got transferred to nurse station to let them know, got rings no answer. Only put in a wheelchair once. Physical therapy

only 10 minutes approx. when done, no equipment used and. the rest of the time just lying in bed. Although cannot walk but at home she was at least able to sit up. This has caused her to feel sad and despondent because we both thought the physical therapy would be more involved and still waiting for her Plan of Care."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Aperion%20Care%20International&query_place_id=ChIJnejv7BEuDogRdRuyU1DcuMg

"I sent my mom here for physical, occupational and speech therapy. Within two days of admission she had decompensated to the extent of experiencing a brain bleed from incompetent management of diagnosed hypertension. A nurse informed me blood pressure medication hadn't arrived at admission, while a nurse I spoke with the day of admission informed me her blood pressure was high, but he was leaving, and something could hopefully be given the next hour or so. .When I requested hospitalization from obviously acute deterioration, one of the nurses tried to argue, informing me "You're not a nurse." Subsequent hospitalization at a stabilizing hospital and Rush confirmed the brain damage I suspected. After the pause from an initial refusal to hospitalize and missed medication prior, a final blood pressure reading was 212, etc.- acute medical distress. If I wanted someone to die I'd send them here; if I wanted something other than that I don't recommend it. R.Evans"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=ALIYA%20on%2087th&query_place_id=ChIJCa-1o9wIDogRx7RKv8i1IK4

"What can I say other than I am truly blessed for this facility. I am homeless and had knee surgery. I was scared and would shut down at the tiniest hint of pain. The rehab staff were so patient and encouraging. They they made me have faith in myself and faith in my leg. I didn't have a place to recuperate after my time here and they found me somewhere to go to where I could still do my therapy and not be outdoors. Their social services and their case management our top notch their CNA's are some of the hardest working there are. It is an older building so it's not like some of the facilities that look like they're just model homes. But where they don't have the prettiest Halls they have the hardest working staff. I cannot say anything more than I have been very blessed for my stay and my time here. I look forward to my next steps and they have prepared me for it. Thank you for all of the hard work and the encouragement."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Desert%20Terrace%20Healthcare%20Center&query_place_id=ChIJkzHFgpQNK4cRcHzo_Qw11bc

The best decision we ever made · 500 documents

20 most engaged of 500 matching documents, complete text.

"Beware.....if you cancel a subscription they will still charge you. I cancelled 2 years ago and suddenly they decided to start charging me again.....I'm out 155.00. I highly recommend not using this service."

fb ad comment · https://www.facebook.com/caredotcom/posts/pfbid04LhPBUXCQ17moqTjqYcYLUcSu7dEJj64iFT9v3q7wyb9HHmeKMGW54QXsUYUfywxl?comment_id=898024503135189

"Search home instead: outstanding model. Search Need a medical alert system? FIND MY MATCH HomeElder Care Home Care Services Updated on 07/22/2019 Home Instead Senior Care Overall Satisfaction Rating Based on 129 ratings SHOW RATING DISTRIBUTION Need a medical alert system? We'll match you with the right company that knows what you need. FIND MY MATCH Home Instead Senior Care ConsumerAffairs Unaccredited Brand This company is not yet accredited. To learn more, see reviews below or submit your own. Home Instead Senior Care does NOT participate in the ConsumerAffairs accreditation program. Learn More Be in the know Get trending consumer news and recalls Email Enter your email here SUBSCRIBE Are you this business? LEARN MORE 146 Home Instead Senior Care Consumer Reviews Sort: Recent Filter by: Any Rated with 1 star profile pic of the author Mary of Clarendon Hills, IL Verified Reviewer Original review: July 12, 2019 We used Home Instead in Oak Park, IL. I feel when we needed them the most they failed us. Most of the staff was ill equipped to handle my mother's needs as she deteriorated. She was bedridden and it took 3 people to change the soiled sheets and her, most of the caretakers had no idea what to do. As if that is not bad enough one of the caretakers decided to clean my mother up, exposing her private parts in front of family (her grandchildren) that were there visiting. I'm appalled that the caretaker would think that was acceptable in any way, shape or form. They also lack communication, as supplies were delivered from hospice boxes were stacked in a place that was not easily seen and never communicated that supplies had been delivered. If you love your family member I do not recommend them at all! HELPFUL Be the first one to find this review helpful Rated with 4 stars profile pic of the author Elaine of Los Angeles, CA Verified Reviewer Original review: July 9, 2019 It is important to understand that the experience I describe here is related to one of Home Instead's many franchises. I have read negative reviews that have nothing to do with the Culver City franchise I used. In fact the home instead office that I dealt with was highly professional, courteous, and client-oriented. At our initial meeting they provided me with a list of qualities that I could expect from my caregivers. They made it very clear that I was to notify the office at any time that I felt I was not appropriately being cared for. VIEW MORE 3 people found this review helpful Not sure how to choose? Get expert buying tips about Home Care Services delivered to your inbox. Email Enter your email here LEARN FROM THE PROS We value your privacy. Unsubscribe easily. Rated with 1 star edie of Vancouver, WA Verified Reviewer Original review: June 5, 2019 Since negative stars are not available, they get one. Totally negative on the high turnover staff. The RN's are combative and prone to slander. They treat workers and families horribly. If you want caregivers sleeping during the shift, and having basically no idea on proper care of your elder, this is the company for you. None of the home staff are licensed, and most are morons. Unfortunately, once they are in your life, its near impossible to get rid of due to attachment with the good ones. Near two years into this adventure leaves a bad taste. HELPFUL 3 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star Larry of Surprise, AZ Verified Reviewer Original review: June 4, 2019 They lasted two days as they dropped my loved one TWICE in 2 days. They also have questionable pricing as 2 twelve hour shifts is not considered 24 hrs in their pricing. They showed one shift as awake and the other resting but charged the higher rate for both. When questioned they told me they didn't have any 24 hour shifts. They are nothing but baby sitters. HELPFUL 5 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star Georgia of Forest Hill, MD Verified Reviewer Original review: March 23, 2019 I had just hired Home Instead Senior Care in Bel Air Maryland for my brother who needed care. Before hiring Home Instead Senior Care my first question was, "How would you know if your employee will be clocking in since their way of doing things does not involve clocking in on the customer phone." I was informed by Kim that Home Instead can

see where they are at all times. So I hired them and they sent over a caregiver Laura and she apparently was clocking in on her phone then leaving the house then coming back to clock out at the end of her shift. She would do certain chores but then leave for the remainder of the required hours. VIEW MORE HELPFUL 18 people found this review helpful How do I know I can trust these reviews about Home Instead Senior Care? 1,876,557 reviews on ConsumerAffairs are verified. We require contact information to ensure our reviewers are real. We use intelligent software that helps us maintain the integrity of reviews. Our moderators read all reviews to verify quality and helpfulness. For more information about reviews on ConsumerAffairs.com please visit our FAQ. Rated with 1 star Jesse of Houston, TX Verified Reviewer Original review: March 1, 2019 Home Instead lies about everything, from background of caregivers, to age and experience. They will say a caregiver has worked for them for a long time and then when the caregiver shows up she says it is her first day to work for Home Instead. Age is misrepresented and caregivers are up to many, many years older than patients are told and they don't feel up to doing much other than sit. The caregivers who have worked for them before are dissatisfied with the company and say they are interviewing with other agencies but would like to work independently. The company is low paying but charges top prices for the caregivers. I do not recommend this company as I had bad experiences with them. HELPFUL 25 people found this review helpful Rated with 5 stars Susie of Tucson, AZ Verified Reviewer Original review: Nov. 30, 2018 From the moment I met with Becky from Home Instead I felt that she had my father's best interest in mind. The next day, both she and our potential caregiver, Brittany, visited with my dad and they made a plan and a schedule for in home visits. My father really appreciated Brittany's help and company. I really appreciated Becky's help finding insurance based PT and OT. She went out of her way to make sure that my dad had follow-up care. I would recommend Home Instead to anyone who needs to plan elder-care for a parent. They are professional, kind, and caring. HELPFUL 5 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star l. of New Zealand Verified Reviewer Original review: Nov. 17, 2018 Two of the seven different caregivers Home Instead sent us bonded well with the patient, actually gave him happiness in the last months of his life. And so when I requested these two special caregivers HOME INSTEAD would not allow them to return. Instead they sent other caregivers who actually made the patient's last months hellish. I am shocked by the cruelty of this company. It is supposed to be a service and yet they are crueler and detrimental. It was extremely hurtful and frustrating to an already difficult situation. STAY AWAY from HOME INSTEAD. HELPFUL 27 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star kira of Farmington, CT Verified Reviewer Original review: June 28, 2018 Well, they lasted a total of 1 1/2 times visit. I met with one person initially and did some sort of interview time thing in my home. I thought this person was fairly pleasant and easy to talk to. So the next time he came back with another worker (They seemed to be some sort of "package deal".) His agenda was to barge into my home, and personal, sacrosanct space, and re-make it according to "his image & liking". He seemed a tad confused, and thought he lived there. Not me! This is so disrespectful! And the other person's agenda was to sit down and never really get up again the entire time or do anything helpful or useful. Alas, we have run into this similar situation many times, with each type of "home health care" we have hired. VIEW MORE HELPFUL 46 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star James of Henrietta, TX Verified Reviewer Original review: May 22, 2018 I do not know anyone that likes or would tolerate a parade of strangers through their home but evidently that's the way Home Instead, does business. In the last 8 months, we have had 5 different people come and go from this company. What does it take to find one person that will do the job of just sitting, watching, and occasionally helping. The job is easy and indoors! They started out just fine for the first couple of months but then a different person every other day started showing up. HELPFUL 46 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star profile pic of the author Lexi of Kersey, CO Verified Reviewer Original review: Feb. 26, 2018 I had an interview with this company's Fort Collins branch last week and was offered a position. I received"

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d38b371f01869069cc2afb8>

"Shady Company/Takes your loved ones 1st month rent. I began a google search for "assisted living places near me". I wrote down all the info for the places near me for my mother in law. I began calling the assisted living facilities. I called a phone number in the nursing home website that was NOT listed as the phone number for a

Place for Mom. I speak to someone who I thought was from the nursing home only it was an operator who did NOT IDENTIFY herself as an operator for a place for mom. I then was directed to an "advisor" who again did NOT identify herself as a Rep for this company. I still thought I was speaking to someone from the nursing home. She began to tell me that she was a referral service and that there is no fee; that it is a free courtesy service. So I listened to her tell me 5 places near me and was reading the same reviews that she googled that I had already read! She then stated she would send my info to those 5 places for me to contact them. I chose a place quickly WITHOUT her help as I already had done the work myself. She did NOTHING, set up nothing, made no phone calls. I received emails from her which I did not read cause I NEVER SOLICITED HER HELP OR SERVICES. I was deferred to this company unbeknownst to me. 3 weeks later I get a text from her offering her help. I said we already found a place. She IMMEDIATELY calls the assisted living place to acquire her commission. I get a call from the director of the assisted living home minutes later asking me if I had used their service. I responded that I hadn't that I was redirected to them. I never asked for or used her help. He told me that they TAKE the loved ones 1st months' rent as their commission. I was furious! None of this was told to me at all! I called this chick up and in a heated discussion she informed me that the director of the nursing home is in violation and breach of their contract between them for telling me that she takes the rent money. I said...How is that not my business to know where my mother's money is going?". I argued that I never ASKED FOR her help and she did nothing to help me find a place so how do you feel justified in earning a \$5000 commission? She said that she sent a referral to them for me and an email with the list of 5 places. I responded that I never asked her to do this nor what she did helped because I already had them on my list to call. I asked why was the 1st months' rent never divulged to me during our 1 conversation? She said they are not taking my loved ones money so basically it doesn't concern me because it is a contract between a Place for mom and the assisted living facility. Then she explained that it is divulged in the emails at the very bottom IN THE FINE PRINT. I said 1.. I never read your emails cause I didn't need your help and 2.. that's not something you put in the fine print. (upon looking at the fine print it directs you to another link for questions/answers which never says their commission is the 1st months rent, just that they are paid a fee by the provider for their service). Shady company who took credit and money for something they never did. All she cared about was her commission. The point is that anyone can do a google search and do the exact same thing that they do. Then you'll know that your money for your loved one is actually going towards their care and NOT a commission fee! Finally, if banking \$5000 from an elderly person for sending out an email (called a referral) is considered ethical and appropriate business, then that is truly disturbing."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5e1dc8c2c845450bec3722b1>

"medical guardian failed in an emergency. My 86-year-old mother is 5 feet tall and weighs 180 pounds. She worked as a registered nurse for forty years and is still sharp as a tack. On September 10, 2025, at 7:30 a.m., she was alone when she fell while stepping out of our home onto the porch. She struck her head on the cement, causing a serious cut above her eye that bled heavily. She was wearing her fully charged Medical Guardian necklace. Three times she pressed the button for help, but there was absolutely no response. She tried to get up on her own and failed. She then pressed the button three more times, holding it down for up to five seconds each time—again with no response at all. Knowing she had no other choice, she problem solved and rallied enough strength to stand. By 8:10 a.m., she was at the bathroom sink tending to her wound. At 8:30, my niece arrived and took her to a walk-in clinic. The nurses there immediately recommended the emergency room. At the ER, her wound was closed with medical glue and she underwent a CAT scan. Thankfully, she had no broken bones and no internal bleeding. The next day, we called Medical Guardian to report the incident. The agent reviewed my mom's charging history and confirmed that her necklace was fully charged at the time of the fall. The agent then ran a test while staying on the line with us. My mom pressed the button—exactly as she had done six times the day before—and this time, the button worked. The agent concluded that my mom did not press the button properly after her fall. She also informed us that our plan did not include "fall protection." What is fall protection? It's a feature that automatically detects when a user falls and immediately responds with verbal assistance—without the user needing to press a button. Our plan did not include fall protection? WHAT? That is exactly why we purchased this

necklace 15 months ago, why we continued to pay for it, why my mom charged it daily, and why she wore it whenever it wasn't on the charger. Why would any company sell this kind of product without fall protection automatically included? The story gets worse. The agent explained that when we purchased the necklace in February 2024, there was a promotion that included free fall protection. Then why didn't we have it? The agent asked us to hold while she checked with a manager about adding that feature to our plan, for free. After placing us on hold, she informed us that the manager said we could not add this feature for free 18 months after we originally signed with the company. Instead, we would have to pay an extra \$10 per month for fall protection. So fall protection is a hidden cost? I explained that when I bought the plan in February 2024 no one ever mentioned anything about needing a separate fall protection plan. Furthermore, if I had been asked whether I wanted the fall protection added for free, why on earth would I have said no? This company claims to care about protecting the elderly, but nothing in our experience supports that claim. After this ordeal, we canceled our Medical Guardian service and purchased a SMART watch instead. I highly recommend you do the same."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/68c5c7fe47a0acdada1ee1acb>

"Life Alert should be sued for HARASSMENT. Bottom line: + Good product for clients without dementia x Horrendous user experience & 'customer svc' This is my personal experience with Life Alert: Life Alert's website is a dial-up from the early 90s. There is no email or mailing address. You have to CALL for anything and everything, as if the adult children of ailing parents want to spend hours on the phone with a Used Car Salesman (which was the vibe). Life Alert requires THREE PHONE CALLS just to sign up. After listening to the original rep drone on and on about the benefits, he informed me that I would receive two more phone calls to confirm that I wanted to sign up for the services. I was like, "Dude, I work full time. I'm sold on the product. Shut up and take my money!" But he would not. It was baffling and RIDICULOUS. After the rigmarole of getting signed up and receiving/setting up the products, Life Alert was great. The first year, my mom fell several times and pressed her necklace button. The paramedics came quickly, and I was thrilled with the products and services. Note on billing: Life Alert was very insistent that I pay by credit card. I was very insistent on paying by check. (I know...Freaky Friday.) I'm SO glad I did this, as I received harassing phone calls and notices for months and months in the beginning of services stating I had not paid my mom's bill. In fact, I had (auto-checks sent from my bank). It was over six months before the harassment temporarily abated. Then, Mom had stroke #3 and became too confused to remember to use the necklace button. I attempted several times to cancel Life Alert and asked for an address to return the equipment, but to no avail. It sat unused for nearly a year. Mom is now in Hospice, and Life Alert calls everyone on my mom's emergency contact list and me several times a week (Jan 2024). I had a lone email from a specific Life Alert employee (no email is listed on their website) and made yet another attempt to return their equipment but haven't heard back. They FORCE you to call them and deal with their absurd hoop-jumping phone transfers. If I didn't work and take care of my terminally ill mother, I might sue Life Alert for harassment. They are truly bullies. Advice: Research medic-alert buttons and go with a different brand. Life Alert doesn't seem to know that they have competition—companies that provide the same level of care *minus* the harassment."

trustpilot · Life Alert · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65aab6f9be44d4364eeee97c>

"I do not recommend their services. You may or may not get a good care giver that understands and speaks English. We got lucky that the first care giver assigned was wonderful but, when they sent a replacement for a day that care giver couldn't come, the replacement was terrible. If there was a time when the assigned care giver couldn't come, I told them not to send a replacement anymore. Another big issue for me was their inaccurate invoices. They consistently overbilled for time not worked. I learned that they don't bill based on the care giver's time sheet. They bill whatever they want and it's up to you to notify them of the actual time worked. It's only after you notify them of the incorrect billing that they bother to look at the employee's time sheet to verify the hours worked. I notified them more than once that I want to be billed correctly and for the actual time worked but they continued to overbill, after they told me they would bill based on the employee's time sheet. They even billed for Monday, July 5, when their employee didn't work because July 4 fell on a Sunday and the employee took Monday

off for the holiday. When I contacted them about billing for a day that the care giver didn't even come, their response was "oh yes, we were supposed to take that off". Just today, I received an invoice from them for the first week of August, which was the last 2 days the care giver worked and, it was wrong! The care giver quit working for this company after the first week of August. If they handle their employees the way they handle their clients, it's no wonder they quit working for them. I only continued doing business with them because of the one care giver but, since she no longer works there, I found other arrangements for my mother. Actually, her quitting was a blessing in disguise because I found someone else to do business with for a lower hourly rate. This company is very expensive. My experience with their management staff shows they are unconcerned about providing good customer service. You would think after numerous emails, complaining about the overbillings, they would make an effort to invoice correctly. They never did. I guess they count on people not looking at the details on the invoice and just paying the amount invoiced. I hope this review saves at least one person from paying more than they received care for."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=At%20Your%20Side%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJgWEGg6LdQIYRt9IKRAZ8H2M

"I do not recommended anyone sending their loved one here. They will tell you exactly what you want to hear but do not deliver. My mom caught COVID in Dec. and was in the hospital they transferred her to a long term facility and then she was sent here. A week after being at Capstone she went from good to bad. My mother had dark circles under her eyes and was just very unhappy. She looked totally different from when she left the long term facility. She couldn't sleep at night because she heard people screaming all night and running up and down the hallways. One time she woke up to a woman in her room staring at her while she slept. When she explained to them she was having trouble sleeping they offered her pain pills to sleep! They moved my mother to a new room and she needed a nurse she kept pressing the nurse call button but no one would come. The next morning she told the nurse only to find out the nurse call button was unplugged. If my mom was in dire need something terrible could've happened. On multiple occasions after visits she was left in a chair for hours unattended. My sister and I had a conference call with the staff there to address these issues was told it wouldn't happened again but it did. The last time it happened my mother was in the chair for 8 hours! Physical therapy was to be done for an hour at least 5 days a week and that didn't happened. When my mom got to Capstone she was able to stand with the help of the therapist but when she left she was so weak because of the lack of PT. Most the people at Capstone are unprofessional starting with the receptionist. There is a tremendous lack of communication that goes on here. My mother had an unsafe and terrible discharge. Capstone sent her home with the wrong medical equipment which caused her to be rushed back to the hospital. When we let them know they said they would work on getting her the right equipment and I have yet to hear from them. She was at Capstone for 25 days or so and has now been at the hospital for 5 and the hospital has done more for my mother than Capstone ever did. Capstone neglected my mother. People need to know how this place is being run. Capstone did nothing for my mom."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Avir%20at%20Orem&query_place_id=ChIJeQC8N-DrQIYRz-sdMRXG_jo

"Don't trust everything the salesperson says.... Finding the right medical alert system for a loved one can be a time-consuming task. To make this task more frustrating, the salesperson who sells you the system and service is not the person you speak with once the product arrives. We were looking for a product that my loved one can wear when he is in the community running errands and visiting with friends. As the salesperson stated and we discovered, this device allows that. My loved one is older, and like many older people has begun to lose his hearing and has a hearing loss. When speaking to the salesperson I asked very specific questions about being able to adjust the volume on the device to accommodate the hearing loss. I was told the volume control does adjust. We bought the product and had it shipped to our house. Here is where it started to become frustrating. When the devices came, we couldn't see how the volume adjusted as my loved one couldn't hear to set it up, nor could he hear the person talking through the speaker. When I called product support, I was told the volume was as high as it could

go and it could not be adjusted any higher. Trying to cancel the service and get our money back has become even more frustrating, and ultimately the reason to write this review. When I called to explain this system would not work for my loved one and why, they eventually canceled the service, but would not refund the cost of the system or the month we had it while not using it trying to figure this out. After explaining it didn't work based on misinformation the company's employee gave and not getting anywhere, I asked to speak to a manager. I gave my name and number so the manager could call me back. After 3 days of not hearing back from a manager I called again. This time a week went by when I realized I didn't hear back. I called again, and again; I didn't hear from a manager. I have called and asked to speak to a manager 4-5 times and still have not heard anything. This experience has cost over \$500 and a lot of time and frustration. I would highly recommend not using Medical Guardian as your medical alert system."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/62c99b5c0c20b4453c34afc9>

"A Smart Bit Of Kit!. This pill dispenser is a smart bit of kit! It won't be suitable for everyone's needs, but in specific situations this pill dispenser could be the answer for medication management. To use this pill dispenser, you're required to download an app. I found set up to be quite simple through the app, and pairing the dispenser to the app was relatively easy. This dispenser requires a Wi-Fi connection to correctly function, so this dispenser is not suitable for those not connected to the internet. For a caregiver, this pill dispenser can be a very useful tool. Once set up, a caregiver can remotely monitor when it's time for the meds to be taken, and check if the dispenser's lid has been opened. As with any pill dispenser, filling each compartment is a bit tedious when you have multiple medications, but it's worth it in the end. This pill dispenser has the capacity to hold anywhere between 3–28 days worth of medication, dependent on how many times a day the meds are required. In terms of quality, this dispenser is okay. It's made out of a plastic that feels to be fine quality, but not the best. I wouldn't have much hope for it surviving any bumps or drops on the floor. The screen is good quality, and is easy to read. I like that the pill dispenser is rechargeable, and is charged via a USB cable, rather than it using standard batteries. Also, another thing to note is that this pill dispenser is quite large. However, when considering it has a capacity to store multiple medications for up to 28 days, I have found it to be much more space efficient than having multiple boxes of different tablets in my bedside draw. Obviously, at just shy of £130, this pill dispenser is not cheap, and I do think it's a little overpriced. It's a nice bit of kit if you/you care for someone who is the kind to forget medication, but if you/the one you care for is always up-to-date with meds, then this dispenser is definitely not worth the price tag! Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/REYI76WXQ4GOM>

"Ambiance setting. I recently purchased the Lynnloland 21" Set of 2 Table Lamps for my bedroom nightstands, and I couldn't be happier with my choice! These lamps are not just stylish but also incredibly functional and user-friendly. The first thing I noticed was how elegant and modern these lamps look. The black fabric shade adds a chic touch to my bedroom décor while creating a warm and cozy ambiance. At 21 inches tall, they are the perfect height—not too big, not too small. They fit beautifully on my nightstands without taking up too much space. One of my favorite features is the touch control dimming! With just a simple tap on the base, I can adjust the brightness to three different levels—low for a relaxing evening, medium for watching TV, and high for reading before bed. It's such a convenient feature, especially when I don't want to fumble for a switch in the middle of the night. Another huge plus is the built-in USB ports and AC outlets. I no longer need to reach for an extra charger or outlet behind my nightstand—I can charge my phone, smartwatch, and even my tablet right from the lamp! It keeps my nightstand clutter-free and makes my nighttime routine so much easier. The included 2700K LED bulbs give off a soft, warm glow, which is exactly what I wanted for my bedroom. It's easy on the eyes, yet bright enough when needed. The black shade does slightly mute the brightness, but it actually works well for creating a calming atmosphere before bed. Final Thoughts – A Must-Have for Any Bedroom! Overall, this lamp set is one of the best purchases I've made for my bedroom! The design is stylish, the touch controls are super convenient, and the built-

in charging ports are a game-changer. If you're looking for a modern, functional, and beautiful nightstand lamp, this is an absolute must-have! ★ Rating: 5/5 – Highly Recommend! Would definitely buy again and might even grab another set for the guest room! 😊 Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1RW3RVA1EM8ID>

"It has taken me a while to sit down and write this. I am a caregiver for my dad, and this facility came highly recommended. Unfortunately, our experience was incredibly stressful—especially for a short respite stay of just six days. From the start, I felt like I had to be there more than I should have been. They asked me to write down what he would eat, which I did—keeping in mind that my dad has dementia, and we are now in our sixth year of navigating this journey. I repeatedly told them to simply walk by and make sure he was sitting upright in bed, since he doesn't always remember to press the call button. I even spoke with Jessica, the manager, about my concerns. My family and I ended up bringing food from home because my dad wouldn't eat what they were serving him. On top of that, every time I visited, I had to refill his water and bring him fresh water myself—it might have been done at some point, but it wasn't consistent. I had an event on Saturday, and instead of letting him stay until Monday as originally planned, I decided to bring him home early—and thank God I did. He came back with an infection and was dehydrated. Since I've been caring for my dad, he has *never* had a UTI or been dehydrated like he was when he returned home from this stay. And honestly, this isn't even everything—I'm being nice. Mind you, there were some good nurses, and I appreciate them. But overall, this was not the level of care I expected, and I would be very hesitant to trust them with his care again. I hope with this review the facility will learn it's not just a job, that to take pride and give more care to those who can't do it for themselves. If you're sitting and it's not your break then you should be checking on your people."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Desert%20Peak%20Care%20Center&query_place_id=ChIJvfxRqA4QK4cRK1n6X9wR2sk

"Absolute necessity for elderly monitoring. Have two of these alarms and we could not be more pleased! One is dedicated to keeping an eye on our elderly parent in bed. The other unit is for when parent is watching TV in family room and we are outdoors gardening, in the barn or mowing. The alarm sound component is portable. We slip it in a pocket or just place it where we're working. We can hear the alarm chime in a pocket over the tractor noise - great for when parent moves or needs our help. We mow about an acre and the unit has no issues covering this area. We use these great little monitors in conjunction with radio wave baby monitors (we never use wifi monitors due to hacking privacy issues). Our elderly parent is monitored while we are going about household chores by day and during the night. Five years of 24/7 use these monitors are still reliable. They are easy on batteries. We've only changed batteries out twice in three years. The unit actually lets you know when the batteries need changing - the alarm starts to sound like a creature from the outer limits. Please note the two alarm sound choices are somewhat sappy, and very loud. That's actually a great feature if you are a sound sleeper or on a tractor. We keep the alarm unit outside our bedroom as it's a bit startling when it goes off. We're ordering a couple more units as spares. We also use the gardening unit to keep an eye on our open (and locked) sliding screen door, just in case a visitor comes there instead of the front door. Unit is simple, low cost, so far completely reliable, no wifi to mess with, no apps, just your ears being alerted if your patient is moving. Kudos to the manufacturer. Highly recommend! Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/Rl8MHRUE9D4TL>

"Life saver !. Love this little setup it has made my night as caretaker so much better. I can set this up, place the caretaker receiver in my room with doors close and it goes off and let's me know when my MIL wants to get up to bathroom as soon as her feet touches floor. I place the motion piece on the floor just under the frame and it pickup about a three foot wide area. No more jumping up when I had baby monitor on cause it would pick up noises which made me believe she was try to get out of bed .I was up and down several times a night. With this set up I

can go to sleep , be woke up only when necessary. Plus I know other people mention you can't adjust volume and it is loud, but I have a hearing problem and don't wear my hearing aid at night so it is perfect for my sound ranged it has two tones one like a door bell the other a tone that goes off twice. My husband says it is loud but you hear it in the room with receiver in it not in the person's room. She just sit up it only goes off while her body is in range and if she tries to stand to get on bedside commode. I highly recommend this to anyone. Plus I turn off during the day if she's in her wheelchair so battery will last longer. Use baby monitor during day if I am out of her sight. UPDATE: Still love this set up so reliable. Been two months batteries haven't been changed, but I am good about turning off when not in use. I would buy again if I ever have the need. It's loud also so with a hearing problem I have no problem hearing and the receiver covers a large range I can go out side with it and it still receives which puts me a good 100 yards from base. I has pay for it self in my getting more sleep. Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R26VZQXK85KQ21>

"Huge relief. Mom has a bit of dementia (not full blown but just enough), and taking medication was becoming confusing for her. This pill dispenser is set on a schedule (for her it's 2x a day), first dose, it sets off an alarm and she knows to go to it and take her pills. It's a locked unit so she can't open it therefore no worries of her taking more medication. It comes with two keys. Each key will open/lock the unit. Of course she does not have access to the keys. The description of the unit will have a full explanation as to how to set it up for one's specific needs. Since my mom has to take her meds in the morning (6 pills fit in one compartment) and in the evening (2pills in a separate compartment), that's one day. For my mom the unit holds two weeks worth of medication twice a day. When the alarm goes off at the time specified for her first dose, she then hears it, goes to the unit, slides open the opening which holds only her first dose, lifts up the lightweight unit with one hand and drops the pills into the other hand and slides the opening closed. That's it, until the next alarm sounds for her evening dose and she does the same thing all over again. This unit has fixed the issue she was having of either forgetting to take her meds or thinking she didn't take them and would take more. I highly recommend this unit for seniors who live on their own and enjoy being in their own space but have trouble remembering to take their medication when they're supposed to. After the unit is empty I reset it with another 14 days worth of medication and have piece of mind that my mom is taking her medication correctly. I hope you found this to be helpful. Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3F2ZQS0892KKK>

"Piece of mind. I bought this tracker for my Mom who has Alzheimers and loves to walk the neighborhood. Occasionally when she is having a bad day, she will leave the neighborhood to look for her house, those who are dealing with alzheimers parents get it. This tracker gives me piece of mind that I can see where she is at when I am at work. It is not without its issues, battery life is lacking, but I do have it set to refresh every minute, so I am experimenting with having the refresh times different when she is home, and changing it when she is walking. Even on the 1 minute refresh, it is more like 3 or 4 minutes till it refreshes her location, even if I close out the app and restart it, but I can still deal with that. I am able to geofence the neighborhood and get notices when she goes of the geofence. I am able to have the app on multiple phones, that way my sons and I can keep track of her as well. But my favorite feature is that I can call the tracker and I have it set to automatically answer so she doesnt have to look for a button to press. The call is clear, and I can even hear her feet walking. It is really a handy feature to have. I use it often just to check in and make sure she is ok, and I know she feels more secure as well. She can also call my phone by clicking the button, hopefully if she gets lost and finds someone to help they will realize to click the button to call me. While its not perfect, it has been a game changer for me, especially when I am at work. There is a monthly fee, and different levels depending on what your needs are. I highly recommend this tracker if you have a loved one you need to constantly keep an eye on! Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2I9NWQ66WZVF8>

"Home Instead provides 24 hour care for my Mom. Staff is personable, professional, caring and attentive to my Mom. The agency has worked very hard with me to find the right personnel to stay with Mom. She can be difficult and smokes!! Anyway, I've been really pleased with Home Instead and would recommend. Lion101 5 | February 8, 2020 I am a current client of this provider We've been with Home Instead for better than a year. They've provided several interim caregivers and two permanent ones. Their nursing supervisor, Laura B. visits the house quarterly to check on things and react to questions or problems. The agency has always responded well to any questions or problems that have surfaced. NancyB1 5 | November 27, 2012 I am a current client of this provider We've been working with Home Instead for quite a while. I think they're doing great. We appreciate very much. We've been happy working with their office, they're very helpful. Everything has been great. Our biggest problem is being able to afford. Of course, they're pretty affordable compare to other groups, but my parents have limited income, so we try to limit the hours as much. ## Services and Amenities of Home Instead - Kennesaw, GA in Kennesaw, Georgia ### Ambulatory Assistance & Accessibility *Transfer Assistance* Mobility & Wheelchair Assistance ### Family/Caregiver & Relocation Services *Family Communication Services* Transitional Care ### Personal Care *Bathing Assistance* Toileting Assistance * Dressing Assi"

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/kennesaw/home-instead-kennesaw-ga>

"We had a wonderful experience with Regency Home Care. They addressed all of our needs and beyond. Kind and Caring are the two words that express how I feel about their services. My Mother has passed on now but she was appreciative of the care they offered her. Thank you again for your services and I highly recommend Regency Home Care for any senior that needs help. [Read All Reviews](#all_reviews_section) ## About Regency Home Care of North Atlanta in Atlanta, Georgia Regency Home Care of North Atlanta is a Senior Care provider in Atlanta, Georgia that offers residents [Home Care](/senior-care/in-home-care/georgia/atlanta) services. Contact Regency Home Care of North Atlanta for more details on services and rates. ## Compare Regency Home Care of North Atlanta with verified providers nearby CURRENTLY VIEWING ![Regency Home Care of North Atlanta](https://d13iq96prksfho.cloudfront.net/cdn/photos/104053/275x275) Regency Home Care of North Atlanta 1633 Mount Vernon Road, Suite 200, Atlanta, GA 30338 Reviews [4.4 (14)](/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/regency-home-care-of-north-atlanta-30338#all_reviews_section) --- Areas Served Atlanta --- Payment Options - --- Highlighted Care Services - --- ![Brighton Gardens of Dunwoody](https://d3ep5zm82rva6t.cloudfront.net/provider-portal/location-images/yj20077u2zzxdszvkiaw.jpg?width=275&height=275&format=auto&quality=70)] (/senior-living/georgia/atlanta/brighton-gardens-of-dunwoody-30338) [Brighton Gardens of Dunwoody] (/senior-living/georgia/at"

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/regency-home-care-of-north-atlanta-30338>

"Home Instead was the best decision we made for the care of my mother. The scheduling process was easy and the caretaker is wonderful. Christine quickly bonded with mom and was a true blessing. My mother loved her companionship, caring nature and all around attitude. In fact, we were just increasing her time each week. Thank you ladies. You are such a blessing. Norma15 4 | December 10, 2014 I am a current client of this provider Good franchise - perhaps the best. They are diligently looking for and working on any improvements they can make. Earl6 5 | October 3, 2014 I am a past client of this provider Giver was attentive, and asked to help, instead of waiting to be asked to help. Thomas39 5 | August 30, 2014 I am a current client of this provider I am very pleased with the service. Everyone is very polite and helpful. Give everyone a raise. ## Services and Amenities of Home Instead West and Southwest Houston in Houston, Texas ### Resident Requirements *Allows Patient Transfers* ### *Companionship & Escort Assistance* Companionship Services ### Fitness & Wellness Programs *Fitness Opportunities* ### *Personal Care* *Bathing Assistance* *Toileting Assistance* *Dressing Assistance* *Personal Care Assistants* ### *Care Management Services* Residency Confirmation ### *Ambulatory Assistance & Accessibility* *Transfer Assistance* Mobility & Wheelchair Assistance ### Family/Caregiver & Relocation Services *Family Communication Services* Transitional Care ### Health Services * Companion"

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/texas/houston/home-instead-west-and-southwest-houston>

"Since 2012, I have had 2 live-in caregivers from Regency Home Care on an alternating weekly assignment. Since the start, two caregivers have left and been replaced by other competitive women. All have been easy for me to live with and good in taking care of me. Caring98222750 5 | September 1, 2014 I am a current client of this provider Our helper is super. She is knowledgeable, pleasant, and kind. She knows the patient's needs and often has it for him before he knows he needs it. She has a neat way to get him to take meds, with an "open wide." Cleaning is not her favorite, but she does it. She is a very good driver. (car) Caring98220350 5 | September 1, 2014 I am a current client of this provider Regency Home Care is my home care provider. The transportation to my physical therapy has always been very good. I also use this agency for trimming my toe nails and light house keeping in which they are very good as well! Joy15 5 | January 28, 2014 I am a past client of this provider My friend has received excellent care from the whole staff at Regency. The staffers are attentive, organized, personable, knowledgeable, and compassionate. I think Erich, Donna, Tammy and Marva are a care-giving team beyond compare. I highly recommend regency Home Care of North Atlanta Barbara81642350 5 | December 24, 2013 I am a current client of this provider The staff are pleasant and easy to work with. We have had several caregivers over the past 3 years and they have been reliable professional and"

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/regency-home-care-of-north-atlanta-30338>

"The start up procedure left much to be desired. I received the Premium Guardian with the Basic Guardian manual. Reaching a representative by phone was extremely frustrating,twice after being on hold for ten minutes The message was to leave my name and phone number and a representative would get back to me,unfortunately no one ever did.This was on a Friday.I called back on Monday and after five minutes I reached a representative. .However for the elderly population these devices are marketed to this could be devastating. The pendant also comes with a long non adjustable cord which can be irritating on the neck.I was told by the representative I could cut the cord off if I wanted to.I solved it for myself by tucking it in my bra.I do not want to wear this over a sweater or shirt. The device also flashes red at times,this is the GPS system searching for a signal. The web site does not give any of this information. I chose this device because of its unlimited range as I am an active senior. I hope the company management would be made aware of these things and :1 Improve phone response time. 2 Consider designing an adjustable chain for the pendant. I have used it for 2 weeks and since you have a 3 month commitment I will continue to evaluate it during that time.It appears to be working fine. When you get the device there is also a fair amount of small print disclaimers.Be sure to read them."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/56db3c790000ff00094285cb>

They came the same day / at a moment's notice · 388 documents

20 most engaged of 388 matching documents, complete text.

"Search home instead: outstanding model. Search Need a medical alert system? FIND MY MATCH HomeElder Care Home Care Services Updated on 07/22/2019 Home Instead Senior Care Overall Satisfaction Rating Based on 129 ratings SHOW RATING DISTRIBUTION Need a medical alert system? We'll match you with the right company that knows what you need. FIND MY MATCH Home Instead Senior Care ConsumerAffairs Unaccredited Brand This company is not yet accredited. To learn more, see reviews below or submit your own. Home Instead Senior Care does NOT participate in the ConsumerAffairs accreditation program. Learn More Be in the know Get trending consumer news and recalls Email Enter your email here SUBSCRIBE Are you this business? LEARN MORE 146 Home Instead Senior Care Consumer Reviews Sort: Recent Filter by: Any Rated with 1 star profile pic of the author Mary of Clarendon Hills, IL Verified Reviewer Original review: July 12, 2019 We used Home Instead in Oak Park, IL. I feel when we needed them the most they failed us. Most of the staff was ill equipped to handle my mother's needs as she deteriorated. She was bedridden and it took 3 people to change the soiled sheets and her, most of the caretakers had no idea what to do. As if that is not bad enough one of the caretakers decided to clean my mother up, exposing her private parts in front of family (her grandchildren) that were there visiting. I'm appalled that the caretaker would think that was acceptable in any way, shape or form. They also lack communication, as supplies were delivered from hospice boxes were stacked in a place that was not easily seen and never communicated that supplies had been delivered. If you love your family member I do not recommend them at all! HELPFUL Be the first one to find this review helpful Rated with 4 stars profile pic of the author Elaine of Los Angeles, CA Verified Reviewer Original review: July 9, 2019 It is important to understand that the experience I describe here is related to one of Home Instead's many franchises. I have read negative reviews that have nothing to do with the Culver City franchise I used. In fact the home instead office that I dealt with was highly professional, courteous, and client-oriented. At our initial meeting they provided me with a list of qualities that I could expect from my caregivers. They made it very clear that I was to notify the office at any time that I felt I was not appropriately being cared for. VIEW MORE 3 people found this review helpful Not sure how to choose? Get expert buying tips about Home Care Services delivered to your inbox. Email Enter your email here LEARN FROM THE PROS We value your privacy. Unsubscribe easily. Rated with 1 star edie of Vancouver, WA Verified Reviewer Original review: June 5, 2019 Since negative stars are not available, they get one. Totally negative on the high turnover staff. The RN's are combative and prone to slander. They treat workers and families horribly. If you want caregivers sleeping during the shift, and having basically no idea on proper care of your elder, this is the company for you. None of the home staff are licensed, and most are morons. Unfortunately, once they are in your life, its near impossible to get rid of due to attachment with the good ones. Near two years into this adventure leaves a bad taste. HELPFUL 3 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star Larry of Surprise, AZ Verified Reviewer Original review: June 4, 2019 They lasted two days as they dropped my loved one TWICE in 2 days. They also have questionable pricing as 2 twelve hour shifts is not considered 24 hrs in their pricing. They showed one shift as awake and the other resting but charged the higher rate for both. When questioned they told me they didn't have any 24 hour shifts. They are nothing but baby sitters. HELPFUL 5 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star Georgia of Forest Hill, MD Verified Reviewer Original review: March 23, 2019 I had just hired Home Instead Senior Care in Bel Air Maryland for my brother who needed care. Before hiring Home Instead Senior Care my first question was, "How would you know if your employee will be clocking in since their way of doing things does not involve clocking in on the customer phone." I was informed by Kim that Home Instead can see where they are at all times. So I hired them and they sent over a caregiver Laura and she apparently was clocking in on her phone then leaving the house then coming back to clock out at the end of her shift. She would do certain chores but then leave for the remainder of the required hours. VIEW MORE HELPFUL 18 people found this review helpful How do I know I can trust these reviews about Home Instead Senior Care? 1,876,557 reviews on ConsumerAffairs are verified. We require contact information to ensure our reviewers are real. We use

intelligent software that helps us maintain the integrity of reviews. Our moderators read all reviews to verify quality and helpfulness. For more information about reviews on ConsumerAffairs.com please visit our FAQ. Rated with 1 star Jesse of Houston, TX Verified Reviewer Original review: March 1, 2019 Home Instead lies about everything, from background of caregivers, to age and experience. They will say a caregiver has worked for them for a long time and then when the caregiver shows up she says it is her first day to work for Home Instead. Age is misrepresented and caregivers are up to many, many years older than patients are told and they don't feel up to doing much other than sit. The caregivers who have worked for them before are dissatisfied with the company and say they are interviewing with other agencies but would like to work independently. The company is low paying but charges top prices for the caregivers. I do not recommend this company as I had bad experiences with them. HELPFUL 25 people found this review helpful Rated with 5 stars Susie of Tucson, AZ Verified Reviewer Original review: Nov. 30, 2018 From the moment I met with Becky from Home Instead I felt that she had my father's best interest in mind. The next day, both she and our potential caregiver, Brittany, visited with my dad and they made a plan and a schedule for in home visits. My father really appreciated Brittany's help and company. I really appreciated Becky's help finding insurance based PT and OT. She went out of her way to make sure that my dad had follow-up care. I would recommend Home Instead to anyone who needs to plan elder-care for a parent. They are professional, kind, and caring. HELPFUL 5 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star l. of New Zealand Verified Reviewer Original review: Nov. 17, 2018 Two of the seven different caregivers Home Instead sent us bonded well with the patient, actually gave him happiness in the last months of his life. And so when I requested these two special caregivers HOME INSTEAD would not allow them to return. Instead they sent other caregivers who actually made the patient's last months hellish. I am shocked by the cruelty of this company. It is supposed to be a service and yet they are crueler and detrimental. It was extremely hurtful and frustrating to an already difficult situation. STAY AWAY from HOME INSTEAD. HELPFUL 27 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star kira of Farmington, CT Verified Reviewer Original review: June 28, 2018 Well, they lasted a total of 1 1/2 times visit. I met with one person initially and did some sort of interview time thing in my home. I thought this person was fairly pleasant and easy to talk to. So the next time he came back with another worker (They seemed to be some sort of "package deal".) His agenda was to barge into my home, and personal, sacrosanct space, and re-make it according to "his image & liking". He seemed a tad confused, and thought he lived there. Not me! This is so disrespectful! And the other person's agenda was to sit down and never really get up again the entire time or do anything helpful or useful. Alas, we have run into this similar situation many times, with each type of "home health care" we have hired. VIEW MORE HELPFUL 46 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star James of Henrietta, TX Verified Reviewer Original review: May 22, 2018 I do not know anyone that likes or would tolerate a parade of strangers through their home but evidently that's the way Home Instead, does business. In the last 8 months, we have had 5 different people come and go from this company. What does it take to find one person that will do the job of just sitting, watching, and occasionally helping. The job is easy and indoors! They started out just fine for the first couple of months but then a different person every other day started showing up. HELPFUL 46 people found this review helpful Rated with 1 star profile pic of the author Lexi of Kersey, CO Verified Reviewer Original review: Feb. 26, 2018 I had an interview with this company's Fort Collins branch last week and was offered a position. I received"

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5d38b371f01869069cc2afb8>

"Here's my resignation letter. Here's my resignation letter, copy pasted. Enjoy! ----- I resign my position with Home Instead. You can't treat people like garbage and expect them to stay. 1. For my very first assignment, you tried putting me with a client who had an EXTREMELY deadly and contagious disease. You tried convincing me to go anyway since the disease was "in his lungs" and therefore not a threat. You are not a doctor and have no medical authority to make such a claim, and the evidence available online clearly contradicts this. The disease is just as contagious when it's in a person's lungs. I explained I could potentially kill the person I live with, and you still persisted that I should take this assignment despite that concern, and without acknowledging that concern. . I said once in a voicemail that I would like to cancel that assignment. I said again in an email that I would like to

cancel the assignment. Despite saying this twice in two different ways, I still got a call that woke me up from a dead sleep the next morning where you continued telling me to go to take the assignment. . 2. I told you several times about my issue with dogs. I carried a cane with me out to my car each time I left the office during the three day training. One of the staff asked why I do this, and I explained that it's to protect myself. The cane is a weapon I can use against dogs if I'm attacked. The matter has to be extremely important if a person carries a weapon expecting a possible confrontation. It's not something a person does casually. I explained the history -- again more than once -- of being attacked by dogs. My statements were acknowledged, and I was told "I'll put that in your file". So for my very first assignment, you put me with a client who has a "medium sized dog" (such as a pit bull.) After acknowledging my concern. And putting it in my file. . 3. I was going into a dangerous situation on my first assignment, and was told I had an emergency number on the back of my name badge that I could call. I tried calling it, and it "didn't recognize my phone number", meaning I could not access the emergency line if I was in trouble. . 4. I spent hours on my day off trying to fix an error in the tax forms, as well as filling out a series of other forms. For the future, you might consider trying to get all paperwork done and out of the way on the first day of the three day training, so by day three, if there are problems, you can fix them while the employee is at location, rather than sending a dozen emails pressuring them to fix such errors at home on their day off. . 5. I told you I strongly prefer shifts starting at 9am. I told you this at our very first interview, and this is another thing I explained several times. I said I was willing to bend a little, and could start work at 8am. My first shift was canceled for reasons discussed above, and my next shift after that one was scheduled not at 9am, not at 8am, but at 7am. It's almost like you've listened closely to everything I've told you, and are deliberately trying to step over every boundary I've put up. . But this one went even further. I was told again and again to begin work at 7am, and had to repeat over and over that I was available starting at 8am at the earliest. It genuinely felt like talking to a brick wall. This tells me that if I stay at this company for any length of time, I'm going to be very routinely ignored, and have to assert the same boundaries repeatedly. And this isn't over taking a week off from work, or needing some special consideration of which the company would have to go out of its way to accommodate. This much fuss was being made over 1 single hour of start time, and again, I told you my availability at our very first interview. . If starting at 8am was a serious problem, you should not have hired me. Or you could have assigned me to literally any other client that does not require a 7am start time. That was another option you decided not to take. Hiring someone who tells you the conditions of their employment, then blatantly ignoring everything that person tells you, might be part of the reason your company has a staffing retention problem. Perhaps you're used to hiring people who are so financially desperate that they don't have a choice. I'm financially stable with multiple sources of income. I took this job purely because I wanted to. Not everyone can be bullied. . I'm not sure how many times I explained that my earliest start time is 8am, but by 5pm on June 20th, it was clear that you simply refuse to listen, and you're seemingly okay putting me in extremely dangerous situations with little regard for my concerns, so I'm resigning. . And since understanding start times is such a problem for you, this email is scheduled to be sent at 6am. I will be sleeping in, so please don't call (and I'm turning my phone off since you'll probably ignore that too.)"

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a3d8794876bdf779f0c33a6>

"Good luck if you want to cancel, they will keep charging your card till you dispute it with your bank . I picked up this service for my 80 yo mother who lives alone, as she wanted something like this to feel more secure, in case something happens. The device was fine, the setup was easy. I have no complains about that part. Disclaimer - my mom actually never had to use the device for real emergency (thanks god). But when we did tests, it worked. I paid for the service for about 2 years. But then my mom confessed to me, that she wasn't actually wearing device for a long time anymore. She didn't want to waste the money, so she asked me to cancel. That's where the problems started. There is no way to cancel the service online, you have to call for that. I called on January 31st of 2026, they told they were canceling the service, I received the email stating "We have received your request to cancel your services with us. We understand that each individual's situation is unique, and your safety is our top priority.". Cancelled, right? but, wait for it. First in the same email down there was another sell pitch: they offered

to keep the membership for the price which was 60% lower. After the price was mentioned, there was this: "If you feel this aligns with your needs and decide to stay with us under this new monthly pricing, simply reply with "Keep my account active with my new monthly price." I didn't reply, didn't click on anything, as I didn't need lower price, I needed to cancel. On February 27th I received their regular email "This is your invoice XXX from Medical Guardian", and my credit card was charged again - for the full amount I was paying before, not even with discounted price. I called them again, and the guy on the phone kind of yelled at me, told me that I was supposed to receive an email with some paper I was supposed to sign and return to them that I do want to cancel (?) I told him that I received the confirmation that my cancellation request was received. But I have received nothing else. He told me in an irritated manner that I should receive it this time. I asked him to stay with me on the phone till I receive the email - normal practice with other companies customer service. He stated he had no time for that, that he told me I should receive it, I should check my spam folder, and hang up on me. I waited for couple hours, checked my spam folder couple times - nothing. So I just contacted Chase (the bank of the credit card I was using), and asked them to dispute the transaction. Which they did immediately. And this tells you something too. I had to do dispute only twice in my life before, and I was asked to provide receipts, describe the situation etc. Here I just provided the date I received the cancellation confirmation and the phone number I called. This probably means that I am not the only one, and Chase already dealt with the company before. So judge to yourself, if you want to deal with the, or not. To add to that, I got a call from them about a week after the guy yelled at me on the phone. I thought it was about cancellation and me disputing the charge, so I called them back. Wrong guess: they just wanted to sell me some extra service for extra charge, like I never cancelled.... Update of 03/27/2026: I just changed my 2-star review to 1-star. Since my review I received couple more calls from Medical Guardian - I assume trying to sell me something. I called them back, talked to a reasonable sounding woman who told me again that I needed to sign some paperwork that I wanted to cancel there services (even though I already requested it and received the confirmation about it on January 31st of 2026). She told me it's their procedure as the equipment needed to be returned. I told her the equipment didn't need to be returned in my situation. She agreed - "yes, I see, you purchased it, so you don't need to return it, but it's our procedure". I said O'k, email it to me right now. And she claimed she did it. We both waited for about 5 minutes - nothing came through - not even to a spam folder. Then she said she would send the papers to me by mail. It's was about 2 weeks ago. Nothing like that came in the mail. But instead my 80 yo mom (even though I was the one paying her bills and buying her device) received a paper by mail dated of March 17th of 2026, that she has an unpaid balance. And guess what - I received an email today with the bill (this one miraculously came through). And another one of my credit cards got charged: I must have switched credit cards at some point. And Medical Guardian made sure they kept all the info on file - must be for the situation like this. I have to dispute this new charge now - two months after I cancelled the service. This place is a total scam."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69af4e56f6eda3f45901489b>

"SALES MGR PREYED ON OLD AND VULNERABLE GRANDMOTHER. AS PER MY REVIEW FOR HOME INSTEAD UK: Where to start?! My late Gran's niece caused the initial mess by sticking her nose in where it wasn't wanted, or needed, and tried to arrange alternative care for my then 95-year-old Gran behind my back (without doing any actual legwork!), even though I was dealing effectively with Gran's care already (and had done for nearly 20 years). Furthermore, at the time of these events, Gran was being cared for in hospital but immediately prior to this had been in respite care in a care home, since she had ailments that meant she could not live at home and the outlook was permanent care in a care home, NOT home care. I was Gran's carer/next-of-kin/POA. The Manager of Live-In Care, Home Instead Glasgow, Stirling, Perth, Ayr and Falkirk (whom we'll call S) started visiting Gran without my knowledge to discuss live-in home care, and I only found out about these visits by chance - just in time too. S ended up preying on Gran - a very elderly, weak and vulnerable person - directly with unethical and aggressive sales tactics, and I believe this is because Gran told S that she had money that her late husband AND late son had left her, and because she had been deemed as having mental capacity, even though she did not have the capacity to manage her own financial affairs - I dealt with this side of things as her carer/POA. S

hid behind Gran's 'capacity' which became her line of defence. I had to step in to stop the nonsense before it went too far. In the end, I sent a MASSIVE complaint email to the Care Inspectorate who passed it to management at Home Instead. The Group Operations Manager sympathetically acknowledged and apologised that the situation had caused me stress and worry, and though S lied through her teeth about her conduct, he prevented S from continuing to pursue this lead. In addition, due to my concerns about S, I had to ask that hospital staff, care home staff and the social worker alert me should they find S speaking to or visiting Gran. SPECIFICS: S did not feel the need to get in touch with Gran's POA/next-of-kin (me), or do a financial assessment, or carry out a risk assessment at Gran's house, or have anyone witness conversations or join in with meetings, nor was she intending to have anyone witness the signing of any forms/agreements (which thankfully never happened but it was close - my Gran couldn't even see the forms!!) S was hesitant to provide me with information when requested (financial or otherwise), and there was no information left for Gran at the hospital or care home for me to see. From conversations with her, I don't believe Gran fully understood the costs, what having a live-in carer meant for her and her home, e.g. what service she was to receive and what changes had to be made to her home, and what privacy and security concerns this arrangement could cause. What information I did finally receive from S was vague. S was pushing to start the service only a week and a half after I got in touch with her (once I found out what was going on) even though Gran did NOT have an agreed discharge date from the hospital and there was NO agreed plan for her continuing care at that point. S caused great confusion with hospital staff who thought Gran had home care arranged when she did not. S even had the gall to ask me for a set of keys to Gran's house and sent me a Direct Debit form to complete! I was SPEECHLESS. I'd never even met the woman and I was to let her and who knows who else into Gran's home?! Plus, as if all of this isn't enough to put people off, it turns out that carers are not always fully qualified to SVQ Level 3 and are often working towards this - therefore you could end up with a 'carer' who started at college yesterday. Don't worry - you can REQUEST A FULLY QUALIFIED CARER (yes, I was actually told this). Please be very wary of Home Instead and DO YOUR HOMEWORK BEFORE LETTING SOMEONE LIKE 'S' OR AN UNQUALIFIED CARER INTO YOUR FAMILY'S LIFE. *I have emails to prove the majority of the information I have provided in this review, which were used as evidence for my complaint to the Care Inspectorate. Other conversations with S were by phone. None were in person."

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/64ccb6076778f2964ff65c56>

"Rude and Greedy. My siblings and I purchased an alarm from (and set up service with) Bay Alarm Medical for our mother in May 2016. I was immediately charged for the alarm pendant. Thinking we were taking advantage of a discount, we set up our account to pay for the service semi-annually. After several days, I noticed that I had not been charged for the upcoming six months of service and that the equipment (receiver) had not shipped. I called and was informed that there had been an error and had to request that they put through the charge again. Nobody had notified me! Further, at no time did anyone point out that, should my mother pass away and we cancel the service during this six-month period, no refund would be given for the portion of the six-month period occurring after her death (i.e., Bay Alarm does not prorate their service). My mother passed away in mid-August (2 ½ months into the six-month period), and within days I called Bay Alarm to cancel the service. I encountered the rudest, most unfeeling customer service representative of my entire life, and she left me in tears. When I expressed surprise that no refund would be forthcoming, she repeatedly told me that I had agreed to it (in the fine print) when I set up the service. She was also very rude in informing me (multiple times) that I would be charged for another six months if I didn't return the equipment before the end of the six-month period we had prepaid. Never once was there any expression of condolence for our loss, or in fact any kind word at all. After receiving an email confirmation that the service had been cancelled, we unplugged the receiver (as the representative had directed). Immediately, my deceased mother's cell phone rang, startling all of us. Then my cell phone rang and each of my siblings' phones rang. Clearly the representative failed to properly cancel the service. We called Bay Alarm back and spoke to another representative, who was also rude and argued with us, not once apologizing for Bay Alarm's error or their lack of kindness. Eventually we spoke to a manager, who assured us that the account was properly canceled and apologized. Since then, my siblings and I have received additional auto-generated

phone calls from Bay Alarm. I eventually blocked the number from my cell phone. My husband called Bay Alarm last week (mid-October) to confirm the details on returning the equipment. Unbelievably, he was informed that a copy of my mother's death certificate was required to close the account (even though we are not getting a refund!). He was treated as if this were the first time anyone had notified Bay Alarm of the cancellation! That, in turn, generated an email expressing condolence and explaining how to return the equipment. However, I am still receiving reminders about an upcoming billing payment that is scheduled, even after Bay Alarm confirmed that they received the equipment! All I can do is shake my head. You sort of assume that the loved one for whom you are purchasing this service will pass away at some point during the contract with Bay Alarm. Customer service representatives should be trained on dealing with grieving loved ones. Bay Alarm should discontinue their greedy practice of failing to refund a prorated amount of the service fees. At the very least, this greedy policy of not prorating service fees should be prominently disclosed to new customers. Bay Alarm's internal computer systems need to be updated to communicate with one another, and people need to be more respectful. I can't believe this company has such good reviews. I would NEVER recommend this company to anyone!"

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/580fb74e19774d0a580ad9a2>

"Shady Company/Takes your loved ones 1st month rent. I began a google search for "assisted living places near me". I wrote down all the info for the places near me for my mother in law. I began calling the assisted living facilities. I called a phone number in the nursing home website that was NOT listed as the phone number for a Place for Mom. I speak to someone who I thought was from the nursing home only it was an operator who did NOT IDENTIFY herself as an operator for a place for mom. I then was directed to an "advisor" who again did NOT identify herself as a Rep for this company. I still thought I was speaking to someone from the nursing home. She began to tell me that she was a referral service and that there is no fee; that it is a free courtesy service. So I listened to her tell me 5 places near me and was reading the same reviews that she googled that I had already read! She then stated she would send my info to those 5 places for me to contact them. I chose a place quickly WITHOUT her help as I already had done the work myself. She did NOTHING, set up nothing, made no phone calls. I received emails from her which I did not read cause I NEVER SOLICITED HER HELP OR SERVICES. I was deferred to this company unbeknownst to me. 3 weeks later I get a text from her offering her help. I said we already found a place. She IMMEDIATELY calls the assisted living place to acquire her commission. I get a call from the director of the assisted living home minutes later asking me if I had used their service. I responded that I hadn't that I was redirected to them. I never asked for or used her help. He told me that they TAKE the loved ones 1st months' rent as their commission. I was furious! None of this was told to me at all! I called this chick up and in a heated discussion she informed me that the director of the nursing home is in violation and breach of their contract between them for telling me that she takes the rent money. I said...How is that not my business to know where my mother's money is going?". I argued that I never ASKED FOR her help and she did nothing to help me find a place so how do you feel justified in earning a \$5000 commission? She said that she sent a referral to them for me and an email with the list of 5 places. I responded that I never asked her to do this nor what she did helped because I already had them on my list to call. I asked why was the 1st months' rent never divulged to me during our 1 conversation? She said they are not taking my loved ones money so basically it doesn't concern me because it is a contract between a Place for mom and the assisted living facility. Then she explained that it is divulged in the emails at the very bottom IN THE FINE PRINT. I said 1.. I never read your emails cause I didn't need your help and 2.. that's not something you put in the fine print. (upon looking at the fine print it directs you to another link for questions/answers which never says their commission is the 1st months rent, just that they are paid a fee by the provider for their service). Shady company who took credit and money for something they never did. All she cared about was her commission. The point is that anyone can do a google search and do the exact same thing that they do. Then you'll know that your money for your loved one is actually going towards their care and NOT a commission fee! Finally, if banking \$5000 from an elderly person for sending out an email (called a referral) is considered ethical and appropriate business, then that is truly disturbing."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5e1dc8c2c845450bec3722b1>

"Confusing cancellation process and extremely frustrating customer service. Title: Confusing cancellation process and extremely frustrating customer service I signed up for Care.com years ago but had not meaningfully used the service in a very long time. After being charged for a renewal previously, I believed I had canceled my subscription. I later discovered that I was charged another annual renewal fee of \$165.65. When I logged in to cancel again, I realized the cancellation process requires multiple screens, confirmations, and additional prompts before cancellation is actually finalized. The workflow is confusing enough that it is very easy to believe your subscription has already been canceled when it has not. As soon as I noticed the charge, I immediately canceled the account and contacted customer service requesting a refund. Unfortunately, most of the responses I received were scripted replies repeating that subscriptions are "non refundable," without meaningfully addressing the cancellation experience itself. The customer service process became frustrating on its own. When I tried replying to support emails, I repeatedly received automated messages saying the issue had already been resolved and directing me back into the Help Center workflow to start over again. Eventually, my newer support requests stopped receiving responses altogether. What concerned me most was discovering during my research that the FTC had previously taken enforcement action against Care.com related to confusing subscription cancellation practices and consumers continuing to be billed after believing they had canceled. I had no prior knowledge of that case before researching my own issue, but the concerns described by the FTC closely matched my experience. This entire situation could have been resolved with a simple goodwill refund for a service I did not knowingly intend to renew and had not meaningfully used in years. Care.com could improve this experience significantly by: *simplifying and clarifying the cancellation process*, providing clearer confirmation when cancellation is complete, * and empowering customer service to reasonably resolve unintended renewal situations instead of relying entirely on scripted responses. Update after Care.com's response: The company's response to this review unfortunately illustrates one of the central issues I described above. After detailing the confusing cancellation experience, the renewal dispute, the repeated scripted customer service interactions, the FTC enforcement action that raised similar concerns, and the months spent attempting to resolve the matter, Care.com's response was simply a generic statement that they were "sorry to hear" about my experience and that they would "share the feedback with the appropriate teams." Notably, the response does not address a single issue raised in the review. It does not address the cancellation process, the renewal dispute, the customer service experience, the refusal to provide a goodwill refund, or the concerns regarding the FTC's prior findings. Prospective customers should understand that if they encounter a billing or cancellation issue, they may receive the same type of scripted, non-specific response rather than a meaningful attempt to address the underlying concern. At this point, my concern is no longer the \$165.65 charge itself. It is the apparent unwillingness to engage substantively with legitimate customer concerns, even after multiple escalations and public reviews."

trustpilot · Care.com · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a0b827320fe7b2d0c1fee82>

"Unethical company. I had a lanyard break and I had to pay Bay Alarm Medical \$12 for THEM to ship me a replacement for THEIR defective lanyard. Even worse, my SOS All-in-one Mobile device stopped working, creating an extremely dangerous situation. To replace the defective device, I could either pay \$12 for 5-9 day shipping, or \$40 for 2-day shipping. This essentially forces you to pay \$40 for them to ship you a replacement device where every minute without can be life-threatening; and again for their defective device. Talk about nickel and diming and taking advantage of their vulnerable clientele. Then they charged me \$90.90 when I pay about \$51 every month. I called billing and was told by Rico that they had sent me an email to deactivate my old device. I was very confused (more than usual) because I had successfully shut down my broken device and was told that I did not have to return the broken one. The email that Bay Alarm sent me contained extremely complicated instructions on how to deactivate the old device, and when I clicked on their link, it was just a blank email that I had no idea what to do with it and I just ignored it, and therefore I was being charged for two devices. Huh? Rico instructed me to cut and paste the pertinent part of the email, then hit reply, and then type my name in the body of the email and send the email back to them. Got that? I'm not tech-savvy but I'm at least a little literate and I had no idea what the heck Rico was talking about. I could detect the growing frustration and impatience in his

voice. Eventually, it was finally done and I will get a pro-rated refund. Remember, a great majority of their customers are elderly, so they expect them to know how to do this? How about just a phone call where the Bay Alarm rep reads them if they agree to the terms of the agreement to terminate the old device instead of torturing us to comply with their complicated and frustrating protocol? Their tech support is only open during Bay Alarm's regular business hours. If your device malfunctions in the middle of the night, there is no one to help you to resolve the problem. If you fall, you're SOL. Help! I've fallen and I can't get up! Tough. Just lie there and die. Since they're so cheap that they make you pay for shipping to replace their defective equipment, presumably they're too cheap to pay for full time tech support. From Bay Alarm's business practices, it appears that they care more about the almighty dollar than the welfare of their paying, vulnerable customers. On several occasions I have had false alarms, which does happen from time to time, but twice the call did not go through. There would be dead silence instead of the usual beeping sound until a representative answers and asks if you need help. After that silence, you hear "your call has ended" and worry that this could happen in a real emergency. To Bay Alarm's credit, they can hear the call go through even if you can't and their emergency dispatch calls your phone immediately to see if you're alright. Twice I told them that I was medically fine but that I was worried and unhappy that I wasn't sure if my call did indeed go through. Apparently, emergency dispatch was unreceptive to my criticism and, without another word, hung up on me. Are you kidding me? Hung up on by EMERGENCY dispatch? Speaks well for the ethics of Bay Alarm Medical."

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65401ecf3e47844d357afba0>

"Insincere, Rude Advisor Not Interested if One's Loved One Can't Afford the Home APFM has Contracts with. On Feb 21, 2020, I desperately contacted APFM looking for assistance in finding a care home for my grandmother-in-law. The main operator connected me to an APFM representative. At first the rep seemed helpful and caring. She provided me with useful websites as resources. She told me about the "spend down" process, when I told her that Grandma only had \$6,000 in her bank account and couldn't afford the pricey senior residence located in a particular region of my state that she appeared to be stuck on promoting. That's when her tone subtly changed. She rattled off a list of some other care homes in my state that were less costly. I asked her if those places accepted the spend down option, i.e., private pay until one's cash runs out, then Medicaid kicks in. She said she didn't know and would have to call each place and check. She assured me that she regularly got back to her clients within 24 hours. Needless to say, I contacted her the following day, on the 22nd, as Grandma had taken another fall and was hospitalized again. I left a distressed message on her business voicemail. 24 hours passed with no follow up! Then 48 hours without a call from her! Luckily for my family, a friend told us about an organization called Care Sift Oahu, an amazing referral service that guides and supports you through each step of the process of finding a care home. When the third day came with still no follow up from the APFM rep, I decided to send her an email about my dissatisfaction with her services. Apparently her ego took offense to that because the following day she responded to my email that APFM did not make referrals to care homes that took Medicaid and attributed my lack of understanding to, and I quote, "my confusion." I felt very bullied by her haughty tone and verbiage. Apparently, I hurt her ego when I expressed my valid disappointment with her lack of follow up. I replied to her terse email that I was indeed not "confused" about what she had told me regarding contacting those care homes and following up with me, as I had taken detailed notes during our telephone conversation. Furthermore, I said that the transcript of our call would support my claims, since APFM records their conversations for quality assurance. I wish I had read the reviews for APFM prior to my initial contact with them, because I have since read a number of reviews similar to mine that speak of rude representatives who only promote the senior living residences that APFM has contracts with. To clarify, APFM's reps only receive a referral fee when a client selects a care home/facility that they have contracts with. Evidently, these heretofore seemingly helpful reps regularly lose their interest when they realize the places they recommend are not affordable options for your loved one. I guess that's why APFM's rep never got back to me regarding my Medicaid inquiry even though she assured me that she

would. All I received was a rude email that said APFM doesn't handle Medicaid referrals. Thank goodness my family found Care Sift Oahu! They were able to help us find Grandma a lovely senior foster care home! Care Sift even texted me the next day to find out how Grandma was doing!"

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5e5937ce3c93ae0bc40c47f4>

"I am writing this review to share my deeply concerning experience with the Buckhead Center for Nursing and Healing, particularly regarding the care provided to my loved one. It is with a heavy heart that I express my belief that anyone who sends their loved one to this facility may not fully understand the level of care—or lack thereof—that they will receive. From the moment my loved one was admitted on March 24th, the service has been alarmingly unprofessional. Within hours of her admission, I received a call informing me that she had fallen while attempting to go to the bathroom. This incident raised immediate concerns about the staff's attentiveness and the overall safety protocols in place. The staff on the 4th floor, particularly the head nurse, Kristin, displayed a troubling lack of professionalism. During our interaction, she was more focused on her tasks than on communicating effectively with me. When I inquired about my loved one's medication—specifically why she was on three blood pressure medications—Kristin seemed unprepared to provide a clear explanation. Furthermore, she could not inform me about the schedule for the Nurse Practitioner or Doctor, which left me feeling frustrated and anxious about my loved one's care. The Unit Nurse on the 4th floor (Kristin) is unprofessional. Her demeanor suggested annoyance whenever I asked questions, making me feel as though I was interrupting her rather than seeking necessary information about my loved one's well-being. On April 9, I received a particularly distressing call from a case/social worker named Ashley. She informed me that my loved one's medical care had been dismissed and that I needed to arrange for her pickup by Saturday. When I clarified that I was only the sister and that her daughter should be contacted, Ashley abruptly cut me off and insisted that I needed to pick her up. Her condescending tone and refusal to listen to my concerns were unacceptable. After attempting to escalate the issue by asking for a supervisor, I was placed on hold multiple times, only to be met with further frustration. My loved one was discharged by the facilities without completing her rehabilitation, the facility stated because her medical ran out. The overall environment on the 4th floor was disheartening. I witnessed patients left to navigate their own care, with some rolling themselves around in wheelchairs or sitting alone in hospital beds. The lack of professionalism among the CNA's and nurses was evident, as their attire and behavior did not inspire confidence in their roles. In conclusion, my experience at Buckhead Center for Nursing and Healing has been overwhelmingly negative. The facility appears to be ill-equipped to provide the necessary care for vulnerable patients, and I strongly urge potential patients and their families to consider other options. I believe that regular evaluations by the state are essential to ensure that the standards of care are met and that the well-being of patients is prioritized. The high turnover rate among staff is also a significant concern that needs to be addressed. I hope that sharing my experience will help others make informed decisions regarding their loved ones' care."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Buckhead%20Center%20for%20Nursing%20and%20Healing&query_place_id=ChIJd8BrNa8F9YgR7qk29p19Ngo

"medical guardian failed in an emergency. My 86-year-old mother is 5 feet tall and weighs 180 pounds. She worked as a registered nurse for forty years and is still sharp as a tack. On September 10, 2025, at 7:30 a.m., she was alone when she fell while stepping out of our home onto the porch. She struck her head on the cement, causing a serious cut above her eye that bled heavily. She was wearing her fully charged Medical Guardian necklace. Three times she pressed the button for help, but there was absolutely no response. She tried to get up on her own and failed. She then pressed the button three more times, holding it down for up to five seconds each time—again with no response at all. Knowing she had no other choice, she problem solved and rallied enough strength to stand. By 8:10 a.m., she was at the bathroom sink tending to her wound. At 8:30, my niece arrived and took her to a walk-in clinic. The nurses there immediately recommended the emergency room. At the ER, her wound was closed with medical glue and she underwent a CAT scan. Thankfully, she had no broken bones and no internal bleeding. The next day, we called Medical Guardian to report the incident. The agent reviewed my mom's

charging history and confirmed that her necklace was fully charged at the time of the fall. The agent then ran a test while staying on the line with us. My mom pressed the button—exactly as she had done six times the day before—and this time, the button worked. The agent concluded that my mom did not press the button properly after her fall. She also informed us that our plan did not include “fall protection.” What is fall protection? It’s a feature that automatically detects when a user falls and immediately responds with verbal assistance—without the user needing to press a button. Our plan did not include fall protection? WHAT? That is exactly why we purchased this necklace 15 months ago, why we continued to pay for it, why my mom charged it daily, and why she wore it whenever it wasn’t on the charger. Why would any company sell this kind of product without fall protection automatically included? The story gets worse. The agent explained that when we purchased the necklace in February 2024, there was a promotion that included free fall protection. Then why didn’t we have it? The agent asked us to hold while she checked with a manager about adding that feature to our plan, for free. After placing us on hold, she informed us that the manager said we could not add this feature for free 18 months after we originally signed with the company. Instead, we would have to pay an extra \$10 per month for fall protection. So fall protection is a hidden cost? I explained that when I bought the plan in February 2024 no one ever mentioned anything about needing a separate fall protection plan. Furthermore, if I had been asked whether I wanted the fall protection added for free, why on earth would I have said no? This company claims to care about protecting the elderly, but nothing in our experience supports that claim. After this ordeal, we canceled our Medical Guardian service and purchased a SMART watch instead. I highly recommend you do the same.”

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/68c5c7fe47a0acd1ee1acb>

"If I could give this facility zero stars, I would. My father was admitted here for rehabilitation, and the experience was nothing short of a nightmare. This place should be shut down immediately. Nursing and Medical Negligence The nursing staff was consistently rude — both verbally and physically. They failed to properly chart his medications and neglected basic wound care. When my father arrived, his wound was nearly healed. Within a week, it was infected due to their negligence. Bandages were applied incorrectly (half-exposed, too tight, no ointment or lidocaine), which caused severe pain and a dangerous setback in his healing. Pain management was virtually nonexistent. Failure of Care and Safety The neglect went beyond wound care. My father needed help getting to the bathroom as he is a fall risk, yet his call button didn’t work. He waited over 40 minutes with no response before being forced to soil himself — and the staff treated him with complete disrespect afterward. Instead of helping patients, staff would rather put them in diapers out of laziness. My father also developed a sore on his backside due to improper care. Vital signs were not checked regularly, and the only reason his infection was caught in time is because my family never left his side. Dialysis and Communication Issues Dialysis scheduling was a complete mess. One day, he was scheduled for 11 AM and wasn’t taken until nearly 4 PM. The dialysis nurses appeared careless and unprofessional. Communication between departments and with families was practically nonexistent. Phone calls to the nursing station went unanswered more often than not. Living Conditions The facility itself was dirty and unkempt. Trash bins overflowed, odd odors filled the halls, and the food was consistently cold and inedible. Patients could be heard screaming in pain down the halls, begging for help, while staff sat on their phones without lifting a finger. Staff Behavior The tech staff was lazy and entitled. The majority of the nursing team displayed no compassion or urgency in caring for vulnerable patients. The only exceptions were the receptionist staff, Latoya the director, and occasionally the lead nurse who showed more empathy than the rest — but one or two decent individuals cannot make up for a completely incompetent team. Final Thoughts My father told us he felt like a “dog on the side of the road.” That is the level of dehumanization he endured at this facility. We trusted them to help him heal, and instead, they endangered his life and dignity. It appears that the facility has people doing a bunch of five star reviews with no additional commentary in order to drive the Overall rating up. Beware of this place!! When my father returned to Piedmont Hospital, the emergency room staff was completely horrified when we told them where he came from. This is common knowledge that this is not a place that ANYONE should be. Do not send your loved one here. This is not a place of healing. It is a place of neglect, indifference, and suffering."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Buckhead%20Center%20for%20Nursing%20and%20Healing&query_place_id=ChIJd8BrNa8F9YgR7qk29p19Ngo

"Despite FTC charges, they are not changing their scammy ways!! Aside from the fact that their business models makes absolutely NO SENSE for parents, they intentionally make it hard to cancel subscriptions. The FTC already went after them 2 years ago for this, but they have not changed!!! I cancelled my subscription and never thought about it again until I saw months of renewal charges posted to my credit card. When I logged on, it appeared as though I had never cancelled it!! Immediately I cancelled again via the website, and it showed that my account would be "downgraded to free" at the end of the billing cycle ... but it also still showed a future billing date and the "manage membership" button still took me to a page that showed an ACTIVE subscription!! It allowed me to go through this PHONY cancellation process as many times as I wanted! I contacted customer support about the issue and all they said was "we don't do refunds" and basically saying I knew that I was signing up for auto-renewals when I signed up. Trying to CLOSE the account entirely just showed, again, that the account "would be closed" at the end of the current billing cycle. Sure buddy! Not buying that bullcrap again! There is not even a way for you to manually delete your stored payment information. Pretty sure that is illegal ... Oh and when you send a message to support they give you a "support ticket number" but the auto-response from the customer support email address literally says "This email address is no longer monitored" so there isn't even a way to follow up on that ticket number!! So after multiple attempts with customer support and finally submitting one last angry complaint via their stupid portal, I went ahead and disputed the charges through my credit card company. I had mentioned in my final complaint that I would do this. The next morning my account had been wiped and it APPEARS that they issued the refunds (after saying they wouldn't). When I called my credit card to remove the disputes they so kindly advised me to wait until the refunds actually get posted on the account, because right now they are just pending. The credit card company said many scammy companies do this - they'll "issue a refund" so it shows up in pending transactions just to get you to drop your charge disputes, but those refunds will drop off and never actually post to your account!!! We'll see what happens but I would not be surprised AT ALL if that's how this shakes out. Care.com is so obviously scammy it's insane. IDK how on earth they're the main provider for connecting parents & nannies."

trustpilot · Care.com · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69bc0546bd07d9eea2b5199f>

"I recently started a home care agency.... I recently started a home care agency and came across A Place for Mom. During our initial Zoom meeting, I shared my concerns, and they explained that I would need to prepay a total of \$580, which they described as covering 10 client referrals. My understanding was that \$58 would be deducted from this prepaid balance only for each referral that resulted in a signed client. I had done my research on them, and some reviews mentioned alleged scamming practices. However, they assured me that they would deliver on their promises and would not set me up for failure which is why I entrusted them. However, during the onboarding Zoom session after I had paid, they introduced a condition that had never been disclosed before. They explained that regardless of how many referral fees were deducted, my prepaid balance would always have to remain at \$580 at the beginning of each month. This meant they would automatically withdraw additional money from my bank account to replenish the balance. This automatic replenishment was never discussed with me before I signed up. I also noticed that they deducted referral fees as soon as they sent a lead, even when the phone numbers provided were unreachable. I suspected that most of these leads were fake. So they just send you a random number from their fake list and immediately deduct their money as soon as they send you a number of the potential fake client. In one instance, they even charged me for a lead that was located outside my service area and faraway in another state, so I did not contact that individual because I could not provide services there. Within just one week of signing up, they had already deducted fees for four leads, even though none of those contacts could be reached. Because I was concerned about the undisclosed automatic withdrawals, I instructed my bank to close my account to prevent any further deductions. I requested to cancel my account and receive a refund because the service I received was not what I had agreed to when I enrolled. They denied my request, stating that

the payment was for leads only and not for referrals that resulted in actual clients. This was inconsistent with my understanding of the agreement and with the expectations that were communicated to me before I signed up. Don't fall for this scam company what they promise is not what they deliver. I think as soon as they take your details they just forget about you and start looking for their next victim to scam without providing any clients. Do business with them at your own risk."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a679ac4a98e3c28c37ba05d>

"This is a data mining service. They do not vett facilities and you will be spammed.. I completed a web form at a specific facility website asking for pricing information. I immediately received several calls from an unfamiliar number which turned out to be from this organization. Thinking it was the facility I'd reached out to via the web form I called back. All I wanted was pricing information for a specific facility and when it (eventually) became clear I was not speaking with that facility, I made my goal abundantly clear. I was told I had to answer a number of (invasive) personal and financial questions in order to get to the person who could help me with that, so I did. Then the person I was transferred to required more deeply (invasive) personal information "to make sure we were a good fit for the community's services. I was told we did and I would receive an email with the documentation shortly. All it produced was AI generated texts, emails, and phone spam for over a month that's still coming and none of these communications have had anything to do with the facility I inquired about. Some were even about facilities not even local to our search area, and I never received the basic information I asked for about the local facility I'd reached out to. It's been non-stop, even though I block the phone #s and email addresses. They just change their contact info, which is very predatory. The entire 30 minutes I spent on the phone trying to get basic pricing information for a single facility was just "data mining" to promote a number of other facilities they contract with and earn commissions from. This "service" is not for families, it's to market facilities who pay them for leads (our information). Instead of helping our family, it's just added more stress, and unwanted complication to what should be a very personal (and is already a difficult choice) and turned it into a greedy numbers game. The negative reviews here are real. Do yourself and favor and DO NOT FILL OUT ANY WEB FORMS. Read facility reviews and check the state website for compliance and violations first, then call the providers that score well, and offer what you're looking for directly, if you have questions or want to do a tour. Quite honestly, the tactical approach of "A Place for Mom" (and 2 others like it) reminded me of interviewing divorce attorneys. It's really all about the money, and the entire process and resulting AI generated and other spam has left me just as disgusted."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6834d4e3852d9da99a6a6993>

"abandoned me during their shift. I am a disabled Veteran with a severe anxiety disorder and ptsd. The other day I had some difficulty breathing through my nose and I needed more air and I needed medicine from the cupboard and my helper started dragging all kinds of things out of the cupboard and my anxiety went up and he left. He just left me and when I called Comfort Keepers to find out why he never come back, they said he said that I yelled at him and if all that is so, I thought it was against the Americans with Disabilities Act to cite the symptoms of somebody's disability as a matter of blame or personal fault, and certainly not to deny anyone's services. In any case they immediately discontinued services to me without even asking me what happened or if I'm all right even. And by the way I don't know why I would yell at him, I don't talk to people like that. My voice have been up in my severe anxiety which I was even having trouble trying to speak as I didn't have my voice box unit handy. They never were interested or attempted to find out from me what happened. It was one-sided and it was their side only, the guy was kind of lazy anyway; most of the time he wanted to sit around and talk. He just vanished and left me when I needed him the most, in a vulnerable moment left alone and no call back from comfortkeepers. Of course I'm not being made privy to any of these things or claims or writings so where's the Justice in that? There isn't. It's a sketchy organization made of basically sketchy people who can't seem to hold a job for very long. The workers constantly complain about the amount of money Comfort Keepers gets from the Veterans Administration per hour compared to their hourly wage as workers. The workers can't stand Comfort Keepers because they get their schedules moved around so much and often don't even get 32 hours a week which they State they must have

to keep their households running. For me the bottom line in all this is that they cite the symptoms of my disability as the reason to disqualify me from receiving services. That is directly against what the Americans with Disabilities Act which states that its illegal to cite the symptoms of someone's disability as a basis for rejecting them from receiving government services, as well as government subsidized services."

trustpilot · Comfortkeepers · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/660b072735fa783210a7058f>

"I do not recommended anyone sending their loved one here. They will tell you exactly what you want to hear but do not deliver. My mom caught COVID in Dec. and was in the hospital they transferred her to a long term facility and then she was sent here. A week after being at Capstone she went from good to bad. My mother had dark circles under her eyes and was just very unhappy. She looked totally different from when she left the long term facility. She couldn't sleep at night because she heard people screaming all night and running up and down the hallways. One time she woke up to a woman in her room staring at her while she slept. When she explained to them she was having trouble sleeping they offered her pain pills to sleep! They moved my mother to a new room and she needed a nurse she kept pressing the nurse call button but no one would come. The next morning she told the nurse only to find out the nurse call button was unplugged. If my mom was in dire need something terrible could've happened. On multiple occasions after visits she was left in a chair for hours unattended. My sister and I had a conference call with the staff there to address these issues was told it wouldn't happened again but it did. The last time it happened my mother was in the chair for 8 hours! Physical therapy was to be done for an hour at least 5 days a week and that didn't happened. When my mom got to Capstone she was able to stand with the help of the therapist but when she left she was so weak because of the lack of PT. Most the people at Capstone are unprofessional starting with the receptionist. There is a tremendous lack of communication that goes on here. My mother had an unsafe and terrible discharge. Capstone sent her home with the wrong medical equipment which caused her to be rushed back to the hospital. When we let them know they said they would work on getting her the right equipment and I have yet to hear from them. She was at Capstone for 25 days or so and has now been at the hospital for 5 and the hospital has done more for my mother than Capstone ever did. Capstone neglected my mother. People need to know how this place is being run. Capstone did nothing for my mom."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Avir%20at%20Orem&query_place_id=ChIJeQC8N-DrQIYRz-sdMRXG_jo

"PAID SUBSCRIBER TO CARE. I AM A PAID SUBSCRIBER ON CARE FOR ALMOST 9 MONTHS. I AM WRITING THIS REVIEW TO PERSUADE CARES MANAGEMENT TO PROVIDE MORE THOROUGH SCREENING OF PROVIDERS AND MONITORING PROVIDERS PERFORMANCE ON THE CARE SITE. I DONT MEAN BACKGROUND CHECKS. I AM REFERRING TO CARES USE OF TECHNOLOGY TO SCREEN OUT APPLICANTS AND PROVIDERS THAT ARE NOT SERIOUS ABOUT USING THE SITE, AND WHO DO NOT PERFORM WELL UNDER THE SITES GUIDELINES. I HAVE INTERVIEWED AND MET WITH 6 PROVIDERS ON CARE AND HIRED 3 OF THEM. I PROBABLY SHOULD HAVE INTERVIEWED WITH THE PROVIDERS WITH MORE QUESTIONS, HOWEVER, I AM A BUSY PERSON AND I DONT HAVE A LOT OF TIME TO MEET AND INTERVIEW, SET SCHEDULES, ETC. I DID MY BEST. THE PROVIDERS I HIRED ON CARE MISQUOTED THEIR ADVERTISED PRICES ON CARE AND ARRIVED WITH A DIFFERENT HIGHER PRICE. OF THE 3 PROVIDERS I HIRED, THE FIRST ONE, WASTED 2 HOURS OF TIME, WHILE ON THE JOB AND EMOTIONALLY EXTORTED \$80 DOLLARS OUT OF ME. SHE DID NOT COMPLETE THE WORK AND LEFT MY PLACE IN A MESS. THE SECOND PROVIDER ARRIVED CLEANED FOR 3 AND A HALF HOURS, BUT DID NOT COMPLETE THE JOB AND WANTED MORE MONEY. SHE THEN MADE FLAKEY EXCUSES OF WHY SHE COULD NOT RETURN TO FINISH THE JOB. MY PLACE IS NOT DIRTY. THE 3RD PROVIDER CAME TO MY HOME INTERVIEWED WITH ME AND BOTH WE AGREED, AND THEN SET A TIME FOR THE NEXT DAY, TO WORK FOR 2 HOURS, AND SHE WAS A NO CALL/NO SHOW. ON THE SUBJECT OF THE OTHER PROVIDERS I HAVE INTERACTED WITH ON CARE AND HAVE GOTTEN A RESPONSE FROM MOST OF THEM WANT LARGE SUMS OF MONEY TO DO THE WORK. \$50 HOUR FOR SOME HOUSE CLEANING.

ADVERTISED PROVIDERS ARE EXTREMELY FLAKEY AND UNTRUSTWORTHY. IT'S A RIDICULOUS SET-UP AND CARE NEEDS TO MONITOR PROVIDERS PERFORMANCE AND PRICING. I ALSO FEEL LIKE CARE DOES NOT DO ENOUGH TO PROTECT THE PRIVACY OF USERS. I FEEL THAT SOME OF YOUR PROVIDERS ARE SHARING CUSTOMER INFORMATION OUTSIDE CARE. I DID INTERFACE WITH ONE OF THE MANAGERS AT CARE AND THEY WERE VERY NICE AND RESPONSIVE. CARE HAS BEEN A WASTE OF MY TIME, MONEY AND ENERGY. I WONT BE RENEWING MY YEARLY CARE SUBSCRIPTION TO CARE.COM."

trustpilot · Care.com · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/66dd1ead5f2f57ac00df945f>

"Here We Go Again.... My membership automatically renews on July 10th. It is now July 07th. I went to cancel. Lo and Behold, my password doesn't work. So, I click the Forgot PW link. Guess what, no e-mail to re-set the link arrives. I try a second e-mail address. Nothing. A 3rd e-mail address. Nothing. A 4th e-mail address. Nothing. I only have 4 e-mail addresses. I write an e-mail to the care.com Help address, which worked a few months ago. Guess what...an automatic reply saying that "that e-mail is no longer monitored." I found that there is, in the "no longer monitored" automatic response, a link to "click here" to cancel your membership. But you have to be able to log in first. I saw another "click here" link which enables you to log in...even without your password. A one-time deal. HOORAY!!! I do so, follow their directions, and push cancel. Immediately, the screen moves back to the "log in" page. I've spent 30 minutes doing all this. Now, you tell me: AM I ACTUALLY CANCELED? UPDATE, JULY 09: I tried a couple more times to log in. Again, no "Forgot password" link sent. UPDATE, JULY 11: No, indeed, I was charged. So pushing the "Cancel Subscription" button wasn't enough. Thanks to the response from Care.com below, I was given another avenue to reach the company. I just did so. I asked them to refund the most recent charge which came through at 1 am today (for 62.00+ dollars) and remove my credit card information from their billing. Thanks to TRUSTPILOT, and also to CARE.COM who responded literally within 10 minutes of me contacting them. They said they'd verified that I'd written on July 07 to cancel, said that they'd refund my money and did not renew the account, which was perfect. I WILL UPGRADE REVIEW when refund arrives. UPDATE: REFUND was made. So, I'm upgrading review from 1 star to 2 stars. Care.com has great, professional and speedy customer service once you reach them, but the combo of malfunctioning website and unavailable help for people who can't sign in/don't have a premium account is pretty bad."

trustpilot · Care.com · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/64a89277f4cf46124a779902>

"It helps but it's also nonintuitive. Overall positive experience after several months, but let me start with the drawbacks: 1) First of all, let me say that I'm in tech. I'm a thirtysomething software developer at a prestigious company. Why is this relevant and not some random brag? Because setting the timer or changing the time on this thing is confusing. (Notice how this review is right after daylight savings time? There's a reason I'm just now getting around to the review...). If a tech person needs to look at the instructions, so will you / your dependent. The instructions are clear, just take a picture of them and put them in your favorites on your phone so when daylight savings rolls around or your routine changes, you'll know what to do. The instructions are probably online somewhere, and of course you can save the piece of paper, but taking a picture of them will probably be your best bet. 2) At one point, this was stored upside down and a tiny pill got lodged in a spot that prevented the wheel from fully rotating, and the mechanism wasn't perfectly aligned after that for several weeks. I don't know why, and honestly, I don't know what fixed it. Maybe I hit the next button enough times? I *think* it's aligned again, but it's weird that it didn't click back into place right away. 3) this thing beeps once every couple of minutes for about an hour and then stops. if you're out of the house during that time, you'll need to remember to take it. 4) it only has 28 days. Why not make it a whole month's worth? Why make us hang on to a couple of extra pills in a bunch of different bottles? I would improve it by - allowing 31 days of medication - connecting to your phone so you can snooze it if you're not around - fixing the weird rotation issue I experienced - making the UI easier to work with, or even printing the instructions on the back. Okay, done with the bad. On with the good. 1) I very rarely have to refill this! It's so much better than a one week organizer 2) I can easily check to see"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3MEEV85FQBD2Q>

Finally, peace of mind and sleep · 231 documents

20 most engaged of 231 matching documents, complete text.

"I do not recommended anyone sending their loved one here. They will tell you exactly what you want to hear but do not deliver. My mom caught COVID in Dec. and was in the hospital they transferred her to a long term facility and then she was sent here. A week after being at Capstone she went from good to bad. My mother had dark circles under her eyes and was just very unhappy. She looked totally different from when she left the long term facility. She couldn't sleep at night because she heard people screaming all night and running up and down the hallways. One time she woke up to a woman in her room staring at her while she slept. When she explained to them she was having trouble sleeping they offered her pain pills to sleep! They moved my mother to a new room and she needed a nurse she kept pressing the nurse call button but no one would come. The next morning she told the nurse only to find out the nurse call button was unplugged. If my mom was in dire need something terrible could've happened. On multiple occasions after visits she was left in a chair for hours unattended. My sister and I had a conference call with the staff there to address these issues was told it wouldn't happened again but it did. The last time it happened my mother was in the chair for 8 hours! Physical therapy was to be done for an hour at least 5 days a week and that didn't happened. When my mom got to Capstone she was able to stand with the help of the therapist but when she left she was so weak because of the lack of PT. Most the people at Capstone are unprofessional starting with the receptionist. There is a tremendous lack of communication that goes on here. My mother had an unsafe and terrible discharge. Capstone sent her home with the wrong medical equipment which caused her to be rushed back to the hospital. When we let them know they said they would work on getting her the right equipment and I have yet to hear from them. She was at Capstone for 25 days or so and has now been at the hospital for 5 and the hospital has done more for my mother than Capstone ever did. Capstone neglected my mother. People need to know how this place is being run. Capstone did nothing for my mom."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Avir%20at%20Orem&query_place_id=ChIJeQC8N-DrQIYRz-sdMRXG_jo

"Very poor system . I indicated today's date, because I've just finished talking with one of the representatives regarding ongoing, reoccurring issues that I have had with this company. I have been a customer for many years, and have been extremely frustrated with their service. I have written letters to their corporate office, as recently as 2 weeks ago. I called last week and was disconnected three times consecutively. There was no callback. I am still in the process of returning the old one, which kept going off for no reason. I was instructed to shut it down before packing it, but while in transit, it kept alarming, resulting in the early morning disturbance of my family contacts. A new one was sent to me 2 weeks ago, and was supposed to include fall detection. However, I literally fell down the steps, but the alarm did not sound. The representative with whom I just spoke had me drop the device several times, but nothing happened. Thank goodness that I survived the fall down the stairs, because if I was unable to move, I would not have been able to use the device. I am an old person living alone, and this device is supposed to give me peace of mind. On the contrary, it has been nothing but stressful to me. They are now in the process of sending me another device (I have lost count of the numerous devices that have been sent to me). If there are any more issues after this, I will definitely terminate my very long contract with Medical Guardian. In the meantime, I will begin to shop around for viable options. 8/30/26 Unfortunately, I need to add this to my recent review. Since I wrote the previous one, a new device was sent to me. This is the third one in a month. A few minutes ago, I wore it in the shower and it fell to the floor because of the faulty string that's attached to the pendant. The alarm did not sound. When I got out of the shower, I held it up and dropped it three times consecutively. The alarm DID NOT sound. I then pressed the help button, but there was no response until almost 10 minutes. I have had enough of these incompetent device and will terminate my service tomorrow. What a shame!"

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a85e1260ba2910d7afd3e2a>

"March 4, 2024-Updating my previous review. Greg and his team have been providing care for my husband for almost three years. Since May 2023 when his care needs dramatically increased, Greg provided exceptional service as we transitioned my husband to bed-bound care. Since then, we have had 1 or 2 hours of care every day and 24/7 overnight care when I need to be out of town for work. Jessica manages the scheduling and I love the easy way I can email her ahead of time with any additional hours needed. When caregivers are unable to come, Home Instead quickly finds a substitute, and I can rely on a caregiver to arrive on time, every shift, every day. One time, the scheduled caregiver had an emergency shortly before their shift, and the office found someone and called to let me know the substitute would arrive shortly. Since my husband wants to receive care at home as long as possible, having Home Instead help me in providing his care is so critical. Previous post- I was referred to Home Instead by an experienced long term care social worker who felt like the company provided the best care model. Greg and his team are doing an excellent job of making sure my husband has a caregiver to meet his needs. I have used this location of Home Instead for more than a year to provide care when I need to be out of town overnight. We don't have family in the Houston area, so if I need to be gone, a caregiver is essential. It was so easy to open the care plan and work with Greg's team on scheduling. A big advantage for me is having Home Instead screen and train the care providers. So much better than trying to do that myself, while still working full time, and being a full time caregiver for my husband. As I know my husband's health will continue to decline, I plan to increase the caregiver's hours to help me in the future, even when I am home. Having a reliable, compassionate group of caregivers "at the ready" to step in and help has provided me with the peace of mind I need."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

"Huge relief. Mom has a bit of dementia (not full blown but just enough), and taking medication was becoming confusing for her. This pill dispenser is set on a schedule (for her it's 2x a day), first dose, it sets off an alarm and she knows to go to it and take her pills. It's a locked unit so she can't open it therefore no worries of her taking more medication. It comes with two keys. Each key will open/lock the unit. Of course she does not have access to the keys. The description of the unit will have a full explanation as to how to set it up for one's specific needs. Since my mom has to take her meds in the morning (6 pills fit in one compartment) and in the evening (2 pills in a separate compartment), that's one day. For my mom the unit holds two weeks worth of medication twice a day. When the alarm goes off at the time specified for her first dose, she then hears it, goes to the unit, slides open the opening which holds only her first dose, lifts up the lightweight unit with one hand and drops the pills into the other hand and slides the opening closed. That's it, until the next alarm sounds for her evening dose and she does the same thing all over again. This unit has fixed the issue she was having of either forgetting to take her meds or thinking she didn't take them and would take more. I highly recommend this unit for seniors who live on their own and enjoy being in their own space but have trouble remembering to take their medication when they're supposed to. After the unit is empty I reset it with another 14 days worth of medication and have piece of mind that my mom is taking her medication correctly. I hope you found this to be helpful. Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3F2ZQS0892KKK>

"Unreliable & Dispatched to a wrong location. I rarely write negative reviews, but I feel obligated to share my experience so other families can make an informed decision. I purchased Medical Guardian to help protect my elderly father, expecting reliability and peace of mind. Unfortunately, my experience has been the exact opposite. The system generated far too many false fall alerts while also failing to detect actual falls. False alarms are more than just an inconvenience. They create unnecessary stress, reduce confidence in the device, and can ultimately lead people to question whether a future alert is real. What concerned me even more was the company's response. After one false alert, Medical Guardian dispatched EMS to the wrong address. An investigation was supposedly opened, but despite multiple emails, phone calls, and follow-up requests, I never received an explanation, update, or even the courtesy of a response. When you're choosing a medical alert system, you're trusting a company to be

there during some of the most vulnerable moments in your loved one's life. That trust depends not only on the technology working correctly, but also on responsive customer support when something goes wrong. In my experience, Medical Guardian failed on both counts. I cannot recommend this company based on my experience. There are too many alternatives on the market to settle for a service that has proven unreliable and unresponsive when it matters most. If you're considering a medical alert system for a parent or loved one, I strongly encourage you to do your research and look carefully at other options before choosing Medical Guardian."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a561eb23948af39b03aed3b>

"I hired Home Instead to provide overnight care for my dying father once he was bed-ridden so I would be able to go home and sleep with some peace of mind. I was especially wary of bringing in strangers because my mother has dementia and doesn't trust easily. The very day I called, someone came to my parents' house to talk with me about our needs and to explain costs and processes. The staff coordinated a caregiver for that same evening who was wonderful and made all of my concerns about bringing in a stranger instantly disappear, as my mother instantly loved her. The other caregivers (we had a regular rotation of three) were angels, listening to my chatty father reminisce and showing kindness and so much care to both of my parents. We also had a visit from the care coordinator, who had a great conversation with my father. After about a month, on the night he passed, we were fortunate to have the most extraordinary caregiver who called my sister and me to come when she saw that things were progressing. We were able to play Dad's favorite music and say goodbye, and I am ever grateful to her for helping us through one of the most difficult situations we've ever encountered. She called hospice and stayed well beyond her shift to offer comfort to my mother, who was a little lost. I received calls of condolences and heard from the care coordinator several times after my father's death, even with ideas to help with my mom's needs, showing me that the entire staff genuinely cares. Home Instead is a blessing and I am thankful I made the decision to hire them!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead&query_place_id=ChIJE-tYoJzrK4cRiYcOgcCrEc
g

"We purchased Medical Guardian to.... UPDATE: Medical Guardian states publicly that it "reached out to get more information\." For the record, we have received no such outreach—no telephone call, voicemail, email, or other communication\. If the company genuinely wishes to investigate why its device failed to alert anyone when we personally witnessed the fall, it already has our customer information and can contact us directly\. This was not a minor inconvenience\. We relied on this device to summon help during precisely this kind of emergency, and it failed to do so\. A public statement expressing concern is not the same as actually contacting the customer, investigating what happened, and providing an explanation\. We purchased Medical Guardian to protect my 90-year-old mother. During an actual fall that I personally witnessed while she was wearing the device, it did not perform as we expected. We then conducted several additional tests and experienced further problems. After that experience, we no longer felt we could rely on the system for her safety. When we contacted the company, we requested a full refund because we were ending the service due to our loss of confidence after the observed failure, not because we changed our minds. The company instead treated it as a standard cancellation and offered only a prorated refund. We purchased this service for peace of mind in an emergency, and after our experience, we no longer had that confidence."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a75ebc3e4a1b027d3508175>

"Watch didnt work after fall. Customer service is a joke. DO NOT USE THIS COMPANY!!!!. I purchased the SOS smart watch from Bay Alarm Medical for my mother in November, 2023. She lives alone and I was worried she would have a fall. We tested the device and it worked. Two days ago, she fell and broke her hip. The watch would not connect to the service. It took her an hour to crawl to the living room to get her phone to call 911. This device was supposed to provide peace of mind. It had one function and it failed during the one time we needed it to work.

When I got to the hospital, I thought maybe in her panic she didn't press the button correctly. I could not get it to connect either. To make matters worse, customer service was the worst part. It was an overseas call center and the customer service rep's actual response to me was, "Im sorry, I can reset the watch from here." I was calm and rational and I'm not even sure what I was expecting to get from the call but that wasn't the response I wanted. Would you want them to simply reset the watch from a distance like it was your cable modem? Would you trust the watch to perform at a later date? So after getting very upset, I canceled my service. They will issue no refund for faulty equipment. After several more calls, I finally got a rep that seemed to care and at least offered an apology. My advice, steer clear of Bay Alarm. They don't actually care about you or your loved one."

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65c15119fdf25da8fcd0e261>

"Sturdy, Secure, and Very Helpful for Bed Mobility. I purchased this bed rail for a family member who was having difficulty getting in and out of bed after surgery, and it has made a noticeable difference. The dual handles are positioned well and feel natural to grip, making it much easier to sit up, stand, and reposition without straining. The padded, non-slip grips provide extra comfort and confidence. What impressed me most is how solid and stable the rail feels. Once assembled and secured with the included safety strap, it doesn't wobble or shift during use. The sturdy steel construction gives peace of mind, especially for seniors or anyone with limited mobility who needs reliable support. Assembly was straightforward, and the instructions were easy to follow. I also appreciate the adjustable design since it allowed us to customize the height and width to fit our bed properly. The storage pocket is a simple but useful addition for keeping glasses, a phone, remote, or book within easy reach. Overall, this bed rail provides excellent support, stability, and convenience. It has helped restore confidence and independence while reducing concerns about falls when getting in and out of bed. I would highly recommend it for seniors, caregivers, or anyone recovering from surgery who needs a little extra assistance. Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2AIN2WLLSJ7K>

"BUYER BEWARE!. BUYER BEWARE! This service is a scam. When reasearching this company it is very hard to find an honest review but do your due diligence and dig. Unfortunately I did not find out about all the billing issues and deceptive practices until my mother passed away and I needed to cancel the service. Even though I told them my mother had passed away and I returned the equipment, they have turned her account over to a collection agency. Her auto renewal was due in August but the credit card on file had been reissued so the payment did not process. During this time my mother was in the hospital and this was not a priority for me. She died in September. BBB gives this company an A+ rating however they have over 40 complaints (which proves a membership and enough money you can buy a rating). This is what Bay Alarm posts on the Consumer Affairs website: "We pride ourselves in providing the highest level of safety, honesty and customer service." This couldn't be further from the truth. The customer service rep was so nasty when I reported my mother's death, I cried. BAY ALARM WAS ENTRUSTED TO PROVIDE PEACE OF MIND FOR ME AND MY LOVED ONE BUT INSTEAD I WAS DECEIVED WHEN CLOSING THE ACCOUNT. Shame on you for preying on your senior customers!!!"

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5a457c12a5b3290b4ca414b6>

"My sister and I engaged with Home Instead to provide caregiving services for our elderly mom. Our mom has always been independent and very social but unfortunately vascular dementia had robbed her of some of her independence. Although I was working from home due to Covid-19, I still spent hours in my home office so I was unable to provide her with a lot of the social interaction needed during the day. From the start, I knew that we'd made the right choice with Home Instead. Before services even began, Greg, the owner, came to our home to meet with us and discuss exactly what would happen on each caregiver visit. He understood that it was a sensitive issue because my mom struggled with losing her independence while recognizing that she needed assistance. He was very thorough and made us very comfortable with the whole process. We had caregiver services two days a week.

The caregivers were all wonderful and my mom bonded with them. She looked forward to the days on which her caregivers came and they enjoyed wonderful conversations. They were so good to my mom and provided a lot of peace of mind for me I would not hesitate for a moment to recommend Home Instead of SW Houston"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

"We were in crisis mode.... We were in crisis mode! Our 90 year-old mom, who is legally blind and has dementia, was supposed to leave rehab the Sunday of Memorial Day after a 3-week hospital stay, and return to her assisted living facility. That Thursday night before at 9pm, the head nurse of her facility told us she could not return to the assisted living where she'd been for nearly two years. We had no idea what to do or where to turn, and had to act fast. So, I went to the website for A Place for Mom and they were WONDERFUL! They listened carefully to our situation, asked us a few questions so that they had a clear picture of mom's needs and said they'd call us back in 30 minutes. Sure enough, the phone rang and we were scheduled to view several facilities the next day and the following. A Place for Mom took us from panic mode to thoughtful next steps. Out of the five or six recommended facilities that had immediate openings, we were able to select a lovely new home for our mom that could accommodate her needs and make her feel welcomed. No more panic, just peace of mind. We are grateful for the services provided by A Place for Mom."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a710995c71d5a041b81e4a2>

"Doug was absolutely outstanding in.... Doug was absolutely outstanding in every way. He provided 24-hour care for me following my surgery, and I truly could not have asked for a better caregiver. From the very beginning, Doug was dependable, attentive, and incredibly caring. He was always early for every appointment and made sure I was where I needed to be on time. He stayed completely on top of my medications, making sure I took everything when I was supposed to and never letting anything slip through the cracks. What impressed me most was how attentive Doug was to my needs. He was always one step ahead, making sure I was comfortable, safe, and taken care of. I felt like I could completely trust him during a time when I was vulnerable and recovering. Doug went far beyond simply doing his job. He was compassionate, professional, reliable, and genuinely concerned about my well-being. His care made my recovery much easier and gave me tremendous peace of mind. I would recommend Doug without hesitation to anyone who needs a caregiver. He was simply awesome in every way imaginable, and I am incredibly grateful for the care he provided."

trustpilot · Care.com · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a9ed1af868666eb6aad70e>

"I got the system for my dad who was.... I got the system for my dad who was living alone. After it went off twice by accident, scaring him horribly he refused to use it again. A little more than a year into the contract my dad moved to where he was never alone so I tried to cancel. Life alert wouldn't let me. My dad passed in June of 2025. I had many things to do following his death. Cancelling a service that wasn't used was NOT in the forefront of my mind. By the time I remembered to cancel life alert continued taking 89 dollars out of my account for 6 months. By the time I was able to finally cancel, they will only refund 38 dollars. I will be sending a copy of this review to the Better Business Bureau. I felt totally ripped off and was given absolutely no concern for my feelings or what my family was going through. I will tell EVERYONE I know about this. You're supposed to give us peace of mind but instead we got ripped off. I will encourage my loved one's to look elsewhere because Life Alert seems to only care about money at the end of the day. Disgusted, Doreen L. Winningham"

trustpilot · Life Alert · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69211c83e2122eea186973ae>

"Exceptional Care and Peace of Mind – Highly Recommend At Your Side Home Care! We recently used At Your Side Home Care for my elderly mother who needed assistance with daily activities after a hospital stay. From the very first call, the team was responsive, professional, and truly listened to our concerns. They created a

personalized care plan that matched her exact needs, including help with medication management, meal preparation, light housekeeping, and companionship. The caregivers they sent were outstanding—kind, patient, respectful, and highly skilled. My mom quickly felt comfortable with them, and we noticed a real improvement in her mood and independence. The office staff was always available, communicated clearly, and ensured everything ran smoothly without any issues. What sets At Your Side apart is how they treat families like their own. They gave us peace of mind knowing Mom was safe and well-cared for in her own home. We couldn't be happier with the service and have already recommended them to friends and family."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=At%20Your%20Side%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJgWEGg6LdQIYRt9IKRAZ8H2M

"For those contemplating utilizing Custom Living Care Free in-home nursing care, this organization is a true lifeline for families with medically fragile children under 21 in the Atlanta, Georgia area. Families receive top-tier private in-home health care services—including both skilled nursing and essential personal care—all through the Georgia Pediatric Program (GAPP). The fact that they provide this high-quality, specialized care at absolutely NO COST to Families is truly life-changing. The care team is professional, compassionate, and highly skilled in handling the unique needs of medically fragile children. Knowing your child is receiving expert care right in the comfort and familiarity of your own home provides you with an immense peace of mind. If you are a Georgia family in need of comprehensive, compassionate, and expert in-home health care for your child, I highly recommend Custom Living Care Free. They are an exceptional, dedicated, and invaluable resource."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Custom%20Living%20Care%20Free%20In-Home%20nursing%20care&query_place_id=ChIJbRxXXYHFGMRH95LPgYeX_U

"Solid, secure, and essential for senior safety. We installed these grab bars in the bathroom for my elderly mother about a year ago, and they've been one of the best safety improvements we've made in our home. Once properly installed into the wall, they feel extremely solid and provide the confidence and stability she needs when getting in and out of the shower. Knowing she has a secure handhold has given both her and our family much greater peace of mind. The stainless steel finish still looks great after daily use in a humid bathroom, and the bars feel sturdy without being bulky. Everything needed for installation was included, and the overall quality exceeded our expectations. Sometimes the simplest products have the biggest impact. These grab bars have helped make my mother's daily routine safer and more comfortable, and I wouldn't hesitate to buy them again. I highly recommend them for anyone caring for an elderly parent or a loved one with limited mobility."

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R1PC13F96QFSZN>

"I had an great experience with Blossom Homecare LLC. Their compassionate and skilled caregivers provided exceptional care and support. They took the time to understand my loved one's unique needs and created a personalized care plan that addressed their requirements. Blossom Homecare LLC's punctuality and reliability were commendable, ensuring peace of mind for me as they never missed a visit. Effective communication and transparency were maintained throughout, keeping me informed about my family member's progress. The comprehensive range of services they offer, from daily living assistance to medication management, impressed me. Overall, Blossom Homecare LLC exceeded my expectations in every aspect. I highly recommend their high-quality, personalized, and reliable homecare services. They genuinely prioritize the well-being and happiness of their clients, providing a sense of security during challenging times."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Blossom%20Home%20Care%20LLC&query_place_id=ChIJPVAoIlkX9YgR_pRu3TESSnA

"Our family has been with Team Select Phoenix for over 4 years, and we can't say enough good things about them. They have been an incredible support for our child, who requires nursing-level care in the home. From the start, their team has gone above and beyond to find compassionate, skilled, and reliable staff who truly connect with our child and meet his complex medical needs. Their nurses and Licensed Health Aides (LHAs) are not only highly trained but also genuinely caring, which gives us peace of mind every day. Team Select is also a fantastic company to work for—they value their staff, communicate clearly, and prioritize the well-being of both the families they serve and the employees who make that care possible. We are so grateful for their commitment to our family and would recommend them without hesitation to anyone in need of in-home nursing or LHA services."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Team%20Select%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJS_55uY1uK4cRGlhZNXsdujw

"Great for caregivers!. These work and are a great assistance for care givers! MIL has dementia but is still able to use her potty chair in her room. I have a video camera in there but it isn't loud enough to wake me at night or if my phone isn't by me when I'm awake. She is a fall risk so it's peace of mind to be alerted she's up (set up on floor so I know when she stands) and I can see her walk to the chair and back. I no longer need to get up and wait until she's finished. If I go out to check mail, sit outside etc I just take the receiver with me. The volume button and on/off button come in handy lol. I do get tired of hearing the tune I've chosen at times and will turn it down or off when I let my niece (who lives with us and helps) know so she can turn hers on (I bought 2 units) and are set at different areas in her room. Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/RGBE8AU757PY3>

What worked with the parent · 118 documents

20 most engaged of 118 matching documents, complete text.

"Good luck if you want to cancel, they will keep charging your card till you dispute it with your bank . I picked up this service for my 80 yo mother who lives alone, as she wanted something like this to feel more secure, in case something happens. The device was fine, the setup was easy. I have no complains about that part. Disclaimer - my mom actually never had to use the device for real emergency (thanks god). But when we did tests, it worked. I paid for the service for about 2 years. But then my mom confessed to me, that she wasn't actually wearing device for a long time anymore. She didn't want to waste the money, so she asked me to cancel. That's where the problems started. There is no way to cancel the service online, you have to call for that. I called on January 31st of 2026, they told they were canceling the service, I received the email stating "We have received your request to cancel your services with us. We understand that each individual's situation is unique, and your safety is our top priority.". Cancelled, right? but, wait for it. First in the same email down there was another sell pitch: they offered to keep the membership for the price which was 60% lower. After the price was mentioned, there was this: "If you feel this aligns with your needs and decide to stay with us under this new monthly pricing, simply reply with "Keep my account active with my new monthly price." I didn't reply, didn't click on anything, as I didn't need lower price, I needed to cancel. On February 27th I received their regular email "This is your invoice XXX from Medical Guardian", and my credit card was charged again - for the full amount I was paying before, not even with discounted price. I called them again, and the guy on the phone kind of yelled at me, told me that I was supposed to receive an email with some paper I was supposed to sign and return to them that I do want to cancel (?) I told him that I received the confirmation that my cancellation request was received. But I have received nothing else. He told me in an irritated manner that I should receive it this time. I asked him to stay with me on the phone till I receive the email - normal practice with other companies customer service. He stated he had no time for that, that he told me I should receive it, I should check my spam folder, and hang up on me. I waited for couple hours, checked my spam folder couple times - nothing. So I just contacted Chase (the bank of the credit card I was using), and asked them to dispute the transaction. Which they did immediately. And this tells you something too. I had to do dispute only twice in my life before, and I was asked to provide receipts, describe the situation etc. Here I just provided the date I received the cancellation confirmation and the phone number I called. This probably means that I am not the only one, and Chase already dealt with the company before. So judge to yourself, if you want to deal with the, or not. To add to that, I got a call from them about a week after the guy yelled at me on the phone. I thought it was about cancellation and me disputing the charge, so I called them back. Wrong guess: they just wanted to sell me some extra service for extra charge, like I never cancelled.... Update of 03/27/2026: I just changed my 2-star review to 1-star. Since my review I received couple more calls from Medical Guardian - I assume trying to sell me something. I called them back, talked to a reasonable sounding woman who told me again that I needed to sign some paperwork that I wanted to cancel there services (even though I already requested it and received the confirmation about it on January 31st of 2026). She told me it's their procedure as the equipment needed to be returned. I told her the equipment didn't need to be returned in my situation. She agreed - "yes, I see, you purchased it, so you don't need to return it, but it's our procedure". I said O'k, email it to me right now. And she claimed she did it. We both waited for about 5 minutes - nothing came through - not even to a spam folder. Then she said she would send the papers to me by mail. It's was about 2 weeks ago. Nothing like that came in the mail. But instead my 80 yo mom (even though I was the one paying her bills and buying her device) received a paper by mail dated of March 17th of 2026, that she has an unpaid balance. And guess what - I received an email today with the bill (this one miraculously came through). And another one of my credit cards got charged: I must have switched credit cards at some point. And Medical Guardian made sure they kept all the info on file - must be for the situation like this. I have to dispute this new charge now - two months after I cancelled the service. This place is a total scam."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69af4e56f6eda3f45901489b>

"Shady Company/Takes your loved ones 1st month rent. I began a google search for "assisted living places near me". I wrote down all the info for the places near me for my mother in law. I began calling the assisted living facilities. I called a phone number in the nursing home website that was NOT listed as the phone number for a Place for Mom. I speak to someone who I thought was from the nursing home only it was an operator who did NOT IDENTIFY herself as an operator for a place for mom. I then was directed to an "advisor" who again did NOT identify herself as a Rep for this company. I still thought I was speaking to someone from the nursing home. She began to tell me that she was a referral service and that there is no fee; that it is a free courtesy service. So I listened to her tell me 5 places near me and was reading the same reviews that she googled that I had already read! She then stated she would send my info to those 5 places for me to contact them. I chose a place quickly WITHOUT her help as I already had done the work myself. She did NOTHING, set up nothing, made no phone calls. I received emails from her which I did not read cause I NEVER SOLICITED HER HELP OR SERVICES. I was deferred to this company unbeknownst to me. 3 weeks later I get a text from her offering her help. I said we already found a place. She IMMEDIATELY calls the assisted living place to acquire her commission. I get a call from the director of the assisted living home minutes later asking me if I had used their service. I responded that I hadn't that I was redirected to them. I never asked for or used her help. He told me that they TAKE the loved ones 1st months' rent as their commission. I was furious! None of this was told to me at all! I called this chick up and in a heated discussion she informed me that the director of the nursing home is in violation and breach of their contract between them for telling me that she takes the rent money. I said...How is that not my business to know where my mother's money is going?". I argued that I never ASKED FOR her help and she did nothing to help me find a place so how do you feel justified in earning a \$5000 commission? She said that she sent a referral to them for me and an email with the list of 5 places. I responded that I never asked her to do this nor what she did helped because I already had them on my list to call. I asked why was the 1st months' rent never divulged to me during our 1 conversation? She said they are not taking my loved ones money so basically it doesn't concern me because it is a contract between a Place for mom and the assisted living facility. Then she explained that it is divulged in the emails at the very bottom IN THE FINE PRINT. I said 1.. I never read your emails cause I didn't need your help and 2.. that's not something you put in the fine print. (upon looking at the fine print it directs you to another link for questions/answers which never says their commission is the 1st months rent, just that they are paid a fee by the provider for their service). Shady company who took credit and money for something they never did. All she cared about was her commission. The point is that anyone can do a google search and do the exact same thing that they do. Then you'll know that your money for your loved one is actually going towards their care and NOT a commission fee! Finally, if banking \$5000 from an elderly person for sending out an email (called a referral) is considered ethical and appropriate business, then that is truly disturbing."

trustpilot · A Place for Mom · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5e1dc8c2c845450bec3722b1>

"Makes an awesome, somewhat reusable pet pad for under my parrot's play pen!. I had a package of a similar item many years ago that I used for an ailing geriatric dog. I loved them because they were super handy, weren't treated with any kind of pheromone-smelling product (I didn't want to encourage my dog to relieve herself in the house, just wanted to have absorbent padding under her in the event of mild incontinence). They worked great for that purpose. Flash forward to many years later, and I had a puppy that I was house training. I'm not a believer in puppy pads because I want my pup to learn that the only place to potty is outside, and IMO, puppy pads just confuse that concept. However, a friend of mine had given me a package of puppy pads. Not wanting them to go to waste, I thought I'd just use them under my parrot's play pen to catch food that he throws, stray corn cob bedding, or in the event that he hangs his bottom off of the side of his play pen to potty. Normally, I use designated microfiber towels for this and just launder as-needed, but needing something in a pinch, I remembered the puppy pads. No sooner had I put one down, my 90% potty-trained pup took one sniff of that puppy pad and promptly peed on it! Obviously, the puppy pads were not a wise choice for under the bird's play pen. That reminded me of

these, and I ordered a pack last week. They're the perfect size for my use, super convenient, and are a time saver. I'm able to re-use one multiple times since the only time I need to replace is if the parrot has...well, you know. These aren't very environmentally friendly, so they're just something to keep on hand as a backup if I anticipate that I won't have a lot of time for laundry. I think they have numerous uses for pets aside from the intended use for humans, and are suitable to protect furniture or carpeting from pets who are experiencing *mild* incontinence (I don't think these pads would absorb a full bladder, and the plastic is rather thin - I have no intention of testing that theory for the obvious reasons!) I expect"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2YVQAD7N4MCNG>

"Terrible company. Please read. My mom was a patient with Gaspy for a few months and everything was going well until covid-19. My mom whom is bed bound, worked well with everyone that was sent to our home. I received a call from Gaspy home health on a Monday morning informing me that the CNA that came to help bathe my Mom on the previous Friday tested positive for COVID-19. I was furious bc I have a premature daughter that also lives in the home. We do not go outside and we order as much as we can to prevent us from going outside so we won't put my Mom whom has brain cancer at risk or my premature daughter at risk. Now we received a call Informing is that the cna tested positive and that we would need to quarantine for 14 days. Some time during the 14 days my mom began to run a low grade fever of 99. Because of the cancer and being around the cna that tested positive we were told to call the ambulance and take her to the hospital. We did and my mom tested positive for covid-19. I was furious. My mom was sent to the icu for a few days then a regular room. I received a call From someone at Gaspy regarding my mom and to schedule her next visits. I informed them that she tested positive was in the hospital and that we would have to wait and that I was having a company come covid clean the home. The lady on the other end of the phone informed me that was fine and that they would need a negative test result to began seeing her again. So today, July 10, 2020, I received a call from my mom's doctors office informing me that they received discharged papers from Gaspy home health discharging my mom as a patient because they don't see covid patients. I am confused because they never contacted me to inform me of any of this and my mom got covid from their staff and she was discharged as a patient because of testing positive. I said all of that to say do not trust this company with your loved ones. Obviously they do not care about their customers nor employees. I am in the process of contacting a lawyer to see what we can do about this."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Gaspy%20Home%20Healthcare&query_place_id=ChIJ8_doVlrGQIYROdBtpQBNCNw

"If you're considering a Right at Home.... If you're considering a Right at Home franchise expecting real partnership and meaningful support to help you succeed as a business owner, be cautious. You are largely paying for the brand name and will be left mostly on your own. I spoke directly with Mallory Hoskinson, Senior Director of Growth and Engagement, who leads the business coaching team and sets the tone for how franchisees are supported. God bless her heart, she genuinely seems to believe that franchisees paying their own hard-earned money are there for her team to manage and audit, rather than to receive true partnership and hands-on help building the business. Instead of the proactive support one would expect when paying to work with a franchise, the approach came across as that of a typical corporate employee focused on minimum effort. It seemed to me that the priority was putting in the least amount of work required while directing her team to do the same and framing it as "risk mitigation." When I asked whether corporate could provide real assistance for time-critical local opportunities that can make or break a new office, the answer was a flat "No." It is disappointing to see a senior leader responsible for franchisee support treat potential franchisees — who are investing significant capital — more like subordinates than valued business partners. This kind of engagement from someone in her position raises serious questions about the actual level of support and partnership Right at Home provides to those who join the system. If you are comfortable paying premium franchise fees while receiving minimal support and little respect as an owner, this may work for you. If you expect genuine partnership and actual help building your business, I would strongly recommend looking elsewhere."

trustpilot · Right at Home · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a30e3492e68a2feb38365d9>

"You have to read this!. I wanted to get my 98 yr old mom a lift chair for her birthday, living 5 hours away I needed to purchase it online. I looked up the top 10 chairs and this Mcombo was on the list, and was one of the few that had the heat and massage feature. I ordered it on Sat. and it was due in Wed., which worked great as we were going down on Thursday to put it together. It actually showed up on Sunday, the day after we ordered it. It was easy to put together, we had it set up and working, but in the final checklist noticed we missed a slot and it was listing to one side. We easily undid a few steps and fixed the listing only to find out the massage and heat features now weren't working. This was late on Friday evening. I did all the troubleshooting and then called the help line and had to leave a message. I was concerned that we would have to send the whole chair back, and we had to head home on Sunday, unsure who could handle that task. I received a call from the company first thing Monday morning and was told I had to fill out a claim form. We did it easily. I received an email the next day and they sent out a new remote for the heat/massage feature. That didn't solve the problem and I emailed them back letting them know. I received an email back stating that they would be sending out a whole new seat back. We got that in two days, and that fixed the problem. I have to say that their customer service was amazing! The chair was elegant to fit into my Mom's living room, comfortable even without the extra heat/massage feature, the lift really helped her get up and down, and the price was very reasonable. I love this company and will use them for all of my chairs in the future. My Mom loves her new chair and I love this company!! Read more"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R20DG8IPBOTAJR>

"I was so excited to work for this.... I was so excited to work for this company. The 3 day induction training was unpaid, Saturday Sunday and Monday 9am-4pm. I was a companionship caregiver, and my clients were dementia clients who I thoroughly enjoyed working with but I initially was told I would have 12hrs a week but I only got 4hrs. As time went on I received 10hrs but that didn't last long before some clients were taken off me. I was misinformed about claiming car travel allowance so I never received any payments for 3 months and had to arrange a meeting with the main boss to finally receive it. The office staff come across as being supportive but aren't and continually lied to me concerning a lot of issues. Never returned my calls. After I'd worked there a short while my client visits were obviously turning into personal care visits which wasn't the role I applied for. I covered holidays for other caregivers and was shocked at the lack of previous care the clients had been receiving. Once I booked a holiday and I received a phone call from the office asking if I needed the holiday as other caregivers that worked more hours than me wanted that day or me having one day's holiday 'messed' it up for other caregivers' holidays. I finally put in my notice I was told I had to work 4wks notice and then I would receive all monies owed including holiday hours accrued. I never had a contract but worked the 4wks as asked but never received the accrued holiday pay. I contacted the office and as always was told they'd get someone to look into it. Every call was ignored, every message was ignored. The caregivers are lovely, the clients are lovely and it was a pleasure spending time with them, but the office staff are not."

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6133d990cc0087e8ef6e5479>

"DO NOT PURCHASE FOR LOVED ONES! \$200 due when it stops working!!!. We bought this unit a month ago while my grandmother was in and out of a care center and it initially worked great when we set it up, then 2 weeks in it started saying the internet strength was weak...(we never moved the unit for 2 weeks, it worked fine). We also bought the wall adapter in case of power outage (which most people would purchase). The unit's lights completely went out and it died. I called to trouble shoot and got Monica, instead of good customer service she puts me on hold as she talks to her supervisor. He then informed her now we owe them \$200 because the unit was damaged....due to power surge OR power failure! I bought the plug in to prevent that from happening and she told me there was nothing more she could do and that we could not get a replacement without sending the unit back and paying another \$200. This is a sure way to cause more stress to your family and your loved one who needs

this kind of help. Please do not make the mistake I did and read over all the negative comments. They are TRUE. This company is a SCAM! As stated below it was a "misunderstanding" now I was told twice by Monica that I was to pay \$200 to get a new system, if it was my grandmother calling they would have taken her to the cleaners!!! Not a proper way to run any business, I am worried for all the elderly that they have taken advantage of in the past and in the future due to inexperienced staff. After a lot of unnecessary upset and time wasted the problem has been corrected."

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/561416a40000ff00090eae93>

"Watch didnt work after fall. Customer service is a joke. DO NOT USE THIS COMPANY!!!!. I purchased the SOS smart watch from Bay Alarm Medical for my mother in November, 2023. She lives alone and I was worried she would have a fall. We tested the device and it worked. Two days ago, she fell and broke her hip. The watch would not connect to the service. It took her an hour to crawl to the living room to get her phone to call 911. This device was supposed to provide peace of mind. It had one function and it failed during the one time we needed it to work. When I got to the hospital, I thought maybe in her panic she didn't press the button correctly. I could not get it to connect either. To make matters worse, customer service was the worst part. It was an overseas call center and the customer service rep's actual response to me was, "Im sorry, I can reset the watch from here." I was calm and rational and I'm not even sure what I was expecting to get from the call but that wasn't the response I wanted. Would you want them to simply reset the watch from a distance like it was your cable modem? Would you trust the watch to perform at a later date? So after getting very upset, I canceled my service. They will issue no refund for faulty equipment. After several more calls, I finally got a rep that seemed to care and at least offered an apology. My advice, steer clear of Bay Alarm. They don't actually care about you or your loved one."

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/65c15119fdf25da8fcd0e261>

"This has been a real help in our home.. This is a great product. Elderly father-in-law lives with us. He is a high fall risk and has dementia. Wanted something that would alert us when he sat up on the edge of his bed in the night before trying to stand and walk to the bathroom. We put it on the floor under his bed. It worked perfect. The alarm part is portable so my husband sleeps with it by his night stand. It has adjustable volume level so you can set it for whether you are a light or heavy sleeper to wake you up at the first movement of patient. Also, because it is portable when his Dad lays down in the afternoon my husband brings it with him to the living room while he watches TV so he is always aware of what his Dad is up to. The only modification I made to the motion detector for our use was that the visual area was wide so even after my husband got his Dad up it would continue to detect motion when they got out of the room and into the hall. Because my father-in-law moves slowly the alarm would go off numerous times. By putting a piece of masking tape over the lens on the area on the side by the hall I was able to restrict the motion pick up to the area where he put his feet over the bed and once my husband was helping him toward the hall the alarm would stop. Also, nice is there are many choices for alarm sounds/songs."

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R35CPR0DQPCD2J>

"Trouble canceling our account. Using the device was easy and worked well. When our mother went into a nursing home, it took me months to cancel our service. Turns out you have to sign and return a Medical Device Cease and Desist letter. Nobody told me this for several months. So, each month I would get billed again, call and be told my account was now canceled. Finally, I was told to sign, scan and return the letter. I don't know how to scan, so I asked if I could fax it. I was given a fax number, and I faxed the signed letter. Then, I was billed again. I called and was told there was no fax machine in their department and they didn't receive the letter. So, I signed another letter and sent it in the mail. Then, I was billed again. I called and the customer service representative told me they hadn't received the letter. She looked into my file and discovered a note that said they had received the faxed letter from 2 months ago. She said my account is now canceled and I will receive a refund for the last 2 months."

We will see if this is the end or if I will still be billed and told to send the Cease and Resist letter. So the product is great, but there is something very wrong with the department that deals with handling people trying to cancel their account."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/64c93ca59b243a9b45cf3a73>

"it actually worked this evening; extremely happy with product and service. It worked. My 83 y.o. mother lives alone, 3,000 miles away. This evening I chatted with her just after her daytime helper left; she had had a snack and was going to call me after going to the bathroom and getting back in bed. Instead I got a phone call from an unfamiliar number and I took it; it was the Bay Alert people. She had fallen in the bathroom and they had talked with her via the alert and then they contacted the local ambulance corps to help her up again (she does not have osteoporosis and she was not injured). Then they called me to tell me they'd called the ambulance, and called me again afterwards to tell me that she wanted me to know she was okay (her phone was in the other room). I am very unhappy that she fell, but I am SO happy that this alarm worked. My mother is the least mechanically inclined person on the planet so it is a marvel that it worked for her in particular. Her daytime helper makes sure it is charged. I bought the device directly from the company, but since the company has a storefront on Amazon I presume it is all the same."

amazon · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2DD4JUVBZ370X>

"This company is low cost and the service works, but not great customer service. This company is low cost. It is very easy to sign up online. I received the equipment as promised. It worked as designed. I purchased this service for my mother, (69). She moved in to our home so we could take care of her. She had complications that made it risky for her to walk, take a bath, etc. She went on hospice shortly after we received the unit. It got tested one night at 2 AM. When Bay Alarm Medical could not reach my wife or myself, they called 911. The firemen woke us up. It turns out she accidentally set it off, and didn't hear the operator call her. It was good to know the system worked. Unfortunately, my mother passed within weeks of getting the service. Bay Alarm Medical terminated the service effective the day of her death. My moderate rating is more related to the less than stellar customer service. I had numerous unanswered emails I sent to their customer service group. Instead of charging the final charges to my credit card, I received a bill in the mail. It was somewhat difficult to cancel the service."

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5aa72c1bd5a570032020f6bc>

"Cancellation Process is fraudulent. Cancellation Process is fraudulent. We started the process to cancel service back in November 2024 with a phone call to customer service. The service was cut off that day. They promised to send us a return label. We called several times to follow up, but a return label was not sent until January 2025. Then, the company refused to confirm receipt of the returned equipment until the end of January. Then they said it needed to be reviewed for 30 days. Then they claimed they still needed more time. It was not until today, more than five months later, that they finally acknowledged receipt, but they would only partially refund the service fee that we had previously paid in December from the end of January. Even though we had no service for months! So, they deliberately delayed closing the account until this week in order to keep more of the service fee. Its a shame, because the bracelet worked well, but after our experience trying to cancel, we are completely turned off to this company and would never recommend to anyone."

trustpilot · Medical Alert · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/67ffe8660cdf8a8e5efa6f1c>

"DO NOT TRUST THIS COMPANY. We wanted a lifeline for our 92 year old mother who lives alone. I placed an order for a landline system. We live in rural NH and there is no cell signal where we live. I was sent a cellular unit. I verified the unit did not work and contacted the rep I had spoken with (Dana Marra at 856-770-4133). The rep did not respond. I called customer service and was on the line for 45 minutes. They told me that we should have a cell signal. After several failed attempts to connect (which I tried even though I kept reiterating to the service rep

that there is no signal). After proving that it didn't work, they offered to replace the unit with a mobile cellular unit, again we have no cell signal. She said that is all we can do for you. DO NOT trust this company (no switch to a landline even though I explained that we previously had a landline with Medical Guardian that worked fine). DO NOT get screwed by this company. They care about your money. That's all."

trustpilot · Medical Alert · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/688c068cf5a54c7e62d16049>

"My mom was transferred from University Medical Center by ambulance. Staff threw her in a chair. Ripped out one of her staples. Said she wasn't allowed any of her meds heart pills etc till after the holidays. She called me crying and begging to leave. Sent me pics of blood and open wound and no one would assist her.. Tried calling multiple times while driving down there.. just rings and says wireless caller can't be reached. Finally got here and no one will answer the door. They have honestly kept her captive. Won't allow her to leave. When I called her cell and asked her to put nurse on phone they wouldn't take the phone. Horrible place that could care less about your loved ones. Would not recommend! BE AWARE!!!! Update we had to call the police and the ambulance took her back to Banner. The neurosurgeon had to run CT scans from the damage they put her through"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Desert%20Terrace%20Healthcare%20Center&query_place_id=ChIJkzHFgpQNK4cRcHzo_Qw11bc

"Worked well...to start with. Although I had been pleased with the unit to start with, I found that it had stopped working suddenly. I tried to check functionality on my cell phone but recorded message stated that the cell signal was not available. My computer measured a download speed of 200 Mgps, so that was silly. Our phones were working. I reset the password and reinstalled the app on my phone. Restarted the phone. Nothing. I finally got a response on the unit and assured that I was testing. It confirmed the testing status. Site on phone still not working. I finally searched the website on my computer and found a way to download the app to my phone, which did the trick. In the meantime, local dispatch called and a local ambulance member showed up at the door. Really not too sure i want to keep this unit for 45.00 per month right now."

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R2VOO8PFEE2L7F>

"Customer Service is Lacking. Only had this a month before my father passed away. When I tried to cancel it was an absolute headache. They sent an email with a document to sign, which elderly really don't know how to use computers so that was less than helpful plus it went to a spam folder and then they never follow up and just continue to bill you. For a device that is designed for the elderly, their process for setting up and disconnecting is NOT elderly friendly. We never had to use the device so I cannot really speak to how well it worked. It charged and we could test it but my dad had a hard time hearing it as he was hard of hearing which I also think is a bit of a problem for what it is supposed to be used for. I don't know if the fall detection part works as thankfully we did not have that experience."

trustpilot · Medical Guardian · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/62854be5045d025d3a97d2ee>

"This is the best US provider, and a great unit.. I anguished about which unit to buy. None had perfect reviews. But I am glad we went with this one. The product engineering is excellent. It is simple to operate, even in—especially in—an emergency. It does not require a smart phone to operate—operation is fairly intuitive. When we tested it, emergency calls are answered immediately and by a US call center (billing questions may be offshore; there is a brief AI that asks whether it is a false alarm, but it redirects immediately to a US call center who have been intelligent and articulate). Connectivity in a deep rural forested area was fantastic. This device can be a watch, necklace, or clip—so you can figure out what mode you like. Again, I could not be more pleased."

amazon · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R4EWGB7X6CJE9>

"High quality device with easy activation at a reasonable price. This is my first time with one of these GPS devices. I was expecting it to be rather complex to setup and get working. But it turned out that setup and activation went very smooth online with no calls needed to support. Tested it with my 92 year old mother and it worked great. Even with her bad hearing the audio quality was better than expected. The phone application also works great. Being able to see the GPS location and the battery level is great. The overall build quality of the device seems above average. Overall I would highly recommend this device if you have elderly parents to look after and you need peace of mind their OK. Thanks SecuLife!"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R3PFBKG1MU45IR>

The office answered and kept me informed · 81 documents

20 most engaged of 81 matching documents, complete text.

"PAID SUBSCRIBER TO CARE. I AM A PAID SUBSCRIBER ON CARE FOR ALMOST 9 MONTHS. I AM WRITING THIS REVIEW TO PERSUADE CARES MANAGEMENT TO PROVIDE MORE THOROUGH SCREENING OF PROVIDERS AND MONITORING PROVIDERS PERFORMANCE ON THE CARE SITE. I DONT MEAN BACKGROUND CHECKS. I AM REFERRING TO CARES USE OF TECHNOLOGY TO SCREEN OUT APPLICANTS AND PROVIDERS THAT ARE NOT SERIOUS ABOUT USING THE SITE, AND WHO DO NOT PERFORM WELL UNDER THE SITES GUIDELINES. I HAVE INTERVIEWED AND MET WITH 6 PROVIDERS ON CARE AND HIRED 3 OF THEM. I PROBABLY SHOULD HAVE INTERVIEWED WITH THE PROVIDERS WITH MORE QUESTIONS, HOWEVER, I AM A BUSY PERSON AND I DONT HAVE A LOT OF TIME TO MEET AND INTERVIEW, SET SCHEDULES, ETC. I DID MY BEST. THE PROVIDERS I HIRED ON CARE MISQUOTED THEIR ADVERTISED PRICES ON CARE AND ARRIVED WITH A DIFFERENT HIGHER PRICE. OF THE 3 PROVIDERS I HIRED, THE FIRST ONE, WASTED 2 HOURS OF TIME, WHILE ON THE JOB AND EMOTIONALLY EXTORTED \$80 DOLLARS OUT OF ME. SHE DID NOT COMPLETE THE WORK AND LEFT MY PLACE IN A MESS. THE SECOND PROVIDER ARRIVED CLEANED FOR 3 AND A HALF HOURS, BUT DID NOT COMPLETE THE JOB AND WANTED MORE MONEY. SHE THEN MADE FLAKEY EXCUSES OF WHY SHE COULD NOT RETURN TO FINISH THE JOB. MY PLACE IS NOT DIRTY. THE 3RD PROVIDER CAME TO MY HOME INTERVIEWED WITH ME AND BOTH WE AGREED, AND THEN SET A TIME FOR THE NEXT DAY, TO WORK FOR 2 HOURS, AND SHE WAS A NO CALL/NO SHOW. ON THE SUBJECT OF THE OTHER PROVIDERS I HAVE INTERACTED WITH ON CARE AND HAVE GOTTEN A RESPONSE FROM MOST OF THEM WANT LARGE SUMS OF MONEY TO DO THE WORK. \$50 HOUR FOR SOME HOUSE CLEANING. ADVERTISED PROVIDERS ARE EXTREMELY FLAKEY AND UNTRUSTWORTHY. IT'S A RIDICULOUS SET-UP AND CARE NEEDS TO MONITOR PROVIDERS PERFORMANCE AND PRICING. I ALSO FEEL LIKE CARE DOES NOT DO ENOUGH TO PROTECT THE PRIVACY OF USERS. I FEEL THAT SOME OF YOUR PROVIDERS ARE SHARING CUSTOMER INFORMATION OUTSIDE CARE. I DID INTERFACE WITH ONE OF THE MANAGERS AT CARE AND THEY WERE VERY NICE AND RESPONSIVE. CARE HAS BEEN A WASTE OF MY TIME, MONEY AND ENERGY. I WONT BE RENEWING MY YEARLY CARE SUBSCRIPTION TO CARE.COM."

trustpilot · Care.com · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/66dd1ead5f2f57ac00df945f>

"Visiting Angels or Visiting Demons?. I am writing this from a CAREGIVER'S perspective. I have been a registered nurse for over 25 years, and just signed on with this company for parttime, something to do work. In the 6 weeks that I was employed by an Austin Texas franchise owned by Sue Guerrero, I became appalled and frightened at the unprofessionalism practiced first by the franchise owner, SUE GUERRERO, borders upon homicidal. She hires "caregivers" without having thoroughly vetting them , in some cases not even background checking them or even asking for identification. I was shocked that I was hired sight unseen , over the phone, not even having to present my nursing license. I was sent DIRECTLY to a patients home for 4 days in a row before I even met her in person. I thought that to be suspect. The other caregivers that I worked with were incompetent to say the least, dangerous in fact. I would NEVER leave one of my loved one's under this company's care. On the other hand, the first two weeks I was paid fairly promptly, albeit less than what we had agreed upon. I was supposed to be paid 22.00 hourly. My check reflected 14.00 and hour. Mind you , this is with no breaks and no lunch and paying gas and car maintenance. The second pay period , I received my check 7 days late. Today is May the 6th. Payday was the 1st. I have been three times to her office which is 55 minutes away because I was told to PICK UP MY CHECK. Each time that I have been there, her office is shut down, locked and she refuses to answer my calls. I am a very

conscientious , punctual individual who cares about her patients. I have done nothing to deserve this treatment. Please be aware that your caregiver, although you, in good conscious pay Visiting Angels in a timely manner, may not be getting paid..... Thank you and God Bless."

trustpilot · Visiting Angels Tustin / Irvine · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/62754d5c166eb7ecbf3f2eb2>

"If you're considering a Right at Home.... If you're considering a Right at Home franchise expecting real partnership and meaningful support to help you succeed as a business owner, be cautious. You are largely paying for the brand name and will be left mostly on your own. I spoke directly with Mallory Hoskinson, Senior Director of Growth and Engagement, who leads the business coaching team and sets the tone for how franchisees are supported. God bless her heart, she genuinely seems to believe that franchisees paying their own hard-earned money are there for her team to manage and audit, rather than to receive true partnership and hands-on help building the business. Instead of the proactive support one would expect when paying to work with a franchise, the approach came across as that of a typical corporate employee focused on minimum effort. It seemed to me that the priority was putting in the least amount of work required while directing her team to do the same and framing it as "risk mitigation." When I asked whether corporate could provide real assistance for time-critical local opportunities that can make or break a new office, the answer was a flat "No." It is disappointing to see a senior leader responsible for franchisee support treat potential franchisees — who are investing significant capital — more like subordinates than valued business partners. This kind of engagement from someone in her position raises serious questions about the actual level of support and partnership Right at Home provides to those who join the system. If you are comfortable paying premium franchise fees while receiving minimal support and little respect as an owner, this may work for you. If you expect genuine partnership and actual help building your business, I would strongly recommend looking elsewhere."

trustpilot · Right at Home · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a30e3492e68a2feb38365d9>

"Home Instead Barnet living Up To Their Name. Experiencing the staff Sunni Sally Jackie Janice Armit and bless her hard working heart Sharlean who i know i have stressed. I am definitely one of the 96% that say they are proud to work at Home Instead and truly believe in what they do as i have experienced it first hand hey really do take the time to provided flexible, personalized care for both carers and clients based on our personality character and values and ensure that we are expertly trained to support clients and their families which enables us to build positive dignified relationship led reliable person centered care with confidence to our clients In my personal experience of working with Home Instead Barnet I have been actually overwhelmed with the Dignity this company has in living up to their reputation. I can attest that you will be genuinely supported as an employee with them being flexible and very responsive to changing needs and always available for advice and support The team has an energy that is very respectful supportive and caring and will really motivate you and enable you to work happily and provide the best care for their clients as they have proven to provide the best care for their employees I have worked for a few different companies and can honestly say, there is not one company that could shine a torch this way☐ Ever! Home Instead Barnet Sunni..5 Star..."

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/5fdc6d56755dc107e0c72fa8>

"I would give zero stars if possible If you get assigned this company for home health care RUN! The office never returns calls, case manager is never " available", nurses are incompetent and rude. I have been doing the wound care for my wife various times and through various surgeries for 7 years. I had to train some nurses in the hospital how to manage the wounds and things my wife is currently going through. No i do not have the degree, but i have been trained by various wound care and ostomy nurses on what needs to be done. For the nurse to say that i am not a professional and dont know what i am doing is very unprofessional and disrespectful. For the last 3 weeks we have been requesting a female nurse due to trama in my wife's past and they have been continually trying to send male nurses. Today the nurse was supposed to just do blood draws but said he was supposed to be doing

wound care which is not needed or even ordered by her doctor. The office does not communicate with their nurses on orders. It has been the same with every nurse since we started this in February. They have no clue what their orders even are. I had to call and get verbal clarification over the phone for orders on her initial intake visit because the nurse could not read her orders correctly. Do not use this company if you have the choice!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Gaspary%20Home%20Healthcare&query_place_id=ChIJ8_doVlrGQIYROdBtpQBNCNw

"We have been using Home Instead - Houston Southwest for sixth months. My husband has mobility issues and needs someone with him at all times. I work outside the home and am unable to be with him during the workday. The team at the agency is so helpful. They walked us through the process prior to providing service. We have long term health coverage, and their team is wonderful in handling the regular submissions to the agency for our reimbursement. The office team is very responsive to our needs. At the beginning, we had a lot of schedule change requests. They handled them all with ease. The caregivers are great. They take care of everything for us during the day while I am away. They are friendly, caring and respectful. I would highly recommend Home Instead - Houston Southwest to anyone in need of home care. KH2 5 | January 19, 2022 Other Our family was extremely pleased with the care my mother received from Home Instead, especially Diamond, Audrey, and Morgan. The program was explained thoroughly prior to the start date. My mother's caregiver was always on time, wonderful, kind, compassionate, thorough, and trustworthy. In addition, the office staff was extremely responsive and understanding. I would highly recommend Home Instead."

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/texas/houston/home-instead-west-and-southwest-houston>

"When needing care for my 90 year old mother Home Instead has proved to be five star! After dad passed, my mom wanted to stay in her home of forty years. I do not live in Houston, therefore I was in desperate need of a solution to providing mom's desire. Home Instead was quick to answer my call for help, set an appointment to meet my mom, assist in the paperwork and begin immediate service. Other providers I contacted forwarded me to an answering service and never returned my call. Greg and his team are "on 24 hour call", always available. They are organized, efficient, and caring. Because I do not live in Houston, communication is essential. Greg, his administration, and the professional caregivers, are excellent in keeping me informed on every aspect of mom's care. Providing for the elderly is a huge challenge. Darlene, Andrea, Beverly and Brenda have been a consistent and huge blessing in meeting that challenge and attending the needs of my mother. Words alone do not seem enough to express gratitude to Greg and his team for their excellent, dependable service and superb professionalism."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

"Exceptional Care and Peace of Mind – Highly Recommend At Your Side Home Care! We recently used At Your Side Home Care for my elderly mother who needed assistance with daily activities after a hospital stay. From the very first call, the team was responsive, professional, and truly listened to our concerns. They created a personalized care plan that matched her exact needs, including help with medication management, meal preparation, light housekeeping, and companionship. The caregivers they sent were outstanding—kind, patient, respectful, and highly skilled. My mom quickly felt comfortable with them, and we noticed a real improvement in her mood and independence. The office staff was always available, communicated clearly, and ensured everything ran smoothly without any issues. What sets At Your Side apart is how they treat families like their own. They gave us peace of mind knowing Mom was safe and well-cared for in her own home. We couldn't be happier with the service and have already recommended them to friends and family."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=At%20Your%20Side%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJgWEGg6LdQIYRt9IKRAZ8H2M

"BrightStar in Columbus. BrightStar in Columbus, Ohio, contracted through the Franklin County Office of Aging, is extremely unprofessional and disorganized. Their schedulers and management do not respond to emails, cannot maintain consistent coverage for the elderly, and frequently ignore calls from both employees and customers. Staff frequently complain about poor communication, and turnover is constant. The scheduling manager provides incorrect information, and the company fails to coordinate properly. In my experience, I was informed only two days before an aide was supposed to assist my 102-year-old grandmother that they had "ended the contract" and no one would be coming—yet the program manager later confirmed that a 30-day notice is required. Overall, BrightStar shows a complete lack of professionalism and respect for clients and staff. I strongly advise against using their services."

trustpilot · BrightStar Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a2acf1bb213535e03b042cf>

"Great Customer Service. First, comes in 3 large boxes, easy to assemble. I bought this chair for my husband recovering from a severe leg injury. It has been a godsend. The lift assist was a tremendous help. He loves the heat & massage on occasion as well. Within the 1st 30 days, we did have an issue with the massager quit working. I emailed seller and their customer service team are super responsive. They tried to identify issue with questions, photos & finally a short 16 sec video. Troubleshooted through remote then connector box and finally the entire back of chair. Each time, they provided ship date & fedex tracking of each part. The entire back rest solved the problem. I was very impressed with the quick responses, quick 2 day shipment of parts and correspondence along the way. McComb stands behind their products. Would definitely recommend purchasing, nice chair for the money!"

amazon browser · <https://www.amazon.com/gp/customer-reviews/R6WLRSLXPIPD>

"I have loved interacting with Team Select for the last several years! I started with them caring for my son. The nurse they sent us is basically family at this point and has caught several illnesses at their earliest signs for him. This helped us get him taken care of sooner, and kept him out of the hospital...a major win for our family! But it doesn't stop there. Their office staff is always incredibly responsive and great about communicating with us with schedule changes. They are always offering extra help where it's needed and supporting our family with finding resources where they can. Recently I signed on with them as an LHA to provide care for my son as well. The training was very personalized and easy to accomplish with the help their training staff gave. All in all, they are a wonderful company to work with and for, and we are so thankful to have them be a part of our life."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Team%20Select%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJS_55uY1uK4cRGihZNxsdujw

"Our family has been with Team Select Phoenix for over 4 years, and we can't say enough good things about them. They have been an incredible support for our child, who requires nursing-level care in the home. From the start, their team has gone above and beyond to find compassionate, skilled, and reliable staff who truly connect with our child and meet his complex medical needs. Their nurses and Licensed Health Aides (LHAs) are not only highly trained but also genuinely caring, which gives us peace of mind every day. Team Select is also a fantastic company to work for—they value their staff, communicate clearly, and prioritize the well-being of both the families they serve and the employees who make that care possible. We are so grateful for their commitment to our family and would recommend them without hesitation to anyone in need of in-home nursing or LHA services."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Team%20Select%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJS_55uY1uK4cRGihZNxsdujw

"We have been extremely pleased with the level of care and attentiveness that Assisting Hands Home Care provides to my elderly mother. The office staff has been very responsive in matching us with caregivers and meeting our needs. They are dependable and flexible at the same time. In particular, Antoinae - who provides a

dual role in-office and direct client contact - stands out as she has consistently gone above and beyond to ensure that our needs are being met. She is a top-notch, caring professional. Maria is also an excellent caregiver. She is punctual, energetic, dependable and genuine. We are impressed with the positive attitude of all of the caregivers that we have interacted with and are thankful to have found Assisting Hands Home Care. I would highly recommend them to anyone who is wanting quality care for a loved one."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Assisting%20Hands%20Home%20Care%20-%20Serving%20Cave%20Creek%20and%20Surrounding%20Areas&query_place_id=ChIJKWfEILVxK4cRyho9vTkcbAo

"Medical Alert is charging us for a device we never requested or recieved. . Medical Alert is charging us for a device we never requested or received. We have spent days/hours with the billing department with no resolution. We have requested to speak with a supervisor or manager, but there is never one available. They are supposed to have one call us back but that never happens. Dealing with their customer service and billing department has been a frustrating nightmare! You never get the same person twice and no one cares to resolve the problem. We were actually told by one employee that it was our problem, not theirs, and we would just have to deal with it. I would never recommend Medical Alert to anyone. They are there to sign you up and wash their hands of you afterward."

trustpilot · Medical Alert · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6786b0fcb1dacb695955d1d6>

"The staff at Team Select Home Care in Phoenix are truly exceptional. Every employee I've encountered is professional, compassionate, and deeply committed to providing outstanding care. They treat each client with respect and kindness, making you feel valued and supported every step of the way. From nurses to administrative staff, the whole team works seamlessly to ensure smooth communication and personalized attention. Their dedication and genuine care make a huge difference in the healing and comfort of their patients. I am so grateful for the Phoenix team's hard work and heart — they go above and beyond, and it shows in everything they do. I highly recommend Team Select Home Care for anyone looking for reliable, compassionate home care."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Team%20Select%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJS_55uY1uK4cRGihZNXsdujw

"My family is very pleased with the response from the Home Instead team. Ibrahim, Audrey, Karen, Lane, and April have all been very accommodating. I appreciate that someone is always available, 24 hours, every day. As with any staffing, some personalities mixed better with me than others. Home Instead never made me feel like I was creating problems for them or imposing on them when I would request a different caregiver —they just fixed the staffing situation. The only thing that I would like better is when new caregivers get assigned to me, that they be introduced to me prior to working a full shift at the home. Otherwise, I'm very happy with the service."

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/texas/houston/home-instead-west-and-southwest-houston>

"Home Instead Senior Care has been amazing. They also provide services for younger adults who need assistance with cooking, light housekeeping and transportation. Chichi has been invaluable to our family. She is always prompt and goes out of her way to make sure I am taken care of each day. She helps take me to doctor appointments and attends to all my tasks/errands for the day. I am so thankful to Chichi for all that she has done. The staff at the Home Instead office have also been wonderful. Audrey is always available to answer questions and adjust to my schedule needs. I would definitely recommend Home Instead."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20West%20and%20Southwest%20Houston&query_place_id=ChIJE92yB9vcQIYRRpNA8t5-1_0

"This company has been wonderful for my daughter. Her home health aide is patient, kind, and dependable, and you can tell she genuinely cares about my daughter's well-being. On top of that, they've gone above and beyond by helping us get connected with other resources and support services my daughter needed. They're not just an in-

home aide service, they truly help your whole family and make your child's life easier. Scheduling has always been smooth, and the staff communicates clearly if anything changes. I definitely recommend them to other parents looking for trustworthy, caring support."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Axess%20Health%20Solutions&query_place_id=ChIJraMf9xyI9YgRBfdEyTj0wwc

"I called Home Instead to help my sister who lives alone; I called them because I had a pretty good experience with them for my mom in another state. However, this particular office has been great! Greg came and talked to us and really listened to what we needed. The caregiver they provided has been great! She communicates with me regularly and truly cares about my sister's wellbeing! My sister can be difficult but she and her caregiver get along very well, this is not a small thing! 😊 . The staff has been very nice and responsive as well. All in all it has been a great experience!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

"Axess Health Solutions came into my family's life at the perfect time. I heard about them through another family that needed similar home health care needs - referrals are always what we try to use when taking care of our family. The owners were incredibly responsive and we had a nurse at our home within a week taking care of our elderly mother-in-law. We also referred Axess to our friends who have a disabled child! They are compassionate and always prioritize the needs of the client. We will continue to recommend this company to anyone who will listen. Thank you!!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Axess%20Health%20Solutions&query_place_id=ChIJraMf9xyI9YgRBfdEyTj0wwc

A named person who became family · 61 documents

20 most engaged of 61 matching documents, complete text.

"Home Instead Senior Care South Loop Houston provided care for our family's elderly mother for over a year in a prominent Houston retirement community. We are very appreciative for the quality caregiving Home Instead provided. They are professional, caring, accommodating, and flexible. Donna, our caregiver did a fantastic job taking care of our mother. She was responsible, caring and made sure our mother received everything she needed during her shifts. We were so fortunate to have her working for us. Home Instead constantly communicated with our family to make sure we were getting everything we needed and making sure we were happy with Donna. For every single day she came to mother's apartment, we were very happy. She did a fantastic job. I wholeheartedly recommend Home Instead South Loop for caregiving services."

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/texas/houston/home-instead-houston-central-medical-center-tx>

"Great Staff I love them. My nurse name was Tracy omg she was so so good she was an angel sent from heaven very patient and kind and got my leg healed very fast liss her so much she was my Nurse RN she would always let me know what time she was coming and was never late she helped me physically, mentally and spiritually I miss her and if you see her tell her she was a great nurse they need more people like her in the hospitals She a wonderful person that takes her job seriously, bright star you got a good nurse. Don't lose her and my PT he did his job and was gone he was great also I can't say or spell his name he was from Nigeria and very kind I miss him to since he been gone my knees have started back hurting"

trustpilot · BrightStar Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a90d8a26cf9ae0e01d2ced>

"Home Instead has my HIGHEST recommendation! When my family made the difficult decision to bring our mother home under Hospice care, we knew we could not do it alone. The owner met with us, listened to our needs, and arranged for 24/7 care to begin the same day. Over the course of a week, we had three exceptional caregivers (Ife, Nathalie, and Esther) that became like family. They immediately bonded with the patient and the family, were highly attentive to the patient's needs, provided us with suggestions for keeping the patient's spirits up, and even assisted with some chores. They treated mom with kindness, tenderness, and respect, and I am truly grateful for the care she received in her final days."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20West%20and%20Southwest%20Houston&query_place_id=ChIJE92yB9vcQIYRRpNA8t5-1_0

"This agency was a nightmare for my family. This agency was a nightmare for my family. We had multiple untrained caregivers that were sent to care for my mom. They basically were "sitters" and refused to do cares. We set up a care plan which the agency did not follow. We knew one caregiver was stealing and snooping in private information so we set up a Ring camera and had everything on video. They still denied he did anything wrong. The caregiver stole my dad's medications. Multiple more examples of the poor caregiving and inconsistent caregivers. Stay clear! The agency treats the family absolutely awful! They do not have high integrity."

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a4c48b924ce60d18391a712>

"Koi Home Care and Brittany provided the best care for our mom in her final months. Peniel was instrumental in selecting and scheduling an array of caregivers to meet our mom's needs on a 24/7 basis in the beginning, then reducing care as requested as Mom rallied. Billing, scheduling, and communication was always straightforward

and accessible, as were care notes via their portal. Caregiver selection was made on capabilities and personality that matched the need. Our interaction with Koi was overwhelmingly positive and we would highly recommend Peniel and his team should you need care for your loved one."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Koi%20Home%20Care%20Services&query_place_id=ChIJqTnVaS14YGQRCV23REUYoQM

"I called Home Instead for assistance in caring for my mother who was already on hospice. I realized I was unable to take care of her all by myself. The caregiver quickly assigned to us was wonderful. When she first came, my mother was walking a little but as that changed to being a bed patient, our caregiver was able to adapt to a changing situation. It was nice to have someone walk with me as my mother neared the end of her life. I can't say enough about how your caregiver took a huge load off of me. Thank you Home Instead, for sending into our home just the right person at just the right time."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

"When looking for a Home Care for my Father-In-Law, I interviewed several. I knew in my mind and my heart which one I was going to go with right away. Trish was responsive, detailed, caring, prompt and understanding exactly what we were looking for in care. During the time of having a caregiver, we have had hospital visits and having them in our corner made all the difference. We wanted more hours for our caregiver and they made it happen what seemed like overnight. They really do care! I HIGHLY recommend Home Care Assistance of Mesa for your loving family members."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=TheKey%20-%20Senior%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJcZb1mzilK4cRbfivT3_8kk

"Caregivers. Since 2021, my family has been utilizing services from Home Instead. The experience has been wonderful. Our caregiver has practically become part of our family and makes me, as a daughter, feel so at ease. I know that my mom is cared for in a way I would love to provide if I didn't have to work. The company works with families to find a caregiver who matches their clients' needs and personalities. You should always feel free to contact them with any questions or concerns you may have!"

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6a1908da393fd567d44dcfe0>

"I have been using the services of FirstLight Home Care for myself, and I am thoroughly impressed with their professionalism and dedication. The caregiver, Deborah, is not only skilled and knowledgeable but also compassionate and attentive. Communication with the agency has always been prompt and clear. I highly recommend FirstLight Home Care to anyone in need of home care services. Their commitment to providing high-quality, personalized care is truly commendable."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=FirstLight%20Home%20Care%20of%20Houston%20Metro&query_place_id=ChIJ-Z2BFGTBQYRiuJo_ZTci44

"I believe my caregiver Jeannette is a very hard worker. She's a very smart, intelligent, and conscientious individual. She's a good cook as well as a wonderful housekeeper. She's always on time and very concerned about my well-being. She's foremost the best caregiver I've had with Home Instead. Words cannot describe the heart felt care she provides. She's a jewel and I wish I could have her everyday. She provides superb care, and I mean it."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

"My children have been receiving skilled nursing care from Team Select Home Health for the past two years, and the skilled nursing services have been nothing short of exceptional. The level of communication from the office is consistently outstanding, ensuring that all our needs are met promptly and efficiently. Team Select treats us like family, providing care that goes beyond the usual expectations."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Team%20Select%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJS_55uY1uK4cRGlhZNXsdujw

"My aunt's caregiver, Kandy, is amazing. My aunt's caregiver is amazing. She takes care of every aspect of my aunt's needs from health to taking care of groceries, pets, and the house. She is kind and compassionate and extremely patient with the many demands and requests my aunt has on a daily basis. Our family appreciates her so much. She has become quite a dear friend."

trustpilot · Home Instead Senior Care · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/69f22690579922ecab494e07>

"I have been a client for 19yrs and RAH has been great to me. I have a wonderful caregiver, LaSean who has been with me the entire time, my nurse Linda is good to me and the staff always check on me. I'm provided with excellent service and all my needs are met. My life has been extended and comfortable thank to them and I'm grateful."

caring.com · <https://www.caring.com/senior-care/georgia/atlanta/right-at-home-greater-atlanta>

"My mother was sent to Elite and the nurse Angie was horrible. This lady had no clue what she was doing she was horrifically rude . Angie told us she didn't care about us because she has "tons of other patients we make no difference " was one of the more nicer things she said. I beg everyone to stay away from this on educated women."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Team%20Select%20Home%20Care&query_place_id=ChIJS_55uY1uK4cRGlhZNXsdujw

"I have used Home Instead of Sugar Land with both of my parents at critical times in caregiving. I can not recommend them enough! The owner Greg, and office staff Lillian have both been hands on setting up care. Our main caregiver Liz was a perfect match and has been a Godsend to our family!! We have had an amazing experience!!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

"App not functioning since its update . We chose Bay alarm for the caregiver tracking component on the app. Since the app has been updated, that component is not functioning. After three calls regarding the app not working, we have not seen any results. When the caregiver function is working, I would choose a five star rating."

trustpilot · Bay Alarm Medical · <https://www.trustpilot.com/reviews/6932fb389fff5e5cd070e8fd>

"Suncrest is a great agency! My mom's nurse aide is absolutely amazing. She is caring, compassionate, attentive, and truly goes above and beyond to meet my mom's needs. I'm so grateful for the wonderful care and peace of mind she provides our family. Highly recommend Suncrest!"

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=SunCrest%20Home%20Health%20Southside&query_place_id=ChIJKVZv47-p9YgRi8vjgPHBYsQ

"My caregiver, Noel, was wonderful! Not only was she professionally competent and skilled, she was also able to anticipate my personal and post surgery needs by making useful observations and suggestions for me to follow. I would highly recommend her and Clear Care's services."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Clear%20Care%20LLC.&query_place_id=ChIJsy4H8TDS50gRn-gq5V8LV9o

"Wonderful company to work with. My father's case caregiver Annie is so compassionate and committed to helping my father with his welfare. I am so relieved and thankful since I live out of state knowing that I have someone to help me. Annie is a God-send. Thank you."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=A%20Step%20Above%20Case%20Management&query_place_id=ChIJfebWO18D9YgRdFFomitHtgI

"My caregiver Annie was amazing, helped my recovery go extremely smoothly. She was wonderful anticipating my needs. She was attentive to my personal needs as well as with small household chores. I would engage her to be my caregiver next time I need assistance."

google review · https://www.google.com/maps/search/?api=1&query=Home%20Instead%20-%20Houston%2C%20Bellaire%2C%20Missouri%20City%20%26%20Sugar%20Land&query_place_id=ChIJ0ek3qo_CQIYRE4qI0bpX_ns

Tab 8 — Desired Outcomes

I don't want to be my mom's caretaker / do this anymore · 539 documents

20 most engaged of 539 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62. I cared for both of my parents for 10 years. It almost killed me. You lose your very self. People tell you to take care of yourself, but there's no time for that. There's no You anymore. My mother was the last one to die. That was 4 years ago. I'm still exhausted, if that tells you anything. I don't want to go anywhere or do anything. I live happily by myself with my phone to keep me company. I may be adding a cat to the scenario soon. I have a wonderful family nearby who I see every now and then, so I'm not totally alone. But I want no other human being living in my space ever. The silence and slowness of life is so sweet. I loved my parents dearly. Now, it's all about me."

youtube · @lindaN236 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1,123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAg

↳ **@Teffi_Club** (93): "It is true when you take care of your parents, you lose your own health."

↳ **@sjtalksandlife** (61): "It's time for you to enjoy your life, you did a great job with your parents, now it's time to focus on you"

↳ **@lordbrunski** (44): "I am so glad you shared that with honesty. I have hypothyroid and looking after my ungrateful and abusive parents has left me in a state of exhaustion that I cannot shake off. I feel like you do. Being solo is the only think I want. Men assume that I am "up for it" and they have no idea that all I want is a book, a cat and a dog. The idea of having to look after anyone else does not appeal."

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞"

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking csre of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏"

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the

bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the “levels of care”, worrying about my mom’s dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA’s, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA’s, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say “when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ”. We actually get used to saying “When they die”, because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she’s RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she’s a little bruised but ok, but I’m berating myself that I couldn’t catch her in time. I’m so upset with myself, then a nurse says “It happens all the time. These 90yo’s are *fast* sometimes!” And sure enough it turns out it’s just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia’s really worsening now, she can’t remember why she’s in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me (“Have you met her? She’s really nice”) - and we’re just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both “really nice” and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I’m driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom’s rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I’ve never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother’s wrecked, we’re all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I’m bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened (“oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing”)... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something’s wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom’s memorial is gonna be because I can’t plan that yet because I’m trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he’s not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there’s two weeks where *every single day* he’s weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It’s okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I’m ready to go. It’s okay. He says, I don’t want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I’m trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we’re all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it’s that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that’s okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking

about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets.. Edit everything I say here is for the USA. private pay insurance. I've worked for home health for around five years now and I want to share some of the good and bad I've learned so you can make an informed decision about the care for your aging parents. There are two kinds of home health care ones thst accept Medicare and one's that do not. The ones that do follow stricter guidelines for care (this doesn't mean they're better it just means they have to follow different rules than private insurance) my information only applies to those that do not take Medicare. First. It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour. So please don't act towards the caregivers like they should be doing \$50 an hour worth of work because they are not getting paid much above minimum wage. Second. Keep track of your loved ones need for care. If they fall and then need care or have a heart attack and need help after surgery. The agency is never ever going to tell you that the person is fine now and doesn't need care anymore. I go to several assignments where I do literally nothing the entire time I'm there just because no body says to stop sending us. Third. If you up the care from one kind to another temporarily after an injury or fall make sure that when you know they can go back down to less care that they return to charging you the lower rate. I've been to several assignments where I'm still being paid for hands on care even though all I'm doing is cleaning house. Fourth. Do not look at the caregivers like you would a cleaning crew That comes in and cleans as fast as they can to get done fast and move on to the next home. Caregivers are there for a set time so we are encouraged to sit and talk to our clients. Watch TV with them. Play games. Go for walks. We won't always be up doing things. We aren't someone who you hired to fix your toilet and now he's sitting on your couch. You hired us to take care of your loved one and sometimes that is just having a conversation or watching TV together. Fifth. Ask the caregiver what they need for the home and for the client. I went to an assignment last month that had no toilet paper in the whole house. The client was bedbound and used diapers so they just never thought to have toilet paper in the house. I literally had no way to wipe for the first day and I ended up bringing my own. Hand soap, paper towels, gloves, hand sanitizer all these things you are responsible for providing. Sixth. Understand that for the most part we are not nurses. Most states require little to no certifications to be a home health aide. So please understand the limitations of what we can/are allowed to do. We can't make medical decisions. We can't administer medicines. We can't change dressings. We can't even trim nails because if we cut you it could cause an infection. So please be very aware of what we are and are not allowed to do and don't ask or expect us to do something we aren't supposed to do. If you want any other advice ask it in the comments I'm happy to answer."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

↳ **comment** (363): "RN here and this is incredibly well written and all very true. Thank you for all you do. You ARE underpaid. Massively."

↳ **comment** (137): "It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients"cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception thst the

caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

↳ **comment** (94): "Thank you. I love my job but I am aware of it's downfalls."

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/live_never_been_more_upset_wit_h_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful.* Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her.* I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom CHOSE this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly AGAINST having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends ALSO saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit AGAIN, find a new place to live AGAIN, set up all my utilities AGAIN, and STILL have to manage HER life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING. I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7 months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER. THIS, more than ANYTHING, should be a clue that mom is NOT who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and THEN people will complain that mom is LONELY. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags

under her bed rather than in the 3 FUCKING HAMPERS I've bought for her) FINALLY getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"How do you manage intense resentment towards your aging parent?. I don't resent that my mom is aging. I resent that she never prepared for the aging process, never saved, never had a plan in place, is barely hanging on living by herself and now it is left all to me, her eldest daughter, to manage her care. Sometimes the resentment is so intense it feels like I might explode. I feel spread so thin, and I know it's impacting my infant and my partner. I don't want to do this anymore. I don't want to be my mom's caretaker. I don't want to go to her house and try to find a clean place to sit. I don't want to have to wait til I get home to use the bathroom because her toilet is covered in feces even with housekeepers. I don't want to see my mom deteriorate before my eyes and feel like the situation is insurmountable. I live 2 blocks away but I don't want to help anymore. I'm so weary. I will never put my own daughter in this situation. Thank you to whoever has listened."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 451 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kzbb9p/how_do_you_manage_intense_re_resentment_towards_your/

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and

shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a

medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delirium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"Overheard parent saying horrible things about me. I'm the default caretaker. How do I go on?. I have a nanny cam on my 78 year old parent. I don't usually spy, but I have it in case I don't hear from them. Tonight, my sister asked me to check the camera because my 78M father didn't answer the phone. I did, but he was calling her back when I looked. I heard the convo. I shoulda clicked out, but I was so shocked by what I was hearing that I froze. He said some really awful things. Luckily, I only got part of it. He has a problem with how I raise my family and what I do in my free time (which is basically a mom of three). He doesn't like that I have a career. He doesn't approve of anything I do unless it benefits him. I'll spare you the details because I'm genuinely embarrassed to admit the things that came from his mouth. Anyway.... The words were so awful and hurtful. How will I recover? I basically orchestrate his life. I do his finances, I make his appointments, I accompany him to his appointments, I pay his home taxes, oil bill and house cleaning service. I'm feeling damaged. I don't know why his opinion of me matters, but it does. I'll admit I have said some pretty crappy things about people in my life for sure, but the stuff he said about me -- his own daughter -- seems inexcusable. How do you cope for a parent that constantly gives you disapproval even when you are doing everything that you can to help? He doesn't have dementia. He is just a mean human. I have to take him to the doctor Wednesday because there's no one else and I honestly just don't know how I can bring myself to do it. I will because no one else will step up. I feel forever changed though. If you're still reading, thank you. What is your coping strategy?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 378 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/

↳ **comment** (323): "Did your sister shut him down? If you have a good relationship with her, I would tell her what you overheard, and that unless she starts to push back on his awfulness, she can take over all of the stuff you are presently doing."

↳ **comment** (309): "You can drop the rope between you. Or you can speak up for yourself and call him out. Or keep doing what you are doing."

↳ **comment** (171): "I wrote my very similar story below. I was never an angry or assertive person. I'm timid and a people pleaser and overachiever, but there came a moment that I got angrier than I'd ever been in my life (at around 55yrs old) with my father and finally stood up to him. I suggest you do the same. You deserve better and need to be assertive and set YOUR boundaries. Think seriously about not taking him to his drs appointment. Either just cancel it yourself and don't show up at his place or make him be the one to cancel it. It's probably best to let him know you heard his comments and telling him that things will be different going forward (setting boundaries) because you're upset with him and consider going no contact with him at least for a while. If confronting him is too hard (I get that), have your sister tell him and just make yourself unavailable. Unless you get an apology, you do you with your own family. My story below. It felt good to write it, but I'm fine if you skip it. I can relate so much to this. My father was always negative and controlling. When I was 55yrs old +, and he was 85+ he would still yell at me like a bad child for ridiculous reasons when I would drive 3 hrs to help him and my mother with dementia with different things. I thought that it was that he thought I was going to take control so he was asserting his. I never talked back or argued with him my whole life. I just took it as did my mom. Then he got upset with me because I put a bottle of Pepsi and a bottle of Fiji water in the refrigerator...for THEM because I thought their power was out from bad storms and it was 93 degrees. "We don't need all these things in the refrigerator." (There was very little in it.) And I snapped and screamed at him. I only had the nerve to do that because I was already packed up to leave their house and I knew my mother wouldn't be upset. I taught middle school so I could do overly dramatic loud yelling. I said that he was ruining my mental health which was true. I had started anxiety and depression meds all because of him and the situation, and I lived 3hrs away. I was just outside the door I slammed (another first for me) and went back in and said, "This is the last thing I'm ever going to say to you. OTHER PEOPLE HAVE FEELINGS TOO. I'm done with how you treat me. When you need help, and you will, call your son. I'm done. You have made me very upset and now I have a lot of time driving ahead of me." And as I drove back home, I was upset but also felt the anxiety of "walking on eggshells" with him my whole life suddenly lift. I called my brother, who lives 6 hrs away and was still working while I had retired already, and I told him I was now estranged from our dad so he needed to be ready if Dad called. He said "okay, I understand" and I felt totally free. I did not call at Christmas or birthdays nor send gifts (my mother wasn't aware of holidays or even who I was) and he called and said "We're worried about you" on my voicemail like nothing had happened. If I got a serious apology from him I would have softened, but that never happened. It felt good to not answer his calls (knowing he could call my brother for help) and knowing I had set a boundary with him that I should have set years earlier. I was still estranged from him when he died, and I don't feel the least bit bad about it or grief that he was dead. In fact, that was a relief too."

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had."* This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin* Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the

fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family *Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin* My cousin also asked her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant **we** would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set of what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rtrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was lewy body dementia. I handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage lewy body. This march, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month

for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"This is my life right now. My 81 year old mom has been on the decline for the last 3 and half years. She lives with me and my spouse. I am 56. it is so hard. I have no life and am worried and stressed constantly. I am beaten down, exhausted & worn out. I rarely laugh anymore. Thank you for posting this!"

youtube · @GenXGal1 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 284 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugyqej9hZ2qGs2YAeBR4AaABAg

↳ **@robogal1** (32): "When I m some days far away from my mother I become a completely different person, happy, laughing, satisfied...it s a feeling of freedom. I m feeling so trapped, when I have to stay with her, cause she is always so mean, controlling everything I do, never satisfied, but it s my sense of duty., that makes me to look after her. I have no help, are completely alone! My brother, who was always her darling, doesn t care at all for her. He calls once a week, never visits her."

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (20): "Hi, I get it. I don't know if it is any tiny comfort but you are one of very many in this situation right now. It's beyond difficult. Do the best you can to be kind to yourself. I appreciate you sharing what's going on."

↳ **@TallRaucousTruthSeeker** (19): "@robogal1you better check she hasn't left everything she owns to your brother if she has a will. It wouldn't be beyond imagining. Either that or she'll take you for granted for years, cost you your life & leave everything to the cat protection society. It happens, I've seen it!"

"Dealing with 'the stuff'. My mom passed away recently. Dad passed away a few years ago. My wife and I just got home after living near Mom for the last seven months — first caring for her, then handling her affairs after she died. I'm an only child, so no brothers or sisters to help (or fight with? I keep getting told how 'lucky' I am and it doesn't feel that way at all). The last few weeks were a blur of going through a lifetime of possessions. During the day my wife would wear herself out sorting, boxing, packing. After I was done with work I'd go through what she'd pre-sorted, or tackle another room myself. There wasn't much quality time — just quick meals so we could keep pushing through. It was physically, mentally, and emotionally exhausting. My wife knew someone who does estate sales, so we signed a contract with them. The last time I left the house I grew up in as it was for my entire life was hard. The next time I see it, it'll be completely empty. It was hard walking away knowing we couldn't keep everything Mom considered valuable. Neither of my parents saved for retirement — they relied on Social Security. As we went through the house, we kept finding eBay listings Mom had printed out for some vase or another thing, price circled. That's when I started getting angry. All this 'stuff' has subjective value that rises and falls as tastes change and things go in and out of style. What if some of that had gone into basic retirement savings instead? I'm not saying they shouldn't have enjoyed having nice things — we all do. But Mom especially treated her possessions like investments, or at least that's what she told herself. I have no idea what the estate sale will net, but I'm not expecting much. I spent a lot out of my own pocket to care for my mom the last few years. I'm not counting it all up — that's not the point. But a lot of that was because she couldn't bring herself to deal with this stuff herself. She was deeply and profoundly attached to possessions in ways that are really hard for me to comprehend. Now we're the ones dealing with it. It's death by a thousand papercuts, trying to figure out what's trash and what's treasure. Why do people think this is something good to leave behind? When my grandmother died years ago, the only thing I wanted from her house was her teapot. She used it every day, and I have so many memories of drinking tea with her. I'd take that over piles of stuff I'll never use, art that isn't my taste, or dining room furniture (who has formal dining rooms anymore?). There were multiple sets of silverware and fine china we never used in my entire life — I guess we were saving those for when the Kennedys came for dinner. LOL The lesson I've taken from all this: we're deluded into thinking we own things. We're just the current caretakers and curators of stuff. And you may like your stuff but other people may or may not like your stuff. And if they like it, that's ok. And if they don't like it, that's ok too."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 278 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v62aym/dealing_with_the_stuff/

↳ **comment** (91): ""She was deeply and profoundly attached to possessions in ways that are really hard for me to comprehend." You stated this perfectly. That's how I feel about my Mom. It hit me hard some years back when we agreed that we'd skip Christmas shopping that year and spend the money on flying in family so we could all be together, my idea because I'd just started an intense new job and didn't have time to shop. It was the best Christmas of my life! When I laid down to sleep I felt this total peace because I'd been with everyone I loved the most all day and knew they were all ok. My worry loop, which runs quietly in the background all the time, could shut off for one whole night, everyone was fine. It was bliss. I found out a couple weeks later that my Mom was furious at me because there were no presents. This while she lives in a house stuffed to the top, with priceless antiques and valuables crammed in every nook and cranny, along with actual garbage, and tons of tacky, cheap Dollar Store crap. That's when I realized that she and I do not love the same way. In her mind, how do you know someone loves you if they don't give you something material? In my mind, stuff doesn't matter, spending time together does."

↳ **comment** (67): "In a world where a married women couldn't open a bank account without her husband, my grandmother bought diamond rings in case she had to cut and run. Definitely second-best to real investment but it was the best she could do. (The law changed in the US in 1974 and she died in 1980.)"

↳ **comment** (66): "My mother constantly shows me items in her home that I know for a fact are worth maybe \$100 at best, and she swears to me that they will be worth enough to help my son pay for college. I mean, shes not wrong, \$100 helps pay for college too, but we all know thats not what she means lol She also keeps drawing

my attention to a ring she wears. She keeps asking me if she should take it to get valued for insurance purposes but I am 95% sure it is borderline worthless and that she would be completely crushed by the news. Her mother gave it to her with the promise that it "could be sold in an emergency for money" and my mother has treasured it ever since. We have tried to encourage my mother to see its value as a sentimental item, but she keeps asserting its monetary value is far greater. Sigh. There is just something about that generation that they keep hearing the siren song of "value" in their prized possessions, and prioritize the collection of valuable items far above saving or investing their money. Younger generations have their own "stupid" investments, I don't think the problem is gone, they just get sucked into a different kind of investing now (like bitcoin and polymarket betting). Same game different pieces. Our childrens children might not have much to clear out of the family home, but might be met with a complex web of lost orphaned brokerage accounts instead 😂 "

"better way to respond to parents saying they want to move back into their house?. Without getting into all the details: My parents both had serious accidents in their home recently. Both were in the hospital, then rehab. Now they are together at a very very nice assisted living place that they have agreed to stay in for at least three months. The problem is that they keep talking about how they plan to move back into the house. The house that has been unsafe for them - where they had their falls. Neither one of them is able to live independently at this point, let alone be a caregiver for the other. My sibling and I are the ones who have handled everything that needs handling during this extremely stressful time - and are still doing it. It's so much. I'm not local - I've been flying back and forth. My sibling lives about an hour away with two little kids and has been driving back and forth. We're exhausted, we're stressed. We are past the crisis part of this - I think - but there is still so, so much to do. For years we begged our parents to move to a one-floor condo or to build a bedroom on the first floor of their house (which is just trip hazard city, between the stairs and a thousand throw rugs everywhere). They never thought this was important - never mind that Mom has Parkinson's and osteoporosis and both are in their 80s. We kept emphasizing that they could make choices while they were fully able, and get exactly what they wanted - or wait until there was a crisis, and have whatever choices were available then. They chose the latter. But they will not stop talking about moving back into the house. They think they can build a bedroom on the first floor, move the washing machine to the first floor, redo the bathroom, hire people to take care of them - and never mind that the two of them can't even figure out how to make a phone call right now. I guess they think the magic construction fairy will wave a wand and make this happen. I'm visiting right now, and it's been another stressful week - but also I am just so glad to spend time with my parents, and so grateful that this isn't worse. But meanwhile I've discovered that their house has mice - one more thing my sibling and I have to take care of. And the mice are living in the garbage they've been keeping in their kitchen cabinets and in the basement. I've asked them to pause talking about the house - I told them that I am at the end of my tether and need to get on top of what is happening more before I can even talk with them about where they are going next. I suggested they do some research about other living situations if they want - independent living, if they want, other ALFs, even construction companies and caregivers. But that I am not ready to talk about any of this while we are still so early in all of this, and I am still trying to get my dad into a doctor for his broken back because for some reason the osteo he's seen will only deal with his broken hip. But last night after dinner - the food at the ALF is good at least! - my mom started up again. And I lost it, in a very very ugly way. You really don't know what shame is until you've yelled at your 80-something year old mother in an assisted living home. I don't want to extinguish their hope - I don't want to be a jerk. I also am apparently furious that we are in this situation because they were living in this house, and I don't have it in me to have a lighthearted conversation about it right now. Not while we're still having to do so much. Given that it is inevitable they will bring up going home again - and given how raw I seem to be - what is the right way to respond next time? Thanks for reading my novel and oy, oy."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 241 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/

↳ **comment** (210): "If they don't have the ability to arrange things, just refuse to execute on the idea and leave it on them to organize, standing firm that they can't move back until they have arranged all of that on their own."

↳ **comment** (207): "I suggest a slightly different approach that's worked well for me. Let them talk. Let them dream, let them plan. Talk is just that - talk. They are not able to actually DO anything without help from you or your sibling. If the talk starts to move into real specifics of "doing", which is unlikely, then you redirect. "Interesting idea mom and dad, let me think about that for a while". "I'll look into that mom and dad, I need a bit of time". This approach worked like a dream for my family."

↳ **comment** (125): "This is similar to getting my mom to stop driving. Her car broke and she wanted to replace it. None of us kids thought her getting behind the wheel again was as good idea. So we just didn't help her get a new one. She talked a lot at first about getting a new one, but couldn't figure out how to do it and none of us took the steps to do it for her. Eventually she stopped talking about it."

"It's been a year since I quit my job and moved back home to care for my 79 year-old mom. I'm only 35... and I've gained more weight, I feel stuck sometimes. I feel like my life is on pause mode. I don't get to meet my friends anymore. I haven't been in a romantic relationship and cannot imagine meeting someone soon. My savings are dwindling... I wonder what will happen in the future. My siblings live in other countries and all have their own families to take care of. I love my mom, but we get into arguments sometimes. It gets really overwhelming to be alone in this journey. :(""

youtube · @ri5876 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 241 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=UgyoDoUxKO49e7lk3N4AaABAq>

↳ **@lynnnettemolinpersonalpage** (39): "Tell your siblings to take their turn. Living in another country is no excuse. You need a break. They can fly her to them to live or at the very least they can spend their vacation weeks living in your home so you can get regular breaks."

↳ **@aeromedical6750** (35): "@R I — I totally understand your situation because I live it. You feel trapped, because their caregiving needs always trump yours. Nothing satisfies my Mom right now. She's a sweet person, but totally self centered. My wife and I are constantly on guard that the next crises is right around the corner. Our lives revolve around her care needs 24/7."

↳ **@crimeariver8370** (29): "Im in the exact same boat as you. And just like you I also feel alone and trapped with no one to help take the edge off. So I totally feel ya."

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF

placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldeercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's

time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are talking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had

heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

I want to sleep through the night · 476 documents

20 most engaged of 476 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a

wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me (“Have you met her? She’s really nice”) - and we’re just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both “really nice” and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I’m driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom’s rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I’ve never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother’s wrecked, we’re all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I’m bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened (“oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing”)... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something’s wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom’s memorial is gonna be because I can’t plan that yet because I’m trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he’s not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there’s two weeks where *every single day* he’s weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It’s okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I’m ready to go. It’s okay. He says, I don’t want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I’m trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we’re all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it’s that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that’s okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he’s sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We’re talking about football and birds. He’s looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says “What a coincidence!” and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily “Because I love you too,” , he’s beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say “See you soon!” and I wave and I leave, and I’m certain I’ll see him next week and we’ll talk about the Super Bowl and I’ll tell him about the birds I’ve seen, I’ll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he’s gone. It’s over”

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"She’s going to trap me in soon, my adult life is over. My mom is 61 and will be getting let go from her factory job soon. She only speaks polish after living in the USA for 25 years and has nowhere to go. She won’t go back to Poland, her retirement won’t be more than \$1,300/month so she won’t be able to afford her apartment. I live in a rural area with no public transportation so I’m it. I’m her only outlet. She’s visiting us right now and is an absolute weirdo. I have a 20 month old baby and am getting ready for a mastectomy for breast cancer. I’m working full time and trying to make things fun for my son but I also need rest. She literally sits on top of me all the time. When I’m reading my son a book she comes in and will point to the pages like a toddler and go “RED CAR” loudly and so on. She tries to butt into my conversations with my husband but doesn’t understand so wants a translation. She tries to steer the stroller or shopping cart with me and when I’m like fucking you do it she runs into me

because she's staring off into the abyss as if she's never seen groceries in her life before. I feel like a trapped animal, I'm caged in my own home. Last night she told me she won't be able to take care of my baby when I'm doing my surgery because "he cries" and she's too uncomfortable. I literally have cancer. Like...what? She said she doesn't know how to build a relationship with him as she doesn't speak English and she doesn't think he likes her. I told her she needs to grow up and act like a caregiver (she won't feed or change his diaper) and not like a friend or grandma for fun she sees in the movies. So now I get to wake up in the hospital alone OR with a mother who doesn't understand shit as my husband is pacing the hotel with our toddler. I'm crushed. I'm so overwhelmed. She's like ready to move in, I mean she literally has nowhere else to go. I don't trust her with my baby after yesterday's shenanigans but most importantly I don't trust that I'll be happy again. My husband and I have build a calm life, we are best friends, and she literally just sits down and stares at us. I was up at 4am having coffee in my living room today and at breakfast she was like "did I see you in the living room this morning" and when I said yes she was like "but why were you sitting there?". I put on lotion and she goes "did you put on lotion? Wow" like wtf do you mean?! Ok rant over just a woman who's so overwhelmed I'm about to rip my hair out. W"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 455 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/

↳ **comment** (650): "She does not get to move in. Get her on waitlists for senior housing or speak to a social worker about how section 8 will go."

↳ **comment** (234): "Tell her no. She's been in the country 25 years, she's 61. I'm 61 and I've had lots of challenges. I figured them out. She can go back to Poland where the money she gets will go further. Just sit her down and say I'm sorry but I have to take care of myself and my family and you have to leave. If it breaks your relationship it breaks it and if she has nowhere to go that's her problem. I know this is harsh but you are currently in a life or death situation with breast cancer. You have your own life and your own kids to worry about and just be mean if you have to. This is something that all of us raised by these parents need to give ourselves permission to do. We have to give ourselves permission to stand up for ourselves even if it means we're going to feel guilty, even if it means they're going to be angry, even if it means they're going to tell relatives that we're awful towards them and abandon them. Too bad we're just going to have to live with that."

↳ **comment** (218): "THIS! THIS! THIS, OP! My mother only has social security and doesn't receive much more than your mother will. She lives in senior housing, and her rent is a percentage of her social security check - I think it's \$200 per month for a nice one-bedroom, one-bathroom apartment. The building itself is staffed 24/7 in case of emergencies. There's a rec room, a laundry room on each floor, and even a shuttle service that will take residents to appointments and stores for free. My mom was on a waiting list for about 6 months, but that was several years ago. Get your mom on those lists now if you can."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as*

my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and

waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society

refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

"The "Go Home" Loop: What my wife's sundowning taught me about my own restless mind. My wife has mid-stage Alzheimer's dementia. Like many of you, I live with the daily rhythm of her asking to "go home"—even when we're sitting in the house we've shared for thirty years. She'll plan the trip, ask about her father picking her up, worry about the time. No redirection works for long. The loop restarts. I want to share something that changed how I sit with her in these moments, and it comes from an unexpected place. I practice Zen meditation. In this discipline, you work to return to "the present moment"—to drop the internal chatter and simply be where you are. But my mind resists. It generates errands to remember, problems to solve, imaginary conversations. It wants to be *anywhere* but here, *anytime* but now. The thinking mind treats the present like a waiting room. One evening, I was sitting with my wife during a difficult sundowning episode. She was agitated, trying to figure out how to get to her childhood home, her father coming to fetch her. I was simultaneously trying to mentally plan tomorrow's doctor appointment, rehearsing what I'd say, solving problems that hadn't happened yet. And I saw it: **We were doing the exact same thing.** Her mind couldn't accept this living room as "home" because it didn't match the felt sense of safety she was seeking. My mind couldn't accept this moment of sitting with her because it didn't match the felt sense of "productive" or "resolved" I was seeking. Both of us were generating solution-thoughts for a problem that only existed in the imagination. Both of us were trying to get "home" to a place that isn't located in time or space. **What this means for us as caregivers:** When your loved one asks to go home for the fifteenth time today, they're not just experiencing a symptom. They're demonstrating—unfiltered, visible, raw—the fundamental restlessness that lives in all of our minds. The inability to be fully present. The conviction that the answer lies just around the corner, in the next moment, after the next problem is solved. I've stopped seeing her repetition as a malfunction to be fixed. Instead, I recognize it as the human condition, made visible. She is, in a strange way, being profoundly honest about something we all disguise with busyness and distraction. This doesn't make the sundowning easier. It doesn't stop the grief. But it has transformed those looping conversations from frustrating obstacles into something else: **moments of shared humanity.** When she asks to go home, I no longer argue with the facts ("Your father died in 1964"). I meet her in the longing. I sit with her in the dislocation. Because I know that longing, I live in it too. We both want to go home. We're both already there, but can't feel it. If you're exhausted today by the repetition, the questions that have no answers, the planning for trips that will never happen—see if you can notice your own mind doing the same thing. Planning dinner while she's asking about her

mother. Rehearsing the conversation with the neurologist while she's describing a house from 1962. We're all trying to get somewhere else. The gift she has given me is this: I can no longer pretend my own restlessness is "productive" while hers is "pathological." We're both standing in the doorway of the present moment, holding a compass that points inward. Her compass is broken. Mine works fine—I just forget to look at it. Be gentle with yourselves today. And when they ask to go home, maybe try meeting them there, in that longing, without needing to fix it. You might find you're standing in the same room. \--- **TL;DR:** My wife's endless "going home" loops and my own busy, planning mind are the same phenomenon—both unable to rest in the present. Recognizing this hasn't cured her Alzheimer's, but it's made me a more patient caregiver and revealed something true about being human."

reddit post · r/dementia · 386 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1vpgoey/the_go_home_loop_what_my_wifes_sundowning_taught/

↳ **comment** (43): "This might work for some: When my dad would insist it was time to go home, my brother would eventually agree with him and offer to drive him home. Once in the car, he would drive him around for awhile and then eventually, take him back home! All forgotten and all good."

↳ **comment** (41): "Thank you for sharing. My mother's small burial stone simply says "home at last". It seemed the most fitting thing for her."

↳ **comment** (29): "I tell my grandma " I'm going to take You home tomorrow we are sleeping here tonight I'll be with you " and she always says " oh ok that's good " ... seriously stops the loops every time !!!! Or I'll say yes I'm going to bring ylu in the morning - it works 🤔🤔🤔 "

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of

everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all

they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugkx_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏 "

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"I'm coming to the conclusion that most of these videos that are supposed to have advice for caregivers to reduce stress don't really have much to say because there isn't really any way to reduce the stress of seeing our parents loose their independence, their functional abilities etc. It is what it is. This isn't a sprint, it's a marathon that ends with the person we love and care for being gone. It's exhausting and heating breaking . It is what it is. The only advice I can give is 1. Take advantage of the social services in your area to get the help your entitled to. 2. Get someone to be with your parent so you can have time away from them. Even if it's just a few minutes away you can catch your breath. 3. Eat well. The extreme mental and physical fatigue will entice us to eat all the things that will make a sick (SUGAR) 4. Get rest. Sleep. It necessary to maintain your sanity. 5. Talk to a counselor, support group, journal. Do whatever you need to do to get your feelings out. Family may not want to hear what you have to say. Talk to an objective ear. 6. Pray! I can't stress how important it is to ask the Creator for strength and endurance. 7. Find something to do that feeds your soul. Crafting, singing, reading etc. I've been at this for 16 years. My dad is in his 90's. I've had moments I felt like giving up. Its probably one of the hardest things we have to do in life. But I always make it back and continue to be there for my dad. I hope this helps."

youtube · @farisasmith7109 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 266 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=UgwplAltYhO-6FoHEM14AaABAq>

↳ **@wallmagic3400** (15): "Ya it helps surely, thanks for penning it so objectively, when you can't escape suffering a situation that's not of your making it helps to know that a big part of the world is sailing in the same creaky leaky boat 🤔 "

↳ **@barbaramitchell6910** (14): "@ElrinconcitodelaSraPerez I totally understand not wanting to put your parents into a nursing home. My mother is 84, my father passed last December and Mom is in deep depression."

She doesn't take her meds, she doesn't eat well, she's so lonely, lives in the same clothes all week and can barely get around her house, she's given up. I don't have any help at all, my husband tries but he doesn't know what to do. Most people would put their in this parents in a nursing home with her condition but I refuse. This is going to be a huge lifestyle change for her and us. She's scared and so am I. She lived in her house for 60 years. I just want to give her the best quality of life in this last chapter. I pray that I'm making the right decision. Sorry for such a long post."

↳ @sisridewita3252 (12): "Your story moved me deeply. I, too, am currently walking a similar path — one filled with love, sacrifice, and quiet strength. Though the journey is not easy, I believe it is one of profound meaning. Please know that my thoughts and prayers are with you, and with everyone who is facing such trials with compassion and courage. You are not alone, and your devotion is seen and honored."

"This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 206 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/oiyuxhp/

"I am done. She's not my problem anymore. I quit.. Update 3: I took several days to think and cool down. I had told my husband he didn't need to confront his mom because she won't change. She'll just pull the "my heart" card to get him to back off. He would never forgive himself if she did end up in the hospital over him chewing her out. He has talked to her before about her attitude to me a few years ago. So this is nothing new. The venom from her this time was new. I realized while thinking, the venom started after her stroke a year and a half ago. Strokes change people. I let my husband know I am not heartless. If she called with a problem I could fix, I would go over and fix it. But if she is wanting me to drive her to the hospital at 2 am because she doesn't want EMTs in her house, i won't do it. She can get one of his brothers up to take her if my husband can't. She knows I don't sleep well and am often up that late. She has almost called me before but then chose not too. She wouldn't feel as badly about calling at 2 am in an emergency since I'm most likely awake. But so far she has talked herself out of it. I told him I am not going over to just check on her and visit anymore. I do not want or need the extra drama in my life. I do not have to put up with being yelled at just because she's made at everyone else or the world in general. I'm sorry there is no great dramatic ending to my post. Yes, I wish my husband had gone over and laid into her verbally. It would have made me feel better. But it wouldn't have accomplished anything but cause issues for him. So I am choosing to not cause him that stress. \----- Update 2: Husband is mad at her because he just talked to her about this exact problem within the last 6 months. Last time I just took it and came home. He is processing about the way he wants to handle it. Tomorrow we've got stuff to do, so he's going to avoid her while he thinks. Honestly, I told him it won't do any good to talk to her. She won't take accountability. She's not going to tell him we had a fight. I asked him to let me know what what is going on when he talks to her. He promised he would. I also told him she has been nasty to me more than he hears. I just took it because I love him and want to help his stress level. He feels terrible because he knows how his mother can be. I said to him, to me the problem is solved. I'm done. She pushed so hard that she gets what she thinks she wants which is for me to go away. He understands. She played that game with him, too. Like he said he stopped going over for 2 weeks when she did that and things fell apart because the rest don't pay attention or think. I'm still done and I told him that. \---- Update 1: Husband got back to me and apologized for the way she treated me. He said he'll be arguing with her this tomorrow over this. I told him ok, but I won't change my mind about helping her or setting foot in her house. In a week or two she'll be asking him if I'm ok because she hasn't seen me in a while. I told him to tell her the truth. I'm done because of her. She refuses to take responsibility for her actions and words. SO that'll be a fun conversation for him. /s \---- My MIL is fighting any and all help. She resents not being able to do things and won't let people help

her. I have been going over once or twice a week just to ask if she needs anything. If she says no I back off. Her BS is affecting my mental health and she's not my mother. I was doing it to help my husband with his stress because his brothers don't help much. My therapist told me to back off and I have. I can't talk about her to my therapist anymore because she is a mandatory reporter and MIL is on the line for my therapist to have to report her. All week my SIL and BIL have been at my MILs house. The needed to get a window replaced and the guy wouldn't do it unless it was in a garage. They also gave a 6 hour window. So SIL and her daughter stayed from 12-6 twice. My SIL is a very in charge type of person. So she did what she wanted at MILs house despite my MIL asking her not to. MIL won't let her anger out on anyone but me. So she wasn't forceful with the SIL. She just sat back and let my SIL push her around. She had some distant cousins come in mid-week and they stayed all day too. Then her neighbor was moving some of his stuff out of his house at 9 pm. That was keeping her dogs up so she couldn't sleep. I went over today to see if MIL had a grocery list for my husband on his way home from work. She unloaded on me today. I got defensive and reminded her I ask before doing anything. She said I don't and everyone wants to control her life. She also accused me of getting defensive. I told her I was because I let her do her thing. She kept interrupting me and raised her voice at me. I finally told her that my therapist told me to back off. She told me good and I need to listen to her because she doesn't need anyone's help. I offered to tell my husband to let her get her own groceries. She said that's different because we know she can't drive. I got mad. And left. She told me that is my choice. I told her I am mad and she is mad and we don't need to be talking with when we're mad. I texted my husband at work and let him know what was going on. I was venting and called his mom some choice names. He told me I don't have to convince him because he knows how she is and he'll handle it tomorrow. He prefers to get told at work in text so he's not getting unloaded on when he gets home. I'm done. I won't set foot in her house ever again. If she calls I'll tell her to call 911 or one of her sons. If my husband is home, he's getting the phone. I'm my MILs only friend. She has now tore the bridge down and set it on fire."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 189 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_proble
m_anymore_i_quit/](https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_proble_m_anymore_i_quit/)

"As if we needed a PSA but, hey. I just saw a really disturbing //confession where a caregiver allowed their mother in this case to sit in soiled diapers with UTI-induced delirium and then assaulted their mother causing them to move into hospice when they wouldn't go to the bathroom when OP wanted their mother to resulting in the mom going into hospice. The comments are all over the place excusing this person's behavior because of burnout and how hard it is to be a caregiver. It's really disturbing the more comments OP makes about how egotistical they come off with the whole thing. If you're here, we know it can suck, caregiving can bring the darkest of the dark out on us. Is you're found in a power struggle especially with someone not making sense—walk away for five or ten minutes. Remember that dementia and delirium is not personal—no matter how much your caregivee sucked as an adult. And if you can't walk away and come back calmly, other arrangements NEED to be made. A difficult job does not excuse abuse just in the case of the ramp up to SBS. Also, especially if you're caring for a woman, diabetic, someone who is elderly and as a non-medical professional—familiarize yourself with the weird symptoms that can happen with UTIs. Idk, things feel especially heavy after a man detained by ICE's son died when he was the primary caregiver and there's so many good caregivers out there trying their best who never do something as awful as that post even at a breaking point."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 173 upvotes · [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1qr8zxz/as_if_we_needed_a_psa_
but_hey/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1qr8zxz/as_if_we_needed_a_psa_but_hey/)

"both of my parents are on hospice. i'm at the hospital, bedside with my mother. my father is at home with in-home agency caregivers. my mother's been on hospice since saturday. my father's been on hospice since last may. for so long i wished they would die so i might be free. and, i know how awful that sounds. but... what i really meant was... i needed a break. i needed help. i needed the responsibility of two at once to stop pulverizing me. i have been mentally depleted, physically exhausted, emotinoally damaged, socially isolated, financially strained, and personally miserable for years-upon-years. when i said that i hated them, when i said that i wished they'd die,

what i meant was that i couldn't... could... not... keep carrying the whole load by myself. i do love my mom and dad. i know my mom and dad love me in their own ways. i started my caregiving journey in 2014. it was a slow burn, running errands, checking in on them, offering assistance, knowing they'd refuse most of it. by 2021, i was a daily caregiver. first for about five hours per day, then nine, then some days 24-hours without breaks. my father has atypical parkinsonism/parkinson's. he refused extensive testing, so we call it parkinson's, but the neuro's notes read "atypical." he's had hallucinations for more than a decade. and, while a neuro diagnosed my dad with parkinson's dementia, a hospital visit indicated suspicion for lewy body dementia, with recommendation for further testing. but, by the time we started running on the hospital "hamster wheel," the amount of chaos my parents created around care made it impossible to take my dad for testing. doctor's appointments seemed like a luxury by the time i was on full-time with them. after three hospitalizations for pneumonia in under six months, my father was sent home from the hospital on hospice last may. my mother has cardiovascular disease, pulmonary disease, thyroid disease, arthritis, osteoporosis, raynaud's, MGUS... etc., etc., etc., and more. she also has either mild cognitive impairment or dementia. she was never tested except while an in-patient, and only ever when she had a UTI. so, i'm inclined to believe she had mild cognitive impairment, likely age-appropriate and age-related. additionally, my mom's always had trouble with UTIs and kidney stones. this round, i thought she had just a UTI, but she was admitted with a kidney stone obstructing infected urine, and i declined surgery. both of my parents are 90 years old. their personal "rules" for healthcare, established well before i came on full-time were: DNR/AND no intubation, no feeding tubes, no ostomy bag or catheterizations, no thickened liquids, no modified food diets, no surgeries, no anesthesia, no stents (heart or urinary) to move the stone from my mother's ureter meant intubation, anesthesia, and surgery. it would have also meant followup procedures, including additional surgeries. honestly... who does surgery on a 90-year-old woman in fragile condition?? or when her wishes were so clear?? so, i refused. i opted instead for a little extra time with her by way of antibiotics, until her kidneys failed. this happened over three days. and, on the afternoon of the third day, i opted to transition her to comfort care. yesterday, i opted to transition her to full hospice. the hospital... i can't even fully believe or explain it. the hospital understands that my father is at home, also on hospice, that his decline has been violent. they're allowing my mom to stay in-house. they offered me the option of giving her "familiarity or peace," meaning "familiarity" of home or "peace" of an institutional death where i press a button and nurses and aides come to help me. i have never ever experienced such kindness or support in all my years of caregiving, not like this. then... there's the stark reality that both of my parents are on hospice at the same time, and... i don't know what i'm doing. i did tell my father that my mother was dying, and he's since decided to stop eating, drinking, and taking meds. his vitals are falling. his hospice nurse believes he's given up, and that he's decided to "go" with my mom. i do believe this... because he's always only lived for her. i came here to post... because i've been in this group, both as a commenter and as a lurker, for so long. i lurked for years before making my account, and then... more than a year commenting. this group is my primary social exposure since i started caregiving; people i knew grew bored of me and my situation, perhaps. but i always knew i could come here and read about someone else's life mirroring mine, or someone else's feelings sitting similarly to mine. i don't remember seeing many posts about having two on hospice at once. but, i came here just the same. maybe to share? maybe for some kind support? maybe just to "be"? and, maybe... to be somewhere with people who understand. anyway, thanks for listening. i'm scared. i'm truly scared. i'm trying not to fail either one of them, but... i'm tired and it seems there's road still ahead... and... again... i truly am scared."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 170 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tkrjqf/both_of_my_parents_are_on_hospice/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her

hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"I am the last kid of the family. The responsibility of caring for my parents fell on me for the last 12 years. Dealing with all the gaslighting, guilt tripping, diapers changing, cleaning feces and urine etc. I have lost all friends, joy of living and faith crisis. The only motivation is when all this over, I look forward to cut ties with the rest of my narcissistic church going siblings. To them doing Godly works is more important. Caring for parents is unproductive to them. Thank you for letting air my frustration to someone who understand it all."

youtube · @SCCDaniel · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 160 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyY0fzoGeQa4xKxpc94AaABAg

↳ **@karendegraaf3572** (12): "Jesus even condemned EXPLICITLY the religious leaders of his day who were placing their religious rituals over the care and honor of their own parents, which was actually one of the original 10 commandments. So, children refusing to care for or love or respect their parents, however they can, is not Christian. May God bless you for doing the hard things at your own expense and sacrifice. I'm sorry it has turned out this way. In keeping with this original youtube, it's true that it's not a Hallmark movie. 🙄🙄"

↳ **@rynneivarsson751** (9): "You cut those ties and wave one finger at them defiantly in your rear view mirror, sister. There's life out here, lots of it. Get you a little dog, hamster or a cat, a camp trailer, learn to paint, whatever. This time, YOU get to choose, you get to choose everything. This can be overwhelming at first, but hell yeah, I'm into it now."

↳ **@rynneivarsson751** (9): "@karendegraaf3572 I think we wade into some uneven ground when we try to apply a biblical commandment to guiltling ourselves into staying in abusive and unhealthy situations."

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play stardew valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many potholes and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"My mom mocks me for being overwhelmed about getting rid of her stuff after she dies. i'm (44) very triggered when going to my parents' house. My mother (83) and father (88) still live in my childhood home. My dad is in the advanced stages of Parkinson's and has a lot of trouble with mobility after a recent hip surgery. Anyway, he is mostly confined to one room (a large room, but still), where has the tv, recliner, and his hospital bed. Even though the house is between 2600-2800 square feet, they have three functional rooms. The rest is filled with 45 years of accumulated crap. On my dad's end, he just never lifted one finger in terms of non-cooking or child-care related chores, which includes periodically getting rid of things. I don't know that he has a particular emotional attachment to them. My mom, on the other hand, if not quite a hoarding condition, has something that comes

close. She's not unsanitary, mostly doesn't keep literal trash (like used napkins and wrappers), and doesn't have a shopping addiction. But she still has an unhealthy attachment to things that were once valuable but have lost their value (like old desktop computers from the 2000s & encyclopedias and couches from the 80s). Anyway, we've been fighting about it a lot lately, because I find it so aggravating that they can't make full use of their home because so much of it is just storage space. The house wasn't that way growing up. It's not that they used to get rid of things. They never did. It just took a long time for it to get as bad as it is. But instead of making use of the sitters who are there, my mom is hobbling around on her swollen foot and bad knee doing everything for my dad herself rather than dealing with her hoard. (Not that she can move heavy things, but she can put old clothes in a box or shred old tax returns). In our last fight, I brought up the hoarding. And then, like it was another insult, she said "Your worst fear is that when I die, you're going to be left with this stuff." It was like she thought that was something shameful for me to be worried about or overwhelmed by. I don't really have a question. I guess I'm just venting and wondering if anyone else has been through anything similar. It's so infuriating and bizarre."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 150 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vfe2f3/my_mom_mockes_me_for_being_overwhelmed_about/

"In a lot of cases though it's not that they refuse help, they just expect YOU to be that help at all costs. My dad is utterly alone and for the most part has himself to blame for it. It didn't seem to be a problem while he was healthy (which he kept a strict regiment to be), Working (successful construction company he built from the ground up), and independent(Beautiful two-story lakefront home). But six years ago when he was in his mid-70s he was plagued with an overwhelming amount of health problems. Caught a bad flu, which turned to pneumonia, shortly after diagnosed with an auto immune disease, and to top all that off was diagnosed with stage 4 melanoma. It was a lot to take, for both of us. To see the once invincible man I knew my whole life be reduced to a shuffling skeleton was a hard pill to swallow. I knew if he lost his independence he was finished so I've done everything in my power since then to give him the space to make his own decisions and treat him like an adult. Which isn't easy to do when the person you're trying to help lives in the middle of nowhere, down a 3 mile dirt road, 25 minutes from the nearest town, and an hour at least from most dr appointments. And just like before his stubbornness, temper, and selfishness has become absolutely unbearable. The same traits that drove my brother (only sibling) to the other side of the country with minimal contact, contributed in part to my mothers raging alcoholism and later suicide, and has driven off almost every other friend and family member. When I say I'm doing it alone I mean it. Drive him to his specialists. Put all his bills on auto pay and keep an eye on his accounts. Maintenance the house and yard. Move the boat dock when the lake levels rise and fall. Cook for him when I can because if not it will be a crap TV dinner. Cover for him with the doctors on the multiple times he's been admitted to the hospital by saying that I'll be with him 24/7 when I know I can't. Have changed diapers, bandaged wounds, administered oxygen, and wiped his drooling lip more times than I can count. His living situation is not safe. He still tries to drive and it's not safe. Almost everything he attempts to do is not safe. I am in a constant state of worry and stress when I'm not with him, and when I am with him I'm in a constant state of frustration and angst. He's my dad and I love him but when is enough enough? He's currently in the hospital with pneumonia again, aspirating food which could be a feeding tube situation, is definitely going to need oxygen, and also had an acute heart attack which means surgery is in the future. He was barely capable of working his flip phone properly and now this. The doctors, as they always do, are inching him back to a stable state and are talking about releasing him next week. He is already talking about " when I get out and get back to the house we're gonna need to..." and I'm about ready to scream. His location makes any kind of home health assistance a brief glimpse or nonexistent. Getting him into a rehab after hospital visits it's like pulling teeth with insurance. And my family " I'm so sorry you have to deal with this" is about as good as it gets. I have a wife and three kids. A full-time job and a house payment. Coach youth soccer and volunteer hours at the school. A multitude of responsibilities and people depending on me that I have put on the back burner a lot of times and put my life on hold so he can have just a little bit more of his.....his way. That's what brought me here and I hope I can manifest some of this information into something positive. My mom's alcoholism I witnessed as a child made me vow as an adult that my kids would never see me drunk, and they

haven't. This situation as an adult has made me vow when/if I become a senior citizen I will never put any of my kids through this. And besides my wonderful and understanding wife the only place I have to talk about it is the emptiness of an online comment section. Ain't that something."

youtube · @amac8237 · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 148 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwrX9JsAlAo&lc=UgyMOKJbUOBupQy1MqR4AaABAg>

↳ @sparkysmom7149 (27): "You have no choice. You have to hold it together for your own sanity. Contact the department of health and aging in your county/state. They will help you. I'm going to have to do this for my Dad too. It's been so stressful, so mentally exhausting, and I'm at the point where the whole situation is effecting my own health. Neither you nor myself can let ourselves decline just to give our dad's "their way". Its wrong. God bless you."

↳ @DWXY (25): "Yes, interesting how much help they'll accept from one of their children but not from a professional, in which case they claim it's not needed."

↳ @mixedredneck3967 (21): "@ShauntelleHamlett And it's a blanket of stress . Like you're being torn by horses but instead of being torn it puts just enough pressure to make you scream. Sounds rough as a metaphor, but some days that's how it is"

"I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 136 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/o4u8eo2/

"Both of my parents are in a life threatening crisis, and they shift the blame on me because I try to help. I live a few states away from my family. My mother (65) had a botched surgery last year and has been in a physical and mental health spiral ever since. She has several comorbidities and one of the top ones is extreme insomnia, like 3 hours of sleep a night on average. This has caused her to lose grasp with reality due to psychosis. She refuses to take any medication, doesn't trust doctors. Doesn't have proper nutrition or hydration. Every time I call she is in absolute hysterics without fail, like full on crying fits and panics. My father is her primary caregiver and he is facing full caregiver collapse. He is now an insomniac too, cries all the time, and I think he is hiding self harm from me. Here's what really bothers me: he reinforces her psychosis. Tells her that she doesn't have to take the medicine if she doesn't want to. Says he doesn't trust her doctors. He is very mentally ill himself and is unfitting as a caregiver. They both have delusions that people are coming to "take them away to the loony bin" or arrest them if they seek help. I have made a million phone calls to physicians, department of aging, other family members.

What ultimately happens is that when my parents are confronted with harsh truths (like "hey you need to escalate care") they refuse, downplay, or just explode in anger. Well I had one of those anger explosions over the phone recently. Suddenly everything was my fault because I was "making too many phone calls". I told them that if my mother does not take her medication I will have to call her doctor again. They both lost it on me. Told me this is my fault because I'm not there with them. Told me both "leave us alone" and "you're too far away", so basically any situation I'm at fault. Full disclosure, my father was very physically and emotionally abusive to me growing and this brought me right back to the feeling of being a little scared boy. At this point I have absolved of the situation. I don't think I will hear my mother's voice again by Christmas and I'm afraid what my dad might will do once she passes. But I can't insert myself in this chaos anymore. No more agencies, no more phone calls. Shit sucks man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 132 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ts88af/both_of_my_parents_are_in_a_life_threatening/

Not to be a burden to my kids / to go on my own terms · 386 documents

20 most engaged of 386 matching documents, complete text.

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞 "

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZOZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ **@cathydyer3774** (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really

nice”) - and we’re just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both “really nice” and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I’m driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom’s rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I’ve never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother’s wrecked, we’re all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I’m bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened (“oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing”)... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something’s wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom’s memorial is gonna be because I can’t plan that yet because I’m trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he’s not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there’s two weeks where *every single day* he’s weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It’s okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I’m ready to go. It’s okay. He says, I don’t want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I’m trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we’re all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it’s that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that’s okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he’s sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We’re talking about football and birds. He’s looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says “What a coincidence!” and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily “Because I love you too,” , he’s beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say “See you soon!” and I wave and I leave, and I’m certain I’ll see him next week and we’ll talk about the Super Bowl and I’ll tell him about the birds I’ve seen, I’ll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he’s gone. It’s over”

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"It's time for the talk. My wife and I are both only children. Between us we've buried three parents. One is left — my father-in-law. Everything below is my experience; yours will differ. But I'd rather say the hard parts out loud than let someone else get blindsided the way we were. Confront reality — and make sure they confront it too. That's the whole thing. Both of us were badly surprised by things we had been told were handled and weren't. My mother-in-law went in for surgery and had a massive stroke on the table. A month in ICU in a coma, then a specialized rehab, then a nursing home — almost a year. She surfaced briefly near the end before a second stroke took her. My father-in-law had a will, an advance directive, and a power of attorney. We assumed she did too. She didn't. She couldn't tolerate what she called death talk, and he was certain he'd go first. I got him in front of an elder care attorney in the middle of the crisis. It was the right call, and it was a year too late. Had she lived longer, the cost would have consumed their savings and everything they meant to leave their grandchildren. After my dad

died suddenly, my mom and I sat down with her affairs. The legal side was easy — wills, POAs, no argument. Two things weren't easy. One I'll come back to. The other was that after multiple conversations about her income and expenses, I found out she was hiding more than \$30,000 in debt from me. We can't fix problems we won't look at. The upfront conversations are unpleasant. Assume they will be. They are still cheaper than picking up the pieces on the back end. So don't take anyone's word for it: \- If they say there's a will, ask to see it. Then ask where it's kept. \- Same for the advance directive and the powers of attorney — financial and healthcare are not the same document. \- Ask to see the bank and credit statements. Not a summary. The statements. \- Get in front of an elder care attorney if you can possibly manage it. Medicaid look-back rules and asset protection are not things to learn during an ICU stay. That's table stakes. And even parents who've done every bit of it aren't out of the woods, because the paperwork is the easy conversation. The hard one is about legacy. This is the one I avoided with my mom, because it was the one that nearly broke her. Not the money. The *possessions*. She collected beautiful things her whole life. Most of it is headed for an estate sale. She made herself sick over it — trauma levels, on the edge of an identity crisis. There was china I never once saw used. Not one Christmas in my entire life. If we'd eaten off it every year I might feel differently. But I don't understand why I'm obligated to carry an attachment that was never mine. She had an old Mercedes. When it was time for independent living, we talked about what to do with it. She wanted to know if her granddaughter could use it. I told her the truth: no. Expensive to maintain, no dealer or independent mechanic anywhere near them, and they hike and camp and have a dog. They needed something that fit their life. Her position was that they should take it anyway — accept the burden, because it was a gift. I'm still working through that one. To me it's like buying piano lessons for someone whose hobby is baking bread. Here's what I think is actually going on. The things aren't the issue. The things are proxies. They're where the feelings get stored, because the feelings themselves never got dealt with. *If you don't keep this thing I owned, you're rejecting me and my memory*. That's why so many of our parents can't sort through it, and why it gets left behind for us. Dealing with the stuff means dealing with everything underneath the stuff. If I could run one conversation over, it's that one. I'd stop negotiating over objects and say: if you love them, let's turn this into something that actually helps them. Sell the car, put it toward the truck they need. Sell the china, fund something they'll remember. They will remember and appreciate that you helped them. **The love transfers**. The dining set doesn't. Have the conversation while it's still a conversation and not an inventory."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 488 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vf1z4k/its_time_for_the_talk/

"Never Say Never. I know I'm preaching to the choir here but never tell your family that you're never going to a nursing home. It's just so many levels of a crappy thing to do to them. Particularly if you haven't done the advanced financial and legal planning to provide for yourself. First of all: Your precipitating event for a nursing home is going to preclude your ability to object to a nursing home for starters. If you have a massive stroke, dementia, Alzheimer's, or a fall that you don't recover well from, you're going to be in no position to object. If you haven't prepared for that moment legally and financially then you are just dumping a huge burden on your family. Is that what you really want to do to them? Did you really raise your kids so they can spend 5-10 years wiping your arse after your stroke? Is this the future you want for them? Do you want them to care for you at such a high level after your food and lifestyle choices incapacitate you? Just no. I am informing my kids that if I am not willing / unable to bathe myself or toilet myself and there is no hope of recovery, then put me in a nursing home already. They do not need to feel guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 447 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ud5jqh/never_say_never/

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations:

You're so strong Translation: You're on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are they're really saying they're not going to help you. They're admiring your ability to handle it so they don't have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow you're so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesn't matter because I've decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. We're just surviving it because there's no other option. I don't need your theology. I need respite care. I don't know how you do it Translation: I'm glad it's you and not me so I'm not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. They'd watch me help my mom with everything then say I don't know how you do it and leave. If you don't know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Don't stand there marveling at my survival skills like I'm some interesting specimen. I'm doing this because I don't have a choice and you won't help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: I'm going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you won't ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers don't let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person we're caring for so we can sleep. Don't make us ask. I've got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. There's more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If you're a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity... you don't need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say I'm coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. That's the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): ""enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their

hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

"My mom finally died. Hi everyone, I want to thank everyone in this sub over the years for providing support for me, no one knows how hard this is like you all. Mom spent the last 1.5 weeks in the hospital with sepsis, was discharged, and after a few days of slowly healing (but not really) complained of not being able to breathe yesterday morning. Paramedics were called to her nursing home and since no one could find her DNR papers they...did CPR on her for 20 minutes. She was 90lbs, 80 years old, and suffering from COPD, liver disease, heart disease, alcoholism, etc. I brought up hospice after this last hospital stint but she didn't want to talk about it yet. I was on my way but didn't get there in time. It's been 10 years of near misses and health crises, her not wanting to do anything for herself but drink and smoke. She was bed bound and incontinent for the past few years and evaded death numerous times. She was on hospice for six months two years ago and then was taken off because she showed no signs of leaving. She was a medical marvel and I really thought she'd pull through again. I'm tired and distraught that they performed CPR on her small frail body, but she was already gone. There's so much relief but also so much sadness. She was a broken old lady and I did my best. Here's a reminder to tell your mom you love her, and also make sure her DNR papers are readily accessible to avoid what my mom went through at the end. Good luck everyone, they really don't make it easy on us."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 393 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tncv7m/my_mom_finally_died/

↳ **comment** (62): "Sending hugs and love. I'm terribly sorry for your loss. Take care of yourself."

↳ **comment** (50): ""She was a broken old lady and I did my best." You get to carry this with pride for the rest of your life. It certainly wasn't easy. My condolences."

↳ **comment** (10): "I'm so sorry for your loss. May you find your peace with all the complex emotions this transition has brought. Your love and care for your mom comes through in your post and, ultimately, I believe the measure of a love is like that of the steady beats of a song, not the that of the occasional bridge."

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her, but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had." This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years,*

along with myself & my cousin Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family *Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin* My cousin also asked her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant we would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set of what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rtrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care, and your adult child wrote you and the whole family this letter regarding that situation?. Dear family, I've been doing a lot of reflecting lately on the situation with Grandma and Grandpa, and I feel a need to share some thoughts that have been weighing on me. I know we are all doing our best to navigate this, but I want to offer a different perspective—one that might be uncomfortable, but feels necessary to voice. I can't help but feel that what we are witnessing is, in many ways, fundamentally unnatural. Decades ago, you rarely heard of couples requiring 24/7 professional assistance simultaneously; there was a natural rhythm to life and passing that seems to have been disrupted. It feels as though modern medicine has become so focused on the mechanics of keeping the body running that it has moved far away from human nature itself. By pushing past what might have once been our natural "expiration dates," we've entered a territory where the cost of longevity is a loss of the very independence that defined them. Perhaps

the most jarring part of this experience for me is seeing the in-home care staff every day. While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge; instead of a family visit, it feels like a supervised appointment in their own home. Because of this, I want to be very clear about my own wishes for the future: Once I reach the age of 75, I do not want any extraordinary measures taken to prolong my life. Whether it is surgery, intensive treatment, or any form of medical intervention, I want to let nature take its course. Furthermore, if I ever reach a point where I can no longer safely live independently, please do not try to recreate a hospital within my home. I am asking you now to please just put me in a professional facility. I would rather my home remain a memory of who I was, rather than a place defined by its clinical needs. I know this is hard to hear, and I don't say it to diminish the love we all have for them. I just feel we need to acknowledge the reality of the era we are living in and how much it has changed the way we experience the end of life. With love and honesty, Jack"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 349 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

↳ **comment** (259): "A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

↳ **comment** (147): "I was Jack almost a decade ago. The PTSD I have associated with helping my mom care for my grandparents will never leave me. It *ruined* my memories of my grandparents who i loved so much and spent much of my childhood with. It sucks to be the elderly person or the caregiver, but being a support person for the caregiver sucks too. We are watching an elderly loved one basically be tortured into living, another loved one get burnt out to a crispy husk of a person, and we just have to sit there like 'This is fine.....' It's really sad, frustrating, depressing to watch, and makes you look around and scream 'am I taking crazy pills?!'"

↳ **comment** (140): "I studied gerontology and death & dying. Because of that, I made an Exit Plan 20 years ago. I saw what was going to happen with the massive, aging, Boomer population & there's nothing good about it. I've completed all my EOL documents (Will, Living Will/Healthcare POA, financial/durable POA), each kid has copies. Pre-planned & pre-paid for my cremation. I'm very open with my kids about EOL stuff and how I don't want to burden them with my care. Of course, they say "we don't mind," but I've seen 1st hand how caregiving tears apart families and breaks caregivers. I don't want to do that to my kids."

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of

these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much

more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏 "

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"I don't know about the ping-ponging but hospice is end of life care. It's normally for those who have a life expectancy of 6 months or less. It's meant to keep you as comfortable as possible, not to prolong life. If your mom had a DNR and stops breathing (as an example), she is allowed to pass naturally. Without a DNR an ambulance would be called and chest compressions would be started. If you've ever taken a CPR course you may recall how forcefully you have to compress to be effective. That's where the injuries and pain come in."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 260 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8oilg8/

"I've told my kids to put me in a home if and when I'm unable to look after myself. I would never put them through the stress I'm currently going through. I didn't bring them into this world for them to put their lives on hold when I'm old. I brought them into the world to fulfil their dreams and I'm never going to stand in the way of them."

youtube · @michellesaupe7346 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 258 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiEw&lc=UgxKMXhAhCoWXobEvxJ4AaABAg>

↳ @wordswordswords8203 (60): "Wow. I wish my mom was like that. She is taking my whole life away from me and making me feel guilty for even bringing up putting her in assisted living."

↳ @iuliqt (33): "You are a lovely mother, that truly loves their children. God bless you!"

↳ @willieoutlaw4957 (23): "You are one heck of a mother! I told my kids the same thing, I want to be a blessing for them not a burden."

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away

to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"both of my parents are on hospice. i'm at the hospital, bedside with my mother. my father is at home with in-home agency caregivers. my mother's been on hospice since saturday. my father's been on hospice since last may. for so long i wished they would die so i might be free. and, i know how awful that sounds. but... what i really meant was... i needed a break. i needed help. i needed the responsibility of two at once to stop pulverizing me. i have been mentally depleted, physically exhausted, emotionally damaged, socially isolated, financially strained, and personally miserable for years-upon-years. when i said that i hated them, when i said that i wished they'd die, what i meant was that i couldn't... could... not... keep carrying the whole load by myself. i do love my mom and dad. i know my mom and dad love me in their own ways. i started my caregiving journey in 2014. it was a slow burn, running errands, checking in on them, offering assistance, knowing they'd refuse most of it. by 2021, i was a daily caregiver. first for about five hours per day, then nine, then some days 24-hours without breaks. my father has atypical parkinsonism/parkinson's. he refused extensive testing, so we call it parkinson's, but the neuro's notes read "atypical." he's had hallucinations for more than a decade. and, while a neuro diagnosed my dad with parkinson's dementia, a hospital visit indicated suspicion for lewy body dementia, with recommendation for further testing. but, by the time we started running on the hospital "hamster wheel," the amount of chaos my parents created around care made it impossible to take my dad for testing. doctor's appointments seemed like a luxury by the time i was on full-time with them. after three hospitalizations for pneumonia in under six months, my father was sent home from the hospital on hospice last may. my mother has cardiovascular disease, pulmonary disease, thyroid disease, arthritis, osteoporosis, raynaud's, MGUS... etc., etc., etc., and more. she also has either mild cognitive impairment or dementia. she was never tested except while an in-patient, and only ever when she had a UTI. so, i'm inclined to believe she had mild cognitive impairment, likely age-appropriate and age-related. additionally, my mom's always had trouble with UTIs and kidney stones. this round, i thought she had just a UTI, but she was admitted with a kidney stone obstructing infected urine, and i declined surgery. both of my parents are 90 years old. their personal "rules" for healthcare, established well before i came on full-time were: DNR/AND no intubation, no feeding tubes, no ostomy bag or catheterizations, no thickened liquids, no modified food diets, no surgeries, no anesthesia, no stents (heart or urinary) to move the stone from my mother's ureter meant intubation, anesthesia, and surgery. it would have also meant followup procedures, including additional surgeries. honestly... who does surgery on a 90-year-old woman in fragile condition?? or when her wishes were so clear?? so, i refused. i opted instead for a little extra time with her by way of antibiotics, until her kidneys failed. this happened over three days. and, on the afternoon of the third day, i opted to transition her to comfort care.

yesterday, i opted to transition her to full hospice. the hospital... i can't even fully believe or explain it. the hospital understands that my father is at home, also on hospice, that his decline has been violent. they're allowing my mom to stay in-house. they offered me the option of giving her "familiarity or peace," meaning "familiarity" of home or "peace" of an institutional death where i press a button and nurses and aides come to help me. i have never ever experienced such kindness or support in all my years of caregiving, not like this. then... there's the stark reality that both of my parents are on hospice at the same time, and... i don't know what i'm doing. i did tell my father that my mother was dying, and he's since decided to stop eating, drinking, and taking meds. his vitals are falling. his hospice nurse believes he's given up, and that he's decided to "go" with my mom. i do believe this... because he's always only lived for her. i came here to post... because i've been in this group, both as a commenter and as a lurker, for so long. i lurked for years before making my account, and then... more than a year commenting. this group is my primary social exposure since i started caregiving; people i knew grew bored of me and my situation, perhaps. but i always knew i could come here and read about someone else's life mirroring mine, or someone else's feelings sitting similarly to mine. i don't remember seeing many posts about having two on hospice at once. but, i came here just the same. maybe to share? maybe for some kind support? maybe just to "be"? and, maybe... to be somewhere with people who understand. anyway, thanks for listening. i'm scared. i'm truly scared. i'm trying not to fail either one of them, but... i'm tired and it seems there's road still ahead... and... again... i truly am scared."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 170 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tkrjqf/both_of_my_parents_are_on_hospice/

"I spent from 2010 to 2023 working a terribly challenging job while dealing with major care issues for my mom (brain aneurysm, heart disease, diabetes, major mobility trouble), for my dad (major heart disease broken hip), and my stepmother (dementia). They have all passed and I've spent the last 2 years trying to recover my own health. I have no answers, but I know when that burden falls on you in your 50s and 60s, especially if you also must work full time, it is exhausting, financially challenging, robs much of your joy, and can make you quite ill. I miss my folks, but I do NOT miss the exhaustion of those years."

youtube · @Calliope8.8-k6z · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 168 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgzD1bXbgo9vHqSbBep4AaABAq>

↳ **@allyssacook5350** (4): "Your comment saddens me because I don't want to be a burden on my son. However, I would like to be there for him...for as long as possible."

↳ **@joshie8045** (3): "@allyssacook5350 As a son who loves his parents so deeply. I'd rather my parents be my "burden" than to not have them at all. I hope your son can share this sentiment with me. As long as you have been a rock for him, like my parents have for me. Im sure he thinks you are a superstar. We all have to be better at living in the moment."

↳ **@lexie-d7190** (2): "People ask me what I do for fun....what is that? Oh and don't get me started on the dating pool!"

"Also, OP is using the term DNR but there are forms like the Physicians Orders for Life Sustaining Treatment that are more nuanced. CPR is in the most aggressive category; antibiotics in a middle category, and then the low category is no treatment at all. I learned after my mom was hospitalized with pneumonia and given antibiotics for it that pneumonia is considered the "old person's friend" because it leads to a fairly painless death without treatment. With treatment, she lived another very miserable two weeks. During those two weeks the hospital pushed her to sign the POLST form and I'm glad she did because it made things simpler when she did pass."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 165 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mq5zwq/why_is_hospice_pushing_me_really_really_hard/n8ow1rx/

"My mom also refuses to give my brother and I the POA or advanced directive, won't do anything for herself, and leaves the burden on us, with no consideration how it affects our lives."

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

"I am a caregiver, and I charge £900 a week to look after elderly people who insist on staying at home. I will NEVER insist my children look after me when I become incapable of wiping my own bum. I am busy giving them all the money I can to help them now, when they need it, because I don't want care bills or taxes to strip all the value of what I leave behind. Besides, by the time I die, they will be financially sound if I help them now. And yes, I am telling them NOW that I am happy to go into a home when I can't look after myself. I am also getting rid of all the things they will never want and that clutter up my home. The 'good' china is being used every day. There is no need for more than one of most things. Except books. If I'm buried with my books, there won't be room for earth. But everything else can go. I don't need to burden my kids with getting rid of 'stuff'. I am currently looking after a lady who has 4 bedrooms full of 'things' she won't part with. Thankfully, that's not something I will have to deal with."

youtube · @silviavousden3316 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 160 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyVm70Sa2j31LOYCml4AaABAq

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (17): "Thank you so much for sharing. I am sure this will help some folks or at least get them talking and thinking. You have seen it all first-hand. I love your realistic approach. All the best ❤️"

↳ **@Introvertcoffeequeen** (12): "God bless you for thinking of your children. I sincerely mean that. My parents have a very large house cluttered with lots of things they refuse to part with. I dread the day I will have to tackle that mess...alone. 😞"

↳ **@lindyrobertson8062** (8): "We had my Mum living with us for the last 7 years of her life (81-88). Thankfully it was a blessing. Our 2 sons (10 and 14 when she came) as well as my husband just loved having her with us. So did I. Only a few times right towards the end she sometimes became a bit confused. Each time when I explained to her what she'd become muddled about "Yes Mum I did bring you supper 😊", "Yes it is night time and no longer day. Maybe you closed your curtains earlier than usual?" - she would realise her mind wasn't functioning clearly, burst out laughing and say "Oh Darling, am I going bats?!" to which I always replied "Yes! I'm afraid so!". The funniest was once she rang her bell imperiously at about 3am. I got the fright of my life. I ran down the passage, out of the back door, down the 3 steps (VERY nearly tripping and falling on my face)..to her flat. I flung open her door. I had imagined that she must've had a fall and broken her hip, and somehow reached the buzzer to the main house. Yet there she was, sitting straight up in bed, with her hands neatly in her lap. "I want biscuits!" she declared. I went through to her little kitchen, made her a pot of tea and brought her 3 biscuits. She took a bite of the first one, a sip of her tea, then looked over the rim of her teacup with her big dark brown eyes. I was sitting on her bed. Suddenly she said "Oh my darling, am I being ridiculous? Did I wake you? I am SO sorry!". We both laughed and laughed. She had become increasingly sweet-natured as she grew older. Not that she'd ever been mean. I had just not been close to her at ALL while growing up. So I was actually grateful for those last years. We did have to get a carer in to help me to care for her 3x a week in the morning. I would not have managed to care for her if she was incontinent. When my one brother had a dreadful aggressive cancer, after 4 mths we could not help him to the bathroom any more: he was 6'4", and he became extremely weak. He had to go into hospital. The last two months he spent in a wonderful old age home. I fully agree and understand what you are all saying here. My husband and I both turn 66 this year. We have spent the last year gradually re-painting the same house to sell it, sorting through our possessions, giving things away, throwing others out, and I've sold a few things and been surprised at how much I earned for them. I gave my precious guitar away 2 weeks ago to our painter - and he lit up like a beacon! He plays beautifully, and it was definitely the right thing to do. We also both have many many books. We're only shedding a few of those at this point! My husband has photographed and "digitised" ALL our photos, and our children's art, and his diaries (mine are private! 😊). He

has shredded over 50 bags of papers, drawings etc. We have kept the VERY precious ones. SO one day when we die, our sons will not have to spend months and months wading through everything, as my husband has been doing over years. He doesn't resent it, but is motivated to avert our sons being landed in a similar stew. After we've moved to a smaller flat, if one of requires care, we have found a carehome that is not exorbitant and where the staff are apparently skilled and patient. Sounds perfect to me. I just pray that until the day we die both of recognise our children and are able to express our love and say a proper goodbye ❤️❤️ Three of us adults cd n not"

A nurse for 12 hours straight, hours that fit, no minimum · 250 documents

20 most engaged of 250 matching documents, complete text.

"How to deal with an aging parent's unrealistic demands. I am 61 (F) and my mother is 86 going on 87. Two years ago, after my father passed away, I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. She has a long list of medical issues and is reluctant to go into care. For the first year I was working from home and balancing her care and the house and my job. Early in 2025 I retired (I took an early retirement offer from my employer) and pretty much immediately my mother's care became more complex. She's had a year of medical issues that I can't even begin to list as it's too long. But in the midst of all of that she saw my retirement as her opportunity to ask me to do all kinds of work around the house. Ok, I agreed to things within my capability like painting a room or doing some gardening work and minor repairs. But she's been bothering me to do more difficult things that (a) I don't have the knowledge to do and (b) are physically too demanding. She's been asking me to lift a bunch of patio slabs that are kind of shifting, refill and level the screening underneath and straighten them up. She mentions this CONSTANTLY. Even in the winter as something she wants done in the spring. We got a quote from someone and it would be close to \$1000 if not more based on the area she wants done. And she says she can't afford it. So I just keep saying no, I'm not doing it. And she keeps insisting "your father would do this; if I were younger and stronger like you I would do this, I used to do these things all the time." Finally, yesterday I had enough when she asked me about it again. I did not lose my temper. When she said "when I was your age I would have done this" I calmly reminded her that at my age she was on track to having her first open heart surgery so no she would not be doing this. Then she said "well your father would..." etc I reminded her that he had help from his friends and brothers most of whom are now too old or deceased. Then when she said well it would cost too much, I finally just said: "Well then, I guess they're going to just have to stay the way they are because I am not doing it and you don't have the money. People who don't have the money and can't do the work don't do it especially if it's not something critical." Like honestly it's all cosmetic at this point. She just doesn't like that they are shifting; nothing is a tripping hazard or anything but this is just one of many things she wants done which I just can not do. And it's a constant "but..." trying to shame me into being lazy and not competent and me saying "no...I'm not doing that; if you want it done we'll hire someone.""

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 362 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/

↳ **comment** (273): "I think they don't have enough going on in their lives so they persevere on this stuff. Also, they do lose track that not everyone who is younger than them has the strength of a 30 year old. 10 or so years ago my mom asked if my husband and his brothers could do some stuff she wanted done around her house, and I had to remind her that that entire crew was now in their mid-fifties and had bad backs! I like to remember that "No" is a full sentence."

↳ **comment** (155): "> I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. There's the problem. edited to add: I count six instances of "her" in that one sentence. It's going to stay all about *her* until you decide to prioritize your own needs and wants."

↳ **comment** (127): "The thing is - this is what's known as "assisted living". If mom can't manage her own care and care of the home (even if "care of the home" means hiring people to do maintenance tasks), then she is no longer living independently. Parents seem to think that adult children as caretakers don't count, and that they are still "independent"."

"Surprised how many people (outside of this sub) feel kids should take care of parents?. I am in the midst of convincing/trying to get help for my parents. They live at home, but they need someone checking in on them a few times a week (early stages of dementia). I think if I gave up my whole life (job, husband, house, etc) to help them full time I honestly think they would be happy instead of sad. I feel like they don't want help from other people, it's so frustrating. Anyway, I truly appreciate this sub. It's been hard dealing with all of this, and I feel like no one understands until you're going through it. I see so many people on instagram say "wow how sad the kids aren't helping these parents" or "parents raise kids all their lives and then the kids just dump them". I feel like these people either haven't been through it yet or are so privileged they have all the time and money to deal with their aging parents? I don't think any parent (that was a good parent) should be dropped off at a sketchy nursing home and never visited, but yes I do think it's ok if a parent needs to be taken out of the home and go into a nursing home, even with family around. Or it's ok to hire someone to come help, versus people giving up their lives to care for someone. I also am not having kids, and hate the notion of kids having to be caregivers. I wasn't born to be a caregiver, I am an individual person who has a life outside of family. I shouldn't owe anyone anything, my parents chose to raise kids and it's the expectation not to be an asshole during that time. That doesn't mean I owe them outside of not completely abandoning them. Just wondering if anyone else has noticed this trend of "if you don't help your parents completely, you are a bad person", outside of this sub."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 316 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1inulwh/surprised_how_many_people_outside_of_this_sub/

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "“People ask how they can help and I have no words.” I completely understand and I’m not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there’s literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband’s family, we basically didn’t have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn’t thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can’t buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it’s hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it’s even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there’s something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"Only Child—Outnumbered by 2 Aging Parents. I'm struggling, and I just don't know how to handle everything I'm supposed to handle. I'm 47, female, single, and an only child. My parents are 75, in declining health, and live 2 hours away. Financially, no one can move closer. I work full-time in a stressful job with 4 days a week mandated RTO, and my commute is over 2 hours a day. I've got chronic health issues I'm dealing with, plus trying to keep a house going. My parents haven't planned for their future and get mad when I try to bring anything up. They're dismissive. My parents are both frail and need help. They have someone who comes to clean periodically, but there's no one there for day to day stuff. My mom gets mad that I'm not there more often. I'm exhausted and sick, but I'm "selfish" for not taking time off work or coming more on weekends. I love them, but I'm upset they haven't and won't do anything to plan. They're struggling, but so am I. And I can't take care of them and me too. I have to keep my job and insurance. I can't afford to not work or to take unpaid leave. They don't want to hire caregivers, and neither of them wants to go into assisted living. I feel like I'm not enough, no matter where I am. If I'm with them, I'm not much help. Drowning at work. Too exhausted to do much at my own house. I don't know what to do. I have to keep my job, and I feel like a bad daughter."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 193 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ue0xdc/only_childoutnumbered_by_2_agiing_parents/

"If I could have hired outside help I would have done it already.. Having been a caretaker since I was a child (I'm 42 now) I genuinely wonder what people are thinking when they tell me "you've got to get help, you can't do this alone." One of my mom's doctors who works at one of the most prestigious medical schools in the world said "hire a personal assistant for her." I'm at my wits end. I can't even pay all of my own bills and I'm expected to magically manifest 15k additional dollars monthly to put my parent in a care home. Perhaps it's because I've always lived under the poverty line, but I genuinely can't wrap my head around how people think this is a helpful statement. Day in and day out people tell me "you've do so much for her, I don't know how you're still carrying on you really need outside help." I fucking know that. I can't afford it. I'm exhausted from having to have conversations with people who have no clue what it's like to be a caregiver when you're poor. The aid that so many people talk about doesn't exist in the real world because we live in America and there are not any effective social safety nets for people like us. I feel like her illnesses have not only ruined her life but have also collapsed my own ability to thrive. Nothing gets better. It will only get worse until she passes and that is a cold reality for me. I don't want to do this anymore, and there is really no hope that it will get better. It's just "keep going because there is no other choice and if you die then you're also in trouble because now you've left your mother without care." Most days I wish I wasn't born."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 177 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1q1choi/if_i_could_have_hired_out_side_help_i_would_have/

"Grandmother is now refusing AL or moving in with other family. I'm done caregiving and have plans to move. WTF do I do now?. I've taken care of my 96yr old grandma since I was 19/20 and am now 31yrs old. She's gone from being wholly independent aside from needing assistance going to appointments to now being mobile for short periods with a walker but has the majority of her mental faculties if not extremely emotionally needy and depressed. The last week after her release from a SNF from a fall she has either barely gotten out of bed or been trying go outside and dig up her garden when I'm not home and at work (neighbors called to let me know). She's going to seriously hurt herself but doesn't seem to care. I am at the end of my rope and ability to take care of her. The last time she fell I could not physically pick her up. I've already lost a ogreat job because of her constantly calling me to come home because she's "sick" and needs to go the ER (she's not, we waste 6+hrs to be told she's perfectly fine every single time), and am in danger of losing my current one for the same reason. I have to be present at home for any other person that stops by whether it's her friends or family visiting or scheduled appointments because she won't answer the door otherwise and she refuses any attempts for me to get respite because she won't go to daycares or senior events that would allow me to do so. So I'm essentially tethered to her anytime I'm not at work. We're at the point where she is only slowly deteriorating and not getting any better while I am no longer eating or sleeping and my own mental health has gotten bad enough my doctors are concerned for me. Neither of us can sustain this. I've spoken with other family that are planning a visit this week to either take her home with them or find an AL or nursing home ASAP. They are very aware that I cannot handle any more and need relief. My bags are actively being packed and I have a place to move to as soon as she's taken care of. Grandma was okay with this progression and change up until today (though obviously not happy about it) when suddenly it's become "oh we'll hire someone to come in and help" and "I'm staying at home or you get nothing". She's insistent we're both staying right here and that's just not happening. I don't care about anything willed to me when she passes anymore. Maybe it makes me a terrible person but I cannot do this any longer. I don't have POA, her son's does (the one coming this week) and she is otherwise still in charge of her own medical decisions. Obviously we can't force her into a facility but if I'm not stopping my plans to leave, what do we do? Do I just leave and let the chips fall if she won't allow herself to be moved somewhere? I spent today feeling like I was arguing with a toddler trying to get across to her that the train is leaving the station and she's not listening."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1np0dlg/grandmother_is_now_refusing_al_or_moving_in_with/

"Assisted living plus required add-ons are out of control. Is this a peculiar circumstance or is it typical? I would like to know if there are other options for our 89-year-old mother: Our mother went to assisted-living a month ago. In less than 24 hours, she was found on the floor and rushed to the hospital. She was diagnosed with a pulmonary embolism and a fractured pelvis. She was in the hospital for almost 2 weeks. She is ineligible for blood thinners because of her other medical conditions. The attending suggested DNR and hospice and we made those changes. Attending also suggested that she go to a nursing home and that she could stay in the hospital until she was admitted, but then the attending changed and that plan was not honored. In order to return her to assisted living, as a fall risk, the facility required that she have a 24/7 1:1 aide. This service is costing more than \$26,000 a month, in addition to more than \$5500 for the assisted living room and board. She was just rejected from the nursing home because it cannot accommodate the one-to-one aid. This cost is exorbitant. Has anyone else experienced this array of necessities and this cost and how do you get around it or get your parent into a nursing home? Staying with family is not an option."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 99 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1umeco7/assisted_living_plus_required_addons_are_out_of/

"I think you need to just hire a private aide for overnight to have the 1:1 care he needs during that time and leave him in the assisted living. I don't think you will get everything you need by having him in an apartment with an aide 24/7. What we found was that the assistant living will oversee the private aide and the private aide will oversee the assisted living and they will rat each other out to you. Win-win. If you don't like the assisted living, then I would just move him to a better one and get an aide overnight. I don't think bringing him to a private apartment is a good thing with everything he has going on. I think that might be a dangerous move and the assisted living is set up already with accessible bathrooms and showers and other fall risk measures. No place is perfect, but you will have to do a LOT to the apartment to make it work like an assisted living."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 97 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/oxjpqez/

"AITA for hiring a caregiver for my mom after my family told me it's "my turn to be responsible"? I (34F) am completely exhausted and need an outside perspective. I (34F) am an only child on my mother's side. My mom has Parkinson's and dementia. My dad is in his 80s and was just hospitalized for a bowel obstruction. I also have a 19-month-old daughter. My dad has children from a previous relationship who are about 20 years older than me. They are my siblings, but they are not my mom's children. Most of them live far away, have established careers, and some have health issues of their own, so they are not very involved in day-to-day caregiving. About a year ago, I moved back to Puerto Rico partly because my parents were aging and needed more support. Since then, I've been trying to balance being a mom, running my own business, managing rental properties, and helping my parents. Honestly, the transition has been much harder than I expected. This past week my dad was hospitalized, so I've been helping care for my mom. I've been going back and forth to the hospital, staying with my mom, caring for my toddler, and putting much of my work on hold. A few days ago, my mom fell while I was helping her. She was okay, but it scared me and made me realize that I cannot safely do everything by myself. I told my family that I was overwhelmed and needed help. I hired a caregiver for just four days, paying out of my own pocket 8am to 12pm (dad pays) 3:00 pm to 8:00pm (I pay), to help my mom for a few hours each day while my dad transitions home from the hospital. My dad was extremely upset. He told me that if I don't take care of my mom myself, then I should give back everything he has given me. He specifically brought up the apartments that were transferred to me when I was 18 years old. I'm now 34 and have spent the last 16 years managing those properties and building a property management business around them. He also told me that I chose to have a child and should have thought about my parents before having one. He said that if I want to focus on my career another business I am building, then he wants the apartments and everything back. When I told my siblings that I was close to collapsing and needed help, they told me that I had a "perfect life" and that it was my turn to be responsible because my dad gave me those apartments and that I have never been fully responsible. What hurts the most is that nobody is offering an alternative solution. Nobody is volunteering to cover shifts, contribute financially, or help coordinate care. They simply believe that because I received property years ago, I should personally be responsible for caring for my mother. I love my parents and want to help them. That's why I moved closer to them, why I've been helping all week, and why I arranged additional care in the first place. But I also have a toddler, a business, my own responsibilities, and limits. Hiring a caregiver for a few hours a day felt like a reasonable solution, but my family sees it as me refusing to take care of my mother. AITA for hiring temporary help because I don't feel capable of doing everything myself?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 92 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uc225q/aita_for_hiring_a_caregiver_for_my_mom_after_my/

"Seriously contemplating walking away from my Mom and Step-Dad. The title says it all. I am seriously considering walking away from my parents. My mother (67) refuses to have a conversation - guaranteed to turn into an argument - with my step-father (77) to demand to hire a home health aide come to assist them daily. They both need help. She is being treated for cancer and having side effects from chemo. He has cancer in remission,

diabetes, can't walk (refuses to walk due to muscle atrophy), after a stroke more than 5 years ago. Otherwise, he is in decent health. Before the stroke, step-dad was belligerent, angry, difficult, and selfish. He hasn't changed and can be mercurial. As a child, I couldn't wait to GTFO of his house. I've been helping my Mom - who was his full-time caregiver until she became sick with cancer herself. I work full-time and am exhausted always taking care of them between hygiene, laundry, shopping, cleaning, and more. They have resources, but only spend money when it is an emergency - like when the hot water tank in their home stopped working. It was an emergency replacement. I've talked to my Mom, texted her to prevent him from hearing the conversation...but she doesn't think there is a problem. I feel as though I will need to collapse and be admitted into the hospital myself before either of them will take my needs seriously. I have an apartment of my own that I barely see because I am taking care of them or at work. Walking away and going no contact is the only option left. Family friends have pleaded with him to get help, to do more. I have pleaded with my Mom, but I think just leaving and not coming back is next. I don't want to do this, but I feel like have no other options. I love my Mom and don't want to abandon her, but she isn't willing to do the one thing I need. I even offered to move her in with me and just leave my step-dad to figure it out on his own...but she feels sorry for him and won't leave. I want to scream. Where is her empathy for me? TL;DR: I am thinking of abandoning my mother and step-father for not hiring a home health aide. After taking care of them for nearly six months alone, I am exhausted. Short of dropping dead or being hospitalized myself, they don't see a problem. Leaving them and not answering their calls feels like the only way out. Just going no contact. They cannot function without help. UPDATE: Thank you for your responses with advice and cautionary stories. There are no siblings who can help. Step-Dad has a step-son, but he is the definition of unreliable. I am making one more pitch for hiring an aide to my Mom and then, I am taking a good, long break."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 84 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walking_a_way_from_my_mom/

↳ **comment** (43): "Go only one day a week. Tell them you can't continue on like this."

↳ **comment** (39): "You must be exhausted. I think that so many parents haven't encouraged their children to develop the skill of recognizing their own normal temporary feelings of tiredness, worry, anger, and other negative emotions. So in everyday life, small negative emotions aren't dealt with in a healthy way, then healthy boundaries and expectations aren't created as the years pass. Then one day, the parent is surprised that their adult child has accumulated too much, is now burnt out and has to go low/no contact to survive. Maybe I'm projecting, but that's how it feels."

↳ **comment** (31): "My dad keeps saying they are managing just fine. I keep wanting my brother and sister to join me in going one week without answering their calls, giving them rides, or going over to do chores for them. One week of letting them be independent, as dad asserts they can be. One week of getting him to face the reality that he can't care for mom single-handedly, that he can't manage a two story house and big yard in his own, and that he can't apply the foot care treatment the doctor prescribed by himself. But my siblings keep sweeping in to help, and dad keeps burying his head in the sand."

">...she is actually cleared to shower herself. She is capable... > > She has always known that I would never be her caregiver. She has always been told by me that I would hire help and I would not be the one changing her and bathing. > > Choosing not to be a caregiver does not mean i do not love her. All valid points and absolutely normal (where I live). Now let go of all the other drama and either have her do it herself or hire someone to do it."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 80 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/osu890d/

"Tell the flying monkeys you're not engaging in this discussion anymore until they spend 12 hours straight with her at the AL. And I'm mean, I'd put that in the group chat so they realize I'm seeing their messages."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 79 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4ugmao/

"My mom's back in the hospital. Dad needs 24/7 care at home. . I'm so mad. I came to visit my parents for the night. It's a 4 hour drive. My mom has a gross scaly skin rash that's oozing on her leg. Her legs are like elephant legs. She hates going to the doctor. She cares for my dad with Parkinson's around the clock. But will not take care of her own health. She was in the hospital 2 weeks ago but checked herself out against medical advice and then just let her skin thing fester and made no effort to see her own doctor. So it was a waste of 2 nights she spent in the hospital last time and we're back to square one. So I convinced her to go back tonight. Of course they are keeping her overnight again. My brother who lives with them is at work overnight. So I'm here with my 2 kids helping my dad pee in a bottle. Something I never wanted to do. I love him but for the love of god, hire a nurse to handle this stuff! I can't stay tomorrow. I have to get my kids back home for school. I have a dog and 2 cats at home and a house and a full time job AND my husband died last year. I'm mad because my mom has known for years how bad my dad is and she's refused to hire help. She has the money but has this phobia about letting anyone else help her. So now she's stuck us in a bad spot where I'm here alone caring for my dad and I don't know what to do exactly and I have no one to call to help me. Im going to call the VA tomorrow morning and see about either getting someone in here to help or bringing him there for a few days while my mom gets her skin thing and swollen legs figured out. 2 weeks ago they wanted to send her home with a visiting nurse checking in and she refused. Like WHY? WHY must you be so difficult? WHY can't you see reason? I'm going to get 0 sleep tonight and I have to drive 4 hours home tomorrow."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cpxyo2/my_moms_back_in_the_hospital_dad_needs_247_care/

↳ **comment** (42): "I'm really sorry. That all sounds really rough. My dad has Parkinson's too, so I know the level of care that is required. I think that it's time to say, "mom, there are no options. You are having the visiting nurse come because I absolutely cannot come back until (much later date). By not allowing them to help, you are causing me a great deal of stress and I cannot do this anymore." Hopefully that will be enough, but I also have a stubborn mom, so I understand that it might not be. But your first priority is taking care of your kids and yourself; it simply has to be."

↳ **comment** (19): "If it's bad enough for her to be kept overnight, it's pretty bad. I'm sorry you are going through this. Can you take your dad for a Dr evaluation so you can talk to Medicare about any benefits you can access for them?"

↳ **comment** (16): "A lot of assisted living places offer short stays for when the primary caregiver needs a break or is just unavailable. Also, they all asked about VA benefits when I was looking for my mom while dad was in hospice."

"I wonder if this tactic would help - it's what I do with my children! You could empathize with her desire to have them moved ("you're right mom, they would look so much better") and her nostalgia for the past ("dad would have been great at this") even while holding on to your firm no ("I'm not Dad nor can I do this. If only Dad were still here, or you had the money to hire someone. I hear you - it's such a bummer!")"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 67 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/o2zkonn/

"Has anyone ever moved their parent OUT of assisted living and instead got them 24/7 caregivers in a private residence?. Considering this for my father in law. He has advanced Parkinson's and dementia from it. He's in a nice assisted living home in memory care. But even so he keeps falling because he keeps trying to get up at night. A week or two ago he fell and fractured his spine and has to be in a brace. Last night he fell and badly hit his head.

We're at the point where he probably needs 24-hour monitoring. Which is going to be.... Expensive. We already pay like \$14k/month for his assisted living. Seriously considering getting him a nice apartment near us and hiring a service to watch him one-on-one. Rent would be more like \$3k/month. Is this a crazy thing to do? He is pretty miserable at the assisted living. And tbh we don't love spending time there either. They are nice and trying their best but it's a tough environment. We are working with hospice to manage his care (thank you to this sub for suggesting it!) Edit: ok we've been thoroughly talked out of this idea. So next question is whether to hire an overnight watch person for his room in memory care... or just let him fall?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 62 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uwk1mi/has_anyone_ever_moved_their_parent_out_of/

↳ **comment** (97): "I think you need to just hire a private aide for overnight to have the 1:1 care he needs during that time and leave him in the assisted living. I don't think you will get everything you need by having him in an apartment with an aide 24/7. What we found was that the assistant living will oversee the private aide and the private aide will oversee the assisted living and they will rat each other out to you. Win-win. If you don't like the assisted living, then I would just move him to a better one and get an aide overnight. I don't think bringing him to a private apartment is a good thing with everything he has going on. I think that might be a dangerous move and the assisted living is set up already with accessible bathrooms and showers and other fall risk measures. No place is perfect, but you will have to do a LOT to the apartment to make it work like an assisted living."

↳ **comment** (53): "I think you are going to find hiring 24 hour care is going to be much more expensive than skilled nursing care unless you have family members that are going to supplement or donut at a reduced rate."

↳ **comment** (35): "Be realistic... you'll need three full time aids seven days a week... that's \$20k/month or more in most areas. A better mix would be a more affordable group home and an overnight companion."

"Can we talk about how undervalued family caregivers are compared to agency supports?. This has been my experience at least. My partner and I care for an aging family member and the attitudes we routinely run into are deplorable. Our loved one has moderate/severe dementia which obviously requires a ton of work. Memory Care homes start at \$10k/month in our area. We are very lucky that our loved one is able to compensate us for the care we provide, but nowhere near \$10k a month. Yet, we play the roles of home health aid, CNA, case manager, Social Worker, transportation, advocate, chef, and so, so much more. As the dementia has progressed, we've obviously needed more supports. It started with my partner not working anymore to do the hands on care, and then I needed to move down from FT work and take a WFH position to manage all the background work and help with the hands on work. We were able to get a few hours a week of a home health aid, but it's still not enough and we are extremely burnt out after five years of this. My husband and I and our loved one all have varying degrees of health issues that are not cheap. If you do the math, my husband and I are compensated maybe 1/4 of minimum wage for all the time we put in. And yet, so many people that we speak to act like the income should be enough to cover all needs and pay for private caregiving/respite, and we are just somehow being greedy. It makes me so angry. No one says that a private caregiver wanting minimum wage is greedy. No one says that a case manager wanting compensated for overtime is greedy. No one questions the outrageous costs of Memory Care homes (that don't even include medical care costs such as medication and other copays). But because we are family we should somehow just be grateful for what we have and be able to do everything ourselves, without proper sleep, without breaks, without any real respite. It makes me so angry. I don't deny that we are luckier than many in that we are able to be at all compensated, but I'm so tired of being treated like crap because we are family and are expected to be able to do everything ourselves with out asking for help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ai7fdz/can_we_talk_about_how_undervalued_family/

↳ **comment** (32): "I caregive for 3 people, my mom and 2 teenage sons with autism. I was trying to get an agency to have a caregiver come to at least help with my mom, but they require a minimum 20 hours a week at

\$37 an hour. And they absolutely refuse to help with anyone else in the house, so it would have been just for my mom. I wish I could restrict my caregiving to just 1 person! So with that math, I should be getting paid \$114 an hour (37 x 3 people) and at 40 hours a week (which is generous because obviously I pull overtime every day) that's like \$18k a month! Over \$200 grand a year! I should be in a freaking mansion driving a Jaguar."

↳ **comment** (16): "You know what else I recently discovered about how undervalued we are? I was looking at physician assistant grad programs and one of the requirements is having worked or volunteered in some sort of healthcare related role, such as a CNA or volunteer EMS. Looking at the lists, caregiving for a stranger for pay or on a volunteer basis counts as top tier experience. Doing the same exact thing for a friend or family member does NOT COUNT AT ALL. Like wtf? Adds insult to injury if you want or need to make a career change after dropping out of the workforce to care give and maybe trying to use your experience to to do so but because it's for family, even if paid, that experience counts for nothing when doing the exact same thing for a stranger is considered top notch experience. So you can't even get into the program despite everything else as a result. In my opinion, that's just such a big FU to family caregivers by the system. Family caregivers do, manage and learn so much more than a stranger that comes in for a few hours a week but that's just worthless apparently."

↳ **comment** (15): "Ha! We really should all be in mansions driving Jaguars. Imagine if we got to demand any semblance of expectations of our work environment (I won't clean, I'll only take care of one person, I won't change diapers, etc), or any sort of wage! It's laughable. \$37/hour?!?! Even if you're able to get paid as an IHSS worker for your family member, that's only minimum wage! It's so backwards! Why are we putting all of this funding into strangers caring for family. Why aren't we working harder to make sure family has the ability to care for family??? It makes no logical sense! It reminds me of how in Foster Care, you used to only be able to get monthly assistance if you were a non-related Foster Parent. So if you were a stranger, you'd get a decent monthly check and a number of other benefits to help care for the child. But if you were family, even an Aunt twice removed, you'd get *nothing!!!* We finally changed the laws when we realized that outcomes for foster kids were so much worse with strangers vs family, but it took way too long. I can only hope that things will eventually change when it comes to caregiving for family."

"Caregiver getting too close to father?. I hire caregivers through a local agency to visit my father and help out for a few hours per day. My father is single, lives alone and probably has early signs of dementia - but still awaiting a formal evaluation. One caregiver in particular seems to have gotten pretty close to my father and I'm not sure if I should be concerned. She buys him things with her own money and has visited his house even when she's not scheduled to be there. My father was recently in physical rehab for a few weeks and she said she called every facility in town trying to locate him so that she could visit. She seems nice and perhaps she just developed a close bond with my father but I do hear the horror stories of predatory caregivers. My father does have considerable assets too. Should I put a stop to it?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 61 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1pck377/caregiver_getting_too_close_to_father/

↳ **comment** (106): "Immediate stop. I hope you are the POA. Check all his financial accounts. Check his household valuables especially jewelry. Call her supervisor and end her assignment."

↳ **comment** (85): "Guardian here. Call the agency and remove her from the staff caring for your father. Block her phone. Talk with the manager and give them a full description of this behavior. Good for you for protecting your Dad."

↳ **comment** (44): "Caregivers are some of the biggest thieves out there. As a matter of fact, some purposely get into tue business to scam the government and to directly steal from the elderly. I know, I work with old folks. Keep a close eye on pop."

"I spent the day with my mom, trying to help her receive necessary medical treatment. I feel like the Geezer Whisperer.. (Please don't @ me. I use inappropriate humor to cope.) Ma is dealing with a recently diagnosed serious health condition. For the past few days, she's been having some major bad symptoms - localized pain and nausea. Obviously, I'm worried. I went shopping for her yesterday, took groceries and dog food and electrolyte drinks. "Mama, you need to talk to your PCP or your oncologist, or I will. And it's OK if you aren't up to making the phone call, I'll gladly do it." "No, it's just that [health issue I had 40 years ago and dealt with.]" "OK. [Not really.] But you need to talk to your oncologist, in case this is one of the serious side effects of the treatment you started on Friday." "No, it's probably just [random bullshit that was properly handled 4 decades ago.] I'm FINE!" Cut to this morning. My phone rings at 8am. I know it's no bueno if my mama is calling before 10. "Baby, I might need you to take me to the emergency room. Get dressed, but let me call the triage nurse at my primary doctor first. I'll call you right back." K. I'm downing coffee like we're gonna impose sanctions on Columbia tomorrow, rushing the dogs through their morning constitutional, shower, dress, update husband in case he needs to pick up from band practice and student council meeting, etc. There's leftovers for dinner. I'm prepared. And I wait. Finally, I text around 10. (Didn't want to call, in case Ma was on the phone with the nurse.) Let's pretend like Mama actually left a message instead of just doom dialing. But Ma said "Come on. I need some relief." Good. It's 15 miles through the country to Ma's, and then back to town. I'm driving. "Maybe I should stop at my PCP before I just go to the emergency room." First good decision of the day, let's go. Ma has a new doctor. I haven't been there. She can't remember the name of the practice nor how to get there, but we made it with 3 detours. Luck was on our side: we walked in at 11:04 am, and the lovely woman at the desk said that Dr. H had a slot open at 11:15. The ludicrous old broad tells the very nice doctor that "Well, I've had a little nausea and some pain." Me: "Translation: she hasn't kept any food or water down in 3 days, and pain has kept her awake for 3 days." Ma: "Oh, it's not that serious. I've googled, and I think it's my gall bladder." In other words, it couldn't possibly be a side effect from the immunotherapy she began receiving Friday for stage IV melanoma. (Mind you, she's never had gall bladder issues.) Aight. Doctor wants to rule out Dr. Google's dx. Sends us straight over to the imaging center for an abdominal CT with contrast, a promise to refer to the gastroenterology practice in case of gallstones, and prescription for a nausea medicine and a pain reliever. It's noon when we arrived at the imaging center. Fill out paperwork, drink this bottle of not-really-fruit-punch. Mama's all "have I ever had surgery? It doesn't really count if it was decades ago, right?" Ma, drink your radioactive shit and hand me the clipboard. I learned how to forge your signature in the 1980s. I rubbed her back and finished the paperwork in between "why is this taking so long?!" And I know time stretches when you're in pain. But she was out of CT at 13:28. (Remember, we arrived at her doctor's office at 11:04. And it's 20 minutes for the contrast solution to be effective, and 10 minutes across town to the imaging center. But I understand. Pain and nausea are a terrible way to live.) Next step: when the PCP receives the scan, he'll refer you to the GE if that's appropriate, or to the oncologist. Cool. Okay, let's go pick up your prescriptions. Back across town, and the pharmacy is closed for lunch until 14:00. It's fine, less than half an hour. "I'm so hungry." I don't doubt that. What do you think you can eat? Y'all. She decided on a McDonald's fish sandwich. I know everyone is different, but a fried fish sandwich?! Whatever. She's grown. So I grabbed us a couple of sandwiches, and we went back to wait in the pharmacy drive through. Ma vomited up her sandwich and the contrast dye in the lane. Fortunately, it's supposed to rain tonight, so maybe someone else won't have to hose that off the driveway. Got her meds, after a little fuss about scanning her ID for a scheduled pain reliever. Drove her home. I get to take her to the oncologist tomorrow. You'll be shocked to know that Mama's gall bladder is fine and her symptoms are almost certainly related to her cancer treatment."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 55 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1axokrw/i_spent_the_day_with_my_mom_trying_to_help_her/

↳ **comment** (18): ""I'm downing coffee like we're gonna impose sanctions on Columbia tomorrow". I legit cackled. Dark humor was how my mom coped with life. I love it! The doctor SHOULD have prescribed her Zofran or some other nausea drug prior to her being put on immunotherapy. If not, express your concerns tomorrow to the oncologist. DO NOT let your mom tell them she is fine or that it was nothing. She disrupted your day for all that. They may even change her immuno treatment if her reaction is this severe. She should NOT be eating

anything heavier than Saltines at this point, and certainly not fast food fish. Bleh. Why would you do that to yourself, ESPECIALLY if you think you are having a gallbladder attack?! 🤢 "

↳ **comment** (12): "At Mom's request, my brother and I both joined her for the first visit to the oncologist. We're in the waiting room, filling out a health history questionnaire. Page 15 or so is sexual/reproductive history. "Are you sexually active?" "Ma, I will give you a quarter if you write 'No, I just lay there.'" So I owe her a quarter."

↳ **comment** (11): "Fortunately, the PCP did prescribe Zofran yesterday. I'll find out this morning whether it helped Ma keep anything down. (My retired cop/former drug dog handler husband is already suggesting the forbidden gummies. I'm letting him source those. I wouldn't know how. I'm sure my young adult kids would have a source, but I'm not going to get them in a bind. "Officer, I swear those are for my poor old sick grandmother!")"

"In home vs Assisted Living. I wanted to share me and my sister's experience so if anyone has similar circumstances you can consider our situation. Our 86yr old parents were moved to a stepless community home they paid for in full when they built it in 2018. Our dad literally had a Widowmaker stroke two weeks after moving in. He survived and recovered (cockroach genetics at work) but it was the warning shot for his slow decline until his passing this past April. Passing at home with hospice care, covered by Medicare but managed by me and my sister. We knew they wanted their independence so we used what savings they had to pay for Visiting Angels in home help. In addition to daily support from my sister and I. Upside: The overall cost of in home care has been less than what it would cost to move to assisted living. And the in-home care is 1billion times better since its legit 1:1 Downside: All costs are not billable to insurance/Medicare. So all our costs have all been funded by retirement & savings. Its been a struggle bus I never expected or planned on supporting. But my parents are living a quality life in their twilight. My hope is that anyone serving as a family caregiver can get any support possible. Its a heavy lift and nobody can do it alone."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 53 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ovlon8/in_home_vs_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (19): "hi, first, may your dad's memory be a blessing. second, i believe what you did was the most selfless and kind, loving and generous thing for your dad. he was fortunate. finally... "cockroach genetics" killed me dead. that is too funny. i'll be using that to describe my dad as he heads into his seventh month on hospice. peace"

↳ **comment** (8): "we dont have 24/7 coverage. we pay for 6, 8hr days a week my mom doesn't need anyone to care for her at night. and i have yet to find a Assised Living that prices under 10k a month. and that is only for room and board. We would still have to cover costs of comfort care"

↳ **comment** (7): "For us, 1 cna, 24/7 was 40 dollars an hour, 44 on weekends. \$14,000 every two weeks. Out of pocket. Mom was incontinent, had dementia and was an elopement risk. Dad lives in AL, 7,500 per month. He has a 1 br apartment with a kitchen (no stove), all meals, meds management and supervision. He has alzhimers, but is surrounded by kind residents and caregivers. He does not have to keep up with a house or yard. When overnight supervision is needed, the costs of in home care add up very quickly."

"You can say no. If he moves into an AL facility and then calls you, asking you to get him groceries, pick things up from Walmart, and clean his apartment, you can say no – "unfortunately, I'm not going to be able to get you any groceries; you'll have to make use of the facility's dining hall/transportation to the grocery store", "I can't make it to Walmart; you'll have to order X online/use the facility's transportation options to get X", "I can't clean for you; you'll have to pick up after yourself/make use of the cleaning services available to you/hire a housekeeper". If he complains that the staff doesn't know you because you never come around, "well, I'm here now, so I guess I should go and introduce myself [and get myself out of this room so I don't have to listen to your criticism – this part left unsaid, of course]", or "I'm busy; I come when I can". Just because someone tries to make you feel guilty doesn't

mean you actually have to feel guilty. You can refuse to feel guilty. Similarly, just because someone wants you to do something doesn't mean you have to do it; *you can say no*. You can do what you are willing and able to do without running yourself into the ground, and then decline when asked (or told) to do more. If you can't bring yourself to say no, or let go of guilt, therapy can help with that."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 41 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nuphf8/dad_discharged_from_hospital_yesterday_now_acting/nh32wxw/

I want my life back · 136 documents

20 most engaged of 136 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"I am 62. I cared for both of my parents for 10 years. It almost killed me. You lose your very self. People tell you to take care of yourself, but there's no time for that. There's no You anymore. My mother was the last one to die. That was 4 years ago. I'm still exhausted, if that tells you anything. I don't want to go anywhere or do anything. I live happily by myself with my phone to keep me company. I may be adding a cat to the scenario soon. I have a wonderful family nearby who I see every now and then, so I'm not totally alone. But I want no other human being living in my space ever. The silence and slowness of life is so sweet. I loved my parents dearly. Now, it's all about me."

youtube · @lindaN236 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 1,123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxBCru86SBHWgrVpXB4AaABAq

↳ **@Teffi_Club** (93): "It is true when you take care of your parents, you lose your own health."

↳ **@sjtalksandlife** (61): "It's time for you to enjoy your life, you did a great job with your parents, now it's time to focus on you"

↳ **@lordbrunski** (44): "I am so glad you shared that with honesty. I have hypothyroid and looking after my ungrateful and abusive parents has left me in a state of exhaustion that I cannot shake off. I feel like you do. Being solo is the only think I want. Men assume that I am "up for it" and they have no idea that all I want is a book, a cat and a dog. The idea of having to look after anyone else does not appeal."

"NPR story on caring for aging parents (venting). NPR did a story yesterday morning on caring for aging parents, interviewing a woman who ended up taking care of her mother 24/7 while her mother was bedridden. While it accurately depicted the struggles of caregiving, it ended as most of these stories do by making it redemptive, saying what a beautiful thing it was or what a privilege it was to take care of her mother. My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together. I used to think I might "get my life back," but I've found that you don't. You can't get back all the lost social and career opportunities. You don't get your mental and physical health back. You have to figure out what to do with what's left. I took care of my mother because I felt it was my duty as her son to do so. Most people tell me I objectively did a good job, but I was never temperamentally suited to the role. I forced myself to do it, every day. I put a mask on and was pleasant to her, but I hated having to try to get my mother to do the basic things she needed to do every day. By the end, as her dementia progressed, it felt pointless. I was maintaining a body that had very little mind left in it when I could have been putting my own mind to work in my business, solving problems for clients. I lost my biggest client because I didn't have time to do the work he needed me to do. I resented it. Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy. It was traumatizing. And now I'm still dealing with my mother's estate with a sibling who thinks she deserves half of everything even though she did absolutely nothing to help, ever. She couldn't care less what it cost me. She takes it all for granted. I just hate when people try to sugar-coat what caregiving does to your life and try to frame it in sentimental terms. It wrecked my mental and physical health. It wrecked my business. It wrecked my social and romantic life. It's made me hate my sister for her apathy and greed. I'm 59 and trying to get back into the dating world, and I feel like I'm having to learn how to do it all over again. I'm having to re-learn how to go out and socialize with people. I can only relate my own story, but caregiving didn't leave me with some rosy afterglow. Caregiving wrecked my life. I'm satisfied that I did my duty to my mother, but that's it. It didn't give me some wonderful gift. The news media will never report that story. Edit: Thanks for all the responses. Part of what set me off yesterday was the fact that it was my mother's birthday, and several people sent me messages about how I must be thinking about my mom today. The thing is, I wasn't. I was working all day trying to get a job done for a new client. And I thought about my mother 24/7 for years. I'm done thinking about my mother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,034 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

"I am 62 and my 88 yr old mom with dementia moved in with me last year ...wow...absolutely the hardest and most stressful thing I've ever had to do... which prompted me to draw up a living, trust, specifying that my children are to hire help and or put me in a facility if/when I can't take care of myself because I would never want to be the burden to them that I am now experiencing with my own mom...and I'm a RN! I've suffered loss of income and freedom... I'm sorry to say this, especially as a Christian, but I have developed resentment towards my own mother 😞"

youtube · @Lori-Urban · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 801 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxNpHmATs-JZ0ZZnJp4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (220): "My friend you may be a nurse and a Christian but first and foremost you are a human. Forgive yourself and give yourself the grace that a human being deserves. I think we can feel love, anger, caring and resentment and everything else all at once and under the circumstances it is normal and natural. Hang in there. You are going through something brutal."

↳ **@chronic2023** (89): "I have a 74-year-old childhood friend who is literally killing herself taking care of her 94-year-old mother. She is also an RN. Her mother doesn't have dementia but she has difficulty moving. You might want to see if you can get help taking care of your mother. My sister had to go into a home at 79. It's unreasonable for you to carry the entire burden."

↳ @cathydyer3774 (55): "😞😞 you are overwhelmed. It has become too much for you. You need help 🙏 "

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :, can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the*

urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents

living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest. The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know I have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. I'm an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business I'm juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking I have some time. A week or so later Dad's friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasn't clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. He's in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when he's lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them I'm looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they don't want

to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's

time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are taking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for

that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to “get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you”. I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I’ve had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I’m so exhausted from hearing about it. I’m taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I’m already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I’ve ever had with my mom because her pride won’t allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can’t help but let this anger consume me. It’s strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I’m tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he’s in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he’s out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I’m balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he’s exhausted too. End rant. I’m just tired and angry y’all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED.”

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the

things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying. My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play stardew valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many potholes and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"I can't do this anymore, and I never agreed to be a caregiver to my mother's husband.. To sum up some background context, my mom remarried when I was in my mid 20's about 20 years ago. My mom asked me to move in 3.5 years ago to temporarily help her with my son. My mom died 3 years ago, my son died a year ago. I have never been close to her husband, he didn't even start being nice to me till my mom died. I feel I can't leave because I'm the only person he doesn't kick out. I'm coming from a place of deep frustration at the moment, and I'm sorry if I sound like a soulless monster. I just can't do this anymore. My parents didn't divorce till I was an adult. In extreme desperation, I assume my married, lets call him Frank. (now 75) Frank was the opposite of my father who my mother loved dearly in every bad way. He was uneducated, uncaring and had no family values, but what I could I do. It was her choice to marry him after 4 months. I had my own life going on and briefly stayed with them after being left during my third trimester of pregnancy till my son was six weeks old. Frank, made sure I knew that I had to get out after I gave birth and that my mom was not going to be a "babysitter" She did what he said, she liked being controlled. So, my mom undergoes what I felt was an unnecessary medical procedure that caused complications. She asked me and my teenage son to move in to help her overcome her health obstacles. Frank decides to get an unnecessary elective surgery and my mom actually kills herself trying to care take to him afterward. I was distraught to say the least and I never blamed Frank for my mom's choices. I could say in detail every event that has made me choose not to leave. But I want someone to read this. I'm being manipulated, and I know this and he kicks out any of his family including his daughter who left earlier this year, traumatized from PTSD he gave her and won't come back. Frank is from a different state, all his large family lives there. He refuses to go there and kicks out any adult grandchild etc that is sent to help because I have made it known I want to move out of here. He is completely fine with me here, especially since my son died. I don't get up in his business because I'm too consumed with my own grief and we live separate lives, but I clean. His life is watching Forensic Files, lurking Facebook and spending my dead mom's money on cam girls and what he knows are scams. Oh, and lot's of Dr visits, he has always loved going to the doctor. He is not being medically neglected, he more overrides the health care system by getting a Dr appointment for anything. He has destroyed his body signing up for clinical trials. He also loves to kick out home health nurses, go to the ER afterward and report the aides of injuring him and theft. (nothing has been stolen) My life is I constantly work to stay busy and out of my own head. I don't stay here out of financial security. I can very much afford to not be here. I'm paying for my own father's assisted living in NYC and I would be in a bind if I was footing two bills. He doesn't want assisted living anyhow and I know its just a matter of time till he burns through my mom's money and I become financially responsible for him. (Help pay for my father's assisted living. He is smart and planned for this, just not in NYC. He hates Texas and I can't blame him. I help with the offset cost, not the entire huge bill) The neighbors of 20 years have been very

supportive of him and me. They will take him to the ER for his unnecessary reasons, or will show up at the hospital because he decides to call 911 while I'm in therapy. Today, Frank has burned bridges with the neighbors and I'm terrified. They are all the support I have. The only support he has. So I come "home" from my typical 12 hour day with a trunk full of groceries only to find a large snake in the garage. I'm like great, go inside to get a broom and Frank calls out my name all cranky. We briefly discuss the snake. He then goes on about how mad he is because he fell twice trying to mow the lawn in 95 degree Texas heat. I'm like why are you mad? That was your own fault. He then goes and blames the next door neighbor for not mowing it for him like she normally does. And then blames me for not reading his mind. I didn't even notice it needed to be mowed. It wasn't that bad. I'm like that is not her job to mow your lawn and you could have asked me. He carries on about how we caused him to fall and I leave the unreasonable situation to get the groceries. My other neighbor calls me over and asks me wtf his problem is because he had to pick him up twice when he tried to mow the lawn causing panic all up the street. I give him the synopsis of what he said. Other neighbor tells me, you know he doesn't have cognitive decline and is just an asshole. I agree and he says I'm done. Go save yourself, I mean that. Other neighbor is a man of his word. He should have been done long ago as should have I. I'm terrified and have to accept that I'm not a horrible person for failing to save Frank from himself and choosing myself. Edit: sorry for all the typos and grammar mistakes my phone is freaking out too, and I need to get this out! And the 3 foot snake is still chilling in the garage. I will snake wrestle when it becomes daylight. Edit Edit: Is this normal on his part. I have read that as people age, they can become the worst form of themselves or the best form of who they wanted be. Edit: Thank you all so much!! The gaslighting is real. I needed to know this is with out a doubt, not my problem. I got into with him over the weekend when he tried to blame me for my mom's death. You don't go there with me and I don't stoop to his level. I was the bigger person and said: Me: I don't know what you want from me! Especially if you treat me like this Him: I should not have to say it. Me: Actually you do have to say what you want from me because I have no idea. Him: You know it! Me: I have no idea Him: I'm sick of repeating myself. Nobody listens. I want you out of here. I'm like sweet! I'll leave happily. I told him I'm leaving after the 4th weekend so I could find a place with out being overly dramatic and he needs to call his family and tell them he asked me to leave. Of course he is acting like that never happened. I just found some big chain complex that has an apartment available for move in 07/06. I'm taking it and can transfer units or complex's later if I need. Im too nice still and hired a lawn company to clear out any snake inviting debris and staying friendly to get what I want of my mother's. I know I'm not through with it all, once he dies, gets forced placed in a nursing home or loses the house taking out equity loans, I will have to clean it up. It will probably all happen within a week and this year. I did what I could but I can't sacrifice the remaining good years of my life so he can do whatever it is he does. Edit edit: I have always refused to be his POA or have any type of decision making authority with him. That was all settled with his family earlier this year and I was vocal I want nothing to do with this. His poor daughter is POA and will be the one really stuck to clean up this mess he leaves behind. He got her to sign up for that while she was emotionally vulnerable. There is nothing to gain when he dies, anything liquid he tore through after my mom died. I will help his daughter though emotionally. Her feelings towards him make mine seem warm and fuzzy. I will keep in my mind that they are not my family and trust no one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 126 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugwxtv/i_cant_do_this_anymore_and_i_never_agreed_to_be_a/

"Stubborn Father Refuses To Downsize Despite Being in His 90's. Expects Me To Be His Caregiver. My mother recently passed away in a tragic car accident and my siblings and I are trying to convince my father to downsize and move either into his own apartment or assisted living. I was living with them before my mother passed away so now I am his unpaid caregiver by default... thankfully he has no major medical issues beside occasional gout flare up's and arthritis since he's 96 but he expects me to cook, do laundry since he should not be going up & down the stairs to the basement, go grocery shopping using my own money (currently unemployed while he makes a pension of \$96,000 per year) clean the house and listen to his political ramblings. Essentially I've turned into a replacement wife for him which gives me a really weird feeling... This is something that a lot of other people here

can relate to but trying to get him to move out of his large suburban house, downsize and simplify his life has been an uphill battle. Throw in severe weather events, a tornado that took out 40% of the large trees in his area, 2 basement floods last month due to the crazy severe weather and going through 5 week long power outages and I'm going insane - it can't be any clearer that he needs to move out of that house. He even got angry when I told him he needs to move and says he's "comfortable" in the house. Tried using logic saying he can't maintain the house anymore but he didn't want to hear it and dropped it before it became an argument.... Even despite all of that he shouldn't be living there since it's too big to maintain, there's the risk of falling down the stairs and he very worryingly will not fully give up the keys since he threw an epic temper tantrum when I tried to take them when he back his 26 year old car out of the garage and seemed to want to take it for a spin around the neighborhood to "run the engine." He been honestly a stubborn and insanely difficult person all of his life but dealing with him through all this has been an insane nightmare to the point of burning me out and exhausted dealing with him (sister-in-law said my mother should have divorced him decades ago since he has not changed his toxic ways as he got older) I don't think it's dementia - it's just him being a jerk and not thinking/ caring about the consequences of his actions which is a lifelong pattern of his as well as being too proud to face reality or adapt to his age. He had no plan for retirement other than saving as much money as possible and penny pinching to the point of deferring repairs on their house for years despite my mother begging him since that brings the value of their home down. I have 3 other siblings who give advice but don't really seem to want to step in due to him being unmanageable and not wanting to work with people. My older sister came to help last month but basically stepped away since she couldn't take him after that. She told me the same thing my therapist recently said: "Walk away and live your own life if he's being like this. He needs to learn to deal with the consequences of his choices instead of making you responsible for them if he's that stubborn." I would feel bit guilty walking away but I'm leaning that way. Weighing my options...."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 120 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w1vwws/stubborn_father_refuses_to_downsize_despite_being/

"My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 115 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/owmtmv8/

"Dad is done taking care of mom. I cant deal with them.. This was inevitably going to happen. My sibling and I have been trying for years to get dad to see reason, that he can't do it alone. We've suggested in home care, traveling nurses, senior living facilities, and more but it all just got ignored. Mom (75) keeps falling. She is partially blind (from a stroke 10 years ago) and deaf (with hearing aids), and she has terrible knees. Dad has to call the ambulance to come pick her up. It is not sustainable. He resents her. He's cruel to her. Abusive verbally. Mom doesn't exactly help. She's naggy and probably stresses him out. Not giving him a pass, ive talked to him about it and he fixes himself for a bit but it always goes back. We finally got them both to agree to look at some senior living facilities. It would be good for them to be able to have a community other than just the 2 of them. Dad continues to dig in his heels. He doesn't want to leave the house. He doesn't want to dump all his money into a senior living facility. I get it, but mom needs assistance. He started cleaning out the house, we were going to help move furniture. Last week he said he would sign the paperwork for the living facility. Mom was so excited. Then the next thing I know Dad changes his mind, tells mom she can go and he will stay. He told her that he doesn't want to take care of her anymore. Im tired, in my mid 30s just wishing I could live my own life and not deal with them and their codependency. I feel selfish sometimes, but I've tried. Its like talking to a wall. I inevitably told him that if he doesn't want to go, then fine, but mom needs to. I told him that they can stay together, divorce, separate, whatever.... I don't care at this point. Im fed up with both of them. My sibling cut off contact with our mom last week and frankly im getting close to doing the same for both."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 96 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vos1wn/dad_is_done_taking_care_of_mom_i_cant_deal_with/

"I retired from my job of 36 years to care form my now 87 yr old dad. I loved my job and my friends and feels like I lost everything. I am constantly up and down and get 15,000 steps in just 5 rooms. He is sharp with his words and doesn't care how he treats people. My husband helps only for a few hours at night. By the time it is bedtime I am mentally drained and physically exhausted. I tried to bring in help, he was horrible to them. My brother is very sick, needs heart and lung transplant. I feel so overwhelmed and just want out your video says u need to b selfish to survive. I wish it was that easy. I love my dad, the person he is now is not my dad. One day I will get my life back. I take it day by day."

youtube · @rebeccatomlinson303 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive | Dave Nassaney | TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 75 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgzTQ7WdfZf_F3sOGaN4AaABAq

↳ **@kshummingbird (7):** "Take heart sweetie. Take heart and have faith. I too had retired from my job to become my both my parents' full-time caregiver. Things happened fast btwn the two of them as if they were tagging each other to see who was it. In the last several years, I had to eventually put my mom in a nursing home. Then in 2020 she got covid but survived. In the meantime I had to care for my dad in his home. I had given up my home, my friends, my job, my life and was taking care of a man in his 90s who was growing crankier by the day. I had two older siblings that did not help much. Btwn arranging patio/window visits and dad breaking his hip and two terrible UTI's...I thought I was going to lose my mind. But God knows how much we can take. My dad passed in 2021 at 94 yrs old. My mom is still alive and will be 95 tomorrow. I have since gone back to work and trying to find me again. It's a slow and weird process but one thing I'm grateful for, is that I was there for them both. Some days were harder than others but then there were days that small blessings came about. Someone left groceries on the porch, a neighbor shoveled me out the driveway, someone else came to mow the lawn. Bless you on this journey ...🌈🌈🌈🌈"

↳ **@carolmusselman8859 (3):** "I hope you are doing better, what you do is priceless"

↳ **@chandychano7 (3):** "I'm praying for you, Rebecca ❤️ I also quit my job and moved to care for my grandpa (87, stroke victim, vascular dementia, bedbound, incontinent) and grandma (84, severe dementia, incontinent). I

am the primary caretaker and live with them and my mom and aunt rotate weeks to help me. There has to be two people to change and move my grandpa because he cannot walk. I can't imagine being by myself all of the time. Do you have any other siblings (I'm so sorry about your brother as well) or children or nieces/nephews that would be willing to help? It is overwhelming. You are so valuable to your family. I'm sending prayers and hopeful thoughts to you today."

"While speaker gives excellent points....it's still the most exhausting time of your life. The dependency, the need, the demands, etc...and my parents live in a very nice retirement facility! They are good and loving people but the stress on my own life is taking its toll physically (emotionally and mentally came first.) I had to start setting boundaries. That has helped a lot."

youtube · @CeeLiberty · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 73 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugzt_xnJkq_89zsfRC94AaABAq

↳ **@peterc9153** (8): "C Liberty - I am 56 and have an 87 year old mother who is slowly succumbing to dementia. I live with her and I find my life now consists of shadowing her every activity. Among other things she leaves taps on in the bathroom sometimes with the pug still in. I now have to put her medication into her mouth and spoon feed her meals. She can just about still toilet herself. But there are frequent unpleasant problems. My sister urges me to put her into a care home. I am despairing at the moment. Caring for an aged parent is challenging enough. But once they have lost their minds it becomes impossible."

↳ **@oliviamae3281** (7): "C Liberty Hi, consider yourself lucky you don't have them both living with you, you are blessed, you can leave them and go home. Be grateful at least for that."

↳ **@michaelchin3550** (3): "Totally understand. I exercise every morning before mom wakes up. Seems to help."

Someone to say 'I'm coming Thursday at 3pm' · 107 documents

20 most engaged of 107 matching documents, complete text.

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations: Youre so strong Translation: Youre on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are theyre really saying theyre not going to help you. Theyre admiring your ability to handle it so they dont have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow youre so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. Were just surviving it because theres no other option. I dont need your theology. I need respite care. I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. Theyd watch me help my mom with everything then say I dont know how you do it and leave. If you dont know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Dont stand there marveling at my survival skills like Im some interesting specimen. Im doing this because I dont have a choice and you wont help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: Im going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you wont ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person were caring for so we can sleep. Dont make us ask. Ive got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. Theres more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If youre a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity... you dont need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say Im coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. Thats the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): ""enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and

who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

"Surprised how many people (outside of this sub) feel kids should take care of parents?. I am in the midst of convincing/trying to get help for my parents. They live at home, but they need someone checking in on them a few times a week (early stages of dementia). I think if I gave up my whole life (job, husband, house, etc) to help them full time I honestly think they would be happy instead of sad. I feel like they don't want help from other people, it's so frustrating. Anyway, I truly appreciate this sub. It's been hard dealing with all of this, and I feel like no one understands until you're going through it. I see so many people on instagram say "wow how sad the kids aren't helping these parents" or "parents raise kids all their lives and then the kids just dump them". I feel like these people either haven't been through it yet or are so privileged they have all the time and money to deal with their aging parents? I don't think any parent (that was a good parent) should be dropped off at a sketchy nursing home and never visited, but yes I do think it's ok if a parent needs to be taken out of the home and go into a nursing home, even with family around. Or it's ok to hire someone to come help, versus people giving up their lives to care for someone. I also am not having kids, and hate the notion of kids having to be caregivers. I wasn't born to be a caregiver, I am an individual person who has a life outside of family. I shouldn't owe anyone anything, my parents chose to raise kids and it's the expectation not to be an asshole during that time. That doesn't mean I owe them outside of not completely abandoning them. Just wondering if anyone else has noticed this trend of "if you don't help your parents completely, you are a bad person", outside of this sub."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 316 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1inulwh/surprised_how_many_people_outside_of_this_sub/

"I took care of my Mom for her last few years. It was exhausting and frustrating because I got no concrete help from my siblings. But, I did the right thing! She was at peace when she went and she said she didn't know what she would have done without me. Even though it was stressful, it was worth it. I have peace with my soul."

youtube · @americansunbeam · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 176 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwdJ3WNa7bqL-UCRKx4AaABAq

↳ **@Sashazur** (18): "You were lucky that she was appreciative and could communicate it. So many are robbed of their previous personalities by dementia, or were never kind people to begin with."

↳ **@64kjf** (6): "@Sashazurironically my MIL was much nicer with dementia than without. It was completely unexpected. Not that she was horrible before, but she was pretty competitive, and sometimes liked to argue just for the sake of arguing. When she started to decline, her personality became very child-like and sweet."

↳ **@nannygirlkc** (5): "I agree. I took care of my parents, and I have no regrets. It was worth every minute to show them the same love they showed me when I was growing up."

"Grandmother is now refusing AL or moving in with other family. I'm done caregiving and have plans to move. WTF do I do now?. I've taken care of my 96yr old grandma since I was 19/20 and am now 31yrs old. She's gone from being wholly independent aside from needing assistance going to appointments to now being mobile for

short periods with a walker but has the majority of her mental faculties if not extremely emotionally needy and depressed. The last week after her release from a SNF from a fall she has either barely gotten out of bed or been trying go outside and dig up her garden when I'm not home and at work (neighbors called to let me know). She's going to seriously hurt herself but doesn't seem to care. I am at the end of my rope and ability to take care of her. The last time she fell I could not physically pick her up. I've already lost a ogreat job because of her constantly calling me to come home because she's "sick" and needs to go the ER (she's not, we waste 6+hrs to be told she's perfectly fine every single time), and am in danger of losing my current one for the same reason. I have to be present at home for any other person that stops by whether it's her friends or family visiting or scheduled appointments because she won't answer the door otherwise and she refuses any attempts for me to get respite because she won't go to daycares or senior events that would allow me to do so. So I'm essentially tethered to her anytime I'm not at work. We're at the point where she is only slowly deteriorating and not getting any better while I am no longer eating or sleeping and my own mental health has gotten bad enough my doctors are concerned for me. Neither of us can sustain this. I've spoken with other family that are planning a visit this week to either take her home with them or find an AL or nursing home ASAP. They are very aware that I cannot handle any more and need relief. My bags are actively being packed and I have a place to move to as soon as she's taken care of. Grandma was okay with this progression and change up until today (though obviously not happy about it) when suddenly it's become "oh we'll hire someone to come in and help" and "I'm staying at home or you get nothing". She's insistent we're both staying right here and that's just not happening. I don't care about anything willed to me when she passes anymore. Maybe it makes me a terrible person but I cannot do this any longer. I don't have POA, her son's does (the one coming this week) and she is otherwise still in charge of her own medical decisions. Obviously we can't force her into a facility but if I'm not stopping my plans to leave, what do we do? Do I just leave and let the chips fall if she won't allow herself to be moved somewhere? I spent today feeling like I was arguing with a toddler trying to get across to her that the train is leaving the station and she's not listening."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1np0dlg/grandmother_is_now_refusing_al_or_moving_in_with/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"Impossible-to-please mother wants to live with me. A year ago, I helped my mom move to my state to live near me. She was living near my brother, but her incessant requests that he drop everything for her were driving him crazy and he needed her to go. I had her move here to give his mental health a break. She lives in an independent living facility about four blocks from my house. The location is perfect because I can get to her quickly and more frequently than I'd otherwise be able to, and I can stop at the store for her on the way over. But she keeps pushing

to live with me and my husband, which is not a good idea. It's mostly because she doesn't like the food there. (Her apartment has a kitchen and she cooks her own stuff most of the time.) My mother is intrusive and oblivious. She doesn't understand basic human interaction rules (it's like she fits the definition of autism in this respect), which means she is constantly saying inappropriate things -- insulting us, or hurting my feelings. If she isn't getting her way, she can get nasty very quickly to where it feels like it's coming out of left field. Her own mother drove her crazy (and her mother was a nice person). She refused to let my grandmother live with her and my dad because she knew she wouldn't be able to stand it. And she swore up and down she would never be a burden to me or my brother. Now, here she is, wanting to live with me. The biggest problem here is that my mom is incapable of being happy. Everything is always terrible where she lives. Any house she's ever lived in is "always falling apart." When I was growing up, it was always my dad's fault for buying the wrong house or not repairing something fast enough. After my dad died, it was my brother's fault for living 3.5 hours away and not being able to come over and change a light bulb instantly. It's like the woman has no concept of how to locate and book with a service provider of any kind. When you suggest she call a handyman, she gets pissed off because she thinks we should do everything for her; that she shouldn't have to pay a handyman. Never mind the fact that she always told us that we "owe her nothing." I lost count of the number of times she complained about her own parents keeping score, swearing that anything she did for my brother and I came without strings attached. I believed her. She moved closer to my brother so he could help her more, but it wasn't enough for her. She complained constantly about the house she bought and how she'd "overpaid" for it. She had the backyard relandscaped and then killed half of it because she couldn't be bothered to water it (even though she had a programmable system and I had created a custom instruction manual for her). Every time something happened at the house -- AC out, broken water heater, roof repairs needed -- my brother had to handle it all for her. She acts like she's completely helpless. And every one of those incidents was the end of the world -- her crying and asking "Why does this always happen to me?" as though no other homeowner in the history of the universe has to deal with repairs. So we all decided that she couldn't handle owning a home; that independent living was the way to go because she could just pay one bill and not have to worry about anything. She's had that for a year now, and all I hear are complaints. Texas was better; her house was better -- she's forgotten all the complaints she had about it. That's how it's always been with her, though. She hates a place until she leaves it. Then, the old place was heavenly and the new place sucks. I don't want her living with me because not only will she annoy the crap out of me, she will be unhappy! I don't want to have to listen to, "I should have stayed where I was. At least I had X and Y." (And I don't want to help her move yet again! The woman's a hoarder, for one thing.) Also, I love my house and planned to stay here. It's not big enough for her to move into, though. We'd have to move to a bigger place, which costs money, and it would mean that someday, I'd be old and stuck with more house than I can handle and NO ONE to help me deal with it. I've told her that, and she doesn't seem to care. I can't figure out how to get her to understand this and stop asking for it. Just when I think we're all clear on how our relationship works, she gets clingy again and starts crying and saying she wants to live with me. I'm going to school full time right now. I'm almost 60 and will be starting a new career, and not by choice. And I have relationship problems as well. I can't handle her b.s. on top of all of this. I love the mother she was when I was growing up, but I don't like the person she is now. If I worked with her, she would be someone I would avoid. But I don't want her to get all dramatic and start crying and saying she's moving back to Texas. She can't afford the move, and Texas is NOT big enough for both her and my brother to live there. We looked into independent living places there, and none of them had kitchens. That was a no-go. She can't buy another home. So WTF can she do but stay where she is? I'm just so sick of the crying and her being miserable. Yes, she's on antidepressants and sees a counselor. I've told her she's the common denominator everywhere she goes, and that she has to figure out why she can't be happy before she can even think about moving anywhere else. Aside from that advice, I don't know what else to do or offer her."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 93 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1unvxd/impossibletoplease_mother_wants_to_live_with_me/

"So...I made out home health care nurse cry today. Hi all, I'll ask the question first then give you context. When a visiting home health nurse or CNA comes to your home and they need help with something that you can do without help, how does that make you feel? Context: husband is bedbound quadriplegic, he has pressure sore on butt and heel of foot. Whenever home health comes in, they ask if I can roll him over so they can change bandages or hold his foot up so they can change bandages. This irritates me, because im spread so thin with all the other things I need to do around home and I figure, if I can do it by myself, why cant you? So i asked the nurse today why they cant do it on thier own, as I have other things I need to tend to. She said "extra hands are nice" I said "ok" But she left here crying and said she will never ask me again to help and she said I was rude to her. I felt really bad. I apologized to her profusely. I explained that Ive been overwhelmed with his care, I didnt mean to sound so rude. I dont know if she's coming back, but what are your thoughts? Should we assist the home health agency with everything even though there's some things they can do own thier own? Ive manged taking care of husband without assistance. And we are all so burnt out from this, I just wanted a break. Give it to me! I can handle it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 88 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mjju5f/soi_made_out_home_health_care_nurse_cry_today/

"I was pestered by them for a long time. I started getting pretty feisty about, saying "No I don't need your help because my mother is DEAD. Stop calling me, you can't make any money off me, because I don't have someone to help!" Eventually they stopped."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 81 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/mmsp9r6l/

"A lot of people DONT. I saw this a lot when I worked as a handyman. What really wrecked my health was getting stuck in a live in caretaker situation for an elderly woman. Then the houses basement with the furnace in it started flooding in the Alaska winter. Family just wouldn't do anything but wanted to add on my stress by constantly contacting me demanding I fix everything. I tell you what. You absolutely have to clean up your diet. This woman never ate a raw vegetable. Processed everything. People are mystified at this cognitive decline but I've seen enough to know you need to eat healthy and stay active ."

youtube · @alaskansummertime · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 78 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugyuu-x8aUvfUove6Od4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (16): "You are absolutely correct about diet and exercise. I can do better in that area myself. Let's all start doing just a little better if we need to. Thanks"

↳ **@LuckyDogDog** (5): "Go carnivore the way to go it'll change your life and your health"

↳ **@Marcie-w1u** (4): "@LuckyDogDog I'm mostly carnivore minus times I just cant be due to travel or whatever. Almost all of my issues have cleared including what was looking like developing MS"

"Thank you. My son and I could not care for my husband; we had to put him in a nursing home. My in-laws would not help with money or even come over for Christmas to see him, but when he was in the hospital, they would show up and lie to the doctor, say they were there, but they were not, so we put him in. It got to where it was unsafe to leave him alone in the house by himself and with kids to raise and another son in a wheelchair. I had to put him in a nursing home. It's brutal and heartbreaking, but in-laws who do not help but only judge and then preach in church, claiming to be preachers, are childish."

youtube · @melindahopson1477 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 53 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgzAFS2p_I1Kq5V-RpV4AaABAg

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (4): "Hi, thank you for sharing your experience. Life presents so many difficulties sometimes. Please be kind to yourself. Those decisions are so difficult but you are right safety for all involved is vital."

"I think I might fall into the "waited too long" category. I've left voice messages for several elder care agencies this morning to get advice on how to get help for my parents-no return calls yet. Out of complete desperation, my mom asked me to pick up her prescriptions yesterday as she had been out of her meds for almost a week. My stepdad is very ill with terminal cancer and my mom is his caregiver. They both appeared to be in very poor condition, physically, when I visited yesterday. They have socially isolated themselves for years prior to the pandemic. It's probably been a decade since they had any visitors to their house aside from me, and I'm only allowed to stand at the front door, no one is allowed to enter the home. My mom is mortified of their hoarding issues, is partially disabled and is now having trouble with things like fixing meals and bathing. Her clothes were all ripped up thanks to a puppy my mom decided to adopt about 6 months ago. It's a german shepherd puppy, and it is completely untrained and is presenting a huge hazard to their safety. She has said that the dog has tripped her before. I suspect the puppy was a way to have an excuse to keep them living in the house. I can hear my mom now, "I can't move to a little apartment with a big dog! The dog has to have a yard!" 😞 I did get eyes on my stepdad, he looked terrible, but was awake and able to stand up to say hello. He did not participate in the conversation, and I suspect that two years of chemo have left him mentally impaired. Both of their cars are broken down now, so they are completely dependent on delivery services for groceries. They haven't taken the trash to the curb since last September. I don't know where they are storing all their garbage, but they are definitely storing it somewhere in the house. I'm one sibling of 6, and the other 5 kids are estranged. A part of me wants to just pretend everything is fine, they are adults who can make their own decisions. There's another part of me that knows that I'm the one who will have to deal with any aftermath of a crisis and would really prefer to avert that crisis first. I suppose that is selfish of me to want them to bend to my will for my comfort. I think I'm going to have to get some authorities involved, but I wish there was another way. I've been using "I" statements when talking about helping them move to a safer home, but it doesn't matter. My mom, who is in control of everything--money, access, medical care, etc.-- keeps pretending that everything will be better soon and she'll just take care of getting them moved into an apartment herself. She's had magical thinking for as long as I can remember, but this just seems beyond the pale for what she says she thinks is going to happen moving forward. "When [stepdad] is better..." is how most of our conversations go when talking about me helping them move. Sorry for the novel length comment. I have friends who have had to help their parents transition to senior living, but in those cases, the parents were in agreement that help was needed. My mom, however, is waiting for Jesus to show up and make everything perfect for her. I wonder, though, if Jesus --in the flesh-- showed up, if she would accept his help? Probably not..."

youtube · @MsGenXodus · MY ELDERLY PARENT REFUSES HELP · 50 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=gwx9JsAlAo&lc=UgyY_9Wty9qB6t6idJN4AaABAg

↳ **@catherineskis** (16): "Ma'am don't beat yourself up. My mental health provider told me that "you can't parent the parent and sometimes you have to let them fail"."

↳ **@claudiacanales2662** (14): "Praying for you, I know how terribly difficult this is! I deal with brothers who barely help and I'm the only girl!"

↳ **@Britishdave09** (11): "that's a huge weight to lift on your own but there's sadly only so much you can do. My heart goes out to you."

"“This house has been too much for you for a while, mom. I’ve helped out with your care and done a lot around the house, but the truth is I’m not a handyman and I’m not a nurse. Think it’s time to find and move into a place that can take care of all of those things for you.”"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/o30f1mf/

"I am deleting my comment because while these are my raw and honest thoughts, I only apply them to myself. I would never want someone to take my comment and apply it to themselves. I would always encourage someone to take care of themselves to the best of their ability, and in line with their values. I honestly didn't think anyone would pay any mind to my comment. ♥"

youtube · @RedLikeWineAgain · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyH7BI-lIriLoGSbAF4AaABAg

↳ **@penelopeprimrose90** (9): "I get what you are saying and don't necessarily disagree. But some people do live a naturally long and healthy life. We have a neighbor that is almost 90 years old. She still lives in her home, still drives, works out at the rec center, does her own shopping, her mind is clear as a bell. She is living like someone 20 years younger. The reason is she took excellent care of her health, eats well and exercises, and has strong social interactions. She is living the old age everyone wants."

↳ **@johgndavis8159** (6): "@penelopeprimrose90 if you can take care of yourself at age 90 that is fine. This video is not about that case. The issue is arise if you are 90 and last 15 years has been draining life of loved ones around you"

↳ **@penelopeprimrose90** (1): "@johgndavis8159 We all will need help at the end no matter what age we live to. My point is that some elderly people don't need the type of help that is draining to their families because they are in good health well into their 90s. I understand what the video is about. My reply was in response to this post specifically. Longevity doesn't always equal poor health. Taking care of yourself and eating well and exercising is the ticket (as in my neighbor's case). Letting yourself go and dying at 65 doesn't sound like a good plan IMO. We don't have to be sick the last 20 years of our life. Lifestyle causes most chronic disease. It has little to do with getting tests like colonoscopies. My grandmother lived to almost 90 and never had a colonoscopy or mammogram in her life. She also never took a single prescription drug. She was never in a nursing facility or required long term care. She died at home in her sleep."

"This is a fantastic list. People who aren't caregivers are clueless, and I say this as a former clueless person. That said, I would amend the "let me know if you need anything" line. Some caregivers need help with literally everything, and some caregivers need VERY specific types of help. Showing up with groceries she can't or won't eat is a waste. Mowing my lawn isn't going to help when it's something I enjoy doing that gets me out of the house. His vision is so bad, he can't read the books you brought. What I really need is someone trustworthy to sit with my elderly parent while I go to the doctor or take my car in for repairs. I need someone to physically be present so I can unplug for a little while. Bonus points if they clean shit and piss."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 22 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/nryb2sr/

"In home care givers or housecleaners?. Hi there. I hired in home care givers to help my mom. They told me legally they can't force her to do anything and cannot help with her meds in the morning due to laws. So they wash the dishes, tidy up a bit and then sit around doing nothing. I feel like I am paying extra for house cleaners. My mom refuses everything from them and as far as cleaning goes, it's only the kitchen. Nothing else gets clean and I'm paying 1K/month and still feel like I have no real help. I feel like it would help my stress if I hired housekeepers to take care of everything if I'm going to be paying for this type of money. My breaking point was at some point in the night my mom got up and her dog had to go to the bathroom. My mom has stopped letting him go outside. I had the day off and I slept in knowing a care worker was still coming today. I go upstairs and see

dried dog piss from last night. No one had cleaned it up, and I get they weren't hired for that, but I'm paying a ton of money for someone to come twice a week for three hours at a time to wash some dishes and sit on their phone. Thoughts? Should I ditch the care workers and just hire home cleaners to help keep up?"

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/sy32o4/in_home_care_givers_or_housecleaners/

"You just have to not. It sounds simpler than it is. But you have to extract yourself from the entire situation, inform them of exactly what you will do moving forward and what you will not do under any circumstances. Because your mother has already moved in with you, ending that situation will be harder than simply telling your dad you are at your limit already of what you can help him with. It's still doable, though. Your parents have every right to plan their own retirement and you have every right to tell them their plan cannot be you. My parents are gone but we have MIL left. She is in a care home. We help, but we could not be the plan. I work from my home. And I'm like you: I am not a nurse. I do not like even my OWN body fluids so others' are a non-starter. I will never be an in-home caregiver unless my spouse needs it and you best believe I'll be paying someone to come in and do the nitty gritty if that's the case."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/p0347ir/

"I think it needs to be more specific. They need to hire someone to help with x, y, and z. And, give a deadline. They has the illusion of independence but they are not independent."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walki_ng_away_from_my_mom/p4fi3x2/

"Finding In-Home Care for Mom. * TLDR - What is a realistic cost and expectation for home care for Mom, and what's an easy solution for finding it? Mom is 70. She was diagnosed with dementia about 3 years ago, but the likelihood is that she started developing it about 5-6 years ago. She's originally from the Midwest, but came to live with my partner and me on the West Coast about 2.5 years ago... due to there not really being any other workable family options available where she was living, or elsewhere for that matter. We're happy to have her. She's peaceful. She's personable. She's in good physical health for her age. But she struggles with short-term memory issues, and cannot retain new information. She doesn't know her phone number or address. Most of the time, she still thinks she lives somewhere in the Midwest near where she grew up. She can't drive anymore. She can't cook for herself. She gets frightened to be home alone for more than 2-3 hours at a time. As a result, my partner and I get very little "us time" and haven't been away together on a vacation or longer term outing in over 3 years. I feel like Mom is the perfect candidate for some part-time, in-home care... which would give her some social interaction outside of just us... and also give us a little more away time to catch our breath and reset, and bond more than we've been able to recently given our caretaker responsibilities. We're not destitute by any stretch, and Mom has some money to help with the cost of in-home care, but realistically... anything over like \$1,500 per month would be difficult. She's on Medicare not Medicaid, so my understanding is that there's not really an option for an insurance contribution here for in-home care. I feel like that's a reasonable budget, but I'm also in my 40s and still think twenty bucks is a lot of gas. So I just don't know. I've posted a couple ads on care.com in the past couple years, but the responses I get are overwhelming, disorganized, and a lot to process. My partner and I both work busy jobs and it's difficult to set aside hours per day for a week at a time to meet people and respond to messages, and make phone calls, to no real conclusion. That may sound bad. But we just haven't had the mental energy to pursue it as we should. In a perfect world, I'd love to find someone to sit with her 15-20 hours per week, just to give us a couple nights out. How realistic is my budget for this? Are there agencies that handle this sort of thing? An agency would seem to be the perfect scenario... I suppose I just worry about cost... or whether someone would even take her if she's not on Medicaid. I guess I just need some help or advice, or even a pep talk. One of my biggest concerns is finding a situation with the highest likelihood of landing a consistent,

reliable, GOOD part-time caregiver. One of the reasons I gave up on care.com so easily is that I felt like I was going to be posting ads and looking for new people every month or two. Help? Thoughts? If you've found a decent in-home caregiver situation for a loved one, will you give me some pointers?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1bvecp3/finding_inhome_care_for_mom/

"What are people paying for in home elderly care these days and how much should I budget for 2026?. My dad is getting older and we're starting to look into options for someone to come help him at home a few times a week. Nothing fancy, just help with daily stuff, maybe some light medical check ins, that kind of thing. I've been doing research but the costs are all over the place. Some agencies want like \$25-30 an hour, others are way more. For those of you who have hired caregivers or are dealing with this now, what are you actually paying? Is it better to go through an agency or hire someone independent? Any hidden costs I should know about? Trying to plan ahead financially so we're not scrambling later. Would appreciate advice from people who've been through this."

reddit post · r/eldercare · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/eldercare/comments/1q06h0t/what_are_people_paying_for_in_home_elderly_care/

For her to stay home safely / accept help · 97 documents

20 most engaged of 97 matching documents, complete text.

"Aging, and the Right to Die with Dignity. My mother is 88. She lives in an assisted living facility about 10 minutes from me. And honestly, every time I walk through the doors, I get overwhelmed by what I see. It's actually a very nice facility for what we often think of as an "old folks home." There are different levels of ability, and there are people who are still social, engaged, and enjoying life. But I would say that more than half of the residents I see are essentially just existing. They are breathing, eating, using the bathroom, sleeping—and repeating it all again the next day. They are alive, but they aren't really *living*. I don't mean that to sound callous. It's just incredibly difficult to watch. My mother no longer enjoys her life. She doesn't have a terminal disease that is going to take her life anytime soon. She had a stroke, is diabetic and has the beginning stages of dementia, but her biggest problem is that her body has essentially stopped working. She can barely stand. She is constantly incontinent and often doesn't even realize when she has urinated or had a bowel movement. The staff helps her change, but they are caring for many other residents too. Sometimes my mother has to sit in her own waste for hours before someone is available to help her. Sometimes I stop by - the smell is so bad and she doesn't even notice it. I ask her if I can change her and she responds by saying it's not necessary (because she can not smell her own waste). She has very little control over her own life. She hates being in assisted living. She hates what has happened to her body. She hates needing help with things she once did without thinking. They do physical therapy with her, but between the damage from her stroke and diabetes, she has very little use of her legs beyond briefly standing to transfer to a toilet or chair. And the saddest part is that my mother is not an isolated case. There are so many people living this way. This is really my rant: I hear people all the time say, "I never want to live like that." And yet, when someone reaches a point where they no longer have any meaningful quality of life, the idea of allowing them to choose when and how they die is considered illegal, immoral, or taboo. I struggle to understand that. When one of my dogs was suffering, unable to walk, and losing control of their bladder and bowels, I could make the heartbreaking decision to let them go peacefully. I could prevent them from having to continue living in a body that no longer allowed them to have any quality of life. Why don't we extend some version of that compassion and autonomy to people? I'm not talking about giving up on someone because they're old or disabled. I'm talking about respecting the wishes of a mentally competent person who has reached a point where they no longer want to continue living in a body that has become a prison. Why can't we decide for ourselves what *living* means to us—and, when the time comes, have the right to die with dignity rather than being forced to simply keep existing? Watching my mother live this way has made me question something I never really questioned before: **Is keeping someone alive always the same thing as giving them a life worth living?"**

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 517 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vnse4u/aging_and_the_right_to_die_with_dignity/

"How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care, and your adult child wrote you and the whole family this letter regarding that situation?. Dear family, I've been doing a lot of reflecting lately on the situation with Grandma and Grandpa, and I feel a need to share some thoughts that have been weighing on me. I know we are all doing our best to navigate this, but I want to offer a different perspective—one that might be uncomfortable, but feels necessary to voice. I can't help but feel that what we are witnessing is, in many ways, fundamentally unnatural. Decades ago, you rarely heard of couples requiring 24/7 professional assistance simultaneously; there was a natural rhythm to life and passing that seems to have been disrupted. It feels as though modern medicine has become so focused on the mechanics of keeping the body running that it has moved far away from human nature itself. By pushing past what might have once been our natural "expiration dates," we've entered a territory where the cost of longevity is a loss of the very independence that defined them. Perhaps the most jarring part of this experience for me is seeing the in-home care staff every day. While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we

knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge; instead of a family visit, it feels like a supervised appointment in their own home. Because of this, I want to be very clear about my own wishes for the future: Once I reach the age of 75, I do not want any extraordinary measures taken to prolong my life. Whether it is surgery, intensive treatment, or any form of medical intervention, I want to let nature take its course. Furthermore, if I ever reach a point where I can no longer safely live independently, please do not try to recreate a hospital within my home. I am asking you now to please just put me in a professional facility. I would rather my home remain a memory of who I was, rather than a place defined by its clinical needs. I know this is hard to hear, and I don't say it to diminish the love we all have for them. I just feel we need to acknowledge the reality of the era we are living in and how much it has changed the way we experience the end of life. With love and honesty, Jack"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 349 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

↳ **comment** (259): "A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

↳ **comment** (147): "I was Jack almost a decade ago. The PTSD I have associated with helping my mom care for my grandparents will never leave me. It *ruined* my memories of my grandparents who i loved so much and spent much of my childhood with. It sucks to be the elderly person or the caregiver, but being a support person for the caregiver sucks too. We are watching an elderly loved one basically be tortured into living, another loved one get burnt out to a crispy husk of a person, and we just have to sit there like 'This is fine.....' It's really sad, frustrating, depressing to watch, and makes you look around and scream 'am I taking crazy pills?!'"

↳ **comment** (140): "I studied gerontology and death & dying. Because of that, I made an Exit Plan 20 years ago. I saw what was going to happen with the massive, aging, Boomer population & there's nothing good about it. I've completed all my EOL documents (Will, Living Will/Healthcare POA, financial/durable POA), each kid has copies. Pre-planned & pre-paid for my cremation. I'm very open with my kids about EOL stuff and how I don't want to burden them with my care. Of course, they say "we don't mind," but I've seen 1st hand how caregiving tears apart families and breaks caregivers. I don't want to do that to my kids."

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they

get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the

stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgXk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to

be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"better way to respond to parents saying they want to move back into their house?. Without getting into all the details: My parents both had serious accidents in their home recently. Both were in the hospital, then rehab. Now they are together at a very very nice assisted living place that they have agreed to stay in for at least three months.

The problem is that they keep talking about how they plan to move back into the house. The house that has been unsafe for them - where they had their falls. Neither one of them is able to live independently at this point, let alone be a caregiver for the other. My sibling and I are the ones who have handled everything that needs handling during this extremely stressful time - and are still doing it. It's so much. I'm not local - I've been flying back and forth. My sibling lives about an hour away with two little kids and has been driving back and forth. We're exhausted, we're stressed. We are past the crisis part of this - I think - but there is still so, so much to do. For years we begged our parents to move to a one-floor condo or to build a bedroom on the first floor of their house (which is just trip hazard city, between the stairs and a thousand throw rugs everywhere). They never thought this was important - never mind that Mom has Parkinson's and osteoporosis and both are in their 80s. We kept emphasizing that they could make choices while they were fully able, and get exactly what they wanted - or wait until there was a crisis, and have whatever choices were available then. They chose the latter. But they will not stop talking about moving back into the house. They think they can build a bedroom on the first floor, move the washing machine to the first floor, redo the bathroom, hire people to take care of them - and never mind that the two of them can't even figure out how to make a phone call right now. I guess they think the magic construction fairy will wave a wand and make this happen. I'm visiting right now, and it's been another stressful week - but also I am just so glad to spend time with my parents, and so grateful that this isn't worse. But meanwhile I've discovered that their house has mice - one more thing my sibling and I have to take care of. And the mice are living in the garbage they've been keeping in their kitchen cabinets and in the basement. I've asked them to pause talking about the house - I told them that I am at the end of my tether and need to get on top of what is happening more before I can even talk with them about where they are going next. I suggested they do some research about other living situations if they want - independent living, if they want, other ALFs, even construction companies and caregivers. But that I am not ready to talk about any of this while we are still so early in all of this, and I am still trying to get my dad into a doctor for his broken back because for some reason the osteo he's seen will only deal with his broken hip. But last night after dinner - the food at the ALF is good at least! - my mom started up again. And I lost it, in a very very ugly way. You really don't know what shame is until you've yelled at your 80-something year old mother in an assisted living home. I don't want to extinguish their hope - I don't want to be a jerk. I also am apparently furious that we are in this situation because they were living in this house, and I don't have it in me to have a lighthearted conversation about it right now. Not while we're still having to do so much. Given that it is inevitable they will bring up going home again - and given how raw I seem to be - what is the right way to respond next time? Thanks for reading my novel and oy, oy."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 241 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/

↳ **comment** (210): "If they don't have the ability to arrange things, just refuse to execute on the idea and leave it on them to organize, standing firm that they can't move back until they have arranged all of that on their own."

↳ **comment** (207): "I suggest a slightly different approach that's worked well for me. Let them talk. Let them dream, let them plan. Talk is just that - talk. They are not able to actually DO anything without help from you or your sibling. If the talk starts to move into real specifics of "doing", which is unlikely, then you redirect. "Interesting idea mom and dad, let me think about that for a while". "I'll look into that mom and dad, I need a bit of time". This approach worked like a dream for my family."

↳ **comment** (125): "This is similar to getting my mom to stop driving. Her car broke and she wanted to replace it. None of us kids thought her getting behind the wheel again was as good idea. So we just didn't help her get a new one. She talked a lot at first about getting a new one, but couldn't figure out how to do it and none of us took the steps to do it for her. Eventually she stopped talking about it."

"Getting kicked out of independent/assisted living facility due to poor hygiene. TL;DR: my grandpa is absolutely disgusting and his lack of hygiene is going to get him kicked out of his living facility. My mom (his daughter) and I have tried everything and at this point, we have no idea what else to do. Warning: this is gross. Some backstory: my grandfather fell about a year ago and was on the ground for 3 days before my mom called for a welfare check. He has a history of forgetting/refusing to charge his phone, so we often weren't able to get ahold of him and were calling for welfare checks multiple times a month. After the fall, he agreed to move into an independent/assisted living facility. The condition of his home was horrifying. Urine and feces everywhere. Dead mice and mouse droppings. Rotting food. Mold. The works. We spent weeks cleaning and threw out at least 2 dumpsters worth of stuff. He would never let anyone into the house so we had no idea how bad it was. We moved him into a lovely facility and he was so happy that he was in tears. I decorated, made it homey, and really set him up for success with an easy-to-maintain and organized space and regularly scheduled housekeeping. It was a great fresh start. Within a few months, the complaints started. Other residents have been complaining that he stinks like urine and feces (and they are correct). The facility contacted us and said that they can smell the apartment from the hallway and other residents are upset. We were surprised because we set up housekeeping and laundry service, as well as someone who comes to give him a bi-weekly shower. Turns out, he's been refusing all of those services. Never cleaning, never showering. We went in and did a full deep-clean and had a very uncomfortable conversation with him. He seemed to understand and promised not to refuse housekeeping anymore. Less than a week later, the apartment was in the same condition as before and he was refusing services again. This has now happened multiple times. Facility staff have also talked to him multiple times. When we ask why he's like this, he just says "I'm lazy" or "I just don't care." He refuses mental health help, won't see a doctor, etc etc etc. The housekeepers have trouble stomaching his apartment. Last time they cleaned, we found out that they had to use paint scrapers to chip feces-coated toilet paper off of the KITCHEN FLOOR. The carpet is soaked in urine. His laundry is piled sky-high and he isn't disposing of his urine/feces soaked Depends, just leaving them in his underwear on the floor. There's blood everywhere from his unmanaged psoriasis. I could go on for hours. It's revolting. The facility contacted us again. Basically, if this doesn't improve immediately, he's going to be evicted. He has one month to get his shit together. I have no idea what to do. He loves living there, but I understand why they can't allow him to stay. All of the other facilities in the area are less nice and more expensive. He has nowhere else to go. We have done everything we can to make this easy for him, but he won't stop turning services away. Nothing we say makes a difference. I am sorry this was so long. At this point, I'm desperate. Has anyone been through something like this? Do you have any advice? Edit to add: This is absolutely a mental health issue, and as much as I want him to see a doctor and get help, he is completely non-compliant. Even when we physically get him to a doctor, he will not engage. He will literally just sit there and refuse to talk, then yell at us for meddling. I wish it was easier. Another quick edit since this is getting some attention: He was never a clean guy - his hygiene has been a lifelong issue. My grandma said it was part of the reason they got divorced (specifically, she remembers crying while scrubbing skid marks out of his underwear at the age of 19 and wondering if that's what marriage was really supposed to be like). This is a new low, but his hygiene has always been a problem."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 203 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t11ql5/getting_kicked_out_of_independent_assisted_living/

"I moved in with my Mom who is 87 2 years ago. Its awful I love her but I dont want to live with her. She is fairly independent but we clash all the time. I am an RN and work on a Psychiatric unit. Its all too much. I dont have anyone I can talk honestly about this. I am praying praying"

youtube · @upclady60 · *How to Manage Compassion Fatigue in Caregiving | Patricia Smith | TEDxSanJuanIsland* · 123 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=7keppA8XRas&lc=UgxMncTtCQluHt7c94AaABAg>

↳ **@bushidooffaith4706** (12): "Stay strong Lucy I am living this now. Micah 7:8 every time you get up your stronger. Don't ever stop praying even through tears God bless you."

↳ **@Germatti13489** (6): "Gosh I sure do understand that. I wish that we could form a group of people to help each other but we're so exhausted it's so tough."

↳ **@reneeschwendi8355** (6): "I am so very sorry for the pain and anguish you are feeling. I can relate so well. My mom's personality has changed so much with her illness. She's always been a bit pessimistic and overbearing, but was also very loving, caring and fun to be around. Now the bad traits are amplified and the negativity is absolutely toxic. I want so badly to be the sweet daughter I used to be but now find myself snapping back at her and finding excuses to leave the room just so I can breathe. My anxiety is through the roof and the guilt is just as bad. I leave her house almost in tears and then beat myself up for being hateful to my dying mother. That is not who I am and I hate myself for it."

"We Will Eventually Have to Tell Our Mother She May Never Come Home. How have any of you gone about telling a parent they may never come home? My 80 year old mother had a stroke in April which badly affected her left side. Cognitively, she's still mostly there but her left arm is useless now and her left leg isn't much better. A couple days after the stroke, we got her into a rehab facility. She was there for a little over two months receiving therapy but eventually the facility terminated her coverage under Medicare due to lack of progress. While she was there, I took the initiative and got my father and brother to agree to get an elder care lawyer. Sadly, given her age and other health issues, I highly suspected she would need continuing care. The law firm we selected was excellent and we were able to get my mother's Medicaid application approved while protecting most of my father's assets. We also took the opportunity to get durable POAs and medical POAs for both of our parents as well as revised wills should our father pass before our mother. Speaking of my father, he's 82 and has pretty bad hearing. He's still able to get around and can drive to see my mother everyday. He's not without other healthcare issues and his short term memory isn't great. We have to be careful what we tell him because he will share everything with everyone. He has a really hard time dealing with any type of technology. My brother and I have managed to get him to allow us to pay most of his bills online and we have access to his various accounts. Now back to mom. We were able to get her into a nursing home at the beginning of July. She received more therapy there but again therapy under Medicare was terminated due to lack of progress. At both her current facility and the previous one, she has fallen several times. Most of them were, unfortunately, her fault as she was trying to move in ways her body can no longer do. She even remarked to my brother that she "knows how to fall". She still needs assistance going to the bathroom, with bathing, with dressing and various other things most of us take for granted. I said earlier the stroke didn't affect her cognitively but over the last few months I've noticed some changes. She's gotten more stubborn and her and my father snap at each other. That's because of his poor hearing. He can't hear her very well or at all sometimes and she gets frustrated. Given all that she's convinced she can come home. My brother and I know that's not feasible. My father is not capable of giving my mom the care she needs and we are sure he understands that. I suspect he will need care of his own in 2-3 years, maybe sooner. His mother eventually succumbed to dementia and I'm worried I see signs of it in him. My brother who lives with him has been doing the lion's share of the work helping him and mom over the years but he has a full time job. He can't financially quit to take care of her. I live 2.5 hours away. The house would need some major work to let her come home and she obviously would need some kind of home health care. While my parents are ok financially for now, the work needed on the house plus home care would drain that fast. The Medicaid waiver program in our state is a mess and it could be months or years to get her on it. Sorry for the long story. I know my family's situation isn't as bad as many on here but I wanted to get it off my chest."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fuy4iw/we_will_eventually_have_to_tell_our_mother_she/

↳ **comment** (61): "Caring for parents carries quite the load and stress. You have a lot going on. My suggestion for your mom would be to tell her the truth: she can go home when she is able to independently care for herself. This includes bathing, using the washroom, maybe even add going x number of weeks without falling. In short,

she can go home when she meets these milestones. Until she is strong enough, she needs to stay where she is to get the help. Will this happen? Unlikely. But it may give her the focus to try. Very best of luck to you and family."

↳ **comment** (22): "My father is in the same position. He was released from hospital to rehab after surgery on his foot, but is unable to stand/walk/bather/dress/etc and my mother, now in an independent living arrangement in the same facility, cannot take care of him. Medicaid/Medicare ran out and we're now having to pay for his care. He frankly preferred to be waited on and served prior to his infection. He's been in hospital or rehab for six weeks, and seems fine there, with mobility provided by a wheelchair only, and only today did it appear to sink in for him that he would continue to be institutionalized until he can deal with regular daily living on his own. We're waiting to see if his foot heals, but there's a good chance that he'll need to stay in nursing care. It sucks. Good luck to you. You're not alone in experiencing this."

↳ **comment** (20): "Perhaps her doctor would be best delivering the news? He could present the medical reasons for her not to return home and answer any questions. This way when moving her to the nursing home you can say you are 'following doctor's orders'."

"Sometime you have to laugh or you'll cry.. So mom has been in and out of the hospital. This last time, it was a drop in blood pressure that lead to a fall that lead to another drop in blood pressure that lead to another fall. 6 visits in as many months for various issues. Each visit we did rehab in her home. A fractured nose and a fractured vertebrae made me say "no more home rehab, I want her in a facility." Everyone but her agreed. Because I'm her advocate, and she wants to go back home to independent living with a home attendant, that has been my focus. Encouraging and sometimes threatening her to work with the PT and OT so she had a chance to go back home. Today I got a call from the facility. She chewed up her very expensive hearing aid. When asked, she swore up and down it wasn't her hearing aid. *Just something in my mouth.* Yeah, she's not going anywhere."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 58 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mwueso/sometime_you_have_to_laugh_or_youll_cry/

↳ **comment** (29): "Oh my goodness. I'm sorry. It's also kinda funny, since I'm not dealing with it. Here's what I'm dealing with currently: FIL (88) had hernia surgery, and all the swelling settled in his scrotum. I'm told that it's the size of a football. He can't afford rehab, so he's here in the house with me. He loves to act helpless so someone else will take care of him 😊. When the doctor was explaining to him that he had to keep his scrotum elevated, he looked at me and said "You're getting all this, right?" No. No Sir. I am not listening to scrotal elevation techniques, because I will never, ever, EVER elevate your swollen scrotum. Walk your dog? Sure. Cook enough dinner for you, my husband, and me? Okay. I'll trade with you! 🤔🤔🤔"

↳ **comment** (25): "Yeah-it is hard and sometimes I just laugh my ass off. At my mom's last Drs appointment, the doctor asked her if she knew what day it was. She said "no." Then he asked her if she knew the month. She said "no, and I don't even care." Lol My mom is a hoot."

↳ **comment** (18): "ok you win. scrotum elevation is going to win every time. i would find something to do ALOT."

"Aunt wants my low functioning mom in home care, I want her in snf? Who is right?. My mom had a major stroke a few months ago. Now her right limbs total dont move. She's bed bound. Definitely needs 24/7 care. She eats through a gastric tube because she can't swallow. My aunt heavily wants her to move into her apartment in which she's the landlord of. She wants a 24-hour caregiver, someone who lives there for free in exchange for looking after my mom and home health visits (We are in the process of interview one). I know that nursing homes are bad, but at the end of the day I know there are several healthcare professionals there looking after her.. The in-home caregiver would have to turn her every 2 hours, feed her through that tube, know medical things. I am a new

graduate nurse so I know what it takes but I can't be there 24/7, and I suck at wound care . I don't know if one person can realistically do that. My mom also has a few wounds from her fall as well which the snf is taking care of. I don't know what to do. My aunt is heavily pushing this. I don't want my mom to stay in the nursing home but at the end of the day..... She's not high functioning enough where I feel comfortable leaving her with a 24 hour caregiver.? My aunt's mom had dementia and this is what happened to her. She lived in that apartment, was bed bound as well and had wounds, a wound care home health nurse would come by and take care of it. I worked out for them so thats why she thinks it'll work for context..[](https://www.reddit.com/submit/?source_id=t3_1pay7yh)"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1pbfw5v/aunt_wants_my_low_functioning_mom_in_home_care_i/

"My mom is dying from COPD and is in denial. My mom has smoked for my entire life. Give or take probably about a pack a day everyday for 30-40 years. I have a wonderful stepfather who has been taking care of her. She started being hospitalized sporadically about 4 years ago with RSV, pneumonia, bronchitis - all things I knew were either because of her smoking or likely much more severe because of so. In the last year or so, these hospitalizations have happened more frequently as well as "mysterious" health issues that have made her lose weight and generally be lethargic and low energy. Through a lot of testing, we were able to rule out cancer and other things like that. This has been frustrating as it has been an elephant in the room that no one brings attention to for fear of my now very physically, mentally, and emotionally fragile mom to become upset. TLDR; over the last week she was hospitalized back to back. Once where my mom was so evasive I finally called her mid panic attack and she acted like nothing was wrong. And a second time where she was so woozy (presumably from high Co2) that she fell and broke her shoulder and had to go to the hospital again. She is now home, only because she was sent home with equipment that will help rid the CO2 out of her effectively and we are consulting with palliative care. I called her (the first time she's let me talk to her since she fell) acting in denial. I told her I was coming home tomorrow and she basically cried and asked me not to - she wants to hide. Whether I'm coming home to spend whatever time I have left with my mom, or to try to help her actually quit smoking, I need to be home with her and we need to get incredibly honest with each other. But talking about smoking with my mom has been the one "non-negotiable" topic we've ever had. She gets defensive and we've never been able to talk openly about it. My mom has an extensive trauma history, she carries a lot of shame, I would bet everything that she is so embarrassed that she is now incurably ill and in denial that she may not make it until the end of the year if she doesn't stop. **Here's where I need your help as those suffering with COPD/as a loved one of someone suffering with COPD (or other chronic illness):** I am almost 30 and became a therapist, specifically specializing in addiction. I don't want to act as a psychoeducator or therapist - I want to be her daughter. While I am desperate for her to quit smoking, I also honor the dignity of her choice to her body and her actions. I want to express this desperate plea once very compassionately (so I don't have any regrets), and then get honest with her about what she's feeling and thinking and figure out how I can best support her for this next chapter of life. **What is your advice about how to talk with her about this? For example, I don't necessarily think that the best thing here is to lead with "STOP SMOKING" aphorisms and hopeful pleas. I want to focus on not letting smoking define how to treat her even if it is the addiction that will take her away from me in front of my very eyes despite my please. What would you want to hear from your child/loved one? How could I support her now if she doesn't believe she can quit smoking? How can I support her if she chooses not to stop smoking? Thank you in advance! We are also in process of getting a family therapy session scheduled with her individual therapist - both parties have already agreed."**

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w8g2pi/my_mom_is_dying_from_copd_and_is_in_denial/

"My father-in-law has had live in care for about a year and a half. The cost was roughly the same as a care home. We arranged this for him because he always made it clear that he did not want to move to a care home or die in a hospital. Unfortunately, he didn't realize that he was in his own home, so it didn't really make any difference that we were honoring his wishes. He only just moved into a care home and then fell and has been in hospital ever since, so I cannot really speak to the differences between a care home and in-home care, but I can tell you about some of the things that I did not like about in-home care. First, there really was no socializing. I'm not even sure it is reasonable to expect the carer, who often has limited English, to do much to entertain a patient who has their own communication challenges. Second, and surprisingly, I don't think live in care provides the kind of order and predictability that I would like to see. The problem is that in-home carers still need breaks. That means that a revolving cast of people drop by to offer short term coverage during those breaks each day. It also means that every so often the full-time carer is given a week or two off and replaced by somebody entirely new, which can be very jarring for the patient. In a care home, I expect that patients are exposed to more people, but on a more regular and predictable schedule. In addition, I found that it was very difficult for information to be passed on from the regular carer to the replacement. They were pretty good about communicating information about medication and meals, but certain basic information about where things belong would just get lost. I would show up a few months later and find that all the cutlery was missing and be about to replace it, only to discover bits and pieces in random places all over the house. This may be less of an issue for you as you are able to visit frequently."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1tlvmn4/anyone_have_around_the_clock_247_caretakers_to/onil5wc/

"After my FIL passed away at 87, we repeatedly asked my MIL to sell her condo and to either live with us, or, move into an independent living facility. She repeatedly refused. Then she fell off a ladder trying to clear a birds nest from her breezeway. Then she started forgetting to pay bills (property taxes/electric). Then she ran a stop sign and hit a State Trooper. True story. She even got a ticket for that! My hubs and SIL put their foots down and started the process for guardianship and POW. By then, she was 85 and still feisty about leaving her home. She had no choice. My husband put her in a facility not too far from us while SIL sold the house and did a fire sale for everything in it. Sometimes you just do what you have to do, regardless of what they insist because the reality is that they can no longer manage and it becomes time consuming and frustrating to deal with. They may want to be independent, but, you have to think about your own life as well. PS: she will be 89 in July and still feisty as heck. LOL"

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/oocpnom/

"Help! Bowel incontinence and refuses to wear briefs.. TL;DR my ambulatory MIL has constant bowel incontinence and refuses to wear briefs – how on earth do I handle this? Three years ago, we moved 1000 miles away from our hometown to have space away from my narcissistic MIL. My partner and I have been together for 25 years, friends for more than 30. We are not close with her. Her other son is not close with her and she has no relationship with her grandchildren because she's been abusive towards us all. My MIL got a pancreatic cancer diagnosis in April and also has dementia. We came out to help when she got the cancer diagnosis and realized that the dementia was very severe. She is amazing at masking, to the point where we have yet to get doctors on board to agree that she can't make her own medical decisions - but we did get a formal dementia diagnosis, but no stage. She's now on hospice but is amazingly "well" for a woman with cancer, insulin dependent diabetes, and dementia. Unfortunately, she has been unable for years to do her own finances - my partner manages that for her from out of state, and when we got to town, we realized that she also hasn't been able to do her own shopping or cooking or cleaning for quite some time (2 years at least - all the food in fridge and pantry expired in the season in which she had a stroke in 2024). Her son and I have stayed here in our RV since April being her primary caregivers and going over twice a day to make sure she is getting food and medication. Thankfully, she is not treating the cancer,

so her lifespan should be on the short side and she's no longer suffering from the side effects of the chemo (which were terrifying). While I have gotten enough therapy over the decades to be able to manage caring for her, we have run into a major issue. She has continual bowel incontinence, and this morning, after soiling the bed overnight, and again a second time by sitting on it after I changed all of the bedding, she has refused to wear incontinence briefs. She has told me that I need to just get used to her pooping all over the house, and that we are going to "own this situation". I don't want feces all over everything in the entire building, and she is still upright, ambulatory, and active – so she routinely goes out to lunch with friends and I really think it's a public health risk at this point. She doesn't wash her hands, and she doesn't have a problem defecating on the furniture. I just literally do not have the skills to deal with this. I am constantly told by Hospice that we can only do what she agrees to, and if she doesn't agree to it, we can't force her. But it feels unfair to me to go out into public while actually crapping all over the place. I am looking into memory care facilities because at some point, she is going to need that. But I just don't know how to get her to agree with me to wear briefs. She says that they are hot and uncomfortable, and she gets very incredibly upset when she has asked to comply and put them on. She is convinced that nobody else will be angry if she poops in their car when she is taken out to lunch or for a ride. It is beyond ridiculous. Any ideas of how on earth to deal with this?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 25 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1vhgax/help_bowel_incontinence_and_refuses_to_wear_briefs/

"Ideally it sounds great except I tried to appeal 3 times and was denied 3 times discharge from a skilled nursing facility. And I am a nurse so I found evidence and was able to articulate in medical terms the need. If there is lack of 'progress' or 'medical need', it may not work. Organizations are very good at documenting so that these appeals fail. I tried everything but my mom was categorized as a long term patient and we needed to go the route of Medicaid in order cover the nursing home, and ultimately a Medicaid home program. Meanwhile we had to pay the long term care out of pocket, which at the time was \$8000/month. Medicare does not cover long term care. Once home, you are challenged with finding caregivers because they are paid so poorly. Its frustrating and was incredibly eye opening. For people with high care needs, options are so limited. If something happens to my dad, my mom will need to go back in a nursing home and there are no beds or places within 200 miles that will accept a Medicaid patient. You are put on a waiting list. And although it's seems logical, I cannot afford to lose my job to care for my mom or make my small house handicap accessible. She is bed bound and needs full care. I already drive 100 miles round trip multiple times per week to help. My mom now qualifies for hospice, which offers a little bit more support and bathing. So not ideal but my parents get to be home together which is what they want. Aging in place sounds so good, but in many states Medicaid has poor funding."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/11fn0tb/how_to_challenge_discharge_of_your_parent_from_a_jalv852/

"How do you get through to an aging parent who refuses to plan for actually getting old?. My dad is in his late 70s, lives alone in the US, and is divorced. I'm his only child, but I've lived permanently overseas with my spouse for the past 11 years. My dad is starting to have some significant health and mobility problems, although he's still independent. He's currently house rich but cash poor. His mortgage is paid off, but due to health problems he hasn't worked in a year, so he's accumulated some debt. He hasn't disclosed the exact amount to me. He's confident he'll be able to resume working as a chiropractor, although he doesn't have a position to return to and would need to find a clinic willing to hire him. Personally, in this job market and given my dad's age and health issues, I don't really see this happening. He's also said he'll "find a job washing dishes" if he has to, which I also find pretty unrealistic. I've repeatedly offered for him to move near us. There are places to rent literally a five-minute walk from our home, and one month of rental income from his US townhouse would cover roughly two months of his living expenses here without even being overly frugal. He's visited the country where I live and likes it. There are activities and an English-speaking community he could become part of. I know visiting somewhere is very different from moving there, especially at his age, but he's actually been open to the idea. He's also admitted

there isn't really anything keeping him where he currently lives. He's divorced, doesn't have friends nearby, and seems to actively hate the state he lives in. He could continue collecting Social Security, rent out his paid-off townhouse, preserve the equity, and live near family in a country with a significantly lower cost of living and where he wouldn't need a car to maintain his independence. If he eventually needed a home nurse or other assistance, we'd be able to afford that here. In short, he could have a very good life without the same financial pressure and have his only family within walking distance. But his openness to moving closer to his only child seems to disappear after our calls. He loves working and is dying to get back to work. And because he needs cash soon, he's looking into a HECM/reverse mortgage instead. The problem is that he genuinely believes the HECM is basically free money. He insists he'll receive a large amount of cash and that it never has to be repaid by him, his estate, or from the property. The financial analysis prepared by the HECM broker literally says that my dad retains ownership and that the loan balance grows as interest and charges accrue. He still insists I'm wrong. Because he believes this money never has to be repaid, he's also keen on using some of the reverse mortgage proceeds to help me with my tuition, something I've repeatedly told him I don't need his help with. He won't listen to me. But the HECM is really just an example of the bigger problem: he seems incapable of imagining his future self. He lives in a townhouse with stairs in an extremely car-dependent area. He can't really downsize to anything cheaper without either moving somewhere even more rural or buying a home in worse condition, both of which come with their own problems. I've asked him, "What happens when you're 84 and can't drive anymore? What if you can't use the stairs? What if your mobility or health gets significantly worse? What's your plan then?" I can't get an answer out of him. When I visited a couple of years ago, I was already terrified of his driving, but he won't hear any of my concerns about that either. If he wants to make financial decisions I disagree with, he's an adult. Honestly, if I knew I would never have to deal with the consequences, I'd let him do whatever he wanted. But at some point he's going to have to face these questions. He knows I can't move back to the US to care for him. He doesn't want me to drop out of university, and he also knows I'm not in a position to become his retirement plan if he runs out of money. For those who have dealt with stubborn aging parents: How did you get them to realistically plan for declining mobility, finances, driving, housing, and care? Or do I need to accept that I can't make him plan, establish my boundaries now, and let him live with the consequences?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w2jif7/how_do_you_get_through_to_an_aging_parent_who/

"Thank you for this. My 92 year old mother with late stage dementia is in a facility. My siblings never visit her. My mother was widowed young and very independent. She didn't want to be a burden on anyone. I feel a small amount of guilt that I don't care for her at home but I have college age kids and a husband who's just retired and wants to travel. I visit several times a week. You reminded me how my mom would not have wanted me to sacrifice my family life for her. Plus I don't have the skills for it. By visiting regularly, the staff knows someone is active in her care and I believe it makes them give her the attention she deserves. It's a very challenging situation that comes with lots of guilt. I know my mom is getting great care and I get to have more fun with her when I am visiting her."

youtube · @lbanducci · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 23 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxtNyJPdSxxCIX0DQt4AaABAq

↳ **@laurawright7477** (3): "You did the right thing! What most of us would love to be able to do. When financial problems prevent that kind of care..those of us that have no choice ...suffer."

↳ **@piecelow2726** (1): "Your doing the right thing. Nothing to feel guilty about."

"I'm a Care Giver for my 81 year old Dad and have been for 6 years. It's been an emotional rollercoaster coaster ride but I don't regret it. I've let go of some friends and my social life has been impacted but I love my Dad so I stay the course. In the beginning it was especially difficult as NO ONE wants to give up their autonomy and

independence even when they need help. I've been disappointed by people I thought were friends but I have gotten over it and keep my focus on what needs to be done and try and let go of things that can wait..... I also have a full time job and responsibilities. My house is often a mess because I am too tired or simply too busy .. one day my Dad will be in heaven and I will look back at the time I devoted to his care and well being and I will be grateful I was able to be present even if it was EXHAUSTING , HARD and at times PAINFUL. Life isn't always easy. Listen to meditation tapes, watch sitcom, pray, take walks and be in the present moment ♥"

youtube · @michelehennessy2086 · *Caregivers Must Be Selfish To Survive I Dave Nassaney I TEDxWilmingtonWomen* · 22 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Ku5piyormwE&lc=UgwyVt8wN_7d8Ayqtm14AaABAg

↳ @BetterByDai (1): "Caring for a parent while working full time and managing your own life is an enormous responsibility. It makes sense that some things fall to the side and that doesn't diminish your commitment. There's a lot of strength in choosing to stay the course, even when it's exhausting."

"Advice needed-hospital discharge. I am an only child. I gave up my life in my 20s to care for my mother. Now at 31, my mother at 62, she has been on dialysis for a few years now. During this time my amazing fiance has moved in with us. We were both working full time, then as her health declined she became unsafe to get herself to dialysis and we made the tough decision for him to quit his job to take her to treatments and all appointments, since I made more hourly. My mother fell in December and broke her right hip, and finally came home from rehab 3 weeks ago. When she came home from rehab she had wounds on her heel, had lost a ton of weight (her own stubbornness by not eating because she didn't like the options and was unwilling to try them), and she was x1 assist for everything mobility related. Last Friday we put her in bed, she knows and hollers for us if she needs to get up to go to the bathroom or needs to be repositioned. But as of a week ago, she has started declining mentally too. This made her try and get herself out of bed and partially down the hallway (bed rails were up, and her feet and legs elevated so her heels wouldn't touch the bed, and her walker away from her reach) before falling and breaking her left hip. The hospital is ready to discharge her today, she is back to being max assist x2 for everything. She has no more Medicare covered rehab days. So we have two choices, which she is refusing to choose between and I am not her POA because she does not want to give up her independence. Choice 1 is to bring her home and try and figure out how we get her in a vehicle to dialysis. Choice 2 is for her to go to long term care and get some rehab, but this will take her check, and leave me to figure out how to suddenly have to take in her household bills plus ours alone until my fiance can find a job. I don't know what to do or how to help. I'm scared and overwhelmed. Has anyone been through something similar?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 20 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1k5wzmj/advice_neededhospital_discharge/

"Jack is right. My Greatest Generation grands didn't need 24/7 care. They were fiercely independent. The men dropped dead. The widows were sweet and either stayed home alone or went to a nursing home. Nobody caused my Mom or Dad to miss graduations, weddings, vacations, grandkids births, etc. They would be horrified at the level of care their kids are needing nowadays. I truly don't know what the cost of care has been to Jack's family but every family pays a huge price if all their elders need to move in."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 18 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oc9tpz/

A way to pay for it that doesn't bankrupt us · 85 documents

20 most engaged of 85 matching documents, complete text.

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial

blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"My mom's hospital stay was awful.. I'm so angry because you can't even depend on "professionals" to take care of your loved ones. The dr's were fine, but the nurses and CNA's were a joke. I keep hearing nursing school is so rigorous and hard and yet the ones I come across completely lack critical thinking skills. When I went to see her this morning my mom was sitting in piss and they didn't put the commode close enough to her, so she kept wetting herself. They didn't even clean her when she was bed! Like why are these people so fucking inept when it comes to disabled people?! Why is that I can clean my mom on my own efficiently, but a group of CNA's are fucking clueless?! Like I find it so fucking baffling. They also didn't change her bandage! It was wet and coming off. I have spent YEARS trying to keep her pressure sores at bay, I get it a lot of these places are short staffed, but I was LIViD. I changed my mom and got her clean and put a ton on zinc oxide on her bottom. I got her home and helped her in the shower and gave her a fresh new bandage. The nurses and CNA's she had the last two days just had this timid vibe when dealing with my mother. It's like they didn't know how to do anything and I was talking circles around them trying to explain to them how she transfers. It really just hit me that I am 100% completely alone in this. I mean I already knew that, but I really just felt it to my core. The medical field is so nauseatingly ableist and not equipped to handle disabled people. I'm so angry about it. I wish these people the same fate when they get older, it's disgusting. My mom had told me to stay home and "rest" I'm glad I didn't listen. Not even the "professionals" can be trusted. The CNA's don't even know how to give a proper bed bath! Like what kind of bullshit are these people being taught?! That's why I always say the anguish doesn't end when you put them in a home. Well for me anyway. Because they get neglected! The hardest I ever worked was when my mom was in a nursing/rehab facility! You need a shit ton of money to afford quality care. I can't believe I thought this was a good hospital."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 107 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1t4s6w4/my_moms_hospital_stay_was_awful/

"2 months of assisted living and they can no longer care for my mom. I've posted a bunch here before, the latest thing was my mom having to rehome her dog. We found a wonderful home for him where he's with a couple other small senior dogs and I'm keeping in touch with his new owner. So that worked out, though it stressed me the hell out. Her assisted living place called me today when I was heading to work to tell me my mom has drastically declined and her need of care will increase \$2000 a month. Which basically means we can no longer afford to have her there. They said they'd admit her to the hospital and then get her placed in a Medicaid nursing home

from there. I cannot take her back home. I can't provide the care she needs anymore. I also just got a new job. I was so relieved my mom had seemed happy at first in her al, but she has gone down hill so fast. They made her get a hospital bed in her room, she was sleeping in her recliner (which she's been doing for years) but then she couldn't get in and out of the bed without help. She's lost over 20 pounds in the last 2 weeks. She has necrosis on her backside. Her potassium is very low and they said she's malnourished. Has any one moved to a nursing home straight from the hospital ? She has Medicare so I know She'll need to spend down to get on Medicaid. She has hardly any savings set aside, especially after moving fees for the assisted living places she's been in. I feel so frustrated, like there's dead ends everywhere and we just keep losing."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 78 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vfk46/2_months_of_assisted_living_and_they_can_no/

↳ **comment** (39): "Look and see if there's either a patient advocate at the hospital or an ombudsman in your state that can help you navigate this situation. Meanwhile, you may want to go ahead and pack up her stuff at the assisted living facility."

↳ **comment** (24): "Talk to the advocate first to see if there's a spend down amount. I wish someone would explain how Medicaid works if you have elderly parents. You can really fuck them and yourself over if you don't know what you're doing. For example, my mother's driving was dangerous, so I thought buying her car was the ideal solution. For reasons I still can't comprehend, that one act really messed with her ability to qualify for Medicaid for a time."

↳ **comment** (22): "I did take care of her for almost 2 years. I physically and mentally couldn't take it anymore. I'm her only family. My depression was worse than it's ever been and physically I had things going on too. It really is a disgrace how these homes are run. They just gave me one week to find a home for her dog just to tell me they can no longer care for her unless I pay an exorbitant amount. We're at their mercy."

"What happens when you can't do this anymore?. I've posted before about feeling evil when you inevitably yell at a dementia patient and having mental breakdowns from caretaking, but when you feel like you can't do it anymore, when you feel "broken" and fear for your health and your patient, what do you do???? My mom has Alzheimer's/dementia. I've been taking care of her for nearly four years. She had a bad reaction to an antipsychotic she started taking a few months ago. She lost trunk control at the end of July. She couldn't walk on her own. I didn't know what to do. My brain froze and couldn't make a decision. I had to call a family member who had to tell me to call 911. Even then, I couldn't do it. I started gathering clothes for her since she wasn't dressed and getting all manner of things ready. She might have had a stroke and I didn't respond in a timely manner. After a hospital stay, my mother ended up in rehab for a month. When she returned to me, the level of care I had to give increased exponentially. Now I'm changing diapers and having to clean up poop. I never wanted children or a family of my own. I don't have the temperament for intimate partners. I knew this about myself. I like peace, calm and anything that disturbs it, gets under my skin. I wake up in the morning and my mind like a movie on repeat keeps showing me the crap I cleaned the day before. I watch my mom pick her nose all day, yell at the TV, make up fake Spanish words. I have to brush her teeth and bathe her and I don't think I'm doing a good job, because I always find more crap. I've found myself crying and yelling and threatening to abandon her when she gets nasty and cusses me. I've thought of taking her to a hospital with no ID and just leaving her there. Where I once said no to a home, now I dream of it. But she needs an NHTD waiver. I've called the agency and NO ONE returns my call. The insurance company expects me to provide extra hours for my mom because we live together. But I'm at the point where my body and brain shuts down when it comes to care. It's like I avoid doing things she needs until I MUST do it. So my mom is not getting the care she needs. I have no family to help, my friends live far away and have their own lives and I'm afraid for myself and her. I had to put a lock on our door to prevent her wandering. That lock prevents people from getting in to. What if we have an emergency and no one can get in? At what point does the State or insurance companies recognize when you can't do this anymore? That you are mentally

incapable, that your own health is in danger? At what point is there help???? Update: I finally did it. :-(last Wednesday, my mom refused to let the aide clean her, was yelling and cussing; refused to drink water. She only had 2 ounces in a 48 hour period. She also had not been cleaned in 18 hours. I explained the consequences of not drinking water, not eating, etc. Normally I can get her to do it by explaining consequences. She understands things, but doesn't hold the memory. This time, nothing I did worked. Finally, I called 911 and expressed my concerns over dehydration etc. They came and she was calm, alert and compliant when they asked her to drink water. She told them she would. I couldn't help but notice the smugness as though they were more capable than I and the aide. She took a sip that was it. No more. They decided it was best to take her to the hospital. They coaxed her up. The smell hit them and they said she needed to be cleaned and dressed before travel. That's when the sweet old lady disappeared. It took the two EMTs and the aide to get her ready. My mom cussed them all out. I couldn't help but laugh because I saw that smugness drop. I didn't travel with her. I spoke to the Dr on the phone and saw my mom for an hour before going home. The Dr called asking where I was. I explained that I left. Dr said her bloodwork was good and she wasn't dehydrated. She could go home. That's when I dropped the "unsafe discharge" language that I was advised about on this board. I said it. Dr insisted she couldn't hold her. She needed to see the neurologist and could go home. I repeated "unsafe discharge" again. Dr was annoyed but said they would admit her and I should see the social worker the next day. My mom is going into a facility until I can get 24 hour care. I'm home today because I've been visiting every day since then. I'm sad, but calm. I miss not having her here. But I know this is what's best for her. When I saw her in the hospital, she was clean and seemed content in a way that I couldn't get her at home. I also noticed her cussing when it took two aides to clean her, but she went back to her quiet self when they were done."

reddit post · r/dementia · 68 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_this_anymore/

↳ **comment** (76): "You do have to take her to an emergency room and leave her there. It's OK. Tell them she isn't safe with you and refuse to take her home. They'll find a place for her. You've done enough."

↳ **comment** (42): "Thank you so much for not judging. Thank you! Thank you! Thank you! I had a family member tell me that no matter what choice I make, I'll be in pain. So I was told to choose my poison. We were once so close my mom and I. It's out of loyalty to who she was that I haven't done it. My mom is gone. I have this doppelgänger living with me. :-(

↳ **comment** (31): "I am so sorry. I can feel your frustration and worry in your words. This is a horrible, cruel disease, and will take down any single thing in its way. You do not have to do this anymore- you are not morally, or legally obligated to keep setting yourself on fire to keep your mother warm! On the contrary, you are doing her a disservice by not getting her placed in long term care. You are not equipped to do the job of every profession working at a facility. I cannot speak for other countries, however, if you are in the US- you take her to the closest Emergency room, TODAY, as in RIGHT NOW- tell them her mental status is altered from her normal baseline. Then, once they've run every test under the sun, you say these exact words: "I am unable to care for her at home. It would be unsafe to discharge her." No more, no less. You'll likely get push-back, possibly even threats of them calling APS, or telling you that you are responsible, and that you must take her home. Some providers have gone as far as telling family members they can be arrested for abandonment; this is simply NOT TRUE. Unless there is a court order signed by a judge stating a person is a responsible guardian, no adult is responsible for another, period. Stand your ground. "This is an unsafe discharge." The onus will be on the hospitals' social work team to find acceptable placement for your mom. Keep in mind you may have no choice in WHERE that placement is, but they will have to find her a clean, dry bed in a setting with the level of care she needs. Is she on Medicare/Medicaid? What's her financial situation? This information will help us give you guidance on how to handle that side of things. Seriously, before you hurt her, or yourself, please don't feel like a failure or horrible child- it's time to wave the white flag."

"We Will Eventually Have to Tell Our Mother She May Never Come Home. How have any of you gone about telling a parent they may never come home? My 80 year old mother had a stroke in April which badly affected her left side. Cognitively, she's still mostly there but her left arm is useless now and her left leg isn't much better. A couple days after the stroke, we got her into a rehab facility. She was there for a little over two months receiving therapy but eventually the facility terminated her coverage under Medicare due to lack of progress. While she was there, I took the initiative and got my father and brother to agree to get an elder care lawyer. Sadly, given her age and other health issues, I highly suspected she would need continuing care. The law firm we selected was excellent and we were able to get my mother's Medicaid application approved while protecting most of my father's assets. We also took the opportunity to get durable POAs and medical POAs for both of our parents as well as revised wills should our father pass before our mother. Speaking of my father, he's 82 and has pretty bad hearing. He's still able to get around and can drive to see my mother everyday. He's not without other healthcare issues and his short term memory isn't great. We have to be careful what we tell him because he will share everything with everyone. He has a really hard time dealing with any type of technology. My brother and I have managed to get him to allow us to pay most of his bills online and we have access to his various accounts. Now back to mom. We were able to get her into a nursing home at the beginning of July. She received more therapy there but again therapy under Medicare was terminated due to lack of progress. At both her current facility and the previous one, she has fallen several times. Most of them were, unfortunately, her fault as she was trying to move in ways her body can no longer do. She even remarked to my brother that she "knows how to fall". She still needs assistance going to the bathroom, with bathing, with dressing and various other things most of us take for granted. I said earlier the stroke didn't affect her cognitively but over the last few months I've noticed some changes. She's gotten more stubborn and her and my father snap at each other. That's because of his poor hearing. He can't hear her very well or at all sometimes and she gets frustrated. Given all that she's convinced she can come home. My brother and I know that's not feasible. My father is not capable of giving my mom the care she needs and we are sure he understands that. I suspect he will need care of his own in 2-3 years, maybe sooner. His mother eventually succumbed to dementia and I'm worried I see signs of it in him. My brother who lives with him has been doing the lion's share of the work helping him and mom over the years but he has a full time job. He can't financially quit to take care of her. I live 2.5 hours away. The house would need some major work to let her come home and she obviously would need some kind of home health care. While my parents are ok financially for now, the work needed on the house plus home care would drain that fast. The Medicaid waiver program in our state is a mess and it could be months or years to get her on it. Sorry for the long story. I know my family's situation isn't as bad as many on here but I wanted to get it off my chest."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 66 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fuy4iw/we_will_eventually_have_to_tell_our_mother_she/

↳ **comment** (61): "Caring for parents carries quite the load and stress. You have a lot going on. My suggestion for your mom would be to tell her the truth: she can go home when she is able to independently care for herself. This includes bathing, using the washroom, maybe even add going x number of weeks without falling. In short, she can go home when she meets these milestones. Until she is strong enough, she needs to stay where she is to get the help. Will this happen? Unlikely. But it may give her the focus to try. Very best of luck to you and family."

↳ **comment** (22): "My father is in the same position. He was released from hospital to rehab after surgery on his foot, but is unable to stand/walk/bathe/dress/etc and my mother, now in an independent living arrangement in the same facility, cannot take care of him. Medicaid/Medicare ran out and we're now having to pay for his care. He frankly preferred to be waited on and served prior to his infection. He's been in hospital or rehab for six weeks, and seems fine there, with mobility provided by a wheelchair only, and only today did it appear to sink in for him that he would continue to be institutionalized until he can deal with regular daily living on his own. We're waiting to see if his foot heals, but there's a good chance that he'll need to stay in nursing care. It sucks. Good luck to you. You're not alone in experiencing this."

↳ **comment** (20): "Perhaps her doctor would be best delivering the news? He could present the medical reasons for her not to return home and answer any questions. This way when moving her to the nursing home you can say you are 'following doctor's orders'."

"PSA for anyone navigating aid for an aging parent: call your Area Agency on Aging before you think you need to. Spent more time than I planned to over the past year helping figure out the financial side of caring for a family member. The single most useful thing I learned, and the thing I see almost nobody mention in threads here, is the Area Agency on Aging. Every region in the US has one. Federally funded, locally run. They coordinate respite care, adult day programs, meal delivery, transportation, in-home support, and often have small emergency funds that don't get advertised anywhere. The locator is at eldercare.acl.gov — type in a zip code, get the agency for that area. The reason I'm mentioning it specifically: most people only find their AAA after they're already in crisis mode. By that point you're trying to learn a new system while also managing a parent's hospitalization or a sudden move. If you call them while things are still relatively stable, they'll walk you through what's available in your specific county, what the waitlists look like, and what to apply for now versus later. It's free. A few other things that come up less than they should in threads here: Caregiver stipends. If you're providing unpaid care, programs like Medicaid's Structured Family Caregiving (in many states) or VA Aid and Attendance (if your parent is a wartime vet or surviving spouse) can pay you a monthly amount. Not life-changing money, but real, and shockingly underclaimed. Medication assistance. Most expensive medications have a manufacturer patient assistance program. NeedyMeds aggregates them. If a parent's hitting the donut hole or paying full price, there's usually a route around it. 211. Dial 211 from any phone. United Way runs it. They know what's available locally for utilities, food, rent, respite — anything social-service adjacent. Five minutes on the phone gets you a list specific to your county. The unifying point is that the system is fragmented. Different agencies, different income rules, different applications. Nobody hands you a roadmap. The AAA is the closest thing to one, which is why I keep flagging it. Happy to talk if anyone's deep in figuring this out or wants to add anything that worked for them please do so. Hope this helps!!!! 🙏"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 63 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t2bz8x/psa_for_anyone_navigating_aid_for_an_aging_parent/

↳ **comment** (20): "My therapist told me I can't tie her to a chair and put her somewhere safer against her will. It's her choice, but I have told her that since she's refused my help over the years, she's now on her own and will have the choices made for her when the time comes. I'm done trying to reason. Im so glad I don't have children to put through this misery."

↳ **comment** (18): "I did, my mom refuses to utilize them. It's so frustrating."

↳ **comment** (11): "Compounding frustration I like to call it. What's the saying ... "you can lead a horse to water but you cant make them drink""

"Oh yes, girl! Just spent five years dealing with my father. They were both the most difficult and rewarding years of my life. Less than a year after he passed, we're now living between two homes taking care of my in-laws. You said it! It's all-consuming and it turns your life upside-down. Hang in there. You truly need to focus on just one day and one moment at a time. You will NEVER look back on the time you helped them as wasted and you'll forever be thankful of the time you got with them. It's definitely hard to believe that while you're in the middle of it. You were meant for such a time as this. Unite your suffering with the one who gave everything for us. 🙏❤️"

youtube · @kimberlyd7748 · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 42 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgwTHzaKjxbMNI6tQ7F4AaABAq>

"I've been calm but direct. My mom is in a SNF following her 3rd stroke and sometimes asks about going back to her house which also was a bad fit for her for a while. There's some cognitive stuff too. But when we talk about bills and planning (when she brings it up) I explain it in the simplest terms. Last week, she was worried about the bills. I told her I've been taking care of them and reviewed which bills were paid. I reminded her that with the medicare/medicaid situation she has 6 months from her start at the facility before she's down to only keeping \$60 of her monthly income with the rest going to the facility. I let her know the house will need to be sold by the end of that period because I won't be paying all of her bills indefinitely. She seemed to accept the financial side better than the fact that she functionally can't live at home alone again. Stick to facts and know where you draw the lines."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 38 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/oockdd1/

"Aunt wants my low functioning mom in home care, I want her in snf? Who is right?. My mom had a major stroke a few months ago. Now her right limbs total dont move. She's bed bound. Definitely needs 24/7 care. She eats through a gastric tube because she can't swallow. My aunt heavily wants her to move into her apartment in which she's the landlord of. She wants a 24-hour caregiver, someone who lives there for free in exchange for looking after my mom and home health visits (We are in the process of interview one). I know that nursing homes are bad, but at the end of the day I know there are several healthcare professionals there looking after her.. The in-home caregiver would have to turn her every 2 hours, feed her through that tube, know medical things. I am a new graduate nurse so I know what it takes but I can't be there 24/7, and I suck at wound care . I don't know if one person can realistically do that. My mom also has a few wounds from her fall as well which the snf is taking care of. I don't know what to do. My aunt is heavily pushing this. I don't want my mom to stay in the nursing home but at the end of the day..... She's not high functioning enough where I feel comfortable leaving her with a 24 hour caregiver.? My aunt's mom had dementia and this is what happened to her. She lived in that apartment, was bed bound as well and had wounds, a wound care home health nurse would come by and take care of it. I worked out for them so thats why she thinks it'll work for context..[(https://www.reddit.com/submit/?source_id=t3_1pay7yhh)]"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 35 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1pbfw5v/aunt_wants_my_low_functioning_mom_in_home_care_i/

"Anyone have experience paying at-home care givers as employees?. Long story short, I am looking for guidance about paying at-home "professional" caregivers as W2 or 1099 employees. My parents need pretty much 24-7 help around the house as of a few months ago. After a subpar experience with a formal caregiving agency, we found a few specific caregivers who agreed to come on essentially full time and we pay direct via check (very grateful my parents had the foresight to start paying for long term care insurance in the 90s). We've just learned, though, that in order to write off these pretty massive expenses on their taxes, we need these homecare employees to be "legit" and have been advised to set up a company and pay them as W2 employees. I'm in my early 30s and this is all pretty overwhelming confusing. Does anyone have experience doing this and setting up payroll?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 33 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p97ruz/anyone_have_experience_paying_athome_care_givers/

"It's insane to me that even this most basic and crucial aspect of the human story has also been commodified. We all die, the vast majority of us will need care in some way along that journey. It seems like quite a few places require supplemental payment on top of long term care insurance as well. Such a racket!"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/ohxk1zs/

"Caregiver burnout and respite care. I've been sick with a respiratory infection, and my husband's PACE program found me three days of respite so I could recover. His homecare nurse even dropped off cough syrup for me. I have a hard time accepting help, and I know that's an obstacle I create for myself, so I'm trying to get over not wanting a lot of strangers in my house. The program works with three nursing homes, one of which is horribly understaffed, one is for severe memory issues, and the other one has a really good and loving care staff. We've used this one a couple of times for respite, and that's where he is right now. We discussed it before they picked him up and he was okay with it, even saying that it was a gift to me for caring for him. I went to my doctor's appointment, then went to sign him into the facility, and when he got there he was agitated and had forgotten all about our discussion. "Did you know this was happening?" he demanded when he saw me. Here comes the guilt. We discussed it again, but he wasn't buying it. A nurse came in to get his vitals, and I left. Yesterday I had a full day without him and without having to go anywhere or do any chores. I go get him tomorrow. Today I have to tidy up myself and the house and get ready for him to come back. I'm dreading it. It will be ten years in April. He's a good guy, but can't get out of bed or out of a chair without help, can barely walk with a walker, is incontinent, has no short term memory. I cook for him, but he often refuses food. I have to do wound care because no matter how clean I keep him, his bum gets itchy and he will scratch himself until he scrapes the skin off and bleeds. With A&D and zinc oxide I can get it to clear up, until the next time. He doesn't believe he does it. In short, he needs a lot of care, and I don't know how much longer I can do this. I just want to call the nursing home and ask them to keep him. He's on Medicaid. The house is in my name. I can just about keep things afloat with both of our social security and what's left of my 401k, which I only use to pay the property tax. So now my choice is to lose my home or my sanity. I don't know which to choose."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 26 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1bahk0o/caregiver_burnout_and_respite_care/

"Impossible Situation. 50F with Silent Generation parents who are 85 and almost 88. They live in New York State. My mother is almost completely blind from Central Retinal Vein Occlusion that occurred in late 2021 and may have been brought on by many years of glaucoma. She was an excellent patient, always doing exactly what the doctor recommended and keeping up with her eye appointments. Her vision loss is tragic and she has very little interest in living. She is also showing signs of dementia (wailing, nagging, repeating the same questions, worrying about odd things like the alarm clock malfunctioning). Otherwise, however, she's in good physical health. My dad has been her sole caregiver and it's taking a big toll on him. He's great cognitively, but needs hearing aids and is having trouble with balance. He went for a few physical therapy sessions, but stopped around the holidays. He still drives and insists on going out whenever he wants, which is often at night. I live 1.5 hours away and have offered, asked, begged, pleaded and done everything short of showing up unannounced to get them to accept my help. My 48M brother lives 5 minutes from them and doesn't do anything for them other than clear their car when it snows. Of course, they don't/won't ask him for help either. Their situation is a ticking time bomb that has me gripped with anxiety on a daily basis. They have very little money, a condo that is mortgaged (but only in my mom's name), no wills, no POA, no burial plans except a vague notion that there is a plot for them in a cemetery 2 hours away that my late paternal grandmother bought in the 1950s! I got them to sign HIPPA releases and healthcare proxies, but there is no plan for any type of emergency. I called my mom's PCP and mentioned her cognitive symptoms, but the nurse said she denied anxiety or depression at her last wellness checkup. The nurse told me that a neurologist would need to diagnose dementia, so I made an appointment for my mom in April. Will she go? I highly doubt it. I recently had a one-hour free consultation with an elder law attorney. My brother didn't want to pay any lawyer that charged a consultation fee and then was "too busy" to attend the Zoom meeting. The lawyer said my mother needs to get on Medicaid and offered to fill out and file the application...for \$15,750. Getting on Medicaid would allow her to have a home health aide, but the likelihood of my mom agreeing to that is very low. Additionally, my dad is a hoarder and the condo is in disrepair, so the lawyer said Medicaid won't even approve them for an aide because a home visit is part of the process. If anything big or little happens to my dad, I don't know what will become of my mom. I live in a different state and am not equipped to care for a blind person with

dementia. My brother seems to think that my husband and I should take her in, even telling me that we could "get a chair lift." Also, despite the lawyer telling me that freewill.com is a scam (?), my brother insists that documents we print off the internet will be sufficient for creating wills and POAs. He's cheap as the day is long and I cannot pay for things unless we go 50/50. I love my parents dearly and have been really struggling with anticipatory grief on top of all these practical concerns. I worry about them constantly and have begun praying that God has mercy on my mom and calls her home first. I'm glad I found this community and am open to any kind suggestions."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iyze4a/impossible_situation/

"Ideally it sounds great except I tried to appeal 3 times and was denied 3 times discharge from a skilled nursing facility. And I am a nurse so I found evidence and was able to articulate in medical terms the need. If there is lack of 'progress' or 'medical need', it may not work. Organizations are very good at documenting so that these appeals fail. I tried everything but my mom was categorized as a long term patient and we needed to go the route of Medicaid in order cover the nursing home, and ultimately a Medicaid home program. Meanwhile we had to pay the long term care out of pocket, which at the time was \$8000/month. Medicare does not cover long term care. Once home, you are challenged with finding caregivers because they are paid so poorly. Its frustrating and was incredibly eye opening. For people with high care needs, options are so limited. If something happens to my dad, my mom will need to go back in a nursing home and there are no beds or places within 200 miles that will accept a Medicaid patient. You are put on a waiting list. And although it's seems logical, I cannot afford to lose my job to care for my mom or make my small house handicap accessible. She is bed bound and needs full care. I already drive 100 miles round trip multiple times per week to help. My mom now qualifies for hospice, which offers a little bit more support and bathing. So not ideal but my parents get to be home together which is what they want. Aging in place sounds so good, but in many states Medicaid has poor funding."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/11fn0tb/how_to_challenge_discharge_of_your_parent_from_a/jalv852/

"Talk to the advocate first to see if theres a spend down amount. I wish someone would explsin how Medicaid works if you have elderly parents. You can really fuck them and yourself over if you dont know what you're doing. For example, my mother's driving was dangerous, so I thought buying her car was the ideal solution. For reasons I still cant comprehend, that one act really messed with her ability to qualify for Medicaid for a time."

reddit comment · r/CaregiverSupport · 24 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1vfk46/2_months_of_assisted_living_and_they_can_no/p2djo0z/

"I was in your situation until my dad finally started trying when I told him he either needs to work on being independent, or he'll go in a nursing home. He said "I'll die before I do that" so I just plainly told him: I have 2 kids, a career, wife, etc. to take care of along with taking care of myself. All he has to do is take care of him. It's completely unfair to expect someone to just take care of you. This isn't sustainable. That's the reality - NO ONE could do it. He needs to be in a care facility. Please start the research process, contact local area on aging, etc.. If they need to sell things to get the assets to cover what they can until medicaid kicks in, then that's just what you've got to do. I'm so sorry you're dealing with this. On another note to continue your rant, why the hell does that generation of parents push their kids to do all this bullshit? My dad can now walk around the kitchen island without a wheelchair, but still expects me to empty his pee jugs (giving Ray vibes from Trailer Park Boys). He expected me to wipe his behind when he got out of skilled nursing. His arms worked fine. I cannot IMAGINE making my kids empty my piss 3 times a day for months, taking my poop in bags down to the trash can all while not even attempting to research or try solutions, other options, home care, etc.. It blows my mind. I never thought parents would turn out that way and be totally fine putting such a MASSIVE burden on their kids that they never had to deal with."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 23 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/ok9168z/

">I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. How exactly does that work?? I live in Vegas and this is not an option I'm aware of. There is no place where you can just drop off your mom and let them deal with it. Are you putting her in a Medicaid facility? If so, you need to apply for Medicaid immediately. It takes at least 3 months for it to get approved."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 21 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/oytotfi/

"DONE!. Just need to vent. I've posted before on this forum, but it's been awhile. My brother and I are only siblings. Mom spent almost 2 years in the nursing home, with a year and a half on PRIVATE PAY, thanks to my brother, who lived with her and was "supposedly" taking care of her. He took care of Dad and Mom ALL THEIR lives, not because they needed him all those years, but because he needed them. They supported him completely and he bought expensive items with his own money (found out later, PLUS some) on a disability check after working 7 years total, at menial jobs. Our mom did everything for him, even washed his hair! She thought the ground he walked on was holy. Anyway, he ended up basically mooching off them all his life, under the pretext of "taking care" of them. Dad passed away almost 20 years ago. Mom lived to be 102, passed last fall. Just suffice it to say that hoarding was a nice (although nowhere near accurate) description of what he did. He basically piled up TWO houses, ruining them BOTH in the process and causing the tax assessed value to drop to 1/3 of the original value. He basically didn't want to do anything I suggested to get the estate deeded to him legally because he was simply too lazy. The second house caused a real problem with her Medicaid eligibility (which my husband and I had tried to discuss with Mom 10-15 years ago, after Dad passed). I said Brother could have it all, I didn't want anything. He ended up ruining Mom financially, and as you can tell from the tax reassessment I had done, wrecked the entire place. I tried reporting to APS, but they never even went inside, and seemed fine with empty beer cans and junkers (8 of those) scattered across the back yard). I eventually had to take over everything to fix her over-drafted bank accounts (with my own funds) and close them out...that even made Bro mad. I eventually just took over because he was lying and hiding bills and letters, almost got Mom evicted for her private pay not being paid...nursing home billing office manager called me, which was the first I was aware. Bro didn't want to deal with the mess he had made, which ended up being dumped on me and my husband...trying to clear out the houses to salvage what we could (FOR my Bro) because once Mom ran out of money, he ran out of money, so he managed to get admitted to the nursing home for leg issues from a car accident in his 20's (he refused all doctor visits for 40 years)...he then said he couldn't walk one night. Since he lived with Mom, even that almost messed up her Medicaid. But eventually I got her Medicaid approved, then she passed two months later. The proceeds from the estate went toward her private pay bill, which did not even cover all of it because Bro hid his head in the sand for all that time, lied, etc. Anyway, he got mad at me about 4 months ago and cursed at me in a text. I ignored it but all he would ever talk about in his texts was the young female aides, and the personal intimate care they were giving him, and he refuses to allow male aides to care for him. I finally told him I really didn't want to hear all that "drama"...I did not feel it appropriate. Never once did he text without going into those sorts of details. He mentioned his showers and his underwear and "wetting" himself every single text. We found porn tapes hidden while salvaging his possessions for him. He has a fake FB page that popped up (he didn't even change his name!) with erotic pictures of young female nurses and teachers. He has a history of ...obsession, I'll call it. Previously on his FB page, he said he was in a relationship with someone he had obviously met on the internet. He has done everything within his power to report the older female staff and asked for the younger ones to replace them for his personal care. Now let me say that he has been having chest pain and high BP, yet what he got mad about was I mentioned seeing OTC testosterone supplements peeking out his bedside table one day...when they told him he wasn't supposed to be taking them, they said that I had "reported" it. So he got very angry. I said, "Fine, let him have an MI. See if I care." I will also add that he has NEVER, to my knowledge, had a normal relationship, never

been married, is 73 years old, slow mentally, and is a nursing home resident! He texted 3 weeks or so ago and said he has lung cancer. He had had a CT scan during an ER visit for high BP and chest pain, and supposedly the hospital had sent him a letter informing him he has lung cancer. Concerned, I drove up to the nursing home that evening. I know that is not the process for patient notification. He showed me the letter and it said he had a couple of nodules that showed up, but most are benign, and his PCP may want to follow up. He argued with me that that meant he has cancer. He also said the nurse had told him he has a huge mass in his stomach. He finally gave me permission to speak with the nurse...I have a healthcare background. The nurse couldn't believe he said that...she said she had explained what "benign" means and had explained the follow-up process to him, and told him his stomach is fine...no mass was even mentioned. So I tried to explain to him, but couldn't tell if he understood. I sent him a text that evening from home explaining it simply and told him if he has questions, he can ask the nurse or me. Nothing from him. So I said, "Or maybe you want me to butt out". Nothing. He hasn't spoken to me in weeks. And he never answered me. He cussed me out one time lately in a text over the testosterone supplement so I just left him alone to chill for awhile. Next thing he texted, "Can you bring my computer"...the one still in the unopened box he ordered two years ago that we salvaged for him from the piles of hoarded stuff. I took it to him, with his mail that he still gets at Mom's PO box. He accused me of not caring anything about him. I said he hadn't answered me. Oh, I was supposed to know that his "phone isn't working" and I should have called and asked the nurse to bring him the phone from the desk. WHAT? How was I supposed to know his phone "isn't working" (which I think is a lie) because he said the typos were due to his phone issue, NOT to HIM! Well, it all got out of hand and he was saying that I was a KNOW IT ALL and I should have checked on him (I asked why he didn't check on US- BECAUSE HIS PHONE WASN'T WORKING!) Claimed I didn't visit Mom or call about her when she was in the hospital...I said, I DID call! We couldn't even get our special needs daughter through Mom's house, and that was before he completely trashed it. Oh no you didn't! I said How would YOU know? Oh, HE knows! And then accused me of being just like Daddy and said he couldn't stand Daddy. I told him I loved our dad, and he said that was just because I didn't know because HE was the one living with them. Like yeah, ALL his life. I didn't intend to, but I finally told him he trashed everything and the place was a pigsty. And, predictably, that was because "he was taking care of Mom in the nursing home!". If I had had the presence of mind, I would have asked him why he managed to endure his hatred for our dad for all those years when Dad was putting a roof over his head and food on the table. At one point, he raised up as if to hit me. I absolutely will not tolerate that and I told him so. (And a very unsettling thing when I entered his room... I don't want to be too graphic here, but he is always lying down in bed, and today he had a blanket over his lower body and there was some suspicious movement down there. But I didn't. I just told him I won't be back, and he said, "Good!". So I'm done. I talked to nursing and the case manager and told them what happened and that I hated I lost my temper because it was not my intention to upset him. The case manager said he has already asked them to remove me as emergency contact from his chart. And they said he has been in one of his complaining moods all day anyway. I do feel bad about losing my temper and I know I could have just exited the room. It was like my feet were glued to the floor. I really didn't mean to upset him but I just won't take his accusations. I really no longer care what he thinks of me. He can bad-mouth me to the staff and say whatever he wants. I think I have come to the conclusion that he is crazy and always has been. He has become agitated lately (IMO) because two of the female aides who he literally talked about all the time were fired. I just don't go in for all that drama. But I think it might have unhinged him. Well, more than usual... But I do have to be honest in that I can't stand to be in the same room with him. I don't know if it is possible to disown a brother, but I am DONE! I'll try to forgive him again, but I'm not there yet after him yelling SHUT UP to me today. And no I don't think he has dementia. I think he's just a selfish little B__ST__D that my mom coddled all his life. I'm not his Mom."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uk7ylh/done/>

"Rock bottom. I hate a whiner but I am pretty much at rock bottom. Every single day something happens. Our special needs daughter lives with us and we are her caregivers. My husband has recently had serious health issues as a result of a complication from surgery, mostly. However, he is diabetic, has renal stones with one procedure

after the other, cardiac issues, back issues, sleep apnea, issues with his feet. Our daughter recently began not walking and she has been diagnosed with arthritis in her knees; she had an MRI a couple of weeks ago on one knee and it had to be done under sedation, just like a surgical procedure. Result will be discussed with her orthoped dr next week, but she has been receiving PT 2x/week and goes to Day Support 2x/week. We are pushing her in a wheelchair everywhere, even in the house now. Part of it is probably behavioral, but it is hard to tell. Our only other child, a son, lives an hour and a half away, has his own family, and commutes back and forth to and from work an hour and a half each way, so he is busy with his own life. We would be doing okay, even with the myriad doctor appointments and procedures even now, except for my mom. My daughter and husband are my priority at home. AS soon as my husband started recovering a bit from his surgical complication (with 2 EMS trips, 2 hospitalizations, 6 ER visits, numerous dr appointments and procedures and med changes) in April, my mom fell at home in May when she developed a UTI. The same scenario almost exactly occurred three years ago with her. She got very confused, was hospitalized for about 3-4 days, then of course they wanted to send her home. My brother has worked only sporadically throughout his 71 years (we are twins) and has lived with our parents all his life; he never married. He is mentally slow, but functional. In 1986 he had a car accident and broke his leg, and has not worked since, and has lived with them in a house beside their doublewide. 17 years ago my father passed away, and my brother moved from the house belonging to my parents over to the DW and began living with Mom. He especially is a hoarder- the house was junked up like the Colyer brothers. My mom has never been too much of a housekeeper, but when he moved in with her, he began junking up her DW. So I tried to discuss the issue with them several times in a round-about way, offering to help clean. I was told no. Eventually the back porch has collapsed and he began "not hearing the doorbell" when I would go there. It was an awkward situation. The outside is junk cars and trash, literally. Since I haven't been inside the house in over a year (and only for her 100th BD then), I don't know how bad it is inside, but it was bad even then. I agonized over the situation; my brother is a "survivalist" type (he fancies himself at least)...now I suspect he has perimeter alarms around the house. Anytime I take him food or show up unexpected, he beelines to meet me outside so I don't go inside. So three years ago, the EMTs could not get Mom out due to the front porch is very narrow and there is restricted angling for a stretcher, plus they probably had trouble getting it through the hoarder piles. The back porch was collapsed (still is). So it took them probably an additional 30 minutes while they waited for backup and they had to roll Mom up in a blanket to remove her from the house. The EMT told me he would make sure she did not return home. I expected that he would be reporting the home to APS. I told my brother about it and even offered to help him clean up the house but, predictably, he got mad and said he might not like how the EMTs house looked. There was no reasoning with him that that was none of his concern, that his and Mom's environment was the issue. The day they were planning on discharging her from acute care, he just texted me and said they were sending her home. I said, No they are not, went to the hospital and got arrangements made for her to be placed in Skilled Care. I talked to him then about the possibility of him getting the house legally deeded to him through the Adult Child Caregiver Medicaid Exemption...he said he would look into it. I sent him everything for him to see a lawyer to discuss and told him he needed POA. And told him it would maybe be better for her to be placed in Long Term Care. On his own, a few weeks later, he took her home without consulting with me. If the EMT reported the home situation, APS did nothing to prevent her returning home as I was told. Fast forward to May of this year...same scenario, UTI, fall, dementia, then I again had to make arrangements for Skilled Care. His legs are in bad shape, he can barely walk and should be in the nursing home himself, but he brags that he has not been to a doctor since 1986. He has obvious lymphedema (from what? who knows?) and hints at the fact that he thinks he doesn't have long to live. I have repeatedly tried to convince him to see a doctor, but he said he didn't see one before "because he figured they would think he wasn't able to take care of Mom." Bingo! I told him they could look at him and see that. Since Mom is now incontinent, he finally agreed with me to place her in Long Term Care. I asked him about what he did about the Medicaid Caregiver Exemption...predictably, NOTHING, because, according to him, he didn't see the need three years ago because she went home. I have also found another possible avenue for him to legally keep the house- as a disabled child (no age limits). I literally dragged him to Social Services myself to check on both options because he just sits there beside Mom holding her hand all day

long, every single day so he says he doesn't have time for anything else. Every evening he texts me the slightest detail about her and both he and Mom are paranoid about her roommate. The case worker office is right down the hall from Mom's room, but he can't leave Mom long enough to check ever about her Medicaid application status. I go up 2-4 times/week and stay 2-3 hours at a time, help Mom brush her teeth (he hands her a paper towel to do that, he says). I trim her nails, label her clothes and personal items, brush her hair, take her games and mental activities, take her outside in her wheelchair for walks, asked her former coworkers to send her get well cards, try to divert her paranoia to positive activities like watching wildlife outside, take her small gifts like bracelets and bonnets that I make. I check periodically on her Medicaid application status...when I ask him, he just says that he figures they will come to him if there is a problem. (I go visit as I can- two weeks in a row, we had 7 appts/procedures each week.) When we went to Social Services, the regular case worker was out of the office and the young woman who filled in for her told me I am incorrect about the Adult Child Caregiver Exemption as well as the Disabled Child Exemption. (He says he can't find his disability record on the SS website, but even if that is so, all he would have to do is go to Social Security right down the road. He has ignored everything, done nothing.) However, I have the federal and state laws that say that I am correct about both exemptions. I sent my brother the links, as well as an application to the Legal Aid organization. I called a lawyer myself about POA for him. I know nothing about the finances other than a minimal amount of information- he literally brought me the documents they requested all mixed together, shoved in an old Amazon mailing bag, and I sorted through everything myself to find what I could. When Social Services requested more information about her annuities, life insurance, pension, etc. that I went to them and literally sat and cried because I couldn't get the information. I met then with someone who tried to help with letters to each company- I still don't know if they got everything returned that they needed. I checked last week but the case worker at the nursing home on her case was out of the office and the other one did not know. Well, today I called Social Services (we both are authorized representatives) and Mom's case worker called me back and Mom has been denied Medicaid because she owns both homes. One is probably worth \$15,000 even cleaned out; the DW may fetch \$30,000 if cleaned up, maybe more, I'm not sure. But both are on the same parcel of land and no separate driveway to the house apart from the DW. The DW as is...someone would look at what I imagine the mess is, and might offer \$15,000. Anyway, had my brother gotten the DW signed over to him, it would not have been considered a transfer of assets because it would have been excluded. Social services told me that they sent him the letter on August 9, and a copy to the nursing home. The copy they sent me was returned as undeliverable because they still had not corrected my address after I had told them in July they had 2 numbers transposed. She could not tell me if they had received the annuity, pens"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1f13y84/rock_bottom/

To be heard: 'I just want to hear from people who've been here' · 19 documents

18 most engaged of 19 matching documents, complete text.

"i am a dementia nurse and former caregiver. back to answer your questions and help you navigate the chaos. ask me anything.. hey everyone. i did a thread like this about two months ago and connected with so many of you who were completely burnt out. since that old post is buried now, i wanted to put this back out there in case anyone new needs some help or just a safe space to vent today. i work professionally as a nurse specializing entirely in dementia and cognitive issues. i have the clinical training for the confusion, the behavior changes, and the medical gaslighting. but i only truly understood the crushing weight of the daily, unseen chaos when i suffered it in my own skin with my family. all the textbook theories went completely out the window. because doctors don't really tell you how to practically handle this stuff at home, i recently turned all those clinical survival hacks into a published book for caregivers. seeing it help families has been amazing, but i want to keep paying it forward directly here too. if you or a loved one are dealing with cognitive symptoms right now, please use this thread to ask anything. whether you need a practical trick for the endless repeating, advice on doctors, or if you just need to vent to someone who gets it. my dms are always open too. you don't have to carry this alone."

reddit post · r/dementia · 300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_care_giver_back/

↳ **comment** (162): "thank you for reaching out. first off, you are not crazy for feeling like you are being punked. the looping questions are literal psychological torture for caregivers and by 5pm your brain is completely fried. what is happening is that her short-term tape recorder is broken but her social instinct is still active. she asks those specific questions because they are her only remaining tools to feel grounded or initiate a connection. to survive this, you have to break the verbal loop. if you just answer the question normally, her brain registers a dead end and simply restarts the cycle. instead, try the whiteboard trick. get a small dry erase board and write the answers to her top questions in huge letters: "you took your meds. lunch was soup. you are 80." when she asks, do not answer verbally, just point to the board. forcing her to read it uses a different part of the brain and often breaks the loop. if she asks about the remotes, answer briefly and immediately give her a simple task to derail her train of thought. "the black one is the phone. hey, can you help me fold these napkins real quick?" you have to physically or mentally redirect her to stop the repetitive cycle."

↳ **comment** (104): "i am so sorry you are at this deeply heavy stage. "my watch will be soon ending" is such a beautiful and heartbreaking way to put it. please do not feel uneasy about the morphine at night. i know it feels strange to medicate someone who is already sleeping but that deep sacrum bedsore is incredibly painful even if he cannot express it anymore. the morphine is doing two crucial things right now. it is staying ahead of that severe pain so it doesn't wake him up in agony and it relaxes his respiratory system to prevent any air hunger or gasping as his body naturally shuts down. you are not doing anything wrong by giving it to him while he rests. keeping him medicated exactly on the hospice schedule is the absolute kindest thing you can do for him right now so he can transition peacefully without any hidden distress. you have done an incredible job caring for him all this time. just keep him comfortable and hold his hand."

↳ **comment** (66): "What a generous offer you've made here. Thank you so much. I would love to hear your practical advice for the constant, endless, repeated questions. We have the same conversations all day, every day, starting with one of a repertoire of 4-5 questions. Sometimes we have the same conversation twice in the span of 10 minutes, sometimes they are cycled through, starting all over again once she has completed the cycle. There are never statements, only questions, mainly to confirm something. Did I take my medicine? How old am I? What did we have for lunch? How old are you? Which of these is the phone (holding two TV remotes). By 5pm, I can't handle another question and just want quiet, which of course doesn't happen. It sometimes feels like she punking me, but I of course know she doesn't have the mental capacity to do that."

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my

muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"I can't do this anymore, and I never agreed to be a caregiver to my mother's husband.. To sum up some background context, my mom remarried when I was in my mid 20's about 20 years ago. My mom asked me to move in 3.5 years ago to temporarily help her with my son. My mom died 3 years ago, my son died a year ago. I have never been close to her husband, he didn't even start being nice to me till my mom died. I feel I can't leave because I'm the only person he doesn't kick out. I'm coming from a place of deep frustration at the moment, and I'm sorry if I sound like a soulless monster. I just can't do this anymore. My parents didn't divorce till I was an adult. In extreme desperation, I assume my married, lets call him Frank. (now 75) Frank was the opposite of my father who my mother loved dearly in every bad way. He was uneducated, uncaring and had no family values, but what I could I do. It was her choice to marry him after 4 months. I had my own life going on and briefly stayed with them after being left during my third trimester of pregnancy till my son was six weeks old. Frank, made sure I knew that I had to get out after I gave birth and that my mom was not going to be a "babysitter" She did what he said, she liked being controlled. So, my mom undergoes what I felt was an unnecessary medical procedure that caused complications. She asked me and my teenage son to move in to help her overcome her health obstacles. Frank decides to get an unnecessary elective surgery and my mom actually kills herself trying to care take to him afterward. I was distraught to say the least and I never blamed Frank for my mom's choices. I could say in detail every event that has made me choose not to leave. But I want someone to read this. I'm being manipulated, and I know this and he kicks out any of his family including his daughter who left earlier this year, traumatized from PTSD he gave her and won't come back. Frank is from a different state, all his large family lives there. He refuses to go there and kicks out any adult grandchild etc that is sent to help because I have made it known I want to move out of here. He is completely fine with me here, especially since my son died. I don't get up in his business because I'm too consumed with my own grief and we live separate lives, but I clean. His life is watching Forensic Files, lurking Facebook and spending my dead mom's money on cam girls and what he knows are scams. Oh, and lot's of Dr visits, he has always loved going to the doctor. He is not being medically neglected, he more overrides the health care system by getting a Dr appointment for anything. He has destroyed his body signing up for clinical trials. He also loves to kick out home health nurses, go to the ER afterward and report the aides of injuring him and theft. (nothing has been stolen) My life is I constantly work to stay busy and out of my own head. I don't stay here out of financial security. I can very much afford to not be here. I'm paying for my own father's assisted living in NYC and I would be in a bind if I was footing two bills. He doesn't want assisted living anyhow and I know its just a matter of time till he burns through my mom's money and I become financially responsible for him. (Help pay for my father's assisted living. He is smart and planned for this, just not in NYC. He hates Texas and I can't blame him. I help with the offset cost, not the entire huge bill) The neighbors of 20 years have been very supportive of him and me. They will take him to the ER for his unnecessary reasons, or will show up at the hospital because he decides to call 911 while I'm in therapy. Today, Frank has burned bridges with the neighbors and I'm terrified. They are all the support I have. The only support he has. So I come "home" from my typical 12 hour day with a trunk full of groceries only to find a large snake in the garage. I'm like great, go inside to get a broom and Frank calls out my name all cranky. We briefly discuss the snake. He then goes on about how mad he is because he fell twice trying to mow the lawn in 95 degree Texas heat. I'm like why are you mad? That was your own fault. He then goes and blames the next door neighbor for not mowing it for him like she normally does. And then blames me for not reading his mind. I didn't even notice it needed to be mowed. It wasn't that bad. I'm like that is not her job to mow your lawn and you could have asked me. He carries on about how we caused him to fall and I leave the unreasonable situation to get the groceries. My other neighbor calls me over and asks me wtf his problem is because he had to pick him up twice when he tried to mow the lawn causing panic all up the street. I

give him the synopsis of what he said. Other neighbor tells me, you know he doesn't have cognitive decline and is just an asshole. I agree and he says I'm done. Go save yourself, I mean that. Other neighbor is a man of his word. He should have been done long ago as should have I. I'm terrified and have to accept that I'm not a horrible person for failing to save Frank from himself and choosing myself. Edit: sorry for all the typos and grammar mistakes my phone is freaking out too, and I need to get this out! And the 3 foot snake is still chilling in the garage. I will snake wrestle when it becomes daylight. Edit Edit: Is this normal on his part. I have read that as people age, they can become the worst form of themselves or the best form of who they wanted be. Edit: Thank you all so much!! The gaslighting is real. I needed to know this is with out a doubt, not my problem. I got into with him over the weekend when he tried to blame me for my mom's death. You don't go there with me and I don't stoop to his level. I was the bigger person and said: Me: I don't know what you want from me! Especially if you treat me like this Him: I should not have to say it. Me: Actually you do have to say what you want from me because I have no idea. Him: You know it! Me: I have no idea Him: I'm sick of repeating myself. Nobody listens. I want you out of here. I'm like sweet! I'll leave happily. I told him I'm leaving after the 4th weekend so I could find a place with out being overly dramatic and he needs to call his family and tell them he asked me to leave. Of course he is acting like that never happened. I just found some big chain complex that has an apartment available for move in 07/06. I'm taking it and can transfer units or complex's later if I need. Im too nice still and hired a lawn company to clear out any snake inviting debris and staying friendlish to get what I want of my mother's. I know I'm not through with it all, once he dies, gets forced placed in a nursing home or loses the house taking out equity loans, I will have to clean it up. It will probably all happen within a week and this year. I did what I could but I can't sacrifice the remaining good years of my life so he can do whatever it is he does. Edit edit: I have always refused to be his POA or have any type of decision making authority with him. That was all settled with his family earlier this year and I was vocal I want nothing to do with this. His poor daughter is POA and will be the one really stuck to clean up this mess he leaves behind. He got her to sign up for that while she was emotionally vulnerable. There is nothing to gain when he dies, anything liquid he tore through after my mom died. I will help his daughter though emotionally. Her feelings towards him make mine seem warm and fuzzy. I will keep in my mind that they are not my family and trust no one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 126 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ugwxtv/i_cant_do_this_anymore_and_i_never_agreed_to_be_a/

"Mom (93) finished cancer treatment and is giving up. Looking for both tactical advice and to hear from anyone who's been through this. Long-time lurker, first time posting. The situation: Mom is 93, just finished radiation for cancer and is in remission with aggressive monitoring. We had to move her from independent living to assisted living about six weeks ago after a hospitalization made it clear she couldn't safely live alone anymore (not taking meds consistently on her own). (She had been in independent for 18 months before the cancer diagnosis and seemed fine.) Treatment went as well as we could've hoped clinically. But now that the active medical crisis is past, she's collapsed. What's happening this week: \- Won't get out of bed. Won't leave her room. Always an excuse for not going to meals or activities. \- Hiding her medications. Staff are catching some of it but probably not all. \- Caught trying to bribe staff — telling them she'll give them her house if they help her go home or look the other way when she does things she's been told not to do. \- I'm pretty sure she thinks that if she gets kicked out of AL, she thinks she goes home. Home is not an option. The next step is SNF, and she doesn't understand that. A counselor is seeing her tomorrow, which I'm grateful for. The staff at AL is working with us — they have really been amazing through all this. What I'm asking: 1. For those whose parent went through post-treatment depression — did meds help? Did therapy? Did anything? How long did the dark stretch last? 2. The bribery / med-hiding behavior — is this depression, early cognitive decline, or both? She's been cognitively intact on testing, but this feels like something shifted. 3. How do you talk to a parent who has decided to give up? Every script I try ("we want you here," "we're doing this because we love you") seems to bounce off. She just keeps saying she understands but then the behavior doesn't align with what she says. 4. Did anyone successfully avoid the SNF transition by getting their parent stabilized in AL after a backslide like this? Or is this how it goes? The harder

thing: We have moved mountains. We (my wife and I) uprooted our lives to temporarily move to be near her and take care of her throughout this process. My employer has been very understanding. We've dealt with all the paperwork, coordinating five specialists across three cities, getting her placed, managing her finances, the cancer treatment, all of it. And it's not enough. She's miserable and I think part of her is angry at us for not letting her go home to die in her own bed. I know there's no magic answer. I just want to hear from people who've been in this exact spot. What helped. What didn't. What you wish you'd known. Thanks for reading. Edit: I wanted to provide some additional info to address some of the comments. Health prior to the cancer diagnosis: First, up until this cancer episode she was in very good shape cognitively and physically - much better than her age would suggest. She only used a walker outside or unfamiliar places. People always commented on how sharp she was. Finances: After my dad passed away, we discussed her finances on many occasions. My only concern was that she was financially ok and she constantly assured me that she was fine. She was paying her bills -- she always paid on time and was never late. I have never pushed her to do anything she didn't want to do. She approached me about moving to IL. We discussed the cost and I agreed to help because it was going to cost more than her monthly income. We discussed selling the house and she agreed. But she kept coming up with excuses to drag out the process and, quite frankly, I was busy with other things in life. Then one morning shortly after the initial cancer diagnosis, she divulged a credit card bill. In trying to get to the bottom of that I discovered that hole was much deeper than she let on. She even tried to hide some of the statements from me. On the cancer diagnosis: Her mother (my GM) died of cancer, so I think mom heard cancer and immediately interpreted that as a death sentence, despite what anyone told her. Multiple doctors told her she would likely die with it and not of it. It was very early stage 1 and very treatable. One oncologist said even at her age, given all the other factors, he gave her a >90% chance of survival. We made the decisions we made with the best intentions and the best information available at the time. That bell has been rung and I'm not going to re-litigate that on an Internet forum. Legal affairs: Before all of this, we had all of her legal affairs in order. She had an AD (no code), and I have full financial and healthcare POA. I have since taken over managing the finances and have an attorney involved to make sure we handle the debt and her care according to her stated wishes. On me "not being able to let go": I have a background in being a first responder. I've seen death in the line of duty and personal experience with other difficult family situations. This is not a situation where I "just can't let go." I have lived through that on my wife's side of the family and it was an awful experience. I have discussed this situation with many doctors and every single one has told me this is not a palliative care situation -- she would likely not qualify for hospice. I'm not an expert in that -- I'm simply going on the advice of others. Now has she just lost the will to live? Yes, very probably. But being depressed is not the same thing as being terminally ill and that's not the same thing as just being old. I'm hoping that independent behavioral health will help us make the best decisions we can from here on out. I appreciate everyone who has taken time to respond."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 125 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4swt3/mom_93_finished_cancer_treatment_and_is_giving_up/

"can you ever MAKE them do it, or do you have to just wash your hands?. *not even sure how much background would be relevant here. I'm in the USA. I've spent about the past 10 months trying to clean out my mother's house. it's a big old farmhouse type thing in a rural area. it's absolutely falling apart. my stepdad passed in 2017. he was significantly older than my mom is (now 71). no retirement savings. no life insurance. some of that WAS his bad choices, some of it was out of his control (when companies go bankrupt, you lose your pension. in his case it happened at least twice). we were ok \$\$\$ wise when I was younger but when we moved and they bought this money pit of a house, it all went to s\|\|. my mom never worked outside the home and so lives off my dad's survivorship SS. she's got no small amount of debt. she lives about an hour from me. she has some disabilities from scoliosis, severe osteoporosis and glaucoma. as of last year she could no longer drive any significant distance and probably shouldn't at all. I have to take her to all dr and dentist appointments which are an hour PAST her house away from mine. for years my mother was totally convinced she was going to move back to our home state despite the fact that it's very VERY expensive now. then she finally relented last year that "I*

have to accept that's not going to happen." well no \\\|. despite having tried myself, and others that she needed to have gotten the heck out of that house years ago, she dug in and fought it. she fights everything that isn't her idea (this has been a lifelong thing, and part of why my relationship with her is so fraught). *she absolutely can-NOT live me with me. full stop.* she is still convinced that she can sell this falling apart ruin of a home for enough money that she can afford to buy ANOTHER home and have enough from my dad's meager survivorship social security to pay on a mortgage and all the maintenance that a house requires. I have tried telling her again and again and again that the market for "as is fixer uppers" is just about gone. people want move in ready and perfect or they won't buy. and people don't do rent-backs anymore either. nobody is going to buy her as-is home and then let her rent back until she finds another house here where I live that checks alllll her boxes AND the cost of homes in my neighborhood has doubled and they either get snapped up by investors or are sold way overpriced but needing a ton of work. anything new being built is all three story townhomes and she can't even manage ONE flight of stairs. *I truly believe the best option for her is an apartment. There are a few of the traditional "garden style" first floor/one floor types as well as some regular apartments that cater to seniors without being a full on assisted living. she wouldn't have to worry about maintenance, she could mostly decorate how she wants. we can set up a living trust for whatever she comes away with after selling her house to cover additional expenses like a cleaning service, uber rides/transport if needed, etc.* except she won't. even now, I've tried to push things along faster because I am 54, I work full time and I am EXHAUSTED. I have spent hours and hours of sorting, taking things to thrift stores, taking what she wants to keep in storage (which I'm paying for) and I AM TIRED. The entire attic is still full of cr\p and she wants to "sort out what she wants to get rid of and then leave what she wants to keep until she moves." *I want to pay whomever we're going to pay to help, get it ALL out of the damn attic and then take whatever she wants to keep and put it in storage NOW. YESTERDAY. get the rest of the furniture out. she keeps insisting it can stay "until she has a house to move into." I CAN'T TAKE THIS ANYMORE.* The year before we started on this I had to spend nearly 6 straight months working on my own house because there were some things that had gotten away from us and needed to be addressed. then I spent pretty much all of last year dealing with this stuff for my mother while one of our dogs had cancer and died. I have basically given up all hobbies, I can't exercise or get to the gym, I barely have the executive function at the end of a workday anymore to COOK let alone take care of myself. I've already spent over 12K just getting her furnace repaired and all the dental work done that Medicare won't cover just in the past 5 years. at what point do I get to just say: *you will move into an apartment the house will be listed within the next 90 days the proceeds pay the debt and then we set up a trust with the rest and you STAY IN AN APARTMENT until you literally cannot take care of yourself anymore (which God willing would be more than the 5 years required).* then if you want to go into a rehab center you can. *Hell if you want to do MAD when the time comes, I would even support that. but God as my witness I am not dealing with another house, all the crap that comes with it, another mortgage when you're gone, blah blah blah.* THIS is the plan that we follow, or I don't do one more thing. Not one more box packed, not one more trip to a thrift store. not one more cent for home repairs. don't call me unless you decide this is what we are doing. sorry. yeah this is really long. and, as most quandaries with aging parents are, it's complicated and ugly."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 123 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qntrif/can_you_ever_make_them_do_it_or_do_you_have_to/

"The cost of caregiving is too high and I can't continue like this. I need to vent. My (26) mom (68) had a fall and broke many bones, after many surgeries and a month long hospital stay, she is now at home with very limited mobility. I am an onlychild, my dad is dead and we don't have other family so everything falls in me and I don't have a lot of support, except from my friends. I was already her caregiver when she broke a leg when I was 21 and have been financially responsible for her for 8 years. I am so tired / angry / frustrated and I can't face to keep being responsible for everything. Being responsible for her health is such a big pressure, as if anything goes wrong it will be my fault. Example, if something is a warning sign and I didn't realize. Cognitively she is great, so she could help me figure out stuff. Instead, she decides to acts like a toddler which gets on my nerves. She has always

being emotionally immature and narcissistic, but she takes it now to an extreme. She doesn't take any agency over her own health or even bothers to try. When I tell her that it is X time and she has to take X pill, she answers something like "Ok, I'll take it only if you want me to take it". At the same time, I can't speak with her like grown ups. When I tell her that I am burn out, her answer is "I'll just make myself invisible so I don't bother you anymore if I am such a burden for you". I hired a caregiver and she refuses to ask her for help if I am around (because she "prefers it when I do it") so I have to leave the apartment. I have no safe space anymore as being in my apartment is being bombarded by things to do. I am emotionally depleted. I work a full time and a part time job (both remote) and I am being a horrible worker because I don't have the time, energy or focus to work on my tasks. I am late to every deadline and I make so many mistakes due to my lack of attention. So I am also constantly afraid of being made redundant (who is going to pay for everything she needs then?). This year, I have received many amazing career opportunities and I feel like I am throwing everything to the trash because I am not up to what they expected from me. And lastly, I have no time for self-care. I feel like I am giving up my youth and all my desires for her, and I don't want to. But then, I feel extremely guilty because I should be a "better daughter" -not based in the US-

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 122 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cbz9g1/the_cost_of_caregiving_is_too_high_and_i_cant/

"offer rejected. My 90 yo mom went home from hospital and rehab stint. My sibling stayed with her for a week. Now all care falls on me. My husband asked my mom to come stay with us for awhile, temporarily until it might need to be permanent . She said she would consider it. I expected her to jump at the chance, but she pretty much turned us down. She said she would be fine alone in her house. The main reason he invited her was to take the burden off of me by having her at our house instead of me going to her house a few times a day. She is going to need more care pretty soon, but now I really don't want her to come live with us. Thanks for allowing a safe space to vent."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 73 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fwww6z/offer_rejected/

↳ **comment** (71): "You are very lucky she said no to coming to live with you and your family. You cannot continue to prop up your mother by going to her house 2 or 3 times a day. She clearly needs more care and supervision and cannot continue to live in her home. You are going to have to let her live her life and fail at this before she is willing to make a change. That change should be in an AL if she can afford it or she will have to hire caregivers to come to her house x number of times a week, if she can afford it or she will need to go back into a facility if she cannot take care of herself. You cannot keep up the pace of running her household and your own. Yes the solutions sound harsh but when an elder refuses to compromise then unfortunately you have to choose your mom or yourself and your own health and emotional and physical well being."

↳ **comment** (18): "Don't take it as a slight to you, it's hard to leave your home. If you have to go there too many times a day, see if she can find a paid caregiver or tell her you can only help if she comes to stay with you."

↳ **comment** (12): "Hi so there are no perfect solutions here, my mom did both the home care thing at our house and is now in AL. I guess a third option might have been moving her to a senior apartment and hiring her care. My thoughts. Two big factors will be how well the house suits your mom and what the labor market is like where she lives. My uncle is 4 years older than my mom, has major memory problems, but has hung in there with the help of an amazing housekeeper, he has a flat house, and is in a compact village in a rural area so he has built in interaction to some degree. My mom was in a large house with difficult steps and falling hazards, she was in a sprawling expensive suburb where it was hard to get good help, and even with help was pretty isolated. Having a person in her house all day seemed to breed conflict. So we went with AL. Also her house was in a great location but aging as fast as her and it was the right time to sell. I have learned the hard way that AL is not very personalized and while my mom fits well into the level of care they provide, it's a very partial solution. She still needs me or someone really frequently, but stuff like caring for the house is no longer an issue and there is structure for her medications. She also is enjoying the social aspect and doing some activities. I will also say that

making a move gets harder as they age, so this may be the window that you need. My mom had pretty major surgery in April and it became apparent her days of living independently were over. I would love to think that your mom is looking out for you and knows on some level that moving in with her would be hard for you. Good luck!"

"Relative didn't sign her will.... TLDR; relative didn't sign her will and now my parent in the nursing home is being punished. Hi guys, I was a pretty active member of this sub until my parent transitioned to long term care last year, but I wanted to tell a cautionary tale. And I want to vent. Over the past two years, my mom's sister has been talking to me about what she's going to leave me in her will. She was going to leave me everything; life changing money. She died suddenly yesterday. Here comes the greedy relative part. Right? Not really. When she passed I made a quick call to the lawyer because there was something I need immediate information on (it was pet related). I'm the course of the conversation, they mentioned that I was her beneficiary—but as the title says, NEVER SIGNED THE WILL. This means that her asset will immediately transfer to her next of kin, my mom. Cool, right? Mom will get some extra cash, live like a princess and probably gift a few bucks to me. No. Mom is on Medicaid. So in essence, my Aunt worked her entire life only for the state to come in and take it. But it gets worse. Because of this increase in assets, mom will actually get kicked off Medicaid and have to go through the whole process again. The real kicker? She got a letter in the mail the day she went back into the hospital letting her know her will was never signed. I am so angry. She would have been better off leaving her entire estate to charity. My feelings aside, she would have never wanted to harm her sister financially. What a mess. Anyway, thank you for reading if you've gotten this far. Please, please check your loved ones documents. No matter what they said and promised, they are elderly and the system is stacked against them."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 47 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nqewid/relative_didnt_sign_her_will/

↳ **comment** (23): "If it was life changing money couldn't your mom give up the medicaid for the nursing home and become private pay??"

↳ **comment** (18): "ugh. yeah. when my mom made up her will, she had to make sure she didn't leave anything to one of her brothers who was on Medicaid and in a care facility so it wouldn't mess up his status and benefits. is there a way for your mom to waive the inheritance?"

↳ **comment** (17): "Hey OP - not sure how helpful this is but my dad is an attorney that specifically focuses on complex trusts/wills/estate cases etc - I'd be happy to run this situation by him to see if there's any other things you can do. Attorneys are expensive but he's my dad so he has to respond to my questions! DMs are open if you want"

"Amy, you just gave me approval on how and why I am such a great caregiver to my mom. It has been ten years since my mom had a stroke. Left her left side paralyzed. I am so grateful I am in the position to help her. In return she has made me feel so good about myself. We do live in a fast paced world and she is a reminder to me that we need to slow down and enjoy the simple things in life. I believe we have more Ying and Yang in our lives because we have each other. Thanks for your video. Too many here are lost to what you are trying to say. I can tell from the comments that many in this situation are frustrated and need to vent. Not easy being a caregiver. Most challenging situation anyone can be in but can be the most rewarding too."

youtube · @michaelchin3550 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 29 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=Ugx8W_SrOnLKd16SDC14AaABAq

"DONE!. Just need to vent. I've posted before on this forum, but it's been awhile. My brother and I are only siblings. Mom spent almost 2 years in the nursing home, with a year and a half on PRIVATE PAY, thanks to my brother, who lived with her and was "supposedly" taking care of her. He took care of Dad and Mom ALL THEIR

lives, not because they needed him all those years, but because he needed them. They supported him completely and he bought expensive items with his own money (found out later, PLUS some) on a disability check after working 7 years total, at menial jobs. Our mom did everything for him, even washed his hair! She thought the ground he walked on was holy. Anyway, he ended up basically mooching off them all his life, under the pretext of "taking care" of them. Dad passed away almost 20 years ago. Mom lived to be 102, passed last fall. Just suffice it to say that hoarding was a nice (although nowhere near accurate) description of what he did. He basically piled up TWO houses, ruining them BOTH in the process and causing the tax assessed value to drop to 1/3 of the original value. He basically didn't want to do anything I suggested to get the estate deeded to him legally because he was simply too lazy. The second house caused a real problem with her Medicaid eligibility (which my husband and I had tried to discuss with Mom 10-15 years ago, after Dad passed). I said Brother could have it all, I didn't want anything. He ended up ruining Mom financially, and as you can tell from the tax reassessment I had done, wrecked the entire place. I tried reporting to APS, but they never even went inside, and seemed fine with empty beer cans and junkers (8 of those) scattered across the back yard). I eventually had to take over everything to fix her over-drafted bank accounts (with my own funds) and close them out...that even made Bro mad. I eventually just took over because he was lying and hiding bills and letters, almost got Mom evicted for her private pay not being paid...nursing home billing office manager called me, which was the first I was aware. Bro didn't want to deal with the mess he had made, which ended up being dumped on me and my husband...trying to clear out the houses to salvage what we could (FOR my Bro) because once Mom ran out of money, he ran out of money, so he managed to get admitted to the nursing home for leg issues from a car accident in his 20's (he refused all doctor visits for 40 years)...he then said he couldn't walk one night. Since he lived with Mom, even that almost messed up her Medicaid. But eventually I got her Medicaid approved, then she passed two months later. The proceeds from the estate went toward her private pay bill, which did not even cover all of it because Bro hid his head in the sand for all that time, lied, etc. Anyway, he got mad at me about 4 months ago and cursed at me in a text. I ignored it but all he would ever talk about in his texts was the young female aides, and the personal intimate care they were giving him, and he refuses to allow male aides to care for him. I finally told him I really didn't want to hear all that "drama"...I did not feel it appropriate. Never once did he text without going into those sorts of details. He mentioned his showers and his underwear and "wetting" himself every single text. We found porn tapes hidden while salvaging his possessions for him. He has a fake FB page that popped up (he didn't even change his name!) with erotic pictures of young female nurses and teachers. He has a history of ...obsession, I'll call it. Previously on his FB page, he said he was in a relationship with someone he had obviously met on the internet. He has done everything within his power to report the older female staff and asked for the younger ones to replace them for his personal care. Now let me say that he has been having chest pain and high BP, yet what he got mad about was I mentioned seeing OTC testosterone supplements peeking out his bedside table one day...when they told him he wasn't supposed to be taking them, they said that I had "reported" it. So he got very angry. I said, "Fine, let him have an MI. See if I care." I will also add that he has NEVER, to my knowledge, had a normal relationship, never been married, is 73 years old, slow mentally, and is a nursing home resident! He texted 3 weeks or so ago and said he has lung cancer. He had had a CT scan during an ER visit for high BP and chest pain, and supposedly the hospital had sent him a letter informing him he has lung cancer. Concerned, I drove up to the nursing home that evening. I know that is not the process for patient notification. He showed me the letter and it said he had a couple of nodules that showed up, but most are benign, and his PCP may want to follow up. He argued with me that that meant he has cancer. He also said the nurse had told him he has a huge mass in his stomach. He finally gave me permission to speak with the nurse...I have a healthcare background. The nurse couldn't believe he said that...she said she had explained what "benign" means and had explained the follow-up process to him, and told him his stomach is fine...no mass was even mentioned. So I tried to explain to him, but couldn't tell if he understood. I sent him a text that evening from home explaining it simply and told him if he has questions, he can ask the nurse or me. Nothing from him. So I said, "Or maybe you want me to butt out". Nothing. He hasn't spoken to me in weeks. And he never answered me. He cussed me out one time lately in a text over the testosterone supplement so I just left him alone to chill for awhile. Next thing he texted, "Can you bring my computer"...the one still in the

unopened box he ordered two years ago that we salvaged for him from the piles of hoarded stuff. I took it to him, with his mail that he still gets at Mom's PO box. He accused me of not caring anything about him. I said he hadn't answered me. Oh, I was supposed to know that his "phone isn't working" and I should have called and asked the nurse to bring him the phone from the desk. WHAT? How was I supposed to know his phone "isn't working" (which I think is a lie) because he said the typos were due to his phone issue, NOT to HIM! Well, it all got out of hand and he was saying that I was a KNOW IT ALL and I should have checked on him (I asked why he didn't check on US- BECAUSE HIS PHONE WASN'T WORKING!) Claimed I didn't visit Mom or call about her when she was in the hospital...I said, I DID call! We couldn't even get our special needs daughter through Mom's house, and that was before he completely trashed it. Oh no you didn't! I said How would YOU know? Oh, HE knows! And then accused me of being just like Daddy and said he couldn't stand Daddy. I told him I loved our dad, and he said that was just because I didn't know because HE was the one living with them. Like yeah, ALL his life. I didn't intend to, but I finally told him he trashed everything and the place was a pigsty. And, predictably, that was because "he was taking care of Mom in the nursing home!". If I had had the presence of mind, I would have asked him why he managed to endure his hatred for our dad for all those years when Dad was putting a roof over his head and food on the table. At one point, he raised up as if to hit me. I absolutely will not tolerate that and I told him so. (And a very unsettling thing when I entered his room... I don't want to be too graphic here, but he is always lying down in bed, and today he had a blanket over his lower body and there was some suspicious movement down there. But I didn't. I just told him I won't be back, and he said, "Good!". So I'm done. I talked to nursing and the case manager and told them what happened and that I hated I lost my temper because it was not my intention to upset him. The case manager said he has already asked them to remove me as emergency contact from his chart. And they said he has been in one of his complaining moods all day anyway. I do feel bad about losing my temper and I know I could have just exited the room. It was like my feet were glued to the floor. I really didn't mean to upset him but I just won't take his accusations. I really no longer care what he thinks of me. He can bad-mouth me to the staff and say whatever he wants. I think I have come to the conclusion that he is crazy and always has been. He has become agitated lately (IMO) because two of the female aides who he literally talked about all the time were fired. I just don't go in for all that drama. But I think it might have unhinged him. Well, more than usual... But I do have to be honest in that I can't stand to be in the same room with him. I don't know if it is possible to disown a brother, but I am DONE! I'll try to forgive him again, but I'm not there yet after him yelling SHUT UP to me today. And no I don't think he has dementia. I think he's just a selfish little B__ST_D that my mom coddled all his life. I'm not his Mom."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 19 upvotes · <https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uk7ylh/done/>

"You're right. You're in hell. And you don't need to be. You just need to give yourself permission to not let the dementia kill you, too. If she has Medicare and already has Medicaid, you should have no financial issues getting her into care. Her social security will go to the facility, so if you count on that money for your monthly expenses, that could be a barrier. Other than that, they'd take any liquid she has, and leave her broke. But so what?!?! You sound relatively young, way too young for your life to be over. I hereby give you permission to not start making calls Monday morning, and instead take her to the ER- she's not living! She's EXISTING, and wouldn't want this for YOU. Sending you a hug. 🤗 . Here if you need to vent or seek advice. 💖💖"

reddit comment · r/dementia · 11 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1nh2anj/what_happens_when_you_cant_do_things_anymore/ne99zhz/

"Anyone have experience with medical alert systems that actually work?. My dad fell in his garage last week and couldn't get up for 20 minutes until my mom found him. I live 3 hours away and this is exactly what keeps me up at night. I've been looking at different medical alert systems but honestly the reviews are all over the place. Some people swear by certain brands, others say they're terrible. What I'm really looking for is something reliable that

won't give false alarms every time he moves wrong, but will actually work when he needs it. He's not great with technology so it needs to be simple. I've been researching bay alarm medical and a few others but would love to hear from people who actually use these things or have parents who do. What's worked for your family?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 10 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfdw3j/anyone_have_experience_with_medical_alert_systems/

"Similar experience here... I am two years in the deepest depths of caretaking and I had to take a big step back and feign an interview for a new job with "terrible hours" before I could get through that someone else needed to help. I also had a conversation with Mom (make sure to do this in a different room or at lunch **without step-dad in earshot** that I was at a breaking point to reinforce the level of help *I* needed to continue to help them. Having conversations in front of step-dad is unproductive because she will be paranoid/ distracted in front of him. It wasn't until she was worried about *me* that she became more open to letting people into the house. Tell her you are worried about losing your (new or current) job because of needing to be available to help them. Happy to talk more in DMs if you need to vent. I dont want to be too specific for privacy reasons. I also found it helpful to find one task she hates the most and to argue for getting help with that one little thing before she got more comfortable asking for help with other things. Maybe laundry? I had to find a way to break the seal of not letting *anyone* into the house and move forward slowly from there with more help. I agree with the person who said to make a schedule of when you are coming over and be clear about what you will and will not do. Once you tell mom she needs to put together a list of what she needs help with for when you visit, that may help her visualize the amount of work involved. If right now you are coming over and just seeing what needs to be done and then doing it, there is little recognition of how much work is involved. The list and getting her to give you directions (aka ask for help) is a paradigm-shift you can obscure through making her think the list is for *you*. Dunno what their health insurance provides, but I was surprised at the resources available for drop-ins through insurance. Sounds like step-dad would be a candidate, at least, to allow mom to leave the house more often. You can argue it's so she can go food shopping, but she may quickly realize she can run other errands and make lunch plans, too. Between social workers, home health aides for hygiene, nurses, volunteers, etc., they came often stay for a max of two hours to facilitate other tasks."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vrnyqa/seriously_contemplating_walkin_g_away_from_my_mom/p4fz81t/

"You aren't alone, know that. I pretty much could have written your post. My mother is currently living in my home. She's 88 and some days I fear she'll bury me. I don't wish this on anyone. My goal is to find an appropriate living situation to transition her into. But this is about you. I'm sorry that anyone else has to deal with this, it sucks. If you need an ear to vent feel free to DM me. Almost everyone on this sub understands and isn't judging."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 5 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/18ccwul/vent_im_exhausted_taking_care_of_someone_who/kceiirq/

"Very eye opening on how to except elderly. I am a caregiver for the elderly and it is the best job I ever had. They just want someone to listen what they have to say and I am learning something every time."

youtube · @blankawilliams3726 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 2 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhikEw&lc=UgxdhrP6UX_REmKSNgZ4AaABAg

"Oh man, the panic attacks. I had one right in front of my mother about three months ago because I had to give her an injection for her nerve pain before it escalated, time was running out, but I couldn't remember how to get the cap off the needle. I completely melted down in hyperventilating panic and scared the life out of Mom before I managed to call a nurse friend and get her to talk me through it. But it was a wake up call for both of us that even after being "trained" to give her injections, I could not handle it on an ongoing basis. She needed someone with

medical experience who could stay calm and objective in a crisis, and that meant putting her in care. Anyway, even though I wouldn't wish that kind of panic on anyone, it's comforting to hear from someone else who has been down the same road. Thanks for your comment."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 1 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iq68hc/the_end_of_a_caregiving_era/md07zym/

"Hey! I'm new here, and I just need to vent for a minute. · First, the positive. I am incredibly thankful that my mom was able to receive a full heart transplant at 70 years old. She's now 72 and has truly been given a new lease on life. She also suffers from Lupus, and before her transplant, she was extremely sick. For that miracle, I will always be grateful. · Now, let me tell you about me. · I'm her only child. I'm 44 years old. I work full-time as a special education teacher. I'm a full-time mom to two wonderful sons, one grown man and one teenager who is involved in every sport imaginable. I'm also a full-time student working toward a higher degree. · On paper, that all sounds great. · But I'm tired. · I'm tired of cleaning and re-cleaning. I'm tired of figuring out transportation to appointments and trying to keep up with which appointments I need to attend with my mom. I'm tired of monitoring what she eats and making sure she has the foods she needs. With all the food recalls lately, I often spend more money than I'd like because I have to be extra careful about how I shop for and handle her food. · I feel like I'm constantly carrying an attitude because I'm running on empty. · Every morning, I make sure my son is ready for school, my dog is taken care of, and then I go to work and give my students my all. When I come home, it doesn't stop. There is always something that needs to be done. · I know I should be grateful, and I am. But I'm also exhausted. · Before anyone asks about resources or assistance, we've already looked into what she might qualify for. The reality is that she receives \$24 in food stamps and Medicare. That's it. I'm the primary provider. Thankfully, I've been able to pick up extra tutoring hours to help make ends meet. · I'm not looking for assistance. I'm just looking for understanding. · I would never let my mom or my family go without. We've been incredibly blessed, and I thank God for that every day. But caregiving, working, parenting, and going to school all at once is a lot. · So that's it. That's my post. · I just needed to say it somewhere. · Some days, staying strong is exhausting."

fb group · <https://www.facebook.com/groups/1581265219534379/posts/1800034654324100/>

"I went to the county office and had my mom taken in for a psych eval (IVC) twice before they would listen to me and recommend placement. Mom is now in a locked down memory care facility that she pays for and they make sure she takes her meds. I spent probably an hour on the phone with a psychiatrist that mom gaslit into believing she was a harmless old woman that missed me dearly. Thankfully the next psychiatrist saw through it and said she was mentally ill and in need of full time care, not by me. A cop told me it can take many such IVCs to get someone to listen. If one hospital won't do it, demand your mom be sent to another. The term, "Unsafe discharge" meant nothing to the gaslit psychiatrist, but a lot to the last social worker at the other hospital. Oh, and disable her car to the point she can't get it fixed. After they take her away, change the locks on your house and take a week's vacation out of town with your phone on silent. Find a home for the cats. Get a security camera so if the homeless men come back you can call 911 if they try to break in."

agingcare · <https://www.agingcare.com/questions/refuse-to-pick-up-my-mother-with-dementia-and-severe-uti-from-an-unsafe-hospital-discharge-498909.htm>

Tab 9 — Typical Day

24/7, for years · 569 documents

20 most engaged of 569 matching documents, complete text.

"NPR story on caring for aging parents (venting). NPR did a story yesterday morning on caring for aging parents, interviewing a woman who ended up taking care of her mother 24/7 while her mother was bedridden. While it accurately depicted the struggles of caregiving, it ended as most of these stories do by making it redemptive, saying what a beautiful thing it was or what a privilege it was to take care of her mother. My mother died last year, and I've been piecing my life back together. I used to think I might "get my life back," but I've found that you don't. You can't get back all the lost social and career opportunities. You don't get your mental and physical health back. You have to figure out what to do with what's left. I took care of my mother because I felt it was my duty as her son to do so. Most people tell me I objectively did a good job, but I was never temperamentally suited to the role. I forced myself to do it, every day. I put a mask on and was pleasant to her, but I hated having to try to get my mother to do the basic things she needed to do every day. By the end, as her dementia progressed, it felt pointless. I was maintaining a body that had very little mind left in it when I could have been putting my own mind to work in my business, solving problems for clients. I lost my biggest client because I didn't have time to do the work he needed me to do. I resented it. Dementia would be my own worst nightmare, and having to be face to face with it day after day is something I'm now dealing with in therapy. It was traumatizing. And now I'm still dealing with my mother's estate with a sibling who thinks she deserves half of everything even though she did absolutely nothing to help, ever. She couldn't care less what it cost me. She takes it all for granted. I just hate when people try to sugar-coat what caregiving does to your life and try to frame it in sentimental terms. It wrecked my mental and physical health. It wrecked my business. It wrecked my social and romantic life. It's made me hate my sister for her apathy and greed. I'm 59 and trying to get back into the dating world, and I feel like I'm having to learn how to do it all over again. I'm having to re-learn how to go out and socialize with people. I can only relate my own story, but caregiving didn't leave me with some rosy afterglow. Caregiving wrecked my life. I'm satisfied that I did my duty to my mother, but that's it. It didn't give me some wonderful gift. The news media will never report that story. Edit: Thanks for all the responses. Part of what set me off yesterday was the fact that it was my mother's birthday, and several people sent me messages about how I must be thinking about my mom today. The thing is, I wasn't. I was working all day trying to get a job done for a new client. And I thought about my mother 24/7 for years. I'm done thinking about my mother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,034 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s1ggmt/npr_story_on_caring_for_aging_parents_venting/

"I have to brag because I'm so freaking happy.... My Mom (then age 84) absolutely ran herself into the ground after my Dad (at age 86) fell and hit his head and walked around with an undiagnosed brain bleed for over 24 hours. After he was released from the hospital and rehab she became his primary caregiver, and learned everything from "scratch". Aides were hired but she was #1 for him. He deteriorated quickly, not even being able to feed or toilet himself. This continued for almost 3 years. After we finally convinced her to admit Dad into a nursing facility, she agreed to clear out her large home of 50 years and moved into an apartment nearby. There, she continued to take care of him, going there for about 5 hours every day, doing his laundry, choosing his favorite foods, and even giving him pt after Medicare said that he didn't need it because he had improved as much as he could and denied coverage. Dad was in nursing for just over 3 years when he passed earlier this year. It was tough. Mom always preferred her garden and kitchen to socializing and she found it difficult to make friends. Her eyesight and hearing are bad, so she had to give up driving and it was difficult to hear what people were saying to her. She turned 90 the week after Dad passed and slowly, with the help of some incredible neighbors in her building, she has become such a different person. She now takes yoga classes 3 mornings a week, and balance/strength-training on one morning. Whenever she hears that a person that she knows isn't feeling well, she makes and gives them soup. She has even participated in potlucks and gone to outdoor concerts over this summer. I am

over the moon with love and respect and happiness for her! Over this past weekend, my husband and I took her to her granddaughter's wedding in the mountains. We got her a hotel room next to ours, she hadn't been away overnight since 2019. I was ready to leave the reception at 8pm and she pressed us to stay on. Then she, when I went to the restroom, decided to dance with everyone! I came back and couldn't believe what I was seeing!! Dancing for at least a half dozen songs in a row (upbeat, loud songs, too!), my niece was crying, my brother was grinning ear-to-ear, others were coming up to hug her. It was wonderful! I am writing this to, well, brag a little. *None* of us thought that she would bounce back from the loss of her husband of over 70 years and the literal hell that was taking care of him practically on her own for so long, but to let anyone else out there who might be in the same sort of situation that with patience and encouragement the path of an older person's life can be changed. Of course, Mom resisted for a bit, but she finally relented and still isn't very social, but she is happy. And has friends. And that's all I could have possibly hoped for. I wish that I could post the photo of her dancing that my husband took, I'm having it framed ❤️ EDIT: I just want to THANK ALL OF YOU for your wonderful replies! I'm so glad that I could give everyone a warm, fuzzy feeling and, just maybe, some hope with their own current or future situation. We have always called Mom "our Energizer Bunny" and somehow, as she has aged, the nickname is even more appropriate. 😊 "

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 830 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3g2fn/i_have_to_brag_because_im_so_freaking_happy/

↳ **comment** (162): "man this got me right in the chest, what a recovery arc for your mom at 90 she went from full time caregiver for years to out here dancing at a wedding like she 25, that's incredible my own grandmother shut down completely after my grandpa passed and never came back from it so reading this hit me in a way i wasn't ready for today the soup thing is so pure too, she sounds like a gem"

↳ **comment** (101): "And now she's spread good feelings all across the internet. ❤️ "

↳ **comment** (33): "She sounds like an extraordinary woman - good for her and you! Loved your post."

"Both of my parents died suddenly without any warning. I didn't realize it at the time, but that turned out to be sort of a blessing. I'm watching a couple of friends of mine caring for their elderly parents with dementia or severe physical debilitation. It's a major struggle every single day and they are destroyed emotionally."

youtube · @christinemarie6976 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 711 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwgdwOMhrW2_y-LEo54AaABAg

↳ **@obstantiadiscindo** (41): "Truly a blessing, for both them and you. What no-one tells you is the exhaustion and eventual resentment because of the exhaustion, is surpassed by guilt at feeling exhausted and resentful. Meanwhile, the person you knew and loved is gone, mentally. There's just a frail husk left. Can't talk, move, feed themselves, is doubly incontinent. Is unaware of the world in any meaningful sense, but is aware of the indignities of being hoisted up to be cleaned up, who looks blankly in your eye as you're feeding them, and you don't know if they recognise you or not. Better to lead a full life and die at 80 than be a zombie at 93, paying thousands every month to be a breathing husk in the hands of strangers because your family, now wracked with guilt and exhaustion, just can't do it any more."

↳ **@Leann-uj9rg** (37): "Mine had warning. My mom 6 months, my dad a week. But I see situations as mentioned in this video and feel the cards dealt to me were a blessing in disguise, although I miss them terribly. Neither made it out of their 70s but each functioned well enough to the very end. At least I got to say goodbye and see you later. ❤️🥺 "

↳ **@RA-sv8lr** (28): "My mother's in her 80s now, bright as a button but lost most of her mobility. It's so hard losing a parent however they go but, for my Mum's sake, I hope when she goes it's peacefully in her sleep and not

from some long, painful illness. I'm so sorry for your losses but glad that you are now able to appreciate the manner of their passing as a blessing of sorts. x"

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :, can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"As an RN for over 40 years, I watched the caregiver collapse when the parent died. The stress and 24/7 care destroyed their health. Some even died. It is usually the female who gives up her career, marriage, life, and ends up with the total responsibility for their parent or grandparent. It is wrong!"

youtube · @nancyhjort5348 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 623 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwvOw2jjfIM5t3-MJR4AaABAq

↳ **@AN-GEL.AI.Official** (64): "That is how I felt yesterday , I thought I am going to die before my Mom. I also have a husband and another household to take care of daily. It is not easy!"

↳ **@gwenaguilar7049** (40): "My mom took care of my nana her whole life. In her later years my nana was too much. My mom did is by herself. My aunt's lived far away. My nana died alone in a nursing home during covid. We weren't allowed to see her because of the ruled during covid. That destroyed my mom. 9 months later my mom had a stroke. She made a miraculous recovery and has very little signs to anyone outside our family that she had a stroke. Now our momma is going to be 78 and our daddy 79. They don't want to be a burden, and don't like

asking for help, because of the burden of taking care of my nana. Thankful my brother, sister-in-law, and hubby all help. Our journey with them is just beginning and can feel it"

↳ **@mariaabreu9085** (40): "The usual social misconception that women must obey, sacrifice and support others."

"Never use "A Place for Mom". They are stalkers. They will call and email you nonstop for YEARS. My dad was 92 when I contacted them many years ago. Nonstop calls and emails. Block the calls? Can't. They either use multiple numbers or they're spoofing their caller ID. My dad died at 100. And yes we found a great place on our own. But even though he died already, I'm STILL getting harassing phone calls from fresh numbers "concerned" about my dad and whether I found a place. Don't do it! In fact if you have an enemy, give them their info. They're the scum of the earth. I almost feel like getting some referrals and then 1-starring those referrals based on them using APFM. Argh. Ok rant over."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 590 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/

↳ **comment** (264): "A reputable company gave me this link to send to APFM so they would LEAVE ME ALONE! I sent in the form and haven't been contacted since. They were horrible and the calls were relentless. [Do Not Represent Me Form](<https://civica.formstack.com/forms/dnrm>)"

↳ **comment** (186): "Just FYI. I may be paranoid, but I suspect APFM has employees monitoring this sub because everytime anything negative about them comes up, a bunch of people rush in to defend them. If you've had good luck with them, awesome for you, but remember that advertising and commercial posts are prohibited in this sub. I, personally, keep my recommendations to nonprofits and governmental agencies in honor of the sub rules. APFM is a for-profit business whose revenue comes through referral fees they collect from senior living communities and home healthcare providers. Not every service provider is willing to pay their fees, so if you enlist APFM's help, you're not seeing every option available. And, yes, if your aging parent is low income, they are disincentivized from helping you. The fact they use aggressive sales techniques like never removing your phone number from their call list should be enough of a clue. Add your number to the FTC's Do Not Call Registry, make sure to get the call center employee to tell you who they are working for, and tell them you're on the DNC registry and will report them for violating the law (and actually follow through...it's easy)."

↳ **comment** (81): "I was pestered by them for a long time. I started getting pretty feisty about, saying "No I don't need your help because my mother is DEAD. Stop calling me, you can't make any money off me, because I don't have someone to help!" Eventually they stopped."

"My mom informed me I will be inheriting the care of my two siblings. I am the oldest of three. Me 50F, sister 46F and brother 37M. Roughly 6 months ago, my mother (75F) and I were discussing her paperwork (POA, will, etc) and all of the necessary related things. She said "don't forget, you will have to look after your siblings". Ok, my siblings have both had their issues. So I dared to ask, what exactly do you do for them regularly? My sister has made numerous stupid decisions over the years, and my mom has bailed her out several times, mostly financially. She is currently living with her boyfriend of 18 years. Just found out he owes \$63K in back taxes to the IRS. They are finally taking action. If he loses his house, my sister will lose the roof over her head. I honestly think my mother expects me to take her in, because I have an "empty bedroom". (My oldest finished college, found a good job and got her own place. I still have two more living at home currently in college.) No. Just NO. My mother has always been my sister's back up plan. Mom said she's ready for me to "take over." No. Next is my brother. He is autistic and has medically well managed schizophrenia. He does have his own place, car, and manages to hold down a 32-hour a week cashier job. Admittedly I have a soft spot for him. So, I asked, how can I help? I was thinking mental health/medical needs (I'm an RN). Nope, my mother micromanages every aspect of this kids life. She spends as much time at his apartment as she does at her house. Cleans, does his laundry, takes out his trash. I

was speechless. They are so intermeshed and co-dependent that I don't even have words. She makes him call her twice a day if she isn't there. I told her my version of "helping" and her version are two VERY different things. I raised my three kids, and thankfully they are all transitioning to adulthood. I'm starting to embrace the 'empty nest', I have zero desire to take on another 'kid'. I probably should have disclosed from the beginning, all three of us have the same parents. We grew up in an abusive/neglectful household. Dad was the main perpetrator, he's been dead for years. All three of us kids got different versions of mom. I bailed as soon as I graduated high school, and am admittedly not that close with anyone. I'm friendly but keep my distance. Apparently my mom thinks I am "taking over" as she is "getting too old" but she does not approve of my boundaries, my "list" of what I am willing/not willing to do. She has accused me of "abandoning my siblings". I'm not even sure what I am asking for here. Just venting? There is much more. I could type for days."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 559 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1q839bu/my_mom_informed_me_i_will_be_inheriting_the_care/

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I

could listen to him bitch and heat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert

systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her, but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had."* This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin My cousin also asked her to consider the same The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I*

tried to explain really meant we would have to deal with it "when she has to." My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set of what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1rtrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"I get to retire today. My sweet mom, after a year with in-home hospice and 4 years of post brain tumor difficulties and 24/7 care, she finally headed home to heaven. Hospice detected signs last Thursday with the finding of a Kennedy ulcer. Bittersweet feelings as life on earth had been torture the last few years for her and glad my Dad and I could take care of her at home. A lot of sacrifice, depression and isolation — but I would do it again. She leaves an ocean sized void in my heart. Caregiving is not for the weak, but it gives you purpose and I am now without purpose. Take care friends and always remember you're not alone."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 355 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nebf4t/i_get_to_retire_today/

"How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care, and your adult child wrote you and the whole family this letter regarding that situation?. Dear family, I've been doing a lot of reflecting lately on the situation with Grandma and Grandpa, and I feel a need to share some thoughts that have been weighing on me. I know we are all doing our best to navigate this, but I want to offer a different perspective—one that might be uncomfortable, but feels necessary to voice. I can't help but feel that what we are witnessing is, in many ways, fundamentally unnatural. Decades ago, you rarely heard of couples requiring 24/7 professional assistance

simultaneously; there was a natural rhythm to life and passing that seems to have been disrupted. It feels as though modern medicine has become so focused on the mechanics of keeping the body running that it has moved far away from human nature itself. By pushing past what might have once been our natural "expiration dates," we've entered a territory where the cost of longevity is a loss of the very independence that defined them. Perhaps the most jarring part of this experience for me is seeing the in-home care staff every day. While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge; instead of a family visit, it feels like a supervised appointment in their own home. Because of this, I want to be very clear about my own wishes for the future: Once I reach the age of 75, I do not want any extraordinary measures taken to prolong my life. Whether it is surgery, intensive treatment, or any form of medical intervention, I want to let nature take its course. Furthermore, if I ever reach a point where I can no longer safely live independently, please do not try to recreate a hospital within my home. I am asking you now to please just put me in a professional facility. I would rather my home remain a memory of who I was, rather than a place defined by its clinical needs. I know this is hard to hear, and I don't say it to diminish the love we all have for them. I just feel we need to acknowledge the reality of the era we are living in and how much it has changed the way we experience the end of life. With love and honesty, Jack"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 349 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

↳ **comment** (259): "A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

↳ **comment** (147): "I was Jack almost a decade ago. The PTSD I have associated with helping my mom care for my grandparents will never leave me. It *ruined* my memories of my grandparents who I loved so much and spent much of my childhood with. It sucks to be the elderly person or the caregiver, but being a support person for the caregiver sucks too. We are watching an elderly loved one basically be tortured into living, another loved one get burnt out to a crispy husk of a person, and we just have to sit there like 'This is fine.....' It's really sad, frustrating, depressing to watch, and makes you look around and scream 'am I taking crazy pills?!'"

↳ **comment** (140): "I studied gerontology and death & dying. Because of that, I made an Exit Plan 20 years ago. I saw what was going to happen with the massive, aging, Boomer population & there's nothing good about it. I've completed all my EOL documents (Will, Living Will/Healthcare POA, financial/durable POA), each kid has copies. Pre-planned & pre-paid for my cremation. I'm very open with my kids about EOL stuff and how I don't want to burden them with my care. Of course, they say "we don't mind," but I've seen 1st hand how caregiving tears apart families and breaks caregivers. I don't want to do that to my kids."

"Rethinking falls. About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they now have (and of course managing this is all on me). Of course multiple people, including myself, had told them they needed a stair lift, but they didn't listen, because it was "too expensive." So much of the advice around aging is around preventing falls. And yes, they

should be prevented if you want to keep living. But – and this is cold – we keep acting as though we want elderly people to live forever, and then as a society we don't support them, or us the caregivers. Falls are terrible and painful and I wish my mom hadn't had one. But it should have been the end. The EMTs should've come and said oh, sweetheart, this is terrible, we are giving you morphine. It is utterly crazy that she was in the hospital for so long and cost taxpayers well over \$1 million in Medicare, only to come home and require so much care and drain their finances and eventually go on Medicaid. I don't know what we do about this. When my mom fell, I felt like she almost subconsciously had done it on purpose. That summer she had been telling me how tired she was, and how she was ready to quit taking care of my dad, who is very demanding, and my disabled sibling (that's a whole other story). I was sure we were going to lose her and of course at the time I didn't want to but now I realize that would have been the natural thing. Figured you all would relate. I am not doing this to my kids."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 337 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

↳ **comment** (206): "This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

↳ **comment** (78): "My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

↳ **comment** (65): "Your poor mama. She is TIRED of dealing with your dad and sibling. The hospital, as awful as they can be, may have been a respite for her. Meals delivered. Her own bathroom. Mostly sweet staff. Poor you. You must be mentally exhausted on top of juggling THREE of them. The money drain is no lie. THREE DEPENDENTS in a two story house? How in the world? She's exhausted caregiving. She's probably been putting up with your difficult daddy with his demands all her life and you don't say when your sibling became disabled, but if it's been lifelong? Or since their 20's? That burns even saints out early. If they've qualified for Medicaid, can the house be sold and they go to skilled care or assisted senior living? Surely that would be cheaper than trying to maintain a home for three people needing 24 hour care."

"Useful items that have made it easier for us and our aging parents. Just a few items that have made caring for my aging parents easier. I want to mention these in case you are not aware or have not considered the benefits. **D-Mannose supplement**: this is the active ingredient in cranberry that helps prevent the formation of biofilm in UTIs. The capsules do not have a flavor. My mother-in-law would balk at the taste of cranberry capsules but does not object to these. **UTI test strips**: these are now over the counter in the US. Don't wonder, diagnose at home. This has been so helpful for my mother-in-law because getting her to the doctor is a difficult process. **Styptic products**: stops bleeding. Remember the white pencil that men used for shaving cuts? Now comes in pre-loaded bandages or loose powder. Check a camping or outdoors store or the pet aisle (dog nail care) for greater selection. The combination of my mother's fragile skin and blood thinners means she just bleeds and bleeds. **Tender tape**: this is a latex-free stretch bandage that sticks to itself but not to anything else. If your parent's skin is fragile, tender tape and a gauze pad is much better than self-adhesive bandages. I first saw this used as a veterinary product for putting bandages over fur, so you know it won't ever stick to skin. **Adhesive release spray**: when self-adhesive bandages can't be avoided, this spray will release the bandage without tearing the skin. My mother used to cry when it was time to change a bandage but no longer. **Compression garments**: look at products for runners, because runners' socks and calf sleeves may be easier to use for low-end compression needs. Cheaper than medical products, and using a combination of socks and calf sleeves means the socks can be changed every day and machine washed/dried. **Wig**: the weirdest helpful thing I ever bought. My mother is focused on her

appearance in a way I have never understood, but it's very important to her so I try to be supportive. When she broke her shoulder she could not color her hair or manage the bouffant style she's been wearing for decades. She wanted *me* to color her hair but I thought that was a recipe for disaster. In desperation, I bought a cheap wig and she looooooves it so much. These have changed since the '70s... the modern wigs are "capless" on a net base and not attached to something like a swim cap as they once were. Her shoulder has long since healed but the wig remains in use every day. ETA suggestions from the comments: Ring camera / Alexa drop-in Laminated page of medications / medical info (have multiple) Wireless cell phone charger Shoe expanders Clock with day/date as well as time Silicone cupcake liners - good for serving meds, modest portions of snacks, etc. easy to hold and non-slip, also useful for hearing aids at night Bed rail Ramp - for entry and exit, rubber or metal Low step stool - useful for getting into car, propping feet up to tie shoes Bath lifter - useful beyond the bathroom Transfer board - helps with transfer from wheelchair to/from bed Car door assist handle - sticks in car door for support getting in and out Car cane - for getting in and out of car Stand up stick - looks like a plunger, helps getting up from floor Bed assist rail Spring-loaded floor-to-ceiling grab pole (Stander Wonder pole) Shower bench, shower transfer bench Shampoo cap for washing hair in bed Hair fiber - Toppik and other brands, makes thin hair look fuller Handheld shower head with multiple holders at various heights Bedside commode Gel powder to soak up urine Shower wipes - look for unscented / sensitive skin version Long-handled toenail clippers Booster pads - for incontinence Quick Change Wraps - for incontinence Bidet attachment"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 326 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w2kxot/useful_items_that_have_made_it_easier_for_us_and/

"My mom has passed. and my heart hurts, literally aches, right now. But I am relieved. At the end she was not really living. She died in my arms here at home 24 hours ago. We had just done the hospice intake 24 hours prior but hadn't yet been seen by a nurse. I wished my mom could have gone out more comfortably than she did, but I am choosing to look at the bigger picture, of all of the love and comfort that she experienced over the course of her decline. She spent the last 3 weeks of her life here with me, pretty much bed-bound, and it all happened rather suddenly. She had Alzheimer's and a whole host of other health concerns (it was undiagnosed heart failure that did her in). But at some point in the past week, she had enough presence of mind to say to me: *you have shown me the most love and care of anyone in my life, you are so good to me, thank you for being so good to me* and I know this may sound odd, but it was a privilege for me to be able to nurse my mother in her final days. I love you mommy. I will always love you. Thank you to all of the kind folks in this subreddit who have been a source of comfort and support"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 304 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p3du0e/my_mom_has_passed/

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of

me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"better way to respond to parents saying they want to move back into their house?. Without getting into all the details: My parents both had serious accidents in their home recently. Both were in the hospital, then rehab. Now they are together at a very very nice assisted living place that they have agreed to stay in for at least three months. The problem is that they keep talking about how they plan to move back into the house. The house that has been unsafe for them - where they had their falls. Neither one of them is able to live independently at this point, let alone be a caregiver for the other. My sibling and I are the ones who have handled everything that needs handling during this extremely stressful time - and are still doing it. It's so much. I'm not local - I've been flying back and forth. My sibling lives about an hour away with two little kids and has been driving back and forth. We're exhausted, we're stressed. We are past the crisis part of this - I think - but there is still so, so much to do. For years we begged our parents to move to a one-floor condo or to build a bedroom on the first floor of their house (which

is just trip hazard city, between the stairs and a thousand throw rugs everywhere). They never thought this was important - never mind that Mom has Parkinson's and osteoporosis and both are in their 80s. We kept emphasizing that they could make choices while they were fully able, and get exactly what they wanted - or wait until there was a crisis, and have whatever choices were available then. They chose the latter. But they will not stop talking about moving back into the house. They think they can build a bedroom on the first floor, move the washing machine to the first floor, redo the bathroom, hire people to take care of them - and never mind that the two of them can't even figure out how to make a phone call right now. I guess they think the magic construction fairy will wave a wand and make this happen. I'm visiting right now, and it's been another stressful week - but also I am just so glad to spend time with my parents, and so grateful that this isn't worse. But meanwhile I've discovered that their house has mice - one more thing my sibling and I have to take care of. And the mice are living in the garbage they've been keeping in their kitchen cabinets and in the basement. I've asked them to pause talking about the house - I told them that I am at the end of my tether and need to get on top of what is happening more before I can even talk with them about where they are going next. I suggested they do some research about other living situations if they want - independent living, if they want, other ALFs, even construction companies and caregivers. But that I am not ready to talk about any of this while we are still so early in all of this, and I am still trying to get my dad into a doctor for his broken back because for some reason the osteo he's seen will only deal with his broken hip. But last night after dinner - the food at the ALF is good at least! - my mom started up again. And I lost it, in a very very ugly way. You really don't know what shame is until you've yelled at your 80-something year old mother in an assisted living home. I don't want to extinguish their hope - I don't want to be a jerk. I also am apparently furious that we are in this situation because they were living in this house, and I don't have it in me to have a lighthearted conversation about it right now. Not while we're still having to do so much. Given that it is inevitable they will bring up going home again - and given how raw I seem to be - what is the right way to respond next time? Thanks for reading my novel and oy, oy."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 241 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwrc/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/

↳ **comment** (210): "If they don't have the ability to arrange things, just refuse to execute on the idea and leave it on them to organize, standing firm that they can't move back until they have arranged all of that on their own."

↳ **comment** (207): "I suggest a slightly different approach that's worked well for me. Let them talk. Let them dream, let them plan. Talk is just that - talk. They are not able to actually DO anything without help from you or your sibling. If the talk starts to move into real specifics of "doing", which is unlikely, then you redirect. "Interesting idea mom and dad, let me think about that for a while". "I'll look into that mom and dad, I need a bit of time". This approach worked like a dream for my family."

↳ **comment** (125): "This is similar to getting my mom to stop driving. Her car broke and she wanted to replace it. None of us kids thought her getting behind the wheel again was as good idea. So we just didn't help her get a new one. She talked a lot at first about getting a new one, but couldn't figure out how to do it and none of us took the steps to do it for her. Eventually she stopped talking about it."

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always were there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws

a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are taking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"Day 3, my prayers were heard.. I swear some nurses are angels in disguise. For now, it's over... and I can finally breathe, shower, clean, whatever I need. My mom had a visiting nurse stop by today and I took that opportunity to tell her about the condition of the house and how there is no one to be there 24/7. She listened and reported it to the social worker. The social worker and the nurse called an ambulance and EMTs took her to a hospital. For the night at least, I can finally breathe. My alcoholic uncle is going off to rehab in another state on Monday. Now it is just me and my cousin and the animals here. I finally have peace for now. I actually laughed today. EDIT: update 9/20: The doctors at this new hospital were horrified with her treatment at the last hospital and she will NOT be coming home this time. She is going to a subacute rehab and will never return home. We are now suing the last hospital for medical malpractice."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 225 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nfiyw/day_3_my_prayers_were_heard/

The bathroom, the sheets, the pills · 485 documents

20 most engaged of 485 matching documents, complete text.

"This goes the same for spouses. My husband had a stroke at 61 and I was changing diapers for 2 years with no help and using the Lahoya lift many times a day. Feeding, bathing and he was diabetic..After 2 years I became ill and he spent the next 9; months in a nursing home where I visited him every day. I was 57 when he died and I have spent the last 15 years alone and the thought of dating never once entered my head because my caretaking days are over. I am happily alone with my cat."

youtube · @AutumnGold0706 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 956 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgztYmazblhZwkmWogF4AaABAq

↳ **@TheDrCatWoman** (68): "@AutumnGold0706 - hello. I don't know you, but you've answered a question for me. My grandmother spent the decade of the 1950s taking care of my grandfather who had become disabled after a series of strokes. She was in her 50s. I would describe her as a down to earth but high energy person. She worked full-time during that decade. And raised her child single-handedly. And cared for her evermore disabled husband. Anyway, I didn't know her until after my grandfather had died. After he died, there were a couple of times that she could've had a partner. There were a couple of men who were interested in being in a relationship with her over the years. One was the widow of a friend of hers, and the other was a man she met on a tour. I wondered why she didn't pursue either of these relationships. She preferred being on her own. And it was probably as you describe - she probably just didn't want to take care of someone else as they began to decline. She didn't begin to decline until she was over 80."

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (52): "Thank you for bringing this up. 💕 Very important to have conversations with spouses and anyone you are close enough with to potentially be a caretaker."

↳ **@luzfeli2964** (34): "@TheDrCatWoman you don't need to have your own spouse disabled to never want to be on a relationship, 😊 men are exhausting even if they're not disabled."

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and boom down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's

are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets.. Edit everything I say here is for the USA. private pay insurance. I've worked for home health for around five years now and I want to share some of the good and bad I've learned so you can make an informed decision about the care for your aging parents. There are two kinds of home health care ones that accept Medicare and one's that do not. The ones that do follow stricter guidelines for care (this doesn't mean they're better it just means they have to follow different rules than private insurance) my information only applies to those that do not take Medicare. First. It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY

CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour. So please don't act towards the caregivers like they should be doing \$50 an hour worth of work because they are not getting paid much above minimum wage. Second. Keep track of your loved ones need for care. If they fall and then need care or have a heart attack and need help after surgery. The agency is never ever going to tell you that the person is fine now and doesn't need care anymore. I go to several assignments where I do literally nothing the entire time I'm there just because no body says to stop sending us. Third. If you up the care from one kind to another temporarily after an injury or fall make sure that when you know they can go back down to less care that they return to charging you the lower rate. I've been to several assignments where I'm still being paid for hands on care even though all I'm doing is cleaning house. Fourth. Do not look at the caregivers like you would a cleaning crew That comes in and cleans as fast as they can to get done fast and move on to the next home. Caregivers are there for a set time so we are encouraged to sit and talk to our clients. Watch TV with them. Play games. Go for walks. We won't always be up doing things. We aren't someone who you hired to fix your toilet and now he's sitting on your couch. You hired us to take care of your loved one and sometimes that is just having a conversation or watching TV together. Fifth. Ask the caregiver what they need for the home and for the client. I went to an assignment last month that had no toilet paper in the whole house. The client was bedbound and used diapers so they just never thought to have toilet paper in the house. I literally had no way to wipe for the first day and I ended up bringing my own. Hand soap, paper towels, gloves, hand sanitizer all these things you are responsible for providing. Sixth. Understand that for the most part we are not nurses. Most states require little to no certifications to be a home health aide. So please understand the limitations of what we can/are allowed to do. We can't make medical decisions. We can't administer medicines. We can't change dressings. We can't even trim nails because if we cut you it could cause an infection. So please be very aware of what we are and are not allowed to do and don't ask or expect us to do something we aren't supposed to do. If you want any other advice ask it in the comments I'm happy to answer."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

↳ **comment** (363): "RN here and this is incredibly well written and all very true. Thank you for all you do. You ARE underpaid. Massively."

↳ **comment** (137): "It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients' cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception that the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

↳ **comment** (94): "Thank you. I love my job but I am aware of it's downfalls."

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone.. [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/) First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my post, I handled the first diaper change with more grace and compassion. I felt bad for 'losing it' the night before so I tried to do my best, again. One hour later a CNA came to help me wash mom and change one more diaper. Her hands and feet had turned purple at this point. Shortly after I realized mom was in pain. She couldn't vocalize anything, and I had expected it to show on her face, but her expression did not tell any discomfort. However she had her eyes wide open, wouldn't stop rocking back and forth, bending her legs, and it dawned on me that she must have been in unbearable pain. I wonder how long she must have been in pain without me realizing it, probably even the day before. I hate the fact that it took me, us, so long to realize she needed the morphine, and that she possibly spent

some of her last few days in pain, without being able to communicate it at all. It hurts my heart. So I called the nurse and we gave her morphine. She relaxed immediately. The doctor came by with a prescription for more morphine for the weekend, but warned me that mom probably wouldn't need it, because she had hours left. The diarrhea stopped too. The nurse came back, helped me prepare more syringes, and I gave her the morphine myself. In the evening she laid on her back immovable, breathing in a sort of robotic, loud way. As if she couldn't breathe, but some automatism was forcing her body to. I remembered that the morphine could help with breathing problems so I started preparing to inject it. I looked at her and noticed the breaths suddenly became more shallow, until she drew her last breath. Her face immediately turned pale. She still had a pulse for a few more moments, until that was gone too. I called the nurse, who was off shift, and she came to help me dress mom anyway. Then the doctor arrived and certified her death. She's now waiting for burial. I can't even describe the pain I'm in right now, but I wanted to let you all know that you've helped me a lot, and I'm glad I pushed through long enough to let her die at home with us. She's in a better place now, it kills me how much she suffered and endured. All I could do in her last hours was carress her and tell her how sorry I was for everything. I wish she had gone peacefully. I miss her already. I can't stop crying. Thank you all again."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/

↳ **comment** (115): "I'm very sorry for your loss. Give yourself some grace over being worn out and scared and grossed out. You're not a machine. And you gave her a gift by just being there until the end. You also figured out she was in pain, and relieved her of it. I'd say you did a great job under horrible circumstances. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (57): "I read your previous post and my heart went out to you. I'm so glad you managed right up to the end - your mom would have been so proud and happy to have had such a wonderful child."

↳ **comment** (43): "It was... it was absolutely worth it and I would do it again. I was imperfect and had my weaknesses and failures but I did show up for mom until the very end. The nurse and the doctor complimented me on my perseverance and it made me feel so seen. Mom would be proud."

"Aging, and the Right to Die with Dignity. My mother is 88. She lives in an assisted living facility about 10 minutes from me. And honestly, every time I walk through the doors, I get overwhelmed by what I see. It's actually a very nice facility for what we often think of as an "old folks home." There are different levels of ability, and there are people who are still social, engaged, and enjoying life. But I would say that more than half of the residents I see are essentially just existing. They are breathing, eating, using the bathroom, sleeping—and repeating it all again the next day. They are alive, but they aren't really *living*. I don't mean that to sound callous. It's just incredibly difficult to watch. My mother no longer enjoys her life. She doesn't have a terminal disease that is going to take her life anytime soon. She had a stroke, is diabetic and has the beginning stages of dementia, but her biggest problem is that her body has essentially stopped working. She can barely stand. She is constantly incontinent and often doesn't even realize when she has urinated or had a bowel movement. The staff helps her change, but they are caring for many other residents too. Sometimes my mother has to sit in her own waste for hours before someone is available to help her. Sometimes I stop by - the smell is so bad and she doesn't even notice it. I ask her if I can change her and she responds by saying it's not necessary (because she can not smell her own waste). She has very little control over her own life. She hates being in assisted living. She hates what has happened to her body. She hates needing help with things she once did without thinking. They do physical therapy with her, but between the damage from her stroke and diabetes, she has very little use of her legs beyond briefly standing to transfer to a toilet or chair. And the saddest part is that my mother is not an isolated case. There are so many people living this way. This is really my rant: I hear people all the time say, "I never want to live like that." And yet, when someone reaches a point where they no longer have any meaningful quality of life, the idea of allowing them to choose when and how they die is considered illegal, immoral, or taboo. I struggle to understand that. When one of my dogs was suffering, unable to walk, and losing control of their bladder and bowels, I could make the

heartbreaking decision to let them go peacefully. I could prevent them from having to continue living in a body that no longer allowed them to have any quality of life. Why don't we extend some version of that compassion and autonomy to people? I'm not talking about giving up on someone because they're old or disabled. I'm talking about respecting the wishes of a mentally competent person who has reached a point where they no longer want to continue living in a body that has become a prison. Why can't we decide for ourselves what *living* means to us—and, when the time comes, have the right to die with dignity rather than being forced to simply keep existing? Watching my mother live this way has made me question something I never really questioned before: **Is keeping someone alive always the same thing as giving them a life worth living?**"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 517 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vnse4u/aging_and_the_right_to_die_with_dignity/

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful*. Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her*. I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom CHOSE this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly AGAINST having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends ALSO saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit AGAIN, find a new place to live AGAIN, set up all my utilities AGAIN, and STILL have to manage HER life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING. I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7

months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER. THIS, more than ANYTHING, should be a clue that mom is NOT who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and THEN people will complain that mom is LONELY. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags under her bed rather than in the 3 FUCKING HAMPERS I've bought for her) FINALLY getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group

chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"She's going to trap me in soon, my adult life is over. My mom is 61 and will be getting let go from her factory job soon. She only speaks polish after living in the USA for 25 years and has nowhere to go. She won't go back to Poland, her retirement won't be more than \$1,300/month so she won't be able to afford her apartment. I live in a rural area with no public transportation so I'm it. I'm her only outlet. She's visiting us right now and is an absolute weirdo. I have a 20 month old baby and am getting ready for a mastectomy for breast cancer. I'm working full time and trying to make things fun for my son but I also need rest. She literally sits on top of me all the time. When I'm reading my son a book she comes in and will point to the pages like a toddler and go "RED CAR" loudly and so on. She tries to butt into my conversations with my husband but doesn't understand so wants a translation. She tries to steer the stroller or shopping cart with me and when I'm like fucking you do it she runs into me because she's staring off into the abyss as if she's never seen groceries in her life before. I feel like a trapped animal, I'm caged in my own home. Last night she told me she won't be able to take care of my baby when I'm doing my surgery because "he cries" and she's too uncomfortable. I literally have cancer. Like...what? She said she doesn't know how to build a relationship with him as she doesn't speak English and she doesn't think he likes her. I told her she needs to grow up and act like a caregiver (she won't feed or change his diaper) and not like a friend or grandma for fun she sees in the movies. So now I get to wake up in the hospital alone OR with a mother who doesn't understand shit as my husband is pacing the hotel with our toddler. I'm crushed. I'm so overwhelmed. She's like ready to move in, I mean she literally has nowhere else to go. I don't trust her with my baby after yesterday's shenanigans but most importantly I don't trust that I'll be happy again. My husband and I have build a calm life, we are best friends, and she literally just sits down and stares at us. I was up at 4am having coffee in my living room today and at breakfast she was like "did I see you in the living room this morning" and when I said yes she was like "but why were you sitting there?". I put on lotion and she goes "did you put on lotion? Wow" like wtf do you mean?! Ok rant over just a woman who's so overwhelmed I'm about to rip my hair out. W"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 455 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/

↳ **comment** (650): "She does not get to move in. Get her on waitlists for senior housing or speak to a social worker about how section 8 will go."

↳ **comment** (234): "Tell her no. She's been in the country 25 years, she's 61. I'm 61 and I've had lots of challenges. I figured them out. She can go back to Poland where the money she gets will go further. Just sit her down and say I'm sorry but I have to take care of myself and my family and you have to leave. If it breaks your relationship it breaks it and if she has nowhere to go that's her problem. I know this is harsh but you are currently in a life or death situation with breast cancer. You have your own life and your own kids to worry about and just be mean if you have to. This is something that all of us raised by these parents need to give ourselves permission to do. We have to give ourselves permission to stand up for ourselves even if it means we're going to feel guilty, even if it means they're going to be angry, even if it means they're going to tell relatives that we're awful towards them and abandon them. Too bad we're just going to have to live with that."

↳ **comment** (218): "THIS! THIS! THIS, OP! My mother only has social security and doesn't receive much more than your mother will. She lives in senior housing, and her rent is a percentage of her social security check - I think it's \$200 per month for a nice one-bedroom, one-bathroom apartment. The building itself is staffed 24/7 in case of emergencies. There's a rec room, a laundry room on each floor, and even a shuttle service that will take residents to appointments and stores for free. My mom was on a waiting list for about 6 months, but that was several years ago. Get your mom on those lists now if you can."

"How do you manage intense resentment towards your aging parent?. I don't resent that my mom is aging. I resent that she never prepared for the aging process, never saved, never had a plan in place, is barely hanging on living by herself and now it is left all to me, her eldest daughter, to manage her care. Sometimes the resentment is so intense it feels like I might explode. I feel spread so thin, and I know it's impacting my infant and my partner. I don't want to do this anymore. I don't want to be my mom's caretaker. I don't want to go to her house and try to find a clean place to sit. I don't want to have to wait til I get home to use the bathroom because her toilet is covered in feces even with housekeepers. I don't want to see my mom deteriorate before my eyes and feel like the situation is insurmountable. I live 2 blocks away but I don't want to help anymore. I'm so weary. I will never put my own daughter in this situation. Thank you to whoever has listened."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 451 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kzbb9p/how_do_you_manage_intense_re_resentment_towards_your/

"Never Say Never. I know I'm preaching to the choir here but never tell your family that you're never going to a nursing home. It's just so many levels of a crappy thing to do to them. Particularly if you haven't done the advanced financial and legal planning to provide for yourself. First of all: Your precipitating event for a nursing home is going to preclude your ability to object to a nursing home for starters. If you have a massive stroke, dementia, Alzheimer's, or a fall that you don't recover well from, you're going to be in no position to object. If you haven't prepared for that moment legally and financially then you are just dumping a huge burden on your family. Is that what you really want to do to them? Did you really raise your kids so they can spend 5-10 years wiping your arse after your stroke? Is this the future you want for them? Do you want them to care for you at such a high level after your food and lifestyle choices incapacitate you? Just no. I am informing my kids that if I am not willing / unable to bathe myself or toilet myself and there is no hope of recovery, then put me in a nursing home already. They do not need to feel guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 447 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ud5jqh/never_say_never/

"Can we normalize NOT wanting to be your parents caregiver?. I(31F) am struggling. My mom(62F) has been in the hospital a week and my siblings and I have been with her every day. I am on day 4 from 8am to 10pm only taking breaks for phone calls and paperwork. The nurses aren't taking care of her hygiene needs and that doesn't matter much bc my mom doesn't want their help. She. Wants. Me. Look plain and simple, I am not made for it. I can't do the smells and i cant do the fluids. I absolutely admire and commend every person who has taken this role but i tried and i cant. My mom asks me to walk her to the bathroom, and i do it, but i fight gags the entire time and crack the door with my nose hanging out. If I can get a nurse to come in, i do. But my mom gets mad bc she wants me. Then when it comes to baths, she ignores the nurses and looks me dead in the eyes and says "I want you to do it." And "you need to learn to do this." And I refuse every time. I tell her no, I wasn't made for it and that I will hire people to do these things. She laughs but I'm serious. We do have a compromise that she can wash her body first then I will go in and wash her hair but today she told me she wants me to wash her. It's not that I don't want to see my mom naked etc, it's just one big aversion. Also, she is actually cleared to shower herself. She is capable but she is milking the pampering by us kids (I don't mind as long as it doesn't involve hygiene). It stresses me out bc it's very clear she expects me to be her caregiver when that time comes but I do not want to. The worst part is this is

nothing new. She has always known that I would never be her caregiver. She has always been told by me that I would hire help and I would not be the one changing her and bathing. I know this is pretty shitty but it's a hill I'll die on. Choosing not to be a caregiver does not mean i do not love her. It just means I wasn't made for that job."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 429 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/

↳ **comment** (138): "Not wanting to be your parents caregiver 'is' the norm (here in America). It's a cultural thing. Other countries have very different attitudes when it comes to caring for elders. This doesn't mean you have to want to do all things all the time or anytime...there are other ways to make sure they're adequately cared for"

↳ **comment** (116): "I've been an RN for 35 years and I am now my mother's caregiver. It sucks even with my background so I can't imagine how I'd feel without my abilities."

↳ **comment** (88): "My siblings and I call these "love tests." "Does it make you uncomfortable? Well, if you really loved me you would do it anyway. You must not love me." Our mother has never met a boundary she didn't try to cross."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"*

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"My mom finally died. Hi everyone, I want to thank everyone in this sub over the years for providing support for me, no one knows how hard this is like you all. Mom spent the last 1.5 weeks in the hospital with sepsis, was discharged, and after a few days of slowly healing (but not really) complained of not being able to breathe yesterday morning. Paramedics were called to her nursing home and since no one could find her DNR papers they...did CPR on her for 20 minutes. She was 90lbs, 80 years old, and suffering from COPD, liver disease, heart disease, alcoholism, etc. I brought up hospice after this last hospital stint but she didn't want to talk about it yet. I was on my way but didn't get there in time. It's been 10 years of near misses and health crises, her not wanting to do anything for herself but drink and smoke. She was bed bound and incontinent for the past few years and evaded death numerous times. She was on hospice for six months two years ago and then was taken off because she showed no signs of leaving. She was a medical marvel and I really thought she'd pull through again. I'm tired and distraught that they performed CPR on her small frail body, but she was already gone. There's so much relief but also so much sadness. She was a broken old lady and I did my best. Here's a reminder to tell your mom you love her, and also make sure her DNR papers are readily accessible to avoid what my mom went through at the end. Good luck everyone, they really don't make it easy on us."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 393 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tnvc7m/my_mom_finally_died/

↳ **comment** (62): "Sending hugs and love. I'm terribly sorry for your loss. Take care of yourself."

↳ **comment** (50): ""She was a broken old lady and I did my best." You get to carry this with pride for the rest of your life. It certainly wasn't easy. My condolences."

↳ **comment** (10): "I'm so sorry for your loss. May you find your peace with all the complex emotions this transition has brought. Your love and care for your mom comes through in your post and, ultimately, I believe the measure of a love is like that of the steady beats of a song, not the that of the occasional bridge."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know I have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. I'm an idiot). I have a family

of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"How would you feel if you had two parents who both required 24/7 assisted care, and your adult child wrote you and the whole family this letter regarding that situation?. Dear family, I've been doing a lot of reflecting lately on the situation with Grandma and Grandpa, and I feel a need to share some thoughts that have been weighing on me. I know we are all doing our best to navigate this, but I want to offer a different perspective—one that might be uncomfortable, but feels necessary to voice. I can't help but feel that what we are witnessing is, in many ways, fundamentally unnatural. Decades ago, you rarely heard of couples requiring 24/7 professional assistance simultaneously; there was a natural rhythm to life and passing that seems to have been disrupted. It feels as though modern medicine has become so focused on the mechanics of keeping the body running that it has moved far away from human nature itself. By pushing past what might have once been our natural "expiration dates,"

we've entered a territory where the cost of longevity is a loss of the very independence that defined them. Perhaps the most jarring part of this experience for me is seeing the in-home care staff every day. While I know they are necessary, I often feel like the presence of a rotating team of professionals is "replacing" the grandparents we knew. Most frustratingly, since Grandma and Grandpa are still mentally sound, I find it incredibly difficult when the care staff feels the need to manage my visits. It creates a barrier where there should be a bridge; instead of a family visit, it feels like a supervised appointment in their own home. Because of this, I want to be very clear about my own wishes for the future: Once I reach the age of 75, I do not want any extraordinary measures taken to prolong my life. Whether it is surgery, intensive treatment, or any form of medical intervention, I want to let nature take its course. Furthermore, if I ever reach a point where I can no longer safely live independently, please do not try to recreate a hospital within my home. I am asking you now to please just put me in a professional facility. I would rather my home remain a memory of who I was, rather than a place defined by its clinical needs. I know this is hard to hear, and I don't say it to diminish the love we all have for them. I just feel we need to acknowledge the reality of the era we are living in and how much it has changed the way we experience the end of life. With love and honesty, Jack"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 349 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/

↳ **comment** (259): "A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

↳ **comment** (147): "I was Jack almost a decade ago. The PTSD I have associated with helping my mom care for my grandparents will never leave me. It *ruined* my memories of my grandparents who i loved so much and spent much of my childhood with. It sucks to be the elderly person or the caregiver, but being a support person for the caregiver sucks too. We are watching an elderly loved one basically be tortured into living, another loved one get burnt out to a crispy husk of a person, and we just have to sit there like 'This is fine.....' It's really sad, frustrating, depressing to watch, and makes you look around and scream 'am I taking crazy pills?!'"

↳ **comment** (140): "I studied gerontology and death & dying. Because of that, I made an Exit Plan 20 years ago. I saw what was going to happen with the massive, aging, Boomer population & there's nothing good about it. I've completed all my EOL documents (Will, Living Will/Healthcare POA, financial/durable POA), each kid has copies. Pre-planned & pre-paid for my cremation. I'm very open with my kids about EOL stuff and how I don't want to burden them with my care. Of course, they say "we don't mind," but I've seen 1st hand how caregiving tears apart families and breaks caregivers. I don't want to do that to my kids."

"This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 331 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_ups_et_with_my_dad_than_i_am/oxbjtlt/

"Useful items that have made it easier for us and our aging parents. Just a few items that have made caring for my aging parents easier. I want to mention these in case you are not aware or have not considered the benefits. **D-Mannose supplement**: this is the active ingredient in cranberry that helps prevent the formation of biofilm in UTIs. The capsules do not have a flavor. My mother-in-law would balk at the taste of cranberry capsules but does not object to these. **UTI test strips**: these are now over the counter in the US. Don't wonder, diagnose at home. This has been so helpful for my mother-in-law because getting her to the doctor is a difficult process. **Styptic products**: stops bleeding. Remember the white pencil that men used for shaving cuts? Now comes in pre-loaded bandages or loose powder. Check a camping or outdoors store or the pet aisle (dog nail care) for greater selection. The combination of my mother's fragile skin and blood thinners means she just bleeds and bleeds. **Tender tape**: this is a latex-free stretch bandage that sticks to itself but not to anything else. If your parent's skin is fragile, tender tape and a gauze pad is much better than self-adhesive bandages. I first saw this used as a veterinary product for putting bandages over fur, so you know it won't ever stick to skin. **Adhesive release spray**: when self-adhesive bandages can't be avoided, this spray will release the bandage without tearing the skin. My mother used to cry when it was time to change a bandage but no longer. **Compression garments**: look at products for runners, because runners' socks and calf sleeves may be easier to use for low-end compression needs. Cheaper than medical products, and using a combination of socks and calf sleeves means the socks can be changed every day and machine washed/dried. **Wig**: the weirdest helpful thing I ever bought. My mother is focused on her appearance in a way I have never understood, but it's very important to her so I try to be supportive. When she broke her shoulder she could not color her hair or manage the bouffant style she's been wearing for decades. She wanted *me* to color her hair but I thought that was a recipe for disaster. In desperation, I bought a cheap wig and she looooooves it so much. These have changed since the '70s... the modern wigs are "capless" on a net base and not attached to something like a swim cap as they once were. Her shoulder has long since healed but the wig remains in use every day. ETA suggestions from the comments: Ring camera / Alexa drop-in Laminated page of medications / medical info (have multiple) Wireless cell phone charger Shoe expanders Clock with day/date as well as time Silicone cupcake liners - good for serving meds, modest portions of snacks, etc. easy to hold and non-slip, also useful for hearing aids at night Bed rail Ramp - for entry and exit, rubber or metal Low step stool - useful for getting into car, propping feet up to tie shoes Bath lifter - useful beyond the bathroom Transfer board - helps with transfer from wheelchair to/from bed Car door assist handle - sticks in car door for support getting in and out Car cane - for getting in and out of car Stand up stick - looks like a plunger, helps getting up from floor Bed assist rail Spring-loaded floor-to-ceiling grab pole (Stander Wonder pole) Shower bench, shower transfer bench Shampoo cap for washing hair in bed Hair fiber - Toppik and other brands, makes thin hair look fuller Handheld shower head with multiple holders at various heights Bedside commode Gel powder to soak up urine Shower wipes - look for unscented / sensitive skin version Long-handled toenail clippers Booster pads - for incontinence Quick Change Wraps - for incontinence Bidet attachment"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 326 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w2kxot/useful_items_that_have_made_it_easier_for_us_and/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of

these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much

more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏 "

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up

her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "'People ask how they can help and I have no words.'" I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"A lot of people feel this way when they are relatively young. When my grandma (80s) moved into a board and care facility, my mom (50s) said that a similar place would be fine for her when the time came. Mom is in her 80s now and really doesn't want to live anywhere but home. I'm not saying your child will change their mind about what they want, but decisions like this look different when they are going to affect life now. I'm curious about whether the care staff interference is a valid complaint. Are they just telling your kid to not smoke around the oxygen cannisters? I care for my mom and I have preferences for when visitors come, what they give her to eat, and how long they stay because I'm the one who has to deal with the aftermath."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 259 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2o3xu/how_would_you_feel_if_you_had_two_parents_who/oc9kl9e/

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are talking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

The drive, the ER, the rehab: every day at the hospital · 437 documents

20 most engaged of 437 matching documents, complete text.

"I have to brag because I'm so freaking happy.... My Mom (then age 84) absolutely ran herself into the ground after my Dad (at age 86) fell and hit his head and walked around with an undiagnosed brain bleed for over 24 hours. After he was released from the hospital and rehab she became his primary caregiver, and learned everything from "scratch". Aides were hired but she was #1 for him. He deteriorated quickly, not even being able to feed or toilet himself. This continued for almost 3 years. After we finally convinced her to admit Dad into a nursing facility, she agreed to clear out her large home of 50 years and moved into an apartment nearby. There, she continued to take care of him, going there for about 5 hours every day, doing his laundry, choosing his favorite foods, and even giving him pt after Medicare said that he didn't need it because he had improved as much as he could and denied coverage. Dad was in nursing for just over 3 years when he passed earlier this year. It was tough. Mom always preferred her garden and kitchen to socializing and she found it difficult to make friends. Her eyesight and hearing are bad, so she had to give up driving and it was difficult to hear what people were saying to her. She turned 90 the week after Dad passed and slowly, with the help of some incredible neighbors in her building, she has become such a different person. She now takes yoga classes 3 mornings a week, and balance/strength-training on one morning. Whenever she hears that a person that she knows isn't feeling well, she makes and gives them soup. She has even participated in potlucks and gone to outdoor concerts over this summer. I am over the moon with love and respect and happiness for her! Over this past weekend, my husband and I took her to her granddaughter's wedding in the mountains. We got her a hotel room next to ours, she hadn't been away overnight since 2019. I was ready to leave the reception at 8pm and she pressed us to stay on. Then she, when I went to the restroom, decided to dance with everyone! I came back and couldn't believe what I was seeing!! Dancing for at least a half dozen songs in a row (upbeat, loud songs, too!), my niece was crying, my brother was grinning ear-to-ear, others were coming up to hug her. It was wonderful! I am writing this to, well, brag a little. *None* of us thought that she would bounce back from the loss of her husband of over 70 years and the literal hell that was taking care of him practically on her own for so long, but to let anyone else out there who might be in the same sort of situation that with patience and encouragement the path of an older person's life can be changed. Of course, Mom resisted for a bit, but she finally relented and still isn't very social, but she is happy. And has friends. And that's all I could have possibly hoped for. I wish that I could post the photo of her dancing that my husband took, I'm having it framed ❤️ EDIT: I just want to THANK ALL OF YOU for your wonderful replies! I'm so glad that I could give everyone a warm, fuzzy feeling and, just maybe, some hope with their own current or future situation. We have always called Mom "our Energizer Bunny" and somehow, as she has aged, the nickname is even more appropriate. 😊"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 830 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3g2fn/i_have_to_brag_because_im_so_freaking_happy/

↳ **comment** (162): "man this got me right in the chest, what a recovery arc for your mom at 90 she went from full time caregiver for years to out here dancing at a wedding like she 25, that's incredible my own grandmother shut down completely after my grandpa passed and never came back from it so reading this hit me in a way i wasnt ready for today the soup thing is so pure too, she sounds like a gem"

↳ **comment** (101): "And now she's spread good feelings all across the internet. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (33): "She sounds like an extraordinary woman - good for her and you! Loved your post."

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me ("Have you met her? She's really nice") - and we're just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both "really nice" and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I'm driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom's rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I've never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother's wrecked, we're all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I'm bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened ("oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing")... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something's wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom's memorial is gonna be because I can't plan that yet because I'm trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he's not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!? How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there's two weeks where *every single day* he's weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It's okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I'm ready to go. It's okay. He says, I don't want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I'm trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other

and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we're all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it's that *you* not suffer. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that's okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he's sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We're talking about football and birds. He's looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says "What a coincidence!" and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily "Because I love you too," , he's beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say "See you soon!" and I wave and I leave, and I'm certain I'll see him next week and we'll talk about the Super Bowl and I'll tell him about the birds I've seen, I'll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he's gone. It's over"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :, can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"i've never been more upset with my dad than I am now.. my mom passed away in december after a 7 year battle with frontotemporal dementia. it was hell. it destroyed our family. her death was difficult but also a necessary end to the suffering, hers and ours. I was beginning to move on with my life and reached a sense of calm happiness. i'm 28, I just moved in with my partner, i'm an attorney and i've been in a job I actually enjoy most of the time for

a little over a year now. my dad was my mom's caregiver but is stubborn as hell and frankly, irresponsible. I begged him for years to get his estate in order, he's 73 and has always been in bad health since his 40s. i told him constantly how i would have to deal with the consequences if he didn't do it, and that it would destroy our family. he never listened. then he had a heart attack in may after neglecting his health for years, followed by a stroke at the end of june. now he can't speak. and all the care decisions are falling to me. i'm furious with him. I took a week off work after the stroke to be with him in the hospital. I live about 2 hours away but I don't want to see him, and I haven't seen him in about 2 weeks. just doing the admin stuff from the phone is exhausting me, and making me more and more resentful. this man who has barely lifted a finger for me all his life outside of the occasional car ride has attempted to offload his care to me, just like he did with my mother. he's going to a nursing home or receiving at home care after all this. Im meeting with an elder care attorney tomorrow to figure out how I can minimize my role as much as possible. but i'm furious. i'm furious at how he took me and all the women in his life for granted. i'm furious how he attempts to take credit for my professional success after doing nothing for me. i'm furious that my mom didn't leave his deadbeat ass because of her fucked up patriarchal religious ideals. i'm furious that his lack of planning is getting in the way of grieving my mom. i'm furious that after he gave me a terrible childhood, and he couldn't give less of shit of how his poor decisions and planning would affect me in my adulthood. I was so afraid of losing my parents I never stopped to realize that I achieved everything I have not because of them, but in spite of them. now that i've realized it, it's easier to wash my hands of it and walk away. i'll do the administrative stuff, but emotionally, i'm done and I refuse to do another goddamn thing for such an ungrateful, petulant, self-centered man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 498 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1uvgvme/ive_never_been_more_upset_with_my_dad_than_i_am/

↳ **comment** (331): "This isn't a defense of this man. But you have to realize: these men have never made a health decision in their lives. They went to work, came home, and sat down to dinner someone else cooked, in a house someone else cleaned. They never did the dishes, never swept a floor, never changed a diaper. A man who was never asked to manage a household never learned to manage himself. The weaponized incompetence of today's men is nothing compared to the institutionalized incompetence of our fathers."

↳ **comment** (92): "Girl, I'm twice your age. Look at you figuring this out way ahead of the curve! You actually don't owe a damned thing to your parent. It took me a while to wash my hands of my dad. He died about two years ago, and I feel zero guilt about planting his ass in a nursing home and walking away a few months earlier. If he refused to make any plans or treat me with respect, I figured out that I didn't have to drive an hour so that I could listen to him bitch and beat to death in his room while he took out his frustrations and made me cry because I couldn't make him young and healthy again. One of the CNAs at the nursing home followed me out to my car that last day. She tapped on my window after I collapsed and started crying. "Baby, I've seen this. I'll take care of him, because that's what I get paid for. He won't be neglected. But it's okay if you don't do this." I needed that woman that day."

↳ **comment** (87): "Omg. So this right here. I'm living with the aftermath of those choices. My mother died, and my father is absolutely helpless. Didn't even know what bank they used."

"It's time for the talk. My wife and I are both only children. Between us we've buried three parents. One is left — my father-in-law. Everything below is my experience; yours will differ. But I'd rather say the hard parts out loud than let someone else get blindsided the way we were. Confront reality — and make sure they confront it too. That's the whole thing. Both of us were badly surprised by things we had been told were handled and weren't. My mother-in-law went in for surgery and had a massive stroke on the table. A month in ICU in a coma, then a specialized rehab, then a nursing home — almost a year. She surfaced briefly near the end before a second stroke took her. My father-in-law had a will, an advance directive, and a power of attorney. We assumed she did too. She didn't. She couldn't tolerate what she called death talk, and he was certain he'd go first. I got him in front of an

elder care attorney in the middle of the crisis. It was the right call, and it was a year too late. Had she lived longer, the cost would have consumed their savings and everything they meant to leave their grandchildren. After my dad died suddenly, my mom and I sat down with her affairs. The legal side was easy — wills, POAs, no argument. Two things weren't easy. One I'll come back to. The other was that after multiple conversations about her income and expenses, I found out she was hiding more than \$30,000 in debt from me. We can't fix problems we won't look at. The upfront conversations are unpleasant. Assume they will be. They are still cheaper than picking up the pieces on the back end. So don't take anyone's word for it: \- If they say there's a will, ask to see it. Then ask where it's kept. \- Same for the advance directive and the powers of attorney — financial and healthcare are not the same document. \- Ask to see the bank and credit statements. Not a summary. The statements. \- Get in front of an elder care attorney if you can possibly manage it. Medicaid look-back rules and asset protection are not things to learn during an ICU stay. That's table stakes. And even parents who've done every bit of it aren't out of the woods, because the paperwork is the easy conversation. The hard one is about legacy. This is the one I avoided with my mom, because it was the one that nearly broke her. Not the money. The *possessions*. She collected beautiful things her whole life. Most of it is headed for an estate sale. She made herself sick over it — trauma levels, on the edge of an identity crisis. There was china I never once saw used. Not one Christmas in my entire life. If we'd eaten off it every year I might feel differently. But I don't understand why I'm obligated to carry an attachment that was never mine. She had an old Mercedes. When it was time for independent living, we talked about what to do with it. She wanted to know if her granddaughter could use it. I told her the truth: no. Expensive to maintain, no dealer or independent mechanic anywhere near them, and they hike and camp and have a dog. They needed something that fit their life. Her position was that they should take it anyway — accept the burden, because it was a gift. I'm still working through that one. To me it's like buying piano lessons for someone whose hobby is baking bread. Here's what I think is actually going on. The things aren't the issue. The things are proxies. They're where the feelings get stored, because the feelings themselves never got dealt with. *If you don't keep this thing I owned, you're rejecting me and my memory*. That's why so many of our parents can't sort through it, and why it gets left behind for us. Dealing with the stuff means dealing with everything underneath the stuff. If I could run one conversation over, it's that one. I'd stop negotiating over objects and say: if you love them, let's turn this into something that actually helps them. Sell the car, put it toward the truck they need. Sell the china, fund something they'll remember. They will remember and appreciate that you helped them. **The love transfers**. The dining set doesn't. Have the conversation while it's still a conversation and not an inventory."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 488 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vf1z4k/its_time_for_the_talk/

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isn't good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71. These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, let's set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesn't tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He can't remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesn't push, because he's mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him,

she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some

confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her, but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"I'm giving up as a caregiver. Letting the state take her.. My father passed exactly two years ago yesterday. He had vascular dementia, and went fairly peacefully, I stepped in when my mother couldn't care for him anymore, and realized as I had to remove him from their home together that she also had dementia. As he faded away and died with me at his side, she was in the hospital and rehab with what the doctors said was lewy body dementia. I handled everything, from his care facility to his burial, while she gave up on life. I found her a care facility, she hated it, berated me daily. Two years of care in high dollar facilities with four doctors and all of her caregivers saying she had mid stage lewy body. This march, she found an incompetent neurologist, who she lied through her teeth about her symptoms to. He said "you don't have lewy body", which was what she wanted to hear, doctor shopped until she did. Right as the money ran out. I moved her into a house with me, became her caregiver, as she let the anosognosia run the show. Abused and berated me daily, as she rejected the financial realities of our new living situation. 27 Amazon orders last month. 30 this one. We are on a budget. A fixed income. 700 this month for her cleaning service, which she "needs to live, as she is allergic to dust". 50 bottles of distilled water for her humidifier and nasal flushes per month, which she "needs to survive". Her behavior is INSANE, but "she doesn't have dementia, Dr. BURDICK SAYS SO". WE ARE BOTH FACING BANKRUPTCY AND HOMELESSNESS, but it's my problem now. How dare I say she needs to cut back, she sacrificed TOO MUCH for this family to be told she can't spend what she wants when she wants. Rent isn't getting paid next month. There's no money. I'm calling the social worker, and having her transferred to the state's responsibility. I did EVERYTHING I could. I gave of myself until I am losing myself. She will now die alone in a state facility, my primary abuser for 49 years, believing she was the best mother ever, and how DARE I fail her. I won't allow myself to take the blame for this. She rejected reality, fell into tried and true abuse when she couldn't get her way, rejecting reality for what she believed

she deserved from me, and I gave until it is GONE. NPD magnified by LBD that she doctor shopped until she was told she didn't have it, making every unreasonable demand MY FAULT for not facilitating. Let the state of Nevada and medicaid take care of her now."

reddit post · r/dementia · 348 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1v27zn4/im_giving_up_as_a_caregiver_letting_the_state/

↳ **comment** (152): "Heard, felt, and understood. You're doing the right thing. Now that you'll finally be free, I hope you get back on your feet and find peace in your life. You deserve it."

↳ **comment** (82): "So sorry you are going through this. You did all you could and everyone needs help at a point. The facility will be better for both of you."

↳ **comment** (60): "I hate to be a downer, but you're not free until they pass on. Even if you go no contact, knowing they're there, and you put them there, even with all the rationalization in the world, there is some associated guilt. There just is. Honestly, even after they pass, you'll feel guilt and question whether you 'did things the right way' or 'if you did enough'. If it helps, even though that guilt will be there, you can rationally know that it isn't deserved, because this is a cruel disease that takes more than people can give."

"Seeing Behind The "Aging Industrial Complex" in The Villages, FL. My husband and I are visiting his elderly parents in The Villages, Florida, for Christmas. My father-in-law (94) is frail and needs a caregiver, while my mother-in-law (82) has been acting as his full-time nurse for two years. She's completely burned out but insists on doing everything herself, refusing outside help because "no one else does it right." This dynamic has concerned us for a while, and now it's come to a head: my MIL started having chest pains and is currently hospitalized. We've canceled our flights home and are trying to figure out next steps—whether it's arranging home care or transitioning them to assisted living. We both work full time and will have to take time off work to stay longer. Last night in the ER was eye-opening and deeply unsettling. We waited over 8 hours before my MIL saw a doctor. I have the utmost respect for healthcare workers, and it was clear they were completely overwhelmed. The staff was stretched too thin, and I saw many elderly patients—just like my in-laws—waiting in hallways due to a lack of space and personnel. It felt like a "cattle call," with everyone suffering: patients waiting in pain, families helpless, and staff dealing with entitled and impatient seniors. During that long wait, I started researching healthcare shortages, especially in elder care. What I learned was grim: a severe lack of healthcare workers, home health aides, and poor staff-to-resident ratios in assisted living and memory care facilities. The Villages markets itself as a paradise for seniors, but the reality I saw was far from idyllic. It seems like an impending crisis is brewing—people are living longer, but the low wages and poor conditions for caregivers make it unsustainable. I'm not sure if I'm venting or asking for advice, but has anyone else witnessed this firsthand? How do we prepare for what feels like an inevitable "boomer crisis" in elder care?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 311 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hoc2wa/seeing_behind_the_aging_industrial_complex_in_the/

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors

telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_important/

"better way to respond to parents saying they want to move back into their house?. Without getting into all the details: My parents both had serious accidents in their home recently. Both were in the hospital, then rehab. Now they are together at a very very nice assisted living place that they have agreed to stay in for at least three months. The problem is that they keep talking about how they plan to move back into the house. The house that has been unsafe for them - where they had their falls. Neither one of them is able to live independently at this point, let

alone be a caregiver for the other. My sibling and I are the ones who have handled everything that needs handling during this extremely stressful time - and are still doing it. It's so much. I'm not local - I've been flying back and forth. My sibling lives about an hour away with two little kids and has been driving back and forth. We're exhausted, we're stressed. We are past the crisis part of this - I think - but there is still so, so much to do. For years we begged our parents to move to a one-floor condo or to build a bedroom on the first floor of their house (which is just trip hazard city, between the stairs and a thousand throw rugs everywhere). They never thought this was important - never mind that Mom has Parkinson's and osteoporosis and both are in their 80s. We kept emphasizing that they could make choices while they were fully able, and get exactly what they wanted - or wait until there was a crisis, and have whatever choices were available then. They chose the latter. But they will not stop talking about moving back into the house. They think they can build a bedroom on the first floor, move the washing machine to the first floor, redo the bathroom, hire people to take care of them - and never mind that the two of them can't even figure out how to make a phone call right now. I guess they think the magic construction fairy will wave a wand and make this happen. I'm visiting right now, and it's been another stressful week - but also I am just so glad to spend time with my parents, and so grateful that this isn't worse. But meanwhile I've discovered that their house has mice - one more thing my sibling and I have to take care of. And the mice are living in the garbage they've been keeping in their kitchen cabinets and in the basement. I've asked them to pause talking about the house - I told them that I am at the end of my tether and need to get on top of what is happening more before I can even talk with them about where they are going next. I suggested they do some research about other living situations if they want - independent living, if they want, other ALFs, even construction companies and caregivers. But that I am not ready to talk about any of this while we are still so early in all of this, and I am still trying to get my dad into a doctor for his broken back because for some reason the osteo he's seen will only deal with his broken hip. But last night after dinner - the food at the ALF is good at least! - my mom started up again. And I lost it, in a very very ugly way. You really don't know what shame is until you've yelled at your 80-something year old mother in an assisted living home. I don't want to extinguish their hope - I don't want to be a jerk. I also am apparently furious that we are in this situation because they were living in this house, and I don't have it in me to have a lighthearted conversation about it right now. Not while we're still having to do so much. Given that it is inevitable they will bring up going home again - and given how raw I seem to be - what is the right way to respond next time? Thanks for reading my novel and oy, oy."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 241 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tpzwr/better_way_to_respond_to_parents_saying_they_want/

↳ **comment** (210): "If they don't have the ability to arrange things, just refuse to execute on the idea and leave it on them to organize, standing firm that they can't move back until they have arranged all of that on their own."

↳ **comment** (207): "I suggest a slightly different approach that's worked well for me. Let them talk. Let them dream, let them plan. Talk is just that - talk. They are not able to actually DO anything without help from you or your sibling. If the talk starts to move into real specifics of "doing", which is unlikely, then you redirect. "Interesting idea mom and dad, let me think about that for a while". "I'll look into that mom and dad, I need a bit of time". This approach worked like a dream for my family."

↳ **comment** (125): "This is similar to getting my mom to stop driving. Her car broke and she wanted to replace it. None of us kids thought her getting behind the wheel again was as good idea. So we just didn't help her get a new one. She talked a lot at first about getting a new one, but couldn't figure out how to do it and none of us took the steps to do it for her. Eventually she stopped talking about it."

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last

week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are talking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my

brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than it's been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"Mom's fall changed everything and I'm fuming. \ contains some mildly graphic medical trauma, so read with caution if that skeeves you out\ In February of this year my mom (78) tripped and fell while entering a clinic to get her mammogram. She already had an existing knee replacement from 12 years prior, and when she fell the knee replacement cracked her femur. She had a new knee put in that accounted for the femoral shortening caused by the break. So it was surgery and rehab, and then she came home a month after the fall. She lives next door to my son, her eldest grandson. I stayed with her the first week and she was getting around pretty well with her walker. The very night I left to go home, she was in the bathroom and the new knee gave out, just came apart and broke. She went straight down and her legs ended up under her. It causes her incision to completely open and the broken metal parts were visible. She was bleeding out on the floor. We had gotten her an alarm button that would ring at my son's house, and she mashed that thing like nobody's business. My DIL is an RN. She stuffed a towel in my mom's open leg and held it together while waiting on EMS. It took a long time for EMS to get her stabilized and transported, due to the broken knee parts being extremely close to arteries. Emergency surgery that night was done by the surgeon on-call. He cleaned it as best he could, put the parts back together and referred her back to her original surgeon. So surgery again and then this time a nursing facility rather than rehab because insurance refused rehab for this event. She has seen her original surgeon multiple times, had multiple x- rays, and me, my sister, my son and my mom herself have told her surgeon the leg doesn't look right, doesn't feel right to her, keeps wanting to collapse again. We've raised concerns to PT, and told the orthopedics team. They just kept telling her that she'll get stronger with PT. However it was only 2 weeks ago, at yet another post surgery appointment that her surgeon finally told us that she put the knee in incorrectly the first time. So it has been incorrect since way

back at the beginning of February when she had her original surgery. It is internally rotated by about 20 degrees. The surgeon even admitted that's very likely why she fell the second time... the time when we almost lost her. Now the surgeon wants to revise her knee. And we will go through this a third time. My poor mom has been working so hard to gain function of a knee that is not placed correctly, that collapses, that locks sideways. When it engages it just flips back and down and deforms her entire lower leg, causing her to scream. It's been heavy work taking care of her as she cannot be left alone. She's spent about 20k outfitting the house with a lift bed, a lift chair, a whole new shower and toilet. Everything we could think of to try to keep her safe. My mom kept thinking she was failing somehow. It's heartbreaking. Watching her struggle has been horrendously hard on my little family. And I'm fuming. So many times we tried to say something was wrong and no one listened. We are reaching out to attorneys and trying to find a different surgeon. We will get through this again, but it's harder on her every time and I've never been so angry in my entire life. To let my mom go through this for 4 months is absolutely egregious and we are nowhere near out of the woods. She's mostly wheel-chair bound now... and back in February, when she was worried she'd miss her granddaughter's May 31st wedding, the surgeon told her she'd be walking and dancing by then, no problem. Fuming."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tszraf/moms_fall_changed_everything_and_im_fuming/

"Day 3, my prayers were heard.. I swear some nurses are angels in disguise. For now, it's over... and I can finally breathe, shower, clean, whatever I need. My mom had a visiting nurse stop by today and I took that opportunity to tell her about the condition of the house and how there is no one to be there 24/7. She listened and reported it to the social worker. The social worker and the nurse called an ambulance and EMTs took her to a hospital. For the night at least, I can finally breathe. My alcoholic uncle is going off to rehab in another state on Monday. Now it is just me and my cousin and the animals here. I finally have peace for now. I actually laughed today. EDIT: update 9/20: The doctors at this new hospital were horrified with her treatment at the last hospital and she will NOT be coming home this time. She is going to a subacute rehab and will never return home. We are now suing the last hospital for medical malpractice."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 225 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1nlfyiw/day_3_my_prayers_were_heard/

"I'm throwing in the towel. My 91 year old mom fell and broke her hip several weeks ago. I've tried for several years to get her to sell her house and move near me. She's refused. I'm 4 hours away and have had to drive back and forth to be with her in hospital and rehab. I can't just live in her home during this time because I have appts, a garden, and other responsibilities in my own home. Mom is telling me one moment she will stay with me in my home for awhile and then sell her home and move to a senior apartment, Then the next moment she is telling me she won't and will move back in her home. So I'm running around making plans and she changes her mind. Different family members are pressuring me to have her do different things. I'm the oldest and my sister moved away. I talked with the social worker, the pt, and a nurse. The nurse had obviously talked with mom before and was a bit passive aggressive with me, She told me that my mom would decide where she was going and that the dr would decide whether it was safe for mom to come live with me. She and mom stared at each other the whole conversation and the comments the nurse made to mom during our conversation led me to believe she and mom had spoken and the nurse was speaking for mom. I could truly tell. She was passive aggressive with me. My mother's home is not equipped for a 91 year old. There are aspects of it that are plain dangerous. My mom shouldn't be driving either but when I mention that, no one is helping me or agreeing with me. She has wrecked several times and gotten lost. I was told by the nurse that the HOSPITAL will make sure she has a safe place to go, not me. I honestly haven't been trying to take control and I haven't been trying to boss anyone. I don't want to be doing this and I don't want to be in charge of anyone. I'm the only child nearby and I just want to try and help. I need a solution that will make this a bit easier on me also. Yesterday I ended up with stomach issues over all of this and was afraid to go back to rehab to visit. I was exhausted. Mom called me and tried to make me feel badly for not coming back up. I told her I didn't feel well and would come up today. She told me not to come until

afternoon because her friend Liz was visiting. She's now giving me hours when I can come. She also made light of the fact that my drive here is "only 4 hours" away. I'm 68 years old and a widow. I have no one to take care of my own home. It also costs me 27 dollars in tolls, not to mention the gas costs to drive up and back. I've decided to just let the hospital decide where mom should go. If they think her house is okay, then that's on them. I'm too tired to deal with this anymore and I'm tired of the battle. I lost a husband and my mom couldn't find a way to his funeral, I lost a daughter 2 years ago and mom rarely asks how I'm doing. She's never been there for me. I've tried to be there for her and I can't fight this battle anymore. I'm throwing in the towel. I'm done. I'm tired of worrying about her because she is too stubborn to care about anyone else."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 216 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ua0sp8/im_throwing_in_the_towel/

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking kilns, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement than means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!???" Seriously, I'm done.

I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house (front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"MIL eloped from memory care. An unexpected slot for 2026 Bingo card. Somehow, my MIL had escaped. How or when, were grilling the memory care facility for. All we know is we were not home and noticed we had several Ring notifications. Normal to get one or so, maybe for Amazon Delivery but it was my MIL. We have her on our Ring sitting on our front porch for about an hour before we had noticed the notifications. We were like who's that lady because there was no way in hell we would think it was my MIL. But yep, it was her. The memory care didn't call us, we had to call them. They are supposed to have someone 24/7 and the door needs to be opened by pushing a button under the front desk and the elevators are coded per floor. So they have someone serious explaining to do. She has no wallet, keys, or cell phone. I'm guessing she had to walk to our home, which just over 5 miles away. We are extremely lucky that she somehow made it safely to our house. I'm actually impressed she remembered where we live. But that's beside the point. I don't know if we need to pursue legal counsel yet, but we sure as heck will be reporting this to regulatory agencies."

reddit post · r/dementia · 204 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1qgtrb0/mil_escaped_from_memory_care/

"Just listened to a lecture that gave me very little useful information. When you are in the trenches, this kind of talk is useless, and possibly damaging. I took care of my father who died of cancer in 2008. My husband helped me immensely. Then we took care of my mother in our home until her death from cancer in 2009 on my father's birthday. By the time my mother had died, my blood pressure was 160/100, I had gained a significant amount of weight and was in very poor health both emotionally and physically. I was forced into a situation where I had to begin taking care of myself or I would drop over of a stroke. My family physician threatened to put me on blood pressure medication if I didn't start eating healthy and exercising regularly to pull my blood pressure down. So I followed doctor's orders and turned my health around. Then we finished that chapter of our lives where our daughter graduated from high school and left for college at a school over 1,000 miles away from our home. So we had to deal with that adjustment. Two years ago we made the decision to have my husband's parents who are both in their mid to late 80's live with us in our home as they were no longer safe living alone in their own home. They do not speak English, do not drive and are completely dependent on my husband and myself. So this talk about getting a 10 year break in between raising our kids and caring for our aging parents does not apply to my life and I would think many people find themselves in the same situation. The most serious problem with this talk is that this presenter never gave any practical advise as to how we as care givers can better take care of ourselves while taking care of everyone else. We already know that caring for our loved ones is a special experience that we should

hold close to our hearts. Otherwise, we wouldn't be here. Perhaps as a licensed psychologist myself combined with many years of care giving for multiple elderly loved ones, I should write and present MY OWN TED TALK; one that can actually benefit the care givers. Let's face it, that's why most of us clicked on here in the first place."

youtube · @reneeraw6927 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 203 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhiKEw&lc=Ugz1pj6jmX3GkNPCy2F4AaABAg>

↳ **@karenrader2160** (15): "I already commented above to someone else on this particular aspect of the issue, but generally I found this talk mostly useless when you are in the middle of the situation."

↳ **@intergxntlcare** (12): "I would love to listen to your TED talk. V powerful story."

↳ **@karencox3235** (12): "I agree. This was a nice pep talk, but no real meat "to relieve stress" as the title suggests. The title needs to be changed."

"As an only child who did this for parents who lived 400 miles away for three years...I agree 100%!!! I was honored and privileged to do it...but relieved when it was over. (Just being honest)"

tiktok · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854> · <https://www.tiktok.com/@jamesbackhome/video/7433200790556183854>

Every single day he's weaker; the questions on repeat · 433 documents

20 most engaged of 433 matching documents, complete text.

"I Wanted My Freedom. Then My Mom Was Gone.. My mom was 86 when she died this March. She was one of those people who refused to become "old." She lived alone, drove her little Mini Cooper all over town (which terrified me), volunteered as a church greeter, ran a widows' group, visited elderly shut-ins, never met a stranger, and thought a trip to Target or World Market counted as a great day. My dad died 31 years ago, and she never remarried. For many years she was my best friend. Then, over the last couple of years, things slowly changed. She became lonely. She started repeating the same stories over and over. She talked almost nonstop. She called constantly. The roles reversed, and I found myself feeling more like the parent than the child. I hated admitting it, but I began to resent it. I loved her deeply, but I also dreaded seeing my phone ring sometimes because I knew it would be another long conversation or another problem to solve. I worried every time she got behind the wheel. I had lunch with her or took her shopping almost every day because I knew she needed me, but I was also exhausted. She had started talking about moving in with us. I knew it was probably coming, and I was going to do it...but I wasn't ready. I'm in my mid-50s. I was dealing with menopause, an empty nest, two demanding jobs, and trying to figure out who I was becoming. Part of me wanted to be the daughter she deserved. Another part desperately wanted a few years that were still mine before becoming a full-time caregiver. I carried enormous guilt over that conflict. The day she fell, she had just left church. She was picking up Girl Scout cookies at a pop-up tent outside Walmart. She called me and said she'd fallen and bumped her knee. I was frustrated because I hadn't planned on seeing her that day. I needed a break. The last thing I ever said to my mother was, "Well...there's always a crisis. I'm on my way." She sounded completely lucid. She never mentioned hitting her chin. I thought I'd pick her up, we'd probably laugh about it, maybe go get lunch. Instead, by the time I got there, she was being loaded into an ambulance. She looked like she was asleep. She never regained consciousness. She had suffered a catastrophic brain bleed. Forty-eight hours later, I had to make the decision to remove her from life support. Just before she died, she lifted both of her arms into the air as if she saw someone she loved and was reaching out to embrace them. I'd like to believe she was seeing my dad. Ever since that day, I've replayed every impatient sigh, every time I wished she'd stop calling, every moment I wanted my own freedom instead of another afternoon wandering Target. I've called myself every horrible name imaginable. But grief has also taught me something. Loving an aging parent is complicated. You can adore them and still feel exhausted. You can be grateful they're alive while mourning the person they used to be. You can resent the responsibility and still show up every single day. Those things can all be true at the same time. People have told me my mom "went out on a high note." She was still living independently. She was active. She never endured years in a nursing home or a long, painful decline. She never knew what happened. Intellectually, I know that's a blessing. Emotionally, I just miss my mom. This week I've been sick with what feels like COVID or the flu, and all I've wanted is to pick up the phone and hear her voice one more time. If you're in the thick of caring for an aging parent, and you're feeling burned out, resentful, guilty, or conflicted... Please know you're not alone. The love doesn't disappear because you're tired. Being overwhelmed doesn't mean you love them less. Sometimes it means you've been loving them for a very long time. I'm still trying to learn how to carry this without letting the guilt define me. If you've walked this road, I'd love to hear how you eventually made peace with it."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 1,300 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1usalwu/i_wanted_my_freedom_then_my_mom_was_gone/

↳ **comment** (846): "If it helps, there is scientific evidence that your brain becomes extremely active 30 seconds before and after the heart stops beating, and that the final activity is a recall of life: "life flashes before your eyes." What your mother was thinking of when she passed away wasn't those last couple of years or even that phone call; she was remembering 50 years of loving you before seeing your dad."

↳ **comment** (169): "This was beautifully written and really encompasses the complicated emotions of caring for an aging parent. I'm so sorry for your loss."

↳ **comment** (115): "My last words with my dad was that of annoyance too. I had spent most of the day with him, cleaning, getting him all setup, etc. and just wanted to have the afternoon to myself and when he called to ask about the same stuff he's asked me a million times(though in retrospect there were some signs I missed), I expressed some annoyance at having been there all day and told him to rest and I'd check back with him later. Once I was home and had a chance to take a breather I started getting really worried and he wasn't answering his phone so I dropped everything and rushed there and well, you know how the story ends. It didn't matter that we were partners together in dealing with his severe declining health for almost 3 years - initially with him getting CHF during the worst part of the pandemic shutdowns and that leading to lung damage and hospitalizations and getting bad news that he would really never get better but somehow we never gave up and did everything asked of us and got an extra 2 1/2 years of life which wasn't all bad and had laughs too. None of that mattered when he suddenly died because I just couldn't stop feeling guilty about all the times I was annoyed at taking him to a doctor or feeling like my life was on hold for 3 years and I missed out on opportunities in my own life. I felt like a terrible son who was annoyed at his dying dad. I still feel that way sometimes 3+ years later but in time, I've remembered the good times too and just how remarkable our relationship was and even when he was sick and we'd argue about a treatment or tomatoes or something, he'd say "our relationship is father and son. If we can't argue about stupid stuff then it's not a real relationship". That's helped me a lot because if that's what he told me while he was alive and in pain then he'd really be mad at me for feeling guilty about dumb stuff when our love was real. And that's what it really comes down to- A real loving relationship with one's parents (or anybody we care about really) is having a full range of emotions with them: We laugh together, we argue together, and yes, sometimes we're annoyed at them and unfortunately we can't always choose which emotion was the last thing when they suddenly die. The important thing is that both people know the love is there and it doesn't matter if at times when we were exhausted we said something we shouldn't have. Caring for an aging parent is exhaustive and thankless work. We're one of the good ones for even attempting it."

"It's over. It's over. The last five years of worry and the gradual decline, all the strategizing and planning, then starting 12 months ago the "hell times" began as my sister & I called it (the first major health crisis - they both got flu, then pneumonia, both ended up in the hospital for 2 weeks, and into the endless chaos that was assisted care, hospital, assisted care, hospital, rehab, hospital, hospital, assisted care, etc). All the scrambling to navigate the bewildering medical & housing systems, the ground constantly shifting underfoot, constantly trying to re-assess their continually failing abilities & what they need next, learning about the "levels of care", worrying about my mom's dementia, thinking through all the critical little specifics (can they even still shower themselves? can Mom even learn the way to the dining hall? Dad can remember his meds, but can he see the bottle labels anymore?) And downsizing and the STUFF and the THINGS and the PHOTOS and the 60,000,000 BOOKS, enormous vanloads of stuff, their beautiful museum of a long time home and their mementos of 90 years of travel all disassembled, and the 2nd museum of their lakeside cabin has to be dealt with too, all of this across three different states (none of which is my home state), sooooo many trips out of state, traveling 2-3 weeks out of every month, too much drinking, forgot what the gym is, my own health nosediving, lawyers, estate planning, taxes, bills, so many frickin passwords that they had on tiny scraps of paper, jfc they saved every bank statement back to 1951, POA's, health care proxies, new different lawyers, new different POA's, how the hell do we talk to Dad about DNRs, the worried visits from longtime friends. To the family friends we sound cautiously optimistic, but privately my sister & I have started to say "when they die, we have to remember to do XYZ". We actually get used to saying "When they die", because we have to; we gotta plan. Mom starts falling. I feel so guilty the first time it happens because she's RIGHT next to me and *boom* down she goes in a split second, she's a little bruised but ok, but I'm berating myself that I couldn't catch her in time. I'm so upset with myself, then a nurse says "It happens all the time. These 90yo's are *fast* sometimes!" And sure enough it turns out it's just the first of a dozen falls. Finally one time she breaks her hip, has to get a knee replacement, the dementia's really worsening now, she can't remember why she's in a

wheelchair, she starts forgetting my name, she tries to introduce my sister to me (“Have you met her? She’s really nice”) - and we’re just touched that even despite all the dementia, she has somehow retained a belief that we are both “really nice” and that we really ought to know each other! She keeps trying to walk... she falls again, dislocates the new hip, she falls again, dislocates the hip AGAIN, hits her head this time, brain bleed... Now I’m driving my poor worried nearly-immobile 91-yo dad to mom’s rehab center every single afternoon so he can wobble very slowly over to her bed and sit there holding her hand, every afternoon, for an hour, then wobble slowly back to my car. It clearly exhausts him but he goes every single day, and my heart breaks every single time. She dies at Thanksgiving. Watching my dad crumple up crying like a tiny little boy over missing my mom...I have crying fits like I’ve never had, full body sobbing. My mother is gone. My sis is wrecked, my brother’s wrecked, we’re all just a complete mess. We stumble through the next weeks. I try to cheer up my dad by dressing us both up in silly Christmas hats on Christmas Eve. Then a freaking emergency call from my cat-sitter of all things, now my cat is dying too of all things (wtf wtf, I was not prepared for that?!?) so I fly home on Christmas morning to put my poor little kitty to sleep, embarrassed and wrecked all over again over how much I’m bawling about a cat when I just lost my mother (but this kitty is *my only companion* and I am just BAWLING packing up her little water dish & her little toys) and I gotta fly right back to my dad, where I pretend nothing happened (“oh I just had to go home to deal with a thing”)... I have to wheel him to every meal now because he is too exhausted to walk, something’s wrong with his lungs, and please everybody just stop asking me when mom’s memorial is gonna be because I can’t plan that yet because I’m trying to keep my father alive, pulmonologists, CT scans, what do you mean his lungs are worsening, what do you mean progressive fibrosis, wait he’s not eating?! wait a second here he has lost 15 pounds in the last month?!?! How did nobody catch this, what is going on, more doctors, we gotta get that DNR in place, we gotta have a real talk with him, we have to talk... Then there’s two weeks where *every single day* he’s weaker than the day before. Now I gotta do the call to the siblings: sibling A, you need to come back this week, not next week. Sibling B, change your ticket, come this week not next month, oh and, we gotta talk about hospice. It’s okay, he says on a Monday, almost two weeks ago now. He says, I’m ready to go. It’s okay. He says, I don’t want you kids to have to grieve two parents at once, so I’m trying to hold on for six months, because I calculate that in six months you will have recovered from losing your mother. My sister and I stare at each other and my sister finally saysum, so how did you do that calculation? - and then somehow we’re all laughing. When we stop laughing I say, actually, *my* absolute top priority is not about spacing out my grieving; it’s that *you not suffer*. I say, If you want to be dragged down the road of all the medical things, I will drag you down that road; but if you feel done, that’s okay. My dad nods. But he actually stabilizes, and two days later the docs are talking about releasing him, and he’s sitting up in bed & smiling at me. We’re talking about football and birds. He’s looking forward to the Super Bowl. My brother & SIL & sister will be with him the rest of the week. He seems pretty good today. I give him the usual goodbye hug, tell him I love him, he beams back at me and says “What a coincidence!” and we laugh, and he adds unnecessarily “Because I love you too,” , he’s beaming at me, that big bright smile; I say “See you soon!” and I wave and I leave, and I’m certain I’ll see him next week and we’ll talk about the Super Bowl and I’ll tell him about the birds I’ve seen, I’ll tell him about those ospreys and the sandhill cranes, but later I get the call: he’s gone. It’s over”

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 775 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iv9b2x/its_over/

"I work in home health and I want to give you some inside secrets.. Edit everything I say here is for the USA. private pay insurance. I've worked for home health for around five years now and I want to share some of the good and bad I've learned so you can make an informed decision about the care for your aging parents. There are two kinds of home health care ones thst accept Medicare and one's that do not. The ones that do follow stricter guidelines for care (this doesn't mean they're better it just means they have to follow different rules than private insurance) my information only applies to those that do not take Medicare. First. It's expensive. Even with insurance you could be paying more than \$50 an hour for care. But something I want to make ABUNDANTLY CLEAR is the caregivers, the ones that come to your home and do the actual work, do not receive this money. You may pay so much an hour but the workers only get paid around \$17-18 an hour. So please don't act towards the

caregivers like they should be doing \$50 an hour worth of work because they are not getting paid much above minimum wage. Second. Keep track of your loved ones need for care. If they fall and then need care or have a heart attack and need help after surgery. The agency is never ever going to tell you that the person is fine now and doesn't need care anymore. I go to several assignments where I do literally nothing the entire time I'm there just because no body says to stop sending us. Third. If you up the care from one kind to another temporarily after an injury or fall make sure that when you know they can go back down to less care that they return to charging you the lower rate. I've been to several assignments where I'm still being paid for hands on care even though all I'm doing is cleaning house. Fourth. Do not look at the caregivers like you would a cleaning crew That comes in and cleans as fast as they can to get done fast and move on to the next home. Caregivers are there for a set time so we are encouraged to sit and talk to our clients. Watch TV with them. Play games. Go for walks. We won't always be up doing things. We aren't someone who you hired to fix your toilet and now he's sitting on your couch. You hired us to take care of your loved one and sometimes that is just having a conversation or watching TV together. Fifth. Ask the caregiver what they need for the home and for the client. I went to an assignment last month that had no toilet paper in the whole house. The client was bedbound and used diapers so they just never thought to have toilet paper in the house. I literally had no way to wipe for the first day and I ended up bringing my own. Hand soap, paper towels, gloves, hand sanitizer all these things you are responsible for providing. Sixth. Understand that for the most part we are not nurses. Most states require little to no certifications to be a home health aide. So please understand the limitations of what we can/are allowed to do. We can't make medical decisions. We can't administer medicines. We can't change dressings. We can't even trim nails because if we cut you it could cause an infection. So please be very aware of what we are and are not allowed to do and don't ask or expect us to do something we aren't supposed to do. If you want any other advice ask it in the comments I'm happy to answer."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 765 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1o35sir/i_work_in_home_health_and_i_want_to_give_you_some/

↳ **comment** (363): "RN here and this is incredibly well written and all very true. Thank you for all you do. You ARE underpaid. Massively."

↳ **comment** (137): "It goes to pay for the office staff. And ALOT of it goes to insurance. They have to carry large liability policies on each worker because we both work in the home and drive the clients" cars. Then of course they must make a profit. I'm not saying they are scamming anyone all I'm focusing on is the misconception thst the caregivers get a large amount of the money paid and clients and family that complain to us that we aren't doing enough seeing as how they pay us so much. I just want people to know that we are minimum wage workers."

↳ **comment** (94): "Thank you. I love my job but I am aware of it's downfalls."

"Both of my parents died suddenly without any warning. I didn't realize it at the time, but that turned out to be sort of a blessing. I'm watching a couple of friends of mine caring for their elderly parents with dementia or severe physical debilitation. It's a major struggle every single day and they are destroyed emotionally."

youtube · @christinemarie6976 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 711 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwgdwOMhrW2_y-LEo54AaABAg

↳ **@obstantiadiscindo** (41): "Truly a blessing, for both them and you. What no-one tells you is the exhaustion and eventual resentment because of the exhaustion, is surpassed by guilt at feeling exhausted and resentful. Meanwhile, the person you knew and loved is gone, mentally. There's just a frail husk left. Can't talk, move, feed themselves, is doubly incontinent. Is unaware of the world in any meaningful sense, but is aware of the indignities of being hoisted up to be cleaned up, who looks blankly in your eye as you're feeding them, and you don't know if they recognise you or not. Better to lead a full life and die at 80 than be a zombie at 93, paying thousands every month to be a breathing husk in the hands of strangers because your family, now wracked with guilt and exhaustion, just can't do it any more."

↳ **@Leann-uj9rg** (37): "Mine had warning. My mom 6 months, my dad a week. But I see situations as mentioned in this video and feel the cards dealt to me were a blessing in disguise, although I miss them terribly. Neither made it out of their 70s but each functioned well enough to the very end. At least I got to say goodbye and see you later. ❤️🥺"

↳ **@RA-sv8lr** (28): "My mother's in her 80s now, bright as a button but lost most of her mobility. It's so hard losing a parent however they go but, for my Mum's sake, I hope when she goes it's peacefully in her sleep and not from some long, painful illness. I'm so sorry for your losses but glad that you are now able to appreciate the manner of their passing as a blessing of sorts. x"

"Moved Mom into Assisted Living.. Like many of you here, my Mom (87) muddled through life without any plans: No savings/investments, progressive physical decline, a run-down house, etc. The shit hit the fan 2+ years ago when my brother, who was living with her, suddenly died. I knew it wasn't a great plan to move her into my small home (600 miles away), but there were no other good options. And both of us being grief-stricken didn't help with making logical decisions. I took over managing her multiple medical problems, cooked healthy meals every day (she lost ~75 pounds, cut her insulin use to ~10% of what she had been taking, and got off oxygen and CPAP!), took her to all Dr.'s appointments, filed for VA Aid and Attendance benefits, had POA/Advance Directives/a Will drawn up, and sold her house (for a song, but it had to happen). I had *zero* help with anything, essentially gave up any semblance of my own life, and resentment built. It got to the point where we were both short-tempered with each other, and it just wasn't a good thing. I told Mom something has got to give, she said she'd go along with whatever I wanted, and I found an ALF about two miles from me. It's the oldest retirement community in the US, has a great reputation, and a nominal up-front fee. She just *barely* financially qualified with the proceeds from her house, and they have a benevolent fund that will cover her care when the money runs out (2-3 years). She moved in on Monday and just called me in tears to say how much she loves it, how pleasant the staff and residents have been, and how much she appreciates everything I did for her. I about fell over because she acted like I owed it to her to take her in, and took everything I did for granted. I got her (small, but private) room all set up and, in three days, Mom's been to exercise classes, music performances, happy hour (I joined her for that...haha), got her hair cut, checked out books from their library, and raves about the food. I feel like we won the lottery and know we will have a much better relationship without being on top of each other 24/7. I couldn't be more relieved and, in my current pink cloud state :, can now say it was all worth it. If I'm dreaming, please don't wake me up!"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 684 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1m7kjkv/moved_mom_into_assisted_living/

↳ **comment** (119): "This is such a nice story to read. I'm so happy for you both!"

↳ **comment** (73): "Thank you. My heart still goes out to everyone who's "in the weeds" taking care of their parents. God knows it takes a toll. All around."

↳ **comment** (55): "It is so nice to read your positive story! You should feel proud of all you have done for her. Now you'll both be better off."

"I wouldn't want to live like this . I'm the primary caregiver for my MIL, she's 92 with advanced dementia. When people visit, including her own daughter and son in law, I constantly hear "I wouldn't want to live like this". Well I wouldn't either but what am I supposed to do? She's fed, clean, comfortable, has her own bedroom, bathroom and sitting room in my home, she has two TVs, entertainment, my dogs to keep her company. I've gone out of my way to provide her with quality of life. But that constant comment just bothers the hell out of me. Like do they expect me to "take care of her" if you know what I mean?? When I agreed to her living with us (two teenagers and her son my husband) she was still coherent if just slightly confused with aphasia. We're now in complete dementia where

she barely understands anything, and it's only been two years. The rapid decline is astonishing. It's just so frustrating to hear that, especially from her daughter, who is 12 years my senior. I'm just going to keep going, trying to keep her out of the \$14k a month memory facility. I'm tired, but I know everyone in this group is. Thanks for letting me rant if you read this far."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 502 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hti4b6/i_wouldnt_want_to_live_like_this/

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"*

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"Dear toxic positivity society: Shove your fake words and fix the respite care system. I became a caregiver at 11 when my father left and my mother started dialysis, grandma became disabled. Fifteen years. I watched my childhood disappear into doctor appointments, dialysis schedules, and keeping my mom and grandma alive. Zero respite. Zero relief. Just grinding every single day. I missed school events. I couldn't do normal kid things. I became an adult before I even understood what that meant. Here's what people told me: "You're so strong." "God only gives us what we can handle." "Your mom is lucky to have you." You know what actually helped? NOTHING on that list. I needed someone to take over for a day. I needed to not feel guilty for wanting my own life. I needed the system to provide ACTUAL support instead of expecting an 11-year-old to figure it out. What caregivers actually need Systemic respite care. Not inspirational quotes. Not thoughts and prayers. Not another reminder that we're blessed to serve. We need a functioning respite care system that doesn't bankrupt families or require six months of paperwork. The respite care reality nobody talks about 75% of family caregivers receive NO respite care (AARP) Most insurance doesn't cover it Medicaid waiting lists are YEARS long Adult day programs barely exist

Rural caregivers have zero options We burn out before we ever get approved Here's the question that breaks my brain: 75% of family caregivers get ZERO respite care. So what happens when THOSE caregivers break? Who takes care of them? The answer is, Nobody. They just keep going until they can't. Until they have a mental breakdown. Until they get physically sick. Until they die from stress-related illness (which happens 2-3x more often to caregivers than non-caregivers). And then what? Their loved one goes into emergency placement. Into an understaffed nursing home. Into a crisis the system COULD have prevented if it had just provided respite care in the first place. I lived this. For fifteen years, I never got a break. And when I finally burned out, people acted like it was MY failure. Not the system's. Here's the uncomfortable truth Our healthcare system is built on unpaid family caregivers sacrificing everything. Kids like I was. Adults caring for aging parents. People caring for disabled partners. And when we say we can't do it anymore, society says "but who else will do it?" The answer shouldn't be nobody. The answer should be POLICY CHANGE. Fixing the respite care system costs money. Telling caregivers to "stay positive" costs nothing. That's why society prefers toxic positivity over actual solutions. Society would rather 75% of caregivers burn out than invest in the infrastructure to prevent it. To every caregiver who's exhausted: Your anger is valid. You're not failing because you can't keep smiling. The SYSTEM is failing you. You don't need better coping skills. You need systemic change. You don't need inspirational quotes. You need affordable respite care. I wrote more about what would actually fix this (the policy changes we need, why society refuses to act, and what happens when caregivers break) I started Day1Father because I'm done with fake positivity. Done with society telling caregivers to smile through suffering. How are you doing by the way? I genuinely care, that's the reason I asked. For caregivers tired of fake positivity. Raw. Real. Unapologetic."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 406 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1oufhcc/dear_toxic_positivity_society_shove_your_fake/

↳ **comment** (95): "THIS is spot on. I don't want to hear how great of a person I am for sacrificing so much-- COME HELP! My sister 26F and I 28F are drowning in butt cream, doctors appointments and diapers, we don't have time for empty words when we should be catching up on sleep, or being a normal 20-something. I took the phone out of the wall yesterday because I just couldn't take another call just "checking on us" only to be unavailable when I ask for help. Spare me!"

↳ **comment** (40): "I am 71 years old. I am taking care of my severely disabled 25 year old adult child for 25 years, by myself. Everyone walked away. I never want to hear how strong I am again. My legs are giving way. I don't know what's wrong. No time to go to the doctor. I work around the clock. What's going to happen to me in a very short while? What will happen to him? He doesn't speak. He is doubly incontinent. I tried for 25 years to get help. Now I just keep going until one day...."

↳ **comment** (26): "My doctor said the secret is to go back to work and have someone take care of her but holy \$\$\$\$\$\$ so i would be working for what ? It's a no win situation. Having someone take care of mom is so expensive."

""It was ok". Where do I start? About 9 months ago, my parent's 1000/month inheritance from a great aunt ran out, which meant they were now upside-down in their finances. They really already were, racking up credit card bills to survive while still managing to maintain their supply of (from some neighbor, non-medical) weed. Without this 1k/month, there was now no possible way they could pay for their manufactured home's mortgage and lot fee (2200/month) plus living expenses, on their social security- total of 2,000/month between the two of them. My husband and I stepped in to save the day. Said we would pay their mortgage and lot fee until further noticed - all we ask in return is that they get along and be kind to each other. (My parents have a volatile relationship and often triangulation with myself and my older sister). This would buy them and us some time to downsize and figure things out. Fast forward, Dad is diagnosed with Parkinsons a couple months later. Doc gives him homework activities to support his movement and health (he refuses to do), along with dopamine meds. His memory isnt good anymore, we tell Mom it is now her job to make sure Dad gets his 3 pills a day. My dad is 74, mom is 71.

These are not super old people. We notice Dad declining. We are told there is confusion with meds. OK, lets set a phone alarm. Dad continues to decline. Mom tells us he falls sometimes. Neurologist says - if he hits his head- this requires an ER visit. Then we find out Mom doesnt tell us when Dad falls - sometimes she hides it. It comes up after the fact. More confusion about if he took meds. He cant remember. He argues with her about taking them. She lays out pills on counter and expects him to take them as instructed. She doesnt push, because hes mean. More falls. Texts and calls from Dad saying hateful things about Mom. (She doesn't love him, she cheated on him, she doesn't clean/cook/take care of him, etc). Mom hides things and only shares when pressed - sometimes with a random text out of the blue. Then start the ER visits. Neighbors call ambulance when Dad falls walking around the neighborhood. I end up at the ER - asking doctors and Social workers what to do, can they keep him please and help place him? They say no - he is of sound mind. He leaves ER multiple times AMA - one time I had to drag him back in with a bloody open head wound. My mental health is shit at this point, I'm so drained, and I know i have to figure out assisted living- but I say I'll deal with it after the holidays (huge mistake. Im an idiot). I have a family of my own and a business Im juggling. No help from my sister except her mental breakdowns. We visit on XMAS. Dad is getting around pretty well. Mom is quiet. I breathe, thinking i have some time. A week or so later Dads friend calls me. Says their house is filthy, Dad is falling constantly, mom is checked out. I go over there with food and a vacuum. In that week after Xmas - it has deteriorated into squalor. It wasnt clean before but this was a whole new level. I start cleaning and take dad to get meds. Hes in a good mood one second, then fighting with mom the next. The house is in shambles. It's disgusting. I wait for when hes lucid and in a good mood and get POA paperwork done with them. Tell them im looking for Assisted living and they agree that yes, they dont want to live in this house anymore. Then I start going on tours and realize that our options are limited because they have NO money, their house isnt worth shit - I will be paying for the ALF until I can secure VA benefits and a medicaid supplemental waiver - both which take months (which i dont have) Dads declining while im working on paperwork, tours, benefits, my own life. He takes another fall - i call the ambulance (mom asks me not to), finally, the doctors admit and hold him this time as I beg them because he is not safe at home. Dad doesnt do well with this. Hospital delerium ensues. He tells me he is going to murder me. Starts talking about being back in his hometown (present day, not memory lane). Says he is going to shoot me when he gets out. Hates me. Im stupid, worthless, done nothing with my life - and Im a cunt, too, btw. Tries to assault nurses. Ends up in restraints. Cant be released to rehab until restraint-free for 72 hours. So, cycle continues for 2 weeks. Meanwhile, we have found a nice place that we will try to afford until benefits kick in, and move in mom. Two days later, we get Dad- who finally is acting mostly normal- not violent anyway - although the night before had called my husband and left a VM calling us cocksuckers. We pick up dad and hes in a wheelchair for now, having been bed bound for 2 weeks. Will need intense PT and OT. My 74 year old 6 foot tall Dad is now in a diaper and wheelchair. I can finally breathe. They are together, safe, in a 1 bedroom apartment with all the care they need. Yes it will be a financial blow until the benefits kick in (which is a PITA btw, doing this VA and medicaid process), but having them safe is the only way I can relax. After their first night I text mom and say I hope you guys had a good first night together. She texts back - "It was ok" I'm hanging on by a thread. I'm traumatized, definitely. No one prepared me for this- and I feel they are too young to be in this position, but here we are. I'm trying to move forward (even though I'm not close to being done), but my mind keeps bringing me back - I cant shake what's happened. Thank you for reading my story so far. I know it's long.... but feels good to get it out."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 387 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1r4kd2s/it_was_ok/

↳ **comment** (149): "The punches just kept coming reading that! Sorry it's so hard."

↳ **comment** (126): "You did very well—not just all you could—very well. You are a good kid who needs to hear that. I wish you could hear it from your parents, but try to hear it from this objective kind stranger. You went above and beyond. There's a lot of pain in your paragraphs, but there's also a lot of love. Most children could not or would not have done this for their parents, especially given their abuse. Please be proud of yourself. And take a deep breath. You did it. You made it. Things will get easier from here."

↳ **comment** (89): "You are an angel. Your care towards your parents is so kind. I'm sorry you've had to deal with such a shit show. Most people would have thrown in the towel. Stay strong."

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her, but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"Rethinking falls. About nine months ago, my mother, then 89, had a catastrophic fall in their house. Her bedroom was on the second floor, and she fell all the way down the stairs and ended up in the ICU for two weeks, and in the hospital for over three months. She's now home and physically almost recovered (miraculously) but has lots of other issues, and her cognition has declined precipitously. So has my dad's, from all the stress, and because he's 92. Their bank accounts are being drained by the 24/7 care they now have (and of course managing this is all on me). Of course multiple people, including myself, had told them they needed a stair lift, but they didn't listen, because it was "too expensive." So much of the advice around aging is around preventing falls. And yes, they should be prevented if you want to keep living. But – and this is cold – we keep acting as though we want elderly people to live forever, and then as a society we don't support them, or us the caregivers. Falls are terrible and painful and I wish my mom hadn't had one. But it should have been the end. The EMTs should've come and said oh, sweetheart, this is terrible, we are giving you morphine. It is utterly crazy that she was in the hospital for so long and cost taxpayers well over \$1 million in Medicare, only to come home and require so much care and drain their finances and eventually go on Medicaid. I don't know what we do about this. When my mom fell, I felt like she almost subconsciously had done it on purpose. That summer she had been telling me how tired she was, and

how she was ready to quit taking care of my dad, who is very demanding, and my disabled sibling (that's a whole other story). I was sure we were going to lose her and of course at the time I didn't want to but now I realize that would have been the natural thing. Figured you all would relate. I am not doing this to my kids."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 337 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1sz3vgm/rethinking_falls/

↳ **comment** (206): "This is such a valuable hard conversation we need to have as a society. We keep our elderly alive long past any quality of life. I'm in a similar boat with two of my loved ones falling with major injuries in the last year. The bills to Medicare were staggering and the 24/7 care adds up fast which wouldn't be a consideration if they were able to live any sort of life after. I had an ICU nurse chat with me late one night that it feels intentional keeping them alive just so healthcare and elder care companies can drain off as much wealth as possible."

↳ **comment** (78): "My father was put on comfort care at the hospital and I got a call asking for permission for a CT scan. Umm, no. I choose to believe it's from the litigious nature in America. Thankfully, Dad made his wishes clear so I had no guilt refusing feeding tubes and such. He passed at home."

↳ **comment** (65): "Your poor mama. She is TIRED of dealing with your dad and sibling. The hospital, as awful as they can be, may have been a respite for her. Meals delivered. Her own bathroom. Mostly sweet staff. Poor you. You must be mentally exhausted on top of juggling THREE of them. The money drain is no lie. THREE DEPENDENTS in a two story house? How in the world? She's exhausted caregiving. She's probably been putting up with your difficult daddy with his demands all her life and you don't say when your sibling became disabled, but if it's been lifelong? Or since their 20's? That burns even saints out early. If they've qualified for Medicaid, can the house be sold and they go to skilled care or assisted senior living? Surely that would be cheaper than trying to maintain a home for three people needing 24 hour care."

"My mom has passed. and my heart hurts, literally aches, right now. But I am relieved. At the end she was not really living. She died in my arms here at home 24 hours ago. We had just done the hospice intake 24 hours prior but hadn't yet been seen by a nurse. I wished my mom could have gone out more comfortably than she did, but I am choosing to look at the bigger picture, of all of the love and comfort that she experienced over the course of her decline. She spent the last 3 weeks of her life here with me, pretty much bed-bound, and it all happened rather suddenly. She had Alzheimer's and a whole host of other health concerns (it was undiagnosed heart failure that did her in). But at some point in the past week, she had enough presence of mind to say to me: *you have shown me the most love and care of anyone in my life, you are so good to me, thank you for being so good to me* and I know this may sound odd, but it was a privilege for me to be able to nurse my mother in her final days. I love you mommy. I will always love you. Thank you to all of the kind folks in this subreddit who have been a source of comfort and support"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 304 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p3du0e/my_mom_has_passed/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of

these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much

more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏 "

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"This is my life right now. My 81 year old mom has been on the decline for the last 3 and half years. She lives with me and my spouse. I am 56. it is so hard. I have no life and am worried and stressed constantly. I am beaten down, exhausted & worn out. I rarely laugh anymore. Thank you for posting this!"

youtube · @GenXGal1 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 284 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugyqej9hZ2qGs2YAeBR4AaABAq

↳ **@robogal1** (32): "When I m some days far away from my mother I become a completely different person, happy, laughing, satisfied...it s a feeling of freedom. I m feeling so trapped, when I have to stay with her, cause she is always so mean, controlling everything I do, never satisfied, but it s my sense of duty., that makes me to look after her. I have no help, are completely alone! My brother, who was always her darling, doesn t care at all for her. He calls once a week, never visits her."

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (20): "Hi, I get it. I don't know if it is any tiny comfort but you are one of very many in this situation right now. It's beyond difficult. Do the best you can to be kind to yourself. I appreciate you sharing what's going on."

↳ **@TallRaucousTruthSeeker** (19): "@robogal1you better check she hasn't left everything she owns to your brother if she has a will. It wouldn't be beyond imagining. Either that or she'll take you for granted for years, cost you your life & leave everything to the cat protection society. It happens, I've seen it!"

"Things I Wish Someone Had Explained to Me About the Actively Dying phase. I wanted to share a few things I've learned during the active dying phase with my mother-in-law because this experience is honestly something most people are not prepared for at all until they're suddenly in it. And I've realized some hospice agencies are amazing at proactively educating families... and others are kind of waiting for the caregiver to know what questions to ask or what options exist. The problem is your brain is already overwhelmed, emotional, sleep deprived, grieving, and trying to function while watching someone decline in real time. Sometimes you don't even know what you don't know. A few things I wish someone had explained to me earlier: hospice can provide a hospital bed in the home at no cost. There are also relatively affordable rotating air mattresses and pressure relief options online that can really help with comfort and tailbone pain. Foam barrier dressings have helped too. The little mouth swabs dipped in water have also made a huge difference for dry mouth and comfort. Another thing that has been hard emotionally is the eating and hydration piece. Every instinct in you wants to push food and water because feeding and nurturing someone feels so tied to love and care. But there really is a lot of hospice and scientific literature around the body naturally beginning to need less at end of life. From what I've read and been told, excess fluids can sometimes increase swelling and discomfort. I've also gone down a rabbit hole reading about ketosis during the dying process and how some researchers believe it may actually help ease pain or discomfort for the body. I'm not a medical professional, just a human trying to help someone I love through one of the hardest and strangest experiences of my life while learning as I go. Sharing in case it helps another caregiver feel a little less lost or alone."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 281 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1tapofw/things_i_wish_someone_had_explained_to_me_about/

↳ **comment** (82): "For anyone interested, there is a YouTube channel called HOSPICE NURSE JULIE. She explains all phases of dying, from all types of diseases and what to expect in each case. She is excellent at answering questions and taking the fear out of the whole process."

↳ **comment** (69): "Thank you for posting this, and massive, massive hugs to you. My sister recently passed but before that, our family was doing the above, actively providing water and nutrients (protein drinks) but also being anxious about knowing that at some point she wouldn't want to and couldn't either, because it became an aspirating danger. Mouth swabs in water are absolutely a game changer for comfort, they also had mouthwash that helped generate saliva that provided some comfort to her. The last thing I'll say about this phase that I never understood despite reading about it ceaselessly, was the restlessness that comes at end of life stage. I didn't know my sister's discomfort and distress would be her last signs before she passed. At that stage, it's was hard to know the degree to which she was in discomfort because it as a constant dance of increasing drugs for not only pain but also discomfort. We heavily leaned on the amazing nursing staff to help us through this distressing time, and for

anyone else seeing a loved one in hospice, just emphasizing that no question is a silly question, they have seen everything under the sun and are experts at noticing all the signs and symptoms."

↳ **comment** (23): "Hospice nurse Julie reels are so helpful. They can be a little jolting; it just depends if you are a person who likes a lot of information or a little. Taking the fear out of the process makes it more tolerable so you can be present."

"Adult only child left to pick up the caregiving pieces. RANT: The inevitable happened. My Mom (F67) who is the full-time caregiver for my stroke-survivor Dad (M77) became ill and is now hospitalized. Dad had months of physical therapy and then decided one day that he didn't want to walk any more. He wanted to die and thought if he stopped walking, that would hasten death. It did not. Now, Dad's legs have atrophied so much from being in bed, he can barely stand up on his own more than a few seconds. My mother, despite my pleas, refused to hire a part-time aide or helper. Instead, she did everything. I literally don't know how, but she did. I think she sped up her own health issues this way. Since Mom's new health issue was an emergency, I am now helping my Dad while working full-time. It has only been a few days, but I am already exhausted. People ask how they can help, and I have no words. Here's the truth: I am so tired. Tired of wiping his behind twice a day every day, tired of cleaning up the behind of a grown adult who chose not to work to recover 80% of his mobility when it was still a real possibility years ago. Tired of having to think about the supply of depends (adult diapers) in the house. Tired of having to have my name called to do everything. Tired of having to remind him to take his meds. What I really want is this: A nurse I can hire to take care of Dad for 12 hours straight. A hotel that would allow me to check in for 10 hours so I could sleep for 7 continuous hours, get 1 hour massage and a pedicure, and watch mindless tv for 30 whole minutes straight. Okay, rant over. Time to end this post and give night meds. UPDATE: Thank you to everyone who has posted a response. I had no idea how many people were going through this same experience. Reading this subreddit helps me to know that I am not alone. The responses, and I am reading all of them, are extremely helpful. I am very grateful."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 267 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1t4ztwe/adult_only_child_left_to_pick_up_the_caregiving/

↳ **comment** (174): "I realize you don't need one more thing on your plate but you may want to start looking for a nursing facility for dad. It takes a while so getting started now is advisable. Neither you nor mom can keep this up. Start with your town department of aging and tell them you need to talk to a social worker."

↳ **comment** (50): "I agree. OP, you are right to be exhausted. The stress of caregiving probably took a toll on your mom's health. This isn't sustainable. If in the USA, your state might have an agency that researches health code violations made by assisted living facilities."

↳ **comment** (40): "“People ask how they can help and I have no words.” I completely understand and I'm not even a full time caregiver. When my mom was hospitalized for a month and I was running back and forth to visit her, take care of her dogs, and try to keep up my full time job every day, I nearly drowned. I know sometimes that there's literally no other option or choice but to step in. One of the few things I did find immensely helpful was gift cards for Uber Eats/doordash/my favorite restaurants or fast casual places. Between my friends, incredible colleagues, and my husband's family, we basically didn't have to think about meals for two weeks and it lifted a huge burden. Being able to get whatever carry out on the way home or delivery directly to my door when I was too exhausted to keep my eyes open let alone cook was invaluable. I wasn't thriving, but it did help me simply survive and meet my nutrition needs. I wanted to pretend like I could do it all and the first few days, I declined offers of help. I know that your situation might be more long term than mine was, and folks can't buy you food forever, but in the short term, could it help bridge a gap between you and something else that needs to be done? Even the mental energy it freed up was huge. I know it's hard to put into words what you want or need and I know it's even harder to ask for something like a gift card or DoorDash credits, but if you have someone you trust

in your life, start there the next time they ask if there's something they can do, and then maybe they can help make others aware this is something they can do to help!"

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full

body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"How did we get here? Why is American eldercare so horrifyingly expensive?. TLDR: What the heck. Why? I'm in the US, so I really shouldn't be shocked by stuff like this anymore, but I am. I'm sick to my stomach at the growing financial stress of trying to keep my mom safe, and I'm only paying for supplemental in-home care and daycare thus far. I see this same pain over and over, hear so many stories like mine. I'm burning through savings and watching my goals slowly erode. I have a friend in her early 70s who has now returned to work after retirement due to the insane costs of her own mom's care. The average person now requires three years of supplemental care, either in-home or in a facility context as they age. Our bodies are outliving our minds a lot more frequently lately. Eldercare as an industry is only going to grow. I'm appalled at how companies happily leverage the desperation of elderly folks and their families. They know we have so little choice, and so, much like drug manufacturers, they get away with charging "whatever the market will bear". The model of most assisted living and memory care facilities as far as I can tell is to strip families of earned wealth at every single opportunity. If you don't come from significant generational wealth how do you even make this work? Is there a lobby that is responsible for manipulating lawmakers to look the other way? Is there no legislation? Are lawmakers themselves all so privileged that they never feel the financial impact of such care needs for their own loved ones? Meanwhile hourly caregivers, the heart and soul of this whole industry, make such demeaning wages. We entrust them with our loved one's lives and yet they're barely able to make ends meet. I've visited dozens of facilities preparing for inevitable SNF placement. My mom is dependent on Medicaid and *boy howdy* you can *REALLY* see the class disparity, she's on 14 waitlists as of this morning. But as I take tours and read the fine print/ see the hard monthly costs for most families, I'm just blown away. \$7,500 per month on the low end, over \$25,000 per month on the high end in my area. Even these most expensive facilities aren't offering much that is really special. They aren't providing caviar with breakfast. They are basically just your standard level of care, a hotel room with a hospital bed. Jello, mashed potatoes, the usual. I won't be personally shouldering that amount because my mom has no money to begin with (a fact that is both horrible and a mercy, somehow), but my heart aches for everyone else."

reddit post · r/dementia · 240 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1sttlq1/how_did_we_get_here_why_is_american_eldercare_so/

↳ **comment** (119): "Profit. The Private Equity companies that are buying out Assisted Living communities & Continuing Care facilities see tremendous opportunity for profit, as significant wealth is held by an aging population with increasingly limited options for Long Term Care insurance. Yet those profits do not necessarily correlate to better care, as keeping facilities short-staffed and paying low wages are often part of the profit-forward business model."

↳ **comment** (83): "God im going to sound terrible, but part of the problem is that people with "terminal illnesses" are living to long. They are treating symptoms and in treating a lot of these symptoms they are lengthening life. We cant just die of natural causes. There has to be a reason and we have to fight for a cure. There isnt a cure for aging. The cure, treatment, livng with it is where the profit is. No one wants to hear that they arent worth saving or their life isnt worth lengthening but there is a cost. Those costs are lost wages/careers, the mental/physical/emotional trauma for family caregivers. Meds, durable and nondurable equipment, special clothes, special underwear, special bed, special everything. Then there are all of the appointments, specialists, tests, procedures, and Lord only knows what else. Who pays...we pay out of pocket, through insurance and/or supplements that a premium is paid for, taxpayer funded programs (Medicare, medicaid, etc), etc. Its all one big

money grab with the premise of life being priceless. Its not really priceless. There are medical grade (just like the mil spec hammer that costs \$1500) costs that inflated to the point of being ridiculous. I wont even go into the accountants, attorneys, therapists, builders, and every other industry that preys on people who are desperate for just a little bit of help."

↳ **comment** (50): "My cousin insists that life is precious. I beg to differ. Existing is not living, and QUALITY of life is what is precious!"

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are talking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"My daughter and I cared for my mom untill her passing at 96 in 2023. It was hard and now I am watching my dad decline and I am not willing to do it again . Everyone else was living thier lives while we were by her side day after day. Thankyou for speaking up about this!"

youtube · @TiaTimberlake · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 227 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgxsDjqerya-PM7RKEV4AaABAg

↳ **@wetlugs** (20): "I'll never care for anyone ever again. It's totally depleting and now I look after me the best I can!"

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (19): "You are welcome. I hope it can shine a light and spark some discussions. It's very real. You know. 💕 "

↳ **@ThePinkPantha21** (16): "Take care of yourself and get help. You are important too."

Work, then her: before work, after work, on my lunch, the weekends · 338 documents

20 most engaged of 338 matching documents, complete text.

"I have to brag because I'm so freaking happy.... My Mom (then age 84) absolutely ran herself into the ground after my Dad (at age 86) fell and hit his head and walked around with an undiagnosed brain bleed for over 24 hours. After he was released from the hospital and rehab she became his primary caregiver, and learned everything from "scratch". Aides were hired but she was #1 for him. He deteriorated quickly, not even being able to feed or toilet himself. This continued for almost 3 years. After we finally convinced her to admit Dad into a nursing facility, she agreed to clear out her large home of 50 years and moved into an apartment nearby. There, she continued to take care of him, going there for about 5 hours every day, doing his laundry, choosing his favorite foods, and even giving him pt after Medicare said that he didn't need it because he had improved as much as he could and denied coverage. Dad was in nursing for just over 3 years when he passed earlier this year. It was tough. Mom always preferred her garden and kitchen to socializing and she found it difficult to make friends. Her eyesight and hearing are bad, so she had to give up driving and it was difficult to hear what people were saying to her. She turned 90 the week after Dad passed and slowly, with the help of some incredible neighbors in her building, she has become such a different person. She now takes yoga classes 3 mornings a week, and balance/strength-training on one morning. Whenever she hears that a person that she knows isn't feeling well, she makes and gives them soup. She has even participated in potlucks and gone to outdoor concerts over this summer. I am over the moon with love and respect and happiness for her! Over this past weekend, my husband and I took her to her granddaughter's wedding in the mountains. We got her a hotel room next to ours, she hadn't been away overnight since 2019. I was ready to leave the reception at 8pm and she pressed us to stay on. Then she, when I went to the restroom, decided to dance with everyone! I came back and couldn't believe what I was seeing!! Dancing for at least a half dozen songs in a row (upbeat, loud songs, too!), my niece was crying, my brother was grinning ear-to-ear, others were coming up to hug her. It was wonderful! I am writing this to, well, brag a little. *None* of us thought that she would bounce back from the loss of her husband of over 70 years and the literal hell that was taking care of him practically on her own for so long, but to let anyone else out there who might be in the same sort of situation that with patience and encouragement the path of an older person's life can be changed. Of course, Mom resisted for a bit, but she finally relented and still isn't very social, but she is happy. And has friends. And that's all I could have possibly hoped for. I wish that I could post the photo of her dancing that my husband took, I'm having it framed ❤️ EDIT: I just want to THANK ALL OF YOU for your wonderful replies! I'm so glad that I could give everyone a warm, fuzzy feeling and, just maybe, some hope with their own current or future situation. We have always called Mom "our Energizer Bunny" and somehow, as she has aged, the nickname is even more appropriate. 😊"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 830 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3g2fn/i_have_to_brag_because_im_so_freaking_happy/

↳ **comment** (162): "man this got me right in the chest, what a recovery arc for your mom at 90 she went from full time caregiver for years to out here dancing at a wedding like she 25, that's incredible my own grandmother shut down completely after my grandpa passed and never came back from it so reading this hit me in a way i wasn't ready for today the soup thing is so pure too, she sounds like a gem"

↳ **comment** (101): "And now she's spread good feelings all across the internet. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (33): "She sounds like an extraordinary woman - good for her and you! Loved your post."

"I am a single child of my parents. I woke up one morning when I was 30 only to come back from a jog to see my father passed away from a heart attack. I quit my job to move in to be with my mother (professor of Sociology at state university) and just when I was gaining momentum in life, mother was diagnosed with polymyositis (autoimmune disorder) & astrocytoma grade III brain tumour. My world crashed. She underwent surgery n chemotherapy and three years later she has lost all speech n the function of a right hand. Did I come close to losing my mind? Yes. Did I at one point of time thought of just running away till I eventually drop dead? Yes. Did I thought of abandoning my mother at a care home so that I can live a "happy" life? Yes. I am guilty of thinking all of this n more. YET! I love her more than my life and I stay put right here with her. Caring for her as much as possible. I am single so it hurts often not having anyone who can hold my hand n embrace me once in a while...but knowing that my mum smiles every morning when she see's me and sometimes folds my clothes with the same love that she had when I was a kid..makes me feel very very deep down inside that... I'm doing the RIGHT thing. Thank you"

youtube · @theeverselfproject · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 566 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKhikEw&lc=Ugxp32WUjPbx4DZw7UZ4AaABAg>

↳ **@wordswordswords8203** (33): "It's good of you to do that but you need to make sure you are ok too. Caregiving is really brutal and unhealthy in the long term. I'm living it."

↳ **@timujin3329** (25): "Similar situation, single child, I was 25(now 30) when my mother had a brain haemorrhage. She has been paralysed and bed ridden since. Its very difficult to juggle career and taking care of old parents. None understands how hard it is for us. My dad is also old and not in prime of health. Things are hard and won't improve , but I will keep caring and fighting in life ♥ Love and Support dear from India🇮🇳💗💗"

↳ **@MeiKoWalker** (23): "I hug you from distance, truly hope you can find someone to give you all the love you deserve"

"I have reached my limit. I want to die. UPDATE: She's gone.. [https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mkc0pb/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die/) First of all, I want to thank this wonderful community for the overwhelming support I received on my last post. You all have given me so much strength to continue doing what was best for my mom. On the morning of the day after my post, I handled the first diaper change with more grace and compassion. I felt bad for 'losing it' the night before so I tried to do my best, again. One hour later a CNA came to help me wash mom and change one more diaper. Her hands and feet had turned purple at this point. Shortly after I realized mom was in pain. She couldn't vocalize anything, and I had expected it to show on her face, but her expression did not tell any discomfort. However she had her eyes wide open, wouldn't stop rocking back and forth, bending her legs, and it dawned on me that she must have been in unbearable pain. I wonder how long she must have been in pain without me realizing it, probably even the day before. I hate the fact that it took me, us, so long to realize she needed the morphine, and that she possibly spent some of her last few days in pain, without being able to communicate it at all. It hurts my heart. So I called the nurse and we gave her morphine. She relaxed immediately. The doctor came by with a prescription for more morphine for the weekend, but warned me that mom probably wouldn't need it, because she had hours left. The diarrhea stopped too. The nurse came back, helped me prepare more syringes, and I gave her the morphine myself. In the evening she laid on her back immovable, breathing in a sort of robotic, loud way. As if she couldn't breathe, but some automatism was forcing her body to. I remembered that the morphine could help with breathing problems so I started preparing to inject it. I looked at her and noticed the breaths suddenly became more shallow, until she drew her last breath. Her face immediately turned pale. She still had a pulse for a few more moments, until that was gone too. I called the nurse, who was off shift, and she came to help me dress mom anyway. Then the doctor arrived and certified her death. She's now waiting for burial. I can't even describe the

pain I'm in right now, but I wanted to let you all know that you've helped me a lot, and I'm glad I pushed through long enough to let her die at home with us. She's in a better place now, it kills me how much she suffered and endured. All I could do in her last hours was carress her and tell her how sorry I was for everything. I wish she had gone peacefully. I miss her already. I can't stop crying. Thank you all again."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 519 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1mlunw0/i_have_reached_my_limit_i_want_to_die_update_shes/

↳ **comment** (115): "I'm very sorry for your loss. Give yourself some grace over being worn out and scared and grossed out. You're not a machine. And you gave her a gift by just being there until the end. You also figured out she was in pain, and relieved her of it. I'd say you did a great job under horrible circumstances. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (57): "I read your previous post and my heart went out to you. I'm so glad you managed right up to the end - your mom would have been so proud and happy to have had such a wonderful child."

↳ **comment** (43): "It was... it was absolutely worth it and I would do it again. I was imperfect and had my weaknesses and failures but I did show up for mom until the very end. The nurse and the doctor complimented me on my perseverance and it made me feel so seen. Mom would be proud."

"I may literally run away so I don't become my parent's caregiver.. Parents didn't plan for retirement. Dad has "joked" more than once than kids are his retirement. Well now both are retired. (Dad retired early, took the minimum amount of social security back in 2008). Dad now needs help with basic rent to get by and pisses and moans and turns into a toddler with **zero** dignity every time he has so much as a cold. Every time I talk to him, which is weekly, he tries to turn it into a big emotional thing like he's on his death bed and has to tell me his last words and last requests. This has been going on for years. I remember it happening the first time when I was in middle school and being completely distraught that my dad was acting like he was going to die. Now I can barely stop from rolling my eyes. The man has diverticulitis and runs around doing yard work at the height of summer. He is nowhere near on his death bed. Mom lives with me. They divorced 20 years ago. She also never planned for retirement but at least kudos to her, she took social security late to get the full amount. She's healthy and will probably live to roughly 1000. I love them both but I'm nearing 40 and it feels like my life is being consumed with my parents needs, financial and emotional. I cannot handle it turning physical, too. I am not a nurse personality. I don't like being around sick people and I will absolutely *not* be wiping adult asses. It's going that way: Now I'm having trouble meeting 40 hours a week working (I'm self employed) because of constant emergencies that my parents needs. (Medical, errands that have to be done during banking/work hours/little "emergencies" here and there. They're healthy but... they're starting to need help more and more.). My house is paid off. Mom can stay there for free. Dad is in VA programs and has access to caregivers if he can trust a "stranger" being around him. I love my mom (I love my dad too though I'm currently exasperated) but she is a strong personality and keeps starting fights with my neighbors, and when she gets bored she starts to meddle. Now she's newly retired and getting bored. I'm literally thinking of just taking my dogs and running across the country to, like, Florida. Maybe live for me for a year or two. I can afford it. Or, I would if I could actually get 40 hours a week in. 50 would be ideal. Self employment usually means working more rather than less, I've found. Is this selfish? I keep hearing stories of people becoming their parent's caregivers and I am filled with horror. I can't do it. I just can't. How have the people here headed off becoming their own parent's caregivers? Specifically women where it's sorta... expected?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 433 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v83aif/i_may_literally_run_away_so_i_dont_become_my/

↳ **comment** (343): "Nope, sounds like a great plan. You don't have to be your parents caregiver, I want to say that very loudly so you can hear me all the way over there. Maybe it's time for Mom to move to a nice retirement facility. She can get bored and meddle all she wants there."

↳ **comment** (144): "If I had a do-over. I would do exactly that. My wife and I had finally gotten settled into a good groove. Solid jobs with benefits/PTO, some decent savings in the bank, no serious bills to speak of and we had begun to celebrate our 50s by seeing the world. Now that my dad is gone my mom lives with us and her financial, medical, and emotional needs cannot possibly be overstated. If you are getting a bad vibe now about the functional end of your life due to being pressed into the role of caregiver, LISTEN TO THAT VOICE."

↳ **comment** (124): "This, OP! Look into getting her an apartment in a building for seniors. They generally charge rent on a sliding scale, and they have all kinds of amenities - 24/7 front desk staffing, medical alert systems in every apartment (as well as grab bars, raised toilets, and non-slip flooring), and free shuttle services to stores, medical appointments, and the local senior center. And drama! Holy crap, do they have drama. Your mother would never get bored. Unfortunately, they usually have long waiting lists too, so it would be a good idea to add her name to a few ASAP if you think you want to go this route."

"Am I evil? I don't want to care for my parents.. The other day, I (36 f) told my mom (60) that both my wife and I have recently gotten raises at work. In response, my mom "jokingly" said that she hopes I'm managing my money well so that she can afford to go into a nice home when she's older. She then told me that she and my father have no savings at all and no feasible plans for their old age. It suddenly hit me for the first time that they may actually be expecting me to care for them financially in the future. I just can't stop thinking about how unfair that is. One reason is the financial strain of it all. My wife and I both work full time. We have a mortgage for a modest home that's 30 years old. We drive a 12 year old pre-owned vehicle. We don't take vacations. Our combined take home income is just under 90k annually. I have student loans that I will be paying back for the next 30 years or more. We don't have a large savings account - just enough for emergencies and a little bit towards projects we'd like to do around the house. Here's the biggest reason, though - my parents were incredibly bad with their finances while I was growing up. "Bad" is an understatement, actually. They made horrific financial choices. We moved constantly. By the time I was 18, I had moved 19 times. My dad bounced from job to job. Money stress was constant, and not only limited to my parents. As a child, the financial stress was passed onto my siblings and I. I remember worrying about how the bills were being paid at an early age, and being hungry at school but afraid to mention it to my parents because I knew we couldn't afford bigger lunches. We spent years on welfare programs and getting handouts from churches. I could never afford new school clothes, or to be in sports or music lessons. I wouldn't even ask for those things - it was so not a part of my reality. At one point I had to live with relatives because my parents became homeless. Hardship happens to everyone, but in the case of my parents, most of their hard times were direct consequences of their own shitty decisions. It wasn't just financially rough growing up, either. They were generally NOT good parents...emotionally and psychologically abusive, neglectful, self-absorbed, immature, selfish, and made terrible choices in nearly every aspect of their parenting. My childhood is something that has set me back in life and caused me to have to work even harder to get to where I am today, rather than setting me up with a strong foundation. I went out into the world at the age of 17 with zero skills, awareness, financial support, emotional support, etc. I had to put in so much work to become who I am today and to overcome my trauma and make something of myself. And I did. Not much, mind you...my childhood stole a lot of my potential from me. But I've still accomplished more than I thought possible and am very proud of myself. I am child-free because my childhood was stolen from me in many regards, and I therefore do not want to sacrifice my adulthood by having children to care for, consider, or pay for. My childhood was not my own - I want the rest of my life to belong to me. I don't want to sacrifice anything anymore...not for anyone other than my wife and I. Yet here we are, expected to be financially responsible for two adults who clearly were not responsible themselves, and still aren't! They are flat broke and struggle to pay their bills, yet they find money to smoke weed and drink and waste in other ways. I just don't want to do it. I don't want to give them a dime. I know there's social norms and expectations and all of that, but I just really don't want to have to spend my hard earned money on my parents living expenses as they age. I feel that it is such a horrible burden to place onto your adult child. It's selfish and entitled. I am trying to figure out how to tell my parents this, and honestly, I'll probably just be brutally honest.

The good thing is my parents have grown a lot over the years and acknowledge all of their failures and shortcomings now, in retrospect. In my adulthood, they have become better parents. More like friends. I think maybe this is why my mom feels comfortable assuming that I'm okay with supporting them as seniors. I am hoping that she will respect what I tell her...and a big part of me is worried, too. My younger siblings both struggle majorly with their mental health and stability...neither of them will ever be able to support my parents even if they wanted to. So I wonder what happens to people in that position. My mom has health and mobility challenges. I worry for their future, and this creates SO much resentment inside of me. I worried about my parents since I was a tiny child - something that never should have been mine to deal with. And here I am again, taking on worry and fear for them that I shouldn't have to hold. I have worked so hard just to have peace, stability, and comfort. I just want to live my own life. ...thanks for reading my rant if you've gotten this far. If you've been in this position, I'd love to hear about your experience. If you think I'm a snotty evil brat, I'm sure you'll let me know that, too, haha. But I'd genuinely love to know if anyone else has dealt with these feelings before. I feel really guilty."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 408 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vhdrk0/am_i_evil_i_dont_want_to_care_for_my_parents/

"I'm urging you to impress upon your aging parent that "I'll deal with it when I have to" really means "My loved ones will deal with it when I have to.". This is an open letter to anyone who's making the same mistake I did for years with an aging parent, allowing them to have full agency and kick the can down the road until it became a crisis. Here's the TL;DR to set the scene: *Mother is a widow for about the last 30 years Lives alone in a four bedroom, two story house For the last ten years or so has been dealing with progressive loss of vision and mobility I'm an only child living about 3.5hrs away I am somewhat estranged from my mother for reasons I won't go into here, but she doesn't know it (easier to mask than to address the problem head-on) I have one cousin she's very close with & calls "the daughter she never had."* This person is also living about 3.5hrs away. *My mother has a large support network of friends where she lives who have been supporting her over the years, along with myself & my cousin* Starting about ten years ago I began asking my mother to please take seriously the fact that she was slowing down & relying much more heavily on support from friends & family *Asked her to move into a house that was easier for her to navigate (single story) closer to myself or my cousin* My cousin also asked her to consider the same *The general response from my mother was she'd deal with it "when I have to," which I tried to explain really meant **we** would have to deal with it "when she has to."* My mother is financially stable with retirement income & the value of this home so money was never a concern in this discussion. "When she has to" finally happened in late February with a retinal detachment in her "good eye." My cousin & I finally put our feet down and said this is the end game, you must move. That has set off what has been weeks of panic to *Find her a place she can afford* Begin the process of selling the house All while dealing with caring for her post-surgery (she has to be managed 24/7 during the healing process), managing her temper tantrums and panic attacks (we took her for a mental health screening but due to age & existing prescriptions any medication intervention wasn't on the table), and in my case, do all this & provide loving and supportive care through what I like to call my Diet Sugar-Free Estrangement Lite® with her. Oh, and my cousin and I both work, did I mention that? I'm currently half way through a two-week hitch up here, one week on "vacation" and the second week I'll be working remote from her dining room. In total I'll be about three weeks up here for the entire of this "event," with family members taking their time in the hole as they're available to relieve me. The net result of this is *Anger Frustration Burn out Bitterness Physical and emotional exhaustion* A widening of the rift between us We have decided to move her closer to my cousin, meaning she will now be 7-8hrs away from me. I'm wondering if, when we move her next week, that won't be the final face to face meeting. I'm not making any decisions on that front & taking it how it comes. My frustration here isn't just the huge amount of stress this has caused us acutely in the moment, it's the years of burden she's put on friends, family, and her entire support network, not to mention the fact that she has negatively impacted her own health and well being, both physically and emotionally. As she continued to age in this house that was not suited to her, her world continued to shrink. She became depressed. She's not eating (she's wasting away to the point where her doctors are raising concerns), all because of her stubborn and selfish demand

that she stay in this house. She's developing compulsive fears of the outside & the unknown. Even with friends and a support network here, the loss of agency she's suffered as her vision & mobility deteriorated took their toll. The situation all around has become an absolute nightmare for all parties involved, including her. This entire rant was to say my one regret in all this was not being more firm ten years ago when it became obvious that this house was no longer a viable solution for her. I attempted to give her the agency she wanted and as a result everyone has suffered. Some people say getting older sucks, but I disagree. I believe that people can age as gracefully as their health & situation affords. In my mother's case, her health and situation afforded her a much safer, healthier, happier, and more secure aging process - until one morning, it didn't. And it's because I didn't step in to become the parent sooner. Don't be afraid to hurt their feelings. Become the parent when the time is right and if they don't like it, they can just be mad about it. I'm sure we all were angry at our parents at times when we were younger as they did what was best for us. Now, it's our turn."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 370 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1trrt0u/im_urging_you_to_impress_upon_your_aging_parent/

"How to deal with an aging parent's unrealistic demands. I am 61 (F) and my mother is 86 going on 87. Two years ago, after my father passed away, I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. She has a long list of medical issues and is reluctant to go into care. For the first year I was working from home and balancing her care and the house and my job. Early in 2025 I retired (I took an early retirement offer from my employer) and pretty much immediately my mother's care became more complex. She's had a year of medical issues that I can't even begin to list as it's too long. But in the midst of all of that she saw my retirement as her opportunity to ask me to do all kinds of work around the house. Ok, I agreed to things within my capability like painting a room or doing some gardening work and minor repairs. But she's been bothering me to do more difficult things that (a) I don't have the knowledge to do and (b) are physically too demanding. She's been asking me to lift a bunch of patio slabs that are kind of shifting, refill and level the screening underneath and straighten them up. She mentions this CONSTANTLY. Even in the winter as something she wants done in the spring. We got a quote from someone and it would be close to \$1000 if not more based on the area she wants done. And she says she can't afford it. So I just keep saying no, I'm not doing it. And she keeps insisting "your father would do this; if I were younger and stronger like you I would do this, I used to do these things all the time." Finally, yesterday I had enough when she asked me about it again. I did not lose my temper. When she said "when I was your age I would have done this" I calmly reminded her that at my age she was on track to having her first open heart surgery so no she would not be doing this. Then she said "well your father would..." etc I reminded her that he had help from his friends and brothers most of whom are now too old or deceased. Then when she said well it would cost too much, I finally just said: "Well then, I guess they're going to just have to stay the way they are because I am not doing it and you don't have the money. People who don't have the money and can't do the work don't do it especially if it's not something critical." Like honestly it's all cosmetic at this point. She just doesn't like that they are shifting; nothing is a tripping hazard or anything but this is just one of many things she wants done which I just can not do. And it's a constant "but..." trying to shame me into being lazy and not competent and me saying "no...I'm not doing that; if you want it done we'll hire someone.""

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 362 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1qt0fs7/how_to_deal_with_an_aging_parents_unrealistic/

↳ **comment** (273): "I think they don't have enough going on in their lives so they persevere on this stuff. Also, they do lose track that not everyone who is younger than them has the strength of a 30 year old. 10 or so years ago my mom asked if my husband and his brothers could do some stuff she wanted done around her house, and I had to remind her that that entire crew was now in their mid-fifties and had bad backs! I like to remember that "No" is a full sentence."

↳ **comment** (155): "> I moved in with her to help her manage herself and her home as her goal is to stay in her home as long as possible. There's the problem. edited to add: I count six instances of "her" in that one sentence."

It's going to stay all about *her* until you decide to prioritize your own needs and wants."

↳ **comment** (127): "The thing is - this is what's known as "assisted living". If mom can't manage her own care and care of the home (even if "care of the home" means hiring people to do maintenance tasks), then she is no longer living independently. Parents seem to think that adult children as caretakers don't count, and that they are still "independent"."

"Seeing Behind The "Aging Industrial Complex" in The Villages, FL. My husband and I are visiting his elderly parents in The Villages, Florida, for Christmas. My father-in-law (94) is frail and needs a caregiver, while my mother-in-law (82) has been acting as his full-time nurse for two years. She's completely burned out but insists on doing everything herself, refusing outside help because "no one else does it right." This dynamic has concerned us for a while, and now it's come to a head: my MIL started having chest pains and is currently hospitalized. We've canceled our flights home and are trying to figure out next steps—whether it's arranging home care or transitioning them to assisted living. We both work full time and will have to take time off work to stay longer. Last night in the ER was eye-opening and deeply unsettling. We waited over 8 hours before my MIL saw a doctor. I have the utmost respect for healthcare workers, and it was clear they were completely overwhelmed. The staff was stretched too thin, and I saw many elderly patients—just like my in-laws—waiting in hallways due to a lack of space and personnel. It felt like a "cattle call," with everyone suffering: patients waiting in pain, families helpless, and staff dealing with entitled and impatient seniors. During that long wait, I started researching healthcare shortages, especially in elder care. What I learned was grim: a severe lack of healthcare workers, home health aides, and poor staff-to-resident ratios in assisted living and memory care facilities. The Villages markets itself as a paradise for seniors, but the reality I saw was far from idyllic. It seems like an impending crisis is brewing—people are living longer, but the low wages and poor conditions for caregivers make it unsustainable. I'm not sure if I'm venting or asking for advice, but has anyone else witnessed this firsthand? How do we prepare for what feels like an inevitable "boomer crisis" in elder care?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 311 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1hoc2wa/seeing_behind_the_aging_industrial_complex_in_the/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit

and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't

already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugkx_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ **@memyself9372** (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel** (30): "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏"

↳ **@BSAllergy** (29): "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"It's been a year since I quit my job and moved back home to care for my 79 year-old mom. I'm only 35... and I've gained more weight, I feel stuck sometimes. I feel like my life is on pause mode. I don't get to meet my friends anymore. I haven't been in a romantic relationship and cannot imagine meeting someone soon. My savings are dwindling... I wonder what will happen in the future. My siblings live in other countries and all have their own families to take care of. I love my mom, but we get into arguments sometimes. It gets really overwhelming to be alone in this journey. :("

youtube · @ri5876 · *How to Relieve the Stress of Caring for an Aging Parent: Amy O'Rourke at TEDxOrlando* · 241 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=4c2grKHiKEw&lc=UgyoDoUxKO49e7lk3N4AaABAq>

↳ **@lynnnettemolinpersonalpage** (39): "Tell your siblings to take their turn. Living in another country is no excuse. You need a break. They can fly her to them to live or at the very least they can spend their vacation weeks living in your home so you can get regular breaks."

↳ **@aeromedical6750** (35): "@R I — I totally understand your situation because I live it. You feel trapped, because their caregiving needs always trump yours. Nothing satisfies my Mom right now. She's a sweet person,

but totally self centered. My wife and I are constantly on guard that the next crises is right around the corner. Our lives revolve around her care needs 24/7."

↳ **@crimeariver8370** (29): "Im in the exact same boat as you. And just like you I also feel alone and trapped with no one to help take the edge off. So I totally feel ya."

"At what point do you let them fail?. 47f with a busy job and my own family that I love very much. My parents are 82 and 88, dad has advanced but undiagnosed dementia. Mom is his caretaker and broke her hip a week ago. They live in the huge house I grew up in, which has more and more deferred maintenance and insurance costs. My sister and I live 500 miles away, a third sister lives locally but travels about half the time for work. For the last week, my sisters and I have been scrambling to be in town to caretake for my dad while my mom is in the hospital with a broken hip. My mom is so sweet but my dad is a narcissist, I've always had a very challenged and distant relationship with him, and while for a few years dementia make him sweeter and less angry to the point where I didn't actively dislike him, at his current stage it's just full dementia plus his full classic narcissism — behaviors that were always there but used to have more of a veneer of social graces that have been removed. He throws a temper tantrum if my mom is talking on the phone to someone. He is really sweet to me when I am pouring whole and adoring and undivided attention on him and listening to the same stories about him on a loop, but gets agitated and has outbursts and paranoia if we're not focused on him. He has major anosognosia and will never admit that anything is wrong. He still can bathe himself, use the toilet, dress himself, turn on the TV, pour a bowl of cereal, have a conversation about things from the last century. He mostly recognizes his family through he's started not being sure which daughter each of us are. Caretaking for him for 6 days was only mentally possible because I'm very even keeled, know that I'm a grownup with a wonderful spouse and kids I love, and know that it's time limited. I can take a little more time off work but not endless. It's virtually impossible to work while caring for him because he demands so much attention. When my mom gets out of the hospital, she's going to need a lot of extra care. We've talked to her about needing home health aides. The hospital social workers are talking to her about it. Other friends and family members are talking to her about it. However, she seems to think that my dad plus a weekly housekeeper will be enough. We've done a lot of things to make sure my dad isn't driving, and had endless conversations with my mom to make sure she knows my dad can't drive, but I am almost positive that if she can't drive and we're not there to prevent it, my dad will drive unless we remove all vehicles from the house. While we were there, the house had a major plumbing emergency that I was coordinating, and it's still not fixed (though there are enough working bathrooms that the house is still livable). But there's a lot more major repairs that are deferred, and I've been coordinating minor repairs for the last couple years because my mom has been struggling with the executive function to do it (between the exhaustion of caring for my dad and her own declining executive function and memory loss). They REFUSE to leave their house, for years have refused to entertain the conversation first of downsizing and then of any sort of assisted living, and I think they're going to refuse in home health aides. And at some point, I feel like I have to let them choose their choice and fail on their own? I am going back next week to care for my dad for a few more days until my mom is discharged, but after that, I have to be tending to my own family. I'm most worried about the driving because that could kill other people, but if I can figure out a way to prevent that from happening, is it so wrong to let them fail if they're refusing help? ETA for clarity: she had surgery last weekend and is in a rehab facility now; she'll probably be there for another week or two doing OT and PT before getting discharged home."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 234 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1un8h0l/at_what_point_do_you_let_them_fail/

"he wouldn't inconvenience himself to go to the doctor so now the expectation is that I have to disrupt my entire life to compensate for his neglect.. my 28F dad 73m had a heart attack back in may after hiding from me that he had been unable to get out of bed for 4 weeks (I live 2 hours away). he was in the hospital for about 4 weeks and they were able to stabilize him and they were getting ready to discharge him to a hospital when he had a stroke

last wednesday. I somewhat reflexively jumped into caregiving mode, called out of work, and am doing the paperwork for a leave of absence from work. his speech is pretty affected and he's not stable enough yet to be discharged, and they're saying he needs 4-6 weeks of rehab, and then at home PT after that. I was filling out the paperwork for my leave when I just realized. what the fuck am I doing. and I've been simmering with rage ever since. its been pretty difficult to be my dad's child. he was chronically ill for my entire childhood and my mom supported him through it. but I think it led to a dynamic where he viewed himself closer to a child in need of caregiving rather than a parent. he has never been reliable, he's never been able to prop me up when i've needed it, and he's he has never taken responsibility for his role as a parent. my mom died this past december after a long battle with dementia and he's been depressed for the last few months and refusing to seek out medical help to an infuriating degree that I had to stop calling him as much. he explicitly said to me my grief isn't as bad as his or my brother's because i didn't live at home with them. there was no consideration that as our father he should be the one trying to keep the family unit together. no consideration that yes, he lost his wife, but I lost my mom first to dementia at 20, and then completely at 27. he's incredibly stubborn and would refuse to go to the doctor no matter how sick he was, and basically would only go if it was an emergency that required an emergency room visit. I spoke with his neighbor last week who's quite fond of him but also frustrated at his refusal to take care of himself. she told me that one time he fell and couldn't get up, and he called her (she's also 73, probably about 5'0 and may 130 lbs) to help him get up, not 911. I was despondent about how all of his recent health stuff was disrupting my life. I just moved in with my partner and we were supposed to celebrate pride this weekend with all our friends, and I had to miss out because I was at the hospital all weekend. i've filed paperwork to take leave from my job as an attorney that i've spent years struggling for. and my mental health is worse than its been in a while, and my partner's worried because i'm just a ball of depression and rage right now. and it just hit me while I was filling out the documentation for my leave, this was all avoidable if he had just gone to the fucking doctor before he had heart failure. he couldn't inconvenience himself so now I have to pretend my life doesn't exist because he was irresponsible. before he got sick he was displaying some passively suicidal behavior, kept saying he doesn't want to be around for much longer now that my moms gone. i couldn't believe he thought that was okay to say to me when i wasn't even six months out of losing a parent. i last saw him 2 days ago and he was beginning to get noncooperative in the hospital, not wanting to do physical therapy, ripping his wires out, etc. and i realized that i think that he doesn't want to actually get better. and I don't think i have anything left to try convince him anymore. i've had to compensate for him and my mom's irresponsibility for nearly my entire adult life and I think I'm realizing, I don't think I can actually do this. I think the role I need to play needs to be much smaller than what I had envisioned. he made his decision to not seek out help when we could've better managed it, and waited until the last possible moment, when everything would be as disruptive as possible. I was so scared at the prospect of losing both my parents in my 20s that I was willing to do anything last week. but yesterday, the weight of my collective effort in my career and my relationship was staring at me and I realized, why am I so willing to throw that away for someone who doesn't want to get better? he made his decision to neglect his health, and we begged him not to, but he wouldn't listen, and he has to live with the consequences now. simple cause and effect."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 228 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ujtemb/he_wouldnt_inconvenience_himself_to_go_to_the/

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good

money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"All the Senior Community Support and Activities in the world - and she's still unhappy.. I'm just posting this to make one point: *It doesn't matter how much money, time, resources you have, the elder in your life may still utterly despise all of it and blame you.* My situation: Four years ago my mother inherited a fortune from her 103 yr old mother. It was MORE than enough to put my mother into the best senior community in Southern California, which happens to be a five min drive from my house. It's got endless clubs, churches, free daily shuttles, landscaping, pools, horses, events, concerts, pet groups, crafting, fucking kilns, looms, painting studios, lakes, ponds, dining halls, eight clubhouses with daily activities, a co-op arrangement than means all her maintenance and appliances and repairs are inclusive. AND SHE HAS \$\$ to SPARE! And yet every time I go see her/call her it's the same story: Well, I'm alone and I have nothing to do...pity me pity me.... Dude. You've lived in old fart paradise for four years now, not ONCE has she stepped outside with her walker to take a look around. She has a clubhouse one block away that has concerts every weekend. She's never been. We got her the event / happenings newsletter - she throws them away. She got her hip replaced to help her mobility and it has improved but she will only leave the house for church on Sunday if somebody from the church picks her up (they do because she gives them a lot of \$\$). We've given her scooters to get around: she doesn't "trust" them and thinks they are

embarrassing although half the community rides around on them just fine as the neighborhood was built to accommodate scooter travel. We've gotten her discount senior cab service since she thinks the FREE shuttle that runs by her front door every hour is "too inconvenient" even though it would take her to every doctor's office and dental office, senior center and clubhouse in the city. She tried it TWICE and the first time she BINGO'd so hard she missed the last shuttle at 7pm and I had to go rescue her ass. Another time it picked her up ten minutes late and she almost missed a dental appointment!!! So, okay fine, use the \$5 cab service. She will for medical/dental/beauty appointments, but otherwise not because she wants to make lots of little shopping stops and the cab won't sit and wait for her and she doesn't want to pay more than \$5 a day. She won't use Uber either. That's \$10!!! Okay, so I even tried hiring her a senior companion to come hang out with her twice a week and take her out on walks, to errands etc. This company will allow them to drive. Very affordable and she loves the nice ladies who help her out (clean, do personal care, heat up her Meals on Wheels). But 90% of the time she just wants to sit and chit-chat and not actually utilize them and then SHE CALLED THEM OFF because she didn't like paying \$250/week. She's a trust fund baby, she CAN AFFORD IT! Nope, what she wants is for me to come over and entertain/clean/help her. And I do once a week or so (take her shopping or lunch) or immediately if she's upset/needs help. But I friggin' work 24/7 as does my husband and son who is in college and I have to clean MY house, buy groceries, cook, yard care, pet care, bills, you name it. We never had much of a relationship growing up as most of my childhood was yelling and beatings so sorry, I've tried everything. EVERYTHING> If you are STILL miserable, it ain't on me. I'm sorry if it doesn't thrill me to come over and just sit in your catbox of a tiny home with the heat cranked up and hear about Jesus all day long while the TV is on top volume. She honestly believes she'd be better off if she was still living alone 500 miles away where she had friends (dead or institutionalized now) and church (shut down during Covid) and a car (she drove into a Church wall - so NO). And it's ALL MY FAULT she's unhappy. No, she won't see a therapist or mental health expert. No, her mind is 100% fine and dandy. If I even suggest mental experts she screams at me. "Oh! You think I'm losing it!!?" Seriously, I'm done. I'm here in an emergency and to handle her bills and medical situations and to call for extra assistance as needed and race over in an emergency (TV won't come on, Alexa is 'broken', lights shut off because she can't remember where the circuit breaker is, help her take her 40 yr old cat to the vet, some weird bill came in that's somehow STILL not on autopay....). But her 'happiness' is not my problem. She wasn't terribly concerned about my health/happiness as a kid: How much forced soap did I ingest? How long did I just have to stop whining and walk to school with a broken tailbone, meningitis, mono, untreated seasonal asthma, horrific cystic ovarian bleeding? How many times did she and my Dad take off to Europe and leave me age 15 with my much younger brother and no extra cash? I HAD a job, I could order pizza - ! And the worst... how many times was I locked out of the house (front door was manually bolted from the inside at 9pm whether I worked until 11pm or not!) and had to sleep in my car or with the dog in the backyard leaky clubhouse?? And don't even get me started on the sheer number of relatives and church people who feel the need to pull me aside and tell me what I NEED TO DO for her because she complains to them about me. I've done everything. You think she needs more? You can come over and sit with her and hear about how you 'just need to hear the good word' and how you're still in trouble for some random thing you did as a teenager forty years ago....' Mentally, I'm OUT. It's just a no-win scenario."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 205 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1l2fp2e/all_the_senior_community_support_and_activities/

"Only Child—Outnumbered by 2 Aging Parents. I'm struggling, and I just don't know how to handle everything I'm supposed to handle. I'm 47, female, single, and an only child. My parents are 75, in declining health, and live 2 hours away. Financially, no one can move closer. I work full-time in a stressful job with 4 days a week mandated RTO, and my commute is over 2 hours a day. I've got chronic health issues I'm dealing with, plus trying to keep a house going. My parents haven't planned for their future and get mad when I try to bring anything up. They're dismissive. My parents are both frail and need help. They have someone who comes to clean periodically, but there's no one there for day to day stuff. My mom gets mad that I'm not there more often. I'm exhausted and sick, but I'm "selfish" for not taking time off work or coming more on weekends. I love them, but I'm upset they haven't

and won't do anything to plan. They're struggling, but so am I. And I can't take care of them and me too. I have to keep my job and insurance. I can't afford to not work or to take unpaid leave. They don't want to hire caregivers, and neither of them wants to go into assisted living. I feel like I'm not enough, no matter where I am. If I'm with them, I'm not much help. Drowning at work. Too exhausted to do much at my own house. I don't know what to do. I have to keep my job, and I feel like a bad daughter."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 193 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ue0xdc/only_childoutnumbered_by_2_aging_parents/

"I'm so angry at my dad for living this long. Venting session, so glad I found this sub because I'm struggling so much with my emotions toward both of my parents. I'm (35 female) constantly battling fuming anger at my 78 year old father, who recently went to live in a home. Some background : My dad has had a myriad of health problems stemming from an unhealthy lifestyle going back to when I was in high school. It's hard for me to remember a time when my mom and I weren't caregiving for him or we weren't dealing with his poor lifestyle choices and health consequences. My dad retired early and did not plan for any serious illness or assisted living coverage as apart of his retirement. He spent of lot of time drinking and playing golf with his friends and pissing away their money on stupid stuff like going out to eat and betting on sports. About two years ago when I was early in my pregnancy with my daughter, my dad's pacemaker was infected and he went septic. We spent about 2 months cycling back and forth from our home to the trauma hospital in Denver 4 hours away. Meanwhile, I'm pregnant and there's no room for me to feel anything or complain about morning sickness or anything because my dad is sick and dying AGAIN. By all accounts it's a miracle my dad lived at his age. However, they had to amputate both legs and most of his fingers due to tissue death. They recommended going into an in-patient rehab facility to work on building back his strength and be fitted for prosthetics, but he refused and insisted he wanted to go home instead- which my mother (who I failed to mention is 13 years younger than him) acquiesced to even tho she had literally just retired from career as an educator (25 years!) It's been a nightmare ever since. My dad has cycled between being a complete asshole who demands so much from those around him, to someone who is so depressed that he has given up entirely. He went into hospice shortly after getting home and we made arrangements for MAID. About 4 times now we have gone so far as to procuring the cocktail, getting the clearance from his doctor, and announcing (by his request) that he was going to do it to friends and family. Meanwhile I'm dealing with my own health crisis and major life event. My daughter was born 2 months early due to HELLP syndrome. I myself almost died, and we spent 2.5 months in the nicu with her while I recovered as well. Meanwhile my mom had no time for us because she is servile and over accommodating to my dad. Instead of looking at caregivers, assisted living, etc. she insisted on being his sole caregiver but never ceasing to complain about how much it ruined her life. I felt abandoned by her when it was a very scary time for me and my husband. After the 4th failed MAID decision, my dad was kicked off hospice because he's not terminally ill. My dad is profoundly disabled, and for that I totally empathise, but he is not dying. His hospice nurse basically told him he needed to "get busy living or get busy dying because the world does not stop for you". I gave her a hug after. We finally made the decision to get my dad into a home about 4 months ago, only because my mom needed her hip replaced and was absolutely no longer able to care for him during her recovery. Yet here we are, my mom has stopped physical therapy, and makes 3-4 trips to see my dad per day to bring him food, supplies, etc. She will go so far as to drive 2 hours away to locate the right size diapers for him instead of ordering them from online or getting them in bulk. She complains to me constantly and I've had to set very strong boundaries around the topic of our conversations because I'm so exhausted from hearing about it. I'm taking my mom and my daughter to the beach next week for a short vacation and I'm already panicking that she is going to cancel or our trip is going to get interrupted because of something with my dad. My mom no longer allows herself to enjoy life and retirement and being a new grandmother because she is consumed by her guilt for putting my dad in a home. And this might all crumble because neither of my parents planned for assisted living and they are running out of money if my dad continues living much longer. I have offered to help them financially, which started probably one of the biggest fights I've ever had with my mom because her pride won't allow her to accept help. I love my parents, but I also love being a

mom. I have to focus on my own family and my beautiful daughter who is now almost 2. But I can't help but let this anger consume me. It's strained my relationship with my mom, I barely speak to my dad anymore, and I'm tortured with constant vivid dreams about just totally having it out with my parents. My brothers are no help. They get involved if he's in the hospital or when he was contemplating MAID, but now that he's out of sight, out of mind we barely talk. I'm balancing raising a toddler, working a full time tech job, and managing a small homestead. My husband has been a wonderful support for me but I can tell he's exhausted too. End rant. I'm just tired and angry y'all. TIRED OF BEING ANGRY AND TIRED OF BEING TIRED."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 188 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v9dbsk/im_so_angry_at_my_dad_for_living_this_long/

"Even as a professional nurse, this is difficult... it is very difficult and expensive to get any kind of help. We are going on 5 years of watching my mom fade away... while working a full time job.. no word from my siblings.. they come once a year. I am glad my mom is safe and well cared for by my husband and I. I am emotionally, physically drained. I feel like my "golden years" have been taken"

youtube · @ValerieLutz-rp3vf · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 183 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgyseQm5vCvOxUZxQjN4AaABAq

↳ **@SoloSecondHalf** (23): "It is beyond difficult and near beyond human capacity. I wish I had something other than to say you aren't alone with this experience. I am very grateful for all you do as a nurse and then you and your family caring for mom. It is beyond tough. I hope the kindness and goodness you are putting out there comes back 10x. Thank you for sharing this. Hang in there."

↳ **@Andy-fr1hu** (9): "I was in this situation (siblings live in other states) one almost never visited in eleven years. I cared for my Mom (dementia, no mobility) and father (abusive, mobile with personality disorder) until two years before they passed (Mom naturally, father took his life). The last two years, I had to walk away. My oldest sister (well to do), paid for their in home care and visited when she could. The other sister never visited. I went from a very active and healthy 50-60's year old married lady to a person with heart problems and Graves Disease. I thank God every day for my patient and loving husband. Please make sure you are cared for also! Being strong for years is great and admirable, but you have no idea how long your parents may need your assistance. In home care is wonderful if you can afford it. I could have never walked away if it meant they had to go to a nursing home. I wish the best for you. You are doing the hardest job there is in life. Bless you ❤️ 🙏 "

↳ **@nt3352** (4): "It's the hardest job indeed that's why not all siblings will cooperate if there is already a main caregiver sibling. Good that one of your sister paid the bill. My siblings were mostly lip service."

"I spent from 2010 to 2023 working a terribly challenging job while dealing with major care issues for my mom (brain aneurysm, heart disease, diabetes, major mobility trouble), for my dad (major heart disease broken hip), and my stepmother (dementia). They have all passed and I've spent the last 2 years trying to recover my own health. I have no answers, but I know when that burden falls on you in your 50s and 60s, especially if you also must work full time, it is exhausting, financially challenging, robs much of your joy, and can make you quite ill. I miss my folks, but I do NOT miss the exhaustion of those years."

youtube · @Calliope8.8-k6z · *Dealing with aging parents: Is anyone else going through this?* · 168 likes · <https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=p8sRNKTGj9g&lc=UgzD1bXbgo9vHqSbBep4AaABAq>

↳ **@allyssacook5350** (4): "Your comment saddens me because I don't want to be a burden on my son. However, I would like to be there for him...for as long as possible."

↳ **@joshie8045** (3): "@allyssacook5350 As a son who loves his parents so deeply. I'd rather my parents be my "burden" than to not have them at all. I hope your son can share this sentiment with me. As long as you have

been a rock for him, like my parents have for me. Im sure he thinks you are a superstar. We all have to be better at living in the moment."

↳ **@lexie-d7190** (2): "People ask me what I do for fun....what is that? Oh and don't get me started on the dating pool!"

"Both of my parents died young, but my father stayed in end stage heart failure for years. In his last year, he lost the ability to walk but refused a care facility. I couldn't get him admitted myself. So i cared for him with no help from siblings or any family. I was only 39 with 2 toddlers and a full time job. It was absolutely the most horrendous and damaging experience of my life. I felt i was getting ill myself. Sure enough, 2 years later i was diagnosed with breast cancer. I wasnt the least bit surprised. We need a solution to this problem of care, it's not sustainable."

youtube · @limo5724 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 159 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=UgwXJzaMFh7d-YG8do94AaABAg

↳ **@obstantiadiscindo** (35): "@limo5724 Our parents didn't have to do this for their parents - people live longer now, but in poorer health, and dementia too. The current system doesn't work. Sometimes the carer dies before the parent. I don't know how you did it with 2 toddlers too. I hope your health improves and you regain your joy of life."

↳ **@jdmmg4904** (28): "Absolutely selfish decision from your father to burden you like that:("

↳ **@elizabethk3238** (17): "Too many selfish parents expecting their children to fully care for them. If they took care of themselves they will strong and self supporting till death. I'm 78, spend my limited pension on eating well, taking the supplements that will help keep me strong, exercise regularly, keep my mind alert. I cared for my parents for years, I will NEVER put my children through that."

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play stardew valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many potholes and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop

that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

Wake up every day wondering if it will get worse; 3am wondering how much longer · 290 documents

20 most engaged of 290 matching documents, complete text.

"I have to brag because I'm so freaking happy.... My Mom (then age 84) absolutely ran herself into the ground after my Dad (at age 86) fell and hit his head and walked around with an undiagnosed brain bleed for over 24 hours. After he was released from the hospital and rehab she became his primary caregiver, and learned everything from "scratch". Aides were hired but she was #1 for him. He deteriorated quickly, not even being able to feed or toilet himself. This continued for almost 3 years. After we finally convinced her to admit Dad into a nursing facility, she agreed to clear out her large home of 50 years and moved into an apartment nearby. There, she continued to take care of him, going there for about 5 hours every day, doing his laundry, choosing his favorite foods, and even giving him pt after Medicare said that he didn't need it because he had improved as much as he could and denied coverage. Dad was in nursing for just over 3 years when he passed earlier this year. It was tough. Mom always preferred her garden and kitchen to socializing and she found it difficult to make friends. Her eyesight and hearing are bad, so she had to give up driving and it was difficult to hear what people were saying to her. She turned 90 the week after Dad passed and slowly, with the help of some incredible neighbors in her building, she has become such a different person. She now takes yoga classes 3 mornings a week, and balance/strength-training on one morning. Whenever she hears that a person that she knows isn't feeling well, she makes and gives them soup. She has even participated in potlucks and gone to outdoor concerts over this summer. I am over the moon with love and respect and happiness for her! Over this past weekend, my husband and I took her to her granddaughter's wedding in the mountains. We got her a hotel room next to ours, she hadn't been away overnight since 2019. I was ready to leave the reception at 8pm and she pressed us to stay on. Then she, when I went to the restroom, decided to dance with everyone! I came back and couldn't believe what I was seeing!! Dancing for at least a half dozen songs in a row (upbeat, loud songs, too!), my niece was crying, my brother was grinning ear-to-ear, others were coming up to hug her. It was wonderful! I am writing this to, well, brag a little. *None* of us thought that she would bounce back from the loss of her husband of over 70 years and the literal hell that was taking care of him practically on her own for so long, but to let anyone else out there who might be in the same sort of situation that with patience and encouragement the path of an older person's life can be changed. Of course, Mom resisted for a bit, but she finally relented and still isn't very social, but she is happy. And has friends. And that's all I could have possibly hoped for. I wish that I could post the photo of her dancing that my husband took, I'm having it framed ❤️ EDIT: I just want to THANK ALL OF YOU for your wonderful replies! I'm so glad that I could give everyone a warm, fuzzy feeling and, just maybe, some hope with their own current or future situation. We have always called Mom "our Energizer Bunny" and somehow, as she has aged, the nickname is even more appropriate. 😊"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 830 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3g2fn/i_have_to_brag_because_im_so_freaking_happy/

↳ **comment** (162): "man this got me right in the chest, what a recovery arc for your mom at 90 she went from full time caregiver for years to out here dancing at a wedding like she 25, that's incredible my own grandmother shut down completely after my grandpa passed and never came back from it so reading this hit me in a way i wasnt ready for today the soup thing is so pure too, she sounds like a gem"

↳ **comment** (101): "And now she's spread good feelings all across the internet. ❤️"

↳ **comment** (33): "She sounds like an extraordinary woman - good for her and you! Loved your post."

""She should be at home with a caregiver and not in this fucking place! THERE I SAID IT". These were the exact words I read in a text sent to my mom (69, diagnosed with dementia 2023, moved into AL in 2024). It was in a chat group and a few other people agreed in it. This text was sent to her from one of the many people shrieking at me to "do something" about/to help my mom, who was exhibiting confusion and hallucinations that worried HER. Ever since I read it, I've just felt completely dead inside. Like, I wish I wasn't here anymore. Why do people do this. Why do people have to constantly undercut all the shitty decisions I have to make, which have shitty outcomes that I have to deal with, which make my day shittier than it needs to be. This lady lost her husband to cancer in 2024 - they kept him home on hospice and the family chipped in to help care for him until he passed. Sure. How wonderful for him and for them. *How fucking beautiful.* Newsflash - I'm not strong, I'm not some beautiful, sacrificial saint. *I'm not her.* I'm just a tired miserable 40 year-old woman who has spent the last 3 years in constant fight-or-flight mode, fielding phonecalls and unsolicited opinions and unhelpful platitudes from people who seem to have conveniently forgot that dementia doesn't get better and that I've personally watched my mom hallucinate, fielded panicked/terrified phonecalls from her at odd hours of the night saying there were "people" in the house, and had several instances where she forgot who I was even when looking me dead in the face. **BEING HOME DOESN'T FIX THIS SHIT. NOTHING DOES. YOU WAKE UP EVERY DAY WONDERING IF IT WILL GET WORSE, AND WHEN IT DOES, YOU GO TO BED THAT NIGHT HOPING IT WILL END SOON.** I get that she loves my mom - she loves her to death. We all do. And it's killing all of us to see her so depressed. I don't get to turn that feeling off, ever. Maybe she just loves mom more than me. But considering that mom **CHOSE** this place after I showed her 4 other locations, and she looked them up, saw their reviews were good and agreed to move, they're still acting as though she was just unceremoniously dumped there and she's just so sad and it's my job to do whatever it takes to make her un-sad because she's their friend. Not to mention - mom has money to be in AL for a good while (thank goodness for pension and social security, along with recently consolidated and fiercely protected investments). We probably would blow through all of that much quicker if we did in-home, and even then, mom was adamantly **AGAINST** having caregivers. Even the ones I hired to take her to appointments, she didn't really like - they talked too much, they got in the way of her wanting to go for a walk or take a nap, etc. Hell, after her diagnosis I was lenient with her - she still lived home alone. But when she started having hallucinations and delusions that made my husband and I agree that it wasn't safe for her to live alone (which coincided with her friends **ALSO** saying she shouldn't live alone), I gave her a fucking choice - I asked if she wanted to go to AL now, if she wanted me to find a live-in carer now, or if she wanted me to move in with her. The condition for me moving in with her was that I would assess when it was time to move her to AL because I already fucking ended the lease on the apartment I loved to move in with her, and I'd be damned if I had to pack all my shit **AGAIN**, find a new place to live **AGAIN**, set up all my utilities **AGAIN**, and **STILL** have to manage HER life from afar. Always a fucking complaint from someone. "Help her," they say. I help. **"OH BUT NOT LIKE THAT."** I'm getting messages from her - *can you get her to a therapist? Have you found a therapist? I thought you said you were looking for a therapist? What meds is she on? Have you made an appointment with her doctor to up her meds? She's so depressed - are you aware?* **FUCKING YES, ON TOP OF ALL THE OTHER SHIT I'M HANDLING.** I've been on the phone with United Healthcare off and on for the last 7 months trying to find something other than a fucking referral service for a psychiatrist/therapist for her - and guess where it got me? "We don't specialize in dementia." "We're not taking new patients right now." "You're on a waiting list!" "Our waiting list is full, and requesting to be placed on the waiting list doesn't guarantee that you'll be placed on the waiting list - you'll have to wait until the waiting list isn't full anymore!" Other messages from others - we're worried about her dog - it keeps having accidents and the room stinks. **BECAUSE SHE'S NOT FUCKING WALKING HER OWN DOG BECAUSE SHE KEEPS MISPLACING THE 3 LEASHES WE'VE BOUGHT HER.** **THIS**, more than **ANYTHING**, should be a clue that mom is **NOT** who she used to be - she prided herself on taking the best care of her dogs - walking, feeding, baths/grooming, all that. It's getting to the point where I'll probably need to take the dog back to the house, and **THEN** people will complain that mom is **LONELY**. As if I haven't already bent over backwards to not only get mom into AL, but also get her into one of the larger rooms, and after fighting a losing battle with mom over getting her laundry together (which she keeps hiding in bags

under her bed rather than in the 3 FUCKING HAMPERS I've bought for her) FINALLY getting some help. I admit I've fallen behind on switching out her sheets because there are 10 million more important things I need to handle. I don't even know why I'm posting this. It shouldn't have been looking through her phone, and really, it shouldn't have set me off the way that it did. I'm just so tired and angry about all this endless thankless bullshit that no one else has to do but any amount of crocodile tears from my mom and everything is my fault and I need to fix it. I had to stop myself from doing a lot of things yesterday, namely sending a blast text to all of her friends that I give up and if they care so much and I'm doing everything wrong they can take over it - they can figure out all her accounts and all her passwords and they can make/take phonecalls. But I mostly sat in my car, listened to the rain, and wished I was just not here. Not that they would care... Unless it affected managing mom's affairs."

reddit post · r/dementia · 479 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_caregiver_and_not_in/

↳ **comment** (229): "We see you. We hear you. Vent away here. I'm worried though - for you. Can you make. Forcibly make.... 48 hours for yourself? For your mom... and her flying monkeys... nothing will ever be right or enough. Any chance you are the scapegoat child of a narcissist? You sound like I did in 20-22 - before that too, but those were the illuminating years."

↳ **comment** (156): "Ok, I apologize for what I'm about to say, because I'm sure it's someone you love. But I couldn't even read all of this because I was so triggered. I don't know how you're living it. But fuck this person. Whoever she is, she can do this shit. She can do all of this worthless running around and pretending to be some sort of hero. I'd leave whatever group chat that was and that would be that. I'd check in with the PROFESSIONALS at the professional facility she's in with professional health care workers who know more about this disease than this woman. I wouldn't take her calls, I wouldn't reply to her texts and if she adds me to another group chat to manipulate me, I'd block her. This is emotional abuse. And you don't deserve it. Watching your mom struggle with dementia is more than a lifetime of pain. You don't need to allow people into the fringes of that pain to pour on gasoline to warm their self righteousness. Leave the group chat. Block her if you must. You're doing way more than enough. This woman is doing nothing. Hugs from a stranger. Edit: I just realized AL is assisted living. So maybe not a full memory care facility. So I guess I'm preemptively supporting you when that time comes because it will. Sooner than later if she's paranoid and hallucinating now. Hugs again. You can do this. Just keep your own peace, cut out the noise and bullshit, and work with professionals to do the best thing, not amateurs who are just running their mouths."

↳ **comment** (136): "I have to be really, really honest with you. Whether your mom wants this or not, those people need to be cut off. Especially if they are visiting her in AL, there is a good chance that they're manipulating her and feeding her psychosis. This can really turn into a dangerous situation where she attempts to abscond, or they try to kidnap her "for her own good." They are not family. They are not her caregivers. Whatever this "friend" went through with her husband with cancer is irrelevant. That's her own, individual experience, and like you said, she had an entire village to help. A lot of caregivers do not have that. They are completely alone, and she is blissfully ignorant to how difficult caring for someone with dementia for years...a decade actually is. That group chat could very well be the thing that's making her depression worse as well. And, again, I have to be honest here, I think it's time to consider memory care. Is there a memory care unit at her AL facility? I'm so sorry. People are just so stupid and unsympathetic. They have no idea what it takes to care for someone with dementia. The slow, agonizing decline, the abandonment because no one actually wants to help. They just want to give you pleasant words and "oh, I'm so sorry you're going through this. Just let me know if you ever need anything!" Then complete radio silence. They love to act so morally pure, but when it's really time to get down in the dirt, they disappear. Ignore them. They have no power, they don't get to make any decisions. YOU are the one in control, and only you, because no one else wants to take control. If no one wants to help, then you have to make whatever choice keeps you alive another day. They rest of them can fuck off!"

"She's going to trap me in soon, my adult life is over. My mom is 61 and will be getting let go from her factory job soon. She only speaks polish after living in the USA for 25 years and has nowhere to go. She won't go back to Poland, her retirement won't be more than \$1,300/month so she won't be able to afford her apartment. I live in a rural area with no public transportation so I'm it. I'm her only outlet. She's visiting us right now and is an absolute weirdo. I have a 20 month old baby and am getting ready for a mastectomy for breast cancer. I'm working full time and trying to make things fun for my son but I also need rest. She literally sits on top of me all the time. When I'm reading my son a book she comes in and will point to the pages like a toddler and go "RED CAR" loudly and so on. She tries to butt into my conversations with my husband but doesn't understand so wants a translation. She tries to steer the stroller or shopping cart with me and when I'm like fucking you do it she runs into me because she's staring off into the abyss as if she's never seen groceries in her life before. I feel like a trapped animal, I'm caged in my own home. Last night she told me she won't be able to take care of my baby when I'm doing my surgery because "he cries" and she's too uncomfortable. I literally have cancer. Like...what? She said she doesn't know how to build a relationship with him as she doesn't speak English and she doesn't think he likes her. I told her she needs to grow up and act like a caregiver (she won't feed or change his diaper) and not like a friend or grandma for fun she sees in the movies. So now I get to wake up in the hospital alone OR with a mother who doesn't understand shit as my husband is pacing the hotel with our toddler. I'm crushed. I'm so overwhelmed. She's like ready to move in, I mean she literally has nowhere else to go. I don't trust her with my baby after yesterday's shenanigans but most importantly I don't trust that I'll be happy again. My husband and I have build a calm life, we are best friends, and she literally just sits down and stares at us. I was up at 4am having coffee in my living room today and at breakfast she was like "did I see you in the living room this morning" and when I said yes she was like "but why were you sitting there?". I put on lotion and she goes "did you put on lotion? Wow" like wtf do you mean?! Ok rant over just a woman who's so overwhelmed I'm about to rip my hair out. W"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 455 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1mtnn23/shes_going_to_trap_me_in_soon_my_adult_life_is/

↳ **comment** (650): "She does not get to move in. Get her on waitlists for senior housing or speak to a social worker about how section 8 will go."

↳ **comment** (234): "Tell her no. She's been in the country 25 years, she's 61. I'm 61 and I've had lots of challenges. I figured them out. She can go back to Poland where the money she gets will go further. Just sit her down and say I'm sorry but I have to take care of myself and my family and you have to leave. If it breaks your relationship it breaks it and if she has nowhere to go that's her problem. I know this is harsh but you are currently in a life or death situation with breast cancer. You have your own life and your own kids to worry about and just be mean if you have to. This is something that all of us raised by these parents need to give ourselves permission to do. We have to give ourselves permission to stand up for ourselves even if it means we're going to feel guilty, even if it means they're going to be angry, even if it means they're going to tell relatives that we're awful towards them and abandon them. Too bad we're just going to have to live with that."

↳ **comment** (218): "THIS! THIS! THIS, OP! My mother only has social security and doesn't receive much more than your mother will. She lives in senior housing, and her rent is a percentage of her social security check - I think it's \$200 per month for a nice one-bedroom, one-bathroom apartment. The building itself is staffed 24/7 in case of emergencies. There's a rec room, a laundry room on each floor, and even a shuttle service that will take residents to appointments and stores for free. My mom was on a waiting list for about 6 months, but that was several years ago. Get your mom on those lists now if you can."

"You're So Strong = You're On Your Own: A Caregiver Translation Guide. Ive been a caregiver for 30 years total. Started at 11 when my dad left and my mom began dialysis. I talk about those first 15 years a lot because thats when I cared for my mom until she died from renal failure. Those years are the foundation of everything. Theyre what shaped me. But the caregiving didnt stop when she died. Its been 30 years total and Im still going. Just

wanted to clarify that upfront since people ask. In three decades Ive learned to translate caregiver platitudes. Because what people SAY and what we HEAR are two completely different things. Here are a few translations: Youre so strong Translation: Youre on your own. When someone tells you how strong you are theyre really saying theyre not going to help you. Theyre admiring your ability to handle it so they dont have to step in. I was 11, riding two buses to dialysis with my mom. People would say wow youre so strong for your age. Nobody said let me drive you. Nobody said I'll watch her next Tuesday so you can be a kid. Nobody said you shouldn't have to do this alone. They just called me strong and kept walking. God only gives you what you can handle Translation: Your suffering doesnt matter because Ive decided it has a purpose. If God only gives you what you can handle then why do caregivers break? Why do we burn out? Why do we cry at 3 AM wondering how much longer we can do this? Because we CANT handle it. Were just surviving it because theres no other option. I dont need your theology. I need respite care. I dont know how you do it Translation: Im glad its you and not me so Im not going to find out how to help. My uncles used to say this. Theyd watch me help my mom with everything then say I dont know how you do it and leave. If you dont know how I do it ask me what I need. Ask how you can help. Dont stand there marveling at my survival skills like Im some interesting specimen. Im doing this because I dont have a choice and you wont help. Let me know if you need anything Translation: Im going to put the burden of asking on you knowing you wont ask because caregivers never do. Caregivers dont let you know. We're too tired to figure out what we need, articulate it, and then ask someone who might say no. If you want to help just show up. Bring food. Mow the lawn. Watch the person were caring for so we can sleep. Dont make us ask. Ive got about 10 of these written down. These four are just the ones that come up most often. Theres more I could translate but these are the ones that made me feel craziest before I learned what people were really saying. If youre a caregiver drowning in toxic positivity... you dont need to be strong. You need help. You need people who show up instead of compliment. You need someone to say Im coming Thursday at 3pm instead of let me know if you need anything. Thats the difference between words and help. We deserve the help."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 427 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1pcgrfu/youre_so_strong_youre_on_your_own_a_caregiver/

↳ **comment** (125): "Enjoy every moment.... Huge guilt trip from someone who doesn't know the reality of caring for elderly parents and think it's some Hallmark movie."

↳ **comment** (69): "That one really grinds my gears. People think elderly folks are sweet, cooperative angels. They aren't, they're just people, and when you add dementia to the mix, yeehaw... And those Visiting Angels abominations on tv....grrr.... Show them turning a bedbound patient and cleaning their shit out of places it shouldn't be, having to cover your face to keep them from slapping you and wanting to react back so badly, but they don't know what they're doing and can't help themselves. Or instead of some nice old man getting help putting on his cardigan, show them putting it on someone who DOES NOT WANT IT and will fight you tooth and nail. THAT'S the ad they need to put out."

↳ **comment** (45): ""enjoy every moment" really makes me sick. The slow torture of early onset dementia has lasted 16 years for us. Quality of life leaks away like air from a worn out tire. I find nothing to enjoy in watching my husband of 50 years have a little more of his brain shut down every day, more simple tasks like buttoning his own shirt or using the TV remote become incomprehensible to him, another little piece of his personality and who he was as a person get lost and fall away, another bit of our relationship fade out, another facet of how we used to communicate and joke around become impossible because he can seldom make a sentence and understands fewer and fewer of the words I say to him. There are a thousand "hardest things" about dementia caregiving. For me, one of the hardest of the "hardest things" is watching my beloved struggle to tell me something by stringing together random words, sounds, and gestures while I try to pretend for him that we are having a conversation. Even councilors say "you have to focus on the positive". There is no positive left. Only heartache, grief, dread of the future, and exhaustion."

"I despise my dad for making me his caregiver..... I have reached the point where I despise my father. I don't want to speak to him, look at him or even think about him. Every single thing I do, at this stage, is out of obligation. He moved in with us (me, my husband and our son) after my mom passed.....then fell and broke his hip 7 months later. He refused to participate in his own recovery - would not do physical therapy, wouldn't complete the exercises, wouldn't get in his wheelchair, etc. Never mind the whole lung cancer leg of our journey where I dragged him and his wheelchair to appointments 5 days a week while he'd light his *f\cking cigarette before I could even get into the driver's seat. Fast forward to now (5 yrs later) and he's been completely bedridden for most of the last 3 yrs. At this point, he cannot even roll over without assistance. So, here we are. I'm responsible for a 350lb man who cannot so much as reach the TV remote if it ends up below his knee on the bed, urinates and sh\ts in his bed (won't wear diapers) and tells me "you'll be signing my death warrant if you move me to a nursing home". I absolutely despise him!!!! How can a person be that selfish??? I would NEVER put this kind of a burden on my son and, the moment she couldn't care for herself, his own mother went into a facility full time. Why in the hell is it acceptable that I pay the price for his poor decisions? Not just me, really, my entire family as my husband and son have to deal with my constant misery. I want my life back! I want to be able to leave the house without planning my every move around him. I want to *not* have to retreat to our bedroom because the urine stench has taken over that day. I want to *not* have to do 5 loads of his laundry EVERY SINGLE DAY. I want to S-L-E-E-P through the night without having to get up and go find his glasses under his own a\$\$!!! I want to stop crying and being pissed off **ALL THE TIME!** I feel like I am one 3AM call from a mental breakdown.....secretly waiting for him to die so I can have some peace and, of course, can torment myself from the guilt of *that* thought for the rest of my own life. How can a parent (knowingly) put this much despair on their own child???? Make it make sense to me..... EDIT: Well, when in doubt, ask random strangers on the internet! This was my first post ever and, frankly, my way of screaming without impacting the people around me! You guys came through :) THANK YOU ALL, from the bottom of my heart, for making me feel validated (and heard).....this situation can feel like the loneliest place on earth at times. I know I need to make the move - I think I just needed someone else to make me feel less guilty about it. I have cried all night reading your replies (chuckled at a few - thanks "unfiltered cigarettes" lol) and am pocketing ALL of your suggestions. Thank you for confirming that I'm not a terrible person!"*

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 411 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p5trpx/i_despise_my_dad_for_making_me_his_caregiver/

"The "Go Home" Loop: What my wife's sundowning taught me about my own restless mind. My wife has mid-stage Alzheimer's dementia. Like many of you, I live with the daily rhythm of her asking to "go home"—even when we're sitting in the house we've shared for thirty years. She'll plan the trip, ask about her father picking her up, worry about the time. No redirection works for long. The loop restarts. I want to share something that changed how I sit with her in these moments, and it comes from an unexpected place. I practice Zen meditation. In this discipline, you work to return to "the present moment"—to drop the internal chatter and simply be where you are. But my mind resists. It generates errands to remember, problems to solve, imaginary conversations. It wants to be *anywhere* but here, *anytime* but now. The thinking mind treats the present like a waiting room. One evening, I was sitting with my wife during a difficult sundowning episode. She was agitated, trying to figure out how to get to her childhood home, her father coming to fetch her. I was simultaneously trying to mentally plan tomorrow's doctor appointment, rehearsing what I'd say, solving problems that hadn't happened yet. And I saw it: **We were doing the exact same thing.** Her mind couldn't accept this living room as "home" because it didn't match the felt sense of safety she was seeking. My mind couldn't accept this moment of sitting with her because it didn't match the felt sense of "productive" or "resolved" I was seeking. Both of us were generating solution-thoughts for a problem that only existed in the imagination. Both of us were trying to get "home" to a place that isn't located in time or space. **What this means for us as caregivers:** When your loved one asks to go home for the fifteenth time today, they're not just experiencing a symptom. They're demonstrating—unfiltered, visible, raw—the fundamental restlessness that lives in all of our minds. The inability to be fully present. The conviction that the

answer lies just around the corner, in the next moment, after the next problem is solved. I've stopped seeing her repetition as a malfunction to be fixed. Instead, I recognize it as the human condition, made visible. She is, in a strange way, being profoundly honest about something we all disguise with busyness and distraction. This doesn't make the sundowning easier. It doesn't stop the grief. But it has transformed those looping conversations from frustrating obstacles into something else: **moments of shared humanity**. When she asks to go home, I no longer argue with the facts ("Your father died in 1964"). I meet her in the longing. I sit with her in the dislocation. Because I know that longing. I live in it too. We both want to go home. We're both already there, but can't feel it. If you're exhausted today by the repetition, the questions that have no answers, the planning for trips that will never happen—see if you can notice your own mind doing the same thing. Planning dinner while she's asking about her mother. Rehearsing the conversation with the neurologist while she's describing a house from 1962. We're all trying to get somewhere else. The gift she has given me is this: I can no longer pretend my own restlessness is "productive" while hers is "pathological." We're both standing in the doorway of the present moment, holding a compass that points inward. Her compass is broken. Mine works fine—I just forget to look at it. Be gentle with yourselves today. And when they ask to go home, maybe try meeting them there, in that longing, without needing to fix it. You might find you're standing in the same room. \--- **TL;DR:** My wife's endless "going home" loops and my own busy, planning mind are the same phenomenon—both unable to rest in the present. Recognizing this hasn't cured her Alzheimer's, but it's made me a more patient caregiver and revealed something true about being human."

reddit post · r/dementia · 386 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1vpgoey/the_go_home_loop_what_my_wifes_sundowning_taught/

↳ **comment** (43): "This might work for some: When my dad would insist it was time to go home, my brother would eventually agree with him and offer to drive him home. Once in the car, he would drive him around for awhile and then eventually, take him back home! All forgotten and all good."

↳ **comment** (41): "Thank you for sharing. My mother's small burial stone simply says "home at last". It seemed the most fitting thing for her."

↳ **comment** (29): "I tell my grandma " I'm going to take You home tomorrow we are sleeping here tonight I'll be with you " and she always says " oh ok that's good " ... seriously stops the loops every time !!!! Or I'll say yes I'm going to bring ylu in the morning - it works 🥹🥹🥹 "

"I no longer have an agingparent.. My mother died today. I've cared for her for three years. Most stubborn woman on the planet. When she was set on a course, there was no deviation. Cancer patient of over four years. Congestive heart failure, and then COPD over the past two years. Two days ago she started having visions, aphasia and some confusion/paranoia with a dash of hostility. Discovered she had been taking things I had cooked for her, and hiding that she hadn't been eating, and had stopped drinking almost anything. I coaxed her into getting a few bites of food, and a few large drinks of orange juice, but when I tried to check her blood glucose level, she refused several times. After being told she'd hate me if I called for an EMT to the ER, I made the decision to call regardless. They were fantastic, kept her calm as they brought her in; they could see just how sick she was, even though she was doing her best to try to hide it. Was responsive in the ER, but still confused, spelling her maiden name and then an ancestor's last name when asked to spell her last name. Left for a bit to take care of the dog, and relax a bit, when I got called back in to the trauma unit. She had stopped being responsive and wasn't opening her eyes. Doctors determined she was too far gone, my brother and I followed my mom's wishes she discussed with us back in July, and opted not to attempt to prolong her suffering, and to try to let her go as peacefully as possible. We got taken up to one of the hospice rooms (seriously awesome and helpful for such a stressful situation, even a fake fireplace, lol, not to mention some comfortable recliners, a couch that converted to a small bed, and a large tv, snacks, and drinks), and best of all, my best friend's wife was working that night, and had been assigned my mother's care. It took about 14 hours, with all of us swapping in and out to see her and sit with her and talk to her,

but she was peaceful and comfortable with the last half day of her life. Much of our extended family was able to be there and say their goodbyes, and the hospital was kind enough to give us time to bring in a few stragglers for an hour or two, even after she passed. I'm at the home she and I shared, now, with her (my) dog, who is an absolute sweetheart and the absolute bestest. I'm dealing with a multitude of emotions right now. Sadness that things ended the way they did. Guilt I wasn't more firm with her. Relief, both that she's no longer suffering, and I no longer have to worry about her 24/7. A dash of fear for the future. And loneliness. I want to thank the people here for all of the answers and discussion that's taken place over the years on here, for the insight I gained and answers I found to questions I've had, to the point I've never felt the need to directly ask anything. I wish you all the best in the future, and that those you love and care for get to live in peace and warmth and safety, and that when the inevitable time comes, the comfort needed to make things smooth for both you and your loved one."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 377 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/177iu63/i_no_longer_have_an_agingparent/

"Useful items that have made it easier for us and our aging parents. Just a few items that have made caring for my aging parents easier. I want to mention these in case you are not aware or have not considered the benefits. **D-Mannose supplement:** this is the active ingredient in cranberry that helps prevent the formation of biofilm in UTIs. The capsules do not have a flavor. My mother-in-law would balk at the taste of cranberry capsules but does not object to these. **UTI test strips:** these are now over the counter in the US. Don't wonder, diagnose at home. This has been so helpful for my mother-in-law because getting her to the doctor is a difficult process. **Styptic products:** stops bleeding. Remember the white pencil that men used for shaving cuts? Now comes in pre-loaded bandages or loose powder. Check a camping or outdoors store or the pet aisle (dog nail care) for greater selection. The combination of my mother's fragile skin and blood thinners means she just bleeds and bleeds. **Tender tape:** this is a latex-free stretch bandage that sticks to itself but not to anything else. If your parent's skin is fragile, tender tape and a gauze pad is much better than self-adhesive bandages. I first saw this used as a veterinary product for putting bandages over fur, so you know it won't ever stick to skin. **Adhesive release spray:** when self-adhesive bandages can't be avoided, this spray will release the bandage without tearing the skin. My mother used to cry when it was time to change a bandage but no longer. **Compression garments:** look at products for runners, because runners' socks and calf sleeves may be easier to use for low-end compression needs. Cheaper than medical products, and using a combination of socks and calf sleeves means the socks can be changed every day and machine washed/dried. **Wig:** the weirdest helpful thing I ever bought. My mother is focused on her appearance in a way I have never understood, but it's very important to her so I try to be supportive. When she broke her shoulder she could not color her hair or manage the bouffant style she's been wearing for decades. She wanted *me* to color her hair but I thought that was a recipe for disaster. In desperation, I bought a cheap wig and she looooooves it so much. These have changed since the '70s... the modern wigs are "capless" on a net base and not attached to something like a swim cap as they once were. Her shoulder has long since healed but the wig remains in use every day. ETA suggestions from the comments: Ring camera / Alexa drop-in Laminated page of medications / medical info (have multiple) Wireless cell phone charger Shoe expanders Clock with day/date as well as time Silicone cupcake liners - good for serving meds, modest portions of snacks, etc. easy to hold and non-slip, also useful for hearing aids at night Bed rail Ramp - for entry and exit, rubber or metal Low step stool - useful for getting into car, propping feet up to tie shoes Bath lifter - useful beyond the bathroom Transfer board - helps with transfer from wheelchair to/from bed Car door assist handle - sticks in car door for support getting in and out Car cane - for getting in and out of car Stand up stick - looks like a plunger, helps getting up from floor Bed assist rail Spring-loaded floor-to-ceiling grab pole (Stander Wonder pole) Shower bench, shower transfer bench Shampoo cap for washing hair in bed Hair fiber - Toppik and other brands, makes thin hair look fuller Handheld shower head with multiple holders at various heights Bedside commode Gel powder to soak up urine Shower wipes - look for unscented / sensitive skin version Long-handled toenail clippers Booster pads - for incontinence Quick Change Wraps - for incontinence Bidet attachment"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 326 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w2kxot/useful_items_that_have_made_it_easier_for_us_and/

"MUST READ! So true. There are so many problems. Here is a typical day for me: Keep in mind I am an only child and there is no other family. I am in my 50's, the parent in their 90's. We do get help from the State and SS so I am able to be here. 1. They wake up at any odd hour yelling to go to the bathroom. 2. I go in and have to lift the person up from behind in order to get up out of bed. They need help getting up at other times also. 3. They need help getting night clothing off before going to the bathroom, like leg warmers, thick socks, and so on. 4. They sit up then and gather a few items from the nightstand. There are 3 glass cases, each with a different item that they feel they must take to bed and back with them.... so an invisible enemy does not steal them. Paranoia and delusions: yes. 5. They use a walker to bulldoze their way around and then get to the toilet. They have severe OCD so they take forever with each task. They put toilet paper on the toilet seat as a seat cover, even though I, the daughter, am the only other person who uses it. They sit and do their business. They wear several layers. An underwear, with a pad. A set of folded paper towel. A diaper. Two pairs of pants. One pair of socks. If any one of these is soiled, it all has to come off which they can't do by themselves. Usually at least one of them is so it all needs to go off and some in the wash. They sit there for a time with a mirror, picking at little things. Finally they get up, dropping most of the toilet paper on the seat to the floor. They grab another small piece of toilet paper... to flush the toilet! Oh, and that falls to the ground as well. They get up and shuffle over to the sink while I pick up all the pieces of wasted TP with a grabber. They wash their hands.... for half an hour. Then, they dry their hands... for another half hour. But... you can't rush them. The faucet handles are slathered in soap so later I wipe them down. They shuffle back to the bedroom where I put all the clean clothes back on and new sets of the items. 6. The bed... has about six blankets on that are slippery so the bed is a mess each morning. They need so many layers of everything and we take sweaters, polar hats, shawls and stuff to the living room when all else is done. 7. They sit and turn on the space heater.... which is on a LOT. Even though it's not that cold. It is also expensive. I fix the meal and do the dishes several times a day. They want tea... again. It got cold... again. It is in a thermus, but they forget to put the lid on and would rather have it off... because... it's too hot. 8. After a meal sometimes they get diarrhea. And it is no small amount. They make it to the toilet as fast as they can, but it still gets everywhere. They can't clean themselves, or the mess left behind that is all over the toilet and the floor. They can even slip in it. So I get to deal with it all, after putting a fresh set of everything on already a little while ago. So it's a new set of everything after the major wipe down and cleaning, sanitizing the area. 9. They make a mess everywhere. They leave little pieces of trash here and there. I do all the housework as it is, laundry, etc. etc. I do bring blankets and warm drinks. I am fine with that and even enjoy it and don't complain about the typical needs, but it's the attitude that is the killer. 10. They insist on putting their contact lenses in. They lose one. But it wasn't them, someone is sneaking in and stealing them. They want to buy more. They spent a lot on lenses as it is. They have old ones but with damage, they insist on using them anyway, they scream in pain, can't get them out, finally do, one gets lost, and it starts all over again. 11. They used to leave things on the stove that would burn due to early dementia. After I'd gone to bed. Trying to get them in bed before me was impossible. If I go on errands I worry about this also. Putting things in the oven 'to dry,' leaving faucets running while doing hand laundry and the sink would run over. One day the house was filled with smoke. The only thing that sinks in is if you get really mad and yell. If they were bed ridden, my life would have been easier! 12. They don't want a traditional bath. 13. Forget about any sort of vacation or travel, decent day off, etc. 14. They have their own version of reality. If they can't push it on you, they get hostile and attack you. 15. They do foolish things and fall down. They have conditions that could lead to broken bones with a fall. I tell them but they don't listen. They can't get up by themselves. I am strong and they are thin so I am able to get them up. But it's not always easy. Sometimes they don't want to use the walker. The cane is not enough. But they have a 'can do' attitude. Great. 16. You can't tell them anything, they won't listen to you... because "you are their child and they are the parent" is in their mind forever. 17. We had to change something at the bank to keep the homecare hours. The parent kept arguing with me about it even though the amount was my money. I finally lost it and yelled and then they cooperated and it turned out okay. 18. I am always worried they

will say something wrong at the reassessments due to dementia and we will lose the hours, like "oh no, I don't need any help with that, or this..." etc. They are very 'independent,' and stubborn and delusional about their abilities. And that situation has happened, causing a loss of some hours. 19. Now hallucinations have begun and there are mysterious people in their bedroom at night. 20. Getting them in bed is now easier due to physical decline and lack of enthusiasm for other things, and the person had always been a night owl. So this was a big win. 21. With dementia people argue, get aggressive, don't want to cooperate, and in this case there is also mental illness. 22. There was an illness earlier that caused terrible behavior that was toxic and verbally abusive. I think it would even go physical but they know I am stronger so they don't dare try anything stupid. The attitude would get better and worse. At one point last winter, and we get snow, it was so bad I did not want to run into them in the hallway and I had to go to the bathroom so I went into the backyard with freezing temperatures just to empty my bladder. The snow cleaned up after me. I would rather shiver than deal with the bad attitude. 23. On top of all this, people still look down on caregivers. There is the attitude of 'just' a caregiver, like you are just a servant, maid, slave, second class citizen, etc. It's just some lowly job in their eyes like a janitor, cleaning lady, etc. 24. In public they can turn on the charm, so they always tell me how 'cute' my parent is and so on, because they know so much more about it of course. All my saintly sweetness goes unnoticed by them most of the time. Patience... the patience that is needed, the nerves that are shredded, the stress... my BP went up, I have other health conditions due to the stress that I haven't had in over a decade, and so on. 25. It just goes on and on and on. The worst combination is when they are still physically able but not mentally. That's when they can start wandering outside at night and stuff. That... did not occur. There are symptoms of nearing death but in this case it is drawn out longer than the time estimates given. For some it goes on for decades depending on when dementia sets in. The worst aggravation is the bad behavior. The accusations. The irrationality and hostility and even harassment. That stuff is what takes such an emotional toll. I could live with the rest, but it is due to that that I am at my wits end! Now I even have to worry about the social safety nets breaking due to doge and then we would be stranded. Because this wasn't already stressful enough. Kids grow up pretty quick, but this can last decades and only gets worse. The physical demands, time demands, need for supervision, they can hardly be left alone, managing them such as redirecting their attention away from something setting them off, etc. It's like having a special needs kid mentally and physically who thinks they are in charge. No one understands that I am praying for this to end. Once life gets to that point it is no longer a quality life. They are human and I don't believe in euthanasia or stuff, but I would not want to get to this point. There is no money for a nursing home either. When conversations used to be a thing, all they would talk about was the bad stuff, the bad people in their life and what they did in the past, which I heard hundreds of times, and it wasn't even all true. Yes.. the little joys! There is probably more that I am forgetting but you get the picture by now I would imagine and you probably want to forget it and run. Lol"

youtube · @maryrosehallowed6662 · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 302 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugk_YPLbQCkuR7nN8l4AaABAq

↳ @memyself9372 (43): "It is okay to take authority over an elderly person to make your life easier. That is not dishonoring them. If someone else pays the price to care for me, that gives them the authority to take away cigarettes. Get rid of junk in their way in order to get work done easier. A nursing home streamlines care. So should you. Walk out of the room if they argue or accuse. They have layers of bed sheets because they demand it? Or is that to protect the bed? Do what makes it easier for you. After all, what would they do without you? I help a sibling take care of our mother who is 90. I keep her one week. Sibling the next. She eats what we fix her. We give her yogurt daily. That keeps her regulated (no messes for us.) We make her drink water, that helps her dementia. We tell her to get up & go to the bathroom. That keeps her mobile. We do not help her dress. That's also good for keeping muscle and mobility. We do treat her like a child. You eat this because it's healthy or you go without. She was type 2 diabetic before we took charge. Guess what what? She's been taken off her medicine because she's not even diabetic anymore. Before YOU could take care of yourself, YOU did not have total autonomy to do as you please. They can't take care of themselves. They do not have the right to force you to give them their autonomy. You have to take care of them. Demand your own terms, please. There's nothing wrong with that."

↳ **@LadyRygel (30):** "I read every single word. I dread this happening to me with my mother especially as I have hated her since I was 2 years old so there are no happy memories even. Bless you and take good care of yourself physically by keeping your sugar intake as low as possible etc. you must survive this to enjoy what's left of your life 🙏 "

↳ **@BSAllergy (29):** "I am caring for a dementia patient, with mental illness. I couldn't imagine trying to manage TWO of them. You poor soul. My heart truly aches, for you."

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost

and i hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_imp/possible/

"I make 140k and still can't afford my mom's care... and now she's being scammed. **UPDATE:** Thanks everyone. Honestly got overwhelmed reading all the responses and needed time to process before I could act. Filed a police report about Frank (elder financial abuse). Also consulted other opinions with elder law attorneys through Avvo - getting clear on guardianship vs POA options and asset protection strategies. Started researching memory care facilities and looking into Medicaid planning. Someone also mentioned Playbook Labs for help to think through the guardianship question. I know what's logical to do but for some reason I'm running in circles with the autonomy vs protection dilemma and need more perspective on this side. Not ready to make final decisions yet but at least I'm moving forward instead of just frozen. Will update once things are clearer. Thanks again for all the recommendations and advice. \----- I'm 52, software engineer, I make \$140,000/year which I know is good money. My mom is 78, widowed, early-stage dementia. Lives alone about 2hrs away. I'm an only child. Six months ago things started going downhill fast. Stove left on, meds forgotten, wandering at night looking for my dad (he died 4 years ago). I hired part-time caregivers - she fired all three of them within 2 months. "I don't need babysitters, I'm FINE." She's not fine. Memory care facilities around here are 7-9k/month. She's got maybe \$180k in savings. That's what, two years? Then it's Medicaid which means spending down everything first, and I make too much for her to qualify while I'm helping but not enough to actually cover 8k/month on top of mortgage + two kids heading to college. Then last month I logged into her bank account to pay her bills (she keeps getting late notices) and there's \$43k MISSING since June. Turns out she has a boyfriend. "Frank." Met him at the grocery store six months ago. He's 68, drives a really nice car, takes her to lunch. She absolutely lights up when she talks about him and honestly it was the first time I'd seen her happy since dad died. So I asked about the money. "Oh, Frank needed help with some expenses, he's going through a hard time." \$12k in March. \$18k in July. Another \$13k two weeks ago. I drove up there and met him. Super charming, very friendly. Said he "appreciated her generosity" but he'd definitely pay her back. When I pushed a little he got defensive real fast - "your mother is a grown woman who can make her own choices." I tried talking to my mom alone after he left. Told her I was worried about the money. She looked at me like I'd just betrayed her. "You've always been jealous when I'm happy. Frank LOVES me. He's the first person who's made me feel alive since your father died." I talked to an elder law attorney. My options are basically: get her to cooperate (she won't) or pursue guardianship which means going to court, proving she's incompetent, which would absolutely destroy her and our relationship. So here's where I'm stuck: If I pursue guardianship to protect the money, she'll hate me forever. Like, our relationship is DONE. But if I don't do anything he's going to drain her dry in 4 months and then what? I'm supposed to pay for memory care I can't afford? Quit my job? Move her into my house with my wife and kids? My wife says "you can't just let him take everything" and she's right but my mom isn't GONE yet, you know? She still has moments of total clarity. And in those moments she's happier than she's been in years. Who am I to take that away from her?? But Frank's not going to stop. And when the money's gone he'll be gone too. And she'll still have dementia. And I'll still be here trying to figure out how to care for her with nothing left. I tried calling her yesterday to talk again and she hung up on me. Has anyone dealt with this?? How do you protect someone who doesn't want to be protected? At

what point do you override their autonomy even when they're still THEM most of the time? I honestly don't know what to do here. **TL;DR:** Mom has dementia, I can't afford memory care (7-9k/month), discovered her new "boyfriend" has taken 43k from her in 6 months. If I pursue guardianship to protect her money she'll hate me forever, if I don't she'll be broke in 4 months and I still can't afford her care. How do you protect someone who doesn't want protection?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1plxnr6/i_make_140k_and_still_cant_afford_my_moms_care/

"Mom's fall changed everything and I'm fuming. \ contains some mildly graphic medical trauma, so read with caution if that skeeves you out | In February of this year my mom (78) tripped and fell while entering a clinic to get her mammogram. She already had an existing knee replacement from 12 years prior, and when she fell the knee replacement cracked her femur. She had a new knee put in that accounted for the femoral shortening caused by the break. So it was surgery and rehab, and then she came home a month after the fall. She lives next door to my son, her eldest grandson. I stayed with her the first week and she was getting around pretty well with her walker. The very night I left to go home, she was in the bathroom and the new knee gave out, just came apart and broke. She went straight down and her legs ended up under her. It causes her incision to completely open and the broken metal parts were visible. She was bleeding out on the floor. We had gotten her an alarm button that would ring at my son's house, and she mashed that thing like nobody's business. My DIL is an RN. She stuffed a towel in my mom's open leg and held it together while waiting on EMS. It took a long time for EMS to get her stabilized and transported, due to the broken knee parts being extremely close to arteries. Emergency surgery that night was done by the surgeon on-call. He cleaned it as best he could, put the parts back together and referred her back to her original surgeon. So surgery again and then this time a nursing facility rather than rehab because insurance refused rehab for this event. She has seen her original surgeon multiple times, had multiple x- rays, and me, my sister, my son and my mom herself have told her surgeon the leg doesn't look right, doesn't feel right to her, keeps wanting to collapse again. We've raised concerns to PT, and told the orthopedics team. They just kept telling her that she'll get stronger with PT. However it was only 2 weeks ago, at yet another post surgery appointment that her surgeon finally told us that she put the knee in incorrectly the first time. So it has been incorrect since way back at the beginning of February when she had her original surgery. It is internally rotated by about 20 degrees. The surgeon even admitted that's very likely why she fell the second time... the time when we almost lost her. Now the surgeon wants to revise her knee. And we will go through this a third time. My poor mom has been working so hard to gain function of a knee that is not placed correctly, that collapses , that locks sideways. When it engages it just flips back and down and deforms her entire lower leg, causing her to scream. It's been heavy work taking care of her as she cannot be left alone. She's spent about 20k outfitting the house with a lift bed, a lift chair, a whole new shower and toilet. Everything we could think of to try to keep her safe. My mom kept thinking she was failing somehow. It's heartbreaking. Watching her struggle has been horrendously hard on my little family. And I'm fuming. So many times we tried to say something was wrong and no one listened. We are reaching out to attorneys and trying to find a different surgeon. We will get through this again, but it's harder on her every time and I've never been so angry in my entire life. To let my mom go through this for 4 months is absolutely egregious and we are no where near out of the woods. She's mostly wheel-chair bound now... and back in February, when she was worried she'd miss her granddaughter's May 31st wedding, the surgeon told her she'd be walking and dancing by then, no problem. Fuming."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 226 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tszraf/moms_fall_changed_everything_and_im_fuming/

"I am done. She's not my problem anymore. I quit.. Update 3: I took several days to think and cool down. I had told my husband he didn't need to confront his mom because she won't change. She'll just pull the "my heart" card to get him to back off. He would never forgive himself if she did end up in the hospital over him chewing her out. He has talked to her before about her attitude to me a few years ago. So this is nothing new. The venom from her

this time was new. I realized while thinking, the venom started after her stroke a year and a half ago. Strokes change people. I let my husband know I am not heartless. If she called with a problem I could fix, I would go over and fix it. But if she is wanting me to drive her to the hospital at 2 am because she doesn't want EMTs in her house, i won't do it. She can get one of his brothers up to take her if my husband can't. She knows I don't sleep well and am often up that late. She has almost called me before but then chose not too. She wouldn't feel as badly about calling at 2 am in an emergency since I'm most likely awake. But so far she has talked herself out of it. I told him I am not going over to just check on her and visit anymore. I do not want or need the extra drama in my life. I do not have to put up with being yelled at just because she's made at everyone else or the world in general. I'm sorry there is no great dramatic ending to my post. Yes, I wish my husband had gone over and laid into her verbally. It would have made me feel better. But it wouldn't have accomplished anything but cause issues for him. So I am choosing to not cause him that stress. \----- Update 2: Husband is mad at her because he just talked to her about this exact problem within the last 6 months. Last time I just took it and came home. He is processing about the way he wants to handle it. Tomorrow we've got stuff to do, so he's going to avoid her while he thinks. Honestly, I told him it won't do any good to talk to her. She won't take accountability. She's not going to tell him we had a fight. I asked him to let me know what what is going on when he talks to her. He promised he would. I also told him she has been nasty to me more than he hears. I just took it because I love him and want to help his stress level. He feels terrible because he knows how his mother can be. I said to him, to me the problem is solved. I'm done. She pushed so hard that she gets what she thinks she wants which is for me to go away. He understands. She played that game with him, too. Like he said he stopped going over for 2 weeks when she did that and things fell apart because the rest don't pay attention or think. I'm still done and I told him that. \---- Update 1: Husband got back to me and apologized for the way she treated me. He said he'll be arguing with her this tomorrow over this. I told him ok, but I won't change my mind about helping her or setting foot in her house. In a week or two she'll be asking him if I'm ok because she hasn't seen me in a while. I told him to tell her the truth. I'm done because of her. She refuses to take responsibility for her actions and words. SO that'll be a fun conversation for him. /s \---- My MIL is fighting any and all help. She resents not being able to do things and won't let people help her. I have been going over once or twice a week just to ask if she needs anything. If she says no I back off. Her BS is affecting my mental health and she's not my mother. I was doing it to help my husband with his stress because his brothers don't help much. My therapist told me to back off and I have. I can't talk about her to my therapist anymore because she is a mandatory reporter and MIL is on the line for my therapist to have to report her. All week my SIL and BIL have been at my MILs house. The needed to get a window replaced and the guy wouldn't do it unless it was in a garage. They also gave a 6 hour window. So SIL and her daughter stayed from 12-6 twice. My SIL is a very in charge type of person. So she did what she wanted at MILs house despite my MIL asking her not to. MIL won't let her anger out on anyone but me. So she wasn't forceful with the SIL. She just sat back and let my SIL push her around. She had some distant cousins come in mid-week and they stayed all day too. Then her neighbor was moving some of his stuff out of his house at 9 pm. That was keeping her dogs up so she couldn't sleep. I went over today to see if MIL had a grocery list for my husband on his way home from work. She unloaded on me today. I got defensive and reminded her I ask before doing anything. She said I don't and everyone wants to control her life. She also accused me of getting defensive. I told her I was because I let her do her thing. She kept interrupting me and raised her voice at me. I finally told her that my therapist told me to back off. She told me good and I need to listen to her because she doesn't need anyone's help. I offered to tell my husband to let her get her own groceries. She said that's different because we know she can't drive. I got mad. And left. She told me that is my choice. I told her I am mad and she is mad and we don't need to be talking with when we're mad. I texted my husband at work and let him know what was going on. I was venting and called his mom some choice names. He told me I don't have to convince him because he knows how she is and he'll handle it tomorrow. He prefers to get told at work in text so he's not getting unloaded on when he gets home. I'm done. I won't set foot in her house ever again. If she calls I'll tell her to call 911 or one of her sons. If my husband is home, he's getting the phone. I'm my MILs only friend. She has now tore the bridge down and set it on fire."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 189 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vj311a/i_am_done_shes_not_my_problem_anymore_i_quit/

"So Angry at My Dad. My 95 yr old father DROVE 5 days after being admitted to ER observation overnight because he fell in a parking lot ... he also dragged my mother down to the ground when he fell. I moved from another state to help them as they age and they never called to tell me until day AFTER they fell. Lots of bruising, pain/aches, immobility etc but neither of them broke anything but we discussed that he would not be driving until he goes to dr for follow- up. He can't put weight on his right leg. And he drove. My mother lied to me about it. (He lies so often that I'm used to it.) On thanksgiving when I told him he can't drive again until his follow-up appt in 5 days he started to lash out and asked me to leave Thanksgiving. As in get out of the house. I left. I had zero alcohol. Planned what I was going to stay and was very calm. Doesn't matter. He just lost it. I really regret moving back as these two are impossible. I know I have to deal with them but I am so angry at their refusal to listen to common sense, not telling me they were both in ER when I loved back FOR THIS REASON, how he hurt my mother because he refuses to use a cane or walker, and the lies. And the verbal abuse. Oh and how he might hit an innocent person and ruin someone's life, or take someone's life. How do I not be angry when they are so challenging and impossible. He has always been a full-on jerk but getting worse now. I know I don't deserve being yelled at and eating Thanksgiving dinner in a diner alone. I have read a ton about dealing with narcissistic people but I am still so angry. HOW am I supposed to handle them? My sister is In another state. There is no one else here to help. He has alienated other family and not a big family in the first place."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 178 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1p9fn38/so_angry_at_my_dad/

"No longer a caregiver. I'm 29, and I was my mom's caregiver for seven years until she passed three days ago. She became paralyzed from the chest down after a botched procedure stroked her spine in 2018. After some extended hospital and rehab stays, she came home in 2019. I didn't hesitate to leave my job and become her full time caregiver. It had just been the two of us my whole life, and I loved her more than I have the words to express. She was my whole world. I never resented her for this. Never. She had been battling pressure wounds since her hospital stay in 2018. We had managed to help them slowly heal at home, but a few months ago she developed new ones, and they deteriorated quickly. I can't stop thinking about the times where we didn't do wound care like we should have. It had become harder and harder for us over the years and some days we just didn't have the strength, emotionally or physically. We had a nurse that would come out weekly to help us out, but it wasn't enough. I didn't realize how bad things had gotten until she got sick. My mom spent a couple weeks in the hospital with a sepsis diagnosis a couple months back. They took care of her, put her on double antibiotics, and sent her home with a healthcare regimen that we followed diligently. Nursing assistance increased, and we thought she was getting better. Fast forward to last Monday. The doctor in charge of her bloodwork called and told my mom to go to the hospital because she was borderline septic again. She said she felt fine, but of course we went anyway. My best friend and I spent all day in the ER with her until she told us to go home, eat, and take care of our cat. She seemed okay then. I returned the next day and delirium was beginning to set in. My mom had experienced symptoms of this before the previous hospital visit, but it was scary to go from her being "fine" to this in less than 24 hours. I stayed with her until late at night, when she once again told me to go home. By the next day, her mind was nearly gone. I sat outside her hospital room while she yelled and begged for help during wound care. She didn't sound like herself. She recognized me when I entered the room afterward, and she seemed comforted by my presence. I didn't know that this would be the last time I would hear her say, "hi sweetie." Thursday, Friday, and Saturday were agonizing. I was there in the ICU with her for hours and hours. I had hard conversations with doctors and nurses. My mom just kept deteriorating until she was gone. I held her hand and talked to her until the end. I wanted her to have no regrets, to not worry about me, and to find peace. I can't stop thinking about the things I didn't do, the things I should have done. I tried and tried but I know there were places I fell down on. I always thought I could fix things if they got bad, but not this time. I loved her so much and I feel like I'm responsible for this. I don't know how to deal with these feelings. The rest of my life staring me down is terrifying.

My mom always told me not to be sorry, that things weren't my fault, that she was so happy to be home eating my food and spending time with me. I know she wouldn't want to see me crying and screaming and agonizing. But I can't stop. I'm sorry this is so long, and if it doesn't make much sense. I'm just desperate to find some solace. I'm wracked with guilt, and I feel like my life has no purpose anymore."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 161 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1o0rvdo/no_longer_a_caregiver/

"My mum is approaching 65 and is becoming incapable of looking after herself. We can't afford a home or carers/nurses. I am the only one and I want a life.. Important edit: my mum deals with multiple chronic pain disorders. That's why I comment on her as elderly and needing caring because she genuinely can't do it herself now. I'm 25F. I've spent most of the last 10 years caring for my grandma. That was a choice I made and one I was happy to make. We got on like a house on fire. I couldn't imagine not being there for her. But I also knew that she wouldn't have the longest life after her second battle with cancer, and this may sound awful to say, but I knew I'd have plenty of time after she passed for my own life. And she passed last year sadly, but I've been trying to now get on my feet and focus on my life. Find my future wife, have kids, find a more suitable full time job to support us while I also work on my own projects to make some awesome stuff. But instead, I'm being faced with having to stay and give all that up. My mum is 65 and gave up living quite a long time ago. She blames everyone else for everything and won't take help. We've tried getting her into therapy, she refuses. We tried getting her into social groups, she refuses. She relies on antidepressants that she hates. That's her entire life. Wake up between 10am-2pm, take her pills, sometimes do some shopping, and since I introduced her to it about 7 years ago, play starwars valley and sometimes solitaire, all day until she goes to bed again at 3am. We can't afford care. There's nowhere we can take her to be looked after. She also won't leave her home. My older sibling is the *very small portion* type of autistic where they believe the world revolves around them and use it as a weapon to get away with doing shitty and abusive things, and is still bullying her to give them the house. I've told her she needs to kick them out because they're making her depression worse. She won't listen. They're about to turn 30. Now that im working on getting my license, I'll be able to get a full time job soon to be able to afford moving out. My sibling lives on disability and will get living assistance so they never have to work. I want my own life. I really do. But she's becoming more and more incapable. Her back car door is barely hanging on from how many posts and walls she's driven into. She's nearly crashed multiple times on the same roundabout. She can barely handle going to the shop that's currently being renovated so things have moved around, without having a breakdown. She hasn't worked since I was 8. Government assistance and carer benefit is the only way she funds herself, plus 1/4 of my paycheck as my 'rent' (which is currently £200, considering her rent for the shared ownership house is just over £300. She won't see the doctor about pains. She won't see the doctor about anything. She once told me to tell her if she ever starts to get the "old person piss smell" and now she has, she won't listen or accept help for it. It's making the house fairly vile to live in because febreze isn't enough and I can't touch her stuff. All she does is sit inside and blame immigrants for why her life is so shit. But I'm the only person who can look after her. I mean, most nurses in our area are migrants. None of them would be safe to work with her. My sibling is still expecting her to baby them. There's no one else to help because she doesn't have friends. Family other than myself is a different matter, they fucked her over. I feel like leaving and going with my own life is a betrayal and leaving her for dead basically. Because again, no one else will look after her. We can't afford anyone. But fucks sake I don't want my entire life to be a free labour carer. I want my own family. My own life. My own life. And I don't know what to do. I already drown in guilt that I don't see my Grandad anymore because my aunt and uncle live with him and I can't face them after what they did to us. I just don't know what to do. I can't abandon her but I can't wait God knows how long for my own life."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 151 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vkf6w2/my_mum_is_approaching_65_and_is_becoming/

"Unending torture. I'm just so tired of waking up every day wanting her to die so I can finally start to live again and then feeling like scum for wanting an end to it. 10 years of struggling to keep her alive and trying to give her a good life has left me devoid of ANY hope of ever just having ANY time to or for myself. It just never ends. And worst of all, the man I love moved out here to be with me because he couldn't wait years for her to not need me anymore but now HE'S trapped here in the misery too. In a place that literally hates us for just being us surrounded by people who make us scared to go outside. But inside is just more slow agonizing decline and now she's dragging us down with her. I've gone in debt to try to help her out and when she does die, I'll be left with all her mess. I hate myself for saying it, but I wish I didn't care about her happiness. I wish I cared about my OWN life and happiness. Or that my freaking religious sister (who my mom moved out to be closer to and who FREQUENTLY treats her like crap) would give a shit and HELP ME OUT! But she doesn't care about anyone but herself and HER family. Which USED to include us. But when mom dies she'll show up with hands held out. Joke's on her. She doesn't even care her mom is dying unless there's a promise of money. How am I the only one holding it all together? And how much longer can I keep going before I give up too? I don't have much left of me, soon maybe nothing. Sorry, just needed to vent. Update: Apparently respite applications for Alabama are closed until October. It was a nice idea, so thank you to everyone who suggested it."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 131 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1u8g15j/unending_torture/

"How do I get my parents to stop hosting Christmas?. My parents are 77 and 80. For 50 years, they have hosted a Christmas Eve party with my godparents that now includes god-siblings and their kids (25+ people). After my grandparents died, my parents took over hosting Christmas Day too, so each year, my brother, my uncle + cousin and my family of 4 all travel 3-6 hours and stay for 3ish days in my parents' home for the holidays. The problem is the hosting is getting to be too much for them. The house is too big for them to take care of and it is just not as clean as it once was. The fridge is filled with expired food so my brother or I go through and throw stuff out so that there is room for holiday food. My mom struggles to throw things away/donate, so they have boxes and boxes of just \things\ from my grandparents--sets of silverware/serving trays/Tupperware lids with no matching bottom/old linens/etc. It is like the clean out is such a big job that it is all they can do to keep things organized. For multiple reasons, they resist having someone come in and help clean, though they could afford it. I have delicately suggested that we could host, but that would mean the end of the Christmas Eve party (and 50 years of tradition) because we live 3+ hours away and also we have only 1 guest room, so we can't sleep everyone. I am struggling with what to do. I don't want to push my parents into changing before they are ready, but I also can't help make it easier on them if they refuse to let me call in additional support to help. How have other families navigated the changing of the guard? Especially when no one lives nearby?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 129 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1px1vtg/how_do_i_get_my_parents_to_stop_hosting_christmas/

"My mother just passed away in 2023 after 6 years of sickness and me taking care of her by myself, even though there are 5 other siblings. I have to adjust my work, share a room with my mom, change diapers, wake at night, help her eat, and so on. Tired in body and spirit, but to see someone that helpless and once a rock in the family, I feel it is time for me to change position because she did the same to her children when we were young. I miss my mom. A mother can take care of many of her children, but many children cannot take care of one mother."

youtube · @UbunUbunLab · *The Brutal Reality about Caring for Elderly Parents No one Talks About* · 123 likes · https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=a4etJo2_x7Y&lc=Ugw52w70MMzzOZpv__p4AaABAq

"i am so sorry you are at this deeply heavy stage. "my watch will be soon ending" is such a beautiful and heartbreaking way to put it. please do not feel uneasy about the morphine at night. i know it feels strange to medicate someone who is already sleeping but that deep sacrum bedsore is incredibly painful even if he cannot express it anymore. the morphine is doing two crucial things right now. it is staying ahead of that severe pain so it

doesn't wake him up in agony and it relaxes his respiratory system to prevent any air hunger or gasping as his body naturally shuts down. you are not doing anything wrong by giving it to him while he rests. keeping him medicated exactly on the hospice schedule is the absolute kindest thing you can do for him right now so he can transition peacefully without any hidden distress. you have done an incredible job caring for him all this time. just keep him comfortable and hold his hand."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 104 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/okt1o0i/

The phone that never stops · 173 documents

20 most engaged of 173 matching documents, complete text.

"Never use 'A Place for Mom'. They are stalkers. They will call and email you nonstop for YEARS. My dad was 92 when I contacted them many years ago. Nonstop calls and emails. Block the calls? Can't. They either use multiple numbers or they're spoofing their caller ID. My dad died at 100. And yes we found a great place on our own. But even though he died already, I'm STILL getting harassing phone calls from fresh numbers 'concerned' about my dad and whether I found a place. Don't do it! In fact if you have an enemy, give them their info. They're the scum of the earth. I almost feel like getting some referrals and then 1-starring those referrals based on them using APFM. Argh. Ok rant over."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 590 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1kocgug/never_use_a_place_for_mom/

↳ **comment** (264): "A reputable company gave me this link to send to APFM so they would LEAVE ME ALONE! I sent in the form and haven't been contacted since. They were horrible and the calls were relentless. [Do Not Represent Me Form](<https://civica.formstack.com/forms/dnrm>)"

↳ **comment** (186): "Just FYI. I may be paranoid, but I suspect APFM has employees monitoring this sub because everytime anything negative about them comes up, a bunch of people rush in to defend them. If you've had good luck with them, awesome for you, but remember that advertising and commercial posts are prohibited in this sub. I, personally, keep my recommendations to nonprofits and governmental agencies in honor of the sub rules. APFM is a for-profit business whose revenue comes through referral fees they collect from senior living communities and home healthcare providers. Not every service provider is willing to pay their fees, so if you enlist APFM's help, you're not seeing every option available. And, yes, if your aging parent is low income, they are disincentivized from helping you. The fact they use aggressive sales techniques like never removing your phone number from their call list should be enough of a clue. Add your number to the FTC's Do Not Call Registry, make sure to get the call center employee to tell you who they are working for, and tell them you're on the DNC registry and will report them for violating the law (and actually follow through...it's easy)."

↳ **comment** (81): "I was pestered by them for a long time. I started getting pretty feisty about, saying 'No I don't need your help because my mother is DEAD. Stop calling me, you can't make any money off me, because I don't have someone to help!' Eventually they stopped."

"Can we normalize NOT wanting to be your parents caregiver?. I(31F) am struggling. My mom(62F) has been in the hospital a week and my siblings and I have been with her every day. I am on day 4 from 8am to 10pm only taking breaks for phone calls and paperwork. The nurses aren't taking care of her hygiene needs and that doesn't matter much bc my mom doesn't want their help. She. Wants. Me. Look plain and simple, I am not made for it. I can't do the smells and i cant do the fluids. I absolutely admire and commend every person who has taken this role but i tried and i cant. My mom asks me to walk her to the bathroom, and i do it, but i fight gags the entire time and crack the door with my nose hanging out. If I can get a nurse to come in, i do. But my mom gets mad bc she wants me. Then when it comes to baths, she ignores the nurses and looks me dead in the eyes and says 'I want you to do it.' And 'you need to learn to do this.' And I refuse every time. I tell her no, I wasn't made for it and that I will hire people to do these things. She laughs but I'm serious. We do have a compromise that she can wash her body first then I will go in and wash her hair but today she told me she wants me to wash her. It's not that I don't want to see my mom naked etc, it's just one big aversion. Also, she is actually cleared to shower herself. She is capable but she is milking the pampering by us kids (I don't mind as long as it doesn't involve hygiene). It stresses me out bc it's very clear she expects me to be her caregiver when that time comes but I do not want to. The worst part is this is

nothing new. She has always known that I would never be her caregiver. She has always been told by me that I would hire help and I would not be the one changing her and bathing. I know this is pretty shitty but it's a hill I'll die on. Choosing not to be a caregiver does not mean i do not love her. It just means I wasn't made for that job."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 429 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/1ub81dl/can_we_normalize_not_wanting_to_be_your_parents/

↳ **comment** (138): "Not wanting to be your parents caregiver 'is' the norm (here in America). It's a cultural thing. Other countries have very different attitudes when it comes to caring for elders. This doesn't mean you have to want to do all things all the time or anytime...there are other ways to make sure they're adequately cared for"

↳ **comment** (116): "I've been an RN for 35 years and I am now my mother's caregiver. It sucks even with my background so I can't imagine how I'd feel without my abilities."

↳ **comment** (88): "My siblings and I call these "love tests." "Does it make you uncomfortable? Well, if you really loved me you would do it anyway. You must not love me." Our mother has never met a boundary she didn't try to cross."

"Overheard parent saying horrible things about me. I'm the default caretaker. How do I go on?. I have a nanny cam on my 78 year old parent. I don't usually spy, but I have it in case I don't hear from them. Tonight, my sister asked me to check the camera because my 78M father didn't answer the phone. I did, but he was calling her back when I looked. I heard the convo. I shoulda clicked out, but I was so shocked by what I was hearing that I froze. He said some really awful things. Luckily, I only got part of it. He has a problem with how I raise my family and what I do in my free time (which is basically a mom of three). He doesn't like that I have a career. He doesn't approve of anything I do unless it benefits him. I'll spare you the details because I'm genuinely embarrassed to admit the things that came from his mouth. Anyway.... The words were so awful and hurtful. How will I recover? I basically orchestrate his life. I do his finances, I make his appointments, I accompany him to his appointments, I pay his home taxes, oil bill and house cleaning service. I'm feeling damaged. I don't know why his opinion of me matters, but it does. I'll admit I have said some pretty crappy things about people in my life for sure, but the stuff he said about me -- his own daughter -- seems inexcusable. How do you cope for a parent that constantly gives you disapproval even when you are doing everything that you can to help? He doesn't have dementia. He is just a mean human. I have to take him to the doctor Wednesday because there's no one else and I honestly just don't know how I can bring myself to do it. I will because no one else will step up. I feel forever changed though. If you're still reading, thank you. What is your coping strategy?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 378 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/

↳ **comment** (323): "Did your sister shut him down? If you have a good relationship with her, I would tell her what you overheard, and that unless she starts to push back on his awfulness, she can take over all of the stuff you are presently doing."

↳ **comment** (309): "You can drop the rope between you. Or you can speak up for yourself and call him out. Or keep doing what you are doing."

↳ **comment** (171): "I wrote my very similar story below. I was never an angry or assertive person. I'm timid and a people pleaser and overachiever, but there came a moment that I got angrier than I'd ever been in my life (at around 55yrs old) with my father and finally stood up to him. I suggest you do the same. You deserve better and need to be assertive and set YOUR boundaries. Think seriously about not taking him to his drs appointment. Either just cancel it yourself and don't show up at his place or make him be the one to cancel it. It's probably best to let him know you heard his comments and telling him that things will be different going forward (setting

boundaries) because you're upset with him and consider going no contact with him at least for a while. If confronting him is too hard (I get that), have your sister tell him and just make yourself unavailable. Unless you get an apology, you do you with your own family. My story below. It felt good to write it, but I'm fine if you skip it. I can relate so much to this. My father was always negative and controlling. When I was 55yrs old +, and he was 85+ he would still yell at me like a bad child for ridiculous reasons when I would drive 3 hrs to help him and my mother with dementia with different things. I thought that it was that he thought I was going to take control so he was asserting his. I never talked back or argued with him my whole life. I just took it as did my mom. Then he got upset with me because I put a bottle of Pepsi and a bottle of Fiji water in the refrigerator...for THEM because I thought their power was out from bad storms and it was 93 degrees. "We don't need all these things in the refrigerator." (There was very little in it.) And I snapped and screamed at him. I only had the nerve to do that because I was already packed up to leave their house and I knew my mother wouldn't be upset. I taught middle school so I could do overly dramatic loud yelling. I said that he was ruining my mental health which was true. I had started anxiety and depression meds all because of him and the situation, and I lived 3hrs away. I was just outside the door I slammed (another first for me) and went back in and said, "This is the last thing I'm ever going to say to you. OTHER PEOPLE HAVE FEELINGS TOO. I'm done with how you treat me. When you need help, and you will, call your son. I'm done. You have made me very upset and now I have a lot of time driving ahead of me." And as I drove back home, I was upset but also felt the anxiety of "walking on eggshells" with him my whole life suddenly lift. I called my brother, who lives 6 hrs away and was still working while I had retired already, and I told him I was now estranged from our dad so he needed to be ready if Dad called. He said "okay, I understand" and I felt totally free. I did not call at Christmas or birthdays nor send gifts (my mother wasn't aware of holidays or even who I was) and he called and said "We're worried about you" on my voicemail like nothing had happened. If I got a serious apology from him I would have softened, but that never happened. It felt good to not answer his calls (knowing he could call my brother for help) and knowing I had set a boundary with him that I should have set years earlier. I was still estranged from him when he died, and I don't feel the least bit bad about it or grief that he was dead. In fact, that was a relief too."

"My dad passed. This feels impossible. . This is going to be a long one but I need to get it out. 3 months ago he had a catastrophic stroke. He was 72. He was on the floor for two days before I got concerned about him not answering my phone calls or texts and called in a welfare check. Miraculously, he survived. I immediately moved out of the city and into his house. My wonderful boyfriend dropped everything and moved with me. He took care of me as I took care of my dad. During these last 3 months he progressed to rehab and was walking with a hemi walker. I was so proud of him. I was always proud of him. I was ready to care for him once he was released from the rehab facility. I would have done anything for my dad, as he would have done anything for me. These last 3 months were a whirlwind of me thinking he had died from the stroke, him surviving but the doctors telling me he was going to be a "vegetable", him becoming conscious and mentally okay, him having petit Mal seizures (that he would get prior to the stroke from a head injury decades ago. Nothing new, but new to the doctors I guess) and doctors telling me he was dying. He obviously didn't die, so then he continued to heal, get stronger and was moved to acute rehab in the hospital and eventually progressed to subacute rehab in a facility. From the beginning, I was with him nearly every single day. I worked remotely at the hospital, and then the rehab facility, only taking a day here and there to go into the office when absolutely necessary. We joked, and talked and I cheered him on in rehab. I spent so many hours with him every day for 3 months, and I'm so grateful for that time. It was weeks of me explaining that he was deaf in his left ear (pre stroke), that he has arthritis in his affected hand, shoulder and hip and to be gentle, that he has these absence seizures and what they look like so they don't think it's another stroke. Over and over and over again, to every new nurse, physical therapist, doctor, aid, of which there were so many. It was endless work to ensure that those caring for him knew about pre existing things, what hurt him physically, and so on as it seemed like no one was briefed or looked at his chart. Soon, his once hearty appetite started to decline. His breathing became labored and gurgly even while laying down. His left foot became swollen. He was eventually sent to the hospital after I sounded the alarm for days. He was there for 5 days. I spent most of those days begging to talk to the cardiologist as I found out that his congestive heart failure was exacerbated. I

finally spoke to the cardiologist and he told me that my dad was very ill and they were going to monitor him for a few more days while giving him diuretics, antibiotics and steroids. He said "baby steps". Even though I was furious that it took DAYS for me to speak to anyone besides nurses, I trusted him and felt better that they were monitoring him. The next morning, I got a call from the hospital telling me that my dad was ready for discharge. Absolutely shocked, I said that was impossible and rushed to the hospital as he looked awful the day before and the cardiologist told me they would be monitoring him for a few days! Turns out that the attending doctor and the cardiologist didn't communicate and the attending doctor was simply ready to discharge my dad. I fought it, and the discharge was canceled and the next day saw improvements, he was taken off oxygen and then he was discharged back to the rehab facility. I trusted the doctors, and was told they communicated, so I didn't fight it this time. I wish I had. Two days later he passed away when I was on my way to visit him for the day. I pick up his ashes and his death certificate tomorrow. I'm heartbroken. I'm absolutely devastated. I'm writing this at 4am because I can't sleep. I'm living at his house and everything reminds me of him. Everything smells like him. I keep thinking I'll see him on the couch in the morning, asking me if I want a cup of coffee because that's what he'd do when I'd visit before he was sick. I make my own coffee now. I was ready to care for him, and help him with anything he needed. I would have done anything for him. But he would have hated that. He hated being doted on and valued his independence which was stolen from him and I think, ultimately, he let go because he didn't want us to be in that position. But I'd have done it. No questions asked. I loved my dad more than anything. I feel lost and I hate how I now must deal with notifying banks and debtors and hospital financials and everyone of his passing while I'm grieving. I hate how I'll never get a text from him telling me a dad joke. I hate how I'll never hear him laugh again or tell me stories about his (and my) favorite baseball team, the ny mets. I'll never again hear him tell me he loves me, or hold his hand or crack jokes or get advice. A few days before his passing, he told nurses that him and my mom creating me was the best thing they had ever done. That will stay with me for ever. It's a full body grief. It's a grief that comes in deep breaths and tears at 4am, or 10am, or 6pm. In bed, in the car, in the grocery store, it doesn't matter where. Grief doesn't wait for a convenient moment or space. I can feel it in my muscles and bones and guts. I don't know how to deal with this, but I know I have to. I have no other choice but to continue to do my absolute best. It's what dad would have wanted, so it's what I'll do. And, of course, Let's go Mets."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 247 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1e6ym6k/my_dad_passed_this_feels_impossible/

"I wrote my very similar story below. I was never an angry or assertive person. I'm timid and a people pleaser and overachiever, but there came a moment that I got angrier than I'd ever been in my life (at around 55yrs old) with my father and finally stood up to him. I suggest you do the same. You deserve better and need to be assertive and set YOUR boundaries. Think seriously about not taking him to his drs appointment. Either just cancel it yourself and don't show up at his place or make him be the one to cancel it. It's probably best to let him know you heard his comments and telling him that things will be different going forward (setting boundaries) because you're upset with him and consider going no contact with him at least for a while. If confronting him is too hard (I get that), have your sister tell him and just make yourself unavailable. Unless you get an apology, you do you with your own family. My story below. It felt good to write it, but I'm fine if you skip it. I can relate so much to this. My father was always negative and controlling. When I was 55yrs old +, and he was 85+ he would still yell at me like a bad child for ridiculous reasons when I would drive 3 hrs to help him and my mother with dementia with different things. I thought that it was that he thought I was going to take control so he was asserting his. I never talked back or argued with him my whole life. I just took it as did my mom. Then he got upset with me because I put a bottle of Pepsi and a bottle of Fiji water in the refrigerator...for THEM because I thought their power was out from bad storms and it was 93 degrees. "We don't need all these things in the refrigerator." (There was very little in it.) And I snapped and screamed at him. I only had the nerve to do that because I was already packed up to leave their house and I knew my mother wouldn't be upset. I taught middle school so I could do overly dramatic loud yelling. I said that he was ruining my mental health which was true. I had started anxiety and depression meds all because

of him and the situation, and I lived 3hrs away. I was just outside the door I slammed (another first for me) and went back in and said, "This is the last thing I'm ever going to say to you. OTHER PEOPLE HAVE FEELINGS TOO. I'm done with how you treat me. When you need help, and you will, call your son. I'm done. You have made me very upset and now I have a lot of time driving ahead of me." And as I drove back home, I was upset but also felt the anxiety of "walking on eggshells" with him my whole life suddenly lift. I called my brother, who lives 6 hrs away and was still working while I had retired already, and I told him I was now estranged from our dad so he needed to be ready if Dad called. He said "okay, I understand" and I felt totally free. I did not call at Christmas or birthdays nor send gifts (my mother wasn't aware of holidays or even who I was) and he called and said "We're worried about you" on my voicemail like nothing had happened. If I got a serious apology from him I would have softened, but that never happened. It felt good to not answer his calls (knowing he could call my brother for help) and knowing I had set a boundary with him that I should have set years earlier. I was still estranged from him when he died, and I don't feel the least bit bad about it or grief that he was dead. In fact, that was a relief too."

reddit comment · r/AgingParents · 171 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1tfnqp/overheard_parent_saying_horrible_things_about_me/op30xw5/

"Put a camera in their room if they are in a facility - best thing I did. Such a lifesaver when mom wasn't able to use her phone anymore. I could talk to her through it and she could see my face. But I would turn off my camera a mic most of the time and the screen would be blank. Again so useful when she moved to memory care. And again when he was actively dying and all alone. I actually was with her on the camera when she passed as I was "dropping-in" regularly. I watched as the staff lovingly prepared her body. And again when the funeral home came to get her. I watched the most loving and amazing caregivers treat her with respect and dignity. I saw nothing that alarmed me and everything that assured me she was in good hands. I used an Echo Show and the caregivers could not tell it was a camera. Used their wifi and mostly didn't disclose. Best decision ever as she resided in a facility in another State. But even if she were down the street, I would still get a camera. The camera let me not bug the overworked staff with my phone calls to check on her. I could see exactly what was going on. I saw the first signs of her UTIs. And when she started really declining I saw and heard her struggles and alerted her doctor and caregivers. Camera in their room. Highly recommend 10/10 Don't take "no cameras" for an answer. Set one up anyway. Also- here's a hack: keep snacks for the caregivers in the room. Fill with sweets and granola bars. They come in the room more often to get them and love it."

reddit post · r/dementia · 138 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1qnu02i/put_a_camera_in_their_room_if_they_are_in_a/

"Both of my parents are in a life threatening crisis, and they shift the blame on me because I try to help. I live a few states away from my family. My mother (65) had a botched surgery last year and has been in a physical and mental health spiral ever since. She has several comorbidities and one of the top ones is extreme insomnia, like 3 hours of sleep a night on average. This has caused her to lose grasp with reality due to psychosis. She refuses to take any medication, doesn't trust doctors. Doesn't have proper nutrition or hydration. Every time I call she is in absolute hysterics without fail, like full on crying fits and panics. My father is her primary caregiver and he is facing full caregiver collapse. He is now an insomniac too, cries all the time, and I think he is hiding self harm from me. Here's what really bothers me: he reinforces her psychosis. Tells her that she doesn't have to take the medicine if she doesn't want to. Says he doesn't trust her doctors. He is very mentally ill himself and is unfitting as a caregiver. They both have delusions that people are coming to "take them away to the loony bin" or arrest them if they seek help. I have made a million phone calls to physicians, department of aging, other family members. What ultimately happens is that when my parents are confronted with harsh truths (like "hey you need to escalate care") they refuse, downplay, or just explode in anger. Well I had one of those anger explosions over the phone recently. Suddenly everything was my fault because I was "making too many phone calls". I told them that if my mother does not take her medication I will have to call her doctor again. They both lost it on me. Told me this is my fault because I'm not there with them. Told me both "leave us alone" and "you're too far away", so basically any

situation I'm at fault. Full disclosure, my father was very physically and emotionally abusive to me growing and this brought me right back to the feeling of being a little scared boy. At this point I have absolved of the situation. I don't think I will hear my mother's voice again by Christmas and I'm afraid what my dad might will do once she passes. But I can't insert myself in this chaos anymore. No more agencies, no more phone calls. Shit sucks man."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 132 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ts88af/both_of_my_parents_are_in_a_life_threatening/

"Hoarder MIL: The ongoing saga. Just to recap: \- MIL is in her 80s \- She had one child, a son, and I married him \- My husband died of cancer about 6 years ago \- MIL drove my husband nuts with her crappy attitude and inability to deal with the consequences of her own actions \- While hubs was going through cancer treatments, she'd come up to offer "moral support". While here, she'd expect him to carry her luggage and order for her and all kinds of whatever and expected me to cater to her because "she's the guest". \- She hated me from the beginning and worked to break us up while we were dating and when we were married. This went on for about 10 years. \- She's a hoarder. Her home was condemned by code enforcement in April 2025 when I called local LE for a wellness check on her. \- Had to pay \$17k to get the house cleared and approved by code enforcement for her to move back in. \- She's fallen several times since, totalled her car because "hoard in car" and a bitcoin scam. \- She has been diagnosed with cyclothymia. This is a mild version of bipolar, but honestly, there's likely more going on. \- She fell again beginning of Dec 2025. She had a nursing service check on her weekly and the nurse called for a wellness check. I went to do some errands for her (she's 3 hours away) and learned the hoarding had resumed with gusto and the toilets were all backed up. At the time, her echocardiogram was normal. \- I got her moved into a personal care home (PCH, not a nursing home) on NYE 2025. She hated it at first, but has been singing praises for the last several months. \- Got her house sold 12 June and her outstanding (massive) credit card bills cleared. One had entered arbitration. She had this idea that, because she was old, she didn't have to pay cc bills anymore. \- The week after the house sold _something happened_. Not sure what. Could have been a silent heart attack, could have been caused by grief over the house selling. Regardless, between Dec 2025 and 2-3 weeks ago, her heart function dropped to 10-15% and she developed congestive heart failure. \- While in the hospital she decided she was refusing medical care. Doc totally confused by this, but ok. She also got a psyche eval while she was there because she kept saying "I just want to die". Also diagnosed with UTI (and her usual delirium). \- Back at the PCH and under hospice care. She won't talk to me on the phone, whines in texts constantly. She's on lasix and O2 for the congestive heart failure. THE NEWS: Sunday (yesterday) AM I got a call from the manager of the PCH. MIL keeps her roommate up all night making her get up and fix her pillows and tuck her in. Roommate is miserable (also in her 80s and in bad health). MIL is not going to the bathroom anymore; she just lies in bed and fills her diapers and expects the PCH staff to clean her up. She won't keep her legs elevated, she won't keep her O2 on. She refuses to eat. Complains about her stomach hurting all the time (not eating, hmmm?). If she won't cooperate, they'll evict her. She has no where else to go. I had guessed at some of what they told me. She'd complained that she was breaking "the new rules" last week, that they wanted to put her in a hospital bed and that was "insane". She whinged on and on about needing a specific blanket from amazon (I finally just caved and got it for her even tho she has blankets). I text her. I cannot call her. She won't answer the phone, and if she calls me, she complains she can't hear me (then says she can't hear anymore, which the PCH says is bogus). I tell her she has decisions to make and it's on her to make them. I tell her that she's being moved to the hospice room that's closer to the toilets and that she's getting a hospital bed so that her legs stay elevated. (The PCH is "losing" the remote, which I totally agree with.) She freaks the fuck out, tells me all this is old news, that she's been in the hospital for tests (they call and tell me when she goes to the hospital and she hasn't been). Bitches that she likes it where she is, she doesn't want to move, yadda yadda. Then she claims the toilet paper holders have cameras on them. A few hours later she says she was moved, it's cold, she has blankets, and I've heard nothing since. So that's where I am today. Concurrently, I'm gonna have to put my 16 year old dog down this week (chronic kidney disease \[CKD\]), my 15 year old dog won't be far behind (heart murmur, congestive heart failure, beginning CKD). A side effect of the CKD is chronic diarrhoea, so I've been cleaning that up for over a month multiple times a day and night; a side

effect of the lasix that younger dog is on is increased urination (more things to clean up). I have pee pads all over the place, but there's only so much of that you can do. And my therapist is on vacation for a few weeks. It will be a month before I get to talk to her again."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 127 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1v1l503/hoarder_mil_the_ongoing_saga/

"Anyone dealing with the anti-text movement?. My (42M) parents are 70, since covid they have been on a crusade to refuse to use any text based communication. Phone calls and Facetime only. Doesn't matter where you are, what you have going on, how hard you work. The expectation is if they call, you stop what you are doing and have a 1-1.5 hour conversation with them. Zero text messaging, they will receive text messages and then call you. I just can't do it anymore and was just in a big blowup fight with them. Working 50-70 hours a week, I get 50 hours or so of peace on the weekend to get all the shit I need to get done. They love to call on Sunday mornings and afternoons. I don't have time at 2pm on a Sunday. They forget everyone is not retired and our generation can't afford stay at home spouses. Couples like my wife and I typically work full time. So everyone chips in on the weekends. I don't have a spouse at home all week to do all the house chores like my mother did growing up, I need to help on the weekends. My wife deserves her rest as well. Not to mention, they have nothing to talk about because they don't leave their house. It's either doctor visits, some friend in the community are ill/worse or whatever political bullshit they are following. The last thing I want to do is talk on the phone about my career, my wife's career, the chores we are doing or whatever. I live it every day, I don't want to talk about it and recap how shitty my week was. They moved away and now they feel entitled to life-coaching level updates of everything going on. They refuse to make trips back usually blaming health, money, travel, or weather issues. Always an excuse, but expect full effort on my part and my siblings to keep them updated using phone calls to keep them in the loop. I'm busy during the week and it's hard to call me, typically my phone is on silent during meetings. I'm very responsive to text messaging, because I can work it in to my schedule. They refuse though, typical boomer, it's their way or no way. They decided to move 2,300 miles away. They've been gone for 10 years, maybe 5-10 trips back home in that time. It would be different if we could meet for dinner on Thursday night or they could come over and I'd cook on Tuesday night. That can't happen, so I don't know what to tell them. They made their life choices. The crazy part is they never changed. They were only parents when it was convenient to them in my childhood they are still doing it now that I'm an adult."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 121 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1w3ebre/anyone_dealing_with_the_antitext_movement/

"Mom not in a facility, wants attention - how often would you visit?. Mom is 87 and doing well, all things considered. She has a lung condition that's been giving her trouble but still drives and gets around. She lives in a condo about 15 miles from me which DH and I had to help pay for so she could get something decent. She didn't save for retirement and we are not in a position to spend 15K a month for her care so she's bored and lonely. I don't think she'd qualify for Medicaid in home care bc she's not at the nursing home level yet. She'd love it if I (mid 50s F) would come over there every day and hold her hand and tut tut over her but I have a life and that isn't going to happen. I used to call her a lot but I just don't know if I can take it any more - every time I talk to her she's moping about her situation. I mean, health I know we can't all do anything about but she's absolutely hung up over not being able to do the things she used to do, nobody comes to see her, self pity party almost all the time. She loves to talk about death - people we know who've died, what's going to happen when she dies, and on and on. I know she's depressed and have been working on her to get some counseling but she won't and just gets mad at me when I suggest it. So I've pulled back on phone calls because I'm tired of listening to the self pity and now she's bugging me a lot about seeing and talking to me more often. I don't think anything I say will make any difference at all. We do have other family members nearby and she has friends - how much contact would you keep with mom if you were in a similar situation? Part of me feels bad for her but OTOH I never signed up to provide her retirement and I have a half sibling who does nothing. I should add she never lifted a finger for either of her own parents - we moved to another state and her siblings took care of that."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 65 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1vgvxzw/mom_not_in_a_facility_wants_attention_how_often/

↳ **comment** (74): "Senior centers, they will sometimes even pick them up"

↳ **comment** (49): "I don't think it's our responsibility to entertain and make out parents happy. I think if we can we should help them be safe and somewhere suitable which you have done. I would find that very hard to listen to so setting boundaries about what will listen to or just a once a week call (and not for hours) is what I would do. I guess it depends how close you are and how much listening to her complaining affects your own mental heath."

↳ comment (37): "I can relate to this. My mom is 84 and does live in a retirement community. I have a sibling who does nothing and is essentially estranged from her, except when it comes to birthdays and Christmas and then she reaches out with the list of things her family wants as gifts. I wish I were exaggerating... My dad was her soulmate and best friend and since he died a couple of years ago she has been sad, fragile, cranky and lonely. I do my best to be there for her but I live 3 hours away, work full time, have animals and a house to care for, and a kid with a lot of health issues that takes up a lot of my time. I am about to drive to go spend 4 days with her and do lots of tasks for her. I am equipped with a lot of weed which makes her incessant talking as well as the 1.5 hour ordeals that meals have become more bearable. (She is very formal and eats verrrrryyyy slowly and I have adhd and it is all I can do not to scream FINISH ALREADY) When I open a book she still stands over me talking. She will sometimes say "oh, I know you're trying to read" and then continues on with her talking. Every phone call becomes 45 min minimum. I often call her on the way home from work so there will be a natural ending to the call - ok, I'm home, love you, gotta go. Instead I'll sit in my driveway idling for like 15 minutes while she keeps going oh one more thing, oh, I also forgot to tell you ... She repeats stories constantly and many of them are incorrect and I know this because they directly involve me. I have learned just to smile and nod and zone out. Last summer I went up to visit her many, many times in a 2 month period and she talks about it as though I never came. It sometimes feels like it's never enough. She guilt trips my kids, who love her but who have the same issues - it's torture to be talked at constantly and to sit through endless meals (we allll have adhd)and be judged for everything. She comments on every outfit they wear, every bite of food they eat, has very specific ideas about how everyone should behave and is very critical when we don't meet those expectations. I do text her daily and I try to call at least once a week. I dread the calls so much; I hate talking on the phone in general and sitting still is torture for me. I love her, and she's incredibly tiresome, and I'm really scared about how this is all going to go in the future, as the clinginess is getting worse. I'm trying so hard to be a good daughter to her. She also adamantly refused to move closer to us, which is her right, but man- it puts a huge strain on me. I wish I could stop in for 30 min with some soup I made, quick visit and then leave, as opposed to those endless marathon visits of being talked at."

"The End of a Caregiving Era. I started my journey of daily, increasingly demanding and finally all-consuming eldercare back in 2015, when it became clear my mom could no longer physically look after my dad any more but I was still raising my three young sons and couldn't do it all on my own either. That was when I made the first round of phone calls to our local government and health care agencies to see what help was available, and the first workers started arriving to help Dad shower a couple of times a week and sometimes get dressed in the morning. Neither he nor my mom really wanted strangers coming into the house, but they did reluctantly agree that it was too much to expect me to do all Dad's care single-handed while looking after my own family at the same time. I'm so glad now that I took that step of introducing one or two regular caregivers early in the process, even a little earlier than my parents thought was necessary, because it made it so much easier to bring in more help later on. But even with all the helpers we could find or afford, it got to a point where Dad's day-to-day care, and later Mom's, was more than I could handle without breaking. After ten years of having their needs on my mind 24/7, lying awake at night trying to solve all their mental and physical problems in my head, being constantly aware that if anything happened to me my parents would be helpless and nobody else in my family would be able to take over

(or at least, not without a huge amount of distress, confusion, and radical changes for everyone involved), I was burned out and exhausted. I'd hoped to keep them both at home until the end, I'd really thought that barring some kind of catastrophe it would be possible, I felt guilty at the thought of uprooting them, but it was also clear -- by God's grace and direction -- that it was time. They needed more help than I could give them even if I dedicated myself to their care 24 hours a day, and I knew neither one of them would have wanted me to neglect my own husband and family or give up everything else in my life to do that. Something had to change. My Dad was the first to move, back in 2019. He wasn't a big man, but by then he was dead weight, with no strength left in his legs, and it took two people or a mechanical lift to assist him. He had to go to a nursing home, and because it needed to happen fast, we weren't able to get our first choice of facility. The place was understaffed and overworked and the food was pretty awful, but it was clean and everybody was trying their best. He lived there for eight months, with my mom visiting him every day, before he passed in early 2020. At that time, Mom was still pretty mobile and cognitively sharp, able to make meals and do her laundry and such on her own -- but then the pandemic kept her even more housebound and isolated than usual, and a mild bout of COVID wrecked her ability to accurately recognize spoken words even with hearing aids (from 56% pre-COVID to 16% afterward). By late 2023 she was showing increasing signs of confusion and struggling with the activities of daily living, and in mid-2024 she began having attacks of sudden, excruciating nerve pain that required immediate heavy-duty pain meds, as well as a daily maintenance dose of gabapentin. Things went even faster downhill from there, until she could no longer be safely left alone at any time, ever. Even going out for a 30-minute walk once turned into a three-hour ordeal of Mom in agony because I wasn't there when she started a pain attack, and the guilt (for me) and distress (for her) was too much for me to ever risk that happening again. Anyway, this week I moved Mom out of my home and into assisted living. It's the strangest feeling knowing -- or sometimes forgetting, then remembering with a jolt -- that she's no longer downstairs in her apartment, sitting in her rocking chair with one of our cats in her lap, waiting for me to check on her. That when I wake up every morning, I don't have to hurry downstairs to give Mom her morning pills and make sure everything she needs is set up and ready for the day. That it's no longer my responsibility to make sure she's had breakfast and make her lunch and dinner, or keep checking the garbage bin to make sure she's actually eaten her food and not thrown it out. That if she gets muddled at night and doesn't know what to do with her day clothes or where to find her pyjamas, if she folds up her dirty underwear and puts it in with the clean ones instead of in the laundry when it belongs, if she wears the same outfit for two or three days because she doesn't remember she already wore it, that's an issue for her caregivers to address instead of me having to solve it on my own. Not that I've stopped thinking about Mom's needs, or trying to anticipate them. For the past few days I've been in regular touch with her care team, making sure they're up to date on all her medications and support needs and so on. Yesterday when I came to visit, I put labels on the drawers and various sections of her closet to make it easier for her (and the caregivers) to find everything, and I took her dead wristwatch home with me to put in a new battery. But that's all easy stuff, things I can do when it's convenient. I no longer have to drop everything and rush to fix all her problems right away. Better still, I don't have to carry the weight of being the only person Mom can fully rely on, the only one who knows all the details of her health conditions and her medications, her hopes and expectations. I don't have to arrange my days and weeks around her care schedule, and wait for a paid support worker or visiting family member to spell me off before I can leave the house. I can actually go out for more than 3-4 hours at a time, enjoy a leisurely visit with a friend, even leave town and drive to another city for a day -- something I haven't been able to do for ages. I can take a walk with my husband, instead of always taking turns so Mom isn't left alone; we can go out for dinner, or do an overnight getaway, without having to plan and prepare for it weeks in advance. After ten years of intense daily caregiving, first for my father (who had Parkinson's, used a wheelchair, and needed to be helped on and off the toilet every 30-45 min all day) and then for my housebound and increasingly confused mother, being free to go anywhere, any time, feels like a wild luxury. I'm not sorry that I kept my parents at home as long as I was able. I have no regrets about the time I spent looking after them, even though it was sometimes difficult, exhausting and emotionally very hard to do it. I have a lot to be grateful for when it comes to my parents and our relationship over the years, and I am truly thankful for that. But I'm also not sorry that when caring for them became so overwhelming that it was

taking over my life, affecting my emotional and mental health, forcing me to prioritize my parents over my husband and children, and keeping me from doing anything creative or restful for myself, I chose to give up full-time care and move them into assisted living. It was hard to break the news to them, hard to see them struggle with it, we all shed tears over it, but once the move finally happened, it didn't take long to recognize that it was truly the best thing for all of us. If anybody has questions about caring for your parents at home and/or the process of transitioning them to full-time care, particularly in Canada (Ontario), please ask and I'll do my best to answer. If you can find the RIGHT assisted living residence (and thank God I have, it's both affordable and perfectly suited to Mom's needs) it's a wonderful relief."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 59 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1iq68hc/the_end_of_a_caregiving_era/

↳ **comment** (7): "I went through this with my parents. I was taking care of them in their house until it became so overwhelmingly difficult that I was literally having panic attacks and had a meltdown. It was a hard decision and they didn't want it but moving them to assisted living has been such a game changer for me. I'm finally feeling a bit like my old self! I hope you get to as well. Of course there is plenty to be done but not having to make meals among all the other tasks is the best!"

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for sharing your story. I am just beginning my caretaking journey. My mother is in the hospital as I type this and I am getting the house ready to have her come home. At this point in time, she is unable to lift her cup to her mouth. Last weekend she was able to all the things. Life happens so fast."

↳ **comment** (3): "Thank you for posting this! This brings me some relief. I am 2 years into my caregiving journey, I work from home and my FiL lives with us. This is the hardest thing I've ever done in my life, it's nice to know that you feel some sense of normalcy at the end of it all."

"I spent the day with my mom, trying to help her receive necessary medical treatment. I feel like the Geezer Whisperer.. (Please don't @ me. I use inappropriate humor to cope.) Ma is dealing with a recently diagnosed serious health condition. For the past few days, she's been having some major bad symptoms - localized pain and nausea. Obviously, I'm worried. I went shopping for her yesterday, took groceries and dog food and electrolyte drinks. "Mama, you need to talk to your PCP or your oncologist, or I will. And it's OK if you aren't up to making the phone call, I'll gladly do it." "No, it's just that [health issue I had 40 years ago and dealt with.]" "OK. [Not really.] But you need to talk to your oncologist, in case this is one of the serious side effects of the treatment you started on Friday." "No, it's probably just [random bullshit that was properly handled 4 decades ago.] I'm FINE!" Cut to this morning. My phone rings at 8am. I know it's no bueno if my mama is calling before 10. "Baby, I might need you to take me to the emergency room. Get dressed, but let me call the triage nurse at my primary doctor first. I'll call you right back." K. I'm downing coffee like we're gonna impose sanctions on Columbia tomorrow, rushing the dogs through their morning constitutional, shower, dress, update husband in case he needs to pick up from band practice and student council meeting, etc. There's leftovers for dinner. I'm prepared. And I wait. Finally, I text around 10. (Didn't want to call, in case Ma was on the phone with the nurse.) Let's pretend like Mama actually left a message instead of just doom dialing. But Ma said "Come on. I need some relief." Good. It's 15 miles through the country to Ma's, and then back to town. I'm driving. "Maybe I should stop at my PCP before I just go to the emergency room." First good decision of the day, let's go. Ma has a new doctor. I haven't been there. She can't remember the name of the practice nor how to get there, but we made it with 3 detours. Luck was on our side: we walked in at 11:04 am, and the lovely woman at the desk said that Dr. H had a slot open at 11:15. The ludicrous old broad tells the very nice doctor that "Well, I've had a little nausea and some pain." Me: "Translation: she hasn't kept any food or water down in 3 days, and pain has kept her awake for 3 days." Ma: "Oh, it's not that serious. I've googled, and I think it's my gall bladder." In other words, it couldn't possibly be a side effect from the immunotherapy she began receiving Friday for stage IV melanoma. (Mind you, she's never had gall bladder issues.) Aight. Doctor wants to rule out Dr. Google's dx. Sends us straight over to the imaging center for an abdominal CT with contrast, a promise to refer to the gastroenterology practice in case of gallstones, and

prescription for a nausea medicine and a pain reliever. It's noon when we arrived at the imaging center. Fill out paperwork, drink this bottle of not-really-fruit-punch. Mama's all "have I ever had surgery? It doesn't really count if it was decades ago, right?" Ma, drink your radioactive shit and hand me the clipboard. I learned how to forge your signature in the 1980s. I rubbed her back and finished the paperwork in between "why is this taking so long?!" And I know time stretches when you're in pain. But she was out of CT at 13:28. (Remember, we arrived at her doctor's office at 11:04. And it's 20 minutes for the contrast solution to be effective, and 10 minutes across town to the imaging center. But I understand. Pain and nausea are a terrible way to live.) Next step: when the PCP receives the scan, he'll refer you to the GE if that's appropriate, or to the oncologist. Cool. Okay, let's go pick up your prescriptions. Back across town, and the pharmacy is closed for lunch until 14:00. It's fine, less than half an hour. "I'm so hungry." I don't doubt that. What do you think you can eat? Y'all. She decided on a McDonald's fish sandwich. I know everyone is different, but a fried fish sandwich?! Whatever. She's grown. So I grabbed us a couple of sandwiches, and we went back to wait in the pharmacy drive through. Ma vomited up her sandwich and the contrast dye in the lane. Fortunately, it's supposed to rain tonight, so maybe someone else won't have to hose that off the driveway. Got her meds, after a little fuss about scanning her ID for a scheduled pain reliever. Drove her home. I get to take her to the oncologist tomorrow. You'll be shocked to know that Mama's gall bladder is fine and her symptoms are almost certainly related to her cancer treatment."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 55 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1axokrw/i_spent_the_day_with_my_mom_trying_to_help_her/

↳ **comment** (18): "'I'm downing coffee like we're gonna impose sanctions on Columbia tomorrow". I legit cackled. Dark humor was how my mom coped with life. I love it! The doctor SHOULD have prescribed her Zofran or some other nausea drug prior to her being put on immunotherapy. If not, express your concerns tomorrow to the oncologist. DO NOT let your mom tell them she is fine or that it was nothing. She disrupted your day for all that. They may even change her immuno treatment if her reaction is this severe. She should NOT be eating anything heavier than Saltines at this point, and certainly not fast food fish. Bleh. Why would you do that to yourself, ESPECIALLY if you think you are having a gallbladder attack?! 🤢"

↳ **comment** (12): "At Mom's request, my brother and I both joined her for the first visit to the oncologist. We're in the waiting room, filling out a health history questionnaire. Page 15 or so is sexual/reproductive history. "Are you sexually active?" "Ma, I will give you a quarter if you write 'No, I just lay there.'" So I owe her a quarter."

↳ **comment** (11): "Fortunately, the PCP did prescribe Zofran yesterday. I'll find out this morning whether it helped Ma keep anything down. (My retired cop/former drug dog handler husband is already suggesting the forbidden gummies. I'm letting him source those. I wouldn't know how. I'm sure my young adult kids would have a source, but I'm not going to get them in a bind. "Officer, I swear those are for my poor old sick grandmother!")"

"Mom FINALLY went to look at assisted living!. It finally happened! I never thought the day would come. My 83yo mother finally agreed to go look at assisted living! Technically- we went to look at two of those continuing care complexes- where you buy in at 300k and then pay rent on your unit monthly. The benefit is that your monthly rent is fixed pricing, and as your care needs increase your cost remains the same. I fully recognize that my mother's cognitive decline will likely have her living independently for less than 2 years tops and I feel like that is unrealistically generous. However, it's a way to get her where she needs to be (I believe she should be in AL now, but these places seem to think she's ok independent somehow) without a fight and going to court. Will it eat up all her life savings and leave her with nothing? Yes, eventually. But it's her money and if she will go into care happily then that is a bargain in my book!!! Now to get her to face the reality of selling her farm of 46 years. I'm going to be shocked if she can, but I feel like there is hope. So how did we get here? Tough love. My angelic blessed oldest sister threw herself on the sword and moved in for three years. She couldn't do it anymore, bless her for enduring that long. Our mother is unable to live alone comfortably. She needs help with driving, shopping, cooking, and anything beyond light cleaning. So not very independent at all. Mom refuses to recognize she needs help.

Demands it from each of us. Eventually we realized all we were doing was enabling her to stay in inadequate conditions at our stress and resentment. So we set some boundaries. My sister moved out. She will come help do chores one day a month. I can no longer be available at a moments notice nor visit every other day. I can no longer call every day. I can call weekly, I can take one day off of work a month to help with anything, and I am available for genuine emergencies anytime. And then we stood firm while she tested every single one. It was brutal to hear her sobbing on the phone about how lonely she is and how we abandoned her. I would gently remind her that I am unable to be her companion, as much as I do enjoy visiting. I am still working and have my own home and family to tend to. I am not able to spend so much of my time entertaining her. She needs to make her own friends and entertain herself. Rinse, repeat. But it finally worked. She's lonely and doesn't want to live in a big old house on a farm all alone anymore. She wants friends and to be active. Hallelujah. Now we hope it sticks."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 51 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1s2y2el/mom_finally_went_to_look_at_assisted_living/

"We are all on your side and have experienced your frustration. Just two days go a well meaning church lady that visits my friend once a month or so for about 15 minutes said something similar. My friend's memory care is closing and I am spending hours upon hours visiting new facilities and looking at her budget trying to figure out how we will meet the inevitable price increase. But, this lovely woman who prays for my friend and keeps her name on the prayer chains, can't trust my decision making because I'm not a church goer. "Why can't she just go home?" Gee! I don't know! Why don't you lift her from her wheelchair into your car. Why don't you drive her the two hours to the Neuro-Psych evaluation, wait for an hour and a half for the testing to be completed and then lift her back into your car for the two hour drive back home? Why don't you offer to make the phone calls wheedling and pleading with that office to move her appointment so it could happen now instead of after the memory care closes? How many nights are you going to volunteer to spend in her mouse infested home that still smells like the chickens she allowed to live in the house with her? I didn't see you help us clean out the 5 years of chicken shit! I don't remember your assistance in cleaning out 15 years of uneaten, outdated canned goods so there was room for her to store actual food! How many home care agencies have you called? How many doctor's offices have you sat in with her while she tells them that except for some arthritis in her knee, she's fine? Even though that's the follow up visit from her last compression fracture because she will not use the cane, walker or wheelchair that are provided for her use. But, you know, since she smiled appropriately when you brought her the candy. She joined you in prayer. And she sincerely prayed to just be allowed to return home, we should just make that happen. I'm sure you will help by praying for divine intervention to keep her safe. Unfortunately that's not the help I need. She needs care 24/7. Since my efforts aren't visible from your church pew and aren't happening on my knees, I guess they don't count. We should just mover her back home. I'm sure she'll be fine."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 31 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1r23wtb/she_should_be_at_home_with_a_care_giver_and_not_in/o4uoelo/

"Mom in hospital dad needs 24/7 care. My dad has Parkinson's and needs 24/7 care. My mom is his caregiver and refuses to let anyone come into the house or help her. I've been telling her this for years and she refuses to listen. She also doesnt go to the doctor for herself and is not very healthy. She's overweight, has bad knees, her legs are so swollen and her feet are hideous. I've been after her to go to the doctors for years to figure out her legs and why they are so swollen. Her excuse is that she can't because my dad needs her. 2 weeks ago my cousin called me to tell me that my mom has an infection in her foot and she needs to go to the doctor or hospital. I called her and told her to go and she promised me she would for 5 days before she finally went. Now she had to be kept overnight and there's no one to take care of my dad. My brother lives at home but is also overweight and has autism and doesn't always grasp the severity of the situation. I live 4 hours away, have a full time job, am taking some graduate classes, and I have 2 children in high school and I'm widowed for a little over a year now. I also have pets and this just happened to happen while I'm on vacation. I'm in another country at the moment. I talked to my dad and brother today and told them both to get help from the VA since my dad is a veteran. I hope they listen to me. My

brother is supposed to go to the hospital for my mom this afternoon and consult with the doctors. He said they want a visiting nurse to come and also PT for my mom. No doubt she will refuse if it's left up to her. I told him to make sure they come. I'm kind of angry because since my mom has refused help all these years now we need it and have no one to call. Like WTF. She's left this all on us. And when she comes home she probably needs to be resting not walking all over the house to do things for my dad. But I'm sure she won't be abiding by doctors orders. This is 1 stressor in my life at the moment. My daughter needs to choose a college in less than 1 week and we have no concrete financial aid package. My dad waffles on paying, which is fine. So we decide on the cheapest out of state place and then today he asks and he says she should go to her top choice in his city since it's close to home. Well it's not close to home for me and I don't want to depends on him paying. What if he has to go to a home and then can't pay because he can't give away money? These are things on my mind. SIGH. I really needed this relaxing beach vacation but. Instead I'm fielding phone calls from aunts, cousins and my brother."

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 30 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1cctcsj/mom_in_hospital_dad_needs_247_care/

"Hired out a caregiver to help for a day, waste of money.. I'm curious as to how many people here have experienced this because it is a common issue with many people I speak to. I'm floored. For \$30-\$40 an hour for 12 hours, what the hell did I just get? I know this isn't the case for all hired caregivers but it seems to be the most common case. In a 12-hour period the only things that were completed: 1. unloading the dishwasher, 2. washing a sink full of dishes which many of them have to be redone because they're still dirty, 3. five loads of laundry, 4. one meal, 5. a not even a fully swept floor and only one of three floors that were to be done, 6. helping me change bedding before they left. What was left behind: dirt from them putting their shoes on and walking through the house and crumbs from their lunch. I could have hired a 12 year old to do this work in less than half the time and less than half the price! In 12 hours I usually complete 2-5 meals, 2-5 loads of laundry, a bath, changing of bedding, bathroom assistance, cleaning of PureWick, meds and vitals and logging properly, paperwork and bills, a sink full of dishes, exercises, multiple phone calls with hospice for meds and equipment and appointments, cleaning at least one room and many many many other miscellaneous tasks. What the hell. New Edit: this says it perfectly [It takes a village](https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/yf5ij2/it_takes_a_village/?utm_source=share&utm_medium=android_app&utm_name=androidcss&utm_term=1&utm_content=share_button) Edit edit: I'm looking at the paperwork right now and it says to clean and sanitize the bathroom and kitchen daily and do housekeeping."

reddit post · r/CaregiverSupport · 28 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/CaregiverSupport/comments/ymg4cy/hired_out_a_caregiver_to_help_for_a_day_waste_of/

"I tried a white board calendar. The trick is getting my dad to read it. It's right by his door with notes and reminders but he just walks right past it, can't learn to go there for information. He lives in a home and has great care. So most of the repetition comes through in texts messages. I think that distance helps me not lose it."

reddit comment · r/dementia · 19 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1t7yzfc/i_am_a_dementia_nurse_and_former_caregiver_back/oku7ojf/

"Rock bottom. I hate a whiner but I am pretty much at rock bottom. Every single day something happens. Our special needs daughter lives with us and we are her caregivers. My husband has recently had serious health issues as a result of a complication from surgery, mostly. However, he is diabetic, has renal stones with one procedure after the other, cardiac issues, back issues, sleep apnea, issues with his feet. Our daughter recently began not walking and she has been diagnosed with arthritis in her knees; she had an MRI a couple of weeks ago on one knee and it had to be done under sedation, just like a surgical procedure. Result will be discussed with her orthoped dr next week, but she has been receiving PT 2x/week and goes to Day Support 2x/week. We are pushing her in a wheelchair everywhere, even in the house now. Part of it is probably behavioral, but it is hard to tell. Our only other child, a son, lives an hour and a half away, has his own family, and commutes back and forth to and

from work an hour and a half each way, so he is busy with his own life. We would be doing okay, even with the myriad doctor appointments and procedures even now, except for my mom. My daughter and husband are my priority at home. AS soon as my husband started recovering a bit from his surgical complication (with 2 EMS trips, 2 hospitalizations, 6 ER visits, numerous dr appointments and procedures and med changes) in April, my mom fell at home in May when she developed a UTI. The same scenario almost exactly occurred three years ago with her. She got very confused, was hospitalized for about 3-4 days, then of course they wanted to send her home. My brother has worked only sporadically throughout his 71 years (we are twins) and has lived with our parents all his life; he never married. He is mentally slow, but functional. In 1986 he had a car accident and broke his leg, and has not worked since, and has lived with them in a house beside their doublewide. 17 years ago my father passed away, and my brother moved from the house belonging to my parents over to the DW and began living with Mom. He especially is a hoarder- the house was junked up like the Colyer brothers. My mom has never been too much of a housekeeper, but when he moved in with her, he began junking up her DW. So I tried to discuss the issue with them several times in a round-about way, offering to help clean. I was told no. Eventually the back porch has collapsed and he began "not hearing the doorbell" when I would go there. It was an awkward situation. The outside is junk cars and trash, literally. Since I haven't been inside the house in over a year (and only for her 100th BD then), I don't know how bad it is inside, but it was bad even then. I agonized over the situation; my brother is a "survivalist" type (he fancies himself at least)...now I suspect he has perimeter alarms around the house. Anytime I take him food or show up unexpected, he beelines to meet me outside so I don't go inside. So three years ago, the EMTs could not get Mom out due to the front porch is very narrow and there is restricted angling for a stretcher, plus they probably had trouble getting it through the hoarder piles. The back porch was collapsed (still is). So it took them probably an additional 30 minutes while they waited for backup and they had to roll Mom up in a blanket to remove her from the house. The EMT told me he would make sure she did not return home. I expected that he would be reporting the home to APS. I told my brother about it and even offered to help him clean up the house but, predictably, he got mad and said he might not like how the EMTs house looked. There was no reasoning with him that that was none of his concern, that his and Mom's environment was the issue. The day they were planning on discharging her from acute care, he just texted me and said they were sending her home. I said, No they are not, went to the hospital and got arrangements made for her to be placed in Skilled Care. I talked to him then about the possibility of him getting the house legally deeded to him through the Adult Child Caregiver Medicaid Exemption...he said he would look into it. I sent him everything for him to see a lawyer to discuss and told him he needed POA. And told him it would maybe be better for her to be placed in Long Term Care. On his own, a few weeks later, he took her home without consulting with me. If the EMT reported the home situation, APS did nothing to prevent her returning home as I was told. Fast forward to May of this year...same scenario, UTI, fall, dementia, then I again had to make arrangements for Skilled Care. His legs are in bad shape, he can barely walk and should be in the nursing home himself, but he brags that he has not been to a doctor since 1986. He has obvious lymphedema (from what? who knows?) and hints at the fact that he thinks he doesn't have long to live. I have repeatedly tried to convince him to see a doctor, but he said he didn't see one before "because he figured they would think he wasn't able to take care of Mom." Bingo! I told him they could look at him and see that. Since Mom is now incontinent, he finally agreed with me to place her in Long Term Care. I asked him about what he did about the Medicaid Caregiver Exemption...predictably, NOTHING, because, according to him, he didn't see the need three years ago because she went home. I have also found another possible avenue for him to legally keep the house- as a disabled child (no age limits). I literally dragged him to Social Services myself to check on both options because he just sits there beside Mom holding her hand all day long, every single day so he says he doesn't have time for anything else. Every evening he texts me the slightest detail about her and both he and Mom are paranoid about her roommate. The case worker office is right down the hall from Mom's room, but he can't leave Mom long enough to check ever about her Medicaid application status. I go up 2-4 times/week and stay 2-3 hours at a time, help Mom brush her teeth (he hands her a paper towel to do that, he says). I trim her nails, label her clothes and personal items, brush her hair, take her games and mental activities, take her outside in her wheelchair for walks, asked her former coworkers to send her get well cards, try

to divert her paranoia to positive activities like watching wildlife outside, take her small gifts like bracelets and bonnets that I make. I check periodically on her Medicaid application status...when I ask him, he just says that he figures they will come to him if there is a problem. (I go visit as I can- two weeks in a row, we had 7 appts/procedures each week.) When we went to Social Services, the regular case worker was out of the office and the young woman who filled in for her told me I am incorrect about the Adult Child Caregiver Exemption as well as the Disabled Child Exemption. (He says he can't find his disability record on the SS website, but even if that is so, all he would have to do is go to Social Security right down the road. He has ignored everything, done nothing.) However, I have the federal and state laws that say that I am correct about both exemptions. I sent my brother the links, as well as an application to the Legal Aid organization. I called a lawyer myself about POA for him. I know nothing about the finances other than a minimal amount of information- he literally brought me the documents they requested all mixed together, shoved in an old Amazon mailing bag, and I sorted through everything myself to find what I could. When Social Services requested more information about her annuities, life insurance, pension, etc. that I went to them and literally sat and cried because I couldn't get the information. I met then with someone who tried to help with letters to each company- I still don't know if they got everything returned that they needed. I checked last week but the case worker at the nursing home on her case was out of the office and the other one did not know. Well, today I called Social Services (we both are authorized representatives) and Mom's case worker called me back and Mom has been denied Medicaid because she owns both homes. One is probably worth \$15,000 even cleaned out; the DW may fetch \$30,000 if cleaned up, maybe more, I'm not sure. But both are on the same parcel of land and no separate driveway to the house apart from the DW. The DW as is...someone would look at what I imagine the mess is, and might offer \$15,000. Anyway, had my brother gotten the DW signed over to him, it would not have been considered a transfer of assets because it would have been excluded. Social services told me that they sent him the letter on August 9, and a copy to the nursing home. The copy they sent me was returned as undeliverable because they still had not corrected my address after I had told them in July they had 2 numbers transposed. She could not tell me if they had received the annuity, pens"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 17 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1fl3y84/rock_bottom/

"Looking for help. Gen X here. I grew up poor with parents who insisted that we couldn't qualify for programs that were available. As an adult, I realize now, that we did qualify, but my parents couldn't handle navigating how to apply. My Mother used made-up excuses to avoid making phone calls and filling out forms. They were content complaining about everything including the made up excuses that I know now, were never even researched or sought out. My parents are difficult. Extremely anxious to their own detriment. Recently, my Father's health has drastically taken a turn. After he recovered from Covid, his lungs started to give him trouble. He is diagnosed with PCOS and ILD (Lung Disease) it just gets worse everyday. Years ago they moved 5 hours away from me and all of the family. They claimed that it was all they could afford. Currently, they have run out of their retirement and live off \$2600 a month. I have visited their home several times this year to help out. I went to the Doctor with my Dad. It is good I did, because they do not advocate for themselves. They are great at using excuses to basically give up. Because of their anxiety, they will complain loudly and to EVERYONE, but do NOTHING to help themselves. They will go to their standard doctor visits, but do not speak up about new health issues, they nod their head, complain a little, and set the next appointment. I had forms filled out for IHSS, I got everything started for them, but of course I had to go back home and left all important details written out clearly. Later, they received a letter that they had been denied care. My parents decided that it must be their doctors fault because she had a form that didn't get sent until one day before the due date. That was it. That is how they operate. Now they are (as always) victims and there is no help for them. However, it was not accurate at all. After I pressed my Mother to call their assigned worker on the case, we found out the denial was because they did not receive a form we sent in for Medical/Medicare. They were given an amount of time to remedy this. AND THEN, I got diagnosed with Breast Cancer. And now my entire focus has to be fighting the Cancer in my body and I have only begun. My parents did nothing. They allowed the date to pass without doing anything and now it is too late to get them in home health aid. My mother insists that my father is exaggerating. She is frustrated and shows signs of resentment. I showed

her how to order groceries online. She did it successfully a couple times, but now she MAKES my father drive her to Walmart and refuses to use the online service. She does not drive, has never had a license. Meanwhile my Father struggles to breath for simply walking to the car from his scooter. He has dizzy spells. At this point, I worry he is going to get in an accident while driving. But my mother insists that he is just playing it up. I have been instructed by my doctors to set boundaries and deal with my Cancer treatment. I think my Father is probably going to pass soon. How do you get someone to step in, when my parents lack the ability to do the work to get care? The constant Facebook posts from my Dad about how helpless he feels is so hard to deal with. I cant just shut it down. These are my folks. I Know they have undiagnosed learning disabilities and their exteme anxiety is a problem. Is there ANYTHING I can do in order to get someone to step in?"

reddit post · r/AgingParents · 16 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/AgingParents/comments/1ol2nod/looking_for_help/

"Finding In-Home Care for Mom. * TLDR - What is a realistic cost and expectation for home care for Mom, and what's an easy solution for finding it? Mom is 70. She was diagnosed with dementia about 3 years ago, but the likelihood is that she started developing it about 5-6 years ago. She's originally from the Midwest, but came to live with my partner and me on the West Coast about 2.5 years ago... due to there not really being any other workable family options available where she was living, or elsewhere for that matter. We're happy to have her. She's peaceful. She's personable. She's in good physical health for her age. But she struggles with short-term memory issues, and cannot retain new information. She doesn't know her phone number or address. Most of the time, she still thinks she lives somewhere in the Midwest near where she grew up. She can't drive anymore. She can't cook for herself. She gets frightened to be home alone for more than 2-3 hours at a time. As a result, my partner and I get very little "us time" and haven't been away together on a vacation or longer term outing in over 3 years. I feel like Mom is the perfect candidate for some part-time, in-home care... which would give her some social interaction outside of just us... and also give us a little more away time to catch our breath and reset, and bond more than we've been able to recently given our caretaker responsibilities. We're not destitute by any stretch, and Mom has some money to help with the cost of in-home care, but realistically... anything over like \$1,500 per month would be difficult. She's on Medicare not Medicaid, so my understanding is that there's not really an option for an insurance contribution here for in-home care. I feel like that's a reasonable budget, but I'm also in my 40s and still think twenty bucks is a lot of gas. So I just don't know. I've posted a couple ads on care.com in the past couple years, but the responses I get are overwhelming, disorganized, and a lot to process. My partner and I both work busy jobs and it's difficult to set aside hours per day for a week at a time to meet people and respond to messages, and make phone calls, to no real conclusion. That may sound bad. But we just haven't had the mental energy to pursue it as we should. In a perfect world, I'd love to find someone to sit with her 15-20 hours per week, just to give us a couple nights out. How realistic is my budget for this? Are there agencies that handle this sort of thing? An agency would seem to be the perfect scenario... I suppose I just worry about cost... or whether someone would even take her if she's not on Medicaid. I guess I just need some help or advice, or even a pep talk. One of my biggest concerns is finding a situation with the highest likelihood of landing a consistent, reliable, GOOD part-time caregiver. One of the reasons I gave up on care.com so easily is that I felt like I was going to be posting ads and looking for new people every month or two. Help? Thoughts? If you've found a decent in-home caregiver situation for a loved one, will you give me some pointers?"

reddit post · r/dementia · 14 upvotes · https://www.reddit.com/r/dementia/comments/1bvecp3/finding_inhome_care_for_mom/